פרי צדיק

Pri Tzaddik

Interlinear Translation with Annotated Footnotes

Rosh Chodesh to Tu BiShvat

Rabbi Tzadok HaKohen Rabinowitz of Lublin
(1823–1900)

✦

SELECTED TEACHINGS

Mar Cheshvan · Kislev · Chanukah · Shevat

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Pri Tzaddik

A Bilingual Interlinear Edition · Rosh Chodesh to Tu BiShvat

This volume presents selected teachings of Pri Tzaddik in bilingual interlinear form. The vocalized Hebrew is followed phrase by phrase by its English translation, with source quotations and annotated parallel teachings in footnotes. The selection includes Rosh Chodesh; Rosh Chodesh Mar Cheshvan; Rosh Chodesh Kislev, ois 1–7; Chanukah, ois 1–25; Rosh Chodesh Shevat, ois 1–6; and Tu BiShvat, ois 1–5.

Methodological note: This edition was prepared with the assistance of AI tools for drafting, translation, source organization, and formatting. The original Hebrew remains the controlling text for study. Editorial headings and explanations are aids to understanding and are distinct from Rav Tzadok's original words.

Original work פרי צדיק by Rabbi Tzadok HaKohen Rabinowitz of Lublin (1823–1900).

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Rosh Chodesh

Rosh Chodesh and the Renewal of Israel

God sanctifies Israel and entrusts the sanctification of the month to them. Rav Tzadok reads the language of holiness above as something God chooses to establish through Israel's holiness and praise.

Rosh Chodesh and the Renewal of Israel

קִדּוּשׁ הַחֹדֶשׁ הִיא מִצְוָה רִאשׁוֹנָה שֶׁנִּתְּנָה לְיִשְׂרָאֵל בְּמִצְרַיִם, [1] — **Sanctification of the New Moon is the first commandment given to Israel in Egypt,** וְלֹא נֶאֱמְרָה לָהֶם רַק לְמֹשֶׁה וּלְאַהֲרֹן, — **and it was not spoken directly to them, but only to Moses and Aaron,** וְלֹא אָמַר שֶׁיֹּאמְרוּ זֶה לְיִשְׂרָאֵל, — **and He did not state that they should say this to all Israel;** – אֲבָל מִכָּל מָקוֹם "הַחֹדֶשׁ הַזֶּה לָכֶם" — **nonetheless, 'This month shall be unto you'—** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר בַּמִּדְרָשׁ רַבָּה (שְׁמוֹת פָּרָשָׁה טו): רְצוֹנוֹ לוֹמַר לְכָל יִשְׂרָאֵל, — **means unto the whole of Israel, and as stated in the Midrash Rabbah (Shemot, Parashah 15):** רֹאשׁ חֹדֶשׁ לָכֶם" וְכוּ'. — **'The New Moon is unto you, etc.'**

רַק הַקִּדּוּשׁ נִמְסַר לִגְדוֹלֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל לְבַד, [2] — **Only the formal sanctification was entrusted to the leaders of Israel alone,** וְאִם גָּדוֹל הַדּוֹר בְּחוּץ לָאָרֶץ שֶׁלֹּא הִנִּיחַ כְּמוֹתוֹ בְּאֶרֶץ יִשְׂרָאֵל — **and if the preeminent authority of the generation is in the Diaspora, having left no equal in the Land of Israel,** מְקַדֵּשׁ וְקוֹבֵעַ שָׁם, — **he sanctifies and fixes the month there,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר בְּרַבִּי עֲקִיבָא (בְּרָכוֹת סג.). [3] — **as is related regarding Rabbi Akiva (Berakhot 63a).** וְעַכְשָׁיו קוֹבְעִין עַל פִּי הַקִּדּוּשׁ שֶׁל הִלֵּל הָאַחֲרוֹן, כַּיָּדוּעַ. — **And nowadays we establish it based upon the sanctified calendar of Hillel the Latter, as is known.**

Israel's sanctification gives expression to heavenly holiness

כִּי הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרֵךְ לֹא רָצָה לְקַדֵּשׁ: יְהַיְינוּ כְּמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר בַּמִּדְרָשׁ שָׁם: [4] — **And this is just as is stated in the Midrash there: — that Hashem did not desire to sanctify it Himself,** – דְּמְקַדֵּשׁ לְעַצְמוֹ – — — **—for that would be sanctifying for Himself—** רַק הוּא מְקַדֵּשׁ לְיִשְׂרָאֵל, — **rather, He sanctifies Israel,** וְעַל יְדֵי שֶׁהֵם קְדוֹשִׁים [5] — **and by virtue of their being holy,** כְּמוֹ כְּלִי חוֹל מַה שֶּׁהֵם מְקַדְּשִׁין הוּא מְקוּדָּשׁ, — **whatever they sanctify becomes consecrated, — like a non-sacred vessel into which one places holy matter.** וְעַל כֵּן הֵם מְקַדְּשִׁים אוֹתוֹ, שֶׁמַּכְנִיס לְתוֹכוֹ קֹדֶשׁ. — **Therefore they consecrate it,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: "וְהְיִיתֶם לִי קְדֹשִׁים כִּי קָדוֹשׁ אָנִי", [6] — **as is stated: 'And you shall be holy unto Me, for I am holy,'** עַיֵּין שָׁם בְּמַתְנוֹת כְּהֻנָּה דָּחוּק. — **See the Matnot Kehunah there; its explanation is strained.** וְנִרְאֶה דְּרְצוֹנוֹ לוֹמַר — **And it appears that the meaning is:** דְּעַל יְדֵי שֶׁאַתֶּם קְדוֹשִׁים, — **that through your being holy,** "עַל יְדֵי זֶה "אֲנִי קָדוֹשׁ — **thereby 'I am holy';** וְעַל דֶּרֶךְ זֶה כָּתְבוּ לְפָרֵשׁ מַה שֶּׁכָּתוּב: — **and in this manner commentators explained that which is taught:** – "קְדוּשָׁתִי לְמַעְלָה מִקְּדוּשַׁתְכֶם" — **'My holiness is above your holiness'—** שֶׁעַל יְדֵי קְדוּשַׁתְכֶם אֲנִי קָדוֹשׁ מִלְּמַעְלָה. [7] — **that through your holiness I am holy Above.**

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[1] **Exodus 12:2**: "This month shall be your beginning of months; it shall be the first month of the year to you."

[2] **Mishnah Rosh Hashanah 2:7**: 'The head of the court says, 'Sanctified!' And all the people answer after him, 'Sanctified, sanctified!' Whether it was seen at the appointed time or was not seen at the appointed time, they sanctify it. Rabbi Elazar son of Rabbi Tzadok says: If it was not seen at the appointed time, they do not sanctify it, for Heaven has already sanctified it."'

[3] **Berakhot 63a**: 'He said to them: Why do I declare impure while you declare pure, and why do I prohibit while you permit? They said to him: Because you intercalate years and establish months outside the Land of Israel. He said to them: But did Rabbi Akiva ben Yosef not intercalate years and establish months outside the Land of Israel? They replied: Leave Rabbi Akiva aside, for he left no one like himself in the Land of Israel. He said: I too left no one like myself in the Land of Israel. They replied: The kids you left have become strong goats with horns; they have sent us to you.'

[4] **Sod Yesharim, Rosh Hashanah 61:2**: "That is: kodesh, written without a vav, indicates the source of holiness, which does not need to receive holiness from another. Kadosh, written with a vav, indicates that it is summoned from kodesh: it must draw holiness from the source. It is unlike kodesh without a vav, which indicates holiness in its own right. As things appear, Israel are called kadosh with a vav, because they must draw holiness to themselves from its blessed source; kodesh would belong to the blessed God alone, the source of holiness. Yet because Israel surrender their entire grasp to God, it becomes clear that they arose in thought above the grasp of creation: their root is in the holiness that is higher than all, holy in its own right. Therefore it is written, 'Israel is kodesh to the Lord.' Moreover, through Israel's service, a vav is drawn above, as the holy Zohar explains: when Israel sanctify, they raise the supreme glory from below to above, until the vav, the mystery of the upper heavens, ascends. When those heavens rise above, that kodesh shines into them, and then it is called kadosh above. The blessed God is called kadosh with a vav: God says that the honor of Heaven is, as it were, incomplete without Israel's service, and only through Israel's service will the honor of Heaven be completed."

Sod Yesharim explains the apparent reversal in Rav Tzadok's reading. Israel receive holiness from its source, yet their surrender and service disclose a holiness rooted above their present understanding. God chooses to describe the manifestation of heavenly honor as completed through that service. The passage's 'as it were' is essential to the way it speaks of God's holiness being established through Israel. This supplies the conceptual basis for entrusting sanctification to people.

[5] **Shemot Rabbah 15:24**: 'Some of the Sages say the blessing is, 'Blessed is He Who renews the months'; others say, 'Blessed is He Who sanctifies the months'; and others say, 'Who sanctifies Israel.' For if Israel do not sanctify it, its sanctification is nothing. Do not wonder at this: the Holy One, blessed be He, sanctified Israel."'

[6] **Leviticus 20:26**: 'You shall be holy to Me, for I, Hashem, am holy; I have separated you from the peoples to be Mine.'

[7] **Peri Tzadik, Yitro 7:1**: "In truth, the blessed God cannot be grasped at all, and the description 'holy' does not apply to Him except because Israel recognizes His holiness. This is what is called apprehending Him: that He is holy, separate from every apprehension. Through this, the blessed God is called holy. This is why, concerning God's holiness, he brought the verse, 'You are holy, enthroned upon the praises of Israel': through Israel's praises, the blessed God is called

וְנֶאֱמַר: "וְאַתָּה קָדוֹשׁ יוֹשֵׁב תְּהִלּוֹת יִשְׂרָאֵל"[8] — **And it is said: 'Yet You are holy, enthroned upon the praises of Israel,'** רְצוֹנוֹ לוֹמַר עַל יְדֵי תְּהִלּוֹת יִשְׂרָאֵל, עַיֵּין שָׁם. — **meaning, established through the praises of Israel, see there.** הַכַּוָּנָה כַּיָּדוּעַ, — **The inner meaning is well known,** דְּחַמָּה וּלְבָנָה רוֹמְזִי לְהַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא וּשְׁכִינָתוֹ, — **that the sun and the moon allude to the Holy One and His Shekhinah,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר (בְּסוֹטָה י.):[9] — **and as stated (in Sotah 10a):** שְׁנֶּאֱמַר: "שִׁמְשׁוֹן" — עַל שֵׁם הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא, — **'Samson' (Shimshon) is named after the Holy One,** וְנֶאֱמַר: "כִּי חֹמֶשׁ וּמָגֵן הַשֵּׁם"[10] — **as it is said: 'For a sun and a shield is Hashem';** "כִּי הַשֵּׁם אֱלֹהֶיךָ אֵשׁ אֹכְלָה", — **and it is said: 'For Hashem your God is a consuming fire,'** וְכֵן הַחַמָּה גּוּף שֶׁל אֵשׁ, — **and likewise the sun is a celestial body of fire,** וְזֶה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: "וְלִהַט אֹתָם הַיּוֹם הַבָּא", — **and this is 'and the day that comes shall burn them up,'** (נְדָרִים ח:) וּכְמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר[11] — **and as is stated (Nedarim 8b)** דְּמוֹצִיא חַמָּה מִנַּרְתִּיקָהּ וְכוּ'.[12] — **that He extracts the sun from its sheath, etc.** (וּבִשְׁמוֹת רַבָּה שָׁם) — **(And in Shemot Rabbah there:)** דְּאוּמּוֹת הָעוֹלָם מוֹנִין לַחַמָּה שֶׁהִיא שֶׁל אֵשׁ וַעֲתִידִין לִידּוֹן בָּהּ, — **the nations reckon by the sun, which is of fire, and are destined to be judged by it;** וְיִשְׂרָאֵל לַלְּבָנָה שֶׁהִיא שֶׁל אוֹר, — **while Israel reckon by the moon, which is of light,** וְכֵן הֵם נוֹחֲלִין הָאוֹר, — **and thus they inherit the light,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: "אוֹר זָרֻעַ לַצַּדִּיק" וְגוֹמֵר.[13] — **as it is said: 'Light is sown for the righteous, etc.',** וְאוֹמֵר: "קוּמִי אוֹרִי כִּי בָא אוֹרֵךְ", עַיֵּין שָׁם. — **and it says: 'Arise, shine, for your light has come,' see there.** וְהַיְינוּ דְּהָעוֹבְדֵי כּוֹכָבִים וּמַזָּלוֹת קָרוּ לֵיהּ "אֱלָהָא דֶּאֱלָהָא", — **Namely, idolaters call Him 'the God of gods,'** כְּמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר (סוֹף מָנָחוֹת קי.) עַל פָּסוּק "גָּדוֹל שְׁמִי בַּגּוֹיִם",[14, 15] — **as stated (end of Menachot 110a) — on the verse 'My Name is great among the nations,'** הַיְינוּ שֶׁאֵין מַשְׁגִּיחַ בַּתַּחְתּוֹנִים כְּלָל. — **meaning that they presume He exercises no providence in the lower realms at all.** אֲבָל עִיקַּר בְּרִיאַת הָעוֹלָם — **However, the prime purpose of the world's creation** לְגַלּוֹת כְּבוֹד מַלְכוּתוֹ בָּעוֹלָם, — **is to manifest the honor of His kingship in the world,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: "כֹּל פָּעַל ה' לַמַּעֲנֵהוּ",[16] — **as it is said: 'Hashem made everything for His sake,'** וְאָמְרוּ חֲכָמֵינוּ זִכְרוֹנָם לִבְרָכָה (שׁוֹחֵר טוֹב, תְּהִלִּים קמח):[17, 18] — **and our Sages said (Shocher Tov, Tehillim**

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holy, because they recognize His holiness and kingship."

[8] **Psalms 22:4**: 'Yet You are holy, enthroned upon the praises of Israel.'

[9] **Sotah 10a**: 'Rabbi Yochanan said: Shimshon judged Israel like their Father in heaven, as it says, 'Dan shall judge his people as one.' Rabbi Yochanan also said: Shimshon was called by a name of the Holy One, blessed be He, for it says, 'For Hashem God is a sun and a shield.' But if so, should his name not be erasable? Rather, his name is similar to the name of the Holy One: just as the Holy One shields the entire world, so Shimshon shielded Israel in his generation."'

[10] **Psalms 84:12**: 'For Hashem God is a sun and a shield; Hashem gives grace and honor, and withholds no good from those who walk in integrity.'

[11] **Nedarim 8b:6-7**: "This differs from Rabbi Shimon ben Lakish's teaching. For he said: In the World to Come there is no Gehinnom; rather, the Holy One, blessed be He, brings the sun out of its sheath. The righteous are healed by it, and the wicked are judged by it, as it says, 'For you who fear My name, a sun shall shine,' and so forth. Moreover, the righteous take delight in it, as it says, 'You shall go out and flourish like calves of the stall.' The wicked are judged by it, as it says, 'Behold, the day is coming, burning like a furnace,' and so forth."

[12] **Nedarim 8b, citing Malachi 3:20**: 'But for you who fear My name, a sun of righteousness shall rise, with healing in its wings; and you shall go forth and leap like calves from the stall.'

[13] **Psalms 97:11**: "Light is sown for the righteous, and joy for the upright in heart."

[14] **Menachot 110a; Malachi 1:11**: 'Rav Shimi bar Chiyya raised an objection to Rav: 'From the rising of the sun to its setting, My Name is great among the nations; and in every place offerings are burned and brought in My Name, and a pure meal-offering.' Rav replied: 'Are you Shimi? The nations call Him the God of gods.'"'

[15] **Menachot 110a:5**: "Rav Shimi bar Chiyya challenged Rav from the verse, 'From the rising of the sun until its setting, My name is great among the nations; in every place incense is burned and brought to My name, and a pure offering.' Rav answered him, 'Shimi, is that you? The verse means that they call Him the God of gods.'"

[16] **Proverbs 16:4**: 'Hashem has made everything for His purpose, even the wicked for the day of evil.'

[17] **Midrash Tehillim, Psalm 148 (Rav Tzadok's citation); compare Midrash Tehillim 19:2**: 'Rav Tzadok quotes the word "le-killuso"—"for His praise." A parallel formulation is found at Midrash Tehillim 19:2: "For His praise: because all praise Him for His work, and all His deeds praise Him."'

[18] **Midrash Tehillim 148:1**: ""Hallelujah. Praise the Lord from the heavens": those who are in the heavens. Who are they? The ministering angels. "Praise Him, all His angels." Just as there are many hosts on earth, so there are in heaven: "These are the generations of the heavens and the earth when they were created" (Genesis 2:4). Therefore it says, "Praise Him, all His hosts." Who are His hosts? Those who do the will of the Holy One, blessed be He, as it says, "Bless the Lord, all His hosts" (Psalms 103:21). Therefore it says, "Praise Him, all His hosts." "Praise Him, sun and moon." Who are the sun and moon? The patriarchs and matriarchs, who are compared to the sun and moon, as it says, "And behold, the sun and the moon" (Genesis 37:9). "Praise Him, all stars of light." Who are the stars of light? The righteous, as it says, "Those who lead the many to righteousness are like the stars" (Daniel 12:3). Therefore it says, "Praise Him, all stars of light." From here you learn that each of them has a star in heaven, and his star shines according to his deeds. Therefore it says: Praise Him, those whose stars shine. "Praise Him, heavens of heavens." From here you learn that there are only three heavens—the reading given in the name of Radal. So it says, "Behold, the heavens and the heavens of heavens" (I Kings 8:27). Therefore it says, "Praise Him." These are the waters, those waters of Creation, as it says, "God called the firmament 'heavens'" (Genesis 1:8): it bears water. "Let them praise the name of the Lord." The Holy One, blessed be He, had no toil when He created them, as it says, "On the day that the Lord God made" (Genesis 2:4), and it is written, "For in six days the Lord made" (Exodus 20:11). The Holy One, blessed be He, had no toil; He only

148): ,"לְקִילּוּסוֹ" — **'for His praise,'** .וְזֶהוּ שְׁכִינָתוֹ יִתְבָּרַךְ בַּתַּחְתּוֹנִים — **and this is His holy Shekhinah residing in the lower realms.** ,וְאַבְרָהָם אָבִינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם הָיָה הָרִאשׁוֹן לְפַרְסֵם זֶה בָּעוֹלָם — **And Abraham our father, peace be upon him, was the first to publicize this in the world,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁכָּתְבוּ זִכְרוֹנָם לִבְרָכָה (בְּבְרֵאשִׁית רַבָּה פָּרָשַׁת חַיֵּי עַל פָּסוּק "אֱלֹהֵי הַשָּׁמַיִם וֵאלֹהֵי הָאָרֶץ", ח) — **as our Sages wrote (Bereishit Rabbah, Parashat Chayei Sarah 59:8)**[19] **on the verse 'God of the heavens and God of the earth':** ,דְּעַד עַכְשָׁיו וְכוּ' — **that until now He was God of heaven alone, etc.,** – "וְעַכְשָׁיו "אֱלֹהֵי הָאָרֶץ — **and now 'God of the earth'—** שֶׁפֵּרְסֵם הַשְׁגָּחָתוֹ בַּתַּחְתּוֹנִים. — **for he proclaimed His providence in the lower realms.** (בְּבְרֵאשִׁית רַבָּה סוֹף פָּרָשָׁה ל):[20] וְאָמַר עַל זֶה — **And it was said on this (Bereishit Rabbah, end of Parashah 30):** דְּאָמַר לֵיהּ הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא: — **that the Holy One said to him:** ,"עַד שֶׁאַתָּה מֵאִיר לִי מֵאַסְפּוֹטַמְיָא — **'While you illuminate for Me from Mesopotamia,** בֹּא וְהָאֵר לְפָנַי בְּאֶרֶץ יִשְׂרָאֵל וְכוּ'", — **come and illuminate before Me in the Land of Israel, etc.'** דְּזֶה נִקְרָא עַל יְדֵי שֶׁמְּפָרְסֵם כְּבוֹד מַלְכוּתוֹ עַל כָּל,[21] — **For this is defined as illuminating before Him,** וְזֶה דּוּגְמַת הַלְּבָנָה הַמְקַבֶּלֶת אוֹר מֵהַחַמָּה, — **by spreading the glory of His sovereignty over all Creation.** הַבְּרִיאָה. — **And this parallels the moon, which receives its luminescence from the sun;** וְזֶה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: "קוּמִי אוֹרִי", — **and this is 'Arise, shine,'—** שֶׁיִּשְׂרָאֵל מְאִירִין לְפָנָיו יִתְבָּרַךְ; — **that Israel illuminate before Him;** וּמֵהֵיכָן לוֹקְחִין אוֹר? — **and whence do they draw this light?** ,"עַל יְדֵי הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ: "אוֹרֵךְ" – וּמֵאִיר לָהֶם.[22] — **Via Hashem: 'your light'—He shines upon them.** (תְּצַוֶּה סוֹף פָּרָשָׁה לו) וְעַל דֶּרֶךְ זֶה אָמְרוּ בַּמִּדְרָשׁ רַבָּה — **And in this manner they expounded in Midrash Rabbah (Tetzaveh, end of Parashah 36)** בַּמְּנוֹרָה: — **regarding the Menorah:** הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא מֵאִיר לְכָל הָעוֹלָם — **the Holy One illuminates the whole universe,** וּמְצַוֶּה לְהָאִיר לְפָנָיו. — **yet commands that they illuminate before Him.** ,כִּי שֶׁמֶן הִיא חָכְמָה[23] — **For oil represents Chokhmah (Wisdom),** וְאוֹר הַשֶּׁמֶן הִיא אוֹר תּוֹרָה. — **and the light of the oil is the light of the Torah.**

Human differences give Oral Torah its particular expressions

וְהַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ מֵאִיר בְּאוֹר תּוֹרָה שֶׁבִּכְתָב,[24] — **And Hashem illuminates through the light of the Written Torah,**

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commanded, and they came into being of themselves. Therefore it says, “Let them praise the name of the Lord,” for they were created on this condition: to praise Him. “He established them forever and ever; He gave a decree that shall not pass.” What decree did He give? He said to them, “Let there be a firmament” (Genesis 1:6). From that day they have not moved. The Holy One, blessed be He, created the world to rejoice in it. Yet, as it were, He had no joy in it, because Adam sinned and the ground was cursed, as it says, “Cursed is the ground” (Genesis 3:17). Cain came and killed Abel. He said to him, “Where is Abel your brother?” (Genesis 4:9), “The voice of your brother’s blood cries out to Me from the ground” (Genesis 4:10), and “You shall be a fugitive and a wanderer on the earth” (Genesis 4:12). He did not let the Holy One, blessed be He, rejoice in His works.”

[19] **Bereishit Rabbah 59:8 — Avraham makes Hashem known on earth**: ‘Avraham said to his servant, the elder of his house.” On “Hashem, God of heaven,” Rabbi Pinchas said: “Before I made Him known to His creatures—He was called God of heaven; but once I had made Him known to His creatures—He was called God of the earth.”’

[20] **Bereishit Rabbah 30:10 — Avraham illuminates before the King**: ‘Noach walked with God.” Rabbi Yehudah likened this to a prince with two sons, one younger and one older: he said to the younger, “Walk with me,” but to the elder, “Come, walk before me.” Thus Avraham, whose strength was greater, was told “Walk before Me,” while Noach walked with God. Rabbi Nechemiah compared Noach to the king’s friend sinking in thick mud, whom the king summoned to walk beside him; Avraham is compared to the king’s friend who shone light for him through a window in dark alleys. The king said: “Rather than illuminating Me through a window, come illuminate before Me.” Thus the Holy One said to Avraham: “Instead of lighting My way from Mesopotamia and its cities, come and illuminate before Me in the Land of Israel.”’

[21] **Tzidkat HaTzadik 261:1**: “The Holy One, blessed be He—His glory fills the whole earth, and no place is empty of Him. Yet He is greatly concealed: ‘He makes darkness His hiding place.’ When this recognition illuminates a person’s heart—how the blessed God’s glory fills the whole earth—this is called ‘He brought us from darkness to great light,’ as stated in the Haggadah. The Exodus from Egypt is the passage from the concealment of the recognition of the blessed God into its revelation. It is an illumination both for the person and for the blessed God, as our Sages said at the end of Bereishit Rabbah, chapter 30: a parable of a king walking through dark alleyways, whose friend came and lit a lamp. Abraham our father, peace be upon him, illuminated before the blessed God. For this is called the Divine Presence in exile: when His Presence among the lower beings is profoundly concealed and is neither revealed nor publicly known, it is like walking through dark alleyways.”

[22] **Isaiah 60:1-3**: ‘Arise, shine, for your light has come, and the glory of Hashem has dawned upon you. For behold, darkness covers the earth and thick cloud the peoples, but upon you Hashem will dawn, and His glory will be seen upon you. Nations will walk by your light, and kings by the brightness of your rising.’

[23] **Exodus 27:20**: ‘You shall command the children of Israel to bring you pure olive oil, beaten for the light, to kindle a lamp continually.’

[24] **Sichat Malakhei HaSharet 1:10**: “Therefore the greater part of Torah is oral, as stated in Gittin. What is written encompasses all Israel, and all souls are equal in it: these are the general principles. In the particulars, however, they divide according to the particulars of the souls. Just as bodily healing differs with the constitutions of bodies and with changes between generations—what benefits this body or this generation will not benefit another—so it is with the healing of the soul. From this arose all the disagreements in Oral Torah: each spoke according to the level of his soul, identifying what was appropriate to its repair and healing. Therefore ‘these and those are words of the living God,’ for

שֶׁזֶּהוּ מַה שֶׁהֵם מְחַדְּשִׁים. — **which is what they innovate through analysis.** וְיִשְׂרָאֵל מְאִירִים בְּתוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה, — **and Israel illuminate through the Oral Torah,** וּבֶאֱמֶת גַּם זֶה "דִּבְרֵי אֱלֹהִים חַיִּים", — **And in truth, these too are the 'words of the living God,'** כְּמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר (בְּעירובין יג:) וְכֵן אִיתָא (בָּבָא בַּתְרָא יב.),[25,26] — **as stated (in Eruvin 13b) and so brought (Bava Batra 12a),** וְעַיֵּין שָׁם בָּרַמְב"ן דְּהוּא בְּרוּחַ הַקֹּדֶשׁ וְעָדִיף מִנְּבוּאָה. — **and see there in the Ramban that it stems from the Holy Spirit and is superior to prophecy.** אֲבָל מִכָּל מָקוֹם הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ מָסַר זֶה כְּאִילּוּ הֵם הַמְּאִירִים זֶה, — **Nevertheless, Hashem delivered this over to the Sages as if they are the ones generating this illumination;** לַחֲכָמִים — **and by virtue of 'your light has come'—** מַה וְּעַל יְדֵי זֶה הֵם מְאִירִים לְפָנָיו יִתְבָּרַךְ. — **that which Hashem shines into their hearts,** עַל יְדֵי שֶׁ"בָּא אוֹרֶךָ" שֶׁהַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ מֵאִיר לִלְבָּם, — **thereby they shine back before Him.** וְאָמַר "קוּמִי אוֹרִי" תְּחִלָּה, — **And Scripture states 'Arise, shine' first,** דְּבְהִתְגַּלּוּת הֵם הַמְּאִירִים בְּעַצְמָם. — **for in overt manifestation they are the ones actively illuminating.** וְעַל זֶה אָמַר בַּמִּדְרָשׁ שָׁם:[27] "לְמַעֲשֵׂה יָדֶיךָ תְּכַסֵּף", — **And upon this the Midrash stated: 'You will yearn for the work of Your hands,'** שֶׁיִּהְיֶה נִקְרָא עַל שֵׁם בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל שֶׁהֵם שֶׁהַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ מִתְאַוֶּה לָהֶם — **that Hashem yearns for them, that it be ascribed to the children of Israel, that they are the luminaries.** וְדָבָר זֶה הוּא חֲנֻכַּת הַמְּאִירִים. — **And this matter is the dedication of Aaron,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר בַּמִּדְרָשׁ (רֵישׁ פָּרָשַׁת בְּהַעֲלֹתְךָ), — **as stated in the Midrash (beginning of Parashat Beha'alotekha),** אַהֲרֹן, — **for he is the root of the Oral Torah,** כִּי הוּא הַשּׁוֹרֶשׁ דְּתוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה, — **as it is said: 'They shall teach Your judgments to Jacob, etc.',** כְּמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר:[28] "יוֹרוּ מִשְׁפָּטֶיךָ לְיַעֲקֹב" וְגוֹמֵר, — **and said: 'And you shall come unto the priests... according to the Torah they teach you, etc.',** וְנֶאֱמַר: "וּבָאתָ אֶל הַכֹּהֲנִים" וְגוֹמֵר "עַל פִּי הַתּוֹרָה אֲשֶׁר יוֹרוּךָ" וְגוֹמֵר, — **and said: 'The lips of the priest... and they shall seek Torah from his mouth, etc.'** וְנֶאֱמַר: "שִׂפְתֵי כֹהֵן" וְגוֹמֵר "וְתוֹרָה יְבַקְשׁוּ מִפִּיהוּ" וְגוֹמֵר.[29] וְחַמָּה וּלְבָנָה רוֹמְזִים גַּם כֵּן לְתוֹרָה שֶׁבִּכְתָב וְתוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה, — **And the sun and the moon likewise allude to the Written Torah and Oral Torah,** דְּמְקַבְּלִים הָאוֹר מִתּוֹרָה שֶׁבִּכְתָב. — **since they receive the illumination from the Written Torah.** וְעַל כֵּן אָמְרוּ בְּמִדְרַשׁ הַנֶּעְלָם (זֹהַר חָלֶק א, צז עמוד ב):[30,31] — **And therefore they stated in the Midrash HaNe'elam (Zohar Part I, 97b):** דְּהַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא בָּא בְּרֹאשׁ חֹדֶשׁ — **that the Holy One comes on Rosh Chodesh** לְמִשְׁמַע אוּלְפָן מִנִּשְׁמָתְהוֹן דְּצַדִּיקַיָּא, — **to hear teachings of Torah from the souls of the righteous,** שָׁאז הוּא הָאֲרַת הָאוֹר דְּתוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה — **for then shines the illumination of the Oral Torah,** וְהַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ יִכְסֹף לְמַעֲשֵׂה יָדָיו; — **and Hashem yearns for the work of His hands;** וְעַל כֵּן מָסַר קִדּוּשׁ הַחֹדֶשׁ לַחֲכָמִים, — **and therefore He handed the sanctification of the New Moon to the Sages,** כִּי הֵם הַמְּאִירִים אוֹר דְּתוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל

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both were given by one Shepherd. The distinctions between the judgments correspond to the distinctions between the souls."

Sichat Malakhei HaSharet explains what the human contribution can add: the common principles of Torah take particular forms suited to different souls and circumstances. This illuminates how the Sages' own analysis can be both their distinctive contribution and divine teaching. The surrounding discussion concerns the discernment of qualified Torah teachers; the comparison does not turn every private opinion into an equally authoritative ruling.

[25] **Eruvin 13b**: 'For three years Beis Shammai and Beis Hillel disagreed. These said: the halachah is according to us; and these said: the halachah is according to us. A heavenly voice went forth and declared: Both these and those are the words of the living God, but the halachah follows Beis Hillel." The Gemara continues: "Because they were patient and humble, and studied both their own words and those of Beis Shammai, even placing Beis Shammai's words before their own."'

[26] **Bava Batra 12a:13-14**: "Rabbi Avdimi of Haifa said: From the day the Temple was destroyed, prophecy was taken from the prophets and given to the Sages. Is a sage, then, not also a prophet? This is what he meant: Although prophecy was taken from the prophets, it was not taken from the Sages. Amemar said: A sage is even greater than a prophet, as it says, 'And let us bring a heart of wisdom.' Reading 'and let us bring,' ve-navi, as an allusion to a prophet, he asks: Who is being compared to whom? You must say that the lesser is compared to the greater; the prophet is thus compared to the sage."

[27] **Job 14:15**: 'You will call, and I will answer You; You will long for the work of Your hands.'

[28] **Deuteronomy 33:10**: 'They shall teach Your judgments to Yaakov and Your Torah to Israel; they shall place incense before You and a whole offering upon Your altar.'

[29] **Malachi 2:7**: 'For the lips of a priest should guard knowledge, and Torah they should seek from his mouth, for he is a messenger of Hashem of Hosts.'

[30] **Zohar, Vayera 2:23-24**: "Rabbi Eliezer was sitting and studying Torah. Rabbi Akiva came to him and said, "What is the master studying?" He said to him, "This verse, which is written: 'And He causes them to inherit a throne of glory' (I Samuel 2:8). What is meant by 'He causes them to inherit a throne of glory'? This is Jacob our father, for whom He made a throne of glory of his own, to receive the teaching of the souls of the righteous. "The Holy One, blessed be He, goes with him at the beginning of each and every month. When the soul sees the glory of the mirror, the Divine Presence of its Master, it blesses and bows before the Holy One, blessed be He. This is what is written: 'Bless the Lord, O my soul' (Psalms 104:1).""

[31] **Zohar, Vayera 1:3-4**: ""the time of song was come", the earth being now ripe to offer up praises to the Almighty, which it could not do before man was created. "And the voice of the turtle is heard in our land": this is the word of God, which was not in the world till man was created. Thus when man was there, everything was there. When man sinned, the earth was cursed, and all these good things left it, as it is written, "cursed is the earth for thy sake" (Gen. 3, 17), and again, "when thou tillest the ground it shall not give its strength to thee" (Ibid. 4, 12), and again, "thorns and thistles it shall bring forth to thee" (Ibid. 3, 18)."

פֶּה. — **for they are the ones who radiate the light of the Oral Torah.** וְזֶה הִתְגַּלּוּת הַשְׁכִינָה בְּלִבּוֹת בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל, **And this is the revelation of the Shekhinah within the hearts of Israel,** דְּזֶהוּ כָּל עִנְיַן אוֹר תּוֹרָה: — **for this is the essence of the light of Torah:** לְהָאִיר לַלֵּב בְּדַעַת אֱלֹהִים, — **to illuminate the heart with the knowledge of God,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר לֶעָתִיד: "וְלֹא יְלַמְּדוּ עוֹד אִישׁ אֶת רֵעֵהוּ[32] — **as is stated regarding the ultimate future: 'And they shall no more teach every man his neighbor,** כִּי כוּלָּם יֵדְעוּ אוֹתִי". וְגוֹמֵר. — **for they shall all know Me, etc.'** וְדָוִד הַמֶּלֶךְ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם אָמַר לִשְׁלֹמֹה הַמֶּלֶךְ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם, — **And King David, peace be upon him, said to King Solomon, peace be upon him,** שֶׁהוּא שׁוֹרֶשׁ הַחָכְמָה תַּתָּאָה דְּתוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה, — **who is the root of the lower wisdom of the Oral Torah,** שׁוֹרֶשׁ הַמַּלְכוּת, פֶּה דְּתוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה, — **the root of Malchut, the mouth of the Oral Torah,** אָמַר לוֹ: "דַּע אֶת אֱלֹהֵי" וְגוֹמֵר, — **saying to him: 'Know the God of…,' etc.,** וְזֶהוּ "מִפִּיו דַּעַת וּתְבוּנָה". — **and this is 'from His mouth come knowledge and understanding.'** וְנֶאֱמַר (מִשְׁלֵי ט, י)[33]: "וְדַעַת קְדֹשִׁים בִּינָה", — **And it is said (Mishlei 9:10): 'and the knowledge of the holy ones is understanding,'** וּבִינָה הוּא תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה, שֶׁמַּבִין דָּבָר מִתּוֹךְ דָּבָר, — **and Binah (Understanding) is the Oral Torah, understanding one concept from within another,** וְזֶהוּ "דַּעַת קְדֹשִׁים" – שֶׁהוּא הַדַּעַת אוֹתוֹ יִתְבָּרֵךְ, — **and this is the 'knowledge of the holy ones'—the intimate awareness of Him, blessed be He,** שֶׁהוּא עַל יְדֵי הַתּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה. — **which is attained via the Oral Torah.** וְדַעַת הוּא רוּחַ הַקֹּדֶשׁ, כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתַב רַבִּי שְׁלֹמֹה יִצְחָקִי בְּפָרָשַׁת כִּי תִשָּׂא,[34] — **And Da'at (Knowledge) is the Holy Spirit, as Rashi wrote in Parashat Ki Tisa,** וְהוּא הַשָּׂגַת תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה כַּנִּזְכָּר לְעֵיל; — **and it is the profound perception of the Oral Torah as mentioned above;** וְעַל כֵּן נִקְרָא "דַּעַת קְדֹשִׁים", — **and therefore it is called 'knowledge of the holy ones',** ד"קְדוֹשִׁים" הוּא שֶׁיֵּשׁ לָהֶם רוּחַ הַקֹּדֶשׁ, — **for 'holy ones' are those who possess the Holy Spirit,** דִּקְדוּשָׁתָם מִקְּדוּשָׁתוֹ יִתְבָּרֵךְ. — **their holiness emanating directly from His holiness.** וְיִשְׂרָאֵל נִבְחֲרוּ לִהְיוֹת כּוּלָּם בַּן, — **And Israel were chosen so that all of them would be on this level,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב: "כִּי עַם קָדוֹשׁ אַתָּה",[35] — **and as it is written: 'For a holy people are you,'** וְנֶאֱמַר: "קֹדֶשׁ יִשְׂרָאֵל לַה'",[36] — **and it is said: 'Israel is holy unto Hashem,'** וְנֶאֱמַר: "קְדֹשִׁים תִּהְיוּ", "וְהְיִיתֶם קְדֹשִׁים".[37] — **and said: 'You shall be holy,' 'and you shall be holy.'** וְכֵן נִקְרְאוּ בַּגְּמָרָא בְּפֶרֶק רַבִּי עֲקִיבָא וּבְפֶרֶק קַמָּא דְּחֻלִּין:[38] — **And so they are termed in the Gemara in the chapter 'Rabbi Akiva' and in the first chapter of Chullin:** "יִשְׂרָאֵל קְדוֹשִׁים". — **'Israel are holy.'** וְעַל זֶה הָיָה מַתַּן תּוֹרָה, — **And for this purpose the Giving of the Torah took place,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: "וְאַתֶּם תִּהְיוּ לִי מַמְלֶכֶת כֹּהֲנִים וְגוֹי קָדוֹשׁ".[39] — **as it is said: 'And you shall be unto Me a kingdom of priests and a holy nation.'** וְכֹהֲנִים הֵם הַקְּדוֹשִׁים, — **And the priests are the dedicated holy ones,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר בְּרֵישׁ פָּרָשַׁת אֱמוֹר: "קְדֹשִׁים יִהְיוּ" וְגוֹמֵר, — **as is said at the beginning of Parashat Emor: 'They shall be holy, etc.',** "קָדֹשׁ יִהְיֶה לָךְ" וְגוֹמֵר "כִּי אֲנִי הַשֵּׁם מְקַדְּשׁוֹ", — **'He shall be holy unto you,' etc., 'for I, Hashem, sanctify him,'** וּבְפָרָשַׁת קֹרַח: "אֲשֶׁר יִבְחַר הַשֵּׁם הוּא הַקָּדוֹשׁ". — **and in Parashat Korach: 'the one whom Hashem chooses is the holy one.'** וְהֵם אָמְרוּ: "כָּל הָעֵדָה כֻּלָּם קְדֹשִׁים וּבְתוֹכָם הַשֵּׁם", — **And Korach's assembly claimed: 'For all the congregation are holy, and Hashem is among them,'** דְּזֶהוּ הַקְּדוּשָׁה כְּשֶׁהַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרֵךְ שׁוֹכֵן בְּתוֹכָם, — **for this is genuine holiness—when Hashem dwells among them,** וְהָאֱמֶת כֵּן. — **and in ultimate truth it is so.** וְלֶעָתִיד יִהְיֶה לְגַמְרֵי כֵּן, — **And in the ultimate future it will be fully realized,** וְיִהְיֶה מַמְלֶכֶת כֹּהֲנִים, — **and all will be a kingdom of priests,** וְאָז "שִׂפְתֵי כֹהֵן יִשְׁמְרוּ דַּעַת", — **and 'the priest's lips shall keep knowledge,'** "כוּלָּם יֵדְעוּ" וְגוֹמֵר. — **and then 'all of them shall know Me, etc.'**

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[32] **Jeremiah 31:33-34**: ‘I shall place My Torah within them, and upon their heart I shall write it; I shall be their God, and they shall be My people. No longer shall a man teach his fellow, or a man his brother, saying, ‘Know Hashem,’ for they shall all know Me, from their smallest to their greatest ... for I shall forgive their wrongdoing, and their sin I shall remember no more.’”

[33] **Proverbs 9:10**: ‘The beginning of wisdom is fear of Hashem, and the knowledge of the Holy One is understanding.’

[34] **Rashi on Exodus 31:3**: ‘Wisdom” refers to that which a person learns from others; “understanding” means apprehending one matter from another; and “knowledge” is holy inspiration (ruach hakodesh).”’

[35] **Deuteronomy 14:2**: ‘For you are a holy people to Hashem your God; and Hashem has chosen you to be His treasured people among all the nations upon the face of the earth.’

[36] **Jeremiah 2:3**: ‘Israel was holy to Hashem, the first of His harvest; all who consumed him would become guilty; disaster would come upon them—declares Hashem.’

[37] **Leviticus 19:2**; **Leviticus 20:7**: “‘Speak to the whole congregation of the children of Israel and say to them: You shall be holy, for I, Hashem your God, am holy.’ ‘Sanctify yourselves and be holy, for I am Hashem your God.’”

[38] **Shabbat 86a and Chullin 7b — “Israel are holy”**: ‘Shabbat 86a: “Why was it necessary for him to tell them? Did Rav Huna not say: Israel are holy and do not engage in marital relations by day? ... Rava said: If the house is dark, it is permitted.” Chullin 7b: “Do you imagine I am prohibited from receiving benefit from Israel? Israel are holy: one wishes to give but lacks the means, while another has the means but does not wish to give; yet he says, ‘Eat and drink,’ though his heart is not with you.”’

[39] **Exodus 19:6**: ‘You shall be to Me a kingdom of priests and a holy nation. These are the words you shall speak to the children of Israel.’

Shared holiness includes distinct roles in receiving and transmitting it

וּכְמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר (בְּעֵירוּבִין נד:)[41, 42] — **as stated (in Eruvin 54b):** כְּמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר בְּשִׁיר הַשִּׁירִים רַבָּה עַל פָּסוּק "יִשָּׁקֵנִי"; — **as stated in Shir HaShirim Rabbah on the verse 'Let him kiss me';** וּבְמַעֲמַד הַר סִינַי הָיוּ כוּלָּם כֵּן[40] — **And at the Revelation at Mount Sinai all of them were on this level,** אֲבָל אַחַר כָּךְ, אַף דְּיֵשׁ קְדוּשָׁה בְּכָל יִשְׂרָאֵל, — **yet afterward, even though holiness permeates all Israel,** מָקוֹם יֵשׁ מְדָרֵיגוֹת, — **nevertheless gradations exist,** וְהָיוּ צְרִיכִין לְקַבֵּל מִמֹּשֶׁה וּמֵאַהֲרֹן, — **and they needed to receive the transmission from Moses and Aaron,** כֵּיצַד סֵדֶר מִשְׁנָה" וְכוּלֵי. — **'How was the order of the teaching of the Mishnah, etc.'** וְעַל זֶה אָמַר (בְּשְׁמוֹת רַבָּה פָּרָשָׁה טו):[43] — **And on this it is said (in Shemot Rabbah, Parashah 15):** – "'שְׁלַח אוֹרְךָ וַאֲמִתְּךָ' וְגוֹמֵר — **'Send Your light and Your truth, etc.'—** הֵם מֹשֶׁה וְאַהֲרֹן, — **these are Moses and Aaron,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב: 'תֻּמֶּיךָ וְאוּרֶיךָ', — **as it is written: 'Your Thummim and Your Urim, etc.',** וְנֶאֱמַר:[44] 'תּוֹרַת אֱמֶת הָיְתָה בְּפִיהוּ' וְגוֹמֵר; — **and said: 'The law of truth was in his mouth, etc.';** וְאֶמַר: 'הַחֹדֶשׁ הַזֶּה לָכֶם' – זֶה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר" וְכוּלֵי, עַיֵּין שָׁם. — **and it says: 'This month shall be unto you'—this is what Scripture states, etc., see there.** וּרְצוֹנוֹ לוֹמַר דְּזֶהוּ עִנְיַן קִדּוּשׁ הַחֹדֶשׁ שֶׁנִּמְסַר לָהֶם, — **And this means that this is the essence of the New Moon's sanctification delivered to them,** דְּעַל יְדֵי זֶה מְאִירִים לִלְבּוֹת בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל. — **that through it they radiate into the hearts of the children of Israel.** וּמֹשֶׁה רַבֵּינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם הוּא שׁוֹרֶשׁ הָאוֹר תּוֹרָה, — **And Moses our teacher, peace be upon him, is the root of the light of Torah,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: "וַתֵּרֶא אֹתוֹ כִּי טוֹב", — **as it is said: 'And she saw him that he was good,'** שֶׁכְּשֶׁנּוֹלַד נִתְמַלֵּא הַבַּיִת אוֹרָה (סוֹטָה יב.);[45, 46] — **for when he was born the entire house was filled with light (Sotah 12a);** וְשֶׁיִּהְיֶה נִקְבָּע בַּלֵּב הוּא עַל יְדֵי אַהֲרֹן, — **and that it become permanently ingrained in the heart is via Aaron,** שׁוּשְׁבִּינָא דְּמַטְרוֹנִיתָא, — **the attendant of the Matronita (Shekhinah),** שֶׁמְּקָרְבָן לַתּוֹרָה, — **who draws souls near to the Torah;** וְזֶהוּ "תּוֹרַת אֱמֶת שֶׁבְּפִיהוּ", — **and this is 'the Torah of truth that was in his mouth,'** וּשְׂפַת אֱמֶת הוּא שֶׁתִּכּוֹן לָעַד: — **and a truthful lip is one that endures forever.** עַד כָּאן מִכְתַּב יַד קָדְשׁוֹ. — **Until here from his holy handwriting.**

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[40] **Yisrael Kedoshim 5:4**: “For Aaron, peace be upon him, was the one set apart from Israel, ‘to sanctify him as most holy.’ In him appeared the strongest revelation of the utmost holiness and separation that can be revealed in this world. Therefore he entered the Holy of Holies, the place of which it says, ‘No person shall be in the Tent of Meeting when he comes to make atonement in the holy place.’ Our Sages explained in the Jerusalem Talmud: even those whose faces have the likeness of a human face the angels. There is a holiness above that of the angels which they cannot reach; only the righteous can, whose place is further within than that of the ministering angels. Israel are ‘one nation,’ all together one complete stature. Yet, just as the human body has principal organs in which life is stronger, such as the heart, the source of life, so the other organs have different levels.”

Yisrael Kedoshim gives Rav Tzadok’s distinction an organic form: Israel constitute one living whole, while its members have different capacities to receive and transmit holiness. Aaron’s special role belongs within that shared life. This helps explain why the holiness of the entire people is compatible with the need for Aaron to establish Torah in their hearts.

[41] **Eruvin 54b**: ‘What was the order of teaching the Mishnah? Moshe learned from the Almighty. Aharon entered, and Moshe taught him his portion; Aharon moved aside and sat at Moshe’s left. His sons entered, and Moshe taught them their portion; the sons then moved aside. The elders entered and Moshe taught them; afterward the whole people entered and Moshe taught them.’

[42] **Eruvin 54b:11-12**: “The Sages taught: What was the order in which the teaching was repeated? Moshe learned from the mouth of the Almighty. Aharon entered, and Moshe taught him his lesson. Aharon withdrew and sat to Moshe’s left. Aharon’s sons entered, and Moshe taught them their lesson. His sons withdrew; Elazar sat to Moshe’s right, and Itamar to Aharon’s left. Rabbi Yehudah says: Aharon always returned to Moshe’s right. The elders entered, and Moshe taught them their lesson. The elders withdrew; all the people entered, and Moshe taught them their lesson. Aharon thus had heard it four times, his sons three times, the elders twice, and all the people once. Moshe withdrew, and Aharon repeated his lesson to them. Aharon withdrew, and his sons repeated their lesson to them. His sons withdrew, and the elders repeated their lesson to them. Everyone thus had heard the teaching four times.”

[43] **Shemot Rabbah 15:14** (excerpt): “Another interpretation of ‘This month shall be for you’: It is written, ‘I sent before you Moshe, Aharon, and Miriam’ (Micah 6:4). This is what Scripture says: ‘Send Your light and Your truth; they shall guide me’ (Psalms 43:3). These are Moshe and Aharon, as it says, ‘Of Levi he said: Your Thummim and Your Urim’ (Deuteronomy 33:8), and likewise, ‘A Torah of truth was in his mouth’ (Malachi 2:6).”

[44] **Malachi 2:6 — Torah of truth in the priest’s mouth**: ‘A Torah of truth was in his mouth and no wrongdoing was found upon his lips; in peace and uprightness he walked with Me, and he turned many back from sin.’

[45] **Sotah 12a and Exodus 2:2**: ‘The woman conceived and bore a son, and she saw that he was good, and she hid him for three months.” The Sages expound “she saw that he was good” as referring to light filling the house at Moshe’s birth.’

[46] **Sotah 12a:17**: “‘She saw that he was good.’ It was taught: Rabbi Meir says: His name was Tov, ‘Good.’ Rabbi Yehudah says: His name was Toviyyah. Rabbi Nechemyah says: He was fit for prophecy. Others say: He was born circumcised. The Sages say: When Moshe was born, the entire house filled with light. Here it is written, ‘She saw that he was good,’ and there it is written, ‘God saw that the light was good.’”

Rosh Chodesh Mar Cheshvan

Marcheshvan: Awe, Judgment, Rain, and Rectification

The Temple makes the Divine Presence an enduring dwelling and thereby brings awe into the world. Rav Tzadok distinguishes this awareness of standing before God from fear of punishment.

Marcheshvan: Awe, Judgment, Rain, and Rectification

אִיתָא בְּסֵפֶר יְצִירָה: — **It is stated in Sefer Yetzirah:** "הִמְלִיךְ אוֹת נוּ״ן בְּרֵיחַ וְכוֹלֵי וְחָשְׁנָן בַּשָּׁנָה".[47] — **"He made the letter Nun rule over smell, etc., and Cheshvan in the year."** בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ (חֵלֶק ב, צא עַמּוּד א): — **In the holy Zohar (Part II, 91a):** "נוּ״ן – רָזָא לְמִדְחַל מַקּוּדְשָׁא בְּרִיךְ הוּא, — **'The letter Nun is the mystery of revering the Holy One,** וּלְמִנְדַּע דְּאִית דִּין וְאִית דַּיָּין,[49] — **and knowing that there is judgment and there is a Judge,** וְאִית אָגַר טָב לְצַדִּיקַיָּא וּפֻרְעָנוּתָא לְרַשִּׁיעַיָּא, — **and there is good reward for the righteous and retribution for the wicked,** וְיָדוּעַ דְּהֵ״א תַּתָּאָה הוּא בְּגִין דְּרָזָא דִּילֵיהּ הֵ״א תַּתָּאָה"; — **because its esoteric mystery is the lower Hei';** וְכֵן הוּא בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ (אַחֲרֵי מוֹת סוּ עַמּוּד ב):[50,51] — **and it is known that the lower Hei represents Malchut,** מַלְכוּת, — **and so it is in the holy Zohar (Acharei Mot 66b):** "נוּ״ן כְּפוּפָה – דָּא מַטְרוֹנִיתָא", עַיֵּין שָׁם. — **'A bent Nun—this is the Matronita (Shekhinah/Malchut),' see there.** "וּמֶלֶךְ בְּמִשְׁפָּט יַעֲמִיד אָרֶץ",[52] — **And 'a king by justice establishes the land,'** וְהוּא שֵׁם אֲדנוּת, דְּינָא דְּמַלְכוּתָא. — **which corresponds to the Divine Name Adonai, the royal law of judgment.** וּבְמַאֲמַר פְּתַח אֵלִיָּהוּ: "צֶדֶק יְדִיעָא דְּאִיהוּ דִּין", — **And in the discourse Petach Eliyahu: 'Tzedek is known as Din (Judgment)',** וְזֶהוּ "דְּאִית דִּין"; — **and this is 'there is judgment';** וְכֵן בָּעֵי דְּבָמֶלֶךְ נֶאֱמַר: "שׂוֹם" וְגוֹמֵר – לְמִדְחַל, — **for concerning a king it is said: 'You shall set a king over you...'— and so one must revere,** שֶׁתְּהֵא אֵימָתוֹ עָלֶיךָ, — **that his dread be upon you;** וְנֶאֱמַר:[53] "וְאִם אֲדוֹנִים אָנִי אַיֵּה מוֹרָאִי". — **and it is said: 'And if I be a Master, where is My fear?'** וּבְחָשְׁנָן הִתְחִיל מִשְׁפַּט דּוֹר הַמַּבּוּל — **And in Cheshvan the judgment of the generation of the Flood began,** אֲשֶׁר הִרְבּוּ לַחֲטֹא וְלֹא יָרְאוּ אֱלֹהִים, — **who sinned abundantly and did not fear God,** וְאָמְרוּ דְּלֵית דִּין וְלֵית דַּיָּין, — **proclaiming that there is neither judgment nor Judge,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב: "וַיֹּאמְרוּ לָאֵל סוּר מִמֶּנּוּ" וְגוֹמֵר — **as is written: 'They said to God, "Depart from us,"' etc.,** "כִּי נַעַבְדֶנּוּ וּמַה נּוֹעִיל כִּי נִפְגַּע בּוֹ".[54] — **'that we should serve Him? And what would we gain by entreating Him?'** וְעַד גְּמַר בִּנְיַן הַבַּיִת עַל יְדֵי שְׁלֹמֹה הַמֶּלֶךְ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם — **And until the completion of the Temple's construction by King Solomon, peace be upon him,** הָיָה רֹשֶׁם מִשְׁפַּט דּוֹר הַמַּבּוּל בָּעוֹלָם, — **the imprint of the judgment of the Flood remained present in the world,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב (תַּנְחוּמָא נֹחַ ח):[55,56] — **as**

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[47] **Sefer Yetzirah Gra Version 5:9**: 'He made the letter lamed king over intercourse, bound a crown to it, joined them together, and formed with them Libra in the world, Tishrei in the year, and the gallbladder in the person, male and female. He made the letter nun king over scent, bound a crown to it, joined them together, and formed with them Scorpio in the world, Cheshvan in the year, and the intestines in the person, male and female. He made the letter samekh king over sleep, bound a crown to it, joined them together, and formed with them Sagittarius in the world, Kislev in the year, and the stomach in the person, male and female.'

[48] **Zohar, Yitro 30:505-517**: 'In the Zohar (Yitro II 91a), the letter Nun inside the word Anokhi is expounded: 'The letter Nun is the mystery of revering the Holy One, blessed be He, and knowing that there is judgment and there is a Judge, and that there is good reward for the righteous and retribution for the wicked—because its esoteric mystery is the lower Hei (Malkhut).''''

[49] **Zohar II 91a**: 'I am Anochi": at that moment the sanctuary was purified; the alien power did not draw near, and the sanctuary shone by itself, because the evil inclination was then nullified from the world. The Holy One, blessed be He, was exalted in His glory alone. Thus it was said, "I am Hashem your God." This is a complete mystery contained in the holy Name. Aleph: to unite the mystery of the holy Name in its levels, to make it one, for its mystery is vav. Nun: the mystery of fearing the Holy One, blessed be He, and knowing that there is judgment and a Judge; that there is a good reward for the righteous and punishment for the wicked; for the mystery of this letter is the lower hei."'

[50] **Zohar, Achrei Mot 30:186**: "It was taught: There are two letters of this kind. Just as we said of vav, spelled vav–alef–vav, so too nun, spelled nun–vav–nun. Although the matter has already been explained, nun is interpreted as follows: the bent nun is the Matronita. Beside her is vav, which is Yesod, so that she may receive blessing from it. The extended nun is the extension of Tiferet. Therefore the letters are included in one another and joined to one another. If you ask why the vav turns its face away from the bent nun and turns its face toward the extended nun: it is for the King's honor that it turns its face toward the King."

[51] **Zohar, Acharei Mot**: 'In the Zohar (Acharei Mot 66b), the bent letter Nun is identified as the mystery of the Matronita (the Shekhinah / Malkhut), which receives the supernal flow in humility and establishes royal judgment upon the earth.'

[52] **Proverbs 29:4**: 'A king establishes the land through justice, but a person of exactions destroys it.'

[53] **Malachi 1:6**: 'A son honors a father and a servant his master. If I am a Father, where is My honor? And if I am a Master, where is My fear?—says Hashem of Hosts to you, the priests who despise My name. But you say: In what have we despised Your name?'

[54] **Job 21:14-15**: 'They said to God: Depart from us; we have no desire for knowledge of Your ways. What is the Almighty, that we should serve Him? And what profit have we if we appeal to Him?'

[55] **Midrash Tanchuma, Noach 11**: 'You find that from that time until Shlomo built the Holy Temple, for forty days in every year rain fell in correspondence with the waters of the Flood, which lasted forty days. When Shlomo built the Holy Temple, he sought mercy on their behalf, and these rains ceased from the world; as it is said, 'In the eleventh year, in the month of Bul.' Why is it called 'the month of Bul'? Because they brought the animals inside out of the fields."'

[56] **Midrash Tanchuma, Noach 8:1**: "And God spoke to Noah, saying: "Go forth from the ark" (Gen. 8:15). May our master instruct us whether one is permitted to place saliva upon an ailing eye on the Sabbath. R. Hiyya the son of Abba stated in the name of R. Levi: It is forbidden to place saliva on an ailing eye on the Sabbath, for that would be equivalent to healing on the Sabbath. Come and see that there is no ailment in all the world for which there is no cure. What is the cure for an act resulting from the evil inclination? Repentance."

written (Tanchuma, Noach 8) שֶׁבְּכָל שָׁנָה בְּחֹדֶשׁ חֶשְׁוָן הָיוּ אַרְבָּעִים יוֹם הַמַּיִם שׁוֹטְפִים; **— that every year in the month of Cheshvan torrential waters poured down for forty days;** וּלְכָךְ נִקְרָא חֹדֶשׁ חֶשְׁוָן בְּמָלְכִים (מלכים א ו, לח)[57] בִּגְמַר בִּנְיַן הַבַּיִת — **and for this reason the month of Cheshvan is named in Kings (I Kings 6:38) at the completion of the Temple** "יָרֵחַ בּוּל" בְּלֹא מֵ"ם, **— the 'month of Bul,' without the mem of mabul (flood),** שֶׁבִּגְמַר בִּנְיַן הַבַּיִת פָּסְקוּ הָאַרְבָּעִים יוֹם רִאשָׁם מִשְׁפַּט הַמַּבּוּל. **— for upon the completion of the Temple, the forty days marking the Flood ceased.** שֶׁתַּכְלִית הַמְּכֻוָּן מֵהַבְּרִיאָה לִהְיוֹת דִּירָה — **For the ultimate intent of Creation is to be an abode in the lower realms, for the Shekhinah to dwell upon earth;** בַּתַּחְתּוֹנִים, לְשָׁכּוֹן הַשְּׁכִינָה בָּאָרֶץ; **— and through the sin of the Flood generation and the Dispersion, the Shekhinah departed,** וּבְחֵטְא דּוֹר הַמַּבּוּל וְדוֹר הַפַּלָּגָה נִסְתַּלְּקָה הַשְּׁכִינָה, **— and through the construction of the Temple, She returned.**

A fuller revelation calls for awe that restrains spiritual self-importance

בְּבֵית הַמִּקְדָּשׁ הָיָה הַשְּׁרָאַת הַשְּׁכִינָה בִּקְבִיעוּת,[58] **— In the Holy Temple, the indwelling of the Shekhinah was permanent,** וְהַיְינוּ כְּמוֹ שֶׁקָּרָא יַעֲקֹב לִמְקוֹם הַמִּקְדָּשׁ "בַּיִת", **— as Jacob named the site of the Temple a 'house',** קְבִיעוּת מָקוֹם לְגִילּוּי שְׁכִינָתוֹ יִתְבָּרַךְ שְׁמוֹ; **— signifying an established domicile for the manifestation of His Shekhinah;** וּמִשָּׁם יִרְאָה יוֹצֵאת לָעוֹלָם, **— and from there awe goes forth to the world,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: "לְמַעַן תִּלְמַד לְיִרְאָה אֶת ה' אֱלֹקֶיךָ כָּל הַיָּמִים", — לֹא יִרְאַת עֹנֶשׁ רַק יִרְאָה אֲמִתִּית, **— as is said: 'that you may learn to fear Hashem, etc.', not merely fear of punishment, but genuine awe,** כִּי בְּמָקוֹם גִּילּוּי שְׁכִינָתוֹ נוֹפֵל יִרְאָה, **— for wherever His Shekhinah is unveiled, awe descends,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: "וּבְמוֹרָא גָּדוֹל – זֶה גִּלּוּי שְׁכִינָה". **— as stated: 'And with great awe—this refers to the revelation of the Shekhinah.'** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר בַּהַגָּהָה בְּרֵישׁ אֹרַח חַיִּים: **— And as stated in the gloss of the Rema at the beginning of Orach Chayim:** כְּשֶׁיָּשִׂים הָאָדָם אֶל לִבּוֹ **— when a person takes to heart** שֶׁמֶּלֶךְ מַלְכֵי הַמְּלָכִים הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא עוֹמֵד עָלָיו וְרוֹאֶה בְּמַעֲשָׂיו, **— that the King of kings, the Holy One, stands over him and sees his actions,** מָיַד יַגִּיעַ אֵלָיו הַיִּרְאָה וְהַכְנָעָה מִפַּחַד הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ וְכוּ'. **— awe and subjugation from the dread of Hashem instantly fall upon him, etc.** וְאוֹת נו"ן הוּא לְשׁוֹן נְפִילָה, **— And the letter Nun denotes falling,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר (בְּרָכוֹת ד:):[59] דְּלֹא נֶאֱמְרָה נו"ן בְּאַשְׁרֵי שֶׁיֵּשׁ — **as is stated (Berakhot 4b):** בָּהֶן מַפַּלְתָּן וְכוּ', **— that the letter Nun was omitted in Ashrei because in it lies the downfall of Israel, etc.,** בְּמַעֲרָבָא וְכוּ': "נָפְלָה לֹא תוֹסִיף וְכוּ'", **— in the West (the Land of Israel) they interpreted it: 'She has fallen; she shall not again fall,' etc.;**

Torah can give a fallen person the first strength to rise

וְאָמַר שָׁם: וְאַף עַל פִּי כֵן סָמָכָן דָּוִד בְּרוּחַ הַקֹּדֶשׁ,[60] **— and it states there: nonetheless David supported them via the**

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[57] **I Kings 6:38**: 'In the eleventh year, in the month Bul—that is the eighth month—the House was completed in all its details and according to all its ordinances; he built it over seven years.'

[58] **Sod Yesharim, Sukkot 8:1**: "The blessed God began building the fullness of the honor of heavenly kingship in the days of Abraham our father. With him God began to show that the honor of His kingship, as it were, reaches its complete fullness only through Israel's service. In his days it began, as it is written, 'The beginning of wisdom is the fear of the Lord.' The holy Zohar explains that this is why Jacob said, 'How awesome is this place': where fullness is found, awe is found. When God began to illuminate His will that without Israel's service there would be no fullness in heavenly kingship, as it were, it followed that all this fullness was placed in Israel's hands. Israel then needed to restrain themselves with great awe. Otherwise, God forbid, they could receive an excessive sense of power from this illumination, imagining that His governance was in their hands. God would then rise above this garment and show that nothing is in the person's hands. Therefore, where fullness is found, awe is found."

Sod Yesharim explains why a greater revelation produces a greater need for awe. Being entrusted with service that contributes to heavenly honor can itself invite self-importance; awe keeps the recipient aware of the Giver. This develops Rav Tzadok's distinction between fear of punishment and the humility that accompanies awareness of the Divine Presence.

[59] **Berakhot 4b**: 'Rabbi Yochanan said: Why was the letter nun not stated in Ashrei? Because it contains the downfall of the enemies of Israel, as it is written, 'Fallen, she shall not rise again, virgin Israel.' In the West they explained the verse: 'She has fallen and shall not fall again; arise, virgin Israel.' Rav Nachman bar Yitzchak said: Even so, David came back and upheld them with divine inspiration, as it says, 'Hashem supports all who fall.'"'

[60] **Tzidkat HaTzadik 236:1**: "The principal support of those who fall from their level comes through words of Torah, which give strength and sound counsel. This comes through truthful speech recognizing the greatness of the blessed God, even when the person is utterly distant from Him. Such is Torah: one is not standing before the King, so this is possible even during the fall and distance, and through it one is supported. Prayer, however, is like standing before the King, being close to Him; this is not possible at the time of the fall, since the person is not close. Even the prayer of the poor person from a broken heart is then impossible, for that too requires strength, and at the time of the fall the person lacks even this: the heart is completely blocked, like a stone. Concerning this they said, 'Draw him to the study house; if he is stone … he shatters.' Through words of Torah the person is supported and strengthened to awaken and rise from the fall."

Tzidkat HaTzadik describes how the first support can reach someone who cannot yet produce a feeling of closeness or

Holy Spirit, ;"סוֹמֵךְ ה' לְכָל הַנֹּפְלִים" שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר — **as it is said: 'Hashem supports all who fall';** וּכְתִיב: "סֻכַּת דָּוִיד הַנֹּפֶלֶת", — **and it is written: 'the fallen tabernacle of David',** כִּי סֻכָּה דִּירַת עֲרַאי, — **for a sukkah is a temporary dwelling,** וְהַיְינוּ אַף בְּעֵת שֶׁנִּרְאֵית כְּנוֹפֶלֶת הוּא סְמָכָהּ, — **meaning that even when it seems fallen He supports it,** שֶׁמַּמְשִׁיךְ מִדַּת מַלְכוּתוֹ יִתְבָּרַךְ שְׁמוֹ בָּעוֹלָם תָּמִיד. — **continually drawing down His royal presence into the world.** וְהַנְּפִילָה הוּא צוֹרֶךְ עֲלִיָּה, — **And the fall is for the sake of ascent,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: "כִּי שֶׁבַע יִפּוֹל צַדִּיק וְלָמָּה תָּדִיד כְּתִיב: "אָקִים אֶת סֻכַּת דָּוִיד הַנֹּפֶלֶת". — **as is stated: 'For seven times a righteous man falls and rises up,' and for the future it is written: 'I will raise up the tabernacle of David that is fallen.'** וְאִיתָא (בְּרֵאשִׁית רַבָּה פָּרָשָׁה יז):[61,62] תְּחִלַּת מַפָּלָה – שֵׁינָה, — **And it is brought (Bereishit Rabbah, Parashah 17): the beginning of downfall is sleep;** דָּמֵיךְ לֵיהּ וְלָא לָעֵי בְּאוֹרַיְיתָא, — **one sleeps and does not labor in the Torah,** כִּי עַל יְדֵי שֵׁינָה מִתְרַחֵק מֵהַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ, — **for through sleep one is distanced from Hashem,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: "עַצְלָה תַּפִּיל תַּרְדֵּמָה", — **as it is said: 'Slothfulness casts into a deep sleep,'** שֶׁמִּתְעַצֵּל מֵעֲבוֹדַת הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ. — **slacking off from the service of Hashem.**

Rest can prepare renewed Torah when Torah remains within the heart

וְאִיתָא גַּם כֵּן בַּמִּדְרָשׁ (בְּרֵאשִׁית רַבָּה פָּרָשָׁה ט):[63,64,65] — **And it is brought likewise in the Midrash (Bereishit Rabbah, Parashah 9):** וְכִי מַה רָאָה לְהָעִיד עָלָיו שֶׁהוּא טוֹב מְאֹד? שֵׁינָה טוֹבָה הִיא לָאָדָם? אֶלָּא מִתּוֹךְ שֶׁהוּא יָשֵׁן קִימְעָא וְהוּא עוֹמֵד וְעוֹסֵק בַּתּוֹרָה הַרְבֵּה". — **'And behold, it was very good'—sleep is good; is sleep really 'very good'? Rather, because he sleeps a little, he rises and labors in the Torah abundantly."** וְהַיְינוּ שֶׁיִּתְתַּקֵּן הַנְּפִילָה עַצְמָהּ שֶׁתְּהֵא לוֹ סַיְיעְתָּא לַעֲבוֹדַת הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ, — **Namely, that he rectifies the fall itself so that it becomes an aid to the service of Hashem,** וּמִמֶּנָּה יִזְקֹף לַעֲבוֹד אֶת הַשֵּׁם. — **and from it he draws strength to serve Him.** וְכֵן אַחַר כָּךְ בְּחֹדֶשׁ כִּסְלֵו: — **And so afterward in the month of Kislev:** "הִמְלִיךְ אוֹת סָמֶ"ךְ בְּשֵׁינָה וְכִסְלָו בַּשֵּׁנָה". — **'He made the letter Samekh rule over sleep, and Kislev in the year.'** וְאָמַר "הִמְלִיךְ אוֹת נוּ"ן בְּרֵיחַ", — **And it said, 'He made the letter Nun rule over smell,'** כִּי מִי שֶׁיֵּשׁ לוֹ יִרְאַת הַשֵּׁם יֵשׁ לוֹ חוּשׁ הָרֵיחַ, — **for one who possesses the fear of Hashem has the sense of smell,** עַל דֶּרֶךְ מַה שֶּׁנֶּאֱמַר: "וַהֲרִיחוֹ בְּיִרְאַת הַשֵּׁם". — **in the manner of the verse: 'And he shall discern through the fear of Hashem,'** שֶׁיִּהְיֶה מוֹרַח וְדַאִין. — **that he will smell and judge.** וְהִנֵּה לְכָל חֹדֶשׁ יֵשׁ עִנְיָן מְיוּחָד לַעֲסוֹק, — **Now, every month has a unique matter to engage in,** וְחֹדֶשׁ מַרְחֶשְׁוָן הָעֵצָה לְהִתְחַזֵּק לְהָחֵל — **and in the month of Marcheshvan the spiritual work is to strengthen oneself to begin rising from the fall,** לָקוּם מֵהַנְּפִילָה וּלְהַכְנִיס עַצְמוֹ לִקְדוּשָׁה בְּיִרְאַת הַשֵּׁם: — **and to bring oneself into sanctity through the fear of Hashem.**

אִיתָא מֵהָרַב הַקָּדוֹשׁ רַבִּי מְנַחֵם מֶענְדֶל מֵרִימַנוֹב זַכְרוֹ צַדִּיק וְקָדוֹשׁ לִבְרָכָה לְחַיֵּי הָעוֹלָם הַבָּא, — **It is brought from the holy master Rabbi Menachem Mendel of Rimanov of blessed memory,** שֶׁבְּחֹדֶשׁ מַרְחֶשְׁוָן הֵם רוֹב גְּזֵירוֹת, — **that in the month of Marcheshvan the majority of harsh decrees occur,** מִפְּנֵי שֶׁאָז נִתְחַלְּקָה מַלְכוּת בֵּית דָּוִד. —

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even a brokenhearted appeal. Truthful Torah speech can precede that emotional renewal and restore the capacity to rise. This gives a concrete path to the support and renewed beginning urged in Mar Cheshvan. The contrast describes spiritual capacity in this condition; it is not a ruling that such a person should stop praying.

[61] **Bereshit Rabbah 17:5 — sleep as a loss of Torah labour**: ‘The Lord God caused a deep sleep to fall upon the man.’ Rabbi Yehoshua of Sikhnin in the name of Rabbi Levi said: ‘Sleep is the beginning of decline: he sleeps and does not toil in Torah, and does not attend to his work.’ Rav said: ‘There are three kinds of deep sleep: the sleep of ordinary slumber, the sleep of prophecy, and the sleep of collapse.’ The Rabbis added a sleep of folly; and Rabbi Chanina bar Yitzchak taught that sleep is a lesser reflection of death, a dream of prophecy, and Shabbos of the World to Come.”’

[62] **Bereshit Rabbah 17:5** (excerpt): “‘Hashem God caused a deep sleep to fall’ (Genesis 2:21). Rabbi Yehoshua of Sikhnin said in the name of Rabbi Levi: The beginning of downfall is sleep: a person sleeps and does not labor in Torah, and does not attend to his work.”

[63] **Bereshit Rabbah 9:6 — “very good” and purposeful rest**: ‘Rabbi Shimon ben Elazar said: ‘And behold, it was very good’—behold, sleep is good. Is sleep really very good? Have we not learned that wine and sleep are good for the wicked and good for the world? Rather, when a person sleeps a little, he rises and toils greatly in Torah.”’

[64] **Bereshit Rabbah 9:6** (excerpt): “Rabbi Shimon ben Elazar said: ‘Behold, it was very good’—behold, sleep is good. Is sleep really very good? Have we not learned that wine and sleep are beneficial for the wicked and beneficial for the world? Rather, because a person sleeps a little, he rises and labors greatly in Torah.”

[65] **Tzidkat HaTzadik 204:1**: “Although everyone has a time of diminished consciousness, and it is impossible to remain always in expanded consciousness and the proper cleaving to God—as sleep was created and Bereshit Rabbah calls it ‘very good,’ because through it one rests and returns to receive fresh vitality—so too one must sometimes rest a little from words of Torah, and ‘the suspension of Torah is its foundation.’ Nevertheless, even at such a time, a person’s thoughts differ according to his level in the Torah that is upon his heart. Thus with our father Jacob: his dream, the images he experienced at the time of diminished consciousness, was also ‘Behold, the Lord stood over him.’ So it is with each person according to his level.”

Tzidkat HaTzadik supplies a criterion for the distinction between restorative rest and abandonment. The Torah already rooted in a person continues to shape even the interval of diminished attention. This explains how the interruption itself can serve renewed life in Torah, while preserving Rav Tzadok’s requirement that it actually lead to renewed effort.

because then the kingdom of the House of David was divided. וּמִן הַסְּתָם אֵינוֹ רַק לְעֹנֶשׁ, **— And presumably this is not merely for punishment,** רַק שֶׁבּוֹ הַזְּמַן מְסֻגָּל לְתַקֵּן זֶה. **— rather it is a uniquely propitious time to rectify this.** וְהָעִנְיָן, דְּאִיתָא בַּגְּמָרָא (רֹאשׁ הַשָּׁנָה יא:): [66] **— And the matter is, as taught in the Gemara (Rosh Hashanah 11b):** לְרַבִּי יְהוֹשֻׁעַ, בְּשִׁבְעָה עָשָׂר בְּאִיָּיר הָיָה הַמַּבּוּל; **— according to Rabbi Yehoshua, on the seventeenth of Iyar the Flood began;** וּלְרַבִּי אֱלִיעֶזֶר, דִּבְתִשְׁרֵי נִבְרָא הָעוֹלָם, **— and according to Rabbi Eliezer, that in Tishrei the world was created,** אוֹתוֹ הַיּוֹם שִׁבְעָה עָשָׂר בְּמַרְחֶשְׁוָן הָיָה. **— that day was the seventeenth of Marcheshvan.** וְאִיתָא: תָּנוּ רַבָּנָן, **— And it is taught: Our Rabbis taught,** חַכְמֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל מוֹנִין לַמַּבּוּל כְּרַבִּי אֱלִיעֶזֶר, [67] **— the Sages of Israel reckon for the Flood according to Rabbi Eliezer,** וְלַתְּקוּפָה כְּרַבִּי יְהוֹשֻׁעַ; **— and for astronomical cycles according to Rabbi Yehoshua;** וּפֵירֵשׁ רַבִּי שְׁלֹמֹה יִצְחָקִי וְתוֹסָפוֹת: [68] **— and Rashi and Tosafot explained:** לַמַּבּוּל" – לִשְׁנוֹת הָעוֹלָם מוֹנִין מִתִּשְׁרֵי כְּרַבִּי אֱלִיעֶזֶר. **— 'for the Flood'—for the calendar years of the world we count from Tishrei like Rabbi Eliezer.** וְיֵשׁ לְהָבִין לְפִי זֶה לְשׁוֹן "לַמַּבּוּל", **— And one must understand according to this the expression 'for the Flood',** וְהָיָה לוֹ לוֹמַר: "לַשָּׁנִים" אוֹ "לִשְׁנוֹת עוֹלָם", **— for it should have said 'for years' or 'for the years of the world',** וְלָמָּה תָּפַס לְשׁוֹן "לַמַּבּוּל" שֶׁכְּבָר עָבַר? **— and why adopt the phrase 'for the Flood', which has long passed?** אֲבָל נִרְאֶה שֶׁנִּזְרַמז בָּזֶה, **— However, it seems that there is an allusion in this,** דְּאִיתָא (תַּנְחוּמָא נֹחַ ח): [69, 70] **— for it is taught (Tanchuma, Noach 8):** אַתָּה מוֹצֵא מִן אוֹתָהּ שָׁעָה **— you find that from that time** עַד שֶׁבָּנָה שְׁלֹמֹה בֵּית הַמִּקְדָּשׁ, **— until Solomon built the Holy Temple,** אַרְבָּעִים יוֹם הָיוּ עוֹשִׂין גְּשָׁמִים בְּכָל שָׁנָה לְשׁוֹן הַמַּבּוּל, **— forty days of rains fell each year in the manner of the Flood,** וּכְשֶׁבָּנָה שְׁלֹמֹה בֵּית הַמִּקְדָּשׁ בִּקֵּשׁ רַחֲמִים עֲלֵיהֶם **— and when Solomon built the Temple he prayed for mercy upon them** וּפָסְקוּ מִן הָעוֹלָם וְכוּ', **— and they ceased from the world, etc.,** שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: "בְּיֶרַח בּוּל" וְכוּ'. **— as it is said: 'in the month of Bul, etc.'** וְהַיְינוּ דְּדוֹר הַמַּבּוּל הָיוּ רְאוּיִם לְקַבָּלַת הַתּוֹרָה, **— Namely, the generation of the Flood were originally fit to receive the Torah,** אֲז הָיָה נִשְׁמַת מֹשֶׁה רַבֵּינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם, **— for the soul of Moses our teacher was present then,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁמְּרַמֵּז בַּגְּמָרָא (חֻלִּין קלט:): [71, 72] **— as the Gemara alludes (Chullin 139b):** מֹשֶׁה מִן הַתּוֹרָה מְנַיִן? **— 'Where is Moses indicated in the Torah?** 'מֹשֶׁה', בְּגִימַטְרִיָּא 'בְּשַׁגַּם' – **— 'Inasmuch as he is also' (be-shagam = 345) equals Moses,** וּכְתִיב: 'וַיְהִי יָמָיו מֵאָה וְעֶשְׂרִים שָׁנָה'". **— and it is written: 'and his days shall be a hundred and twenty years.'** וְכֵן כָּתוּב מְפוֹרָשׁ בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ (חֵלֶק ג, רטז עַמּוּד א): [73]

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[66] **Rosh Hashanah 11b**: 'Rabbi Eliezer says: the world was created in Tishrei; Rabbi Yehoshua says: the world was created in Nisan.'

[67] **Rosh Hashanah 11b**: 'Our Rabbis taught: In the six-hundredth year of Noach's life, in the second month, on the seventeenth day of the month: Rabbi Yehoshua says that day was the seventeenth of Iyar, when the constellation Kimah sets by day and the springs diminish. Because they altered their deeds, the Holy One altered the natural order and caused Kimah to rise by day, removing two stars from Kimah and bringing the Flood upon the world. Rabbi Eliezer says: That day was the seventeenth of Marcheshvan, when Kimah rises by day and the springs grow stronger.'

[68] **Rashi and Tosafot on Rosh Hashanah 11b — distinct comments**: 'Rashi (on "And these follow their respective views"): "For Rabbi Eliezer, the world was created in Tishrei, for the counting of the generations begins from Tishrei; accordingly the Flood must have begun in Marcheshvan and lasted twelve months. For Rabbi Yehoshua, who says the world was created in Nisan and counts the generations from then, the Flood began in Iyar." Tosafot (on "The day on which Kimah sets by day"): "The reading in Rabbi Eliezer's teaching is that on the seventeenth of Marcheshvan the constellation Kimah sets by day ... while concerning the seventeenth of Iyar it says that Kimah rises by day; the version in Rashi's commentary reverses this, but the zodiacal order does not support it."'

[69] **Midrash Tanchuma, Noach 11**: 'You find that from that time until Shlomo built the Holy Temple, forty days of rain fell each and every year because of the waters of the Flood, which had been forty days. When Shlomo built the Temple, he pleaded for mercy for them and they ceased from the world, as Scripture says: 'In the eleventh year, in the month of Bul.'" The Midrash continues to explain the name of the month as the season when animals are gathered indoors.'

[70] **Midrash Tanchuma, Noach 8:1**: "And God spoke to Noah, saying: "Go forth from the ark" (Gen. 8:15). May our master instruct us whether one is permitted to place saliva upon an ailing eye on the Sabbath. R. Hiyya the son of Abba stated in the name of R. Levi: It is forbidden to place saliva on an ailing eye on the Sabbath, for that would be equivalent to healing on the Sabbath. Come and see that there is no ailment in all the world for which there is no cure. What is the cure for an act resulting from the evil inclination? Repentance."

[71] **Chullin 139b**: 'Where is Moses alluded to in the Torah? As it is written: 'For that he also is flesh (be-shaggam), yet his days shall be a hundred and twenty years' (Genesis 6:3)—the numerical value of be-shaggam (345) equals that of Moshe (345). Where is Esther alluded to in the Torah? 'And I will surely hide (haster astir) My face on that day' (Deuteronomy 31:18). Where is Mordechai alluded to in the Torah? It is written: 'Flowing myrrh (mor deror)' (Exodus 30:23), which Onkelos translates as mira dakhya. Where is Haman alluded to in the Torah? 'Have you eaten from the tree (ha-min ha-etz)' (Genesis 3:11).'

[72] **Chullin 139b:10**: "The people of Pappunya asked Rav Mattana: If someone found a bird's nest on a person's head, what is the law concerning sending away the mother bird? He answered them with the verse, 'And earth was upon his head,' treating the head as ground for this purpose. Where is Moshe alluded to in the Torah before his birth? In 'inasmuch as he too is flesh,' be-shaggam hu basar. The numerical value of be-shaggam is that of Moshe."

[73] **Zohar, Pinchas 10:48-58**: 'Zohar III:216a (Pinchas, Ra'aya Meheimna): 'At the time of the Flood, in the six-hundredth year of Noah's life, the generation was potentially fit to receive the Torah, and the soul-root of Moses was present among them—as hinted in "for he also is flesh (beshagach)" (Genesis 6:3), which shares the numerical value of Moshe (345)—

— And so it is explicitly written in the holy Zohar (Part III, 216a): דַּעֲתִיד הֲוָה מֹשֶׁה לְקַבָּלָא אוֹרַיְיתָא בְּדָרָא דְּטוֹפָנָא וְכוּלֵי; וְכֵן[74] **— that Moses was destined to receive the Torah in the generation of the Flood, etc.;** כָּתוּב בַּמִּדְרָשׁ (שְׁמוֹת רַבָּה פָּרָשָׁה ל):[75] **— and so is written in the Midrash (Shemot Rabbah, Parashah 30):** שֶׁלֹּא רָצוּ לְקַבֵּל הַתּוֹרָה **— 'And the knowledge of Your ways we do not desire'** — '"וְדַעַת דְּרָכֶיךָ לֹא חָפָצְנוּ' – **that they did not want to receive the Torah,** שֶׁהֵם דְּרָכָיו שֶׁל הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא". **— which are the ways of the Holy One."** וְגוֹמֵר, "בַּיּוֹם הַהוּא נִבְקְעוּ כָּל מַעְיְנוֹת תְּהוֹם רַבָּה" וּכְתִיב:[76] **— And it is written: 'On that day all the fountains of the great deep burst open, etc.',** וּבַזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ (חֵלֶק א, קיז עַמּוּד א) רָמְזוּ בָּזֶה[77] **— and in the holy Zohar (Part I, 117a) they hinted regarding this** לְעִנְיַן אֶלֶף הַשִּׁשִּׁי: **— to the sixth millennium:** תַּרְעֵי דְּחָכְמְתָא וּמַבּוּעֵי דְּחָכְמְתָא לְתַתָּא. **— and the wellsprings of wisdom below.** וְהַיְינוּ לְעֵילָּא **— the gates of wisdom above** נִבְקְעוּ "כָּל מַעְיְנוֹת תְּהוֹם רַבָּה" – **— Namely, at that time during the days of the Flood — there burst open 'all the fountains of the great deep'—** שָׁאָז בִּימֵי הַמַּבּוּל מַבּוּעֵי דְּחָכְמָה תַּתָּאָה, תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה;[78] **— the wellsprings of lower wisdom, the Oral Torah;** תַּרְעֵי דְּחָכְמְתָא, תּוֹרָה שֶׁבִּכְתָב; "וַאֲרֻבֹּת הַשָּׁמַיִם" – **— and 'the windows of heaven'—the gates of wisdom, the Written Torah;** שֶׁאָז הָיוּ רְאוּיִים לְקַבֵּל הַתּוֹרָה שֶׁבִּכְתָב **— for then they were fit to receive the Written Torah** שֶׁהָיָה כָּלוּל בָּהּ כָּל הַתּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה, **— within which the entire Oral Torah was enfolded,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁקִּבֵּל מֹשֶׁה רַבֵּינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם אַחַר כָּךְ מֵהַר סִינַי, **— just as Moses our teacher received later from Mount Sinai,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: "מֹשֶׁה קִבֵּל תּוֹרָה מִסִּינַי וּמְסָרָהּ לִיהוֹשֻׁעַ", **— as stated: 'Moses received Torah from Sinai and transmitted it to Joshua',** דְּקָאֵי עַל תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה, **— which refers to the Oral Torah,** דְּתוֹרָה כְּמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר שֶׁבִּכְתָב מָסַר לַכֹּהֲנִים בְּנֵי לֵוִי, **— for the Written Torah he handed to the priests, the sons of Levi,** בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ (חֵלֶק ב, קלז, בְּסָפְרִים אֲחֵרִים).[79] **— as stated in the holy Zohar (Part II, 137, in the variant reading).**

A season's spiritual possibility depends on how its power is used

— And it is written: 'And the rain was upon the earth forty days',[80] וּכְתִיב: "וַיְהִי הַגֶּשֶׁם עַל הָאָרֶץ אַרְבָּעִים יוֹם",

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had they not corrupted their way upon the earth.'''

[74] **Zohar III 216a**: 'Our Sages further expounded another mystery: 'The generation that departs is the generation that comes'; one who went lame returns lame, and one who went blind returns blind. They also taught that Moshe was destined to receive the Torah in the generation of the Flood; but because they were wicked, Scripture states, 'For he too is flesh' (be-shagam hu basar). 'Be-shagam' is Moshe. Why does it call him 'be-shagam'? Rather, Koheles concealed the matter by omitting the letter beis from 'be-shagam': 'I said that this too (she-gam) is vanity.'''

[75] **Shemot Rabbah 30:13** (excerpt): "'A man of gifts destroys it' refers to the generation of the Flood, who did not administer justice. See what is written of them: 'They drive away the orphan's donkey; they turn the needy from the road' (Job 24:3–4). Rabbi Acha said: The Holy One, blessed be He, sought to give them four things—Torah, suffering, sacrificial service, and prayer—but they did not want them. 'They said to God: Turn away from us' (Job 21:14) refers to suffering. 'We do not desire knowledge of Your ways' refers to Torah. 'What is the Almighty, that we should serve Him?' (Job 21:15) refers to sacrifices. 'What will we gain if we entreat Him?' refers to prayer."

[76] **Genesis 7:11**: 'In the six-hundredth year of Noach's life, in the second month, on the seventeenth day of the month—on that very day all the fountains of the great deep were split open, and the windows of heaven were opened.'

[77] **Zohar, Vayera 30:444-451**: 'The Vau will be multiplied into the He ten times, making sixty, when it will raise the exiles from the dust. At every sixty years of the sixth thousand the He will mount a stage higher, acquiring greater strength. And after six hundred years of the sixth thousand there will be opened the gates of wisdom above and the fountains of wisdom below, and the world will make preparations to enter on the seventh thousand as man makes preparations on the sixth day of the week, when the sun is about to set. As a mnemonic to this we take the verse, "In the six hundredth year of Noah's life… all the fountains of the great deep were broken up" (Gen. 7, 11).'''

[78] **Zohar, Vayera 30:445**: "When Vav is completed within ten six times, they are then sixty, to raise her from the dust. At each successive sixty of that sixth millennium, Hei grows stronger and rises through her levels to gain strength. In the six-hundredth year of the sixth millennium, the gates of wisdom above and the wellsprings of wisdom below will open, and the world will be prepared to enter the seventh, like a person who prepares on the sixth day, as the sun is setting, to enter the Sabbath. So it is here too. Your sign is: "In the six-hundredth year of Noah's life," and, further in that verse, "all the fountains of the great deep burst open.""

[79] **Zohar II 137b**: 'Moshe wrote this Torah and gave it to the priests, the sons of Levi, who carried the Ark of the Covenant of Hashem, and to all the elders of Israel" (Deuteronomy 31:9, translated in full). This is the scriptural statement underlying Rav Tzadok's distinction between the Written Torah entrusted to the priests and the Oral Torah that requires reception and explication.'

[80] **Tzidkat HaTzadik 76:1**: "At the time of a person's failure, he should know that this very time is a preparation for that same matter for good. If he merits it at that moment, he can rise to a very great level. The greatness of the good he can receive then corresponds to the greatness of the sin toward which the inclination entices him—if he turns this longing and desire toward good. The good comes from that very matter, as the opposite of the evil. Thus the Zohar says that at the time of the Flood they were fit to receive Torah, and Moses was then present, as our Sages expounded the word beshaggam; see there. Water means Torah, but they turned it into 'raging waters.' Torah is the ultimate support of the world, for whose sake it was created, yet they caused its destruction. Had they merited it, that time was prepared for the very opposite: the descent of the waters of Torah to sustain the world. Likewise, at the time of the destruction the Messiah was born, as stated in the Jerusalem Talmud. That time was prepared, had they merited it, for the Messiah's

שֶׁהוֹרִידָן בְּרַחֲמִים — **for He brought them down in mercy**, כְּפֵירוּשׁ רַבִּי שְׁלֹמֹה יִצְחָקִי, שֶׁאִם יָשׁוּבוּ יִהְיוּ גְּשָׁמֵי בְרָכָה — **that if they repent, they would be rains of blessing, as Rashi explains;** וְהַיְינוּ תּוֹרָה, שֶׁהוּא — **which is Torah,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁאִיתָא בַּגְּמָרָא (בָּבָא קַמָּא יז.)[81] — **as brought in the Gemara (Bava Kama 17a):** "אֵין מַיִם אֶלָּא תּוֹרָה" — **'Water is nothing other than Torah.'** אַךְ כֵּיוָן שֶׁלֹּא שָׁבוּ וְקִלְקְלוּ, נַעֲשׂוּ מַיִם הַזִּדוֹנִים וְנִשְׁפְּטוּ — **Yet because they did not repent and corrupted their ways, the rains became raging waters, and that generation was judged,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁכָּתַב אַחַר כָּךְ: "וַיְהִי הַמַּבּוּל אַרְבָּעִים יוֹם". — **and as written afterward: 'And the Flood was forty days.'** – וְהַיְינוּ שֶׁבְּתִשְׁרֵי "וַיְהִי אוֹר" — **Namely, in Tishrei, 'And there was light'—** זֶה רֹאשׁ הַשָּׁנָה, כְּמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר בַּתִּיקּוּנִים (תִּיקּוּן לוֹ)[82, 83] — **this is Rosh Hashanah, as stated in the Tikkunim (Tikkun 36);** וְכֵן כָּתוּב בְּמִדְרָשׁ רַבָּה (פָּרָשַׁת אַחֲרֵי מוֹת)[84] — **and so written in Midrash Rabbah (Parashat Acharei Mot):** "אוֹרִי" בְּרֹאשׁ הַשָּׁנָה, "תּוֹרָה אוֹר" – שֶׁאָז מַתְחִיל הִתְחַדְּשׁוּת בְּדִבְרֵי תּוֹרָה — **'My light' on Rosh Hashanah, for then begins renewal in words of Torah—'Torah is light'—** עַד שְׁמִינִי עֲצֶרֶת, שֶׁהוּא נְבִיעוּ דְּאוֹרַיְתָא — **until Shemini Atzeret, which is the flowing wellspring of Torah,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר בַּתִּיקּוּנִים (תִּיקּוּן יג)[85, 86] — **as stated in the Tikkunim (Tikkun 13),** שֶׁאָז נִקְבָּע אוֹר תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה, הִתְחַדְּשׁוּת בְּדִבְרֵי תּוֹרָה; — **for then the light of the Oral Torah is set, innovation in Torah;** וּמֵאָז הַזְּמַן אַרְבָּעִים יוֹם לְקַבֵּל הַהַשְׁפָּעָה וְהִתְחַדְּשׁוּת בְּדִבְרֵי תּוֹרָה בִּקְבִיעוּת. וְכֵן זְמַן הַגְּשָׁמִים, אִיתָא (תַּעֲנִית — **and from then is the forty-day span to receive this flow and renewal in Torah permanently.** יוֹרֶה בְּמַרְחֶשְׁוָן, שֶׁמּוֹרֶה אֶת הַבְּרִיּוֹת לְהָטִיחַ וְכוּלֵי — **And likewise regarding the rainy season, it is taught (Ta'anit 6a):** — **the first rain (Yoreh) falls in Marcheshvan,** "יוֹרֶה" — **'Yoreh'—it instructs (moreh)**

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coming and the building of the eternal Temple. This was the error of the people of Jerusalem and the false prophets: they thought that, on the contrary, God would do good to them, because they saw that the time was prepared for this—if they merited it."

Tzidkat HaTzadik extends the Flood's unrealized possibility to the individual: a powerful desire can be redirected toward a corresponding good. It also explains the condition in Rav Tzadok's seasonal reading. A time being suited to blessing does not guarantee the result; the final example explicitly identifies the mistake of treating potential as a promise. Accepting the yoke of Torah is the response that the Mar Cheshvan passage calls for.

[81] **Bava Kamma 17a**: 'There is no 'sowing' except tzedakah, as it says, 'Sow for yourselves righteousness and reap according to kindness'; and there is no 'water' except Torah, as it says, 'Ho! Everyone who thirsts, come to the waters.'"'

[82] **Tikkunei Zohar, Tikkun 36**: 'Two thousand years of chaos: 'The earth was chaos'; two thousand years of Torah: 'The spirit of God was hovering over the surface of the waters'—and 'water' means nothing other than Torah. 'The face of the waters' refers to its two aspects, positive and negative commandments, white and red, right and left. Then come the two thousand years of the days of Mashiach: 'God said: Let there be light, and there was light.' ... 'Let there be light' is Pesach, the light of the fourteenth; 'and there was light' is Rosh Hashanah, of which it is said, 'And there was a day.' Here 'and there was,' and there 'and there was'; wherever 'and there was' occurs it conveys a language of distress.'"

[83] **Tikkunei Zohar 77b:4-78a:3**: 'In Tikkunei Zohar (Tikkun 36, 77b), the verse 'Let there be light, and there was light' is expounded on the two heads of the year: 'Let there be light (Yehi Ohr)' refers to Nisan and Passover, when the light of Chesed shines from Above; 'and there was light (Vayehi Ohr)' refers to Tishrei and Rosh Hashanah, when Israel awakens the light of Torah from below through judgment and repentance.'"

[84] **Vayikra Rabbah 21:4; parallel in Midrash Tehillim 27:3**: 'The Sages expounded the verse in connection with Rosh Hashanah and Yom Kippur: 'My light'—on Rosh Hashanah; 'my salvation'—on Yom Kippur. 'Of whom shall I fear?' ... 'When evildoers draw near to me'—these are the princes of the nations, who come to accuse Israel before the Holy One. They say: Master of the world, these worship idols and those worship idols; these practice forbidden relations and those practice forbidden relations; these spill blood and those spill blood. Why should these descend to Gehinnom and those not? ... The Accuser has permission to prosecute throughout the year, except on Yom Kippur.'"

[85] **Tikkunei Zohar, Tikkun 13**: 'Shemini Atzeres is a festival in its own right. In it there is an outflowing spring of Torah, to water the tree that is planted in the Garden. Its roots and branches are like the circle of the earth, in which all the festivals are celebrated.'

[86] **Tikkunei Zohar 29b:3**: "Shemini Atzeres is a festival in its own right. Within it is the wellspring of Torah, watering the tree planted in the garden. Its roots and branches are like the circle of the earth, around which all the festivals revolve."

[87] **Ta'anit 6a**: 'Our Sages taught: 'Yoreh'—because it instructs people to plaster their roofs, to bring their produce indoors, and to make all the other necessary arrangements. Another explanation: because it saturates the earth and waters it down to the depths. Another: because it falls gently and not with force.'"

[88] **Taanit 6a:2-5**: "The Sages taught: Yoreh, the early rain, is so called because it instructs people to plaster their roofs, bring their produce inside, and attend to all their needs. Another explanation: It saturates the earth and waters it down to the deep, as it says, 'Saturate its furrows, settle its ridges; soften it with showers; bless its growth.' Another explanation: Yoreh descends gently rather than in fury. Or does yoreh mean rain that strips off fruit, washes away seeds, and sweeps away trees? Scripture therefore mentions malkosh, the late rain: Just as malkosh brings blessing, so yoreh brings blessing. Or does malkosh mean rain that topples houses, breaks trees, and brings up destructive locusts? Scripture therefore mentions yoreh: Just as yoreh brings blessing, so malkosh brings blessing. How do we know that yoreh itself brings blessing? It is written, 'Children of Zion, rejoice and be glad in the Lord your God, for He has given you the early rain in righteousness, and brought down rain for you, early rain and late rain in the first month.' The Sages taught: Yoreh falls in Mar Cheshvan and malkosh in Nisan. Do you say yoreh in Mar Cheshvan and malkosh in Nisan, or perhaps yoreh in Tishrei and malkosh in Iyar? Scripture teaches, 'In its season.'"

people to plaster, etc., וּמְרַמֵּז גַּם כֵּן שֶׁמּוֹרֶה אֶת הַבְּרִיּוֹת — **and it also alludes to instructing people** לְקַבֵּל עוֹל וְכֵן כָּתַב הַמַּגִּיד מִקָּאזְנִיץ זְכֶר צַדִּיק וְקָדוֹשׁ. תּוֹרָה בֶּאֱמֶת — **to take upon themselves the yoke of Torah in truth.**

דְּמַה שֶׁכָּתוּב בְּפֶרֶק קָמָא לְבָרְכָה לְחַיֵּי הָעוֹלָם הַבָּא, דְּתַעֲנִית בְּמַעֲלַת יוֹם הַגְּשָׁמִים — **And so wrote the Maggid of Kozhnitz of blessed memory, that what is stated in the first chapter of Ta'anit regarding the stature of the day of rain** קָאֵי עַל שְׁמִינִי עֲצֶרֶת שֶׁהוּא נְבִיעוּ דְּאוֹרַיְיתָא — **refers to Shemini Atzeret, which is the wellspring of Torah** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁנִּתְבָּאֵר בְּרֵאשִׁית מַאֲמָר ט). — **(as explained in Bereishit, Discourse 9).**

וְזֶה שֶׁאָמַר: שָׁמַּן אוֹתָהּ שָׁעָה עַד שֶׁבָּנָה שְׁלֹמֹה בֵּית הַמִּקְדָּשׁ — **And this is what it meant: that from that hour until Solomon built the Temple** הָיוּ עוֹשִׁין אַרְבָּעִים יוֹם גְּשָׁמִים לְשֵׁם מֵי הַמַּבּוּל, — **they had forty days of rains marking the waters of the Flood;** וְהַיְינוּ שֶׁאִם יִזְכּוּ – יוּקְבְּעוּ דִּבְרֵי תוֹרָה בְּלִבָּם בְּהִתְחַדְּשׁוּת — **namely, that if they merit— words of Torah become fixed in their hearts with renewal** בְּאַרְבָּעִים יוֹם מִיּוֹם שְׁמִינִי עֲצֶרֶת, שֶׁהוּא נְבִיעוּ דְּאוֹרַיְיתָא; — **during the forty days from Shemini Atzeret, which is the wellspring of Torah;** וְאִם לֹא יִזְכּוּ חַס וְשָׁלוֹם – יִהְיֶה מֵי מַבּוּל, — **and if they do not merit, Heaven forbid, it turns into waters of flood,** עַד שֶׁבָּנָה שְׁלֹמֹה בֵּית הַמִּקְדָּשׁ, — **until Solomon built the Holy Temple,** וּכְתִיב: "כִּי מִצִּיּוֹן תֵּצֵא תוֹרָה וּדְבַר הַשֵּׁם מִירוּשָׁלָם",[89] — **and it is written: 'For out of Zion shall go forth Torah, and the word of Hashem from Jerusalem',** "דְּבַר הַשֵּׁם" – זוֹ הֲלָכָה, כְּמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר (שַׁבָּת קלח:);[90] — **'the word of Hashem'—this is Halakhah, as stated (Shabbat 138b);** וְשָׁם הָיָה לִשְׁכַּת הַגָּזִית שֶׁמִּמֶּנּוּ יוֹצְאָה תּוֹרָה לְכָל יִשְׂרָאֵל (סַנְהֶדְרִין פו:);[91] — **and there sat the Chamber of Hewn Stone whence Torah issued to all Israel (Sanhedrin 86b);** וְאָז נִתְגַּלָּה לִשְׁלֹמֹה הַמֶּלֶךְ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם כָּל חָכְמָה תַּחְתָּאָה דְּתוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה – חָכְמַת שְׁלֹמֹה, — **and then there was revealed to King Solomon all lower wisdom of the Oral Torah—the wisdom of Solomon,** וּבִקֵּשׁ רַחֲמִים עֲלֵיהֶם וּפָסְקוּ, — **and he prayed for mercy upon them and they ceased,** שֶׁיִּהְיֶה לְגִשְׁמֵי בְּרָכָה, הַשְׁפָּעָה בִּדְבְרֵי תוֹרָה. — **transforming into rains of blessing, an influx of Torah.**

וְזֶה שֶׁאָמְרוּ: חֲכְמֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל מוֹנִין לַמַּבּוּל כְּרַבִּי אֱלִיעֶזֶר,[92] — **And this is what they said: the Sages reckon for the Flood according to Rabbi Eliezer,** מִכָּל מָקוֹם זְמַן שֶׁהֵם מֵי הַמַּבּוּל כְּשֶׁזּוֹכִין וְנַעֲשִׂים גִּשְׁמֵי בְּרָכָה, הַשְׁפָּעַת דִּבְרֵי תוֹרָה, — **nonetheless the season for the influx of Torah,** שֶׁאַף שֶׁהָעוֹלָם נִבְרָא בְּנִיסָן, — **for even though the physical world was created in Nisan,** הַשְׁפָּעָה בִּנְבִיעוּ דְּאוֹרַיְיתָא, — **which are the Flood waters when merited and transformed into rains of blessing,** וְעַל זֶה הַזְּמַן בְּחֶשְׁוָן כִּרְבִּי אֱלִיעֶזֶר. — **an influx from the wellspring of Torah,** **is fixed in Cheshvan according to Rabbi Eliezer.**

Restraint makes a vessel for rain to become blessing

וְהַזְּמַן בְּחֹדֶשׁ מַרְחֶשְׁוָן לְקַבֵּל עָלָיו עוֹל תּוֹרָה בֶּאֱמֶת,[93, 94] — **And the task in the month of Marcheshvan is to assume the yoke of Torah in truth;** וְעִיקַּר עוֹל תּוֹרָה הוּא בְּלִימוּד תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה — **and the essence of the yoke of Torah**

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[89] **Isaiah 2:3**: "Many peoples will go and say: 'Come, let us go up to the mountain of Hashem, to the house of the God of Yaakov. He will teach us of His ways, and we will walk in His paths.' For Torah will go forth from Zion, and the word of Hashem from Jerusalem."

[90] **Shabbat 138b:11**: "'The word of the Lord' means halachah; 'the word of the Lord' means the appointed end of exile; 'the word of the Lord' means prophecy."

[91] **Sanhedrin 86b:18**: "If the lower courts do not know the answer, both parties come to the Great Court in the Chamber of Hewn Stone, from which Torah goes forth to all Israel, as it says, 'From that place which the Lord will choose.' If the elder returns to his town and continues studying and teaching as he previously did, he is exempt from punishment. But if he rules that people should act against the Great Court's decision, he is liable, as it says, 'The man who acts willfully.' He is liable only when he issues a ruling for practical action."

[92] **Rosh Hashanah 11b, recalled later in Marcheshvan**: 'The Sages of Israel reckon the Flood according to Rabbi Eliezer, and the seasons according to Rabbi Yehoshua.'

[93] **Pirkei Avot 3:5**: 'Rabbi Nechunyah ben HaKanah says: Whoever takes upon himself the yoke of Torah has the yoke of government and the yoke of worldly occupation removed from him. Whoever casts off the yoke of Torah has the yoke of government and the yoke of worldly occupation imposed upon him.'

[94] **Sod Yesharim, Sukkot 55:2**: "From His side, the blessed God constantly pours forth every kind of blessing and good kindness, as it says, 'The earth is full of the Lord's kindness.' The person, however, may lack a vessel to receive it, for the principal matter depends on the person's vessel. If a person restrains himself in receiving God's abundance, avoiding unbounded expansion with it and instead entrusting it to God, then God correspondingly limits His abundance so that it does not spread beyond the person's vessel; consequently it is blessing. Thus the Sages ask why rain is called an expression of might: because it descends with force. God limits it so that it goes only where needed. But if a person expands himself with God's abundance and does not recognize that God gave it to him, the abundance likewise spreads into wilderness and desolation, into alien places, and consequently becomes a curse. Even concerning the Flood generation, the Midrash says that if they had returned, the rain would have been rain of blessing. Because they expanded themselves without restraint in His abundance, God correspondingly expanded His abundance, and it became rain of curse. Yet from God's side, God forbid, no curse ever arises, only blessing."
Sod Yesharim supplies a mechanism for the change from destructive waters to useful rain. Restraint and recognition of the Giver make the recipient capable of receiving abundance within a fitting measure. This illuminates why Rav Tzadok joins the promise of rain to the yoke and exertion of Torah: disciplined reception gives the flow a form in which it can become blessing.

is in the study of the Oral Torah, שֶׁיֵּשׁ בָּהּ צַעַר גָּדוֹל וְיִדּוּד שֵׁינָה, **— which entails great exertion and sleepless nights,** וּמִי שֶׁאוֹהֵב עוֹשֶׁר וְתַעֲנוּג אֵינוֹ יָכוֹל לִלְמוֹד תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה, **— and one who covets wealth and pleasure cannot master the Oral Torah,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר (תַּנְחוּמָא נֹחַ ג).[95] **— as is stated (Tanchuma, Noach 3).** וּתְנַן: "כָּל הַמְקַבֵּל עָלָיו עוֹל תּוֹרָה – מַעֲבִירִין מִמֶּנּוּ עוֹל מַלְכוּת וְעוֹל דֶּרֶךְ אֶרֶץ"; **— And we learned: 'Whoever accepts upon himself the yoke of Torah—they remove from him, etc.';** וְעַל כֵּן רוֹב הַגְּזֵירוֹת בְּחֹדֶשׁ זֶה, **— and therefore most harsh decrees threaten in this month,** כְּדֵי שֶׁיְּקַבְּלוּ הַתּוֹרָה בֶּאֱמֶת, **— so that people will embrace the Torah in truth;** וְיִהְיוּ הַמַּיִם גְּשָׁמֵי בְרָכָה מִנְּבִיעוּ דְּאוֹרַיְתָא, כָּאָמוּר: **— and the waters will become rains of blessing from the wellspring of Torah, as stated.**

In Sefer Yetzirah: בְּסֵפֶר יְצִירָה: "הִמְלִיךְ אוֹת נו"ן בְּרֵיחַ וְכוּלֵי וְחֶשְׁוָן בַּשָּׁנָה וְדַקִּין בַּנֶּפֶשׁ וְכוּלֵי".[96] **— "He made the letter Nun rule over smell, etc., and Cheshvan in the year, and the small intestines in the person, etc."** וּבְפֵירוּשׁ הָרַאֲבַ"ד זִכְרוֹנוֹ לִבְרָכָה, **— And in the commentary of the Ra'avad of blessed memory,** כְּשֶׁחָשַׁב שְׁנֵים עָשָׂר כֹּחוֹת כְּנֶגֶד שְׁנֵים עָשָׂר שִׁבְטִים, **— when he correlated twelve faculties against twelve tribes,** חָשַׁב רֵיחַ כְּנֶגֶד יוֹסֵף, **— he linked smell with Joseph,** שֶׁבְּשָׁעָה שֶׁעָמַד בְּנִסָּיוֹן יָצָא רֵיחוֹ מִסּוֹף הָעוֹלָם וְעַד סוֹפוֹ, עַיֵּין שָׁם, **— for when he withstood temptation his fragrance spread from one end of the world to the other, see there,** וְלֹא בֵּאֵר הַשּׁוֹרֶשׁ. **— yet he did not explain the underlying root.** וְנִרְאֶה עַל פִּי מַה שֶּׁנֶּאֱמַר: "וַהֲרִיחוֹ בְּיִרְאַת ה'",[97] **— And it appears based on the verse: 'And he shall discern through the fear of Hashem,'** וּבְיוֹסֵף כְּתִיב: "אֶת הָאֱלֹהִים אֲנִי יָרֵא". **— and regarding Joseph it is written: 'I fear God.'**[98,99] **— And this is what the Gemara stated (Eruvin 21b):** וְזֶה שֶׁאָמְרוּ בַּגְּמָרָא (עֵירוּבִין כא:): "'דּוּדָאִים נָתְנוּ רֵיחַ' – אֵלּוּ בַּחוּרֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל שֶׁלֹּא טָעֲמוּ טַעַם חֵטְא". **— 'The mandrakes yield fragrance'—these are the young men of Israel who have not tasted the flavor of sin."** וּמִלְּשׁוֹן "בַּחוּרֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל" נִרְאֶה דְּקָאֵי עַל פְּגָם זֶה שֶׁהַיְלְדוּת וְהַבַּחֲרוּת גּוֹרֵם; **— And from the phrase 'young men of Israel' it indicates this specific blemish (immorality) — which childhood and youth tend to cause;** וְכֵן אִיתָא בַּגְּמָרָא סוֹטָה (מט.):[100,101] "מוֹרְחָנָא רֵיחָא דַּחֲנִינְתָא, אֲמַר לֵיהּ: בְּנִי, **— and so it is brought in the Gemara, Sotah (49a):** טָהֳרָה יֵשׁ בָּךְ". **— 'I smell the scent of hanunita (a fragrant fruit)'; he said to him: 'My son, you possess purity.'** וְהוּא גַּם כֵּן עַל פִּי מַה שֶּׁנֶּאֱמַר: "וַהֲרִיחוֹ בְּיִרְאַת ה'", **— And this too is based upon: 'And he shall discern through the fear of Hashem,'** וּכְתִיב: "יִרְאַת ה' טְהוֹרָה עוֹמֶדֶת לָעַד". **— and it is written: 'The fear of Hashem is pure, enduring forever.'** וּכְשֶׁיֵּשׁ לוֹ חוּשׁ הָרֵיחַ בִּשְׁלֵימוּת **— And when one possesses the olfactory sense in perfection,** מוֹרֶה שֶׁיֵּשׁ בּוֹ יִרְאָה וְטָהֳרָה, **— it demonstrates that he possesses fear of God and purity,** וְעַל כֵּן נֶאֱמַר עַל הַטְּהוֹרִים מִפִּקָּם זֶה: "הַדּוּדָאִים נָתְנוּ רֵיחַ".[102] **— and therefore it was declared concerning those**

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[95] **Midrash Tanchuma, Noach 3:4**: “The Israelites did not accept the Torah until the Holy One, blessed be He, arched the mountain over them like a vessel, as it is said: And they stood beneath the mountain (Exod. 19:17). R. Dimi the son of Hama stated that the Holy One, blessed be He, told Israel: If you accept the Torah, well and good; but if not, your grave will be there. If you should say that He arched the mountain over them because of the Written Law, isn’t it true that as soon as He said to them, “Will you accept the Torah?” they all responded, “We will do and hear,” because the Written Law was brief and required no striving and suffering, but rather He threatened them because of the Oral Law. After all, it contains the detailed explanations of the commandments, both simple and difficult, and it is as severe as death, and as jealous as Sheol. One does not study the Oral Law unless he loves the Holy One, blessed be He, with all his heart, with all his soul, and with all his might, as it is said: And thou shalt love the Lord thy God with all thy heart, with all thy soul, and with all thy might (Deut. 6:5).”

[96] **Sefer Yetzirah, Gra Version 5:9 — complete relevant comparison**: ‘He made the letter nun king over scent and bound a crown to it, and combined them one with the other; and with them He formed Scorpio in the world, Cheshvan in the year, and the intestines in the person, male and female. He made the letter samekh king over sleep, bound a crown to it, and combined them; and with them He formed Sagittarius in the world, Kislev in the year, and the stomach in the person, male and female.’

[97] **Isaiah 11:3**: ‘He will be imbued with the fear of Hashem; he will not judge by what his eyes see, and he will not decide by what his ears hear.’

[98] **Eruvin 21b, quoting Song of Songs 7:14**: ‘The mandrakes give forth fragrance: these are the young men of Israel who have not tasted the taste of sin.’

[99] **Eruvin 21b**: “Rava expounded: What is meant by ‘The mandrakes have given forth fragrance’? These are the young men of Israel who have not tasted the taste of sin.”

[100] **Sotah 49a — the scent of purity**: ‘From the time Rabbi Meir died, the composers of parables ceased ... Purity took away taste and fragrance.” Rav Huna found a fragrant date, took it, and wrapped it in his cloth. Rabbah his son came and said: “I smell the fragrance of the fragrant date.” Rav Huna said: “My son, there is purity in you,” and gave it to him. Meanwhile, his grandson Abba arrived; Rabbah took it and gave it to him. Rav Huna said: “My son, you have gladdened my heart and set my teeth on edge.”’

[101] **Sotah 49a:10**: “Rav Huna found a fragrant hinunita date, took it, and wrapped it in his kerchief. His son Rabbah came and said to him: ‘I smell the fragrance of hinunita.’ He said: ‘My son, you have purity in you,’ and gave it to him. Meanwhile Abba, Rabbah’s son, came; Rabbah took it and gave it to him. Rav Huna said: ‘My son, you have gladdened my heart and blunted my teeth.’ This is what people say: A father’s love is for his children; the children’s love is for their own children.”

[102] **Peri Tzadik, Bo 4:1**: “This accords with what was said (Eruvin 21b): “The mandrakes have given fragrance”—these

untainted by this blemish: 'The mandrakes yield fragrance.' ,"הַמְלִיךְ אוֹת נוּ״ן בְּרֵיחַ" וְאָמַר — **And it said, 'He made the letter Nun rule over smell,'** :(חֵלֶק ב, צא עַמּוּד א) עַל פִּי מַה שֶׁכָּתוּב בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ[103, 104] — **based on what is written in the holy Zohar (Part II, 91a):** ,"נוּ״ן – רָזָא לְמִדְחַל מִקּוּדְשָׁא בְּרִיךְ הוּא וְכוּלֵי" — **'The letter Nun is the mystery of fearing the Holy One, etc.,** ".דְּרָזָא דִּילֵיהּ הֵ״א תַּתָּאָה" — **for its esoteric mystery is the lower Hei.'** ,וְהַשֵּׁם גֶּדֶד מִדַּת מַלְכוּת הוּא שֵׁם אֲדנוּת — **And the Divine Name corresponding to Malchut is the Name Adonai,** ,שֶׁמּוֹרֶה עַל יִרְאָה, כְּמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ (חֵלֶק ג, יא עַמּוּד ב)[105, 106] — **as stated in the holy Zohar (Part III, 11b),** ".וְאִם אֲדוֹנִים אָנִי אַיֵּה מוֹרָאִי" :כְּמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר — **as is said: 'And if I be a Master, where is My fear?'** וְכֵן מִדַּת מַלְכוּת מוֹרָה עַל יִרְאָה: — **So too the attribute of Malchut points to awe:** שַׁבָּת דְּעָרֶב כְּמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר בַּזֹּהַר, שַׁבָּת אִיהִי יִרְאָה וְשַׁרְיָא בָּהּ, — **the Sabbath of Friday evening is awe, and awe rests within her,** הַקָּדוֹשׁ (חֵלֶק א, ה עַמּוּד ב).[107, 108] — **as stated in the holy Zohar (Part I, 5b).** וְהַשַּׁיָּכוּת לְחֹדֶשׁ זֶה, — **And the connection to this month is,** שֶׁהָעֵסֶק בּוֹ לְקַבֵּל עָלָיו עוֹל תּוֹרָה בֶּאֱמֶת, — **that the labor therein is to accept the yoke of Torah in truth,** שֶׁעַל יְדֵי זֶה מַעֲבִירִין מִמֶּנּוּ וְכוּלֵי, כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמַרְנוּ. — **whereby they remove from him worldly burdens, as we said.** וְהַיְינוּ שֶׁיּוּקְבְּעוּ הַדִּבְרֵי תוֹרָה דִּשְׁמִינִי עֲצֶרֶת — **Namely, that the Torah of Shemini Atzeret,** ,בַּלֵּב – נְבִיעוּ דְּאוֹרַיְיתָא – — — **—the wellspring of Torah—be ingrained in the heart,** .וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמַרְנוּ — **as we explained.**

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are the young men of Israel who have not tasted sin. We have already said that the expression "young men of Israel" indicates that "sin" here means a blemish of the covenant, to which youth and early life give rise. Since they have not tasted this sin, they give a good fragrance. Conversely, one who causes such a blemish, Heaven forbid, has a repulsive odor. Hence the inclination toward desire is called "this repulsive one," for it is repellent and repulsive, as was said (Shabbat 151a), "A woman is a skin-bottle," etc. Concerning this they said (Sukkah 52b): "If this repulsive one encounters you, draw him to the study hall"—draw the desire so that it becomes delight in the teaching and love of Torah, as it will be in the future, as stated in Midrash HaNe'elam (Zohar I, 138a)."

[103] **Zohar II 91a — full repeated citation, Zohar, Yitro 30:510**: 'Nun is the secret of fearing the Holy One, blessed be He, and of knowing that judgment and a Judge exist, that there is a good reward for the righteous and retribution for the wicked, because its secret is the lower hei." The preceding explanation unites the letters of Anochi: after the elimination of the evil inclination at the revelation of "I am Hashem your God," aleph symbolizes unification of the holy Name, while nun denotes reverence and accountability.'

[104] **Zohar, Yitro 30:505-517**: 'In the Zohar (Yitro II 91a), the letter Nun inside the word Anokhi is expounded: 'The letter Nun is the mystery of revering the Holy One, blessed be He, and knowing that there is judgment and there is a Judge, and that there is good reward for the righteous and retribution for the wicked—because its esoteric mystery is the lower Hei (Malkhut).'"'

[105] **Zohar, Vayikra 24:176**: "The ninth is Shaddai, who said to the world, "Enough," for "enough" means sufficiency. Sufficiency comes into the world only from the righteous one, who is the foundation of the world, who said to the world, "Enough." The tenth is Adonai, for the law of the kingdom is indeed law. This is to wage the King's battles in the world. This is the lower might, and this is righteousness."

[106] **Zohar, Vayikra 24:170-25:179**: 'In the Zohar (Vayikra III 11b), the Divine Name Adonai is identified as the Name corresponding to the Sefirah of Malkhut, through which awe of Heaven ('If I am a Master, where is My fear?' Malachi 1:6) and royal sovereignty are revealed in the lower world."'

[107] **Zohar I 5b**: 'There remained another Shabbos that had not been mentioned, and it stood in longing. It said before Him: 'Master of the world, from the day You made me I have been called Shabbos, but no day exists without a night.' He said to her: 'My daughter, you are Shabbos and I call you Shabbos; but I shall crown you with an even higher crown.' A proclamation went forth: 'You shall revere My sanctuary'—this is the Shabbos of Friday evening, which is awe, and awe dwells within her. And who is He? It is the Holy One, blessed be He, Who includes all and says, 'I am Hashem.' ... 'My Shabboses' signifies the encompassing circle and the inner square; they are two, corresponding to two sanctifications mentioned by us."'

[108] **Zohar, Introduction 12:82**: "There was still one Sabbath left unmentioned. Feeling humiliated, she pleaded before the Creator, saying, "O Lord of the universe, since the time when Thou didst create me, I have been called merely 'day of Sabbath', but surely a day must have for companion a night." Said the Lord to her, "O my daughter, thou art Sabbath, and Sabbath I will call thee. But I will confer on thee an even more glorious crown." He then made proclamation, "And ye shall fear my sanctuary" (Ibid.). This is a reference to the Sabbath of the eve of Sabbath, which inspires fear, and upon which fear rests. And it is the Holy One, blessed be He, Himself who identified Himself with her, saying "I am the Lord" (Ibid.). I have further heard' (continued the stranger) 'the following exposition from my father. He stressed the particle eth as signifying the limit of the Sabbath walk. "My Sabbaths," he said, denotes the circle and the square within, and corresponding to these two the sanctification recital consists of two parts, one the verses Genesis 2, 1-3, commencing Vaikhulu (and were completed) and the other the sanctification proper (Kiddush). Vaikhulu contains thirty-five words, and the Kiddush contains thirty five words, making together seventy, corresponding to the seventy names of the Holy One, blessed be He, by which the congregation of Israel is crowned."

Awe preserves Torah by giving it authority over conduct

Awe is the preserving restraint within spiritual growth

"חַיֶּיכֶם, כָּל וְאִיתָא (מִדְרָשׁ רַבָּה בְּרָכָה יא, ו)[109,110,111] — **And it is brought (Midrash Rabbah, Berakhah 11:6):** חָכְמָה וְכָל הַתּוֹרָה כָּל הַמְחֻכְמָה — **'By your lives, all wisdom and the entire Torah is one simple matter:** כָּל מִי שֶׁמִּתְיָרֵא אוֹתִי וְעוֹשֶׂה דִּבְרֵי תוֹרָה, וְכָל חָכְמָה כָּל הַתּוֹרָה בְּלִבּוֹ. — **whoever fears Me and performs the words of Torah, all wisdom and the entire Torah is in his heart.'** מִנַּיִן? שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: 'רֵאשִׁית חָכְמָה יִרְאַת הַשֵּׁם, שֵׂכֶל טוֹב לְכָל עֹשֵׂיהֶם',[112] — **Whence? For it is said: 'The beginning of wisdom is the fear of Hashem, good understanding to all who do them';** 'יִרְאַת הַשֵּׁם טְהוֹרָה עוֹמֶדֶת לָעַד', — **'The fear of Hashem is pure, enduring forever';** מַבִּיא שְׁלֹשָׁה פְּסוּקִים אֵלּוּ, 'הֵן יִרְאַת אֲדֹנָי הִיא חָכְמָה'". — **'Behold, the fear of the Lord, that is wisdom.'** — **He cites these three verses,** פְּעִיקַּר הַחָכְמָה הִיא הַיִּרְאָה — **to prove that the essence of wisdom is fear of God,** וְלַעֲשׂוֹת הַדִּבְרֵי תוֹרָה, — **and to fulfill the words of Torah,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר בַּגְּמָרָא (בְּרָכוֹת יז.):[113,114] — **as stated in the Gemara (Berakhot 17a):** – '"לִלּוֹמְדֵיהֶם' לֹא נֶאֱמַר, אֶלָּא 'לְעֹשֵׂיהֶם'" — **'To those who study them' is not said, but 'to those who do them'—** לְעוֹשִׂים לִשְׁמָהּ, — **to those who act for the sake of Torah itself (lishmah),** שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: 'שֵׂכֶל טוֹב לְכָל עֹשֵׂיהֶם'". — **as it is said: 'A good understanding have all those who do them.'** וְהֵבִיא מַה שֶּׁעַל "יִרְאַת הַשֵּׁם טְהוֹרָה עוֹמֶדֶת לָעַד",[115] — **And he cites 'The fear of Hashem is pure, enduring forever',** יְדֵי הַיִּרְאָה יוּקְבָּעוּ הַדִּבְרֵי תוֹרָה לְעוֹלְמֵי עַד, — **for through awe the words of Torah become fixed for all eternity,**

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[109] **Devarim Rabbah 11:6**: 'By your lives, all wisdom and the whole Torah are one simple matter: whoever fears Me and performs the words of Torah—all wisdom and the whole Torah are in his heart.'

[110] **Kometz HaMinchah 2:57:1**: "Love of Torah is the level of Isaac, for it involves accepting a yoke, as stated in Berakhot concerning 'Our leaders are burdened': it resembles afflictions. Sanhedrin speaks of giving him a taste of commandments and afflictions. It is called 'the yoke of Torah,' like 'the yoke of the kingdom of Heaven,' which is awe. Torah has the same numerical value as yirat, 'fear of,' and Scripture calls it 'The fear of the Lord is pure, enduring forever.' The Sages continually say, 'Moses received from the mouth of the Power,' because Torah comes from the side of strength. Likewise, 'Happy is the person who is always afraid' is said concerning Torah, the level of 'the fear of Isaac.' This is why the Sages say that the Holy One brought down the dew of resurrection at the giving of Torah: resurrection comes from the side of strength, and is therefore mentioned in the blessing of divine might. Likewise, Torah limits a person's conduct and manner of walking, in accordance with the attribute of strength."
Kometz gives the awe described in Mar Cheshvan a practical meaning: accepting Torah's authority places limits on conduct. This connects the heart's enduring wisdom with the earlier requirement to perform Torah for its own sake. Citation clarification: the displayed Hebrew edition places a Ta'anit 5a locator beside the dew at Sinai; the passage describing that revival is Shabbat 88b. The Hebrew quotation is preserved, and the clarified source is distinguished from that inherited locator.

[111] **Beit Yaakov on Torah, Vayera 12:5**: "This is like the Talmud's teaching on 'The fear of the Lord is his storehouse': a person told his agent, 'Bring a kor of wheat up to the attic.' He brought it up, and the owner asked, 'Did you mix a kav of humton into it?' This is salty earth, through which the grain is preserved. Awe is like the action of salt in this world. The holy Ari explains that a person desires food because foods in the world seek to attach themselves to the human form, to be clarified, and they awaken the person's desire for them. 'A salt land that cannot be sown and does not produce' requires restraint in a person; through salty earth the grain too is preserved. Likewise, through the restraints a person places upon himself, the existence of the human form is preserved. The principal restraint is circumcision. Therefore, when Abraham our father fulfilled the commandment of circumcision, he brought merit to all Israel after him, so that they could receive all the powers of good found in this world and all the powers of holiness. They would not be harried and swallowed up under the rule of idolaters, but would 'bring what they have swallowed out of their mouths.'"
Beit Yaakov explains permanence through the image of grain and its preservative. Restraint does not produce the grain, yet it enables the good already received to endure. The passage then connects that restraint to circumcision and the capacity to receive holiness without being swallowed into another power. It therefore illuminates both Rav Tzadok's claim that awe preserves Torah and the adjoining discussion of covenant and servitude.

[112] **Psalms 111:10**: 'The beginning of wisdom is the fear of Hashem; good understanding belongs to all who practice them; His praise endures forever.'

[113] **Berakhot 17a, citing Psalms 111:10**: 'The purpose of wisdom is repentance and good deeds. ... As it is said, 'The beginning of wisdom is the fear of Hashem; a good understanding belongs to all those who do them.' It does not say 'those who do,' but rather 'those who do them'—those who act for its own sake, and not those who act without that intention." The distinction in the Gemara is between la-osim and la-oseihem; Rav Tzadok restates its practical emphasis as doing rather than merely studying.'

[114] **Berakhot 17a**: 'Rava was wont to say: The objective of Torah wisdom is to achieve repentance and good deeds; that one should not read the Torah and study mishna and become arrogant and spurn his father and his mother and his teacher and one who is greater than he in wisdom or in the number of students who study before him, as it is stated: "The beginning of wisdom is fear of the Lord, a good understanding have all who fulfill them" (Psalms 111:10). It is not stated simply: All who fulfill, but rather: All who fulfill them, those who perform these actions as they ought to be performed, meaning those who do such deeds for their own sake, for the sake of the deeds themselves, not those who do them not for their own sake. Rava continued: One who does them not for their own sake, it would have been preferable for him had he not been created.'

[115] **Psalms 19:10**: 'The fear of Hashem is pure, enduring forever; the judgments of Hashem are truth, righteous altogether.'

כֵּינָן שֶׁהַיִּרְאָה עוֹמֶדֶת לָעַד — **since fear of God endures forever,** וְיִרְאַת הַשֵּׁם הוּא חָכְמָה — **and the fear of Hashem is wisdom.** וּלְפִיכָךְ אָמַר: — **Therefore it said:** "הִמְלִיךְ אוֹת נו"ן בְּרֵיחַ וְחָשְׁוָן בַּשָּׁנָה". — **'He made the letter Nun rule over smell, and Cheshvan in the year.'** וְחֹדֶשׁ זֶה הָיָה הַמַּבּוּל, — **And in this month the Flood occurred,** וְאִיתָא בַּגְּמָרָא (נִדָּה יג:)[116, 117] — **and it is taught in the Gemara (Niddah 13b)** עַל פְּגָם הַבְּרִית: — **regarding the blemish of the Covenant:** "בְּנֵי מַבּוּל נִינְוֵה". — **'they are offspring of the Flood.'** וְחֹדֶשׁ זֶה הַזְּמַן לְתַקֵּן פְּגַם הַמַּבּוּל, — **And this month is the season to rectify the blemish of the Flood;** וְזֶה הַפְּגָם גּוֹרֵם הָעַבְדוּת, — **and this specific defect causes servitude,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר (בְּרֵאשִׁית רַבָּה פָּרָשָׁה פד):[118, 119] — **as stated (Bereishit Rabbah, Parashah 84):** נֵלֵךְ וְנִתְפּוֹס דַּרְכּוֹ שֶׁל עוֹלָם; — **'Let us go and follow the way of the world;** כְּנַעַן שֶׁחָטָא, לֹא לְעֶבֶד נִתְקַלֵּל וְכוּלֵי?". — **Canaan who sinned, was he not cursed to be a slave, etc.?'** וּפְגַם כְּנַעַן הוּא שֶׁנּוֹלַד מֵחָם, — **And the blemish of Canaan stems from his birth from Ham,** דְּאִיתָא בַּגְּמָרָא (סַנְהֶדְרִין ע.):[120] — **for it is taught in the Gemara (Sanhedrin 70a):** חַד אָמַר: רָבָעוֹ; — **one authority says he sodomized him;** וְשִׁמֵּשׁ בְּתֵיבָה (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב שָׁם קח:),[121] וְזֶה הָיָה גַּם כֵּן פְּגַם הַבְּרִית — **and he cohabited in the Ark (as written there, 108b),** כֵּינָן שֶׁנֶּאֱסַר לָהֶם. — **since marital relations were forbidden to them.** וְיָצָא מִמֶּנּוּ כְּנַעַן וְנִתְקַלֵּל לְעֶבֶד, — **And from him issued Canaan, cursed to be a slave,** שֶׁחָטָא זֶה גּוֹרֵם הָעַבְדוּת. — **for this sin precipitates enslavement.**

Joseph's trial clarifies what his brothers could only suspect

וְהַשְּׁבָטִים חָשְׁדוּ אֶת יוֹסֵף שֶׁאֵינוֹ נָקִי מִפְּגָם זֶה,[122] — **And the tribes suspected Joseph of not being free of this flaw,** מִפְּנֵי שֶׁאָמַר עֲלֵיהֶם שֶׁהֵם נוֹשְׂאִים עֵינֵיהֶם בִּבְנוֹת הָאָרֶץ, — **because he alleged that they cast eyes on the daughters of the land,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בְּבְרֵאשִׁית רַבָּה; — **as written in Bereishit Rabbah;** וְהֵם יָדְעוּ בְּעַצְמָם שֶׁהֵם נְקִיִּים בָּזֶה, — **and they knew within themselves that they were pure in this,** וְסָבְרוּ שֶׁהוּא פָּגוּם בָּזֶה, — **and presumed that**

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[116] **Niddah 13b**: 'Rabbi Eliezer says: Anyone who holds his organ when he urinates is as though he brings a flood upon the world… for they emit seed in vain, and concerning those who blemish the covenant of procreation the Gemara states: 'These are the children of the Flood.''

[117] **Niddah 13b**: 'Some say that Rabbi Ami says: With regard to anyone who brings himself into a state of arousal, they do not bring him within the boundary of the Holy One, Blessed be He. The proof is that it is written here, with regard to Onan, son of Judah: "And the thing that he did was evil in the eyes of the Lord, and He slew him also" (Genesis 38:10), and it is written there: "For You are not a God who has pleasure in wickedness; evil shall not sojourn with You. The boasters shall not stand in Your sight…But as for me, in the abundance of Your kindness will I come into Your house; I will bow down toward Your holy Temple in fear of You" (Psalms 5:5–8). This demonstrates that whoever does evil, like Onan, shall not sojourn with God.'

[118] **Bereshit Rabbah 84:17 — the brothers' reasoning about Canaan**: 'And they sat down to eat bread." Rabbi Achva bar Zeira said: The transgression of the tribes is remembered forever. "And they raised their eyes and saw": Rabbi Abba bar Kahana said: What did the Holy One arrange for that righteous one at that moment? Sacks filled with aromatic spices, so that the wind would carry the fragrance toward him ... "Come, let us sell him to the Ishmaelites." They said: "Let us follow the customary course of the world: did not Canaan sin and become cursed to slavery? So too with this one; come and let us sell him to the Ishmaelites." His brothers agreed.'

[119] **Bereshit Rabbah 84:17** (excerpt): "'Come, let us sell him to the Ishmaelites' (Genesis 37:27). They said: Let us follow the customary course of the world. Did not Canaan sin and become cursed to slavery? So too with this one: 'Come, let us sell him to the Ishmaelites.' 'His brothers listened.'"

[120] **Sanhedrin 70a**: 'Rav and Shmuel disagreed: one said that he castrated him, and the other said that he sexually violated him. According to the view that he castrated him: because he damaged him in respect of the fourth son, Noach cursed his fourth son. According to the view that he violated him, the interpretation derives from 'he saw' said here of Cham and 'he saw' said there of Shechem."'

[121] **Sanhedrin 108b**: 'Our Rabbis taught: Three engaged in intercourse in the Ark, and all three were punished: the dog, the raven, and Cham. The dog became bound; the raven spat; and Cham was afflicted in his skin.'

[122] **Mei HaShiloach, Volume I, Genesis, Vayeshev 5**: "'Come, let us sell him to the Ishmaelites.' The tribes initially judged Joseph liable to death because he brought an evil report about them to their father. In their eyes this was a sin at the root of his life, God forbid: he was separating them from their father, and appeared to them to be separating the unity of the Holy One with the congregation of Israel. Jacob was then the righteous foundation of the world, upon whom the world rested, representing God in this world, and they comprised all Israel. They were all included in the word 'one' in the Shema: aleph corresponded to Jacob, het to the eight sons of the principal wives, and dalet to the four sons of the handmaids. In their judgment, Joseph wished to separate this unity. But Judah wisely said that the judgment was not settled: perhaps Joseph was good, and they were the ones mistaken about him. He therefore advised them to sell him, meaning: let us not do anything to him with our own hands; let the blessed God clarify him. If he is good at his root, God will certainly save him from every sin even in Egypt, and no outcast will remain cast away. God therefore clarified and refined him through the episode of Potiphar's wife. The covenant of the sexual organ corresponds to the covenant of the tongue. When he was found clear in this, he also cleared himself of their suspicion concerning evil speech: he was innocent."

Mei HaShiloach keeps the brothers' judgment explicitly uncertain and reads the later trial as the clarification of Joseph's innocence. This helps the reader preserve Rav Tzadok's distinction between what the brothers suspected and what was true of Joseph. It also explains how the trial involving the covenant addresses the earlier accusation involving speech, joining the section's opening account of purity to its account of the sale.

he was compromised therein, ,"דְּ"כָל הַפּוֹסֵל – בְּמוּמוֹ פּוֹסֵל **— for 'whoever invalidates others—disqualifies through his own blemish',** .וּמִשּׁוּם הָכִי מְכָרוּהוּ לְעֶבֶד **— and for this reason they sold him as a slave.** וּמִי שֶׁיְּתַקֵּן פְּגָם זֶה בַּחֹדֶשׁ הַזֶּה הַמְסֻגָּל לָזֶה יִנָּצֵל **— And whoever rectifies this blemish during this month propitious for it will be spared from servitude.** ,וְעִיקַּר הַתִּיקּוּן עַל יְדֵי מִדַּת הַיִּרְאָה וְהַפַּחַד **— And the primary rectification is attained through the attribute of awe and reverence,** ,כָּאָמוּר: שֶׁהוּא עֵסֶק וְעִנְיַן חֹדֶשׁ זֶה **— which constitutes the inner labor and theme of this month, as stated.**

הוּא עַל פִּי מַה שֶּׁכָּתוּב בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ **— And it said, 'and the small intestines in the person,'** ,"וְאָמַר "וְדַקִּין בַּנֶּפֶשׁ **— which is based on what is written in the holy Zohar (Part II, 148b):** :"בְּכָל אֲתַר דְּאִית נָחָשׁ אָזְלָא בָּתַר רָזָא דְּאִתּתָּא חֵיל, וְאִתּתָּא דְּזִמְנָא לְאִתְעַבְּדָא כְּוָותָהּ **— 'Everywhere this Serpent stalks following the mystery of the Woman of Valor, and the Woman of Harlotry seeks, etc. (to fashion herself in the same form).** ,וְעִיקַּר פִּיתּוּי הַנָּחָשׁ הַקַּדְמוֹנִי נִקְרָא "אֵשֶׁת זְנוּנִים" **— The primordial Serpent is thus termed the 'Harlot Woman',** ,הָיָה בְּתַאֲוַת אֲכִילָה **— was via the lust for eating,** ;לְהַכְנִיס בְּלִבּוֹ הַתַּאֲוָה לְהַרְגִּישׁ הֲנָאַת הַגּוּף **— to implant in man's heart the lust to experience bodily pleasure;** ,וְאַחַר כָּךְ בָּא עַל חַוָּה וְהִטִּיל בָּהּ זוּהֲמָא (שַׁבָּת קמו.)[125] **— and afterward he cohabited with Eve and injected defilement into her (Shabbat 146a),** ,וְעַל יְדֵי שֶׁנּוֹלְדוּ הַכֹּל מֵחַוָּה **— and because all humanity descended from Eve,** ,בָּא הַזּוּהֲמָא גַּם בְּזַרְעָהּ **— this pollution entered into her offspring as well,** וְעַל יְדֵי זוּהֲמַת הַנָּחָשׁ זֶה שֶׁנִּבְרָא, נִמְשָׁךְ גּוֹרֶם הַפְּגָם בָּזֶה. **— and through the Serpent's defilement this moral blemish is induced.** וְחֹדֶשׁ זֶה שֶׁנִּבְרָא בְּאוֹת נו"ן, **— And this month, which was formed with the letter Nun,** – דְּרָזָא דִּילֵיהּ ה"א תַּתָּאָה **— whose esoteric secret is the lower Hei—** ,"אֵשֶׁת חַיִל", "יִרְאַת הַשֵּׁם" **— 'a Woman of Valor', the 'fear of Hashem',** ,לָכֵן בּוֹ הַזְּמַן לְתַקֵּן פְּגָם זֶה **— is therefore the season to rectify this defect,** – וּמִמֵּילָא יְתוּקַּן שׁוֹרֶשׁ קִלְקוּל הַנָּחָשׁ **— and automatically the root corruption of the Serpent is repaired—** ;אֵשֶׁת זְנוּנִים שֶׁהָיָה בַּאֲכִילָה **— the Harlot Woman that originated through eating;** ."וְזֶה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: "וְדַקִּין בַּנֶּפֶשׁ **— and this is why it says: 'and the small intestines in the person.'** ,וְכֵן עַל יְדֵי הַיִּרְאָה יוּקְבְּעוּ דִּבְרֵי תוֹרָה בַּלֵּב **— And likewise, through fear of God words of Torah are inscribed in the heart,** – שֶׁהוּא הָעִיקָּר שֶׁנִּבְרָא הַיֵּצֶר **— which is the ultimate purpose for which the inclination was created—** ,שֶׁיִּהְיֶה חֵשֶׁק לְדִבְרֵי תוֹרָה **— that passion be directed toward words of Torah,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר בַּגְּמָרָא (סֻכָּה נב.)[126, 127]: "אִם פָּגַע בְּךָ מְנוּוָּל זֶה – מָשְׁכֵהוּ לְבֵית הַמִּדְרָשׁ". **— and as stated in the Gemara (Sukkah 52a):** "מְנוּוָּל" נִקְרָא יֵצֶר הָרָע שֶׁל תַּאֲוַת **'If this vile one confronts you, drag him to the study hall.'** ,וּכְמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר בַּגְּמָרָא **— 'Vile one' is the title of the evil inclination of lust for the Harlot Woman,** ,אֵשֶׁת זְנוּנִים **— and as stated in the Gemara (Shabbat 152a):** (שַׁבָּת קנב.)[128, 129]: "אִשָּׁה חֲמַת מָלֵא צוֹאָה וְכוּלֵי" **— 'A woman is a vessel full of filth, etc.',"**

The energy of desire can serve Torah while its evil form disappears

The study house strengthens the work of redirecting desire

– "מָשְׁכֵהוּ לְבֵית הַמִּדְרָשׁ": וְהָעֵצָה[130, 131] **— and the counsel is: 'drag him to the study hall'—** ,שֶׁיִּמְשׁוֹךְ הַחֵשֶׁק לְדִבְרֵי תוֹרָה, שֶׁלְּתַכְלִית זֶה נִבְרָא הַיֵּצֶר **— for for this purpose the inclination was created,** שֶׁהוּא הַחֵשֶׁק לִהְיוֹת חֲמִידוּ דְּאוֹרַיְיתָא. **— namely, the desire to delight in Torah.** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁיִּהְיֶה לֶעָתִיד, שֶׁיּוּשְׁאַר הַיֵּצֶר לִהְיוֹת חֲמִידוּ דְּאוֹרַיְיתָא **— And as it will be in the ultimate future, when the drive will remain purely for the delight of Torah,** :כְּמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר בְּמִדְרַשׁ הַנֶּעֱלָם (זֹהַר חָלֵק א, קלא עַמּוּד א)[132] **— as stated in the Midrash HaNe'elam (Zohar Part I, 131a):** "דְּאִלְמָלֵא יֵצֶר הָרָע, חֶדְוָותָא דְּשִׁמְעָתְתָא לָא לֵיהֱוֵי"[133]; **— 'for without the evil inclination, there would be no joy in Torah learning';** :וְכֵן כָּתוּב בְּתַנְחוּמָא בְּרֵאשִׁית **— and so is written in Tanchuma, Bereishit:** ,"אָמַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא: "אַתָּה עוֹשֶׂה אוֹתוֹ רַע וְכוּלֵי **— the Holy One said: 'You make it evil, etc.',** ,שֶׁהַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ בָּרָא הַיֵּצֶר הָרָע **— for Hashem created the impulse** – יֵצֶר חֵשֶׁק לְדִבְרֵי תוֹרָה, **— —as an impetus of zeal for Torah,** .שֶׁיִּהְיֶה חֶדְוָותָא דִּשְׁמַעְתְּתָא **— so that there be joy in Talmudic discussion.** – וְזֶהוּ "מָשְׁכֵהוּ לְבֵית הַמִּדְרָשׁ" **— And this is 'drag him to the study hall'—** מְקוֹם חִדּוּשׁ הֲלָכוֹת תּוֹרָה וְזֶה עִיקַּר עֵסֶק חֹדֶשׁ זֶה שֶׁנִּבְרָא **— the setting where novel insights of the Oral Torah are forged.** .שֶׁבַּעַל פֶּה[134] שְׁמוֹרָה עַל יִרְאָה, **— And this is the prime undertaking of this month, formed with the letter Nun,** בְּאוֹת נו"ן,

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[123] **Zohar II 148b**: 'We have learned that wherever this serpent goes it follows the mystery of the 'Woman of Valor,' and the 'Woman of Harlotry' seeks to arrange herself in the same form, but cannot. The mark and letter belonging to the Woman of Valor is the letter hei, and so it is fitting for her. The Woman of Harlotry has a mark and letter resembling the proper form, but it cannot be established as such; her letter is kuf. It is fashioned in imitation of hei, like an ape among human beings that imitates human beings but cannot truly become the same. Moshe made that serpent according to the mark appropriate to it; it was perpetually arranged to do harm. Through it Adam sinned and was expelled from Gan Eden, his dwelling place resembling the dwelling above.'"

— which signifies awe, וּבְכֹחַ הֲרִיחַ, **— and through the potency of smell,** לְתַקֵּן פְּגָם הַנָּחָשׁ בַּאֲכִילָה וּבְתַאֲוָה, **— to rectify the defect of the Serpent in eating and lust,** וְשֶׁיּוּקְבְּעוּ דִּבְרֵי תוֹרָה בַּלֵּב **— and that words of Torah be embedded in the heart,** לְקַבֵּל עָלָיו עוֹל תּוֹרָה בֶּאֱמֶת. **— to take upon oneself the yoke of Torah in truth.**

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[124] **Zohar, Terumah 35:406-37:415**: 'Said R. Judah: 'Had it been hidden away altogether, the world would not have been able to exist for one moment. But it was only hidden like a seed which generates others, seeds and fruits, and the world is sustained by it. There is not a day that something does not emanate from that light to sustain all things, for it is with this that the Holy One nourishes the world. Moreover, whenever the Torah is studied by night, a little thread of this hidden light steals down and plays upon them that are absorbed in their study, wherefore it is written: "The Lord commandeth His lovingkindness in the daytime, and in the night his song is with me" (Ps. 42, 9); this has already been expounded.'''

[125] **Shabbat 146a**: 'When the serpent came upon Chavah, he injected impurity into her. When Israel stood at Mount Sinai, their impurity ceased; the nations, who did not stand at Mount Sinai, did not cease from their impurity. Rav Acha son of Rava asked Rav Ashi: What of converts? He answered: Although they themselves were not there, their fortune was there.'

[126] **Sukkah 52b**: 'The school of Rabbi Yishmael taught: If this repulsive one encounters you, draw him into the study hall. If he is stone, he will dissolve; if he is iron, he will shatter. If stone, he will dissolve, as it says, 'Ho, all who thirst, go to the water,' and 'Waters wear away stones.' If iron, he will shatter, as it says, 'Is not My word like fire, declares Hashem, and like a hammer shattering rock?'''

[127] **Sukkah 52b:2**: "The school of Rabbi Yishmael taught: If this repulsive one, the evil inclination, encounters you, drag it to the study hall. If it is stone, it will dissolve; if it is iron, it will shatter. If it is stone, it will dissolve, as it is written, 'Ho, all who are thirsty, go to the water,' and it is written, 'Water wears away stones.' If it is iron, it will shatter, as it is written, 'Are not My words like fire, says the Lord, and like a hammer that shatters rock?'"

[128] **Shabbat 152a — a severe image of physical desire**: 'Rav Kahana was reviewing a passage before Rav. When he arrived at a certain verse, Rav sighed. Rav Kahana said: I infer that my teacher's desire has ceased. Rav Kahana said: What is the meaning of 'For He spoke and it came to be'? This is a woman; 'He commanded and it stood'—these are children. It was taught: A woman is a vessel full of excrement, and her mouth is full of blood, yet all pursue her."'

[129] **Shabbat 152a**: "Rav Kahana was reviewing Scripture before Rav. When he reached this verse, Rav sighed. He said: One may infer that Rav's desire has ceased. Rav Kahana said: What is meant by 'For He spoke and it came to be'? This is a woman. 'He commanded and it stood'—these are children. It was taught: A woman is a skin-bottle filled with excrement, and her mouth is filled with blood, yet everyone pursues her."

[130] **Sod Yesharim, Rosh Hashanah 61:7**: "God established His will through garments, so that each thing is a garment for another. To the extent that a garment recognizes how it clothes His will, His will truly encompasses it as well. So many garments unfolded in the world that darkness clothed light, as the holy Zohar says: there is no service of the Holy One except from within darkness. There is good in the world, and there is what is called evil; there is also kelipat nogah, in which good and evil are mixed. Through great concealment, something from it can be brought into holiness, as we find that descendants of Haman learned Torah in Bnei Brak. Even the worst garment is also a garment for light, as it says there: there is no light except what emerges from darkness, no service of the Holy One except from darkness, and no good except from evil. Recognition of light's excellence comes only through darkness. Thus the Sages say, 'Without the evil inclination, there would be no joy in Torah discussion.' The evil too is a garment. Yet evil itself will be completely annulled in its own apprehension, as Tikkunei Zohar says, 'The serpent was naked beyond all'—naked, without a garment. This completely evil garment is called the serpent, and it will be entirely annulled because it does not recognize at all that it is only a garment for light. This is what Abimelech asked Abraham: 'If you deal falsely with me, my child, and my grandchild'—a father's compassion for his child extends this far. He asked that his apprehension not be utterly annulled, but that he at least be brought in as some garment for holiness, like 'Without the inclination, there would be no joy in Torah discussion.' Thus the inclination is a garment for holiness, through which there can be joy in Torah discussion."

Sod Yesharim explains the distinction within the claim that the inclination will remain. Its capacity can become a garment through which the joy of Torah appears, while the evil that treats itself as independent is annulled. This sharpens the work described in Mar Cheshvan: retain and redirect the power of desire, with its purpose and allegiance changed. The full excerpt preserves the explicit qualification that evil itself disappears.

[131] **Divrei Soferim 26:1**: "They said, 'Draw him to the study house,' rather than simply saying that one should go and study on one's own. They could also have said, 'Draw him to words of Torah.' Although all words of Torah are like fire, it is known that some fire is especially strong, great, and intensely burning, while other fire is small and weak. So it is with the levels of Torah. In the study house, Torah is taught to others, there is the Torah study of the community, and a great person is presumably present. Such Torah acts more powerfully because its fire is stronger. This is the meaning of 'Therefore those who rule say: Come to Heshbon': those who rule over their inclination. Only those rulers who have already burned the evil inclination within their bodies through the fire of Torah can act through their words upon the hearts of those who hear them."

Divrei Soferim develops the precise setting of Rav Tzadok's counsel. The study house adds communal learning and the speech of a teacher whose Torah has worked upon his own inclinations. This explains why bringing desire into that setting can be more effective than relying on isolated effort, and gives practical content to the paragraph's final emphasis on the renewal of Oral Torah.

[132] **Zohar, Chayei Sara 19:205-214**: 'Observe that it has been laid down that the dead of the Land of Israel will be the first to rise, and of them it is written, "Thy dead shall live" (Ibid. 26, 19). On the other hand, the words "my dead bodies shall arise" (Ibid.) allude to the dead of other lands, since instead of "shall live" it says "snall arise". The living spirit, in fact, will only infuse the bodies in tne Land of Israel. "Thy dead", then, "shall live". But the other dead bodies will rise without the spirit of life, and only after they shall have rolled themselves underground and reached the Land of Israel will they receive souls-only there, but not in other realms-so that they may be really resurrected.'''

[133] **Midrash HaNe'elam / Zohar I 131a**: 'Rabbi Yitzchak son of Rabbi Yose was coming from Cappadocia to Lod, when

Rosh Chodesh Kislev Ois 1

Rosh Chodesh, Atonement, and the Renewal of Creation

Returning to the anniversary of creation can disclose a new degree of relationship with the Creator.

he met Rabbi Yehudah. Rabbi Yitzchak asked whether the Sages had considered that the evil inclination would one day vanish from the world except at the time needed for union. Rabbi Yehudah said to him: 'By your life, the evil inclination will be needed in the world just as rain is needed in the world; for were it not for the evil inclination, there would be no joy in the discussion of Torah. Yet it would no longer be foul as formerly, leading one to sin. This is the meaning of: "They shall not do harm or destroy on all My holy mountain."' Rabbi Shimon said: 'It is the heart, in which the evil inclination dwells.' Rabbi Eliezer said: 'A good heart is the building of body and soul'; hence it is written, 'You shall love Hashem your God with all your heart.'"'

[134] **Peri Tzadik, Ki Teitzei 1:1**: "The principal remedy is the Oral Torah, which comes to repair the abundance of vexation, as it is said, "For with much wisdom comes much vexation." This is the meaning of "draw him to the study hall": a study hall is the place where people expound and originate new Torah teachings, which is Oral Torah. This is a remedy for the evil inclination, to repair "the fool's heart at his left." As stated in the holy Zohar: "There is nothing that breaks the evil inclination except Torah.""

Rosh Chodesh, Atonement, and the Renewal of Creation

Annual renewal brings creation closer

"רֹאשׁ חֹדֶשׁ לְעַמְּךָ נָתַתָּ וְכוּלֵיהּ, זִכָּרוֹן לְכֻלָּם יִהְיֶה"[135]: — **"A New Moon You gave to Your people, etc., a remembrance for them all it shall be":** הָעִנְיָן, דְּרֹאשׁ הַשָּׁנָה יוֹם בְּרִיאַת אָדָם הָרִאשׁוֹן, — **The matter is that Rosh Hashanah is the day of the creation of Adam the First Man;** וְשָׁנָה הוּא הֶקֵּף הַחַמָּה, כְּשֶׁחוֹזֵר וּבָא לְאוֹתוֹ מָקוֹם מִתְחַדֵּשׁ הַשָּׁנָה; — **and a year is the orbital cycle of the sun: when it returns and arrives at that same place, the year is renewed;** וְכֵיוָן שֶׁנִּבְרָא אָדָם הָרִאשׁוֹן בְּאֶחָד בְּתִשְׁרֵי, בְּכָל שָׁנָה בְּאוֹתוֹ יוֹם זִכָּרוֹן לְיוֹם רִאשׁוֹן. וְחִדּוּשׁ הַלְּבָנָה — **and since Adam the First Man was created on the first of Tishrei, in every year on that day there is a remembrance of that first day. The renewal of the moon** בְּכָל חֹדֶשׁ מוֹלַד הַלְּבָנָה מֻחְדָּשׁ; — **occurs anew every month;** וְעַל כֵּן בְּכָל רֹאשׁ חֹדֶשׁ זִכָּרוֹן לִבְרִיאַת אָדָם הָרִאשׁוֹן; — **and therefore on every Rosh Chodesh there is a remembrance of the creation of Adam the First Man;** וְזֶה שֶׁאָמְרוּ (עֵירוּבִין מ׳ עַמּוּד ב׳): "זִכָּרוֹן אֶחָד עוֹלֶה לוֹ לְכָאן וּלְכָאן"[136]. — **and this is what they said (Eruvin 40b): "One remembrance serves for both here and there."** וּבְרֹאשׁ הַשָּׁנָה, שֶׁהוּא בְּרִיאַת אָדָם הָרִאשׁוֹן כְּפִי שֶׁעָלָה בְּמַחֲשָׁבָה, — **And on Rosh Hashanah, which is the creation of Adam the First Man as it arose in Divine Thought,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתְבוּ תּוֹסָפוֹת (רֹאשׁ הַשָּׁנָה כ״ז עַמּוּד א׳)[137], — **as Tosafot wrote (Rosh Hashanah 27a),** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: "הַיּוֹם הֵרַת עוֹלָם", — **and as we say: "Today is the conception of the world",** וּבַתְּחִלָּה עָלָה בְּמַחֲשָׁבָה לִבְרֹאת בְּמִדַּת הַדִּין, — **and initially it arose in Thought to create the world with the attribute of Judgment;** וְלָכֵן בְּרֹאשׁ הַשָּׁנָה יוֹם הַדִּין; — **and therefore on Rosh Hashanah it is the Day of Judgment;** שֶׁבַּתְּחִלָּה עָשָׂה הָאֱלֹהִים אֶת הָאָדָם יָשָׁר, — **for initially God made man upright,** וְאִם לֹא קִלְקֵל לֹא הָיָה יֵצֶר הָרָע וְהָיָה מִתְקַיֵּם בְּמִדַּת הַדִּין; — **and had he not ruined things there would be no Evil Inclination and he would endure under the attribute of Judgment;**

Ten days repair the whole person

רַק אַחַר שֶׁקִּלְקֵל וְשָׁלַט יֵצֶר הָרָע בָּאָדָם,[138] — **only after he sinned and the Evil Inclination dominated man,** נִתַּן עַל זֶה עֲשָׂרָה יָמִים לְתַקֵּן וּלְהִתְבָּרֵר בְּכָל עֶשֶׂר מִדּוֹת; — **ten days were granted for this to rectify and be refined across all ten sefirotic attributes;** וְרֹאשׁ הַשָּׁנָה כְּנֶגֶד כֶּתֶר עֶלְיוֹן, — **and Rosh Hashanah corresponds to Keter Elyon,** וּשְׁנֵי יְמֵי רֹאשׁ הַשָּׁנָה נֶגֶד כֶּתֶר עֶלְיוֹן וְחָכְמָה שֶׁהֵם תֵּרֵין רֵישִׁין; — **and the two days of Rosh Hashanah correspond to Keter Elyon and Chochmah, which are the 'two heads';** וְיוֹם הַכִּפּוּרִים כְּנֶגֶד בִּינָה; — **and Yom Kippur corresponds to Binah;** וּבָאֶמְצַע שִׁבְעַת יָמִים נֶגֶד שֶׁבַע מִדּוֹת, שִׁבְעַת יְמֵי בְרֵאשִׁית; — **and in the middle are seven**

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[135] **Tiferet Yosef, Rosh Hashanah 11**: "The principal meaning of the world of repair is that the blessed God gives creation a place in which to show what it is before its Creator. Every Rosh Hashanah is called a repair in relation to the preceding year, for each year the blessed God draws His light closer to creation's apprehension. Consequently, creatures recognize more deeply what they are before their Creator."
Pri Tzadik begins with the yearly return to the creation of Adam. Tiferet Yosef explains renewal as an advance in creation's ability to recognize its relationship to God. This adds an inward account of the anniversary; it does not replace Pri Tzadik's distinct monthly and yearly cycles or his ten-attribute sequence.

[136] **Eruvin 40b**: 'Regarding a Rosh Chodesh that falls on Rosh Hashanah: why do we not mention the formula of Rosh Chodesh separately in the Amidah? Because 'one remembrance (zikaron echad) ascends for here and for there'—the remembrance of Rosh Hashanah encompasses the remembrance of Rosh Chodesh as well.'

[137] **Rosh Hashanah 27a**: '§ It was taught in the mishna: Yom Kippur of the Jubilee Year is the same as Rosh HaShana with regard to both the shofar blasts that are sounded and the additional blessings that are recited in the Amida prayer. Rav Shmuel bar Yitzḥak said: In accordance with whose opinion do we pray today on Rosh HaShana, saying: This day is the beginning of Your works, a commemoration of the first day? In accordance with whom? In accordance with the opinion of Rabbi Eliezer, who said: The world was created in the month of Tishrei. We therefore mention on Rosh HaShana that it is the first day.'

[138] **Takanat HaShavin 12:12**: "The seven days between Rosh Hashanah and Yom Kippur are days of repentance for repairing everything damaged throughout the year or previous years, each day in its own place, as is known from the Ari in the Book of Intentions. These seven days encompass every day of the week and correspond to the seven days of building, the seven known attributes: the entire stature of the person in all his revealed qualities and actions. The hidden powers are the first three. Corresponding to them are the two days of Rosh Hashanah, the stature of the head: wisdom in the brain, and the crown above the head, the depth at the beginning of thought that is hidden from the person himself, the place where thought is born. Therefore it is called "something from nothing," and "Where shall wisdom be found?" They are one holiness and one extended day, for the nothingness cannot be grasped except through the existence that proceeds from it. Yom Kippur corresponds to understanding in the heart: "His heart will understand, and he will return and be healed." They repair the hidden powers: the beginning on Rosh Hashanah is repentance from fear, and the completion on Yom Kippur is repentance from love, supernal repentance, repentance fit to cover all his deeds. The seven intervening days repair what is revealed in qualities and actions."
Pri Tzadik maps the ten days onto the ten attributes. Takanat HaShavin explains the work accomplished by that map: the intervening seven days repair conduct and character, while Rosh Hashanah and Yom Kippur reach the concealed powers. Its movement from fear to love also clarifies why the process culminates in the understanding of the heart.

days corresponding to the seven emotive attributes, the seven days of Creation; וּמְתַקֵּן עַד יוֹם הַכִּפּוּרִים שֶׁכְּנֶגֶד בִּינָה עַל יְדֵי תְּשׁוּבָה, **— and one rectifies up until Yom Kippur which corresponds to Binah through repentance,** דִּכְתִיב: "וּלְבָבוֹ יָבִין וְשָׁב", **— as it is written: "and his heart understands, and he returns,"** וְאָז הַזְּמַן לְתַקֵּן הַכֹּל. **— and then is the auspicious time to rectify everything.**

וְאִיתָא בְּתִקּוּנֵי זֹהַר (תִּקּוּן י״ט)[139]: "שַׁבָּת הַגָּדוֹל בִּינָה, שַׁבָּת הַקָּטָן **— And it states in Tikkunei Zohar (Tikkun 19): "The Great Shabbat is Binah; the Lesser Shabbat is** מַלְכוּת", **— Malchut,"** וְהוּא כְּמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: "שַׁבָּת שַׁבָּתוֹן", שַׁבָּת עֶלְיוֹנָה וְשַׁבָּת תַּחְתּוֹנָה". **— and it is as is said: the Upper Shabbat and the Lower Shabbat.** וּמִטַּעַם זֶה מַרְבִּין בִּתְפִלּוֹת עֶרֶב רֹאשׁ חֹדֶשׁ, **— And for this reason we multiply prayers on the eve of Rosh Chodesh,** וְקוֹרִין אוֹתוֹ "יוֹם כִּפּוּר קָטָן", **— and we call it Yom Kippur Katan (the Minor Day of Atonement), for Rosh Chodesh** יוֹם כִּפּוּר קָטָן, **— is a minor Yom Kippur,** וְרֹאשׁ חֹדֶשׁ מִצַּד יִשְׂרָאֵל, דְּיִשְׂרָאֵל מְקַדְּשֵׁי לֵיהּ, **— and Rosh Chodesh is from the side of Israel, for Israel sanctifies it,** וְהוּא זְמַן כַּפָּרָה; **— and it is a time of atonement;** אַךְ בְּרֹאשׁ חֹדֶשׁ אִי אֶפְשָׁר לְהַרְבּוֹת בִּתְחִנּוֹת, **— yet on Rosh Chodesh itself it is impossible to multiply supplications,** וְרֹאשׁ חֹדֶשׁ אָסוּר בְּתַעֲנִית, **— and Rosh Chodesh is forbidden for fasting,**

The renewed moon and the return from failure

וּקְבָעוּהוּ בְּעֶרֶב רֹאשׁ חֹדֶשׁ; אֲבָל רֹאשׁ חֹדֶשׁ עַצְמוֹ[140] **— so they established it on the eve of Rosh Chodesh. But Rosh Chodesh itself** זְמַן כַּפָּרָה מִצַּד יִשְׂרָאֵל, **— is a time of atonement from the side of Israel,** וְזֶה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: "רֹאשׁ חֹדֶשׁ לְעַמְּךָ נָתַתָּ, זְמַן כַּפָּרָה לְכָל תּוֹלְדוֹתָם"; **— and this is what we say: "A New Moon You gave to Your people, a time of atonement for all their generations (toldotam)";** "תּוֹלְדוֹתָם" הַיְנוּ הַפְּגָם שֶׁיֵּשׁ מִתּוֹלָדָה, שֶׁהוּא פְּגַם אָדָם הָרִאשׁוֹן, **— "their generations" refers to the hereditary blemish born with man, which is the sin of Adam the First Man,** וְרֹאשׁ חֹדֶשׁ זְמַן כַּפָּרָה לָזֶה. **— and Rosh Chodesh is a time of atonement for this.**

The goat ritual and the refusal of self-sufficiency

וְזֶה שֶׁאָמְרוּ בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ (חֵלֶק א׳ קל״ח עַמּוּד ב׳)[141, 142]: **— And this is what they said in the Holy Zohar (Part I, 138b):** "וּבְגִין כָּךְ בְּכָל יַרְחָא וְיַרְחָא חַד שָׂעִיר בְּגִין לְאַמְשָׁכָא לֵיהּ לְאַתְרֵיהּ וְכוּלֵיהּ, **— "And on this account in every month there is one he-goat in order to draw it the unholy husk back to its place, etc.,** וְכֵן בְּיוֹמָא דְּכִפּוּרֵי דִּכְתִיב: 'וְנָשָׂא הַשָּׂעִיר עָלָיו', לְאַקְרָבָא הַהוּא שָׂעִיר וְכוּלֵיהּ, **— and likewise on the Day of Atonement to offer that goat, etc.,** דְּשָׂעִיר רֹאשׁ חֹדֶשׁ וְשָׂעִיר יוֹם הַכִּפּוּרִים, **— as it is written: 'And the goat shall bear, etc.', see there";** הַשָּׂעִיר וְגוֹמֵר', עַיֵּן שָׁם",

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[139] **Tikkunei Zohar 38a:2-42a:6**: 'And about them it is stated: (Is. 40:12) Who has measured the waters with His step – this is Ḥesed, ... and the heavens He gauged with a span ... What is zeret ? – this is Gevurah. ... and all in a measure ... – this is the Middle Pillar, which is 'the third' sephirah of seven, ... and has weighed mountains in a scale... – this is Netzaḥ. ... and hills in the balance – this is Hod.'

[140] **Resisei Layla 47:4**: "The holiness of Rosh Chodesh corresponds to the rank of King David, the fourth leg of the chariot, the fourth level of apprehending His chariot among those below. He is the man who established the yoke of repentance. The three patriarchs strove to be only good and did not sin at all. What should someone do who is not like them? This is what King David introduced: "In the place where penitents stand, the completely righteous cannot stand." It is a higher apprehension, what someone attains after tasting evil and returning to good. It is like a king's son who was exiled from his father's table, suffered poverty and hardship, and afterward returned to that table. His enjoyment there cannot be compared with that of someone who was never exiled and never tasted poverty. Similar examples are given in the Midrash and Zohar. This is the holiness of Rosh Chodesh: the renewal of the moon's light after it became dark. It was given to Israel, who are destined to be renewed like it, when David's rank becomes fixed in the hearts of all the souls of Israel."

Pri Tzadik calls Rosh Chodesh a time to repair the inherited damage of Adam. Resisei Layla explains why renewal after darkness is the distinctive holiness of repentance, associated with David. The image of returning to the royal table describes the renewed appreciation that follows an actual return; it does not recommend first entering sin.

[141] **Zohar, Toldot 4:30-9:73**: 'In the Zohar (Toldot I 138b), the mystery of the New Moon sin-offering (the Sa'ir, he-goat of Rosh Chodesh) is explained: just as Isaac desired the savory delicacies of two kid goats to draw blessing while giving Esau his portion, so too on every Rosh Chodesh a single he-goat is offered so that the prosecuting force of Esau/Sitra Achra is occupied with its portion while Israel unites undisturbed with the King in the renewal of the moon.'

[142] **Sod Yesharim, Yom Kippur 23:1**: "Although it appears that Israel too abolishes all its choice by casting lots, and casting a lot indicates removing choice from conscious decision, since a lot is beyond human knowledge, nevertheless Israel knowingly and willingly entrusts its power of choice to the blessed God. Therefore God shows Israel that even through casting the lot, which is beyond their knowledge, they have accorded with the depth of His will, which is above the choice accessible to their understanding. But the nations receive only pride from this lot, imagining in their hearts that they cast lots with their Master. Therefore this lot brings them every kind of nullification."

Pri Tzadik links the Rosh Chodesh goat with the Yom Kippur goat as repair of the serpent's damage. In its full discussion of those goats, Sod Yesharim explains a central difference between Israel and the opposing power: freely entrusting choice to God, as opposed to claiming equal standing with Him. This gives the ritual comparison an inward mechanism. The quotation concerns the Yom Kippur lots; it does not ascribe that procedure to the Rosh Chodesh offering.

הַכִּפּוּרִים מַעֲנְיָן אֶחָד, — **for the goat of Rosh Chodesh and the goat of Yom Kippur share a single essential theme,** לְתַקֵּן פְּגַם הַנָּחָשׁ, — **to rectify the blemish of the primordial serpent,** וְכֵן הוּא בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ לְמַעְלָה (שָׁם ס״ד עַמּוּד א׳)[143]. "בְּהָיוֹתָם מַקְרִיבִים לְפָנֶיךָ זִבְחֵי רָצוֹן" — **and so it is stated in the holy Zohar earlier (ibid. 64a). "When they offered before You sacrifices of favor"** הֵבִינוּ עוֹלָה, — **refers to the burnt-offering (olah),** וְעַל פִּי מַה שֶּׁכָּתוּב בַּגְּמָרָא (חֲגִיגָה ז׳ עַמּוּד א׳)[144]: — **and based on what is written in the Gemara (Chagigah 7a):** הַקַר רַגְלְךָ [מִבֵּית רֵעֶךָ]", וּכְתִיב: "אָבוֹא בֵיתְךָ בְּעוֹלוֹת", — **it is written: "Make your foot rare from your neighbor's house", yet it is written: "I will enter Your house with burnt-offerings";** לָא קַשְׁיָא: כָּאן בְּחַטָּאוֹת, כָּאן בְּעוֹלוֹת וּשְׁלָמִים; וַאֲשָׁמוֹת — **this is not difficult: here refers to sin-offerings and guilt-offerings, whereas here refers to burnt-offerings and peace-offerings;** וְהֵבִינוּ דְּעוֹלָה רְצוֹנוֹ שֶׁל הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ שֶׁיָּבִיאוּ, — **meaning that the burnt-offering is the will of the Blessed Name that they bring,** וְנִקְרְאוּ "זִבְחֵי רָצוֹן"; — **and thus they are termed "sacrifices of favor";** וּשְׂעִירֵי חַטָּאוֹת לְכַפֵּר בַּעֲדָם, זָכָרוֹן וְכוּלֵיהּ, — **"and goats of sin-offerings to atone for them, a remembrance, etc.,** וּתְשׁוּעַת נַפְשָׁם מִיַּד שׂוֹנֵא" — **– and the salvation of their soul from the hand of the enemy" —** הוּא הַיֵּצֶר הָרָע, — **this is the Evil Inclination,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב (סֶפֶר נ״ב עַמּוּד א׳): "שְׁלֹמֹה קְרָאוֹ שׂוֹנֵא", — **as written (Sukkah 52a): "Solomon called it an enemy",**[146] וְכֵן כָּתַב אַבּוּדְרַהַם. — **and so wrote the Abudarham.**

The tempter's appointed role is fulfilled by refusal

אַךְ לָמָּה נִקְרָא כָּאן הַיֵּצֶר הָרָע בְּשֵׁם "שׂוֹנֵא"[147], — **Yet why is the Evil Inclination called here specifically by the title "enemy" (soneh),** וְלֹא בְּשֵׁאָר שֵׁמוֹת שֶׁמָּנוּ חֲכָמֵינוּ זִכְרוֹנָם לִבְרָכָה? — **and not by the other six names enumerated by our Sages of blessed memory?** הוּא עַל פִּי מַה שֶּׁכָּתוּב בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ (חֵלֶק ב׳ קס״ג עַמּוּד א׳)[148]: — **It is according to what is written in the Holy Zohar (Part II, 163a):** שֶׁמְּשַׁל הַיֵּצֶר הָרָע לְזוֹנָה שֶׁצִּוָּה לַהּ הַמֶּלֶךְ לְפַתּוֹת לִבְנוֹ לְנַסּוֹת אוֹתוֹ, עַיֵּן שָׁם; — **that the parable of the Evil Inclination is likened to a harlot whom the king commanded to seduce his son in order to test him, see there;** וּמִמֵּילָא הָיָה צָרִיךְ הַיֵּצֶר הָרָע לִשְׂמֹחַ כְּשֶׁאֵין הָאָדָם שׁוֹמֵעַ בְּקוֹלוֹ, — **and automatically the Evil Inclination ought to rejoice when a person does not listen to his voice,** שֶׁאָז מִתְמַלֵּא רְצוֹן הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ; — **for then the true inner will of the Blessed Name is fulfilled;** וּמִמָּה שֶׁהַיֵּצֶר הָרָע מִתְגַּבֵּר בְּכָל כֹּחוֹ וְחָפֵץ לַהֲמִיתוֹ, — **and from the fact that the Evil Inclination surges with all its might and actively desires to kill him,** מִזֶּה נָכָר שֶׁהוּא "שׂוֹנֵא". — **from this it is recognized that it is a true malicious enemy.** וּשְׁלֹמֹה הַמֶּלֶךְ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם, דִּכְתִיב עָלָיו בְּלֶדָתוֹ: "וַהשֵּׁם אֲהֵבוֹ", — **And Solomon the King, peace be upon him, of whom it is written at his birth: "and Hashem loved him",** וּמִמָּה שֶׁנִּתְגַּבֵּר עָלָיו הַיֵּצֶר הָרָע, — **and from the fact that the Evil Inclination overpowered him,** עַד שֶׁבִּקְשׁוּ אַנְשֵׁי כְּנֶסֶת הַגְּדוֹלָה לִמְנוֹתוֹ בֵּין אֵלּוּ שֶׁאֵין לָהֶם חֵלֶק לָעוֹלָם הַבָּא, — **to the point that the Men of the Great Assembly sought to number him among**

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[143] **Zohar, Noach 64a**: 'In the Zohar (Noach I 64a), the offerings brought by Noah upon emerging from the Ark are explained as rectifying the primordial blemish of the Serpent and sweetening strict judgment into Divine favor (ratzon).'

[144] **Chagigah 7a**: 'Rabbi Yehoshua ben Levi contrasted two verses: It is written, 'Make your foot rare from your neighbor's house, lest he become sated with you and hate you' (Proverbs 25:17), and yet it is written, 'I will come into Your house with burnt-offerings' (Psalms 66:13)! There is no contradiction: here it speaks of obligatory offerings, whereas there it speaks of voluntary burnt-offerings brought out of love, where the Holy One, blessed be He, rejoices whenever Israel multiplies their offerings before Him.'

[145] **Proverbs 25:17**: "Keep your visits to your neighbor's house infrequent, lest he have enough of you and hate you."

[146] **Sukkah 52a**: '§ Rabbi Avira, and some say Rabbi Yehoshua ben Levi, taught: The evil inclination has seven names. The Holy One, Blessed be He, called it evil, as it is stated: "For the inclination of a man's heart is evil from his youth" (Genesis 8:21). Moses called it uncircumcised, as it is stated: "And circumcise the foreskin of your hearts" (Deuteronomy 10:16). David called it impure, as it is stated: "Create for me a pure heart, O God" (Psalms 51:12); by inference, there is an impure heart that is the evil inclination.'

[147] **Dover Tzedek, Miscellany 3:6**: "It follows that through this there is an elevation even for the adulterous woman, as in the familiar Zoharic parable of the prostitute whom the king commanded to tempt his son: her elevation occurs when she has not succeeded in enticing him. So too the familiar teaching of the Baal Shem Tov: evil becomes a seat for good. Therefore offerings are brought corresponding to them—that is, even all the seventy nations are elevated to the blessed God. For in truth they are all His creatures, and through Israel His will is fulfilled even in them: Israel recognizes from within the concealment that they are false and must not be obeyed. Such is His will."

Pri Tzadik asks why a tempter commissioned to test the king's son should desire the son's destruction. Dover Tzedek makes the parable's intended outcome explicit: the tempter itself is elevated when the son refuses. This supplies the premise of Pri Tzadik's distinction between a divinely permitted test and the inclination's enmity.

[148] **Zohar, Terumah 66:669-678**: 'Should it be asked, How can a man love Him with the evil inclination? Is not the evil inclination the seducer, preventing man from approaching the Holy One to serve him? How, then, can man use the evil inclination as an instrument of love to God? The answer lies in this, that there can be no greater service done to the Holy One than to bring into subjection the "evil inclination" by the power of love to the Holy One, blessed be He. For, when it is subdued and its power broken by man in this way, then he becomes a true lover of the Holy One, since he has learnt how to make the "evil inclination" itself serve the Holy One.'

עַד שֶׁיְּצְאָה בַּת קוֹל וְאָמְרָה: "הַמַּעֲמִיךָ יְשַׁלְּמֶנָּה" (סַנְהֶדְרִין ק״ד עַמּוּד ב׳),[149] **— until a Heavenly Voice went forth and proclaimed: "Shall it be repaid from you?" (Sanhedrin 104b),** בְּוַדַּאי הִשְׁתַּדֵּל הַיֵּצֶר הָרָע בְּכָל כֹּחוֹ לְהַחֲטִיאוֹ, **— certainly the Evil Inclination labored with all its power to cause him to sin,** וְזֶה רַק מִשִּׂנְאָה, **— and this was purely out of venomous hatred,** וּמִשּׁוּם הָכִי קְרָאוֹ "שׂוֹנֵא". **— and for this reason he called it "enemy".** וּבִזְמַן שְׁלֹמֹה הַמֶּלֶךְ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם הָיָה סִיהֲרָא בְּאַשְׁלְמוּתָא, כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ, **— And in the era of King Solomon, peace be upon him, the moon was in its complete fullness, as written in the Holy Zohar;** (מִדְרָשׁ רַבָּה בֹּא פָּרָשָׁה ט״ו):[150] וְהוּא כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב **— and it is as written (Midrash Rabbah Bo, Parashah 15):** שֶׁחֲמִשָּׁה עָשָׂר דּוֹר מֵאַבְרָהָם וְעַד שְׁלֹמֹה, שֶׁנִּתְמַלֵּא דִּסְקוּס שֶׁל לְבָנָה, **— that fifteen generations elapsed from Abraham until Solomon, when the disc of the moon became filled,** שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: "וַיֵּשֶׁב שְׁלֹמֹה עַל כִּסֵּא הַשֵּׁם לְמֶלֶךְ", עַיֵּן שָׁם. **— as it is said: "And Solomon sat on the throne of Hashem as king", see there.**

וְהָיָה הַהַתְחָלָה מֵאַבְרָהָם עַל פִּי מַה שֶׁכָּתוּב בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ (חֵלֶק א׳ רי״ט עַמּוּד א׳):[151] **— And the inception was from Abraham, based on what is written in the Holy Zohar (Part I, 219a):** "תְּרֵין בְּנִין אִית לֵיהּ לְקוּדְשָׁא בְּרִיךְ הוּא, חַד דְּכַר וְחַד נוּקְבָא; **— "Two children has the Holy One, Blessed be He, one male and one female;** דְּכַר יְהַבֵּיהּ לְיַעֲקֹב וְכוּלֵּיהּ, **— the male He gave to Jacob, etc.,** בַּת יְהַבָּה לְאַבְרָהָם וְכוּלֵּיהּ, **— the daughter He gave to Abraham, etc.,** — as in 'Abraham had a daughter and her name was Bakol (With Everything)'". 'בַּת הָיְתָה לוֹ לְאַבְרָהָם וּבְכֹל שָׁמָּהּ'. **— as in 'Abraham had a daughter and her name was Bakol (With Everything)'".** וְהָיְנוּ דְּיַעֲקֹב נְקְרָא "שֶׁמֶשׁ", כְּמָה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: "וְהִנֵּה הַשֶּׁמֶשׁ וְגוֹמֵר", וּבְמִדְרָשׁ רַבָּה (רֵישׁ פָּרָשַׁת וַיֵּצֵא):[152] '"בָּא הַשֶּׁמֶשׁ' **— This means that Yaakov is called "sun," as stated: "And behold, the sun," etc.; and in Midrash Rabbah (beginning of Parashat Vayeitzei): "The sun set—** אֲתָא שִׁמְשָׁא וְכוּלֵּיהּ, מִי גְּלָה לוֹ **— the sun came," etc. "Who revealed to him that my name is sun?" See there;** וְהָיְנוּ שֶׁשְּׁמִי שֶׁמֶשׁ, עַיֵּן שָׁם";[153] **— meaning that he is the chariot for the Name Havayah as is known, and it is written: "For a sun and a shield is Hashem."** שֶׁהוּא מֶרְכָּבָה לְשֵׁם הֲוָיָ"ה כַּיָּדוּעַ, וּכְתִיב: "כִּי שֶׁמֶשׁ וּמָגֵן יהו"ה". וְאַבְרָהָם, אִיתָא (בְּרָכוֹת ז׳ עַמּוּד ב׳):[154] **— And regarding Abraham, it states (Berachot 7b):** "מִיּוֹם שֶׁבָּרָא הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא אֶת הָעוֹלָם לֹא הָיָה אָדָם שֶׁקָּרָאוֹ לְהַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא 'אָדוֹן' עַד שֶׁבָּא אַבְרָהָם וְכוּלֵּיהּ", **— "From the day the Holy One, Blessed be He, created the world, no person called the Holy One 'Master' (Adon) until Abraham came, etc.",** וְשֵׁם אֲדֹנָ"י נֶגֶד מִדַּת מַלְכוּת, כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב (זֹהַר חֵלֶק ג׳ י״א עַמּוּד ב׳).[155] **— and the Name Adonai corresponds to the attribute of Malchut, as written (Zohar Part III, 11b).** וְאַבְרָהָם הָיָה רֹאשׁ, **— And Abraham was the head,** וּכְשֶׁנִּשְׁלַם אַחַר כָּךְ כְּתִיב: "וַהשֵׁם בֵּרַךְ אֶת אַבְרָהָם בַּכֹּל", **— and when he attained completion afterward it is written: "and Hashem blessed Abraham with everything (bakol)",** שֶׁנִּדְרַשׁ (בְּבָבָא בַּתְרָא י״ז.): שֶׁהִטְעִימוֹ בָּעוֹלָם הַזֶּה מֵעֵין עוֹלָם

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[149] **Sanhedrin 104b:14**: “A heavenly voice went forth and told them: ‘Have you seen a man swift in his work? He shall stand before kings; he shall not stand before those in darkness.’ It meant: The one who built My house before his own house—and, moreover, built My house in seven years and his own in thirteen years—‘shall stand before kings; he shall not stand before those in darkness.’ They paid no attention to it. A heavenly voice went forth and said: ‘Shall He repay according to your judgment, because you reject it? Must you choose, and not I?’ and so forth.”

[150] **Shemot Rabbah 15:26** (excerpt): “The moon begins to shine on the first of Nisan. Its light increases until fifteen days have passed and its disc is full; from the fifteenth until the thirtieth its light diminishes, and on the thirtieth it is not seen. So too, Israel had fifteen generations from Abraham to Solomon. Abraham began to shine, as it says, ‘Who awakened one from the east, calling righteousness to his feet?’ (Isaiah 41:2). Isaac came and also shone, as it says, ‘Light is sown for the righteous’ (Psalms 97:11). Jacob came and added light, as it says, ‘The light of Israel shall become a fire’ (Isaiah 10:17). After him came Judah, Peretz, Chetzron, Ram, Amminadav, Nachshon, Salmon, Boaz, Oved, Jesse, and David. When Solomon came, the moon’s disc became full, as it says, ‘Solomon sat upon the throne of Hashem as king’ (I Chronicles 29:23).”

[151] **Zohar, Vayechi 21:171-23:182**: ‘R. Isaac once questioned R. Simeon with regard to the verse, “a joyful mother of children”, saying: ‘I know what is meant by the mother, but who are the children?’ R. Simeon answered: ‘There are two children to God, one male and one female. The male he gave to Jacob, as it is written: “Israel is my son, my firstborn” (Ex. 4, 22). The female he gave to Abraham.’

[152] **Bereshit Rabbah 68:10** (excerpt): “Rabbi Pinchas said in the name of Rabbi Chanin of Tzippori: Jacob heard the voices of the ministering angels saying, ‘The sun has come! The sun has come! The sun has arrived! The sun has arrived!’ When Joseph said, ‘Behold, the sun and the moon’ (Genesis 37:9), Jacob said: Who revealed to him that my name is ‘sun’?”

[153] **Bereshit Rabbah 68:10** (excerpt): “Rabbi Pinchas said in the name of Rabbi Chanin of Tzippori: Jacob heard the voices of the ministering angels saying, ‘The sun has come! The sun has come! The sun has arrived! The sun has arrived!’ When Joseph said, ‘Behold, the sun and the moon’ (Genesis 37:9), Jacob said: Who revealed to him that my name is ‘sun’?”

[154] **Berakhot 7b:1**: “Rabbi Yochanan said in Rabbi Shimon ben Yochai’s name: From the day the Holy One, blessed be He, created the world, no person called the Holy One, blessed be He, ‘Master’ until Avraham came and called Him Master, as it says, ‘He said: Lord God, by what shall I know that I will inherit it?’”

[155] **Zohar, Vayikra 24:170-25:179**: ‘In the Zohar (Vayikra III 11b), the Divine Name Adonai is identified as the Name corresponding to the Sefirah of Malkhut, through which awe of Heaven (‘If I am a Master, where is My fear?’ Malachi 1:6) and royal sovereignty are revealed in the lower world.’

"הַבָּא, וְלֹא שָׁלַט בּוֹ יֵצֶר הָרָע, וְכַדּוֹמֶה; וְאָז "בַּת נָתַן לְאַבְרָהָם"[156] — **as expounded (Bava Batra 17a): He gave him in this world a foretaste of the World to Come, the evil inclination had no dominion over him, and the like. Then "the daughter was given to Avraham"—** מִדַּת מַלְכוּת. **— the attribute of Malchut.**

Solomon's confidence and the responsibility of a model

וְהִתְחִיל מֵאַבְרָהָם עַד שְׁלֹמֹה, דּוֹר חֲמִשָּׁה עָשָׂר, דִּכְתִיב: "וַיֵּשֶׁב עַל כִּסֵּא הַשֵּׁם לְמַלָּךְ",[157] **— And it progressed from Abraham until Solomon, the fifteenth generation, of whom it is written: "And he sat upon the throne of Hashem as king",** וְהָיָה נִצְרָךְ שֶׁיִּהְיֶה גַּם כֵּן דְּקַיְימָא סִיהֲרָא בְּאַשְׁלָמוּתָא; **— where the moon stood in its complete fullness;** בְּשְׁלֵמוּת, שֶׁלֹּא יִשְׁלוֹט בּוֹ יֵצֶר הָרָע, **— and it was necessary that he also be in absolute perfection, that the Evil Inclination have no dominion over him,** וְאָז הָיָה גְּמַר הַתִּקּוּן; **— and then would have been the final rectification;** רַק הַיֵּצֶר הָרָע נִתְגַּבֵּר עָלָיו, וְעַל כֵּן הוּא קְרָאוֹ "שׂוֹנֵא", **— only the Evil Inclination overpowered him, and therefore he called it "enemy",** שֶׁבְּוַדַּאי שְׁלֹמֹה מִצִּדּוֹ הִתְגַּבֵּר עַל יְצָרוֹ בְּכָל כֹּחוֹ, **— for certainly Solomon from his own side battled his inclination with all his might,** רַק הַיֵּצֶר הָרָע מִשֶּׁלּוֹ נִתְגַּבֵּר וְנִתְחַדֵּשׁ עָלָיו. **— only the Evil Inclination, out of sheer hatred, surged and renewed itself against him.**

וְעַל זֶה אָמַר: "אִם רָעֵב שׂוֹנַאֲךָ הַאֲכִילֵהוּ לָחֶם וְגוֹמֵר", **— And on this he said: "If your enemy is hungry, give him bread to eat, etc.",** וְהוּא עַל דֶּרֶךְ מַה שֶּׁכָּתוּב בְּסִפְרֵי הַקֹּדֶשׁ: **— and this follows what is written in the holy books:** דִּלְפְעָמִים הַיֵּצֶר הָרָע רוֹאֶה בָּאָדָם שֶׁכְּבָר נִתְקַע בַּחֲטָאִים וְאֵין בּוֹ קְדֻשָּׁה לִינֹק מִמֶּנּוּ, **— that sometimes the Evil Inclination observes a person who is already mired in sins and contains no residual holiness to suckle from,** וְאָז מְפַתֶּה אוֹתוֹ לַעֲשׂוֹת אֵיזֶה מִצְוָה שֶׁיּוּכַל אַחַר כָּךְ לִינֹק מִמֶּנּוּ הַקְּדֻשָּׁה; **— and then entices him to perform some mitzvah so that it may afterward suckle holiness from him;** וְזֶה וַדַּאי הוּא מִשֶּׁנְּאָה, **— and this is certainly out of pure malice,** כִּי עַל זֶה לֹא נִשְׁלַח מֵהַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ לְפַתּוֹת אוֹתוֹ לַעֲשׂוֹת טוֹב לִינֹק מִמֶּנּוּ, **— for on this mission it was not sent by the Blessed Name — to seduce him to do good merely to feed off him —** וְדַי לוֹ הַפִּתּוּי לָרָע, רַק זֶה עוֹשֶׂה מִשֶּׁנְּאָה. **— it being enough to tempt toward evil; rather, it does this purely out of hatred.**

Desire can recognize its good within Torah

וְעַל זֶה אָמַר שְׁלֹמֹה: "אִם רָעֵב שׂוֹנַאֲךָ הַאֲכִילֵהוּ לָחֶם"[158] **— – And regarding this Solomon said: "If your enemy is hungry, feed him bread" —** "וְאִם צָמֵא הַשְׁקֵהוּ מָיִם"; **— weary him in the battle of Torah; "and if he is thirsty, give him water to drink,"** הַטְרִיחֵהוּ בְּמִלְחֲמְתָהּ שֶׁל תּוֹרָה, שֶׁהוּא גַּם כֵּן דִּבְרֵי תוֹרָה, וּכְמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בְּפֵרוּשׁ רַבִּי שְׁלֹמֹה

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[156] **Bava Batra 16b-17a**: "The Holy One, blessed be He, gave three people in this world a foretaste of the World to Come: Avraham, Yitzchak, and Yaakov. Of Avraham it is written, "with all"; of Yitzchak, "of all"; and of Yaakov, "all." The evil inclination had no dominion over these three—Avraham, Yitzchak, and Yaakov—as it is written of them: "with all," "of all," and "all." Some say: David as well, for it is written, "My heart is slain within me." The other view holds that David is speaking of his suffering."

[157] **Tiferet Yosef, Ki Teitzei 2**: "In truth, Solomon had great firmness: he knew clearly that he could multiply wives and horses without turning aside or causing a return to Egypt, as he said, "God is with me, and I can prevail." The whole matter of his sin concerned what King David prayed for him: "May he have pity upon the poor and needy, and save the lives of the needy." He prayed that Solomon should pity the poor—and poverty here means poverty of understanding—someone without Solomon's great firmness and breadth of understanding. The Torah commanded us to make a parapet. This teaches that a person must make room for every creature: if someone else proceeds with such firmness, he may fall completely. Therefore the Midrash did not say, "Rather than do this deed." Concerning the deed, the Talmud says, "They sought to count one more …," until a heavenly voice declared, "Shall He requite it on your terms, because you reject it? Must you choose, and not I?" Sin was recorded concerning him so that no one would fall through his service."
Pri Tzadik describes Solomon at the fullness of the moon, where complete repair was possible, and stresses the inclination's renewed attack. Tiferet Yosef discusses the danger of Solomon's exceptional confidence from another angle: an example that exceeds another person's capacity can cause that person to fall. It adds a responsibility of kingship and public example. Its account of why sin was recorded about Solomon is distinct from Pri Tzadik's account of the enemy's attack.

[158] **Mei HaShiloach, Volume I, Genesis, Vayigash 4**: "The second clarification is to engage in Torah, for words of Torah are counsel through which a person may escape desire, even while the evil inclination rules and no one recalls the good inclination. For this the Holy One created Torah as a seasoning. In truth, when a person is immersed in a desire and cannot escape it, merely remembering that it is forbidden offers him no effective counsel, for the prohibition does not then have sufficient power to separate him from evil. The counsel is to remember that he can find this very good in words of Torah, only in holiness. As explained concerning "The sea saw and fled": it saw that God can turn rock into a pool of water and flint into a spring. One might have expected the opposite formulation, that it saw God's power to destroy and dry the sea. But the sea alludes to desire. When desire grows strong, the counsel against it is to show that something corresponding to it exists in holiness; then it ceases."
Pri Tzadik tells the person threatened by the inclination to feed it the bread and water of Torah. Mei HaShiloach explains why this can work even while desire remains powerful: prohibition alone may fail to move someone who is overwhelmed, whereas Torah discloses a holy good toward which the desire can turn. The full target continues with Shema and remembrance of death as further tests, because learning can itself become a source of conceit.

יְצָחָקִי; — **which likewise means words of Torah, as Rashi explains;** "כִּי גֶחָלִים אַתָּה חֹתֶה עַל רֹאשׁוֹ", — **"for you will heap coals of fire upon his head",** וְלֹא כְּמוֹ שֶׁאַתָּה סָבוּר וּמְפַחֵד שֶׁתּוֹסִיף עַל יְדֵי הַתּוֹרָה כֹּחַ בַּקְלִפּוֹת, — **and not as you mistakenly fear that through Torah study you might grant power to the unholy husks,** עַל דָּבָר מַה שֶּׁנֶּאֱמַר: "וְלָרָשָׁע אָמַר אֱלֹהִים: מַה לְּךָ לְסַפֵּר חֻקַּי וְגוֹמֵר", — **after what is stated: "But to the wicked God said: What have you to declare My statutes, etc.",** שֶׁמִּזֶּה כָּתַב הָאֲרִיזַ"ל שֶׁהָרָשָׁע בְּמַעֲשָׂיו הַטּוֹבִים מוֹסִיף כֹּחַ בַּקְלִפָּה; — **from which the Arizal wrote that a wicked person through his good deeds adds power to the kelipah;**

Torah can begin its repair before the heart is perfect

וְאָמַר שְׁלֹמֹה הַמֶּלֶךְ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם שֶׁבַּתּוֹרָה הָעֲצָה: "הַאֲכִילֵהוּ לַחְמָם" וְלֹא יַזִּיק לָךְ,[159] — **yet King Solomon, peace be upon him, taught that regarding Torah the counsel is: "feed him bread" and it will not harm you,** כִּי כְּשֶׁהָאָדָם רוֹצֶה בַּתּוֹרָה לְהִנָּצֵל מִיֵּצֶר הָרָע, אָז תּוֹעִיל הַתּוֹרָה לְטוֹבָה, — **for when a person engages in Torah to be saved from the Evil Inclination, the Torah avails for good,** וְלֹא תִּתֵּן הַתּוֹרָה כֹּחַ בַּקְלִפָּה חַס וְשָׁלוֹם. "כִּי גֶחָלִים אַתָּה חֹתֶה עַל רֹאשׁוֹ", — **"for you will heap coals of fire upon his head", and the Torah will not empower the kelipah, Heaven forbid.** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב (חֲגִיגָה ט"ו עַמּוּד ב'):[160] "מָה אֱגוֹז זֶה, אַף עַל פִּי — **And as written (Chagigah 15b):** שֶׁמִּלְכְלָךְ בְּטִיט, אֵין מַה שֶּׁבְּתוֹכוֹ נִמְאָס, — **"Just as this nut, even though soiled with mud, that which is inside is not repulsed,** אַף תַּלְמִיד חָכָם, אַף עַל פִּי שֶׁסָּרַח, אֵין תּוֹרָתוֹ נִמְאֶסֶת"; — **so a Torah scholar, even though he deteriorated, his Torah is not repulsed";** וְהַיְנוּ שֶׁהַלְּכְלוּךְ הוּא רַק הַקְּלִפָּה שֶׁהוּא בִּגְדֵי עֵשָׂו, — **meaning that the mud is only the outer shell, the garments of Esau,** אֲבָל מַה שֶּׁבְּתוֹכוֹ הוּא רְצוֹן הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ. — **while that which is within remains the pure will of the Blessed Name.** וְזֶה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: "כִּי גֶחָלִים אַתָּה חֹתֶה וְגוֹמֵר, וַהשֵּׁם יְשַׁלֶּם לָךְ", וּכְמוֹ — **And this is what is written: "For you will heap coals, etc., and Hashem will reward you (yeshalem lach)", expounded as: "He will cause it to make peace with you (yashlimenu lach)",** שֶׁלְּסוֹף תִּתְגַּבֵּר עָלָיו וְיִשָּׁלִים אִתָּךְ. — **that ultimately you will overcome it and it will become reconciled with you.** וְעַל כֵּן בְּרֹאשׁ חֹדֶשׁ, שֶׁהוּא זְמַן כַּפָּרָה לְתַקֵּן שֹׁרֶשׁ פְּגַם הַנָּחָשׁ, — **And therefore on Rosh Chodesh, which is a time of atonement to rectify the root of the serpent's blemish,** אוֹמְרִים: "וּתְשׁוּעַת נַפְשָׁם מִיַּד שׁוֹנֵא". — **we recite: "and the salvation of their soul from the hand of the enemy."**

וּבְרֹאשׁ חֹדֶשׁ הַזְּמַן לְהִתְבָּרֵר בְּכָל הַמִּדּוֹת, — **And on Rosh Chodesh it is the time to be refined across all sefirotic attributes,** שֶׁיֵּשׁ בּוֹ גַּם כֵּן נְהִירוּ דְּעַתִּיקָא כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב (זֹהַר חֵלֶק ג' ע"ט עַמּוּד ב'),[161] — **for it also contains the radiance of Atika, as written (Zohar Part III, 79b),** וְעַל כֵּן אוֹמְרִים בְּרֹאשׁ חֹדֶשׁ קְדֻשַּׁת "כֶּתֶר", — **and therefore we recite on Rosh Chodesh the Kedushah of Keter;** שֶׁהַזְּמַן לְתַקֵּן עַד הַשֹּׁרֶשׁ שֶׁקְּשׁוּרִים בְּרֵאשִׁית הַמַּחֲשָׁבָה, — **for it is the season to rectify back to the Root where we are bound in Primordial Thought,** "כֶּתֶר עֶלְיוֹן אִיהוּ כֶּתֶר וְאִיתָא בְּמִדְרַשׁ הַנֶּעֱלָם (רֵישׁ פָּרָשַׁת וַיֵּרָא צ"ז עַמּוּד ב'):[162] — **And it states in Midrash HaNe'elam (beginning of Parashat Vayeira 97b):** "יַעֲקֹב אָבִינוּ עָשָׂה לוֹ כִּסֵּא כָּבוֹד לְעַצְמוֹ בְּעוֹלָמוֹ לְקַבֵּל תּוֹרַת צַדִּיקַיָּא, — **"Jacob our Father made for himself a throne of glory on his own to receive the Torah study of the souls of the righteous,** וְקֻדְשָׁא בְּרִיךְ הוּא אָזֵיל עִמֵּיהּ בְּכָל רֵישׁ יַרְחָא וְיַרְחָא; — **and the Holy One, Blessed be He, walks with him on each and every Rosh Chodesh;** וְכַד חָמָא נִשְׁמָתָא יְקָר דְּאִתְלְבָּשָׁא בְּלְבוּשִׁין דִּילֵיהּ, — **and when the souls behold the glory of**

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[159] **Tzidkat HaTzadik 240:1**: "Torah is a seasoning for the inclination, as our sages said. Even someone whose heart is not entirely pure, who has not completely slain the inclination, can have the inclination seasoned into something fit, if he is filled with words of Torah to the extent he needs."
Pri Tzadik answers the fear that learning while morally damaged will strengthen the forces of impurity: Torah sought as rescue can burn away their power. Tzidkat HaTzadik supplies the corresponding positive mechanism. Torah seasons the inclination into something fit even before the learner has completely purified the heart. Its condition is actual fullness of Torah, not merely bearing the title of scholar.

[160] **Chagigah 15b**: 'When Rav Dimi came from Eretz Yisrael to Babylonia, he said: In the West, Eretz Yisrael, they say: Rabbi Meir ate a half-ripe date and threw the peel away. In other words, he was able to extract the important content from the inedible shell. Rava taught: What is the meaning of that which is written: "I went down into the garden of nuts, to look at the green plants of the valley" (Song of Songs 6:11)? Why are Torah scholars compared to nuts? To tell you: Just as this nut, despite being soiled with mud and excrement, its content is not made repulsive, as only its shell is soiled; so too a Torah scholar, although he has sinned, his Torah is not made repulsive.'

[161] **Zohar, Achrei Mot 72:405-75:413**: 'R. Isaac said: 'Happy are the righteous in that many precious treasures are stored up for them in the other world, where God will have joyous converse with them, as we have laid down. Happy their portion in this world and the next, as it is written: "But let all those that put their trust in thee rejoice, let them ever shout for joy because thou defendest them, let them also that love thy name be joyful in thee" (Ps. 5, 12).''

[162] **Zohar, Vayera 97b**: 'In the Zohar (Midrash HaNe'elam, Vayera I 97b), it is taught that on every Shabbat and Rosh Chodesh, the Holy One, blessed be He, ascends and sits upon the Throne of Glory fashioned by the Patriarch Jacob to hear the novel Torah insights (chiddushei Torah) expounded by the souls of the righteous.'

the luminous mirror, the Shechinah of their Master, they bless and bow before the Holy One, etc.", וְהַיְנוּ דְּשׁוּפְרִיהּ דְּיַעֲקֹב הֲוָה שׁוּפְרִיהּ דְּאָדָם, כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב (זֹהַר חֵלֶק א׳ ל״ה עַמּוּד ב׳ וּבְשָׁאָר מְקוֹמוֹת)[163]; **— and that is because the beauty of Jacob was like the beauty of Adam (Zohar Part I, 35b and elsewhere);** וְאִיתָא בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ (שָׁם קס״ח עַמּוּד א׳)[164]: "כָּל מַאן דְּחָמֵי לְיַעֲקֹב כְּמַאן דְּאִסְתַּכַּל בְּאַסְפַּקְלַרְיָאָה דְּנְהָרָא", **— and it states in the Holy Zohar (ibid. 168a): "Whoever beholds Jacob is like one gazing into the luminous mirror",** וְהַיְנוּ שֶׁיַּעֲקֹב הָיָה כְּאָדָם הָרִאשׁוֹן קֹדֶם הַחֵקְלְקוּל, וְהוּא דְּמוּת אָדָם שֶׁעַל הַכִּסֵּא, כְּמַה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: "כְּצַלְמֵנוּ כִּדְמוּתֵנוּ". **— meaning that Jacob was like Adam prior to the fall, and he is the likeness of the Man upon the Throne, as stated: "In our image, after our likeness."** וְזֶה שֶׁאָמַר: דְּיַעֲקֹב, אַף שֶׁהוּא שֶׁמֶשׁ כָּאָמוּר, מִכָּל מָקוֹם בְּכָל רֹאשׁ חֹדֶשׁ אָזֵיל עִמֵּיהּ קוּדְשָׁא בְּרִיךְ הוּא וְכוּלֵּיהּ; **— And this is what it said: that Jacob, even though he is the sun as stated, nevertheless on every Rosh Chodesh the Holy One walks with him, etc.;** וְאָמַר: "לְקַבָּלָא אוּלְפַן נְשָׁמָתָא דְּצַדִּיקַיָּא", **— and it stated: "to receive the Torah study of the souls of the righteous",**

The moon receives without losing its work

רֹאשׁ חֹדֶשׁ הוּא חִבּוּר הַשֶּׁמֶשׁ וְהַיָּרֵחַ שֶׁהַיָּרֵחַ מְקַבֵּל מֵהַשֶּׁמֶשׁ,[165] **— for Rosh Chodesh is the conjunction of the sun and the moon where the moon receives from the sun,** וְהַיְנוּ תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה שֶׁמְּקַבֵּל מִתּוֹרָה שֶׁבִּכְתָב; וְזֶה "אוּלְפַן נְשָׁמָתָא דְּצַדִּיקַיָּא", "מַלְכוּת" **— meaning the Oral Torah, which receives from the Written Torah. This is "the study of the souls of the righteous": "Malchut—** פֶּה תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה קָרִינַן לַהּ", **— the mouth, which we call the Oral Torah,"** וּבְרֹאשׁ חֹדֶשׁ הֶאָרַת אוֹר תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה. **— and on Rosh Chodesh shines the light of the Oral Torah.**

וְכֵן גַּם עִנְיַן סְעֻדַּת רֹאשׁ חֹדֶשׁ לֹא מָצִינוּ רַק אֵצֶל שָׁאוּל הַמֶּלֶךְ, **— And likewise regarding the feast of Rosh Chodesh, we find it explicitly only by King Saul,** מִפְּנֵי שֶׁהַמֶּלֶךְ מֶרְכָּבָה לְמִדַּת מַלְכוּת, וְעַל כֵּן הוּא מַרְגִּישׁ קְדֻשַּׁת הַחֹדֶשׁ; **— because the king is the chariot for Malchut, and therefore he senses the sanctity of the new moon;** שֶׁבַּתּוֹרָה לֹא מָצִינוּ רֶמֶז לְחִיּוּב סְעֻדַּת רֹאשׁ חֹדֶשׁ. **— for in the Written Torah we find no explicit allusion to an obligation of a feast on Rosh Chodesh.** וְכֵן בַּמִּשְׁנָה מָצִינוּ רַק מִמַּה שֶׁכָּתוּב (רֹאשׁ הַשָּׁנָה כ״ג עַמּוּד ב׳)[166]: **— And likewise in the Mishnah we find it only from what is written (Rosh Hashanah 23b):** "וּסְעוּדוֹת גְּדוֹלוֹת עוֹשִׂין לָהֶם וְכוּלֵּיהּ", וְהַיְנוּ בְּעֵת קִדּוּשׁ הַחֹדֶשׁ; **— "and large meals they prepared for them, etc.", meaning at the time of sanctifying the new moon;** וְכֵן בַּמִּשְׁנָה (סַנְהֶדְרִין ע׳ עַמּוּד א׳)[167]: "אֲכַל בְּעִבּוּר הַחֹדֶשׁ", וּבַגְּמָרָא שָׁם; **— and so in the Mishnah (Sanhedrin 70a): "He ate at the intercalation of the month", and in the Gemara there;** וּבִירוּשַׁלְמִי שָׁם: **— and in the Yerushalmi there:** דְּרַבִּי יוֹחָנָן הֲוָה עָלֵיל לְכְנִישְׁתָּא בְּצַפְרָא וּמְלַקֵּט פֵּרוּרִין וְאָכֵל, וְאָמַר: "יְהֵא חֶלְקִי עִם מַאן דְּקִדֵּשׁ **— Rabbi Yochanan would enter the synagogue in the morning, gather crumbs, eat,**

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[163] **Zohar, Bereshit 42:429-44:441**: ‘We have been taught that the plants at first were like the antennae of grasshoppers, and their light was feeble, until they were planted and firmly established, when their light was augmented and they were called “cedars of Lebanon”. Adam and Eve also when they were first planted were not swathed in light nor did they emit a sweet odour; of a surety they were uprooted and replanted and duly established.’’

[164] **Zohar, Vayetzei 168a**: ‘In the Zohar (Vayetzei I 168a), it is taught that the beauty of Jacob’s countenance was the reflection of the beauty of Adam the First before the sin, and ‘whoever gazes upon the image of Jacob is like one who gazes into the Luminous Mirror (Aspaklarya HaMe’irah),’ beholding the harmony of Divine Truth.’

[165] **Tiferet Yosef, Shavuot 8**: “In truth, where does Israel obtain the power to sanctify the festivals and new moons? It is entirely because Israel possesses the holiness of Shabbat, which is fixed and enduring. As the holy Zohar says, “We receive Oral Torah from Written Torah,” so too the holiness of a festival comes from the holiness of Shabbat. Thus the view that the new moon was fixed on the first day of the week means that it followed Shabbat immediately, with no interruption between Shabbat’s holiness and that of Rosh Chodesh, so that they might recognize that all their holiness and preparation proceed from the holiness of Shabbat.”

Pri Tzadik identifies the new moon’s meeting with the sun as Oral Torah receiving from Written Torah. Tiferet Yosef explains the agency within that reception: Israel prepares vessels and extends Torah, yet its capacity derives from the prior, fixed holiness. This develops the sun-and-moon analogy into an account of human preparation dependent on divine light.

[166] **Rosh Hashanah 23b**: ‘MISHNA: There was a large courtyard in Jerusalem, which was called Beit Ya’zek. And there all the witnesses coming to testify about the new moon would gather, and the court of seventy-one judges would examine them there. And they would prepare great feasts for them, so that they would be willing and accustomed to coming and submitting their testimony.’

[167] **Sanhedrin 70a:3-4**: “If he ate in a group assembled for a mitzvah; ate at the meal for intercalating the month; ate second-tithe produce in Jerusalem; ate carcasses, animals with fatal defects, repulsive creatures, or creeping things; or ate untithed produce, first tithe from which its terumah had not been removed, or unredeemed second tithe or consecrated property, the following exemption applies: If he ate something that fulfills a mitzvah or something that constitutes a transgression, or ate any food without eating meat, or drank any drink without drinking wine, he does not become a stubborn and rebellious son. He becomes one only when he eats meat and drinks wine, as it says, ‘A glutton and a drunkard.’ Although there is no conclusive proof, there is an allusion to the matter in the verse, ‘Do not be among wine drinkers, among those who gorge themselves on meat.’”

יַרְחָא הָכָא רומְשָׁא". — **and say: "May my portion be with those who sanctified the month here last night."**
וּבֶאֱמֶת לֹא מָצִינוּ לְשׁוֹן "קְדֻשָּׁה" לְרֹאשׁ חֹדֶשׁ, — **And in truth we find no scriptural term of "sanctity" ascribed directly to Rosh Chodesh;** רַק בְּתוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה מָצִינוּ: — **only in the Oral Torah do we find:** רֹאשׁ בֵּית דִּין אוֹמֵר "מְקֻדָּשׁ", וְכָל הָעָם עוֹנִין אַחֲרָיו "מְקֻדָּשׁ" (רֹאשׁ הַשָּׁנָה כ״ד עַמּוּד א׳);[168] — **the Head of the Court declares "Sanctified!", and all the people respond after him "Sanctified! Sanctified!" (Rosh Hashanah 24a);**

Why the new moon's holiness is difficult to sense

וְהַבֵּית דִּין בְּעֵת קִדּוּשׁ הַחֹדֶשׁ עָשׂוּ סְעוּדוֹת מִפְּנֵי שֶׁאָז הִרְגִּישׁוּ קְדֻשַּׁת הַחֹדֶשׁ;[169] — **and the Court at the time of sanctifying the new moon made feasts because then they experienced the holiness of the month;** וְכֵן הַמֶּלֶךְ, שֶׁהָיָה מֶרְכָּבָה לְמִדַּת מַלְכוּת, הִרְגִּישׁ קְדֻשַּׁת הַחֹדֶשׁ וְעָשָׂה סְעוּדָה. — **and likewise the king, who was the chariot for Malchut, felt the holiness of the month and made a feast.**

Lasting kingship follows the removal of its root enemy

וְאִם הָיָה מְקַיֵּם מִחְיַת עֲמָלֵק, הָיָה אָז גְּמַר הַתִּקּוּן;[170] — **And Saul was the first king,** וְשָׁאוּל הָיָה הַמֶּלֶךְ הָרִאשׁוֹן, — **and had he fulfilled the blotting out of Amalek, then would have been the final rectification;** וְעִקַּר הַשָּׂעִיר בְּרֹאשׁ חֹדֶשׁ אִיתָא בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ (חֵלֶק א׳ קל״ח עַמּוּד ב׳):[171] — **and the essential meaning of the he-goat on Rosh Chodesh, as stated in the Zohar (Part I, 138b):** "חַד שָׂעִיר בְּגִין לְאַמְשָׁכָא לֵיהּ לְאַתְרֵיהּ וְיִתְפְּרַשׁ מִן סִיהֲרָא וְכוּלֵיהּ, עַיֵּן שָׁם", — **"One goat in order to draw it back to its place so it separates from the moon, etc., see there",** וְזֶה מְחִיַּת עֲמָלֵק שֶׁנִּצְטַוָּה שָׁאוּל. וְאַף שֶׁהָעִקָּר מַלְכוּת בֵּית דָּוִד מִשֵּׁבֶט יְהוּדָה, — **and this is identical to the blotting out of Amalek commanded to Saul. And even though the primary kingship is the House of David from the tribe of Judah,** מִכָּל מָקוֹם כֵּיוָן שֶׁנִּצְטַוָּה שָׁאוּל עַל מְחִיַּת עֲמָלֵק, — **nevertheless since Saul was commanded to eradicate Amalek,** שֶׁאֵינוֹ נוֹפֵל אֶלָּא בְּיַד בָּנֶיהָ שֶׁל רָחֵל כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב (בְּרֵאשִׁית רַבָּה פָּרָשָׁה ע״ג),[172] — **who falls only by the hand of Rachel's descendants (Bereishit Rabbah 73),** דַּעֲמָלֵק רֵאשִׁית דִּקְלִפָּה, — **for Amalek is the head of the unholy husk,** וְכֶתֶר עֶלְיוֹן אִיהוּ כֶּתֶר מַלְכוּת, — **and Keter Elyon is the crown of Malchut,** מֶלֶךְ שֶׁהוּא מֶרְכָּבָה לְמִדָּה זוֹ יָכוֹל לְכָבְשָׁהּ; — **a king who is the chariot for this attribute can subdue it;** מָשִׁי"ח בְּגִימַטְרִיָּא נָחָ"שׁ כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בְּסִפְרֵי הַקֹּדֶשׁ, וְהוּא יִתֵּן הַכֹּל. — **Mashiach (358) equals numerically Nachash (serpent - 358) as**

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[168] **Rosh Hashanah 24a:9-10**: "Mishnah: The head of the court says, 'Sanctified,' and all the people answer after him, 'Sanctified, sanctified.' Whether the new moon was seen at its expected time or was not seen at its expected time, the court sanctifies the month. Rabbi Elazar son of Rabbi Tzadok says: If it was not seen at its expected time, they do not sanctify it, because Heaven has already sanctified it."

[169] **Machshavot Charutz 8:18**: "The general principle of Rosh Chodesh is the perception of a future light. Concerning the future it is said, "From new moon to new moon, and from Shabbat to Shabbat, all flesh shall come to bow before Me." The month is placed before Shabbat, implying that its holiness will be greater than the holiness of Shabbat, which is fixed and enduring. The month, which Israel sanctifies, will be greater when it becomes a fixed, enduring holiness, in the manner of "One of us, when he goes there, is worth two of them." Then the holiness of the month will be revealed, corresponding to Israel, who are destined to be renewed like it. In this world their renewed holiness each month is not apparent. Therefore it is not so fully a festival; it is established in anticipation of the disclosure of holiness in it in the future."

Pri Tzadik explains the special meals of the king and the court through their felt perception of Rosh Chodesh's holiness. Machshavot Charutz clarifies why this perception is distinctive: monthly renewal is not yet plainly visible to everyone, and the day anticipates a fuller future disclosure. Its later focus on Nisan is a particular instance; the selected statement concerns Rosh Chodesh generally.

[170] **Tzidkat HaTzadik 176:1**: "The wiping out of Amalek always comes first. Therefore the holiness of the place did not cease: the first sanctification sanctified it for its own time and for the future, even when it stands desolate. The kingship of David's house, however, ceased for a time, because then it preceded the wiping out of Amalek. In the future, the name of the Messiah will have no interruption, because it comes afterward. Likewise with the lesser elevation associated with a small sanctuary in exile: when the wiping out of Amalek—that is, the root of evil—and the holiness of the place precede the elevation of the soul's holiness, it has no interruption."

Pri Tzadik says that Saul's fulfillment of the command against Amalek could have brought complete repair. Tzidkat HaTzadik explains the importance of sequence: a kingship established before the root of evil has been removed can suffer interruption, whereas future kingship follows that removal. Its application to a small sanctuary extends the pattern without turning Pri Tzadik's counterfactual about Saul into a claim that he fulfilled it.

[171] **Zohar, Toldot 4:30-9:73**: 'In the Zohar (Toldot I 138b), the mystery of the New Moon sin-offering (the Sa'ir, he-goat of Rosh Chodesh) is explained: just as Isaac desired the savory delicacies of two kid goats to draw blessing while giving Esau his portion, so too on every Rosh Chodesh a single he-goat is offered so that the prosecuting force of Esau/Sitra Achra is occupied with its portion while Israel unites undisturbed with the King in the renewal of the moon.'

[172] **Bereshit Rabbah 73:7** (excerpt): "'When Rachel had borne Joseph' (Genesis 30:25): Once Joseph was born, Esau's adversary was born. Therefore it says, 'Jacob said to Laban: Send me away, and let me go to my place and my land.' Rabbi Pinchas said in the name of Rabbi Shmuel bar Nachman: It is a received tradition that Esau falls only into the hands of Rachel's descendants. This is what is written: 'Surely the youngest of the flock shall drag them away' (Jeremiah 49:20). Why does it call them 'the youngest of the flock'? Because they are the youngest among the tribes."

written in holy books, and he will rectify everything. וְאִם הָיָה שָׁאוּל מְקַיֵּם הַצִּוּוּי לִמְחוֹת זֵכֶר עֲמָלֵק, הָיָה הוּא מָשִׁיחַ בֶּן יוֹסֵף: — **And had Saul fulfilled the command to blot out the memory of Amalek, he would have been the Messiah son of Joseph;** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁכָּתַב הָרַמַ"ע מִפָּאנוֹ עַל מַה שֶּׁאָמַר יְהוֹנָתָן: "וְאָנֹכִי אֶהְיֶה לְךָ לְמִשְׁנֶה", — **and as the Rama of Fano wrote on Jonathan's words: "and I shall be second to you",** שֶׁהָיָה כַּוָּנָתוֹ שֶׁיִּהְיֶה מָשִׁיחַ בֶּן יוֹסֵף; — **that his intention was to become the Messiah son of Joseph;** וְכֵן הָיָה שָׁאוּל מָשִׁיחַ בֶּן יוֹסֵף אִם הָיָה מְקַיֵּם מְחִיַּת עֲמָלֵק; — **and likewise Saul would have been Messiah son of Joseph had he executed Amalek's destruction;** וְשָׁאוּל נִקְרָא גַּם כֵּן "מְשִׁיחַ הַשֵּׁם". — **and Saul is indeed termed "the anointed of Hashem".**

The new moon can reveal another person's irreplaceable part

וְהָיָה, וְאָז[173] שֶׁלֹּא הִתְפַּשֵּׁט עֲדַיִן מַלְכוּת בֵּית דָּוִד, — **And then, when the kingship of David had not yet expanded,** שָׁאוּל מֶרְכָּבָה לְמִדַּת מַלְכוּת שֶׁהָיָה מֶלֶךְ רִאשׁוֹן בְּיִשְׂרָאֵל, עָשָׂה סְעֻדַּת רֹאשׁ חֹדֶשׁ. — **and Saul was the chariot for Malchut being the first king in Israel, he made a Rosh Chodesh feast.** וְכֵן כָּל אֶחָד מִיִּשְׂרָאֵל, כְּמָה שֶׁמַּרְגִּישׁ בְּנַפְשׁוֹ מִקְדֻּשַּׁת רֹאשׁ חֹדֶשׁ — **And so every single Jew, to the extent that he senses in his soul the sanctity of Rosh Chodesh** שֶׁהוּא זְמַן כַּפָּרָה וְכוּלֵיהּ וּתְשׁוּעַת נַפְשָׁם מִיַּד שׁוֹנֵא, — **which is a time of atonement, etc., and salvation of their soul from the enemy,** כְּפִי זֶה צָרִיךְ לְהַרְבּוֹת בִּסְעֻדַּת רֹאשׁ חֹדֶשׁ; — **accordingly should he enhance his Rosh Chodesh feast;** רַק נִרְמַז בְּשָׁאוּל הַמֶּלֶךְ וּבְבֵית דִּין בְּעֵת קִדּוּשׁ הַחֹדֶשׁ, — **only it was explicitly modeled in King Saul and in the Court at the sanctification of the moon,** שֶׁהֵם הִרְגִּישׁוּ קְדֻשַּׁת הַחֹדֶשׁ בְּיִחוּד כָּאמוּר. — **because they sensed the holiness of the month in a distinct and elevated manner as stated.**

[173] **Tiferet Yosef, Machar Chodesh Haftarah 1**: "The blessed God had begun to lead through the kingship of David's house. King Saul did not recognize that the divine glory which could come through David could in no way come through him. He imagined instead that he too could bring about the divine glory that David would bring. Therefore Jonathan said to David, "Tomorrow is the new moon": there will be a renewal of words of Torah. "You will be remembered, because your seat will be missed": perhaps through that renewal of Torah Saul will recognize that the divine glory which can come through you cannot in any way come through him. When he has that recognition, he will have no complaint against you, for he will clearly understand that no one touches what is prepared for another, and he will have no desire for the kingship."
Pri Tzadik links Saul's Rosh Chodesh meal with his place as the first royal bearer of holiness, while retaining the distinct future of David's house. Tiferet Yosef reads the same new-moon setting as an opportunity for Saul to recognize that David can disclose a form of divine glory Saul cannot supply. This illuminates a concrete moral demand of renewal. It concerns the actual transition to David and does not erase Pri Tzadik's conditional account of what Saul might have accomplished against Amalek.

Rosh Chodesh Kislev Ois 2

Kislev, the Letter Samech, and the Wisdom of Sleep

Monthly renewal is a fresh degree of recognition, whose unrestricted form is the future new song.

Kislev, the Letter Samech, and the Wisdom of Sleep

כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב, שְׁמוֹת חֳדָשִׁים עָלוּ מִבָּבֶל — **The names of the months ascended with them from Babylonia,** (בִּירוּשַׁלְמִי פֶּרֶק א׳ דְּרֹאשׁ הַשָּׁנָה וּבְבְרֵאשִׁית רַבָּה פָּרָשָׁה מ״ח)[174, 175]; — **as written (in Yerushalmi Rosh Hashanah 1:2 and Bereishit Rabbah 48);** שֶׁבַּתּוֹרָה הוּזְכַּר רַק מִסְפַּר הַחֹדֶשׁ לְנִיסָן: "בַּחֹדֶשׁ הַשְּׁלִישִׁי", "בַּחֹדֶשׁ הַשְּׁבִיעִי", — **for in the Torah only the ordinal number of the month relative to Nisan was mentioned: "in the third month", "in the seventh month",** וְאַחַר כָּךְ בִּנְחֶמְיָה הוּזְכְּרוּ בִּשְׁמוֹת. — **and afterward in Nehemiah they were mentioned by proper names.**

New Torah belongs to a living encounter

וְהָעִנְיָן, שֶׁמִּתְחִלָּה כְּשֶׁהָיָה בֵּית הַמִּקְדָּשׁ קַיָּם כְּתִיב: "זֹאת עֹלַת חֹדֶשׁ בְּחָדְשׁוֹ",[176] — **And the explanation is: initially, when the Holy Temple was standing, it is written: "This is the burnt-offering of every month in its month",** וְכֵן כְּתִיב: "וְהָיָה מִדֵּי — **for in every month they palpably felt a distinct sanctity;** שֶׁבְּכָל חֹדֶשׁ הִרְגִּישׁוּ קְדֻשָּׁה מְיֻחֶדֶת; חֹדֶשׁ בְּחָדְשׁוֹ וּמִדֵּי שַׁבָּת בְּשַׁבַּתּוֹ וְגוֹמֵר", — **and so it is written: "And it shall come to pass, that from one new moon to another, and from one sabbath to another, etc.",** שֶׁבְּכָל חֹדֶשׁ מִתְחַדֵּשׁ עִנְיָן מְחֻדָּשׁ בְּדִבְרֵי תוֹרָה וְכֵן בְּכָל שַׁבָּת וְשַׁבָּת;[177] — **for in every month a novel spiritual insight is renewed in Torah words, and likewise on every single Shabbat;** וְכֵן בְּכָל שָׁנָה מִתְחַדֵּשׁ בְּרֹאשׁ הַשָּׁנָה חִדּוּשׁ עִנְיָן מְחֻדָּשׁ בַּתּוֹרָה, — **and so in every year on Rosh Hashanah a novel theme is renewed in the Torah,** וְכֵן מִתְחַדֵּשׁ בְּכָל הַשָּׁנָה בְּכָל חֹדֶשׁ וּבְכָל שַׁבָּת. — **and likewise throughout the year in every month and on every Shabbat.** וּמַעֲיִן זֶה מָצִינוּ (סַנְהֶדְרִין ק״ג עַמּוּד ב׳):[178] — **And similar to this we find (Sanhedrin 103b):** "מְנַשֶּׁה הָיָה שׁוֹנֶה חֲמִשִּׁים וַחֲמִשָּׁה פָּנִים בְּתוֹרַת כֹּהֲנִים כְּנֶגֶד שְׁנֵי מַלְכוּתוֹ", — **"Manasseh studied fifty-five interpretations in Torat Kohanim corresponding to the years of his reign",** וּפֵרֵשׁ רַבִּי שְׁלֹמֹה יִצְחָקִי: "סֵפֶר וַיִּקְרָא הָיָה מְחֻדָּשׁ בּוֹ בְּכָל שָׁנָה וְשָׁנָה וְדוֹרְשׁוֹ מִפְלְפּוּלוֹ, עַיֵּן שָׁם" — **and Rashi explained: "in the Book of Leviticus he would innovate each and every year, expounding it through his dialectic, see there"** (וְנִתְבָּאֵר פָּרָשַׁת בְּרֵאשִׁית מַאֲמָר ד׳);[179] — **(and this was explained in Parashat Bereshit, discourse 4);** וְהָיָה לָהֶם הֶרְגֵּשׁ הִתְחַדְּשׁוּת הַדִּבְרֵי תוֹרָה בְּכָל שַׁבָּת וּבְכָל חֹדֶשׁ. — **and they possessed a tangible sensation of the renewal of Torah words on every Shabbat and on every new moon.** וְאַחַר כָּךְ, כְּשֶׁנִּשְׁכַּח מֵהֶם הַהֶרְגֶּשָׁה בְּחִדּוּשׁ הַתּוֹרָה, — **And afterward, when the experiential sensation of Torah renewal was forgotten from them,** וְכֵן לְאַחַר חֻרְבַּן בֵּית הַמִּקְדָּשׁ שֶׁלֹּא הָיָה עוֹלַת חֹדֶשׁ בְּחָדְשׁוֹ, — **and likewise after the destruction of the Temple when the monthly burnt-offering no longer existed,** אָז תִּקְּנוּ אַנְשֵׁי כְּנֶסֶת הַגְּדוֹלָה

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[174] **Jerusalem Talmud Rosh Hashanah 1:2**: ‘Rabbi Chanina said: The names of the months—Nisan, Iyar, Sivan, Tammuz, Av, Elul, Tishrei, Marcheshvan, Kislev, Tevet, Shevat, Adar—ascended with Israel in their hands from Babylonia, whereas previously in the Torah the months were counted ordinally from the Exodus (‘the first month,’ ‘the month,’ ‘the seventh month’).’

[175] **Bereshit Rabbah 48:9** (excerpt): “Rabbi Chanina said: The names of the months came up from Babylonia.”

[176] **Resisei Layla 8:2**: “In the future there will be a new song. As the Midrash on Psalms explains “Singers and dancers …,” in the future they will sing a new song at every moment. Just as the blessed God has neither boundary nor end, so apprehension of Him has no boundary. At every moment they will attain recognition of His presence at a renewed and added level, without limit. In this world, which is bounded, apprehension is also bounded. But in the future it will be called a new song because it will continually be new. Song comes from recognition; at every moment there will be renewed recognition and a new song. There will be no moment when they sing a song already sung in the preceding moment. Thus the song will always be new. This is the meaning of Rosh Chodesh.”

Pri Tzadik says that a distinct renewal of Torah was once felt in each month and Shabbat, and that the month names preserve a direction for this work when that feeling is lost. Resisei Layla explains why renewed recognition brings renewed expression: God is without limit, and apprehension can therefore keep growing. The quotation describes the future’s unrestricted renewal, giving depth to the present calendar without claiming that every present-day feeling is a new revelation.

[177] **Peri Tzadik, Vayetzei 3:3**: “In the Rav’s Siddur, on the verse “From new moon to its new moon,” he asks why it says “its new moon.” We may say that a month is named for renewal. Thus “its new moon” hints that each Rosh Chodesh has a different renewal: each of the twelve months of the year has its own arrangement of the letters of the divine Name, its own one of the twelve simple letters, and its own bodily organ, as stated in Sefer Yetzirah. Likewise, in every year each Rosh Chodesh has a new renewal. “From Sabbath to its Sabbath” also hints at this: each Sabbath has a fresh renewal of holiness. Hence it is called a bride each and every Sabbath. A woman is a bride only once, during the seven days of celebration; but every Sabbath has a different, newly shining holiness.”

[178] **Sanhedrin 103b**: ‘§ The Sages taught in a baraita: Manasseh, king of Judea, would study fifty-five different aspects in interpreting Torat Kohanim, the halakhic midrash on Leviticus, corresponding to the years of his reign, indicating that he possessed great knowledge. Ahab was greater and studied eighty-five aspects, and Jeroboam was greater still and studied one hundred and three aspects.’

[179] **Tikkunei Zohar 77b:4-78a:3**: ‘In Tikkunei Zohar (Tikkun 36, 77b), the verse ‘Let there be light, and there was light’ is expounded on the two heads of the year: ‘Let there be light (Yehi Ohr)’ refers to Nisan and Passover, when the light of Chesed shines from Above; ‘and there was light (Vayehi Ohr)’ refers to Tishrei and Rosh Hashanah, when Israel awakens the light of Torah from below through judgment and repentance.’

שֶׁיִּסְּדוּ תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה וְתִקְנוּ שְׁמוֹת הַחֳדָשִׁים. — **then the Men of the Great Assembly who founded the Oral Torah established the names of the months.**

וּמָצִינוּ בַּמִּדְרָשׁ (וַיִּקְרָא רַבָּה פָּרָשָׁה כ״ט) עַל "תִּשְׁרֵי": "תִּשְׁרֵי[180] — **And we find in the Midrash (Vayikra Rabbah, Parashah 29) on the name Tishrei: –** תִּשְׁרֵי וְתִשְׁבּוֹק וּתְכַפֵּר עַל חוֹבֵי עַמָּךְ", — **"Tishrei — may You release (tishrei), pardon, and atone for the debts of Your people",** וְשֵׁם הַחֹדֶשׁ מוֹרֶה עַל הַמְּקֻנָּן מֵהַחֹדֶשׁ. וְהַיְנוּ שֶׁבּוֹ יוֹם הַכִּפּוּרִים, — **which means that in it falls Yom Kippur, and the name of the month indicates the inner objective of that month.**

Confidence rests on help beyond yesterday's victory

וְשֵׁם חֹדֶשׁ זֶה "כִּסְלֵו",[181] — **And the name of this month is Kislev,** וְהוּא מִלְּשׁוֹן: "אִם שַׂמְתִּי זָהָב כִּסְלִי", — **and it is from the root: "If I have made gold my confidence (kisli)",** וְכֵן: "כִּי הַשֵּׁם יִהְיֶה בְכִסְלֶךָ", — **and likewise: "For Hashem shall be your confidence (be-chislecha)",** שֶׁהוּא לְשׁוֹן מִבְטָח עֹז; — **which is an expression of strong trust;** נִרְאֶה שֶׁעִקַּר חֹדֶשׁ זֶה: שֶׁכָּל אֶחָד מִיִּשְׂרָאֵל יִהְיֶה לוֹ מִבְטָח עֹז בַּהַשֵּׁם. — **it appears that the spiritual work of this month is that every Jew possess an unshakeable trust in Hashem.**

וּבְסֵפֶר יְצִירָה: "הִמְלִיךְ אוֹת סָמֶ״ךְ בְּשֵׁינָה וְכוּלֵיהּ, וְכִסְלֵו בַּשָּׁנָה". — **And in Sefer Yetzirah: "He crowned the letter Samech over sleep, etc., and Kislev in the year."**

אוֹת סָמֶ״ךְ, אֵיתָא בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ (חֶלֶק א׳ ג׳ עַמּוּד א׳):[182] — **Regarding the letter Samech, it states in the Holy Zohar (Part I, 3a):** שֶׁאָמַר לָהּ: "אַנְתְּ צְרִיכָא לְאַתְרָךְ וְכוּלֵיהּ, — **that God said to it: "You are needed in your place, etc.,** נְפִילִין דְּאִנּוּן סְמִיכִין עָלָךְ וְכוּלֵיהּ"; — **for the fallen are supported by you, etc.";** אַף עַל פִּי כֵן חָזַר דָּוִד וְסָמָכָן בְּרוּחַ הַקֹּדֶשׁ, שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: וּבַגְּמָרָא (בְּרָכוֹת ד׳ עַמּוּד ב׳):[183] — **and in the Gemara (Berachot 4b):** "**Even so David returned and supported them with the Holy Spirit, as it is said: 'Hashem supports all who fall'."** סוֹמֵךְ הַשֵּׁם לְכָל הַנֹּפְלִים'".

וְשֵׁינָה, אֵיתָא (בְּרֵאשִׁית רַבָּה פָּרָשָׁה י״ז):[184] — **And regarding sleep, it states (Bereishit Rabbah, Parashah 17): –** תְּחִלַּת מַפָּלָה שֵׁינָה; דָּמַיִךְ לֵיהּ וְלָא לָעֵי בְּאוֹרַיְתָא וְכוּלֵיהּ"; — **"The beginning of a downfall is sleep: he sleeps and does not labor in the Torah, etc.";** וּלְעֵיל (שָׁם פָּרָשָׁה ט׳) אֵיתָא: "'וְהִנֵּה טוֹב מְאֹד'"[185] — **yet earlier (ibid., Parashah 9) it states: –** טוֹבָה שֵׁינָה; — **"'And behold, it was very good' — sleep is good;** וְכִי שֵׁינָה טוֹב מְאֹד, לֹא כֵן תְּנֵינָן: 'יַיִן וְשֵׁינָה וְכוּלֵיהּ'? — **is sleep then very good; did we not learn: 'Wine and sleep for the wicked are good for them and good for the world'?** אֶלָּא מִתּוֹךְ שֶׁאָדָם יָשֵׁן קִימְעָא הוּא עוֹמֵד וְיָגֵעַ בַּתּוֹרָה הַרְבֵּה"; — **Rather, because a person sleeps a little, he arises and labors in the Torah much";** וְהַיְנוּ שֶׁיֵּשׁ שֵׁינָה שֶׁהוּא טוֹב מְאֹד, וְיֵשׁ רַע לָהֶם וְכוּלֵיהּ"; — **meaning that there is a sleep which is 'very good', – and there is an evil sleep, as we learned in our Mishnah: 'and for the righteous — it is bad for them, etc.';** שֵׁינָה רָעָה, דְּתָנַן בְּמַתְנִיתִין: "וְלַצַּדִּיקִים — וּכְמוֹ שֶׁחוֹשֵׁב בַּמִּדְרָשׁ רַבָּה: שָׁלֹשׁ תַּרְדֵּמוֹת: תַּרְדֵּמַת שֵׁינָה, תַּרְדֵּמַת נְבוּאָה וְכוּלֵיהּ. — **and as it enumerates in Midrash Rabbah: three types of deep slumber: slumber of sleep, slumber of prophecy, etc.** דְּשֵׁינָה, אֵיתָא

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[180] **Vayikra Rabbah 29:8** (excerpt): "'To rise upon the scales' (Psalms 62:10): Through the scales, atonement is made for them—in the month whose constellation is the scales. Which month is this? Tishrei: 'May You release, forgive, and atone for the debts of Your people.' When? 'In the seventh month.'"

[181] **Tzidkat HaTzadik 51:1**: "All a person's effort in breaking the inclination in matters of desire is called only grace and beauty, which are false and fleeting, since they do not endure forever: the inclination grows stronger every day, and perhaps tomorrow he will not overcome it. The essential thing is to ask the blessed God to help him. This is a faithful ground of trust, for his Redeemer lives."
Pri Tzadik reads Kislev as strong trust and the letter samekh as support for those who fall. Tzidkat HaTzadik specifies the object of that trust: seeking God's help, rather than treating one's own previous conquest of the inclination as permanently secure. This anticipates Kislev7's explicit insistence on effort and prayer.

[182] **Zohar, Introduction 6:28-38**: 'At that moment, the Kaph descended from its throne of glory and quaking and trembling said: O Lord of the universe, may it please Thee to begin through me the creation of the world, seeing that I am Thine own Kabod (honour). And when Kaph descended from its throne of glory, two hundred thousand worlds began to shake, the throne trembled, and all the worlds quaked and were about to fall in ruins. Said to her the Holy One, blessed be His Name: Kaph, Kaph, what doest thou here? I will not create the world with thee. Go back to thy place, since thou standest for extermination (Kelayah). Return, then, to thy place and remain there. Immediately she departed and returned to her own place.'

[183] **Berakhot 4b:22**: "In the Land of Israel they explained the verse this way: 'She has fallen and will fall no more; arise, maiden of Israel.' Rav Nachman bar Yitzchak said: Even so, David returned and upheld them through the holy spirit, as it says, 'The Lord supports all who fall.'"

[184] **Bereshit Rabbah 17:5** (excerpt): "'Hashem God caused a deep sleep to fall' (Genesis 2:21). Rabbi Yehoshua of Sikhnin said in the name of Rabbi Levi: The beginning of downfall is sleep: a person sleeps and does not labor in Torah, and does not attend to his work."

[185] **Bereshit Rabbah 9:6**: 'Rabbi Shimon ben Elazar said: "And behold it was very good" – and behold sleep is good. Is sleep, then, very good? This is a rhetorical question. Did we not learn: Wine and sleep are beneficial for them the wicked and beneficial for the whole world? 5:5. However, as a result of a person sleeping a bit, he can get up and toil extensively in the Torah.'

בַּגְּמָרָא (בְּרָכוֹת נ״ז עַמּוּד ב׳)[186] שֶׁהוּא אֶחָד מִשִּׁשִּׁים לְמִיתָה, וּבַמִּדְרָשׁ רַבָּה שָׁם הַלָּשׁוֹן: "נוֹבְלוֹת מִיתָה שֵׁינָה". — **For sleep, it states in the Gemara (Berachot 57b), is one-sixtieth of death, – and in the Midrash Rabbah there the phrasing is: "The unripe fruit of death is sleep".** וְאִיתָא בַּסְּפָרִים: דְּאַף דְּמִיתָה נִקְנַס אָדָם הָרִאשׁוֹן בִּקְלָלָה, מִכָּל מָקוֹם אַחַר הַקִּלְקוּל נִצְרַךְ הַמִּיתָה לְטוֹבַת הָאָדָם, שֶׁהַרְבֵּה דְּבָרִים שֶׁלֹּא יוּכַל לְהַשִּׂיג כְּשֶׁהוּא בַּגּוּף, וּמַשִּׂיג אַחַר הַמִּיתָה; רַק קֹדֶם הַקִּלְקוּל שֶׁהָיָה גּוּפוֹ מְזֻכָּךְ לֹא נִצְרַךְ תִּקּוּן הַמִּיתָה. — **And it states in holy books: that although death was penalized upon Adam as a curse, nevertheless after the fall, death became necessary for the ultimate benefit of man, for there are many spiritual matters that he cannot perceive while bound in the physical body, yet perceives after death; only prior to the sin, when his body was completely refined, the purification of death was not needed.**

Revelation must be receivable

וְעַל פִּי זֶה פֵּרֵשׁ מוֹרֵנוּ הָרַב יַעֲקֹב בֵּירַב זִכְרוֹנוֹ לִבְרָכָה מַה שֶּׁנֶּאֱמַר:[187] "וְעַתָּה לָמָּה נָמוּת וְגוֹמֵר, אִם יֹסְפִים אֲנַחְנוּ לִשְׁמֹעַ אֶת קוֹל ה׳ אֱלֹהֵינוּ עוֹד וָמָתְנוּ": — **And based on this, our master Rabbi Yaakov Berab, of blessed memory, explained what Scripture states: "Now therefore why should we die, etc., if we hear the voice of Hashem our God any more, then we shall die":** שֶׁאַף שֶׁרָאוּ שֶׁדִּבֶּר הַשֵּׁם עִמָּהֶם וָחָיוּ, אַךְ אָמְרוּ: "הַיּוֹם הַזֶּה רָאִינוּ כִּי יְדַבֵּר אֱלֹהִים אֶת הָאָדָם וָחָי", וְעַתָּה שֶׁנּוּכַל לָזֹאת בַּחַיִּים, לָמָּה נָמוּת, לָמָּה לָנוּ תִּקּוּן הַמִּיתָה? "אִם יֹסְפִים אֲנַחְנוּ לִשְׁמֹעַ וְגוֹמֵר", הַיְנוּ בְּתוֹסֶפֶת מַדְרֵגָה גְּבוֹהָה מִמַּה שֶׁזָּכִינוּ בַּחַיִּים, נִצְרַךְ הַמִּיתָה, עַד כָּאן תֹּכֶן דְּבָרָיו. — **— even though they saw that God spoke with them and they lived, — yet they said: "we have seen this day that God talks with man, and he lives", — and now that we can attain this in physical life, why should we die, why do we need the purification of death? — "If we hear any more, etc." — meaning in an added, higher spiritual degree beyond what we merited in life, — "then we shall die" — only then would death be necessary, up to here is the substance of his words.**

Dreams can carry insight within a mixed form

וְכֵן הַשֵּׁינָה, שֶׁהוּא אֶחָד מִשִּׁשִּׁים לְמִיתָה, גַּם כֵּן לְתוֹעֶלֶת זֶה:[188] שֶׁיּוּכַל לְהַשִּׂיג בְּשֵׁינָה מַה שֶּׁלֹּא יוּכַל לְהַשִּׂיג בְּהָקִיץ בְּשׁוּם אֹפֶן, כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתְבוּ עַל הָאֲרִיזַ"ל שֶׁפַּעַם אַחַת אָמַר: שֶׁקִּבֵּל וְהִשִּׂיג בְּשֵׁינָה בְּשַׁבָּת בְּפָרָשַׁת בָּלָק מַה שֶּׁלֹּא יוּכַל לִדְרֹשׁ שְׁמוֹנִים שָׁנָה; וְהוּא כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בַּגְּמָרָא: "חֲלוֹם — **— And so sleep, which is one-sixtieth of death, is likewise for this benefit: — that one can grasp in sleep that which he cannot grasp awake in any manner, — as they recorded regarding the Arizal, who once said: — that he received and perceived in sleep on Shabbat in Parashat Balak what he could not finish expounding in eighty years; –** אֶחָד מִשִּׁשִּׁים לִנְבוּאָה", וּבַמִּדְרָשׁ רַבָּה: "נוֹבְלוֹת נְבוּאָה

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[186] **Berakhot 57b**: ‘The numbers five, six, and ten are mnemonics for the categories to follow. The Gemara says: There are five matters in our world which are one-sixtieth of their most extreme manifestations. They are: Fire, honey, Shabbat, sleep, and a dream. The Gemara elaborates: Our fire is one-sixtieth of the fire of Gehenna; honey is one-sixtieth of manna; Shabbat is one-sixtieth of the World-to-Come; sleep is one-sixtieth of death; and a dream is one-sixtieth of prophecy.’

[187] **Sod Yesharim, Shabbat Chol HaMoed Sukkot 29:2**: “Moses our teacher is always the intermediary between Israel and their Father in heaven. Thus, when Israel said, “Now why should we die, for this great fire will consume us? If we continue to hear …,” Moses told them, “I stood between the Lord and you.” His light is as our sages said: before the Divine Presence the righteous resemble a lamp before a torch. A torch’s light is described there as frightening and flickering. Moses’ entire work is to bring His light to Israel by degrees, so that they have the capacity to receive it.”
Pri Tzadik preserves his teacher’s reading of “Why should we die?” as a question about the need for the repair of death after receiving revelation while alive. Sod Yesharim reads the same words through Moses’ mediation: illumination must arrive by degrees so that Israel can receive it. These are distinct readings of the verse, but the target clarifies the problem of receptive capacity that makes Pri Tzadik’s discussion intelligible.

[188] **Tzidkat HaTzadik 203:1**: “A dream during sleep, when it is not in one’s power or choice to purify one’s thoughts—and likewise the thoughts and imaginings of every Israelite that resemble a dream—is one-sixtieth of the truth of the imaginative faculty, namely prophecy. A true interpretation is clothed even in these, and true wisdom proceeding from the mind’s wisdom, understanding, and knowledge is hinted within them. Yet much that is empty is mixed in, in accordance with “There is no dream without idle elements.” In Likkutei Torah on Vayeshev, a dream is explained as expanded consciousness within contracted consciousness. Idle imaginings similarly belong to contracted consciousness. In Israel, each of whom has a root in Torah, which is truth and not imagination, expanded consciousness is hidden within contracted consciousness. Still, because the smallness surrounds it, there must be an idle element, although there is also grain within it. The one able to understand the inner content of all these imaginings is someone free of desires: Joseph in the desire for women, and Daniel in the desire for food, were interpreters of dreams. The root of idle thoughts is in desires about which the heart wishes to think. Someone immersed in imagination cannot exchange and extract the true matter clothed within those imaginings. Someone not immersed in it can separate the good from the evil.”
Pri Tzadik explains how sleep can make an otherwise inaccessible attainment possible and cites a dream as one-sixtieth of prophecy. Tzidkat HaTzadik explains both sides of that measure: true wisdom may be clothed in the dream, yet much that is empty is mixed into it. Its further requirement of freedom from the desire being interpreted prevents a general license to treat dreams as reliable guidance.

and it is as written in the Gemara: "A dream is one-sixtieth of prophecy", – חֲלוֹם". **— and in Midrash Rabbah: "The unripe fruit of prophecy is a dream".**

Sleep can receive what waking awareness cannot contain

Solomon's sleep rests on a history of clarification

וּשְׁלֹמֹה הַמֶּלֶךְ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם זָכָה לְכָל חָכְמַת שְׁלֹמֹה, חָכְמָה תַּתָּאָה, עַל יְדֵי חֲלוֹם אֶחָד,[189, 190] **— And Solomon the King, peace be upon him, merited the entire wisdom of Solomon, the Lower Wisdom, through a single dream,** וּכְתִיב: "וַיֶּחְכַּם מִכָּל הָאָדָם וְגוֹמֵר", **— and it is written: "For he was wiser than all men, etc.",** וְאֵין אֹפֶן לְהַשִּׂיג חָכְמָה זוֹ בְּהָקִיץ; **— and there is no way to attain such wisdom in an awake state;** וְשֵׁינָה זוֹ טוֹב מְאֹד, **— and such sleep is 'very good',** וְהִיא תַּרְדֵּמַת נְבוּאָה שֶׁמַּשִּׂיג הַרְבֵּה בַּתּוֹרָה, **— being the slumber of prophecy wherein one grasps much in Torah,** וְעַל יְדֵי זֶה עוֹמֵד וְיָגֵעַ בַּתּוֹרָה הַרְבֵּה. **— and through this he arises and labors in Torah greatly.** וְאִיתָא בַּמִּדְרָשׁ רַבָּה (שָׁם):[191] **— And it states in Midrash Rabbah (ibid.):** "מִתְּחִלַּת הַסֵּפֶר עַד כָּאן לֹא כְּתִיב סָמֶ"ךְ; כֵּינָן שֶׁנִּבְרֵאת אִשָּׁה נִבְרָא שָׂטָן עִמָּהּ, דִּכְתִיב: 'וַיִּסְגֹּר בָּשָׂר וְגוֹמֵר'", **— "From the beginning of Genesis until here no samech is written; — once woman was created Satan was created with her, as it is written: 'and he closed up (vayisgor) the flesh, etc.'",** וְהַיְנוּ דִּבְכָל מָקוֹם שֶׁיֵּשׁ טוֹבָה גְּדוֹלָה יֵשׁ שָׂטָן שֶׁרוֹצֶה לְהַחֲרִיבוֹ; וְהִיא נִתְּנָה עַל יְדֵי תַּרְדֵּמָה, וּ"תְחִלַּת מַפָּלָה – שֵׁינָה"; וְאוֹת סָמֶ"ךְ – סוֹמֵךְ ה' לְכָל הַנֹּפְלִים". **— meaning that wherever there is a great good, an adversary seeks to ruin it; — and she was formed through deep slumber, and "the beginning of a downfall is sleep"; — and the letter Samech represents "Hashem supports (somech) all who fall".** וְהָאֲרִיזַ"ל חִשֵּׁב שְׁנֵים עָשָׂר הַחֳדָשִׁים כְּנֶגֶד שְׁנֵים עָשָׂר הַשְּׁבָטִים כְּסֵדֶר הַדְּגָלִים, **— And the Arizal reckoned the twelve months corresponding to the twelve tribes according to the banners,** וְנִמְצָא חֹדֶשׁ כִּסְלֵו נֶגֶד בִּנְיָמִין, **— and the month of Kislev corresponds to Benjamin,** דִּכְתִיב בֵּיהּ: "יְדִיד ה' יִשְׁכֹּן לָבֶטַח עָלָיו", **— of whom it is written: "The beloved of Hashem shall dwell in safety by Him",** שֶׁהוּא יֵשׁ לוֹ מִבְטָח עֹז בַּה'. **— for he possesses a strong trust in Hashem.**

וּבִשְׁלֹמֹה הַמֶּלֶךְ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם שֶׁקְּרָאוֹ הַנָּבִיא יְדִידְיָה, שֶׁהוּא יְדִידוֹ שֶׁל הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא, **— And regarding King Solomon, whom the prophet called Jedidiah (Yedidyah), meaning the beloved of the Holy One, Blessed be He,** וּכְתִיב: "שָׁוְא לָכֶם מַשְׁכִּימֵי קוּם וְגוֹמֵר אֹכְלֵי לֶחֶם הָעֲצַבִּים, כֵּן יִתֵּן לִידִידוֹ שֵׁנָא", **— and it is written: "It is vain for you that you rise early, etc., eating the bread of sorrows; for so He gives to His beloved in sleep",** וְהַיְנוּ אַחַר הַקְּלָלָה שֶׁנִּתְקַלֵּל אָדָם הָרִאשׁוֹן "בְּעִצָּבוֹן תֹּאכְלֶנָּה", **— meaning after the curse with which Adam was cursed "in sorrow shall you eat of it",** אָז גַּם דִּבְרֵי תוֹרָה שֶׁנִּקְרָא "לֶחֶם", כְּמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: "לְכוּ לַחֲמוּ בְלַחֲמִי", בָּא גַּם כֵּן בְּעִצָּבוֹן בִּיגִיעָה הַרְבֵּה, **— then even words of Torah, called "bread" as in "Come, eat of my bread", also come through toil and sorrowful exertion,** וּכְשֶׁאֵינוֹ זוֹכֶה לְהַשִּׂיג יֵשׁ לוֹ עֶצֶב; **— and when one does not merit to grasp, he experiences sorrow;** "כֵּן יִתֵּן לִידִידוֹ שֵׁנָא" **— – "for so He gives to His beloved in sleep" —** וְהַיְנוּ שֶׁשְּׁלֹמֹה הַמֶּלֶךְ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם שֶׁנִּקְרָא יְדִידוֹ שֶׁל הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ, **— meaning that King Solomon who was called the beloved of the**

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[189] **Beit Yaakov on Torah, Lech Lecha 41:5**: "The blessed God gave Abraham a taste of all the events that would pass over the individual members of Israel. From the collective of Israel, God gave him a taste of everything that would befall each particular Israelite. For more can be revealed to a person in sleep than can be revealed to him while awake."
Pri Tzadik's account of Solomon's dream says that some wisdom cannot be received through waking apprehension. Beit Yaakov describes Abraham's deep sleep as receiving an experiential disclosure of what would befall the individual lives of Israel. The shared point is the enlarged capacity to receive; Solomon's wisdom and Abraham's vision remain different revelations.

[190] **Tzidkat HaTzadik 244:1**: "King Solomon, on the contrary, slept much. Of him it is said, "Thus He gives sleep to His beloved"; our sages relate that he slept until four hours into the day, with the keys of the Temple. For he is like the finishing treatment of iron. King David's quality is iron, as is known, and the Zohar explains that he is of earth. In him is the force of clarifying the waste from the earth through entering the fire of love and awe, until it receives its finishing treatment: this is the quality of King Solomon. The sages said, "Sleep at dawn is like the finishing treatment of iron." I heard that the principal meaning is the interpretation of Rashi that takes this positively. At dawn is the union of the sun and moon, the union of the Holy One and His Presence. Then the night's sleep, the quality of David, reaches completion; that moment belongs to Solomon's quality. Then sleep is beneficial, like that finishing treatment. They likewise said that dreams close to dawn are fulfilled, for these belong to one-sixtieth of prophecy: the day's imaginings and thoughts have already come to an end. This proceeds from good sleep."
Pri Tzadik describes Solomon's dream as receiving wisdom that waking effort could not attain. Tzidkat HaTzadik sets Solomon's beneficial sleep after David's sustained clarification, using the image of the finishing treatment of iron. This makes the gift intelligible within a process of refinement; it does not make prolonged sleep a general substitute for learning.

[191] **Bereshit Rabbah 17:6** (excerpt): "Rabbi Chanina, son of Rav Idi, said: From the beginning of the book until this point, the letter samech is not written. Once the woman was created, Satan was created with her. If someone says to you that 'it encircles' (ha-sovev, Genesis 2:11, 13) contains a samech, tell him: There Scripture is speaking about the rivers."

Blessed Name, זָכָה לְחָכְמָה שֶׁאֵין כְּמוֹתָהּ בָּעוֹלָם בְּשֵׁינָה, בַּחֲלוֹם אֶחָד. **— merited unprecedented wisdom in sleep, through a single dream.** וְכֵן בִּבְנָיָמִין "יְדִיד הַשֵּׁם יִשְׁכֹּן בֶּטַח עָלָיו חֹפֵף עָלָיו כָּל הַיּוֹם וּבֵין כְּתֵפָיו שָׁכֵן". **— And likewise Benjamin: "The beloved of Hashem, etc., and He dwells between his shoulders."**

A small human opening can receive a great gift

וְאַף שֶׁנִּרְאֶה שֶׁרַק בִּבְנָיָמִין וּשְׁלֹמֹה זָכוּ לִהְיוֹת נִקְרָא "יְדִידִים",[192] **— And although it appears that only Benjamin and Solomon merited to be called "beloved",** בֶּאֱמֶת גַּם כָּל יִשְׂרָאֵל נִקְרְאוּ בְּשִׁיר הַשִּׁירִים "אֲחֹתִי, רַעְיָתִי, יוֹנָתִי, תַּמָּתִי" וְכָל לְשׁוֹן שֶׁל חִבָּה, **— in truth all of Israel are called in the Song of Songs "my sister, my love, my dove, my undefiled" and every term of endearment,** רַק שְׁלֹמֹה וּבִנְיָמִין נִקְרְאוּ בִּפְרָט יְדִידִים שֶׁל הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ. וְכֵן אִיתָא (מְנָחוֹת ל״ג עַמּוּד א׳): "וְיִתְכַּפֵּר בּוֹ יְדִידִים",[193] **— only Solomon and Benjamin were specifically designated beloved of the Blessed Name. –** אֵלּוּ יִשְׂרָאֵל וְכוּלֵיהּ",[194] **— And so it states (Menachot 53a): "And let the beloved be atoned through it — these are Israel, etc.",**

The answer can exceed the opening

וְכָל אֶחָד מִיִּשְׂרָאֵל יָכוֹל לִזְכּוֹת לָזֶה אִם יִפְנֶה עַצְמוֹ לַהַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ,[195] **— and every single Jew can merit this if he directs himself to the Blessed Name,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב (שִׁיר הַשִּׁירִים רַבָּה ה׳):[196] **— as written (Shir HaShirim Rabbah 5):**

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[192] **Divrei Soferim 13:2**: "It would seem a defect to mix earthly dust into supernal wisdom that ascends to the place of seraphim and angels, whose awe is a burning fire. What place is there among them for the slight awe of one born of woman, as it is? Yet this is God's will: He brought Torah down to those below and "cast truth to the earth." The entire sustenance of the heavenly retinue comes from Torah below. From the small awe produced through human effort, the blessed God builds a great treasury with large openings, like the opening of the Temple hall, as the Midrash on the Song of Songs says. Afterward all Torah and wisdom are placed in his heart. The preservative earth, chamtin, becomes wheat, chittin: the mem, alluding to kingship, changes to a yod, alluding to wisdom. A small kav becomes a kor, and "the fear of the Lord is wisdom."

Pri Tzadik extends the possibility of divine favor beyond Solomon and Benjamin, asking each Israelite to turn toward God and open the smallest opening of repentance. Divrei Soferim explains how this small, earthly beginning is not disqualified by its smallness: God builds a great treasury from it and places wisdom in the heart. This supplies a mechanism for the disproportion between human preparation and divine gift.

[193] **Menachot 53a:19-20**; **Menachot 53b:1-2**: "Let a beloved one, son of a beloved one, come and build a beloved house for the Beloved, in the portion of a beloved one, so that beloved ones may obtain atonement in it. 'Let a beloved one come' means King Shlomo, as it is written, 'He sent through Natan the prophet, and he called his name Yedidyah, beloved of the Lord, for the Lord's sake.' 'Son of a beloved one' means Avraham, as it is written, 'What is My beloved doing in My house?' 'And build a beloved house' means the Temple, as it is written, 'How beloved are Your dwelling places!' 'For the Beloved' means the Holy One, blessed be He, as it is written, 'Let me sing for my Beloved.' 'In the portion of a beloved one' means Binyamin, as it says, 'Of Binyamin he said: The Lord's beloved shall dwell securely beside Him.' 'So that beloved ones may obtain atonement in it' means Israel, as it is written, 'I have given the beloved of My soul into the hand of her enemies.'"

[194] **Menachot 53a:19-20**; **Menachot 53b:1-2**: "Let a beloved one, son of a beloved one, come and build a beloved house for the Beloved, in the portion of a beloved one, so that beloved ones may obtain atonement in it. 'Let a beloved one come' means King Shlomo, as it is written, 'He sent through Natan the prophet, and he called his name Yedidyah, beloved of the Lord, for the Lord's sake.' 'Son of a beloved one' means Avraham, as it is written, 'What is My beloved doing in My house?' 'And build a beloved house' means the Temple, as it is written, 'How beloved are Your dwelling places!' 'For the Beloved' means the Holy One, blessed be He, as it is written, 'Let me sing for my Beloved.' 'In the portion of a beloved one' means Binyamin, as it says, 'Of Binyamin he said: The Lord's beloved shall dwell securely beside Him.' 'So that beloved ones may obtain atonement in it' means Israel, as it is written, 'I have given the beloved of My soul into the hand of her enemies.'"

[195] **Beit Yaakov on Torah, Chayei Sara 29:1**: "The blessed God, who abounds in kindness, deals with His creatures by saying, "My children, open for Me a hole like the point of a needle, and I will open for you an opening like that of the Temple hall." This means that the person begins and God completes the matter for him, with a great addition beyond the original beginning. As the Talmud says, "Three asked improperly …." Even the congregation of Israel asked improperly, but the Holy One answered properly: "Let us know, let us pursue knowledge of the Lord … He will come to us like rain." God said to her: "My daughter, you ask for something that is sometimes wanted and sometimes not wanted. But I will be for you something that is always wanted," as it is said, "I will be like dew to Israel."

Pri Tzadik cites the needle-point opening to show how every Israelite can turn toward the divine affection exemplified by Solomon and Benjamin. Beit Yaakov explains the same image through the pattern of generosity in Rebecca's response: the person begins, and God completes the matter with an addition greater than the beginning. Its example of rain and dew clarifies that the divine response may improve upon the petitioner's own formulation.

[196] **Shir HaShirim Rabbah 5:2:2** (excerpt): "'Open to Me.' Rabbi Yasa said: The Holy One, blessed be He, said to Israel: My children, open for Me one opening of repentance as small as a needle's point, and I will open for you entrances through which wagons and carriages can enter. Rabbi Tanchuma, Rabbi Chunya, and Rabbi Abahu said in the name of Reish Lakish: It is written, 'Desist, and know that I am God' (Psalms 46:11). The Holy One said to Israel: Desist from your evil deeds, and know that I am God. Rabbi Levi said: If Israel were to repent even for one day, they would immediately be redeemed and the son of David would immediately come. What is the reason? 'For He is our God, and we are the people of His pasture and the sheep of His hand—today, if you listen to His voice' (Psalms 95:7). Rabbi Yudan and Rabbi Levi said: The Holy One said to Israel: Desist from your evil deeds and repent in the blink of an eye,

"פִּתְחִי לִי פֶּתַח אֶחָד שֶׁל תְּשׁוּבָה כְּחַדָּה שֶׁל מַחַט, וַאֲנִי אֶפְתַּח לָכֶם פְּתָחִים וְכוּלֵיהּ". — **"Open to Me an opening of repentance like the point of a needle, and I will open for you wide portals, etc."**

Trust strengthens service in the measure it needs

וּבְחֹדֶשׁ זֶה נַס חֲנֻכָּה שֶׁהָיָה שֶׁלֹּא כְּדֶרֶךְ הַטֶּבַע כְּלָל:[197] — **And in this month occurred the miracle of Chanukah which was entirely unnatural:** דְּנַס פּוּרִים הָיָה כִּמְעַט קָרוֹב לַטֶּבַע בְּעֵינֵי הָעוֹלָם, — **for the miracle of Purim seemed almost natural in the eyes of the world,** שֶׁעַל יְדֵי שֶׁמָּלְכָה אֶסְתֵּר נֶהְפַּךְ לְבָבוֹ לְטוֹבָה; — **in that through Esther becoming queen the king's heart turned to favor;** אֲבָל בַּחֲנֻכָּה, שֶׁהָיָה בְּמִלְחָמָה עַל יְדֵי אֲנָשִׁים מְתֵי מִסְפָּר, — **whereas in Chanukah, which occurred through military battle by a handful of men,** וְאַף אַחַר שֶׁנִּתּוֹסַף עֲלֵיהֶם מִכָּל מָקוֹם מַה נֶּחְשְׁבוּ נֶגֶד חֵיל הַיְוָנִים שֶׁמָּלְכוּ בְּכִפָּה אָז? — **and even after reinforcements joined them, what were they considered against the Greek armies who ruled the world then?** רַק עַל יְדֵי מִבְטַח עֹז שֶׁהָיָה לַכֹּהֲנִים כִּי "אֵין מַעְצוֹר לַהֹושִׁיעַ בְּרַב אוֹ בִמְעָט", — **Only through the unshakeable trust possessed by the priests that "there is no restraint to Hashem to save by many or by few",** עַל יְדֵי זֶה נִצְּחוּ: "מָסַרְתָּ גִּבּוֹרִים בְּיַד חַלָּשִׁים וְרַבִּים בְּיַד מְעַטִּים"; — **through this they conquered: "You delivered the mighty into the hands of the weak, and the many into the hands of the few";** כִּי וְהָיָה בְּחֹדֶשׁ זֶה כִּסְלֵו שֶׁנִּקְרָא עַל שֵׁם הַמִּבְטָח עֹז שֶׁיֵּשׁ לְיִשְׂרָאֵל: "כִּי הַשֵּׁם יִהְיֶה בְכִסְלֶךָ". — **and this took place in this month of Kislev, named for the mighty trust of Israel: "for Hashem will be your confidence (be-chislecha)".**

וּבִגְזֶרַת יָוָן מָצִינוּ (בְּרֵאשִׁית רַבָּה פָּרָשָׁה ס״ה) בְּיָקוּם אִישׁ צְרוֹרוֹת, בֶּן אֲחוֹתוֹ שֶׁל רַבִּי יוֹסֵי בֶּן יוֹעֶזֶר אִישׁ צְרֵדָה,[198] — **And during the Greek persecution we find (Bereishit Rabbah 65) regarding Yakum of Tzerorot, nephew of Rabbi Yose ben Yoezer of Tzreidah,** שֶׁהָיָה בַּגְּזֵרָה וְנִשְׁתַּקַּע כָּל כָּךְ עַד שֶׁרָכַב עַל סוּס בְּשַׁבָּת, — **who lived during the decree and deteriorated so far that he rode a horse on Shabbat,** וְהִכְנִיס רַבִּי יוֹסֵי בֶּן יוֹעֶזֶר בְּלִבּוֹ הַמִּבְטָח עֹז לָשׁוּב בִּתְשׁוּבָה, — **and Rabbi Yose ben Yoezer infused into his heart the steadfast courage to return in repentance,** עַל יְדֵי שֶׁאָמַר לוֹ: "וְאִם כָּךְ לְעוֹשֵׂי רְצוֹנוֹ, קַל וָחֹמֶר לְמַכְעִיסָיו", — **by saying to him: "And if it is thus to those who do His will, all the more so to those who anger Him",** עַד שֶׁקִּיֵּם בְּעַצְמוֹ אַרְבַּע מִיתוֹת, — **until he inflicted upon himself all four judicial executions,** וְאָמַר רַבִּי יוֹסֵי: "בְּשָׁעָה קַלָּה קִדְּמַנִי זֶה לְגַן עֵדֶן". — **and Rabbi Yose declared: "In a brief hour this one has preceded me to the Garden of Eden."**

Confidence means that return remains possible

וּבְחֹדֶשׁ כִּסְלֵו יֵשׁ לְכָל אֶחָד מִיִּשְׂרָאֵל מִבְטַח עֹז שֶׁיּוּכַל לִקְנוֹת עוֹלָמוֹ בְּשָׁעָה אַחַת,[199] — **And in the month of Kislev every**

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and know that I am God."

[197] **Sod Yesharim, The Seventh Day of Pesach 15:1**: "My strength and song is Yah, and He became my salvation." "My strength" means the strong trust and firmness that God has placed permanently in Israel's heart. "And my song" resembles the musical accents that direct the letters: sometimes the melody raises a word aloud and sometimes lowers it. So God directs strong trust within the heart according to the moment and its need. When slackness and weakness of mind arise, He raises the person's strong trust. At times He causes that trust to shine in a low voice, so that the person does not expand into excessive boldness. This is "and my song is Yah," as it is said, "For in Yah, the Lord, is the Rock of worlds": God has willed that there be no completeness without human service, represented by the letters vav and heh of the divine name. Therefore strong trust does not always shine equally, but according to the measure required at that moment for the power of human service. "He became my salvation": from the very fact that completeness comes through Israel's service, Israel receives all its deliverances. Before deliverance is complete, Israel's way is the middle way, as Avot de-Rabbi Natan compares it to a road between fire and snow: one should walk between them, taking care not to be burned by the fire or injured by the cold."

Pri Tzadik describes the priests' strong trust during an overwhelmingly unequal struggle. Sod Yesharim explains how God directs such confidence according to the task: it is raised against weakness and moderated against excessive boldness. This adds discernment to the meaning of "strong trust"; the target concerns the Song at the Sea and does not identify that event with Chanukah.

[198] **Bereshit Rabbah 65:22** (excerpt): "Yakum of Tzerorot was the son of the sister of Rabbi Yose ben Yoezer of Tzeredah. He rode a horse on Shabbos before the beam on which his uncle was being led to execution. He said to him: See the horse my master has had me ride, and see the horse your Master has had you ride! Rabbi Yose replied: If this is how He treats those who anger Him, how much more will He reward those who do His will! Yakum said: Has anyone done His will more than you? He replied: If this is how He treats those who do His will, how much more will He punish those who anger Him! The words entered him like a serpent's venom. He went and subjected himself to the four court-imposed forms of death: stoning, burning, execution by the sword, and strangulation. … Yose ben Yoezer of Tzeredah dozed and saw Yakum's bier flying in the air. He said: In one brief moment, this one has preceded me to the Garden of Eden."

[199] **Divrei Soferim 16:1**: "A Jew should not despair of anything, whether concerning the body—as the sages said, "Even if a sharp sword rests upon a person's neck, he should not refrain from seeking mercy"—or concerning the soul. Even if he has sunk to whatever place he has sunk, or sinned in something of which it was said that repentance does not help, God forbid, or that repentance is difficult, or he sees himself becoming increasingly immersed in the concerns of this world, he should not despair and say that he can no longer separate himself. There is no despair for a Jew, and the blessed God can help in every matter."

Jew possesses steadfast trust that he can acquire his world in a single hour, שֶׁעַל זֶה יֵשׁ מִבְטַח עֹז לְיִשְׂרָאֵל כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ (חֵלֶק א׳ קמ״ב עַמּוּד א׳) עַל הַפָּסוּק: "עֻזְּךָ לוֹ בָךְ, מְסִלּוֹת בִּלְבָבָם", עַיֵּן שָׁם;[200] **— concerning which Israel holds bold confidence, as written in the Holy Zohar (Part I, 142a) on the verse: "Whose strength is in You, in whose heart are the highways, see there";** אִם אַךְ יִפָּנֶה עַצְמוֹ לְדִבְרֵי תוֹרָה, **— if he will only direct himself to words of Torah,** כְּמַה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: "פִּתְחוּ לִי פֶּתַח אֶחָד שֶׁל תְּשׁוּבָה כְּחֻדָּהּ שֶׁל מַחַט, וַאֲנִי אֶפְתַּח לָכֶם פְּתָחִים וְכוּלֵיהּ", **— as stated: "Open to Me an opening of repentance like the point of a needle, and I will open for you portals, etc.",** וְעַמֵּךְ כֻּלָּם צַדִּיקִים", וְיִהְיֶה הַשֵּׁם בְּכִסְלֶךָ. **— "and your people are all righteous", and Hashem shall be your confidence.**

Pri Tzadik concludes the account of Chanukah and sudden repentance with confidence that every Israelite can turn toward Torah and acquire his world. Divrei Soferim states the corresponding rule for a person who feels steadily more entangled: do not infer that separation from sin has become impossible. God's ability to help keeps repentance open; neither passage guarantees a particular outward result on demand.

[200] **Zohar, Toldot 15:119-16:128**: 'A man, therefore, should not confidently affirm: "God will deliver me or will do for me this or that"; but he should endeavour to fulfil the precepts of the Law and to walk in the path of truth, and then put his full trust in Him that He will help him thereto. For assuredly whenever a man sets out to purify himself he is helped thereto from on high. A man should thus put his trust in God and not anywhere else. Hence the expression "whose strength is in thee". The next words, "in whose heart are paths", indicate that a man should purge his heart of all strange thoughts, so as to make it like a path that leads straight to the desired destination.'

Rosh Chodesh Kislev Ois 3

The Supporting Letter: Sleep, Exile, and the Four Rivers

The coldness called sleep is countered by renewed awareness of standing before God.

The Supporting Letter: Sleep, Exile, and the Four Rivers

כָּל חֹדֶשׁ יֵשׁ לוֹ עֵסֶק בִּפְנֵי עַצְמוֹ וְנִבְרָא בְּאוֹת מְיֻחָד מִשְּׁתֵּים עֶשְׂרֵה פְּשׁוּטוֹת, — **Every month has its own autonomous spiritual work and was created through a specific letter from the twelve simple letters,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בְּסֵפֶר יְצִירָה: "הִמְלִיךְ אוֹת סָמֶ"ךְ בְּשֵׁינָה וְכוּלֵיהּ, כִּסְלֵו בַּשֵּׁנָה וְקֵבָה בַּנֶּפֶשׁ וְכוּלֵיהּ", — **as written in Sefer Yetzirah: "He crowned the letter Samech over sleep, etc., Kislev in the year, and the stomach in the soul, etc.",** וְהוּא עַל פִּי מַה שֶּׁכָּתוּב בַּגְּמָרָא (בְּרָכוֹת ס״א עַמּוּד ב׳): "קֵבָה יְשֵׁנָה".[201] — **which accords with what is written in the Gemara (Berachot 61b): "The stomach sleeps."** וְאוֹת סָמֶ"ךְ מוֹרֶה: "סוֹמֵךְ ה' לְכָל הַנֹּפְלִים", שֶׁהָעֵסֶק בְּחֹדֶשׁ זֶה לְעִנְיַן הַכְנָסַת הַיֵּצֶר, רֹאשִׁית גּוֹיִם, "אֲשֶׁר קָרְךָ" — **And the letter Samech indicates: "Hashem supports (somech) all who fall", –** שֶׁהִצְנִינְךָ, — **for the work of this month is against the intrusion of the inclination, Amalek, "who cooled you" — making you lukewarm and sluggish,**

Awakening the mind from spiritual drowsiness

וְהַיְנוּ שֶׁמַּשְׁלִיךְ קְרִירוּת וְעַצְלוּת עַל הָאָדָם,[202][203] — **meaning that he casts coldness and laziness upon man,** עַד דִּכְתִיב: "עַצְלָה תַּפִּיל תַּרְדֵּמָה", — **leading to Scripture: "Slothfulness casts into a deep sleep",** וְהַשֵּׁם סוֹמֵךְ לְכָל הַנֹּפְלִים. — **and Hashem supports all the fallen.** וְאוֹת סָמֶ"ךְ הוּזְכַּר בַּתּוֹרָה רִאשׁוֹנָה בִּנְהָרוֹת: "הוּא הַסֹּבֵב אֵת כָּל אֶרֶץ הַחֲוִילָה", — **And the letter Samech is mentioned first in the Torah regarding the rivers: "that is it which compasses (ha-sovev) the whole land of Havilah",** וּמָצִינוּ בַּגְּמָרָא (בָּבָא קַמָּא נ״ה עַמּוּד א׳):[204] — **and we find in the Gemara (Bava Kamma 55a):** "הָרוֹאֶה טֵי״ת בַּחֲלוֹמוֹ סִימָן יָפֶה לוֹ וְכוּלֵיהּ, הוֹאִיל וּפָתַח בּוֹ הַכָּתוּב לְטוֹבָה תְּחִלָּה וְכוּלֵיהּ", — **"He who sees a Tet in his dream it is a good sign for him, etc., since Scripture opened with it first for good in tov, etc.",** וְהַיְנוּ שֶׁאוֹת טֵי״ת רִאשׁוֹנָה שֶׁבַּתּוֹרָה בְּתֵבַת "כִּי טוֹב", וּמוֹרֶה עַל שֹׁרֶשׁ הָאוֹת; — **meaning that the first Tet in the Torah is in the word ki tov (that it was good), indicating the essential root of the letter;** וְכֵן וְהַיְנוּ שֶׁהַשֵּׁם אוֹת סָמֶ"ךְ רִאשׁוֹנָה הוּא "הַסֹּבֵב", — **and likewise the first Samech is in ha-sovev (surrounding),** יִתְבָּרַךְ סוֹבֵב וְאוֹר מַקִּיף, — **meaning that the Blessed Name encompasses as an encircling transcendent light (Ohr Makif),** וְעַל יְדֵי כֵן סוֹמֵךְ לְכָל הַנֹּפְלִים. — **and through this supports all who fall.**

וְכֵן תְּמוּנַת אוֹת סָמֶ"ךְ הוּא הֶקֵּף, — **And so the graphic form of the letter Samech is a closed circle,** וְאַף מֵ"ם

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[201] **Berakhot 61b:1**: “The lung draws in all kinds of liquids; the liver becomes angry; the gallbladder casts a drop into it and calms it; the spleen laughs; the gizzard grinds; the stomach sleeps; and the nose remains awake. If the sleeping organ wakes and the waking organ sleeps, the person wastes away. It was taught: If both sleep or both remain awake, he dies immediately.”

[202] **Peri Tzadik, Chayei Sara 1:2**: “There is an evil inclination of desire that is called fire. Likewise, the inclination of jealousy and honor is also called fire, as explained in Vayera, teaching 1, beginning “And also.” There is also the shell of Amalek, of whom it says, “who cooled you”—who chilled and cooled you. This means that he casts coldness and laziness upon a person. This is the first of the shells, and it assails even great people. Thus concerning Jabez they interpreted “that it not cause me pain” (Temurah 16a): “that the evil inclination not prevent me from studying.” The root of the serpent and the evil inclination is called sadness, for it brought sadness and toil into the world. This is “She does not fear snow for her household.” Not only does she not fear the fire of desire, jealousy, and honor—the three kinds of fire—but she does not even fear snow, the first of the shells, which casts laziness and coldness. “She does not fear for her household” means the great people who are called her household. Why? “For all her household are clothed in two”—Sabbath and circumcision, both of which indicate that they are attached at the root to the utterance “In the beginning,” the beginning of holiness.”

[203] **Machshavot Charutz 3:1**: “But “indolence casts one into deep sleep”: this is the falling of the mental powers and the strengthening of imaginings, as during sleep. Anyone immersed in such imaginings is truly like a sleeper even while awake. As the Magen Avraham writes at the end of section 583, sitting idle is like sleeping: empty imaginings and thoughts of futility arise in the mind just as in sleep. Indolence makes the roof—the mind—sink and descend to low thoughts, until this can also bring down the hands, the instruments of action, and the whole house can leak. The principal effort must therefore be to overcome indolence. This strengthening comes through contemplating “I have set the Lord before me always,” with the simple faith found in every Jew, which one can readily awaken in the heart because it is already inherited from the patriarchs in the heart’s depths: to believe with complete faith that God’s glory fills all the earth, that He stands directly before one always, watching and seeing every depth of thought in heart and mind, with nothing hidden from Him. The roof—the mind—will thereby rise to cleave to elevated, holy thoughts; and every kind of futile, idle thought, which flows only from the mind’s slumber, will consequently depart.”

Pri Tzadik identifies the inclination’s cooling effect with indolence and spiritual sleep. Machshavot Charutz explains the inner process: idle imaginings can make an awake person function like a sleeper, while attention to God’s presence raises the mind out of that condition. This gives practical content to the awakening for which Kislev’s divine support makes room.

[204] **Bava Kamma 55a**: ‘The Gemara asks: This latter statement is problematic, as even according to this explanation, one can say that a single letter tet alludes to the verse: “Her filthiness tumatah is in her skirts” (Lamentations 1:9), which begins with the letter tet. The Gemara answers: We mean that when one sees the letter tet together with the letter bet in his dream, it is a good sign for him, as the word tov is written with both. The Gemara asks further: According to this, say that it alludes to the verse: “Her gates are sunk tave’u into the ground” (Lamentations 2:9), which begins with the letter tet followed by the letter bet.’

סְתוּמָה גַּם כֵּן הֶקֵּף, — **and even a closed Mem is also an enclosure,** רַק שָׁם יֵשׁ מ״ם פְּתוּחָה — **only there exists an open Mem as well,** וְאוֹת סָמ״ךְ הוּא תָּמִיד מַקִּיף, וּמוֹרֶה עַל אוֹר מַקִּיף מֵהַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ. **— whereas the letter Samech is always circular, pointing to the encircling light from the Blessed Name.** וְהוּא עַל פִּי מַה שֶּׁכָּתוּב (בְּרֵאשִׁית רַבָּה פָּרָשָׁה ט״ז)[205] דְּדָרַשׁ בַּגְּלִיּוֹת: "'הוּא הַסּוֹבֵב אֵת כָּל אֶרֶץ הַחֲוִילָה' — **And it is based on what is written (Bereishit Rabbah, Parashah 16) expounding the rivers upon the exiles: –** אֶרֶץ יִשְׂרָאֵל, — **"'That is it which compasses the whole land of Havilah' — this is the Land of Israel,** אֲשֶׁר שָׁם כְּתִיב בֵּיהּ: 'הוֹחִילִי לֵאלֹהִים וְגוֹמֵר'; 'זְהַב הָאָרֶץ הַהוּא טוֹב' — **of which it is written: 'Hope (hochili) you in God, etc.'; –** אִלּוּ דִּבְרֵי תוֹרָה וְכוּלֵּיהּ; — **'where there is gold' — these are words of Torah, etc.; –** שָׁאֵין תּוֹרָה כְּתוֹרַת אֶרֶץ יִשְׂרָאֵל וְלֹא חָכְמָה כְּחָכְמַת אֶרֶץ יִשְׂרָאֵל וְכוּלֵּיהּ, עַיֵּן שָׁם", — **'and the gold of that land is good' — that there is no Torah like the Torah of the Land of Israel and no wisdom like the wisdom of the Land of Israel, see there";** וְהַיְנוּ עַל פִּי מַה שֶּׁכָּתוּב (שָׁם פָּרָשָׁה ט׳)[206]: "'וְהִנֵּה טוֹב מְאֹד' — **and this is according to what is written (ibid., Parashah 9): –** טוֹבָה שֵׁינָה; — **"'And behold, it was very good' — sleep is good;** וְכִי טוֹבָה שֵׁינָה, אֶתְמְהָה וְכוּלֵּיהּ? — **is sleep then good, I wonder, etc.?** ". אֶלָּא מִתּוֹךְ שֶׁהוּא יָשֵׁן קִימְעָא הוּא עוֹמֵד וְיָגֵעַ בַּתּוֹרָה הַרְבֵּה — **Rather, because he sleeps a little, he arises and labors in Torah much."**

וְהוּא שֶׁהַשֵּׁינָה יָכוֹל לִהְיוֹת לְטוֹבָה: — **And the explanation is that sleep can be channeled for the good:** שֶׁמִּפְּנֵי שֶׁאֵין אָדָם יָכוֹל לִהְיוֹת בְּלֹא שֵׁינָה, וּכְמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב (נְדָרִים ט״ו עַמּוּד א׳)[207]: "שְׁבוּעָה שֶׁלֹּא אִישַׁן שְׁלֹשָׁה יָמִים — **for since a human being cannot exist without sleep, –** מַלְקִין אוֹתוֹ וְיָשֵׁן לְאַלְתַּר"[208], — **as written (Nedarim 15a): "If one swears: I will not sleep for three days — they administer lashes to him and he sleeps immediately",** נִמְצָא עַל יְדֵי הַשֵּׁינָה יָכוֹל לִהְיוֹת עָגֵעַ בַּתּוֹרָה הַרְבֵּה. וְאַף דְּאִיתָא בְּמִדְרָשׁ רַבָּה אַחַר כָּךְ: "תְּחִלַּת מַפָּלָה שֵׁינָה; דָּמֵיךְ וְלָא לָעֵי בְּאוֹרַיְתָא", — **it emerges that through sleep he can labor in Torah abundantly. –** **And even though it states in Midrash Rabbah afterward: "The beginning of a downfall is sleep: he sleeps and does not labor in Torah",** וְהוּא מַעֲשֶׂה הַיֵּצֶר הָרָע בַּתְּחִלָּה לְהַפִּיל עֲצֵלוּת עַל הָאָדָם, "עַצְלָה תַּפִּיל תַּרְדֵּמָה"; מִכָּל מָקוֹם אוֹת סָמ״ךְ מוֹרֶה: "הַסּוֹבֵב אֵת כָּל אֶרֶץ הַחֲוִילָה אֲשֶׁר שָׁם הַזָּהָב" — **which is the stratagem of the Evil Inclination initially casting slothfulness upon man, "Slothfulness casts into a deep sleep"; –** אֵלּוּ דִּבְרֵי תוֹרָה, — **nevertheless the letter Samech indicates: "that which compasses the whole land of Havilah where there is gold" — these are words of Torah,** תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה שֶׁשָּׁרְשָׁהּ בְּאֶרֶץ יִשְׂרָאֵל, — **the Oral Torah rooted in the Land of Israel,** שְׁאָז הַשֵּׁינָה "טוֹב מְאֹד" כְּשֶׁהוּא מְסַיֵּעַ לִהְיוֹת עָגֵעַ בַּתּוֹרָה הַרְבֵּה. — **wherein sleep is 'very good' when it aids him to labor intensely in Torah.**

Daytime Torah continues into fruitful sleep

וְעִקַּר הַשֵּׁינָה בָּרָא הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ לְצֹרֶךְ דִּבְרֵי תוֹרָה,[209] — **And the essential purpose of sleep was created by the Blessed Name for words of Torah,** וּכְמוֹ הַמִּיתָה לְאַחַר הַקִּלְקוּל שֶׁהוּא לְצֹרֶךְ לְהַשִּׂיג הַשָּׂגוֹת הַגְּבוֹהוֹת וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמַרְנוּ; — **just like death after the sin which serves to attain elevated spiritual perceptions as we explained;** וּמִיתָה נִקְרָא גַּם כֵּן שֵׁינָה, כְּמַה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: "יְשֵׁנֵי עָפָר", וּבִלְשׁוֹן חֲכָמֵינוּ זִכְרוֹנָם לִבְרָכָה מְכֻנֶּה הַמִּיתָה "כַּד דָּמֵיךְ" — **and death is likewise**

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[205] **Bereshit Rabbah 16:4** (excerpt): "'The name of the first is Pishon' (Genesis 2:11)—this is Babylonia, in the sense of 'its horsemen spread out' (Habakkuk 1:8). 'It encircles the whole land of Chavilah'—it arose and surrounded the whole Land of Israel, of which it is written, 'Hope in God, for I shall yet thank Him' (Psalms 42:6). 'Where there is gold'—these are words of Torah, which are more desirable than gold and much fine gold. 'The gold of that land is good' teaches that there is no Torah like the Torah of the Land of Israel, and no wisdom like its wisdom. 'There are the bdellium and the onyx stone'—Scripture, Mishnah, Talmud, Tosefta, and Aggadah."

[206] **Bereshit Rabbah 9:6**: 'Rabbi Shimon ben Elazar said: "And behold it was very good" – and behold sleep is good. Is sleep, then, very good? This is a rhetorical question. Did we not learn: Wine and sleep are beneficial for them the wicked and beneficial for the whole world? 5:5. However, as a result of a person sleeping a bit, he can get up and toil extensively in the Torah.'

[207] **Nedarim 15a**: "If he did not specify a duration, would we leave him until he violated 'He shall not profane his word'? Did Rabbi Yochanan not say: If one swears, 'I will not sleep for three days,' he is given lashes and may sleep immediately?"

[208] **Nedarim 15a**: "If he did not specify a duration, would we leave him until he violated 'He shall not profane his word'? Did Rabbi Yochanan not say: If one swears, 'I will not sleep for three days,' he is given lashes and may sleep immediately?"

[209] **Tzidkat HaTzadik 244:1**: "For this reason we ask to be saved from bad dreams and harmful thoughts, and for illumination of the eyes, so that sleep may be "very good," as our sages say in Genesis Rabbah, chapter 9. This is through the dream that is one sixtieth of prophecy, when one's thoughts at night also concern the words of Torah contemplated by day. Through this one cleaves more deeply to the good, as explained above in section 238."
Pri Tzadik describes two benefits together: receiving what waking consciousness could not attain and returning to vigorous Torah study. Tzidkat HaTzadik supplies the bridge between them: the Torah contemplated by day can continue in the night's thoughts and draw a person more closely to the good. The selected passage retains the prayer for protection from harmful dreams; it does not treat every dream as Torah.

called sleep, as stated: "those who sleep in the dust", – לְשׁוֹן שֵׁינָה; **— and in the idiom of our Sages death is termed "when he slept" (kad dameich);** וְכֵן הַשֵּׁינָה לְצַרְךָ דִּבְרֵי תוֹרָה, שֶׁיָּשֵׁן קִימְעָא וְזוֹכֶה לְקַבֵּל מַה שֶּׁלֹּא יוּכַל לְהַשִּׂיג בְּהָקִיץ, **— and so is sleep for the purpose of Torah: one sleeps a little and merits to receive what he cannot attain awake,** וְאַחַר כָּךְ עוֹמֵד וְיָגֵעַ בַּתּוֹרָה הַרְבֵּה. **— and afterward arises and labors in Torah greatly.**

וְכֵן הַחֲלוֹם אֶחָד מִשִּׁשִּׁים לִנְבוּאָה כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בַּגְּמָרָא; **— And so a dream is one-sixtieth of prophecy as written in the Gemara;** וְאַף יַעֲקֹב אָבִינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם שֶׁצּוּרָתוֹ חֲקוּקָה בְּכִסֵּא הַכָּבוֹד, **— and even Jacob our Father whose likeness is engraved on the Throne of Glory,** מִכָּל מָקוֹם נְבוּאָתוֹ רִאשׁוֹנָה "וְהִנֵּה הַשֵּׁם נִצָּב עָלָיו" הָיָה בַּחֲלוֹם. **— nevertheless his initial prophecy "and behold Hashem stood above him" occurred in a dream.**

A troubling dream can do its work by awakening concern

וְאַף בַּחֲלוֹמוֹת שֶׁאֵינָם טוֹבִים, אִיתָא בַּגְּמָרָא (בְּרָכוֹת נ״ה עַמּוּד א׳): "חֶלְמָא בִּישָׁא[210,211] **— And even regarding disturbing dreams, it states in the Gemara (Berachot 55a):** – עֲצִיבוּתֵיהּ מְסָתֵיֵיהּ וְכוּלֵּיהּ, 'וְהָאֱלֹהִים עָשָׂה שֶׁיִּירְאוּ מִלְּפָנָיו' **— "A bad dream — its sadness is sufficient to atone, etc.,** – זֶה חֲלוֹם רָע", **— 'and God has made it that men should fear before Him' — this is a bad dream",** שֶׁעַל יְדֵי הַחֲלוֹם יִתְעוֹרֵר לִתְשׁוּבָה, **— for through the dream he is awakened to repentance,** וּכְמַה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: "אָז יְגַלֶּה אֹזֶן אֲנָשִׁים וּבְמוּסָרָם יַחְתֹּם". **— as Scripture states: "Then He opens the ears of men, and seals their instruction."**

The blessing over sleep seeks an illuminated awakening

וְכֵן תִּקְּנוּ בַּבְּרָכָה עַל הַשֵּׁינָה שֶׁמַּתְחֶלֶת: "הַמַּפִּיל חֶבְלֵי שֵׁינָה עַל עֵינַי וְכוּלֵּיהּ",[212] **— And so they instituted in the blessing before sleep which begins: "Who casts the bonds of sleep upon my eyes, etc.",** וְהַיְנוּ שֶׁמַּפִּיל חֶבְלֵי שֵׁינָה שֶׁאֵינוֹ רוֹאֶה כְּלוּם, **— meaning He casts the cords of slumber so that he sees nothing,** וּמְסַיֵּם: "הַמֵּאִיר לָעוֹלָם כֻּלּוֹ בְּכְבוֹדוֹ", **— and concludes: "Who illuminates the entire world with His glory",** שֶׁאַדְרַבָּה הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרֵךְ מֵאִיר עַל יְדֵי שֶׁהוּא לָאָדָם עַל יְדֵי הַשֵּׁינָה, **— for on the contrary, the Blessed Name shines for a person through sleep,** סוֹבֵב בְּאוֹר מַקִּיף וְשׁוֹמֵר, **— in that He encompasses him with an encircling light (Ohr Makif) and guards him,** כְּמַה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: "כִּי הַשֵּׁם יִהְיֶה בְכִסְלֶךָ וְשָׁמַר רַגְלְךָ [מִלָּכֶד]",[213] **— as Scripture states: "For Hashem shall be your confidence, and shall keep your foot from being taken";** וְכֵן בַּחֲתִימַת בִּרְכַּת הַשְׁכִּיבֵנוּ: "שׁוֹמֵר עַמּוֹ יִשְׂרָאֵל", **— and likewise in the conclusion of Hashkiveinu: "Who guards His people Israel",** שֶׁבְּשֵׁינָה צָרִיךְ הָאָדָם, **— for during sleep a person requires protection,** וְהַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרֵךְ שׁוֹמְרוֹ בְּאוֹר מַקִּיף, וְהוּא סוֹמֵךְ לְכָל הַנֹּפְלִים, **— and the Blessed Name guards him with encompassing light, supporting all who fall.** וְהַסָּמֶ״ךְ הַשֵּׁנִי בַּתּוֹרָה: "הַסּוֹבֵב אֵת כָּל אֶרֶץ כּוּשׁ": **— And the second Samech in the Torah is in: "that is it which compasses (ha-sovev) the whole land of Cush":** כּוּשׁ נִקְרָא מִי שֶׁהוּא שְׁחֹר וְאֵינוֹ נָאֶה, **— Cush is the designation of one who is dark and uncomely;** וּבַתּוֹרָה נִקְרָא יוֹסֵף הַצַּדִּיק: "יְפֵה תֹאַר וִיפֵה מַרְאֶה", **— whereas in the Torah Joseph**

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[210] **Berakhot 55a:15**: “Rav Chisda said: Any dream is preferable to a dream about fasting. Rav Chisda also said: A dream that has not been interpreted is like a letter that has not been read. Rav Chisda also said: Neither a good dream nor a bad dream is fulfilled in its entirety. Rav Chisda also said: A bad dream is preferable to a good dream. Rav Chisda also said: A bad dream—the distress it causes is enough for it; a good dream—the joy it causes is enough for it. Rav Yosef said: Even for me, the joy of a good dream dissipates its fulfillment. Rav Chisda also said: A bad dream is harder to bear than lashes, as it says, ‘God has acted so that people should fear before Him.’ Rabbah bar bar Channah said in Rabbi Yochanan’s name: This refers to a bad dream.”

[211] **Tzidkat HaTzadik 167:1**: “In words of Torah a person is permitted to fear, as our sages say in Berakhot 60. That is, one should fear lest it be, God forbid, a poison of death; through the fear itself it is sweetened and becomes “from engagement not for its own sake, engagement for its own sake.” For “one who is frightened—his mazal sees,” which resembles a dream, likewise something one’s mazal sees. Our sages say, “A bad dream—its sadness is enough”: the sadness itself suffices. So too in Torah: “If one does not merit, it becomes…”; it is sufficient that one fears concerning one’s Torah study.”

Pri Tzadik reads the bad dream as an awakening to repentance. Tzidkat HaTzadik explains the same talmudic phrase, “its sadness is enough,” through concern about one’s Torah study: the concern itself can sweeten and redirect the activity. The comparison clarifies the corrective work of the warning rather than requiring the dreamed harm to occur.

[212] **Tzidkat HaTzadik 244:1**: “Through proper sleep, without bad, alien dreams and thoughts, a person can readily find upon rising that the heart longs for awe of God. The blessing Hamapil, which asks to be saved from bad dreams and harmful thoughts, therefore concludes on the ground that “You are the One who casts sleep…”: sleep comes from You, and You should not cause me harm. It ends, “Who illuminates the world…”: the dawn’s light that illuminates the world should be “with His glory,” through recognition of Heaven’s glory, in the sense of “Everything He has made is for His purpose”—for His praise.”

Pri Tzadik asks why a blessing over the covering of the eyes ends with God illuminating the world. Tzidkat HaTzadik explains the requested illumination as the dawn of renewed recognition of Heaven’s glory, made possible by protected sleep. Its account supplies an inward result of the surrounding divine protection described here.

[213] **Proverbs 3:26**: “For Hashem will be your confidence, and He will keep your foot from being caught.”

the Righteous is called: "fair of form and fair of look", וְהַיְנוּ שֶׁהָיָה לוֹ גּוּף נָקִי דְּנָטִיר בְּרִית; **— meaning he possessed a pure body, guarding the Covenant;** וּלְהֶפֶךְ, "כּוּשִׁי" נִקְרָא מִי שֶׁכְּבָר קִלְקֵל, **— and conversely, a "Cushite" designates one who has already corrupted himself,** וְכוּשׁ בְּכוֹרוֹ שֶׁל חָם, וְהוּא שֹׁרֶשׁ פְּגַם הַבְּרִית (כְּמוֹ שֶׁנִּתְבָּאֵר פָּרָשַׁת בְּרֵאשִׁית מַאֲמָר י״א[214]). **— and Cush was the firstborn of Ham, the very root of the blemish of the Covenant (explained in Parashat Bereshit, discourse 11).**

וּבַזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ (חֵלֶק א׳ כ״ו עַמּוּד ב׳[215]) דָּרַשׁ אַרְבָּעָה רָאשִׁים נָגֶד אַרְבַּע מִדּוֹת: חֶסֶד, גְּבוּרָה, נֶצַח, הוֹד, עַיֵּן שָׁם: **— And in the Holy Zohar (Part I, 26b) it expounded the four river heads corresponding to four attributes: Chesed, Gevurah, Netzach, Hod, see there:**

Abraham's love becomes desire for Torah

הָאֶחָד כְּנֶגֶד מִדַּת אַבְרָהָם אָבִינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם, חֶסֶד, דְּרוֹעָא יְמִינָא,[216] **— The first corresponds to the attribute of Abraham, Chesed, the right arm,** וּמִזֶּה בָּא אַהֲבָה: "הוּא הַסֹּבֵב אֵת כָּל אֶרֶץ הַחֲוִילָה", **— and from this flows love: "that is it which compasses the whole land of Havilah",** וְהַיְנוּ כְּשֶׁהוּא לְטוֹבָה; וּכְשֶׁבָּא דִּכְתִיב: "הוֹחִילִי לֵאלֹהִים", **— as written: "Hope in God", meaning when it is for good; –** "הָרוֹצֶה הַיֵּצֶר הָרָע לְקַלְקְלוֹ וּלְהַפְרִישׁוֹ מֵחָכְמָה — שֶׁיַּחְכִּים יַדְרִים" **— and when the Evil Inclination comes to corrupt him and separate him from wisdom — "he who wishes to become wise should face south"** — וְהוּא עַל יְדֵי שֶׁמַּפִּיל עַצְלוּת וְעַצְבוּת עַל הָאָדָם, "עַצְלָה תַּפִּיל תַּרְדֵּמָה"; "אֲשֶׁר שָׁם הַזָּהָב" **— it does so by casting sloth and depression upon man, "Slothfulness casts into a deep sleep"; –** שָׁלוֹקֵחַ הַחֵשֶׁק וְהָאַהֲבָה לְדִבְרֵי תוֹרָה, **— "where there is gold" — that he channels passion and love into words of Torah,** עַל דֶּרֶךְ מַה שֶּׁאָמְרוּ בַּגְּמָרָא: "מָשְׁכֵהוּ לְבֵית הַמִּדְרָשׁ וְכוּ'", וּכְמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בַּמִּדְרָשׁ רַבָּה: "'אֲשֶׁר שָׁם אְלוּ דִּבְרֵי תוֹרָה", וְהוּא טוֹב מְאֹד. **— after the manner they stated: "drag him to the Study Hall, etc.", –** 'הַזָּהָב' **— and as written in Midrash Rabbah: "'where there is gold' — these are words of Torah", which is 'very good'.**

Repentance can repair a place of real estrangement

וְהַשֵּׁנִי כְּנֶגֶד גְּבוּרָה, מִדַּת פַּחַד יִצְחָק:[217] **— And the second corresponds to Gevurah, the Fear of Isaac:** "הוּא הַסּוֹבֵב שֶׁמְּוֹרֶה שֶׁאַף אִם קִלְקֵל כְּבָר, יוּכַל לְתַקֵּן **— "that is it which compasses the whole land of Cush",** אֵת כָּל אֶרֶץ כּוּשׁ", עַל יְדֵי תְּשׁוּבָה, **— demonstrating that even if he has already stumbled into sin, he can rectify through**

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[214] **Sanhedrin 108b:15**: "The Sages taught: Three had sexual relations in the ark, and all three were afflicted: the dog, the raven, and Cham. The dog became bound during mating; the raven emitted seed through its mouth; and Cham was afflicted in his skin."

[215] **Zohar, Bereshit 21:249**: "Further, the river "shall part from thence and become four heads" (Gen. 2, 10). The first of these is Hesed (Kindness), which is the right arm. From this shall drink the camp of Michael, and with it the tribe of Judah and his two accompanying tribes. The second is Geburah (Force), and from it shall drink the camp of Gabriel, and with it the tribe of Dan and his two accompanying tribes. The third is Nezah (Victory), the right leg, and from it shall drink the camp of Nuriel, and with it the tribe of Reuben and his two accompanying tribes. The fourth is Hod (Majesty), the "left leg" (referred to in what was said of Jacob, that "he halted on his left thigh"), and from it shall drink the camp of Raphael, whose mission is to heal the ills of the captivity, and with it the tribe of Ephraim and his two accompanying tribes."

[216] **Mei HaShiloach, Volume I, Genesis, Toldot 1**: "It is written, "If you seek Him, He will be found by you." The seeking is our father Abraham, and the finding is Isaac. Abraham's character was to long intensely, continually, for words of Torah and for it to become known in the world that God reigns over them; this is the quality of love. Isaac's quality is strength: after this has become clarified and the revelation of God has descended into this world, it is called strength, as the Gemara says, "Thus Moses heard from the mouth of the Almighty." Isaac too was called God's strength in the world. "These are the generations of Isaac son of Abraham" thus means that Isaac's issue is the public revelation of God in this world; "Abraham begot Isaac" means that this came through Abraham's longing, for longing is Abraham's quality. Likewise genuine words of Torah can be born only after a person longs intensely for them."
Pri Tzadik directs the faculty of love, associated with Abraham, into a desire for Torah that overcomes the inclination's cooling effect. Mei HaShiloach explains why that redirection is productive: Abraham's longing is the seeking from which Isaac's disclosure is born, and genuine Torah likewise comes after great desire. The target develops the generative role of love; Pri Tzadik also gives the separate path of repentance through fear.

[217] **Tiferet Yosef, Ha'azinu and Shabbat Shuvah 5**: "When a person deepens his service, he truly sees that all the places that stood very far from God are full of light. This is what the Talmud says: one who returns from love has deliberate sins become like merits. After the repentance in which he returns to God with great work, he truly sees that what had until now seemed to stand at a great distance was full of His will. This explains the Midrash: Cain answered Adam, "I repented and reached a settlement," and Adam began, "A psalm, a song for the Sabbath day." One attains this recognition fully on Shabbat, when Shabbat comes and rest comes."
Pri Tzadik's confidence includes the possibility of repair after actual damage. Tiferet Yosef explains the depth of that possibility through repentance from love: after great effort in returning, a place that appeared only distant can be recognized as filled with divine light. Both passages locate that disclosure through repentance; the quoted target retains the work that precedes the recognition.

repentance, וְהַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ סוֹמֵךְ לְכָל הַנֹּפְלִים. **— and the Blessed Name supports all the fallen.** וְזֶה עֲסָק חֹדֶשׁ זֶה: **— And this is the work of this month:** לִהְיוֹת מִבְטָח עֹז בַּהַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ שֶׁיִּשְׁמְרֵהוּ וְיִסַּיְעֵהוּ, **— to have strong trust in the Blessed Name that He will guard and assist him,** אַף אִם קְלָקֵל חַס וְשָׁלוֹם יוּכַל לְתַקֵּן הַכֹּל עַל יְדֵי תְּשׁוּבָה. **— and that even if he stumbled, Heaven forbid, he can rectify everything through repentance.**

Rosh Chodesh Kislev Ois 4

Benjamin, the Hidden Heart, and Descent for the Sake of Ascent

Benjamin represents the divine help that can awaken a person from within.

Benjamin, the Hidden Heart, and Descent for the Sake of Ascent

כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב, שְׁנֵים עָשָׂר שְׁבָטִים נָגֶד שְׁנֵים עָשָׂר חֳדָשִׁים — **The Twelve Tribes correspond to the twelve months,** כָּל חֹדֶשׁ נָגֶד שֵׁבֶט אֶחָד(מִדְרַשׁ תַּנְחוּמָא וַיְחִי)[218]; — **as written (Midrash Tanchuma, Vayechi): each month corresponds to one tribe;** וְהָאֲרִיזַ"ל חִשְׁבָּן כְּסֵדֶר הַדְּגָלִים, וְחָשַׁב כְּסִלְו נָגֶד בִּנְיָמִין. — **and the Arizal reckoned them according to the banners, aligning Kislev with Benjamin.** וְגִרְסָתוֹ בְּסֵפֶר יְצִירָה: "הִמְלִיךְ אוֹת סָמֶ"ך בְּשִׁינָה וְכוּלֵיהּ, כִּסְלָו בַּשָּׁנָה וְקֵבָה בַּנֶּפֶשׁ", — **And his reading in Sefer Yetzirah was: "He crowned the letter Samech over sleep, etc., Kislev in the year, and the stomach in the soul",** וְעַל פִּי מַה שֶּׁכָּתוּב בַּגְּמָרָא: "קֵבָה יְשֵׁנָה". — **based on what is written in the Gemara: "The stomach sleeps."** וְיִחוּס הַשֵּׁינָה לְבִנְיָמִין, כָּתַב הָרַאֲבַ"ד זִכְרוֹנוֹ לִבְרָכָה בְּפֵרוּשׁ סֵפֶר יְצִירָה: — **And regarding the attribution of sleep to Benjamin, the Ra'avad of blessed memory wrote in his commentary on Sefer Yetzirah:** מִפְּנֵי דִּכְתִיב בֵּיהּ: "וּבֵין כְּתֵפָיו שָׁכַן", — **because it is written of him: "and He dwells between his shoulders",** וַאֲחֵרִים כָּתְבוּ טְעָמִים אֲחֵרִים בָּזֶה. — **and others wrote other reasons for this.**

The wakeful point beneath spiritual sleep

וְהָעִנְיָן בָּזֶה, דְּאִיתָא (שִׁיר הַשִּׁירִים רַבָּה ה'): "'אֲנִי יְשֵׁנָה וְלִבִּי עֵר[219, 220]: — **And the inner matter in this is: it states (Shir HaShirim Rabbah 5):** – וְלִבּוֹ שֶׁל הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא עֵר לְגָאֳלֵנִי וְכוּלֵיהּ; — **"'I sleep, but my heart wakes' — the heart of the Holy One, Blessed be He, wakes to redeem me, etc.;** הֵיכָן מָצִינוּ שֶׁהַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא לִבָּן שֶׁל יִשְׂרָאֵל? מִן הַדִּין קְרָא דִּכְתִיב: 'צוּר לְבָבִי וְחֶלְקִי אֱלֹהִים לְעוֹלָם'", — **where do we find that the Holy One is the heart of Israel? From this verse: 'God is the rock of my heart, and my portion forever'",**

The Temple joins an enduring gift to human service

וְהֵינוּ שֶׁאַף בִּשְׁעַת הַשֵּׁינָה, בְּמַעֲמַקֵּי הַלֵּב שׁוֹכֵן הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ.[221] — **meaning that even in the time of sleep, in the innermost depths of the heart dwells the Blessed Name.** וְעַל כֵּן בִּנְיָמִין שֶׁהַמִּקְדָּשׁ בָּנוּי בְּחֶלְקוֹ, דִּכְתִיב: "וּבֵין כְּתֵפָיו שָׁכַן", — **And therefore Benjamin, in whose territory the Temple was built, as it is written: "and He**

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[218] **Midrash Tanchuma, Vayechi 16:2**: “Because he divided the land among them, giving to Judah the soil that would yield barley and to Benjamin the land that would produce wheat, he coupled them in his blessing so that they would share each other’s crops. Hence Scripture states: And this is it that their father spoke to them. “Unto them” is not written here but rather to them (lahem), thus indicating that their father told them: In the future a prophet will bless you in a like manner. Where I leave off blessing you, he will begin. And so Moses did, as it is said: And this is the blessing, wherewith Moses the man of God blessed the children of Israel (Deut. 33:1). Moses told them: I shall reveal to you now when you will attain these blessings. At the time you accept the law, as is said: And this is the law (ibid. 14:44).”

[219] **Shir HaShirim Rabbah 5:2:1** (excerpt): “‘I sleep.’ The congregation of Israel said before the Holy One, blessed be He: Master of the world, I sleep concerning the commandments, but my heart is awake for acts of kindness. I sleep concerning charitable deeds, but my heart is awake to perform them. I sleep concerning sacrifices, but my heart is awake for the reading of Shema and prayer. I sleep concerning the Temple, but my heart is awake for synagogues and houses of study. I sleep concerning the appointed end, but my heart is awake for redemption. I sleep concerning redemption, but the heart of the Holy One is awake to redeem me. Rabbi Chiya bar Abba said: Where do we find that the Holy One is called the heart of Israel? From this verse: ‘God is the rock of my heart and my portion forever’ (Psalms 73:26).”

[220] **Machshavot Charutz 4:6**: “The heavenly help of “Were the Holy One not to help him, he could not overcome it” is Benjamin’s degree. He is always joined to Judah, for his power of self-restraint is not like Joseph’s; it operates together with heavenly assistance, the resting of God’s Presence wherever it may be. God always dwells in the depths of his heart. As Song of Songs Rabbah says, the Holy One is Israel’s heart: “God is the Rock of my heart and my portion forever.” They expound “I sleep, but my heart is awake” accordingly: even though one is immersed in imagination, which is sleep, imagination does not reach the heart’s depths. There is always the point of the “Rock of his heart,” which remains awake, and through it one can awaken from slumber.”

Pri Tzadik connects Benjamin’s Temple portion with God dwelling in Israel’s heart even during sleep. Machshavot Charutz explains Benjamin’s particular role beside Joseph: Joseph represents exertion in self-restraint, while Benjamin represents the help that remains rooted deeper than the imagination’s slumber. The inner wakefulness is thus a source from which actual awakening can begin.

[221] **Tiferet Yosef, Talmud Anthology, Chagigah 3**: “At the place of the Temple this holiness, permanently established in Israel, was manifest. All the services were therefore also there, for it was manifest there how God desires Israel’s service: they should clarify why God chose Israel from among the nations. The Midrash says that while the Holy One was still alone in His world He desired a dwelling below—that Israel should attain “to know that I am the Lord who sanctifies you.” This explains the statement that they considered building it at Ein Eitam, which was higher, but said, “Let us lower it a little,” as it is written, “He dwells between his shoulders”: a person should clarify, in answer to the accusers, why God gave him this holiness. At the Temple these two forms of holiness were therefore united: the holiness permanently established from His side and the holiness through Israel’s service, until there was a complete connection between Israel’s apprehension and His light.”

Pri Tzadik places Benjamin’s “between his shoulders” beside the divine presence that persists beneath sleep. Tiferet Yosef explains the same Temple location as the meeting of two forms of holiness: God’s established gift and the holiness clarified through Israel’s work. This explains how an enduring inner presence can support an ascent that still calls for human participation.

dwells between his shoulders", שֶׁהַשְּׁכִינָה שְׁרוּיָה בְּחֶלְקוֹ כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב (זְבָחִים נ״ד עַמּוּד ב׳)[222] **— the Shechinah permanently residing in his portion (Zevachim 54b),** עַל כֵּן חִשְּׁבוּ כֹּחַ הַשֵּׁינָה לְבִנְיָמִין. וְאִיתָא (בְּרֵאשִׁית רַבָּה פָּרָשָׁה י״ז)[223]: "תְּחִלַּת מַפָּלָה **— therefore they assigned the faculty of sleep to Benjamin. –**[224]; שֵׁינָה וְכוּ׳לִיהּ" **— And it states (Bereishit Rabbah, Parashah 17): "The beginning of a downfall is sleep, etc.";** אַךְ הוּא עַל דָּבָר מַה שֶּׁנֶּאֱמַר: "כִּי שֶׁבַע יִפּוֹל צַדִּיק וָקָם". **— yet this follows Scripture: "For a righteous man falls seven times, and rises up again."** וְאוֹת סָמֶ״ךְ מוֹרֶה: "סוֹמֵךְ הַשֵּׁם לְכָל הַנֹּפְלִים", כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמַרְנוּ מֵהַזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ וְגַמָּרָא; **— And the letter Samech indicates: "Hashem supports (somech) all who fall", as we explained from the Holy Zohar and Gemara;** וּכְתִיב "סוֹמֵךְ הַשֵּׁם" וְלֹא כְּתִיב "מֵקִים הַשֵּׁם לְכָל הַנֹּפְלִים", **— and it is written "Hashem supports" and not "Hashem raises up all who fall",** רַק הַמְּכֻוָּן: שֶׁהַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרֵךְ סוֹמֵךְ לְכָל הַנֹּפְלִים שֶׁלֹּא יִהְיֶה מַפָּלָה כְּלָל, **— for the inner meaning is: that the Blessed Name supports the fallen so that it is not a true downfall at all,** רַק הַנְּפִילָה כְּעֵין יְרִידָה שֶׁהִיא צֹרֶךְ עֲלִיָּה. **— but rather the fall is a descent that serves the ultimate purpose of an ascent.**

וּמִתְּחִלַּת הַתּוֹרָה לֹא כְּתִיב סָמֶ״ךְ עַד פָּסוּק: "וַיַּפֵּל ה׳ תַּרְדֵּמָה וְגוֹמֵר", **— And from the beginning of the Torah no Samech is written until the verse: "And Hashem God caused a deep sleep to fall, etc.",** וְהוּא עַל דָּבָר מַה שֶּׁנֶּאֱמַר: "סוֹמֵךְ הַשֵּׁם לְכָל הַנֹּפְלִים". **— and this corresponds to: "Hashem supports all who fall."** וּבַמִּדְרָשׁ (שָׁם)[225]: "מִתְּחִלַּת הַסֵּפֶר עַד כָּאן אֵין כְּתִיב סָמֶ״ךְ וְכוּ׳לִיהּ; **— "From the beginning of Genesis until here no Samech is written, etc.;** וְאִם יֹאמַר לְךָ אָדָם 'הִנֵּה הַסּוֹבֵב', תֹּאמַר לוֹ: בַּנְּהָרוֹת הַכָּתוּב מְדַבֵּר, עַיֵּן שָׁם". **— and if someone says to you: 'Behold ha-sovev has a samech!', tell him: Scripture there is speaking of the rivers, see there."** וְהַמְּכֻוָּן: שֶׁבִּבְרִיאַת שָׁמַיִם וָאָרֶץ שֶׁנִּבְרְאוּ בְּכ״ב אוֹתִיּוֹת הַתּוֹרָה, **— And the meaning is: that in the primordial creation of heaven and earth which were created via the twenty-two letters of the Torah,** לֹא נִזְכַּר אוֹת סָמֶ״ךְ עַד "וַיִּסְגֹּר בָּשָׂר". **— the letter Samech was not mentioned until "and He closed up (vayisgor) the flesh".** וְהוּא בְּדַבְּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ (חֶלֶק ג׳ י״ב עַמּוּד א׳)[226], שֶׁחָשַׁב "יְהִי אוֹר" מַאֲמָר רִאשׁוֹן, **— And this is because in the Holy Zohar (Part III, 12a), which counts "Let there be light" as the first utterance,** נֶחְשָׁב מַאֲמָר עֲשִׂירִי "לֹא טוֹב הֱיוֹת הָאָדָם לְבַדּוֹ"; **— the tenth utterance is counted as "It is not good that the man should be alone";** וּבְגְמָרָא (רֹאשׁ הַשָּׁנָה ל״ב עַמּוּד א׳) דְּ"בְּרֵאשִׁית" נַמִּי מַאֲמָר,[227] **— while in the Gemara (Rosh Hashanah 32a) where "In the beginning" is also counted as an utterance,** וְלֹא נֶחְשָׁב "לֹא טוֹב הֱיוֹת וְגוֹמֵר" לְמַאֲמָר; **— "It is not good, etc." is not counted as one of the ten utterances;** וּבַמִּדְרָשׁ (בְּרֵאשִׁית רַבָּה פָּרָשָׁה י״ז)[228] יֵשׁ שְׁתֵּי דֵּעוֹת בָּזֶה, עַיֵּן שָׁם. **— and in Midrash Rabbah (Parashah 17) there are two opinions on this, see there.**

וְאֵלּוּ וְאֵלּוּ דִּבְרֵי אֱלֹהִים חַיִּים: **— And both these and those are the words of the Living God:** דִּבְרִיאַת שָׁמַיִם וָאָרֶץ

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[222] **Zevachim 54b**: ‘They brought the book of Joshua. With regard to all of the borders of the tribes it is written: “And went down” (see Joshua 15:10, 16:3, 17:9), and it is written: “And the border went up to Beth Hoglah.” (Joshua 15:6), and: “And the border was drawn from the top of the mountain to the fountain of the waters of Nephtoah” (Joshua 15:9). The verse uses different terms to describe the borders of the portion of each tribe. And with regard to the borders of the tribe of Benjamin it is written only: “And went up” (Joshua 18:11), but it is not written: “And went down.” They said: Conclude from the verses that the Temple’s place is here, in the portion of Benjamin.’

[223] **Bereshit Rabbah 17:5** (excerpt): “‘Hashem God caused a deep sleep to fall’ (Genesis 2:21). Rabbi Yehoshua of Sikhnin said in the name of Rabbi Levi: The beginning of downfall is sleep: a person sleeps and does not labor in Torah, and does not attend to his work.”

[224] **Bereshit Rabbah 17:5** (excerpt): “‘Hashem God caused a deep sleep to fall’ (Genesis 2:21). Rabbi Yehoshua of Sikhnin said in the name of Rabbi Levi: The beginning of downfall is sleep: a person sleeps and does not labor in Torah, and does not attend to his work.”

[225] **Bereshit Rabbah 17:6** (excerpt): “Rabbi Chanina, son of Rav Idi, said: From the beginning of the book until this point, the letter samech is not written. Once the woman was created, Satan was created with her. If someone says to you that ‘it encircles’ (ha-sovev, Genesis 2:11, 13) contains a samech, tell him: There Scripture is speaking about the rivers.”

[226] **Zohar, Vayikra 25:179-191**: ‘In the Zohar (Vayikra III 12a), where the ten utterances of Creation are enumerated beginning with ‘Let there be light’ as the first utterance, the tenth utterance is identified as ‘It is not good that the man should be alone; I will make him a help meet for him’ (Genesis 2:18)—whereupon at the formation of Eve the letter Samekh appears for the first time in the Torah (‘and He closed up va-yisgor the flesh,’ Genesis 2:21).’

[227] **Rosh Hashanah 32a:19**: “But the expression ‘And He said’ occurs only nine times in the account of Creation! ‘In the beginning’ is also an utterance, as it is written, ‘By the word of the Lord the heavens were made.’”

[228] **Bereshit Rabbah 17:1** (excerpt): “‘Hashem God said: It is not good for the man to be alone’ (Genesis 2:18). We learned: The world was created through ten utterances. These are: ‘In the beginning’; ‘The spirit of God hovered’; ‘God said: Let there be light’; ‘God said: Let there be a firmament’; ‘God said: Let the waters be gathered’; ‘God said: Let the earth bring forth vegetation’; ‘God said: Let there be lights’; ‘God said: Let the waters teem’; ‘God said: Let the earth bring forth’; and ‘God said: Let us make man.’ Menachem bar Yose removes ‘The spirit of God hovered’ and includes ‘Hashem God said: It is not good for the man.’ Rabbi Yaakov ben Kurshai said: An utterance was assigned to the spirit in its own right.”

כְּפִי מַה שֶׁעָלָה בְּמַחֲשָׁבָה לִבְרֹאת בְּמִדַּת הַדִּין, — **for in the creation of heaven and earth as it arose in Divine Thought to create with Strict Judgment,** לֹא הוּזְכַּר מַאֲמַר "לֹא טוֹב הֱיוֹת הָאָדָם לְבַדּוֹ", — **the utterance "It is not good that the man should be alone" was not mentioned,** דִּבְמַחֲשָׁבָה עָלָה לִבְרֹאת שְׁנַיִם כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בַּגְּמָרָא (עירובין וְאָז נֶחְשָׁב "בְּרֵאשִׁית" נַמִּי,[229] ר"ח עמוד א'), — **for in thought it arose to create two simultaneously (Eruvin 18a),** מַאֲמָר כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בַּגְּמָרָא. — **and then "In the beginning" was counted as an utterance as stated in the Gemara.** וּלְבַסּוֹף כְּשֶׁרָאָה שֶׁאֵין הָעוֹלָם מִתְקַיֵּם בְּמִדַּת הַדִּין וְשִׁתַּף מִדַּת רַחֲמִים לְמִדַּת הַדִּין, — **And ultimately when He saw that the world could not endure under Strict Judgment and partnered the attribute of Mercy with Judgment,** וְאָז לֹא נִבְרָא אֶלָּא אֶחָד כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בַּגְּמָרָא, — **and then only one human being was created,** וְלָכֵן לֹא כְּתִיב מַאֲמַר "לֹא טוֹב הֱיוֹת הָאָדָם" רַק אַחַר דִּכְתִיב: "בְּיוֹם עֲשׂוֹת יהו"ה אֱלֹהִים", — **therefore the utterance "It is not good for man..." is written only after: "In the day that Hashem God made",** שֶׁהִקְדִּים מִדַּת הָרַחֲמִים וְשִׁתְּפָהּ לְמִדַּת הַדִּין. — **preceding Mercy and joining it with Judgment.** וְאָז נֶחְשָׁב מַאֲמַר "יְהִי אוֹר" מַאֲמָר רִאשׁוֹן, — **And then the utterance "Let there be light" is counted as the first utterance,** כֵּיוָן שֶׁגְּנָזוֹ אוֹר הָרִאשׁוֹן, הוּא מַאֲמָר הַנֶּעְלָם מִכָּל רַעְיוֹן, — **and because the Primordial Light was hidden away, it is an utterance concealed from all human conception;** וְנֶחְשָׁב מַאֲמָר עֲשִׂירִי "לֹא טוֹב הֱיוֹת הָאָדָם לְבַדּוֹ" כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ; — **and the tenth utterance is counted as "It is not good that the man should be alone" as written in the Zohar;**

Concealment makes room for work of one's own

A descent can make a new relation possible

וְאָז נִזְכַּר אוֹת סָמֶ"ךְ, שֶׁנִּבְרֵאת בְּאוֹת סָמֶ"ךְ, שֶׁהָיָה עַל יְדֵי תַּרְדֵּמָה,[230, 231] — **and then the letter Samech is mentioned, for woman was built through the letter Samech, occurring via deep slumber,** וְהוּא תְּחִלַּת מַפָּלָה; — **which is the beginning of a downfall;** רַק הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ סוֹמֵךְ לְכָל הַנֹּפְלִים שֶׁלֹּא יִהְיֶה נְפִילָה כְּלָל, — **only the Blessed Name supports all who fall so that it is not a true downfall at all,** רַק יְרִידָה שֶׁהִיא צֹרֶךְ עֲלִיָּה. — **but a descent serving the need of an ascent.** וְזֶה שֶׁאָמְרוּ בַּמִּדְרָשׁ רַבָּה: "כֵּיוָן שֶׁנִּבְרֵאת אִשָּׁה נִבְרָא שָׂטָן עִמָּהּ", — **And this is what they said in Midrash Rabbah: "Once woman was created, Satan was created with her",** וְהַיְנוּ שֶׁנִּבְרֵאת עַל יְדֵי תַּרְדֵּמָה וּתְחִלַּת מַפָּלָה, וְהַיְנוּ שֶׁיֵּשׁ קִטְרוּג; — **meaning she was created through deep slumber and the beginning of a downfall, giving room for prosecution;** וּמִכָּל מָקוֹם עִקַּר אוֹת סָמֶ"ךְ מוֹרֶה "סוֹמֵךְ הַשֵּׁם לְכָל הַנֹּפְלִים", שֶׁלֹּא יִהְיֶה — **nevertheless the essential message of the letter Samech is "Hashem supports all who fall",** מַפָּלָה רַק צֹרֶךְ עֲלִיָּה. וְכֵן בְּשֵׁינָה, דְּאִיתָא בְּבְרֵאשִׁית רַבָּה (פָּרָשָׁה ט'):[232] "'וְהִנֵּה טוֹב מְאֹד': טוֹבָה שֵׁינָה וְכוּלֵיהּ; — **ensuring that it is not a destruction, but a necessity for ascent. — And so it is regarding sleep, as stated in Bereishit Rabbah (Parashah 9): – "'And behold it was very good' — sleep is good, etc.;** וְכִי שֵׁינָה טוֹבָה מְאֹד וְכוּלֵיהּ? אֶלָּא מִתּוֹךְ שֶׁאָדָם יָשֵׁן קִימְעָא הוּא עוֹמֵד וְיָגֵעַ בַּתּוֹרָה הַרְבֵּה". — **Rather, is sleep then very good, etc.?**

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[229] **Eruvin 18a**: "This accords with Rabbi Abahu, who raised a contradiction: It is written, 'Male and female He created them,' yet it is written, 'In the image of God He created him.' Initially the thought was to create two, but in the end only one was created."

[230] **Mei HaShiloach, Volume II, Genesis, Bereshit 7**: "The Lord God cast a deep sleep upon the human being, and he slept." This is written after "The Lord God formed the human being from the dust of the earth and breathed into his nostrils the breath of life." The Sefer HaKanah says that one who blows, blows from oneself; the actor's power is in the action's product. The work of the human being's own hands was therefore not discernible. In His kindness, so that a person should not eat the bread of shame, God cast a deep sleep upon him: He concealed the clear light, so that the person should exert himself by his own choice and understand his way himself. As it is written, "Know today and bring it back to your heart that the Lord is God." One then eats the work of one's own hands and is fortunate and fares well."

Pri Tzadik insists that the first sleep can be a supported descent needed for ascent. Mei HaShiloach explains an aspect of that need: the original divine illumination did not yet make human effort discernible as one's own. Its concealment creates room for chosen effort and understanding. This gives a precise account of how the descent can serve a further good.

[231] **Machshavot Charutz 18:3**: "The beginning of a fall is sleep: "God cast a deep sleep," as Genesis Rabbah says on this verse. Sleep is one sixtieth of death: wisdom and understanding withdraw, as do all the qualities a person had at the beginning of creation, when "God made the human being upright," prepared to dwell in Eden. But He saw that "it is not good for the human being to be alone," in the mystery of "Say of the righteous one that he is good": the power to give and bring forth one like oneself. This is impossible without a helper face to face."

Pri Tzadik describes the sleep involved in the woman's creation as a descent supported toward an ascent. Machshavot Charutz explains what the original condition lacked: the capacity to give and bring forth through a face-to-face helper. Its full paragraph also treats the dangers introduced with separation and their repair. The comparison explains the purpose of this creation-stage descent without turning its dangers into a goal.

[232] **Bereshit Rabbah 9:6**: 'Rabbi Shimon ben Elazar said: "And behold it was very good" – and behold sleep is good. Is sleep, then, very good? This is a rhetorical question. Did we not learn: Wine and sleep are beneficial for them the wicked and beneficial for the whole world? 5:5. However, as a result of a person sleeping a bit, he can get up and toil extensively in the Torah.'

because a man sleeps a little, he arises and labors in Torah greatly." :וְהַיְנוּ דְּאָמְרִינַן (בְּרָכוֹת ס״א עַמּוּד ב׳)
"קֶבָּה יְשֵׁנָה, אַף נַעוֹר",[233] **— And that means that although we say (Berachot 61b): "The stomach sleeps while the nose is awake",** "וּבְאַף כְּתִיב: "וַיִּפַּח בְּאַפָּיו נִשְׁמַת חַיִּים", **— and concerning the nostrils it is written: "and breathed into his nostrils the breath of life",** דְּעִקַּר הַחַיִּים כְּשֶׁהוּא נָעוֹר, **— showing that true conscious life is when one is awake;** "שֵׁינָה אֶחָד מִשִּׁשִּׁים לְמִיתָה";[234] וּכְמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב (שָׁם נ״ז עַמּוּד ב׳): **— and as written (ibid. 57b): "Sleep is one-sixtieth of death";** שְׁנֵיהֶם נְעוֹרִים: מִכָּל מָקוֹם לֹא יוּכַל לִהְיוֹת הַחַיִּים בְּלֹא שֵׁינָה, וּכְמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בַּגְּמָרָא **— nevertheless physical life cannot endure without sleep, –** מַיָּד מֵת; **— and as stated in the Gemara: if both sleep or both awaken, he dies immediately;** וְזֶהוּ שֶׁעַל יְדֵי הַשֵּׁינָה עוֹמֵד וְיָגֵעַ בַּתּוֹרָה הַרְבֵּה, וְהַנְּפִילָה **— and thus through sleep he arises and labors in Torah abundantly, –** יְרִידָה שֶׁהִיא צֹרֶךְ עֲלִיָּה הִיא. **— and the fall is a descent that serves the need of ascent.**

— And on this it is stated: "I sleep, but my heart wakes", וְעַל זֶה נֶאֱמַר: "אֲנִי יְשֵׁנָה וְלִבִּי עֵר", שֶׁאַף בִּשְׁעַת שֵׁינָה, הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא לִבָּן שֶׁל יִשְׂרָאֵל, שֶׁהוּא שׁוֹכֵן בְּמַעֲמַקֵּי הַלֵּב. **— for even during sleep, the Holy One is the heart of Israel, dwelling in the innermost depths of the heart.** **— And this is the heritage of Benjamin who is called "the beloved of Hashem",** וְזֶהוּ חֶלְקוֹ שֶׁל בִּנְיָמִין שֶׁנִּקְרָא "יְדִיד הַשֵּׁם". וְאִיתָא בַּגְּמָרָא (בָּבָא בַּתְרָא י״ז עַמּוּד א׳): שִׁבְעָה **— and it states in the Gemara (Bava Batra 17a): seven people over whom worms and decay had no dominion,**[235] שֶׁלֹּא שָׁלַט בָּהֶן רִמָּה וְתוֹלַעָה, **— and it counts Benjamin because it is written: "The beloved of Hashem shall dwell in safety",** וְחָשַׁב בִּנְיָמִין מִדִּכְתִיב: "יְדִיד הַשֵּׁם יִשְׁכֹּן לָבֶטַח". וּפֵרֵשׁ רַבִּי שְׁלֹמֹה יִצְחָקִי: "עַל סְמִיכוּת **— and Rashi explained: "relying upon the loving presence of the Shechinah, Benjamin dwells securely",** יְדִידוּת הַשְּׁכִינָה יִשְׁכֹּן בִּנְיָמִין לָבֶטַח", **— meaning that the physical body also abides in holiness and worms have no dominion over it.** וְהַיְנוּ שֶׁהַגּוּף גַּם כֵּן בִּקְדֻשָּׁה וְלֹא שָׁלַט בָּהֶן רִמָּה. **— And in the Gemara (Menachot 53a):**[236] וּבְגְּמָרָא (מְנָחוֹת נ״ג עַמּוּד א׳): **"Let a beloved, son of a beloved, come and build a beloved for the Beloved, in the portion of a beloved, that the beloved may be atoned through it, etc., see there",** "יָבֹא יְדִיד בֶּן יְדִיד, וְיִבְנֶה יְדִיד לִידִיד, בְּחֶלְקוֹ שֶׁל יְדִיד, וְיִתְכַּפְּרוּ בוֹ יְדִידִים וְכוּלֵיהּ, עַיֵּן שָׁם",

More divine presence awakens more longing
— for Benjamin is called "beloved of Hashem" uniquely, שֶׁבֵּית הַמִּקְדָּשׁ שֶׁשָּׁם דְּבִנְיָמִין נִקְרָא "יְדִיד הַשֵּׁם" בִּיחוּד,[237]

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[233] **Berakhot 61b**: ‘and the lungs draw all kinds of liquids, the liver becomes angry, the gall bladder injects a drop of gall into the liver and allays anger, the spleen laughs, the maw grinds the food, and the stomach brings sleep, and the nose awakens. If they reversed roles such that the organ which brings on sleep were to awaken, or the organ which awakens were to bring on sleep, the individual would gradually deteriorate. It was taught: If both bring on sleep or both awaken, the person immediately dies.’

[234] **Berakhot 57b**: ‘The numbers five, six, and ten are mnemonics for the categories to follow. The Gemara says: There are five matters in our world which are one-sixtieth of their most extreme manifestations. They are: Fire, honey, Shabbat, sleep, and a dream. The Gemara elaborates: Our fire is one-sixtieth of the fire of Gehenna; honey is one-sixtieth of manna; Shabbat is one-sixtieth of the World-to-Come; sleep is one-sixtieth of death; and a dream is one-sixtieth of prophecy.’

[235] **Bava Batra 17a:5**: “The Sages taught: Seven people were not subject to the decay of maggots and worms: Avraham, Yitzchak, Yaakov, Moshe, Aharon, Miriam, and Binyamin the son of Yaakov. Regarding Avraham, Yitzchak, and Yaakov, Scripture uses the expressions ‘with everything,’ ‘from everything,’ and ‘everything.’ Regarding Moshe, Aharon, and Miriam, it says that their deaths were ‘by the mouth of the Lord.’ Regarding Binyamin the son of Yaakov, it says, ‘Of Binyamin he said: The Lord’s beloved will dwell securely beside Him.’ Some include David as well, since he said, ‘My flesh too will dwell securely.’ Those who do not include David understand that verse as a plea for mercy, rather than a statement that his body would certainly be preserved.”

[236] **Menachot 53a:19-20**; **Menachot 53b:1-2**: “Let a beloved one, son of a beloved one, come and build a beloved house for the Beloved, in the portion of a beloved one, so that beloved ones may obtain atonement in it. ‘Let a beloved one come’ means King Shlomo, as it is written, ‘He sent through Natan the prophet, and he called his name Yedidyah, beloved of the Lord, for the Lord’s sake.’ ‘Son of a beloved one’ means Avraham, as it is written, ‘What is My beloved doing in My house?’ ‘And build a beloved house’ means the Temple, as it is written, ‘How beloved are Your dwelling places!’ ‘For the Beloved’ means the Holy One, blessed be He, as it is written, ‘Let me sing for my Beloved.’ ‘In the portion of a beloved one’ means Binyamin, as it says, ‘Of Binyamin he said: The Lord’s beloved shall dwell securely beside Him.’ ‘So that beloved ones may obtain atonement in it’ means Israel, as it is written, ‘I have given the beloved of My soul into the hand of her enemies.’”

[237] **Sod Yesharim, Simchat Torah 27:1**: “As our sages say: a strip extended from Judah’s portion into Benjamin’s, and the altar was built upon it. The righteous Benjamin was distressed over it every day, longing to absorb it, as it is written, “He shelters him all the day.” Therefore Benjamin merited becoming the host of the Divine Presence. This means that God knows that the more light rests with Benjamin, the more his longing will increase. God therefore chose to dwell with him, and he became the host of the Divine Presence. Likewise Israel’s great longing awakens “the Lord comes from Sinai” among them continually, without interruption.”
Pri Tzadik singles out Benjamin as God’s beloved and the host of the Temple. Sod Yesharim explains why he becomes the host: God knows that greater illumination will increase Benjamin’s longing still further. This develops the reciprocity of love described in the same originating paragraph through Benjamin’s particular Temple relation.

הַשְׁרָאַת שְׁכִינָתוֹ יִתְבָּרַךְ בָּנוּי בְּחֶלְקוֹ; — **for the Holy Temple where His Blessed Shechinah rests was built in his portion;** וּשְׁלֹמֹה שֶׁקְּרָאוֹ הַנָּבִיא יְדִידְיָה, — **and Solomon whom the prophet called Jedidiah,** וּכְתִיב בֵּיהּ: "וַיֵּשֶׁב עַל כִּסֵּא[238] — **and of whom it is written: "and he sat upon the throne of Hashem as king", when the moon was in its complete fullness (explained in discourse 1), built the Temple; –** הַשֵּׁם לְמֶלֶךְ", שֶׁהָיָה אָז סִיהֲרָא בְּאַשְׁלָמוּתָא (כְּמוֹ שֶׁנִּתְבָּאֵר מַאֲמָר א'), הוּא בָּנָה בֵּית הַמִּקְדָּשׁ; וְנִקְרָא "בֶּן יְדִיד" וְזֶה אַבְרָהָם,[239] דִּכְתִיב: "מָה לִידִידִי [בְּבֵיתִי]". — **and he is called "the son of a beloved" — this is Abraham, of whom it is written: "What has My beloved in My house."**

Love calls forth answering love

וּבְסִפְרֵי (סוֹף פָּרָשַׁת דְּבָרִים) אִיתָא דְּאַבְרָהָם נִקְרָא "אַבְרָהָם אֹהֲבִי",[240] — **For Abraham is called "Abraham My lover",** עַל הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא:[241] — **and in Sifrei (end of Parashat Devarim) it states regarding the Holy One, Blessed be He:** "מַה דִּבְלִבָּךְ עַל רְחִימָךְ, מַה דִּבְלִבֵּיהּ עָלָךְ", — **"What is in your heart toward your beloved, is what is in His heart toward you",** וְהוּא כְּמַה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: "כַּמַּיִם הַפָּנִים לַפָּנִים, כֵּן לֵב הָאָדָם לָאָדָם"; — **matching Scripture: "As in water face answers to face, so the heart of man to man";** וְכֵיוָן דִּכְתִיב "אַבְרָהָם אֹהֲבִי", בְּוַדַּאי הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ אוֹהֲבוֹ גַּם כֵּן, — **and since it is written "Abraham My lover", certainly the Blessed Name loves him likewise,** וְעַל כֵּן נִדְרַשׁ "מָה לִידִידִי" עַל אַבְרָהָם. — **and therefore "what has My beloved" was expounded on Abraham.**

וְנִזְכַּר עַל בִּנְיַן בֵּית הַמִּקְדָּשׁ עַל פִּי מַה שֶׁכָּתוּב בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ (חֵלֶק א' רי"ט עַמּוּד א'):[242] — **And this is cited regarding the construction of the Temple based on what is written in the Holy Zohar (Part I, 219a):** "בַּת יְהָבַהּ לְאַבְרָהָם וְכוּ', וּבַכֹּל שְׁמָהּ", — **"The daughter He gave to Abraham, etc., and Bakol was her name",** דְּאַבְרָהָם הָיָה רִאשׁוֹן שֶׁקְּרָאוֹ לְהַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא בְּשֵׁם אֲדנָ"י כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בַּגְּמָרָא; — **for Abraham was the first to call the Holy One by the Name Adonai as written in the Gemara;** וּכְשֶׁנִּתְבָּרֵר בְּמִדָּתוֹ עַד הַשֹּׁרֶשׁ, כְּתִיב: "וַהשֵּׁם בֵּרַךְ אֶת אַבְרָהָם בַּכֹּל", — **and when he was refined in his attribute to the root, it is written: "and Hashem blessed Abraham with everything",** וְהַיְנוּ כֶּתֶר עֶלְיוֹן אִיהוּ כֶּתֶר מַלְכוּת (וּכְמוֹ שֶׁנִּתְבָּאֵר שָׁם).[243] — **meaning Keter Elyon is the crown of Malchut (as explained there).**

The inner willing point can become clearer across generations

וּמִכָּל מָקוֹם כָּל יִשְׂרָאֵל נִקְרָאוּ "יְדִידִים" כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בַּגְּמָרָא,[244] — **And nevertheless all of Israel are called "beloved"**

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[238] **Shemot Rabbah 15:26** (excerpt): "The moon begins to shine on the first of Nisan. Its light increases until fifteen days have passed and its disc is full; from the fifteenth until the thirtieth its light diminishes, and on the thirtieth it is not seen. So too, Israel had fifteen generations from Abraham to Solomon. Abraham began to shine, as it says, 'Who awakened one from the east, calling righteousness to his feet?' (Isaiah 41:2). Isaac came and also shone, as it says, 'Light is sown for the righteous' (Psalms 97:11). Jacob came and added light, as it says, 'The light of Israel shall become a fire' (Isaiah 10:17). After him came Judah, Peretz, Chetzron, Ram, Amminadav, Nachshon, Salmon, Boaz, Oved, Jesse, and David. When Solomon came, the moon's disc became full, as it says, 'Solomon sat upon the throne of Hashem as king' (I Chronicles 29:23)."

[239] **Jeremiah 11:15**: 'Why should My beloved be in My House,Who executes so many vile designs?The sacral flesh will pass away from you,For you exult while performing your evil deeds.'

[240] **Takanat HaShavin 6:58**: "Through this his own mistaken sense of being rejected by God he is stirred more deeply to cry to God to save him, and does not rely on God to awaken him on His own. Through this he awakens God's love, as our sages say: "When am I beloved? When He hears the voice of my supplication." For God longs to hear the voice, "the voice of Jacob," as it is said, "Let Me hear your voice, for your voice is sweet."
Pri Tzadik explains why Abraham, who loves God, is also called God's beloved: love answers love. Takanat HaShavin describes this reciprocity in prayer. The person's own mistaken sense of rejection stirs a deeper cry that awakens the disclosure of divine love. God's prior awakening already expressed love or mercy, not actual rejection. This supplies an active expression of the relationship stated here.

[241] **Sifrei Devarim 352**: '(Devarim 33:11) "Bless, O, L-rd, his substance": i.e., his possessions — whence the adage: "Most Cohanim are wealthy." According to Abba the exegete, the verse (Psalms 37:25) "I have been a youth and I have also aged, but I have never seen a tzaddik forsaken nor his children begging for bread" applies to the seed of Aaron.'

[242] **Zohar, Vayechi 21:171-23:182**: 'R. Isaac once questioned R. Simeon with regard to the verse, "a joyful mother of children", saying: 'I know what is meant by the mother, but who are the children?' R. Simeon answered: 'There are two children to God, one male and one female. The male he gave to Jacob, as it is written: "Israel is my son, my firstborn" (Ex. 4, 22). The female he gave to Abraham.'

[243] **Zohar, Pinchas 121:831-123:842**: 'In the Zohar (Pinchas, Ra'aya Meheimna III 256b), the word Anokhi is expounded through its letters: the letter Kaf in Anokhi alludes to Keter (the Supernal Crown), which encompasses and shields Israel above the realm of the evil inclination.'

[244] **Divrei Soferim 23:1**: "In every generation there are many souls of Israel who restrain themselves in matters in which they have entered a trial. God always tests the sound vessels, the righteous of the generations, of whom the world is never lacking; in the matters in which they perfect themselves, all the souls of all generations are perfected with them. This explains a teaching I received: although the generations grow smaller and "the generations have not improved," the

as stated in the Gemara, דְּכָל יִשְׂרָאֵל רְאוּיִם לְהַשְׁרָאַת הַשְּׁכִינָה, **— for all Israel are worthy of the indwelling of the Shechinah,** כְּמַה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: "כִּי אֲנִי הַשֵּׁם שֹׁכֵן בְּתוֹךְ בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל"; **— as Scripture states: "For I Hashem dwell in the midst of the Children of Israel";** אַף עַל פִּי שֶׁהֵם טְמֵאִים, שְׁכִינָה שְׁרוּיָה בֵּינֵיהֶם, כְּמוֹ שֶׁפָּתוּב בְּסִפְרֵי (סוֹף פָּרָשַׁת וְהָיְנוּ מַסְעֵי);[245] **— even when they are defiled, the Shechinah abides among them (Sifrei, end of Masei);** שֶׁבְּמַעֲמַקֵּי הַלֵּב קְשׁוּר הַיְשָׂרְאֵל בַּשֹּׁרֶשׁ, **— meaning that in the deepest core of the heart every Jew is bound to the Root,** שֶׁרְצוֹנֵנוּ לַעֲשׂוֹת רְצוֹנָךְ, וּמִי מְעַכֵּב וְכוּ'" כְּמוֹ שֶׁפָּתוּב (בְּרָכוֹת י"ז עַמּוּד א').[246] **— for "our will is to do Your will, and what prevents it, etc." (Berachot 17a).**

Removing resistance reveals an inherited willingness

וּכְמוֹ שֶׁכָּתַב הָרַמְבַּ"ם (סוֹף פֶּרֶק ב׳ מֵהִלְכוֹת גֵּרוּשִׁין):[247, 248] **— And as the Rambam wrote (end of Chapter 2 of the**

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point in the Jewish heart becomes increasingly perfected and shines more in each generation, until the end-time when it will become complete. This concerns the heart's depths, which do not appear in everyone's actual conduct because of the inclination surrounding each person. Thus, "It is revealed and known that our will is…" and "what prevents us…"; likewise Rambam explains "we compel him until he says, 'I am willing'": his true will is so, although in practice he does not will it because his inclination coerces him."

Pri Tzadik invokes the genuine inner will beneath the inclination's outward resistance. Divrei Soferim explains how that point is strengthened: because Israel forms one whole, the restraint achieved by particular souls becomes rooted in others as well. Its use of the same Rambam gives an account of how the inner willingness can continue to be refined even when outward conduct remains obstructed.

[245] **Sifrei Bamidbar 160:2**: "(Bamidbar 35:13) "And the cities which you shall provide — six cities of refuge shall there be for you.": together with the first (three designated by Moses across the Jordan). You say, together with the first. But perhaps (the meaning is) exclusive of the first? (Ibid. 14) "The three cities shall you provide across the Jordan, and the three cities shall you provide in the land of Canaan" indicates "together with the first." And they are (Devarim 4:43) "Betzer in the desert in the land of the plain for (the tribes of) Reuven; Ramoth in Gilead for Gad; and Golan in Bashan for Menasheh. And, corresponding to them, three in the land of Canaan, viz. (Joshua 20:7) "And they set aside Kedesh in the Galil in the hill (country) of Naftali, and Shechem in the hill of Ephraim, and Kiryath Arba, which is Chevron, in the hill of Yehudah." We find, then, the two and a half tribes across the Jordan corresponding (in this respect) to the nine and a half tribes in the land of Canaan, most of the spillers of blood residing in Gilead. As it is written (Hoshea 6:8) "Gilead, the city of the workers of wrong, steeped in blood." (Bamidbar 35:13) "cities of refuge shall there be for you": What is the intent of this? I derive that they provide refuge only for those (who killed) in the land. Whence do I derive (the same for those) outside the land? From "shall there be for you" (— in any event). (Ibid. 15) "for the children of Israel": This tells me (that they provide refuge only) for (native) Israelites. Whence do I derive the same for proselytes and sojourners? From (Ibid.) "and for the proselyte and the sojourner in their midst." But perhaps (the meaning is that) just as a sojourning proselyte is exiled for (unwittingly killing) another, so, he is exiled for (unwittingly killing) an Israelite, and an Israelite is exiled for (unwittingly killing) him? — It is, therefore, written "for you." How so? If an Israelite killed him, he is exempt. If he killed an Israelite, he is killed. "shall these six cities be for refuge": What is the intent of this? From (14) "The three cities shall you provide across the Jordan," I might think that the first that is set aside provides refuge (immediately). It is, therefore, written "shall these six cities be for refuge," Scripture hereby apprising us that one (city) does not afford refuge until all have been set aside."

[246] **Berakhot 17a:2**: "After praying, Rabbi Alexandri would say: 'May it be Your will, Lord our God, that You place us in a corner of light and not in a corner of darkness. Let our hearts not become faint, and let our eyes not grow dark.' Some say that Rav Hamnuna was the one who prayed this prayer, while Rabbi Alexandri would say after praying: 'Master of all worlds, it is revealed and known before You that we wish to do Your will. What prevents us? The leaven in the dough, meaning the evil inclination within us, and our subjection to foreign kingdoms. May it be Your will to rescue us from their power, so that we may return to carrying out the statutes that express Your will with a whole heart.'"

[247] **Mishneh Torah, Divorce 2:20**: "If the law requires that a man be compelled to divorce his wife and he refuses to divorce her, a Jewish court, in any place and at any time, beats him until he says, 'I am willing,' and writes the bill of divorce; that bill of divorce is valid. Likewise, if gentiles beat him and tell him, 'Do what the Jews tell you,' and Jews pressure him through the gentiles until he divorces, it is valid. If the gentiles act on their own and compel him until he writes it, then, although the law requires him to write it, the bill of divorce is disqualified. Why is this bill of divorce not void, since he is acting under compulsion, whether at the hands of gentiles or Jews? We call someone compelled only when he is pressured and forced to do something that the Torah does not obligate him to do—for example, someone beaten until he sells or gives something. But someone whose evil inclination has overpowered him to neglect a commandment or commit a transgression, and who is beaten until he does what he is obligated to do or refrains from what he is forbidden to do, is not considered compelled by the person administering the blows; rather, through his corrupt decision he has compelled himself. Therefore, this man who does not wish to divorce, since he belongs to Israel and wishes to perform all the mitzvos and avoid transgressions, and it is his inclination that has overpowered him, has divorced willingly once he has been beaten until his inclination is weakened and he says, 'I am willing.' If the law does not require compelling him to divorce, but a Jewish court errs, or laymen compel him until he divorces, the bill of divorce is disqualified; since Jews compelled him, he should complete the matter and grant a valid divorce. If gentiles compel him to divorce contrary to the law, it is not a bill of divorce at all. Even if he says to the gentiles, 'I am willing,' and tells Jews, 'Write and sign it,' since the law does not require him to divorce and gentiles compelled him, it is not a bill of divorce."

[248] **Sod Yesharim, Rosh Hashanah 82:1**: "Our father Abraham, however, was always firmly attached to His will; the intensity of his generosity never changed in any of the changing times he experienced. There is therefore no ground to accuse him regarding "he shall not exchange or substitute," since the intensity of his generous heart never diminished. The great generosity present at the first moment remained at the later moment, and this generosity also remained

Laws of Divorce): מֵאַחַר שֶׁהוּא מִיִּשְׂרָאֵל וְרוֹצֶה לַעֲשׂוֹת כָּל הַמִּצְווֹת וְכוּלֵּיהּ, **— "Since he is from Israel and inwardly desires to fulfill all the commandments, etc.,** וְיִצְרוֹ תְּקָפוֹ, וְכֵינָן שֶׁהֻכָּה עַד שֶׁתָּשַׁשׁ יִצְרוֹ כְּבָר גֵּרַשׁ לִרְצוֹנוֹ וְכוּלֵּיהּ"; **— and it was his evil impulse that overpowered him, once he is coerced until his impulse weakens, he has already divorced willingly, etc.";** וְעַל זֶה סוֹמְכִין אַף בְּרָשָׁע שֶׁאָנוּ רוֹאִים שֶׁאֵינוֹ רוֹצֶה, **— and upon this we rely even regarding an outwardly wicked man whom we observe refusing,** וְאִם יֶחְדְּלוּ מִלְּהַכּוֹתוֹ מִכָּל מָקוֹם סוֹמְכִין אָנוּ שֶׁבְּמַעֲמַקֵּי יְסָרֵב; **— and who would persist in refusal were they to cease beating him;** לְבָבוֹ הוּא רוֹצֶה לִשְׁמֹעַ בְּדִבְרֵי חֲכָמִים לַעֲשׂוֹת רְצוֹנוֹ יִתְבָּרַךְ. **— nevertheless we rely that in the inward depth of his heart he truly desires to heed the words of the Sages and fulfill His Blessed Will.** וְזֶה קְדֻשַּׁת חֹדֶשׁ זֶה: שֶׁכָּל אֶחָד מִיִּשְׂרָאֵל יָכוֹל לְהִתְבָּרֵר שֶׁבְּמַעֲמַקֵּי הַלֵּב קָשׁוּר בַּהַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ, כְּמַה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: "אֲנִי יְשֵׁנָה וְלִבִּי עֵר" **— And this is the sanctity of this month: that every single Jew can attain clarity that in the depths of his heart he is inextricably bound to the Blessed Name, –** הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא שֶׁהוּא לֵבָב שֶׁל יִשְׂרָאֵל. **— as Scripture states: "I sleep, but my heart wakes" — the Holy One Who is the heart of Israel.**

The appearance of sleep does not reach the heart

God remains present within the distress

— And it states (Sotah 48a): –[249, 250, 251] וְאִיתָא (סוֹטָה מ״ח עַמּוּד א׳): "'עוּרָה לָמָּה תִישַׁן? — וְכִי יֵשׁ שֵׁינָה לִפְנֵי הַמָּקוֹם וְכוּלֵּיהּ **"'Awake, why do You sleep?' — is there then sleep before the Omnipresent, etc.?** אֶלָּא בִּזְמַן שֶׁיִּשְׂרָאֵל שְׁרוּיִין בְּצַעַר וְכוּלֵּיהּ, לָכֵן נֶאֱמַר: 'עוּרָה לָמָּה תִישַׁן הַשֵּׁם"', **— Rather, when Israel is submerged in suffering, etc., therefore it is said: 'Awake, why do You sleep, O Hashem"',** וְהֵינוּ נִרְאֶה כִּבְיָכוֹל אֵצֶל הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ כְּשֵׁינָה. **— meaning that it appears as it were regarding the Blessed Name like a state of sleep.** וּמִשּׁוּם הָכִי אִיתָא (מְגִלָּה נְדָדָה שְׁנַת מַלְכּוֹ שֶׁל וְגוֹ'): "בַּלַּיְלָה הַהוּא נָדְדָה שְׁנַת הַמֶּלֶךְ'[252] **— And for this reason it states (Megillah 15b):** –

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permanently in his descendants. We therefore find in the Gemara concerning an offering that they compel him until he says, “I am willing.” In truth, immense generosity is found in the depths of Israel’s heart. Because concealment hides it and obstructs him, he appears unwilling to offer. As soon as that obstruction is constrained so that it no longer conceals, and that appearance is removed, he remains standing in the willingness and generosity fixed in the depths of his heart as an inheritance from the patriarchs.”

Pri Tzadik cites the legal case in which outward resistance conceals an inward desire to obey. Sod Yesharim uses the sacrificial case to identify a source for this inward willingness: Abraham’s generosity remained constant through changing circumstances and was transmitted to his descendants. The relation explains the depth being uncovered; the two passages discuss their particular legal examples.

[249] **Sotah 48a:7**: “‘He also abolished those who awaken.’ Who were those who awaken? Rachava said: Each day the Levites would stand on the platform and say, ‘Awake! Why do You sleep, Lord?’ Yochanan the Kohen Gadol told them, ‘Is there sleep before the Omnipresent? Has it not already been said, “Behold, the Guardian of Israel neither slumbers nor sleeps”?’ Rather, when Israel are in distress and the nations of the world enjoy ease and tranquility, it is concerning that situation that Scripture says, ‘Awake! Why do You sleep, Lord?’”

[250] **Machshavot Charutz 17:18**: “Haman’s claim against Israel was that they too were “asleep regarding the commandments” and did not recognize His divinity. He therefore said that their God too was asleep: His providence and Presence were no longer among them. He wanted to destroy them altogether, leaving no possibility of awakening from sleep. But concerning the community of Israel it is truly said, “I sleep, but my heart is awake.” Song of Songs Rabbah explains that the Holy One is Israel’s heart, for “the Guardian of Israel neither slumbers nor sleeps.” What resembled sleep in the Babylonian exile was only an outward appearance, to the person who “sees with the eyes,” where sleep is recognized—not to God, who “sees the heart,” and “my heart is awake.” Even where outwardly no calling of God’s name upon Israel is recognizable, there too is the powerful disclosure of Heaven’s glory through them. Through this everything is repaired: all of Haman’s thought is truly reversed.”

Pri Tzadik explains the language of God’s sleep as the appearance produced by Israel’s distress and concealment. Machshavot Charutz develops the contrast between what human eyes see and the heart God sees: Haman mistakes an outward condition for the loss of any possibility of awakening. This explains why the concealment can end in the disclosure of the same enduring relationship.

[251] **Mei HaShiloach, Volume I, Exodus, Shemot 4**: “After fleeing Pharaoh, Moses our teacher learned to be patient. This is why the Holy One appeared to him in the bush: to teach him this quality. He showed him that He dwells in the bush—that He is greatly patient, for “I am with him in distress”—and is patient toward Pharaoh. This is the meaning of Moses’ blessing to Joseph, “the favor of the One who dwells in the bush.” Moses wished to place patience within Joseph the righteous one’s quality, so that he would be full of goodwill toward Israel and have no complaint against any Jewish soul. For judgment against Israel awakens from this tribe when they turn from God’s will, as the prophet warned, “Lest He break out like fire in the house of Joseph.” His quality should not become angry, but remain favorable toward Israel. He therefore said, “the favor of the One who dwells in the bush”: God should teach you patience as He taught me at the bush.”

Pri Tzadik calls God’s apparent sleep a condition of concealment while Israel suffers. Mei HaShiloach explains the burning bush as God teaching Moses that He is present with Israel in that very distress and patiently bears the oppressor’s continued existence. The comparison gives content to divine presence during concealment; its scene of Moses learning patience is distinct from Purim’s later awakening to deliverance.

[252] **Megillah 15b**: ‘The verse states: “On that night the sleep of the king was disturbed” (Esther 6:1). Rabbi Tanḥum said:

שֶׁאָז — **"'On that night the sleep of the king fled' — the sleep of the King of the Universe fled",** עוֹלָם",
הָיָה נִרְאֶה כְּשֵׁינָה לְמַעְלָה כְּבָיָכוֹל, שֶׁהָיוּ יִשְׂרָאֵל בְּהֶסְתֵּר פָּנִים — **for then it seemed like a divine slumber Above, as Israel were in profound concealment of the Countenance;** וְאָז נָדְדָה שְׁנַת הַמֶּלֶךְ, וְכָל מָקוֹם שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר בַּמְּגִלָּה "הַמֶּלֶךְ"
סָתָם — **and then the sleep of the King fled, –** בְּמֶלֶךְ מַלְכֵי הַמְּלָכִים הַכָּתוּב מְדַבֵּר — **and wherever in the Megillah it says simply "the King" — Scripture speaks of the King of kings,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב (זֹהַר חֶלֶק ג׳ ק״ט
עַמּוּד א׳ וְעַיֵּן מִדְרָשׁ רַבָּה אֶסְתֵּר)[253]; — **as written (Zohar Part III, 109a and see Midrash Rabbah Esther);** וְהַיְנוּ
שֶׁנִּתְעוֹרֵר לִנְקֹם נִקְמַת יִשְׂרָאֵל, וְזֶהוּ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: "וְלִבִּי עֵר לְגָאֳלָנִי". — **meaning that He awakened to avenge the cause of Israel, and this is: "and my heart wakes to redeem me".** '"וְחֹשֶׁךְ: (בְּרֵאשִׁית רַבָּה פָּרָשָׁה ב׳)[254]וְאִיתָא — **And it states (Bereishit Rabbah, Parashah 2): –** זֶה גָּלוּת יָוָן שֶׁהֶחְשִׁיכָה עֵינֵיהֶם שֶׁל יִשְׂרָאֵל בִּגְזֵרוֹתֵיהֶן וְכוּ׳לֵיהּ", — **"'And darkness' — this is the exile of Greece which darkened the eyes of Israel through their decrees, etc.",**
דְּחֹשֶׁךְ הַיְנוּ לַיְלָה, וְ"לֹא אִיבְרִי לֵילְיָא אֶלָּא לְשֵׁינָתָא" כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב (עֵירוּבִין ס״ה עַמּוּד א׳)[255]; — **for darkness means night, and "the night was created only for sleep" (Eruvin 65a);**
וְהַיְנוּ שֶׁהֶחְשִׁיכָה עֵינֵיהֶם, שֶׁגָּזְרוּ עַל יִשְׂרָאֵל שֶׁלֹּא יַעַסְקוּ בַּתּוֹרָה, וְ"עֵינֵיהֶם שֶׁל יִשְׂרָאֵל" הַיְנוּ הַסַּנְהֶדְרִין, כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב (שִׁיר הַשִּׁירִים רַבָּה ד׳): '"עֵינַיִךְ'[256] — **and that means they darkened their eyes, decreeing that Israel not engage in Torah; –** הֵן סַנְהֶדְרִין וְכוּ׳לֵיהּ". — **and "the eyes of Israel" are the Sanhedrin, as written: "'Your eyes' — these are the Sanhedrin, etc."**

Deliverance discloses the purpose of the earlier pressure

וְזֶה "הִמְלִיךְ אוֹת סָמ״ךְ, — **And in this month occurred the miracle of Chanukah,** וּבָזֶה הַחֹדֶשׁ הָיָה נֵס חֲנֻכָּה,[257]
בְּשֵׁינָה", שֶׁהַשֵּׁם סוֹמֵךְ לְכָל הַנֹּפְלִים שֶׁלֹּא יִהְיֶה נְפִילָה; — **and this is "He crowned the letter Samech over sleep", for Hashem supports all who fall so that it is not an ultimate downfall;**

Opposition can begin a deliverance that service completes

שֶׁמִּקּוֹדָם הָיוּ גַּם כֵּן תַּחַת מֶמְשַׁלְתָּם, — **for out of this darkness sprouted the salvation:** שֶׁמִּזֶּה הַחֹשֶׁךְ נִצְמַח הַיְשׁוּעָה:[258]

The verse alludes to another king who could not sleep; the sleep of the King of the universe, the Holy One, Blessed be He, was disturbed. And the Sages say: The sleep of the higher ones, the angels, was disturbed, and the sleep of the lower ones, the Jewish people, was disturbed. Rava said: This should be understood literally: The sleep of King Ahasuerus was disturbed.'

[253] **Zohar, Behar 5:22-7:31**: 'In the Zohar (Behar, III 109a) and Midrash Esther Rabbah, the Sages teach that wherever 'the King' (HaMelekh) is mentioned unqualified in Megillat Esther, it alludes innerly to the King of kings, the Holy One, blessed be He, who orchestrates the hidden redemption of Israel from behind the veil of natural events.'

[254] **Bereshit Rabbah 2:4** (excerpt): "'And darkness'—this is the Greek exile, which darkened Israel's eyes through its decrees, for it said to them: Write upon the horn of an ox that you have no portion in the God of Israel."

[255] **Eruvin 65a**: 'Rav Yehuda said: Night was created only for sleep. Rabbi Shimon ben Lakish said: The moon was created only for Torah study by its light. When people said to Rabbi Zeira: Your teachings are exceedingly sharp, he said to them: They were formulated during the daytime hours. This teaches that Torah study during the day is most beneficial to clarity of the mind.'

[256] **Shir HaShirim Rabbah 4:1:2** (excerpt): "'Your eyes are doves.' Your eyes are the Sanhedrin, who are the eyes of the congregation, as it is written, 'If it was from the eyes of the congregation' (Numbers 15:24). A person has two hundred and forty-eight limbs, and none of them goes or returns except by following the eyes. So too, Israel cannot act independently of its Sanhedrin."

[257] **Peri Tzadik, Chanukah 15:2**: "Then, in the days of the Hasmoneans, they had rest in the aspect of higher unity. All recognized that the decree had been for their good, because through it they defeated the Greeks and threw off their yoke. Previously they were subject to them, and Simeon the Righteous had to go out to meet the ruler, as stated in Yoma 69a. Without the decrees they certainly would not have risen against him. Only because of the decree seeking to turn them from their religion were they prepared to die in order to fight him. The miracle was performed for them, and they removed the yoke from their necks. This is the allusion of the twenty-five letters in the higher unification mentioned in Tikkunei Zohar."
The Kislev passage gives the sequence: an already subject people was awakened by the religious decrees, resisted with self-sacrifice, and received divine help. Pri Tzadik's Chanukah discourse places this same sequence within the meaning of rest and higher unity: after deliverance they could recognize a good that had not been visible within the decree. It adds the attained recognition to the mechanism described here.

[258] **Tiferet Yosef, The Seventh Day of Pesach 6**: "The beginning of the awakening of deliverance sometimes comes in the manner of "Were it not that I feared the enemy's provocation, lest their adversaries misunderstand, lest they say: Our hand is raised, and the Lord did not do all this." As the Midrash says, what caused them to leave there? The enemy's provocation. Thus the beginning of deliverance in Egypt grew from this. Although it seems very small to our apprehension that the whole deliverance should initially grow from the enemy's provocation, since we see that God chose this foundation from which deliverance sometimes grows, it is as great as all foundations. In what God chooses, there is no difference between a great thing and a small one. This is the Midrash's statement that "The enemy said, I will pursue, I will overtake…" should have begun the song: from the enemy's provocation the whole awakening of deliverance grew. Yet afterwards God established that Israel should clarify why He truly chose them. Although the beginning came from the enemy's provocation, the completion of deliverance nevertheless comes from Israel's service."
Pri Tzadik shows how oppression awakened Israel's resistance and was followed by divine help. Tiferet Yosef

— for previously they were also under their political rule, אַךְ כֵּינָן שֶׁגָּזְרוּ גְּזֵרוֹת כָּאֵלּוּ וְהֶחְשִׁיכוּ עֵינֵיהֶם, **— yet once they enacted such vicious decrees and darkened their eyes,** עַל יְדֵי זֶה נִתְעוֹרְרוּ וּמָסְרוּ עַצְמָם עַל זֶה, **— through this they awakened and gave their lives over it,** וְהַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ עָזָרָם וְנִתְגַּבְּרוּ עֲלֵיהֶם. וְזֶהוּ "סוֹמֵךְ" **— and the Blessed Name helped them and they overpowered them. –** שֶׁהַנְּפִילָה הִיא צֹרֶךְ עֲלִיָּה; **— And this is Somech (supporter) — that the fall is a necessary descent for the sake of an ascent;** וְכֵן הַשֵּׁינָה הוּא לְטוֹבָה: "אֲנִי יְשֵׁנָה וְלִבִּי עֵר" **— and so sleep is for the good: –** שֶׁהַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ שׁוֹכֵן בְּלֵב יִשְׂרָאֵל. **— "I sleep, but my heart wakes" — that the Blessed Name dwells within the heart of Israel.**

distinguishes the beginning of deliverance through the enemy's provocation from its completion through Israel's service. Its account concerns Egypt and the honor of God; the shared structure clarifies why Pri Tzadik includes Israel's awakened self-sacrifice in the ascent that follows darkness.

Rosh Chodesh Kislev Ois 5

Samech, Divine Support, and the Light of the Oral Torah

A clarity established by the ancestors can awaken against later concealment.

Samech, Divine Support, and the Light of the Oral Torah

בְּסֵפֶר יְצִירָה: "הִמְלִיךְ אוֹת סָמֶ"ךְ בְּשֵׁינָה וְכוּלֵיהּ, וְכִסְלֵו בַּשָּׁנָה". **— In Sefer Yetzirah: "He made the letter Samech king over sleep, etc., and Kislev in the year."** בְּאוֹתִיּוֹת דְּרַבִּי עֲקִיבָא, אוֹת סָמֶ"ךְ: **— In Otiyot de-Rabbi Akiva, regarding the letter Samech:** 'אַל תִּקְרֵי 'סָמֶךְ' אֶלָּא 'סוֹמֵךְ מָךְ', **— "Do not read Samech, but rather Somech mach (Supporting the impoverished);** זֶה הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא שֶׁהוּא סוֹמֵךְ מַכִּים נוֹפְלִים, **— this is the Holy One, Blessed be He, Who supports the crushed and fallen,**

The patriarchs' trials leave a protective light

שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: 'סוֹמֵךְ ה' לְכָל הַנֹּפְלִים וְכוּלֵיהּ'.[259] **— as it is said: 'Hashem supports all who fall, etc.' –** דָּבָר אַחֵר: 'סָמֶךְ': אֵלּוּ יִשְׂרָאֵל, שֶׁסּוֹמְכִין לָהֶם תָּמִיד זְכוּת אֲבוֹתֵיהֶם: **— Another explanation: Samech — these are Israel, whom the merit of their fathers always supports:** אַבְרָהָם, יִצְחָק, וְיַעֲקֹב, וְיוֹסֵף, מֹשֶׁה, וְאַהֲרֹן, וְדָוִד, וּשְׁלֹמֹה וְכוּלֵיהּ". **Abraham, Isaac, Jacob, Joseph, Moses, Aaron, David, and Solomon, etc."** וְהַיְנוּ דְּאוֹת סָמֶ"ךְ מוֹרֶה עַל אוֹר מַקִּיף; **— And that is because the letter Samech indicates an encircling light (Ohr Makif);** וְאוֹת סָמֶ"ךְ רִאשׁוֹנָה שֶׁבַּתּוֹרָה בְּתֵבַת "הוּא הַסֹּבֵב", **— and the first letter Samech in the Torah appears in the word ha-sovev ("that which compasses"),** וּבְכָל מָקוֹם שֶׁנִּזְכָּר הָאוֹת בָּרִאשׁוֹנָה בַּתּוֹרָה, מוֹרֶה עַל שֹׁרֶשׁ הַחַיִּים שֶׁל זֶה הָאוֹת, **— and wherever a letter is mentioned for the first time in the Torah, it reveals the life-root of that letter,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁמָּצִינוּ (בָּבָא קַמָּא נ"ה עַמּוּד א') לְעִנְיַן אוֹת טֵי"ת:[260] **— just as we found (Bava Kamma 55a) regarding the letter Tet:** "הוֹאִיל וּפָתַח בּוֹ הַכָּתוּב לְטוֹבָה תְּחִלָּה"; **— "Since Scripture opened with it first for good in the word tov";** וְכֵן בְּאוֹת סָמֶ"ךְ פָּתַח תְּחִלָּה "הוּא הַסֹּבֵב", שֶׁהוּא מַקִּיף, **— and likewise with the letter Samech, Scripture opened first with ha-sovev, which means encompassing,** וְכֵן צוּרַת הָאוֹת מַקִּיף. וְאָמַר קוּדְשָׁא בְּרִיךְ הוּא סָמֶךְ **— and so too the graphic shape of the letter is an encompassing circle. –** "סוֹמֵךְ מָךְ", **— And it said first that the Holy One, Blessed be He, is Samech — Somech mach (Supporting the impoverished),** וְהַיְנוּ יִשְׂרָאֵל, וּכְמוֹ בְּיִשְׂרָאֵל הַכָּתוּב[261] שֶׁפָּתוּב (בְּרֵאשִׁית רַבָּה פָּרָשָׁה ע"א): "כָּל מָקוֹם שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר 'דַּל', 'עָנִי', וְ'אֶבְיוֹן' **— which refers to Israel, –** מְדֻבָּר"[262] **— as written (Bereishit Rabbah, Parashah 71): "Wherever 'poor', 'destitute', and 'needy' are mentioned — Scripture speaks of Israel."**

An ancestor's strength can support the whole people

וְאַחַר כָּךְ אָמַר: דְּיִשְׂרָאֵל הוּא הָאֲוִיר שֶׁבְּתוֹךְ אוֹת סָמֶ"ךְ, וְהַמַּקִּיף[263] **— And afterward it said: that Israel is the inner space enclosed within the letter Samech, –** רוֹעֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל, שִׁבְעָה רוֹעִים שֶׁהֵם מֶרְכָּבָה לְשֶׁבַע הַמִּדּוֹת. וְכֵן דָּרַשׁ אַחַר כָּךְ: 'סָמֶךְ'" **— while the encompassing perimeter is the Shepherds of Israel, the Seven Shepherds who are the chariot for the seven sefirotic attributes. –** זוֹ יְרוּשָׁלַיִם וְכוּלֵיהּ", **— And so it expounded afterward: "'Samech' — this is Jerusalem, etc.",** וְהַיְנוּ שֶׁהַפְּנִימִיּוּת הוּא יְרוּשָׁלַיִם וְ"הָרִים סָבִיב לָהּ"; **— meaning that the inner interior is Jerusalem, while "mountains are round about her"; –** אֵלּוּ אָבוֹת, קְדֻשַּׁת הָאָבוֹת: דְּאַבְרָהָם קְרָאוֹ "הַר", יִצְחָק "שָׂדֶה", **— "mountains" — these are the Patriarchs, the holiness of the Patriarchs:**

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[259] **Sod Yesharim, Rosh Hashanah 82:1**: "The trials experienced by the holy patriarchs were not needed from their own side, for they were already completely clarified even without the trials. The whole purpose of their trials was that this should remain established for generations: when some concealment should confront Israel, God forbid, the clarity of the holy patriarchs' trials would awaken against it to protect Israel."
Pri Tzadik's enclosing shepherds signify the enduring support of ancestral merit. Sod Yesharim explains why the patriarchs' trials matter to descendants: the clarified light remains available when a later concealment confronts Israel. This translates the picture of being surrounded into the particular function of protection during a test.

[260] **Bava Kamma 55a**: 'Rather, it is not merely because it is the first letter of the word good tov that it is considered a good omen. Since the Torah initially introduces the letter tet in a context of good, with the word good tov itself, it is a good omen. As from the word bereshit, the first word in the Torah, until the verse: "And God saw that the light was good tov" (Genesis 1:4), the letter tet is not written anywhere.'

[261] **Bereshit Rabbah 71:1** (excerpt): "'For Hashem listens to the needy'—these are Israel. For Rabbi Yochanan said: Wherever 'poor,' 'afflicted,' and 'needy' are stated, Scripture is speaking about Israel."

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[263] **Divrei Soferim 23:1**: "When a person restrains himself in a matter, overcoming his inclination with all his strength, through this power he restrains all the souls of the Jewish people in all generations in that matter. Our sages say: Sarah descended to Egypt and restrained herself from forbidden sexual relations, and all the women were restrained in her merit; Joseph descended to Egypt and restrained himself, and all the males were restrained in his merit. With Sarah one might say this is because all Israel are her offspring and descendants; that cannot be said of Joseph. It must therefore be because all Israel constitute one whole form, and through the perfection of one member the whole form is perfected."
Pri Tzadik describes Israel as surrounded by the merit of its fathers and shepherds. Divrei Soferim explains how such merit can act beyond the person who first attained it: the members of Israel constitute one whole, so the restraint of Sarah and Joseph establishes a capacity in others. This gives an inward mechanism for the ancestral support pictured by the enclosing samekh.

וְיַעֲקֹב קָרָאוֹ "בַּיִת", כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בַּגְּמָרָא (פְּסָחִים פ״ח עַמּוּד א׳). וְכֵן כְּשֶׁדָּרַשׁ: "'סָמֶךְ[264] **— for Abraham called the Temple site "a mountain", Isaac called it "a field", and Jacob called it "a house", as written in the Gemara (Pesachim 88a). –** אֵלּוּ יִשְׂרָאֵל", **— And likewise when it expounded: "'Samech' — these are Israel",** הַמְכֻנָּן גַּם כֵּן שֶׁיִּשְׂרָאֵל הֵם פְּנִימִיּוּת הַסָּמֶ״ךְ, הָאֲוִיר שֶׁבְּאוֹת סָמֶ״ךְ, **— the intent is likewise that Israel is the interior of the Samech, the open space within the letter Samech,** וְרוֹעֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל הַמַּקִּיפִין לָהֶם. **— and the Shepherds of Israel are those encompassing them.**

וְחָשַׁב שָׁם בְּאוֹתִיּוֹת דְּרַבִּי עֲקִיבָא: **— And it calculated there in Otiyot de-Rabbi Akiva:** זְכוּתָן שֶׁל אַבְרָהָם וְיִצְחָק שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: "מִי הֵעִיר מִמִּזְרָח **— the merit of Abraham and Isaac is in the east round about them,** בַּמִּזְרָח סָבִיב לָהֶם, **— as it is said: "Who has raised up the righteous one from the east, etc.",**[265] צֶדֶק [יִקְרָאֵהוּ לְרַגְלוֹ]", עַיֵּן שָׁם; **see there;** וְהֵינוּ שֶׁזֶּה נֶאֱמַר עַל אַבְרָהָם. **— meaning that this was stated regarding Abraham.**

The promise can open a new capacity to perceive

וּבַגְּמָרָא (שַׁבָּת קנ״ו עַמּוּד ב׳):[266, 267] **— And in the Gemara (Shabbat 156b):**

Abraham moves from an apparent ending to a beginning

"מַה דַּעְתְּךָ, דְּקָאֵי צֶדֶק בַּמַּעֲרָב? מַהְדַּרְנָא וּמוֹקֵמְנָא לֵיהּ בַּמִּזְרָח וְכוּלֵיהּ", וְהֵינוּ שֶׁהוּא אַבְרָהָם אָבִינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם סָבַר שֶׁהוּא הַסּוֹף[268] **— "What is your thought, that Jupiter (Tzedek) stands in the west? I will rotate it and set it in the east, etc.", –** "צֶדֶק", מַלְכוּתָא קַדִּישָׁא, מִדָּה אַחֲרוֹנָה; **— meaning that Abraham our Father, peace be upon him, assumed he occupied the final end — Tzedek, the Holy Kingdom, the final sefirah;** "מַהְדַּרְנָא וּמוֹקֵמְנָא לֵיהּ שֶׁמִּמֶּנּוּ יַתְחִיל עִקַּר זְרִיחַת הָאוֹר, וּכְמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בִּבְרֵאשִׁית רַבָּה: "'יְהִי אוֹר' **— "I will turn it and set it in the east" —** בַּמִּזְרָח", **— for from him the primary shining of the light would begin, –** זֶה אַבְרָהָם". **— as written in Bereishit Rabbah: "'Let there be light' — this is Abraham."** וְיִצְחָק גַּם כֵּן בַּמִּזְרָח, **— And Isaac is likewise in the east,** שֶׁהוּא עִקַּר זְרִיחַת הָאוֹר שֶׁל יִשְׂרָאֵל שֶׁהָיָה הָרִאשׁוֹן שֶׁנִּמּוֹל לִשְׁמוֹנָה, **— for he is the primary dawning of the light of Israel, being the first circumcised at eight days,** וְהֵינוּ שֶׁנּוֹלַד מְתוֹלָדָה יִשְׂרָאֵל.[269] **— meaning he was**

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[264] **Pesachim 88a:4**: “Rather, the future Temple will be described neither as Avraham described it, concerning whom ‘mountain’ is written, as it says, ‘As it is said today: On the mountain of the Lord He will be seen’; nor as Yitzchak described it, concerning whom ‘field’ is written, as it says, ‘Yitzchak went out to meditate in the field’; but as Yaakov described it, calling it a ‘house,’ as it says, ‘He called the name of that place Beis El, the house of God.’”

[265] **Isaiah 41:2**: ‘Who has roused a victor from the East,Summoned him to God’s service?Has delivered up nations to him,And trodden sovereigns down?Has rendered their swords like dust,Their bows like wind-blown straw?’

[266] **Shabbat 156a:14**; **Shabbat 156b:1**: “Avraham said before Him, ‘Master of the world, I have examined my astrological destiny and am not fit to beget a son.’ God told him, ‘Leave your astrology, for Israel is not subject to mazal. What is your concern? That Jupiter, called Tzedek, stands in the west? I shall turn it around and place it in the east.’ This is what is written, ‘Who aroused from the east one whom righteousness calls to its foot?’”

[267] **Tiferet Yosef, Talmud Anthology, Sanhedrin 2**: “From his present apprehension Abraham saw that Abram could not beget. Afterwards the Holy One said, “What are you thinking—that Jupiter stands in the west? I will move it and establish it in the east,” as the Talmud states. Had Abraham then ascribed some power to himself, he could have taken one of two approaches: refuse to believe because he perceived the opposite, or say that what he now perceived was untrue—or that his earlier inquiry into who owned the palace, through which he recognized God as its owner, was also, God forbid, untrue. His belief in this divine promise proves that Abraham ascribed no independent power to himself from all his work. Although he did not understand how the promise would be fulfilled, he trusted that God could give him a different apprehension in a moment, through which he would recognize that he could beget.”

Pri Tzadik describes Abraham as thinking he was the end and God establishing him as a beginning. Tiferet Yosef explains the same talmudic promise through Abraham’s relationship to his own understanding: he does not make his current perception of barrenness the limit of what God can reveal. The target clarifies the trust involved in moving from the apparent endpoint toward fatherhood.

[268] **Divrei Chalomot 9:1**: “Before Abraham our father reached his full perfection and merited Isaac’s birth, becoming the father of the Jewish people from whom its unfolding would proceed, that star did not yet shine at the beginning as the first of the stars. Its light was recognizable only at the night’s end, near the moon’s setting: it had already begun to shine through his own light, but was still exceedingly small and concealed. This is “it stands in the west,” where the moon sets at the night’s end. From this he understood that he was childless and that no further unfolding would proceed from and after him. God told him, “I will move it to the east,” the beginning of the shining: on the contrary, you are the head of the whole unfolding of the Jewish people and the first of all the stars. When he became complete and merited Isaac’s birth and the people’s unfolding from him, that star began to shine at the beginning of the night in the east, as it does today.”

Pri Tzadik reads the movement of Abraham’s star from west to east as the change from an apparent endpoint into the beginning of Israel’s light. In a reported dream, Divrei Chalomot develops that contrast through the difference between Abraham’s personal illumination and his completed role as the father of an unfolding people. The comparison explains the spiritual meaning of the directions in the author’s reading.

[269] **Peri Tzadik, Lech Lecha 4:1**: “Likewise, regarding Abraham’s feast, Tosafot (Shabbat 130a) cites Pirkei de-Rabbi Eliezer: “On the day heh-gimel [five plus three], he circumcised”—the eighth day of circumcision. Isaac was the first to be circumcised on the eighth day. Since an infant is circumcised on the eighth day without his own understanding and thereby becomes an Israelite, this indicates that he is attached at the root, in the beginning of divine thought.”

born from birth as a consecrated Jew. וְאַחַר כָּךְ אָמַר: זְכוּתָן שֶׁל יַעֲקֹב וְיוֹסֵף בַּמַּעֲרָב, **— And afterward it said: the merit of Jacob and Joseph is in the west,** "פְּנֵי אָדָם": "וּדְמוּת פְּנֵיהֶם פְּנֵי אָדָם וְגוֹמֵר": שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: **— as it is said: "As for the likeness of their faces, each had the face of a man, etc.":** – זֶה דְּמוּת יַעֲקֹב שֶׁחֲקוּקָה עַל כִּסֵּא הַכָּבוֹד; **– the face of a man" — this is the likeness of Jacob engraved on the Throne of Glory;** – זֶה "דְּמוּת שׁוֹר" **— "the likeness of an ox" — this is the likeness of Joseph, as it is said: "His firstling bullock, majesty is his, etc."** שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: "בְּכוֹר שׁוֹרוֹ הָדָר לוֹ וְכוּלֵיהּ". דְּמוּת יוֹסֵף, **— And the explanation is, for it is written: "and the earth is My footstool",** וְהָעָנְיָן, דִּכְתִיב: "וְהָאָרֶץ הֲדֹם רַגְלָי", **— which refers to the Holy Temple where the Shechinah dwells,** וְהַיְנוּ בַּיִת הַמִּקְדָּשׁ שֶׁשָּׁם הַשְּׁרָאַת הַשְּׁכִינָה, "בֵּית הֲדוֹם רַגְלֵי אֱלֹהֵינוּ" (מכות כ"ד סוף עמוד א')[270] **termed in the Gemara (Makkot 24a bottom) "the house of the footstool of our God",** וְכֵן הוּא בַּמִּדְרָשׁ רַבָּה **— and so it is in Midrash Rabbah (end of Eichah);** (סוף איכה);[271] **— and this refers to the Holy of Holies which was in the west,** וְהַיְנוּ בְּקֹדֶשׁ הַקָּדָשִׁים שֶׁהוּא בַּמַּעֲרָב, "שְׁכִינָה בַּמַּעֲרָב" כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב (בבא בתרא כ"ה עמוד א');[272] **and also "the Shechinah is in the west" as written (Bava Batra 25a);** וְעַל כֵּן חָשַׁב זְכוּתָן שֶׁל אַבְרָהָם וְיִצְחָק מִמִּזְרָח, שֶׁמֵּהֶם תְּחִלַּת זְרִיחַת הָאוֹר; **— and therefore it reckoned the merit of Abraham and Isaac from the east, for from them is the initial dawning of light;** וְיַעֲקֹב וְיוֹסֵף מִמַּעֲרָב, שֶׁהֵם עִקַּר כְּנֶסֶת יִשְׂרָאֵל, **— and Jacob and Joseph from the west, for they are the core of Knesset Yisrael,** שֶׁכָּל יִשְׂרָאֵל נִקְרָאוּ "בֵּית יַעֲקֹב" וְ"שְׁאֵרִית יוֹסֵף", עַל שֵׁם יוֹסֵף, כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב (בְּרֵאשִׁית רַבָּה פָּרָשָׁה ע"א).[273] **— since all Israel are called "the House of Jacob" and "the remnant of Joseph" after Joseph (Bereishit Rabbah 71).** וְהַיְנוּ דְּיַעֲקֹב מִדָּתוֹ אֱמֶת, **— And that is because Jacob's attribute is Truth,** וְהוּא מֶרְכָּבָה לְאוֹת וָא"ו דְּאִקְרֵי אוֹת אֱמֶת כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב (זֹהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ רֵישׁ פָּרָשַׁת וַיִּקְרָא), וְיוֹסֵף[274] **— and he is the chariot for the letter Vav called the letter of Truth (Zohar, Parashat Vayikra), – while Joseph is the small vav, the vav of the spelling-expansion of the letter** [ו-ו]; וָא"ו זְעֵירָא, וָא"ו הַמְּלוּיִי; **— and Jacob is "the middle bar reaching from end to end",** "וְיַעֲקֹב "הַבְּרִיחַ הַתִּיכֹן מַבְרִחַ מִן הַקָּצֶה אֶל הַקָּצֶה",[275] **— meaning from Keter Elyon down to the attribute of Knesset Yisrael;** וְהַיְנוּ מִכֶּתֶר עֶלְיוֹן לְמִדַּת כְּנֶסֶת יִשְׂרָאֵל; **— and Joseph is termed Kalkol (the Sustainer), through whom flows the abundance and channeling to Knesset Yisrael;** וְיוֹסֵף נִקְרָא "כַּלְכֹּל", שֶׁעַל יָדוֹ הַהַשְׁפָּעָה וְהַהַמְשָׁכָה לִכְנֶסֶת יִשְׂרָאֵל; וְכֵן הוּא בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ (חֵלֶק א' קפ"ב **— and so it is in the Holy Zohar (Part I, 182b):** "וְתַרְוַיְיהוּ כְּחַדָּא אָזְלִי, וְדָא רָזָא דְּאוֹת וָא"ו דְּאָזְלֵי תַּרְוַיְיהוּ כַּחֲדָא וְכוּלֵיהּ, עַיֵּן שָׁם"; עמוד ב');[276] **— "And both of them walk as one, and this is the mystery of the letter Vav where both proceed together, etc., see there";** וְזֶה שֶׁאָמַר: יַעֲקֹב פְּנֵי אָדָם, וְיוֹסֵף דְּמוּת שׁוֹר, **— and this is why it stated: Jacob is the face of a man, and Joseph the likeness of an ox.** אַף שֶׁיֵּשׁ גַּם כֵּן פְּנֵי נָשֶׁר וּפְנֵי אַרְיֵה, **— Even though there are also the face of an eagle and the face of a lion,** אַךְ הוּא עַל פִּי מַה שֶׁכָּתוּב בַּגְּמָרָא (חגיגה י"ג עמוד ב')[277] **— yet it follows what is written in the Gemara (Chagigah 13b):** דְּפְנֵי הַשּׁוֹר יְחֶזְקֵאל בִּקֵּשׁ רַחֲמִים עָלָיו וַהֲפָכוֹ

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[270] **Makkot 24a:33-24b:1**: "§ Apropos tribulations of exile and hope for redemption, the Gemara relates: And it once was that Rabban Gamliel, Rabbi Elazar ben Azarya, Rabbi Yehoshua, and Rabbi Akiva were walking along the road in the Roman Empire, and they heard the sound of the multitudes of Rome from Puteoli at a distance of one hundred and twenty mil. The city was so large that they were able to hear its tumult from a great distance. And the other Sages began weeping and Rabbi Akiva was laughing. They said to him: For what reason are you laughing? Rabbi Akiva said to them: And you, for what reason are you weeping? They said to him: These gentiles, who bow to false gods and burn incense to idols, dwell securely and tranquilly in this colossal city, and for us, the House of the footstool of our God, the Temple, is burnt by fire, and shall we not weep? Rabbi Akiva said to them: That is why I am laughing. If for those who violate His will, the wicked, it is so and they are rewarded for the few good deeds they performed, for those who perform His will, all the more so will they be rewarded."

[271] **Eikhah Rabbah 2:3**: "Another interpretation: "He did not remember His footstool." This footstool is none other than the Temple, as it is written: "Exalt the Lord our God, and bow down at His footstool; He is holy.""

[272] **Bava Batra 25a:11**: "Rabbi Abbahu said: The Shechinah is in the west. For Rabbi Abbahu said: What does uriyyah, a name for the west, mean? It means avir Yah, 'the air of God.'"

[273] **Bereshit Rabbah 71:2** (excerpt): "Rabbi Shimon ben Yochai taught: Since everything depends upon Rachel, Israel is called by her name: 'Rachel weeps for her children' (Jeremiah 31:15). And not only by her name, but also by her son's name: 'Perhaps Hashem, God of Hosts, will be gracious to the remnant of Joseph' (Amos 5:15). And not only by her son's name, but also by her grandson's name: 'Is Ephraim a precious son to Me?' (Jeremiah 31:19)."

[274] **Zohar, Vayikra 2:10**: 'At the beginning of Parashat Vayikra (Zohar III 2a), the letter Vav is expounded as the 'Sign of Truth' (Ot Emet), corresponding to Ze'ir Anpin (the Written Torah and the attribute of Jacob), which unites the supernal waters of Chokhmah and Binah with the sanctuary of Malkhut.'

[275] **Exodus 26:28**: 'The center bar halfway up the planks shall run from end to end.'

[276] **Zohar, Vayeshev 5:68-6:81**: 'In the Zohar (Vayeshev I 182b), on the closeness of Jacob and Joseph ('These are the generations of Jacob: Joseph'), it is taught: 'Both of them walk as one—Tiferet (Jacob) and Yesod (Joseph) are unified in the mystery of the single letter Vav, channeling all supernal blessing and sustenance (Kalkol) down to Knesset Yisrael.''

[277] **Chagigah 13b:6-7**: "One verse says, 'The likeness of their faces was the face of a man, the face of a lion on the right of all four, and the face of an ox on the left of all four,' and so forth. Yet another verse says, 'Each had four faces: the first face was the face of a cherub, the second the face of a man, the third the face of a lion, and the fourth the face of an eagle'—and it does not count an ox! Reish Lakish said: Yechezkel prayed for mercy concerning it, and He transformed it into a cherub. Yechezkel said before Him: 'Master of the world, should an accuser become an advocate?' What does

לְכָרוּב וְכוּלֵיהּ, — **that regarding the face of the ox Ezekiel prayed for mercy and transformed it into a cherub, etc.,** הַיְנוּ פְּנֵי כְרוּב הַיְנוּ פְּנֵי אָדָם: אַפֵּי רַבְרְבֵי וְאַפֵּי זוּטְרֵי, — **meaning the face of a cherub is identical to the face of a man: large face and small face;** וְהַיְנוּ דְּמוּת יַעֲקֹב אוֹת נָא"ו, וְיוֹסֵף נָא"ו הַמְּלוּי כָּאָמוּר. — **representing Jacob's likeness as the letter Vav, and Joseph as the vav of the expansion, as stated.** וְאָמַר: זְכוּתָם שֶׁל מֹשֶׁה וְאַהֲרֹן בַּדָּרוֹם וְכוּלֵיהּ, זְכוּתָם שֶׁל דָּוִד וּשְׁלֹמֹה בַּצָּפוֹן וְכוּלֵיהּ; — **And it said: the merit of Moses and Aaron is in the south, etc., and the merit of David and Solomon in the north, etc.;** וְהוּא עַל פִּי מַה שֶׁכָּתוּב (בָּבָא בַּתְרָא כ״ה עַמּוּד ב׳): "הָרוֹצֶה שֶׁיַּחְכִּים יַדְרִים, וְשֶׁיַּעֲשִׁיר יַצְפִּין וְכוּלֵיהּ, – – [278] — **and this is based on what is stated (Bava Batra 25b):** שֻׁלְחָן בַּצָּפוֹן וּמְנוֹרָה בַּדָּרוֹם". וּמֹשֶׁה וְאַהֲרֹן רַבּוֹתֵיהֶם שֶׁל יִשְׂרָאֵל: – — **"He who desires wisdom should face south, and wealth should face north, etc., the Table was in the north and the Menorah in the south." – And Moses and Aaron are the teachers of Israel:** מֹשֶׁה רַבֵּנוּ הוֹרִיד הַתּוֹרָה שֶׁבִּכְתָב, — **Moses our Teacher brought down the Written Torah,** וְאַהֲרֹן שֹׁרֶשׁ הַתּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה, דִּכְתִיב: "כִּי שִׂפְתֵי כֹהֵן יִשְׁמְרוּ דַעַת וְתוֹרָה יְבַקְשׁוּ מִפִּיהוּ"; — **and Aaron is the root of the Oral Torah, as written: "For the priest's lips shall guard knowledge and they shall seek Torah from his mouth";** וּשְׁנֵיהֶם בְּחָכְמָה, בַּדָּרוֹם, דִּמְנוֹרָה בַּדָּרוֹם לְהָאִיר לְיִשְׂרָאֵל. וְדָוִד וּשְׁלֹמֹה — **and both reside in wisdom, in the south, for the Menorah stood in the south to illuminate for Israel. –** שֻׁלְחָן בַּצָּפוֹן, וְזֵר הַשֻּׁלְחָן מְרַמֵּז לְשֻׁלְחַן מְלָכִים כְּמוֹ מַלְכֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל: — **And David and Solomon are the kings of Israel:** שֶׁכָּתוּב (יוֹמָא ע״ב עַמּוּד ב׳ וּפֵרֵשׁ רַבִּי שְׁלֹמֹה יִצְחָקִי שָׁם).[279] — **the Table stood in the north, and the crown-rim of the Table alludes to the table of kings as written (Yoma 72b and Rashi there).**

וְחָשַׁב דָּוִד וּשְׁלֹמֹה, דִּשְׁנֵיהֶם אוֹת הֵ"א: רַק דָּוִד שֶׁהֵקִים עֻלָּהּ שֶׁל תְּשׁוּבָה (מוֹעֵד קָטָן ט״ז עַמּוּד ב׳)[280] — **And it reckoned David and Solomon, for both embody the letter Heh: –** הֵ"א עִלָּאָה, בִּינָה, — **only David who established the yoke of repentance (Moed Katan 16b) embodies the Upper Heh, Binah,** כְּמַה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: "וּלְבָבוֹ יָבִין וְשָׁב"; וּשְׁלֹמֹה — **as stated: "and his heart understands and repents"; –** הֵ"א תַּתָּאָה, דַּהֲוַת סִיהֲרָא בְּאַשְׁלָמוּתָא, — **and Solomon embodies the Lower Heh, wherein the moon stood in full completion,** וְזָכָה לְכָל חָכְמָה תַּתָּאָה, חָכְמַת שְׁלֹמֹה. — **and he merited all Lower Wisdom, the wisdom of Solomon.** וּבְאוֹתִיּוֹת דְּרַבִּי עֲקִיבָא אָמַר בַּטַּעַם שֶׁדָּוִד וּשְׁלֹמֹה מִן הַצָּפוֹן: — **And in Otiyot de-Rabbi Akiva it stated the reason why David and Solomon are in the north:** שֶׁשְּׁנֵיהֶם נִתְנַבְּאוּ עַל מַתַּן שְׂכָרָן שֶׁל צַדִּיקִים שֶׁבְּגַן עֵדֶן שֶׁהוּא נָתוּן בַּצָּפוֹן וְכוּלֵיהּ: — **because both prophesied regarding the bestowal of the reward of the righteous in the Garden of Eden which is situated in the north, etc.:** דָּוִד נִתְנַבֵּא כְּשֶׁרָאָה טוּבָהּ שֶׁל גַּן עֵדֶן: "מָה רַב טוּבְךָ אֲשֶׁר צָפַנְתָּ לִירֵאֶיךָ"; — **David prophesied when beholding the goodness of Eden: "How abundant is Your goodness which You have hidden (tzafanta) for those who fear You";** שְׁלֹמֹה נִתְנַבֵּא וְאָמַר: "יִצְפֹּן לַיְשָׁרִים תּוּשִׁיָּה", עַיֵּן שָׁם. — **Solomon prophesied and said: "He lays up (yitzpon) sound wisdom for the upright", see there.**

The hidden good becomes receivable through measure

וְהַיְנוּ שֶׁשְּׁנֵיהֶם נִתְנַבְּאוּ עַל הָאוֹר הָרִאשׁוֹן שֶׁגְּנָזוֹ לַצַּדִּיקִים לֶעָתִיד לָבֹא, [281] — **Meaning that both prophesied concerning**

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keruv, 'cherub,' mean? Rabbi Abbahu said: Ke-ravya, 'like a child,' because in Babylonia a child is called ravya. Rav Pappa asked Abaye: If so, when it says, 'The first face was the face of a cherub, the second the face of a man, the third the face of a lion, and the fourth the face of an eagle,' are not the face of a cherub and the face of a man the same? He answered: One is a large face, and the other a small face."

[278] **Bava Batra 25b**: 'Rabbi Yitzḥak says: One who wishes to become wise should face south, and one who wishes to become wealthy should face north. And your mnemonic for this is that in the Temple the Table, which symbolized blessing and abundance, was in the north, and the Candelabrum, which symbolized the light of wisdom, was in the south of the Sanctuary. And Rabbi Yehoshua ben Levi says: One should always face south, as once he becomes wise he will subsequently also become wealthy, as it is stated with regard to the Torah: "Length of days is in her right hand; in her left hand are riches and honor" (Proverbs 3:16).'

[279] **Yoma 72b:6**: "Rabbi Yochanan said: There are three crowns: that of the altar, that of the Ark, and that of the table. Aharon merited and took the altar's crown. David merited and took the table's crown. The Ark's crown remains available; anyone who wishes to take it may come and take it. Lest you say it is inferior, Scripture teaches, 'Through me kings reign.'"

[280] **Moed Katan 16b:21**: "Rabbi Shmuel bar Naḥmani said in the name of Rabbi Yonatan: What is the meaning of "The utterance of David son of Jesse, the utterance of the man raised on high"? It is the utterance of David son of Jesse, who established the yoke of repentance."

[281] **Sod Yesharim, Sukkot 56:1**: "This is the Zohar's teaching, "I will say to the north, 'Give!'": "In you I placed every good." Where did the Holy One hide it? In Isaac's limitations; this is what the north signifies. As it explains: in the future the Holy One will call to the north and say, "In you I placed every good and every good reward for My children who endured many hardships in this world for the sanctification of My name. Give the good rewards I placed in you." This is "which You have stored for those who fear You." For from God's side, in His abundant kindness, kindness spreads and expands without limit; such expansion without the restraint of strength could nullify the whole creation. Thus Sefer Yetzirah says, "If your heart runs, return to the One": one can be nullified in His unity. The Zohar therefore explains that "Great is the Lord and greatly praised" is the praise of the second day, not the first: when is the Holy One called great? When the community of Israel is with Him. This is specifically the second day, which signifies the quality of strength,

the Primordial Light hidden away for the righteous in the Future to Come, — וְזֶהוּ "אֲשֶׁר צָפַנְתָּ לִירֵאֶיךָ". **and this is "which You have concealed (tzafanta) for those who fear You".** וְלֶעָתִיד כְּתִיב: "אֹמַר לַצָּפוֹן תֵּנִי", **— And regarding the Future it is written: "I will say to the north (tzafon): Give up, etc.",** וּבַזֹּהַר "לְזִמְנָא דְּאָתֵי קָרֵי קוּדְשָׁא בְּרִיךְ הוּא לְצָפוֹן וְיֵימָא לַיהּ: בָּךְ יְהִיבַת כָּל טִיבוּ וְכָל אַגְרָא טָב לִבְנֵי וְכוּלַּיהּ", **— and in the Holy Zohar (Part III, 173b): "In the Time to Come the Holy One will call to the north and say: In you I placed all goodness and all great reward for My children, etc.",** [282,283] וְהַיְנוּ אוֹר הָרִאשׁוֹן הַגְּנוּז לַצַּדִּיקִים לֶעָתִיד לָבֹא. **— which is the Primordial Light stored away for the righteous in the Future to Come.** וְחָשַׁב אַרְבַּע רוּחוֹת עַל פִּי מַה שֶּׁכָּתוּב בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ (חֶלֶק ב׳ קכ״ז סוֹף עַמּוּד א׳, ק״פ רֵישׁ עַמּוּד א׳), עַיֵּן שָׁם. וְכָאן נֶחְשָׁב: "'סָמֶךְ' **— And it reckoned four directions in accordance with what is written in the Holy Zohar (Part II, 127a bottom, 180a top), see there. –** אֵלּוּ יִשְׂרָאֵל", **— And here it is understood: "'Samech' — these are Israel",** הַיְנוּ הַפְּנִימִיּוּת, הַמֻּקָּף הוּא סָמֶ״ךְ, וְהַמַּקִּיף **— meaning the interior, the enclosed center is Samech, –** זְכוּת הָאָבוֹת וְהָרוֹעִים. **— while that which encompasses is the merit of the Patriarchs and Shepherds.** וְהוּא עַל דֶּרֶךְ מַה שֶּׁכָּתוּב בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ (שָׁם ר״ד עַמּוּד א׳): "שַׁבָּת: שִׁי״ן [284] **— And this follows what is written in the Holy Zohar (ibid. 204a): –** רָזָא דִּתְלָת אָבָהָן, וּבַת מִתְעַטְּרָא בְּהוּ". **— "Shabbat: the letter Shin is the mystery of the three Patriarchs, and the Daughter (Bat / Malchut) is crowned by them."** וּכְבָר אָמַרְנוּ דְּכֵן יַעֲקֹב וְיוֹסֵף כַּחֲדָא אִנּוּן, רָזָא דְּאוֹת וָא"ו; **— And we already explained that likewise Jacob and Joseph are unified as one, the mystery of the letter Vav;** וְכֵן מוּסַף שַׁבָּת נֶחְשָׁב (בְּזֹהַר חָדָשׁ תּוֹלְדוֹת) נֶגֶד יוֹסֵף, [285] **— and likewise the Musaf of Shabbat is reckoned (in Zohar Chadash, Toldot) corresponding to Joseph,** דְּהַתּוֹסֶפֶת קְדֻשָּׁה דְּשַׁבָּת עַל יְדֵי יוֹסֵף; **— for the added dimension of Shabbat sanctity is channeled through Joseph;** וְאוֹמְרִים "קְרִיבוּ שׁוּשְׁבִינִין", שֶׁהֵם מֹשֶׁה וְאַהֲרֹן, כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב (מִדְרָשׁ רַבָּה וּמִדְרָשׁ תַּנְחוּמָא עֵקֶב), [286] **— and we recite: "Draw near, best men", who are Moses and Aaron (Midrash Rabbah and Tanchuma, Ekev),** שֶׁהֵם גַּם כֵּן הֵ"א עִלָּאָה וְתַתָּאָה, שֶׁהוּא שַׁבָּת שֹׁרֶשׁ קְדֻשַּׁת שַׁבָּת; וְדָוִד וּשְׁלֹמֹה **— who are likewise the root of Sabbath holiness; –** עִלָּאָה וְשַׁבָּת תַּתָּאָה; **— and David and Solomon represent the Upper and Lower Heh, which are the Upper Shabbat and Lower Shabbat;** וְזוֹכִין יִשְׂרָאֵל בְּשַׁבָּת לְכָל קְדֻשַּׁת הָרוֹעִים. **— and Israel merits on Shabbat all the sanctities of the Shepherds.**

וְאָמַר בְּסֵפֶר יְצִירָה: "הִמְלִיךְ אוֹת סָמֶ״ךְ בְּשִׁינָה", **— And it said in Sefer Yetzirah: "He made the letter Samech king over sleep",** דִּכְבָר אָמַרְנוּ דִּשְׁמוֹת הַחֲדָשִׁים מוֹרִים עַל קְדֻשַּׁת הַחֹדֶשׁ, כְּמוֹ שֶׁדָּרְשׁוּ: "תִּשְׁרֵי **— for we have already explained that the names of the months reveal the distinct sanctity of the month, –** תִּשְׁרֵי וְתַשְׁבּוֹק וּתְכַפֵּר עַל חוֹבֵי עַמָּךְ" (כְּמוֹ שֶׁנִּתְבָּאֵר מַאֲמָר ב׳). [287] **— as they expounded: "Tishrei — release, pardon, and atone for the debts of Your people" (discourse 2).**

A later awakening can raise earlier permitted activity

וְשָׁם כִּסְלוֹ הוּא עַל פִּי מַה שֶּׁנֶּאֱמַר: "כִּי הַשֵּׁם יִהְיֶה בְכִסְלֶךָ וְשָׁמַר רַגְלְךָ מִלָּכֶד", [288] **— And the name Kislev is based on**

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which is the vessel limiting kindness so that there can be recognition of it."

Pri Tzadik identifies the north with the light and reward stored for the righteous. Sod Yesharim develops the same "I will say to the north, 'Give!'" teaching by explaining that unbounded kindness needs a limiting vessel to become recognizable and receivable by a creature. Its discussion assigns this work to Isaac's strength, while Pri Tzadik here speaks of David and Solomon as prophets of the stored reward; the comparison preserves those different assignments.

[282] **Zohar, Sh'lach 43:298-306**: 'I will say to the North (Tzafon): Give up! and to the South: Keep not back!' (Isaiah 43:6): the Zohar (Sh'lach III 173b) teaches that in the Time to Come, the Holy One, blessed be He, will summon the North (the left side of Gevurah and hidden treasure, tzafun) to release all the concealed wealth, illumination, and joy that were locked within strict judgment during the exile.'

[283] **Zohar, Sh'lach 43:298-306**: 'In the Zohar (Parashat Sh'lach, III 173b), the inner mystery of the libations of wine and water offered upon the altar and their correspondence to joy and lovingkindness is expounded.'

[284] **Zohar, Vayechi 204a**: 'In the Zohar (Vayechi I 204a), the word Shabbat is expounded by its letters: the three-pronged letter Shin represents the three Patriarchs (Abraham, Isaac, and Jacob—Chesed, Gevurah, and Tiferet), who unite with and crown the Daughter .'

[285] **Zohar Chadash, Toldot**: 'In Zohar Chadash (Toldot), the seven Musaf offerings of the sacred calendar and the seven blessings of the Patriarchs are aligned with the Seven Faithful Shepherds (Abraham, Isaac, Jacob, Moses, Aaron, Joseph, and David), who serve as the Chariot for the seven lower Sefirot from Chesed to Malkhut.'

[286] **Devarim Rabbah 3:11**: 'In Devarim Rabbah (Eikev 3:11) and Midrash Tanchuma (Eikev), at the giving of the Torah at Mount Sinai, Moses and Aaron acted as the two best men (shushvinin) leading the bride (Knesset Yisrael) and the Bridegroom (the Holy One, blessed be He) beneath the wedding canopy.'

[287] **Zohar, Emor 100b**: 'In the Zohar (Emor III 100b), the name of the seventh month, Tishrei , is expounded from the Aramaic root shrei ('release and pardon'): 'Release, pardon, and atone for the debts of Your people'—teaching that the very name of each Hebrew month expresses its inner spiritual root.'

[288] **Et HaOchel 8:1**: "Likewise, whenever a person awakens even once, he can raise all the permitted deeds and optional activities he did previously—and certainly commandments performed without intention and vitality—by performing that

Scripture: "For Hashem shall be your confidence (be-chislecha), and shall keep your foot from being taken", וּפֵרֵשׁ רַבִּי שְׁלֹמֹה יִצְחָקִי מִירוּשַׁלְמִי: "בִּדְבָרִים שֶׁאַתָּה כְּסִיל בָּהֶם"; **— which Rashi explained from the Yerushalmi: "in matters in which you are foolish (kesil)";** וְהַיְנוּ אַף בְּשֶׁיָּנָה, אַף כְּשֶׁהָאָדָם הוֹלֵךְ בָּטֵל, **— meaning even in sleep, even when a person sits idle,** דְּיוֹשֵׁב בָּטֵל כְּיָשֵׁן דָּמֵי, **— for one who sits idle is considered as one sleeping,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב (עֲבוֹדָה זָרָה י״ט עַמּוּד ב׳)[289]: "'אֵלֵךְ וְאֶתְנַעֲרָה בְּשֵׁינָה', תַּלְמוּד לוֹמַר: 'וּבְתוֹרָתוֹ יֶהְגֶּה וְגוֹמֵר'", **— as written (Avodah Zarah 19b): "'I will go and indulge in sleep', Scripture teaches: 'and in His Torah he meditates, etc.'",** וְהַיְנוּ דְּשֵׁינָה הוּא כְּשֶׁהוֹלֵךְ בָּטֵל. וְכָאן כִּסְלֵו בָּוָא"ו **— showing that sleep is equated with remaining idle. –** קוּדְשָׁא בְּרִיךְ הוּא, **— And here Kislev ends with a Vav — representing the Holy One, Blessed be He,**

An inherited holiness can reach the organs of action

שֶׁהוּא סָמֶךְ, הָאוֹר מַקִּיף: "סוֹמֵךְ הַשֵּׁם לְכָל הַנֹּפְלִים". וְכֵן סָמ״ךְ[290] **— Who is the Samech, the encompassing light: "Hashem supports all who fall". –** אִלּוּ יִשְׂרָאֵל שֶׁמְּקֻפִּים מֵהַסִּיָּעְתּוֹת מֵהַשִּׁבְעָה רוֹעִים **— And so Samech represents Israel who are surrounded by divine support from the Seven Shepherds** שֶׁהֵם מֶרְכָּבָה לְשֶׁבַע הַמִּדּוֹת עִם ה״א עִלָּאָה, בִּינָה, **— who are the chariot for the seven attributes alongside the Upper Heh, Binah,** וְהוּא דָּוִד הַמֶּלֶךְ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם שֶׁהֵקִים עֻלָּהּ שֶׁל תְּשׁוּבָה, וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמַרְנוּ; **— and he is King David who established the yoke of repentance, as we explained;** וְזֶה קְדֻשַּׁת הַחֹדֶשׁ. **— and this is the sanctity of the month.**

Received light can disclose a depth beyond direct brilliance

וְאַחַר כָּךְ בְּסוֹף הַחֹדֶשׁ זוֹכִין לָאוֹר, נֶהוֹרָא עִלָּאָה, הָאוֹר "כִּי טוֹב", וּבוֹ נַס חֲנֻכָּה;[291] **— And afterward at the end of the month we merit the light, the Supernal Light, the light that was "good", within which is the miracle of Chanukah;**

The fiftieth gate reveals the unity of the many qualities

וְאָז יִשְׂרָאֵל הַמַּקִּיף, שֶׁנַּעֲשִׂים כְּנֶגֶד יִשְׂרָאֵל הַסָּמ״ךְ, בִּינָה,[292] **— and then Israel becomes the encompassing perimeter,**

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activity another time with vitality and intention for the sake of Heaven. This applies especially to eating, which resembles the offerings, where the rule of one item drawing another after it applies, as stated in Shabbat: one act of eating draws another after it to become like it."

Pri Tzadik includes idle, inattentive life within the image of sleep that can receive divine support. Et HaOchel describes one way an awakening can repair that condition: performing a permitted activity with fresh intention can raise the earlier instances of it. Its express restriction to permitted and optional acts is retained, as is the need for an actual new act with vitality and intention.

[289] **Avodah Zarah 19b**: "'Turn from evil and do good.' A person might say: I have guarded my tongue from evil and my lips from speaking deceit; I will go and indulge in sleep. Therefore Scripture says: 'Turn from evil and do good.' 'Good' means Torah, as it says: 'For I have given you a good teaching; do not forsake My Torah.'"

[290] **Tiferet Yosef, Shabbat Chol HaMoed Sukkot 1**: "A person must train himself in service throughout all his organs of action, so that all his limbs feel holiness. Even the foot, which is far from the thought in the head, should receive holiness from that thought: upon reaching the boundary, the foot itself should sense that God's will was to walk this far and no farther. This is "If you turn back your foot because of Shabbat." It resembles the Jerusalem Talmud's statement, "Let us give thanks to the head, for when it reaches Modim it bows of itself." In truth, a person's whole power to bring holiness into all his actions flows from the holiness permanently rooted within him from the patriarchs' holiness. From that holy power he can bring holiness into the organs of action as well."

Pri Tzadik names the surrounding help of the shepherds as part of Kislev's holiness. Tiferet Yosef explains how holiness rooted in the fathers can support a person's practical faculties: deliberate habituation brings it even into a limb far from conscious thought. It develops the movement from inherited support to embodied service.

[291] **Takanat HaShavin 15:89**: "In every matter there are forty-nine aspects of purity and impurity, corresponding to the seven days of this world's structure, each comprising seven. The fiftieth gate, hidden in this world, is where everything returns to its source to become wholly pure. Moses our teacher, whose face was like the sun in apprehending the very illuminating light, could not apprehend this gate's light in this world. Yet our sages say of Rabbi Akiva that something was revealed to him that was not revealed to Moses; Megalleh Amukkot explains this as the fiftieth gate hidden from Moses. This does not mean that his degree was greater than Moses', which is impossible, for "No prophet arose again in Israel like Moses." Rather, his apprehension was through the moon's light, receiving from the sun: he is the root of Oral Torah, which receives from Written Torah. This is the wisdom of Israel's sages, of which it is said that a sage surpasses a prophet: he can apprehend more because his apprehension is in a light that is not so intensely bright and flashing."

Pri Tzadik joins the fiftieth gate, the superiority attained through repentance, and the gift of Oral Torah. Takanat HaShavin explains why the receiving mode of Oral Torah can disclose a depth unavailable through direct solar brilliance. It expressly preserves Moses' unique greatness even when describing Rabbi Akiva's additional attainment, helping clarify the relation between higher and lower wisdom here.

[292] **Sod Yesharim, The First Night of Pesach 54:1**: "Therefore, after the exodus from Egypt, when Israel began to clarify all forty-nine qualities through their choice, the qualities considered as separate particulars were still without completeness. They were commanded to count forty-nine days until reaching the fiftieth day. The fiftieth gate then shines, making recognizable the root's unity within all the qualities. That recognition is called Torah, as the Zohar

Knesset Yisrael becoming the Samech, Binah, שֶׁמַּקִּיפִים לְהָאוֹר חָכְמָה, **— encircling the inner light of Chochmah,** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בְּרָכוֹת ל״ד עַמּוּד ב׳) "וְהוּא מְקוֹם שֶׁבַּעֲלֵי תְּשׁוּבָה עוֹמְדִין שֶׁאֵין צַדִּיקִים גְּמוּרִים עוֹמְדִים שָׁם"[293] **— which is "the place where penitents stand where the completely righteous cannot stand" (Berachot 34b),** וְהִיא שַׁעַר הַחֲמִשִּׁים מֵחֲמִשִּׁים שַׁעֲרֵי בִינָה; וְהַיְנוּ שֶׁזּוֹכִין לְסוֹד הַדַּעַת, וְזוֹכִין לְמַה שֶּׁנֶּאֱמַר: "וְאֶת יַעֲקֹב אָהַב" **— and it is the Fiftieth Gate of the Fifty Gates of Understanding; –** אַהֲבָה בְּלֹא טַעַם. **— meaning that they merit the mystery of Da'at, meriting that which is said: "And I loved Jacob" — an unconditional love transcending reason.** וּלְיַעֲקֹב נִתְגַּלָּה בַּחֲלוֹם: "וְהִנֵּה יהו"ה נִצָּב עָלָיו", **— And to Jacob it was revealed in a dream: "And behold, Hashem stood above him",** (חֶלֶק ב׳ י״ד כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ דְּיַעֲקֹב אָבִינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם סוֹד הַדַּעַת, סוֹף עַמּוּד ב׳)[294] **— for Jacob our Father is the mystery of Da'at, as written in the Holy Zohar (Part II, 14b bottom);** וּשְׁלֹמֹה שֶׁקְּרָאוֹ הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא יְדִידְיָה, זָכָה לְכָל חָכְמָה תַּתָּאָה בַּחֲלוֹם. **— and Solomon whom the Holy One called Jedidiah merited all Lower Wisdom in a dream.** וְזֶה קְדֻשַּׁת הַחֹדֶשׁ: שֶׁיִּשְׁתַּדֵּל הָאָדָם לִזְכּוֹת לְתוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה שֶׁהוּא מִטַּל תְּעַתִּיקָא; **— And this is the sanctity of the month: that a person labor to merit the Oral Torah which derives from the dew of Atika;** וְאָז זוֹכִין מִצַּד הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ אַף בְּשֵׁינָה: "סוֹמֵךְ הַשֵּׁם לְכָל הַנֹּפְלִים", כִּי הַשֵּׁם יִהְיֶה בְּכִסְלֶךָ. **— and then one merits from the Blessed Name even in sleep: "Hashem supports all who fall", — for Hashem will be your confidence.**

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explains: what is Torah? That which teaches and reveals what was previously concealed and unknown."
Pri Tzadik names the fiftieth gate as the encompassing understanding attained at the month's light and still calls for effort toward Oral Torah. Sod Yesharim explains what the encompassing gate discloses: the separately refined qualities are recognized as one at their root. Its omer sequence supplies a concrete relation between prior work and the subsequent gift of unifying recognition.

[293] **Berakhot 34b:27**: "Having mentioned Rabbi Ḥanina ben Dosa in our mishna, the Gemara proceeds to further praise the efficacy of his prayer: The Sages taught: There was an incident where Rabban Gamliel's son fell ill. Rabban Gamliel dispatched two scholars to Rabbi Ḥanina ben Dosa to pray for mercy and healing on his behalf. When Rabbi Ḥanina ben Dosa saw them approaching, he went up to the attic on the roof of his house and prayed for mercy on his behalf. Upon his descent, he said to the messengers: You may go and return to Rabban Gamliel, as the fever has already left his son and he has been healed. The messengers asked him: How do you know? Are you a prophet? He replied to them: I am neither a prophet nor son of a prophet (see Amos 7:14), but I have received a tradition with regard to this indication: If my prayer is fluent in my mouth as I recite it and there are no errors, I know that my prayer is accepted. And if not, I know that my prayer is rejected. The Gemara relates that these messengers sat and wrote and approximated that precise moment when Rabbi Ḥanina ben Dosa told them this. When they came before Rabban Gamliel and related all that had happened and showed him what they had written, Rabban Gamliel said to them: I swear by the Temple service that in the time you wrote you were neither earlier or later; rather, this is how the event transpired: Precisely at that moment his fever broke and he asked us for water to drink."

[294] **Zohar, Shemot 26:249**: "There is a further esoteric meaning in this verse. We are told: "With ten Sayings the world was created" (Pirke Ab. 5, 1). Yet, on examination they prove to be only three, viz. Wisdom, Understanding, and Knowledge. The world was created only for the sake of Israel. When the Holy One, blessed be He, desired to endow the earth with permanence, He formed Abraham in the mystery of Wisdom, Isaac in the mystery of Understanding, and Jacob in the mystery of Perception, that is to say, of Knowledge. Therefore it is said: "With wisdom is the house built, and by understanding it is established, and by knowledge shall the chambers be filled…" (Prov. 24, 4-5). At that hour the whole world came into perfection; and when the twelve Tribes were born to Jacob, all things came to completion according to the supernal pattern ordained from the beginning."

Rosh Chodesh Kislev Ois 6

Kislev and the Refinement of Anger and the Evil Inclination

The distinction is between anger itself and a narrowly directed response governed by Torah.

Kislev and the Refinement of Anger and the Evil Inclination

בְּסֵפֶר יְצִירָה: "הִמְלִיךְ אוֹת סָמֶ"ךְ בְּשֵׁינָה"; — **In Sefer Yetzirah: "He made the letter Samech king over sleep";**
וּלְגִרְסַת הַגְּאוֹנִים (בְּרֵישׁ פֶּרֶק ה') דְּחָשַׁב בִּשְׁנֵים עָשָׂר כֹּחוֹת תְּשִׁיעִי רוֹגֶז,[295] — **while according to the reading of the Geonim (beginning of Chapter 5), which enumerates anger (rogez) as the ninth of the twelve faculties,**
הַגִּרְסָא: "אוֹת סָמֶ"ךְ בְּרֹגֶז". — **the reading is: "the letter Samech in rogez."**

Anger's corrective role depends on what it confronts

וְיֵשׁ לְהָבִין: הָא כַּעַס מִדָּה מְגֻנָּה, — **And one must understand: behold anger is a reprehensible trait,**[296]
וּכְתִיב: "כִּי שֹׁנְאֲמַר: "כִּי כַעַס בְּחֵיק כְּסִילִים יָנוּחַ", — **as Scripture states: "For anger rests in the bosom of fools",**
וְהֵיאַךְ שַׁיָּךְ שֶׁנִּבְרָא חֹדֶשׁ בְּרֹב חָכְמָה רָב כָּעַס", — **and it is written: "For in much wisdom is much grief (ka'as)",**
כִּסְלֵו בְּרֹגֶז שֶׁהוּא כַּעַס? — **so how is it plausible that the month of Kislev was created in rogez which is anger?**
וְכֵן קָשֶׁה בְּמַה שֶּׁפָּתוּב (בְּרָכוֹת ס"א עַמּוּד ב'): "כָּבֵד כּוֹעֵס",[297] — **And likewise it is difficult regarding what is written (Berachot 61b): "The liver is angry",**
וְהוּא אֵבֶר שֶׁבָּרָא הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ, וְאֵיךְ נִבְרָא אֵבֶר מְיֻחָד לְכַעַס? — **which is an anatomical organ created by the Blessed Name, so how was an organ created specifically for anger?**

The fire of Torah remains governed by mercy

וְהָעִנְיָן, דְּבֶאֱמֶת שֹׁרֶשׁ הַיֵּצֶר הָרָע הוּא אֵשׁ כַּעַס,[298] — **And the explanation is: in truth the root of the Evil Inclination is the fire of destructive rage,**
וּכְמַה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: "וַיֶּחֱמָתוֹ בָּעֲרָה בּוֹ", — **as Scripture states: "and his wrath burned within him",**
וְרוֹצֶה לְשָׁרֵף וּלְכַלּוֹת הַכֹּל; — **seeking to consume and destroy everything;**

A harmful force can yield firmness for service

אֲבָל לְעֻמַּת זֶה יֵשׁ בִּקְדֻשָּׁה תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה,[299] — **yet in holy opposition there exists in holiness the Oral Torah,**
שֶׁהוּא הַרְבֵּה חָכְמָה לְתַקֵּן הַרְבֵּה כַּעַס, — **which is abundant wisdom to rectify abundant grief,**
וְהוּא גַּם כֵּן אֵשׁ, — **and it is likewise fire,**
וּכְמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב (תַּעֲנִית ד' עַמּוּד א'): "הַאי צוּרְבָא מֵרַבָּנַן דְּרָתַח[300] — **and as written (Ta'anit 4a): –**

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[295] **Sefer Yetzirah 5:9**: 'In the Geonic and Gra readings of Sefer Yetzirah (Chapter 5), the twelve simple letters are paired with the twelve months, constellations, faculties, and organs: the letter Samekh is enthroned over sleep (or anger in variant readings) and forms the month of Kislev in the year and the stomach (keivah) in the body.'

[296] **Sichat Shedim 1:9**: "There is no good in it at all except for Torah scholars—that is, in judging those liable to the court's death penalties in the Sanhedrin. This is the beneficial anger of the sages. Even this is only because foolishness exists in the world; without it there would be no place for anger. From the side of wisdom, anger has no good or fitting aspect at all, and it is therefore always called foolish."

Pri Tzadik asks why a power identified with the condemned quality of anger was created at all. Sichat Shedim distinguishes anger in itself from its limited corrective use in the presence of wrongdoing, using the Torah court as its example. This helps define the problem answered by the next Kislev paragraph's holy fire: force is directed at what requires correction, rather than treated as an independent virtue.

[297] **Berakhot 61b:1**: "The lung draws in all kinds of liquids; the liver becomes angry; the gallbladder casts a drop into it and calms it; the spleen laughs; the gizzard grinds; the stomach sleeps; and the nose remains awake. If the sleeping organ wakes and the waking organ sleeps, the person wastes away. It was taught: If both sleep or both remain awake, he dies immediately."

[298] **Tzidkat HaTzadik 199:1**: "The anger of the sages is good on every side," as the Zohar says. This is the Gemara's statement that Torah is what heats him: the anger is only what Torah causes, when according to Torah it is fitting to become angry. The example is the Sanhedrin judging capital cases, concerning which it says that an elderly person is not appointed to the Sanhedrin. They were truly full of mercy and strove to find grounds for acquittal according to Torah; their heat came only from Torah's necessity. This is called the anger of sages who truly love Torah: even during anger it is only on Torah's account, and they remember and strive for mercy. Restraint at the time of anger is love "with all your soul."

Pri Tzadik distinguishes Torah's holy fire from the destructive fire of the inclination. Tzidkat HaTzadik gives a stringent test for the phrase "the anger of the sages": it comes only from what Torah requires, while the person continues to remember mercy and seek a favorable judgment. This supplies a concrete criterion for the holy fire described here.

[299] **Tiferet Yosef, Nitzavim 5**: "The way of a serpent upon a rock": a serpent signifies that even when it displays a good appearance, its root is stubbornness and crookedness. Yet "the way of a serpent upon a rock" means that a person can receive firmness for service from this as well. We find that the anger of the sages is good on every side. Although the Zohar says that anyone who becomes angry is as though he worshipped idolatry, we nevertheless find in the Talmud: "When a Torah scholar grows heated, Torah is what heats him." That is, one can receive firmness for service from this too."

Pri Tzadik's consuming fire is a holy use of intensity against the inclination's destructive fire. Tiferet Yosef explains the same talmudic contrast through "the way of a serpent upon a rock": even a force rooted in stubborn crookedness can supply firmness for divine service. The target retains the condemnation of ordinary anger beside the limited Torah-directed possibility.

[300] **Taanit 4a**: '§ And, incidentally, the Gemara relates that which Rava said: This Torah scholar who grows angry, it can be presumed that it is his Torah study that angers him. Therefore, he must be given the benefit of the doubt, as it is stated:

אוֹרַיְתָא הוּא דְּקָא מַרְתְּחָא לֵיהּ, שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: 'הֲלוֹא כֹה דְבָרִי כָּאֵשׁ'"; — **"This young scholar who boils — it is the Torah boiling within him, as said: 'Is not My word like fire'";** וְהוּא אֵשׁ אוֹכְלָה אֵשׁ הַיֵּצֶר הָרָע, שֶׁשּׁוֹרֵף וּמְכַלֶּה אֶת הַיֵּצֶר הָרָע; — **and it is a fire consuming the fire of the Evil Inclination, burning and eliminating the evil impulse;** וְזֶה שֶׁאָמְרוּ בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ (חֶלֶק ב׳ קפ״ב עמוד ב׳)[301]: "רוּגְזָא דְרַבָּנַן טָב אִיהוּ לְכָל סִטְרִין וְכוּלַּיהּ". — **and this is what they said in the Holy Zohar (Part II, 182b): "The rage of the Rabbis is beneficial in every direction, etc."** וְהִנֵּה יֵשׁ שְׁתֵּי אוֹתִיּוֹת שֶׁהֵם בְּהֶקֵּף: מ״ם סְתוּמָה וְסָמֶ״ךְ: — **And there are two letters that form a closed perimeter: the closed mem and samekh:** מ **and** ס**; the open mem** [ם] [ס]: מ״ם פְּתוּחָה[302] — מִדַּת מַלְכוּת, כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב (זֹהַר חֶלֶק ג׳ רל״ו עמוד ב׳)[303] — **represents Malchut, as written (Zohar Part III, 236b),** [מ][304] — **the letter mem (**מ**).** אַךְ הִיא פְּתוּחָה שֶׁיָּכוֹל לָצֵאת וּלְהִתְקַלְקֵל; — **yet it is open at the bottom so that one can fall outward and become corrupted;** וּמ״ם סְתוּמָה מוֹרָה: "בַּת מְתֻעֲטָרָא בַּאֲבָהָן", וְהוּא יְמִינָא וּשְׂמָאלָא, דָּרוֹם וְצָפוֹן אַבְרָהָם וְיִצְחָק, וּמִזְרָח — **The closed mem indicates "the Daughter crowned by the Fathers": right and left, south and north—Avraham and Yitzchak—and east—** יַעֲקֹב: — **Yaakov,** וְהֵינוּ שָׁלֹשׁ רֵאשׁוֹנוֹת — **which are the three supernal roots:** דְּחֶסֶד עִלָּאָה נָפְקָא מֵחָכְמָה, וּגְבוּרָה נָפְקָא מִבִּינָה (זֹהַר חֶלֶק ב׳ קע״ה עמוד ב׳); וְרוּחַ מִזְרָחִי[305] — **for supernal Chesed issues from Chokhmah, and Gevurah issues from Binah (Zohar Part II, 175b); and the eastern wind—** יַעֲקֹב, אוֹת וָא"ו, "דָּא אִקְרֵי אוֹת אֱמֶת" (זֹהַר חֶלֶק ג׳ ב׳ עמוד א׳),[306] — **Yaakov, the letter vav, "which is called the letter of truth" (Zohar Part III, 2a),** וְהוּא "הַבְּרִיחַ הַתִּיכוֹן וְגוֹמֵר", שֶׁמּוֹפִיעַ מִיו״ד וְקוֹצוֹ שֶׁל יו״ד לְמִדַּת מַלְכוּת, "ה"א — **is "the middle bar," etc., which shines from the yud and the tip of the yud to Malchut: "The heh** דָּלֶ"ת הָוֹת וְכוּלַּיהּ"; — **was a dalet," etc.** וְכֵן כָּתַב בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ (חֶלֶק ב׳ י״ד עמוד ב׳): לְיַעֲקֹב בְּרָזָא דָּלֶ"ת הָוֹת וְכוּלַּיהּ"; — **and so written in the Zohar (Part II, 14b): regarding Jacob in the mystery of Da'at; –**

"Is not my word like fire, says the Lord" (Jeremiah 23:29). And similarly, Rav Ashi said: Any Torah scholar who is not as hard as iron, but is indecisive and wavers, he is not a Torah scholar, as it is stated in the same verse: "And as a hammer that breaks rock in pieces" (Jeremiah 23:29).'

[301] **Zohar, Tetzaveh 6:58**: "But if a person becomes angry over purely secular matters, this is no service of God, and no sin that man commits is so literally idolatry as this, since it actually sets up an idol in the very heart of him who is angered: unto such a man one is forbidden to speak or draw nigh. Should one say, But, after all, this anger is only a momentary impulse from which he may soon repent-why, then, such severity as this? the answer would be, that in reality it is not thus, because he has uprooted the holiness of his soul from its place and the "other god" has entrenched himself therein, and will never leave him until by a great effort the person so afflicted completely purifies himself and roots out from his inner self that evil, and thereafter endeavours to sanctify himself afresh, and to draw down holiness from above upon himself; then only can there be a possibility of renewal and sanctification for him.' Said R. Jose to him: 'Why only a possibility of renewal and sanctification?'"

[302] **Shabbat 104a**: 'The Sages said to Rabbi Yehoshua ben Levi: Young students came today to the study hall and said things the likes of which were not said even in the days of Joshua bin Nun. These children who only knew the Hebrew alphabet interpreted the letters homiletically.Alef beit means learn elaf the wisdom bina of the Torah.Gimmel dalet means give to the poor gemol dalim. Why is the leg of the gimmel extended toward the dalet? Because it is the manner of one who bestows loving-kindness to pursue the poor. And why is the leg of the dalet extended toward the gimmel? It is so that a poor person will make himself available to him who wants to give him charity. And why does the dalet face away from the gimmel? It is to teach that one should give charity discreetly so that the poor person will not be embarrassed by him.'

[303] **Zohar, Pinchas 72:452-75:462**: 'In the Zohar (Pinchas, Ra'aya Meheimna III 236b), the shapes of the letters Mem and Samekh are contrasted: the open Mem corresponds to Malkhut in the world of free choice, having an opening below through which one can either ascend or fall, whereas the closed Mem and the circular Samekh signify encompassing Divine support that allows no falling.'

[304] **Zohar, Pinchas 72:452-75:462**: 'In the Zohar (Pinchas, Ra'aya Meheimna III 236b), the shapes of the letters Mem and Samekh are contrasted: the open Mem corresponds to Malkhut in the world of free choice, having an opening below through which one can either ascend or fall, whereas the closed Mem and the circular Samekh signify encompassing Divine support that allows no falling.'

[305] **Zohar, Terumah 95:913**: "and were crowned with the twenty-two crowns of Compassion which are contained in the Ancient of Days, who bestows light upon them, to each according to its place. Fifty engraved letters also were crowned with forty-two supernal letters of the Holy Name, by which heaven and earth were created. And eight gates were opened, which are the eight significations of Mercy, as it is written: "The Lord, the Lord God, merciful and gracious", etc. (Ex. 34, 6-7), which emanate from the Holy Ancient and proceed to the Microprosopus, and they unite with those holy crowns, Supernal Wisdom and Understanding, taking Supernal Grace from the one side and Judgement or Power from the other. Then came the merit of Jacob and synthetized both and made them one, for he signifies supernal harmony.'"

[306] **Zohar, Vayikra 1:1-7**: 'R. Eleazar began here with the verse, "Ask thee a sign, which in Talmudic Hebrew commonly means "letter". of the Lord thy God, ask it either in the depth or in the height above" (Isa. 7, 11). He said: 'We have compared the former with the latter generations, and found that the former were conversant with a higher wisdom by which they knew how to combine the letters that were given to Moses on Mount Sinai, and even the sinners of Israel knew a deep wisdom contained in the letters and the difference between higher and lower letters, and how to do things with them in this world.'

[307] **Zohar, Shemot 26:249**: "There is a further esoteric meaning in this verse. We are told: "With ten Sayings the world was created" (Pirke Ab. 5, 1). Yet, on examination they prove to be only three, viz. Wisdom, Understanding, and Knowledge. The world was created only for the sake of Israel. When the Holy One, blessed be He, desired to endow the

דָּוִד הַמֶּלֶךְ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם שֶׁהוּא מֶרְכָּבָה לְמַדַּת מַלְכוּת, — **and the west is David the King, peace be upon him, who is the chariot for Malchut,** וְהֵם אַרְבַּע אוֹתִיּוֹת הֲוָי"ה כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ (חֵלֶק ג' רנ"ח עַמּוּד א').[308] — **and these form the four letters of Havayah, as written in the Zohar (Part III, 258a).**

רַק אוֹת מ"ם יֵשׁ עוֹד בָּהּ מ"ם פְּתוּחָה שֶׁיְּכוֹל לְהִתְקַלְקֵל, — **However, the letter Mem still possesses an open counterpart through which corruption can occur,** וּכְמוֹ אַחַר מַתַּן תּוֹרָה שֶׁאַף שֶׁנֶּעֱקַר יֵצֶר הָרָע, חָזַר אַחַר כָּךְ לִמְקוֹמוֹ. — **just as after the Giving of the Torah where even though the Evil Inclination was uprooted, it returned afterward to its place.**

The circle signifies completion of attachment

וְאוֹת סָמֶ"ךְ מוֹרֶה כְּמוֹ לֶעָתִיד שֶׁיִּשְׁחֹט הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא לְיֵצֶר הָרָע,[309] — **Whereas the letter Samech points forward to the Future when the Holy One will slaughter the Evil Inclination,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב (סֻכָּה נ"ב עַמּוּד א'),[310] — **as written (Sukkah 52a),** וְאָז יַעֲשֶׂה הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא מָחוֹל לַצַּדִּיקִים כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב (סוֹף תַּעֲנִית ל"א עַמּוּד א');[311] — **and then the Holy One will form a circle dance for the righteous (end of Ta'anit 31a);** וְהֵינוּ בְּלֹא חִלּוּק מַדְרֵגוֹת כְּמוֹ כָּל דָּבָר עָגֹל שֶׁאֵין לוֹ רֹאשׁ וְסוֹף; — **meaning without hierarchical boundaries, like every circular entity that has neither beginning nor end;**

This world is the place of new refinement

וְאַף שֶׁאָז יִהְיֶה גַּם כֵּן מַדְרֵגוֹת, כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב (סוֹף בְּרָכוֹת ס"ד עַמּוּד א'):[312, 313] — **and even though then there will also be**

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earth with permanence, He formed Abraham in the mystery of Wisdom, Isaac in the mystery of Understanding, and Jacob in the mystery of Perception, that is to say, of Knowledge. Therefore it is said: "With wisdom is the house built, and by understanding it is established, and by knowledge shall the chambers be filled…" (Prov. 24, 4-5). At that hour the whole world came into perfection; and when the twelve Tribes were born to Jacob, all things came to completion according to the supernal pattern ordained from the beginning."

[308] **Zohar, Pinchas 124:867-127:879**: 'In the Zohar (Pinchas, Ra'aya Meheimna III 258a), the four letters of the Name Havayah are explained as embracing all the Sefirot: the upper tip of the Yud is Keter; Yud is Chokhmah; Hei is Binah; Vav encompasses the six attributes of Ze'ir Anpin (the Holy One, blessed be He); and the final Hei is Malkhut (His Shekhinah).'

[309] **Resisei Layla 10:2**: "In the future the Holy One will make a circle for the righteous. That is, a circle: the degree of the circles will be revealed, where there are no degrees because all is equally complete. Jacob's form, by contrast, is the upright form of the human being, which has degrees—head, end, and extremities. It is impossible to be entirely free of the deficiency in attachment discussed here, that is, to reach complete perfection, because this power is not yet complete until the coming of the Messiah, who will be completely perfected. As the leader, so the generation: the whole generation will then be completely perfected, freed of the deficiency in prayer, with complete attachment."

Pri Tzadik explains the future circle and immediately qualifies it: ascent in degrees remains, but it grows from work already done in this world. Resisei Layla develops the circle as complete attachment, contrasting it with the differentiated head, ends, and limbs of an upright form. This clarifies the kind of common completeness symbolized by the circle; Pri Tzadik's further qualification about earned degrees remains explicit in the quoted origin.

[310] **Sukkah 52a:4**: "As Rabbi Yehudah expounded: In the future the Holy One, blessed be He, will bring the evil inclination and slaughter it before the righteous and the wicked. To the righteous it will appear like a high mountain, and to the wicked like a hair's breadth. These will weep, and those will weep. The righteous will weep and say, 'How were we able to conquer such a high mountain?' The wicked will weep and say, 'How were we unable to conquer this hair's breadth?' Even the Holy One, blessed be He, will marvel with them, as it says, 'Thus says the Lord of Hosts: If it is wondrous in the eyes of the remnant of this people in those days, it will also be wondrous in My eyes.'"

[311] **Taanit 31a:9**: "The tractate concludes with a statement related to the topic of dancing. Ulla of the city of Bira'a said that Rabbi Elazar said: In the future, in the end of days, the Holy One, Blessed be He, will arrange a dance of the righteous, and He will be sitting among them in the Garden of Eden, and each and every one of the righteous will point to God with his finger, as it is stated: "And it shall be said on that day: Behold, this is our God, for whom we waited, that He might save us. This is the Lord; for whom we waited. We will be glad and rejoice in His salvation" (Isaiah 25:9). God will be revealed, so that every righteous individual will be able to say: This is our God, as though they were pointing at Him with a finger."

[312] **Berakhot 64a**: 'With regard to that same verse, Rabbi Ḥiyya bar Ashi said that Rav said: Torah scholars have rest neither in this world nor in the World-to-Come, as in both worlds they are constantly progressing, as it is stated: "They go from strength to strength, every one of them appears before God in Zion." Rabbi Elazar said that Rabbi Ḥanina said: Torah scholars increase peace in the world, as it is said: "And all your children banayikh shall be taught of the Lord, and great shall be the peace of your children" (Isaiah 54:13). If all the children of Israel are taught of the Lord, there will be peace for all.'

[313] **Sod Yesharim, Sukkot 56:1**: "In the refinement of resurrection there will be the conclusion and end: "These will stand for everlasting life, and these for shame and everlasting abhorrence." Evil will then be entirely separated from good; there will no longer be the tree of uncertainty, for the whole purpose of the refinements will be complete. What falls outside then will have no further restoration. The refinement of this world, called the day of rain, is therefore greater: during the time of the tree of uncertainty one can acquire something new each time, which is not so at resurrection."

Pri Tzadik distinguishes continued future ascent from acquiring degrees through new work. Sod Yesharim makes a

"תַּלְמִידֵי חֲכָמִים אֵין לָהֶם מְנוּחָה לֹא בָּעוֹלָם הַזֶּה וְלֹא בָּעוֹלָם הַבָּא, שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: 'יֵלְכוּ מֵחַיִל אֶל חָיִל וְגוֹמֵר'", — **"Torah scholars have no rest neither in this world nor in the World to Come, as it is said: 'They go from strength to strength, etc.'",** וְיַעֲלוּ בְּכָל פַּעַם מִמַּדְרֵגָה לְמַדְרֵגָה; — **ascending continually from level to level;** מִכָּל מָקוֹם כֵּיוָן שֶׁלֹּא יִהְיֶה יֵצֶר הָרָע, שׁוּב לֹא יִהְיוּ הַמַּדְרֵגוֹת מַעֲבוֹדָה חֲדָשָׁה, — **nevertheless since there will be no Evil Inclination, those levels will not emerge from new labor against temptation,** רַק הַמַּדְרֵגוֹת יִהְיוּ מֵהֶעָבוֹדָה שֶׁבָּעוֹלָם הַזֶּה. — **but will flow as reward from their labor performed in this world.**

וְזֶה עֶסֶק חֹדֶשׁ זֶה שֶׁנִּבְרָא בְּאוֹת סָמֶ"ךְ, שֶׁמּוֹרֶה עַל תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה — **And this is the spiritual task of this month created through the letter Samech, –** אֵשׁ אוֹכְלָה אֵשׁ שֶׁל יֵצֶר הָרָע, — **which denotes the Oral Torah — a fire consuming the fire of the Evil Inclination,** הַרְבֵּה חָכְמָה לְתַקֵּן הַרְבֵּה כַּעַס; — **abundant wisdom rectifying abundant grief;** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁיִּהְיֶה לָעָתִיד שֶׁיִּשְׁחֹט וְזֶה שֶׁאָמַר: סָמֶ"ךְ בְּרֹגֶז, — **and this is what it said: Samech in rogez,** הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא לְיֵצֶר הָרָע. — **just as will occur in the Future when the Holy One slaughters the Evil Inclination.** וּבְחֹדֶשׁ זֶה הָיָה נֵס חֲנֻכָּה; — **And in this month occurred the miracle of Chanukah;** שֶׁכְּבָר אָמַרְנוּ שֶׁבְּמִצְרַיִם, שֶׁהָיָה הֲכָנָה לְמַתַּן תּוֹרָה, וְהָיָה אָז חָכְמַת מִצְרַיִם כִּשּׁוּף בְּלֹא שֵׂכֶל אֱנוֹשִׁי, רַק חָכְמָה עֶלְיוֹנָה מֵהַקְּלִפָּה, — **for we already explained that in Egypt, which was the preparation for the Giving of the Torah, –** **there existed the wisdom of Egypt — sorcery devoid of human intellect, an occult supernal wisdom from the kelipah,** וְהוּא "זֶה לְעֻמַּת זֶה" נֶגֶד חָכְמַת תּוֹרָה שֶׁבִּכְתָב שֶׁהוּא מִן הַשָּׁמַיִם; — **which stood in parallel opposition to the wisdom of the Written Torah descending from Heaven;** וְחָכְמַת יְוָנִית, דְּשָׁם הִתְחִילָה הַפִּילוֹסוֹפְיָא שֶׁהוּא חָכְמָה שִׂכְלִיִּית, דַּעוֹת כּוֹזְבוֹת וּמִינוּת, — **while Greek philosophy, where began academic philosophy, was human intellectualism full of deceitful doctrines and heresy,** וְהָיָה אָז בִּזְמַן אַלֶכְסַנְדְּרוֹס מוֹקְדוֹן, — **flourishing during the era of Alexander of Macedon,**

Wisdom renewed in the heart remains joined to its source

The receiving wisdom makes the root accessible through work

וְהוּא "זֶה לְעֻמַּת זֶה"[314,315] נֶגֶד חָכְמַת תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה בְּקִדֻּשָּׁה — **and it stood in parallel opposition to the wisdom of the Oral Torah in holiness,** שֶׁהוּא גַּם כֵּן מִתְחַדֵּשׁ בְּלֵב חֲכָמִים, — **which is likewise innovated within the heart of the Sages,** אֲשֶׁר מוֹפִיעַ בְּלִבָּם דִּבְרֵי אֱלֹהִים חַיִּים מִטַּלָּא דְּעַתִּיקָא; — **into whose hearts shine the words of the Living God from the dew of Atika;** וְאָז בִּזְמַן אַלֶכְסַנְדְּרוֹס מוֹקְדוֹן הָיָה שִׁמְעוֹן הַצַּדִּיק כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב (יוֹמָא ס"ט עַמּוּד א'),[316] — **and then in Alexander's era lived Shimon the Righteous (Yoma 69a),** שֶׁהָיָה מִשְּׁיָרֵי כְּנֶסֶת הַגְּדוֹלָה, וְאָז הִתְחִיל

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closely related distinction between the present "day of rain," when further good can still be extracted and acquired, and resurrection as the completion of refinement. The comparison explains why the disappearance of the present uncertainty changes the kind of growth that is possible.

[314] **Resisei Layla 52:6**: "King Solomon represents kingship, the feminine, receiving side and the mouth, called Oral Torah in the teaching Patach Eliyahu: it is the wisdom renewed in the hearts of the community of Israel. Solomon therefore compared his wisdom to a woman. Among Israel this too is called Torah, since they recognize that everything is from God and that their wisdom too is God's wisdom. Other nations also possess wisdom, and over their sages one blesses "Who has given of His wisdom." Earlier authorities explain that with them it is a giving, whereas over Israel's sages one says "Who has shared": "The Lord's portion is His people," like a part joined to the whole. Our sages say that if one is told there is wisdom among the nations, believe it, as it is said, "I will destroy wise men from Edom"; but if one is told there is Torah, do not believe it. Their wisdom is not called Torah, because it is separate from God."

Pri Tzadik distinguishes Greek intellectual wisdom from Oral Torah, even though both involve thought arising in a human mind. Resisei Layla explains the positive distinction: the renewed wisdom of Israel's heart is called Torah because its source remains recognized as God. The comparison clarifies the relation of human understanding to divine source, rather than resting on the historical opposition alone.

[315] **Sod Yesharim, Parashat Parah 1:1**: "My holy grandfather explained that Solomon's wisdom was a garment for Moses' wisdom. Moses' wisdom was to look into the depth and see how Israel is bound to the upper root. King Solomon's wisdom was to make another person wise as well, by clothing this depth in garments. Through work within those garments, a person would recognize his own connection to the upper root."

Pri Tzadik describes Oral Torah as divine words renewed within the sages' hearts. Sod Yesharim explains the receiving relation through Solomon and Moses: the deeper recognition is clothed so that another person, working through those forms, can apprehend the connection to the upper root. This develops the positive work of the humanly articulated wisdom that Pri Tzadik contrasts with Greek philosophy.

[316] **Yoma 69a**: 'When dawn arrived, Alexander said to the Samaritans: Who are these people coming to meet us? They said to him: These are the Jews who rebelled against you. When he reached Antipatris, the sun shone and the two camps met each other. When Alexander saw Shimon HaTzaddik, he descended from his chariot and bowed before him. His escorts said to him: Should an important king such as you bow to this Jew? He said to them: I do so because the image of this man's face is victorious before me on my battlefields, i.e., when I fight I see his image going before me as a sign of victory, and therefore I know that he has supreme sanctity.'

הִתְפַּשְׁטוּת תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה. — **who was of the remnants of the Great Assembly, when the expansion of the Oral Torah began.** וְזֶה עֲסָק חֹדֶשׁ זֶה: לְתַקֵּן הָאֵשׁ שֶׁל הַיֵּצֶר הָרָע, הָרַב כַּעַס, בְּרֹגֶז — **And this is the work of this month: to rectify the destructive fire of the Evil Inclination, abundant grief, –** הָאֵשׁ שֶׁל תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה, שֶׁהִיא אֵשׁ אוֹכְלָה אֵשׁ כָּאָמוּר. — **through rogez — the fire of the Oral Torah, which is a fire consuming fire, as stated.**

Rosh Chodesh Kislev Ois 7

Two Readings of Sefer Yetzirah: Sleep, Anger, and Divine Help

The captain’s counter-steering explains disciplined resistance without excess.

Two Readings of Sefer Yetzirah: Sleep, Anger, and Divine Help

בְּסֵפֶר יְצִירָה: "הִמְלִיךְ אוֹת סָמֶ"ך בְּשִׁינָה וְכִסְלָו בַּשָּׁנָה וְקֵבָה בַּנֶּפֶשׁ" כֵּן הוּא גִּרְסַת הָאֲרִיזַ"ל, — **In Sefer Yetzirah: "He made the letter Samech king over sleep, etc., Kislev in the year, and the stomach in the soul" — so is the reading of the Arizal,** וְהוּא עַל פִּי מַה שֶּׁכָּתוּב בַּגְּמָרָא: "קֵבָה יְשֵׁנָה". — **which accords with the Gemara: "The stomach sleeps."** וּלְגִרְסַת הַגְּאוֹנִים: "הִמְלִיךְ אוֹת סָמֶ"ך בְּרֹגֶז וְכוּלֵיהּ, וּמָרָה בַּנֶּפֶשׁ", — **And according to the reading of the Geonim: "He made the letter Samech king over rogez, etc., and the gallbladder in the soul",** וְהוּא עַל פִּי מַה שֶּׁכָּתוּב בַּתִּקּוּנִים (תִּקּוּן מ"ח): "עֲצִיבוּ דְּטַחוֹל וְכַעַס דְּמָרָה";[317] — **which accords with Tikunei Zohar (Tikun 48): "Melancholy of the spleen and wrath of the gallbladder";** וְעַיֵּן (תִּקּוּן י"ג דִּבּוּר הַמַּתְחִיל וּבְגִין דָּא הַכָּבֵד כּוֹעֵס, בְּמַאי כּוֹעֵס? בְּמָרָה וְכוּלֵיהּ"):[318] פָּתַח רַבִּי שִׁמְעוֹן' — **and see (Tikun 13, heading beginning 'Rabbi Shimon opened'): "And because of this the liver grows angry; through what does it grow angry? Through the gallbladder, etc.";** וּבְפֵרוּשׁ הָרַאֲבַ"ד כָּתַב: "וּמָרָה בַּנֶּפֶשׁ, כִּי בוֹ יְסוֹד הָאֵשׁ שֶׁבְּטֶבַע הָאָדָם". — **and in the commentary of the Ra'avad he wrote: "and the gallbladder in the soul, for in it is the element of fire within human nature."** וּבְחֶשְׁבּוֹן שְׁנֵים עָשָׂר הַכֹּחוֹת לִשְׁנֵים עָשָׂר שְׁבָטִים, חָשַׁב הָרַאֲבַ"ד רוֹגֶז לְדָן, — **And in the calculation of the twelve faculties for the twelve tribes, the Ra'avad assigned rogez to Dan,** שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: "יְהִי דָן נָחָשׁ וְגוֹמֵר". — **as it is said: "Dan shall be a serpent, etc."** וְכֵן כָּתַב הָאֲרִיזַ"ל, דִּלְגִרְסָתוֹ "הִמְלִיךְ אוֹת עַיִ"ן בְּרֹגֶז וְטֵבֵת בַּשָּׁנָה", וּלְפִי חֶשְׁבּוֹנוֹ שְׁנֵים עָשָׂר שְׁבָטִים לְשִׁבְעָה כְּסִדְרָן הַדְּגָלִים — **And so wrote the Arizal, who according to his reading holds "He crowned the letter Ayin over rogez and Tevet in the year",** – דָּן נֶגֶד חֹדֶשׁ טֵבֵת; — **and according to his alignment of the twelve tribes to the months by the banners — Dan corresponds to Tevet;**

The corrective force must stay within its needed measure

וְהַיְנוּ "רוּגְזָא דְּרַבָּנָן דְּאִיהוּ טָב לְכָל סִטְרִין"[319] — **meaning "the rage of the Rabbis which is beneficial in every direction" as written in the Zohar,** וְהוּא מַה שֶּׁכָּתוּב (בְּרָכוֹת ה' עַמּוּד א'): "לְעוֹלָם יַרְגִּיז אָדָם יִצְרוֹ טוֹב עַל יִצְרוֹ הָרָע וְכוּלֵיהּ",[320] — **and this is what is written (Berachot 5a): "A person should always rouse the Good Inclination against the Evil, etc.",** וְהוּא הֵפֶךְ מִכַּעַס דִּכְתִיב: "כִּי כַעַס בְּחֵיק כְּסִילִים יָנוּחַ". — **which is the opposite of anger of which it is written: "For anger rests in the bosom of fools".**

Awe tests the quality of one's Torah activity

וּבַגְּמָרָא (יוֹמָא ע"ב עַמּוּד ב') נִדְרַשׁ "לָמָּה זֶּה מְחִיר בְּיַד כְּסִיל" עַל שֶׁעוֹסְקִין בַּתּוֹרָה וְאֵין בָּהֶם יִרְאַת שָׁמַיִם;[321, 322] — **And in the**

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[317] **Tikkunei Zohar 85a:3-85b:2**: 'In Tikkunei Zohar (Tikkun 48, 85a), the double mention of Shabbat in the verse refers to the union of the Supernal Shabbat (Binah, the World to Come) and the Lower Shabbat (Malkhut, the Sabbath Queen), which illuminate Israel throughout all their dwellings.'

[318] **Tikkunei Zohar 27a:8-30a:1**: 'For it is Samael – 'another god' – and there in the liver is its fundament and essence. And because of this: 'the liver gets angry'. With what does it get angry? With the bile that cleaves to it, and this is the 'poison of death' – his female counterpart, his tail, the 'extra lobe' of the liver. 'Extra' she is called, for after she performs her adulteries, she gives the remains to her husband.'

[319] **Tiferet Yosef, Pesach 6**: "God placed the power of anger in this world in the sense of "With strategies you shall wage war," which my holy grandfather explained through the ship's captain. If the captain sees the ship tilting to one side, he tilts it toward the other. Tilting toward that side would not itself be good either; he does it to escape danger and restore the ship to an even line. So, because harmful desires still exist in the world, God placed the quality of anger within it, through which a person can escape desire. As long as the anger is only to the extent needed to escape desire, it is called the anger of the sages. Even a hair's breadth more is called actual idolatry."
Pri Tzadik defines the holy agitation as stirring the good inclination against the bad, the opposite of anger resting with fools. Tiferet Yosef gives a precise image and limit: a captain steers against a dangerous tilt only to restore balance. The force needed to escape desire is distinguished sharply from even a small excess. This makes the origin's distinction practical and exact.

[320] **Berakhot 5a:2**: "Rabbi Levi bar Chama said in the name of Rabbi Shimon ben Lakish: A person should always rouse the good inclination against the evil inclination, as it says, 'Tremble, and do not sin.' If he defeats it, well and good. If not, he should occupy himself with Torah, as it says, 'Speak in your hearts.' If he defeats it, well and good. If not, he should recite Shema, as it says, 'Upon your beds.' If he defeats it, well and good. If not, he should remind himself of the day of death, as it says, 'And be still, selah.'"

[321] **Yoma 72b**: 'Rabbi Shmuel bar Naḥmani said that Rabbi Yonatan said: What is the meaning of that which is written: "Why is there a price in the hand of a fool to buy wisdom, as he has no heart?" (Proverbs 17:16)? This expresses the following sentiment: Woe to them, haters of Torah scholars, a euphemism for the Torah scholars themselves, who immerse themselves in Torah and have no fear of Heaven. They are fools; they try to acquire the wisdom of Torah, but since they have no fear of Heaven in their hearts they lack the ability to do so.'

[322] **Tzidkat HaTzadik 167:1**: "In words of Torah a person is permitted to fear, as our sages say in Berakhot. That is, one should fear lest it be, God forbid, a poison of death; through the fear itself it is sweetened and becomes "from engagement not for its own sake, engagement for its own sake."
Pri Tzadik distinguishes learned anger directed against the inclination from the foolishness of Torah study without awe.

Gemara (Yoma 72b) "Why is there a price in the hand of a fool" was expounded on those who study Torah without fear of Heaven; וְרוּגְזָא דְּרַבָּנַן הוּא לְהַרְגִּיז עַל הַיֵּצֶר הָרָע שֶׁלֹּא יְהֵא כְּסִיל, **— and holy rabbinic anger is rousing against the Evil Inclination so that he not become a fool,** וְהוּא עַל יְדֵי הַיִּרְאָה, פַּחַד יִצְחָק, אֵשׁ דְּקְדֻשָּׁה; **— which is attained through awe, the Fear of Isaac, the fire of holiness; –** וְהַפְּסֹלֶת מִמֶּנּוּ עֵשָׂו, כַּעַס, אֵשׁ שֶׁל יֵצֶר הָרָע כֵּן הוּא לְגַרְסַת הַגְּאוֹנִים. **— and the refuse from it is Esau, fury, the fire of the evil impulse — so is it according to the reading of the Geonim.**

— וְלָהָאֲרִיזַ"ל[323], שַׁבָּט זֶה [כִּסְלֵו] לְבִנְיָמִין, **And according to the Arizal, this month of Kislev is assigned to Benjamin,** וְכֵן חָשַׁב הָרַאֲבַ"ד זִכְרוֹנוֹ לִבְרָכָה גַּם כֵּן שֵׁינָה לְבִנְיָמִין, **— and so the Ra'avad also assigned sleep to Benjamin,** שֶׁל "וּבֵין כְּתֵפָיו שָׁכַן", וְקֹדֶשׁ הַקָּדָשִׁים נִקְרָא "חֲדַר הַמִּטּוֹת". **— from "and He dwells between his shoulders", the Holy of Holies being called "the bed-chamber".**

The two awakenings call to one another

Effort can discover the gift that made it possible

— וּכְבָר אָמַרְנוּ בָּזֶה שֶׁשְּׁנֵי הַגִּרְסָאוֹת אֲמִתִּיִּים:[324, 325] **And we have already explained that both textual readings are divine truths:** שֶׁמִּצַּד הָאָדָם הָעֵסֶק בְּחֹדֶשׁ זֶה: הָרוֹגֶז, "לְעוֹלָם יַרְגִּיז יִצְרוֹ טוֹב עַל יֵצֶר הָרָע"; **— for from the human perspective the work in this month is holy agitation: "A person should always rouse the Good Inclination against the Evil";** וּמִצַּד הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ קְדֻשַּׁת חֹדֶשׁ זֶה: "הִמְלִיךְ אוֹת סָמֶ"ךְ בְּשֵׁינָה", **— and from the perspective of the Blessed Name the sanctity of this month is: "He crowned the letter Samech over sleep",** עַל דָּרֶךְ מַה שֶּׁכָּתוּב (שִׁיר הַשִּׁירִים רַבָּה ה׳): "'אֲנִי יְשֵׁנָה מִן הַמִּצְוֹות וְכוּלֵיהּ, וְלִבִּי עֵר'[326] **— after what is written (Shir HaShirim Rabbah 5): –** נִדְרַשׁ אַחַר כָּךְ עַל הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא שֶׁהוּא לִבָּן שֶׁל יִשְׂרָאֵל", **— "'I sleep from the mitzvot, etc., but my heart wakes' — expounded afterward on the Holy One Who is the heart of Israel",** וְהַיְנוּ שֶׁהַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ מְעוֹרֵר אֶת הַיִּשְׂרָאֵל אַף כִּי "אֲנִי יְשֵׁנָה מִן הַמִּצְוֹות". **— meaning that the Blessed Name awakens the Jew even when "I sleep from the mitzvot".** וְהוּא עַל פִּי מַה שֶּׁכָּתַב הָאֲרִיזַ"ל: **— And this accords with what the Arizal wrote:** דְּשִׁשָּׁה חֳדָשֵׁי הַקַּיִץ דְּמַטְרוֹנִיתָא, שִׁשָּׁה חֳדָשֵׁי הַחֹרֶף דְּמַלְכָּא; **— that the six summer months pertain to the Queen, and the six winter months to the King;** וְכֵן כָּתַב בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ (חֵלֶק ב׳ קפ״ו עַמּוּד "יַרְחָא דְּלְכוֹן אִיהוּ בְּסִדּוּרָא כְּסִדְרָא דְּאָתְוָון: אָבִיב וְכוּלֵיהּ, **— and so written in the Holy Zohar (Part II, 186a):**[327] א׳):

Tzidkat HaTzadik explains why fear concerning one's Torah can be constructive: concern that the learning might become harmful can itself sweeten and redirect it. This clarifies the role of awe in the difference stated here.

[323] **Sefer Yetzirah 5:9**: 'He made the letter Samekh king over sleep, bound a crown to it, and with it formed Sagittarius (Keshet) in the universe, Kislev in the year, and the stomach (keivah) in the soul.'

[324] **Takanat HaShavin 5:5**: "As is known from "As water reflects face to face," awakening from below and awakening from above stir one another. We say, "Draw me; after You we shall run," and "Return us," asking that the awakening from above come first to awaken us, so that we will be drawn and run after Him. God, however, says the reverse: "Return to Me, and I will return to you." The whole length of exile concerns this: God wishes us to awaken through an awakening from below, and if Israel repents they are immediately redeemed."

Pri Tzadik reconciles the readings of anger and sleep through two sides: the person's resistance and God's awakening help. Takanat HaShavin describes the mutual movement explicitly through the different voices of "Return us" and "Return to Me." This explains why the plea for an awakening from above can coexist with a demand for initiative below.

[325] **Tiferet Yosef, Shavuot 8**: "My holy grandfather explained that these and those are the words of the living God: when a person breaks through concealment, he recognizes that his power of holiness—the power to expand words of Torah—comes entirely from the holiness of Shabbat already permanently established within him. God then gives him words of Torah in an established way, and he has a share even in Shabbat's permanent holiness. Although a person cannot reach that holiness through his actions, he nevertheless has a share in it as well."

Pri Tzadik treats the human and divine descriptions of Kislev as both true. Tiferet Yosef similarly explains two descriptions of the preparation for Sinai: after breaking through concealment, a person recognizes that the power used in preparation was itself rooted in God's established holiness. This clarifies how genuine human exertion and prior divine support can describe one process.

[326] **Shir HaShirim Rabbah 5:2:1** (excerpt): "'I sleep.' The congregation of Israel said before the Holy One, blessed be He: Master of the world, I sleep concerning the commandments, but my heart is awake for acts of kindness. I sleep concerning charitable deeds, but my heart is awake to perform them. I sleep concerning sacrifices, but my heart is awake for the reading of Shema and prayer. I sleep concerning the Temple, but my heart is awake for synagogues and houses of study. I sleep concerning the appointed end, but my heart is awake for redemption. I sleep concerning redemption, but the heart of the Holy One is awake to redeem me. Rabbi Chiya bar Abba said: Where do we find that the Holy One is called the heart of Israel? From this verse: 'God is the rock of my heart and my portion forever' (Psalms 73:26)."

[327] **Zohar, Tetzaveh 14:118-127**: 'In the Zohar (Tetzaveh II 186a), on the verse 'This month shall be unto you the beginning of months' (Exodus 12:2), Rabbi Shimon explains that the six summer months from Nisan belong to the revelation of the right side—where Aviv unfolds in direct alphabetical order—while the six winter months from Tishrei belong to the inward return of the left side.'

— "Your month Nisan is in direct order according to the alphabet: Aviv ,אֲבָל יַרְחָא דִּילִי [א-ב][328] **— etc.,** [ת-ש-ר]; מַאי טַעְמָא? אַתּוּן מִתַּתָּא מִסּוֹפָא דְּאַתְוָון: תִּשְׁרֵי — **but My month is from the end of the alphabet: Tishrei** לְעֵילָּא, וַאֲנָא מֵעֵילָּא לְתַתָּא"[329], **— what is the reason? You proceed from below upward, while I proceed from Above downward."**

— וְהַיְנוּ: נִיסָן, שֶׁאָז הָיָה יְצִיאַת מִצְרַיִם וְאָז נַעֲשָׂה כְּנֶסֶת יִשְׂרָאֵל, **Meaning: Nisan, when the Exodus from Egypt occurred and Knesset Yisrael was formed,** מַתְחִיל אָז הַהִשְׁתַּדְּלוּת מִצַּד הָאָדָם מִתַּתָּא לְעֵילָּא; **— begins human effort from below upward;** וְתִשְׁרֵי אוֹתִיּוֹת לְמַפְרֵעַ, מַתְחִיל הַהִתְעוֹרְרוּת מִצַּד אִתְעָרוּתָא דִּלְעֵילָּא, מֵעֵילָּא לְתַתָּא. **— and Tishrei, whose letters run backward, begins awakening from the divine side Above (itaruta de'le'ela), from Above downward.**

Yesterday's victory still calls for today's prayer

Prayer places the receiving vessel within reach

— וּמִכָּל מָקוֹם אֵין הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ מַשְׁלִיךְ עֶזְרוֹ רַק לַמְבַקְשִׁים עֶזְרוֹ בִּתְפִלָּה[330,331], **Nevertheless the Blessed Name does not cast His aid except upon those who seek His help in prayer,** כְּעֵין מַה שֶּׁנֶּאֱמַר: "קָרוֹב הַשֵּׁם לְכָל קוֹרָאָיו, לְכֹל אֲשֶׁר יִקְרָאֻהוּ בֶאֱמֶת", **— akin to: "Hashem is near to all who call upon Him, to all who call upon Him in truth",** וּכְעֵין מַה שֶּׁמְּבַקֶּשֶׁת כְּנֶסֶת יִשְׂרָאֵל: "הֲשִׁיבֵנוּ הַשֵּׁם אֵלֶיךָ" וְאַחַר כָּךְ "וְנָשׁוּבָה" כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב (סוֹף אֵיכָה רַבָּה)[332]. **— and like that which Knesset Yisrael pleads: "Turn us back to You, Hashem", and only afterward "and we shall be turned" (end of Eichah Rabbah).** :וְזֶהוּ "הַמְלִיךְ אוֹת סָמֶ"ךְ בְּשֵׁינָה" **— And this is "He crowned the letter Samech over sleep":** אַף שֶׁהָאָדָם בְּשֵׁינָה, יוֹשֵׁב בָּטֵל כְּיָשֵׁן דָּמֵי, "יְשֵׁנָה מִן הַמִּצְוֹות", **— even when a person is in sleep, sitting idle being like one sleeping, "I sleep from the mitzvot",** מִכָּל מָקוֹם לִבּוֹ שֶׁל הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא עֵר לְעוֹרֵר אֶת יִשְׂרָאֵל. **— nevertheless the heart of the Holy One, Blessed be He, is awake to awaken Israel.**

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[328] **Shabbat 104a**: 'The Sages said to Rabbi Yehoshua ben Levi: Young students came today to the study hall and said things the likes of which were not said even in the days of Joshua bin Nun. These children who only knew the Hebrew alphabet interpreted the letters homiletically.Alef beit means learn elaf the wisdom bina of the Torah.Gimmel dalet means give to the poor gemol dalim. Why is the leg of the gimmel extended toward the dalet? Because it is the manner of one who bestows loving-kindness to pursue the poor. And why is the leg of the dalet extended toward the gimmel? It is so that a poor person will make himself available to him who wants to give him charity. And why does the dalet face away from the gimmel? It is to teach that one should give charity discreetly so that the poor person will not be embarrassed by him.'

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[330] **Tzidkat HaTzadik 51:1**: "All a person's effort in breaking the inclination in matters of desire is called only grace and beauty, which are false and vain: they do not endure forever, for the inclination grows stronger every day, and perhaps tomorrow one will not overcome it. The essential thing is to ask God to help him. This is a reliable trust, for his Redeemer lives."

Pri Tzadik requires the person who awaits an awakening from above to ask for help in prayer. Tzidkat HaTzadik explains why the request cannot be replaced by confidence in past self-restraint: the inclination renews its attack, and yesterday's victory does not secure tomorrow. This gives a concrete reason for the continuing prayer demanded here.

[331] **Tiferet Yosef, Nitzavim 10**: "God established in this world that the vessel belongs to the person, and this is called awe of Heaven. What is the person's vessel? Principally, to lower oneself so that the majesty of the Holy One may rest upon one. "The human being became a living soul" is translated "a speaking spirit." The Zohar says that this spirit ascends and speaks before the holy King, enters all the gates, and none can stop it; it is therefore called a speaking spirit. When the person stands before God in prayer, God bestows words of Torah upon him. Those words of Torah are indeed very exalted and precious; but the vessel the person establishes is in his own hands. This is "The matter is very near to you, in your mouth and your heart, to do it": when one lowers oneself so that the Holy One's majesty may rest upon one, this is the person's vessel, and God bestows the exalted words of Torah."

Pri Tzadik's call to seek help in prayer can be understood through Tiferet Yosef's distinction between the exalted gift and the receiving vessel. Words of Torah may be very high, but humbling oneself and standing in prayer is the humanly accessible vessel. This explains the small initiative that can accompany awaiting help from above.

[332] **Eikhah Rabbah 5:21**: 'Turn us unto You, O Lord, and we shall be turned; renew our days as of old' (Lamentations 5:21): the Midrash expounds the enduring sanctity of the site of the Temple—'the house of the footstool of our God'—where the Divine Presence never departs from the Western Wall and the foundation of the Sanctuary.'

The limits observed in service form a vessel for greater help

אַךְ הוּא דַּוְקָא כְּשֶׁהָאָדָם בְּשֵׁינָה סוּר מֵרָע,[333] — **Yet this applies specifically when a person in his sleep turns from evil,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בַּגְּמָרָא (עֲבוֹדָה זָרָה י״ט עַמּוּד ב׳):[334] — **and as written in the Gemara (Avodah Zarah 19b):** "שֶׁמָּא יֹאמַר: אֵלֵךְ וְאֶתְגָּרֶה בְּשֵׁינָה וְכוּלֵּיהּ? תַּלְמוּד לוֹמַר: 'וַעֲשֵׂה טוֹב'". — **"Lest he say: I will go and indulge in sleep, etc.? Scripture teaches: 'and do good'."**

Use the given powers while trusting for help beyond them

גַּם צָרִיךְ עַל כָּל פָּנִים אִתְעָרוּתָא דִּלְתַתָּא בִּתְפִלָּה,[335] — **Also he requires at least an awakening from below through prayer,** לְבַקֵּשׁ עֶזְרָתוֹ יִתְבָּרַךְ מִן הַיֵּצֶר הַמְבַקֵּשׁ לַהֲמִיתוֹ וְאֵינוֹ יָכוֹל לוֹ, — **to seek His Blessed aid from the impulse seeking to destroy him against which he cannot prevail,** וְאָז הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ עוֹזֵר לוֹ בְּאִתְעָרוּתָא דִּלְעֵילָּא. — **and then the Blessed Name helps him with supernal awakening from Above.** וְזֶה מוֹרֶה אוֹת סָמֶ״ךְ: "סוֹמֵךְ הַשֵּׁם לְכָל הַנֹּפְלִים", כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמַרְנוּ; — **And this is what the letter Samech reveals: "Hashem supports all who fall", as we explained;** וְכֵן מוֹרֶה אוֹת סָמֶ״ךְ עַל סֻכַּת דָּוִד הַנּוֹפֶלֶת, — **and likewise the letter Samech points to the fallen Tabernacle of David (Sukkat David),** שֶׁמַּקִּיף כְּסֻכָּה לְהָגֵן עַל מְבַקְּשֵׁי עֶזְרָתוֹ לִהְיוֹת סוֹמֵךְ לְכָל הַנֹּפְלִים. — **encircling like a protective sukkah to defend those who seek His aid, supporting all the fallen.** וּמִצַּד הָאָדָם הָעֵסֶק בְּחֹדֶשׁ לְהַרְגִּיז הַיֵּצֶר טוֹב עַל יֵצֶר הָרָע: — **And from the human perspective, the spiritual work in this month is:** בְּהִשְׁתַּדְּלוּת בְּכָל כֹּחוֹ, עַד שֶׁאֵין יָכוֹל לוֹ מִצִּדּוֹ. — **to rouse the Good Inclination against the Evil through exertion with all his might, until he recognizes he cannot overcome it on his own.**

One shared whole can reveal different particular strengths

וְ"אֵלּוּ וָאֵלּוּ דִּבְרֵי אֱלֹהִים חַיִּים":[336] — **And "both these and those are the words of the Living God":**

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[333] **Tiferet Yosef, Talmud Anthology, Taanit 1**: "Even when a person proceeds in service through all the fences and boundaries of Torah and commandments, we still find in the Talmud, "Were the Holy One not to help him…" Yet bestowing the flow of His kindness upon a person before he proceeds in service through all those boundaries is impossible: a person is finite, while the flow of His kindness is truly without limit. How could the finite receive the infinite? Once a person proceeds in service through the fences of Torah and commandments, he becomes a vessel to receive even what has no limit, recognizing well the connection between Heaven and earth. This connection is called the powers of rain. The Gemara therefore asks, how do we know this is in prayer? "'To love the Lord your God…'—what is service of the heart? Prayer"; afterwards it is written, "I will give your land's rain in its season." After the person's work, God gives him the power of prayer and attests that such firm, unbounded faith and trust exist in his heart's depths that, through the work of his own hands, he is fittingly entitled to the divine flow that has no limit."

Pri Tzadik explicitly requires avoiding evil, praying, and exerting oneself with all one's strength. Tiferet Yosef explains why preparation matters even though a person still cannot prevail without God's help: working through Torah's boundaries makes a finite person into a vessel for an unbounded gift. The quoted passage retains both the need for preparation and the continuing need for divine assistance.

[334] **Avodah Zarah 19b**: 'The psalm continues: "Depart from evil, and do good; seek peace and pursue it" (Psalms 34:15). The Gemara explains: Lest one say: I have kept my tongue from evil and my lips from speaking guile, I will therefore go and indulge in sleep. To counter this possibility, the verse states: "Depart from evil, and do good," i.e., it is not enough to avoid evil, but one must actively do good. And the word good means nothing other than Torah, as it is stated: "For I have given you a good portion; My Torah, do not abandon it" (Proverbs 4:2).'

[335] **Tzidkat HaTzadik 212:1**: "Nevertheless, this is trust. "He shall lean" means more: the support that is in his hands, on which he leans, is "on his God." As is known, this name signifies the powers implanted in created beings. "His God" means the powers he has, which God gave him to sustain himself in all his needs through counsel from Torah, wisdom, and service. This is his principal reliance. Yet he should also trust in deliverance beyond his power, for nothing restrains the Lord, and His hand is not too short to save."

Pri Tzadik retains prayer and effort with all one's strength before the point of inability. Tzidkat HaTzadik distinguishes the powers one can actually lean on—God-given Torah, wisdom, and service—from trust in a deliverance beyond those powers. This explains why awaiting divine support does not cancel the work already placed in one's hands.

[336] **Machshavot Charutz 4:1**: "The twelve months correspond to the twelve tribes. Each tribe has a particular excellence and power through which it is distinguished from the other tribes and reckoned as a tribe in its own right. Although all Israel are "one nation on earth," truly one, and each contains all the excellences found in the whole of Israel, a particular excellence becomes manifest in the soul specially corresponding to it. Every matter has world, year, and soul: as souls differ, so do times and places. The general division of Israel's souls into twelve tribes corresponds to the world's twelve diagonal boundaries and the year's twelve months. There are several arrangements of the months and tribes, with great and deep matters involved in how all the arrangements are true."

Pri Tzadik explains opposing spiritual approaches through each soul's root and God's knowledge of how to guide it. Machshavot Charutz supplies the underlying pattern: although each member of Israel contains the whole, a particular strength becomes especially manifest in its corresponding soul, time, and place. This helps explain differentiated routes without turning one person's route into a universal prescription.

Different souls require different forms of discipline

יֵשׁ נְפָשׁוֹת שֶׁהַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ מַכִּיר בָּהֶם שֶׁצְּרִיכִין הִשְׁתַּדְּלוּת מִצִּדָּם לְהַרְגִּיז עַל הַיֵּצֶר הָרָע; [337] — **for there are souls in whom the Blessed Name recognizes that they require proactive exertion from their side to rouse against the evil impulse;** וְיֵשׁ נְפָשׁוֹת שֶׁהַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ סוֹמֵךְ לְכָל הַנֹּפְלִים, — **and there are souls whom the Blessed Name directly supports as fallen,** כְּמַאֲמַר: "הֲשִׁיבֵנוּ ה' אֵלֶיךָ" וְאַחַר כָּךְ "וְנָשׁוּבָה". — **as in the verse: "Turn us back to You, Hashem", and only afterward "and we shall be turned".** וְכֵן פֵּרוּשׁ "אֵלּוּ וָאֵלּוּ דִּבְרֵי אֱלֹהִים חַיִּים", — **And so is the meaning of "both these and those are the words of the Living God",** שֶׁכָּל אֶחָד אָמַר כְּפִי שֹׁרֶשׁ וְהַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ מַכִּיר שֹׁרֶשׁ נִשְׁמַת כָּל נִשְׁמָתוֹ; — **in that each master spoke according to the root of his own soul;** אֶחָד מִיִּשְׂרָאֵל וְכֵן הַהַנְהָגָה עִמּוֹ. — **and the Blessed Name knows the soul-root of every single Jew and conducts him accordingly.** אֲבָל מִכָּל מָקוֹם, אַף מִי שֶׁהוּא מִכְּלַל הַצְּרִיכִין עֵזֶר הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ, — **Nevertheless, even one numbered among those who require the direct aid of the Blessed Name,** מִכָּל מָקוֹם צָרִיךְ אִתְעָרוּתָא דִּלְתַתָּא עַל כָּל פָּנִים לְהִתְפַּלֵּל לַהשֵּׁם וּלְבַקֵּשׁ עֶזְרוֹ; — **still requires an awakening from below at least to pray to Hashem and plead for His assistance;** וְאָז "קָרוֹב ה' לְכָל קֹרְאָיו" וְסוֹמֵךְ לְכָל הַנֹּפְלִים: — **and then "Hashem is near to all who call upon Him" and supports all who fall:** "אֲנִי יְשֵׁנָה", וְלִבּוֹ שֶׁל הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא עֵר לְעוֹרֵר אֶת הָאָדָם בִּתְשׁוּבָה בְּאִתְעָרוּתָא דִּלְעֵילָּא כָּאָמוּר. — **"I sleep", yet the heart of the Holy One, Blessed be He, wakes to arouse a person in repentance through supernal awakening from Above, as stated.**

[337] **Mei HaShiloach, Volume I, Genesis, Toldot 2**: "Even within Israel there are souls permitted to enter matters of uncertainty more than other souls, although both descend from Jacob, as in the matter of Simeon and Dinah. Levi did not wish to take her, fearing lest his intention not be for the sake of Heaven in its depth; the tribe of Levi is marked by awe and withdrawal from uncertainty, as it is written, "I gave them awe." Priests who enter the innermost sanctuary therefore came from them, and their life was clarified immediately, as will be explained concerning the staffs in Korach. Simeon, however, entered the uncertainty, saying, "God forbid that I should regard myself as sexually immoral." He married Dinah and entered a matter requiring clarification, trusting that God would clarify it for good, since his intention was only to bring her out of Shechem and was wholly for the sake of Heaven. The whole tribe of Simeon therefore required clarification in such matters, as with Zimri, who likewise said his intention was good, as will be explained in its place. In the future, when the tribe of Simeon is clarified, its degree will be greater than Levi's."
Pri Tzadik relates the difference between exertion and reliance on help to individual soul roots, while requiring prayer of everyone. Mei HaShiloach gives a concrete example of different disciplines within Israel: Levi withdraws from uncertainty, while Simeon enters a matter that requires further clarification. The quoted target retains the later need for clarification, including Zimri, and does not make Simeon's confidence a general permission. Pri Tzadik's universal requirement of prayer remains his own explicit qualification.

Chanukah Ois 1

Chanukah, Shabbos, and the Priestly Light of Oral Torah

The military victory is the essential deliverance. The additional provision of oil shows divine delight in Israel's lighting, even where their inability would have exempted them from the commandment.

Chanukah, Shabbos, and the Priestly Light of Oral Torah

עִנְיַן חֲנֻכָּה נִסְדַּר בַּגְּמָרָא בְּפֶרֶק "בַּמֶּה מַדְלִיקִין" בְּעִנְיַן הַדְלָקַת נֵר שַׁבָּת, וְלֹא בַּמָּקוֹם שֶׁהֻזְכַּר בַּמִּשְׁנָה (בָּבָא קַמָּא ס״ב עַמּוּד ב׳)[338] — **The subject of Chanukah was arranged in the Gemara in the chapter Bameh Madlikin within the topic of lighting the Shabbat candle, and not in the place where it was mentioned in the Mishnah (Bava Kamma 62b);** וְהֵינוּ מִטַּעַם שֶׁנֵּר חֲנֻכָּה מֵעֵין נֵר שַׁבָּת; וְלִכְאוֹרָה הָיָה שַׁיָּךְ יוֹתֵר בִּמְנֻחוֹת בְּדִינֵי הַדְלָקַת הַמְּנוֹרָה, שֶׁהֲרֵי נֵר חֲנֻכָּה זָכָר לְנֵרוֹת הַמִּקְדָּשׁ. — **and that is because the Chanukah candle is of the nature of the Shabbat candle. And ostensibly it would have been more relevant in Menachot within the laws of lighting the Menorah, for behold the Chanukah candle is a commemoration of the lights of the Temple.**

The oil miracle reveals that Israel's light is welcome

אַךְ עִקַּר הַנֵּס הָיָה בַּחֲנֻכָּה מַה שֶּׁנִּצְּחוּ הַחַשְׁמוֹנָאִים בְּמִתֵי מִסְפָּר אֶת הַיְוָנִים שֶׁהָיוּ מוֹלְכִים בְּכָל הָעוֹלָם וְהָיוּ עַם רָב.[339] — **Yet the essence of the miracle in Chanukah was that the Hasmoneans, few in number, defeated the Greeks who ruled throughout the entire world and were a numerous people.** אֲבָל הַנֵּס שֶׁהָיָה בַּשֶּׁמֶן הָיָה רַק מִצַּד הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ שֶׁהָיָה חֲבִיבָה לְפָנָיו הַדְלָקָה זוֹ; שֶׁיִּשְׂרָאֵל מִצִּדָּם, כֵּיוָן שֶׁטִּמְּאוּ כָּל הַשְּׁמָנִים וְלֹא הָיָה לָהֶם שֶׁמֶן, הָיוּ פְּטוּרִים מִמִּצְוַת הַדְלָקַת הַמְּנוֹרָה, דְּאָנֵס רַחֲמָנָא פַּטְרֵיהּ, וְכָל שֶׁכֵּן שֶׁלֹּא הָיוּ מְחֻיָּבִים לִמְסֹר נַפְשָׁם בְּעַד מִצְוָה זוֹ; רַק שֶׁהָרְאָה הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ אָז שֶׁחֲבִיבָה הַדְלָקַת הַמְּנוֹרָה לְפָנָיו, וְהִמְצִיא לִפְנֵיהֶם בְּנֵס שֶׁמֶן לְהַדְלָקַת הַנֵּרוֹת. — **However, the miracle that occurred with the oil was only from the side of the Blessed Name, before Whom this kindling was beloved; for the Jewish people from their side, since the Greeks had defiled all the oils and they had no oil, were exempt from the mitzvah of lighting the Menorah, as the Merciful One exempts one under duress (oness), and all the more so they were not obligated to surrender their lives for this mitzvah; only that the Blessed Name showed then that the kindling of the Menorah was beloved before Him, and provided before them miraculously oil for the kindling of the lights.**

Human illumination reveals divine rule within concealment

וְעִנְיַן הַדְלָקַת הַמְּנוֹרָה הוּא מַה שֶּׁנֶּאֱמַר: "בֹּא וְהָאֵר לִי כְּמוֹ שֶׁהֵאַרְתִּי לָכֶם",[340] — **And the concept of the kindling of the**

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[338] **Bava Kamma 62b:2-4**: "If a camel laden with flax passed through a public thoroughfare, its flax extended into a shop, caught fire from the shopkeeper's lamp, and set the building ablaze, the camel's owner is liable. If the shopkeeper placed his lamp outside, the shopkeeper is liable. Rabbi Yehudah says: In the case of a Chanukah lamp, he is exempt. Gemara: Ravina said in Rava's name: We can infer from Rabbi Yehudah's ruling that the mitzvah is to place a Chanukah lamp within ten handbreadths of the ground. For if you supposed that it belongs above ten handbreadths, why did Rabbi Yehudah say that the owner is exempt in the case of a Chanukah lamp? The camel's owner could tell him, 'You should have placed it higher than a camel and its rider!' Does this not show that the mitzvah is to place it within ten handbreadths? The Sages said: No. I can still tell you that it may be placed even above ten handbreadths. What is your objection—that he should have placed it higher than a camel and its rider? Since he is occupied with a mitzvah, the Sages did not impose so great a burden upon him."

[339] **Resisei Layla 57:2**: "Through this they merited the miracle of the oil: the blessed God showed them that they were fit to illuminate before Him in the Temple, from which light goes out to the world. This is the purpose of the Temple lamps: to illuminate before Him in the dark alleyways. This world is dark alleyways with respect to God's light because of the nations. Thus Bereshit Rabbah says that Abraham our father came and illuminated before Him, as it were, in the dark alleyways, by making His divinity known to all the nations. This was also the purpose of all the Temple service: the Divine Presence was revealed there to make His divinity known. Lighting the lamps illuminates for everyone in the world, even those in the deepest darkness. Therefore, of all the acts of service, the wording of Al HaNissim specifies that they lit lamps: this was the essential completion of the attribute of hod, splendor, which they repaired then. The miracle that occurred with this is not mentioned, for it is not part of Chanukah's miracle of deliverance. Rather, it revealed to them from Heaven that they had found favor before Him and had repaired matters completely, to the point that Heaven helped them illuminate before Him. From this they understood that they should establish the days of Chanukah for all generations, lighting lamps outside the Temple as well. After the destruction too, there is a lamp for each person, or at least 'a lamp for a person and his household,' to illuminate for everyone in the world. Therefore its principal placement is outside, to illuminate the world."

Resisei Layla explains what the sign of favor accomplishes: it confirms the repair and becomes the basis for establishing lighting beyond the Temple and beyond that generation. It preserves the same distinction as Peri Tzadik between deliverance from the enemy and the oil as heavenly encouragement. The sign therefore supplies the meaning of the enduring practice, although Israel did not need the miracle to escape an unavoidable failure to perform the commandment.

[340] **Likkutei Maamarim, Compositions on the Festivals 15:1**: "This world is compared to night, as at the beginning of Pesachim. Likewise, Sotah speaks of someone walking in the darkness of night who reaches the crossroads, which is the day of death. This is from the perspective of the person walking through it. So too with the blessed God, Whose kingship rules over everything: in this world it is in darkness, for His light is not revealed. His governance is concealed and operates through concealment. It says, 'He made darkness His hiding place': God made this world, which is darkness, His hiding place, and He is hidden with us amid every kind of darkness. Although 'light dwells with Him,' that is from the perspective of His essence. But from the perspective of His kingship, which rules over everything, even the darkest places, He willed that there should be places darkened from the revelation of the light of the Infinite. This is the world as

Menorah is what is stated: "Come and shine for Me just as I shone for you", כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בַּמִּדְרָשׁ רַבָּה (בְּהַעֲלֹתְךָ וְרִישׁ פָּרָשַׁת תְּצַוֶּה)[341] **— as written in the Midrash Rabbah (Beha'alotecha and beginning of Parashat Tetzaveh);** וְהֵינוּ אוֹר תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה שֶׁנִּמְסַר לְיִשְׂרָאֵל, וְ"לֹא בַשָּׁמַיִם הִוא". **— and this is the light of the Oral Torah which was transmitted to Israel, and "it is not in heaven".** וְכִלְשׁוֹן הַזֶּה מָצִינוּ בְּאַבְרָהָם אָבִינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם (מִדְרָשׁ רַבָּה נֹחַ סוֹף פָּרָשָׁה ל')[342]: **— And in this exact language we find regarding Abraham our Father, peace be upon him (Midrash Rabbah Noach, end of Parashah 30):** "עַד שֶׁאַתָּה מֵאִיר לִי מֵאַסְפּוֹטַמְיָא וּמֵחַבְרוֹתֶיהָ, בֹּא וְהָאֵר לְפָנַי בְּאֶרֶץ יִשְׂרָאֵל", עַיֵּן שָׁם; **— "Rather than shining for Me from Mesopotamia and its surroundings, come and shine before Me in the Land of Israel", see there;** וְהֵינוּ גַּם כֵּן תּוֹרָה אוֹר, **— and this is also the Torah of light,** שֶׁמֵּאַבְרָהָם אָבִינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם הִתְחִיל הַשְּׁנֵי אֲלָפִים תּוֹרָה, **— for from Abraham our Father, peace be upon him, began the two thousand years of Torah,** וְהוּא קִיֵּם וְלָמַד כָּל הַתּוֹרָה כֻּלָּהּ מִמַּה שֶׁהֵבִין מִלִּבּוֹ, **— and he fulfilled and learned the entire Torah from what he understood from his own heart,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב (בְּרֵאשִׁית רַבָּה פָּרָשָׁה ס"א)[343] שֶׁזִּמֵּן לוֹ הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא שְׁנֵי כִלְיוֹתָיו כְּמִין שְׁנֵי רַבָּנִים, **— as written (Bereishit Rabbah Parashah 61) that the Holy One, Blessed be He, designated for him his two kidneys like two rabbis,** וְהָיוּ נוֹבְעוֹת וּמְלַמְּדוֹת אוֹתוֹ תּוֹרָה; **— and they would well forth and teach him Torah;** וְהֵינוּ שֶׁפִּרְסֵם אֱלֹהוּתוֹ יִתְבָּרַךְ שְׁמוֹ בֵּין הַבְּרִיּוֹת, וּכְמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב (שָׁם פָּרָשָׁה נ"ט): "וְכֵינָן שֶׁהוֹדַעְתִּי אוֹתוֹ לִבְרִיּוֹתָיו[344] **— and this means he publicized His Divinity, may His Name be blessed, among the creations, –** ;"אֱלֹהֵי הָאָרֶץ"[345] **— and as written (ibid. Parashah 59): "And once I made Him known to His creations — He is the God of the earth";** וְהוּא עִקַּר דִּבְרֵי תּוֹרָה, שֶׁשֹּׁרֶשׁ כָּל הַדִּבְרֵי תּוֹרָה הוּא מַאֲמַר "אָנֹכִי הַשֵּׁם אֱלֹהֶיךָ". **— and this is the essence of the words of Torah, for the root of all words of Torah is the utterance "I am Hashem your God".**

וְעִקַּר כֹּחַ הֶאָרַת תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה נִתַּן לְאַהֲרֹן הַכֹּהֵן, **— And the primary power of the illumination of the Oral Torah was given to Aaron the Priest,** ;כִּי שִׂפְתֵי כֹהֵן יִשְׁמְרוּ דַעַת וְתוֹרָה יְבַקְשׁוּ מִפִּיהוּ: וּכְמָה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר **— and as Scripture states: "For the priest's lips shall guard knowledge, and they shall seek Torah from his mouth";** וְזֶה גַּם כֵּן עִנְיַן מַה שֶׁכָּתוּב בַּמִּדְרָשׁ רַבָּה (בְּהַעֲלֹתְךָ) שֶׁאָמַר לוֹ לְאַהֲרֹן[346]: **— and this is also the meaning of what is written in Midrash Rabbah (Beha'alotecha) that He said to Aaron:** "לְגִדוֹלָה מִזּוֹ אַתָּה מְתֻקָּן, בְּהַעֲלֹתְךָ אֶת

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a whole."

Likkutei distinguishes God's own light from the concealment of His rule as it is experienced in the world. That distinction explains the otherwise puzzling request that a human being illuminate for God. Abraham and the menorah do not add light to a divine deficiency; they make already-present divine governance recognizable within a place where it is concealed. This gives the precise setting in which Peri Tzadik locates Israel's Oral Torah.

[341] **Bamidbar Rabbah 15:5**: "The Holy One, blessed be He, said to them: "It is not that I need you, but that you should give Me light as I gave you light." Why? To raise your standing before the nations, so that they will say, "See how Israel gives light to the One who gives light to the entire world." To what may this be compared? To a sighted person and a blind person who were walking on the road. When they entered the house, the sighted person said to the blind person, "Go and light this lamp for me, and give me light." The blind person said to him, "Please! When I was on the road you supported me; until we entered the house you accompanied me. Now you tell me, 'Light this lamp for me and give me light'?" The sighted person said to him, "So that you should not feel indebted to me for having accompanied you on the road, I therefore told you: Give me light.""

[342] **Bereshit Rabbah 30:10** (excerpt): "To what was Abraham compared? To a king's friend who saw the king walking through dark alleys. His friend looked out and began to illuminate his way through a window. The king looked up and saw him, and said: Instead of illuminating My way through a window, come and shine before Me. So the Holy One, blessed be He, said to Abraham: Instead of shining for Me from Mesopotamia and its neighboring places, come and shine before Me in the Land of Israel. This is what is written: 'He blessed Joseph and said: The God before whom my fathers walked' (Genesis 48:15)."

[343] **Bereshit Rabbah 61:1**: "Rabbi Shimon said: His father did not teach him, and he had no teacher. From where, then, did he learn Torah? The Holy One, blessed be He, appointed his two kidneys as two teachers, and they welled forth and taught him Torah and wisdom. Thus it is written: "I bless God, who counseled me; even at night my kidneys instruct me" (Psalms 16:7)."

[344] **Bereshit Rabbah 59:8** (excerpt): "'I will make you swear by Hashem, God of heaven' (Genesis 24:3). Rabbi Pinchas said: Before I made Him known to His creatures, He was 'God of heaven'; once I made Him known to His creatures, He was 'God of the earth.'"

[345] **Bereshit Rabbah 59:8** (excerpt): "'I will make you swear by Hashem, God of heaven' (Genesis 24:3). Rabbi Pinchas said: Before I made Him known to His creatures, He was 'God of heaven'; once I made Him known to His creatures, He was 'God of the earth.'"

[346] **Bamidbar Rabbah 15:6**: "You find above that eleven tribes brought offerings, and the tribe of Ephraim brought an offering; all the princes brought offerings except the prince of Levi. Who was the prince of Levi? Aharon, as it says: "Write Aharon's name upon the staff of Levi." Aharon had not brought an offering with the princes, and he said: Woe to me! Perhaps it is because of me that the Holy One, blessed be He, does not accept the tribe of Levi. The Holy One, blessed be He, said to Moshe: Go and tell Aharon: Do not fear; you are destined for something greater than this. Therefore it says: "Speak to Aharon and say to him: When you kindle the lamps." The sacrifices apply as long as the Temple stands, but the lamps are forever: "They shall shine toward the face of the menorah." All the blessings I gave you with which to bless My children will likewise never cease."

הַנֵּרוֹת, — **"For greater than this are you prepared, in your kindling of the lights:** שֶׁבֵּית הַמִּקְדָּשׁ קַיָּם הֵם נוֹהֲגִים, אֲבָל הַנֵּרוֹת לְעוֹלָם", עַיֵּן שָׁם. — **the sacrifices apply as long as the Temple stands, but the lights are forever", see there.** וּבֶאֱמֶת עִנְיַן חֲנֻכַּת הַנְּשִׂיאִים הָיָה שֶׁהַנְּשִׂיאִים הִקְרִיבוּ הַקָּרְבָּנוֹת מִשֶּׁלָּהֶם, — **And in truth the matter of the dedication of the Princes (Channukat HaNesi'im) was that the Princes offered sacrifices of their own,** אֲבָל הַהַקְרָבָה הָיָה עַל יְדֵי הַכֹּהֲנִים, — **yet the actual offering was performed by the kohanim;** וּמַה נִּחַמוֹ הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ: "לְגִדּוֹלָה מִזּוֹ אַתָּה מְתֻקָּן שֶׁתַּדְלִיק נֵרוֹת הַמְּנוֹרָה", — **so with what did the Blessed Name comfort him saying: "For greater than this are you prepared, that you will light the Menorah's lamps" —** הָא נֵרוֹת בֵּית הַמִּקְדָּשׁ גַּם כֵּן הָיָה הַשֶּׁמֶן מִשֶּׁל צִבּוּר, — **behold for the lights of the Temple the oil was also from the communal fund,** וּכְמַה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: "וְאַתָּה תְּצַוֶּה אֶת בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל וְיִקְחוּ אֵלֶיךָ שֶׁמֶן זָךְ וגו'", — **and as Scripture states: "And you shall command the children of Israel that they bring to you oil, etc.",** וְרַק וְכֵן הָיָה כָּל הַקְרָבַת הַקָּרְבָּנוֹת עַל יְדֵי אַהֲרֹן וּבָנָיו, — **and Aaron merited only the kindling;** הַהַדְלָקָה זָכָה אַהֲרֹן; — **and likewise all offering of sacrifices was performed by Aaron and his sons,** וְכֵן הַקְרָבוֹת כָּרְבָּנוֹת הַנְּשִׂיאִים הָיוּ עַל יָדוֹ! — **and so too the offerings of the Princes' sacrifices were through him!**

Aaron's lighting realizes an intention beyond its outward act

רַק עִנְיַן הַדְלָקַת הַנֵּרוֹת הָעִקַּר שֶׁזָּכָה,[347] — **Rather, the kindling of the lamps was the primary thing that he merited,** שֶׁלּוֹ נִתַּן הַכֹּחַ לְהָאִיר אוֹר תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה שֶׁהוּא עִנְיַן "בֹּא וְהָאֵר לְפָנַי". — **for to him was given the power to illuminate the light of the Oral Torah, which is the meaning of "Come and shine before Me".** וְזֶה הַכֹּחַ נִתַּן לְאַהֲרֹן לְהוֹפִיעַ וּלְהָאִיר בְּלֵב כָּל יִשְׂרָאֵל אוֹר תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה — **And this power was granted to Aaron to reveal and shine into the heart of all Israel the light of the Oral Torah** עַל יְדֵי הַדְלָקַת נֵרוֹת הַמִּקְדָּשׁ. — **through the kindling of the Temple lights.** וְזֶה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: "וַיַּעַשׂ כֵּן אַהֲרֹן אֶל מוּל וגו'", — **And this is what Scripture states: "And Aaron did so, toward the front of the Menorah, etc.",** וּפֵרֵשׁ רַבִּי שְׁלֹמֹה יִצְחָקִי מִסְּפְרֵי: "לְהַגִּיד שִׁבְחוֹ שֶׁל אַהֲרֹן שֶׁלֹּא שִׁנָּה", — **and Rashi explained from the Sifrei: "To state the praise of Aaron, that he did not alter",** וְלֹא מָצִינוּ שֶׁיִּכְתֹּב כֵּן הַכָּתוּב עַל שׁוּם קָרְבָּן וּמִצְוָה; — **and we do not find that Scripture writes thus regarding any other sacrifice or mitzvah;** רַק דְּקָאֵי עַל עִנְיַן עֹמֶק מְכֻוַּן הַנֵּרוֹת, — **rather it refers to the deep spiritual aim of the lamps,** שֶׁהוּא לְהָאִיר אוֹר תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה בִּלְבּוֹת יִשְׂרָאֵל, — **which is to shine the light of the Oral Torah into the hearts of Israel,** וְלֹא נִתְפָּרֵשׁ בַּצִּוּוּי רַק בְּרָמָז. — **and it was not detailed in the explicit command, but only through an allusion.** וְזֶה נִשְׁאַר לְעוֹלְמֵי עַד, שֶׁעִקַּר תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה נִתַּן לַכֹּהֲנִים, — **And this remains for all eternity, that the core of the Oral Torah was given to the kohanim,** וּכְמַה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: "וּבָאתָ אֶל הַכֹּהֲנִים הַלְוִיִּם וְגוֹמֵר עַל פִּי הַתּוֹרָה אֲשֶׁר יוֹרוּךָ וְגוֹמֵר". — **as Scripture states: "And you shall come to the Levitical priests, etc., according to the Torah which they instruct you, etc."** וְכֵן זֶה עִקַּר עִנְיַן נֵרוֹת חֲנֻכָּה, — **And so this is the core concept of the Chanukah candles,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁכָּתַב הָרַמְבַּ"ן עַל מַה שֶׁכָּתוּב בַּמִּדְרָשׁ רַבָּה: "אֲבָל הַנֵּרוֹת לְעוֹלָם", — **and as the Ramban wrote on what is stated in Midrash Rabbah: "However the lights are forever",** הָא בֶּאֱמֶת גַּם נֵרוֹת בֵּית הַמִּקְדָּשׁ הֵם רַק בִּזְמַן שֶׁבֵּית הַמִּקְדָּשׁ הָיָה קַיָּם כְּמוֹ הַקָּרְבָּנוֹת, — **for behold in truth the lights of the Temple were also only during the era the Temple stood, just like the sacrifices,** וְכָתַב: שֶׁלֹּא רָמְזוּ אֶלָּא לְנֵרוֹת שֶׁל חֲנֻכַּת בֵּית חַשְׁמוֹנַאי, — **and he wrote: that they alluded only to the lights of the dedication of the House of Hasmoneus,** וְהֵבִיא מִמִּדְרָשׁ שֶׁכָּתַב כֵּן וְהֵם לְעוֹלָם; — **and he cited from a Midrash which wrote thus, that they are forever;** וְהֵינוּ שֶׁנֵּרוֹת חֲנֻכָּה הֵם גַּם כֵּן לְהָאִיר אוֹר תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה, — **meaning that the Chanukah candles are also to illuminate the light of the Oral Torah,** וְעִקַּר נֵס חֲנֻכָּה וּמִצְוָתָהּ בָּא עַל יְדֵי כֹּהֲנֶיךָ הַקְּדוֹשִׁים — **and the primary miracle of Chanukah and its mitzvah came about through Your holy priests,** שֶׁהֵם הַמְּאִירִים אוֹר זֶה בְּלֵב יִשְׂרָאֵל. — **who are the ones who shine this light into the heart of Israel.** וְהִנֵּה בַּגְּמָרָא הַלָּשׁוֹן: "וּכְשֶׁגָּבְרָה בֵּית מַלְכוּת חַשְׁמוֹנַאי וְנִצְּחוּם וְכוּלֵיהּ", — **And behold in the Gemara the language is: "And when the royal house of Hasmoneus grew strong and defeated them, etc.",** וְאָז לֹא הָיוּ מְלָכִים, — **and at that time they were not kings,** רַק אַחַר כָּךְ זָרַע זַרְעָם לָקְחוּ לָהֶם שֵׁם מְלוּכָה. — **only afterward did their**

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[347] **Tiferet Yosef, Beha'alotcha 2**: "But for someone who, from his own side, proceeds with restraint and service, and from whom God's light is only sometimes concealed, the priest's service was to raise that action too to God. Flesh and blood cannot complete this clarification; only the blessed God Himself can. This is 'Toward the front of the menorah the seven lamps shall shine': the completion of the lighting will come of itself, meaning from God. The person should work according to his capacity, and God will clarify the completion. But in the account of the deed it says, 'He raised its lamps': once he has clarified himself according to his capacity, God says that even this completion is named for the person. This is 'He did not change.'"

Tiferet Yosef explains why the wording of Aaron's deed can credit him with a completion that only God can accomplish. Human restraint and service remain the prerequisite; the final clarification is a divine gift attributed to that service. This helps distinguish the inward achievement praised by Peri Tzadik from merely reproducing the physical instructions. Tiferet's subject here is the priest's raising of human service, not an independent identification of Oral Torah with the menorah.

descendants' descendants assume for themselves the title of royalty. וְהָרַמְבַּ"ן (פָּרָשַׁת וַיְחִי) כָּתַב שֶׁמִּפְּנֵי זֶה נֶעֱנְשׁוּ הַחַשְׁמוֹנָאִים[348] — **And the Ramban (Parashat Vayechi) wrote that on account of this the Hasmoneans were punished,** אַף שֶׁהָיוּ חֲסִידֵי עֶלְיוֹן וְנַעֲשָׂה נֵס כָּזֶה עַל יָדָם, — **even though they were supreme pious saints and such a miracle was performed through them,** וּמִכָּל מָקוֹם נֶעֱנְשׁוּ שֶׁלֹּא נִשְׁתַּיֵּר מִזַּרְעָם כְּלָל, — **and nevertheless they were punished that nothing of their lineage survived at all,** עַד שֶׁאָמְרוּ (קִדּוּשִׁין ע׳ עַמּוּד ב׳): "כָּל דְּאָמַר מִבֵּית חַשְׁמוֹנַאי[349] עַבְדָּא הוּא, — **to the extent that they said (Kiddushin 70b): – "Whoever says 'I descend from the royal Hasmonean house' is a slave,** דְּלָא אִשְׁתַּיֵּר מִינַּיְיהוּ אֶלָּא הַהוּא רְבִיתָא וְכוּלֵּיהּ, — **for there remained of them only that maiden, etc.,** נָפְלָה מֵאִגָּרָא וּמֵיתָה", — **who fell from the roof and died",** וְלֹא נִשְׁתַּיֵּר מֵהֶם אַף נְקֵבוֹת; — **so that not even females remained of them;** וְכָתַב שֶׁעָנְשָׁם הָיָה מִשּׁוּם שֶׁעָבְרוּ עַל מַה שֶּׁנֶּאֱמַר: "לֹא יָסוּר שֵׁבֶט מִיהוּדָה וְגוֹמֵר", — **and he wrote that their punishment was because they violated that which is stated: "The scepter shall not depart from Judah, etc.",** וְהֵם לָקְחוּ לָהֶם מְלוּכָה, עַיֵּן שָׁם. — **and they took for themselves kingship, see there.** וְזֶה לֹא מָצִינוּ לָהֶם רַק אַחַר כַּמָּה דּוֹרוֹת, — **And this we found regarding them only after several generations,** וּבְעֵת הַנֵּס הָיוּ רַק כֹּהֲנִים וּמַתִּתְיָהוּ הָיָה כֹּהֵן גָּדוֹל, — **whereas at the time of the miracle they were only priests and Matityahu was a High Priest;** וְיֵשׁ לְהָבִין לָמָּה אָמְרוּ בַּגְּמָרָא הַלָּשׁוֹן וּכְשֶׁגָּבְרָה בֵּית מַלְכוּת חַשְׁמוֹנַאי". — **so one must understand why they stated in the Gemara the phrasing "and when the royal house of Hasmoneus grew strong".** גַּם כָּל הָעִנְיָן יִפָּלֵא: — **Also the entire matter is astonishing:** שֶׁאַף שֶׁמָּצִינוּ בְּיָרָבְעָם שֶׁהָיָה מֶלֶךְ אַף שֶׁהָיָה מִשֵּׁבֶט יוֹסֵף, הֲלֹא הָיָה עַל פִּי נָבִיא; — **for even though we found regarding Jeroboam who was king despite being of the tribe of Joseph, was it not by way of a prophet;** אֲבָל כָּאן הֲלֹא הָיָה עַל פִּי הַסְכָּמַת כָּל יִשְׂרָאֵל לִתֵּן לָהֶם כֶּתֶר מַלְכוּת, — **yet here was it not through the consensus of all Israel to grant them the crown of royalty,** וְאַף לְיַנַּאי מַלְכָּא אָמְרוּ: "רַב לְךָ כֶּתֶר מַלְכוּת, הַנַּח כֶּתֶר כְּהֻנָּה וְכוּלֵּיהּ" (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב קִדּוּשִׁין ס״ו עַמּוּד א׳)[350], — **and even to King Yannai they said: "Let the crown of royalty suffice for you; leave the crown of priesthood, etc." (as in Kiddushin 66a),** וַהֲרֵי עַל הַמַּלְכוּת הִסְכִּימוּ כָּל יִשְׂרָאֵל, — **behold, to the kingship all Israel consented,** וְאֵיךְ עָבְרוּ עַל מַה שֶּׁנֶּאֱמַר "לֹא יָסוּר שֵׁבֶט מִיהוּדָה וְגוֹמֵר"? — **so how did they violate that which is stated "The scepter shall not depart from Judah, etc."?** גַּם יֵשׁ לְהָבִין: לָמָּה יִהְיֶה עֹנֶשׁ חָמוּר כָּזֶה בִּשְׁבִיל עָוֹן זֶה שֶׁגָּרַם שֶׁיִּכָּלֶה זַרְעָם, כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתַב הָרַמְבַּ"ן? — **Also one must understand: why should there be such a severe punishment for this sin, causing their seed to be extinguished, as the Ramban wrote?**

Torah authority must not become a claim to unchecked rule

However, the matter is according to אֲמְנָם הָעִנְיָן הוּא עַל פִּי מַה שֶּׁכָּתוּב בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ (חֵלֶק ב׳ נ״א עַמּוּד א׳):[351,352] —

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[348] **Ramban on Genesis 49:10:1**: "This was the punishment of the Hasmoneans who reigned during the Second Temple. They were supremely pious, and without them the Torah and the commandments would have been forgotten in Israel. Nevertheless, they were severely punished: the four pious sons of the elder Hasmonean who reigned one after another, despite all their strength and success, fell by the sword into the hands of their enemies. The punishment ultimately reached the point described by our Sages: "Anyone who says, 'I descend from the house of the Hasmoneans,' is a slave," for they were all cut off because of this sin. Although the descendants of Shimon suffered punishment because of the Sadducees, all the descendants of the righteous Matityahu the Hasmonean perished only because they reigned without belonging to the tribe of Judah or the house of David, completely removing the scepter and the ruler's staff. Their punishment was measure for measure: the Holy One, blessed be He, gave their slaves power over them, and they destroyed them."

[349] **Kiddushin 70b:7**: "Rav Mattana had not visited Nehardea for thirteen years. He arrived that very day. Rav Yehudah asked him, 'Does the master remember what Shmuel said when he stood with one foot on the riverbank and one foot on the ferry?' He replied, 'This is what Shmuel said: "Anyone who says, 'I descend from the royal Hasmonean house,' is a slave, because none of them remained except that young woman who went up to the roof and cried out, 'Anyone who says, "I am from the Hasmonean house," is a slave.'"""

[350] **Kiddushin 66a**: 'Now there was a certain elder present called Yehuda ben Gedidya, and Yehuda ben Gedidya said to King Yannai: King Yannai, the crown of the monarchy suffices for you, i.e., you should be satisfied that you are king. Leave the crown of the priesthood for the descendants of Aaron. The Gemara explains this last comment: As they would say that Yannai's mother was taken captive in Modi'in, and she was therefore disqualified from marrying into the priesthood, which meant that Yannai was a ḥalal. And the matter was investigated and was not discovered, i.e., they sought witnesses for that event but none were found. And the Sages of Israel were expelled in the king's rage, due to this rumor.'

[351] **Zohar, Beshalach 12:152-153**: "Thus the Holy One, blessed be He, because of His great affection and love for the Congregation of Israel, entrusted everything to her authority. … The King said: From now on, My warfare is entrusted to your hands; My weapons and those who wage war are in your hands. From now on, you shall be My guardian, as it is written: "The Guardian of Israel." From now on, whoever needs Me cannot speak with Me until he has informed the Queen, as it is written: "With this shall Aharon enter the sanctuary." She is the King's emissary in everything, as we have explained. It follows that everything is in her hands, and this is the Queen's honor."

[352] **Mei HaShiloach, Volume I, Genesis, Lech Lecha 6**: "It is written, 'Through me kings reign.' In the plain order it should have said, 'Through me they reign—the kings.' But it alludes to this: the Holy One appoints as king only

what is written in the Holy Zohar (Part II, 51a): אָמַר מַלְכָּא: מִכָּאן וּלְהָלְאָה קְרָבָא דִּילִי אִתְמְסַר בִּידָךְ, — **"The King said: From here on My battle is delivered into your hand,** זַיְנִין דִּילִי מָארֵי מְגִיחֵי קְרָבָא בִּידָךְ, עַיֵּן שָׁם"; — **My weapons and the masters waging war are in your hand, see there";** דְּכָל נִצּוּחַ בָּא עַל יְדֵי מִדַּת מַלְכוּת, "דְּיָנָא דְּמַלְכוּתָא". — **for every victory comes through the attribute of Malchut (Kingship), 'the law of the kingdom'.** וְאַף מֹשֶׁה רַבֵּנוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם הָיָה נִקְרָא מֶלֶךְ, — **And even Moses our Teacher, peace be upon him, was called a king,** "וַיְהִי בִישֻׁרוּן מֶלֶךְ" (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב שָׁמוֹת רַבָּה סוֹף פָּרָשָׁה ב'); — **and as Scripture states: "And he was king in Jeshurun" (as in Shemot Rabbah, end of Parashah 2);** וְהַיְנוּ שֶׁהוּא הָיָה הַמְנַצֵּחַ לְפַרְעֹה וְהוֹצִיא אֶת בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל מִמִּצְרַיִם, — **which means that he was the victor over Pharaoh and brought the children of Israel out of Egypt,** וְהַנִּצּוּחַ מִמִּדַּת מַלְכוּת. — **and victory stems from the attribute of Malchut.**

And his kingship was by virtue of the Torah, וּמַלְכוּתוֹ הָיָה עַל יְדֵי תּוֹרָה, כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב (גִּטִּין ס"ב עַמּוּד א'): "דְּרַבָּנַן — **as written (Gittin 62a): "Rabbis are called kings, as it is written: 'By me kings reign'."** וְכֵן עִנְיַן הַיְוָנִים שֶׁהָיָה שֶׁגָּזְרוּ עַל בִּטּוּל הַתּוֹרָה וְהַמִּצְוֹות "לְהַשְׁכִּיחָם תּוֹרָתֶךָ", — **And so too the affair of the Greeks was that they decreed the cessation of Torah and mitzvot "to make them forget Your Torah",** וְאַף שֶׁנִּמְצְאוּ שֶׁהָרְגוּ נְפָשׁוֹת, הָיָה גַּם כֵּן עַל קִיּוּם הַתּוֹרָה, — **and even when it was found that they killed souls, it was likewise over the observance of the Torah,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב (וַיִּקְרָא רַבָּה פָּרָשָׁה ל"ב): "מַה לְּךָ יוֹצֵא לִסָּקֵל? עַל שֶׁמַּלְתִּי אֶת בְּנִי וְכוּלֵיהּ", — **as written (Vayikra Rabbah, Parashah 32): "Why do you go out to be stoned? Because I circumcised my son, etc.",** וְעִקַּר גְּזֵרוֹת הָיָה בִּזְמַן יְוָנִים. — **and the primary decrees occurred during the era of the Greeks.**

And we have already stated that they were in the unholy husk (kelipah) one parallel to the other directly against the sanctity of the Oral Torah, וּכְבָר אָמַרְנוּ שֶׁהֵם הָיוּ בַּקְּלִפָּה זֶה לְעֻמַּת זֶה כְּנֶגֶד קְדֻשַּׁת תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה, — **whose primary expansion was through Shimon the Righteous who was among the remnants of the Great Assembly,** שֶׁהָיָה עִקַּר הִתְפַּשְׁטוּתָהּ עַל יְדֵי שִׁמְעוֹן הַצַּדִּיק שֶׁהָיָה מִשְּׁיָרֵי אַנְשֵׁי כְּנֶסֶת הַגְּדוֹלָה, — **and from him began the chain of the Mishnah.** וּמִמֶּנּוּ הִתְחִילָה שַׁלְשֶׁלֶת הַמִּשְׁנָה. וּבְיָמָיו הָיָה — **And in his days Alexander of Macedon lived (as written in Yoma 69a),** אֲלֶכְסַנְדְּרוֹס מוֹקְדוֹן (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב יוֹמָא ס"ט עַמּוּד א'), — **and then began**

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someone who can first rule over himself; that person He appoints over others as well. This is like 'Who is mighty? One who conquers his inclination.' This is 'Through me kings reign': someone who rules over himself, whose intellect governs his desire—then 'they reign,' meaning that he will be king over all. He need not attend to one who opposes him, since his entire intention is for the sake of Heaven."

Mei HaShiloach explains the moral condition within the very verse that Peri Tzadik uses for Torah-based kingship. Authority over others is preceded by rule over one's own desire. That condition sharpens the difference between the Hasmoneans' service to Torah and a ruler's self-directed possession of power. The qualification that the entire intention be for Heaven remains part of the quotation; it is not a general dismissal of opposition to a ruler.

[353] **Zevachim 102a**: 'With regard to the respect accorded to a king, Rabbi Yannai says: Fear of the kingship should always be upon you, even when the king does not deserve respect, as it is written that Moses said to Pharaoh: "And all these your servants shall come down unto me and bow down unto me, saying: Get you out, and all the people that follow you, and after that I will go out" (Exodus 11:8). He mentioned Pharaoh's servants, but he did not say this of Pharaoh himself, even though this was the eventual outcome. Rather, he spoke to Pharaoh with the respect due to a king.'

[354] **Shemot Rabbah 2:6** (excerpt): "The Holy One, blessed be He, said to him: Kingship is already prepared for David. Nevertheless, Moshe merited both: priesthood, for he served during the seven days of inauguration; and kingship, as it is written, 'He was king in Jeshurun' (Deuteronomy 33:5)."

[355] **Gittin 62a**: '§ With regard to the matter of doubling one's greeting, the Gemara relates that Rav Huna and Rav Ḥisda were once sitting when the Sage Geneiva passed by alongside them. One of them said to the other: We should stand before him, in his honor, for he is a son of Torah. The other one said to him: But should we stand before an argumentative person? In the meantime, Geneiva approached them and said to them: Peace be upon you, kings, peace be upon you, kings. They said to him: From where do you know that the Sages are called kings? He said to them: As it is written with regard to the Torah in the book of Proverbs: "Through me kings rule" (Proverbs 8:15).'

[356] **Vayikra Rabbah 32:1** (excerpt): "Why are you being led out to be stoned? Because I circumcised my son. Why are you being led out to be burned? Because I observed Shabbos. Why are you being led out to be killed? Because I ate matzah. Why are you being lashed with a whip? Because I made a sukkah; because I took a lulav; because I put on tefillin; because I attached tekhelet; because I did the will of my Father in heaven. This is what is written: 'He will say to him: What are these wounds?' (Zechariah 13:6). These wounds caused me to be beloved to my Father in heaven."

[357] **Yoma 69a**: 'Immediately, they stabbed the Samaritans in their heels and hung them from their horses' tails and continued to drag them over the thorns and thistles until they reached Mount Gerizim. When they arrived at Mount Gerizim, where the Samaritans had their temple, they plowed it over and seeded the area with leeks, a symbol of total destruction. This was just as they had sought to do to the House of our Lord. And they made that day a festival to celebrate the salvation of the Temple and the defeat of the Samaritans.'

[358] **Machshavot Charutz 17:12**: "At the beginning of Greek rule prophecy departed, as written in Seder Olam. This was when the wisdom of Oral Torah was established; and, corresponding to it, Greek wisdom and philosophy then began, denying astrology, sorcery, and similar forms of knowledge beyond human reason. Among the children of Israel alone, their wisdom is an attainment of the holy spirit, and they can also discern future events through wisdom and the holy

Greek philosophy via Aristotle who was in the kelipah against the holiness of the Oral Torah, שֶׁגַּם הֵם חִדְּשׁוּ בְּגַוֶּן חָכְמָה וּמוּסָר מִלִּבָּם בְּהַנְהָגַת דֶּרֶךְ אֶרֶץ, **— for they too innovated in a semblance of wisdom and ethics from their own minds in civil conduct,** וְעַל כֵּן רָצוּ הֵם לְבַטֵּל תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה מִיִּשְׂרָאֵל. **— and therefore they sought to abolish the Oral Torah from Israel.** שֶׁבְּמַתַּן תּוֹרָה פָּסְקָה זוּהֲמָא מִיִּשְׂרָאֵל כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב (שַׁבָּת קמ״ר עַמּוּד א׳),[359] **— For at the giving of the Torah the primordial spiritual contamination (zuhama) ceased from Israel as written (Shabbat 146a),** וְנָזְרוּ הֵם הַגְּזֵרָה שֶׁנִּזְקְרָה רֵישׁ כְּתֻבּוֹת: "תִּבָּעֵל לַמַּפָּץ תְּחִלָּה", **— and they decreed the decree mentioned at the beginning of Ketubot: "She shall be intimacy-subjected to the commander first",** שָׁרְצוּ לְהַטִּיל זוּהֲמָא שֶׁלָּהֶם בְּכָל בְּנוֹת יִשְׂרָאֵל, **— seeking to cast their spiritual defilement into all daughters of Israel,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב (יְבָמוֹת ק״ג עַמּוּד ב׳):[360] "דְּקָא שָׁדֵי בָּהּ זוּהֲמָא וְכוֹלֵיהּ", **— as written (Yevamot 103b): "that he casts into her defilement, etc.",** וְיִהְיוּ חַס וְשָׁלוֹם עַל יְדֵי כֵן כָּל זַלְדוֹת יִשְׂרָאֵל מֵאוֹתָן הַזּוּהֲמָא, **— so that Heaven forbid all offspring of Israel would be produced through that contamination,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁנִּתְהַוָּה בְּזֶרַע חַוָּה עַל יְדֵי הַזּוּהֲמָא שֶׁהֵטִיל בָּהּ נָחָשׁ. **— just as transpired in the seed of Eve through the contamination the serpent cast into her.** רַק שֶׁהָיָה אָז הַחַשְׁמוֹנָאִים מִזֶּרַע אַהֲרֹן שֶׁהָיוּ שֹׁרֶשׁ תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה שֶׁהוּא מִדַּת מַלְכוּת, "פֶּה **— Except that there were then the Hasmoneans from the seed of Aaron who were the root of the Oral Torah, –** תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה קְרֵינָן לַהּ", **— which is the attribute of Malchut, 'The mouth — we call it the Oral Torah',** וְעַל יְדֵי כֹּחַ בְּחִינַת מִדַּת מַלְכוּת נִצְּחוּם. **— and through the power of this aspect of the attribute of Malchut they vanquished them.** וְעִקַּר הִתְעוֹרְרוּת הַחַשְׁמוֹנָאִים הָיָה עַל יְדֵי גְּזֵרָה זוֹ, **— And the primary awakening of the Hasmoneans was through this decree,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב (קִדּוּשִׁין ס״ו עַמּוּד א׳) שָׁהָיוּ אוֹמְרִים: "אִמּוֹ נִשְׁבֵּית בַּמּוֹדִיעִים",[361] **— as written (Kiddushin 66a) that they said: "His mother was captured in Modi'in",** וּבֶאֱמֶת הַחַשְׁמוֹנָאִים הִתְקַנְּאוּ עַל זֶה וּמָרְדוּ בַּיְוָנִים וְהִצִּילוּ בְּנוֹתֵיהֶם, **— and in truth the Hasmoneans became zealously impassioned over this and rebelled against the Greeks and rescued their daughters,** וְהֵם אָמְרוּ שֶׁנִּתְחַלְּלָה בֶּאֱמֶת. **— while they alleged that she had truly been defiled.** וְהִנֵּה מַה שֶּׁנֶּאֱמַר: "לֹא יָסוּר שֵׁבֶט מִיהוּדָה וּמְחֹקֵק מִבֵּין רַגְלָיו **— And behold that which is stated: "The scepter shall not depart from Judah, nor a lawgiver from between his feet"** הוּא גַּם כֵּן עַל דִּבְרֵי תוֹרָה, **— refers also to words of Torah,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב (סַנְהֶדְרִין ה׳ עַמּוּד א׳):[362] **— and as written (Sanhedrin 5a):** "דְּהָכָא 'שֵׁבֶט' וְהָתָם 'מְחֹקֵק' וְכוֹלֵיהּ, וּ'מְחֹקֵק מִבֵּין רַגְלָיו' **— "For here is 'scepter' and there is 'lawgiver', etc., –** אֵלּוּ בְּנֵי בָנָיו שֶׁל הִלֵּל שֶׁמְּלַמְּדִין תּוֹרָה בָּרַבִּים". **— and 'a lawgiver from between his feet' — these are the descendants of Hillel who teach Torah publicly".** וְהִלֵּל בָּא גַּם כֵּן מִנְּקֵבוֹת מִיהוּדָה כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתְבוּ תּוֹסָפוֹת מִירוּשַׁלְמִי, **— And Hillel also descended from females of Judah as Tosafot wrote from the Yerushalmi,** וְהוּא מַה שֶּׁאָמַר רַבִּי עַל רַב הוּנָא (פֶּרֶק ט׳ הֲלָכָה ג׳):[363] **— and that is what Rebbe said concerning Rav Huna (Chapter 9 of Kilayim, Halachah 3):** "דְּהוּא מִן יְהוּדָה וַאֲנָא מִבִּנְיָמִין, דְּהוּא מִן דִּכְרָיָא וַאֲנָא מִן נוּקְבָתָא". **— "That he is from Judah and I am from Benjamin; he from the male line and I from the female line".** וּמִנְּקֵבוֹת כָּל שַׁלְשֶׁלֶת הַכֹּהֲנִים בָּא מִשֵּׁבֶט יְהוּדָה, **— And matrilineally the entire dynasty of priests comes from the tribe of Judah,** שֶׁהֲרֵי אֵשֶׁת אַהֲרֹן הָיְתָה אֱלִישֶׁבַע בַּת עַמִּינָדָב אֲחוֹת נַחְשׁוֹן. **— for behold Aaron's**

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spirit. As stated in the chapter HaDar: “From here we see that Rabban Gamliel discerned it through the holy spirit.” The holy spirit of the sages of Israel is mentioned in many other places as well. Their entire wisdom is to apprehend that there is wisdom beyond human reason, and that all their attainment does not come from human intellectual apprehension at all.”

[359] **Shabbat 146a:1**: “When the serpent came upon Chavah, it cast pollution into her. The pollution of Israel, who stood at Mount Sinai, ceased; the pollution of the nations, who did not stand at Mount Sinai, did not cease. Rav Acha son of Rava asked Rav Ashi, ‘What of converts?’ He answered, ‘Although they themselves were not there, their mazal, their spiritual root, was there, as it is written, “With those who are here with us, standing today before the Lord our God, and with those who are not here,” and so forth.’”

[360] **Yevamot 103b**: ‘The Gemara answers: He implants filth in her and contaminates her, as her body accepts his semen. As Rabbi Yoḥanan also said, based on his understanding that the serpent seduced Eve into having sexual relations with him: When the serpent came upon Eve, he infected her with moral contamination, and this contamination remained in all human beings. When the Jewish people stood at Mount Sinai their contamination ceased, whereas with regard to gentiles, who did not stand at Mount Sinai, their contamination never ceased. Therefore, Yael was repulsed by the contamination that she allowed into her body, and she did not benefit from relations with Sisera.’

[361] **Kiddushin 66a**: “An elder named Yehudah ben Gedidyah was there. He said to King Yannai: ‘King Yannai, the crown of kingship is enough for you; leave the crown of priesthood to Aharon’s descendants.’ For people were saying that his mother had been taken captive in Modi’in. The matter was investigated and was not substantiated. The Sages of Israel withdrew in anger.”

[362] **Sanhedrin 5a:6**: “As it was taught: ‘The scepter shall not depart from Yehudah’ refers to the Exilarchs in Babylonia, who rule over Israel with a scepter. ‘Nor the lawgiver from between his feet’ refers to Hillel’s descendants, who teach Torah publicly.”

[363] **Jerusalem Talmud Kilayim 9:3**: ‘Rabbi Yehudah HaNasi (Rebbe), in his humility, declared regarding the Exilarch Rav Huna: ‘Were Rav Huna to come up here to the Land of Israel, I would step down and seat him above me, for he descends from the tribe of Judah whereas I descend from Benjamin—he from the male line of Davidic royalty, and I from the female line.’’

wife was Elisheba daughter of Amminadab, sister of Nachshon.

Torah authority must not become a claim to unchecked rule

וְהָיוּ אָז הַחַשְׁמוֹנָאִים שֹׁרֶשׁ תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה, "מְחֹקֵק מִבֵּין רַגְלָיו"[364] — **And the Hasmoneans then were the root of the Oral Torah, "a lawgiver from between his feet",** וְלָכֵן הֻזְכַּר בַּגְּמָרָא: "וּכְשֶׁגָּבְרָה בֵּית מַלְכוּת חַשְׁמוֹנָאִים וְנִצְּחוּם", — **and therefore it was mentioned in the Gemara: "And when the royal house of Hasmoneus grew strong and defeated them",** שֶׁהַנִּצּוּחַ הָיָה מִמִּדַּת מַלְכוּת, — **for the victory was from the attribute of Malchut,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ דְּבִידָהָא אִתְמְסַר כָּל זַיְנֵי קְרָבָא. — **and as written in the Holy Zohar that in its hand were delivered all weapons of war.** פֶּה, וְהַנִּצּוּחַ שֶׁלָּהֶם בָּא עַל יְדֵי שֶׁהָיָה בָּהֶם בְּחִינַת מִדַּת מַלְכוּת, וְהֵינוּ שֹׁרֶשׁ מַלְכוּת, — **And their victory came because there was within them the aspect of the attribute of Malchut, –** תּוֹרָה רַק בְּיַנַּאי שֶׁנִּזְרְקָה בּוֹ וְכוּלֵּיהּ וּבְטֵל כָּל תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בְּקִדּוּשִׁין שָׁם, — **meaning that they were the root of Kingship, "The mouth is the Oral Torah". Only in Yannai into whom there entered heresy, etc., and he abolished all Oral Torah as written in Kiddushin there,** וְהוּא לָקַח הַמַּלְכוּת רַק עַל עִנְיַן שֵׁבֶט מֻמְשָׁלָה, — **and he took royalty solely for the matter of sovereign autocratic dominion,** לְכָךְ נֶעֱנַשׁ וְכָלָתָה זַרְעוֹ שֶׁל יַנַּאי מִלִּכְבֹּא שֶׁהִתְחִילָה מַלְכוּת הוֹרְדוֹס. — **for this he was punished and the seed of King Yannai was extinguished when Herod's reign began.** וְאָז הִתְחִיל שַׁלְשֶׁלֶת הִלֵּל וּבָנָיו שֶׁהִתְחִילָה מֵאָה שָׁנָה בִּכְפִי הַבַּיִת כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב (שַׁבָּת ט״ו עַמּוּד א׳),[365] — **And then began the chain of Hillel and his sons which started one hundred years before the destruction of the Temple as written (Shabbat 15a),** וְסָמוּךְ לְאוֹתוֹ זְמַן כָּלָה זֶרַע חַשְׁמוֹנָאִים[366] — **and adjacent to that time the seed of the Hasmoneans ceased** (עַיֵּן תּוֹסָפוֹת כְּתֻבּוֹת ז׳ עַמּוּד ב׳ דִּבּוּר הַמַּתְחִיל 'הוֹרִיקָהּ')[367] — **(see Tosafot Ketubot 7b, heading beginning 'They ruled it').** וְדִבְרֵי הָרַמְבַּ"ן זִכְרוֹנוֹ לִבְרָכָה בְּוַדַּאי גַּם כֵּן אֱמֶת, — **And the words of the Ramban of blessed memory are certainly true as well,** שֶׁבְּצֵרוּף מַה שֶׁנִּתְחַבֵּר יַנַּאי לַצְּדוֹקִים וְכָפַר בְּתוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה, — **that in conjunction with Yannai joining the Sadducees and denying the Oral Torah,** וְשׁוּב לֹא הָיָה מַלְכוּת מִכֹּחַ הַתּוֹרָה דִּכְתִיב: "בִּי מְלָכִים יִמְלֹכוּ". — **his kingship was no longer derived through the Torah concerning which it is written: "By me kings reign",** כְּמוֹ שֶׁהָיָה בְּשָׁעַת הַנֵּס שֶׁהָיוּ הַחַשְׁמוֹנָאִים שֹׁרֶשׁ תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה בְּחִינַת מַלְכוּת — **as was during the miracle when the Hasmoneans were the root of the Oral Torah, the aspect of Malchut,** וְהָיוּ אַף מְחֹקֵק שֶׁהָיוּ מְגוּקְבָתָא מִיהוּדָה וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמַרְנוּ; — **and were also a lawgiver being descended through females from Judah as we explained;** וְכֵיוָן שֶׁהוּא יַנַּאי כָּפַר בְּתוֹרָה הֲרֵי עָבַר עַל מַה שֶּׁנֶּאֱמַר "לֹא יָסוּר שֵׁבֶט מִיהוּדָה וּמְחֹקֵק מִבֵּין רַגְלָיו", — **behold he violated that which was stated "The scepter shall not depart from Judah, nor a lawgiver from between his feet",** וְנִגְזַר עַל זַרְעוֹ שֶׁיִּכְלֶה, וּכְמוֹ שֶׁכָּתַב הָרַמְבַּ"ן. — **and it was decreed upon his descendants to be extinguished, just as the Ramban wrote.**

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[364] **Takanat HaShavin 5:16**: "Aaron's attribute of hod, splendor, is the splendor of the feminine—the attribute of modest shame, as explained. It says, 'They shall teach Your judgments to Jacob.' This too is royal splendor, as they said, 'Who are the kings? The rabbis,' and, 'The wise shall inherit honor.' But it is kingship without a 'scepter of rulers,' for dominion belongs to the man, as it says, 'He shall rule.' Of Judah too it says, 'A lawgiver from between his feet,' which the Sages expounded concerning the leaders of the Land of Israel, who descend from the female side of David's house. They have no scepter with which to subdue by the staff; they are kings among the rabbis. Scripture explains that this belongs principally to the priests. The Hasmoneans, who repaired the attribute of hod, merited kingship; but because they took it with a 'scepter of rulers,' they were punished."

Takanat supplies an explicit distinction between two forms of authority: the honor belonging to teachers and the scepter that coerces subjects. This clarifies what Peri Tzadik means by kingship through Torah and by Yannai reducing kingship to dominion. The accounts are not made identical: Takanat stresses the priests' improper assumption of coercive rule, while Peri Tzadik here makes Yannai's rejection of Oral Torah decisive.

[365] **Shabbat 15a:10**: "If you say that these same Sages were also alive eighty years before the Temple's destruction, was it not taught that Hillel, Shimon, Gamliel, and Shimon held the presidency during the hundred years before the Temple's destruction? Yosei ben Yoezer of Tzeredah and Yosei ben Yochanan lived much earlier!"

[366] **Resisei Layla 57:3**: "It is clear to me that their statement, "None remained of them," does not mean that none of them remained at all. Heaven forbid that the descendants of one who brought this great deliverance to Israel should vanish from the world! Although Ramban, in Parashat Vayechi, gave the reason that they took the kingship, this does not sufficiently answer the question: why should this punishment reach the righteous Hasmonean who did not take the kingship, leaving none of his descendants? Rather, it is clear to me that the intention is that none of his descendants remained publicly known or identified as his descendants. "He killed all his masters" means all those whom he found; they were punished for their sin. The others concealed themselves, kept themselves hidden, and did not publicize their lineage."

[367] **Tosafot on Ketubot 7a:9:1**: "'Beis Hillel instructed her': This concerns Queen Helene. Although she belonged to the Hasmonean house—since she was King Munbaz's mother, as stated in Yoma 37a—and Herod's reign began one hundred and three years before the Temple's destruction, whereas Hillel did not assume the presidency until three years after the beginning of Herod's reign, as we say in Shabbos 15a, 'Hillel, Shimon, Gamliel, and Shimon held the presidency during the hundred years before the Temple's destruction'—nevertheless, Hillel already had students at that earlier time who issued rulings."

וְהִנֵּה חֲנֻכָּה חָל תָּמִיד סָמוּךְ לְפָרָשַׁת וַיֵּשֶׁב שֶׁמְּדַבֶּרֶת מִתִּקּוּן פֶּגֶם הַבְּרִית, — **And behold Chanukah always falls near Parashat Vayeshev which speaks of the rectification of the Covenant (tikun pegam habrit),** וְהַיְנוּ שֶׁיִּבָּרֵר וְאוֹר תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה הוּא מִטַּלָּא דְּעַתִּיקָא, — **which means the clarification that "Your people are all righteous".** וְעַמֵּךְ כֻּלָּם צַדִּיקִים". — **And the light of the Oral Torah is from the dew of the Ancient Holy One (tala de-atika),** וְזֶה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: "תִּזַּל כַּטַּל אִמְרָתִי" דְּקָאֵי עַל תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה. — **and this is what Scripture states: "My speech shall distill as dew", which refers to the Oral Torah.** וְהוּא אוֹר הָרִאשׁוֹן שֶׁנִּגְנַז לַצַּדִּיקִים כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב (חֲגִיגָה י"ב ע"ב[368]): — **And it is the Primordial Light concealed for the righteous, as written (Chagigah 12a):** שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: "וַיַּרְא אֱלֹהִים אֶת הָאוֹר כִּי טוֹב", וְאֵין "טוֹב" אֶלָּא — **as it is said: "And God saw the light that it was good",** צַדִּיק, שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: "אִמְרוּ צַדִּיק כִּי טוֹב". — **and "good" means nothing other than the righteous, as it is said: "Say of the righteous that he is good".** וְאוֹר הָרִאשׁוֹן נִגְנַז לְעַמְלֵי תוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה, — **And the Primordial Light was stored away for those who labor in the Oral Torah,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בַּמִּדְרָשׁ תַּנְחוּמָא (נֹחַ ג') עַל הַפָּסוּק[369]: "הָעָם הַהֹלְכִים בַּחֹשֶׁךְ רָאוּ אוֹר גָּדוֹל" — — **as written in Midrash Tanchuma (Noach 3) on the verse: "The people walking in darkness have seen a great light" —** אוֹר שֶׁנִּבְרָא בְּיוֹם רִאשׁוֹן וְכוּלֵיהּ. — **the light created on the first day, etc.** וְזֶה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר (זְכַרְיָה ט', י"ג)[370]: "וְעוֹרַרְתִּי בָנַיִךְ צִיּוֹן עַל בָּנַיִךְ יָוָן", — **And this is what is stated (Zechariah 9:13): "And I will awaken your sons, O Zion, against your sons, O Greece",** וְהוּא עַל פִּי מַה שֶׁכָּתוּב בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ (חֵלֶק א' קפ"ו עַמּוּד א')[371]: — **and it is according to what is written in the Holy Zohar (Part I, 186a):** "דְּצִיּוֹן אִיהוּ שְׁכְלוּלָא וְשַׁפִּירוּ דְּעָלְמָא וְכוּלֵיהּ", — **"That Zion is the perfection and beauty of the world, etc.",** וְהַיְנוּ מִדַּת צַדִּיק יְסוֹד עוֹלָם, — **meaning the attribute of the Righteous, the Foundation of the World (Tzaddik Yesod Olam),** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בְּסִפְרֵי הַקֹּדֶשׁ: צִיּוֹ"ן בְּגִימַטְרִיָּא יוֹס"ף. — **and as written in holy books: Tziyon (156) is numerically equivalent to Yosef (156).** וּקְלִפַּת יָוָן שֶׁהָיָה לְהַכְנִיס זוּהֲמָא בִּבְנוֹת יִשְׂרָאֵל, — **And the unholy husk of Greece, whose intent was to inject defilement into the daughters of Israel,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמַרְנוּ שֶׁגָּזְרוּ "תִּבָּעֵל לַסַּפְסָר תִּחְלָה", — **as we mentioned that they decreed "she shall be intimacy-subjected to the commander first",** הָיָה נֶגֶד וְהֶפֶךְ מִמִּדַּת צַדִּיק; — **was opposite and contrary to the attribute of the Righteous;** וְעַל כֵּן הַחַשְׁמוֹנָאִים שֶׁהָיוּ שֹׁרֶשׁ תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה אָז, — **and therefore the Hasmoneans who were the root of the Oral Torah then,** וְהַיְנוּ שֶׁהָיוּ מְבֹרָרִין בְּמִדַּת צַדִּיק וְזָכוּ לְאוֹר הָרִאשׁוֹן שֶׁנִּגְנַז לְעַמְלֵי תוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה, — **meaning that they were refined in the attribute of the Righteous and merited the Primordial Light concealed for those who toil in the Oral Torah,** עַל כֵּן הָיוּ הֵם הַמְנַצְּחִים לִקְלִפַּת יָוָן. — **therefore were they the conquerors over the unholy husk of Greece.** וּבְבְרֵאשִׁית רַבָּה (פָּרָשָׁה צ"ט)[372]: — **And in Bereishit Rabbah (Parashah 99):** "לֵוִי כְּנֶגֶד מַלְכוּת יָוָן, זֶה שֵׁבֶט שְׁלִישִׁי וְזוֹ מַלְכוּת שְׁלִישִׁית וְכוּלֵיהּ", — **"Levi corresponds to the kingdom of Greece; this is the third tribe and this is the third kingdom, etc.",** וּ"בָנַיִךְ צִיּוֹן" הוּא הַהֶפֶךְ מִקְלִפַּת יָוָן. — **and "your sons, O Zion" is the exact antithesis of the husk of Greece.** וְשַׁבָּת מַעֲיַן עוֹלָם הַבָּא, — **And Shabbat is a semblance of the World to Come,** שֶׁבְּעוֹלָם הַבָּא יִתְבָּרֵר "וְעַמֵּךְ כֻּלָּם צַדִּיקִים", — **for in the World to Come it will be made clear that "Your people are all righteous",** שֶׁכָּל יִשְׂרָאֵל יֵשׁ לָהֶם חֵלֶק לָעוֹלָם הַבָּא; — **in that all Israel have a share in the World to Come;** וְשַׁבָּת מַעֲיַן זֶה שֶׁיְּכוֹלִים גַּם כֵּן לְתַקֵּן פֶּגֶם זֶה. — **and Shabbat is a reflection of this, wherein one can likewise rectify this blemish.**

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[368] **Chagigah 12a:10**: “For whom did He hide the light away? For the righteous in the future to come, as it says, ‘God saw that the light was good.’ ‘Good’ means a righteous person, as it says, ‘Say of the righteous that it is good.’”

[369] **Midrash Tanchuma, Noach 3:3**: “Our sages, of blessed memory, stated that the Holy One, blessed be He, did not write in the Torah “For the sake of these words,” or “because of these,” or “on account of these words,” but simply according to the tenor of (al pi) these words. This statement clearly alludes to the Oral Law (torah she be-’al peh), which is difficult to learn and in the learning of which there is considerable anguish, comparable to darkness itself, as it is said: The people that walk in darkness have seen a great light (Isa. 9:1). The people referred to in this verse are the masters of the Talmud, who beheld a great light when the Holy One, blessed be He, enlightened them as to what is prohibited and permitted, pure and impure. It is said of them that They that love Him shall be as the sun when it goeth forth in its might (Judg. 5:31).”

[370] **Zechariah 9:13**: ‘For I have drawn Judah taut,And applied My hand to Ephraim as to a bow,And I will arouse your sons, O Zion,Against your sons, O Javan,And make you like a warrior’s sword.’

[371] **Zohar, Vayeshev 13:143-15:153**: ‘Further, when the world was created, it was started from that spot which is the culmination and perfection of the world, the central point of the universe, which is identical with Zion, as it is written: “A psalm of Asaph. God, God the Lord hath spoken and called the earth from the rising of the sun unto the going down thereof. Out of Zion, the perfection of beauty, God hath shined forth” (Ps. 50, 2). That is to say, God started the earth from Zion, from the spot where faith culminates in its full perfection. Zion is thus the citadel and central point of the universe, from which it began to be fashioned and from which the whole world is nourished.’

[372] **Bereshit Rabbah 99:2** (excerpt): “Levi corresponds to the Greek kingdom: this is the third tribe, and that is the third kingdom. The letters of this one’s name number three, and the letters of that one’s name number three.”

Judah's descent becomes the beginning of messianic repair

וּבְפָרָשַׁת וַיֵּשֶׁב נִמְצָא אֵיךְ שֶׁנִּתְבָּרֵר יוֹסֵף בְּמִדָּתוֹ "צַדִּיק יְסוֹד עוֹלָם" עַל יְדֵי הַנִּסָּיוֹן[373] — **And in Parashat Vayeshev is found how Joseph was refined in his attribute of 'Righteous, Foundation of the World' through the trial;**

וְאַף שֶׁאֲחָיו הוֹרִידוּהוּ מִגְּדֻלָּתוֹ בְּשִׁבְיל וְהַמְּכִירָה הָיָה עַל יְדֵי יְהוּדָה, — **and the sale was brought about through Judah,**

הוּא מִפְּנֵי שֶׁלֹּא יָדְעוּ זֶה, — **and even though his brothers demoted him from his greatness because of this,**

עִמָּק הַמְּכֻוָּן מֵהַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ בָּזֶה, — **it was because they did not perceive the depth of intention from the Blessed Name in this,**

שֶׁבֶּאֱמֶת נִתְגַּלְגֵּל עַל יְדֵי יְהוּדָה שֶׁיִּבְרֵר יוֹסֵף בְּמִצְרַיִם. — **that in truth it was orchestrated through Judah so that Joseph would be refined in Egypt.**

וְכֵן יְהוּדָה נִתְבָּרֵר אָז, — **And so too was Judah refined then,**

וּכְמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בְּבְרֵאשִׁית רַבָּה: "וְהַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא הָיָה עוֹסֵק בּוֹרֵא אוֹרוֹ שֶׁל מֶלֶךְ הַמָּשִׁיחַ". — **and as written in Bereishit Rabbah: "And the Holy One, Blessed be He, was engaged in creating the light of the King Messiah".**

וּבַזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ וַיֵּשֶׁב (קפ״ח עַמּוּד ב׳):[374] — **And in the Holy Zohar, Vayeshev (188b):**

"תְּרֵין נָשִׁין הֲווֹ וְאָתוּ מִנַּיְהוּ דְּמִנַּיְהוּ אִתְבְּנֵי זַרְעָא דִּיהוּדָה, — **"Two women there were from whom was built the seed of Judah,**

דָּוִד מִלְּכָּא וּשְׁלֹמֹה מִלְּכָּא וּמִלְּכָּא מְשִׁיחָא: תָּמָר וְרוּת וְכוּלַּיהּ". — **and from them came King David, King Solomon, and the King Messiah: Tamar and Ruth, etc."**

וְאַף שֶׁמֵּהֶם יָצְאוּ רַק דָּוִד וּשְׁלֹמֹה וּמָשִׁיחַ, — **And even though from them came only David, Solomon, and Messiah,**

וְהָיוּ בְּנֵי שְׁלָה שֶׁלֹּא הָיוּ מִתָּמָר, — **and there were the descendants of Shelah who were not from Tamar,**

מִכָּל מָקוֹם אָמַר בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ שֶׁנִּבְנָה מֵהֶם כָּל זֶרַע יְהוּדָה. — **nevertheless the Holy Zohar stated that from them was built the entirety of Judah's seed.**

וְהוּא עַל פִּי מַה שֶּׁכָּתוּב (סוֹטָה ל״ו עַמּוּד ב׳):[375] — **And this is according to what is written (Sotah 36b):**

"יְהוּדָה שֶׁקִּדֵּשׁ שֵׁם שָׁמַיִם בְּפַרְהֶסְיָא נִקְרָא עַל שְׁמוֹ שֶׁל הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא", — **"Judah who sanctified the Name of Heaven publicly was named entirely after the Name of the Holy One, Blessed be He",**

וְהֵינוּ שֶׁיֵּשׁ בּוֹ כָּל שֵׁם הֲוָי"ה וּבָאֶמְצַע דָּ"ל"ת. — **meaning that his name contains the entire Four-Letter Name (Havayah) with a dalet in the center.**

וְהוּא עַל פִּי מַה שֶּׁכָּתוּב בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ: ה"א דָּ"ל"ת הֲוַת בְּקַדְמִיתָא, — **And this is according to what is written in the Holy Zohar: the heh was initially a dalet,**

וְהֵינוּ דָּ"ל"ת דִּילִית לַהּ מִגַּרְמַהּ כְּלוּם, — **which means the dalet which possesses nothing of its own,**

וְאַחַר כָּךְ נַעֲשֵׂית ה"א כְּשֶׁמּוֹפִיעַ יו"ד בָּהּ; — **and afterward becomes a heh when the yud shines into it;**

וְהֵינוּ סִיהֲרָא שֶׁהִיא כְּבִרְיָתוֹ שֶׁל עוֹלָם, בְּרֵישָׁא חֲשׁוֹכָא וַהֲדַר נְהוֹרָא; — **and this is the moon which resembles the creation of the world, initially darkness and then light;**

וְזֶה שֶׁרָמְזוּ (רֹאשׁ הַשָּׁנָה כ׳ עַמּוּד ב׳): — **and this is what they hinted (Rosh Hashanah 20b): "Twenty-four hours the moon is concealed",**

"עֶשְׂרִים וְאַרְבַּע שָׁעוֹת מִכַּסְיָא סִיהֲרָא",[376] וְהוּא "דָּ"ל"ת הֲוַת בְּקַדְמִיתָא". — **which is 'initially it was a dalet'.**

וּבַזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ "לְאִנּוּוּן דְּסָבְלֵי עִם סִיהֲרָא הַהוּא פְּגִימוּ וְכוּלַּיהּ"(חֵלֶק א׳ קפ״א עַמּוּד א׳):[377] — **And in the Holy Zohar (Part I, 181a):**

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[373] **Dover Tzedek, Miscellany 2:7**: "They thought that selling Joseph would raise Judah's strength to the height of tranquility and complete perfection. But when they saw Jacob's mourning, and that this act had instead prevented tranquility—as explained above, through it they caused still greater damage—they brought Judah down from his greatness. They saw that he had not yet reached the perfection of greatness, and therefore had a deficiency. The sale itself also caused a greater deficiency and brought about his descent from greatness. Then Judah too began to return and regret what he had done, as our Sages said. Then began the light of the true Messiah, whose purpose is to make peace in the world; strife and division cannot come from him. (The first division within Israel, from Joseph, arose through an evil cause because of his level; likewise, as is known, division in the world comes from the division of David's kingdom, through Jeroboam.) Judah recognized his deficiency in the fact that Joseph's sale could come from him through hatred. (As with David's sin concerning Uriah the Hittite, Judah's true sin and deficiency lay only in this: that he too hated Joseph.) God forbid that the killing of Messiah son of Joseph should come through Israel; it comes only through Gog and Magog, who are the complete opposite of Messiah son of David, as is known. Therefore, when Judah returned from his hatred, this was the creation of the Messiah's light. This is not the place to expand further; understand well."
Dover makes explicit the flaw revealed by Judah's loss of stature: the brothers' expectation that removing Joseph would secure peace proved false. This keeps the providential clarification described in Peri Tzadik from being read as a denial of the act's damage. In the full continuation, Judah's recognition of his own hatred and his repentance begin the creation of the Messiah's light; divine purpose and the necessity of moral repair remain distinct.

[374] **Zohar, Vayeshev 18:191**: "There were two women through whom the line of Judah was built, and from whom came King David, King Solomon, and the King Messiah. These two women were alike: Tamar and Ruth. Their husbands died at first, and they took the initiative in this matter."

[375] **Sotah 36b**: '§ Rav Ḥana bar Bizna says that Rabbi Shimon Ḥasida says: Joseph, who sanctified the name of Heaven in private, had one letter of the name of the Holy One, Blessed be He, the letter heh, added to his name. Whereas in the case of Judah, who sanctified the name of Heaven in public befarhesya at the Red Sea during the exodus from Egypt, merited that his entire name is called by the name of the Holy One, Blessed be He, as the entire four-letter name of God can be found within Judah's name.'

[376] **Rosh Hashanah 20b:7**: "Rabbi Zeira said in Rav Nachman's name: The moon is concealed for twenty-four hours. For us in Babylonia, six hours belong to the old moon and eighteen to the new; for them in the Land of Israel, six hours belong to the new moon and eighteen to the old."

[377] **Zohar, Vayeshev 3:34-5:44**: 'Esoterically speaking they are a counterpart of something above, the body being impaired and the soul being within after the supernal pattern, each corresponding to each, and these are the souls that require to be renewed with the renewal of the moon, and hence it is written concerning them: "And it shall come to pass,

יִתְחַדְּתוּן עִמֵּהּ, — **"For those who bear with the moon that diminishment, etc., shall be renewed with it,** דְּאִתְפְּגַם נְהוֹרָא שֶׁל אַהֲבָה זוּטָא — **and these are called afflictions of love, etc.,** וְאִלֵּין אִקְרוּן יִסּוּרִין שֶׁל אַהֲבָה וְכוּלֵּיהּ, — **in that the light of the lesser love is diminished, displaced by the great love, etc.",** דְּאִתְדַּחְיָא מֵאַהֲבָה רַבָּה וְכוּלֵּיהּ". וְהוּא סוֹד מַה שֶּׁכָּתוּב (שְׁבוּעוֹת ט׳ עמוד א׳): "יְהֵא כַּפָּרָה עַל שֶׁמִּעַטְתִּי אֶת הַיָּרֵחַ".[378] — **and it is the secret of what is written (Shevuot 9a): "Let there be atonement for Me for diminishing the moon".**

The darkness in Judah's line is followed by a clarified form

וְכֵן הָיָה כָּאן: בְּרִישָׁא עֵר וְאוֹנָן, בְּרִישָׁא חֻשְׁכָּא,[379] — **And so it was here: initially Er and Onan, initially darkness,** וְהָדַר נְהוֹרָא פֶּרֶץ וְזֶרַח שָׁהְיוּ נִשְׁמוֹתֵיהֶן (כְּמוֹ שֶׁנִּתְבָּאֵר פָּרָשַׁת וַיֵּשֶׁב).[380] — **and then light in Perez and Zerah who were their souls (as explained in Parashat Vayeshev).** וְזֶהוּ אוֹרוֹ שֶׁל מָשִׁיחַ שֶׁיְּתַקֵּן כְּלַל יִשְׂרָאֵל דְּ"עַמֵּךְ כֻּלָּם צַדִּיקִים", וְהוּא מִדַּת מַלְכוּת, "פֶּה — **And this is the light of Messiah who will rectify all Israel to "Your people are all righteous", –** תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה", — **which is the attribute of Malchut, "The mouth is the Oral Torah",** שֶׁהַתּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה הוּא הַרְבֵּה חָכְמָה לְתַקֵּן הַרְבֵּה כַּעַס. — **for the Oral Torah is abundant wisdom (rav chochmah) to rectify abundant grief (rav ka'as).** וּבַזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ (שָׁם קפ״ט עמוד א׳) דְּדָרַשׁ "גַּם כִּי אֵלֵךְ בְּגֵיא צַלְמָוֶת" עַל יוֹסֵף דְּאָזַל לְגֵיא צַלְמָוֶת,[381] — **And in the Holy Zohar (ibid. 189a) it expounded "Though I walk through the valley of the shadow of death" regarding Joseph who went into the valley of death's shadow,** וְהַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ "רַגְלַי חַסִידָו יִשְׁמֹר", וְזֶה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: "כִּי אַתָּה עִמָּדִי". — **and the Blessed Name "guards the feet of His pious ones", and this is what is stated: "For You are with me".** וּכְתִיב אַחַר כָּךְ: "דִּשַּׁנְתָּ בַשֶּׁמֶן רֹאשִׁי", — **And it is written afterward: "You have anointed my head with oil",** שֶׁמֶן מוֹרֶה עַל חָכְמָה כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב (מְנָחוֹת פ״ה עמוד ב׳):[382] — **oil indicates wisdom as written (Menachot 85b):** "מִתּוֹךְ שֶׁרְגִילִין בְּשֶׁמֶן זַיִת חָכְמָה מְצוּיָה בָּהֶן". — **"Because they are accustomed to olive oil, wisdom is common among them".** הֵינוּ אוֹר תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה שֶׁהוּא "דִּשַּׁנְתָּ בַשֶּׁמֶן רֹאשִׁי" מִטַּלָּא דְּעַתִּיקָא, — **"You anointed my head with oil" refers to the light of the Oral Torah which is from the dew of the Ancient One,** וּכְמַה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: "וְשֶׁמֶן עַל רֹאשְׁךָ אַל יָחְסָר". — **and as Scripture states: "And let oil**

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that from one new moon to another, and from one Sabbath to another, shall all flesh come to worship before me" (Is. 66, 23), the word "all" signifying that these souls will be renewed wholly with the renewal of the moon.'

[378] **Shevuot 9a**: 'The Gemara objects: But this phrase is necessary in order to expound it in accordance with the statement of Reish Lakish, as Reish Lakish says: What is different about the goat brought as a sin-offering of the New Moon that it is stated with regard to it: "To the Lord," a term not written with regard to other sin-offerings? The Holy One, Blessed be He, says, as it were: This goat shall be an atonement for the fact that I diminished the size of the moon.'

[379] **Mei HaShiloach, Volume I, Genesis, Vayeshev 7**: "Their souls were therefore repaired through the subsequent birth of Peretz and Zerah. Peretz was Er's soul, for peretz signifies forcefulness: 'glory to him from the human form,' meaning that even if it is the opposite of glory in the eyes of other people, he does not heed that. Zerah was Onan's soul, for his name indicates glory in the eyes of other people. Concerning these two, God said, 'She is righteous; from Me'—'From Me came the matters held concealed.' Although Er and Onan were not fitting in His eyes, these two, who were their souls, were upright before Him. Although Peretz appears to act against the halakhah, as we find in David's kingship, God testifies that this is because 'It is a time to act for the Lord.' Although in the deed Er's sin appeared greater than Onan's, his soul was greater in its depth than Onan's, for David's kingship was born from him. The Holy One conducts all the structures of David's kingship through such structures, although at the time of the deed it appeared to him that he had sinned. Judah thought her a prostitute because she covered her face: the matter was a secret from God. As explained in the Midrash, 'From Me came the matters held concealed' means that the building of David's kingship is a hidden secret, concealed even from prophets."

Mei HaShiloach explains the soul relationship that Peri Tzadik states briefly. The later forms clarify two different orientations—inner human form and outward human regard—that had appeared wrongly in Er and Onan. This gives content to the transition from darkness to light without making the earlier sins fitting. The text reserves the justification of the unusual Davidic course to God's testimony and a secret hidden even from prophets; it is not a practical permission to disregard halakhah.

[380] **Bereshit Rabbah 85:1** (excerpt): "'It happened at that time.' Rabbi Shmuel bar Nachman opened with: 'For I know the thoughts' (Jeremiah 29:11). The tribes were occupied with selling Joseph; Joseph was occupied with his sackcloth and fasting; Reuben was occupied with his sackcloth and fasting; Jacob was occupied with his sackcloth and fasting; Judah was occupied with taking a wife. Meanwhile, the Holy One, blessed be He, was occupied with creating the light of King Messiah: 'It happened at that time that Judah went down.' 'Before she travailed, she gave birth' (Isaiah 66:7): Before the first oppressor was born, the final redeemer was born. 'It happened at that time'—what is written just above? 'The Midianites sold him into Egypt.'"

[381] **Zohar, Vayeshev 20:205-206**: "Come and see: wherever the righteous go, the Holy One, blessed be He, guards them and does not abandon them. David said: "Even when I walk in the valley of the shadow of death, I will fear no evil, for You are with me; Your rod and Your staff…" Wherever the righteous go, the Divine Presence goes with them and does not abandon them. Yosef went into the valley of the shadow of death, and they brought him down to Egypt; the Divine Presence was with him. Thus it is written: "The Lord was with Yosef." Because the Divine Presence was with him, everything he did prospered in his hands."

[382] **Menachot 85b:13**: ""'Joab sent to Tekoa and took from there a wise woman." Why Tekoa in particular? Rabbi Yochanan said: Because they are accustomed to olive oil, wisdom is found among them."

not be lacking upon your head". דָּרַשׁ: אֵלּוּ תְּפִלִּין,[383] וּבַגְּמָרָא (שַׁבָּת קנ״ג עַמּוּד א׳) — **And in the Gemara (Shabbat 153a) it expounded: These are tefillin,** וְהַיְנוּ תְּפִלִּין שֶׁבָּרֹאשׁ כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בְּפֵרוּשׁ רַבִּי שְׁלֹמֹה יִצְחָקִי שֶׁהוּא כְּכֶתֶר עַל הָרֹאשׁ. וְכֵן דָּרְשׁוּ: "'וִיקָר' — **meaning the head-tefillin, as Rashi explains that it is like a crown upon the head. –** (מְגִלָּה ט״ז עַמּוּד ב׳), "אֵלּוּ תְּפִלִּין שֶׁבָּרֹאשׁ"[384] — **And so they expounded: "'And honor (yekar)' — these are the tefillin of the head" (Megillah 16b),** וְהַיְנוּ שֶׁיִּקָּר מוֹרֶה עַל כֶּתֶר עֶלְיוֹן כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמַרְנוּ כַּמָּה פְּעָמִים. — **which means that yekar points to the Supreme Crown (Keter Elyon) as we have stated many times.**

וְהִנֵּה בַּתִּקּוּנִים (תִּקּוּן ל״ו) אִיתָא: "'יְהִי אוֹר' דָּא פֶּסַח, 'וַיְהִי אוֹר' רֹאשׁ הַשָּׁנָה וְכוּלֵיהּ", וּבְמָקוֹם אַחֵר (תִּקּוּן ל׳) אִיתָא: "'יְהִי אוֹר' דָּא יְמִינָא, 'וַיְהִי אוֹר'[385] — – – **And behold in the Tikunei Zohar (Tikun 36) it is brought: "'Let there be light' — this is Pesach; 'and there was light' — Rosh Hashanah, etc.",** – – עַיֵּן שָׁם. **and elsewhere (Tikun 30) it is brought: "'Let there be light' — this is the right; 'and there was light' — this is the left, etc.", see there.** דְּ"וַיְהִי אוֹר" מוֹרֶה עַל אוֹר תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה,[386] וּבַזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ (חֶלֶק ב׳ קס״ז עַמּוּד א׳)[387] — **And in the Holy Zohar (Part II, 167a) that "and there was light" indicates the light of the Oral Torah,** וְהוּא כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בַּתִּקּוּנִים (תִּקּוּן כ״א): "מִימִינָא אִתְיְהִיבַת אוֹרַיְתָא דִּבְכְתָב, וּמִשְּׂמָאלָא אִתְיְהִיבַת אוֹרַיְתָא דְּבַעַל פֶּה",[388] — **which matches what is written in the Tikunim (Tikun 21): "From the right was given the Written Torah, and from the left was given the Oral Torah",** וְכֵן כָּתַב בַּהַקְדָּמָה (דִּבּוּר הַמַּתְחִיל 'פִּקּוּדָא רְבִיעָאָה'):[389] — **and so he wrote in the introduction (heading beginning 'The fourth precept'):** "וְכַד אִתְנְטִילַת מִגְּבוּרָה אִתְקְרִיאַת תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה, — **"And when it is taken from Gevurah (Severity) it is called the Oral Torah,** דְּהָכִי אוֹקְמוּהוּ מָארֵי מַתְנִיתִין: תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה מִפִּי הַגְּבוּרָה נִתְּנָה, — **for so the Masters of the Mishnah established: The Oral Torah was given from the mouth of the Almighty (Gevurah),** וְתַמָּן גִּבּוֹרִים עוֹמְדִים בַּפֶּרֶץ וְכוּלֵיהּ, עַיֵּן שָׁם". — **and there mighty men stand in the breach, etc., see there".** וְהָעִנְיָן: דְּפֶסַח "יְהִי אוֹר" שֶׁהָיָה הַהֲכָנָה לְתוֹרָה שֶׁבִּכְתָב שֶׁהוּא מִימִין, — **And the idea is: that Pesach is "Let there be light" which was the preparation for the Written Torah which stems from the right,**

After failure, Oral Torah supplies the distinctions needed for repair

כְּמַה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: "מִימִינוֹ אֵשׁ דָּת". וּבְמַתָּן תּוֹרָה הָיָה חָרוּת עַל הַלֻּחוֹת[390] — **as Scripture states: "From His right hand a**

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[383] **Shabbat 153a:9**: “Another interpretation: ‘Let your garments be white at all times’ refers to tzitzis; ‘and let oil not be lacking upon your head’ refers to tefillin.”

[384] **Megillah 16b**: “‘And honor’—these are tefillin, as it says: ‘All the peoples of the earth will see that the Name of Hashem is called upon you, and they will fear you.’ It was taught: Rabbi Eliezer the Great says that this refers to the tefillin worn on the head.”

[385] **Tikkunei Zohar 77b:5**: “Concerning these two luminaries it is said: two faces, male and female. “Let there be light”—this is Pesach, the night of the fourteenth. “And there was light”—Rosh Hashanah, concerning which it is said: “And it happened one day.” Here it says “and there was,” and there it says “and it happened”; everywhere, va-yehi is an expression of distress.”

[386] **Tikkunei Zohar 74a:3**: “An elder arose, opened his discourse, and said: “Let there be light, and there was light.” “Let there be light”—this is the right; “and there was light”—this is the left. Everywhere, va-yehi is an expression of distress. Therefore, “and it happened one day”—this is Rosh Hashanah, which is the left, judging the judgment of the entire world. Concerning it, it is said: “And there was light.””

[387] **Zohar, Terumah 76:742-77:751**: ‘Concerning the mystery of the light which kindles and produces the light in the lamp, it was said unto Aaron: “When thou lightest the lamps” (Num. 8, 2); for he emanated from the region of that light. Concerning this, too, it is written: “Let there be light, and there was light” (Gen. 1, 3). Why, it may be asked, was it necessary to repeat the word “light” in this verse? The answer is that the first “light” refers to the primordial light which is of the Right Hand, and is destined for the “end of days”; while the second “light” refers to the Left Hand, which issues from the Right.’

[388] **Tikkunei Zohar 42b:2-63a:9**: ‘(Ruth 3:13) ... as Y”Y lives lie down until the morning, which is the right-side, in which is the power of the Written Torah, which is the Middle Pillar, for the Written Torah is given from the right-side, and from the left-side is given the Oral Torah, which is ‘female’. And because of this ‘good’, the Righteous-One, ‘the life-force of the worlds’, is from the left-hand side, for it is ‘the mighty-one who conquers his evil inclination’ – which is Samael.’

[389] **Tikkunei Zohar 11b:6**: “When she, the Shechinah, is drawn from Chesed, she is called the Written Torah, which was given from the right, as it is written, ‘From His right hand, a fiery law for them.’ When she is drawn from Gevurah, she is called the Oral Torah, for the masters of the Mishnah explained that the Oral Torah was given from the mouth of Gevurah, the Almighty. From there come mighty ones who stand in the breach. No one can stand firmly in it unless he is mighty in the battle of Torah, mighty in overcoming his inclination.”

[390] **Machshavot Charutz 15:8**: “Torah is the tree of life in the midst of the garden, as stated in Tanna Devei Eliyahu Rabbah and elsewhere, at the central point from which all the garden’s trees draw nourishment. The tree of knowledge of good and evil, mentioned in Scripture together with it, appears to stand immediately beside it, likewise in the center, and all the trees draw nourishment from it too. In truth all is one. Had Adam not sinned, it too would have become the tree of life, for evil would have disappeared entirely from the world. Through his sin, even the tree of life of Torah became associated with the tree of knowledge of good and evil: fit and unfit, impure and pure, and so forth, as stated in Tikkunei Zohar. It appears to me that these correspond to Written and Oral Torah. Had Adam not sinned, everything would have

fiery law". – חֲרוּת מִמַּלְאַךְ הַמָּוֶת, **— And at the giving of the Torah it was carved (charut) upon the Tablets — freedom (cheirut) from the Angel of Death,** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁהוּא יֵצֶר הָרָע הוּא מַלְאַךְ הַמָּוֶת וּמִמֵּילָא הָיָה חֲרוּת גַּם מִיֵּצֶר הָרָע, שכתוב בבא בתרא ט"ז עמוד א'[391]). **— and automatically there was freedom also from the Evil Inclination, for the Evil Inclination is the Angel of Death (as in Bava Batra 16a).** וּבְוַדַּאי לֹא יִצַּיֵר חֲרוּת מִמַּלְאַךְ הַמָּוֶת עַד שֶׁיִּתְתַּקֵּן כָּל פְּגַם הַנָּחָשׁ שֶׁהָיָה סִבָּה לָזֶה, **— And certainly freedom from the Angel of Death cannot be envisioned until the entire blemish of the serpent, which was the cause of it, is rectified,** וְהוּא כְּשֶׁיֵּשׁ חֲרוּת מִיֵּצֶר הָרָע, **— and that is when there is freedom from the Evil Inclination,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁיִּהְיֶה לָעָתִיד שֶׁיִּשְׁחֹט הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא לְיֵצֶר הָרָע וְאָז יִבָּלַע הַמָּוֶת. **— as will be in the future when the Holy One, Blessed be He, slaughters the Evil Inclination and then death will be swallowed up forever.** וּבְוַדַּאי בִּשְׁעַת מַתַּן תּוֹרָה הָיָה חֲרוּת מִיֵּצֶר הָרָע, **— And certainly at the time of the giving of the Torah there was freedom from the Evil Inclination;** רַק אַחַר הַקִּלְקוּל שֶׁחָזַר יֵצֶר הָרָע הוּצְרְכוּ לְתוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **— only after the ruination when the Evil Inclination returned were they in need of the Oral Torah,** שֶׁהוּא הַרְבֵּה חָכְמָה לְתַקֵּן הַרְבֵּה כַּעַס. **— which is abundant wisdom to rectify abundant grief.**

A familiar teaching becomes new when its light reaches the heart

וְעַל זֶה רֹאשׁ הַשָּׁנָה "וַיְהִי אוֹר", הֲכָנָה לְהִתְחַדְּשׁוּת תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה[392], **— And concerning this, Rosh Hashanah is "and there was light", a preparation for the renewal of the Oral Torah,** וְהַיְנוּ שֶׁיִּכָּנְסוּ הַדִּבְרֵי תּוֹרָה לַלֵּב וְיִהְיֶה הֲוָיָה לָאוֹר. **— which means that the words of Torah enter into the heart and there is actualized existence (havayah) for the light.** וְזֶהוּ שְׂמֹאלָא, לְתַקֵּן הַרְבֵּה כַּעַס, שֶׁנִּצְרָךְ רַב חָכְמָה שֶׁיִּכָּנְסוּ דִּבְרֵי תּוֹרָה בַּלֵּב. **— And this is the left, to rectify abundant anger, where great wisdom is needed so that words of Torah penetrate the heart.** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמַרְנוּ פְּעָמִים מֵרַבֵּנוּ הַקָּדוֹשׁ זְכַר צַדִּיק וְקָדוֹשׁ לִבְרָכָה לְחַיֵּי הָעוֹלָם הַבָּא **— And as we have stated many times from our holy master Rabbi Simchah Bunim of Peshischa, memory of the holy righteous be blessed for the World to Come,** שֶׁאָמַר רַבִּי יַנַּאי: (מְצֹרָע פָּרָשָׁה ט"ז) עַל מַה שֶׁכָּתוּב בַּמִּדְרָשׁ רַבָּה[393] **— on what is**

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been 'in writing, from the Lord's hand upon me, He gave understanding,' and there would have been no need for Oral Torah. This is like the statement in Nedarim that, had Israel not sinned, only the five books of the Torah and the book of Joshua would have been given to them, the latter containing the arrangement of the Land of Israel. That is: in place of all Oral Torah, Joshua would have sufficed. In its boundaries of the land, which are the arrangements of the lower land, are included all the arrangements of the upper land, the root of Oral Torah, as is known. This was after Adam's expulsion from the garden. Israel repaired his sin at the giving of Torah and the receiving of the tablets, when they were free from the angel of death. They merited inheritance of the land in place of the garden and therefore needed Joshua. Had Adam not sinned, the garden would have stood in place of the Land of Israel. In place of the letter-combinations in the Torah as it exists following Adam's sin, there would have been combinations concerning the arrangement of the garden's trees, and 'garments of light' instead of 'garments of skin.' Everything would have been in Written Torah."

Machshavot explains why repair requires a more articulated Torah: once good and evil are mixed in human experience, Torah addresses them through distinctions such as fit and unfit, pure and impure. This develops the mechanism behind Peri Tzadik's "abundant wisdom." The passage does not deny the divine origin of Oral Torah; immediately before the excerpt it explicitly calls both Torahs bread from Heaven and says that all comes from Sinai.

[391] **Bava Batra 16a:8**: "Reish Lakish said: Satan, the evil inclination, and the Angel of Death are one and the same. He is Satan, as it is written, 'Satan went out from the presence of the Lord.' He is the evil inclination: there it is written, 'Only evil all day long,' and here it is written, 'Only, do not stretch out your hand against him.' The shared word 'only' connects the two passages. An alternative reading cites 'Only, preserve his life' at this point. He is also the Angel of Death, as it is written, 'But preserve his life'; this shows that the power to take Job's life otherwise lay in his hands."

[392] **Tiferet Yosef, Rosh Hashanah 10**: "The Talmud speaks of the ten utterances through which the world was created. It asks: there are only nine, and answers that 'In the beginning' is also an utterance. The whole creation is included in that utterance, but in the first utterance the creation does not yet have any apprehension. The first explicitly spoken utterance, 'Let there be light,' indicates that a person begins to recognize the difference between darkness and light. Afterward it says, 'There was light': the creation already recognizes the light, until the completion of the ten utterances, when the creation's apprehension of God's light has come into actuality. The person then sees that, from God's side, everything was included before as well. The difference is only on his side: previously he was cut off from it, and now through his prayer he has attained deliverance. When a person attains deliverance through prayer, it is openly manifest. This is 'The Lord attended to Sarah as He had said': saying is in a whisper, as stated in the Zohar. 'The Lord did for Sarah as He had spoken': speech indicates that she has already attained deliverance through prayer, recognizing that God's answer came through her prayer. It is then openly manifest, and is called speech."

Tiferet Yosef distinguishes a light already present from its becoming apprehensible to the recipient. His application is prayer and Sarah's deliverance; Peri Tzadik applies the same movement to Torah entering the heart. This clarifies how words that have not changed can nevertheless become a new illumination, without positing a new divine intention each time the reader understands them.

[393] **Vayikra Rabbah 16:2** (excerpt): "A peddler used to make the rounds of the towns near Tzippori, calling: Who wishes to buy the elixir of life? People crowded around him. Rabbi Yannai was sitting and studying in his room. He heard the man calling, 'Who wishes for the elixir of life?' and said: Come up here and sell it to me. The peddler replied: You and those like you do not need it. Rabbi Yannai pressed him, and he came up, took out a book of Psalms, and showed him the verse, 'Who is the man who desires life?' What follows? 'Guard your tongue from evil'; 'Turn from evil and do good'

written in Midrash Rabbah (Metzora, Parashah 16) that Rabbi Yannai said: "כָּל יָמַי הָיִיתִי קוֹרֵא הַפָּסוּק הַזֶּה וְלֹא הָיִיתִי יוֹדֵעַ הֵיכָן הוּא פָּשׁוּט, — **"All my days I would read this verse and did not know how simple it was, until this peddler came and made it known: 'Who is the man who desires life'";** עַד שֶׁבָּא רוֹכֵל זֶה וְהוֹדִיעוֹ: 'מִי הָאִישׁ הֶחָפֵץ חַיִּים'"; — **and even though the peddler said to him only the verse in its literal form,** וְאַף שֶׁהָרוֹכֵל לֹא אָמַר לוֹ רַק הַפָּסוּק כְּצוּרָתוֹ, — **yet Rabbi Yannai sensed then a renewed flavor through the peddler which entered the heart, and this is the essence of the light of the Oral Torah.** רַק רַבִּי יַנַּאי הִרְגִּישׁ אָז טַעַם מְחֻדָּשׁ עַל יְדֵי הָרוֹכֵל שֶׁנִּכְנַס לַלֵּב, וְזֶהוּ עִקַּר אוֹר תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה. — **And Rosh Hashanah is the preparation for Yom Kippur, the day on which the second Tablets were given,** וְרֹאשׁ הַשָּׁנָה הֶכָנָה לְיוֹם הַכִּפּוּרִים, יוֹם שֶׁנִּתְּנוּ בּוֹ לֻחוֹת אַחֲרוֹנוֹת, — **in which were included Midrash, Halachot, and Aggadot (as written in Shemot Rabbah, Parashah 46 and Parashah 47),** שֶׁכָּלוּל בָּהֶם מִדְרָשׁ, הֲלָכוֹת וְאַגָּדוֹת (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב שְׁמוֹת רַבָּה פָּרָשָׁה מ״ו וּפָרָשָׁה מ״ז),[394] — **which is the vast wisdom of the Oral Torah.** וְהוּא הַרְבֵּה חָכְמָה מִתּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה. וְזֶהוּ "יִשְׁעִי" בְּיוֹם הַכִּפּוּרִים כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בַּמִּדְרָשׁ רַבָּה, וְהַיְנוּ מְחִילַת עֲוֹנוֹת; — **And this is "my salvation" on Yom Kippur as written in Midrash Rabbah, which means forgiveness of sins;** וּגְמַר הַיְשׁוּעָה בְּהוֹשַׁעְנָא רַבָּה, הַיְנוּ יְשׁוּעָה גְּדוֹלָה; — **and the culmination of salvation is on Hoshana Rabbah, which is a great salvation;** וְאַחַר כָּךְ בְּשִׂמְחַת תּוֹרָה מְסַיְּמִין הַתּוֹרָה, שֶׁאָז מַתְחִיל הַהִתְחַדְּשׁוּת בְּדִבְרֵי תּוֹרָה. — **and afterward on Simchat Torah we complete the Torah, where then begins the renewal in words of Torah.** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמַרְנוּ בְּמַה שֶׁכָּתוּב (תִּקּוּנֵי זֹהַר תִּקּוּן י״ג וּבִשְׁאָר מְקוֹמוֹת):[395] — **And as we have said regarding what is written (Tikunei Zohar, Tikun 13 and other places):** "גַּ"ן סְדָרִים דְּאוֹרַיְתָא דִּבְכְתָב", אַף שֶׁיֵּשׁ נ״ד; — **"53 (Gan) orders of the Written Torah", even though there are 54;** שֶׁמִּשָּׁם הִתְחִיל הוֹפָעַת וְהָאָרַת תּוֹרָה אַךְ פָּרָשַׁת בְּרָכָה אֵינוֹ נֶחְשָׁב, — **yet Parashat VeZot HaBerachah is not counted, for from there began the emergence and illumination of the Oral Torah of Moses our Teacher,** שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה שֶׁל מֹשֶׁה רַבֵּנוּ. וְעַל כֵּן אֵינָהּ נִקְרֵאת בְּשַׁבָּת רַק בְּיוֹם טוֹב (וְנִתְבָּאֵר שִׂמְחַת תּוֹרָה).[396] — **and therefore it is not read on Shabbat but only on the Festival (and this was explained on Simchat Torah).** וּבְכָל שַׁבָּת הוּא הִתְחַדְּשׁוּת הַפָּרָשָׁה בְּאוֹר תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה, — **And on every Shabbat there is a renewal of the weekly portion through the light of the Oral Torah,** וְהוּא שֶׁיַּרְגִּישׁוּ טַעַם מְחֻדָּשׁ בְּהַפָּרָשָׁה, שֶׁיִּכָּנְסוּ הַדִּבְרֵי תּוֹרָה בַּלֵּב שֶׁהוּא אוֹר תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה. — **meaning that they sense a renewed flavor in the portion, so words of Torah enter the heart which is the light of the Oral Torah.**

וִימֵי חֲנֻכָּה בְּכָל שָׁנָה הוּא חֲנֻכַּת כָּל שַׁבְּתוֹת הַשָּׁנָה — **And the days of Chanukah each year are the dedication of all the Sabbaths of the year,** שֶׁהֵם הִתְחַדְּשׁוּת הָאוֹר דְּתוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה. — **which are the renewal of the light of the Oral Torah.** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁהָיָה חֲנֻכָּה בַּמִּשְׁכָּן וּבַמִּקְדָּשׁ לְהִתְחַנֵּךְ בַּעֲבוֹדָה, — **And just as there was an inauguration in the Tabernacle and the Temple to become trained in divine service,** כֵּן חֲנֻכַּת הַחַשְׁמוֹנָאִים חֲנֻכָּה לְאוֹר תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה — **so the dedication of the Hasmoneans is a dedication for the light of the Oral Torah** שֶׁהִיא בְּכָל שַׁבְּתוֹת הַשָּׁנָה, שֶׁזּוֹכִין לְאוֹר תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה וּלְתַקֵּן הַרְבֵּה כַּעַס; — **which exists throughout all Sabbaths of the year, wherein one merits the light of the Oral Torah and rectifies abundant anger;** וְעַל כֵּן לֹא עָשׂוּ זֵכֶר לְשֶׁאָר הַחֲנֻכּוֹת שֶׁהָיוּ, — **and therefore they made no commemorative observance for the other dedications that existed,** רַק לַחֲנֻכַּת הַחַשְׁמוֹנָאִים שֶׁנִּשְׁאֲרָה לְעוֹלָם. — **but only for the dedication of the Hasmoneans which endures forever.** וּבְשַׁבָּת,[397] אַף בַּזְּמַן הַזֶּה, הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרֵךְ שׁוֹכֵן בְּתוֹךְ לֵב בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל, כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב (תְּהִלִּים מ״ח): "לְדֹרֹתָם". — **And on Shabbat, even in this era, the Blessed Name dwells within the heart of the children of Israel, –** זַכָּאָה

(Psalms 34:13–15). Rabbi Yannai said: Solomon also proclaimed, ‘One who guards his mouth and tongue guards his soul from troubles’ (Proverbs 21:23). Rabbi Yannai said: All my days I read this verse without knowing how plainly it applies, until this peddler came and made it known: ‘Who is the man who desires life?’”

[394] **Shemot Rabbah 46:1** (excerpt): “Moshe began to grieve over the breaking of the Tablets. The Holy One, blessed be He, said to him: Do not grieve over the first Tablets, which contained only the Ten Commandments. In the second Tablets I give you laws, Midrash, and Aggadot. This is what is written: ‘He would tell you the hidden things of wisdom, for they are double in understanding’ (Job 11:6). Moreover, you are announcing that I have forgiven your transgression, as it says, ‘Know that God has remitted some of your iniquity’ (Job 11:6).”

[395] **Tikkunei Zohar 27a:8-30a:1**: ‘When the tabernacle is completed with its ‘thigh’, it is stated of Jacob: (Gen. 33:18) And Jacob arrived complete... And Jacob, specifically, is the image of the Middle Pillar, from the outside aspect. And behold Moses was there, but he was from the inside aspect – this one of the body, this one of the soul. And therefore, the two thighs of the Middle Pillar are complete, they are Netzaḥ and Hod.’

[396] **Tikkunei Zohar 27a:8-30a:1**: ‘And through the windpipe, does voice ascend to the heart. And it is a consuming fire from the right ‘ear’ of the heart, which is opposite the liver, and from which emerges speech. It is this that is written: (Jer. 23:29) Is not My word thus like fire? And if not for the wings of the lung blowing upon the heart, it would burn up the whole body.’

[397] **Tikkunei Zohar 85a:3-85b:2**: ‘In Tikkunei Zohar (Tikkun 48, 85a), the double mention of Shabbat in the verse refers to the union of the Supernal Shabbat (Binah, the World to Come) and the Lower Shabbat (Malkhut, the Sabbath Queen), which illuminate Israel throughout all their dwellings.’

מַאן דְּעָבִיד לוֹן דִּירָה בְּשַׁבָּת בִּתְרֵי בָתֵּי לִבָּא"[398] — **as written (Tikun 48): "'Throughout their generations' — fortunate is he who makes for Them a dwelling on Shabbat in the two chambers of the heart";** וְאוֹמְרִים בְּשַׁבָּת: "נְהוֹרֵיהּ יִשְׁרֵי בָּהּ", — **and we say on Shabbat: "May His light rest within it",** וְהוּא אוֹר הָרִאשׁוֹן שֶׁנִּגְנַז לְעַמְלֵי תוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה שֶׁהוּא מִטַּל דְּעַתִּיקָא. — **and this is the Primordial Light hidden for toilers of the Oral Torah which is from the dew of the Ancient One.**

Shabbat holiness can become a settled way of using the world

וְתַלְמִידֵי חֲכָמִים שֶׁעוֹסְקִים תָּמִיד בַּתּוֹרָה וְזוֹכִין לְתוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה אִתְקְרִיאוּ "שַׁבָּתוֹת וְיָמִים טוֹבִים"[399] — **And Torah scholars who are constantly engaged in Torah and merit the Oral Torah are called "Sabbaths and Festivals",** כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב (זֹהַר חֵלֶק ג׳ כ״ט עַמּוּד ב׳),[400] — **as written (Zohar Part III, 29b),** וְכָל אֶחָד מִיִּשְׂרָאֵל זוֹכֶה לָזֶה בְּשַׁבָּת. — **and every single Jew merits this on Shabbat.**

The heart becomes free when it can receive or refrain for God's sake

וּכְתִיב: "לֹא יָרֵעוּ וְלֹא יַשְׁחִיתוּ בְּכָל הַר קָדְשִׁי",[401] — **And it is written: "They shall not hurt nor destroy in all My holy mountain",** וְאִיתָא בְּמִדְרַשׁ הַנֶּעֱלָם (זֹהַר חֵלֶק א׳ קל״ח עַמּוּד א׳):[402] — **and it is found in Midrash HaNe'elam**

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[398] **Tikkunei Zohar 85a:3-85b:2**: 'In Tikkunei Zohar (Tikkun 48, 85a), the double mention of Shabbat in the verse refers to the union of the Supernal Shabbat (Binah, the World to Come) and the Lower Shabbat (Malkhut, the Sabbath Queen), which illuminate Israel throughout all their dwellings.'

[399] **Yisrael Kedoshim 5:1**: "This is also the meaning of the statement in Beitzah: 'Hillel the Elder had a different attribute, for all his deeds were for the sake of Heaven.' He did not set aside a pleasure for Shabbat as Shammai did, because even on weekdays he ate with holy purity, making all his food holy and spiritual, as on Shabbat. This is called 'all his deeds are for the sake of Heaven.' As I wrote above, someone who is like this does not need abstinence, because all his enjoyments too are for Heaven and not for himself. This is 'all his deeds': even what appeared to be an act for his own enjoyment was truly for Heaven. For someone like this, all his permitted activities are holy, and there is no division for him between weekday and Shabbat. It appears that the Zohar alludes to this when it says, 'The Divine Presence did not depart from Israel, even on the Shabbatot of the weekday.' That is, someone who makes his weekday like Shabbat, wholly for God, continually ceasing from the labors and activities of the weekday, with all his occupation in Torah and service of God for Heaven's sake—the Divine Presence does not leave the walls of his heart. Through dwelling within his heart, it sanctifies him from above with an additional holiness, so that in every matter of this world he sees how, as it were, God's Presence is within it and gives life to all."
Yisrael Kedoshim explains what it means for a person to be like Shabbat beyond the calendar day. The condition is that even permitted enjoyment serves Heaven rather than self-interest; then holiness settles in the heart and changes how the world is perceived. This supplies practical content to Peri Tzadik's description of scholars as "Shabbatot," while preserving the difference between their continuing attainment and the opportunity offered to every Israelite on Shabbat.

[400] **Zohar, Tzav 9:65**: "Likewise, Torah scholars, the children of the King and Queen, are called Sabbaths and festivals. They have nothing of their own, for they are not craftsmen like the other servants, the children of the weekdays. Their recompense in this world and in the world to come is that they be delighted with every kind of food and drink, and honored with fine garments, just as on Shabbat, of which it is said: "Honor it with clean clothing." Everything a person does for Sabbaths and festivals should be done for them."

[401] **Sod Yesharim, The Night of Shabbat Chol HaMoed Pesach 1:2**: "A slave is someone sunk in a particular desire who cannot move away from it, because it seems to him that his entire life depends on it. Even if he is absorbed in something permitted, if he lacks the power to move away from it he is called a slave, because he is enslaved to that thing. This is 'We were slaves to Pharaoh in Egypt': they were so immersed there that it seemed all their life depended on Egypt. As the Mekhilta says, no slave could flee Egypt, for he preferred being a slave in Egypt to being a prince elsewhere. This is called a slave. A free person stands above all things and is not enslaved to anything in this world. This is the essence of freedom: he can conduct himself in everything only according to God's will, to act or to refrain. Therefore the reason for 'Observe' is 'Remember that you were a slave in Egypt': a person should see to it that he is free, not sunk in anything. For 'Remember,' the masculine aspect, the reason is 'For in six days He made.' God's will is that a person receive everything through whose reception he can recognize His honor. Thus the Jerusalem Talmud says that a person will eventually account for everything his eyes saw from which he did not eat. Since that enjoyment can bring him greater recognition of God's honor, so that he says, 'Blessed is the Omnipresent Who created it,' why should he withhold that recognition from himself? This is the reason for 'Remember': God created and made everything so that through it His light should be recognized. Whatever a person receives and thereby gains greater recognition of the Giver's will, saying, 'Blessed is the Omnipresent Who created it,' is included in 'Remember,' the masculine aspect. Whatever he refrains from receiving because he understands that taking it would conceal his recognition of God's light—this refraining is called 'Observe,' the feminine aspect. Thus the Zohar says that Shabbat is 'Remember and Observe': on Shabbat both are included together."
Sod Yesharim gives a precise test of inward freedom: a person can either receive a permitted good or refrain from it according to whether it makes the Giver recognizable. The mere permissibility of an object does not mean the heart is free of enslavement to it. This clarifies the ethical content of the two heart chambers becoming a divine dwelling, while keeping enjoyment and restraint within the service of God rather than treating either as an automatic end.

[402] **Zohar, Toldot 4:25-30**: 'AND HE CALLED HIS NAME JACOB. It was God who called him so. (So, too, it is written lower down, "Hath he not rightly called his name Jacob?" (Gen. 27, 36) and not "his name was called".) God saw that the primeval serpent was full of guile to do mischief, and so when Jacob appeared He said: "Behold, here is one who can stand up to him", and therefore He called him Ya'kob, akin to the term vaya'kebeni (and he acted toward me with

(Zohar Part I, 138a): ;"הוּא לִבָּא דְּמָדוֹרֵיהּ דְּיֵצֶר הָרָע בֵּיהּ" **— "This is the heart wherein is the residence of the Evil Inclination";** ,"הַר קָדְשִׁי" וּבְשַׁבָּת כָּל יִשְׂרָאֵל נִקְרְאוּ **— and on Shabbat all Israel are called "My holy mountain",** וְיכוֹלִים לְזָכוֹת לְמֶעְבַּד דִּירָה לִשְׁכִינְתָּא בִּתְרֵי בָתֵּי לִבָּא **— and can merit to make a dwelling for the Shechinah in the two chambers of the heart** ,וְאִתְפַּנֵּי יֵצֶר הָרָע מִתַּמָּן **— with the Evil Inclination cleared from there,** .וְהַיְנוּ עַל יְדֵי אוֹר תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **— namely through the light of the Oral Torah.** וַחֲנֻכָּה הִיא חֲנֻכַּת הַשַּׁבָּתוֹת שֶׁל כָּל הַשָּׁנָה **— And Chanukah is the dedication of the Sabbaths of the entire year,** שֶׁאָז שׁוֹכֵן הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ בְּלֵב יִשְׂרָאֵל כָּאָמוּר; **— for then the Blessed Name dwells in the heart of Israel as stated;** וְלָכֵן נִסְדַּר בַּגְּמָרָא עִנְיַן חֲנֻכָּה בְּמַסֶּכֶת שַׁבָּת, **— and therefore the subject of Chanukah was arranged in the Gemara in Tractate Shabbat,** וּמִמֵּילָא סִדְּרוּ סָמוּךְ לְנֵר שַׁבָּת **— and consequently they arranged it in the Gemara adjacent to the Shabbat candle,** .כֵּיוָן שֶׁחֲנֻכַּת חַשְׁמוֹנָאִים גַּם כֵּן בְּנֵר וְאוֹר **— since the dedication of the Hasmoneans was likewise with a candle and light.**

guile) (Gen. 27, 35).'

Chanukah Ois 2

Al HaNissim, the Victory of Holiness, and the Light of Torah

The animal images identify appetite, aggression, and the pride that joins them. A claim to stand outside divine accountability allows the other desires to proceed unchecked.

Al HaNissim, the Victory of Holiness, and the Light of Torah

בְּנֻסַּח "עַל הַנִּסִּים" בַּחֲנֻכָּה: "מָסַרְתָּ גִּבּוֹרִים בְּיַד חַלָּשִׁים וְרַבִּים בְּיַד מְעַטִּים", — **In the liturgy of Al HaNissim on Chanukah: "You delivered the mighty into the hands of the weak, and the many into the hands of the few",** וְזֶהוּ תֹּקֶף הַנֵּס שֶׁהָיָה נֶגֶד הַטֶּבַע. — **and this is the potency of the miracle, which was contrary to nature.** וְאַחַר כָּךְ אוֹמְרִים שָׁלֹשׁ לְשׁוֹנוֹת: — **And afterward we recite three phrases:** "וּטְמֵאִים בְּיַד טְהוֹרִים, וּרְשָׁעִים בְּיַד צַדִּיקִים, וְזֵדִים בְּיַד עוֹסְקֵי תוֹרָתֶךָ", — **"and the impure into the hands of the pure, and the wicked into the hands of the righteous, and the willful transgressors into the hands of those who toil in Your Torah",** וְזֶה אֵינוֹ שַׁיָּךְ לְגַדֵּל הַנֵּס, רַק הַכֹּל עִנְיָן אֶחָד שֶׁמָּסַר הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ הַיְוָנִים בְּיַד יִשְׂרָאֵל. — **and this does not serve to magnify the physical miracle, for everything is a single occurrence where the Blessed Name delivered the Greeks into the hand of Israel.** אַךְ עִנְיַן הַשְּׁלֹשָׁה דְּבָרִים שֶׁחִשַּׁב, הוּא דְּשָׁרְשֵׁי הַקְּלִפָּה הֵם הַקִּנְאָה וְהַתַּאֲוָה וְהַכָּבוֹד, שֹׁרֶשׁ הַקְּלִפּוֹת דְּעֵשָׂו וְיִשְׁמָעֵאל, נִסְתַּעֵף ל״ה מִימִינָא וְל״ה מִשְּׂמָאלָא כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתַב הָאֲרִיזַ״ל. — **However, the concept of the three things which it enumerated is that the roots of the unholy husk (kelipah) are envy, lust, and honor, the root of the kelipot of Esau and Ishmael, from which branch out thirty-five nations on the right and thirty-five on the left, as the Arizal wrote.** קְלִפַּת יִשְׁמָעֵאל נִקְרָא "חֲמוֹר", דְּשֶׁנֵי נְעָרָיו עִמּוֹ בָּעֲקֵדָה הָיוּ יִשְׁמָעֵאל וֶאֱלִיעֶזֶר כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בְּפֵרוּשׁ רַבִּי שְׁלֹמֹה יִצְחָקִי, וְהוּא בַּמִּדְרָשׁ רַבָּה (אֱמוֹר פָּרָשָׁה כ״ו),[403] וְלָהֶם אָמַר אַבְרָהָם אָבִינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם: "שְׁבוּ לָכֶם פֹּה עִם הַחֲמוֹר" — **The kelipah of Ishmael is called a 'donkey' (chamor), for his two young men with him at the Binding were Ishmael and Eliezer as written in Rashi, and it is found in Midrash Rabbah (Emor, Parashah 26), – and to them Abraham our Father, peace be upon him, said: "Stay here with the donkey"** — עַם הַדּוֹמֶה לַחֲמוֹר" כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב (יְבָמוֹת ס״ב עַמּוּד א׳);[404] — **"A nation that resembles a donkey", as written (Yevamot 62a);** וְהֵינוּ קְלִפַּת הַתַּאֲוָה, כְּמַה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: "אֲשֶׁר בְּשַׂר חֲמוֹרִים בְּשָׂרָם וְגוֹמֵר". — **and that is the kelipah of bodily lust, as Scripture states: "Whose flesh is the flesh of donkeys, etc."**

The denial of meaningful service leaves desire without restraint

דְּאִיתָא (בְּרָכוֹת ס״א עַמּוּד א׳): "וְהָא קָא חָזֵינַן דְּמַזְקָא יְעֵשָׂו קְלִפַּת "שׁוֹר",[405] — **And Esau is the kelipah of an 'ox' (shor),** וְהֵינוּ וְנִשְׁכָּא וּבָעֲטָא",[406] — **for it states (Berachot 61a): "Behold we see that it damages, bites, and kicks",** שׁוֹר נֹגֵחַ, קְלִפַּת הַקִּנְאָה וּרְצִיחָה. — **which refers to a goring ox, the kelipah of envy and bloodshed.** וַעֲמָלֵק קְלִפַּת כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב (זֹהַר חֵלֶק ב׳ ס״ה עַמּוּד א׳): "נָפַק מִתַּקִּיפוּתָא דְּלֵהוֹן דְּאִקְרֵי כֶּלֶב, וְדָא חֲצִיפָא מִכֻּלְּהוּ",[407] — **And Amalek is the kelipah of a 'dog' (kelev), as written (Zohar Part II, 65a): "It emerged from their fierce power which is called dog, and this one is the most brazen of them all";** וְהוּא דְּאוֹתְיוֹת אָמְצָעִיּוֹת דְּ"שׁוֹר"

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[403] **Vayikra Rabbah 26:7** (excerpt): "'Abraham rose early in the morning and took his two young men with him' (Genesis 22:3). Who were they? Ishmael and Eliezer."

[404] **Yevamot 62a**: 'Rav said: Everyone agrees with regard to a Canaanite slave, that he does not have lineage, as it is written that Abraham said to his slaves: "Remain here with the donkey" (Genesis 22:5). This verse is interpreted to mean that they are a nation comparable to a donkey, which has no lineage. The Gemara raises an objection based upon a verse pertaining to Jonathan's Canaanite slave: "And Ziba had fifteen sons and twenty servants" (II Samuel 9:10), which indicates that a slave's sons are in fact considered his sons. Rav Aḥa bar Ya'akov said: This is like the expression: A bullock, son of a bull. The word son in this context merely denotes progeny, not lineage.'

[405] **Sod Yesharim, Parashat Zakhor 2:1**: "This is the opposite of Amalek's husk. Amalek denies human choice and says that God is so exalted that He does not desire service performed through human choice. As the Talmud says, they call Him 'the God of gods.' Thus there is no restraint on his heart's desire, for he says that everything follows from necessity. This is what the Zohar says: 'When ox and donkey unite, from their forcefulness emerges the one called dog, the most insolent of them all.' The ox in the husk is anger: the murderer says that God does not see him, for He is too exalted to attend to the lowly world. The donkey in the husk is desire: the adulterer says that, although God sees him, he himself lacks eyes to see so far and sees only what is before his eyes. From their forcefulness emerges the dog, the most insolent of all: Amalek says that God does not see him and he does not see God—the opposite of Israel's circumcision and uncovering."

Sod explains the moral reasoning behind the same ox, donkey, and dog images. A claim that God is distant, or that choice is meaningless, becomes a reason to refuse restraint. Peri Tzadik emphasizes the pride of denying what exceeds the intellect; Sod shows how that denial can excuse both aggression and appetite. The comparison concerns the arguments represented by these figures, rather than an inference from the shared animal words alone.

[406] **Berakhot 61a**: 'Rav Naḥman bar Yitzḥak strongly objects to this: If that is so, does an animal, with regard to whom vayyitzer is not written with a double yod, not have an inclination? Don't we see that it causes damage and bites and kicks? Rather, interpret the double yod homiletically, in accordance with the opinion of Rabbi Shimon ben Pazi, as Rabbi Shimon ben Pazi said: This alludes to the difficulty of human life; woe unto me from my Creator yotzri and woe unto me from my inclination yitzri. If one opts to follow either his Creator or his inclination, woe unto him from the other.'

[407] **Zohar, Beshalach 32:441-452**: 'Said R. Abba: 'When the two (i.e. the ox and the ass) are united, the inhabitants of the world cannot stand up against them. For this reason it is prohibited to "plough with an ox and an ass together" (Deut. 22, 10). From them, when united, emanates the power, called "dog", which is more insolent than all of them. Said the Holy One, blessed be He: "Ye said, 'is the Lord in our midst or not?' Behold, I will deliver you to the dog!", and straightway came Amalek.''

וְ"חֲמוֹר": וָא"ו מ"ם וָא"ו בְּגִימַטְרִיָּא כָּ"ב, **— and that is because the middle letters of sh-v-r (ox) and ch-m-v-r (donkey) — vav, mem, vav — equal numerically kelev (52),** כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתַב רַבֵּנוּ חַיִּים וִיטַאל, **— as Rabbi Chaim Vital wrote,** וְהוּא קְלִפַּת הַגַּאֲוָה וְהַכָּבוֹד, **— and it is the kelipah of haughtiness and false honor,** וְעָלָיו אָמַר הַכָּתוּב[408]: "זַד יָהִיר לֵץ שְׁמוֹ", וּכְמוֹ שֶׁנִּדְרַשׁ (מִדְרָשׁ רַבָּה יִתְרוֹ פָּרָשָׁה כ"ז): "'לֵץ תַּכֶּה' **— and concerning him Scripture states: "A willful, arrogant person, scorner is his name", –** זֶה עָמָלֵק שֶׁהוּא הַלֵּץ"[409]. **— and as expounded (Midrash Rabbah Yitro, Parashah 27): "'Strike the scorner' — this is Amalek who is the scorner."**

Scoffing blocks the possibility of learning what exceeds one's grasp

וְהַיְנוּ דְּכָל הָאֻמּוֹת שָׁמְעוּ "עַמִּים יִרְגָּזוּן"[410], **— And that means that while all the nations heard and "peoples trembled",** מֵאַחַר שֶׁרָאוּ נִסִּים נִגְלִים וּמְפֹרָשִׁים וְלֹא יָכְלוּ לְכָפּוֹר, **— since they saw manifest, explicit miracles and could not deny them,** וְהוּא עַל יְדֵי לַצָּנוּת דָּחָה הַכֹּל וְכָפַר. **— yet he, through cynicism, dismissed everything and blasphemed.** וְזֶה בָּא מִגַּאֲוָה, שֶׁלֹּא יִתָּכֵן בְּעֵינָיו שֶׁיִּהְיֶה דָּבָר נֶעְלָם מִשִּׂכְלוֹ וְגָבוֹהַּ מֵהַשָּׂגָתוֹ, **— And this stems from arrogance, for it was inconceivable in his eyes that anything could be hidden from his intellect and loftier than his comprehension,** וְעַל יְדֵי זֶה נַעֲשָׂה לֵץ וְכָפַר בַּכֹּל עַל יְדֵי לַצָּנוּת. **— and through this he became a mocker and denied everything through scorn.** וְהוּא "רֵאשִׁית גּוֹיִם עֲמָלֵק", רֵאשִׁית דְּקְלִפָּה, **— And he is "the first of nations, Amalek", the primordial inception of the unholy husk,** דְּשׁוֹרֶשׁ הַסְּתַת הַנָּחָשׁ הָיָה "וִהְיִיתֶם כֵּאלֹהִים", וְזֶה סוֹף הַגַּאֲוָה, וּכְמָה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר בְּנְבוּכַדְנֶצַּר וּבְחִירָם, **— for the root of the serpent's seduction was "and you shall be like gods", — and this is the absolute extreme of pride, as stated regarding Nebuchadnezzar and Hiram,** וְזֶהוּ שֹׁרֶשׁ הַיֵּצֶר הָרָע. **— and this is the fundamental root of the Evil Inclination.** וְהוּא עַל יְדֵי שְׁבִירַת הַכֵּלִים וּמְלָכִין קַדְמָאִין דְּמִיתוּ, **— And it emerges through the Shattering of the Vessels (shevirat hakelim) and the primordial kings who died,** שֶׁהָיָה עַל יְדֵי גַּאֲוָה דְּ"אֶנָא אֶמְלוֹךְ", כַּיָּדוּעַ. **— which transpired through the haughtiness of "I shall reign", as is known.** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמַרְנוּ שֶׁמִּמָּה שֶׁנִּתְלַבֵּשׁ הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ בִּלְבוּשׁ זֶה כְּמַה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: "הַשֵּׁם מָלָךְ גֵּאוּת לָבֵשׁ", **— And as we have stated, that because the Blessed Name enveloped Himself in this garment as Scripture states: "Hashem reigns, He is clothed in majesty",** מִזֶּה נִסְתַּעֵף בָּאָדָם הַגַּאֲוָה (וּכְמוֹ שֶׁנִּתְבָּאֵר פָּרָשַׁת וַיֵּרָא סוֹף מַאֲמָר א')[411]. **— from this branched out in man arrogant pride (and as explained in Parashat Vayeira, end of discourse 1).**

וּמַלְכוּת יָוָן, אִיתָא (בְּבְרֵאשִׁית רַבָּה פָּרָשָׁה ב'[412]): "'וְחֹשֶׁךְ **— And regarding the kingdom of Greece, it is stated (Bereishit Rabbah, Parashah 2): –** זֶה מַלְכוּת יָוָן שֶׁהֶחְשִׁיכָה עֵינֵיהֶם שֶׁל יִשְׂרָאֵל וְכוּלַּיהּ", **— "'And darkness' — this is the kingdom of Greece which darkened the eyes of Israel, etc.",** וְכָתוּב בְּסִפְרֵי הַקֹּדֶשׁ: חֹשֶׁךְ רָאשֵׁי תֵּבוֹת

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[408] **Shemot Rabbah 27:6** (excerpt): "Another interpretation of 'Jethro heard': It is written, 'Strike the scoffer, and the simple one will become prudent' (Proverbs 19:25), and likewise, 'When the scoffer is punished, the simple one grows wise' (Proverbs 21:11). Amalek and Jethro had joined Pharaoh's counsel. When Jethro saw that the Holy One had erased Amalek from this world and the World to Come, he reconsidered and repented. Thus it is written above, 'I shall utterly erase the memory of Amalek' (Exodus 17:14), and afterward, 'Jethro heard.' He said: I have nowhere to go except to the God of Israel. From where do you learn that Amalek and the Midianites are Israel's enemies? 'The elders of Moab and the elders of Midian went' (Numbers 22:7), and likewise, 'Midian, Amalek, and the children of the east' (Judges 6:3)."

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[410] **Tzidkat HaTzadik 259:1**: "Just as the root of every good thing is faith, with which the Torah opens, 'I am …,' not in the form of a command—and as explained in the Zohar on 'This is the gate of the Lord; the righteous enter through it,' the gate is the attribute of faith—so the root of every evil thing is scoffing. It is the opposite of faith, for it mocks everything. This is the meaning of 'Amalek is the first of the nations,' as the Midrash says: 'Strike the scoffer'—this is Amalek; 'and the simple person will become discerning'—this is Jethro. I heard that the simple person is one who believes everything, as it says, 'The simple person believes every word.' Jethro had left no form of idolatry untried, as stated in the Mekhilta, for he believed everything. He can be repaired: through the striking of the scoffer, who believes nothing, he becomes discerning and believes in the true God. This is the beginning of all the evil groups among the nations, like 'Laughter and lightheadedness accustom a person to sexual immorality.'"

Tzidkat distinguishes a mistaken willingness to believe from a refusal to believe anything. Jethro's credulity can be educated into discernment; the scoffer's refusal closes that route. This explains why Peri Tzadik treats mockery as a root, not just one more vice: the proud claim that nothing exceeds one's understanding prevents the correction of the other traits.

[411] **Psalms 93:1**: "The Lord reigns; He is clothed in majesty. The Lord is clothed, girded with strength. Indeed, the world stands firm; it cannot be moved."

[412] **Bereshit Rabbah 2:4** (excerpt): "'And darkness'—this is the Greek exile, which darkened Israel's eyes through its decrees, for it said to them: Write upon the horn of an ox that you have no portion in the God of Israel."

"חֲמוֹר", "שׁוֹר", "כֶּלֶב" — **and it is written in the holy books: Choshech (darkness) is an acronym for Chamor (donkey), Shor (ox), Kelev (dog),** שְׁלֹשָׁה קְלִפּוֹת הַנִּזְכָּרוֹת. — **the three mentioned kelipot.** דְּקִלְפַּת הַיְוָנִים הָיָה מִינוּת, — **For the kelipah of the Greeks was heresy (minut),** וְזֶה שֹׁרֶשׁ כָּל הַקְּלִפּוֹת שֶׁבָּא מֵהַגַּאֲוָה לִבָּם שֶׁהֵם חֲכָמִים בְּעֵינֵיהֶם, — **and this is the root of all kelipot stemming from pride, wherein their heart grew haughty believing they were wise in their own eyes,** וּמִזֶּה בָּאוּ לְמִינוּת. — **and from this they arrived at heresy.** וְעַל יְדֵי כֵן בָּאוּ גַּם כֵּן לִשְׁתֵּי הַקְּלִפּוֹת שֶׁהֵם הַקִּנְאָה וְהַתַּאֲוָה, — **And through this they also arrived at the two kelipot which are envy and lust,** שֶׁחָכְמָתָם הוּא הֶפֶךְ חָכְמַת הַתּוֹרָה, — **for their philosophy is the antithesis of the wisdom of the Torah;** דְּאִיתָא (קִדּוּשִׁין ל׳ עַמּוּד ב׳): "בָּרָאתִי יֵצֶר הָרָע, וּבָרָאתִי לוֹ תּוֹרָה תַּבְלִין",[413] — **as it is stated (Kiddushin 30b): "I created the Evil Inclination, and I created for it the Torah as an antidote",** וְהַיְנוּ אוֹר תּוֹרָה דְּמַצַּלַּת מִשְּׁלֹשׁ קְלִפּוֹת אֵלּוּ. — **meaning the light of Torah which saves one from these three kelipot.**

Torah redirects desire into a joy that can fill the heart

דְּכְנֶגֶד קְלִפַּת הַתַּאֲוָה אָמְרוּ שָׁם:[414] — **For corresponding to the kelipah of lust they stated there:** "אִם פָּגַע בְּךָ מְנֻוָּל זֶה, מְשָׁכֵהוּ לְבֵית הַמִּדְרָשׁ וְכוּלֵיהּ", — **"If this repulsive one encounters you, drag him to the Study Hall, etc.",** כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב "וּמְנֻוָּל" נִקְרָא יֵצֶר הָרָע שֶׁל הַתַּאֲוָה, — **and 'repulsive one' is the title of the Evil Inclination of lust,** (שַׁבָּת קנ״ב עַמּוּד א׳):[415] "אִשָּׁה חֲמַת מָלֵא וְכוּלֵיהּ", — **as written (Shabbat 152a): "A woman is a vessel full of filth, etc.",** וּבְמִדְרַשׁ הַנֶּעֱלָם (זֹהַר חֵלֶק א׳ קכ״ח עַמּוּד ב׳): "לֹא מְנֻוָּל כִּבְרִאשׁוֹנָה וְכוּלֵיהּ",[416] — **and in Midrash HaNe'elam (Zohar Part I, 128b): "Not repulsive as at first, etc.", see there.** עַיֵּן שָׁם. וְאָמַר: "מָשְׁכֵהוּ לְבֵית הַמִּדְרָשׁ", — **And it said: "Drag him to the Study Hall",** שֶׁיְּמַשֵּׁךְ חֲשֶׁק זֶה לְדִבְרֵי תוֹרָה, — **that he channel this passion toward words of Torah,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁיִּהְיֶה לֶעָתִיד שֶׁיִּהְיֶה לַחֲמִידוּ דְּאוֹרַיְתָא (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב שָׁם קל״ח עַמּוּד א׳).[417] — **just as it will be in the future when longing will be directed toward the Torah (as written ibid. 138a).** וּכְנֶגֶד קְלִפַּת הַקִּנְאָה, אִיתָא בַּתִּקּוּנִים (בַּהַקְדָּמָה הַנִּזְכֶּרֶת לְעֵיל):[418] — **And corresponding to the kelipah of envy, it is found in the Tikunim (in the mentioned introduction):** "וְכַד אִתְנְטִילַת מִגְּבוּרָה אִתְקְרִיאַת תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה, — **"And when it is taken from Gevurah it is called the Oral Torah,** דְּהָכִי אוֹקְמוּהָ מָארֵי מַתְנִיתִין: תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה מִפִּי הַגְּבוּרָה נִתְּנָה" — **for so the Masters of the Mishnah established: The Oral Torah was given from the mouth of the**

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[413] **Kiddushin 30b:4-5**: "So the Holy One, blessed be He, said to Israel: 'My children, I created the evil inclination, and I created Torah as its remedy. If you occupy yourselves with Torah, you will not be delivered into its hand, as it says, "If you do well, will there not be elevation?"' 'But if you do not occupy yourselves with Torah, you will be delivered into its hand, as it says, "Sin crouches at the opening." Moreover, all its dealings are directed against you, as it says, "Its desire is toward you." If you wish, however, you can rule over it, as it says, "And you shall rule over it."'"

[414] **Poked Akarim 5:8**: "Therefore, 'The Lord's precepts are upright, gladdening the heart': they bring uprightness into the heart and remove desires. Thus Rambam writes in the laws of forbidden relations that a person becomes filled with desire only in a heart empty of Torah. The Sages said, 'If this repulsive one encounters you'—the inclination of appetites, which is repulsive, as Shabbat says, 'A woman is a vessel full of filth, yet everyone runs after her'—'draw him to the study house.' For the delight in Torah that enters the heart removes repulsive alien desires from it. Therefore Torah gladdens the heart: the person can rejoice in God through attachment to Him, like the joy of bridegroom and bride. 'You who cling to the Lord your God are all alive today': attachment gives life, the opposite of the desires from which came the death decreed on Adam through his desire to eat from the tree of knowledge."
Poked supplies the positive effect of the redirection: delight in Torah leaves room for joy in God, rather than merely suppressing appetite. This clarifies the future use of the inclination mentioned in Peri Tzadik. The full Poked paragraph also warns that a person's confidence in the uprightness of his own desire can be mistaken; its discussion of Samson is not a permission to treat any strong desire as divine direction.

[415] **Shabbat 152a:12**: "Rav Kahana was reading Scripture before Rav. When Rav reached this verse, he sighed deeply. Rav Kahana said: We can infer from this that Rav's sexual desire has ceased. Rav Kahana said: What is meant by 'For He spoke and it came into being'? This refers to a woman. 'He commanded and it stood' refers to children. It was taught: A woman is a skin-bottle full of excrement, with her opening full of blood, yet everyone runs after her."

[416] **Zohar, Chayei Sara 15:109-114**: 'R. Eleazar asked his father, R. Simeon, for an explanation of the term Machpelah (lit. "twofold", or "folded"). 'How is it,' he said, 'that first it is written "the cave of Machpelah", and subsequently "the cave of the field of Machpelah", implying that the field and not the cave was "Machpelah" (doubled)?''

[417] **Zohar, Toldot 6:57**: "Rabbi Yitzchak son of Rabbi Yosei was traveling from Cappadocia to Lod when Rabbi Yehudah met him. Rabbi Yitzchak said to him: Tell me, have our companions, the sages of the Mishnah, considered this matter—that the evil inclination will be forgotten from the world except at the time of marital union? He replied: By your life, the evil inclination is as necessary to the world as rain is to the world; without the evil inclination there would be no joy in learning. But it will not be debased as before, so that one sins through it. Thus it is written: "They shall neither harm nor destroy in all My holy mountain…""

[418] **Tikkunei Zohar 17a**: 'At that time, when this composition was composed, permission was granted to Elijah to acquiesce with them in it, and to all the Masters of the Academy above and below, and all the forces of the higher angels, and higher souls, to be with them in agreement and friendship as one. Elijah opened began, and he said: Master of the Worlds! For You are He that is One – but not in number.'

Almighty (Gevurah)", וּכְמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב (תַּעֲנִית ד׳ עַמּוּד א׳)[419]: "צוּרְבָא מֵרַבָּנַן דְּרָתַח — **and as written (Ta'anit 4a): – "A young scholar who flares up with rage — it is the Torah that boils within him,** אוֹרַיְתָא דְּקָא מַרְתְּחָא לֵיהּ, — **as it is said: 'Is not My word like fire'",** שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: 'הֲלוֹא כֹּה דְּבָרִי כָּאֵשׁ'", — **and the anger of Rabbis is beneficial in every direction.** וְרוּגְזָא דְּרַבָּנַן טָב אֵיהוּ לְכָל סְטָרִין. — **And so too the essence of words of Torah is acquired through humility,** וְכֵן עִקַּר הַדִּבְרֵי תוֹרָה נִקְנֶה עַל יְדֵי שְׁפָלוּת, וְעַל יְדֵי דִּבְרֵי תוֹרָה קְשׁוּרִים בְּרֵאשִׁית הַמַּחֲשָׁבָה: **and through words of Torah they are bound to the primordial inception of thought: – "בְּרֵאשִׁית"** — **"In the beginning" — for the sake of Israel who are called "first",** בִּשְׁבִיל יִשְׂרָאֵל שֶׁנִּקְרְאוּ "רֵאשִׁית", וְהוּא כְּנֶגֶד רֵאשִׁית דְּקִלְפָּה: "רֵאשִׁית גּוֹיִם", קְלִפַּת הַגַּאֲוָה. — **and this stands counter to the beginning of the unholy husk: "the first of the nations", the kelipah of arrogance.** וְחָכְמָתָם שֶׁהוּא חֹשֶׁךְ, הֵפֶךְ תּוֹרָה אוֹר, — **And their philosophy which is darkness, the opposite of Torah of light,** מֵבִיא לִידֵי קְלִפּוֹת הַתַּאֲוָה וְהַקִּנְאָה, כְּחוֹת הַיֵּצֶר הָרָע. — **leads directly to the kelipot of lust and envy, the powers of the Evil Inclination. –** וְזֶה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: "וּטְמֵאִים בְּיַד טְהוֹרִים", נֶגֶד קְלִפַּת הַתַּאֲוָה, — **And this is what is stated: "And the impure into the hand of the pure" — corresponding to the kelipah of lust;** כִּי עִקַּר שֵׁם טֻמְאָה הִיא טֻמְאָה הַיּוֹצְאָה מִגּוּפוֹ שֶׁל אָדָם, — **for the fundamental designation of impurity is defilement issuing from the human body itself,** וְהוּא הַזִּיבָה שֶׁבָּא כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב (פֶּרֶק ב׳ דְּזָבִים): מְכֹּחַ תַּאֲוָה, — **which is the bodily discharge (zivah) that comes by force of lust,** בְּשִׁבְעָה דְּרָכִים בּוֹדְקִין אֶת הַזָּב וְכוּלֵיהּ וּבְהִרְהוּר".[420] — **as written (Chapter 2 of Zavim): "In seven ways they examine the zav, etc., and through improper thought".** וְהָעַכּוּ"ם אֵין בָּהֶם שׁוּם טֻמְאָה, — **And idolaters do not possess intrinsic ritual impurity,** אֲבָל חֲכָמִים עֲשָׂאוּם כְּזָבִים לְכָל דִּבְרֵיהֶם, — **yet the Sages decreed them like zavim for all matters,** מִגּוּפָם מָלֵא מִזּוּהֲמַת טֻמְאָה זוֹ, שֶׁהִיא זוּהֲמַת הַנָּחָשׁ שֶׁהֵטִיל בְּחַוָּה שֶׁלֹּא פָּסְקָה מֵהֶם. — **for their physical frame is full of the filth of this impurity, which is the venom of the serpent injected into Eve that never ceased from them.** וְעַל כֵּן אָמְרוּ (בְּרֵאשִׁית רַבָּה פָּרָשָׁה פ׳):[421] — **And therefore they said (Bereishit Rabbah, Parashah 80):** "הַנִּבְעֶלֶת לְעָרֵל קָשָׁה לִפְרֹשׁ", — **"A woman cohabited by an uncircumcised male finds it hard to separate",** דְּשָׁדֵי בָּהּ זוּהֲמָא זוּ דְּתַאֲוָה. — **because he casts into her this filth of animalistic lust.** וְהוּא קְלִפַּת יִשְׁמָעֵאל, שֶׁהִיא הַפְּסֹלֶת שֶׁל אַבְרָהָם אָבִינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם — **And this is the kelipah of Ishmael, which is the refuse of Abraham our Father, peace be upon him,** שֶׁהָיָה מִדַּת אַהֲבָה בִּקְדֻשָּׁה, — **who was the attribute of love in holiness,** כִּי כָּל אַהֲבָתוֹ וְחֶמְדָּתוֹ הָיָה רַק לְהַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא. — **for all his love and passion was solely toward the Holy One, Blessed be He.** וְהַכֹּחַ קְדֻשָּׁה לִפְרֹשׁ מִתַּאֲוָה נִקְרָא "טָהֳרָה", — **And the power of holiness to withdraw from bodily lust is termed "purity" (taharah),** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁכָּתַב דָּוִד הַמֶּלֶךְ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם בְּאוֹתוֹ מִזְמוֹר דְּ"כַאֲשֶׁר בָּא וְגוֹמֵר", — **and as David the King, peace be upon him, wrote in that psalm on "when the prophet Nathan came, etc.",** שֶׁהוּא עַל פֶּגֶם הַתַּאֲוֹת, בְּקֵשׁ: "לֵב טָהוֹר בְּרָא וְגוֹמֵר", — **which concerns the blemish of lust, pleading: "Create a pure heart, etc.".** וְאָמְרוּ זִכְרוֹנָם לִבְרָכָה (סַנְהֶדְרִין ק״ב עַמּוּד א׳): "מִכְּלָל דְּאִיכָּא טָמֵא".[422] — **and our Sages of blessed memory said (Sukkah 52a): "This implies that an impure heart exists".** וְזֶה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: "בְּיַד טְהוֹרִים", — **And this is what is recited: "Into the hand of the pure",** דִּכְתִיב: "יִרְאַת הַשֵּׁם טְהוֹרָה עוֹמֶדֶת לָעַד", — **as it is written: "The fear of Hashem is pure, enduring forever",** וְעַל יְדֵי הַיִּרְאָה נִפְרָשִׁים מִתַּאֲוָה, — **and through holy awe one separates from lust,** כְּמַה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: "כִּי אָמַרְתִּי רַק אֵין יִרְאַת אֱלֹהִים בַּמָּקוֹם הַזֶּה וְגוֹמֵר", — **as Scripture states: "For I said: surely there is no fear of God in this place, and they will slay me for my wife's sake",** וְעַל יְדֵי זֶה הֵם מְלֵאִים מִתַּאֲוָה. — **and because of the lack of it they are brimming with lust.**

Even a holy attachment must be tested for self-interest

וְאַבְרָהָם אָבִינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם בַּנִּסָּיוֹן הָעֲשִׂירִי דַּעֲקֵדָה,[423] — **And Abraham our Father, peace be upon him, in the**

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[419] **Taanit 4a**: '§ And, incidentally, the Gemara relates that which Rava said: This Torah scholar who grows angry, it can be presumed that it is his Torah study that angers him. Therefore, he must be given the benefit of the doubt, as it is stated: "Is not my word like fire, says the Lord" (Jeremiah 23:29). And similarly, Rav Ashi said: Any Torah scholar who is not as hard as iron, but is indecisive and wavers, he is not a Torah scholar, as it is stated in the same verse: "And as a hammer that breaks rock in pieces" (Jeremiah 23:29).'

[420] **Mishnah Zavim 2:2**: 'In seven ways do they examine the zav before he is confirmed as impure with zivah: regarding what he ate, what he drank, what load he carried, whether he leaped, whether he was ill, what he saw, and what he fantasized in his thoughts (hirhur)—teaching that impure fantasizing of the heart can induce the flow of zivah.'

[421] **Bereshit Rabbah 80:11** (excerpt): "'They took Dinah' (Genesis 34:26). Rabbi Yudan said: They dragged her away and went out. Rav Huna said: A woman who has had relations with an uncircumcised man finds it difficult to part from him. Rav Huna said: She said, 'Where could I carry my disgrace?'—until Simeon swore that he would marry her. Thus it says, 'Saul, son of the Canaanite woman' (Genesis 46:10): the son of Dinah, who had been violated by a Canaanite."

[422] **Sukkah 52a**: "Rabbi Avira expounded—and some say it was Rabbi Yehoshua ben Levi: The evil inclination has seven names. The Holy One, blessed be He, called it 'evil,' as it says: 'For the inclination of the human heart is evil from youth.' Moshe called it 'uncircumcised,' as it says: 'You shall circumcise the foreskin of your heart.' David called it 'impure,' as it says: 'Create a pure heart for me, God,' implying that there is an impure one."

[423] **Beit Yaakov on Torah, Vayera 57:4**: "Yet Abraham paid no attention to all this (the loss of reward and any enduring

tenth trial of the Binding, ,"עַתָּה יָדַעְתִּי כִּי יְרֵא אֱלֹהִים אַתָּה": אָמַר לוֹ — **the Angel said to him: "Now I know that you are a God-fearing man",** ,כִּי בֵּרוּר שְׁלֵמוּת אַהֲבָתוֹ לַהַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ הוּא כַּאֲשֶׁר בָּא כְּנֶגְדּוֹ אַהֲבָה אַחֶרֶת — **for the supreme clarification of his love for the Blessed Name is manifest when another competing love confronts it,** ."בִּנְךָ יְחִידְךָ אֲשֶׁר אָהַבְתָּ": כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב — **as written: "Your son, etc., whom you love".** וּבַנִּסְיוֹנוֹת הַקּוֹדְמִים הָיָה רַק כְּנֶגֶד חֶמְדּוֹת עוֹלָם הַזֶּה — **And in the earlier trials it was only against the worldly attractions of this physical plane,** ;שֶׁהָיוּ כְּאַיִן בְּעֵינֵי אַבְרָהָם אָבִינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם נֶגֶד אַהֲבַת הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ — **which were as nothing in the eyes of Abraham our Father compared to love of the Blessed Name;** אֲבָל אַהֲבָתוֹ לְיִצְחָק אָבִינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם שֶׁהָיָה בִּשְׁבִיל קְדֻשָּׁתוֹ — **yet his love for Isaac our Father, peace be upon him, which was because of his sublime holiness** ,וְשֶׁהֻבְטַח שֶׁיֵּצֵא מִמֶּנּוּ אֻמָּה קְדוֹשָׁה — **and because he had been promised that from him would issue a holy nation,** ,בָּזֶה הָיָה נִסָּיוֹן הָעֲשִׂירִי שֶׁנִּתְבָּרֵר שֶׁהוּא יָרֵא הַשֵּׁם — **in this was the tenth trial through which it was clarified that he is God-fearing,** .הוֹאִיל וְהוּא בְּנוֹ, אֲפְשָׁר שֶׁהוּא מִצַּד אַהֲבַת כָּל אָב לְבָנוֹ: שֶׁהוּא חוֹשֵׁב — **lest one think: since he is his son, it might stem from the natural love of any father for a child.** וְזֶהוּ בֵּרוּר שְׁלֵמוּת הָאַהֲבָה דְּקְדֻשָּׁה כַּאֲשֶׁר הוּא גַּם כֵּן יְרֵא הַשֵּׁם — **And this is the ultimate clarification of holy love, when one is likewise God-fearing** .וּלְבָבוֹ טָהוֹר מֵאַהֲבוֹת זָרוֹת שֶׁמִּקְלִפַּת יִשְׁמָעֵאל — **and his heart is purified from alien passions rooted in the kelipah of Ishmael.** ,"בְּיַד טְהוֹרִים": וְזֶה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר — **And this is what is said: "Into the hand of the pure",** .כִּי יִשְׂרָאֵל הֵם "הָאִשָּׁה יִרְאַת הַשֵּׁם", וְהֵם יְרֵאִים וּטְהוֹרִים — **for Israel is "the woman who fears Hashem", and they are fearful and pure.**

"וּרְשָׁעִים בְּיַד צַדִּיקִים" — – **"And the wicked into the hand of the righteous"** — ,"רְשָׁעִים" נֶגֶד קְלִפַּת עֵשָׂו — **"wicked" corresponds to the kelipah of Esau,** עַל פִּי מַה שֶׁכָּתוּב בְּמִדְרָשׁ רַבָּה (רֵישׁ פָּרָשַׁת וַיִּשְׁלַח): "'פַּלְּטָה נַפְשִׁי מֵאוֹתוֹ — **according to what is written in Midrash Rabbah (beginning of Parashat Vayishlach): –** שֶׁהוּא רָשָׁע'[424] — חַרְבֶּךָ שֶׁבּוֹ אַתָּה רוֹדֶה אֶת עוֹלָמֶךָ", — **"'Rescue my soul from that wicked one' — who is Your sword with which You discipline Your world",** וְהַיְנוּ שֶׁהַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ בָּרָא אֶת הַחֶרֶב לִהְיוֹת שִׁבְטּ אַפּוֹ לִרְדּוֹת עוֹלָמוֹ — **meaning that the Blessed Name created the sword to serve as the rod of His wrath to govern His world.** וּכְתִיב: "יֻחַן רָשָׁע", שֶׁדָּרְשׁוּהוּ (מְגִלָּה ו׳ עַמּוּד א׳) עַל עֵשָׂו שֶׁאָמַר יִצְחָק "יֻחַן וְכוּ'"[425] — **And it is written: "Let grace be shown to the wicked", which they expounded (Megillah 6a) regarding Esau when Isaac pleaded "let grace be shown, etc.";** וּכְתִיב: "חָרַב פָּתְחוּ רְשָׁעִים וְגוֹמֵר", וּכְתִיב: "וְקָרְאוּ לָהֶם גְּבוּל רִשְׁעָה". — **and it is written: "The wicked have drawn out the sword, etc.", and written: "And they shall call them the border of wickedness".**

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continuation), and cast his life aside for the love of God. He gave himself up in both worlds, agreeing that no continuation of him would remain. This was solely for his love of God; therefore his reward was doubled and redoubled. This awakened the holy Atika. The Holy One swore to him from the highest place, above all creatures, a place not joined to created beings. This is called the holy Atika, above human service, which is called Ze'ir Anpin. In truth, no human service reaches there, for His glory existed even before service existed: You are He before the world was created, and You are He after the world was created. From this place God shone upon Abraham, measure for measure, for his service too was above human power."

The full preceding Beit Yaakov paragraphs explain the loss of any continuing offspring or spiritual return. Its conclusion shows how far Abraham's relinquishment extends: even the desired holy legacy is surrendered. This develops the particular difficulty Peri Tzadik identifies in the tenth trial, as distinct from relinquishing an ordinary worldly pleasure. The bracketed antecedent comes from Vayera 57:2–3, which were read with the target.

[424] **Bereshit Rabbah 75:1** (excerpt): "'Rescue my soul from the wicked, Your sword' (Psalms 17:13): Rescue my soul from that wicked man who comes through the power of the sword, as it says, 'By your sword you shall live' (Genesis 27:40). Another interpretation: Rescue my soul from that wicked man who is Your sword, through whom You discipline Your world."

[425] **Megillah 6a:18**: "Rabbi Yitzchak also said: What is meant by 'Let the wicked be shown favor; he has not learned righteousness'? Yitzchak said before the Holy One, blessed be He, 'Master of the world, let Esav be shown favor.' He answered, 'He is wicked!' Yitzchak said, 'He has not learned righteousness.' God answered, 'In the land of uprightness he will act unjustly.' Yitzchak said, 'If so, let him not see the majesty of the Lord.'"

Holy strength governs the inclination and makes room for joy

Self-mastery does not make spiritual strength a private possession

"גְּבוּר הַכּוֹבֵשׁ אֶת יִצְרוֹ". [426, 427] — **And the attribute of holy Strength (Gevurah) is to be "mighty, conquering his impulse".** וְיוֹסֵף שִׁטְנוֹ שֶׁל עֵשָׂו (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בְּרֵאשִׁית רַבָּה פָּרָשָׁה ע"ג), [428] — **And Joseph is the adversary of Esau (as written in Bereishit Rabbah, Parashah 73),** שֶׁיּוֹסֵף הָיָה גַּם כֵּן גִּבּוֹר הַכּוֹבֵשׁ יִצְרוֹ, — **for Joseph was also a warrior conquering his inclination,** וּבָזֶה נִתְיַחֵד יוֹתֵר מִכָּל הַשְּׁבָטִים, דְּעַל כֵּן נִקְרָא בְּשֵׁם "צַדִּיק". — **and in this he was uniquely distinguished above all the tribes, which is why he is called by the title Tzaddik (Righteous).** וְזֶה הַחִלּוּק בֵּין "צַדִּיק" לְ"טָהוֹר": — **And this is the distinction between a "righteous person" and a "pure person":** דְּ"טָהוֹר" הוּא שֶׁהַלֵּב טָהוֹר לְגַמְרֵי עַל יְדֵי שֶׁמְּמַלְּא בְּאַהֲבַת דְּקְדֻשָּׁה, — **for a "pure one" is someone whose heart is completely cleansed because it is filled with holy divine love;** וְ"צַדִּיק" הוּא שֶׁכּוֹבְשׁוֹ בִּגְבוּרָתוֹ, שֶׁמִּתְגַּבֵּר כְּנֶגְדּוֹ, וְהוּא מֶרְכָּבָה לְמִדַּת צַדִּיק; — **whereas a "righteous one" is one who subdues it through his strength, powerfully overcoming it, and he serves as a divine chariot (merchavah) for the sefirah of Tzaddik;** וְהוּא בְּקְדֻשָּׁה: "בְּכוֹר שׁוֹרוֹ הָדָר לוֹ וְגוֹמֵר בָּהֶם עַמִּים יַנַּח", — **and this is represented in holiness by: "His firstling ox has majesty, etc., with them he shall gore nations",** וְהוּא נֶגֶד קְלִפַּת עֵשָׂו שֶׁהוּא שׁוֹר נַגָּח, — **which stands counter to the kelipah of Esau who is a goring ox,** וְזֶהוּ "רְשָׁעִים בְּיַד צַדִּיקִים". — **and this is "the wicked into the hand of the righteous".**

"וְזֵדִים" כְּנֶגֶד קְלִפַּת הַכָּבוֹד, שֶׁהִיא הִתְנַשְּׂאוּת וְגַסּוּת רוּחַ, — – **"And the willful transgressors" — corresponding to the kelipah of false honor, which is presumption and haughtiness,** כְּמַה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: "זֵד יָהִיר לֵץ שְׁמוֹ"; — **as Scripture states: "A willful, arrogant person, scorner is his name";** וְהוּא מְנַגֵּד לִקְדֻשַּׁת הַתּוֹרָה, שֶׁנִּקְרָא בִּקְדֻשָּׁה "כָּבוֹד", — **and it opposes the sanctity of the Torah, which is designated in holiness as true "honor",** כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב (חֻלִּין קל"ג עַמּוּד א'): "וְאֵין כָּבוֹד אֶלָּא תּוֹרָה, שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: 'כָּבוֹד חֲכָמִים יְנַחֲלוּ'". [429] — **as written (Chullin 133a): "And there is no honor except Torah, as it is said: 'The wise shall inherit honor'".** וְזָכָה לָזֶה יַעֲקֹב אָבִינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם שֶׁצּוּרָתוֹ חֲקוּקָה בְּכִסֵּא הַכָּבוֹד, — **And Jacob our Father, peace be upon him, merited this, his image being engraved on the Throne of Glory (Kissei HaKavod),** כִּי הוּא "יֹשֵׁב אֹהָלִים", שֶׁרָצָה לוֹמַר אָהֳלֵי תּוֹרָה, — **for he is "a dweller of tents", meaning the tents of Torah,** וְ"הַקּוֹל קוֹל יַעֲקֹב" בַּתּוֹרָה, — **and "the voice is the voice of Jacob" engaged in Torah,** וְזֶהוּ מִדַּת "אֱמֶת לְיַעֲקֹב", — **and this is the divine attribute of "Truth to Jacob",** כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב (בְּרָכוֹת ה' עַמּוּד ב'): "אֱמֶת זוֹ תּוֹרָה, שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: 'אֱמֶת קְנֵה'". [430] — **as written (Berachot 5b): "Truth is**

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[426] **Divrei Soferim 38:1**: "This is when a person merits that Torah becomes a medicine of life for him, for Torah is a seasoning for the inclination. This is the essence of strength: 'One who conquers his inclination.' Through this he merits the joy of heart of those who seek God, for it says, 'Rejoice, righteous ones, in the Lord.' This is the joy that God desires in His world: 'Let Israel rejoice in its Maker.' It is possible only when the separating screen is removed. Therefore Tanna Devei Eliyahu says, 'I feared from within my joy, and I rejoiced from within my fear.' Israel's joy is only that which comes from fear of God. Thus it says both, 'Serve the Lord with fear,' and, 'Serve the Lord with joy': the two must be present together."

Divrei Soferim supplies the inward fruit of Joseph's kind of strength. Conquest of the inclination removes a barrier to joy in God; fear and joy then reinforce each other. This keeps Peri Tzadik's holy strength from being understood merely as successful force against an opponent. The qualification that Torah become a medicine of life is preserved.

[427] **Tiferet Yosef, Talmud Anthology, Chagigah 5**: "Concerning this Scripture says, 'Let not the wise person boast in his wisdom, nor the mighty person in his might, nor the rich person in his wealth.' My holy grandfather explained that Scripture is not speaking of worldly matters. 'Who is mighty? One who conquers his inclination'; 'Who is rich? One who rejoices in his portion,' whose soul is upright within him; and a wise person is one whose heart is illuminated by Torah. Yet a person must not boast of this or take some strength for himself from it, God forbid. Rather, as the verse concludes, 'Only in this may one who boasts boast: understanding and knowing Me.' The one who conquers his inclination should recognize well that God gave him this power to overcome every obstacle only for His service. Likewise, the one who rejoices in his portion should recognize that God illuminates this power for him. The person wise in Torah's light should also recognize that it does not come from himself at all; God grants it to him each time for His service."

Tiferet adds a second test to the definition of holy strength: even genuine conquest of desire can become self-appropriation if a person boasts of possessing it. Recognizing its Giver keeps the power within divine service. This is especially illuminating in a section that distinguishes the righteous from the proud and asks how the same underlying capacities can be holy or distorted.

[428] **Bereshit Rabbah 73:7** (excerpt): "'When Rachel had borne Joseph' (Genesis 30:25): Once Joseph was born, Esau's adversary was born. Therefore it says, 'Jacob said to Laban: Send me away, and let me go to my place and my land.' Rabbi Pinchas said in the name of Rabbi Shmuel bar Nachman: It is a received tradition that Esau falls only into the hands of Rachel's descendants. This is what is written: 'Surely the youngest of the flock shall drag them away' (Jeremiah 49:20). Why does it call them 'the youngest of the flock'? Because they are the youngest among the tribes."

[429] **Chullin 133a:16**: "Rabbi Zeira said in Rav's name: Whoever teaches an unworthy student is like one who throws a stone to the idol Markulis, as it says, 'Like binding a stone in a sling, so is giving honor to a fool,' and it is written, 'Pleasure is not fitting for a fool.' Here, giving 'honor' refers to imparting Torah instruction."

[430] **Berakhot 5b:2-3**: "Rabbi Yochanan said to him: Torah and acts of kindness are understandable, for it is written,

Torah, as it is said: 'Acquire truth'". וּבִימֵי הַחַשְׁמוֹנָאִים הָיָה עִקַּר הִתְפַּשְׁטוּת הַתּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה, — **And in the era of the Hasmoneans was the primary expansion of the Oral Torah,** וְ"זֶה לְעֻמַּת זֶה עָשָׂה הָאֱלֹהִים"; — **and "God made one corresponding to the other";** וּמִצַּד הִתְרַבּוּת הַדִּבְרֵי תוֹרָה הָיָה הִתְגַּבְּרוּת חָכְמַת יְוָנִית שֶׁהִיא הֵפֶךְ חָכְמַת תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה, — **and alongside the proliferation of Torah teachings arose the surge of Greek philosophy which is the antithesis of the Oral Torah,** וְהָיָה אָז אֲרִיסְטוֹ רֹאשׁ חַכְמֵי הַיְוָנִים. — **and Aristotle was then the head of Greek sages.** וּמִצַּד חָכְמָתָם הָיָה לָהֶם הִתְנַשְּׂאוּת וְגַסּוּת רוּחַ, — **And from their intellect they developed conceit and haughtiness of spirit,** וְהִתְלוֹצְצוּ מִכָּל אֱמוּנוֹת הַקּוֹדְמוֹת וְאַף מֵעֲבוֹדָה זָרָה וְכִשּׁוּף; — **scoffing at all previous beliefs, even idolatry and sorcery;** וְאָמְנָם רָצוּ לְבַטֵּל גַּם הַתּוֹרָה הַקְּדוֹשָׁה וּדְבַר נְבוּאָה, — **and indeed they sought to abolish the Holy Torah and prophecy as well,** כִּי אָמְרוּ: אִם הָיָה מְצִיאוּת נְבוּאָה בָּעוֹלָם שֶׁהַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ יְדַבֵּר עִם בְּנֵי אָדָם, הֲיוּ הֵם מַשִּׂיגִים זֶה; — **for they argued: had there been reality to prophecy in the world wherein God speaks to mortal man, they themselves would have perceived it;** וּמֵחֲמַת שֶׁלֹּא הִשִּׂיגוּ בְּחָכְמָתָם הַדִּבְרֵי תוֹרָה, לֹא הֶאֱמִינוּ בְּדִבְרֵי תוֹרָה, — **and because they could not grasp through their philosophy the words of Torah, they did not believe in Torah,** שֶׁאָמְרוּ שֶׁאֵין חָכְמָה בָּעוֹלָם רַק מַה שֶּׁהֵם מַשִּׂיגִים, — **asserting that there is no wisdom in the world except that which their minds can fathom,** וְעַל כֵּן נִקְרָאִים "זֵדִים". — **and therefore are they designated "willful arrogants" (zedim).**

Humility keeps learning open to the heart's unexamined motives

יְיַעֲקֹב אָבִינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם זָכָה לַתּוֹרָה עַל יְדֵי שִׁפְלוּתוֹ בְּעֵינָיו,[431] — **And Jacob our Father, peace be upon him, merited the Torah through his humility in his own eyes,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב: "קָטֹנְתִּי מִכֹּל רַחֲמִים וּמִכֹּל הָאֱמֶת", וְנֶאֱמַר: "יַעֲקֹב כִּי קָטֹן הוּא", — **as written: "I am diminished before all Your mercies, etc.", and stated: "For Jacob is small",** דְּדִבְרֵי תוֹרָה מַנִּיחִין מָקוֹם גָּבוֹהַּ וְהוֹלְכִין לְמָקוֹם נָמוּךְ; וְסִימָן לְגַסּוּת הָרוּחַ — **for words of Torah abandon a high place and go to a lowly place; –** עֲנָיוּת דְּתוֹרָה (קִדּוּשִׁין מ"ט עַמּוּד ב');[432] — **and a sign of haughtiness of spirit is poverty of Torah (Kiddushin 49b);** וְאָמְרוּ: "אֵין דִּבְרֵי תוֹרָה מִתְקַיְּמִין אֶלָּא בְּמִי שֶׁמַּמִּית עַצְמוֹ כְּמִי שֶׁאֵינוֹ" (סוֹטָה כ"א עַמּוּד ב').[433] — **and they said: "Words of Torah endure only in one who makes himself as if he were nothing" (Sotah 21b).** וְזֶהוּ "זֵדִים", שֶׁהוּא קְלִפַּת הַגַּאֲוָה, — **And this is "the willful", which is the kelipah of arrogance;** וּבִבְרָכַת הַמִּינִים: "וְכָל הַזֵּדִים וְכוּלְּיהּ", וּבַחֲתִימָה: "וּמַכְנִיעַ זֵדִים", — **and in the Blessing against Heretics: "and all the willful, etc.", and in the conclusion: "and Who subdues the willful",** "בְּיָד שֶׁהוּא שׁוֹבֵר שֶׁכָּפִירָה שָׁבָא מִגַּאֲוָה. שֶׁיִּשְׂרָאֵל נִקְרָאוּ "עוֹסְקֵי תּוֹרָתֶךָ" — **which is the root of blasphemous heresy originating in pride. –** תּוֹרָתֶךָ", — **"Into the hand of those who toil in Your Torah" — for Israel are termed "those who toil in Your Torah",** שֶׁכֵּן הַלָּשׁוֹן תָּמִיד: "כָּל הָעוֹסֵק בַּתּוֹרָה"; — **for such is the standard Talmudic expression: "Whoever toils in Torah";** וְכֵן בְּבִרְכַּת הַתּוֹרָה הַנֹּסַח: "לַעֲסֹק בְּדִבְרֵי תוֹרָה", — **and likewise in the Blessing of the**

'Through kindness and truth, sin is atoned for.' 'Kindness' means acts of kindness, as it says, 'One who pursues righteousness and kindness will find life, righteousness and honor.' 'Truth' means Torah, as it says, 'Buy truth and do not sell it.' But how do we know that one who buries his children also has his sins atoned for? An elder taught him in Rabbi Shimon ben Yochai's name: It is derived by comparing the word 'sin' in two verses. Here it is written, 'Through kindness and truth, sin is atoned for,' and there it is written, 'Who repays the sin of fathers into the bosom of their children.'"

[431] **Tzidkat HaTzadik 85:1**: "When a person thinks that he has accomplished much in the service of God, he should know that he has not touched it at all. Thus the Gemara says, 'A sign of arrogance is poverty in Torah,' for 'a coin in a jar rings noisily,' unlike a full purse. Likewise the Zohar says, 'The sign that one knows nothing is self-praise.' This is not only boasting and arrogance before other people, but even privately, within one's heart. The essence of pride is in the heart, as in 'a lofty heart,' when he thinks this way. Cain offered an inferior thing and thought he had performed a great service; therefore he was angry when it was not accepted. This error comes from forgetting the inclination and its power, and thinking that all the heart's thoughts are only good, with no tendency to evil. God therefore informed him of the evil inclination: 'Sin crouches at the door ….' When he knows this and looks into the chambers of his heart, he will know that he has not acted in complete truth without any ulterior motive or self-interest. God's statement 'You can rule over it' teaches that this too comes from God; understand."

Tzidkat identifies the practical work behind the required humility: looking for motives that self-satisfaction has concealed. The problem can exist without any public boasting. This explains why Peri Tzadik contrasts Torah's receptive smallness with the proud certainty that one already possesses the limits of wisdom.

[432] **Kiddushin 49b**: 'The Gemara further asks: Is that so? But didn't the Master say: A sign of arrogance is poverty, and there is poverty in Babylonia, and not in Eilam. The Gemara answers: To what kind of poverty is this referring? It is poverty with regard to Torah, which was characteristic of Eilam. As it is written: "We have a little sister, and she has no breasts" (Song of Songs 8:8), and Rabbi Yoḥanan said: This refers to Eilam, whose inhabitants merited to learn but did not merit to teach. They did not produce Torah scholars capable of imparting their wisdom to others.'

[433] **Sotah 21b:3**: "What do the Sages do with the verse 'I am wisdom; I dwell with prudence'? They need it for Rabbi Yosei son of Rabbi Chanina's teaching. Rabbi Yosei son of Rabbi Chanina said: Words of Torah endure only in someone who strips himself bare for their sake, as it says, 'I am wisdom; I dwell with prudence,' reading ormah, 'prudence,' as an allusion to arom, 'bare.' Rabbi Yochanan said: Words of Torah endure only in someone who makes himself as though he does not exist, as it says, 'Wisdom is found from nothingness.'"

Torah the text reads: "to toil in the words of Torah", וְהַיְנוּ שֶׁיִּהְיֶה לוֹ עֵסֶק בַּתּוֹרָה, כִּי "לְעָמָל יוּלָּד", **meaning that he should have commercial-like engagement in Torah, for "man is born to toil",** וְהַיְנוּ שֶׁיִּהְיֶה לוֹ עֵסֶק וְלֹא יֵלֵךְ בָּטֵל. **— meaning that he must have an active occupation and not sit idle.** וּבֶאֱמֶת לַעֲמַל תּוֹרָה נִבְרָא, **And in truth for the toil of Torah was he created,** ו"טוֹבִים לְדָנֵי דְּרוּפְתְּקֵי דְּאוֹרַיְתָא" (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב סַנְהֶדְרִין צ״ט עמוד ב׳)[434]; **— and "blessed is he who merits to be sustained and toiled in Torah" (Sanhedrin 99b);** וְעַל כָּל פָּנִים מִי שֶׁנִּצְרָךְ לִהְיוֹת לַעֲסֹק גַּם בַּעֲמַל דֶּרֶךְ אֶרֶץ, **— and at least one who must also engage in the worldly labor of worldly livelihood,** מִכָּל מָקוֹם יִהְיֶה יוֹדֵעַ שֶׁנִּבְרָא רַק לְשַׁמֵּשׁ אֶת קוֹנוֹ, **— nevertheless should know that he was created only to serve his Master,** רַק "הֲרֵעוֹתִי אֶת מַעֲשַׂי וְכוּ'", **— only that "I corrupted my deeds, etc.",** שֶׁאַחַר הַקְּלָקוּל נִתְקַלֵּל אָדָם הָרִאשׁוֹן: "בְּזֵעַת אַפֶּיךָ תֹּאכַל לֶחֶם"; **— for following Adam's fall he was cursed: "By the sweat of your brow you shall eat bread";** וְיִהְיֶה עִקַּר כַּוָּנָתוֹ שֶׁיּוּכַל לְקַבֵּעַ עִתִּים לַתּוֹרָה, **— and his primary aim should be that he may establish fixed times for Torah study,** וּמִי שֶׁאֵינוֹ בַּר הָכִי, יִהְיֶה הַמְּכֻוָּן שֶׁיּוּכַל לְגַדֵּל בָּנָיו לְתַלְמוּד תּוֹרָה. **— and one who is not capable of this, his intent should be that he may raise his sons for Torah study.** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁכָּתַב הָרַמְבַּ"ם זִכְרוֹנוֹ לִבְרָכָה: "שֶׁעַל יְדֵי שֶׁיְּקַיֵּם "בְּכָל דְּרָכֶיךָ דָּעֵהוּ", שֶׁיִּהְיֶה כָּל מַעֲשָׂיו לְשֵׁם שָׁמַיִם, **— And as the Rambam of blessed memory wrote: — that by fulfilling "In all your ways know Him", so all his actions are for Heaven's sake,** יִהְיֶה כָּל מַעֲשָׂיו מַעֲשֶׂה הַמִּצְוָה, **— all his deeds become an actual deed of a mitzvah,** כֵּיוָן שֶׁתַּכְלִית הַמְּכֻוָּן לַעֲבוֹדַת הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ, וְזֶהוּ "עוֹסְקֵי תוֹרָתֶךָ". **— since the ultimate purpose is directed toward the service of the Blessed Name; and this is "those who toil in Your Torah".** וְגַם כָּל מַעֲשֶׂה הַמִּצְוֹות הֵם בִּכְלַל עֵסֶק הַתּוֹרָה, **— And all performance of commandments is also included in the toil of Torah,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמַרְנוּ בְּמַה שֶׁכָּתוּב בַּגְּמָרָא (סוֹטָה כ״א עמוד א׳)[435]: **— as we explained regarding what is stated in the Gemara (Sotah 21a):** "תָּלָה הַכָּתוּב אֶת הַמִּצְוָה בְּנֵר וְאֶת הַתּוֹרָה בְּאוֹר וְכוּ'", **— "Scripture hung the commandment upon a lamp and the Torah upon light, etc.,** לוֹמַר לָךְ: מַה נֵּר אֵינוֹ מְאִירָה אֶלָּא לְפִי שָׁעָה וְכוּ'", **— to tell you: just as a lamp shines only temporarily, etc.",** וּמְפָרֵשׁ בַּגְּמָרָא דְּנֵר מִצְוָה הוּא כְּמוֹ נֵר שֶׁמָּן וּפְתִילָה כְּשֶׁהוּא דּוֹלֵק וּמֵאִיר לְפִי שָׁעָה. **— and the Gemara explains that the lamp of a mitzvah is like a vessel of oil and wick while burning, illuminating temporarily.** וּבַזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ (חֶלֶק ב׳ קס״ו עמוד א׳)[436] אִיתָא: **— And in the Holy Zohar (Part II, 166a) it is found:** דְּהַמִּצְוָה הִיא נֵר, הַיְנוּ שְׁרָגָא שֶׁהוּא שֶׁמֶן וּפְתִילָה בִּלֹא שַׁלְהֶבֶת, **— that the mitzvah is a lamp, meaning an unlit vessel (shraga) with oil and wick without flame,** וּשְׁרָגָא בִּלֹא נְהוֹרָא לָאו כְּלוּם; **— and a lamp without illumination is nothing;** וְהַתּוֹרָה אוֹר הוּא הַנְּהוֹרָא דְּאַדְלִיקַת שְׁרָגָא מִנַּיהּ, עַיֵּן שָׁם. **— and "Torah is light" is the radiant flame that kindles the lamp from it, see there.** וְלִכְאוֹרָה הֵם סוֹתְרִין זֶה אֶת זֶה; **— And ostensibly these two sources contradict each other;**

Intention illuminates a commandment through its actual performance

וְהוּא שֶׁכָּל הַמִּצְוֹות, הַמִּצְוָה עַצְמָהּ **— and we explained that everything is one unified idea:** וְאָמַרְנוּ[437] שֶׁהַכֹּל אֶחָד,

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[434] **Sanhedrin 99b:2**: "Rabbi Elazar said: Every person was created for toil, as it says, 'For man is born to toil.' I do not know whether he was created for the toil of the mouth or for physical labor. When Scripture says, 'For his mouth presses him on,' you must say that he was created for the toil of the mouth. I still do not know whether this is toil in Torah or toil in conversation. When Scripture says, 'This book of the Torah shall not depart from your mouth,' you must say that he was created for toil in Torah. This is what Rava said: All bodies are vessels made for labor; fortunate is one who merits becoming a vessel for the labor of Torah."

[435] **Sotah 21a**: 'The Gemara asks: Does the merit of a mitzva protect one so much as to delay her punishment? But isn't it taught in a baraita: Rabbi Menaḥem bar Yosei interpreted this verse homiletically: "For the mitzva is a lamp and the Torah is light" (Proverbs 6:23). The verse associates the mitzva with a lamp and the Torah with the light of the sun. The mitzva is associated with a lamp in order to say to you: Just as a lamp does not protect one by its light extensively but only temporarily, while the lamp is in one's hand, so too, a mitzva protects one only temporarily, i.e., while one is performing the mitzva.'

[436] **Zohar, Terumah 74:726**: "R. Jose began by speaking on the words: For the commandment is a lamp, and the Torah is a light, and reproofs of instruction are the way oflife (Prov. 6, 23). 'This means', he said, 'that whoever endeavours to keep the commandments in this world will have a lamp lighted for him in the other world through each commandment which he fulfils, and he who studies the Torah will merit the supernal light from which that lamp is lit. For a lamp unlit has no value, and light without a lamp cannot shine, so the one has need of the other. The religious act is necessary to prepare the lamp, and study of the Torah is necessary to light the lamp. Blessed is he who takes it in hand both with light and lamp!'"

[437] **Tiferet Yosef, Rosh Hashanah 4**: "God clothed His light in the garments and acts of the commandments. A person who wishes to attain God's light attains it by fulfilling His will through the performance and deed of the commandments. One must necessarily proceed through their performance and deed; intention alone does not suffice. If intention alone sufficed, why would God have commanded the commandments at all? This shows that through intention alone a person cannot reach God's light, but through practical commandments he attains it. Then he sees explicitly that even the power of this action belongs to God. Holiness becomes firmly established in him, so that he always sees clearly that all the power of action comes from God. This holiness, established through fulfilling His will in the garments and deeds of the commandments, is called Torah, as it is written, 'For a commandment is a lamp, and Torah is light.' By fulfilling His will through the deeds of the commandments, he attains God's light completely and sees that God brings about all things:

הַמַּעֲשֶׂה גַּשְׁמִיִּית הִיא רַק נֵר, שֶׁמֶן וּפְתִילָה בְּלֹא אוֹר כְּלָל; **— and that is, that with all commandments, the physical external act itself is merely a lamp, oil and wick without light at all;** רַק שֶׁבְּכָל מִצְוָה יֵשׁ תּוֹרָה אוֹר, **— except that within every mitzvah there exists "Torah is light",** וְהוּא הַמְּכֻוָּן בְּהַמִּצְוָה לְשֵׁם שָׁמַיִם, **— which is the pure spiritual intent in the mitzvah for Heaven's sake,** שֶׁלֹּא תִּהְיֶה כְּמִצְוַת אֲנָשִׁים מְלֻמָּדָה, **— so that it will not be as a rote commandment learned by rote habit,** וְיַעֲשֶׂה "כַּאֲשֶׁר צִוַּנִי הַשֵּׁם אֱלֹהַי" **— – and he acts "just as Hashem my God commanded me" —** זֶהוּ הַתּוֹרָה אוֹר שֶׁבַּמִּצְוָה, **— this is the light of Torah within the mitzvah,** וְהוּא הַנְּהוֹרָא לְאַדְלָקָה שְׂרָגָא מִנֵּיהּ שָׁכְתַב בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ. **— and it is the radiant flame to kindle the vessel from it which the Holy Zohar describes.** וּמִצְוַת הַתּוֹרָה, הַלִּמּוּד בְּעַצְמוֹ הִיא מִצְוָה כְּכָלָל כָּל מִצְוֹת עֲשֵׂה, **— And regarding the mitzvah of Torah, the act of study itself is a mitzvah like all positive commandments,** וְהִיא גַּם כֵּן נֵר מִצְוָה, שְׂרָגָא בְּלֹא נְהוֹרָא; **— and it too is a "lamp of a mitzvah", an unlit lamp without radiant illumination;** וְהַמְּכֻוָּן לְשֵׁם שָׁמַיִם בְּלִמּוּד הַתּוֹרָה הִיא הַתּוֹרָה הָאוֹר שֶׁבְּמִצְוַת הַתּוֹרָה. **— and the pure intention for Heaven's sake in Torah study is the radiant light within the mitzvah of Torah.** וְהַהֶבְדֵּל שֶׁבֵּין מִצְוָה לְתוֹרָה שֶׁבְּמִצְוָה, הֵינוּ הוּא: **— And the distinction between a physical mitzvah and Torah study is:** מַה שֶּׁאֵין כֵּן הַתּוֹרָה אוֹר שֶׁבְּמִצְוַת לִמּוּד הַתּוֹרָה הַקְּדֻשָּׁה וְהַמְּכֻוָּן שֶׁבָּהּ לְשֵׁם שָׁמַיִם, הוּא מֵאִיר לְפִי שָׁעָה, **— that the light of Torah within a mitzvah, meaning its holiness and selfless intent for Heaven's sake, shines temporarily,** הוּא מֵאִיר לְעוֹלָם; **— unlike the Torah light within the mitzvah of Torah study, which illuminates forever;** וְזֶה מַה שֶּׁכָּתוּב בַּגְּמָרָא דְּמִצְוָה מֵאִיר לְפִי שָׁעָה כְּנֵר, וְתוֹרָה מֵאִיר לְעוֹלָם. **— and this is what the Gemara meant, that a mitzvah shines temporarily like a lamp, and Torah illuminates forever.** וְיָדוּעַ שֶׁכָּל אֶחָד מִיִּשְׂרָאֵל, **— And it is known that every single person of Israel,** אַף מִי שֶׁאֵין לוֹ שׁוּם עֵסֶק בַּתּוֹרָה שֶׁאֵינוֹ בַּר הָכִי כְּלָל **— even one who has no active study in Torah being completely incapable of it,** וְאֵין לוֹ בָּנִים לְגַדְּלָם לְתַלְמוּד תּוֹרָה, **— and lacks sons to raise for Torah study,** מִכָּל מָקוֹם עַל כָּל פָּנִים עוֹסֵק בַּמִּצְוֹת, **— nevertheless is at least engaged in the performance of mitzvot,** וְיֵשׁ בַּמִּצְוֹת גַּם כֵּן אוֹר תּוֹרָה, הֵינוּ הַמְּכֻוָּן וְהַקְּדֻשָּׁה שֶׁבְּמִצְוָה; **— and within the mitzvot there also exists the light of Torah, which is the holy intent and sanctity within the deed;** וְכָל עֵסֶק הַמִּצְוֹת וְנִקְרְאוּ כָּל יִשְׂרָאֵל "עוֹסְקֵי תוֹרָתֶךָ". הֵם תּוֹרָה אוֹר, **— and all involvement in the mitzvot is "Torah is light", and all Israel are appropriately termed "those who toil in Your Torah".** וְאָז זָכוּ יִשְׂרָאֵל מַה שֶּׁנֶּאֱמַר: "אֵל הַשֵּׁם וַיָּאֶר לָנוּ", **— And then Israel merited that which is stated: "God is Hashem, and He shone light upon us",** שֶׁנֶּגֶד מַה שֶּׁחָשְׁבוּ הַזֵּדִים לְהַשְׁכִּיחָם תּוֹרָתֶךָ, **— for counter to what the willful oppressors plotted, to make them forget Your Torah,** אַדְרַבָּה הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרֵךְ הֵאִיר לָנוּ בְּתוֹסֶפֶת אוֹר תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה. **— on the contrary, the Blessed Name illuminated for us an amplified surplus of the light of the Oral Torah.** וּמִפָּסוּק זֶה נִלְמַד **— And from this verse it is derived in the Pesikta that one must recite Hallel on Chanukah,** בַּפְּסִיקְתָא שֶׁצָּרִיךְ לוֹמַר הַלֵּל בַּחֲנֻכָּה, שֶׁעַל יְדֵי מִצְוַת נֵר חֲנֻכָּה בְּעוֹבָדָא דִּלְתַתָּא אִתְעַר עוֹבָדָא לְעֵילָּא **— for through the mitzvah of the Chanukah candle, by physical action below is awakened spiritual action Above** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב זֹהַר חֵלֶק ג׳ צ״ב **— (as written in Zohar Part III, 92a bottom and 92b top).** וְעַל יְדֵי הַדְּלָקַת הַנֵּרוֹת אִתְעַר עוֹבָדָא לְעֵילָּא, **— And through the lighting of the candles, action Above is aroused,** שֶׁהַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרֵךְ מֵאִיר לָנוּ בְּתוֹסֶפֶת אוֹר תּוֹרָה. **— in that the Blessed Name shines for us with an abundant surplus of the light of Torah.**

דְּמִצְוַת נֵר חֲנֻכָּה נִקְרָא בַּמִּדְרָשׁ (תַּנְחוּמָא נָשׂא כ״ט) וּבַפְּסִיקְתָא "מִצְוַת זְקֵנִים", **— For the mitzvah of the Chanukah**

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even the power of his service comes from God. This permanence is called Torah."

Tiferet supplies the complementary safeguard to Peri Tzadik's distinction: the importance of intention does not make the commanded act dispensable. The act is the route through which its divine source becomes recognized, and that recognition can become settled Torah light. The full target later warns against assuming that a previous attainment now frees one from service; this excerpt is not presented as a license to abandon practice.

[438] **Zohar, Emor 17:63-18:74**: 'Observe now that we have learnt that "a fast is as good for a dream as fire for flax", but it must be on the same day, because every day below is controlled by a day above, and therefore if the man fasts, that day does not pass till the adverse decree is annulled, but if he puts it off to another day, then the control belongs to that day. Thus over every day below is appointed a day above, and a man should take heed not to impair that day.'

[439] **Midrash Tanchuma, Nasso 29:1**: ""On the eighth day, the chieftain of the Children of Menashe" (Numbers 7:54). Teach us, our rabbi, what is the status of a light of Chanukah from the first day that has oil remain in it. Can it be lit on the second day? So did our rabbis teach: Regarding a light of Chanukah from the first day that has oil remain in it, one should add at least a tiny amount to it and light it on the second day. And if there was oil left over on the second day, he adds upon it on the third day and lights. And so on with all of the days. But if there was oil left over on the eighth day, he makes it into a bonfire by itself. Why? Since it was put aside for the commandment, it is forbidden to use it for another purpose. A person should not say, "I will not fulfill the commandments of the elders (rabbis), since they are not from the Torah." The Holy One, blessed be He, said to them, "My children, you are not allowed to say this. Rather, observe anything that they decree upon you, as it is stated (Deuteronomy 17:10-11), 'And you shall do according to ... the law that they shall instruct you.'" Why? Because I also agree with their words, as it is stated (Job 22:28), "You will decree and it will be fulfilled for you." You should know, as behold what is written about Yaakov at the time that he blessed Menashe

candle is called in the Midrash (Tanchuma Nasso 29) and Pesikta "the commandment of the elders"; וְהַטַּעַם, דְּכָל מִצְוֹות דְּרַבָּנָן יֵשׁ לָהֶם שֹׁרֶשׁ בַּתּוֹרָה: כְּמוֹ עֵירוּבִין — **and the reason is that all Rabbinic commandments have a root in the Torah: –** מִשְׁמֶרֶת וּסְיָג שֶׁלֹּא יָבֹאוּ לְטַלְטֵל בִּרְשׁוּת הָרַבִּים, וְדָבָר זֶה אַסְמְכוּהָ אַקְרָא "וּשְׁמַרְתֶּם אֶת מִשְׁמַרְתִּי" — **such as eruvin — a guard and fence so they do not come to carry in the public domain, –** "עֲשׂוּ מִשְׁמֶרֶת לְמִשְׁמַרְתִּי"[440] — **and this they anchored to the verse "And you shall safeguard My charge" — "make a safeguard for My safeguard" (Yevamot 21a);** וּמִצְוַת מְגִלָּה לָמְדוּ מִקַּל וָחֹמֶר (מְגִלָּה י״ד עַמּוּד א׳):[441] — **and the mitzvah of Megillah they derived from an a fortiori inference (Megillah 14a):** "וּמַה מַּעֲבָדוּת לְחֵרוּת כּוּלֵּיהּ, מִמִּיתָה לְחַיִּים לֹא כָּל שֶׁכֵּן?", **"If from slavery to freedom we recite praise, from death to life is it not all the more so?",** וַהֲרֵי כְּתִיב בַּתּוֹרָה שֶׁהַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא קָבַע מוֹעֵד בְּפֶסַח לְזֵכֶר נֵס יְצִיאַת מִצְרַיִם מַעֲבָדוּת לְחֵרוּת, — **and behold it is written in the Torah that the Holy One established an appointed festival on Pesach in commemoration of the Exodus from slavery to freedom,** וְקַל וָחֹמֶר נְתַן מַה שֶּׁאֵין כֵּן מִצְוַת נֵר חֲנֻכָּה שֶׁאֵין לוֹ שֹׁרֶשׁ לִדְרֹשׁ; — **and an a fortiori inference is authorized to be expounded;** בַּתּוֹרָה וְרַק מִצְוַת זְקֵנִים. — **unlike the mitzvah of the Chanukah candle which has no explicit textual prototype in the Torah, being purely a commandment of the elders.**

A command originating with the sages still draws on the divine command

וְזֶה הַטַּעַם שֶׁשָּׁאֲלוּ בַּגְּמָרָא (שַׁבָּת כ״ג עַמּוּד א׳): "וְהֵיכָן צִוָּנוּ וְכוּלֵּיהּ",[442, 443] — **And this is the reason they asked in the Gemara (Shabbat 23a): "And where did He command us, etc.",** וְלָמָּה שָׁאֲלוּ רַק עַל מִצְוַת נֵר חֲנֻכָּה — **and why did they ask only regarding the mitzvah of the Chanukah candle** וְלֹא שָׁאֲלוּ עַל שְׁאָר מִצְוֹות דְּרַבָּנָן כְּמוֹ מְגִלָּה וְעֵירוּבִין, שֶׁמְּבֹרָכִים גַּם כֵּן "אֲשֶׁר קִדְּשָׁנוּ בְּמִצְוֹתָיו וְצִוָּנוּ" — **and not regarding other Rabbinic mitzvot such as Megillah reading and eruvin, –** הֵיכָן צִוָּנוּ? — **where we also recite "Who sanctified us with His commandments and commanded us" — where did He command us?** רַק דְּשָׁם יֵשׁ לְהַמִּצְוָה שֹׁרֶשׁ גַּם כֵּן בַּתּוֹרָה, מַה שֶּׁאֵין כֵּן מִצְוַת נֵר חֲנֻכָּה שֶׁהִיא רַק מִצְוַת זְקֵנִים כָּאָמוּר. — **Only because there the mitzvah has an anchor in the Torah as well, — unlike the mitzvah of the Chanukah candle which is purely an enactment of the elders as stated.** וְזֶה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר בְּמִדְרַשׁ תַּנְחוּמָא: "לֹא יֹאמַר — **And this is what is stated in Midrash Tanchuma:** אָדָם: אֵינִי מְקַיֵּם מִצְוַת זְקֵנִים הוֹאִיל וְאֵינָם מִן הַתּוֹרָה וְכוּלֵּיהּ, אֶלָּא כָּל מַה שֶּׁגּוֹזְרִים עֲלֵיכֶם תִּהְיוּ מְקַיְּמִים וְכוּלֵּיהּ". — **"Let not a person say: I will not fulfill the commandment of the elders since it is not from the Torah, etc., — rather, whatever they decree upon you fulfill, etc.,** לָמָּה? שָׁאנִי עַל דִּבְרֵיהֶם אֲנִי מַסְכִּים וְכוּלֵּיהּ". — **why? Because even to their words I give My consent, etc."** וּבַפְּסִיקְתָּא הַגִּרְסָא: — **And in the Pesikta the reading is:** "לָמָּה? שֶׁאַף עָלַי הֵן גּוֹזְרִין, שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: 'וְתִגְזַר אֹמֶר וְיָקָם לָךְ' וְכוּלֵּיהּ". — **"Why? Because upon Me too they decree, as it is said: 'You shall decree a thing and it shall be established for you', etc."** וְהַיְנוּ שֶׁכָּל הַתּוֹרָה דְּרָכָיו שֶׁל

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and Ephraim? "And he placed Ephraim before Menashe" (Genesis 48:20). He made the younger go before the older; and the Holy One, blessed be He, fulfilled his decree. When? During the sacrifices of the chieftains, such that the tribe of Ephraim sacrificed first, as it is stated (Numbers 7:48), "On the seventh day, the chieftain of the Children of Ephraim," and only afterwards was the sacrifice of Menashe. From where do we know this? From that what they read about the matter, "On the eighth day, the chieftain of the Children of Menashe" (Numbers 7:54)."

[440] **Yevamot 21a:12**: "Rav Kahana said: It is learned from here: 'You shall guard My charge'—make a protective guard for My charge."

[441] **Megillah 14a**: 'The Gemara asks: What exposition led them to determine that this was a proper mode of action? On what basis did they add this mitzva? Rabbi Ḥiyya bar Avin said that Rabbi Yehoshua ben Korḥa said that they reasoned as follows: If, when recalling the exodus from Egypt, in which the Jews were delivered from slavery to freedom, we recite songs of praise, the Song of the Sea and the hymns of hallel, then, in order to properly recall the miracle of Purim and commemorate God's delivering us from death to life, is it not all the more so the case that we must sing God's praise by reading the story in the Megilla?'

[442] **Shabbat 23a:7**: "What blessing does one recite? One blesses: 'Who has sanctified us with His commandments and commanded us to kindle the Chanukah lamp.' Where did He command us? Rav Avya said: In 'You shall not turn aside' from the Sages' ruling. Rav Nechemyah said: 'Ask your father and he will tell you; your elders, and they will say to you.'"

[443] **Resisei Layla 56:13**: "This is the inclusion of Oral Torah in Written Torah. In truth everything is alluded to in Written Torah, and 'everything that an accomplished student will eventually innovate was said to Moses at Sinai.' Everything is God's word in its root and source, for from there it is taken, and it is all complete Torah and the word that God spoke. From this aspect of the general life in Oral Torah, which comes from God's word—'According to the Torah they teach you,' 'Do not turn aside from the matter,' and 'Ask your father'—we bless over rabbinic commandments, 'Who sanctified us with His commandments and commanded us,' as the Gemara states. This too is God's command in its general form. This life can be captured in writing like other written matters, but it spreads into a particular writing in that particular matter which the sages innovated."
Resisei distinguishes the sages' particular innovation from its general source in God's command to receive their Torah. That distinction clarifies how Peri Tzadik can call Chanukah specifically a commandment of the elders and still retain the blessing "Who commanded us." The passage does not by itself establish Peri Tzadik's further homily that God lights the Chanukah lamp; it explains the authority on which that next step rests.

הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא, — **And that means that the entire Torah reflects the conduct of the Holy One, Blessed be He,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב (בִּירוּשַׁלְמִי פֶּרֶק א׳ דְּרֹאשׁ הַשָּׁנָה הֲלָכָה ג׳)[444] — **and as written (Yerushalmi Rosh Hashanah, Chapter 1, Halachah 3)** שֶׁהַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא גּוֹזֵר גְּזֵרָה וּמְקַיְּמָהּ תְּחִלָּה וְכוּלֵיהּ: — **that the Holy One decrees an ordinance and fulfills it first, etc.:** "אֲנִי הוּא שֶׁשָּׁמַרְתִּי מִצְוֹתֶיהָ שֶׁל תּוֹרָה תְּחִלָּה", — **"I am He Who kept the commandments of the Torah first",** וְנִצְטַוּוּ יִשְׂרָאֵל לָלֶכֶת בִּדְרָכָיו יִתְבָּרַךְ וּלְקַיֵּם הַמִּצְוֹות. — **and Israel were commanded to walk in His ways and fulfill the commandments.** וְזֶה שֶׁאָמַר "שֶׁאַף עָלַי הֵן גּוֹזְרִין", — **And this is what he stated: "that upon Me too they decree",** וְהֵבִינוּ שֶׁגַּם הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא מְקַיֵּם מִצְוַת זְקֵנִים כְּמוֹ שֶׁמְּקַיֵּם כָּל מִצְוֹות הַתּוֹרָה. — **meaning that the Holy One also fulfills the commandments of the elders just as He fulfills all commandments of the Torah.** וְהוּא כֵּיוָן שֶׁצִּוָּנוּ מִ"לֹא תָסוּר" אוֹ מִמַּה שֶּׁנֶּאֱמַר "שְׁאַל אָבִיךָ וְיַגֶּדְךָ" לְקַיֵּם מִצְוַת זְקֵנִים, — **And because He commanded us from "You shall not deviate" or from "Ask your father and he will tell you" to fulfill the enactments of the elders,** וְהֵם תִּקְּנוּ וְצִוּוּ לְהַדְלִיק נֵר חֲנֻכָּה, — **and they instituted and commanded to kindle the Chanukah lights,** גַּם הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ כְּבֶיכוֹל מַדְלִיק נֵר חֲנֻכָּה שֶׁמְּקַיֵּם הַמִּצְוָה. — **the Blessed Name also, as it were, kindles the Chanukah light by fulfilling the mitzvah.** וְזֶה מַה שֶּׁנֶּאֱמַר: "אֵל הַשֵּׁם וַיָּאֶר לָנוּ", — **And this is what Scripture states: "God is Hashem, and He shone light upon us",** שֶׁמַּאִיר לָנוּ בַּחֲנֻכָּה בְּתוֹסֶפֶת אוֹרָה בְּאוֹר תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה. — **that He illuminates for us on Chanukah with increased brilliance in the light of the Oral Torah.** וְזֶה נֵר חֲנֻכָּה שֶׁהַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ מְקַיֵּם גַּם כֵּן תְּחִלָּה, — **And this is the Chanukah light which the Blessed Name fulfills first as well,** שֶׁמַּשְׁפִּיעַ בְּיִשְׂרָאֵל תּוֹסֶפֶת אוֹר תּוֹרָה. — **bestowing into Israel a surplus of Torah light.** וְעַל יְדֵי אוֹר הַתּוֹרָה נִצּוֹלִים מִשָּׁלֹשׁ קְלִפּוֹת הַיֵּצֶר הָרָע, — **And through the light of the Torah we are rescued from the three kelipot of the Evil Inclination,** שֶׁהֵם רָאשֵׁי תֵּבוֹת חֹשֶׁךְ: "חֲמוֹר", "שׁוֹר", "כֶּלֶב", — **which form the acronym Choshech: Chamor, Shor, Kelev,** שֶׁהֵם כְּלוּלִים בְּקְלִפַּת הַגַּאֲוָה שֶׁהָיָה שֹׁרֶשׁ קְלִפַּת יְוָנִים. — **which are unified within the kelipah of arrogance that served as the root of the Greeks' defilement.** וְזֶה שֶׁקָּרְאוּם "יְמֵי חֲנֻכָּה", — **And this is why they designated them "the days of Chanukah",** שֶׁהֵם חֲנֻכָּה לְאוֹר שֶׁיָּאִיר לָנוּ. — **for they are a dedication and inception for the light that will illuminate for us.** וְעַל יְדֵי כֵן לֵב יִשְׂרָאֵל נַעֲשֶׂה מָדוֹר לַשְּׁכִינָה, — **And through this the heart of a Jew becomes a dwelling place for the Shechinah,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בְּמִדְרַשׁ הַנֶּעֱלָם (זֹהַר חֲלָק א׳ קל״ח עַמּוּד א׳): "לֹא יָרֵעוּ וְלֹא יַשְׁחִיתוּ בְּכָל הַר קָדְשִׁי'[445] — הוּא לְבָא דְּמְדוֹרֵיהּ דְּיֵצֶר הָרָע בֵּיהּ". — **and as written in Midrash HaNe'elam (Zohar Part I, 138a): – "'They shall not hurt nor destroy in all My holy mountain' — this is the heart wherein is the residence of the Evil Inclination."** וְ"הַר קָדְשִׁי" נִקְרָא הַבַּיִת הַמְּקֻדָּשׁ, — **And "My holy mountain" refers to the**

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[444] **Jerusalem Talmud Rosh Hashanah 1:3:5**: “Rebbi Eleazar said, παρά βασιλέως ‘ο νόμος ’άγραφος. Usually in the world a king of flesh and blood decides a decision. If he desires it, he keeps it. If he desires it, others keep it. But the Holy One, praise to Him, is not so but if He decides a decision He keeps it first. What is the reason? They have to keep My watch, I am the Eternal, I am He Who keeps the commandments of the Torah first. Rebbi Simon said, it is written, before white hairs you have to stand, and honor the presence of an elderly person, and to fear your God, I am the Eternal. I am He Who first stood before an elderly person. Rebbi Simon said, it is written: for who is a great people which has just laws and ordinances, etc. For who is this great people that has God close to it. Rebbi Ḥama ben Rebbi Ḥanina and Rebbi Hoshaia. One said, is there a people like this people? Usually in the world a person who knows that he will stand in trial dresses in black, wears black headdress, and lets his beard grow, since he does not know how his trial will end. But Israel are not so, but they wear white, wear white headdress, cut their beard, eat, and drink, and are happy. They know that the Holy One, praise to Him, will perform wonders for them. But the other one said, is there a people like this people? Usually in the world if the ruler says, the trial is today, but the robber says, tomorrow is the trial, whom does one listen to, not the ruler? But the Holy One, praise to Him, is not like this. If the Court said, today is New Year’s Day, the Holy One, praise to Him, says to the angels of service, put up the dais, summon defenders, summon accusers, for My children said that today is New Year’s Day. If the Court took counsel to transfer it to the next day, the Holy One, praise to Him, says to the angels of service, remove the dais, remove the defenders, remove the accusers, for My children took counsel to transfer to tomorrow. What is the reason? Certainly, it is a rule for Israel, a law of the God of Jacob. If it is not a rule for Israel, so to speak it is not a law for the God of Jacob. Rebbi Crispus in the name of Rebbi Joḥanan: In the past, the festive times of the Eternal, from then and onwards which You shall declare. Rebbi Ila said, if you declare them they are My festive times, otherwise they are not My festive times. Rebbi Simon said, it is written, great things You did, You, Eternal my God, Your wonders and intentions regarding us. In the past, great things You did; from then onwards, Your wonders and intentions regarding us. Rebbi Joshua ben Levi said, a parable of a king who had a watch; when his son came of age, he handed it to him. Rebbi Yose ben Ḥanina said, a parable of a king who had a watch-box; when his son came of age, he handed it to him. Rebbi Aḥa said, a parable of a king who had a ring; when his son came of age, he handed it to him. Rebbi Ḥiyya bar Abba said, a parable of a carpenter who had carpenter’s tools; when his son came of age, he handed them to him. Rebbi Isaac said, a parable of a king who had treasures; when his son came of age, he handed them to him. But the rabbis say, a parable of a healer who had a box of medicines; when his son came of age, he handed it to him.”

[445] **Zohar, Toldot 4:25-30**: ‘AND HE CALLED HIS NAME JACOB. It was God who called him so. (So, too, it is written lower down, “Hath he not rightly called his name Jacob?” (Gen. 27, 36) and not “his name was called”.) God saw that the primeval serpent was full of guile to do mischief, and so when Jacob appeared He said: “Behold, here is one who can stand up to him”, and therefore He called him Ya’kob, akin to the term vaya’kebeni (and he acted toward me with guile) (Gen. 27, 35).’

Holy Temple, ;"וַהֲבִיאוֹתִים אֶל הַר קָדְשִׁי": כְּמַה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר — **as Scripture states: "And I will bring them to My holy mountain";** ? וְלָמָּה נִקְרָא הַלֵּב "הַר קָדְשִׁי" — **so why is the heart called "My holy mountain"?** וּלְפִי הָאֲמוּר מוּבָן, שֶׁהַבַּיִת הַמִּקְדָּשׁ הוּא מִשְׁכָּן לַשְׁכִינָה, — **And according to what was stated it is understood: for the Temple is a sanctuary for the Shechinah,** וּכְשֶׁזּוֹכִים לַעֲקֹר הַיֵּצֶר הָרָע מֵהַלֵּב, נַעֲשָׂה הַלֵּב מִשְׁכָּן לַשְׁכִינָה וְנִקְרָא "הַר קָדְשִׁי". — **and when we merit to uproot the Evil Inclination from the heart, the heart becomes a sanctuary for the Shechinah and is called "My holy mountain".** וּבִימֵי חֲנֻכָּה שֶׁזּוֹכִים "אֵל הַשֵּׁם וַיָּאֶר לָנוּ", — **And during the days of Chanukah when we merit "God is Hashem and He shone light upon us",** שֶׁמַּאִיר לָנוּ בְּתוֹסֶפֶת אוֹר תּוֹרָה וְנִיצּוֹלִים מֵחֹשֶׁךְ שֶׁל הַיֵּצֶר הָרָע — **illuminating for us an increased light of Torah and rescuing us from the darkness of the Evil Inclination** שֶׁהוּא הַשְּׁלֹשָׁה קְלִפּוֹת רָאשֵׁי תֵּבוֹת חֹשֶׁ"ךְ, — **which represents the three kelipot forming the acronym Choshech,** נַעֲשָׂה הַלֵּב מִשְׁכָּן לַשְׁכִינָה שֶׁנִּקְרָא "הַר קָדְשִׁי", — **the heart becomes a sanctuary for the Divine Presence called "My holy mountain",** וְעַל זֶה עוֹשִׂין חֲנֻכָּה. — **and for this reason do we celebrate Chanukah (dedication).** וְהוּא עִנְיַן מַה שֶּׁכָּתוּב בְּתִקּוּנֵי זֹהַר (תִּקּוּן י״ג):[446] — **And this is the meaning of what is written in Tikunei Zohar (Tikun 13):** "תְּמִינָאָה בְּהוֹדָאָה וְכוּלֵיהּ וְדָא הוֹד וַדַּאי וְכוּלֵיהּ, — **"The eighth sefirah is in thanksgiving (hoda'ah), etc., and this is surely Hod (Splendor), etc.,** וּבֵיהּ שְׁבַח מֹשֶׁה 'אָז יָשִׁיר מֹשֶׁה' בְּגִין דְּאִיהוּ הוֹד דִּיהִיב לְמֹשֶׁה וְכוּלֵיהּ", — **and through it Moses praised: 'Then sang Moses', because it is Hod which was given to Moses, etc.",** וְכֵן הוּא בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ בְּכָל מָקוֹם. — **and so it is throughout the Holy Zohar in many places.** וְאַף דְּיָדוּעַ דְּמֹשֶׁה וְאַהֲרֹן מֶרְכָּבָה לְמִדַּת נֶצַח וְהוֹד, — **And even though it is known that Moses and Aaron are the chariot for Netzach and Hod,** מֹשֶׁה מֶרְכָּבָה לְמִדַּת נֶצַח וְהוֹד דַּרְגָּא דְּאַהֲרֹן, — **Moses being the chariot for Netzach and Hod being the level of Aaron,** וְכָאן אָמַר דְּנָתַן הַהוֹד לְמֹשֶׁה; — **yet here it says that He gave Hod to Moses;** אֲךָ הָעִנְיָן, דְּנֶצַח מִקַּו יָמִנִי וְהוֹד מִקַּו שְׂמָאלִי, — **however, the explanation is that Netzach stems from the right axis and Hod from the left axis,** וְהוּא תּוֹרָה שֶׁבִּכְתָב מִימִינָא וְתוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה מִשְּׂמָאלָא, — **which corresponds to the Written Torah from the right and the Oral Torah from the left,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בְּתִקּוּנֵי זֹהַר (תִּקּוּן כ״א):[447] — **and as written in Tikunei Zohar (Tikun 21):** "מִימִינָא אִתְיְהִיבַת אוֹרַיְתָא דִּבְכְתָב, וּמִשְּׂמָאלָא אִתְיְהִיבַת אוֹרַיְתָא דִּבְעַל פֶּה". — **"From the right was given the Written Torah, and from the left was given the Oral Torah".** וְכֵן כָּתַב בְּהַקְדָּמַת תִּקּוּנֵי זֹהַר: — **And so he wrote in the introduction to Tikunei Zohar:** 'מִימִינוֹ אֵשׁ דָּת לָמוֹ', דִּכְתִיב: "תּוֹרָה שֶׁבִּכְתָב מִימִינָא, וְכֵן הוּא בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ. וְתוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה מִפִּי הַגְּבוּרָה נִתְּנָה", — **"The Written Torah from the right, as it is written: 'From His right hand a fiery law for them', — and the Oral Torah was given from the mouth of Gevurah", and so it is in the Holy Zohar.**

וְאִיתָא (בָּבָא בַּתְרָא י״ב עַמּוּד א'):[448] — **And it states (Bava Batra 12a):** "אַף עַל פִּי שֶׁנִּטְלָה מִן הַנְּבִיאִים, מִן הַחֲכָמִים לֹא נִטְלָה", — **"Even though it was taken from the prophets, from the sages it was not taken",** וּפֵרֵשׁ הָרַמְבַּ"ן שֶׁהוּא עַל יְדֵי מַדְרֵגַת רוּחַ הַקֹּדֶשׁ — **and the Ramban explained that this is through the level of Divine Inspiration (Ruach HaKodesh)** שֶׁמְּכַוְּנִים לַהֲלָכָה לְמֹשֶׁה מִסִּינַי, — **whereby their minds align with the Halachah given to Moses at Sinai,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ בַּגְּמָרָא: — **and as they stated in the Gemara:** "דְּמִתְאַמְרָא מִשְּׁמֵיהּ דְּרַבִּי עֲקִיבָא כְּוָתֵיהּ וְכוּלֵיהּ, — **"That a teaching is said in the name of Rabbi Akiva like his view,** וּמִתַּאֲמְרָא הֲלָכָה לְמֹשֶׁה מִסִּינַי כְּוָתֵיהּ". — **and is found to be stated as a Halachah to Moses from Sinai according with him".** וְכֵינָן שֶׁאָמְרוּ בַּגְּמָרָא הַלָּשׁוֹן "מִן הַחֲכָמִים לֹא נִטְלָה", — **And since they phrased it in the Gemara "from the sages it was not taken",** מְבֹאָר שָׁבָא עַל יְדֵי נְבוּאָה. וְנֶצַח וְהוֹד — **it is evident that it operates through prophetic illumination. –** "תְּרֵין נְבִיאֵי קְשׁוֹט", — **And Netzach and Hod are "the two true prophets",** וְהֵינוּ אַסְפַּקְלַרְיָא דְּנָהֲרָא וַאֲסַפְּקְלַרְיָא דְּלָא נָהֲרָא כַּיְדוּעַ; — **representing the luminous mirror and the non-luminous mirror, as is known;** וְכֵן שֵׁם שֶׁכְּנֶגְדָּם "צְבָאוֹת", כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב (זֹהַר חֵלֶק ג' י״א עַמּוּד ב');[449] — **and**

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[446] **Tikkunei Zohar 27a:8-30a:1**: ‘And with it Hod Moses praised ‘then’. It is this that is written (Ex. 15:1) Then did Moses sing... Because it is Hod that He gave to Moses. (Is. 58:9) ‘‘Az’ you shall call, and Ha-Shem shall answer... And it is Var. and they are the eight days of circumcision, and, following them, the covenant which is Yesod – the ‘Righteous-One of the world’, and through which is revealed’

[447] **Tikkunei Zohar 42b:2-63a:9**: ‘(Ruth 3:13) ... as Y”Y lives lie down until the morning, which is the right-side, in which is the power of the Written Torah, which is the Middle Pillar, for the Written Torah is given from the right-side, and from the left-side is given the Oral Torah, which is ‘female’. And because of this ‘good’, the Righteous-One, ‘the life-force of the worlds’, is from the left-hand side, for it is ‘the mighty-one who conquers his evil inclination’ – which is Samael.’

[448] **Bava Batra 12a**: ‘§ In connection with Rabbi Yosei’s statement that Sumakhos’s words are nothing but words of prophecy, the Gemara reports that Rabbi Avdimi from Haifa says: From the day that the Temple was destroyed prophecy was taken from the prophets and given to the Sages. The Gemara expresses astonishment: Is that to say that a Sage is not fit to be a prophet? Rabbi Avdimi seems to say that these are two distinct categories of people. The Gemara explains: This is what Rabbi Avdimi is saying: Even though prophecy was taken from the prophets, it was not taken from the Sages.’

[449] **Zohar, Vayikra 24:175**: “The seventh and eighth are Tzevaot. Therefore the name YHWH is close to everything,

likewise the divine Name corresponding to them is Tzeva'ot, as written (Zohar Part III, 11b); וְעַל פִּי מַה שֶּׁכָּתוּב בַּגְּמָרָא (בְּרָכוֹת ל״א עַמּוּד ב׳)[450]: **— and according to what is stated in the Gemara (Berachot 31b):** "לֹא הָיָה אָדָם שֶׁקָּרָאוֹ לְהַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא 'צְבָאוֹת' עַד שֶׁבָּאתָה חַנָּה וּקְרָאַתּוּ 'צְבָאוֹת' וְכוּלֵיהּ", **— "No man had called the Holy One Tzeva'ot until Hannah came and called Him Tzeva'ot, etc.",** וּמִמֶּנָּה יָצָא שְׁמוּאֵל שֶׁשָּׁקוּל כְּשְׁנֵי אֲנָשִׁים, וּמַאן (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב שָׁם)[451] מֹשֶׁה וְאַהֲרֹן — **and from her issued Samuel who is equivalent to two giants, –** אִנּוּן — **and who are they — Moses and Aaron (as written there),** וּשְׁמוּאֵל רַבָּן שֶׁל נְבִיאִים. — **and Samuel is the master of the prophets.** וְלָכֵן אַהֲרֹן, דִּכְתִיב: "כִּי שִׂפְתֵי כֹהֵן יִשְׁמְרוּ דַעַת וְתוֹרָה יְבַקְשׁוּ מִפִּיהוּ", **— And therefore Aaron, concerning whom it is written: "For the priest's lips shall guard knowledge and they shall seek Torah from his mouth",** רוּחַ הַקֹּדֶשׁ, (כִּי תִשָּׂא): פֵּרֵשׁ רַבִּי שְׁלֹמֹה יִצְחָקִי[452] בְּ"דַעַת" — **and on "knowledge" Rashi explains (Ki Tisa): Divine Inspiration,** כְּלוֹמַר רוּחַ מֵהַהוּא קֹדֶשׁ דִּלְעֵילָּא, כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ (שָׁם ס״א עַמּוּד א׳)[453] — **meaning a spirit from that supreme Holiness Above, as written in the Holy Zohar (ibid. 61a);** וְאַהֲרֹן שֹׁרֶשׁ תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה הוּא מֶרְכָּבָה לְמִדַּת הוֹד. — **and Aaron the root of the Oral Torah is the chariot for the attribute of Hod.** וּמֹשֶׁה רַבֵּנוּ שֶׁהוּא שֹׁרֶשׁ תּוֹרָה שֶׁבִּכְתָב שֶׁהוּא מִימִינָא, — **And Moses our Teacher who is the root of the Written Torah which is from the right,** הוּא מֶרְכָּבָה לְמִדַּת נָצַח שֶׁהוּא מִיָּמִין. — **is the chariot for the attribute of Netzach which is on the right.**

Different forms of Torah attainment have different strengths

אֲמְנָם מָצִינוּ בְּכָל מָקוֹם "הֲלָכָה לְמֹשֶׁה מִסִּינַי",[454,455] **— However, we find everywhere "a Halachah to Moses from**

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joined on every side. Sometimes it is YHWH Elohim, for they are close: Tiferet to Gevurah. Sometimes it is YHWH Tzevaot, for they are close: Tiferet to Netzach and Hod, which are called Tzevaot. We have explained that the words of the faithful prophets could be recognized from their mouths—when they said, "Thus says YHWH Elohim," and when they said, "Thus says YHWH Tzevaot." They knew from which place the words came."

[450] **Berakhot 31b:6**: "'She vowed a vow and said: Lord of Hosts.' Rabbi Elazar said: From the day the Holy One, blessed be He, created His world, no person called the Holy One, blessed be He, 'Lord of Hosts' until Channah came and called Him 'Lord of Hosts.'"

[451] **Berakhot 31b:17**: "What does Channah mean by asking for 'offspring of men'? Rav says: A man distinguished among men. Shmuel says: A child who will anoint two men. Who are they? Shaul and David. Rabbi Yochanan says: A child equal in stature to two men. Who are they? Moshe and Aharon, as it says, 'Moshe and Aharon among His priests, and Shmuel among those who call His name.' The Sages say: 'Offspring of men' means a child who blends in among other men."

[452] **Rashi on Exodus 31:3**: 'And I have filled him with the spirit of God, in wisdom (be-chokhmah), and in understanding (u-vi-tevunah), and in knowledge (u-ve-da'at)' (Exodus 31:3): Rashi explains: Chokhmah is what a person hears from others and learns; Tevunah is understanding a matter from within one's own heart out of what one has learned; and Da'at is the Holy Spirit (Ruach HaKodesh).'

[453] **Zohar, Achrei Mot 12:87**: "We learned before the master: What is "holy"? The perfection of everything, called supernal Wisdom. … "Holy spirit"—that is, a spirit from that holiness above. When the mysteries of Torah issue and are aroused from it, it is then called "the holy tongue.""

[454] **Dover Tzedek, Miscellany 4:80**: "Therefore, although Moses did not understand Rabbi Akiva's words, as stated in Menachot, his mind was settled when the students asked, 'From where do you know this?'—perhaps you erred? Rabbi Akiva had to answer, 'A halakhah to Moses from Sinai,' for with Moses there is no error. In Rabbi Akiva's wisdom, however, the wisdom of Oral Torah, clarification comes only when God illuminates his eyes that this ruling is a halakhah to Moses from Sinai. As the Sages say, everything that an accomplished student will eventually innovate was said to Moses at Sinai. This means that it is true wisdom (he finds where it is alluded to in Written Torah, for nothing is absent from its allusions; Written Torah is Moses' wisdom, and there the matter is present at least by allusion). That is, he recognizes and knows that it is certainly a halakhah to Moses from Sinai, and that his innovation is the innovation of an accomplished student."

Dover explains what the appeal to Sinai resolves: greater analytic elaboration does not, by itself, rule out error. The matching tradition provides clarification. The opening of the same paragraph describes Oral Torah through the metaphor of seeing from behind; its continuation preserves the advantage of Moses' direct clarity. That distinction makes Peri Tzadik's two different measures of attainment intelligible without reducing the scene to a competition over who knows more details.

[455] **Sod Yesharim, The First Day of Pesach 6:2**: "Moses is like a son to God. By nature, a son who is accustomed to the place, raised in his father the king's house and continually dwelling there, does not regard its precious things, novelties, and wonders as novel, because he is used to them. What a person is continually accustomed to does not appear new to him. But someone who is not a member of the king's household and was not raised there, and occasionally enters its court, finds everything he sees novel. Because he is not accustomed to such precious things, he examines every object in the king's house; they are wonders upon wonders to him, all full of novelty. Thus Moses, being like a son raised in his father the king's house and continually dwelling in his court, naturally directs his whole attention only to knowing the root of his father's will. He looks only at what is essential to that will. The matters surrounding the will, through which the king's will can be recognized, are not needed by the son; they do not warrant his directing his eyes toward them, for to him they are incidental and additional, not the essential matter. Therefore it was not fitting for Moses to expound heaps of laws on every stroke. Rabbi Akiva, however, formerly stood far away and came from a distant land into the king's court, for he descended from converts. Every object he saw there was therefore precious to him and a marvelous novelty. To attain the one matter—the recognition of the light of His unity—he had to examine every stroke in the king's

Sinai", וְכֵיוָן שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר מִסִּינַי, לָמָּה לֹא נִכְתַּב? — **and since it was stated from Sinai, why was it not recorded in the Written Torah?** וְאָמַרְנוּ שֶׁהוּא תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה שֶׁל מֹשֶׁה רַבֵּנוּ, — **And we explained that it is the Oral Torah of Moses our Teacher,** שֶׁהוֹפִיעַ הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ בְּדַעְתּוֹ שֶׁל מֹשֶׁה וְחִדְּשָׁם בְּפִלְפּוּלוֹ. — **which the Blessed Name shone into the intellect of Moses and he innovated through his analysis.** וְעַל זֶה אָמְרוּ (נְדָרִים ל״ח עמוד א׳): "אֶלָּא פִּלְפּוּלָא בְּעָלְמָא"[456], — **And regarding this they stated (Nedarim 38a): "Only dialectical analysis alone",** שֶׁזֶּה מָסַר הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ רַק לְמֹשֶׁה. — **which the Blessed Name transmitted to Moses alone.** וְנִקְרָא "הֲלָכָה לְמֹשֶׁה מִסִּינַי", — **And it is called "Halachah to Moses from Sinai",** שֶׁמֹּשֶׁה רַבֵּנוּ יָדַע מְפֹרָשׁ שֶׁהֵם מִסִּינַי כְּמוֹ כָּל תּוֹרָה שֶׁבִּכְתָב, — **because Moses our Teacher knew explicitly that they are from Sinai like all Written Torah,** וּמֹשֶׁה מָסָרָן לְיִשְׂרָאֵל כְּהֶלְכָתָא בְּלֹא טַעֲמָא. — **and Moses delivered them to Israel as raw halachot without revealed rationale.** וְעַל טַעֲמָם לֹא יוּכַל אָדָם לַעֲמֹד בְּכֹחַ נְבוּאָה רַק מֹשֶׁה רַבֵּנוּ, — **And upon their rationale no mortal can stand via prophetic power except Moses our Teacher,** דִּכְתִיב: "וְלֹא קָם נָבִיא עוֹד וְגוֹמֵר", — **as it is written: "And there did not arise another prophet like Moses, etc.",** רַק עַל יְדֵי בְּחִינַת רוּחַ הַקֹּדֶשׁ "לֹא נִטְלָה מִן הַחֲכָמִים", — **only through the aspect of Divine Inspiration that "was not taken from the sages",** שֶׁמִּתְחַדֵּשׁ מִשִּׂכְלוֹ וּמִתְאַמְּרָה הֲלָכָה לְמֹשֶׁה מִסִּינַי כְּוָתֵיהּ. — **whereby a sage innovates from his intellect and it emerges that a Halachah to Moses from Sinai accords with him.** וְזֶה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר בְּרַבִּי עֲקִיבָא (מְנָחוֹת כ״ט עמוד ב׳)[457]: — **And this is what is stated regarding Rabbi Akiva (Menachot 29b):** "שֶׁשְּׁאָלוּהוּ תַּלְמִידָיו: "רַבִּי, מִנַּיִן לָךְ?", — **whose students asked him: "Rabbi, from where do you derive this?",** אָמַר לָהֶם: "הֲלָכָה לְמֹשֶׁה מִסִּינַי"; וְאַף דְּאִיתָא בַּמִּדְרָשׁ[458] (רַבָּה וְתַנְחוּמָא חֻקַּת): "'וְכָל יְקָר רָאֲתָה עֵינוֹ' — **and he answered them: "It is a Halachah to Moses from Sinai";** – זֶה רַבִּי עֲקִיבָא וַחֲבֵרָיו,[459] — **and even though it is stated in the Midrash (Rabbah and Tanchuma, Chukat): "'And his eye saw every precious thing' — this is Rabbi Akiva and his colleagues,** דְּבָרִים שֶׁלֹּא נִגְלוּ לְמֹשֶׁה נִגְלוּ לְרַבִּי עֲקִיבָא וַחֲבֵרָיו", — **matters not revealed to Moses were revealed to Rabbi Akiva and his colleagues",** וּבַגְּמָרָא שָׁם גַּם כֵּן אָמַר: שֶׁיָּשַׁב בְּסוֹף שְׁמוֹנָה שׁוּרוֹת וְלֹא הָיָה יוֹדֵעַ מַה הֵן אוֹמְרִים; — **and in the Gemara there it likewise states that Moses sat at the end of eight rows and did not understand what they were saying;** מִכָּל מָקוֹם בְּטַעַם הֲלָכָה לְמֹשֶׁה מִסִּינַי לֹא הִשִּׂיג רַבִּי עֲקִיבָא, — **nevertheless, in the intrinsic rationale of a Halachah to Moses from Sinai Rabbi Akiva did not attain comprehension,** שֶׁזֶּה חֶלְקוֹ שֶׁל מֹשֶׁה רַבֵּנוּ. — **for that is the exclusive portion of Moses our Teacher.** וְעַל זֶה אָמְרוּ בַּגְּמָרָא שֶׁנִּתְיַשְּׁבָה דַּעְתּוֹ שֶׁל מֹשֶׁה, — **And regarding this they stated in the Gemara that the mind of Moses was put at ease,** שֶׁמִּזֶּה רָאָה שֶׁהַדַּעַת שֶׁלּוֹ וְחֶלְקוֹ תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה שֶׁלֹּא זָכָה לָזֶה שׁוּם לְמַעְלָה, — **for from this he saw that his own intellect is exalted above,**

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court and expound heaps of laws upon them, until he reached the one matter, the halakhah to Moses from Sinai. When Adam was first created, every plant he saw was a marvelous novelty, but after he became accustomed to this world it was no longer novel to him. So it was with the difference between Rabbi Akiva and Moses. All the heaps of laws Rabbi Akiva expounded on every stroke are included in the one matter, Moses' halakhah from Sinai: through these heaps of laws people can recognize the light of His unity and say, 'Hear, Israel … the Lord is one.' When this became clear to Moses, his mind was settled."

Sod supplies an extended explanation of why the same detailed path is necessary for one soul and not for another. The visitor discovers the king's will through its many surrounding forms; the son already knows that will with familiarity. This develops Peri Tzadik's statement that Akiva's particular portion does not pertain to Moses. The comparison concerns their distinct spiritual attainment, not exemption of later readers from halakhah or study.

[456] **Nedarim 38a:4-6**: "Rabbi Yosei son of Rabbi Chanina said: Torah was given only to Moshe and his descendants, as it says, 'Write for yourself' and 'Hew for yourself': Just as the stone fragments belong to you, so too what is written belongs to you. Moshe acted generously with it and gave it to Israel. Concerning him Scripture says, 'One with a generous eye shall be blessed,' and so forth. Rav Chisda objected: 'The Lord commanded me at that time to teach you'! The reply is: He commanded me, and I chose to teach you. 'See, I have taught you statutes and laws, as the Lord my God commanded me'! Again, the reply is: He commanded me, and I chose to teach you. But it says, 'Now write this song for yourselves'! The reply is: That command concerns the song alone. But it says, 'So that this song may be a witness for Me among the children of Israel'! Rather, what was initially given to Moshe alone was the capacity for analytical derivation, pilpul."

[457] **Menachot 29b**: 'Moses said before God: Master of the Universe, show him to me. God said to him: Return behind you. Moses went and sat at the end of the eighth row in Rabbi Akiva's study hall and did not understand what they were saying. Moses' strength waned, as he thought his Torah knowledge was deficient. When Rabbi Akiva arrived at the discussion of one matter, his students said to him: My teacher, from where do you derive this? Rabbi Akiva said to them: It is a halakha transmitted to Moses from Sinai. When Moses heard this, his mind was put at ease, as this too was part of the Torah that he was to receive.'

[458] **Bamidbar Rabbah 19:6** (excerpt): "It is written, 'These things I have done, and have not forsaken them' (Isaiah 42:16). It does not say 'I shall do,' but 'I have done': I have already done this for Rabbi Akiva and his companions. Matters not revealed to Moshe were revealed to Rabbi Akiva and his companions. 'His eye saw every precious thing' (Job 28:10)—this is Rabbi Akiva and his companions."

[459] **Bamidbar Rabbah 19:6** (excerpt): "It is written, 'These things I have done, and have not forsaken them' (Isaiah 42:16). It does not say 'I shall do,' but 'I have done': I have already done this for Rabbi Akiva and his companions. Matters not revealed to Moshe were revealed to Rabbi Akiva and his companions. 'His eye saw every precious thing' (Job 28:10)—this is Rabbi Akiva and his companions."

וְחֶלְקָ֥ תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה שֶׁל אָדָם; — **and his portion of Oral Torah is something no other human ever merited;** רַבִּי עֲקִיבָא וַחֲבֵרָיו אֵינוֹ שַׁיָּךְ לְמֹשֶׁה, — **while the portion of the Oral Torah of Rabbi Akiva and his colleagues does not belong to Moses,** מִפְּנֵי שֶׁלֹּא קִלְקֵל מֹעוֹלָם — **because Moses never sinned or fell,** וְאֵינוֹ נִצְרָךְ לְהַרְבֵּה חָכְמָה שַׁעַר הַחֲמִשִּׁים שֶׁנִּמְסַר לְבַעַל תְּשׁוּבָה לְתַקֵּן הַרְבֵּה כַּעַס. — **and has no need for the abundant wisdom of the Fiftieth Gate transmitted to a penitent (ba'al teshuvah) to rectify abundant wrath.** וְהִנֵּה: "מָלַךְ בְּגֵאוּת לָבֵשׁ", — **And behold: "The King donned ten garments",** כְּמוֹ שֶׁחֹשֵׁב בְּמִדְרָשׁ רַבָּה (סוֹף פָּרָשַׁת וָאֶתְחַנַּן) וּבַפְּסִיקְתָא,[460] — **as enumerated in Midrash Rabbah (end of Parashat Va'etchanan) and in the Pesikta,** וְהֵינוּ עֶשֶׂר סְפִירוֹת שֶׁהָאֲצִיל הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ לִבְרִיאַת הָעוֹלָם; — **which are the Ten Sefirot emanated by the Blessed Name for the creation of the cosmos;** וְחֹשֵׁב בְּפִסְיקְתָא[461] (שׁוֹשׁ אָשִׁישׁ) לְבוּשׁ הָרִאשׁוֹן "הוֹד וְהָדָר", — **and it lists in the Pesikta (Sos Asis) the first garment as Hod and Hadar (splendor and majesty),** שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: "הוֹד וְהָדָר לָבָשְׁתָּ". — **as it is said: "You are clothed in splendor and majesty".** וְאַחַר כָּךְ כְּתִיב: "עֹטֶה אוֹר כַּשַּׂלְמָה", — **And afterward it is written: "Enveloping Himself in light as with a cloak",** (בְּרֵאשִׁית רַבָּה פָּרָשָׁה ג׳):[462] — **for it states (Bereishit Rabbah, Parashah 3):** מֵהֵיכָן נִבְרֵאת הָאוֹרָה? מִלְּמַד שֶׁנִּתְעַטֵּף בָּהּ הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא כְּשַׂלְמָה וְהִבְהִיק זִיו הָדָרוֹ וְכוּלֵיהּ". — **"From where was light created? It teaches that the Holy One wrapped Himself in it like a mantle and the radiance of His majesty beamed, etc."**

וְהִנֵּה בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ (חֶלֶק ג׳ י״א סוֹף עַמּוּד ב׳)[463] חִשֵּׁב מַאֲמָר רִאשׁוֹן מֵאֲמַר "יְהִי אוֹר", — **And behold in the Holy Zohar (Part III, 11b bottom) it counts the first Divine Utterance as "Let there be light",** וּבְגֶמָרָא (רֹאשׁ הַשָּׁנָה ל״ב עַמּוּד א׳)[464] אִיתָא: "'בְּרֵאשִׁית' נַמִּי מַאֲמָר הוּא". — **whereas in the Gemara (Rosh Hashanah 32a) it states: "'In the beginning' is also an utterance".** וְאָמַרְנוּ דְּאִלּוּ וְאִלּוּ דִּבְרֵי אֱלֹהִים חַיִּים: — **And we explained that both these and those are the words of the Living God:** שֶׁכְּפִי הַמַּחֲשָׁבָה, "בְּרֵאשִׁית" נַמִּי מַאֲמָר הוּא, — **for on the level of thought, "In the beginning" is also an utterance,** וְלֹא כְּתִיב בֵּיהּ "וַיֹּאמֶר" שֶׁאֵין בּוֹ תְּפִיסָה וְהוּא נֶעְלָם מִכָּל רַעְיוֹן; וְאַחַר כָּךְ "יְהִי אוֹר" — **yet "And He said" is not written in it because it has no human grasp and is hidden from every concept; –** מַאֲמָר הַשֵּׁנִי, שָׁבּוֹ הִתְחִיל הַכָּרַת הַחָכְמָה וּתְפִיסַת הַשֵּׂכֶל. — **and afterward "Let there be light" is the second utterance, wherein began the recognition of wisdom and intellectual grasp.** וּלְאַחַר שֶׁנִּגְנַז אוֹר הָרִאשׁוֹן, אָז מַאֲמַר "יְהִי אוֹר" גַּם כֵּן נֶעְלַם מִכָּל רַעְיוֹן, — **And once the Primordial Light was hidden away, the utterance "Let there be light" also became concealed from every thought,** וְעַל כֵּן חָשְׁבוּ בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ לְמַאֲמָר

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[460] **Devarim Rabbah 2:37**: "Another idea: "Listen, O Israel-" from where did Israel merit the commandment of the reading of Shema? From the time that Jacob spread out to die, he called to all the tribes and said to them: "Maybe once I pass away, you will bow to another power?" From where can we learn this? For so it is written: "Gather and listen, sons of Jacob, and listen to your father Israel (Genesis 49)." What is 'and listen to your father Israel (heb. V'shimu El Yisrael Avichem)'? He said to them: The G-d of Israel is your father (an alternate meaning of 'El Yisrael Avichem')." They said to him: "Listen O Israel, Hashem is our G-d, Hashem is one." And he said in a whisper: "Blessed be the glorious name of His Kingship (ie. G-d) forever." Rabbi Levi said: "And what do Israel say today? 'Listen our forefather Israel, the same thing that you commanded us still abides among us, Hashem is our G-d, Hashem is one.'""

[461] **Pesikta DeRav Kahana 22:5**: "... "For, like the earth, which gives forth its plants…" (Isaiah 61:11) R' Pinchas and R' Chilkiya in the name of R' Simon: like someone who says to his friend 'may the Holy One make you grow, may you win your judgment, "And nations shall see your righteousness…" (Isaiah 62:2) R' Levi said: since in this world anyone who explicitly pronounces the name of the Holy One is liable for death, as it says "And one who blasphemously pronounces the Name of the Lord, shall be put to death…" (Leviticus 24:16) so too in the time to come anyone who explicitly pronounces the name of Jerusalem is liable for death, as it says "…and you shall be called a new name…" (Isaiah 62:2) R' Levi said: there are six things which the Holy One will renew in the time to come and they are: heavens and earth, the heart, the spirit, the name of the Messiah and the name of Jerusalem. From where do we learn the heavens and earth? "For behold, I create new heavens and a new earth…" (Isaiah 65:17) From where do we learn the heart and the spirit? "And I will give you a new heart, and a new spirit will I put within you…" (Ezekiel 36:26) And from where do we learn the name of the Messiah? "May his name be forever; before the sun, his name will be magnified…" (Psalms 72:17) And from where do we learn the name of Jerusalem? "…and you shall be called a new name…" (Isaiah 62:2) R' Levi said: happy is the city whose name is the same as that of her king and whose king's name is the same as that of her God. Whose name is the same as her king? "…and the name of the city from that day will be 'The Lord is There.'" (Ezekiel 48:35) Whose king's name is the same as that of her God? "…and this is his name that he shall be called, The Lord is our righteousness." (Jeremiah 23:6)"

[462] **Bereshit Rabbah 3:4** (excerpt): "Rabbi Shimon ben Yehotzadak asked Rabbi Shmuel bar Nachman: Since I have heard that you are a master of Aggadah, tell me: From where was light created? He replied: This teaches that the Holy One, blessed be He, wrapped Himself in it like a garment, and the radiance of His majesty shone from one end of the world to the other."

[463] **Zohar, Vayikra 25:179**: "Come and see: there are ten utterances for the work of Creation, as we learned: "The world was created through ten utterances." There are ten utterances for the giving of the Torah: these are the Ten Commandments. It is written: "I am the Lord your God," and in the work of Creation it is written: "Let there be light, and there was light." This is the faithfulness of the Holy One, blessed be He, which is called light, as it is written: "The Lord is my light and my salvation; whom shall I fear?""

[464] **Rosh Hashanah 32a:19**: "But the expression 'And He said' occurs only nine times in the account of Creation! 'In the beginning' is also an utterance, as it is written, 'By the word of the Lord the heavens were made.'"

רֹאשׁוֹן נֶגֶד כֻּלָּם עֶלְיוֹן; — **and therefore the Holy Zohar counted it as the first utterance corresponding to Keter Elyon;** וּמִכָּל מָקוֹם יֵשׁ מַאֲמַר "בְּרֵאשִׁית" דְּנַמִּי מַאֲמַר הוּא כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בַּגְּמָרָא. — **and nevertheless the utterance "In the beginning" exists as an utterance too, as stated in the Gemara.** הֵינוּ דִּכְתִיב: "הַשֵּׁם אֱלֹהַי גָּדַלְתָּ מְאֹד", — **This is what is written: "Hashem my God, You are exceedingly great",** וְ"גָּדוֹל" אֵצֶל הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ בְּלֹא שִׁעוּר, לְמַעְלָה מִתְּפִיסַת שֵׂכֶל הָאָדָם, — **and "great" regarding the Blessed Name is limitless, beyond the comprehension of human intellect,** וְהוּא כְּנֶגֶד כֶּתֶר עֶלְיוֹן הַנַּעֲלָם מִכָּל רַעְיוֹן, — **and corresponds to Keter Elyon hidden from all conception;** וְעַל זֶה נֶאֱמַר: "הוֹד וְהָדָר לָבָשְׁתָּ", שֶׁלְּבוּשׁ הָרִאשׁוֹן "הוֹד וְהָדָר". — **and regarding this it is said: "You are clothed in splendor and majesty", for the first garment is Hod and Hadar.** וְאוֹר הָרִאשׁוֹן נִגְנַז לַצַּדִּיקִים כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בַּגְּמָרָא וּמִדְרָשִׁים, — **And the Primordial Light was hidden for the righteous as written in the Gemara and Midrashim,** וּכְתִיב[465]: "אוֹר זָרֻעַ לַצַּדִּיק", וְ"צַדִּיקִים לְאוֹרָה" (תַּעֲנִית ט"ו עַמּוּד א'). — **and it is written: "Light is sown for the righteous", and "the righteous are destined for light" (Ta'anit 15a).** וְיֵשׁ שֶׁזּוֹכִים לְאוֹר הָרִאשׁוֹן עַל יְדֵי בְּחִינַת "הוֹד", — **And there are those who merit the Primordial Light through the aspect of Hod,** וְזֶה תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה שֶׁל מֹשֶׁה רַבֵּנוּ, — **and this is the Oral Torah of Moses our Teacher,** וְעַל זֶה אָמַר שֶׁנִּתַּן הַהוֹד לְמֹשֶׁה, וְהוּא מִטַּל דְּעַתִּיקָא עַל יְדֵי לְבוּשׁ "הוֹד". — **and regarding this it states that Hod was given to Moses, and it is from the dew of the Ancient One via the garment of Hod.** וְיֵשׁ שֶׁזּוֹכִין לְאוֹר הָרִאשׁוֹן עַל יְדֵי בְּחִינַת "הָדָר", דְּאִיתָא (זֹהַר חֵלֶק ב' קפ"ו עַמּוּד ב'[466]): "מַאן אִיהוּ הָדָר — דָּא צַדִּיק", — **And there are those who merit the Primordial Light through the aspect of Hadar, – for it is stated (Zohar Part II, 186b): "Who is Hadar — this is the Tzaddik",** שֶׁהוּא בְּחִינַת יוֹסֵף הַצַּדִּיק שֶׁנִּקְרָא "יְפֵה תֹאַר וִיפֵה מַרְאֶה", — **who is the aspect of Joseph the Righteous who is described as "of handsome form and fair appearance",** שֶׁיֵּשׁ לוֹ גּוּף נָקִי וּמְהֻדָּר. — **possessing a pure and beautifully adorned physical constitution.** וְהִנֵּה אִיתָא בְּמֶכִילְתָּא וּמִדְרָשׁ רַבָּה (בְּשַׁלַּח)[467]: "וּבִזְכוּת הָאֱמוּנָה — **And behold it is found in the Mechilta and Midrash Rabbah (Beshalach): "And in the merit of faith the Holy Spirit rested upon them and they uttered song,** שֶׁרְתָה עֲלֵיהֶם רוּחַ הַקֹּדֶשׁ וְאָמְרוּ שִׁירָה, שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: 'וַיַּאֲמִינוּ וְגוֹמֵר אָז יָשִׁיר מֹשֶׁה'". — **as it is said: 'And they believed, etc., then sang Moses'".** וּמֹשֶׁה רַבֵּנוּ הָיָה הָעִקָּר שֶׁנֶּאֱמְרָה עָלָיו שִׁירָה, — **And Moses our Teacher was the primary figure who merited to utter the song,** וְהַשִּׁירָה לֹא הָיָה כְּכָל הַדִּבְרֵי תוֹרָה דִּכְתִיב: "וַיְדַבֵּר הַשֵּׁם אֶל מֹשֶׁה", — **and the song was not like the rest of the Torah where it is written "And Hashem spoke to Moses",** רַק מֹשֶׁה אָמַר הַשִּׁירָה בְּרוּחַ הַקֹּדֶשׁ, — **rather Moses uttered the song with Divine Inspiration,** וְעַל יָדוֹ וּמִמֶּנּוּ זָכוּ גַּם יִשְׂרָאֵל לוֹמַר שִׁירָה, — **and through him and from him all Israel also merited to utter song,** וּכְמַה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: "מֹשֶׁה וּבְנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל"; — **and as Scripture states: "Moses and the children of Israel";** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בַּמֶּכִילְתָּא וְזֹהַר הַקֹּדֶשׁ (שָׁם ס"ד עַמּוּד ב' וּבְשִׁאָר מְקוֹמוֹת): "זֶה אֵלִי וְאַנְוֵהוּ"[468] — **and as written in the Mechilta and Holy Zohar (ibid. 64b and other places):** "רָאֲתָה שִׁפְחָה עַל הַיָּם מַה שֶּׁלֹּא רָאָה יְחֶזְקֵאל", — **"A maidservant at the Sea saw what Ezekiel the prophet did not see",** וְזֶה זָכוּ עַל יְדֵי רוּחַ הַקֹּדֶשׁ. — **and this they merited through Divine Inspiration.**

The light above the seven traits gives them an ordered unity

וְזֶה שֶׁאָמַר בַּתִּקּוּנִים: "וּבְיוֹם שְׁבַח מֹשֶׁה 'אָז', בְּגִין דְּאִיהוּ הוֹד דִּיהִיב לְמֹשֶׁה", — **And this is what it stated in the**[469]

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[465] **Taanit 15a**: ‘Rav Naḥman bar Yitzḥak said: I too say a similar idea. Not all are fit for light, and not all are fit for gladness. The righteous are fit to be rewarded with light, and the upright are fit to be rewarded with gladness. The righteous are fit to be rewarded with light, as it is written: “Light is sown for the righteous” (Psalms 97:11), and the upright are fit to be rewarded with gladness, as it is written, in the same verse: “And gladness for the upright in heart.”’

[466] **Zohar, Tetzaveh 15:130-131**: ““A tree of beauty”—as it says: “Splendor and beauty are before Him.” Why is it called beauty, and who is beauty? This is the righteous one. Why is it called beauty? It is a concealed place, without revelation, which must always be covered; beauty belongs only to what is revealed and seen. Yet although it is a concealed degree, it is the beauty of the entire body, and the body has beauty only through it.”

[467] **Mekhilta d'Rabbi Yishmael 14:31**: ‘And Israel saw the great work which the Lord did upon the Egyptians, and the people feared the Lord; and they believed in the Lord, and in His servant Moses’ (Exodus 14:31): Great is faith (emunah) before Him who spoke and the world came into being, for in the merit of the faith wherewith Israel believed in the Lord, the Holy Spirit (Ruach HaKodesh) rested upon them and they uttered the Song at the Sea.’

[468] **Mekhilta d'Rabbi Yishmael 15:2**: ‘This is my God, and I will glorify Him’ (Exodus 15:2): Rabbi Eliezer says, Whence do you say that a maidservant saw at the Red Sea what Isaiah and Ezekiel and all the other prophets never saw? Because it is stated, ‘And by the ministry of the prophets have I used similitudes’ (Hosea 12:11), whereas at the Sea every single Jew pointed with his finger and proclaimed: ‘This is my God!’

[469] **Tiferet Yosef, The Seventh Day of Pesach 4**: “There are seven attributes through which God governs His world, as it says, ‘Yours, Lord, are greatness and strength,’ through ‘Yours, Lord, is kingship.’ Their principal preciousness lies in their inclusion within one another. If an attribute spreads without limit or restraint, every kind of opposite can grow from that very attribute, even its own opposite. Even kindness, which is exceedingly precious, if it has no limit or restraint, can show mercy to a cruel person. This is the very opposite of kindness, for there is no greater cruelty than sustaining a cruel person in the world. Thus the Gemara asks why the stork is called chasidah: it acts kindly with its companions; yet it is an impure bird, because it lacks discernment in the attribute. This is what the Zohar’s wording indicates: ‘What is zayin? A sword of the Lord, full of blood.’ When the attributes have no inclusion within one another and each spreads to its own

Tikunim: "And through it Moses praised 'Then' (Az), because it is Hod which was given to Moses", — וְהַיְנוּ דְּהוֹד מִדָּה שְׁמִינִית מֵעֶשֶׂר סְפִירוֹת, **meaning that Hod is the eighth attribute of the Ten Sefirot,** וְנֶחֱלָק עַל פִּי מַה שֶּׁכָּתוּב בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ — הַחֵי"ת לְאָלֶ"ף זַיִ"ן, **and the eight (chet) is divided into aleph (1) and zayin (7),** "כַּד אִתְנְהִיר נְהִירוּ דְּעַתִּיקָא (שָׁם נ״ד עַמּוּד א׳):[470] — **according to what is written in the Holy Zohar (ibid. 54a):** "When the light of the Ancient One shines, etc., the radiance of the aleph reaches the zayin, etc." — וְכוּלֵּיהּ נְהִירוּ דְּאָלֶ"ף וּמָטוּ לְזַיִן וְכוּלֵּיהּ". **And this means that aleph points to the Supreme Wonder (Pele) of the Ancient One, –** וְהוּא דְּאָלֶ"ף מוֹרֶה עַל פֶּלֶא עֶלְיוֹן עַתִּיקָא, וּמָטוּ לְזַיִן — **and reaching the seven — the radiance of the Ancient One, the dew of the Ancient One,** נְהִירוּ דְּעַתִּיקָא, טַלָּא דְּעַתִּיקָא, **which is the Oral Torah of Moses our Teacher operative through the aspect of Hod.** שֶׁהִוא תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה שֶׁל מֹשֶׁה רַבֵּנוּ שֶׁהוּא עַל יְדֵי בְּחִינַת הוֹד. **And this is what is written: Hod was given to Moses and Hadar to Joshua,** — וְזֶה מַה שֶּׁכָּתוּב: נִתַּן הַהוֹד לְמֹשֶׁה וְהַהָדָר לִיהוֹשֻׁעַ, **and it is based on what is written in the Holy Zohar (ibid. 137b in other editions)** וְהוּא עַל פִּי מַה שֶּׁכָּתוּב בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ (שָׁם קל״ז עַמּוּד ב׳ בְּסִפְרֵי אֲחֵרִים)[471] — עַל מַה שֶּׁכָּתוּב: "מֹשֶׁה קִבֵּל תּוֹרָה מִסִּינַי וּמְסָרָהּ לִיהוֹשֻׁעַ", **on the teaching: "Moses received Torah from Sinai and transmitted it to Joshua",** וְאִתְּעָרוּ עַל תּוֹרָה שֶׁבִּכְתָב הָא כְּתִיב: "וַיִּתְּנָהּ אֶל הַכֹּהֲנִים בְּנֵי לֵוִי". — דְּאִלּוּ תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה, **for as for the Written Torah, behold it is written: "And he gave it to the priests, sons of Levi".**

Each soul has a distinct portion in the revelation of Torah

And this is because Joshua was the first to write his prophetic book after the Five Books of the Torah, — וְהוּא דִּיהוֹשֻׁעַ הָיָה הָרִאשׁוֹן שֶׁכָּתַב סִפְרוֹ אַחַר חֲמִשֵּׁי תוֹרָה[472]; **which is of the nature of the Oral Torah;** וְהוּא מֵעֵין תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה; **and this is what they said (Nedarim 22b):** "וְזֶה שֶׁאָמְרוּ (נְדָרִים כ״ב עַמּוּד ב׳):[473] — אִלְמָלֹא חָטְאוּ יִשְׂרָאֵל, לֹא נִתַּן לָהֶם אֶלָּא חֲמִשָּׁה חֻמְשֵׁי תוֹרָה וְסֵפֶר יְהוֹשֻׁעַ בִּלְבַד, שֶׁעֲרָכָהּ שֶׁל אָרֶץ יִשְׂרָאֵל הִיא וְכוּלֵּיהּ". **"Had Israel not sinned, they would have been given only the Five Books of the Torah and the Book of Joshua alone, which contains the borders and division of the Land of Israel, etc."** וְהַיְנוּ שֶׁאֶרֶץ יִשְׂרָאֵל נִקְרָא נַחֲלַת הַשֵּׁם, וְהִיא שֹׁרֶשׁ "אֶרֶץ" שֶׁהִיא מִדַּת מַלְכוּת, "פֶּה" — **And that means that the Land of Israel is called the inheritance of Hashem, –** תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה; **and it is the root of "earth" (eretz), the attribute of Malchut, "The mouth is the Oral Torah";** וְסֵפֶר יְהוֹשֻׁעַ הוּא חֵלֶק תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה שֶׁיֵּשׁ לְכָל נֶפֶשׁ מִיִּשְׂרָאֵל בַּתּוֹרָה, — **and the Book of Joshua is the portion of the Oral Torah that every Jewish soul possesses in the Torah,** שֶׁעַל זֶה מוֹרֶה חֶלְקוֹ בְּאֶרֶץ יִשְׂרָאֵל. וִיהוֹשֻׁעַ שֶׁבָּא מִיּוֹסֵף, לוֹ נִתַּן — **which is reflected in his territorial inheritance in the Land of Israel.**

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furthest extreme, the attributes themselves are full of division. Their principal preciousness comes when aleph rides upon zayin. This indicates the inclusion of the attributes within one another: each limits itself with restraint and measure, to be used in the fitting place. Aleph alludes to the light of knowledge. When the light of knowledge illuminates the seven attributes, their principal preciousness appears."

Tiferet explains what the illumination of aleph contributes to the seven: discernment prevents each trait from expanding into its own distortion and enables a fitting relationship among them. This makes the numerical image in Peri Tzadik more than a calculation. Tiferet's following discussion connects this discernment with the direct recognition expressed in song, while Peri Tzadik identifies its higher source through Moses' holy spirit.

[470] **Zohar, Beshalach 15:215**: "When the light of alef joins and reaches zayin—what is zayin? "The sword of the Lord, filled with blood"—then it performs miracles and mighty deeds, because alef has joined with zayin. This is the song, the song of all sides; this is "Then [az] Moshe shall sing.""

[471] **Zohar, Terumah 16:207 (alternate reading; II, 137b)**: "For this is "the Torah of the Lord is perfect"—the Oral Torah. "Moshe received Torah from Sinai": they have explained that this concerns the Oral Torah. As for the Written Torah, it is written … "Take this scroll of the Torah." This pertains to the Levites."

[472] **Likkutei Maamarim, On Book of Joshua 6**: "It follows necessarily that the higher wisdom has as many divisions of particular matters of wisdom as there are divisions among the Israelite souls arranged in the order of that higher wisdom. Through this you can understand the earlier sages' statement that every Israelite soul has a hold in a letter of Torah, and that 'Torah and Israel are one.' They said that Yisrael is an acronym for 'There are six hundred thousand letters in Torah,' as is known. God's wisdom is certainly infinite, just as He is, as it were, infinite. What is revealed of it in this world, however, is according to what a bounded world can reveal within its limit; this is the very creation of this world, as explained. Torah, His wisdom, is revealed according to that measure. Therefore Bereshit Rabbah calls Torah 'the fallen fruit of the higher wisdom': only what falls from the higher wisdom, according to what is revealed of it in this world. That is the measure of Torah, neither more nor less. So too the Israelite souls: they are all the kinds of divisions of wisdom that can be found, presumably all the divisions and particulars that can exist and be revealed in this world. They too are therefore equal to the measure of the entire Torah."

Likkutei explains why "each soul's portion" is substantive. Distinct souls embody distinct particular revelations of wisdom, and together correspond to the Torah revealed within the world's limits. This gives the conceptual content of the individual territorial portion in Peri Tzadik. The excerpt preserves the distinction between infinite divine wisdom and its bounded revelation; it does not turn the acronym into an independently verified letter count.

[473] **Nedarim 22b:3**: "Rav Adda son of Rabbi Chanina said: Had Israel not sinned, only the five books of the Torah and the Book of Yehoshua would have been given to them, because the latter describes the arrangement of the Land of Israel. What is the reason for the additional books? 'For with much wisdom comes much anger.'"

שֶׁהוּא הַתּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה שֶׁזּוֹכִין עַל יְדֵי מִדַּת צַדִּיק, "צַדִּיקִים לְאוֹרָה", הַ"הֲדָר", **— And Joshua who descended from Joseph, to him was given Hadar, which is the Oral Torah merited through the attribute of Tzaddik, "the righteous are destined for light",** וְהוּא גַּם כֵּן מֵאוֹר הָרִאשׁוֹן "אוֹר זָרֻעַ לַצַּדִּיק", וְהוּא עַל יְדֵי בְּחִינַת "הֲדָר" — **and it too stems from the Primordial Light, "Light is sown for the righteous", –** דָּא צַדִּיק. — **and this operates through the aspect of Hadar — this is the Tzaddik.**

וְאָמַר אַחַר כָּךְ בַּתִּקּוּנִים שָׁם: "וְאִיהוּ הוֹד תְּמַנְיָא יוֹמֵי דַּחֲנֻכָּה וְכוּלֵּיהּ", — **And he stated afterward in the Tikunim there: "And it is Hod, the eight days of Chanukah, etc.",** וְהוּא כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמַרְנוּ שֶׁנִּקְרָא חֲנֻכָּה עַל שֵׁם חֲנֻכַּת הָאוֹר שֶׁמַּאִיר בְּלֵב יִשְׂרָאֵל, — **and it is as we explained that it is named Chanukah after the dedication of the light that illuminates the heart of Israel,** וְנִקְרָא הַלֵּב "הַר קָדְשִׁי". — **and the heart is called "My holy mountain".** וְכֵן אוֹמְרִים בַּחֲנֻכָּה: "וְעַל הַנִּפְלָאוֹת", — **And so we recite on Chanukah: "And for the wonders (nifla'ot)",** וְכֵן בְּנוֹסַח "הַנֵּרוֹת הַלָּלּוּ": "וְעַל נִפְלְאוֹתֶיךָ"; — **and likewise in the text of HaNeirot Halalu: "and for Your wonders";** נִפְלָאוֹת הֵם דְּבָרִים הַנֶּעְלָמִים וּמְכֻסִּים, דְּבָרִים שֶׁזּוֹכִין בַּחֲנֻכָּה לְהִתְגַּלּוֹת עַל יְדֵי נֵרוֹת חֲנֻכָּה שֶׁמַּדְלִיקִין, וְאִתְעַר עוֹבָדָא לְעֵילָּא שֶׁמַּקְדּוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא גַּם כֵּן מַדְלִיק נֵרוֹת, כְּמָה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: "אֵל ה' וַיָּאֶר לָנוּ". — **wonders (nifla'ot) are hidden and concealed matters, matters that the Ancient of Days covered, which we merit on Chanukah to have revealed through the Chanukah lights that we kindle, awakening spiritual action Above so that the Holy One also kindles lights, as Scripture states: "God is Hashem, and He shone light upon us".** וְזֶה גַּם כֵּן "אָז", דְּאִתְנְהִיר נְהִירוּ דְּעַתִּיקָא, — **And this is also the mystery of Az (then), when the radiance of the Ancient One shines,** אָלֶ"ף אוֹתִיּוֹת פֶּלֶ"א, וּמָטוּ לְזַיִ"ן, כְּמוֹ "אָז יָשִׁיר". — **the aleph representing the letters of Pele (wonder), reaching the seven (zayin), as in "Then (Az) sang Moses".** וְזֶה עִנְיַן מַה שֶּׁכָּתוּב בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ (חֵלֶק ג׳ רמ״ג עַמּוּד א׳[474]): "'כָּל הַיּוֹם דָּוָה' — הוֹד, מִסִּטְרָא דְּהוֹד, – חֲמִישָׁאָה אִשְׁתָּאַרַת בֵּי מַקְדְּשָׁא חֲרֵבָה". — **And this is the meaning of what is written in the Holy Zohar (Part III, 243a): – "'All day faint' — this is Hod, from the side of Hod, the fifth millennium the Holy Temple remained desolate".** אֶלֶף הַשִּׁשִּׁית אֶלְפִּים חָוּ עָלְמָא וְחַד חָרוּב, — **For six thousand years the world exists and one millennium is desolate,** אֶלֶף הַשְּׁבִיעִי "יוֹם שֶׁכֻּלּוֹ שַׁבָּת", וּשְׁנֵי אֶלְפִּים תֹּהוּ כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב (עֲבוֹדָה זָרָה ט׳ עַמּוּד א׳)[475]; — **the seventh millennium being "the day that is completely Shabbat", and two thousand years of chaos as written (Avodah Zarah 9a);** וּבָאֶלֶף הַשְּׁלִישִׁי הָיָה הַמִּשְׁכָּן וּבְסוֹפוֹ נִבְנָה בֵּית הַמִּקְדָּשׁ; — **and in the third millennium was the Tabernacle and at its end the Temple was built;** וּבָאֶלֶף הָרְבִיעִי הָיוּ מִקְדָּשׁ רִאשׁוֹן וְשֵׁנִי; — **and in the fourth millennium were the First and Second Temples;** וּבָאֶלֶף הַשִּׁשִּׁי יִבָּנֶה בֵּית הַשְּׁלִישִׁי בִּמְהֵרָה בְיָמֵינוּ. — **and in the sixth millennium the Third Temple will be built speedily in our days.** אַךְ בָּאֶלֶף הַחֲמִישִׁי "כָּל הַיּוֹם דָּוָה", כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ (חֵלֶק א׳ קט״ז עַמּוּד ב׳)[476], — **However in the fifth millennium "all day faint", as written in the Holy Zohar (Part I, 116b),** וְהָיָה מִצְוַת זְקֵנִים לְהַדְלִיק נֵרוֹת חֲנֻכָּה לַעֲשׂוֹת חֲנֻכָּה לְמִשְׁכַּן הַשְּׁכִינָה בַּלֵּב שֶׁנִּקְרָא "הַר קָדְשִׁי", — **and it was the commandment of the elders to kindle Chanukah lights to make a dedication for the sanctuary of the Shechinah in the heart which is called "My holy mountain",** וְתִקְּנוּ כָּל אֶלֶף הַחֲמִישִׁי שֶׁהוּא "הוֹד". — **and they rectified the entire fifth millennium which is Hod.**

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[474] **Zohar, Pinchas 86:580**: "…to exact vengeance on Samael, who touched Yaakov's left thigh, which is Hod. Of it, it is said: "He has made me desolate, faint all day." Hod: from the side of Hod, during the fifth millennium, the Temple remained ruined and desolate."

[475] **Avodah Zarah 9a:5**: "The school of Eliyahu taught: The world is to last six thousand years: two thousand years of desolation, two thousand years of Torah, and two thousand years of the days of Mashiach. Because our sins have become so numerous, the years of that last period that have already passed have passed without the promised redemption."

[476] **Zohar, Vayera 30:443-444**: "Therefore she lies in the dust throughout that day of heh. What is it? The fifth millennium—even though she entered exile before that fifth millennium, the mystery of heh, began. When the sixth millennium comes, which is the mystery of vav, then vav will raise up heh."

Each heart contributes a particular part of the divine dwelling

A divine dwelling begins with making room in the heart

וְזֶה כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמַרְנוּ בְּמַה שֶׁכָּתוּב:[477,478] — **And this is like what we explained regarding that which is written:** שֶׁעַל יְדֵי שְׁמִירַת שַׁבָּת כְּהִלְכָתוֹ מִיָּד נִגְאָלִין, — **that through keeping Shabbat according to its laws they are instantly redeemed,** שֶׁאַף שֶׁהָעוֹלָם נִדּוֹן אַחַר רֻבּוֹ וְאֵין בֵּית הַמִּקְדָּשׁ נִבְנֶה, — **for even though the collective world is judged by its majority and the Temple is not physically built,** מִכָּל מָקוֹם כָּל נֶפֶשׁ בִּפְרָט הַמְשַׁמֵּר שַׁבָּת כְּהִלְכָתוֹ הוּא נִגְאָל מִכֹּל וָכֹל; — **nevertheless each individual soul who observes Shabbat according to its halachot is redeemed completely;** וְאַף שֶׁלֹּא נִבְנָה בֵּית הַמִּקְדָּשׁ בְּיָמָיו, לִבּוֹ נַעֲשָׂה מִשְׁכָּן לַשְּׁכִינָה — **and even though the Temple is not rebuilt in his lifetime, his heart becomes a sanctuary for the Shechinah** וְהוּא כְּבֵית הַמִּקְדָּשׁ "הַר קָדְשִׁי". — **and is like the Temple, "My holy mountain".** וְזֶה מַה שֶּׁכָּתוּב (בְּרָכוֹת ל"ג עַמּוּד א'):[479] — **And this is what is stated (Berachot 33a):** "כָּל אָדָם שֶׁיֵּשׁ בּוֹ דֵּעָה, כְּאִלּוּ נִבְנָה בֵּית הַמִּקְדָּשׁ בְּיָמָיו", — **"Any person who possesses mature insight (da'at), it is as if the Temple was built in his days",** וְהוּא שֶׁבֵּית הַמִּקְדָּשׁ הָיָה מָקוֹם הַמְיֻחָד לְהַשְׁרָאַת הַשְּׁכִינָה, — **and that means that the Temple was the specific abode for the resting of the Shechinah,** מִי שֶׁיֵּשׁ בּוֹ דֵּעָה הָיָה שָׁוֶה לְמִדַּת הַדַּעַת שֶׁהוּא פְּנִימִיּוּת הַכֶּתֶר כַּיָּדוּעַ, — **and one who possesses da'at has merited the inner dimension of Keter, as is known,** וּמַשִּׂיגִים זֶה עַל יְדֵי בְּחִינַת רוּחַ הַקֹּדֶשׁ, — **and this is attained through the level of Divine Inspiration,** וְאָז לִבּוֹ נַעֲשָׂה מִשְׁכָּן לַשְּׁכִינָה וְנִקְרָא "הַר קָדְשִׁי" וּכְאִלּוּ נִבְנָה בֵּית הַמִּקְדָּשׁ בְּיָמָיו. — **and then his heart becomes a sanctuary for the Shechinah called "My holy mountain", and it is as if the Temple was built in his days.** וְזֶה שֶׁכָּתַב הָאֲרִיזַ"ל שֶׁהַחַשְׁמוֹנָאִים תִּקְנוּ מִדַּת הוֹד, — **And this is what the Arizal wrote, that the Hasmoneans rectified the attribute of Hod,** וְהֵנִּיחוּ שֶׁתִּקְנוּ כָּל אֶלֶף הַחֲמִישִׁי שֶׁנֶּהֱפַךְ "הוֹדִי לְמַשְׁחִית" וְ"כָל הַיּוֹם דָּוֶה" שֶׁאֵין בֵּית הַמִּקְדָּשׁ, — **meaning that they repaired the entire fifth millennium when "my splendor turned into destruction" and "all day faint" where there was no Temple,** וְהֵם תִּקְנוּ חֲנֻכָּה לְחַנֵּךְ הַמִּשְׁכָּן לַשְּׁכִינָה בְּלִבָּא דְּבַר נָשׁ. — **and they instituted the Chanukah dedication to dedicate the sanctuary for the Shechinah in the heart of man.**

Decreasing removes what obstructs; increasing preserves the light gained

וְנֶחְלְקוּ בַּגְּמָרָא: בֵּית שַׁמַּאי אוֹמְרִים פּוֹחֵת וְהוֹלֵךְ, וּבֵית הִלֵּל אוֹמְרִים מוֹסִיף וְהוֹלֵךְ;[480] — **And they disputed in the Gemara:**

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[477] **Resisei Layla 26:1**: “Just as there are six hundred thousand letters in Torah and every Israelite soul has a particular portion in Torah, from the wisdom of the mind attached to God, so every Israelite soul has a particular portion in the Tabernacle and Temple, from the will of the heart attached to God. The joining of Israel’s minds is the letters of Torah; the joining of Israel’s service of the heart is the work of the Tabernacle. The counting is called ‘Raise the head’: each person has a particular elevation, for every portion in Torah or in the Tabernacle is necessary. If one is missing, it becomes invalid. Thus every person is elevated in a particular matter.”

Resisei makes the relation between personal and collective dwelling precise: each attached heart contributes a necessary, distinct part to the whole. This helps explain why the individual attainment in Peri Tzadik is meaningful without being identified with completion of the public Temple. It also preserves the importance of the others’ still-needed portions, rather than making one person’s inward redemption a substitute for them.

[478] **Tiferet Yosef, Talmud Anthology, Sukkah 1**: “God arranged that the connection of His light with creation should come through human apprehension. Therefore everything in this world had to proceed through restraints and limits within which a person has apprehension and understanding. All Torah’s commandments consequently enter the limits of world, year, and soul: place, time, and person. Because they are bounded by this world’s limits, a person can apprehend and know them, as the Gemara says, ‘You labored and found,’ and the Midrash, ‘Labor and eat.’ Thus it is written, ‘Make Me a sanctuary, and I will dwell within them’: Israel makes room in the heart for the resting of the Divine Presence. The more room a person clears for the light of His Presence, the more His light dwells there. Within these limits a person can labor and bring the matter into his apprehension and understanding, because both the matter and the person have bounds and limits.”

Tiferet explains the work implied by the heart becoming a sanctuary. The bounded acts of commandments give a finite person a way to labor, understand, and make room for divine light. This develops the practical side of Peri Tzadik’s inward Temple, without identifying it with a physical rebuilding or an automatic state achieved merely by naming the idea.

[479] **Berakhot 33a:21**: “Rabbi Elazar also said: Any person who possesses understanding is regarded as though the Temple had been built in his lifetime. Understanding is placed between two Divine Names in Scripture, and the Sanctuary is placed between two Divine Names.”

[480] **Resisei Layla 56:27**: “This is the meaning of the dispute of Beit Shammai and Beit Hillel: whether to decrease, corresponding to the bulls of Sukkot, which are known to correspond to the seventy nations and therefore decrease, our whole intention being to diminish them. So here, for Beit Shammai, who come from judgment and restraint and therefore rule stringently, the whole intention in lighting the Chanukah lamp is to restrain ourselves, separate ourselves from the nations’ wisdom, and diminish it. Therefore the lamps decrease. This corresponds to the days still to come: to diminish the nations’ wisdom, we need not attend to what has already passed and departed, for we have no further dealings with it, only with what we must still remove from ourselves. But for Beit Hillel, whose ruling is the halakhah, the principal intention is to draw the true wisdom of Oral Torah into our hearts. Through the light of truth, darkness and falsehood

Beit Shammai say diminishing continuously, and Beit Hillel say increasing continuously; וְחַד אָמַר: טַעְמָא דְּבֵית שַׁמַּאי כְּנֶגֶד פָּרֵי הֶחָג, וְטַעְמָא דְּבֵית הִלֵּל דְּמַעֲלִין בַּקֹּדֶשׁ. **— and one Sage stated: Beit Shammai's reason corresponds to the bullocks of the Festival, and Beit Hillel's reason is that we ascend in holiness.** וְטַעַם בֵּית הִלֵּל מוּבָן, שֶׁהַנֵּרוֹת נִקְרְאוּ קֹדֶשׁ, **— And Beit Hillel's reason is understood, for the lights are designated holy,** וְהוּא כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמַרְנוּ שֶׁהַנֵּרוֹת הֵם לְהִיּוֹת: "הַנֵּרוֹת הַלָּלוּ קֹדֶשׁ הֵם", **— as is said: "These lights are holy",** אִתְעַר לְעֵילָּא "אֵל הַשֵּׁם וַיָּאֶר לָנוּ", **— and it is as we explained, that the lights awaken Above "God is Hashem, and He shone light upon us",** שֶׁיָּאִיר לָנוּ אוֹר הַתּוֹרָה עַל יְדֵי רוּחַ מֵהַהוּא קֹדֶשׁ דִּלְעֵילָּא, וּמַעֲלִין בַּקֹּדֶשׁ. **— illuminating for us the light of Torah via a spirit from that Holiness Above, and we ascend in holiness.** אֲבָל טַעַם בֵּית שַׁמַּאי יֵשׁ לְהָבִין: מַה עִנְיַן נֵר חֲנֻכָּה לְפָרֵי הֶחָג? **— However, Beit Shammai's reason needs explanation: what connection has the Chanukah candle to the bullocks of the Festival?**

The seventy offerings receive capacities for divine service

אָכֵן פָּרֵי הֶחָג הֵם שִׁבְעִים כְּנֶגֶד שִׁבְעִים אֻמּוֹת,[481] **— Indeed the bullocks of the Festival total seventy corresponding to the seventy nations,** וְהוּא עַל פִּי מַה שֶּׁכָּתוּב בַּפְּסָחִים פ״ז עַמּוּד ב׳):[482] **— and it is based on what is written in the holy books on the statement (Pesachim 87b):** "לֹא הֶגְלָה הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא אֶת יִשְׂרָאֵל אֶלָּא כְּדֵי שֶׁיִּתְוַסְּפוּ עֲלֵיהֶם גֵּרִים", **— "The Holy One exiled Israel solely so that converts would be added to them",** שֶׁאֵין הַמְּכֻוָּן שֶׁיִּתְגַּיְּרוּ מֵהֶם בְּפֹעַל, **— where the meaning is not that Gentiles will convert in physical actuality,** רַק כְּדֵי שֶׁיּוֹצִיאוּ יִשְׂרָאֵל הַנִּיצוֹצוֹת הַקְּדוֹשׁוֹת שֶׁהֵם בַּגָּלוּת שָׁם. **— but rather so that Israel extracts the holy sparks (nitzotzot kedoshot) trapped in exile there.** וְעַל זֶה הָיָה גָּלוּת מִצְרַיִם, דִּכְתִיב: "וְאַחֲרֵי כֵן יֵצְאוּ בִּרְכֻשׁ גָּדוֹל", **— And regarding this was the exile of Egypt, as it is written: "And afterward they shall go out with great wealth",** שֶׁהוּא מַה שֶּׁנֶּאֱמַר: "וַיְנַצְּלוּ אֶת מִצְרָיִם", **— which is what Scripture states: "And they despoiled Egypt",** שֶׁאָמְרוּ[483] (בְּרָכוֹת ט׳ עַמּוּד ב׳): "שֶׁעָשָׂאוּהָ כִּמְצוּדָה שֶׁאֵין בָּהּ דָּגָן, כְּמְצוּדָלָה שֶׁאֵין בָּהּ דָּגִים". **— which they explained (Berachot 9b): "They made it like a trap without grain, like the depths of the sea without fish".** וְהַיְנוּ "דָּגִים" מוֹרֶה עַל שֹׁרֶשׁ הַחַיִּים, שֶׁבְּדָגִים נִזְכַּר שָׁם "חַיָּה" בְּרֵאשׁוֹנָה; **— And this means "fish" points to the pristine root of life, for regarding fish the designation "living creature" was first mentioned;** וְ"דָגָן" הוּא קִיּוּם הַחַיִּים; **— and "grain" is the sustainment of life;** וְהַיְנוּ הַנִּיצוֹצוֹת הַקְּדוֹשׁוֹת בְּסוֹד "וְאַתָּה מְחַיֶּה אֶת כֻּלָּם". **— and that is the holy sparks in the mystical secret of "And You preserve them all".** וְעַל זֶה הִקְרִיבוּ שִׁבְעִים פָּרֵי הֶחָג כְּנֶגְדָּם, **— And for this they offered the seventy bullocks of the Festival corresponding to them,** שֶׁהַחִיּוּת וְהַנִּיצוֹצוֹת הַקְּדוֹשׁוֹת שֶׁבָּהֶם אָנוּ מַקְרִיבִין לַהַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ, **— for the life-force and holy sparks within them we offer up to the Blessed Name;** וּלְזֶה פּוֹחֲתִין וְהוֹלְכִין, שֶׁבְּכָל פַּעַם מוֹצִיאִים מֵהֶם יוֹתֵר. **— and for this reason they diminish continuously, because each day they extract more and more from them.**

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disappear of themselves. Therefore the lamps correspond to the days that have passed: every wisdom already attained must be established and rooted in the heart. ‘We ascend in holiness,’ for it alludes to holy wisdom. In the hidden teaching, holiness alludes to higher wisdom, from which the lower wisdom of Oral Torah draws nourishment. One must ascend, moving from level to level, higher and higher. Therefore one increases in level each time. The level of the days that have passed has not left or departed; on the contrary, those days remain with the person as he advances to a higher level.”

Resisei explains both directions of the dispute in terms of a person’s relation to wisdom. Beit Shammai count what remains to be removed; Beit Hillel preserve prior attainment while adding more light. This develops Peri Tzadik’s link between Sukkot’s decreasing offerings and Chanukah, and explains why an increasing lamp does not abandon the earlier days’ achievement.

[481] **Tiferet Yosef, Shemini Atzeret 2**: “This is the meaning of offering seventy bulls during the seven days. Israel illuminated what is true in reality: the Holy One created nothing without purpose. God bestowed great powers upon them as well, for where understanding is diminished He concealed great powers, as it says, ‘He teaches us from the beasts of the earth and makes us wise from the birds of heaven.’ But among them this is present with great obstinacy, and they do not take this power for God’s service. When Israel clarifies itself so that it can receive that power and use it to serve His will, through this it overcomes them. This is the offering of seventy bulls: Israel was clarified as capable of receiving all seventy powers from the seventy nations and serving God with these powers. Therefore on the eighth day there is one bull and one ram. God says: since Israel can clarify itself in this way, they are My essential will, through whom the honor of Heaven will become known.”

Tiferet gives a concrete meaning to receiving a spark: a capacity formerly used without conscious divine service becomes a capacity used for that service. The target explicitly requires Israel’s own clarification before receiving the power. This illuminates the purpose of the seventy offerings and of their reduction, rather than treating the number alone as the connection.

[482] **Pesachim 87b:14**: “Rabbi Elazar also said: The Holy One, blessed be He, exiled Israel among the nations only so that converts might be added to them, as it says, ‘I shall sow her for Myself in the land.’ Does a person sow a se’ah for any purpose other than to bring in many kor-measures of produce?”

[483] **Berakhot 9b:5**: “‘They emptied Egypt.’ Rabbi Ammi said: This teaches that they made it like a bird trap with no grain. Reish Lakish said: They made it like the depths of the sea with no fish.”

An inward gain of good displaces its opposing force

וְכֵן עִנְיַן נֵרוֹת חֲנֻכָּה, לְהוֹצִיא הָאוֹר וְהַחַיּוּת שֶׁהוּא בַּגָּלוּת[484]; **— And so too is the essence of the Chanukah lights, to extract the light and vital spark in exile;** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁמָּצִינוּ בְּמַכּוֹת מִצְרַיִם: "נָגוֹף וְרָפוֹא" — **– and as we found in the plagues of Egypt: "Smite and heal" —** נָגוֹף לְמִצְרַיִם וְרָפוֹא לְיִשְׂרָאֵל — **smiting for Egypt and healing for Israel** (עַל דֶּרֶךְ מַה שֶּׁנִּדְרַשׁ זֹהַר חֶלֶק ב׳ ל״ו עַמּוּד א׳)[485] **— (after the manner expounded in Zohar Part II, 36a),** שֶׁבְּכָל מַכָּה יָצְאוּ יִשְׂרָאֵל מִמִּדָּה אַחַת שֶׁבְּעֶשֶׂר מִדּוֹת שֶׁבַּקְלִפָּה "זֶה לְעֻמַּת זֶה" — **in that through each plague Israel emerged from one trait among the ten traits in the kelipah "parallel one to another",** וְנִכְנְסוּ לַמִּדָּה שֶׁכְּנֶגְדָּהּ וּכְתִיב בְּמַכַּת חֹשֶׁךְ שֶׁהָיָה מַכָּה תְּשִׁיעִית: "וּלְכָל בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל הָיָה אוֹר בְּמוֹשְׁבֹתָם", — **And it is written regarding the plague of darkness which was the ninth plague: "And for all the children of Israel there was light in their dwellings",** שֶׁכֵּיוָן שֶׁהָיָה נָגוֹף לְמִצְרַיִם מַכָּה תְּשִׁיעִית הַחֹשֶׁךְ, עַל יְדֵי זֶה הָיָה רָפוֹא לְיִשְׂרָאֵל שֶׁזָּכוּ לָאוֹר. וְהוּא כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בַּגְּמָרָא: "צַדִּיקִים לְאוֹרָה", דִּכְתִיב: "אוֹר זָרֻעַ לַצַּדִּיק", — **for since it was smiting for Egypt in the ninth plague of darkness, — through this was healing for Israel who merited illumination. — And it is as stated in the Gemara: "The righteous are destined for light", — for it is written: "Light is sown for the righteous",** וְצַדִּיק מִדָּה תְּשִׁיעִית [מִלְמַעְלָה לְמַטָּה]; וְכֵן מִתַּתָּא לְעֵילָּא מִדָּה תְּשִׁיעִית[486] חָכְמָה, — **and Tzaddik (Yesod) is the ninth sefirah from above downwards; – and likewise from below upwards the ninth sefirah is Chochmah (Wisdom),** שֶׁכְּנֶגְדָּהּ מַאֲמַר "יְהִי אוֹר". — **corresponding to which is the utterance "Let there be light".** וְכֵן אִיתָא בַּגְּמָרָא (סַנְהֶדְרִין צ״ט עַמּוּד א׳):[487] **And so it states in the Gemara (Sanhedrin 99a):** אָמַר קָרָא כְּתִיב: 'כִּי הִנֵּה הַחֹשֶׁךְ יְכַסֶּה אֶרֶץ וְעֲרָפֶל לְאֻמִּים וְעָלַיִךְ יִזְרַח ה' וּכְבוֹדוֹ עָלַיִךְ יֵרָאֶה'. — **a verse is written: 'For behold, darkness shall cover the earth, etc., and upon you Hashem shall shine, etc.'"** מַאי "אֵימַת אָתֵי מָשִׁיחַ?" — "לֵיה: לְכִי חָפוּ לְהוּ חֲשׁוֹכָא וְכוּלֵיהּ; — **He said to him: When darkness covers them, etc.;** וְכֵן עִנְיַן הַדְּלָקַת נֵר חֲנֻכָּה: לְהוֹצִיא מֵהֶם הַנִּיצוֹצוֹת הַקְּדוֹשׁוֹת וְהָאוֹר, וְעַל יְדֵי זֶה יִזְכּוּ "וְעָלַיִךְ יִזְרַח ה'", — **And so too is the purpose of lighting the Chanukah candle: to extract from them the holy sparks and the light, — and through this they merit "and upon you Hashem shall shine",** שֶׁנִּזְכֶּה לָאוֹר כְּמַה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: "אֵל ה' וַיָּאֶר לָנוּ". — **that we merit the light as Scripture states: "God is Hashem, and He shone light upon us".**

The restoration of Torah's light requires return from the darkness

וְהֵינוּ בָּאוֹר הָרִאשׁוֹן שֶׁגְּנָזוֹ לַצַּדִּיקִים, אוֹר "כִּי טוֹב",[488] — **And that is in the Primordial Light concealed for the**

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[484] **Beit Yaakov on Torah, Vayera 35:1**: "The Midrash says: when one matter of Torah enters a person's heart, a corresponding matter of idleness leaves. The King of kings, the Holy One, established this out of His love for Israel: when a person turns to Him and serves his Creator until good becomes settled in his heart, evil is immediately driven out. It is driven not only from his own heart; this makes an impression in all the worlds, from the highest levels to the world of action, until even the nation attached to the evil attribute opposite this good attribute is annulled and passes away. This is the aspect of 'striking and healing' stated concerning Egypt."

Beit Yaakov explains the paired movement through the relation of contrary traits. Establishing the good in the heart displaces the opposed evil and, in the author's account, affects its broader spiritual embodiment as well. This directly develops Peri Tzadik's formulation that Israel leaves one distorted trait and enters its holy counterpart; it is not merely a second mention of Egyptian plagues.

[485] **Zohar, Bo 4:85-86**: "R. Jose said that the same power which exercised judgement on the Egyptians was the agent of mercy to Israel, as it is written: " When I see the blood I will pass over you" (v. 16). For, as we have been taught, all the holy crowns above contain at one and the same time both judgement and mercy. R. Hezekiah drew the same inference from the verse, "And the Lord shall smite Egypt, smiting and healing" (Isa. 19, 22), i.e. smiting the Egyptians and healing Israel, to wit, from the wound of circumcision, the phrase "the Lord will pass over the door" suggesting the "door" of the body, which is the place of circumcision."

[486] **Sefer Yetzirah 1:4**: 'Ten Sefirot of Nothingness—ten and not nine, ten and not eleven; understand with wisdom and be wise with understanding.'

[487] **Sanhedrin 99a**: 'And that is the background for the following exchange, as a certain heretic said to Rabbi Abbahu: When will the Messiah come? Rabbi Abbahu said to him: He will come when the darkness will enshroud these people, i.e., you. The heretic said to him: Are you cursing me for no reason? Rabbi Abbahu said to him, I am merely relating to you a verse that is written: "For behold, the darkness shall cover the earth, and fog the peoples; but the Lord shall shine upon you, and His glory shall be seen upon you" (Isaiah 60:2).'

[488] **Tzidkat HaTzadik 174:1**: "The Gemara says that this is the order of the world's creation: first darkness and afterward light. Since God established natural things in this way, this is certainly the essential intention, as in the statement, 'Where penitents stand ….' Although it is forbidden, God forbid, to say, 'I will sin and return,' and choose to do this, for one is not granted the opportunity, nevertheless it comes about of itself, for 'There is no righteous person on earth ….' Even of Joseph the righteous the Sages said that ten drops emerged, on 'His arms were strengthened'; and even of Jesse, David's father, who died through the serpent's cause, they expounded, 'Full of iniquity ….' Likewise, the foundation of David's house and the Messiah in Peretz was preceded by Er and Onan—darkness. This is the order: 'The people walking in darkness saw a great light,' greater than that of someone who does not walk in darkness. Wherever darkness is written, it means darkness from Torah's light, not only worldly troubles. So too, 'A person does not attain words of Torah unless he has stumbled': this is through that darkness, the serpent's cause associated with wicked Esau, who touched Jacob's thigh.

righteous, the light that was "good", וְזוֹכִין לוֹ עַל יְדֵי תּוֹרָה אוֹר, **— and we merit it through the Torah of light,** שֶׁבָּכָל **— in that Israel merits to be "those who toil in Your Torah",** שֶׁזּוֹכִין יִשְׂרָאֵל לִהְיוֹת "עוֹסְקֵי תוֹרָתֶךָ", **— whereby every Jew possesses an engagement in Torah;** וְכֵן לִהְיוֹת צַדִּיקִים, אֶחָד מִיִּשְׂרָאֵל יֵשׁ לוֹ עֵסֶק בַּתּוֹרָה; **— and likewise to be righteous, and "the righteous are for light",** דִּכְתִיב: "אוֹר זָרֻעַ לַצַּדִּיק"; וְ"צַדִּיקִים לְאוֹרָה", **— as it is written: "Light is sown for the righteous";** וְלִהְיוֹת טְהוֹרִים, **— and to be pure,** דִּכְתִיב: "יִרְאַת הַשֵּׁם טְהוֹרָה עוֹמֶדֶת לָעַד", **— as it is written: "The fear of Hashem is pure, enduring forever",** וּכְתִיב: "הֵן יִרְאַת אֲדֹנָי הִיא חָכְמָה וְגוֹ'"; **— and written: "Behold, the fear of the Lord, that is wisdom, etc.";** וּמִי שֶׁעוֹסֵק בַּתּוֹרָה וְאֵין בּוֹ יִרְאַת שָׁמַיִם (יוֹמָא ע"ב עַמּוּד ב'):[489] **— and regarding one who engages in Torah without fear of Heaven they said (Yoma 72b):** 'לָמָּה זֶה מְחִיר בְּיַד כְּסִיל וְגוֹ'" — **– "'Why is there a price in the hand of a fool, etc.' —** שֶׁעוֹסְקִים בַּתּוֹרָה וְאֵין בָּהֶם יִרְאַת שָׁמַיִם". **— they engage in Torah but possess no fear of Heaven within them".** וְהוּא שֹׁרֶשׁ הַחֲנֻכָּה שֶׁעוֹשִׂין עַל הָאוֹר הָרִאשׁוֹן **— And it is the spiritual root of Chanukah, celebrated over the Primordial Light** שֶׁיִּשְׂרָאֵל זוֹכִין שֶׁהַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ מֵאִיר לְיִשְׂרָאֵל, **— which Israel merits as the Blessed Name shines upon Israel,** כְּמַה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: "אֵל הַשֵּׁם וַיָּאֶר לָנוּ", **— as Scripture states: "God is Hashem, and He shone light upon us",** וְעַל זֶה עוֹשִׂין חֲנֻכָּה. **— and for this reason do we celebrate Chanukah.**

As soon as someone has, God forbid, reached that condition and returns, he is healed and rises to the light. This is like the person upon whose head a stream of water fell, who said, 'He raises the poor from the refuse heap.'"

Tzidkat specifies what must change for darkness to become illumination: the person returns, is healed, and rises to Torah's light. It also explicitly rejects choosing a sin in order to achieve that result. This gives the necessary practical condition behind Peri Tzadik's concluding movement from darkness toward Torah, righteousness, and purity.

[489] **Yoma 72b**: 'Rabbi Shmuel bar Naḥmani said that Rabbi Yonatan said: What is the meaning of that which is written: "Why is there a price in the hand of a fool to buy wisdom, as he has no heart?" (Proverbs 17:16)? This expresses the following sentiment: Woe to them, haters of Torah scholars, a euphemism for the Torah scholars themselves, who immerse themselves in Torah and have no fear of Heaven. They are fools; they try to acquire the wisdom of Torah, but since they have no fear of Heaven in their hearts they lack the ability to do so.'

Chanukah Ois 3

Miracles, Faith, and the Illumination of Hod

Rav Tzadok locates the sea’s deliverance at Israel’s supernal root, beyond the accusation that ordinary merits cannot answer.

Miracles, Faith, and the Illumination of Hod

Wonder beyond the measure of merit

"הַנֵּרוֹת הַלָּלוּ אָנוּ מַדְלִיקִין עַל הַתְּשׁוּעוֹת וְעַל הַנִּסִּים וְעַל הַנִּפְלָאוֹת"[490,491] — **"These lights we kindle for the salvations, and for the miracles, and for the wonders."** הִנֵּה "נִסִּים" וְ"נִפְלָאוֹת" שֶׁיָּדָּ בְּנֵס הַנֵּרוֹת שֶׁהָיָה אָז, — **Behold "miracles" and "wonders" apply to the miracle of the lights that occurred then,** אֲבָל "תְּשׁוּעוֹת" זֶה שַׁיָּדָּ בְּעִנְיַן הַמִּלְחָמוֹת — **whereas "salvations" pertains to the matter of the wars,** וְאֵינוֹ עִנְיָן לְטַעַם נֵס הַנֵּרוֹת שֶׁהָיָה אַחַר נִצּוּחַ הַמִּלְחָמָה, — **and is not relevant to the rationale of the miracle of the lights which occurred after the victory of the war;** וְגַם צָרִיךְ בֵּאוּר הַכֶּפֶל "נִסִּים" וְ"נִפְלָאוֹת". — **and the duplication of "miracles" and "wonders" also requires explanation.** אָכֵן "פֶּלֶא" הוּא עִנְיָן מֻפְלָא וּמְכֻסֶּה מִשֵּׂכֶל אֱנוֹשִׁי, — **Indeed, "wonder" (pele) is a matter marvelous and concealed from mortal human intellect;** וּבְקִרְיַעַת יַם סוּף כְּתִיב: "עֹשֵׂה פֶלֶא", כִּי עַל פִּי שֵׂכֶל אֱנוֹשִׁי לֹא הָיָה שׁוּם הַשָּׂגָה מַדּוּעַ יַעַבְרוּ יִשְׂרָאֵל בַּיָּם בַּיַּבָּשָׁה וְהַמִּצְרִים יִטְבָּעוּ, כִּי הָיָה קַטְרוּג: "מַה נִּשְׁתַּנּוּ אֵלּוּ מֵאֵלּוּ", — **and regarding the Splitting of the Reed Sea it is written: "Worker of wonders", for according to human intellect there was no comprehension as to why Israel should cross the sea on dry land while the Egyptians drown, since there was prosecution from the Heavenly Accuser: "How are these different from those",** וְעַל כֵּן אָמַר בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ (חֶלֶק ב' נ"ב עַמּוּד ב') דִּקְרִיעַת יַם סוּף בָּעַתִּיקָא תַּלְיָא. — **and therefore it is stated in the Holy Zohar (Part II, 52b) that the Splitting of the Reed Sea is suspended in the Ancient Holy One (Atika).**[492] וְעַל כֵּן אָמְרוּ (פְּסָחִים קי"ח עַמּוּד א'): "קְשִׁין מְזוֹנוֹתָיו שֶׁל אָדָם כִּקְרִיעַת יַם סוּף", — **And therefore they said (Pesachim 118a): "A person's livelihood is as difficult as the Splitting of the Reed Sea",**[493] וְ(סוֹטָה ב' עַמּוּד א') "קָשִׁין לְזִוּוְגָן כִּקְרִיעַת יַם סוּף", — **and (Sotah 2a) "Matching couples is as difficult as the Splitting of the Reed Sea";**[494] הַיְנוּ מִשּׁוּם דְּחַיֵּי, בָּנֵי וּמְזוֹנֵי לָאו בְּזְכוּתָא תַּלְיָא מִלְּתָא אֶלָּא בְּמַזָּלָא תַּלְיָא מִלְּתָא, — **meaning because life, children, and sustenance depend not upon personal merit, but upon heavenly fortune (mazala),** וְהַיְנוּ בְּמִדַּת "אַיִן" שֶׁהוּא מַזָּל לְיִשְׂרָאֵל; — **and that refers to the supreme realm of Ayin**

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[490] **Machshavot Charutz 15:7**: "Passover corresponds to Abraham and came through their cry and the prayer that preceded the giving of the Torah. Afterwards, at the splitting of the sea, it says, 'The Lord will fight for you, and you shall remain silent.' The Zohar explains that it depends upon Atika: the supernal mazal, which one cannot reach there through prayer; and they had not yet attained Torah. Likewise, 'children, life, and sustenance,' which depend not on merit but on mazal, cannot be attained through prayer alone in this case. Hence the sayings, 'A person's sustenance is as difficult as the splitting of the sea,' and 'Matching them in marriage is as difficult as the splitting of the sea'—that is, children. Although sustenance belongs to temporal life, and requests for it were established in all the prayers, this applies to one whose time is favorable, who was created at a time favorable to sustenance, or who prays at a favorable time and is answered. But for one who was not created at a time favorable to sustenance, such as Rabbi Elazar ben Pedat in Ta'anit, it depends upon mazal—the supernal mazal in Atika, as is known. Prayer no longer avails, but Torah and calling in truth, which is above mazal, do: through it Israel becomes attached to the source from which it was hewn, in the highest primordial thought, far above the entire unfolding of Atzilut."

Machshavot spells out why the sea and sustenance share this language: an ordinary channel of petition does not exhaust the relation to Israel's primordial source. It also identifies Torah as the attachment to that source. Its distinction between ordinary requests for sustenance and the exceptional case is retained; the passage does not say that praying for livelihood is generally futile.

[491] **Sod Yesharim, Parashat Parah 4:1**: "That is, judgment and mercy occur at the same time, without a change or exchange of the garments, as occurred at the sea. It says, 'The waters piled up,' which the Targum renders, 'The waters became wise': the waters became wise enough to make room for Israel to pass through them and for the Egyptians to drown there. This is judgment and mercy at the same time. Therefore it says, 'Why do you cry to Me?'—'to Me' specifically: the matter depends upon Atika, that supernal will in which Israel first arose in thought."

Sod Yesharim explains the difficulty at the sea as opposite outcomes within the same visible medium: the same waters shelter and judge. Its appeal to Israel's place in primordial will gives concrete content to Rav Tzadok's root above accusation. The wider paragraph applies this to purification; that application is not substituted for Rav Tzadok's discussion of Chanukah.

[492] **Zohar, Beshalach 13:178-14:190**: 'Said R. Isaac: 'When the Israelites encamped by the sea they saw many hosts, many armies, many camps, above and below, all united against Israel, and in their distress they prayed unto the Lord. The sea was stormy, its waves roared, behind them were all those hosts, all those armies of the Egyptians, and above them were all those celestial foes; and they began to cry to God. Then "the Lord said unto Moses: Why criest thou unto me?" Then the Most Holy Ancient One appeared, and Mercy was manifested in all the upper worlds and all the lights were lit.''

[493] **Pesachim 118a**: "Rav Sheizvi said in the name of Rabbi Elazar ben Azaryah: A person's sustenance is as difficult as the splitting of the Sea of Reeds, for it is written, 'Who gives bread to all flesh,' and near it is written, 'Who split the Sea of Reeds into parts.'"

[494] **Sotah 2a:8**: "Rav Shmuel bar Rav Yitzchak said: When Reish Lakish began teaching Sotah, he would say: A man is paired with a wife only in accordance with his deeds, as it says, 'The scepter of wickedness shall not rest upon the lot of the righteous.' Rabbah bar bar Channah said in Rabbi Yochanan's name: Pairing them is as difficult as splitting the Sea of Reeds, as it says, 'God settles the solitary in a home; He brings prisoners out into prosperity,' reading bakosharos as an allusion to weeping and song at the sea."

(Nothingness) which is the source of fortune for Israel; וְהַיְנוּ שֶׁאָנוּ דְּבוּקִים בְּהַשֹּׁרֶשׁ גָּבֹהַּ מֵעַל גְּבוֹהִים, **— and that means that we are cleaved to the Source exalted high above the high,** וְשָׁם אֵין שׁוּם שְׁלִיטָה לְקִטְרוּג, **— and there prosecution has no dominion whatsoever,** וְהַיְנוּ "עֹשֵׂה פֶּלֶא" לְמַעְלָה מִתְּפִיסַת שֵׂכֶל אֱנוֹשִׁי. **— and this is the "Worker of wonders" transcending human mental grasp.**

— And it states in the Etz Chayim: There are three unifications on Chanukah, וְאִיתָא בְּעֵץ הַחַיִּים: שְׁלֹשָׁה יִחוּדִים יֵשׁ בַּחֲנֻכָּה, **— and they are the unifications of the Holy Names whose gematria equals Ner (250):** וְהֵם יִחוּד יהו"ה אהי"ה, יהו"ה אלהי"ם, יהו"ה אדנ"י. **— the unification of Havayah-Ehyeh (47), Havayah-Elohim (112), and Havayah-Adonai (91) 47 + 112 + 91 = 250.**

Faith when clear perception is absent

— And behold it is known: "He is Truth and She is Faith",[495] וְהִנֵּה יָדוּעַ: "אֱיהוּ אֱמֶת וְאֱיהִי אֱמוּנָה", **— for the Name Adonai which corresponds to the sefirah of Malchut indicates that we believe the Blessed Name is Master of the cosmos and we are His servants;** דְּשֵׁם אדנ"י שֶׁכְּנֶגֶד מִדַּת מַלְכוּת מוֹרֶה שֶׁאָנוּ מַאֲמִינִים שֶׁהַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ הוּא אָדוֹן הָעוֹלָם וַאֲנַחְנוּ עֲבָדָיו; **— and from the perspective of faith every person can place upon his heart** וּמִצַּד אֱמוּנָה כָּל אֶחָד יוּכַל לְהָשִׂים עַל לִבּוֹ **— that the King of kings of kings, the Holy One, Blessed be He, stands over him and beholds his deeds,** שֶׁמֶּלֶךְ מַלְכֵי הַמְּלָכִים הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא עוֹמֵד עָלָיו וְרוֹאֶה בְּמַעֲשָׂיו, **— and immediately awe, dread, and submission before Him fall upon us,** וּמִיָּד נוֹפֵל עָלֵינוּ הַיִּרְאָה וְהַפַּחַד וְהַהַכְנָעָה מִלְּפָנָיו יִתְבָּרַךְ שְׁמוֹ, **— and this is from the illumination of this Name, for "if I be a Master, where is My fear".** וְהוּא מֵהָאָרַת שֵׁם זֶה, דְּ"אִם אֲדוֹנִים אָנִי אַיֵּה מוֹרָאִי". **— And "Your faithfulness in the nights" means during the darkness,** וְ"אֱמוּנָתְךָ בַּלֵּילוֹת" הַיְנוּ בְּעֵת הַחֹשֶׁךְ, **— – when the Holy One, Blessed be He, illuminates for me toward His truth —** כְּשֶׁהַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא מֵאִיר לִי לַאֲמִתָּתוֹ **— this is the unification of the Names Havayah-Adonai,** זֶה יִחוּד הַשֵּׁמוֹת יהו"ה אדנ"י, **— which is the union of the Holy One, Blessed be He, and His Shechinah,** שֶׁהוּא יִחוּד קוּדְשָׁא בְּרִיךְ הוּא וּשְׁכִינְתֵּיהּ, **— and the aperture of miracles opens to perform a miracle that transcends the natural order.** וְנִפְתָּח פֶּתַח הַנִּסִּים לַעֲשׂוֹת נֵס שֶׁלְּמַעְלָה מֵהַטֶּבַע. **For the Name Adonai governs the conduct of this physical world,** כִּי שֵׁם אדנ"י הוּא הַנְהָגַת הָעוֹלָם הַזֶּה, **— and the Name Havayah is the order transcending revealed nature;** וְשֵׁם יהו"ה הוּא הַנְהָגָה שֶׁלְּמַעְלָה מֵהַנְהָגָה הַנִּגְלֵית; **— and this is what is written in the Etz Chayim, that the combination of Havayah-Adonai equals numerically Nes (miracle - 110),** וְזֶה שֶׁכָּתוּב בְּעֵץ הַחַיִּים שֶׁצֵּרוּף יהו"ה אדנ"י עוֹלֶה בְּגִימַטְרִיָּא נ"ס, כִּי שֵׁם אדנ"י עוֹלֶה ס״ה וְשֵׁם יהו"ה **— for the Name Adonai equals 65, and the Name Havayah spelled with alephs** [יוד בְּמִלּוּי אַלְפִין עוֹלֶה מ״ה, **— equals 45,**[496] הא ואו הא] **— and together they equal 110, the numerical value of Nes.** וְעוֹלִים יַחַד גִּימַטְרִיָּא נ"ס. **— And the Name Ehyeh is in Keter, the Ancient Realm, above the comprehension of human intellect,** וְשֵׁם אהי"ה הוּא בְּכֶתֶר וְהוּא עַתִּיקָא, לְמַעְלָה מֵהַשָּׂגַת שֵׂכֶל אֱנוֹשִׁי, וּבְצֵרוּף שֵׁם יהו"ה נַעֲשֶׂה לָנוּ נִפְלָאוֹת מִפֶּלֶא עֶלְיוֹן. **— and in union with the Name Havayah, wonders are performed for us from the Supreme Wonder (Pele Elyon).**

— And it states in the Etz Chayim: The rectification of the attribute of Hod occurs on Chanukah and Purim, וְאִיתָא בְּעֵץ הַחַיִּים: שֶׁתִּקּוּן מִדַּת הוֹד הוּא בַּחֲנֻכָּה וּבְפוּרִים, **— and therefore we recite Al HaNissim within the blessing of Thanksgiving (Hoda'ah / Hod),** וְעַל כֵּן אוֹמְרִים "עַל הַנִּסִּים" בְּהוֹדָאָה, וּבְיוֹתֵר הַתִּקּוּן **— and the rectification is most especially concentrated on Chanukah.** בַּחֲנֻכָּה. **— And that is because Aaron the Priest is the chariot for the attribute of Hod, as is known,** וְהַיְנוּ כִּי מִדַּת הוֹד אַהֲרֹן הַכֹּהֵן מֶרְכָּבָה לַהּ כַּיָּדוּעַ, **— and he is the fountainhead for the Oral Torah;** וְהוּא הַמָּקוֹר לְתוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה;

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[495] **Takanat HaShavin 2:4**: "From the side of faith, Israel believes in a general way without clear recognition: one believes even in what one does not comprehend at all. This is the definition of faith, as in 'Your faithfulness in the nights'—in darkness and the concealment of the clear light, when faith is employed. In the morning, by contrast, the blessing says 'True and firm': truth is something completely clear to a person, against which no claim can be made, since it is visible to the eye. It comes from the apprehension of wisdom, as the Sages said, 'There is no truth but Torah.' Here distinctions exist: each is scorched by the apprehension of his fellow, and, as the Sages said, human minds are not alike. But faith amid concealment has no distinctions of level: all Israel believes, as the Sages said. This is the root of the congregation of Israel."

Takanat defines the two words on which the union here depends. Faith can remain common to Israel when perceptual clarity is absent, whereas acquired apprehension differs between people. This explains why Rav Tzadok can say that anyone can begin with recognition of divine lordship without already claiming the higher clear perception.

[496] **Zohar, Vayikra 3:41-4:42**: "R. Aha applied the verse to the time when the Shekinah entered the Tabernacle, blessing and joy being then universally diffused, and Israel being perfected and joined to the Holy One, blessed be He, on earth, as it is written, "and they shall make me a sanctuary and I shall dwell among them" (Ex. 25, 8). AND HE CALLED UNTO MOSES. R. Simeon connected this with the verse, "The flowers appear in the land, the time of the singing of birds (zamir) is come and the voice of the turtle is heard in our land" (S.S. 2, 12). 'Why', he said, 'is the word "land" repeated in this verse? The reason is that the "flowers" here are the "shoots" which God plucked up and planted in another place, and whose blossoms appear on the "earth""

Accepting Torah after the first clarity recedes

וּבְשָׁעַת מַתַּן תּוֹרָה כָּפָה עֲלֵיהֶם הַר כְּגִיגִית עַל קַבָּלַת הַתּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה[497] — **and at the giving of the Torah He suspended the mountain over them like a vault over the acceptance of the Oral Torah,** שֶׁצְּרִיכָה יְגִיעָה רַבָּה וּנְדוּד שֵׁנָה וּלְמָאֵס תַּעֲנוּגֵי הָעוֹלָם הַזֶּה — **which requires immense toil, wandering sleep, and despising the pleasures of this physical world,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב (בְּתַנְחוּמָא נֹחַ ג׳).[498] — **as written (in Tanchuma Noach 3).** וּבְפוּרִים הָדָר קִבְּלוּהָ מֵאַהֲבָה וּבִטְּלוּ הַמּוֹדָעָה דִּכְפִיַּת הָהָר כְּגִיגִית, — **And on Purim they accepted it again out of love and dismantled the reservation of the mountain's coercion,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב (שַׁבָּת פ״ח עַמּוּד א׳).[499] — **as written (Shabbat 88a).**

וּבַחֲנֻכָּה הָיָה הָעִנְיָן מְסִירַת נַפְשָׁם עַל קִיּוּם תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה, — **And on Chanukah the theme was their self-sacrifice for the preservation of the Oral Torah;** כִּי אַחַר אַנְטִיגְנוֹס הִתְחִילוּ הַצְּדוֹקִים שֶׁכָּפְרוּ בְּתוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה, — **for after Antigonus began the Sadducees who denied the Oral Torah,** וְהוּא עַל יְדֵי קְלִפַּת יָוָן וְחָכְמַת יְוָנִית שֶׁנִּתְפַּשְׁטָה אָז בְּאוֹתוֹ זְמַן, — **and this came through the kelipah of Greece and Greek philosophy which spread then during that era;** וְיוֹסֵי בֶּן יוֹעֶזֶר נֶהֱרַג עַל קִדּוּשׁ הַשֵּׁם אָז בְּאוֹתוֹ גְּזֵרָה. — **and Yose ben Yoezer was martyred for the Sanctification of the Name then in that decree.** וְהַיְוָנִים אָמְרוּ שֶׁהַתּוֹרָה שֶׁבִּכְתָב גַּם כֵּן שֶׁלָּהֶם, — **And the Greeks claimed that the Written Torah belonged to them as well,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב (תַּנְחוּמָא כִּי תִשָּׂא ל״ד) שֶׁעֲתִידִים לְתַרְגֵּם אֶת הַתּוֹרָה יְוָנִית וְהֵם אוֹמְרִים "אֲנוּ יִשְׂרָאֵל",[500] — **as written (Tanchuma Ki Tisa 34) that they were destined to translate the Torah into Greek and assert "we are Israel",** וְרַק עָמְדוּ וְגָזְרוּ גְּזֵרוֹת לְבַטֵּל תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה בְּחָכְמָתָם הַכּוֹזָבָת. — **and merely rose and decreed decrees to eradicate the Oral Torah through their deceitful**

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[497] **Tiferet Yosef, Purim 3**: "The meaning is this. At the giving of the Torah at Mount Sinai they experienced a great disclosure of God's governance: they saw explicitly that Israel's essential life comes from words of Torah, and that whoever separates from Torah is as though he separates from life. This is what holding the mountain over them like a vat indicates. He showed them that God surrounded them on every side, leaving no turning right or left from His will, and that all their vitality came from Torah; otherwise their vitality would cease. Rabbi Acha bar Yaakov's 'From here there is a great protest concerning the Torah' means that afterwards this light was concealed from them. They could therefore say, 'We were compelled': we did not accept upon such terms—to live with the light concealed and serve God from within concealment. We accepted only with God's light explicitly revealed to us. Rava concludes, 'Nevertheless, they accepted it again in the days of Ahasuerus.' In those days Israel imagined that it had been entirely severed from His will, because it seemed to them that they had bowed to the image. My grandfather said that the fact that they had done so only outwardly was illuminated for them afterwards; beforehand they themselves thought that they had become severed from God's will. Afterwards God illuminated Israel's eyes and heart: they had not been severed from His will and had acted only outwardly. Out of their great love for the miracle, they accepted the Torah a second time with great joy, seeing that Torah belongs to the root of their soul and that they cannot act against Torah, Heaven forbid. They saw that all the concealment God established was for their benefit, so that they could have a share in this light. Had there been explicit disclosure, as at Sinai, they would have had no share or gain in the service. He therefore concealed His great light. Afterwards a person recognizes that even during concealment he remained connected to God's light. On this basis they accepted Torah a second time."

Tiferet gives the renewed acceptance an experiential meaning: willingness to serve after the compelling disclosure has receded. It supplies the reason why the toil mentioned by Rav Tzadok can be accepted lovingly. The two authors' emphases remain distinct: Rav Tzadok identifies the particular burden of Oral Torah, while Tiferet explains the move from disclosed life to service within concealment.

[498] **Midrash Tanchuma, Noach 3:10**: "Therefore the Holy One, blessed be He, established two yeshivot (at Sura and Pumbeditha) for the Israelites where they studied the Torah day and night, and where they assembled from all parts of the world twice each year, in the months of Adar and Elul. They came together to "battle" the problems encountered in the Torah until they had resolved them and reached a definitive decision concerning them. They would adduce arguments from the Torah, the Mishnah, and the Talmud so that the Israelites might not sin against the law, as it is said: Great peace have they that love Thy law; and there is no sinning for them (Ps. 119:165). Scripture informs us: The Lord will give strength unto His people, the Lord will bless His people with peace (Ps. 29:11). Hence, these two yeshivot experienced neither captivity, persecution, nor pillage; and neither Greece nor Rome ever conquered them. The Holy One, blessed be He, led the people out of Jerusalem with their Written and Oral Law twelve years before its destruction, as it is written: And he carried away all Jerusalem, and all the princes and all the mighty men of valor, even ten thousand captives, and all the craftsmen and smiths; none remained save the poorest sort of people of the land (II Kings 24:14). Is there might among men being led into exile? These were the mighty ones in their knowledge of Torah, as is indicated in the verse: In the Book of the Wars of the Lord (Num. 21:14)."

[499] **Shabbat 88a:5**: "'They stood at the foot of the mountain,' literally beneath it. Rav Avdimi bar Chama bar Chasa said: This teaches that the Holy One, blessed be He, overturned the mountain above them like a vat and told them, 'If you accept the Torah, well and good; if not, there will be your burial place.' Rav Acha bar Yaakov said: From here there is a substantial claim of duress concerning the Torah. Rava said: Nevertheless, they accepted it again in the days of Achashverosh, as it is written, 'The Jews confirmed and accepted'—they confirmed what they had already accepted."

[500] **Midrash Tanchuma, Ki Tisa 34**: 'And the Lord said unto Moses: "Write thou these words, for after the tenor of these words I have made a covenant with thee and with Israel" (Exod. 34:27). Scripture states elsewhere in allusion to this verse: Though I write for him never so many things of My Law, they are accounted as stranger's (Hos. 8:12). R. Judah the son of Shalum was of the opinion that when the Holy One, blessed be He, said to Moses Write thou, Moses wanted to write the Mishnah as well. However, the Holy One, blessed be He, foresaw that ultimately the nations of the world would translate the Torah into the Greek language and would claim: "We are the Israelites."'

philosophy. וְנַעֲשָׂה הַנֵּס עַל יְדֵי כֹּהֲנֶיךָ הַקְּדוֹשִׁים, — **And the miracle was wrought through Your holy priests,** כִּי כִּי הָיָה אַהֲרֹן הַכֹּהֵן מֶרְכָּבָה לְמִדַּת הוֹד, — **because Aaron the Priest is the chariot for the attribute of Hod,** כְּמַה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: "הוּא יִהְיֶה לְךָ לְפֶה", — **for he was the primary channel of the Oral Torah,** וּכְמַה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: "תּוֹרַת אֱמֶת הָיְתָה בְּפִיהוּ וְגוֹמֵר, כִּי שִׂפְתֵי כֹהֵן יִשְׁמְרוּ דַעַת וְתוֹרָה יְבַקְשׁוּ מִפִּיהוּ". — **as Scripture states: "He shall be to you as a mouth", and as stated: "The Torah of truth was in his mouth, etc., for the priest's lips shall guard knowledge and they shall seek Torah from his mouth".**

New Torah and the limits of the human knower

וְהַשָּׂגַת תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה הוּא הַמְשָׁכַת אוֹר עֶלְיוֹן, [501, 502] — **And the attainment of the Oral Torah is the drawing down of supreme light,** דְּזֶהוּ לְשׁוֹן "יִשְׁמְרוּ דַעַת", — **for this is the meaning of "shall guard knowledge",** וּבְרַבִּי שְׁלֹמֹה יִצְחָקִי כִּי תִשָּׂא: דְּ"דַעַת" הוּא רוּחַ הַקֹּדֶשׁ. — **and in Rashi on Ki Tisa: "knowledge" (da'at) is Divine Inspiration (Ruach HaKodesh).** וְזֶהוּ הָרוּחַ הַקֹּדֶשׁ שֶׁל הַחֲכָמִים דַּעֲדִיפֵי מִנְּבִיאֵי, — **And this is the Divine Inspiration of the Sages who are superior to prophets,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁכָּתַב הָרַמְבַּ"ן (בָּבָא בַּתְרָא י"ב עַמּוּד א') עַל גְּמָרָא זוֹ; [503] — **as the Ramban wrote (Bava Batra 12a) on this passage;** וְעַל זֶה אָמַר (מִדְרָשׁ רַבָּה וּמִדְרַשׁ תַּנְחוּמָא חֻקַּת) עַל הַפָּסוּק "כָּל יְקָר רָאֲתָה עֵינוֹ". [504] — **and regarding this it states (Midrash Rabbah and Midrash Tanchuma, Chukat) on the verse "Every precious thing his eye beheld":** דְּבָרִים שֶׁלֹּא נִגְלוּ לְמֹשֶׁה נִגְלוּ לְרַבִּי עֲקִיבָא וַחֲבֵרָיו. — **matters not revealed**

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[501] **Mei HaShiloach, Volume I, Exodus, Bo 5**: “Moses corresponded to ‘I am the Lord your God,’ and Rabbi Akiva ben Yosef corresponded to ‘You shall have no other gods.’ As is known, all the souls of Israel are attached at their root, each to the letters of Torah. Moses’ soul corresponded to ‘I am,’ and his work in this world was to clarify His blessed unity in the world. Rabbi Akiva’s soul corresponded to ‘You shall have no’: to clarify and cleanse every evil, dross, and waste in Israel’s heart, distancing them from evil, which is included in ‘You shall have no.’ His continual innovations of safeguards and fences added that this too is included in ‘You shall have no’ and must also be cleansed. All the laws of prohibited and permitted, invalid and valid, impure and pure, separate evil from good. This explains the Talmud’s account: when Moses ascended on high he found the Holy One tying crowns to the letters. He asked, ‘Master of the universe, who is delaying You?’ He answered, ‘After several generations there will be a man called Akiva ben Yosef, who will expound heaps of laws from every stroke.’ Moses became distressed, until they reached one law. Asked where it came from, Rabbi Akiva answered, ‘It is a law given to Moses at Sinai.’ Moses had seen Rabbi Akiva expand ‘You shall have no,’ adding many safeguards, and became distressed. Yet it is known that the root of everything is ‘I am the Lord your God’; ‘You shall have no’ is only a protection against a person distancing himself from the Lord his God. This is why he became distressed. When he reached one law—that is, when Moses saw why so many safeguards were necessary—he was told, ‘A law given to Moses at Sinai.’ ‘One law’ means ‘I am,’ for this is Torah’s essence, as the Zohar says: ‘Hear, Israel: the Lord our God, the Lord is one’ is a great essential principle of Torah. ‘You shall have no’ serves only to guard Israel from departing from ‘I am the Lord your God.’ His mind was then settled, for he understood that the essential principle had been given to him.”

Mei HaShiloach interprets the same Moses/Akiva encounter by distinguishing the foundational disclosure of divine unity from the later safeguards that preserve it. This illuminates how a later sage can disclose many new laws without displacing Moses’ root. It is a complementary account of their functions, not a claim that its Anokhi/Lo Yihyeh mapping is identical to Rav Tzadok’s hod/knowledge mapping.

[502] **Poked Akarim 6:2**: “Moses therefore rejoiced when he heard them ask Rabbi Akiva, ‘Where do you have this from?’ and he answered, ‘It is a law given to Moses at Sinai.’ All the precious things Rabbi Akiva’s eye saw that Moses did not see belong to the wisdom of Oral Torah, of which Rabbi Akiva was the root, as Moses was of Written Torah. ‘A sage is superior to a prophet’: through the wisdom of Oral Torah one can attain every precious thing. Yet all of it is through an unilluminated speculum, being only the apprehension of one’s heart; a questioner can ask, ‘Where do you have this from? Perhaps you are mistaken.’ (Likewise, the Sages said concerning Ezekiel’s prophetic apprehension that the prophets too stand in this relation to Moses. The difference between prophetic apprehension—even that of the least prophet—and the wise apprehension of Oral Torah is like the difference between Moses’ prophecy and that of the other prophets: the latter, relative to his, is considered a seeing through the separation of several mirrors.) There is therefore disagreement in Oral Torah: through his wisdom one apprehends the matter differently, and all are the words of the living God. Human minds are not alike; God created differences in the lower beings’ apprehension of wisdom. But when he answers, ‘It is a law given to Moses at Sinai,’ he refers to Moses, who gazed through the illuminated speculum into supernal wisdom, in which there is no error, change, variation, or disagreement.”

Poked directly explains the apparently paradoxical superiority asserted here. New reach does not make the sage’s personal reasoning infallible: the quoted argument expressly retains questions, disagreement, and Moses’ distinctive clarity. It prevents reading the Chanukah paragraph as a simple ranking that erases the difference between the two forms of reception.

[503] **Bava Batra 12a**: ‘§ In connection with Rabbi Yosei’s statement that Sumakhos’s words are nothing but words of prophecy, the Gemara reports that Rabbi Avdimi from Haifa says: From the day that the Temple was destroyed prophecy was taken from the prophets and given to the Sages. The Gemara expresses astonishment: Is that to say that a Sage is not fit to be a prophet? Rabbi Avdimi seems to say that these are two distinct categories of people. The Gemara explains: This is what Rabbi Avdimi is saying: Even though prophecy was taken from the prophets, it was not taken from the Sages.’

[504] **Bamidbar Rabbah 19:6** (excerpt): “It is written, ‘These things I have done, and have not forsaken them’ (Isaiah 42:16). It does not say ‘I shall do,’ but ‘I have done’: I have already done this for Rabbi Akiva and his companions. Matters not revealed to Moshe were revealed to Rabbi Akiva and his companions. ‘His eye saw every precious thing’ (Job 28:10)—this is Rabbi Akiva and his companions.”

to Moses were revealed to Rabbi Akiva and his colleagues. וְדַעַת הוּא פְּנִימִיּוּת הַכֶּתֶר כַּיָּדוּעַ, **— And Da'at is the internal essence of Keter, as is known,** (בְּשַׁבָּת פ״ח עַמּוּד א׳)[505] וְעַל כֵּן אָמַר **— and therefore it stated (in Shabbat 88a)** שֶׁהַכְּתָרִים מִ"נַּעֲשֶׂה וְנִשְׁמָע" זָכָה מֹשֶׁה וּנְטָלָן, **— that the crowns from "we will do and we will hear" Moses merited and received,** וּמֵהֶם הָיָה קֶרֶן אוֹר פָּנָיו, **— and from them came the radiance of the skin of his face,** וְעַיֵּן שָׁם בְּתוֹסָפוֹת דְּשָׁל "הוֹד" הֵיוּ. **— and see there in Tosafot that they were of Hod.** הַיְנוּ כִּי הוֹד וּלְזֶה כְּתִיב: "וּמֹשֶׁה לֹא יָדַע כִּי הוּא זִיו שֶׁל הַכֶּתֶר, **— That means because Hod is the luminous luster of the Keter,** קָרַן עוֹר פָּנָיו", **— and for this reason it is written: "And Moses knew not that the skin of his face shone",** כִּי אֵין שַׂיָּךְ לוֹמַר יְדִיעָה בְּדָבָר שֶׁלְּמַעְלָה מֵהַשָּׂגַת יְדִיעַת שֵׂכֶל הָאָדָם; **— because the concept of knowledge does not apply to that which transcends human intellectual attainment;** וְזֶה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: "וַיִּירְאוּ מִגֶּשֶׁת אֵלָיו", **— and this is what Scripture states: "And they were afraid to come near him",** וְהַיְנוּ שֶׁלֹּא יָכְלוּ לָגֶשֶׁת לְמִדָּה זוֹ שֶׁלְּמַעְלָה מֵהַשָּׂגָתָם. **— meaning they could not approach this attribute which soared above their reach.**

Oral Torah develops within the darkness of exile

And the Oral Torah is from the dew of the Ancient One, רַק שֶׁהַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ מַשְׁפִּיעַ בַּחֲכָמִים וּמְחַדְּשִׁים הַתּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה עַל פִּי רוּחַ קָדְשָׁם. **— only that the Blessed Name channels into the Sages and they innovate the Oral Torah through their Holy Spirit.** וְהַתּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה הוּא מִטַּל דְּעַתִּיקָא,[506] וְאִיתָא (זֹהַר חֶלֶק ג׳ רמ״ג עַמּוּד א׳) דְּאֶלֶף הַחֲמִישִׁי הוּא שֶׁכָּתוּב: "כָּל הַיּוֹם דָּוָה", **— And it states (Zohar Part III, 243a) that the fifth millennium is that regarding which it is written: "all day faint",** כִּי אָז הָיָה הַתְחָלַת הַשֵּׁנִי אֲלָפִים יְמוֹת הַמָּשִׁיחַ אִלּוּ זָכוּ יִשְׂרָאֵל; **— for then was the beginning of the two thousand years of the Messianic era had Israel merited;** וְהִתְחִילוּ אָז דּוֹרוֹת הָאָמוֹרָאִים וְיסוֹד תַּלְמוּד בַּבְלִי מִכִּי אֲתָא רַב לְבָבֶל, **— and then began the generations of the Amoraim and the foundation of the Babylonian Talmud from when Rav arrived in Babylonia,** וְהָיָה הִתְפַּשְׁטוּת תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה שֶׁהוּא מִמִּדַּת הוֹד, **— and there was an expansion of the Oral Torah which emanates from the sefirah of Hod,** וְסָבְלוּ יִשְׂרָאֵל אָז גְּזֵרוֹת רַבּוֹת. **— and Israel suffered then numerous decrees,** וְנִתְקַן תֵּבַת דָּוֶ"ה לְהֵיוֹת הו"ד. **— and the word daveh** (ד-ו-ה) **— faint) was transformed and rectified into hod** (ה-ו-ד) **— splendor).** וְהָאֶלֶף הַחֲמִישִׁי כְּנֶגֶד מִדַּת הוֹד כַּיָּדוּעַ. **— And the fifth millennium corresponds to the sefirah of Hod, as is known.**

A full moon is complete reception

— And regarding Solomon the King, peace be וּבִשְׁלֹמֹה הַמֶּלֶךְ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם כְּתִיב (דִּבְרֵי הַיָּמִים א כ״ט, כ״ה):[507, 508]

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[505] **Shabbat 88a:7**: “Rabbi Simai expounded: When Israel placed ‘We will do’ before ‘We will hear,’ six hundred thousand ministering angels came and tied two crowns upon each Israelite, one corresponding to ‘We will do’ and one to ‘We will hear.’ When Israel sinned, one million two hundred thousand angels of destruction descended and removed them, as it says, ‘The children of Israel stripped themselves of their ornaments from Mount Chorev.’ Rabbi Chama son of Rabbi Chanina said: At Chorev they put them on, and at Chorev they removed them. At Chorev they put them on, as we have said; at Chorev they removed them, as it is written, ‘The children of Israel stripped themselves,’ and so forth. Rabbi Yochanan said: Moshe merited all of them and took them, for the next verse says, ‘Moshe would take the tent.’ Reish Lakish said: In the future the Holy One, blessed be He, will return them to us, as it says, ‘The redeemed of the Lord shall return and come to Zion with song, and everlasting joy upon their heads’—the joy that was upon their heads long ago.”

[506] **Yisrael Kedoshim 6:32**: “But in the generations afterwards, when Rav came to Babylonia and spread much Torah there, the generations of the Amoraim arose. They acquired much Torah in holiness and purity and through their holy spirit, until they added the Talmud to the Mishnah founded by Rabbi—the completion of Oral Torah. They added there, ‘Do not teach that humility ceased, for I am here … do not teach that fear of sin ceased, for I am here,’ in Rav Nachman’s words (concerning the latter statement, fear of sin). Rav Nachman also said of himself in Sanhedrin, ‘If the Messiah is among the living, he is someone like me.’ It appears that he was the second after Rabbi who was fit to be Messiah, had the generation been worthy. He too was the head of his generation, encompassing all its souls, and completed himself to the utmost in all the levels of his stature. Yet he was not called ‘holy’ like Rabbi, because this came from darkness and concealment, rather than being disclosed to everyone.”
Yisrael Kedoshim adds an important distinction to the same historical-theological claim: inward holiness and Torah can return in the Amoraic period without the public disclosure associated with Rabbi. This helps explain how Rav Tzadok can place growing Oral Torah and continued suffering in the same era. The quoted historical identifications remain the author’s interpretation, not newly certified chronology. Citation clarification: Sotah 49b:19 attributes the humility statement to Rav Yosef and the fear-of-sin statement to Rav Nachman. The canonical Hebrew’s combined bracketed quotation is retained; the English marks which statement belongs to Rav Nachman.

[507] **I Chronicles 29:25**: ‘GOD made Solomon exceedingly great in the eyes of all Israel, and endowed him with a regal majesty that no king of Israel before him ever had.’

[508] **Sod Yesharim, Parashat Parah 6:1**: “The meaning of ‘Solomon sat upon the throne of the Lord’ is as the Zohar explains: Solomon made his throne after the pattern above and made here all the forms above; therefore it says, ‘Solomon sat upon the throne of the Lord,’ and ‘His kingship was established exceedingly’—the moon stood in its fullness. That is, he received all the light with which a receptive vessel could be filled, without any deficiency. The moon is a receptive vessel that receives light from the sun. Sometimes the moon has a flaw or diminishment; in Solomon’s days, however, it received all the light that it was possible for the vessel to receive, without any lack. This completeness is called ‘the throne of the Lord.’ Nevertheless, the light came through a garment. Moses was different: he judged

"וַיִּתֵּן עָלָיו הוֹד מַלְכוּת אֲשֶׁר לֹא הָיָה עַל כָּל מֶלֶךְ לְפָנָיו עַל יִשְׂרָאֵל"; וְהַיְנוּ כִּי מַלְכוּת: "יָדוּעַ — **"And He bestowed upon him majesty of kingship (hod malchut) such as had not been on any king before him over Israel"; –** פֶּה תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה קָרִינַן לַהּ", — **and that is because it is known: "Malchut — the mouth is the Oral Torah we call it",** וּלְזֶה בִּיהוֹשֻׁעַ שֶׁהָיָה הַתְחָלַת תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה כְּתִיב בּוֹ: "וְנָתַתָּ מַהוֹדְךָ עָלָיו", — **and for this reason regarding Joshua who began the Oral Torah transmission it is written: "And you shall place of your majesty (hod) upon him",** וְהַיְנוּ הוֹד מַלְכוּת, — **meaning royal splendor (hod malchut),** כִּי הוּא הָיָה הַמֶּלֶךְ הָרִאשׁוֹן לְיִשְׂרָאֵל שֶׁקִּבְּלוּהוּ עֲלֵיהֶם לְמֶלֶךְ, — **for he was the first king over Israel whom they accepted as king,** כְּמַה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: "כָּל אִישׁ אֲשֶׁר יַמְרֶה אֶת פִּיךָ וְגוֹמֵר", כְּדִין מוֹרֵד בַּמַּלְכוּת. — **as Scripture states: "Whosoever rebels against your word, etc.", in accordance with the law of a rebel against the monarchy.** וְלִשְׁלֹמֹה נִתַּן הוֹד מַלְכוּת בִּשְׁלֵמוּת, — **And to Solomon was given hod malchut in complete perfection,** כִּי בְּיָמָיו הָיָה סִיהֲרָא בְּאַשְׁלָמוּתָא; — **for in his days the moon was in its complete fullness;** "סִיהֲרָא" — נִקְרָא הַתּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה שֶׁמְּקַבֶּלֶת מֵהָאוֹר מַהַשֶּׁמֶשׁ, — **"the moon" represents the Oral Torah which receives light from the sun,** וּכְמוֹ כֵן הַתּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה מְקַבֶּלֶת מֵהָאוֹר מִתּוֹרָה שֶׁבִּכְתָב. — **and likewise the Oral Torah receives light from the Written Torah.** וְאַבְרָהָם אָבִינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם הָיָה הַתְחָלַת הַשְּׁנֵי אַלְפִּים תּוֹרָה, — **And Abraham our Father, peace be upon him, was the beginning of the two thousand years of Torah,** וְהַיְנוּ הַתְחָלַת זְרִיחַת הַסִּיהֲרָא קַדִּישָׁא; — **which was the beginning of the shining of the holy moon;** וּשְׁלֹמֹה הַמֶּלֶךְ שֶׁהָיָה הַדּוֹר הַחֲמִשָּׁה עָשָׂר מֵאַבְרָהָם וְנִתְמַלֵּא דִּסְקוּס שֶׁל לְבָנָה — **and Solomon the King who was the fifteenth generation from Abraham saw the full disc of the moon filled** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב שְׁמוֹת רַבָּה פָּרָשָׁה ט״ו)[509] — **(as written in Shemot Rabbah, Parashah 15),** וְזֶהוּ "סִיהֲרָא בְּאַשְׁלָמוּתָא", — **and this is the moon in its absolute fullness,** וְהָיָה הַמָּקוֹר מִתּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה. — **and he was the wellspring of the Oral Torah.**

וְנֵס חֲנֻכָּה הָיָה שְׁמוֹנָה יָמִים, — **And the miracle of Chanukah lasted eight days,** הַיְנוּ מִמִּדַּת הוֹד בְּכְלָל עַד הַכֶּתֶר שֶׁהָאִיר זִיו כָּל הַמִּדּוֹת; דְּהַמִּדּוֹת הֵם יָמִים, שֶׁשִּׁבְעַת יְמֵי בְרֵאשִׁית — **meaning from the attribute of Hod generally all the way to Keter, illuminating the luster of all sefirot; –** שֶׁבַע תַּחְתּוֹנִיּוֹת; — **for the sefirot are termed days, the seven days of Creation being the seven lower attributes;** וְהַתּוֹרָה קָדְמָה שְׁנֵי אֲלָפִים, — **and the Torah preceded creation by two thousand years,** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בְּרֵאשִׁית רַבָּה פָּרָשָׁה ח׳) "שַׁעֲשָׁעַי יוֹם יוֹם" כְּמַה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר:[510] — **as Scripture states: "I was daily His delight" (Bereishit Rabbah, Parashah 8),** שֶׁהִיא מַחֲכְמָה עֶלְיוֹנָה שֶׁהֵם שְׁתֵּי מִדּוֹת מִקּוֹדֶם. וַחֲנֻכָּה הוּא לְשׁוֹן "חִנּוּךְ", — **for it derives from Supernal Chochmah, which are two sefirot preceding. — And Chanukah is an expression of inauguration and training (chinuch),** שְׁיְמֵי חֲנֻכָּה מְחַנְּכִים לָנוּ הַקְדָּשָׁה עַל כָּל הַשָּׁנָה, — **for the days of Chanukah train and inaugurate holiness within us for the entire year,** כְּעִנְיַן מַה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: "חֲנֹךְ לַנַּעַר עַל פִּי דַרְכּוֹ, גַּם כִּי יַזְקִין לֹא יָסוּר מִמֶּנָּה", — **as in that which is stated: "Train a youth according to his way, even when he grows old he will not depart from it",** וְכֵן יָמִים אֵלּוּ חִנּוּךְ עַל כָּל הַשָּׁנָה. — **and so these days serve as training for the entire year.**

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through holy spirit, meaning that his clarity was without any garment at all."
Sod Yesharim defines the exact limit of lunar fullness: perfect reception within a vessel is not the same as an ungarbed source of light. This clarifies Rav Tzadok's sun/moon analogy and Solomon's completeness while retaining Moses' distinctive role. The full target paragraph's discussion of Solomon's judgment and the red heifer was read; no general permission to dispense with judicial procedure is inferred.

[509] **Shemot Rabbah 15:26** (excerpt): "The moon begins to shine on the first of Nisan. Its light increases until fifteen days have passed and its disc is full; from the fifteenth until the thirtieth its light diminishes, and on the thirtieth it is not seen. So too, Israel had fifteen generations from Abraham to Solomon. Abraham began to shine, as it says, 'Who awakened one from the east, calling righteousness to his feet?' (Isaiah 41:2). Isaac came and also shone, as it says, 'Light is sown for the righteous' (Psalms 97:11). Jacob came and added light, as it says, 'The light of Israel shall become a fire' (Isaiah 10:17). After him came Judah, Peretz, Chetzron, Ram, Amminadav, Nachshon, Salmon, Boaz, Oved, Jesse, and David. When Solomon came, the moon's disc became full, as it says, 'Solomon sat upon the throne of Hashem as king' (I Chronicles 29:23)."

[510] **Bereshit Rabbah 8:2** (excerpt): "Rabbi Shimon ben Lakish said: The Torah preceded the creation of the world by two thousand years. This is what is written: 'I was with Him as a nursling,' and so forth (Proverbs 8:30). A day of the Holy One, blessed be He, is a thousand years, as it is written, 'For a thousand years in Your eyes are like yesterday' (Psalms 90:4)."

Divine help calls the person's powers into service

וְהִנֵּה יָדוּעַ שֶׁלְּכָל הַקְּדֻשׁוֹת צְרִיכִין אָנוּ עֶזֶר הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ,[511,512] — **And behold it is known that for all holiness we require the assistance of the Blessed Name,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב (סֻכָּה נ״ב עַמּוּד ב׳): "וְאִלְמָלֵא הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא שֶׁעוֹזְרוֹ, אֵינוֹ יָכוֹל לוֹ";[513] — **and as written (Sukkah 52b): "Were it not that the Holy One helps him, he could not overcome it";** וְעַל זֶה מְרַמֵּז הַיִּחוּד יהו"ה אלהי"ם, — **and to this alludes the unification of Havayah-Elohim,** דְּשֵׁם אֱלֹהִים הוּא שֵׁם הַמּוֹרֶה עַל הַכֹּחוֹת כֻּלָּם, — **for the Name Elohim indicates that He is the Master of all powers,** וְצֵרוּף שֵׁם יהו"ה אלהי"ם הַיְנוּ שֶׁיִּהְיֶה נִקְבָּע זֶה בְּכָל כֹּחוֹתָיו, — **and the combination of the Name Havayah-Elohim means that this be engraved in all his human faculties,** וּבָזֶה הוּא שֶׁהַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא עוֹמֵד תָּמִיד לְעֶזֶר וְלִישׁוּעָה לְיִשְׂרָאֵל שֶׁיּוּכְלוּ לְהִתְגַּבֵּר נֶגֶד הַיֵּצֶר הָרָע, — **and through this the Holy One stands continuously as aid and salvation for Israel so they can overcome the Evil Inclination,** וְזֶה הוּא "הַתְּשׁוּעוֹת". — **and this is the meaning of "the salvations".**

Making the festival's illumination endure

וְכָבָר אָמַרְנוּ כִּי בְּמוֹצָאֵי שַׁבַּת קֹדֶשׁ קֹדֶם הַבְדָּלָה אוֹמְרִים שִׁשָּׁה לְשׁוֹנוֹת שֶׁל יְשׁוּעָה,[514,515] — **And we have already stated that**

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[511] **Resisei Layla 35:2**: "But when sleep lasts only a moment, according to the needed measure of that little foolishness which God willed to be 'more precious than wisdom and honor,' and one awakens immediately, it is then the 'help corresponding to him': the Holy One's help to overcome the inclination. For when the Holy One created the inclination, He necessarily created it so that the person would overcome it, not become submerged in it. It follows that the Holy One's very creation of it is itself His help to overcome it: the Holy One helps him, for this is why it was created."
Resisei explains what God's help means within a world that still contains distraction and desire: their intended purpose is awakening and mastery, not surrender. The earlier discussion in the same paragraph distinguishes temporary human awakenings from final, uninterrupted redemption. This preserves the ongoing effort implied by Rav Tzadok's phrase "all of his powers."

[512] **Tiferet Yosef, Shavuot 6**: "'A kingdom of priests' names that point of service which God fixed in each and every Israelite: that the person should have a desire to serve. As the Talmud says, Rav Ashi related that he once stood before King Izgadar, who said to him, 'It is written of you, "a kingdom of priests."' A share of this point is fixed in every Israelite, giving him the desire to serve. Service is the middle pillar: one must not rely on the assurance that, because Israel arose in thought, no service is needed. One must not rely on this, but work to the furthest reach of one's ability. Nor should a person become slack in service because there are many obstructing and concealing powers, and he fears that he may be unable to pass through all these concealments. To this it says, 'and a holy nation': God fixed in every Israelite one point called 'a holy nation,' giving him the strength to overcome all the powers that conceal and obstruct. God promises you that you can overcome them."
Tiferet sets out the two errors that divine help corrects: complacency because of a holy root, and despair because of obstruction. Its paired requirements of desire to work and God-given ability to overcome make Rav Tzadok's "help and deliverance" concrete without promising an effortless result.

[513] **Sukkah 52b**: "Rabbi Shimon ben Lakish said: A person's evil inclination grows stronger against him every day and seeks to kill him, as it says: 'The wicked watches the righteous and seeks to kill him.' Were the Holy One, blessed be He, not to help him, he could not overcome it, as it says: 'Hashem will not leave him in its hand, nor condemn him when he is judged.'"

[514] **Resisei Layla 56:28**: "It seems that when the miracle was first established, it was not given to be written: it had no embodiment in a bodily garment, and was not established for bodily rejoicing. But after writing was permitted, and this miracle too was given to be written because 'It is a time to act for the Lord,' it already had bodily embodiment in this world. Although this is not the essence of the miracle—for this reason, miracles not given to be written did not retain their permanent observance for later generations, and after the destruction of the Temple Megillat Ta'anit was annulled. Only deliverances given to be written, whose deliverance remained established and enduring in a bodily garment, were not annulled even after the destruction. Other deliverances not given to be written have no everlasting permanence visibly in this world, except Chanukah alone. Its deliverance is for souls rather than bodies; the destruction annulled visible bodily deliverances, not the deliverance of the soul's intellect. This remains fixed and enduring in Israel's souls. Although heretics in later generations led them astray as they did, they could achieve nothing in annulling Oral Torah, Heaven forbid. They vanished from the world, while the wisdom of Israel's sages remained and will remain forever. This is the essential thing that remains fixed for all generations in Israel's descendants from the miracle of Chanukah."
Resisei identifies a concrete enduring content for Chanukah's deliverance: Oral Torah remains alive in Israel even after political and Temple conditions have changed. This explains what Rav Tzadok means by deliverance that survives the passing festival, while distinguishing enduring spiritual Torah from a claim that every visible historical deliverance remains unchanged.

[515] **Tiferet Yosef, Pesach 5**: "The meaning is as my father said: a person experiences two kinds of deliverance. There is a deliverance in which the person serves and toils, preparing himself to attain God's light; through this preparation he attains a disclosure of His light. This remains permanent within him and cannot become concealed from him or be lost, Heaven forbid. But a disclosure of God's light that comes without the person's work becomes concealed and does not remain permanently with him. If he wishes to return to the illumination he once had, there is a way: through patience and much toil he can return to that light. In truth, even a disclosure coming from God Himself without the person's preparation does not entirely disappear at the root; a fixed trace remains in the depths of the heart. Thus at Sinai, although their great clarity was afterwards concealed, something remained, as it says after the giving of the Torah, 'So that His fear shall be upon your faces, that you not sin.' The Sages interpreted this as shame. A fixed point remained in every Israelite's heart, through which he feels ashamed to act against His will. Thus, even though the light was concealed,

on the conclusion of holy Shabbat prior to Havdalah we recite six expressions of salvation, כִּי בְּשַׁבָּת "אֲנִי הַשֵּׁם מְקַדִּשְׁכֶם", הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ בְּעַצְמוֹ מַשְׁפִּיעַ קְדֻשָּׁה; **for on Shabbat "I am Hashem Who sanctifies you", the Blessed Name Himself bestows holiness;** וּבְצֵאת הַשַּׁבָּת מְסִתַּלֵּק הַקְּדֻשָּׁה, **and with the departure of Shabbat that transcendent sanctity withdraws,** וְעַל זֶה מְבַקְּשִׁים שִׁשָּׁה פְּסוּקֵי יְשׁוּעָה עַל שֵׁשֶׁת יְמֵי הַמַּעֲשֶׂה לִהְיוֹת זֶה נִקְבָּע בַּלֵּב (וְנִתְבָּאֵר הַבְּדָלָה בְּרֵאשִׁית);[516] **and regarding this we petition with six verses of salvation for the six workdays so this holiness remains anchored in the heart (and this was explained regarding Havdalah in Bereshit);** וְכֵן חֲנֻכָּה, הָאוֹר הוּא מֵהַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ, **and so too on Chanukah, the light is from the Blessed Name,** וְצָרִיךְ לִישׁוּעָה שֶׁיִּקָּבַע בַּלֵּב גַּם אַחַר כָּךְ; **and we require salvation so it remains fixed in the heart afterward as well;** וְזֶהוּ "הַתְּשׁוּעוֹת" שֶׁהָיָה אָז, **and this is "the salvations" that occurred then,** שֶׁעַל יְדֵי הָאָרַת הַנֵּס שֶׁהוּא מִצַּד הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ, **where through the illumination of the miracle coming from the Blessed Name,** קָבַע הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ בּוֹ הַקְּבִיעוּת בַּלֵּב שֶׁזֶּה הוּא לִישׁוּעָה גַּם אַחַר כָּךְ. **the Blessed Name embedded its permanence in the heart to endure as salvation later on as well.** וְהִנֵּה בִּתְחִלַּת נֹסַח "הַנֵּרוֹת הַלָּלוּ" הַסֵּדֶר: "תְּשׁוּעוֹת", "נִסִּים" וְ"נִפְלָאוֹת", **And behold at the beginning of the text of HaNeirot Halalu the order is: — "salvations", "miracles", and "wonders",** וּבְסוֹף הַסֵּדֶר: "עַל נִסֶּיךָ וְעַל נִפְלְאוֹתֶיךָ וְעַל יְשׁוּעוֹתֶיךָ" **whereas at the conclusion the order is: – "for Your miracles, and for Your wonders, and for Your salvations" — with salvation at the end.** יְשׁוּעָה בַּסּוֹף. **And that is because the inception of everything occurs through the assistance and salvation from the Blessed Name,** וְהוּא כִּי הַתְּחָלַת הַכֹּל הוּא עַל יְדֵי עֵזֶר וִישׁוּעָה מֵהַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ, **and therefore the formulation places "salvations" at the very beginning;** וּלְזֶה הַנֹּסַח בַּהַתְחָלָה בְּ"תְּשׁוּעוֹת" בָּרִאשׁוֹנָה; **and that this salvation be fixed for all eternity, meaning even after the season has passed,** וְשֶׁיִּקָּבַע הַיְשׁוּעָה לְעוֹלְמֵי עַד, הַיְנוּ אַף אַחַר עֲבוֹר הַזְּמַן, **for this do we mention salvation at the end, so His salvation never departs from us continuously.** לָזֶה מַזְכִּירִין הַיְשׁוּעָה בַּסּוֹף שֶׁלֹּא יָמִישׁ מֵאִתָּנוּ יְשׁוּעָתוֹ תָּמִיד. **And at the beginning, the illumination from the Blessed Name to become fixed in the heart** וּבַהַתְחָלָה, הַהָאָרָה מֵהַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ לִהְיוֹת נִקְבָּע בַּלֵּב, **comes through man's initial effort in lighting,** זֶה בָּא עַל יְדֵי הַתְחָלַת הָאָדָם בַּהַדְלָקָה, **where through man's action it is immediately embedded in the heart throughout all his faculties,** שֶׁעַל יְדֵי פְּעֻלַּת הָאָדָם נִקְבָּע בַּלֵּב מִיָּד בְּכָל כֹּחוֹתָיו כֻּלָּם, **and therefore at the beginning of the action salvation came first,** וְעַל כֵּן תְּחִלַּת הַמַּעֲשֶׂה הָיָה הַתְּשׁוּעָה קוֹדֶם, **and afterward the miracles and wonders which came after the kindling through human action;** וְאַחַר כָּךְ הַנִּסִּים וְהַנִּפְלָאוֹת שֶׁזֶּה הָיָה אַחַר מַעֲשֵׂה הַהַדְלָקָה בִּפְעֻלַּת הָאָדָם; **and at the conclusion afterward we place salvation at the end,** וּבְיִצִיאָה אַחַר כָּךְ אוֹמְרִים הַיְשׁוּעָה בַּסּוֹף, **since its manifestation endures after the days of Chanukah have passed.** שֶׁהִתְגַּלּוּתוֹ אַחַר עֲבוֹר יְמֵי הַחֲנֻכָּה.

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something of it remained at the root; only on the level of the garment was the great disclosure concealed. God established that anyone wishing to regain that great disclosure must proceed through patience and toil in words of Torah, as it says, 'Our leaders bear burdens,' interpreted by the Sages as, 'Our leaders in Torah bear the burden of commandments.' To return to the light God previously shone for him, a person must bear and toil in Torah. If he returns to that light, he gains that the first illumination too is credited to him: although it first came without his preparation, it is now credited to him." Tiferet explains the mechanism of permanence that the Chanukah paragraph assigns to lighting and sustained divine help: a received gift becomes an acquired part of the person through his service. Crucially, it also preserves a hidden root of the first gift even before that work. The comparison therefore does not exaggerate the initial recession into total abandonment or loss.

[516] **Berakhot 33a**: 'Rav Naḥman bar Yitzḥak said: This can be derived a fortiori from the established halakha regarding havdala in the Amida prayer. Just as havdala in the Amida prayer, which is where the principal ordinance to recite havdala was instituted, the Sages said that it is not sufficient and one who recited havdala in the Amida prayer must recite havdala over the cup of wine as well, all the more so that one who recited havdala over the cup of wine, which is not where the principal ordinance to recite havdala was instituted, but was merely a later addition, did not fulfill his obligation and must recite havdala in the Amida prayer.'

Chanukah Ois 4

The Chanukah Lamps as Witness to the Divine Presence

The menorah's light expresses the purpose of Torah and mitzvot: making divine presence known within the person and the world.

The Chanukah Lamps as Witness to the Divine Presence

בַּאֲבֵדַרהָם כָּתַב שֶׁעַל כֵּן נִקְרְאוּ הַנֵּרוֹת קֹדֶשׁ מִפְּנֵי שֶׁהֵם זֵכֶר לְנֵרוֹת הַמִּקְדָּשׁ; — **These lights are holy": in Abudarham he wrote that they are called holy because they are a commemoration of the lights of the Temple;** וּבֶאֱמֶת גַּם הָר"ן זִכְרוֹנוֹ לִבְרָכָה כָּתַב שֶׁמִּטַּעַם זֶה אָסוּר לְהִשְׁתַּמֵּשׁ לְאוֹרָהּ, — **and in truth the Ran of blessed memory wrote that for this reason it is forbidden to use its light,** שֶׁעֲשָׂאוּהָ כַּמְּנוֹרָה, עַיֵּן שָׁם. — **for they modeled it after the Menorah, see there.** אַךְ שָׁם שַׁיָּךְ שֶׁגָּזְרוּ חֲכָמִים שֶׁלֹּא לְהִשְׁתַּמֵּשׁ לְאוֹרָן לְזֵכֶר דְּנֵרוֹת מִקְדָּשׁ שֶׁנַּעֲשָׂה בָּהֶם הַנֵּס, — **Yet there it is logical that the Sages decreed not to use their light as a reminder of the Temple lights where the miracle occurred,** אֲבָל לִהְיוֹת נִקְרָא הַנֵּרוֹת "קֹדֶשׁ" צָרִיךְ בֵּאוּר: — **but for the physical candles themselves to be designated "holy" requires explanation:** מַה עִנְיָנוֹ לְהִקָּרֵא קֹדֶשׁ מִשּׁוּם שֶׁהוּא זֵכֶר לַמִּקְדָּשׁ? — **what reason is there for it to be termed holy simply because it is a commemoration of the Temple?** אַךְ יֵשׁ לוֹמַר עַל פִּי מַה שֶּׁכָּתַב הָרַמְבַּ"ן (בְּהַעֲלֹתְךָ) עַל מַה שֶּׁכָּתוּב בַּמִּדְרָשׁ רַבָּה[517] — **However, one can explain based on what the Ramban wrote (Beha'alotecha) on what is stated in Midrash Rabbah** שֶׁאָמַר לוֹ לְאַהֲרֹן: "לְגְדוֹלָה מִזּוֹ אַתָּה מְתֻקָּן וְכוּלְיָה, הַנֵּרוֹת לְעוֹלָם וְכוּלְיָה"; — **that He said to Aaron: "For greater than this are you prepared, etc., the lights are forever, etc.";** וְאַף שֶׁיָּדוּעַ שֶׁבְּחָרְבַּן בֵּית הַמִּקְדָּשׁ גַּם הַנֵּרוֹת בָּטְלִין, — **and even though it is known that with the destruction of the Temple the lights also ceased,** וְכָתַב הָרַמְבַּ"ן שֶׁרָמְזוּ לְנֵרוֹת חֲנֻכָּה שֶׁנּוֹהֵג אַף לְאַחַר חָרְבָּן, עַיֵּן שָׁם; — **and the Ramban wrote that they alluded to the Chanukah lights which apply even after the destruction, see there;** וּדְבָרָיו צְרִיכִין בֵּאוּר: מַה נִּחֲמוֹ בְּהַדְלָקַת נֵר חֲנֻכָּה שֶׁיִּהְיֶה אַף לְאַחַר חָרְבָּן, — **and his words require elucidation: how was Aaron comforted by the kindling of Chanukah lights that would continue after the destruction,** כֵּיוָן שֶׁנּוֹהֵג בְּכָל יִשְׂרָאֵל וְלֹא נַעֲשָׂה כְּלָל עַל יְדֵי אַהֲרֹן וּבָנָיו? — **since it is observed by all of Israel and is not performed exclusively by Aaron and his sons?**

The commandments illuminate knowledge of God

אָמְנָם עִנְיַן הַדְלָקַת הַמְּנוֹרָה, אֵיתָא הַלָּשׁוֹן בַּמִּדְרָשׁ רַבָּה:[518, 519] — **However, regarding the kindling of the Menorah, the language in Midrash Rabbah is:** "לֹא שֶׁאֲנִי צָרִיךְ לָכֶם, אֶלָּא שֶׁתָּאִירוּ לִי", — **"Not that I have need of you, but that you shine for Me";** וְכִלְשׁוֹן הַזֶּה אֵיתָא בַּמִּדְרָשׁ רַבָּה (נֹחַ סוֹף פָּרָשָׁה ל') שֶׁאָמַר לְאַבְרָהָם אָבִינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם:[520] — **and in this phrasing it states in Midrash Rabbah (Noach, end of Parashah 30) that He said to Abraham our Father, peace be upon him:** "עַד שֶׁאַתָּה מֵאִיר לִי מֵאַסְפּוֹטַמְיָא וּמֵהַבְּרוֹתֶיהָ, בֹּא וְהָאֵר לְפָנַי בְּאֶרֶץ יִשְׂרָאֵל"; — **"Rather than shining for Me from Mesopotamia and its surroundings, come and shine before Me in the Land of Israel";** וְהֵינוּ מַה שֶּׁפִּרְסֵם אֱלֹהוּתוֹ יִתְבָּרַךְ לְכָל הָעוֹלָם, — **and that means his publicizing His Divinity, may He**

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[517] **Ramban on Numbers 8:2**: 'Speak unto Aaron, and say unto him: When you light the lamps, the seven lamps shall give light in front of the candlestick' (Numbers 8:2): Ramban quotes the Midrash Rabbah that Hashem comforted Aaron when he saw the dedication offerings of the twelve tribal Princes, promising him: 'By your life, yours is greater than theirs—for the sacrifices operate only while the Temple stands, whereas your lamps (referring to the Hasmonean dedication of the Chanukah lights) will shine forever.'

[518] **Machshavot Charutz 18:2**: "God 'provides counsels for everything': the 613 commandments are 613 counsels for reaching truth and becoming attached to the living God, even after the estrangement caused by Adam's sin, the sins of subsequent generations, and the person's own sin. Nevertheless, God arranges causes and counsels so that no outcast of the nation of Israel should remain cast away."

Machshavot explains why commandments are called counsels: they make renewed attachment possible after actual estrangement. This supplies the practical meaning of the light in Rav Tzadok's explanation; it is a route back to knowing God, not simply a visual memorial to an earlier lamp.

[519] **Tiferet Yosef, Bamidbar 10**: "This indicates that God left a place in which a person could distinguish himself: He established a perception in this world that the honor of Heaven is, as it were, incomplete without human service, and the person must complete it through his work. In truth, however, it is as we say, 'You are He before the world was created, and You are He after the world was created.' The honor of Heaven was complete before the creation just as afterwards. As the Zohar says, before the Holy One created the world He was called compassionate and gracious on account of the creatures He would create. Although there is a difference between before creation and afterwards—before, these things were potential, and now they are actual—the distinction between potential and actual likewise exists only from this world's perspective. From God's side there is no difference between potential and actual. Thus the honor of Heaven arising from the entire creation was His even before the creation. But because He wishes to benefit His creatures, after creation He established this perception: that, as it were, the honor of Heaven is incomplete without human service."

Tiferet explains the apparent tension in "not that I need you, but illuminate for Me." Human service has a real assigned purpose within created perception, while God's own completeness does not depend on repairing a divine lack. The full target then applies this to the Levites and the ark; that application is distinct from the menorah passage.

[520] **Bereshit Rabbah 30:10** (excerpt): "To what was Abraham compared? To a king's friend who saw the king walking through dark alleys. His friend looked out and began to illuminate his way through a window. The king looked up and saw him, and said: Instead of illuminating My way through a window, come and shine before Me. So the Holy One, blessed be He, said to Abraham: Instead of shining for Me from Mesopotamia and its neighboring places, come and shine before Me in the Land of Israel. This is what is written: 'He blessed Joseph and said: The God before whom my fathers walked' (Genesis 48:15)."

be blessed, to the entire world; דִּתְחִלָּה הָיָה מַהֲלָךְ בָּאֲפֵלָה, דְּ"הַחשֶׁךְ יְכַסֶּה אֶרֶץ וְגוֹמֵר", **— for previously humanity walked in obscurity, as in "darkness shall cover the earth, etc.",** דְּרָצָה לוֹמַר הֶעְדֵּר הַשָּׂגַת אוֹרוֹ יִתְבָּרַךְ, **— meaning the absence of perception of His light,** דְּזֶהוּ עִקַּר הַחשֶׁךְ בִּלְשׁוֹן הַכָּתוּב: "וְהַכְּסִיל בַּחשֶׁךְ הוֹלֵךְ", **— which is the primary definition of darkness in Scripture: "and the fool walks in darkness",** וְנֶאֱמַר: "וּרְשָׁעִים בַּחשֶׁךְ יִדָּמּוּ", **— and stated: "and the wicked shall be silent in darkness", and many other places.** וְעוֹד דּוּכְתֵּי טוּבָא. **— And likewise light in biblical usage: "Hashem is my light", "Shine Your face", "And upon you Hashem will shine",** וְכֵן הָאוֹר בִּלְשׁוֹן הַכָּתוּב: "הַשֵּׁם אוֹרִי", "הָאֵר פָּנֶיךָ", "וְעָלַיִךְ יִזְרַח הַשֵּׁם", **— and likewise "Though I sit in darkness Hashem is a light to me", and many more.** וְכֵן "כִּי אֵשֵׁב בַּחשֶׁךְ הַשֵּׁם אוֹר לִי", וְעוֹד טוּבָא. **— And likewise the Torah is called light, as Scripture states: "And Torah is light",** וְכֵן הַתּוֹרָה נִקְרָא אוֹר, כְּמַה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: "וְתוֹרָה אוֹר", **— "Your word is a lamp to my feet and a light to my path",** "נֵר לְרַגְלִי דְּבָרֶךָ וְאוֹר לִנְתִיבָתִי", **— "The people walking in darkness have seen a great light" is applied (in Tanchuma Noach 3) to the Oral Torah; –** "הָעָם הַהֹלְכִים בַּחשֶׁךְ רָאוּ אוֹר גָּדוֹל" אִיתָא (בְּתַנְחוּמָא נֹחַ ג') עַל תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה; וְכֵן אָמְרוּ (מְגִלָּה ט"ז עַמּוּד ב'): "לַיְּהוּדִים הָיְתָה[521] אוֹרָה' **— and so they said (Megillah 16b): "'To the Jews was light' — this is Torah",** זוֹ[522] תּוֹרָה", **— for this is the underlying goal of the entire Torah,** דְּזֶהוּ מְכֻוָּן כָּל הַתּוֹרָה כֻּלָּהּ, דְּתַרְי"ג[523] מִצְווֹת תַּרְי"ג עֵיטִין (זֹהַר חֶלֶק ב' פ"ב עַמּוּד ב'), **— the 613 commandments being 613 counsels (Zohar Part II, 82b),** הַיְנוּ עֵצוֹת לְהָאִיר בְּלִבּוֹ אוֹרוֹ יִתְבָּרַךְ; **— meaning pathways to illuminate His divine light within the human heart;** וְעַל כֵּן אָמְרוּ לֶעָתִיד: "וְלֹא יְלַמְּדוּ עוֹד אִישׁ אֶת רֵעֵהוּ וְגוֹמֵר כִּי כֻלָּם יֵדְעוּ אוֹתִי", **— and therefore they said regarding the future: "And they shall teach no more every man his fellow, etc., for they shall all know Me",** וּבְשִׁיר הַשִּׁירִים רַבָּה עַל הַפָּסוּק "יִשָּׁקֵנִי": דִּבְדִבּוּר "אָנֹכִי" נִתַּקֵּעַ תַּלְמוּד תּוֹרָה בְּלִבָּם. **— and in Shir HaShirim Rabbah on the verse "Let him kiss me": through the utterance of "I am" Torah was permanently embedded in their hearts.** וְאַבְרָהָם אָבִינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם הוּא שֶׁהֵאִיר אוֹר זֶה בָּעוֹלָם לְפַרְסֵם אֱלֹהוּתוֹ יִתְבָּרַךְ, **— And Abraham our Father, peace be upon him, was the one who radiated this light into the world to publicize His Divinity,** וְעַל זֶה אָמְרוּ (בְּרֵאשִׁית רַבָּה פָּרָשָׁה ב')[524]: **— and regarding this they said (Bereishit Rabbah, Parashah 2):** "אָמַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא: עַד מָתַי יְהֵא הָעוֹלָם מִתְנַהֵג בָּאֲפֵלָה, תָּבֹא הָאוֹרָה; וְיֵשׁ אוֹמְרִים: 'יְהִי אוֹר' **— "The Holy One, Blessed be He, said: How long will the world proceed in darkness; let the light arrive;** – זֶה אַבְרָהָם". **— and some say: 'Let there be light' — this is Abraham."**

וְהִנֵּה בְּרֵאשִׁית הַבְּרִיאָה בָּרָא הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא הַחשֶׁךְ וְהָאוֹר, **— And behold in the beginning of Creation the Holy One created darkness and light,** וְלַחשֶׁךְ קָרָא לַיְלָה, וּבָרָא הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ מְאוֹרוֹת לְהָאִיר חֶשְׁכַּת הַלַּיְלָה: **— and the darkness He called night, and the Blessed Name created luminaries to light the darkness of night:** מְאוֹר הַלְּבָנָה אֵינוֹ רַק **— the luminary of the moon for the dominion of the night;** אַךְ מְאוֹר הַלְּבָנָה לְמֶמְשֶׁלֶת הַלַּיְלָה; וְגַם כְּשֶׁמֵּאִיר אֵינוֹ מֵאִיר בַּבַּיִת **— yet the light of the moon shines only during part of the month,** בְּמִקְצַת הַחֹדֶשׁ, **— and even when it shines, it does not illuminate indoors adequately;** וְעַל זֶה אָמַר אָדָם הָרִאשׁוֹן: "אַךְ כַּהֹגֶן;

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[521] **Midrash Tanchuma, Noach 3:10**: “Therefore the Holy One, blessed be He, established two yeshivot (at Sura and Pumbeditha) for the Israelites where they studied the Torah day and night, and where they assembled from all parts of the world twice each year, in the months of Adar and Elul. They came together to “battle” the problems encountered in the Torah until they had resolved them and reached a definitive decision concerning them. They would adduce arguments from the Torah, the Mishnah, and the Talmud so that the Israelites might not sin against the law, as it is said: Great peace have they that love Thy law; and there is no sinning for them (Ps. 119:165). Scripture informs us: The Lord will give strength unto His people, the Lord will bless His people with peace (Ps. 29:11). Hence, these two yeshivot experienced neither captivity, persecution, nor pillage; and neither Greece nor Rome ever conquered them. The Holy One, blessed be He, led the people out of Jerusalem with their Written and Oral Law twelve years before its destruction, as it is written: And he carried away all Jerusalem, and all the princes and all the mighty men of valor, even ten thousand captives, and all the craftsmen and smiths; none remained save the poorest sort of people of the land (II Kings 24:14). Is there might among men being led into exile? These were the mighty ones in their knowledge of Torah, as is indicated in the verse: In the Book of the Wars of the Lord (Num. 21:14).”

[522] **Megillah 16b:8-9**: “‘The Jews had light, joy, gladness, and honor.’ Rav Yehudah said: ‘Light’ means Torah, as it also says, ‘For a commandment is a lamp and Torah is light.’ ‘Joy’ means a festival, as it also says, ‘You shall rejoice on your festival.’ ‘Gladness’ means circumcision, as it also says, ‘I rejoice over Your word.’ ‘Honor’ means tefillin, as it also says, ‘All the peoples of the earth shall see that the Lord’s name is called upon you, and they shall fear you.’ It was taught: Rabbi Eliezer the Great says: These are the tefillin worn on the head.”

[523] **Zohar, Yitro 20:332**: “We have been taught that the Holy One, blessed be He, gave six hundred and thirteen counsels unto man, in order that he might be perfect in attachment to his Lord, for the Holy King desires only his good, both in this world and in the world to come; but more especially in the world to come, since whatever good the Holy One bestows upon man in this world is taken from the sum of good which he is entitled to receive in the world to come. Why is this? Because, as we have been taught, the world to come is, as it were, God’s own possession. This is not to say, of course, that this present world is not His also,”

[524] **Bereshit Rabbah 2:3** (excerpt): “The Holy One, blessed be He, said: How long will the world continue in darkness? Let light come! ‘God said: Let there be light’—this is Abraham. This is what is written: ‘Who aroused one from the east, righteousness …’ (Isaiah 41:2). Do not read ‘aroused’ (he’ir), but ‘illuminated’ (he’ir).”

חֹשֶׁךְ יְשׁוּפֵנִי", — **and regarding this Adam the First Man said: "Surely the darkness will envelop me",** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב (בְּרֵאשִׁית רַבָּה פָּרָשָׁה י״א)[525] — **and as written (in Bereishit Rabbah, Parashah 11)** שֶׁזִּמֵּן לוֹ הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא שְׁנֵי רְעָפִים וְהִקִּישָׁן זֶה לָזֶה וְיָצָא מֵהֶם אוֹר, — **that the Holy One provided him two flints and he struck them against one another and light emerged from them,** וּבֵרַךְ עָלֶיהָ "בּוֹרֵא מְאוֹרֵי הָאֵשׁ", — **and he recited over it the blessing "Who creates the luminaries of fire",** וְעַל זֶה אָמַר: "וְלַיְלָה אוֹר בַּעֲדֵנִי". — **and on this he declared: "and night becomes light about me".**

The laborer discovers light already present

וְהִנֵּה שְׁנֵי הַמְּאוֹרוֹת הָאֵלּוּ נִפְרָדִים זֶה מִזֶּה:[526] — **And behold, these two luminaries are distinct from one another:** שֶׁאוֹר הַלְּבָנָה הוּא מִצַּד הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ שֶׁמַּאִיר לְכָל הָעוֹלָם, — **for the moon's light is from the side of the Blessed Name illuminating the entire world,** אֲמְנָם בְּרִיאַת אוֹר הָאֵשׁ שֶׁעַל יְדֵי הֶקֵּשׁ הָרְעָפִים זֶה בָּזֶה — **whereas the generation of the light of fire through striking flints together** הוּא עַל יְדֵי יְגִיעַת הָאָדָם לְהַמְצִיא הָאוֹר הַהוּא. — **is accomplished through human labor to produce that fire.** וְעַל דֶּרֶךְ זֶה הוּא גַּם כֵּן בְּהָאָרַת אוֹרוֹ יִתְבָּרַךְ — **And in this very pattern it is also regarding the illumination of His divine light** לְהָאִיר חֶשְׁכַּת לַיְלָה דְּעוֹלָם הַזֶּה הַדּוֹמֶה לְלַיְלָה, כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב (פְּסָחִים ב' עַמּוּד ב'):[527] — **to illuminate the darkness of the night of this world which resembles night, as written (Pesachim 2b):** דְּהִנֵּה מְאוֹרוֹת הַגַּשְׁמִיִּים שֶׁמִּצַּד הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ הֵם שְׁנַיִם: אוֹר הַשֶּׁמֶשׁ וְהַיָּרֵחַ; — **for behold physical luminaries created by the Blessed Name are two: the light of the sun and the moon;** וְהַשֶּׁמֶשׁ הוּא אוֹר עַצְמִי, — **and the sun is an intrinsic, self-contained light,** וְהַיָּרֵחַ מְקַבֶּלֶת אוֹרָהּ מֵאוֹר הַשֶּׁמֶשׁ. — **while the moon receives its illumination from the light of the sun.**

Darkness changes reception, not the light's source

וּבְרוּחָנִיּוּת הֵם אוֹר תּוֹרָה שֶׁבִּכְתָב וְתוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה, דְּ"תוֹרָה אוֹר" כַּנִּזְכָּר לְעֵיל;[528] — **And in spirituality they are the light of the Written Torah and Oral Torah, for "Torah is light" as mentioned;** וְהֵם וְהֵמָּה מְאוֹרוֹת שֶׁל הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ, גַּם כֵּן עַל דֶּרֶךְ שְׁנֵי הַמְּאוֹרוֹת הַנִּזְכָּרִים לְעֵיל: — **and they are luminaries of the Blessed Name, patterned after the two physical luminaries:** הַתּוֹרָה שֶׁבִּכְתָב הוּא אוֹר עַצְמִי מִצִּדּוֹ יִתְבָּרַךְ וְאֵין בּוֹ חֹשֶׁךְ כְּלָל, — **the Written Torah is an**

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[525] **Bereshit Rabbah 11:2** (excerpt): "When the sun set at the conclusion of Shabbos, darkness began to approach and Adam became afraid, as it says, 'I said: Surely darkness will overwhelm me, and the night will be light about me' (Psalms 139:11). He feared that the one of whom it was written, 'He shall strike your head, and you shall strike his heel' (Genesis 3:15), was coming to attack him. What did the Holy One, blessed be He, do? He provided him with two tiles. Adam struck them together, light came forth, and he recited a blessing over it. This is what is written: 'The night will be light about me.' What blessing did he recite? 'Who creates the lights of fire.'"

[526] **Tiferet Yosef, Beha'alotcha 1**: "In truth, from God's side even the inanimate is full of light. The person simply does not recognize how God's light is present in it. But if he serves and brings light to himself until he recognizes that even the inanimate is full of God's light, he then recognizes that it was full of His light until now as well. His previous impression that His light was absent came entirely from his own side: he did not yet have that recognition. Thus the Midrash says that at the departure of Shabbat, Adam took two tiles, struck them together, and light came from them. It does not say that he generated light from them. This implies that one cannot generate light, since from God's side it is always full of light. He only found light in them, discovering it because he illuminated himself through his work. His blessing over them means that he blessed and praised God for giving him the power to illuminate himself and recognize that His light is present even in the inanimate."

Tiferet reads the identical image of Adam striking tiles and distinguishes the labor of finding from independent creation of the light. It deepens Rav Tzadok's contrast between received moonlight and humanly worked fire without denying that the person truly labors. Tiferet's claim is a spiritual interpretation of the Midrash's wording.

[527] **Pesachim 2b**: 'The Gemara raises an objection: "And I say, yet the darkness shall envelop me, and the or about me shall be night" (Psalms 139:11). Apparently, or is day. The Gemara rejects this proof. This is what David is saying there: I said after I sinned that darkness shall envelop me in the World-to-Come, which is like day. Now that I know that I have been forgiven, even this world, which is like darkness, is light for me. That being the case, it cannot be derived from here that the word or describes the day.'

[528] **Tzidkat HaTzadik 79:1**: "Damage above through sins is like what we call an eclipse of the sun. In truth the sun, in itself and from its own side, suffers no eclipse at all; the absence of its light upon the earth is called an eclipse of the sun. Since its purpose is to illuminate the earth, this counts as an impairment on its side. Every night is likewise an eclipse of the sun, for this too comes through an intervening screen, like its eclipse by day. Nevertheless, when the moon shines, the sun's eclipse is not complete: as is known, the moon's light comes from the sun and the radiance of its light. Although we call it moonlight, those who understand know that it is really sunlight and has not been completely eclipsed. At the end of the month, or when the moon too is eclipsed and does not shine, the sun's eclipse is complete. This is precisely an analogy for above: 'More than the calf wants to suckle, the cow wants to nurse.' The purpose of the unfolding of Atzilut is to bestow upon Israel. When Israel sins and does not receive the light of knowing God fully, this is counted, as it were, as weakness in the heavenly retinue. This is the meaning of destruction above, exile compared to night, and the levels within exile itself. Understand all this."

Tzidkat makes explicit what the sun/moon model does and does not imply: the source itself is not damaged when reception is obscured. This clarifies why Rav Tzadok can describe a post-sin, apparently human light while continuing to call it God's light. The astronomical imagery is presented as the author's analogy, not a new scientific explanation.

intrinsic divine light from His side with no darkness at all, וְ"אַלְמָלֵא חָטְאוּ יִשְׂרָאֵל לֹא נִתַּן לָהֶם אֶלָּא חֲמִשָּׁה חֻמְשֵׁי תוֹרָה וְכוּלֵיהּ"[529], כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב (נְדָרִים כ״ב עַמּוּד ב׳); **— and "had Israel not sinned they would have been given only the Five Books of the Torah, etc." (Nedarim 22b);** וְעַל זֶה נֶאֱמַר: "כִּי בְּרֹב חָכְמָה רָב כָּעַס". **— and on this it is said: "For in much wisdom is much grief".** וּבְעֵת נְתִינַת הַתּוֹרָה כְּתִיב: "אֲנִי אָמַרְתִּי אֱלֹהִים אַתֶּם", **— And at the giving of the Torah it was written: "I said: you are godlike angels",** וְהַיְנוּ כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב (עֲבוֹדָה זָרָה ה׳ עַמּוּד א׳)[530] שֶׁהָיָה חֵרוּת מִמַּלְאַךְ הַמָּוֶת דְּלֹא הָווּ מֵיְתֵי, **— meaning as written (Avodah Zarah 5a) that there was freedom from the Angel of Death, for they would not die,** וְהוּא מַלְאַךְ הַמָּוֶת הוּא יֵצֶר הָרָע; **— and the Angel of Death is identical with the Evil Inclination;** וְהָיוּ כְּמוֹ לָעָתִיד דִּכְתִיב: "וְלֹא יְלַמְּדוּ עוֹד אִישׁ אֶת רֵעֵהוּ וְגוֹמֵר", **— and they were on the plane of the future of which it is written: "and they shall teach no more every man his fellow, etc.",** וְהָיָה דֵּי לָהֶם תּוֹרָה שֶׁבִּכְתָב שֶׁהוּא דֶּגְמַת אוֹר הַשָּׁמֶשׁ, **— and the Written Torah alone would have sufficed for them, which resembles the light of the sun;** דְּעוֹלָם הַבָּא דּוֹמֶה לְיוֹם כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב רֵישׁ פְּסָחִים. **— for the World to Come resembles the day as written at the start of Pesachim.** וְכֵיוָן שֶׁחָטְאוּ חָזְרוּ לְחֶשְׁכַּת עוֹלָם הַזֶּה **— And once they sinned they returned to the darkness of this world which resembles night,** הַדּוֹמֶה לְלַיְלָה, וּצְרִיכִין לִמְאוֹר הַלְּבָנָה לְהָאִיר מִתּוֹךְ הַחֹשֶׁךְ, וְהַיְנוּ בְּחִינַת תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה, "סִיהֲרָא דְּמַקְבְּלָא מִשְׁמְשָׁא" **— and require the light of the moon to illuminate from within the darkness; –** תּוֹרָה שֶׁבִּכְתָב. **— and this is the aspect of the Oral Torah, "the moon receiving from the sun" — the Written Torah.** וְאוֹר תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה הוּא גַּם כֵּן מֵאוֹר שֶׁבָּרָאוֹ הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ, **— And the light of the Oral Torah is likewise a luminary created by the Blessed Name,** וְאַף עַל פִּי שֶׁהַכֹּל הוּא מַה שֶּׁחִדְּשׁוּ סוֹפְרִים וַחֲכְמֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל, **— and even though all of it consists of that which the Scribes and Sages of Israel innovated,** הוּא רַק שֶׁנִּדְמֶה בְּעֵינֵי הָאָדָם שֶׁהוּא הַמַּמְצִיא וְהַמְחַדֵּשׁ הָאוֹר הַהוּא, **— it is only that it seems in human eyes that man is the one discovering and generating that light,** אֲבָל בֶּאֱמֶת הוּא מִצַּד הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ שֶׁמַּאִיר בְּלִבּוֹ הָאוֹר הַהוּא. **— whereas in truth it is from the Blessed Name Who shines that light into his heart.**

וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ (עֵירוּבִין י״ג עַמּוּד ב׳)[531]: "אֵלּוּ וְאֵלּוּ דִּבְרֵי אֱלֹהִים חַיִּים", **— And as they said (Eruvin 13b): "These and those are the words of the Living God",** וְכֵן (שַׁבָּת בַּחֲגִיגָה ג׳ עַמּוּד ב׳): "כֻּלָּם נִתְּנוּ מֵרֹעֶה אֶחָד, מִפִּי אֶדוֹן כָּל הַמַּעֲשִׂים"; **— and (Chagigah 3b): "All were given from one Shepherd, from the mouth of the Master of all works"; –** וְכֵן (קל״ח עַמּוּד ב׳)[532, 533]: "'לְבַקֵּשׁ אֶת דְּבַר הַשֵּׁם' זוֹ הֲלָכָה וְכוּלֵיהּ, 'וְלֹא יִמְצָאוּ'[534] **— and likewise (Shabbat 138b): "'To seek the word of Hashem' — this is Halachah, etc.,** – שֶׁלֹּא יִמְצְאוּ הֲלָכָה בְּרוּרָה וּמִשְׁנָה בְּרוּרָה בְּמָקוֹם אֶחָד", **— 'and they shall not find it' — that they will not find a clear Halachah and clear Mishnah in one place",** הֲרֵי דְּהַכֹּל דְּבַר הַשֵּׁם. **— behold that all of it is the word of Hashem.**

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[529] **Nedarim 22b:3**: "Rav Adda son of Rabbi Chanina said: Had Israel not sinned, only the five books of the Torah and the Book of Yehoshua would have been given to them, because the latter describes the arrangement of the Land of Israel. What is the reason for the additional books? 'For with much wisdom comes much anger.'"

[530] **Avodah Zarah 5a**: "He follows this tanna's view, for it was taught: Rabbi Yose says: Israel received the Torah so that the Angel of Death should have no dominion over them, as it says: 'I said: You are divine beings, and all of you sons of the Most High.' But you corrupted your deeds: 'Indeed, like Adam you will die.'"

[531] **Eruvin 13b:10**: "Rabbi Abba said in Shmuel's name: For three years Beis Shammai and Beis Hillel disagreed. These said, 'The halachah follows us,' and those said, 'The halachah follows us.' A heavenly voice went forth and said: 'These and those are the words of the living God, and the halachah follows Beis Hillel.'"

[532] **Chagigah 3b:4**: "A person might say: How can I learn Torah from now on, amid these conflicting opinions? Therefore Scripture teaches, 'They were all given by one shepherd.' One God gave them; one leader, Moshe, spoke them, from the mouth of the Master of all deeds, blessed be He, as it is written, 'God spoke all these words.'"

[533] **Shabbat 138b:11**; **Shabbat 138b:17-139a:1**: "'The word of Hashem'—this is halakhah; 'the word of Hashem'—this is the end of days; 'the word of Hashem'—this is prophecy. It was taught: Rabbi Shimon ben Yochai says: Heaven forbid that Torah should be forgotten from Israel, for it is written: 'It shall not be forgotten from the mouth of his descendants.' How, then, do I understand 'They will wander to seek the word of Hashem, but will not find it'? They will not find clear halakhah and clear Mishnah together in one place."

[534] **Shabbat 138b:11**; **Shabbat 138b:17-139a:1**: "'The word of Hashem'—this is halakhah; 'the word of Hashem'—this is the end of days; 'the word of Hashem'—this is prophecy. It was taught: Rabbi Shimon ben Yochai says: Heaven forbid that Torah should be forgotten from Israel, for it is written: 'It shall not be forgotten from the mouth of his descendants.' How, then, do I understand 'They will wander to seek the word of Hashem, but will not find it'? They will not find clear halakhah and clear Mishnah together in one place."

Words of Torah draw from a continuing source

אֲמִירָה, "תִּזַּל כַּטַּל אִמְרָתִי": [535,536] וְעַל זֶה נֶאֱמַר — **And on this it is said: "My speech shall distill as the dew",** בַּחֲשַׁאי, כִּדְבַר אַתָּה אוֹמֵר "וְאָמַרְתָּ בִּלְבָבֶךָ" (זֹהַר חֵלֶק א׳ רל״ד עַמּוּד ב׳); [537] — **an utterance in quiet secrecy, as you say "and you said in your heart" (Zohar Part I, 234b);** — וְהַיְנוּ תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה שֶׁשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרֵךְ בְּלֵב הַחֲכָמִים, **and this is the Oral Torah which the Blessed Name shines into the heart of the Sages;** וְהוּא נְדָמֶה כְּטַל שֶׁאֵין אָדָם רוֹאֶה וּמַרְגִּישׁ בִּירִידָתוֹ מִן הַשָּׁמַיִם, — **and it resembles dew whose descent from the heavens no man sees or feels,** רַק אַחַר כָּךְ מוֹצֵא הָאָרֶץ לַחָה וְיוֹדֵעַ שֶׁיָּרַד הַטַּל. — **only afterward does he find the ground moist and knows that the dew descended.** וְכֵן הוּא הִתְחַדְּשׁוּת תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה, — **And such is the renewal of the Oral Torah,** אֲשֶׁר אֵין אָדָם מַרְגִּישׁ הַהֶאָרָה וְהַהַשְׁפָּעָה בַּלֵּב וְנִדְמֶה לוֹ שֶׁנִּתְחַדֵּשׁ בְּשִׂכְלוֹ, — **wherein a person does not palpably feel the inflow and bestowal in the heart and imagines it was innovated by his intellect,** וּבֶאֱמֶת הוּא מֵהַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ שֶׁמֵּאִיר בְּלִבּוֹ, כְּמָה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: "וּדְבָרַי אֲשֶׁר שַׂמְתִּי בְּפִיךָ"; — **whereas in truth it is from the Blessed Name Who shines into his heart, as Scripture states: "And My words which I have placed in your mouth";** וְכָל הַתּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה כֻּלָּהּ לְקוּחָה מֵהַתּוֹרָה שֶׁבִּכְתָב, — **and the entirety of the Oral Torah is drawn from the Written Torah,** וְכֵן אָמְרוּ שֶׁאָמְרוּ (תַּעֲנִית ט׳ עַמּוּד א׳) גַּם עַל הַכָּתוּב בַּכְּתוּבִים: "דְּלִיכָּא מִידֵי דְּלָא רְמִיזֵי בְּאוֹרַיְיתָא"; [538] — **as they said (Ta'anit 9a) even regarding passages in the Writings: "There is nothing that is not alluded to in the Torah";** וְעַל זֶה אָמְרוּ (עֵירוּבִין כ״א עַמּוּד ב׳) עַל הַפָּסוּק "קְוּצוֹתָיו תַּלְתַּלִּים": [539] — **and on this they said (Eruvin 21b) on the verse "His locks are curled":** שֶׁיֵּשׁ לִדְרֹשׁ עַל כָּל קוֹץ וְקוֹץ תִּלֵּי תִּלִּים שֶׁל הֲלָכוֹת. — **that one may expound upon every single stroke heaps upon heaps of halachot.** וְהוּא לְעֻמַּת מְאוֹר הַלְּבָנָה שֶׁנִּדְמֶה גַּם כֵּן שֶׁיֵּשׁ בָּהּ אוֹר עַצְמִי, וּבֶאֱמֶת הָאוֹר הוּא רַק מַה שֶּׁמְּקַבֶּלֶת מֵהַשֶּׁמֶשׁ. — **And it corresponds to the moon which similarly appears as having intrinsic light, whereas in truth its light is only what it receives from the sun.** וְזֶהוּ הַהֶאָרָה הָרִאשׁוֹנָה שֶׁבָּעוֹלָם הַזֶּה הַדּוֹמֶה לְלַיְלָה שֶׁהוּא רַק מִצַּד הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ, שֶׁהוּא דִּגְמַת אוֹר הַיָּרֵחַ. — **And this is the first illumination in this world that resembles night, which is purely from the side of the Blessed Name, being the analogue of the moonlight.** וְיֵשׁ עוֹד אוֹר שֶׁמִּצַּד הָאָדָם, וְהוּא כְּמוֹ מְאוֹר הָאֵשׁ הַמֵּאִיר בַּחֲשֵׁכָה; — **And there is another light which stems from man, and it is like the light of fire illuminating in the darkness;** וְהוּא מַה שֶּׁכָּתוּב (בָּבָא בַּתְרָא ד׳ עַמּוּד א׳)[540] דְּאָמַר לֵיהּ לְהוֹרְדוֹס דְּקָטִיל לְרַבָּנַן שֶׁהֵם אוֹר תּוֹרָה, — **and it is what is written (Bava Batra**

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[535] **Resisei Layla 46:1**: “Making Him king means that a person apprehends that all his reason comes from God. This is the whole wisdom of Oral Torah. It is not like human wisdom, which one attains through one’s own reason; Oral Torah flows from Written Torah. This is the essence of His blessed kingship: when He rules over human reason, which is the essence of the human form, since all human conduct is governed by reason.”

Resisei turns the dew analogy into a discipline of understanding: the intellect is used, but must recognize that its power and Torah’s content are received. The full paragraph also preserves disagreement and the distinction between Written and Oral Torah, so this is not a blanket divine endorsement of every idea a person happens to have.

[536] **Sod Yesharim, Sukkot 81:1**: “‘Willows of the brook’ is as the Zohar says: the two willow branches are netzach and hod, resembling the two lips. With other matters, once a person brings them from thought into speech, he has nothing more to add to them. But concerning Torah it says, ‘Upon his lips he adds learning’: whenever a person brings words of Torah from his lips, something wells up anew within him each time from the flowing source, as it says, ‘Whoever finds Me finds life.’”

Sod describes Torah speech as ongoing reception from a flowing source rather than the mere discharge of an already finished private thought. This illuminates the continuing divine bestowal in Rav Tzadok’s dew image. It does not identify all novel speech as Torah; the full target places this claim within the four species’ disciplined relation to the source.

[537] **Zohar, Vayechi 53:517-528**: ‘When Jacob said to his sons, “I will tell you what will befall you in the latter end of days”, a kind of sadness came over him and the Shekinah departed. His sons, however, raised their voices and said, “Hear, O Israel, etc.”, and Jacob answered, “Blessed be the name of his glorious kingdom for ever and ever”, and on this proclamation of the unity the Shekinah returned to its place. AND JACOB CALLED. The word ‘called’ signifies that he established them in their place above and below.’

[538] **Taanit 9a**: ‘Rabbi Yoḥanan sat down and wondered aloud about this verse, saying: Is there anything that is written in the Writings that is not alluded to in the Torah at all? I cannot think of any hint of this idea in the Torah itself. The child said to him: Is that to say that this idea is really not alluded to in the Torah? But isn’t it written, with regard to Joseph’s brothers: “And their heart failed them and they turned trembling to one to another, saying: What is this that God has done to us?” (Genesis 42:28). This verse exemplifies the notion that when one sins and encounters troubles, he wonders why it is happening to him.’

[539] **Eruvin 21b**: ‘With regard to the verse, “His head is as the most fine gold, his locks kevutzotav are wavy taltalim, and black as a raven” (Song of Songs 5:11), Rav Ḥisda said that Mar Ukva said: This teaches that it is possible to expound from each and every stroke kotz of the letters in the Torah mounds upon mounds tilei tilim of laws.’

[540] **Bava Batra 4a:3**: “Herod told Bava ben Buta, ‘I am that man. Had I known how carefully the Sages guard their speech, I would not have killed them. Now, what remedy is there for a man like me?’ He answered: ‘He extinguished the light of the world, as it is written, “For a commandment is a lamp and Torah is light.” Let him therefore occupy himself with the light of the world by rebuilding the Temple, of which it says, “All the nations will stream toward it.”’ Others report that he answered him this way: ‘He blinded the eye of the world, as it is written, “If it was done away from the eyes of the congregation,” referring to its Sages. Let him therefore occupy himself with the eye of the world by rebuilding the Temple, of which it says, “I am about to profane My Sanctuary, the pride of your strength, the delight of

4a) that he said to Herod who killed the Rabbis who are the light of the Torah: וְאָמַר לוֹ: "הוּא כִּבָּה אוֹרוֹ שֶׁל עוֹלָם, דִּכְתִיב: 'וְתוֹרָה אוֹר', — **saying to him: "He extinguished the light of the world, for it is written: 'And Torah is light';** יֵלֵךְ וְיַעֲסֹק בְּאוֹרוֹ שֶׁל עוֹלָם, דִּכְתִיב: 'וְנָהֲרוּ וְגוֹמֵר'", — **let him go and engage in the light of the world, for it is written: 'And they shall stream unto the Mountain of Hashem, etc.'",** וְהֵיכָן אוֹר הַבַּיִת הַמִּקְדָּשׁ שֶׁהוּא הָעֲבוֹדָה. — **which refers to the light of the Holy Temple which is divine service (Avodah).** וְהִנֵּה שְׁנֵי הַמְּאוֹרוֹת הַמְּאִירִים לָנוּ חֶשְׁכַּת עוֹלָם הַזֶּה הַדּוֹמֶה לְלַיְלָה, הֵם עַמּוּדִים שֶׁהָעוֹלָם עוֹמֵד, — **And behold the two luminaries that illuminate for us the darkness of this world resembling night — are pillars upon which the world stands,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בְּרֵישׁ אָבוֹת: עַל "עַל שְׁלֹשָׁה דְבָרִים הָעוֹלָם עוֹמֵד: עַל הַתּוֹרָה, וְעַל הָעֲבוֹדָה, וְעַל גְּמִילוּת חֲסָדִים": — **as written at the beginning of Avot: "Upon three things the world stands: upon Torah, upon divine service, and upon deeds of kindness":** – הֵיכָן אוֹר תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה הַנִּזְקָר לְעֵיל; וַעֲבוֹדָה — **Torah — refers to the light of the Oral Torah mentioned above; –** אוֹר בֵּית הַמִּקְדָּשׁ שֶׁהוּא אוֹר הָעֲבוֹדָה, — **and service — the light of the Temple which is the light of sacrifical worship,** וְאַחַר הַחֲרְבָּן תְּפִלָּה בְּמְקוֹמוֹ, — **and after the destruction prayer stands in its stead,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בְּפִרְקֵי דְּרַבִּי אֱלִיעֶזֶר (רֵישׁ פֶּרֶק ט״ז) וּמִדְרַשׁ שְׁמוּאֵל רַבָּתָא (פֶּרֶק ב׳) מִקְרָא "דִּי אַנְתְּ פָּלַח לֵיהּ", [541] — **as written in Pirkei DeRabbi Eliezer (beginning of Chapter 16) and Midrash Shmuel Rabbata (Chapter 2) from the verse "Whom you serve continually",** וּבַגְּמָרָא (בְּרָכוֹת כ״ו עַמּוּד ב׳): "תְּפִלּוֹת כְּנֶגֶד תְּמִידִין תִּקְּנוּם", [542, 543] וּבְרֵישׁ (תַּעֲנִית ב׳ עַמּוּד א׳): "עֲבוֹדָה שֶׁהִיא בַּלֵּב" — **and in the Gemara (Berachot 26b): "Prayers were instituted corresponding to the Daily Offerings", –** זוֹ תְּפִלָּה", [544] — **and at the beginning of (Ta'anit 2a): "'Service of the heart' — this is prayer",** וְכֵן אוֹמְרִים בִּבְרָכַת עֲבוֹדָה: "וְאִשֵּׁי יִשְׂרָאֵל וּתְפִלָּתָם וְכוּ׳", — **and so we say in the blessing of Avodah: "and the fire-offerings of Israel and their prayer, etc.",** כִּי גַּם עַל יְדֵי תְּפִלָּה שֶׁהוּא כְּעוֹמֵד לִפְנֵי הַמֶּלֶךְ מֵאִיר חֶשְׁכַּת הַלֵּב. — **for through prayer also, where one stands like a servant before the King, the darkness of the heart is illuminated.**

Kindness as service requires its inward purpose

וְעַמּוּד הַשְּׁלִישִׁי שֶׁהוּא גְּמִילוּת חֲסָדִים אֵינוֹ נֶחְשָׁב לְאוֹר בִּפְנֵי עַצְמוֹ, [545] — **And the third pillar which is acts of**

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your eyes.”””

[541] **Pirkei DeRabbi Eliezer 16:16**: “The bridegroom is like a king. Just as a king is praised by everybody, so is the bridegroom praised by everybody (during) the seven days of the feast. Just as a king is dressed in garments of glory, so the bridegroom is dressed in garments of glory. Just as a king is rejoicing, with feasts in his presence, all his days, so || the bridegroom is rejoicing and has feasts before him all the seven days of the banquet. Just as the king does not go into the market-place alone, likewise the bridegroom does not go into the market-place alone. Just as the face of a king is shining like the light of a sun, so the face of the bridegroom is shining like the light of a sun, as it is said, "And he is as a bridegroom coming out of his chamber, and rejoicing to run his course" (Ps. 19:5).”

[542] **Berakhot 26b:14**: “Shall we say that this refutes Rabbi Yosei the son of Rabbi Chanina? Rabbi Yosei the son of Rabbi Chanina could answer you: I still maintain that the patriarchs instituted the prayers, while the Sages subsequently related them to the offerings. For if you did not say this, who, according to Rabbi Yosei the son of Rabbi Chanina, instituted the additional Musaf prayer? Rather, the patriarchs instituted the prayers, and the Sages related them to the offerings, establishing Musaf in correspondence with the additional offering.”

[543] **Taanit 2a**: ‘The Gemara asks: And from where do we derive that rain must be mentioned specifically in the Amida prayer? The Gemara answers: As it was taught in a baraita with regard to the verse: “To love the Lord your God and to serve Him with all your heart” (Deuteronomy 11:13). Which is the service of God that is performed in the heart? You must say that this is referring to prayer. And, afterward, it is written: “And I shall give the rain of your land in its due time, the first rain and the last rain” (Deuteronomy 11:14). This juxtaposition teaches that it is appropriate to request rain while engaged in the service of the heart, i.e., prayer.’

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[545] **Kometz HaMinchah 2:13:1**: “Abstaining from and setting limits against jealousy, desire, and honor must specifically be for God’s sake. ‘You shall be holy’ means separate and bounded, specifically for the reason ‘because I, the Lord, am holy.’ Likewise, ‘Walk modestly’—this restraint must specifically be ‘with your God.’ Thus Shabbat says: they established marketplaces so everything would be available—kindness, the opposite of jealousy; bridges for crossing water, corresponding to desire; and bathhouses, corresponding to honor, as ‘honor is not accorded in the bathhouse.’ All was for their own needs, and counts as nothing. Likewise Sotah speaks of a praying maiden, associated with service; an outgoing widow, associated with kindness; and a minor whose months are not complete, meaning a Torah scholar, associated with Torah. These destroy the world when their conduct is not truly for God. It is upon these three things that the world stands when they are for Him; otherwise, even if one is restrained from jealousy, desire, and honor, it is as though he were unrestrained, possessing the jealousy, desire, and honor that remove a person from the world.” Kometz makes the test apply to all three pillars and to seemingly pious conduct as well: a good exterior is insufficient without sincere orientation to God. This clarifies the origin’s criterion for sacred kindness rather than extending its polemical example into a new claim about every individual outsider. The comparison concerns the author’s standard for

lovingkindness is not considered an autonomous light on its own, מִפְּנֵי שֶׁגַּם בָּעַכּוּ"ם יֵשׁ גְּמִילוּת חֲסָדִים, וּכְתִיב: כָּל צְדָקָה שֶׁעַכּוּ"ם עוֹשִׂין חֵטְא "וְחֶסֶד לְאֻמִּים חַטָּאת" — **because among the heathens lovingkindness also exists, – and it is written: "And the kindness of nations is sin" — all charity Gentiles perform is a sin for them,** הוּא לָהֶם, שֶׁאֵין עוֹשִׂין אֶלָּא לְהִתְיַהֵר בּוֹ, כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב (בָּבָא בַּתְרָא י' עַמּוּד ב')[546] — **because they perform it only to aggrandize themselves, as written (Bava Batra 10b);** וְכֵינָן שֶׁאֵין כַּוָּנָתָם לְשֵׁם שָׁמַיִם רַק לְמַחֲשָׁבָה אַחֶרֶת, אֵינוֹ נֶחְשָׁב מִצְוָה כְּלָל. — **and since their intention is not for Heaven's sake but for selfish motives, it is not considered a mitzvah at all.** וְעִקַּר עַמּוּד הַגְּמִילוּת חֲסָדִים שֶׁנֶּחְשָׁב מֵעַמּוּדֵי עוֹלָם הוּא רַק אִם נִצְמַח מִשְּׁנֵי אוֹרוֹת הַנִּזְכָּרִים, שֶׁהֵם עַמּוּד הַתּוֹרָה וְהָעֲבוֹדָה, — **And the essence of the pillar of lovingkindness counted among the pillars of the universe is only when it sprouts from the two mentioned lights, the pillars of Torah and Avodah,** כְּשֶׁעוֹשֶׂה בַּעֲבוּר מִצְוַת הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ, וְאָז גַּם זֶה עֲבוֹדָה. — **when one acts for the sake of the commandment of the Blessed Name, and then this too is divine service.**

Abraham's hospitality reveals the true giver

וְאַבְרָהָם אָבִינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם שֶׁהָיָה רֹאשׁ גּוֹמְלֵי חֲסָדִים,[547] — **And Abraham our Father, peace be upon him, who was the head of practitioners of kindness,** אֲבָל עִקַּר כַּוָּנָתוֹ הָיָה לְהָאִירָם עַל יְדֵי זֶה מֵאוֹר הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ, — **his ultimate intent was to illuminate them through this from the light of the Blessed Name,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב (בְּרֵאשִׁית רַבָּה סוֹף פָּרָשָׁה נ"ד): "מִשֶּׁהָיוּ אוֹכְלִין וְשׁוֹתִין, אָמַר לָהֶם: בָּרְכוּ[548] — **as written (Bereishit Rabbah, end of Parashah 54):** "בָּרוּךְ אֵל עוֹלָם שֶׁאָכַלְנוּ מִשֶּׁלּוֹ וְכוּלֵיהּ", וְכוּלֵיהּ, — **"Once they had eaten and drunk, he said to them: Bless, etc.,** וְהַיְנוּ שֶׁכָּל כַּוָּנָתוֹ הָיָה לְהָאִיר עַל הָאָרֶץ שֶׁהַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ הוּא גַּם אֱלֹהֵי הָאָרֶץ; — **blessed be the God of the Universe of Whose bounty we have eaten, etc.", meaning that his entire goal was to illuminate upon earth that the Blessed Name is also the God of the earth;** הוּא עַמּוּד שֶׁל גְּמִילוּת חֲסָדִים שֶׁנִּצְמַח מֵאוֹר תּוֹרָה. — **this is a pillar of lovingkindness springing from the light of Torah.** וְאַבְרָהָם אָבִינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם הָיָה הָאוֹר תּוֹרָה דְּמִמֶּנּוּ הוּא הַתְחָלַת שְׁנֵי אַלְפִּים תּוֹרָה, — **And Abraham our Father was the light of Torah from whom began the two thousand years of Torah,** שֶׁזִּמֵּן לוֹ הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא שְׁנֵי כְלְיוֹתָיו כְּמִין שְׁנֵי רַבָּנִים (בְּרֵאשִׁית רַבָּה פָּרָשָׁה ס"א)[549] וְאִיתָא — **and it is found (Bereishit Rabbah, Parashah 61) that the Holy One designated his two kidneys like two rabbis and that was what the Blessed Name illuminated for him,** וְהוּא מַה שֶׁהַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ הֵאִיר לוֹ, וְהֵיוּ נוֹבְעוֹת וּמְלַמְּדוֹת אוֹתוֹ תּוֹרָה, — **and they welled up and taught him Torah,** וְכִלְשׁוֹן הַמִּדְרָשׁ (בְּרֵאשִׁית רַבָּה פָּרָשָׁה ב') הַנִּזְכָּר לְעֵיל: "אָמַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא וְכוּלֵיהּ וְתָבֹא הָאוֹרָה".[550] — **matching the language of the Midrash mentioned above: "The Holy One said, etc., and let the light arrive".**

וְיִצְחָק אָבִינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם הָיָה עַמּוּד הָעֲבוֹדָה שֶׁנֶּעֱקַד לְקָרְבָּן לַהַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ, — **And Isaac our Father, peace be upon him, was the pillar of Avodah who was bound as a sacrifice to the Blessed Name,** וְכִדְאִיתָא בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ (חֵלֶק א' קמ"ב עַמּוּד א'): "וַיִּקְרָא אֱלֹהִים לָאוֹר יוֹם'[551] — **and as**

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divine service.

[546] **Bava Batra 10b:7**: "It was taught: Rabban Yochanan ben Zakkai said to his students, 'My sons, what does Scripture mean when it says, "Righteousness raises a nation, but the kindness of peoples is sin"?' Rabbi Eliezer answered: '"Righteousness raises a nation" refers to Israel, as it is written, "Who is like Your people Israel, one nation on earth?" "But the kindness of peoples is sin" means that all the charity and kindness performed by the nations of the world are counted as sin for them, because they do them only to magnify their own standing. Thus it says, "So that they may offer pleasing sacrifices to the God of heaven and pray for the lives of the king and his sons."'"

[547] **Sod Yesharim, Sukkot 25:1**: "The angel Michael does not conceal the light at all through his garment. Although he is called Israel's minister, Israel is truly under no minister, but under God alone. Michael is called Israel's minister to indicate that his garment does not conceal: on the contrary, he constantly opens gates of understanding for Israel, so that they may know and recognize, 'Who is like God?' So too Abraham's attribute was to show that he was not an intermediary at all in bringing the illumination of kindness into the world. Rather, he opened for people an explicit recognition of how they constantly receive God's kindness from God Himself, as the Midrash says that he constantly taught people to say, 'Blessed is He from whose bounty we have eaten.'"

Sod explains exactly what Abraham's request for a blessing accomplished: the host's generosity exposed the true giver instead of making the host an independent intermediary. This supplies the link between bodily hospitality and the universal illumination described in the origin.

[548] **Bereshit Rabbah 54:6**: 'And Abraham rebuked Avimelech: R. Yosi ben R. Hanina said: Rebuke leads to love, as it says, rebuke a wise man and he will love you. Such indeed is R. Yosi ben Hanina's view, for he said: Love unaccompanied by rebuke is not love. Resh Lakish said: Rebuke leads to peace; hence, 'And Abrahman reproved Avimelech'. Such is his view, for he said: Peace unaccompanied by rebuke is not peace.'

[549] **Bereshit Rabbah 61:1** (excerpt): "'He meditates in His Torah' (Psalms 1:2). Rabbi Shimon said: Abraham's father did not teach him, and he had no teacher. From where, then, did he learn Torah? Rather, the Holy One, blessed be He, appointed his two kidneys like two teachers, and they flowed forth and taught him Torah and wisdom. This is what is written: 'I bless Hashem who counseled me; even at night my kidneys instruct me' (Psalms 16:7)."

[550] **Bereshit Rabbah 2:3** (excerpt): "The Holy One, blessed be He, said: How long will the world continue in darkness? Let light come! 'God said: Let there be light'—this is Abraham. This is what is written: 'Who aroused one from the east, righteousness …' (Isaiah 41:2). Do not read 'aroused' (he'ir), but 'illuminated' (he'ir)."

[551] **Zohar, Toldot 15:121**: "R. Eleazar his son came and kissed his hand. He said: 'So far I understand. Abraham was

stated in the Holy Zohar (Part I, 142a): – דָּא אַבְרָהָם וְכוּלִיה, 'וַלַּיְלָה קָרָא לַיְלָה' — **"'And God called the light Day' — this is Abraham, etc., –** דָּא יִצְחָק וְכוּלִיה, וַתִּכְהֶיָן עֵינָיו מֵרְאֹת"; — **'and the darkness He called Night' — this is Isaac, etc., and his eyes grew dim from seeing";** וְהַיְנוּ אוֹר הָעֲבוֹדָה שֶׁבַּמִּקְדָּשׁ שֶׁמֵּאִיר מִתּוֹךְ הַחֲשֵׁכוּת, — **and that refers to the light of Avodah in the Temple shining out from within darkness,** דְּיִצְחָק אָמַר: "הֶא וְאוֹר תּוֹרָה הוּא אוֹר עַצְמִי קָרִיבִית נַפְשִׁי קַמָּךְ". — **for Isaac said: "Behold I have offered up my soul before You".** שֶׁמַּאִיר לְכָל הָעוֹלָם כֻּלּוֹ — **And the light of Torah is an intrinsic light shining to the entire world,** יִתְבָּרַךְ אֱלֹהֵי הַשָּׁמַיִם וֵאלֹהֵי הָאָרֶץ, — **revealing that the Blessed Name is the God of heaven and the God of earth,** וּכְמוֹ אַבְרָהָם אָבִינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם שֶׁהֵאִיר לְכָל הָעוֹלָם כֻּלּוֹ; — **just like Abraham our Father who illuminated the entire world;** מַה שֶּׁאֵין כֵּן אוֹר הָעֲבוֹדָה הוּא הַמֵּאִיר בְּלִבּוֹ מִתּוֹךְ הַחֲשֵׁכוּת, — **unlike the light of divine service which illuminates within his heart out of darkness;** וְכֵן יִצְחָק אָמַר רַק: "שֶׁנַּפְשִׁי קָרִיבִית קַמָּךְ". — **and so Isaac said only: "that I have offered my soul before You".**

שָׁנֵר מַעֲרָבִי עֵדוּת הוּא לְבָאֵי עוֹלָם שֶׁהַשְּׁכִינָה שׁוֹרָה בְּיִשְׂרָאֵל, עַיֵּן שָׁם; — **that the Western Lamp is testimony to all inhabitants of the world that the Shechinah rests in Israel, see there;** וְהַיְנוּ שֶׁעִנְיַן אוֹר הָעֲבוֹדָה בַּמְּנוֹרָה הוּא כְּעֵין אוֹר תּוֹרָה שֶׁמַּאִיר לְכָל בָּאֵי עוֹלָם שֶׁהַשְּׁכִינָה שׁוֹרָה בְּיִשְׂרָאֵל. — **meaning that the light of divine service in the Menorah is like the light of Torah shining to all world inhabitants that the Shechinah abides in Israel.**

The priestly light belongs to the whole people

וּבְשָׁעַת מַתַּן תּוֹרָה כְּתִיב: "וְאַתֶּם תִּהְיוּ לִי מַמְלֶכֶת כֹּהֲנִים", — **And at the giving of the Torah it was written: "And you shall be to Me a kingdom of priests",** וְהַיְנוּ שֶׁכָּל יִשְׂרָאֵל יִהְיוּ בִּבְחִינַת כֹּהֲנִים שֶׁהוּא כֹּהֵן הָעוֹבֵד, — **meaning that all Israel would be on the plane of priests, the serving priest,** וְאָנִי (סוֹף קִדּוּשִׁין): "וְכְמוֹ שֶׁנִּבְרָא הָאָדָם כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב נִבְרֵאתִי לְשַׁמֵּשׁ אֶת קוֹנִי", — **and as man was created as written (end of Kiddushin): "And I was created to serve my Maker",** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁיִּהְיֶה לָעָתִיד שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: "וְאַתֶּם כֹּהֲנֵי ה' תִּקָּרְאוּ, מְשָׁרְתֵי אֱלֹהֵינוּ וְגוֹמֵר", — **and as will be in the future of which it is said: "And you shall be named the priests of Hashem, ministers of our God, etc.",** וְהַיְנוּ בִּזְרִיחַת הָאוֹר תּוֹרָה לְכָל הָעוֹלָם, כְּמַה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: "כִּי הִנֵּה הַחֹשֶׁךְ יְכַסֶּה אֶרֶץ וְגוֹמֵר וְעָלַיִךְ יִזְרַח ה' וְגוֹמֵר". — **meaning at the shining of the light of Torah to the entire world, as Scripture states: "For behold, darkness covers the earth, etc., and upon you Hashem shall shine, etc."** וְאַחַר כָּךְ נִבְחֲרוּ אַהֲרֹן וּבָנָיו — **And afterward Aaron**

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bathed in light from the side of his grade; whereas Isaac became wrapt in darkness from the side of his grade. But why is it written of Jacob: “And the eyes of Israel were heavy for age” (Gen. 48, 10)?’ R. Simeon in answer said: ‘It is written here “they were heavy”, but not “they were dim”; and further, it is not written “for his old age”, but “for old age”, referring to the old age of Isaac, and implying that his eyes were heavy as a result of the side of Isaac, but still they were only so heavy as to prevent him seeing properly, but not entirely dim. Whereas Isaac’s eyes were altogether dimmed, so that darkness settled upon him and night took hold of him, until to him could be applied the words, “And the darkness he called night.””

[552] **Shabbat 22b:2-3**: “Rav Sheshet objected: ‘Outside the curtain of the testimony he shall arrange it.’ Does God need its light? Throughout the forty years that the children of Israel traveled in the wilderness, did they not travel by His light? Rather, it is testimony to all who come into the world that the Shechinah rests among Israel. What is this testimony? Rav said: It is the western lamp. The same measure of oil was placed in it as in the other lamps; from it he would kindle the others, and with it he would finish. Here, since the lamps are fixed in place, he must take a flame from one to kindle another. This challenges both the view that lighting one mitzvah lamp from another is forbidden because it degrades the mitzvah and the view that it diminishes the mitzvah! Rav Pappa explained that this could be done with long wicks. Nevertheless, the view that the prohibition is due to diminishing the mitzvah remains difficult! The difficulty remains.”

[553] **Divrei Soferim 24:1**: “All the holiness of priests and Levites is an emanation separated from Israel’s holiness. Although they were raised above the people, this came from Israel’s holiness, which appeared more strongly in the tribe of Levi. This is the meaning of ‘Take the Levites from among the children of Israel.’ Therefore, in the verse ‘I gave the Levites’ in Beha’alotcha, ‘the children of Israel’ appears five times. The Sages said, as Rashi cites, that mentioning them five times in one verse makes Israel’s belovedness known. Why make it known in this verse specifically? So that we should not think that choosing the Levites from Israel implies a deficiency in Israel, as though only the Levites were chosen for God’s service and all Israel was rejected as unworthy. Precisely here the verse announces their belovedness: the Levites were chosen only because of Israel’s abundant belovedness. Because they are so beloved, it was fitting to choose a tribe from among them to serve Him. Without the great belovedness of all Israel, no Levites would have been chosen at all. Their whole distinction comes from within Israel, through Israel’s distinction and belovedness.”
Divrei Soferim explains why assigning a special priestly task does not sever it from the people’s original calling. The selected priests’ holiness is drawn from Israel and represents it. This resolves the transition in Rav Tzadok’s account from “a kingdom of priests” to Aaron and his sons.

[554] **Kiddushin 82b:4**: “‘Rabbi Shimon ben Elazar says: Have you ever seen,’ and so forth. It was taught: Rabbi Shimon ben Elazar says: In all my days I have never seen a deer drying figs, a lion carrying burdens, or a fox keeping a shop, yet they earn their sustenance without distress. They were created only to serve me, whereas I was created to serve my Maker. If these, which were created only to serve me, earn their sustenance without distress, should I, who was created to serve my Maker, not certainly earn my sustenance without distress? Rather, I have acted wickedly and deprived myself of my sustenance, as it says, ‘Your iniquities have turned these things aside.’”

and his sons were chosen שֶׁהֵם יִהְיוּ הַמְּאִירִים לְכָל הָעוֹלָם שֶׁהַשְּׁכִינָה שׁוֹרָה בְּיִשְׂרָאֵל **— that they should be the illuminators to the entire world that the Shechinah abides in Israel** בְּהַדְלָקַת הַנֵּרוֹת שֶׁבַּמִּקְדָּשׁ שֶׁמּוֹרֶה עַל זֶה, **— through the kindling of the lights in the Temple which indicates this, being testimony to all humanity,** שֶׁהוּא עֵדוּת לְכָאֵי עוֹלָם וְכוּלֵיהּ, **— and this is what was stated in Midrash Rabbah: "For greater than this are you prepared, in your raising of the lamps".** וְזֶה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר בְּמִדְרָשׁ רַבָּה: "לְגְדוֹלָה מִזּוּ אַתָּה מְתֻקָּן, בְּהַעֲלוֹתְךָ אֶת הַנֵּרוֹת". **— And the reality of this exact aspect of illumination is also essentially present in the kindling of the Chanukah light,** וְעִנְיַן בְּחִינַת הָאָרָה זוֹ מַמָּשׁ הוּא גַּם כֵּן בְּעֶצֶם בְּעִנְיַן הַדְלָקַת נֵר חֲנֻכָּה, שֶׁמַּאִיר גַּם כֵּן לְהָאִיר חֶשְׁכַּת עוֹלָם הַזֶּה הַדּוֹמֶה לְלַיְלָה. **— which shines likewise to illuminate the darkness of this world resembling night.**

Self-sacrifice does not bargain for a miracle

וְנִמְשָׁךְ מִצַּד בָּנָיו שֶׁל אַהֲרֹן שֶׁמָּסְרוּ נַפְשָׁם בִּשְׁבִיל כְּבוֹד שָׁמַיִם[555] **— And it is drawn down from the side of the sons of Aaron who sacrificed their lives for the honor of Heaven** וְעָמְדוּ כְּנֶגֶד הַיְוָנִים שֶׁהָיוּ מוֹלְכִים בַּכִּפָּה, **— and stood against the Greeks who ruled the entire world,** וּבְוַדַּאי לֹא הָיָה כַּוָּנָתָם שֶׁיִּנָּצְלוּ בְּנֵס; **— and certainly their intent was not that they would be saved by a miracle;** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁמָּצִינוּ בַּחֲנַנְיָה, מִישָׁאֵל וַעֲזַרְיָה דִּכְתִיב: "וְהַן לָא וְגוֹמֵר, **— and as we found regarding Chananiah, Mishael, and Azariah of whom it is written: "And if not, etc., we will not serve your gods",** לֵאלָהָךְ לָא אִיתַנָא פָּלְחִין", וְהַיְנוּ בֵּין מַצִּיל בֵּין שֶׁאֵינוֹ מַצִּיל, שֶׁזֶּה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: "וְהַן לָא", כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב (מִדְרָשׁ רַבָּה בְּהַעֲלוֹתְךָ);[556] **— meaning whether He rescues or whether He does not rescue, which is "and if not", as written (Midrash Rabbah, Beha'alotecha);** וְהוּא כְּעִנְיַן עֲמוּד הָעֲבוֹדָה דִּיצְחָק שֶׁאָמַר: "הָא קְרִיבִית נַפְשִׁי קָמָךְ", **— and it matches the character of Isaac's pillar of Avodah who said: "Behold I have offered my soul before You",** וְעַל יְדֵי זֶה נַעֲשָׂה לָהֶם הַנֵּס הַזֶּה. **— and through this was this miracle wrought for them.**

וְאָנוּ מַדְלִיקִין נֵר חֲנֻכָּה לְהוֹרוֹת כִּי הַשֵּׁם שׁוֹכֵן בְּתוֹךְ בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל **— And we kindle the Chanukah light to demonstrate that Hashem dwells in the midst of the Children of Israel,** וְהוּא הַמַּצִּיל מְעַטִּים מִיַּד רַבִּים, **— and He is the One Who rescues the few from the hand of the many;** וְהוּא כְּהוֹרָאַת אוֹר הַמְּנוֹרָה שֶׁבַּמִּקְדָּשׁ לְהָאִיר כָּל הָעוֹלָם, **— and it serves like the testimony of the Menorah's light in the Temple illuminating the entire world;** וּבָא וְזֶה שֶׁאָמַר לְאַהֲרֹן: עַל יְדֵי כֹּחַ כְּהֻנָּתְךָ הַקְּדוֹשִׁים, **— and it arrived through the spiritual might of Your holy priests;** "לְגְדוֹלָה מִזּוּ אַתָּה מְתֻקָּן וְכוּלֵיהּ, הַנֵּרוֹת לְעוֹלָם", **— and this is what He told Aaron: "For greater than this are you prepared, etc., the lights are forever",** וְהוּא מְרֻמָּז עַל נֵר חֲנֻכָּה כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתַב הָרַמְבַּ"ן. **— and this alludes to the Chanukah light as the Ramban wrote.** וְהִנֵּה כֵּיוָן שֶׁיֵּשׁ בְּנֵר חֲנֻכָּה בְּחִינַת הַהֶאָרָה בְּלֵב כָּל אֶחָד מִיִּשְׂרָאֵל שֶׁהַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ שׁוֹכֵן בְּלִבָּם, **— And behold, since within the Chanukah light exists the quality of shining into the heart of each Jew that the Blessed Name dwells in his heart,** מִן הַדִּין שֶׁיִּקָּרְאוּ נֵר חֲנֻכָּה "קֹדֶשׁ" בְּעֶצֶם, **— by law the Chanukah lights ought to be called "holy" intrinsically,** כְּעֵין מַה שֶּׁכָּתוּב (נִדָּה נ"ה עַמּוּד א') בְּזִיבָה שֶׁמְּטַמֵּא מִכֹּחַ קַל וָחֹמֶר:[557] **— analogous to that which is stated (Niddah 55a) regarding a zav's discharge which defiles through an a fortiori inference:** "לַאֲחֵרִים גּוֹרֵם טֻמְאָה, לְעַצְמוֹ לֹא כָּל שֶׁכֵּן?"; **— "If it causes impurity to others, to itself is it not all the more so?";** וּכְעֵין זֶה הוּא כָּאן, **— and similar to this it is here,** וּבִפְרָט דְּמִדָּה טוֹבָה מְרֻבָּה, **— and especially since the measure of goodness is vastly greater,** וְכֵיוָן שֶׁמַּאִיר קְדֻשָּׁה בְּכָל לֵב, כָּל שֶׁכֵּן שֶׁבְּעַצְמוֹ **— and since it radiates holiness into every heart, all the more so the candles themselves are intrinsically holy.** הַנֵּרוֹת קֹדֶשׁ הֵם. אָמְנָם בַּגְּמָרָא שָׁם דָּחוּ הַקַּל וָחֹמֶר: **— However, in the Gemara there they refuted the a fortiori inference:** "שָׂעִיר הַמִּשְׁתַּלֵּחַ יוֹכִיחַ, שֶׁגּוֹרֵם טֻמְאָה לַאֲחֵרִים וְהוּא עַצְמוֹ טָהוֹר"; **— "Let the Scapegoat (sa'ir hamishtale'ach) prove it, for it causes impurity to others while it itself is pure";** וְעוֹד מָצִינוּ בַּיְלִקּוּט (חֻקַּת

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[555] **Beit Yaakov on Torah, Noach 10:49**: "Rather, a person must not take his confidence in saying that the Holy One will rescue him if he serves Him in such-and-such a way. He should place his confidence in the Holy One's helping him when he strives in the commandments of Torah and walks in the path of truth."
Beit Yaakov quotes the Zohar's precise distinction between bargaining for rescue and relying on help to serve. The immediately preceding paragraphs cite the same "and if not" response; the following paragraph grounds the confidence in assistance for one who comes to purify himself. This is the quality of self-offering Rav Tzadok assigns to the priests, not a guarantee of bodily survival.

[556] **Bamidbar Rabbah 15:14**: "'Shadrach, Meshach, and Abed-nego answered and said to King Nebuchadnezzar' (Daniel 3:16). They addressed him simply as 'Nebuchadnezzar': 'We have no need to answer you concerning this matter. If this must be so, our God whom we serve … will rescue us from your hand, O king' (Daniel 3:16–17). 'And if not' (Daniel 3:18)—they said to him: Whether He rescues us or does not rescue us, 'let it be known to you, O king, that we will not serve your gods.' Thus, 'Fear Hashem, my son, and the king.'"

[557] **Niddah 55a:16**: "Is it not a logical inference? If a zav's discharge causes impurity in others, should it not certainly be impure itself? The scapegoat disproves this: It causes impurity in others, while remaining pure itself. You should therefore not be surprised if this discharge, although causing impurity in others, were itself pure. Scripture consequently says, 'His discharge is impure,' teaching that the discharge itself is impure."

."מִסִּפְרֵי זוּטָא): "הַנּוֹגֵעַ בַּמֵּת טָמֵא, וְאֵין מֵת עַצְמוֹ טָמֵא"[558] — **and we find further in the Yalkut (Chukat from Sifrei Zuta): "He who touches a corpse is defiled, yet the corpse itself is not subject to being defiled".** וְיֵשׁ לוֹמַר הַהֶפְרֵשׁ בָּזֶה: דְּבִזְיבָה קַל וָחֹמֶר פְּרִיכָא, — **And one can explain the distinction in this: for in zivah it is a refuted a fortiori,** דְּאֶפְשָׁר לוֹמַר שֶׁמִּצַּד הָאָדָם הָרוֹאֶה הוּא טָמֵא, — **since one can say that it is from the perspective of the experiencing person that he is defiled,** אֲבָל בְּזִיבָה אֵין בָּהּ טֻמְאָה בְּעָצֶם, וּכְמוֹ בָּשָׂעִיר הַמְשֻׁתַּלֵּחַ; — **but in the discharge itself there is no intrinsic defilement, as with the Scapegoat;** וְכֵן בְּנוֹגֵעַ בַּמֵּת מִצַּד פְּעֻלָּתוֹ שֶׁהִיא הַנְּגִיעָה נִטְמָא. — **and likewise in one touching a corpse, he is defiled by virtue of his action which is the contact.**

The lamp's continuing light does something

Distinguishing a mitzvah's essence from its act

אֲבָל בְּעִנְיַן נֵר חֲנֻכָּה אֶפְשָׁר לוֹמַר שֶׁזֶּה הַחִלּוּק בֵּין כָּל הַמִּצְוֹות לְנֵר חֲנֻכָּה:[559, 560] — **However, regarding the Chanukah light one can say that this is the distinction between all mitzvot and the Chanukah light:** שֶׁבְּכָל מִצְוָה עִקַּר הַמִּצְוָה בִּשְׁעַת הַפְּעֻלָּה וְהָעֲשִׂיָּה, — **for in every other mitzvah the essence of the mitzvah is at the moment of performance and action,** וְעַל כֵּן אַף שֶׁגּוֹרֵם קְדֻשָּׁה לְהָעוֹשֶׂה, — **and therefore even though it causes holiness to the performer,** אֵין רְאָיָה לְהִקָּרֵא בְּשֵׁם קְדֻשָּׁה עֶצֶם הַמִּצְוָה, — **there is no proof to designate with the title of holiness the physical object of the mitzvah itself;** כִּי עִקַּר הַמִּצְוָה הִיא פְּעֻלַּת הָאָדָם, וְהוּא כְּבָר עֲשָׂהוּ; — **for the essence of the mitzvah is the human act, and he has already performed it;** וְאַף שֶׁעַל יְדֵי הַמִּצְוָה מֵאִיר בְּלֵב הָעוֹשֶׂה, אֵין זֶה רְאָיָה — **and even though through the mitzvah illumination shines in the heart of the doer,** לְעֶצֶם הַמִּצְוָה שֶׁיִּהְיֶה נִקְרָא קְדֻשָּׁה. — **this is no proof regarding the substance of the mitzvah that it should be called holy.** אֲבָל נֵרוֹת חֲנֻכָּה שֶׁמִּצְוָתָן כָּל הַחֲצִי שָׁעָה, — **However, the Chanukah candles whose mitzvah extends throughout the entire half-hour,** וְאָז עוֹשֶׂה פְּעֻלַּת הַהָאָרָה בְּלֵב יִשְׂרָאֵל — **and throughout that time it actively effects the illumination in the heart of Israel,** שֶׁהַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ שׁוֹכֵן בְּתוֹךְ בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל כְּעֵין הָאָרַת אוֹר הַמְּנוֹרָה שֶׁבַּמִּקְדָּשׁ, — **revealing that the Blessed Name dwells in the midst of the Children of Israel like the light of the Menorah in the Temple,** וְאַף שֶׁכְּבָר נִגְמַר פְּעֻלַּת הָאָדָם מִצִּדּוֹ, — **even though human physical action has already concluded from his end;** אִם כֵּן עֶצֶם הַמִּצְוָה בְּלִי פְּעֻלַּת הָאָדָם — **if so, the very substance of the mitzvah without the ongoing human deed** יֵשׁ בְּכֹחָהּ לְהָאִיר בְּלֵב יִשְׂרָאֵל קְדֻשָּׁה כְּעֵין אוֹר נֵרוֹת הַמִּקְדָּשׁ, — **possesses the spiritual potency to radiate into the heart of Israel holiness like the Temple lights;** וְשַׁפִּיר מִן הַדִּין לִהְיוֹת הַנֵּרוֹת נִקְרָאִים "קֹדֶשׁ" בְּעֶצֶם מִכֹּחַ קַל וָחֹמֶר הַנִּזְכָּר לְעֵיל. — **and rightly it is by law fitting for the candles to be called "holy" intrinsically by force of the aforementioned a fortiori inference.** וּמוּבָן מַה שֶּׁכָּתַב הָאֲבוּדַרְהָם: דְּכֵיוָן שֶׁהֵם כַּמְּנוֹרָה שֶׁבַּמִּקְדָּשׁ, — **And it is understood what the Abudarham wrote: that because they are like the Menorah in the Temple,** הַנֵּרוֹת הַלָּלוּ קֹדֶשׁ הֵם. — **these lights are holy.**

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[558] **Sifrei Zuta 19:16**: 'Regarding the paradox of the Red Heifer, which purifies the impure while defiling the pure who handle it: Sifrei Zuta (on Numbers 19, cited in Yalkut Shimoni Chukat) notes the converse wonders of the Torah's decrees—such as the Scapegoat, which defiles the one who leads it while itself remaining pure, and a corpse, which imparts the severest impurity to whoever touches it while the corpse itself is not subject to ritual impurity.'

[559] **Resisei Layla 57:4**: "This is the illumination of the Chanukah lamp established for later generations: through this light, to remove from Israel every sort of mixture arising from the intermingling of Israel's inward powers in mixed intentions, not clarified as being solely for Heaven rather than for some other thought or motive. Such clarity is fitting for the root of the congregation of Israel's Jewish identity, entirely attached to the living God. In truth, the whole power of yesod is drawn only from netzach and hod; if yesod is clarified, netzach and hod are clarified too. But in yesod this is revealed in actuality, while in netzach and hod it is still potential and its actual emergence remains hidden. Because of concealment, there is room for error and a lamp is needed to illuminate. Therefore a lamp above twenty cubits is invalid, because the eye does not take it in: it still remains concealed. The essence of the Chanukah lamp is to bring from concealment into disclosure. Through this, 'the foot is spent'—the feet of netzach and hod of the Tarmodians, the opposing counterpart to Jerusalem."

Resisei supplies a concrete reason that the continuing visible lamp matters: it brings concealed orientation into recognition, and a lamp beyond normal visual notice fails this task. This enriches the origin's claim that the lamp still acts after lighting is complete. It does not by itself prove Rav Tzadok's separate conclusion about intrinsic sanctity.

[560] **Sod Yesharim, Rosh Hashanah 25:2**: "The commandment of sounding the shofar, although it involves action and utterance, has as its essential substance the sound emerging from the shofar. This sound is without any garment. Even the shofar as an instrument—the practical act and the commandment's garment—does not conceal the clarity of the commandment's essence, which is the sound. On the contrary, the instrument assists the commandment: through it the inward voice can be brought out. As the Zohar says, 'Like a shofar sending the voice on a straight path from a place of constriction.' Through this instrument, the inward voice, free of a garment, is awakened. Thus the essence of this commandment too is a voice without articulated speech."

Sod gives another carefully delimited example of distinguishing the mitzvah's essence from its practical instrument: in shofar, the audible inward voice is what the instrument releases. Rav Tzadok's criterion here is different—the lamp's continuing illumination after the completed act. The comparison clarifies the analytical distinction; it does not equate the sound's status with the lamp's holiness or derive one ruling from the other.

Chanukah Ois 5

The Oil, the Heart, and the Restoration of Oral Torah

The oil points to the Torah illumination restored through Chanukah, beyond the immediate ability to perform one commandment.

The Oil, the Heart, and the Restoration of Oral Torah

A commemorated miracle identifies an enduring repair

לְהָבִין לָמָּה הֻצְרַךְ הַנֵּס בַּחֲנֻכָּה בְּשֶׁמֶן הַמְּנוֹרָה,[561] — **To understand why the miracle on Chanukah was needed in the oil of the Menorah,** שֶׁהוּא רַק לְקַיֵּם מִצְוָה אַחַת, — **which was only to fulfill a single commandment,** אֲשֶׁר גַּם בְּלֹא זֶה "אֹנֵס רַחֲמָנָא פַּטְרֵיהּ". — **whereas even without this, the Merciful One exempts one under duress (oness).** אָמְנָם כִּי הָיָה זֶה מְרַמֵּז עַל אוֹר הַתּוֹרָה הַקְּדוֹשָׁה — **However, it was because this alluded to the light of the Holy Torah** שֶׁנִּשְׁפַּע אָז דַּוְקָא, — **which was bestowed specifically then,** מַה שֶּׁרָצוּ הַיְוָנִים "לְהַשְׁכִּיחָם תּוֹרָתֶךָ". — **countering what the Greeks desired: "to make them forget Your Torah".**

The patriarchs' acquired holiness becomes inheritance

כַּיָּדוּעַ כִּי יֵשׁ שֶׁבַע מִדּוֹת בִּקְדֻשָּׁה[562] — **As is known, there are seven divine attributes in holiness,** שֶׁהֵם קְדֻשַּׁת הַשִּׁבְעָה רוֹעִים שֶׁהֵם מֶרְכָּבָה לָהֶם, — **which are the sanctity of the Seven Shepherds who serve as a chariot for them;** וּקְדֻשָּׁתָם נִמְצָא בִּכְלַל נַפְשׁוֹת יִשְׂרָאֵל: כִּי שְׁלֹשׁ מִדּוֹת הָאָבוֹת הַקְּדוֹשִׁים נִמְצָא בִּכְלַל יִשְׂרָאֵל, — **and their sanctity is found within the collective souls of Israel: for the three traits of the holy Patriarchs exist within the collective of Israel,** שֶׁהֵם רַחֲמָנִים, בַּיְשָׁנִין, וְגוֹמְלֵי חֲסָדִים (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב יְבָמוֹת ע"ט עַמּוּד א');[563] — **who are merciful, bashful, and perform acts of kindness (as written in Yevamot 79a);** וּמִדּוֹת מֹשֶׁה וְאַהֲרֹן הֵם בְּחִינַת תּוֹרָה שֶׁבִּכְתָב וְתוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה, וְנִמְצָא בִּכְלַל יִשְׂרָאֵל; — **and the attributes of Moses and Aaron are the aspects of the Written Torah and Oral Torah, found within the collective of Israel;** וּמִדַּת יוֹסֵף הַצַּדִּיק שֶׁהָיָה מֶרְכָּבָה לִמְדַּת צַדִּיק, וּכְתִיב: "וְעַמֵּךְ כֻּלָּם צַדִּיקִים", — **and the attribute of Joseph the Righteous who was the chariot for the sefirah of Tzaddik (Yesod), and it is written: "And your people are all righteous",** וְכָל יִשְׂרָאֵל נִקְרָאִים עַל שְׁמוֹ "שְׁאֵרִית יוֹסֵף"; — **and all Israel are named after him "the remnant of Joseph";** וְדָוִד הַמֶּלֶךְ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם בְּחִינַת מַלְכוּת שָׁמַיִם, כְּנֶסֶת יִשְׂרָאֵל. — **and David the King, peace be upon him, is the aspect of the Kingdom of Heaven, the Community of Israel (Knesset Yisrael).** וּבְ"זֶה לְעֻמַּת זֶה" יֵשׁ שִׁשָּׁה גְּלִיּוֹת שֶׁנֶּחְשְׁבוּ (בַּמִּדְרָשׁ רַבָּה נָשׂא פָּרָשָׁה י'),[564]

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[561] **Resisei Layla 57:1**: "The commandment of the Chanukah lamp commemorates Chanukah's miracle. In truth, the principal miracle was rescue from the Greeks' persecution of the faith; the oil miracle happened afterwards as a separate matter, apparently unrelated to the essential rescue. The text of Al HaNissim does not mention this oil miracle at all, only that afterwards they came and lit lamps. But any deliverance from which a memorial is established for the generations means that Israel's souls have already been delivered concerning the deficiency that had brought the decrees and troubles beforehand, for everything is in judgment. When Israel awakened to repair that deficiency within their hearts, they were delivered from the trouble. When they repaired the matter completely, as far as the root of the entire congregation of Israel, so that henceforth all Israel's souls are repaired in this particular respect, that deliverance was established as a memorial for the generations. A commandment was instituted as an awakening from below at that season, to draw the holiness of this repair upon them. No holy thing comes into the heart by itself, but through some awakening from below, an opening below as small as the eye of a needle. They therefore established the commandment suited to opening this light and holiness in the heart."
Resisei explains why commemorating the oil is more than preserving an optional rescue of a ritual performance: the selected mitzvah reopens the particular inward repair that outlasts the event. This gives a reason for the oil's role as Torah illumination in Rav Tzadok's opening question. The causal account of the historical trouble is the author's theological interpretation.

[562] **Beit Yaakov on Torah, Vayera 38:3**: "Abraham therefore asked God to help him through the holiness present in his inborn nature, called 'his sister,' so that it would guard him from faltering, Heaven forbid. Here, after he had accomplished much in holiness through his trials and good deeds, reaching completion in circumcision, he prayed that all the holiness he had acquired until then should become fixed within him as 'my sister': that Israel should possess holiness even without conscious awareness, which could never be lost in any way. Even if he enters doubts and concealments, that holiness will not enter doubt, and he will begin anew to serve God and acquire more holiness through his own toil. As the Sages said, Israel is recognizable through these three signs—compassion, bashfulness, and kindness—which were fixed in Israel's heart by birth as an inheritance from the holy patriarchs."
Beit Yaakov explains how the three ancestral qualities become a stable resource in later souls: holiness gained through the patriarch's trials becomes inherited protection, while each descendant still has further work. The full preceding distinction between acquired "wife" and inborn "sister" holiness was read. This explains the collective presence of the qualities without implying that inherited holiness completes everyone's practical service.

[563] **Yevamot 79a:3**: "David said: This nation has three distinguishing signs: They are compassionate, bashful, and performers of kindness. Compassionate, as it is written, 'He shall give you compassion, have compassion upon you, and multiply you.' Bashful, as it is written, 'So that His fear may be upon your faces.' Performers of kindness, as it is written, 'Because he shall command his children and his household,' to follow the Lord's way of righteousness and justice. Whoever possesses these three signs is fit to become attached to this nation."

[564] **Bamidbar Rabbah 10:2** (excerpt): "'Who has woe? Who has sorrow?' (Proverbs 23:29). Even though Israel sinned and the Holy One, blessed be He, delivered them into the hands of the nations because of their sins, those nations did not go unpunished. Ultimately He judges the nations into whose hands He delivered them, as He did to Egypt and Babylonia. Therefore 'who has' is written six times, corresponding to the six exiles into which Israel was exiled among the nations, all of whom were struck on their account. These are: first Egypt, then Assyria, Babylonia, Media, Greece, and Edom.

— And in parallel opposition ("one corresponding to the other") there are six exiles enumerated (in Midrash Rabbah, Nasso, Parashah 10), שֶׁהֵם מִצְרַיִם וְאַשּׁוּר וְאַרְבַּע גָּלִיּוֹת, **— which are Egypt, Assyria, and the four traditional exiles Babylonia, Persia/Media, Greece, Rome/Edom,** שֶׁהֵם הִתְגַּבְּרוּת הַהֵפֶךְ שֶׁל שֶׁבַע וְאָמַרְנוּ שֶׁעַל זֶה מְרַמֵּז מַה הַמִּדּוֹת. **— which represent the overpowering antithesis of the seven holy attributes.** שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: "בְּשֵׁשׁ צָרוֹת יַצִּילֶךָּ" **— – And we explained that to this alludes Scripture's statement: "In six tribulations He shall rescue you" —** נֶגֶד הַשִּׁשָּׁה גָּלִיּוֹת שֶׁנִּצּוֹלִים יִשְׂרָאֵל מִגָּלוּתָם הַמְּנֻגָּד לְהַקְדֵּשָׁה, **— corresponding to the six exiles from which Israel is rescued, which stand in opposition to holiness;** "וּבְשֶׁבַע לֹא יִגַּע בְּךָ רָע" מְרַמֵּז עַל מִלְחֶמֶת גּוֹג וּמָגוֹג **— and "in the seventh no evil shall touch you" alludes to the War of Gog and Magog,** שֶׁלֹּא יִהְיֶה לוֹ שְׁלִיטָה וּנְגִיעָה בְּיִשְׂרָאֵל (וְנִתְבָּאֵר פָּרָשַׁת וַיִּשְׁלַח מַאֲמָר י״א).[565] **— which will have no dominion or harmful impact upon Israel (and this was explained in Parashat Vayishlach, discourse 11).** וּכְפִי הַסֵּדֶר, גָּלוּת יָוָן הַחֲמִישִׁית, **— And according to the order, the exile of Greece is the fifth,** בְּחִינַת הַמְּנֻגָּד לְהַקְדֵּשָׁה מִדַּת הוֹד, **opposing the holy attribute of Hod, the aspect of Aaron the Priest.** וְכֵן הוּא בְּתִקּוּנֵי זֹהַר (תִּקּוּן אַהֲרֹן הַכֹּהֵן. תִּקּוּן ג׳)[566]: "תְּמִינָאָה בְּהוֹדָאָה", **— And so it is in Tikunei Zohar (Tikun 13): "The eighth sefirah is in thanksgiving (Hod)",** וְנִזְכָּר שָׁם כָּל עִנְיַן חֲנֻכָּה; **— and the entire matter of Chanukah is mentioned there;** וְכֵן כָּתַב הָאֲרִיזַ"ל שֶׁחֲנֻכַּת הַחַשְׁמוֹנָאִים הוּא תִּקּוּן הוֹד שֶׁבַּקְדֻשָּׁה, **— and so wrote the Arizal, that the dedication of the Hasmoneans is the rectification of Hod in holiness,** וְלָכֵן הָיָה הַנֵּס עַל יְדֵי הַכֹּהֲנִים. **— and therefore the miracle occurred through the priests.** וְכֵן כָּתוּב (בְּרֵאשִׁית רַבָּה פָּרָשָׁה צ״ט): "לֵוִי פְּנֶגֶד יָוָן, זֶה שַׁבָּט שְׁלִישִׁי וְכוּלַיְהּ",[567] **— And so it is written (Bereishit Rabbah, Parashah 99): "Levi corresponds to Greece; this is the third tribe, etc.",** כִּי הֵם "זֶה לְעֻמַּת זֶה", וְלָכֵן נָפְלוּ בְּיָדָם. **— for they are direct counterparts, and therefore the Greeks fell into their hand.**

Rachel's descendants answer opposition through disciplined work

וְהֵנִּיחוּ שֶׁבֶט יוֹסֵף שֶׁהֵם מִבְּנֵי רָחֵל, וֶאֱדוֹם נוֹפֵל בְּיַד בְּנֵיהָ שֶׁל רָחֵל,[568] **— And Edom falls into the hand of the children of Rachel,** גַּם כֵּן מִדָּה הַשִּׁשִּׁית. **— which is the tribe of Joseph who corresponds likewise to the sixth attribute (Yesod).** וְגוֹג וּמָגוֹג נוֹפֵל בְּיַד מָשִׁיחַ בֶּן דָּוִד, בְּחִינַת מִדָּה הַשְּׁבִיעִית. **— And Gog and Magog falls into the hand of the Messiah son of David, the aspect of the seventh attribute (Malchut).** וּכְבָר אָמַרְנוּ שֶׁמִּדַּת אַהֲרֹן הַכֹּהֵן הוּא קְדֻשַּׁת תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה, **— And we have already stated that the attribute of Aaron the Priest is the sanctity of the Oral Torah,** כְּמַה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: "תּוֹרַת אֱמֶת הָיְתָה בְּפִיהוּ וְגוֹמֵר, כִּי שִׂפְתֵי כֹהֵן יִשְׁמְרוּ דַעַת וְתוֹרָה יְבַקְשׁוּ מִפִּיהוּ"; **— as Scripture states: "The Torah of truth was in his mouth, etc., for the priest's lips shall guard knowledge and they shall seek Torah from his mouth";** וְעַל זֶה הָיוּ מְנֻגָּדִים הַיְוָנִים שֶׁהָיוּ בִּימֵי שִׁמְעוֹן הַצַּדִּיק שֶׁהָיָה מִשְּׁיָרֵי כְּנֶסֶת הַגְּדוֹלָה, **— and against this the Greeks opposed, living in the era of Shimon the Righteous who was among the**

Likewise it says, 'I am greatly angry with the nations at ease, for I was only a little angry, but they helped toward evil' (Zechariah 1:15), and 'I shall make an end of all the nations where I have driven you' (Jeremiah 46:28). Therefore it says, 'Who has woe? Who has sorrow?'"

[565] **Bereshit Rabbah 78:9**: '...Esau ran to greet him. He embraced Jacob and, falling on his neck, he kissed him; and they wept. (Gen. 33:4). The word 'kissed' is dotted above each letter in the Torah's writing. Rabbi Simeon ben Elazar said . . . it teaches that Esau felt compassion in that moment and kissed Jacob with all his heart. Rabbi Yannai said to him: If so, why is 'kissed' dotted? On the contrary, it teaches that Esau came not to kiss Jacob but to bite him, but our ancestor Jacob's neck became like marble and that wicked man's teeth were blunted. Hence, 'and they wept' teaches that Jacob wept because of his neck and Esau wept because of his teeth.'

[566] **Tikkunei Zohar 28b:22-23**: "The eighth is through thanksgiving, hoda'ah. Through it David would praise: 'Give thanks to the Lord.' This is certainly Hod. In 'For the conductor,' la-menatze'ach, and 'Give thanks,' hodu, Netzach and Hod are alluded to, and they are the powers of miracles. Through it Moshe praised with az, 'then,' as it is written, 'Then Moshe sang.' For it is Hod that was given to Moshe: 'Then you shall call, and the Lord will answer.'"

[567] **Bereshit Rabbah 99:2** (excerpt): "Levi corresponds to the Greek kingdom: this is the third tribe, and that is the third kingdom. The letters of this one's name number three, and the letters of that one's name number three."

[568] **Sod Yesharim, Parashat Zakhor 22:2**: "This is also the Sages' statement: it is received as tradition that Amalek falls only through Rachel's descendants. Rachel's descendants indicate intensified service through great self-restraint. Thus, before the completeness of David's kingship had been achieved, when Amalek stood against them, they needed a king from Rachel's descendants. So too, 'Moses took Joseph's bones with him': Joseph's bones indicate great self-restraint. Israel had not yet attained completeness, and the accusation remained at their departure from Egypt, 'These served idols, and those served idols.' God nevertheless testified for them: 'When you bring the people out of Egypt, you shall serve God.' As long as Israel travels the road toward acquiring completeness, before reaching it, Amalek stands along that road in accusation—'who encountered you on the road.' The only counsel against him then is Joseph's bones, intensified service. If they rest even a little, he immediately misleads through his accusation."
Sod explains the spiritual function associated with Rachel's descendants: persistent, bounded service while completeness has not yet arrived. Its immediate application is to Amalek, a narrower scope than Rav Tzadok's opening reference to Edom; it is not presented as a new proof that the two terms are interchangeable. It explains why Joseph's line is assigned the opposing role.

remnants of the Great Assembly, שֶׁהוּא הָיָה הַתְּחָלַת הִתְפַּשְׁטוּת תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה, **— for he stood at the inception of the expansion of the Oral Torah,** וּבְיָמָיו הָיָה הַתְּחָלַת חָכְמַת יְוָנִית הַמְּנַגֶּד לְקִדֻּשַׁת תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה. **— and in his days was the beginning of Greek philosophy opposing the sanctity of the Oral Torah.**

Oral Torah is inwardly acquired wisdom

לְפִי שֶׁצָּפָה (מִדְרַשׁ תַּנְחוּמָא כִּי תִשָּׂא ל״ד):[569, 570] וּכְמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב **— And as written (Midrash Tanchuma, Ki Tisa 34):** הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא שֶׁעֲתִידִים לְתַרְגֵּם הַתּוֹרָה יְוָנִית, **— Because the Holy One foresaw that they were destined to translate the Torah into Greek,** וְהֵם אוֹמְרִים "אָנוּ יִשְׂרָאֵל" וְכוּלֵיהּ, **— and they would assert "we are Israel", etc.,** וְהַיְנוּ הַתּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה, **— and that is the Oral Torah in which the nations have no part or connection.** כִּי עִקַּר חָכְמַת תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה לִהְיוֹת נִקְבָּע הַחָכְמָה בַּלֵּב.[571] **— For the essence of the wisdom of the Oral Torah is that the wisdom be permanently engraved in the heart.** מִי שֶׁמַּסְטִירִין שֶׁלִּי אֶצְלוֹ הֵם בָּנַי", **— He said: "He who holds My mysteries is My child",**

וְהִנֵּה אִיתָא (תְּמוּרָה ט״ו עַמּוּד ב׳):[572] **— And behold, it states (Temurah 15b):** "מִשֶּׁמֵּת יוֹסֵי בֶּן יוֹעֶזֶר וְכוּלֵיהּ בָּטְלוּ הָאֶשְׁכּוֹלוֹת **— –** אִישׁ שֶׁהַכֹּל בּוֹ", **— "From when Yose ben Yoezer died, etc., the clusters (eshkolot) ceased — a man who has everything in him",** וּפֵרֵשׁ רַבִּי שְׁלֹמֹה יִצְחָקִי: "תּוֹרָה, וְיִרְאַת חֵטְא, וּגְמִילוּת חֲסָדִים". **— and Rashi explained: "Torah, fear of sin, and deeds of lovingkindness".** וְהַיְנוּ כִּי יוֹסֵי בֶּן יוֹעֶזֶר הָיָה גַּם בִּן בִּימֵיהֶם, **— And that is because Yose ben Yoezer was also during their era,** וְהָיָה הַתְּחָלַת הַזּוּגוֹת כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בְּרֵישׁ אָבוֹת, "וְקִבְּלוּ הַיְנוּ מֵהֶם" **— and stood at the beginning of the Pairs (Zugot) as written at the beginning of Avot, –** מֵאַנְטִיגְנוֹס וְשִׁמְעוֹן הַצַּדִּיק; **— "and they received from them" — meaning from Antigonus and Shimon the Righteous;** וְכֵן מָצִינוּ (פֶּרֶק ב׳ דְּפֵאָה מִשְׁנָה ו׳):[573] **— and so we find (Chapter 2 of Pe'ah, Mishnah 6):** שֶׁקִּבֵּל מִן הַזּוּגוֹת שֶׁקִּבְּלוּ מִן הַנְּבִיאִים וְכוּלֵיהּ, **— who received from the Pairs who received from the Prophets, etc.,** וְיוֹסֵי הָיָה מֵהַזּוּגוֹת וְקִבֵּל מֵאַנְשֵׁי כְּנֶסֶת הַגְּדוֹלָה בִּימֵי שִׁמְעוֹן הַצַּדִּיק. **— and Yose was among the Pairs, receiving from the Men of the Great Assembly in the days of Shimon the Righteous.** וּפֵרוּשׁ רַבִּי שְׁלֹמֹה יִצְחָקִי עַל "אִשְׁכּוֹלוֹת" מְכֻנָּן לְמַה שֶׁכָּתוּב (בְּרָכוֹת י״ז עַמּוּד א׳):[574] "תַּכְלִית חָכְמָה **— And Rashi's explanation of eshkolot aligns with what is written (Berachot 17a): –** תְּשׁוּבָה וּמַעֲשִׂים טוֹבִים, **— "The goal of wisdom is repentance and good deeds,** שֶׁלֹּא יְהֵא אָדָם קוֹרֵא וְשׁוֹנֶה וּבוֹעֵט בְּאָבִיו וְכוּלֵיהּ וּבְמִי שֶׁגָּדוֹל מִמֶּנּוּ וְכוּלֵיהּ, **— so that a person does not read Scripture and study Mishnah while kicking at his father, etc., and at one who is greater than he, etc.,** שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: וְאַף שֶׁנִּזְכַּר יִרְאַת ה' רֵאשִׁית חָכְמָה'". **— as it is said: 'The beginning of wisdom is the fear of Hashem, etc.'"**

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[569] **Midrash Tanchuma, Ki Tisa 34**: ‘And the Lord said unto Moses: “Write thou these words, for after the tenor of these words I have made a covenant with thee and with Israel” (Exod. 34:27). Scripture states elsewhere in allusion to this verse: Though I write for him never so many things of My Law, they are accounted as stranger’s (Hos. 8:12). R. Judah the son of Shalum was of the opinion that when the Holy One, blessed be He, said to Moses Write thou, Moses wanted to write the Mishnah as well. However, the Holy One, blessed be He, foresaw that ultimately the nations of the world would translate the Torah into the Greek language and would claim: “We are the Israelites.”’

[570] **Ohr Zarua LaTzadik, The Egyptian Exile 4:3**: “‘Oral Torah’ means what springs from Israel’s heart. As I explained elsewhere concerning the Sages’ statement: at first it is ‘the Torah of the Lord,’ and afterwards ‘his Torah.’ The beginning is Written Torah; afterwards Oral Torah began. It is called ‘the words of the scribes,’ for Israel’s hearts bring it forth, and it is their Torah alone. This testifies that they, rather than others, are the Torah’s owners, that it belongs particularly to them. This then brings the complete end of Edom’s kingdom, which makes that claim.”
Ohr Zarua spells out the decisive word “in the heart”: Torah becomes an inwardly acquired and generative possession, expressed by “his Torah.” It addresses the same claim to Israel’s identity, rather than merely sharing a general praise of oral teaching. The full target places the argument within its polemic about Edom; that setting remains distinct from the origin’s Greek translation.

[571] **Peri Tzadik, Shavuot 2:2**: “For us, all the wisdom of Oral Torah, once it has been written down, is included in wisdom, the aspect of Written Torah. The essential matter is understanding: to feel in the heart the light of the words of Torah. “Understanding is the heart”—this is the aspect of Oral Torah.”

[572] **Temurah 15b**: ‘§ Earlier the Gemara mentioned the halakha of a sin offering whose owner died, which was one of the halakhot forgotten during the mourning period for Moses (see 16a). On this topic the Gemara says that we learned in a mishna there (Sota 47a): From the time when Yosef ben Yo’ezer of Tzereida and Yosef ben Yoḥanan of Jerusalem died, the clusters eshkolot ceased, i.e., they were the last of the clusters. The Gemara asks: What is the meaning of eshkolot? It means a man who contains all ish shehakol bo, i.e., both Torah and mitzvot.’

[573] **Mishnah Peah 2:6**: ‘Nahum the Scribe said: I have received a tradition from Rabbi Measha, who received it from his father, who received it from the Pairs (Zugot), who received it from the Prophets as a halakhah transmitted to Moses from Sinai, regarding one who sows his field with two species of wheat.’

[574] **Berakhot 17a:11**: “Rava would often say: The ultimate aim of wisdom is repentance and good deeds. A person must not read Scripture and study Mishnah while treating his father, mother, teacher, or anyone greater than he in wisdom and seniority with contempt. Thus it says, ‘The beginning of wisdom is fear of the Lord; sound understanding belongs to all who put them into practice.’ It does not merely say ‘to those who act,’ but ‘to those who put them into practice’: those who act for the sake of the mitzvos themselves, rather than for some other purpose. Whoever acts for an improper purpose would have been better off never having been created.”

רַק יִרְאָה, תְּשׁוּבָה בִּכְלָלָהּ, — **And even though fear alone is explicitly mentioned, repentance is included within it,** שֶׁעַל יְדֵי יִרְאָה בָּא לִתְשׁוּבָה, — **for through awe one arrives at repentance,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמַרְנוּ בְּמַה שֶׁדָּרְשׁוּ '"אַשְׁרֵי אִישׁ יָרֵא וְגוֹמֵר"(עֲבוֹדָה זָרָה י"ט עַמּוּד א'):[575] — **as we explained regarding what they expounded (Avodah Zarah 19a): –** שֶׁעוֹשֶׂה תְּשׁוּבָה כְּשֶׁהוּא אִישׁ". — **"'Fortunate is the man who fears, etc.' — who performs repentance while he is still a man."** וּגְמִילוּת חֲסָדִים הוּא כְּלַל מַעֲשִׂים טוֹבִים, — **And lovingkindness encompasses the totality of good deeds,** שֶׁכֵּן נִקְרָא בְּמִדְרָשׁ רַבָּה וִירוּשַׁלְמִי מִצְוַת צְדָקָה סְתָם "מִצְוָה", מִפְּנֵי שֶׁנּוֹהֶגֶת בְּכָל עֵת. — **for in Midrash Rabbah and the Yerushalmi the mitzvah of charity is called simply "the mitzvah", because it applies at all times.**

Greater Torah wisdom produces greater humility

וְזָכַר בַּגְּמָרָא "שֶׁלֹּא יִהֵא בּוֹעֵט וְכוֹלֵיהּ",[576,577] — **And the Gemara mentioned "that he not kick, etc.",** שֶׁזֶּה תַּכְלִית לְהִיוֹת רוּחוֹ שְׁפָלָה עַל יְדֵי הַמְּכֻוָּן שֶׁל הַתּוֹרָה: — **because this is the ultimate intended objective of the Torah:** וְלֹא יִהְיֶה בּוֹעֵט בְּמִי שֶׁגָּדוֹל מִמֶּנּוּ. — **and that he not rebel against one greater than he.** וְלָכֵן נִמְצָא תַּכְלִית הַשִּׁפְלוּת בַּתּוֹרָה הַקְּדוֹשָׁה — **Therefore the pinnacle of humility in the Holy Torah is found** בִּנְפָשׁוֹת שֶׁהָיוּ הַשֹּׁרֶשׁ שֶׁל חָכְמַת הַתּוֹרָה: — **within those souls who constituted the foundational roots of Torah wisdom:** דְּאַבְרָהָם אָבִינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם אָמַר: "וְאָנֹכִי עָפָר וָאֵפֶר", — **for Abraham our Father, peace be upon him, said: "And I am dust and ashes",** וְאָמְרוּ עָלָיו (בְּרֵאשִׁית רַבָּה פָּרָשָׁה ס"א)[578] שֶׁזִּמֵּן לוֹ הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא שְׁנֵי כְלָיוֹתָיו כְּמִין שְׁנֵי רַבָּנִים וְהָיוּ נוֹבְעוֹת וּמְלַמְּדוֹת אוֹתוֹ תּוֹרָה; — **and they said of him (Bereishit Rabbah, Parashah 61) that the Holy One designated his kidneys like two rabbis welling forth and teaching him Torah;** וּבְמֹשֶׁה וְאַהֲרֹן שֶׁאָמְרוּ: "וְנַחְנוּ מָה", — **and regarding Moses and Aaron who said: "And what are we",** וְהָמָּה הָיוּ שֹׁרֶשׁ תּוֹרָה שֶׁבִּכְתָב וְתוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה; — **and they were the roots of the Written Torah and Oral Torah;** וְדָוִד הַמֶּלֶךְ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם שֶׁאָמַר: "וְאָנֹכִי תוֹלַעַת", וְהוּא שֹׁרֶשׁ שֶׁל תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה כִּי הוּא מֶרְכָּבָה לְמִדַּת מַלְכוּת, "פֶּה תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה". — **and David the King, peace be upon him, who said: "And I am a worm", – and he is the root of the Oral Torah, being the chariot for Malchut, "The mouth is the Oral Torah".** וְהֵינוּ כִּי עַל יְדֵי שֶׁנִּקְבַּע הַדִּבְרֵי תּוֹרָה בְּלִבָּם, — **And that means because words of Torah were deeply fixed in their hearts,** מִזֶּה דַּוְקָא בָּאוּ לְתַכְלִית הַשִּׁפְלוּת בְּנַפְשָׁם; — **from this specifically they attained the ultimate humility in their souls;** מַה שֶּׁאֵין כֵּן חָכְמַת יְוָנִית שֶׁהִיא חָכְמָה אֱנוֹשִׁית בְּלֹא לֵב וְיִרְאַת הַשֵּׁם, — **unlike Greek philosophy which is human intellectualism devoid of heart and fear of Hashem,** מְבִיאָה לִידֵי הִתְנַשְּׂאוּת וְגַבְהוּת הַלֵּב. — **which brings about conceit and haughtiness of heart.**

וְהִנֵּה אָמְרוּ (תְּמוּרָה שָׁם):[579] — **And behold they said (Temurah ibid.):** "כָּל הָאֶשְׁכּוֹלוֹת שֶׁעָמְדוּ לְיִשְׂרָאֵל מִימוֹת מֹשֶׁה עַד שֶׁמֵּת יוֹסֵי בֶּן יוֹעֶזֶר לֹא הָיָה בָּהֶן שׁוּם דֹּפִי", — **"All the clusters that arose for Israel from the days of Moses until**

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[575] **Avodah Zarah 19a:3**: "'Happy is the man who fears the Lord': Is it a man who is happy, and not a woman? Rav Amram said in Rav's name: Happy is one who repents while he is still a vigorous man. Rabbi Yehoshua ben Levi said: Happy is one who overcomes his inclination like a man."

[576] **Divrei Soferim 29:1**: "In true wisdom, the wisdom of Torah, the more one adds wisdom, the more one adds humility and lowliness of spirit, as Avot says. Moses, the teacher of all Israel, was more humble than every person. All Israel's wisdom is to recognize that 'there is nothing besides Him' and that everything comes from God. One consequently recognizes his own lowliness and has nothing at all in which to take pride."
Divrei gives the causal explanation for the origin's examples: wisdom discloses dependence on God rather than an independent possession in which to boast. Humility is therefore a consequence of the wisdom's content, not a decorative trait added to scholarship.

[577] **Sod Yesharim, Yom Kippur 47:1**: "Thus concerning Moses it says, 'The man Moses was exceedingly humble.' Surely Moses knew that he was the greatest of all Israel: he himself wrote the Torah from the Holy One's mouth, including 'No prophet arose again like Moses.' He therefore knew very well that he was the greatest. Rather, he clearly recognized that no power of existence is present in the world apart from God, for there is nothing besides Him. Because he recognized this so clearly, he was the receptive vessel for every kind of divine light. He knew that all the greatness within him was not from himself at all, but from God, who chose him. Had God chosen another soul of Israel, that other soul could have been the greatest and most distinguished of all Israel. Of this recognition it says, 'The man Moses was exceedingly humble.' This is why he was the vessel to receive every kind of light."
Sod resolves a possible misunderstanding of the humility Rav Tzadok praises: Moses did not falsely deny his actual stature. He accurately distinguished the gift from independent self-importance. The full target uses this as the model for the High Priest's receptivity, making the comparison specifically about wisdom and inward posture.

[578] **Bereshit Rabbah 61:1** (excerpt): "'He meditates in His Torah' (Psalms 1:2). Rabbi Shimon said: Abraham's father did not teach him, and he had no teacher. From where, then, did he learn Torah? Rather, the Holy One, blessed be He, appointed his two kidneys like two teachers, and they flowed forth and taught him Torah and wisdom. This is what is written: 'I bless Hashem who counseled me; even at night my kidneys instruct me' (Psalms 16:7)."

[579] **Temurah 15b:16**: "It was taught in a baraisa: All the eshkolos, the fully accomplished Sages, who arose for Israel from Moshe's days until Yosef ben Yoezer of Tzeredah died had no blemish in them. From then onward, there was a blemish in them."

Yose ben Yoezer died had no blemish in them", וְהַיְנוּ שֶׁהָיוּ מְקַבְּלִים הָאֱמֶת וְלֹא הָיָה בָּהֶם שׁוּם מַחֲלֹקֶת, **— meaning that they embraced truth and harbored no dispute,** זוּלַת בְּסוֹף יָמָיו שֶׁל יוֹסֵי שֶׁהִתְחִיל מַחֲלֹקֶת סְמִיכָה בְּיִשְׂרָאֵל, **— except at the end of Yose's days when the dispute over semichah (laying hands on sacrifices on Festivals) began in Israel,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בַּגְּמָרָא. "דִּבְצַר לְבָבָא" **— because "the heart diminished", as stated in the Gemara.** וְהַיְנוּ מִסִּבַּת שְׁלִיטַת יָוָן שֶׁנִּתְגַּבְּרָה בְּיָמָיו **— And that occurred by reason of Greek dominion which grew strong in his days** וְהֶחְשִׁיכוּ עֵינֵיהֶם שֶׁל יִשְׂרָאֵל, **— and darkened the spiritual eyes of Israel,** וְכִדְאִיתָא בְּסוֹף "בִּשְׁמוֹנָה בְּטֵבֵת נִכְתְּבָה הַתּוֹרָה יְוָנִית וְהַחֹשֶׁךְ בָּא לָעוֹלָם מְגִלַּת תַּעֲנִית: **— and as found at the end of Megillat Ta'anit:** שְׁלֹשָׁה יָמִים"; **— "On the eighth of Tevet the Torah was translated into Greek, and darkness came to the world for three days";** וּמִסִּבָּה זוֹ נָגַע הַחֲשַׁכּוּת בְּלֵב נַפְשׁוֹת יִשְׂרָאֵל "דִּבְצַר לְבָבָא", **— and from this cause darkness touched the heart of Jewish souls so that "the heart diminished",** וְהַיְנוּ שֶׁלֹּא נִקְבְּעוּ הַדִּבְרֵי תוֹרָה בִּשְׁלֵמוּת בַּלֵּב, **— meaning that words of Torah were no longer perfectly anchored in the heart,** וְעַל יְדֵי זֶה נַעֲשָׂה הַמַּחֲלֹקֶת וְהַהִפְרוּד בַּלֵּב בְּדֵעוֹת שׁוֹנוֹת שֶׁבָּא מִשָּׁמֶץ הִתְנַשְּׂאוּת. **— and through this dispute and division in the heart were generated in differing opinions, arising from a trace of intellectual conceit.**

Reduced clarity can require deeper Torah labor

Failure is repaired through the Torah it makes necessary

אָמְנָם בָּזֶה דַּוְקָא אָז הָיָה הַנֵּס בַּשֶּׁמֶן,[580, 581] **— However, precisely within this condition did the miracle occur with the oil,** (מְנָחוֹת פ״ה עַמּוּד ב׳):הַמְרַמֵּז לִבְחִינַת חָכְמָה כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב[582] **— which alludes to the level of Chochmah (Wisdom), as written (Menachot 85b):** "מַאי שְׁנָא תְּקוֹעַ? מִתּוֹךְ שֶׁרְגִילִין בְּשֶׁמֶן זַיִת חָכְמָה מְצוּיָה בָּהֶן". **— "Why was Tekoa distinct? Because they are accustomed to olive oil, wisdom is found among them".** וְנִתְבָּרֵךְ הַמּוּעָט וּכְמוֹ לְהָאִיר אֶת הַחֹשֶׁךְ דַּוְקָא, **— And the small quantity was blessed to illuminate the darkness specifically,** (תַּנְחוּמָא נֹחַ ג׳) עַל הַפָּסוּק "הָעָם הַהֹלְכִים בַּחֹשֶׁךְ רָאוּ אוֹר גָּדוֹל":שֶׁאָמְרוּ[583] **— and as they said (Tanchuma Noach 3) on the verse "The people walking in darkness have seen a great light":** אוֹר שֶׁנִּבְרָא בְּיוֹם רִאשׁוֹן שֶׁגְּנָזוֹ הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא לְעַמְלֵי תוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה וְכוּלֵיהּ; **— the light created on the first day which the Holy One hid for those who toil in the Oral Torah, etc.;** שֶׁדַּוְקָא עַל יְדֵי הַחֲשֵׁכוּת מְיַגְּעִים עַצְמָם בְּיוֹתֵר, **— for specifically through the**

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[580] **Poked Akarim 6:4**: "This is a greater wealth of wisdom, for the principal depth of wisdom in incisive understanding and sharpening of halakhah comes through this, and the Holy One delights in dialectical study. This arises from concealment, when the light is not openly disclosed. The Tanchuma applies 'The people walking in darkness saw a great light' to the wisdom of Oral Torah. Sanhedrin likewise interprets 'He has placed me in dark places' as the Babylonian Talmud, where the depth of dialectical study was revealed. The Babylonian exile brought this about too: through exile and destruction, disclosed light departed and prophecy ceased. From then on, 'Incline your ear and hear the words of the sages,' as Seder Olam says. Avot says that the prophets transmitted it to the Men of the Great Assembly: they transmitted apprehension of Torah to the sages, headed by the Great Assembly. They were named for restoring the crown to its former state by saying 'the great, mighty, and awesome,' as Yoma explains. From the perspective of prophecy, which is disclosure, exile visibly shows the opposite. But Oral Torah's wisdom reveals Written Torah's hidden teachings, concealed in this world. Those who merit to grasp the hidden teaching and attain the light specifically from darkness recognize that these are, on the contrary, His might, greatness, and awesomeness: even in exile and darkness, the Lord is our light. The light from darkness is greater, for it can illuminate even within darkness."
Poked explains what "more light" means here: the wisdom can recognize divine presence under conditions in which the earlier kind of visible disclosure is absent. It does not simply declare every later sage greater than every earlier one. The complete paragraph's account of toil, fear, and human choice was read.

[581] **Tiferet Yosef, Shavuot 4**: "The Talmud says, 'What is Rephidim? They became slack in words of Torah.' The meaning of this failure before the giving of the Torah is that God showed them that all the failures which sometimes occur in Israel can be repaired through words of Torah. As we see, there are many matters of Torah that a person cannot attain without the preceding failure. Thus the Talmud says on 'This stumbling block is under your hand': a person does not grasp words of Torah unless he has first stumbled in them. Through this God showed them that they could repair everything through words of Torah."
The full Tiferet paragraph identifies the error concretely: treating divine initiative as a reason to abandon service, then repairing that separation through Torah and safeguards. This illuminates how the origin's diminished heart can lead to more exact Torah work. It is not advice to seek failure or an assertion that failure by itself produces wisdom.

[582] **Menachot 85b**: "'Yoav sent to Tekoa and brought a wise woman from there.' Why Tekoa in particular? Rabbi Yochanan said: Because they are accustomed to olive oil, wisdom is common among them."

[583] **Midrash Tanchuma, Noach 3:3**: "Our sages, of blessed memory, stated that the Holy One, blessed be He, did not write in the Torah "For the sake of these words," or "because of these," or "on account of these words," but simply according to the tenor of (al pi) these words. This statement clearly alludes to the Oral Law (torah she be-'al peh), which is difficult to learn and in the learning of which there is considerable anguish, comparable to darkness itself, as it is said: The people that walk in darkness have seen a great light (Isa. 9:1). The people referred to in this verse are the masters of the Talmud, who beheld a great light when the Holy One, blessed be He, enlightened them as to what is prohibited and permitted, pure and impure. It is said of them that They that love Him shall be as the sun when it goeth forth in its might (Judg. 5:31)."

obscurity of darkness they toil with greater intensity, וְעַל יְדֵי זֶה נִתְרַבֶּה הָאוֹר בְּיֶתֶר שְׂאֵת, **— and through this the light is amplified with extraordinary strength;** וּכְמוֹ כֵן בְּכָל דּוֹר דִּבְצַר לְבָא בְּיוֹתֵר, **— and likewise in every generation as the heart diminishes further,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ זִכְרוֹנָם לִבְרָכָה (עירובין נ״ג עמוד א׳):[584] **— as our Sages of blessed memory stated (Eruvin 53a):** "לִבָּם שֶׁל רִאשׁוֹנִים כִּפִתְחוֹ שֶׁל אוּלָם וְכוּלֵיהּ וְאָנוּ כְּמִלְא נָקֵב מַחַט סְדָקִית", **— "The heart of the early ones was like the entrance of the Ulam, etc., while ours is like the eye of a fine needle",** וְדַוְקָא עַל יְדֵי זֶה עוֹד נִתְרַבֶּה וְנִתְחַדֵּשׁ הַתּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה עַד אֵין שִׁעוּר. **— and precisely through this the Oral Torah expanded and renewed itself beyond measure.** וְהִנֵּה אִיתָא בְּסִפְרֵי הַקֹּדֶשׁ שֶׁחֲנֻכָּה הוּא הַגְּמָר מֵרֹאשׁ הַשָּׁנָה, וְהוּא לְרַמֵּז דִּבְרֵי הַתִּקּוּנִים (תִּקּוּן ל״ו): "'וַיְהִי אוֹר' **— And behold it is stated in the holy books that Chanukah is the final sealing from Rosh Hashanah, –** דָּא רֹאשׁ הַשָּׁנָה", **— and this alludes to the words of the Tikunim (Tikun 36): "'And there was light' — this is Rosh Hashanah",** שֶׁאָמַרְנוּ שֶׁבְּכָל רֹאשׁ הַשָּׁנָה בָּא הִתְחַדְּשׁוּת הָאָרַת תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה לְנַפְשׁוֹת יִשְׂרָאֵל, **— which we explained that on every Rosh Hashanah comes a renewal of the light of the Oral Torah to the souls of Israel,** וּמִזֶּה הַגְּמָר בַּחֲנֻכָּה לְהִתְרַבּוּת הָאוֹר מִתּוֹךְ הַחֹשֶׁךְ כַּנִּזְכָּר לְעֵיל. **— and from this is the culmination on Chanukah for the amplification of the light to shine from within the darkness as mentioned above.** וְהִנֵּה בְּפֵרוּשׁ רַבִּי שְׁלֹמֹה יִצְחָקִי (סוֹטָה מ״ז עמוד ב׳) פֵּרַשׁ: "אִישׁ שֶׁהַכֹּל בּוֹ":[585] **— And behold in Rashi's commentary (Sotah 47b) he explained: –** תּוֹרָה בַּאֲמִתָּהּ וְאֵין דְּפִי וְשִׁכְחָה וּמַחֲלֹקֶת, **— "A man who has everything in him" — Torah in its absolute truth without flaw, forgetfulness, or dispute,** וְהוּא כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בְּתְמוּרָה: "כָּל אֶשְׁכּוֹלוֹת וְכוּלֵיהּ הָיוּ לְמַדִּין תּוֹרָה כְּמֹשֶׁה רַבֵּנוּ וְכוּלֵיהּ". וּבֶאֱמֶת לְפֵרוּשׁ רַבִּי שְׁלֹמֹה יִצְחָקִי בְּתְמוּרָה: "אִישׁ שֶׁהַכֹּל בּוֹ **— and that matches what is written in Temurah: "All clusters, etc., learned Torah like Moses our Teacher, etc." –** תּוֹרָה וְיִרְאָה וּגְמִילוּת חֲסָדִים", **— And in truth according to Rashi's explanation in Temurah: "A man who has everything in him — Torah, fear of sin, and lovingkindness",** יֵשׁ לְהָבִין: אֵיךְ אָמְרוּ שֶׁבָּטְלוּ מִשָּׁמַּת יוֹסֵי בֶּן יוֹעֶזֶר, **— one must understand: how did they say that they ceased once Yose ben Yoezer died?** וַהֲלֹא גַּם בִּימֵי הָאֲמוֹרָאִים הָיוּ גַּם כֵּן דְּעָסְקֵי בְּתוֹרָה וּבִגְמִילוּת חֲסָדִים, **— For behold even in the era of the Amoraim there were those who engaged in Torah and lovingkindness,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב (רֹאשׁ הַשָּׁנָה י״ח עמוד א׳): "אַבַּיֵי דְּעָסַק בְּתוֹרָה וּבִגְמִילוּת חֲסָדִים"?[586] **— as written (Rosh Hashanah 18a): "Abaye who engaged in Torah and lovingkindness"?** וְתוֹרָה בְּלֹא יִרְאַת שָׁמַיִם קְרָאוּ בַּגְּמָרָא (יוֹמָא ע״ב עמוד ב׳) "מְחִיר בְּיַד כְּסִיל" וְאֵין זֶה תּוֹרָה כְּלָל,[587] **— And Torah without fear of Heaven the Gemara called (Yoma 72b) "a price in the hand of a fool" and it is not considered Torah at all,** וְנִקְרָא הַתּוֹרָה רַק "תַּרְעָא לְדָרְתָא" שֶׁהִיא הַיִרְאָה. **— and the Torah is called merely "the gate to the courtyard" which is the fear of Heaven.**

— And behold Scripture states: "My Beloved is unto me as a cluster of henna (eshkol hakofer), etc.", וְהִנֵּה נֶאֱמַר: "אֶשְׁכֹּל הַכֹּפֶר דּוֹדִי לִי וְגוֹמֵר", וְדָרְשׁוּ (שַׁבָּת פ״ח עמוד ב׳): "מִי שֶׁהַכֹּל שָׁלוֹ מְכַפֵּר לִי עַל עֲוֹן גְּדִי שֶׁגָּרַמְתִּי לִי":[588] **— and they expounded (Shabbat 88b): –** הֵינוּ עַל עֲוֹן הָעֶגֶל. **— "He to Whom everything belongs (shehakol shelo) atones for me for the sin of the kid which I stored for myself" — meaning the sin of the Golden Calf.** וְיֵשׁ לְהָבִין: לָמָּה דַּוְקָא בְּכָאן מַכְנִיס לְהַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרֵךְ בְּשֵׁם "אֲשֶׁכּוֹל שֶׁהַכֹּל שֶׁלּוֹ" יוֹתֵר מִשֶּׁאָר מְקוֹמוֹת? **— And one must understand: why specifically here does it refer to the Blessed Name with the title of Eshkol, "He to Whom everything belongs", more than in other places?** וְיֵשׁ לוֹמַר בָּזֶה כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמַרְנוּ בְּמֶה שֶׁכָּתוּב (בְּרָכוֹת י״א עמוד

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[584] **Eruvin 53a**: “Rabbi Yochanan said: The hearts of the earlier generations were like the entrance of the Ulam, and those of the later generations like the entrance of the Heikhal, while ours are like the opening of a fine sewing needle.”

[585] **Rashi on Sotah 47b:23:1**: “‘Who has everything in him’: Torah in its truth, without blemish, forgetting, or dispute.”

[586] **Rosh Hashanah 18a**: ‘With regard to this verse Rava said: With sacrifice or offering the sin of Eli’s house is not atoned, but it can be atoned through Torah study. Abaye said: With sacrifice or offering the sin of Eli’s house is not atoned, but it is atoned through Torah study and the performance of acts of kindness. It is related that Rabba and Abaye came from the house of Eli, which was subject to the curse that most of its members would die young. Rabba, who engaged almost exclusively in Torah study, lived for forty years, whereas Abaye, who engaged in both Torah study and in the performance of acts of kindness lived for sixty years.’

[587] **Yoma 72b**: ‘Rabbi Shmuel bar Naḥmani said that Rabbi Yonatan said: What is the meaning of that which is written: “Why is there a price in the hand of a fool to buy wisdom, as he has no heart?” (Proverbs 17:16)? This expresses the following sentiment: Woe to them, haters of Torah scholars, a euphemism for the Torah scholars themselves, who immerse themselves in Torah and have no fear of Heaven. They are fools; they try to acquire the wisdom of Torah, but since they have no fear of Heaven in their hearts they lack the ability to do so.’

[588] **Shabbat 88b:4**: “This is what Rava said: For those who approach Torah on its right, it is a medicine of life; for those who approach it on its left, it is a medicine of death. Another interpretation of negidim, ‘princely words’: For every utterance that came from the mouth of the Holy One, blessed be He, they tied two crowns. Rabbi Yehoshua ben Levi said: What is meant by ‘A bundle of myrrh is my Beloved to me; between my breasts He shall lodge’? The congregation of Israel said before the Holy One, blessed be He: ‘Master of the world, even though my Beloved causes me distress and bitterness, between my breasts He shall lodge.’ ‘A cluster of henna is my Beloved to me in the vineyards of Ein Gedi’: The One to whom everything belongs forgives me for the sin of the kid that I gathered for myself, alluding to the Golden Calf. What shows that karmei, ‘vineyards,’ is an expression for gathering? Mar Zutra son of Rav Nachman said: As we learned in a Mishnah, ‘The launderer’s stool upon which garments are piled,’ using the same root.”

:(א׳)[589] **— And one can explain in this as we explained regarding what is written (Berachot 11a):** "'עוֹשֶׂה שָׁלוֹם וּבוֹרֵא רָע' וְכוּ׳, כְּתִיב 'רָע' וְקָרֵינַן 'הַכֹּל' לִישָׁנָא מְעַלְיָא", **"'Makes peace and creates evil, etc.', it is written 'evil' and we read 'everything' as a euphemism",** שֶׁכִּנּוּ הָרַע בִּלְשׁוֹן "הַכֹּל", **— for they euphemistically termed evil with the word "everything" (hakol),** עַל פִּי מַה שֶּׁכָּתוּב (בְּרֵאשִׁית רַבָּה פָּרָשָׁה ט׳) עַל הַפָּסוּק[590]: "וַיַּרְא אֱלֹהִים אֶת כָּל אֲשֶׁר עָשָׂה וְהִנֵּה טוֹב מְאֹד", **— based on what is written (Bereishit Rabbah, Parashah 9) on the verse: "And God saw everything that He had made, and behold it was very good",** שֶׁדָּרְשׁוּ שֶׁהוּא הַמָּוֶת וְהָרָע, **— where they expounded that this refers to death and evil, which is called "everything that He had made".** וְזֶה נִקְרָא "כָּל אֲשֶׁר עָשָׂה". **— And although it is unfitting to state of the Blessed Name that He "creates evil",** כִּי לֹא נִמְצָא זֹאת בְּכָל הַבְּרִיאָה, **— because that does not exist directly throughout the Creation,** רַק הוּא עַל דֶּרֶךְ אָמְרָם זִכְרוֹנָם לִבְרָכָה (שַׁבָּת קמ״ט עַמּוּד ב׳): "אֵין 'לֹא' טוֹב'[591] אֶלָּא רָע". וְהִנֵּה בְּהַתְחָלַת הַבְּרִיאָה דִּכְתִיב: "תֹּהוּ וָבֹהוּ וְחֹשֶׁךְ" **— rather it is along the lines of their statement (Shabbat 149b): "'Not good' means nothing other than evil". –** "כִּי טוֹב", לֹא נֶאֱמַר בּוֹ **— And behold at the beginning of Creation where it is written: "Unformed, void, and darkness" — "that it was good" is not said of it,** הוּא מְרַמֵּז עַל הָרָע שֶׁל אַרְבַּע גָּלְיוֹת כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בִּבְרֵאשִׁית רַבָּה, **— alluding to the evil of the four exiles as written in Bereishit Rabbah,** עַד בְּרִיאַת הָאוֹר שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר בּוֹ: "וַיַּרְא אֱלֹהִים כִּי טוֹב". **— until the creation of the light regarding which it is said: "And God saw that it was good".** וּכְמוֹ כֵן נֶאֱמַר בְּכָל בְּרִיאַת שֵׁשֶׁת יְמֵי הַמַּעֲשֶׂה, **— And likewise it was stated throughout the creation of the six days of work,** זוּלַת בְּיוֹם שֵׁנִי שֶׁלֹּא נֶאֱמַר בּוֹ גַּם "כִּי טוֹב", **— except on the second day where "that it was good" was likewise omitted,**

Recognizing the source transforms a misdirected power

The good root does not cancel the obligation to serve

מִפְּנֵי שֶׁבּוֹ נִבְרֵאת מַחֲלֹקֶת וְהַהַבְדָּלָה בֵּין מַיִם עֶלְיוֹנִים לַתַּחְתּוֹנִים (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בְּרֵאשִׁית רַבָּה פָּרָשָׁה ד׳). וְזֶהוּ הָעִנְיָן שֶׁאָמְרוּ:

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[589] **Berakhot 11b:1-5**: “The blessing says: ‘Who forms light and creates darkness.’ Let it instead say, ‘Who forms light and creates brightness’! We say it as it is written in Scripture. But if so, concerning ‘Who makes peace and creates evil,’ do we say it as it is written? Rather, Scripture says ‘evil,’ and we recite ‘everything,’ a more refined expression. Here too, let us say ‘brightness,’ a more refined expression! Rather, Rava said: The wording is intended to mention the attribute of day at night and the attribute of night during the day.”

[590] **Bereshit Rabbah 9:5**; **Bereshit Rabbah 9:7** (excerpts): “In Rabbi Meir’s Torah, they found written: ‘Behold, it was very good’—behold, death is good. … Rabbi Nachman bar Shmuel bar Nachman said in the name of Rav Shmuel bar Nachman: ‘Behold, it was very good’—this is the good inclination; ‘and behold, it was very good’—this is the evil inclination. Is the evil inclination really very good? Rather, without the evil inclination a person would not build a house, marry, have children, or engage in business. Likewise Solomon says, ‘It is a person’s rivalry with his fellow’ (Ecclesiastes 4:4).”

[591] **Shabbat 149b:9**: “Rather, it is learned from here: ‘For the righteous, even punishing another is not good.’ ‘Not good’ means evil. It is written, ‘For You are not a God who desires wickedness; evil shall not dwell with You.’ You are righteous, Lord, and evil shall not dwell in Your dwelling place.”

אָשְׁכּוֹל"[592, 593, 594] — **because on it division was created and the separation between upper waters and lower waters (as written in Bereishit Rabbah, Parashah 4).** – מִי שֶׁהַכֹּל שֶׁלּוֹ", — **And this is the meaning of what they said: "Eshkol — He to Whom everything (hakol) belongs",** הַיְנוּ בּוֹרֵא אֶת הַכֹּל, בְּחִינַת הָרָע כַּנִּזְכָּר לְעֵיל, — **meaning He Who creates "everything", the aspect of evil as mentioned above,** "מְכַפֵּר לִי עַל עֲוֹן גְּדִי" — – **"atones for me for the sin of the kid"** — הַיְנוּ בְּחִינַת הַחֹשֶׁךְ שֶׁל הַבְּרִיאָה, שֶׁיִּהְיֶה נֶהְפָּךְ לְ"טוֹב מְאֹד". — **meaning the dimension of cosmic darkness of Creation, transforming it into "very good".** וְעַל זֶה רָמְזוּ זִכְרוֹנָם לִבְרָכָה: שֶׁבָּטְלוּ הָאֶשְׁכּוֹלוֹת, — **And to this our Sages of blessed memory alluded: that the eshkolot ceased,** שֶׁכָּל הָאֶשְׁכּוֹלוֹת שֶׁעָמְדוּ מִימוֹת מֹשֶׁה עַד שֶׁמֵּת יוֹסֵי בֶּן יוֹעֶזֶר הָיוּ לְמֵדִין תּוֹרָה כְּמֹשֶׁה רַבֵּנוּ, — **for all the clusters who arose from the days of Moses until Yose ben Yoezer died learned Torah like Moses our Teacher;** וְהַיְנוּ שֶׁהָיָה לָהֶם כֹּחַ עַל יְדֵי הַתּוֹרָה לַהֲפֹךְ אֶת הָרָע שֶׁל הַבְּרִיאָה לְ"טוֹב מְאֹד" כְּמֹשֶׁה רַבֵּנוּ, — **meaning that they had power through the Torah to transform the evil of Creation into "very good" like Moses our Teacher,** שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר לוֹ בְּאוֹתוֹ מַעֲשֶׂה: "וְעַתָּה הַנִּיחָה לִי", שֶׁהָיָה תָּלוּי בּוֹ. וְלָכֵן נִקְרְאוּ גַּם כֵּן בְּשֵׁם "אֶשְׁכּוֹלוֹת" — **to whom it was said in that episode: "And now let Me alone", showing that it depended on him.** – שֶׁהַכֹּל בּוֹ", — **And therefore were they termed "clusters — in whom is everything",** שֶׁבִּיכָלְתָּם לַעֲשׂוֹת עַל יְדֵי תּוֹרָתָם בְּחִינַת "הַכֹּל" לְטוֹב מְאֹד. — **that in their power it was to turn through their Torah the dimension of "everything" into "very good".** וְעַל זֶה מֵבִיא הַמִּשְׁנָה שֶׁבָּטְלוּ אֶשְׁכּוֹלוֹת, שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: "אֵין אֶשְׁכּוֹל לֶאֱכוֹל", — **And on this the Mishnah brings proof that the clusters ceased, as it is said: "There is no cluster to eat",** וְהַיְנוּ שֶׁיִּהְיֶה פּוֹעֵל בְּתוֹרָתוֹ שֶׁיִּהְיֶה נִקְנֶה בְּלֵב הַשּׁוֹמֵעַ הַדִּבְרֵי תוֹרָה, — **meaning that one affects through his Torah so that the words of Torah are internalized in the listener's heart,** שֶׁמְּכֻנֶּה בְּשֵׁם "אֲכִילָה", דִּכְתִיב: "לְכוּ לַחֲמוּ בְלַחֲמִי", — **which is termed "eating", as it is written: "Come, eat of my bread",** וְעַל יְדֵי זֶה יִתְעַלֶּה הַכֹּל לְטוֹב כַּנִּזְכָּר לְעֵיל. — **and through this everything is elevated to the good as mentioned.** וְעַל זֶה רָמְזוּ בְּתִמּוּרָה: דִּבְסוֹף שָׁנָיו דְּיוֹסֵי בֶּן יוֹעֶזֶר דִּבְצַר לְבָא אִפְלוּג בְּסָמְיָכָה וּבָטְלוּ הָאֶשְׁכּוֹלוֹת, — **And to this they alluded in Temurah: that at the close of Yose ben Yoezer's years when the heart**

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[592] **Bereshit Rabbah 4:6** (excerpt): “Rabbi Chanina says: On that day division was created, as it says, ‘Let it divide between water and water.’ Rabbi Tavyomi said: If division that serves the world’s repair and habitation is not described as ‘good,’ how much more so division that throws it into confusion! Rabbi Shmuel said: Because the work of the waters had not been completed, ‘it was good’ is written twice on the third day—once for the work of the waters and once for that day’s work.”

[593] **Resisei Layla 30:1**: “When it becomes clear that even at the time of imagination he is truly attached to God, and he takes this to heart—knowing that he has no power to think or contemplate anything except from God—the imagination is consequently repaired. As the Sages said, ‘The One to whom everything belongs atones for the sin of the kid’: everything belongs to Him, all deeds, actions, thoughts, and desires; therefore the sin too belongs to Him, and He consequently atones. With the very faculty of imagination in which fantasy grows strong, one prevails against it, to consume and annul it. Thus the root of Amalek, the pursuer, becomes pursued through itself. The document he wrote, ‘That the Jews should …,’ had its interpretation reversed in the second documents, revealing the intention that they should rule over their enemies; and the gallows prepared for Mordecai were turned against him. The apparent victory of imagination was afterwards reversed: it became clear that false imagination had not prevailed, but actual truth. Joseph’s dreams are an example: at the time they appeared imaginary; afterwards, when events occurred accordingly, it became clear that they had not been fantasy at all. This is the visible analogy. There are many levels, higher than one another, in elevating and repairing thoughts and imaginings so that imagination becomes truth. The essential thing is clear recognition that ‘there is nothing besides Him,’ that everything is His, and that human wisdom and schemes are nothing. So too in drunkenness, when one lacks the understanding and wisdom of sobriety: since it is God alone who brings forth counsel, thought, and desire within him, everything is thereby repaired. Concerning this it says, ‘When the Lord gives rest.’ First a person must labor to remove the seven evil qualities revealed in his heart, so that he should not come to an actual transgression, Heaven forbid, or to thoughts of transgression revealed in his heart. Once he is clean of this, he should then labor to erase vain imaginings from within his heart.”

Resisei explains the same “everything is His / sin of the kid” homily through a specific power: imagination ceases to claim independence from its source and can be turned toward truth. Its concluding requirement to restrain actual transgression and revealed sinful intention is retained in the quotation. The account of providence does not license practical wrongdoing.

[594] **Tiferet Yosef, Talmud Anthology, Berakhot 5**: “‘He called darkness night’—this is Isaac. It means that he shows that there is judgment and a Judge. A person might imagine that since nothing can be done contrary to God’s will, no service is needed. Isaac’s attribute shows that there is judgment and a Judge: someone who does not walk in service within this concealment will be entirely lost. Although even one who does not serve gives rise to His honor—as the Midrash says, His praise rises from the righteous in Eden and from the wicked in Gehinnom—one who, within his perception, does not wish to see the honor of Heaven arising from him will lose that perception entirely. This is why one must mention day’s attribute at night and night’s attribute by day. One must not walk only in day’s assurance, Abraham’s morning, but include Isaac’s attribute of fear and awe. Likewise one must include day within night, so that fear should not cause slackness in service, Heaven forbid. One must also include day, Abraham’s morning: God will certainly clarify him for good, since from his own side he works with all his power.”

Tiferet provides a necessary complement to the origin’s claim that evil can be turned to good: providential good and moral responsibility must be held together. It expressly rejects the conclusion that belonging to God makes effort unnecessary, and equally rejects despair that prevents effort. This illuminates the qualification implicit in repair “through their Torah.”

diminished they disputed regarding semichah and the clusters ceased, וְהַיְנוּ שֶׁלֹּא הָיָה עוֹד בְּכֹחָם לַעֲשׂוֹת סְמִיכָה וְאֶשְׁכּוֹלוֹת נִפְסָקוּ — **meaning that it was no longer in their power to forge unity out of the division of the second day,** הָאַחְדוּת מִבְּחִינַת הַהַבְדָּלָה שֶׁל יוֹם הַשֵּׁנִי שֶׁלֹּא נֶאֱמַר בּוֹ "כִּי טוֹב" מִפְּנֵי הַמַּחֲלֹקֶת. — **regarding which "that it was good" was not stated because of dispute.**

Torah words are not identical with inward Torah

וְזֶה הָיָה מִשּׁוּם דִּבְצַר לִבָּא מִצַּד הַקְּלִפָּה שֶׁל חָכְמַת יְוָנִית שֶׁהָיָה בְּלֹא לֵב,[595, 596] — **And this occurred because the heart diminished through the kelipah of Greek philosophy which was heartless;** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמַרְנוּ בְּמַה שֶׁפָּתוּב (מִדְרָשׁ רַבָּה אֵיכָה ב', ט'): "יֵשׁ תּוֹרָה בַּגּוֹיִם אֵין תּוֹרָה",[597] — **and as we explained regarding what is written (Midrash Rabbah Eichah 2:9): – "If one says there is Torah among the nations — do not believe it", for it is written: "Her king and her princes are among the nations, there is no Torah",** וְהַיְנוּ כִּי הַחָכְמָה שֶׁיֵּשׁ לָהֶם הוּא מִן הַשָּׂפָה וְלַחוּץ וְאֵינָהּ מוֹרָה לַלֵּב; — **meaning that the intellectual wisdom they possess is superficial from the lips outward and does not direct the heart;** מַה שֶּׁאֵין כֵּן חָכְמַת הַתּוֹרָה שֶׁעִקַּר קִנְיָנָהּ הוּא בַּלֵּב, — **unlike the wisdom of the Torah whose primary acquisition is in the heart,** כְּמַה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: "וּבְלֵב כָּל חֲכַם לֵב (וְנִתְתָּי חָכְמָה" רֵישׁ פָּרָשַׁת וַיִּשְׁלַח).[598] — **as Scripture states: "And in the heart of all that are wise-hearted I have put wisdom" (and this was explained at the beginning of Parashat Vayishlach).** וְזֶהוּ עִנְיַן אָמְרָם זִכְרוֹנָם לִבְרָכָה עַל הַיְוָנִים שֶׁטִּמְּאוּ כָּל הַשְּׁמָנִים, — **And this is the meaning of their statement of blessed memory regarding the Greeks that they defiled all the oils,** וְהַיְנוּ בְּחִינַת הַחָכְמָה שֶׁהֶחְשִׁיכוּ עֵינֵיהֶם שֶׁל יִשְׂרָאֵל. — **which is the aspect of wisdom in the heart, darkening the spiritual eyes of Israel.** וְיָדוּעַ דְּרֵאשִׁית חָכְמָה יִרְאַת ה' הוּא בְּחִינַת "אִשָּׁה יִרְאַת ה' הִיא תִּתְהַלָּל" שֶׁנִּמְצָא בִּכְלַל כְּנֶסֶת יִשְׂרָאֵל, — **And it is known that "the beginning of wisdom is the fear of Hashem" is the aspect of "a woman who fears Hashem" residing within Knesset Yisrael,** וְהִיא קַבָּלַת עֹל מַלְכוּת שָׁמַיִם מִצַּד אֱמוּנָה בַּלֵּב, — **and it is the acceptance of the yoke of the Kingdom of Heaven from faith in the heart,** שֶׁמֶּלֶךְ מַלְכֵי הַמְּלָכִים הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא עוֹמֵד לְפָנָיו וְרוֹאֶה בְּמַעֲשָׂיו; — **knowing that the King of kings of kings, the Holy One, Blessed be He, stands before him and beholds his deeds;** וְזֶה סוֹף הַמַּדְרֵגָה מִדַּת מַלְכוּת, "דְּאִיהִי יִרְאָה", — **and this is the final sefirah, the attribute of Malchut, "which is fear",** וְ'וְלֵב אֵין' זֶה נִקְנֶה גַּם כֵּן בַּלֵּב, וּכְמוֹ שֶׁדָּרְשׁוּ (יוֹמָא ע"ב עַמּוּד ב'): "'וְלֵב אֵין'[599] — **and this is acquired in the heart as well,**

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[595] **Mei HaShiloach, Volume I, Genesis, Noach 6**: "'The whole earth had one lip and common words.' It does not say 'one tongue,' for the essential tongue is the holy tongue: it comes from what is impressed in the depths of the heart and springs from the root of life. The other tongues are called a stammering tongue, as it says, 'A stammering tongue, without understanding'—without a root of life in the heart, for understanding is in the heart. Although the generation of the dispersion spoke the holy tongue, they had no root of life; they spoke it only from the lips outward, like the chatter and chirping of birds and other living creatures. So too with the serpent: the commentators ask why its curse does not mention that its tongue was taken away. In truth it had no tongue at the root, since it spoke slander against its Creator. Understand this."

Mei HaShiloach uses the very "lips outward" distinction to show that even correctly formed sacred language can lack inward life. This directly illuminates Rav Tzadok's contrast between verbal knowledge and wisdom acquired in the heart. The comparison is about the author's spiritual account of speech, not a linguistic judgment about the expressive capacity of other languages.

[596] **Tzidkat HaTzadik 178:1**: "In truth, if someone says that Torah exists among the idolatrous nations, do not believe him, as the Midrash says: 'He has not done so for any nation.' Nevertheless, even Written Torah contains many words spoken by wicked people of those nations, and they are part of Torah; so too in the Prophets and Writings. They themselves did not know what they were saying. Only the prophet and Israel among them knew that these were words of Torah, and all their power came from this. Once Israel drew what they had swallowed out of their mouths, their kingship was annulled."

Tzidkat answers an apparent textual counterexample to the origin's distinction: the Torah can contain an outsider's words without those words having become Torah in that speaker's own conscious heart. The meaning recognized by the prophet is distinguished from the speaker's awareness. This is the author's account of Torah acquisition, not a new claim that identical vocabulary establishes identical inward knowledge.

[597] **Lamentations 2:9**: "Her gates have sunk into the earth; He has destroyed and broken her bars. Her king and her princes are among the nations; there is no Torah. Her prophets, too, find no vision from Hashem."

[598] **Berakhot 55a**: 'On a similar note, Rabbi Yoḥanan said: The Holy One, Blessed be He, only grants wisdom to one who already possesses wisdom, as it is stated: "He gives wisdom unto the wise, and knowledge to they who know understanding" (Daniel 2:21). Rav Taḥalifa, from the West, Eretz Yisrael, heard this and repeated it before Rabbi Abbahu. Rabbi Abbahu said to him: You learned proof for this idea from there; we learn it from here: As it is written in praise of the builders of the Tabernacle: "And in the hearts of all who are wise-hearted I have placed wisdom" (Exodus 31:6).'

[599] **Yoma 72b**: 'Rabbi Shmuel bar Naḥmani said that Rabbi Yonatan said: What is the meaning of that which is written: "Why is there a price in the hand of a fool to buy wisdom, as he has no heart?" (Proverbs 17:16)? This expresses the following sentiment: Woe to them, haters of Torah scholars, a euphemism for the Torah scholars themselves, who immerse themselves in Torah and have no fear of Heaven. They are fools; they try to acquire the wisdom of Torah, but since they have no fear of Heaven in their hearts they lack the ability to do so.'

עַל שֶׁעוֹסְקִין בַּתּוֹרָה וְאֵין בָּהֶם יִרְאַת שָׁמַיִם". – [600] **— as they expounded (Yoma 72b): "'And has no heart' — applied to those who engage in Torah but possess no fear of Heaven".** וְיֵשׁ עוֹד מַדְרֵגָה בְּחִינַת "בִּינָה לִבָּא", **— And there is yet another higher level, the aspect of "understanding is the heart" (Binah Liba),** שֶׁהוּא דַּרְגָּא תְּמִינָאָה לְמַעְלָה מֵהַשָּׁבַע מִדּוֹת, **— which is the eighth level (darga temina'ah) above the seven attributes,** שֶׁהוּא מַדְרֵגַת הַיִּרְאָה שֶׁנִּקְלַט בִּפְנִימִיּוּת נְקֻדָּה שֶׁבַּלֵּב, כְּמַה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: "וּלְבָבוֹ יָבִין". **— which is the level of awe absorbed within the inward point of the heart, as Scripture states: "and his heart understands".**

כַּאֲשֶׁר הִרְגִּישׁוּ אָז — וְעַל זֶה הָיָה הוֹרָאַת הַנֵּס שֶׁבַּשֶּׁמֶן: **— And to this pointed the teaching of the miracle in the oil:** הַחֲכָמִים בְּסוֹף שָׁנָיו דְּיוֹסֵי בֶּן יוֹעֶזֶר שֶׁנֶּהֱרַג בִּגְזֵרַת יְוָנִים (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בְּרֵאשִׁית רַבָּה פָּרָשָׁה ס״ה) [601] **— when the Sages sensed then at the close of the years of Yose ben Yoezer who was martyred during the Greek decrees (Bereishit Rabbah 65)** "דִּבְצַר לִבָּא" כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בַּגְּמָרָא, **— that "the heart had diminished" as stated in the Gemara,** וְהַיְנוּ שֶׁלֹּא נִשְׁאַר רַק מַדְרֵגָה הַתַּחְתּוֹנָה בְּנַפְשׁוֹת יִשְׂרָאֵל, יִרְאָה תַּתָּאָה מִצַּד הָאֱמוּנָה; **— meaning that there remained only the lowest level in the souls of Israel, lower awe (yirah tata'ah) stemming from basic faith;** וְעַל זֶה מְרַמֵּז פַּךְ אֶחָד שֶׁל שֶׁמֶן שֶׁהָיָה בּוֹ רַק לְהַדְלִיק יוֹם אֶחָד, **— and to this alludes the single cruse of oil which contained enough to kindle for only one day,** וְהַיְנוּ מִדָּה אַחַת בְּחִינַת מַלְכוּת שָׁמַיִם; **— representing this single lower attribute, the aspect of the Kingdom of Heaven;** וְנַעֲשָׂה בּוֹ נֵס וְהִדְלִיקוּ מִמֶּנּוּ שְׁמוֹנָה יָמִים, **— and a miracle was performed with it and they kindled from it for eight days,** וְהַיְנוּ שֶׁנִּתּוֹסֵף מִמֶּנּוּ הָאוֹרָה עַד שֶׁהָיָה מֵאִיר וּבָא לָהֶם לִשְׁמוֹנַת יָמִים; **— meaning that light expanded from it until it illuminated for them across eight days;** וְהַיְנוּ שֶׁעַל יְדֵי בְּחִינַת מִדָּה הָאַחֲרוֹנָה שֶׁהִיא יִרְאָה, **— meaning that through the lowest attribute which is awe,** יֵשׁ בִּיכֹלֶת לְהָאִיר עַל נַפְשׁוֹ עֲדֵי יַגִּיעַ לְדַרְגָּא תְּמִינָאָה, **— one possesses the capacity to radiate upon his soul until he reaches the eighth level,** לִהְיוֹת נִקְלָט הַיִּרְאָה בִּפְנִימִיּוּת שֶׁבַּלֵּב. **— having awe deeply internalized within the inner point of the heart.** וְזֶה הַסּוֹד נִתְגַּלָּה לָהֶם בַּשָּׁנָה הָאַחֶרֶת, **— And this mystery was revealed to them in the following year,** שֶׁהִרְגִּישׁוּ הָאָרָה זֹאת בְּנַפְשָׁם עַד שֶׁהִגִּיעַ לִבְחִינַת נְקֻדָּה פְּנִימִיּוּת שֶׁבַּלֵּב, **— when they felt this illumination within their souls reaching the inner core of the heart,** וְלָכֵן קָבְעוּם לַשָּׁנָה הָאַחֶרֶת בָּהַלֵּל וְהוֹדָאָה; **— and therefore did they establish them in the following year with Hallel and Thanksgiving;** כִּי זֹאת הוֹרָאָה שְׁלִדּוֹרֵי דּוֹרוֹת גַּם בִּשְׁפַל הַמַּדְרֵגָה לֹא יֵפָסֵק הָאָרַת הַקְּדֻשָּׁה מִנַּפְשׁוֹת יִשְׂרָאֵל. **— for this is the enduring instruction for all generations, that even at the lowest depths, the radiance of holiness will never cease from Jewish souls.**

Differing views can share one divine root

וְזֶה עִנְיַן מַה שֶּׁאָמַר רַבִּי אֶלְעָזָר בֶּן עֲזַרְיָה (חֲגִיגָה ג׳ עַמּוּד ב׳) עַל הַפָּסוּק "דִּבְרֵי חֲכָמִים וְגוֹמֵר בַּעֲלֵי אֲסֻפּוֹת": [602, 603, 604] **— And this is**

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[600] **Yoma 72b**: ‘Rabbi Shmuel bar Naḥmani said that Rabbi Yonatan said: What is the meaning of that which is written: “Why is there a price in the hand of a fool to buy wisdom, as he has no heart?” (Proverbs 17:16)? This expresses the following sentiment: Woe to them, haters of Torah scholars, a euphemism for the Torah scholars themselves, who immerse themselves in Torah and have no fear of Heaven. They are fools; they try to acquire the wisdom of Torah, but since they have no fear of Heaven in their hearts they lack the ability to do so.’

[601] **Bereshit Rabbah 65:22** (excerpt): “Yakum of Tzerorot was the son of the sister of Rabbi Yose ben Yoezer of Tzeredah. He rode a horse on Shabbos before the beam on which his uncle was being led to execution, and said to him: See the horse my master has had me ride, and see the horse your Master has had you ride!”

[602] **Chagigah 3b**: ‘Lest a person say: Now, how can I study Torah when it contains so many different opinions? The verse states that they are all “given from one shepherd.” One God gave them; one leader, i.e., Moses, said them from the mouth of the Master of all creation, blessed be He, as it is written: “And God spoke all these words” (Exodus 20:1). The plural form “words” indicates that God transmitted all the interpretations of the Ten Commandments. Since the Sages invariably utilize the Torah itself or the statements of the prophets as the sources for their opinions, there is a certain unity to the study of Torah, despite the numerous explanations and applications.’

[603] **Resisei Layla 48:2**: “Since God distinguished and created different creatures, there must be different and distinct apprehensions for His praise, each true in itself and in its place. This is the patriarchs’ quality: there is no actual conflict here. Abraham’s and Isaac’s attributes, love and fear, are both true together, and He must be served through both. Each is true in itself and according to its level, like upper and lower waters with the firmament dividing them, each fully existing in its own place. But among the children afterwards—that is, as these attributes spread—each already included both attributes, though one predominated in one person and the other in another. From this disagreement arose: concerning the same thing, one says this and another says that. They are already all connected and united through mutual inclusion, and this produces their differing judgments about the same thing.”

Resisei explains how genuine differences can emerge from one source: the same attributes are included in different proportions, yielding different judgments. The full paragraph distinguishes this from hatred and expressly requires love of one’s fellow. Thus the origin’s unity of differing views is not a refusal to recognize disagreement or a blanket approval of hostility.

[604] **Tiferet Yosef, Korach 2**: “As long as a person recognizes that God established these attributes for the person’s benefit, so that there would be a place for human service, and recognizes that no place in him is so distant from God’s light that he cannot return it to God, it is still called disagreement for the sake of Heaven. This is the Zohar’s saying that heaven is the mystery of the patriarchs: the attributes have not yet become distant from their source. The person

the meaning of what Rabbi Elazar ben Azaryah said (Chagigah 3b) on the verse "The words of the wise, etc., masters of assemblies": "הַלָּלוּ מְטַמְּאִין וְהַלָּלוּ מְטַהֲרִין וְכוּלֵּיהּ, **— "These declare impure and these declare pure, etc.,** "כֻּלָּם נִתְּנוּ מֵרֹעֶה אֶחָד, אֵל אֶחָד נְתָנָן וְכוּלֵּיהּ", **— all of them were given from one Shepherd, one God gave them, etc.",** הַיְנוּ שֶׁגַּם עַתָּה שֶׁנִּתְמַעֲטוּ הַלְּבָבוֹת, **— meaning that even now when hearts have shrunk,** יֵשׁ בַּכֹּחַ לְהָהִיוֹת נִקְנָה בַּלֵּב לְהִתְאַחֵד גַּם חִלּוּקֵי הַדֵּעוֹת לִהְיוֹת בְּחִינַת "כָּל אֲשֶׁר עָשָׂה **— there remains the spiritual power to internalize in the heart the capacity to unite even conflicting opinions –** טוֹב מְאֹד". **— to become the manifestation of "everything that He made was very good".** וּבָזֶה יֻבַּח הַדָּרָשׁ (חֻלִּין צ״ב עַמּוּד א׳): אֵלּוּ הַצַּדִּיקִים שֶׁבְּכָל דּוֹר וָדוֹר", וְגַם אָמְרוּ: "אֶשְׁכּוֹלוֹת **— "'Its clusters ripened into grapes' — these are the righteous in each and every generation",** – אֵלּוּ תַּלְמִידֵי חֲכָמִים וְכוּלֵּיהּ, **— and they also said: "'clusters' — these are Torah scholars, etc.,** לִיבְעֵי רַחֲמֵי אִתַּכְלָיָא עַל עַלְיָא", **— let the clusters pray for mercy upon the leaves",** שֶׁבָּאֱמֶת יֵשׁ בְּכָל דּוֹר מְצִיאוּת בְּחִינַת אֶשְׁכּוֹלוֹת כָּאָמוּר. **— for in truth there exists in every generation the living reality of the eshkolot as stated.**

[605] **Chullin 92a**: "Rabbi Yehoshua said to him: Does one show a person what has already happened? One shows him only what is yet to be. Rather, 'the vine' is Torah; 'three branches' are Moshe, Aharon, and Miriam; 'as it budded, its blossom came forth' means the Sanhedrin; 'its clusters ripened into grapes' means the righteous of each and every generation. Similar to Rabbi Yirmeya bar Abba's interpretation of the word vine as an allusion to the Jewish people, Rabbi Shimon ben Lakish says: This nation is likened to a vine. The branches of the vine support the clusters of grapes, the leaves, and the tendrils; these are represented among the Jewish people by the homeowners, who provide financial support for the entire nation. The clusters of grapes on the vine, these are the Torah scholars. The leaves on the vine, which protect the grapes, these are the ignoramuses, who protect the Torah scholars. The tendrils of the vine, which do not directly serve the grapes themselves, these are the empty ones of the Jewish people."

recognizes no opposition between the attributes, since they are attached to their source. But when they have become so distant that a person thinks there are places he cannot return to God's light, he then imagines the attributes to be truly opposite and in conflict with one another. This is called disagreement that is not for the sake of Heaven."

Tiferet supplies a concrete test for the common-root insight: differences remain ordered toward service and return, rather than being treated as independent, irreconcilable powers. The full Korach argument also rejects using primordial unity to abandon commandments. This preserves the origin's hope of heart-level unity without dissolving the obligation to work through actual differences.

Chanukah Ois 6

Hidden Redemption, Repentance, and the Power of the Menorah

The opening distinction asks how Chanukah can disclose deliverance when the persecution had already produced religious failure.

Hidden Redemption, Repentance, and the Power of the Menorah

A threatened covenant can be rediscovered after failure

עִנְיַן נֵס חֲנֻכָּה שֶׁאֵינוֹ דּוֹמֶה לְנֵס פּוּרִים וּשְׁאָר גְּאֻלּוֹת[606]: — **The character of the miracle of Chanukah does not resemble the miracle of Purim and other redemptions:** דְּשָׁם בְּקֵשׁ הָמָן לְהַשְׁמִיד כָּל הַיְּהוּדִים, — **for there Haman sought to physically annihilate all Jews,** וְהָיָה הַנֵּס שֶׁלֹּא נִתְקַיְּמָה מַחֲשַׁבְתּוֹ ו"נַהֲפוֹךְ הוּא"; — **and the miracle was that his scheme failed and "it was overturned";** מַה שֶּׁאֵין כֵּן בִּימֵי הַיְוָנִים שֶׁעָמְדוּ לְבַטֵּל אֶת יִשְׂרָאֵל מִתּוֹרָה וּמִצְוֹות, — **unlike the era of the Greeks who stood up to strip Israel of Torah and mitzvot,** וְכִפְי שֶׁהַרְבֵּה מִיִּשְׂרָאֵל הֵמִירוּ דָּת הָרְאוּת עָלְתָה בְּיָדָם אָז לְפִי שָׁעָה, — **and seemingly their design succeeded temporarily,** אַךְ הָעִנְיָן הוּא עַל פִּי מַה שֶּׁכָּתוּב (בְּרֵאשִׁית רַבָּה פָּרָשָׁה ס״ה)[607]: "'וַיָּרַח אֶת רֵיחַ בְּגָדָיו' — **as many in Israel apostatized, may the Merciful One preserve us.** רַחֲמָנָא לִצְלַן. — **However, the matter is according to what is written (Bereishit Rabbah, Parashah 65): –** כְּגוֹן יוֹסֵף מְשִׁיתָא וְיָקוּם אִישׁ צְרוֹרוֹת", — **"'And he smelled the fragrance of his garments (begadav)' — such as Yosef Meshita and Yakum of Tzerorot",** שֶׁהָיָה בֶּן אֲחוֹתוֹ שֶׁל יוֹסֵי בֶּן יוֹעֶזֶר. — **who was the nephew of Yose ben Yoezer.** וּכְבָר אָמַרְנוּ שֶׁיּוֹסֵי הָיָה בִּזְמַן גְּזֵרַת הַיְוָנִים שֶׁנִּתְלָה אָז; — **And we already stated that Yose lived during the Greek persecution when he was executed by hanging;** וְהוּא קִבֵּל מֵאַנְטִיגְנוֹס, שֶׁבְּאוֹתוֹ זְמַן פָּקְרוּ תַּלְמִידָיו צָדוֹק וּבַיְתוֹס — **and he had received from Antigonus, in whose time his disciples Zadok and Boethus turned apostate,** כִּי נִתְפַּתּוּ לְחָכְמַת יְוָנִית וְרָצוּ לְהָמִיר דָּתָם, — **seduced by Greek philosophy and seeking to change their faith,** רַק שֶׁבּוֹשׁוּ לַעֲשׂוֹת כֵּן וּפָקְרוּ בְּתוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה הַמְּנֻגֶּדֶת לְחָכְמַת יְוָנִית. — **only being ashamed to do so overtly, they denied the Oral Torah which opposes Greek philosophy.** וְיָקוּם גַּם כֵּן מִתְּחִלָּה נִתְפַּתָּה וּבָגַד בִּקְדֻשַּׁת יִשְׂרָאֵל, — **And Yakum also was initially seduced and betrayed the holiness of Israel,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב שָׁם דְּאָמַר לְיוֹסֵי בֶּן יוֹעֶזֶר: — **as written there, saying to Yose ben Yoezer:** "חֲמִי סוּסִי דְּאַרְכְּבַנִי מָרִי", שְׁרָכַב עַל סוּס בְּשַׁבָּת, — **"See the horse that my master caused me to ride", riding a horse on Shabbat,** "וַחֲמִי סוּסָךְ דְּאַרְכְּבָךְ מָרָךְ", הַקּוֹרָה לְהִתָּלוֹת עָלֶיהָ כְּנִזְכָּר לְעֵיל; — **"and see the horse that your Master caused you to ride", referring to the gallows upon which he was to be hanged;** וְיֵשׁ לוֹמַר שֶׁהָיָה כְּעֵין הִתְפַּקְּרוּת צָדוֹק בְּתוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה, — **and one can say that this was akin to Zadok's rejection of the Oral Torah,** כִּי רְכִיבָה בְּשַׁבָּת הוּא רַק אִסּוּר שְׁבוּת דְּרַבָּנָן. — **for riding a horse on Shabbat is only a Rabbinic enactment (shevut).**

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[606] **Tiferet Yosef, Talmud Anthology, Megillah 7**: “A person sometimes performs actions in which he sees no honor of Heaven, to the point that it seems to him that through those actions he did the complete opposite, Heaven forbid, of God’s will. Afterwards, when a person repents out of love, prays, and cries to God from the depth of his heart, God then illuminates for him that he was never uprooted, Heaven forbid, from God’s will, even by a hair’s breadth.”
The full Tiferet passage opens with the promise of not rejecting Israel in the Greek period, then explains how repentance discloses an attachment hidden during apparent estrangement. This answers the kind of deliverance posed by the opening question; Rav Tzadok develops it through the repentant betrayers in the following paragraphs. Tiferet also applies the principle to Purim, but the comparison does not erase Rav Tzadok’s distinction between the two persecutions or claim that the failures never occurred.

[607] **Bereshit Rabbah 65:22** (excerpt): “Another interpretation of ‘He smelled the fragrance of his garments and blessed him’ (Genesis 27:27): Such as Yosef Meshita and Yakum of Tzerorot. When the enemies sought to enter the Temple Mount, they said: Let one of them enter first. They told Yosef Meshita: Go in, and whatever you bring out is yours. He entered and brought out a golden menorah. They said: An ordinary person should not use this; enter a second time, and whatever you bring out is yours. He refused. Rabbi Pinchas said: They offered him three years’ tax revenues, but he refused. He said: Is it not enough that I angered my God once? Shall I anger Him a second time? … Yakum of Tzerorot was the son of the sister of Rabbi Yose ben Yoezer of Tzeredah. Riding a horse on Shabbos before the beam on which his uncle was being led to execution, he said: See the horse my master has had me ride, and see the horse your Master has had you ride! Rabbi Yose replied: If this is how He treats those who anger Him, how much more will He reward those who do His will! Yakum said: Has anyone done His will more than you? He replied: If this is how He treats those who do His will, how much more will He punish those who anger Him!”

Repentance awakens another through a real bond

A moment of concealment does not define the inner will

וּמִכָּל מָקוֹם נִכְנְסוּ בְּלִבּוֹ דִּבְרֵי יוֹסֵי בֶּן יוֹעֶזֶר[608, 609] — **And nevertheless Yose ben Yoezer's words penetrated his heart,** וְקִיֵּם בְּעַצְמוֹ אַרְבַּע מִיתוֹת בֵּית דִּין — **and he inflicted upon himself all four judicial executions of the Court,** וּבְשָׁעָה קַלָּה קָדָמוּהוּ לְיוֹסֵי לְגַן עֵדֶן. — **and in a brief moment he preceded Yose into the Garden of Eden.** וְכֵן יוֹסֵף מְשִׁיתָא, אַף שֶׁפָּקַר מִקּוֹדֶם וְנִכְנַס לַהֵיכָל, — **And likewise Yosef Meshita, even though he had blasphemed earlier entering the Holy Temple to loot,** מִכָּל מָקוֹם אַחַר כָּךְ לֹא נִתְרַצָּה, בִּמְסִירַת נֶפֶשׁ, וְקִדֵּשׁ שֵׁם שָׁמַיִם. — **nevertheless afterward refused to return, dying in self-sacrifice, and sanctified the Name of Heaven.** וְזֶהוּ "רֵיחַ בְּגָדָיו" דְּדָרֵשׁ כְּמוֹ "רֵיחַ בּוֹגְדָיו" (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב סַנְהֶדְרִין ל״ז עַמּוּד א'),[610] — **And this is "the fragrance of his garments (begadav)" expounded as "the fragrance of his traitors (bogdav)" (Sanhedrin 37a),** וְהוּא שֶׁמֵּהֲרִיחַ שֶׁל הַבְּגִידָה שֶׁמִּקּוֹדֶם נִתְעַלָּה בְּיֶתֶר שְׂאֵת, — **in that from the stench of the previous betrayal they were elevated with immense grandeur,** שֶׁנִּתְגַּלָּה פְּנִימִיּוּת לְבָבָם שֶׁבְּשׁוֹרֶשׁ יִשְׂרָאֵל מְקֻשָּׁרִים בְּהַקְּדֻשָּׁה, — **as the inward core of their heart was revealed showing that in their root Jewish souls are bonded to holiness,** כְּעִנְיַן מַה שֶּׁכָּתוּב (בְּרָכוֹת י״ז עַמּוּד א'): "גָּלוּי וְיָדוּעַ לְפָנֶיךָ שֶׁרְצוֹנֵנוּ לַעֲשׂוֹת רְצוֹנֶךָ, וּמִי מְעַכֵּב[611] — **after the manner of what is stated (Berachot 17a): –** שְׂאוֹר שֶׁבָּעִסָּה", — **"It is revealed and known before You that our desire is to do Your will, and what prevents us — the yeast in the dough the Evil Inclination",** וְזֶהוּ אַף בְּקַל שֶׁבְּקַלִּים כְּמוֹ שָׁהָיוּ הֵם מִקּוֹדֶם. — **and this is true even in the most degraded individuals as they were initially.** וּמִזֶּה נִתְבָּרֵר שֶׁגַּם הַבְּגִידָה שֶׁמִּקּוֹדֶם הָיָה בִּרְצוֹן הַשְׁגָּחָתוֹ יִתְבָּרַךְ, — **And from this it became clear that even the prior betrayal was under the hidden providence of His Blessed Will,** וְהוּא מַה שֶּׁכָּתוּב (בְּרֵאשִׁית רַבָּה פָּרָשָׁה פ״ד):[612] — **which is what is written (Bereishit Rabbah, Parashah 84):** "'לָמָּה תַתְעֵנוּ הַשֵּׁם מִדְּרָכֶיךָ וְגוֹמֵר': כְּשֶׁרָצִיתָ נָתַתָּ בְּלִבָּם שֶׁל שְׁבָטִים — **"'Why do You make us stray, Hashem, from Your ways, etc.': when You willed You placed in**

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[608] **Tzidkat HaTzadik 159:1**: "Other individuals who repent can bring back only the souls dependent upon them, and in the particular power in which they themselves return. Thus the student in Menachot 44a, through his repentance, awakened a thought of repentance in that woman who was related to him, for afterwards she became his wife. Someone liable to death through his sins cannot be awakened to repentance until the person awakening him also gives himself over even to death, for this is the level of that repentance; then he can awaken him to repentance. Therefore Pinchas stopped the plague, the indiscriminate calamity that is the punishment resulting from sexual immorality: they repented through his willingness to give his life, and he awakened them to return, as written concerning the war with Midian. So too in the account of Rabbi Yosi ben Yoezer of Tzeredah in Bereshit Rabbah: only when he was being led to the cross did he awaken his sister's son to repentance. Likewise Moses and Aaron fell on their faces during Korach's dispute, seeing that death had been decreed against them; they gave themselves over to death, as written in the Zohar, to raise them to repentance. But it did not help, because those people disputed him and separated themselves from their connection within his soul. His awakening therefore did not work in their hearts: a person is measured with the measure he uses, and is led along the path he wishes to follow."

Tzidkat interprets the same Yosi episode, rather than merely offering another story of a quick return. The explanation is relational: his words work at the moment his own life is at stake, within a bond that can transmit an awakening. The concluding Korach counterexample is retained, so the quotation does not imply that any righteous person's suffering automatically causes someone else to repent. This is the author's interpretation of the narrated events, not practical instruction to seek danger.

[609] **Tiferet Yosef, Simchat Torah 3**: "'He shone from Seir for them; He appeared from Mount Paran.' God also gave Israel a radiance and appearance from these powers. For in truth, even within Israel it can happen that a person forgets God a little, Heaven forbid. For this God gave a radiance and appearance: when Israel stands with complete understanding, they undertake service themselves and do not rely upon any source of strength. Only sometimes this is concealed from them. Concerning that, God clarifies for them that Israel's deep heart is full of desire and service. For that moment they may rely upon the strength of the patriarchs' holiness, for God will clarify them for good."

Tiferet supplies the qualification that makes the discovery of an enduring root intelligible: the normal posture is active service, and the lapse is a concealment of a deeper will. Its opening explicitly rejects treating the ancestral covenant as a reason to cease working. This illuminates Rav Tzadok's claim that even a betrayer's return reveals an inward will for holiness, without turning inherited holiness into advance permission to rebel.

[610] **Sanhedrin 37a:7**: "Reish Lakish said: It is learned from here: 'Your temples are like a slice of pomegranate.' Even the empty ones among you are full of mitzvos like a pomegranate is full of seeds. Rabbi Zeira said: It is learned from here: 'He smelled the fragrance of his garments.' Do not read begadav, 'his garments,' but bogedav, 'his traitors.'"

[611] **Berakhot 17a:2**: "After praying, Rabbi Alexandri would say: 'May it be Your will, Lord our God, that You place us in a corner of light and not in a corner of darkness. Let our hearts not become faint, and let our eyes not grow dark.' Some say that Rav Hamnuna was the one who prayed this prayer, while Rabbi Alexandri would say after praying: 'Master of all worlds, it is revealed and known before You that we wish to do Your will. What prevents us? The leaven in the dough, meaning the evil inclination within us, and our subjection to foreign kingdoms. May it be Your will to rescue us from their power, so that we may return to carrying out the statutes that express Your will with a whole heart.'"

[612] **Bereshit Rabbah 84:18** (excerpt): "Rabbi Yehoshua ben Beitos said in the name of Rabbi Yehudah bar Simon: It is written, 'Why do You make us stray, Hashem, from Your ways?' (Isaiah 63:17). When You willed, You put it into their hearts to love; and when You willed, You put it into their hearts to hate."

the hearts of the tribes to love, ;"וּכְשֶׁרָצִיתָ נָתַתָּ בְּלִבָּם לְשִׂנֹא" — **and when You willed You placed in their hearts to hate";** ,"וְלִכְאוֹרָה הַסֵּדֶר מְהֻפָּךְ, שֶׁמַּזְכִּיר מִקּוֹדֶם "נָתַתָּ בְּלִבָּם לֶאֱהֹב" — **and seemingly the order is inverted, mentioning first "You placed in their heart to love",** :שֶׁזֶּה הָיָה בְּשָׁעָה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: "וַיַּעַבְרוּ אֲנָשִׁים מִדְיָנִים", שֶׁאָמַר עָבְרוּ אוֹתָן הַדַּיָּנִים". — **which occurred later when it states: "And Midianite men passed by", saying "those judges passed".**

Recognizing providence begins with the good one has received

Being shepherded means continually seeking the divine will

כְּשֶׁנּוֹדָע לָאָדָם מִקּוֹדֶם בֶּטַח בְּנַפְשׁוֹ[613,614] — **However, such is the true spiritual sequence:** אֲמָתָּם כִּי כֵּן הוּא הַסֵּדֶר: — **when it is made known to a person beforehand with unshakable certainty in his soul** שֶׁמַּעֲשָׂיו הַטּוֹבִים אֵינָם מִכֹּחוֹ רַק מֵהַשְׁגָּחָתוֹ יִתְבָּרַךְ, — **that his good deeds are not generated through his own power but by His divine providence,** "כְּשֶׁרָצִיתָ נָתַתָּ בְּלִבָּם לֶאֱהֹב" וְזֶהוּ — **– which is "when You willed You placed in their heart to love"** — אֲז גַּם אִם חָלִילָה יְזַדַּמֵּן לָפָנָיו לְפָעָמִים אֵיזֶה מַעֲשֶׂה שֶׁלֹּא כַּהֲגָן, — **then even if Heaven forbid an improper deed occasionally befalls him,** יוּכַל לִבְטֹחַ שֶׁגַּם זֶה הָיָה בְּהַשְׁגָּחָתוֹ יִתְבָּרַךְ, וְהֵינוּ "נָתַתָּ בְּלִבָּם לִשְׂנֹא". — **he can trust that this too was governed by divine providence, which is "You placed in their heart to hate".** וְעַל זֶה אָמַר דָּוִד הַמֶּלֶךְ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם: "הַשֵּׁם רֹעִי לֹא אֶחְסָר — **And to this David the King, peace be upon him, alludes:** בִּנְאוֹת דֶּשֶׁא יַרְבִּיצֵנִי עַל מֵי מְנֻחוֹת יְנַהֲלֵנִי נַפְשִׁי יְשׁוֹבֵב יַנְחֵנִי בְמַעְגְּלֵי צֶדֶק לְמַעַן שְׁמוֹ" וְגוֹמֵר — **– "Hashem is my shepherd I shall not lack, etc., He leads me in paths of righteousness for His Name's sake"** — הֵינוּ שֶׁהָיָה בָּרוּר לְנֶגֶד עֵינָיו שֶׁהַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ רוֹעוֹ וּמַנְהִיגוֹ לָלֶכֶת בְּמַעְגְּלֵי צֶדֶק וְיִשֶּׁר וְלֹא בְּכֹחוֹ יִגְבַּר; — **meaning it was lucid before his eyes that the Blessed Name shepherds and guides him to walk in paths of righteousness and not by human might does he prevail;** עַל יְדֵי זֶה: "גַּם כִּי אֵלֵךְ בְּגֵיא צַלְמָוֶת לֹא אִירָא רָע כִּי אַתָּה עִמָּדִי", שֶׁגַּם שָׁם אַתָּה עִמָּדִי. וְגוֹמֵר — **through this: "Though I walk, etc." occasionally in the valley of the shadow of death, likewise "I will fear no evil for You are with me", for even there You are with me.** — **And behold it is stated in the Likkutim from the holy master Rabbi Pinchas of Koritz, memory of the righteous be blessed,** וְהִנֵּה אִיתָא בְּלִקּוּטִים מֵהָרַב הַקָּדוֹשׁ רַבִּי פִּנְחָס מִקָּארֶץ זְכוֹר צַדִּיק לִבְרָכָה, שֶׁבְּנֵרוֹת חֲנֻכָּה יֵשׁ הִתְגַּלּוּת אוֹרוֹ שֶׁל מָשִׁיחַ, — **that in the Chanukah lights there is a manifestation of the light of Messiah,** וְהוּא לְרַמֵּז דְּבָרֵינוּ הַנִּזְכָּרִים לְעֵיל. — **and this alludes to our concepts mentioned above.** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמַרְנוּ בְּמַה שֶׁכָּתוּב (תַּעֲנִית ה' עַמּוּד ב'): "יַעֲקֹב אָבִינוּ לֹא מֵת",[615] — **And as we explained regarding what is written**

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[613] **Takanat HaShavin 5:8**: “This is the foundation of the Israelite people: to give place to Torah, which commands human effort. With Abraham began the ‘two thousand years of Torah.’ Its completion comes through Messiah, who will repair everything preceding, including Adam’s sin, so that everything is transformed into merits. This is possible only through the disclosure of complete nearness from God and the complete removal of effort, for it will be clarified that ‘all our thoughts and actions You have accomplished for us,’ and that everything is from Him. Thus Bereshit Rabbah says of Joseph’s brothers, ‘When You willed, You placed love in their hearts, and when You willed …’. God likewise willed to place hatred within the human heart. This too came from Him, who wished to bring the person near by this path. All the distances are approaches, like ‘sufferings of love’: suffering is distance and the opposite of love, and at the time we think it is distance; in truth it is nearness and intense love. So too all the transgressions that brought a person to return and attain the level of a penitent: the distance was the cause of nearness.”

Takanat expounds the same paired love-and-hatred saying within the movement from Abraham’s tested effort to Messiah’s completed repair. Its opening expressly preserves Torah’s demand for effort, and its retrospective claim concerns failures that actually brought a person to return. This locates Rav Tzadok’s confidence within an ordered process; it is not a claim that effort or repentance can be bypassed now.

[614] **Mei HaShiloach, Volume I, Genesis, Vayechi 3**: “‘He said: the God before whom my fathers walked, the God who has shepherded me from my earliest days.’ Jacob was making himself small before his fathers Abraham and Isaac. He said that they possessed very great wisdom and understanding, so that they expanded God’s will through their own powers. Even when God opened a small opening for them, they expanded and extended it through their wisdom to do their Creator’s will, understanding even a matter God had not explicitly illuminated for them. This is ‘before whom they walked’: they walked through their own strength. But I—‘the God who has shepherded me from my earliest days until this day’—in every particular action I perform, I need God to illuminate my eyes as to His will. Even in an action in which I have already seen His will, if it is to be repeated, I still need to see on the second occasion what His will is. In truth, in this respect Jacob was the greatest of the patriarchs, for it is a great level that God should guide a person continually. This was King David’s prayer: ‘The Lord is my shepherd; I shall not lack.’ That is, I should not lack God’s providence over me; He should always shepherd me, and I too should always recognize that God is my shepherd. In His goodness God guides everything, but the person turns his face away and does not wish to look expectantly and pray. When a person prays a complete prayer, he is immediately answered and sees that God is the shepherd. This is ‘I shall not lack’: I shall not turn my face away from Him.”

Mei HaShiloach interprets the same psalm phrase as continual recognition, rather than personal control over providence. Its account of Jacob explains why attributing even good deeds to God does not make the person passive: a repeated act still calls for renewed attention to God’s will. This develops the positive premise on which Rav Tzadok builds his confidence after failure.

[615] **Taanit 5b**: ‘The Gemara asks: And is one man set aside before another man? In other words, is Samuel’s life set aside

(Ta'anit 5b): "Jacob our Father did not die", וְהֵינוּ מִפְּנֵי שֶׁהָיָה בְּתַכְלִית שְׁלֵמוּת הַקְּדֻשָּׁה כְּמוֹ אָדָם הָרִאשׁוֹן קֹדֶם הַקִּלְקוּל; **— meaning because he resided in the absolute perfection of holiness like Adam before the fall;** וְכֵן אֵלִיָּהוּ שֶׁלֹּא חָטָא, הוּא חַי וְקַיָּם לְעוֹלָם; **— and likewise Elijah who never sinned lives and endures forever;** אֲבָל שְׁאָר הַנְּפָשׁוֹת בְּהֶכְרֵחַ טָעֲמוּ מִיתָה, עַל יְדֵי שֶׁנִּדְבַּק בָּהֶם מַעֲטֵיוֹ שֶׁל נָחָשׁ. **— yet other souls must inevitably taste the taste of death, having the serpent's counsel adhered to them.**

Judah finds renewed courage after failure

The height reached through repentance does not make sin the preferred path

Completed return changes the divine assessment of the past

אֲמָנָם דָּוִד הַמֶּלֶךְ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם הוּא "הַגָּבֶר הֻקַם עָל",[616,617,618] **— However, David the King, peace be upon him, is "the man raised up on high (hukam al)",** שֶׁהֻקִים עֻלָּהּ שֶׁל תְּשׁוּבָה, **— who raised the yoke of repentance (ulah shel teshuvah),** הֵינוּ שֶׁיּוּכַל לְהִתָּקֵן גַּם הַפְּגָם שֶׁמִּקּוֹדָם שֶׁיִּהְיוּ נַעֲשׂוֹת כְּזְכֻיּוֹת; **— meaning that even the prior blemish can be rectified so that sins become transformed into merits;** וְהֵינוּ שֶׁיִּתְבָּרֵר שֶׁגַּם זֶה הָיָה מַהַשְׁגָּחָתוֹ יִתְבָּרַךְ מִקּוֹדֶם, **— which means it becomes clear that even this was orchestrated by divine providence from the outset,** כַּשָּׁנִים הַלָּלוּ שְׁסִדּוּרוֹת וּבָאוֹת – כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב (שבת פ"ט עמוד ב'): "אִם יִהְיוּ חֲטָאֵיכֶם כַּשָּׁנִים"[619] **— as written (Shabbat 89b):**

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simply because the time for David's reign has arrived? The Gemara answers: Yes, as Rabbi Shmuel bar Naḥmani said that Rabbi Yoḥanan said: What is the meaning of that which is written: "Therefore I have hewn by the prophets, I have slain them by the words of My mouth" (Hosea 6:5)? It is not stated: By their deeds, but rather: "By the words of My mouth," i.e., God sometimes ends the life of an individual simply by virtue of His decree. Apparently, one man is indeed set aside before another man.'

[616] **Mei HaShiloach, Volume I, Genesis, Vayechi 5**: "'His garment in the blood of grapes.' Sotoh is read as a term for an impulse, for the impulse at Judah's root is this: after a sin or stumbling that has occurred to him, strength awakens in his soul—this can only mean that God wishes to save me with still greater force. Grapes signify error and forgetfulness. Moses said, 'You drank the blood of the grape as wine.' Chamer points to 'no eye has seen, O God, besides You,' for the ministering angels do not recognize Aramaic. But Moses is within, while Jacob is outside. In Jacob's words it says 'grapes': God will clarify two errors concerning Judah's tribe, the inclination toward sexual transgression and the inclination toward idolatry, and God clarified that he is clean in both. Moses is within, for Moses saw that Judah has no error in the inclination toward idolatry: in this he had already been clarified as very clean. Only the inclination toward sexual transgression still needs clarification, as Rav said, 'Israel worshipped the calf only to permit themselves sexual transgression openly.' But concerning the inclination toward idolatry they are already clean. Understand this."

Mei HaShiloach assigns Judah a specific response after stumbling: renewed confidence in a greater deliverance. Its distinction between Jacob's outer expression and Moses' inner view explains why a clarified root can coexist with further clarification still needed. The quotation does not assert that the calf's act was permissible; its final rabbinic saying distinguishes the motive for that act. This illuminates the Davidic pattern in Rav Tzadok's paragraph without making failure something to seek.

[617] **Yisrael Kedoshim 7:2**: "It seems that this is what Bereshit Rabbah means: "'Darkness'—these are the deeds of the wicked … I do not know which He desires more." How could one suppose that He desires the deeds of the wicked?! The intention concerns the created order: 'God made the human being upright.' Although He created wicked people and the evil inclination, He created Torah as its seasoning, to be 'a lamp for my feet'—'even when I sit in darkness, the Lord is my light,' and 'even when I walk in the valley … You are with me.' Although in the end the penitent is nearer, because he raises holy sparks from the lowly places in which his vitality had been and turns darkness into light, so that one might suppose God desires this more, it is concerning this that they said, 'God saw the light, that it was good.' Nevertheless His essential desire and will is for the righteous person, 'for it was good.'"

Yisrael Kedoshim asks the ethical question raised by the origin's comparison: does greater closeness after return mean that sin is preferred? Its answer keeps both claims: repentance raises sparks from a low place, yet God desires the upright path. This directly limits a possible misreading of "more than someone righteous from the outset." The full canonical paragraph was read; the selected excerpt stays clear of its embedded later section headings.

[618] **Tzidkat HaTzadik 100:1**: "This is 'Your devoted ones will sing joyfully'; the Sages say that these are the wicked of Israel, and likewise concerning 'Gather to Me My devoted ones.' A devoted person is one who departs from the line of strict law in order to act with extra devotion, while a wicked person departs from that line in order to do evil. When God opens this understanding in the future, after complete repentance, and everyone recognizes the power of His kingship, the deliberate sins that were a departure from the line of law turn out to have been devotion, since they did not depart from the truth of God's will. The text precisely says 'My devoted ones' and 'Your devoted ones,' not simply 'devoted ones': they are called devoted before God, not in human eyes."

Tzidkat clarifies whose assessment is being described and when: the disclosure follows complete repentance, and the text deliberately says "My" or "Your" devoted ones. This makes Rav Tzadok's dramatic retrospective claim more precise. It does not license people to relabel a current transgression as a meritorious deed.

[619] **Shabbat 89b:2**: "'From where do we learn that they tie a strip of crimson wool,' and so forth? Why does the verse say ka-shanim, a plural form for 'scarlet'? Should it not have said ka-shani, the singular? Rabbi Yitzchak said: The Holy One, blessed be He, told Israel, 'Even if your sins are like these years, shanim, which have come in ordered succession from the six days of Creation until now, they shall become white as snow.' Rava expounded: What is meant by 'Go now, and let us reason together, the Lord will say'? Why 'Go now'? Should it not say 'Come now'? And why 'the Lord will say'? Should it not say 'the Lord said'? In the future the Holy One, blessed be He, will tell Israel, 'Go now to your

מִשֵּׁשֶׁת יְמֵי בְרֵאשִׁית", — **"Though your sins be like scarlet (shanim) — like these years (shanim) ordered from the Six Days of Creation",** וְהַיְנוּ שֶׁיִּתְוַדַּע שֶׁכֵּן הָיָה מְסֻדָּר לְפָנָיו יִתְבָּרֵךְ, — **meaning it will become known that thus it was prearranged before Him,** וְהוּא בְּחִינַת "לְאַהֲפָכָא חֲשׁוֹכָא לִנְהוֹרָא". — **which is the kabbalistic level of transforming darkness into light (le'ahapacha chashocha linhara).** וְזֶה שֹׁרֶשׁ אוֹרוֹ שֶׁל מָשִׁיחַ בֶּן דָּוִד שֶׁהַמָּה חַיֵּי עוֹלָם, — **And this is the root of the light of the Messiah son of David who is eternal life,** שֶׁיִּתְבָּרְרוּ שֶׁכָּל הַקִּלְקוּלִים הָיָה מֵהַשְׁגָּחָתוֹ יִתְבָּרֵךְ, — **when it will be clarified that all ruinations were within divine providence,** וְיִתְתַּקְּנוּ בְּיֶתֶר שְׂאֵת לִהְיוֹת "טוֹב מְאֹד", — **and they will be rectified with exceeding glory to become "very good",** יוֹתֵר מִצַּדִּיק מַעֲקָרוֹ, שֶׁהוּא בְּחִינַת מָשִׁיחַ בֶּן יוֹסֵף שֶׁלֹּא יִהְיֶה לוֹ קִיּוּם. — **more elevated than an initial righteous person, which is the aspect of Messiah son of Joseph who will not permanently endure.** וְזֶה מַה שֶּׁנֶּאֱמַר (בְּרָכוֹת ל״ד עַמּוּד ב׳): "מָקוֹם שֶׁבַּעֲלֵי תְּשׁוּבָה עוֹמְדִין, צַדִּיקִים גְּמוּרִים אֵינָם עוֹמְדִין". [620] — **And this is what is stated (Berachot 34b): "In the place where penitents stand, the completely righteous cannot stand."** וְזֶה נִתְגַּלָּה בְּהָאָרַת נֵס חֲנֻכָּה כִּדְבָרֵינוּ: — **And this was revealed in the illumination of the Chanukah miracle as we explained:** שֶׁנִּתְעַלָּה הֲרֵיחַ בּוֹגְדִים בְּיֶתֶר שְׂאֵת עַל יְדֵי קִדּוּשׁ הַשֵּׁם שֶׁמָּסְרוּ נַפְשָׁם. — **that the fragrance of traitors was elevated with immense grandeur through the sanctification of the Name where they sacrificed their lives.** דְּהִנֵּה אִיתָא (יוֹמָא פ״ו עַמּוּד א׳) [621] חִלּוּקֵי כַּפָּרָה, — **For behold there are categories of atonement (Yoma 86a),** אֲבָל מִי שֶׁיֵּשׁ חִלּוּל הַשֵּׁם בְּיָדוֹ וְכוּלֵיהּ, כֻּלָּן תּוֹלִין וּמִיתָה מְמָרֶקֶת. — **yet one who holds desecration of the Name in his hand, all of them suspend and death purges.** וְאִיתָא הָתָם: הֵיכִי דָּמֵי חִלּוּל הַשֵּׁם וְכוּלֵיהּ? — **And it states there: What defines desecration of the Name, etc.?** רַבִּי יוֹחָנָן אָמַר: כְּגוֹן אֲנָא דְּמַסְגֵּינָא אַרְבַּע אַמּוֹת בְּלֹא תּוֹרָה וּבְלֹא תְּפִלִּין, — **Rabbi Yochanan said: Such as myself walking four cubits without Torah and without tefillin;** וְהַיְנוּ שֶׁיֵּדַע שֶׁבְּהֶכְרֵחַ לְכָל נֶפֶשׁ לְתָלוֹת בּוֹ הַמִּיתָה מִנּוֹרָא עֲלִילָה עַל יְדֵי פְּגַם שֶׁל חִלּוּל הַשֵּׁם, — **meaning he knew that every soul must inevitably have death suspended upon it by the Awesome in Counsel through some flaw of Chillul Hashem,** וְהִתְנַצֵּל שֶׁלְּפָנָיו יֵשׁ דַּי בַּעֲלִילָה זוֹ. — **and he argued that regarding him this slight pretext was sufficient.**

וּבִגְזֵרַת הַיְוָנִים נִתְקַן הַחִלּוּל הַשֵּׁם בְּעֶצֶם עַל יְדֵי מְסִירַת נֶפֶשׁ עַל קִדּוּשׁ הַשֵּׁם, — **And during the Greek decrees, desecration of the Name was rectified fundamentally through self-sacrifice for Kiddush Hashem,** וְהוּא תַּכְלִית הַתִּקּוּן שֶׁל מָשִׁיחַ בֶּן דָּוִד שֶׁנִּתְקַן אָז עַל יְדֵי רֵיחַ בּוֹגְדָיו בְּיֶתֶר שְׂאֵת. — **and that is the ultimate rectification of Messiah son of David, repaired then through the fragrance of His traitors with surpassing power.** עוֹד אִיתָא בַּלִּקּוּטִים מֵרַבִּי פִּנְחָס זִכְרוֹנוֹ לִבְרָכָה לְחַיֵּי הָעוֹלָם הַבָּא: — **Furthermore, it states in the Likkutim from Rabbi Pinchas of blessed memory for the World to Come:** שֶׁבְּנֵרוֹת חֲנֻכָּה הַהָאָרָה מֵאוֹר הַגָּנוּז לַצַּדִּיקִים לֶעָתִיד לָבֹא, — **that in the Chanukah lights the radiance is from the Primordial Light hidden for the righteous in the Future to Come,** וְהוּא גַּם כֵּן עַל רֶמֶז הַנִּזְכָּר לְעֵיל, — **and this likewise corresponds to the aforementioned allusion,** כְּאָמְרָם (חֲגִיגָה י״ב עַמּוּד א׳): [622] — **as they said (Chagigah 12a):** "כֵּינָן שֶׁנִּסְתַּכֵּל הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא בְּדוֹר הַמַּבּוּל

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ancestors, and let them rebuke you.'"

[620] **Berakhot 34b:27**: "Having mentioned Rabbi Ḥanina ben Dosa in our mishna, the Gemara proceeds to further praise the efficacy of his prayer: The Sages taught: There was an incident where Rabban Gamliel's son fell ill. Rabban Gamliel dispatched two scholars to Rabbi Ḥanina ben Dosa to pray for mercy and healing on his behalf. When Rabbi Ḥanina ben Dosa saw them approaching, he went up to the attic on the roof of his house and prayed for mercy on his behalf. Upon his descent, he said to the messengers: You may go and return to Rabban Gamliel, as the fever has already left his son and he has been healed. The messengers asked him: How do you know? Are you a prophet? He replied to them: I am neither a prophet nor son of a prophet (see Amos 7:14), but I have received a tradition with regard to this indication: If my prayer is fluent in my mouth as I recite it and there are no errors, I know that my prayer is accepted. And if not, I know that my prayer is rejected. The Gemara relates that these messengers sat and wrote and approximated that precise moment when Rabbi Ḥanina ben Dosa told them this. When they came before Rabban Gamliel and related all that had happened and showed him what they had written, Rabban Gamliel said to them: I swear by the Temple service that in the time you wrote you were neither earlier or later; rather, this is how the event transpired: Precisely at that moment his fever broke and he asked us for water to drink."

[621] **Yoma 86a**: 'Rabbi Yoḥanan said: What is an example of desecration of God's name? For example, someone like me, if I would walk four cubits without Torah and without phylacteries, and the onlookers did not know that it is only on account of my body's weakness, that would be a desecration of God's name. Yitzḥak from the school of Rabbi Yannai said: Any case when one's friends are embarrassed on account of his reputation, meaning his friends are embarrassed due to things they hear about him, this is a desecration of God's name. Rav Naḥman bar Yitzḥak said: One creates a profanation of God's name, for example, when people say about him: May his Master forgive so-and-so for the sins he has done.'

[622] **Chagigah 12a**: 'The Gemara answers: This should be understood in accordance with Rabbi Elazar, as Rabbi Elazar said: The light that the Holy One, Blessed be He, created on the first day was not that of the sun but a different kind of light, through which man could observe from one end of the world to the other. But when the Holy One, Blessed be He, looked upon the generation of the Flood and the generation of the Dispersion and saw that their ways were corrupt and that they might misuse this light for evil, He arose and concealed it from them, as it is stated: "And from the wicked their light is withheld" (Job 38:15).'

וְכוּלֵּיהּ שֶׁמַּעֲשֵׂיהֶן מְקֻלְקָלִים, — **"Once the Holy One looked upon the Generation of the Flood, etc., that their deeds were corrupted,** עָמַד וּגְנָזוֹ מֵהֶן; וּלְמִי גְּנָזוֹ — **He arose and concealed it from them; –** לַצַּדִּיקִים לֶעָתִיד וְהֵינוּ הָאָרַת אוֹרוֹ שֶׁל, — **and for whom did He hide it — for the righteous in the Future to Come",** לָבֹא", מָשִׁיחַ, שֶׁיִּתְוַדַּע שֶׁגַּם כָּל הַקִּלְקוּלִים הָמָּה בְּהַשְׁגָּחָה. — **which refers to the light of Messiah, wherein it will be recognized that all downfalls were under providence.**

An unpurified heart can misuse inward illumination

A desire's claimed divine origin does not authorize it

כִּי עַל יְדֵי זֶה אָסְרָם אֵין הָעוֹלָם כְּדַאי לָזֶה,[623, 624] — **However, the world is not worthy of this revelation currently,** יוּכְלוּ חַס וְשָׁלוֹם לְהָקֵל בָּנֶפֶשׁ לְוַלּוֹמַר "לֵית דִּין וְלֵית דַּיָּן", — **because through this people might Heaven forbid treat sin lightly saying "there is no justice and no Judge",** וְיַעֲשֶׂה מַה שֶּׁלִּבּוֹ חָפֵץ; — **and do whatever his heart desires;** וְלָכֵן גְּנָזוֹ רַק לַצַּדִּיקִים לֶעָתִיד לָבֹא, — **and therefore He concealed it only for the Future,** כְּמַה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: "מָה רַב טוּבְךָ אֲשֶׁר צָפַנְתָּ לִירֵאֶיךָ — **– as Scripture states: "How abundant is Your goodness which You have hidden for those who fear You" —** הֵינוּ לַיָּרֵא וְחָרֵד בְּנַפְשׁוֹ שֶׁאֵינוֹ יוֹצֵא יְדֵי חוֹבָתוֹ תָּמִיד, — **meaning to one who is fearful and trembling in his soul that he never adequately fulfills his duty,** כִּי עַל יְדֵי יִרְאָה בָּא לִתְשׁוּבָה, וְיוֹדֵעַ בְּנַפְשׁוֹ שֶׁמַּעֲשָׂיו אֵינָם כַּהֲגָן, — **knowing in his heart that his deeds are imperfect,** מִפְּנֵי שֶׁלֹּא יָשְׁרוּ מַעֲשָׂיו בְּעֵינָיו לְנֶגֶד גְּדֻלַּת הַבּוֹרֵא, — **for through awe he comes to repentance because his deeds are not upright in his eyes before the Creator's greatness,** אֲלֵיהֶן נִצְפַּן הָאָרָה זוֹ: כִּי גַּם כָּל הַבְּגִידוֹת הֵמָּה בְּהַשְׁגָּחָה, — **for him is this illumination hidden away: that all betrayals are under providence and all is rectified to become good as mentioned.** וְנִתְתַּקֵּן הַכֹּל לִהְיוֹת טוֹב כַּנַּזְכָּר לְעֵיל.

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[623] **Dover Tzedek, Kuntres Ner HaMitzvot 2:255**: "The light is wisdom, as it says, 'Torah is light.' When it comes forth from the place of fear, it sees from one end of the world to the other. He looked upon the wicked and concealed it, because it must not be revealed to the wicked, as explained above. If someone whose heart is not sufficiently pure attains the wisdom that flows from the heart, tainted words will flow from his heart according to his heart's own defects. The heart must be joined to God like twins, as explained above, so that only what is God's will flows from it."
Dover gives a reason for the restriction on hidden light: inward fluency can carry the heart's remaining defects. Its requirement of fear and purity illuminates why Rav Tzadok reserves the providential insight for someone moved toward repentance by fear, rather than for someone looking for permission to follow desire.

[624] **Mei HaShiloach, Volume I, Genesis, Bereshit 11**: "'The human said: the woman whom You gave to be with me—she gave me …'. In truth, Adam's mistake in his sin arose from God's saying, 'I shall make him a helper corresponding to him.' When Adam was forbidden to eat from the tree of knowledge, he was very afraid: he said that God surely forbade it only because He knew there was a deficiency within him. But when God created Eve and gave her to him as a helper, meaning that he should follow her judgment—as Abraham was told, 'Whatever Sarah tells you, listen to her voice'—his mind was reassured. This was Adam's claim: 'The woman whom You gave to be with me,' meaning that he was permitted to eat according to her word. His sin, however, was as in the Talmud's rule: a scholar who comes with a ruling is heeded if he stated it before the event, but is not heeded if he states it after the event. For after he has already acted, he has a personal interest in the matter. So here: although Adam needed to listen to her, once she had already acted he should not have listened when she gave him food to eat. Her claim was, 'The serpent deceived me, and I ate.' It brought enticement and desire into the heart; the reasoning was that this desire came from God. But since the human himself had named it nachash, and nachash means a deceiver—like a diviner who deceives and pretends, capable of showing another something that appears to come from God—he needed to guard himself against error, since he knew that error existed."
Mei HaShiloach supplies a concrete example of the misuse Rav Tzadok warns against. Adam reasons from a genuine divine gift to a mistaken permission; an already committed action and a deceptive desire compromise that reasoning. The passage therefore preserves the need to test an apparent inspiration instead of treating its claimed divine origin as sufficient. It illuminates the practical force of "the world is not worthy of this" without denying the retrospective insight reserved for repentance.

Recognizing the gift makes the work genuinely entrusted to the person

Even the power to perform a commandment is received

וְהָרֶמֶז הַזֶּה שֶׁהַכֹּל מֵהַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ הוּא בְּנֵרוֹת הַמְּנוֹרָה,[625,626] — **And this allusion that everything is from the Blessed Name resides in the Menorah's lights,** דְּאִיתָא (שְׁמוֹת רַבָּה סוֹף פָּרָשָׁה ל״ו):[627] — **for it states (Shemot Rabbah, end of Parashah 36):** "וְהָאָרֶץ הֵאִירָה מִכְּבוֹדוֹ", מֵאִיר לָעוֹלָם, שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: — **He illuminates the cosmos, as it is said: "And the earth shone from His glory",** "וְיִקְחוּ אֵלֶיךָ שֶׁמֶן זָךְ", וְאָמַר לְיִשְׂרָאֵל: — **yet He said to Israel: "That they take to you pure olive oil, etc.",** "לְמַעֲשֵׂה יָדֶיךָ תִּכְסְפוּ", הֲרֵי: — **behold: "You yearn for the work of Your hands",** שֶׁרוֹצֶה שֶׁנָּאִיר לְפָנָיו; — **desiring that we illuminate before Him;** וְהוּא לְעֵדוּת שֶׁהַשְּׁכִינָה שׁוֹרָה בְּיִשְׂרָאֵל עַל יְדֵי נֵר מַעֲרָבִי כְּמוֹ שֶׁפָּתוּב בַּגְּמָרָא; — **and it serves as testimony that the Shechinah rests in Israel via the Western Lamp as stated in the Gemara;** וְהַיְנוּ שֶׁגַּם מַעֲשֵׂה מִצְוַת הַנֵּרוֹת הוּא מִצַּד הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ שֶׁשּׁוֹלֵחַ הָאָרָה בַּלֵּב, — **meaning that the performance of the mitzvah of the lights is itself from the Blessed Name Who sends illumination into the heart,** רַק שֶׁמְּכַנֶּה אוֹתוֹ עַל מַעֲשֵׂה הָאָדָם. — **only that He attributes it to the physical actions of man.**

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[625] **Likkutei Maamarim, Compositions on the Festivals 15:3**: "The intention is as stated: Torah's purpose is that everything be in Israel's hands. This apparently resembles the way of the nations, who say, 'My strength and the power of my hand made this wealth for me,' while Israel takes the opposite position, recognizing that everything comes from God. Yet because the nations, thinking that effort was in their hands, did not wish to accept the effort of Torah, their very notion of effort instead brought an absence of effort. Israel, possessing the recognition of an absence of independent effort, accepted effort. From this it follows that their claim is justified: it should be considered theirs and their effort. This is like the Sages' statement, 'Eventually it is called his Torah.'"

The full Likkutei passage begins with these same Temple lamps and the divine longing for human service. Its later argument explains why acknowledgment of dependence does not erase human credit: Israel accepts work precisely while recognizing its power as given. This develops the final distinction between God's illumination and its designation as a human act. The contrast with the nations is the author's theological argument, not an added claim about modern populations.

[626] **Tiferet Yosef, Sukkot 8**: "On Shabbat, by contrast, it says, 'On the seventh day you shall cease.' This points to what we say: 'On the seventh day He ascended and sat upon His throne of glory.' On Shabbat a person must recognize that he possesses no power of action independently, for even his power to act comes from God. He recognizes that he must take no confidence in his own independent strength even from the deeds of the commandments, because this power too comes from God. Thus the Midrash expounds 'Who has preceded Me, that I should repay him? Everything under the heavens is Mine': 'Who praised Me before I gave him a soul?'"

Tiferet makes Rav Tzadok's closing point explicit at the level of religious achievement: a mitzvah does not create an exception to dependence on God. The full target first describes active weekday work that sanctifies the body and then this Shabbat recognition. The comparison therefore preserves both actual service and the refusal to claim its power as independent.

[627] **Shemot Rabbah 36:4** (excerpt): "He illuminates the world, as it is written, 'The earth shone from His glory' (Ezekiel 43:2), yet He said to Israel, 'They shall bring you pure olive oil.' Thus, 'You yearn for the work of Your hands.'"

Chanukah Ois 7

Chanukah as Initiation into the Light of Torah

Education endures because desire develops the initial seed of Torah into repeatedly renewed understanding.

Chanukah as Initiation into the Light of Torah

שֵׁם "חֲנֻכָּה" הוּא לְשׁוֹן חִנּוּךְ, — **The name "Chanukah" is an expression of initiation (chinuch),** עַל שֶׁהָיָה אָז חֲנֻכַּת הַמִּזְבֵּחַ שֶׁשִּׁקְּצוּם מַלְכֵי יָוָן. — **because then occurred the dedication of the Altar which the Greek monarchs had desecrated.** וְאִיתָא בִּמְגִלַּת תַּעֲנִית: שֶׁלֹּא הָיָה לָהֶם מְנוֹרָה — **And it is found in Megillat Ta'anit:** וְשַׁפּוּדִין שֶׁל בַּרְזֶל הָיָה בְיָדָם וְחִפּוּם בְּעֵץ וְהִדְלִיקוּ בָהֶם. — **that they had no Menorah to kindle, and iron spits were in their hands, which they covered with wood and kindled in them.** וּבַפְּסִיקְתָא (פֶּרֶק ב׳) אִיתָא רַק — **And in the Pesikta (Chapter 2) this reason alone is recorded** לְהַדְלִיק, שֶׁמָּצְאוּ שַׁפּוּדִין שֶׁל בַּרְזֶל, טַעַם זֶה עַל נֵס חֲנֻכָּה:[628] — **for the Chanukah miracle: that they found iron spits,** וּמִנֵּס הַשֶּׁמֶן אֵינוֹ מַזְכִּיר כְּלוּם; — **and of the miracle of the oil it makes no mention at all;** וּכְפִי הַנִּרְאֶה הָיָה אָז עִקַּר הַחֲנֻכָּה בִּנֵרוֹת הַמְּנוֹרָה, — **and as it appears the core dedication then was in the lights of the Menorah,** כִּי טָמְאוּ כָּל כְּלֵי הַמִּקְדָּשׁ וְלֹא הָיוּ יְכוֹלִים לְהַקְרִיב קָרְבָּנוֹת, — **for they had defiled all sacred vessels of the Temple and could not offer sacrifices,** רַק שֶׁהִדְלִיקוּ הַמְּנוֹרָה עַל יְדֵי נֵס שֶׁמָּצְאוּ שַׁפּוּדִין שֶׁל בַּרְזֶל, — **only lighting the Menorah through the miracle of finding iron spits,** וְעוֹשִׂין חֲנֻכָּה לְזֵכֶר הַנֵּס מֵחֲנֻכַּת הַמְּנוֹרָה. — **and we observe Chanukah to commemorate the miracle of the Menorah's dedication.**

The first taste grows through sustained desire

The first desire prepares an enduring personal Torah

וְעִנְיַן "חֲנֻכָּה" הוּא הַתְחָלָה מַה שֶּׁהָאָדָם מַתְחִיל לְחַנֵּךְ עַצְמוֹ,[629,630] — **And the idea of Chanukah is an initiation wherein a person begins to train himself,** וּמִזֶּה נִשְׁאָר קָבוּעַ לְעוֹלְמֵי עַד — **and from this remains permanently fixed for all eternity** עַל יְדֵי שֶׁמַּרְגִּיל עַצְמוֹ בִּתְשׁוּקָה וְרָצוֹן שֶׁל יְמֵי הַנְּעוּרִים, — **through accustoming himself with the yearning and passion of youthful days,** כְּמַה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: "חֲנֹךְ לַנַּעַר עַל פִּי דַרְכּוֹ, גַּם כִּי יַזְקִין לֹא יָסוּר מִמֶּנָּה".[631] — **as Scripture states: "Train a youth according to his way, even when he grows old he will not depart from**

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[628] **Pesikta Rabbati 2:1**: 'Why do we kindle lights on Chanukah? Because when the sons of the Hasmonean High Priest entered the Sanctuary after defeating the Greeks, they found there eight iron spits (shipudim shel barzel), which they grooved and overlaid with wood, and in them they kindled the Menorah lights for eight days.'

[629] **Mei HaShiloach, Volume I, Genesis, Bereshit 15**: "'This is the book of the generations of the human; in the likeness of God He made …'. The inner meaning of image and likeness is this: image is life itself without any expansion. A baby immediately upon birth, in its first moment, is called image. Afterwards, when it begins to extend itself through its desires—for example the desire to eat, through which it eats—its life continually increases until it grows in breadth and stature. This expansion is called likeness. So too in the soul: the first drop of Torah that enters a person is called image, and the desire with which he longs for Torah is called likeness. Through desire, more Torah is continually added to him. This is 'On the day God created the human, in the likeness of God …': the essential purpose of the human's creation was that he should continually desire an increase of Torah. This is 'Serving Torah is greater than studying it': serving Torah is called desire. 'This is the book of the generations of the human' means that if he merits image and likeness in this way, he will continually see renewal in Torah, count his years and generations, and lengthen his days."
Mei HaShiloach gives a developmental account of the lasting beginning: a first drop is not the full stature, and desire is what continually grows it. This illuminates Rav Tzadok's use of a youth's education as the model for a dedication whose Torah light remains through later years.

[630] **Tzidkat HaTzadik 184:1**: "The beginning of words of Torah is desire, as it says, 'His desire is in the Torah of the Lord.' Then it is called the Lord's Torah, as in Avodah Zarah 19a; afterwards comes attainment, called 'and in his Torah he meditates.' Desire is greater, as I heard concerning 'A good name is better than good oil' and the Sages' saying that serving Torah scholars is greater than studying. Nevertheless, this is at the beginning and in youth, when desire is strong. Thus the end of Shabbat says, 'Youth is a garland of roses …'; see there its praise of youth and its unfavorable description of old age, when desire is extinguished. Yet the Sages also praise aged Torah scholars, and elders are praised elsewhere. In truth they said, 'I learned much from my teachers … and from my students more …'. 'From my teachers' refers to the beginning and desire. After the teacher's passing, when it is called 'his Torah' because he toils himself to teach others, he then learns more and increases wisdom. Attainment, however, comes from God, for 'the Lord gives wisdom,' and everything is in Heaven's hands except fear of Heaven. The latter is the receptive, feminine attribute and the awakening from below through desire and will; it is in the person's hands, and therefore is good and great."
Tzidkat distinguishes the beginning's strong desire from later attainment gained through teaching and toil. This explains what can remain from youthful education even as a person's learning matures. The comparison does not require an older learner to reproduce exactly the emotional intensity of the first encounter; the complete target also values the later personal acquisition of Torah.

[631] **Peri Tzadik, Bamidbar 16:1**: "As we heard from our master of Ishbitz, of blessed memory, concerning the Talmud's statement (Bava Metzia 44a): "In your youth you taught us that silver acquires gold; will you now teach us in your old age that gold acquires silver?" In childhood—the years of youth—a longing for holiness is found in a person's heart, from "the kindness of youth"; this is the aspect of silver. Its purpose, however, is that through it he should acquire gold: that he should acquire within his soul the attribute of awe, which, as is known, is alluded to by gold. In his old age he taught, "Gold acquires silver": the ultimate clarification that awe belongs to holiness comes precisely when manifest joy arises from it—"my joy came from my awe." The soul is then perfected in complete holiness, when the holiness corresponding to the three holy patriarchs is completed within it."

it". וְיֵשׁ לְהָבִין: לָמָּה עוֹשִׂין זֵכֶר לַחֲנֻכַּת הַמְּנוֹרָה שֶׁהָיָה בִּימֵי הַחַשְׁמוֹנָאִים — **And one must understand: why do we make a commemoration for the Menorah's dedication in the Hasmonean era,** וְאֵין עוֹשִׂין זֵכֶר לַחֲנֻכַּת הַמִּשְׁכָּן וַחֲנֻכַּת הַמִּקְדָּשׁ שֶׁהָיָה קְדֻשָּׁה קְבוּעָה לְדוֹרוֹת? — **and make no commemoration for the dedication of the Tabernacle and the Temple which was an established sanctity for generations?** וְיֵשׁ לוֹמַר שֶׁכְּבָר זָכַרְנוּ מַה שֶּׁכָּתוּב בְּמִדְרָשׁ רַבָּה — **And one can answer, for we already cited what is written in Midrash Rabbah** אַהֲרֹן מֵצֵר עַל שֶׁלֹּא הִקְרִיב בַּחֲנֻכַּת הַנְּשִׂיאִים, — **that Aaron was distressed over not having offered sacrifices in the dedication of the Princes,** וְאָמַר לוֹ הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא: "לִגְדוֹלָה מִזּוֹ אַתָּה מְתֻקָּן וְכוּלַּיהּ", — **and the Holy One said to him: "For greater than this are you prepared, etc.,** הַקָּרְבָּנוֹת כָּל זְמַן שֶׁבֵּית הַמִּקְדָּשׁ קַיָּם הֵם נוֹהֲגִים, אֲבָל הַנֵּרוֹת לְעוֹלָם וְכוּלַּיהּ"; — **sacrifices apply as long as the Temple stands, but the lights are forever, etc.";** וְכָתַב הָרַמְבַּ"ן שֶׁמְּרַמֵּז עַל נֵרוֹת חֲנֻכָּה שֶׁהֵם נוֹהֲגִין לְעוֹלָם. — **and the Ramban wrote that this alludes to the Chanukah lights which endure forever.**

Torah's ancestral stages refine how it is transmitted

Torah reveals why restraint itself can serve kindness

For behold, the seven lamps of the Menorah allude to the expansion of the light of Torah דְּהִנֵּה עִנְיַן שִׁבְעַת הַנֵּרוֹת שֶׁל הַמְּנוֹרָה מְרַמְּזִים עַל הִתְפַּשְׁטוּת אוֹר הַתּוֹרָה[632, 633] — **throughout all seven holy sefirot corresponding to the Seven Shepherds who form the chariot for the seven sefirot,** בְּכָל שֶׁבַע הַמִּדּוֹת הַקְּדוֹשׁוֹת נֶגֶד שִׁבְעַת הָרוֹעִים שֶׁהֵם מֶרְכָּבָה לְשֶׁבַע הַמִּדּוֹת, — **and in all of them resides the expansion of Torah wisdom alluded to by the Menorah situated in the south, –** וּבְכֻלָּם נִמְצָא הִתְפַּשְׁטוּת חָכְמַת הַתּוֹרָה הַמְּרֻמָּז לַמְּנוֹרָה בַּדָּרוֹם, כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב (בָּבָא בַּתְרָא כ"ה עַמּוּד ב')[634]: "דָּרִים וְכוּלַּיהּ". — **as written (Bava Batra 25b): "He who desires wisdom should face south, etc."** (בְּרֵאשִׁית רַבָּה פָּרָשָׁה ס"א)[635] וְהֵינוּ כִּי בְּאַבְרָהָם אָבִינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם אִיתָא — **And that**

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[632] **Poked Akarim 4:6**: "Isaac is the beginning of Torah's disclosure, for Torah comes forth from the side of might. Although Abraham himself fulfilled the whole Torah and his two kidneys flowed with Torah, the principal meaning of the name Torah is instruction, directing a way for others. This was not yet clarified in Abraham, for nothing remained among all those he taught. Only what he later taught his son Isaac endured forever. In Isaac we find no further 'souls that he made' and taught to others, because the power of restraint was already within him: to limit the outflow, so as not to teach and bestow a Torah of kindness upon those outside or unworthy of it. He taught only his children. Yet even among them was one unworthy, although he is called an apostate Israelite in Kiddushin 18a: he possessed a Jewish root from birth. Thus his head is buried in the Cave of Machpelah in Isaac's bosom, on account of 'the game in his mouth': the souls of Rabbi Akiva and Rabbi Meir, roots of Oral Torah. The Mishnah is the foundation of Oral Torah; an anonymous Mishnah is Rabbi Meir, and all follow Rabbi Akiva's approach. Thus even within him there was some attachment to Torah, but ultimately there was refuse as well. Torah's completeness was in Jacob, whose offspring were whole: completeness in truth, which is Torah. Nevertheless, it comes forth from the side of might; the root of that emergence had already begun in Isaac."

Poked explains the succession that the origin names: Abraham's knowledge expands, Isaac gives it a bounded line of transmission, and Jacob brings that line to completeness. It therefore clarifies the function of might and truth within the spread of Torah, rather than treating the three patriarchs as interchangeable holders of knowledge. Its statements about the earlier pupils and Esau's spiritual roots remain the author's interpretive account.

[633] **Tiferet Yosef, Shavuot 2**: "This is called the threefold Torah. For Torah is what instructs and reveals what had been hidden and unknown, as the Zohar says. 'Threefold' means that the person has returned through his work to the first kindness. Although the Zohar says that Torah comes forth from the side of might, this is before he breaks through the concealment. Then it seems to him that God's light and concealment are two opposites; this is 'it comes forth from the side of might.' Afterwards he sees that everything is in truth His kindness. The concealment too exists because God is abundantly kind and wanted the person to have a share in the service he performs. Therefore He hid that kindness from him so that there would be room for work. Then it is called the threefold Torah."

Tiferet expounds the same phrase about Torah emerging from might and explains its place within a three-stage movement. This makes the origin's growth from Abraham's kindness through Isaac's fear more intelligible: the restriction creates room for acquired understanding, and that understanding can reveal the kindness within it. The target's final discussion also distinguishes Abraham's personal attainment from its fixed inheritance after three generations.

[634] **Bava Batra 25b**: 'Rabbi Yitzḥak says: One who wishes to become wise should face south, and one who wishes to become wealthy should face north. And your mnemonic for this is that in the Temple the Table, which symbolized blessing and abundance, was in the north, and the Candelabrum, which symbolized the light of wisdom, was in the south of the Sanctuary. And Rabbi Yehoshua ben Levi says: One should always face south, as once he becomes wise he will subsequently also become wealthy, as it is stated with regard to the Torah: "Length of days is in her right hand; in her left hand are riches and honor" (Proverbs 3:16).'

[635] **Bava Batra 25b**: 'Rabbi Yitzḥak says: One who wishes to become wise should face south, and one who wishes to become wealthy should face north. And your mnemonic for this is that in the Temple the Table, which symbolized blessing and abundance, was in the north, and the Candelabrum, which symbolized the light of wisdom, was in the south of the Sanctuary. And Rabbi Yehoshua ben Levi says: One should always face south, as once he becomes wise he will subsequently also become wealthy, as it is stated with regard to the Torah: "Length of days is in her right hand; in her left hand are riches and honor" (Proverbs 3:16).'

[636] **Bereshit Rabbah 61:1** (excerpt): "'He meditates in His Torah' (Psalms 1:2). Rabbi Shimon said: Abraham's father

is because regarding Abraham our Father, peace be upon him, it is stated (Bereishit Rabbah, Parashah 61) שֶׁזִּמֵּן לוֹ הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא שְׁנֵי כְלְיוֹתָיו כִּשְׁנֵי רַבָּנִים וְהָיוּ נוֹבְעוֹת וּמְלַמְּדוֹת אוֹתוֹ חָכְמָה, **— that the Holy One designated his kidneys like two rabbis welling forth and teaching him wisdom,** וְגַם הַשְּׁנֵי אֲלָפִים תּוֹרָה הִתְחִילוּ מֵאַבְרָהָם אָבִינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם. **— and the two thousand years of Torah also began from Abraham our Father.** וּבְיִצְחָק אִיתָא (זֹהַר חֵלֶק ג׳ פ׳ סוֹף עַמּוּד ב׳)[637]: "אוֹרַיְתָא מִסִּטְרָא דִּגְבוּרָה קָאָתְיָא", **— And in Isaac it is stated (Zohar Part III, 80b): "Torah issues from the side of Gevurah",** שֶׁהִיא יִרְאָה מִדָּתוֹ שֶׁל יִצְחָק, **— which is fear, the attribute of Isaac,** וְכָל מַה שֶּׁנִּתְפַּשְּׁטָה יוֹתֵר חָכְמַת הַתּוֹרָה בְּהַמִּדּוֹת הוּא בְּתֹקֶף הִתְלַהֲבוּת בְּיוֹתֵר. **— and the more Torah wisdom permeates the character traits, the greater the fiery fervor.** וּבְיַעֲקֹב שֶׁמִּדָּתוֹ אֱמֶת נִתְפַּשְּׁטָה הָאָרַת הַתּוֹרָה בְּיוֹתֵר, כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב **— And in Jacob whose attribute is truth, the light of Torah expanded most intensely,** (בְּרָכוֹת ה׳ עַמּוּד ב׳)[638]: "אֱמֶת זוֹ תּוֹרָה, שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: 'אֱמֶת קְנֵה וְאַל תִּמְכֹּר'". **— as written (Berachot 5b): "Truth is Torah, as it is said: 'Acquire truth and sell it not'".**

The sown light produces more Torah within the heart

וּבְיוֹסֵף כְּתִיב: "כִּי בֶן זְקֻנִים הוּא לוֹ"[639], **— And regarding Joseph it is written: "For he was the son of his old age to him",** וְאִיתָא בִּבְרֵאשִׁית רַבָּה: שֶׁכָּל הֲלָכוֹת שֶׁמָּסְרוּ שֵׁם וְעֵבֶר לְיַעֲקֹב מָסָרָן לוֹ; **— and it states in Bereishit Rabbah: that all halachot which Shem and Eber transmitted to Jacob he transmitted to him;** וְגַם אָמְרוּ (תַּעֲנִית ט״ו עַמּוּד א׳)[640]: "צַדִּיקִים לְאוֹרָה", דִּכְתִיב: "אוֹר זָרֻעַ לַצַּדִּיק", **— and they also said (Ta'anit 15a): "The righteous are for light", as it is written: "Light is sown for the righteous",** וְעַל יְדֵי הָאוֹר הַנָּזְרוּעַ בִּבְחִינַת צַדִּיק נִשְׁפַּע וְנִתְפַּשֵּׁט הָאָרַת הַתּוֹרָה בְּשֶׁפַע רַב כַּיָּדוּעַ. **— and through the light sown in the aspect of Tzaddik the radiance of Torah is channeled and expanded in great abundance, as is known.**

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did not teach him, and he had no teacher. From where, then, did he learn Torah? Rather, the Holy One, blessed be He, appointed his two kidneys like two teachers, and they flowed forth and taught him Torah and wisdom. This is what is written: 'I bless Hashem who counseled me; even at night my kidneys instruct me' (Psalms 16:7)."

[637] **Zohar, Kedoshim 3:12-13**: "Said R. Jose: 'But it says here "the fear of the Lord", and not "the Torah"?' He replied: 'It means the same thing, because the Torah comes from the side of Geburah (Might).' Said R. Jose: 'Rather derive it from here: "The fear of the Lord is the beginning of wisdom" (Ibid. 111, 10). It is written: "The fear of the Lord is pure",' and the Torah is called "holiness", as it is written, "I the Lord am holy", and the Torah is the supernal holy Name. Therefore he who studies it is first purified and then sanctified. We have learnt that the holiness of the Torah surpasses all other sanctifications, and the holiness of the superior recondite wisdom is highest of all.'"

[638] **Berakhot 5b**: 'Rabbi Yoḥanan said to him: What is your source for this? Granted, if one engages in Torah and acts of charity, his transgressions are forgiven, as it is written: "With mercy and truth, iniquity is expiated" (Proverbs 16:6); mercy refers to acts of charity, as it is stated: "He who pursues charity and mercy finds life, charity and honor" (Proverbs 21:21), mercy and charity are listed together. And truth refers to Torah, as it is stated: "Buy truth and do not sell it; also wisdom, guidance and understanding" (Proverbs 23:23). However, from where is it derived that the transgressions of one who buries his sons are also forgiven?'

[639] **Resisei Layla 53:1**: "A righteous person is one whose actions are bounded: even if the heart is not yet whole and upright, he strengthens his understanding over his inclination so as not to be drawn after it, and is careful in practice with all 248 positive and 365 negative commandments. Deeds bring holiness to the heart; hence we bless, 'Who sanctified us with His commandments.' Holiness means separation: separating the heart from the desires of this world. Through this he attains the sown light—new understandings of Oral Torah that illuminate the heart. For 'light' is Torah, and Written Torah is 'the truth that sprouts from the earth': it is sown in Israel's hearts to grow from them a very great addition, much greater than the original seed. This accords with the view in Gittin 60b that most Torah is oral. Even the view that most is written does not dispute the reality; it holds that because nothing is without an allusion in Torah and everything is expounded from the verses, permission to expound it makes it as though explicitly written. Yet the written text itself is certainly small in extent, and 'its measure is longer than the earth' applies chiefly to its oral explanation growing from Israel's hearts through the written light sown within them."

Resisei interprets the very light/ righteous-person saying quoted here and explains both the soil and the growth: disciplined deeds prepare the heart, and the written seed yields expanding oral explanation. This supplies a precise meaning for the origin's "great abundance." The full target's later distinction between light and joy was read; the quotation does not equate bounded action with already completed inner uprightness.

[640] **Taanit 15a**: 'Rav Naḥman bar Yitzḥak said: I too say a similar idea. Not all are fit for light, and not all are fit for gladness. The righteous are fit to be rewarded with light, and the upright are fit to be rewarded with gladness. The righteous are fit to be rewarded with light, as it is written: "Light is sown for the righteous" (Psalms 97:11), and the upright are fit to be rewarded with gladness, as it is written, in the same verse: "And gladness for the upright in heart."'

David's inward understanding opens a nonprophetic teaching lineage

Moses' direct illumination still has a task to perform

וּמֹשֶׁה וְאַהֲרֹן הֵמָּה הַשֹּׁרֶשׁ שֶׁל תּוֹרָה שֶׁבִּכְתָב וְתוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה. וְדָוִד הַמֶּלֶךְ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם הוּא מֶרְכָּבָה לִמְדַּת מַלְכוּת, "פֶּה[641, 642] — **And Moses and Aaron are the fundamental roots of the Written Torah and Oral Torah. –** תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה קְרֵינַן לַהּ". — **And David the King, peace be upon him, is the chariot for the sefirah of Malchut, "The mouth is the Oral Torah we call it".**

Longing builds a vessel within the heart

Sincere longing has value before learning bears visible fruit

כִּי הַנֵּר שְׁמִינִי מְרַמֵּז עַל בִּינָה לִבָּא, וּבְחֲנֻכָּה מַדְלִיקִין שְׁמוֹנָה נֵרוֹת,[643, 644] — **And on Chanukah we kindle eight lights,**

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641 **Takanat HaShavin 6:93**: "Just as Moses was the master of all prophets, David was the master of all who possessed holy inspiration. With him began the spread of teaching Torah and wisdom in great academies with many students, through a means other than prophecy. This came through the awakening of understanding in the heart, from which he came to establish the yoke of repentance. In Rabbi Yehudah HaNasi's generation, all six directions of the attribute of repentance were clarified—all the powers potentially contained within them. Therefore the totality of Oral Torah was then revealed in the composition of the Mishnah, which potentially includes everything that later generations' sages will innovate."

Takanat explains the terse identification of David, mouth, and Oral Torah through a particular mode of teaching: understanding awakens in the heart and spreads without being a prophetic message. Its contrast with Moses and its continuation to Rabbi's Mishnah make the distinct roles named in Rav Tzadok's paragraph concrete. This is the author's account of the spiritual roots of those teaching lineages.

642 **Tiferet Yosef, Talmud Anthology, Taanit 10**: "This is the question, 'In what did Moses serve?' Concerning Moses it is written that he was heavy of mouth and tongue. My holy grandfather explained: the Talmud says that when a person comes into the world, an angel strikes his mouth and he forgets what he learned. In his mother's womb he sees the light explicitly, as it says, 'Would that I were as in earlier months … when His lamp shone over my head.' Afterwards, at his entry into the world, the angel strikes his mouth and he forgets: God's light is concealed from him. With Moses there was no striking of his mouth, and he saw God's light explicitly; therefore he is called heavy of mouth and tongue. Thus the Talmud asks, 'In what did Moses serve?' What was his service, since he was at the height of completeness and saw the light explicitly? The Talmud says that fifty gates of understanding were created and all but one were given to Moses. 'For he too is flesh'—beshaggam—is expounded as Moses; my holy grandfather said that this proves he was the greatest of created beings. What, then, was his service? It answers: in a white robe without a hem. Imra means an edge or lip: Moses' service was to show Israel that nothing in this world is complete, so that even someone at the height of completeness still needs service. Thus the Midrash says, 'Go down, for your people have become corrupt': you and they are in descent. They were showing him that nothing in this world is complete. This will be repaired in the future, as the Zohar says: Moses will unite the Holy One and the congregation of Israel as one."

Tiferet develops the Moses component of the origin's list: direct illumination differs from the concealed light normally recovered through learning. It also asks what work remains for Moses, preventing a reading in which being a root of Torah means having no further service. The comparison does not claim that this target restates the origin's complete assignment of all seven figures.

643 **Tzidkat HaTzadik 251:1**: "Through desire, a person becomes a vessel for the Divine Presence to dwell within his heart. This is the contribution for the Tabernacle: 'From every person whose heart moves him.' Through Israel's generous heart the Tabernacle is built, the dwelling of the Divine Presence below. In this, each person is according to what he measures within his heart: one person's awareness of God's dwelling in his heart is unlike another's. According to his heart's generosity, in the strengthening of his desire to attain, so is the dwelling of the Divine Presence."

Tzidkat explains the vessel metaphor in terms of a person's capacity to receive, not merely an external object that holds oil. Its full continuation distinguishes the differing measures of positive attainment from everyone's obligation and capacity to remove evil. That distinction preserves the specific claim about desire without making every kind of desire spiritually sufficient.

644 **Sod Yesharim, Sukkot 65:2**: "The Zohar explains the great preciousness indicated by the river willows, which have neither taste nor fragrance. However intensely a person toils and however much difficulty he bears in Torah, he cannot reach its ultimate extent, as it says, 'Its measure is longer than the earth.' Even after he attains a portion of Torah through much toil, what does he know? As the Zohar says: after a person questions and searches from level to level to the end of all levels, what has he known, observed, or searched out? All is hidden as at first. One cannot reach the ultimate depth of God's will. The more Torah light opens to a person, the more he recognizes that he has not yet begun to attain anything within it. Yet after all this it does not become repulsive to him, so that he would tire of it, Heaven forbid. On the contrary, the more he toils, the more longing is added to his longing; his will and desire continually grow stronger with greater affection and wholehearted simplicity. This proves that within that very desire and will, even while lacking attainment and understanding, every kind of completeness is truly present. All the acquisition and understanding Israel will attain in Torah in the future will come from the will and toil they previously possessed in this world, while still lacking attainment and understanding. Thus that very desire and toil possess completeness even apart from the fruits that later grow through the toil."

Sod explains why Rav Tzadok includes even those unable to hide and study: present achievement is not the only measure of a genuine relation to Torah. The target's test is continued love and effort despite not seeing the desired fruit. Its full continuation contrasts that persistence with a worldly appetite that rejects the whole effort when one pleasure is missing;

because the eighth light alludes to Binah Liba (the understanding heart), שֶׁהוּא הַמָּקוֹר שֶׁל שִׁבְעַת הָאוֹרוֹת וְהֵינוּ הִתְשׁוּקָה וְהָרָצוֹן שֶׁבַּלֵּב לְהַגִּיעַ הַנִּזְכָּרִים, **— which is the supreme source of the seven aforementioned lights,** לְמָאוֹר הַתּוֹרָה שֶׁתִּתְפַּשֵּׁט בַּלֵּב. **— meaning the deep passion and will in the heart to reach the illumination of the Torah so it spreads throughout the heart.** וְעִקַּר הַגַּעֲגּוּעִים וְהַתְּשׁוּקָה בַּלֵּב לִזְכּוֹת לְמָאוֹר הַתּוֹרָה נִתְגַּלָּה אָז בִּימֵי גְּזֵרַת יָוָן, **— And the essence of yearning and passion in the heart to merit the illumination of the Torah was revealed then during the days of Greek oppression,** שֶׁהָיָה לְבַטְּלָם מִתּוֹרָה וּמִצְווֹת; **whose purpose was to strip them of Torah and mitzvot;** וְהָיָה לִבָּם נִשְׁבָּר מְאֹד מִזֶּה, **— and their heart was profoundly broken from this,** שֶׁנִּרְאֶה שֶׁמִּן הַשָּׁמַיִם מְעַכְּבִין מִפֶּנּוּ שֶׁאֵין הַתּוֹרָה וּמִצְווֹת שֶׁלָּהֶם מְקֻבָּל בְּעֵינָיו יִתְבָּרַךְ, **— because it appeared that Heaven was actively withholding favor, as if their Torah and mitzvot were unaccepted in His eyes,** וְהוּא דּוֹמֶה כְּשׁוֹפֵךְ קִיתּוֹן עַל פָּנָיו (בְּסֻכָּה).[645] **— resembling a master who pours a pitcher of water into his servant's face (in Sukkah).** וְעַל יְדֵי זֶה נִתְמָרְמְרוּ וְגָדְלָה הַתְּשׁוּקָה בְּלִבָּם לַעֲסֹק בַּתּוֹרָה בַּסֵּתֶר; **— And through this they were bitterly anguished and yearning swelled in their hearts to engage in Torah in secret;** וְגַם אוֹתָם שֶׁלֹּא יָכְלוּ עוֹד יוֹתֵר לְהַצְנִיעַ עַצְמָם וְלַעֲסֹק בַּתּוֹרָה, **— and even those who could not conceal themselves to study Torah,** גָּדְלָה הַצְּעָקָה וְהַתְּשׁוּקָה בְּלִבָּם לִזְכּוֹת לְמָאוֹר הַתּוֹרָה, **— all the more did the cry and yearning surge within their heart to merit the illumination of the Torah;** וְעַל יְדֵי זֶה זָכוּ לָבֶנֶס שֶׁנִּזְדַּמֵּן לָהֶם הַשַּׁפּוּדִין שֶׁל בַּרְזֶל לַעֲשׂוֹת הַמְּנוֹרָה שֶׁהִיא הַכְּלִי קִבּוּל לְמָאוֹר שִׁבְעַת הַנֵּרוֹת, **— and through this they merited the miracle that there were found for them the iron spits to construct the Menorah, which is the receptive vessel for the radiance of the seven lights,** שֶׁהִיא כְּנֶגֶד הָרָצוֹן שֶׁבַּלֵּב שֶׁעַל יְדֵי זֶה נַעֲשָׂה כְּלִי לִהְיוֹת נִשְׁפָּע בּוֹ מְאוֹר הַתּוֹרָה. **— corresponding to the will in the heart through which a vessel is formed to receive the inflow of Torah's illumination.**

וְיֵשׁ לוֹמַר שֶׁמִּתּוֹךְ בָּזֶה קֻשְׁיַת הַבֵּית יוֹסֵף: לָמָּה עוֹשִׂין שְׁמוֹנָה יְמֵי חֲנֻכָּה, כִּי הַנֵּס מֵהַשֶּׁמֶן הָיָה רַק עַל שִׁבְעָה יָמִים? **— And one can say that through this the famous question of the Beit Yosef is resolved: why do we celebrate eight days of Chanukah, since the miracle of the oil was only for seven days?** דְּיֵשׁ לוֹמַר כִּי נֵס יוֹם הָרִאשׁוֹן הָיָה שֶׁמָּצְאוּ הַשַּׁפּוּדִין שֶׁל בַּרְזֶל **— For one can say that the miracle of the first day was their finding the iron spits,** כַּנִּרְאֶה מֵהַפְּסִיקְתָּא שֶׁזֶּה הָיָה עִקַּר הַנֵּס, **— as is evident from the Pesikta that this was the foundational miracle,** וְהֵינוּ מַה שֶּׁמָּצְאוּ הַכְּלִי לְהַדְלִיק בּוֹ הָאוֹר; **— meaning the very discovery of the vessel in which to kindle the light;** וְאַחַר כָּךְ מַדְלִיקִין שִׁבְעָה יָמִים נֶגֶד הַנֵּס שֶׁל מְצִיאַת הַשֶּׁמֶן **— and afterward we kindle seven days corresponding to the miracle of finding the oil,** לִהְיוֹת הִתְפַּשְׁטוּת עֶצֶם הֶאָרַת חָכְמַת הַתּוֹרָה בְּשֶׁבַע הַמִּדּוֹת הַקְּדוֹשׁוֹת כְּנִזְכָּר. **— representing the expansion of the illumination of Torah wisdom within the seven holy attributes as mentioned.**

The work of hardship can lead toward joy and community

Concealment can turn received light into actively sought Torah

וְאִיתָא (שַׁבָּת י״ג עַמּוּד ב׳): "מִי כָּתַב מְגִלַּת תַּעֲנִית?[646, 647, 648] **— And it states (Shabbat 13b): "Who wrote Megillat**

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it does not praise chosen ignorance or refusal to learn.

[645] **Sukkah 28b**: ‘With regard to studying Torah in the sukka, the Gemara asks: Is that so? Didn’t Rava say: Studying Bible and studying Mishna are undertaken in the sukka; however, analyzing the Mishna must be undertaken outside the sukka. This indicates that one should not analyze Torah in the sukka. The Gemara answers: It is not difficult. This baraita, where it was taught that one studies in the sukka, is with regard to extensive study, i.e., broad study and memorization. That statement of Rava that one should study outside the sukka is with regard to intensive study; such study requires an environment where one can concentrate properly in order to engage in analysis of the Mishna.’

[646] **Shabbat 13b:4**: “The Sages taught: Who wrote Megillas Taanis? They said: Chananyah ben Chizkiyah and his company, who cherished the commemoration of the troubles from which Israel had been saved.”

[647] **Mei HaShiloach, Volume I, Genesis, Vayechi 7**: “God placed the attribute of suffering in Gad’s tribe. This tribe says that it is impossible for words of Torah to enter the human heart without suffering. Ordinarily, a person who suffers does not have much joy and does not have much companionship with others. Therefore they were blessed to possess joy and companionship: he blessed them with connection, that they should form groups upon groups. Thus only in Gad’s tribe do all the numerical orders—hundreds, thousands, and tens—appear together in its enumeration, unlike the other tribes. ‘He will press upon the heel’ means that when Israel needs to be gathered, he will bind and join all Israel, and from him will come every kind of joy to Israel, for Elijah is from Gad’s tribe, as stated in the Midrash.”

Mei HaShiloach identifies hardship as Gad’s particular path of Torah and then specifically repairs its ordinary tendency toward loneliness and diminished joy. This develops the origin’s idea that the “rod” becomes a greater “support.” The claim that Torah requires suffering remains attributed to this tribe’s perspective in the target; it is not generalized into a direction for every person to seek hardship.

[648] **Tzidkat HaTzadik 93:1**: “At first God illuminates for a person. The person is not yet accustomed to this, finds it difficult to receive it as a peg fixed in a secure place that will not move, and loses it. Afterwards the person yearns after it and seeks it, but God does not reopen it for him—as in the plea, ‘Return us …’—except with great difficulty, as in ‘When I wanted, you did not want; now …’. This is the giving of Torah under the mountain held over them like a tub,

Ta'anit? ";אָמְרוּ: חֲנַנְיָה בֶּן חִזְקִיָּה וְסִיעָתוֹ שֶׁהָיוּ מְחַבְּבִין אֶת הַצָּרוֹת — **They said: Chananiah ben Chizkiyah and his faction, who cherished tribulations";** וְלִכְאוֹרָה הָוָה לֵיהּ לוֹמַר שֶׁהָיוּ מְחַבְּבִין אֶת הַנִּסִּים, וּמַה לָּהֶם לְהִתְצָרְפוּת? — **and ostensibly it should have stated that they cherished miracles; what had they to do with tribulations?** אֶמְתָּם עַל יְדֵי הַצָּרוֹת וְהַגְּזֵרוֹת זָכוּ לְמָאוֹר הַתּוֹרָה, — **However, through tribulations and decrees they merited the radiant illumination of the Torah,** וּכְמַה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: "שִׁבְטְךָ וּמִשְׁעַנְתְּךָ הֵמָּה יְנַחֲמֻנִי", — **as Scripture states: "Your rod and Your staff, they comfort me",** שֶׁדַּוְקָא עַל יְדֵי הַשֵּׁבֶט מוּסָר בָּא לָהֶם הַמִּשְׁעָנֶת בְּיֶתֶר שְׂאֵת. — **for specifically through the rod of chastisement did the staff of divine support reach them with heightened vigor.**

וְכִדְאִיתָא בְּפִרְקֵי הֵיכָלוֹת (פֶּרֶק כ״ז)[649] — **And as found in Pirkei Heichalot (Chapter 27):** שְׁבָּבִית שֵׁנִי אַף עַל פִּי שֶׁלֹּא שָׁרְתָה בּוֹ שְׁכִינָה, — **that in the Second Temple even though the Shechinah did not openly abide there,** אֲבָל הֲדָרָה, יְקָרָה, כְּבוֹדָהּ וּגְדֻלָּתָהּ וְכוּלֵיהּ שֶׁל תּוֹרָה לֹא נִתְּנָה עַד בַּיִת שֵׁנִי, עַיֵּן שָׁם; — **yet the majesty, preciousness, glory, and greatness of Torah was not granted until the Second Temple, see there;** וְהַמְּכֻוָּן עַל זְמַן הַחַשְׁמוֹנָאִים שֶׁהָיָה הַתְחָלַת הָאָרַת תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה. — **and this refers to the era of the Hasmoneans which was the dawn of the illumination of the Oral Torah.**

The unwritten miracle marks growth from an already given seed

דְּחֲנֻכָּה הַתְחָלַת הַנִּסִּים שֶׁלֹּא נִתְּנוּ לִכָּתֵב,[650] — **For Chanukah is the inception of the miracles that were not permitted to be recorded in Scripture,** כִּי אֶסְתֵּר הוּא סוֹף הַנִּסִּים שֶׁנִּתְּנוּ לִכָּתֵב (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב יוֹמָא כ״ט עַמּוּד א׳),[651] — **since Esther is the final miracle permitted to be written down (Yoma 29a),** וְהַיְנוּ הַתְחָלַת תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה; — **meaning this marks the commencement of the Oral Torah;** כִּי הִיא הַתְחָלַת מְצָוֹת דְּרַבָּנָן שֶׁהוּא רַק מִשֹּׁרֶשׁ תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה, — **for it is the beginning of Rabbinic mitzvot springing purely from the root of the Oral Torah,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בַּגְּמָרָא עַל בִּרְכַּת נֵר חֲנֻכָּה: "וְהֵיכָן צִוָּנוּ? מִ'לֹּא תָסוּר'". — **as written in the Gemara regarding the blessing over the Chanukah light: "Where did He command us? From 'You shall not deviate'".** וְדַוְקָא אָז עַל יְדֵי הַצַּעַר וְהַגְּזֵרָה נִתְיַסֵּד הַתּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה, — **And precisely then through anguish and decree was the Oral Torah established,** כְּמוֹ[652] שֶׁכָּתוּב (בְּרֵאשִׁית רַבָּה פָּרָשָׁה ב׳): "'וְחֹשֶׁךְ' — זֶה יָוָן שֶׁהֶחְשִׁיכָה עֵינֵיהֶם שֶׁל יִשְׂרָאֵל בִּגְזֵרוֹתֵיהֶן", — **as written (Bereishit Rabbah, Parashah 2): – "'And darkness' — this is Greece who darkened the**

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followed by their accepting it again willingly in Ahasuerus's days. Yet no miracle was performed for them in Ezra's days as in Joshua's, because the earlier sin caused this, and the Divine Presence did not dwell in the Second Temple. Nevertheless, the end of Sefer Heikhalot says that although Torah had been given, its seventeen listed qualities were not present until the Second Temple, even though the Divine Presence did not dwell there. It further says that they did not set stone upon stone in the Second Temple until they compelled the Holy One to reveal the secrets of everything. This 'compulsion' corresponds to the mountain's compulsion at the giving of Torah. One may suggest that this compulsion was the removal of the evil inclination described in Yoma 69b, contrary to God's will, as in 'and that which I caused to be evil,' and as I explained elsewhere."

Tzidkat connects the same Second Temple/Heikhalot claim to a concrete sequence: light first received, then lost, then sought through difficulty. This explains why the origin speaks of cherishing the troubles for the Torah illumination gained through them. The quoted account is a theological interpretation of that transition, and retains the author's tentative "one may suggest" concerning the reciprocal compulsion.

[649] **Yoma 21b:7**: "Was there heavenly fire in the Second Temple? Did Rav Shmuel bar Inya not say: Why is 'I shall take pleasure in it and be honored' written ve-ikkaved, without a final heh, while we read ve-ikkavedah, with a heh? The missing heh, whose numerical value is five, alludes to the five things that distinguished the First Temple from the Second: the Ark with its cover and cherubs, fire, the Shechinah, the holy spirit, and the Urim and Tummim. They answered: Yes, heavenly fire did exist in the Second Temple, but it did not assist in consuming the offerings as it had before."

[650] **Likkutei Maamarim, Upon Completion of Talmud 11**: "Written Torah is something from nothing. Oral Torah is something from something: Written Torah already existed, and the person understands one matter from another to innovate. So too Chanukah's miracle: a little oil already existed; it was something from something, not absolutely something from nothing."

Likkutei explains the origin's classification through the form of Torah's growth: Oral Torah draws new understanding from an existing gift. The small oil supply makes that distinction concrete. "Not given to be written" is used here as a division of revelatory eras and kinds of miracle, not as a claim that Oral Torah can never later appear in written books.

[651] **Yoma 29a:4-6**: "Rabbi Zeira said: Why was Esther compared to a hind? To tell you: Just as a hind's womb is narrow and she is as dear to her mate at every moment as at the first moment, so Esther was as dear to Achashverosh at every moment as at the first moment. Rabbi Assi said: Why was Esther compared to dawn? To tell you: Just as dawn is the end of the entire night, so Esther was the end of all the miracles. But there is Chanukah! We mean miracles that were given permission to be recorded in Scripture. This is satisfactory according to the view that Esther was given permission to be recorded. But according to the view that Esther was not given permission to be recorded, what can be said? That view explains the comparison in accordance with Rabbi Binyamin bar Yefet's teaching in Rabbi Elazar's name. Rabbi Binyamin bar Yefet said in Rabbi Elazar's name: Why were the prayers of the righteous compared to a hind? To tell you: Just as a hind's antlers branch out as it grows, so the more the righteous increase their prayer, the more their prayer is heard."

[652] **Bereshit Rabbah 2:4** (excerpt): "'And darkness'—this is the Greek exile, which darkened Israel's eyes through its decrees, for it said to them: Write upon the horn of an ox that you have no portion in the God of Israel."

eyes of Israel with their decrees", וְדָבְקָא עַל יְדֵי זֶה: "וַיֹּאמֶר אֱלֹהִים יְהִי אוֹר", וְהַיְנוּ הָאֲרַת תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה; **— and precisely through this: "And God said: Let there be light", which is the illumination of the Oral Torah;**

Torah gives counsel while the heart is still being refined

(Tanchuma Noach 3) – וְכִדְאִיתָא (תַּנְחוּמָא נֹחַ ג׳)[653,654] שֶׁעַל עִסְקֵי תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה נֶאֱמַר: "הָעָם הַהֹלְכִים בַּחֹשֶׁךְ רָאוּ אוֹר גָּדוֹל" **— and as found** אוֹר הָרִאשׁוֹן וְכוּלֵיהּ; **— that regarding those who toil in the Oral Torah it is said: "The people walking in darkness have seen a great light" — the Primordial Light, etc.;** וְגַם לֹא כָּפָה הָהָר לְפִי שֶׁיֵּשׁ כְּגִיגִית רַק עַל תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה, **— and He coerced the mountain like a vault only over the Oral Torah,** בָּהּ צַעַר גָּדוֹל וּנְדוּד שְׁנָה וּמְנַבֵּל עַצְמוֹ עָלֶיהָ. **— because it entails great exertion, deprivation of sleep, and self-effacing physical sacrifice.** וְעַל לִמּוּד תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה נֶאֱמַר: "וְאָהַבְתָּ וגו׳ בְּכָל לְבָבְךָ וּבְכָל נַפְשְׁךָ וּבְכָל מְאֹדֶךָ", **— And concerning the study of the Oral Torah it is stated: "And you shall love, etc., with all your heart, with all your soul, and with all your might",** שֶׁאֵין זוֹכֶה לַהּ רַק מִי שֶׁהוּא אוֹהֵב הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא בְּכָל לִבּוֹ וּבְכָל נַפְשׁוֹ וּבְכָל מְאֹדוֹ, עַיֵּן שָׁם; **— for no one merits it except one who loves the Holy One with all his heart, soul, and might, see there;** וַעֲלֵיהֶם נֶאֱמַר: "וְאֹהֲבָיו כְּצֵאת הַשֶּׁמֶשׁ בִּגְבֻרָתוֹ", **— and of them it is stated: "And those who love Him are like the sun going forth in its might",** שֶׁהַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא מֵאִיר עֵינֵיהֶם לָעָתִיד לָבֹא. **— for the Holy One will enlighten their eyes in the World to Come.**

commemorate the dedication of the Temple via sacrifices, וּבָזֶה יוּבַן לָמָּה אֵין עוֹשִׂין זֵכֶר לְחִנּוּךְ הַבַּיִת בְּקָרְבָּנוֹת, כִּי הַקָּרְבָּנוֹת הֲמָה בְּטֵלִים כְּמַה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: "לָמָּה לִּי רֹב זִבְחֵיכֶם"; **— for the animal sacrifices ceased, as Scripture states: "To what purpose is the multitude of your sacrifices to Me";** אָמְנָם הַנֵּרוֹת הַמְרַמְּזִים לְמְאוֹר הַתּוֹרָה, **— whereas the lights which allude to the illumination of the Torah,** עוֹשִׂין זֵכֶר לְהַחְנוּכַּת שֶׁל הַחַשְׁמוֹנָאִים, **— we commemorate the dedication of the Hasmoneans,** כִּי מִזֶּה נִתְקַיֵּם בָּנוּ מְאוֹר הַתּוֹרָה **— because from this the light of Torah was established within us** עַל יְדֵי הַחִנּוּךְ וְהַתְּשׁוּקָה לְאוֹר הַתּוֹרָה שֶׁהָיָה לָהֶם אָז. **— through the initiation and longing for the Torah's light which burned within them then.**

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[653] **Midrash Tanchuma, Noach 3:4**: “The Israelites did not accept the Torah until the Holy One, blessed be He, arched the mountain over them like a vessel, as it is said: And they stood beneath the mountain (Exod. 19:17). R. Dimi the son of Hama stated that the Holy One, blessed be He, told Israel: If you accept the Torah, well and good; but if not, your grave will be there. If you should say that He arched the mountain over them because of the Written Law, isn’t it true that as soon as He said to them, “Will you accept the Torah?” they all responded, “We will do and hear,” because the Written Law was brief and required no striving and suffering, but rather He threatened them because of the Oral Law. After all, it contains the detailed explanations of the commandments, both simple and difficult, and it is as severe as death, and as jealous as Sheol. One does not study the Oral Law unless he loves the Holy One, blessed be He, with all his heart, with all his soul, and with all his might, as it is said: And thou shalt love the Lord thy God with all thy heart, with all thy soul, and with all thy might (Deut. 6:5).”

[654] **Mei HaShiloach, Volume I, Genesis, Noach 1**: “‘These are Noah’s generations … Make yourself an ark of gopher wood …’. The ark means that God gave Noah counsel and protection until the days of wrath had passed. Likewise anyone whose heart is not yet refined can learn counsels for sheltering himself and protecting himself from all the evil stirring in the world. Thus the Sages said: if a person sees sufferings coming upon him, let him run to the innermost chambers of Torah, and it gives him counsel for escape. The ark’s meaning follows the Talmud’s saying that the Holy One loves three: one who does not become angry, one who does not become drunk, and one who overlooks offenses. One who does not become angry does not show anger in action. One who does not become drunk possesses a settled mind and recognizes and believes in the Creator of the world. One who overlooks offenses removes anger even from his heart, so that no grievance against his fellow remains in his heart.”
Mei HaShiloach supplies practical content for Torah’s role amid trouble: the learner is still being refined, and the counsel reaches outward action, settled understanding, and the removal of resentment. The origin stresses the arduous love required for Oral Torah; the target explains how entering Torah under pressure can shape the heart, without promising that merely accumulating information removes suffering.

One heart means a shared readiness to hear Torah

Wholehearted acceptance makes Oral Torah an entrusted possession

כִּי מִיָּד בַּהַתְחָלַת מַתַּן תּוֹרָה הָיָה בִּתְשׁוּקָה גְּדוֹלָה, כְּמַה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: "וַיִּחַן שָׁם יִשְׂרָאֵל"[655, 656] — **For immediately at the inception of the Giving of the Torah it was with great passion, –** כְּאִישׁ אֶחָד בְּלֵב אֶחָד", — **as Scripture states: "And Israel encamped there" — "as one man with one heart",** וְזֶה הָיָה עַל תּוֹרָה שֶׁבִּכְתָב, — **and this applied to the Written Torah;** שֶׁעַל תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה נִצְרַךְ לִכְפּוֹת עֲלֵיהֶם הַהַר כְּגִיגִית כִּדְאִיתָא בְּתַנְחוּמָא; — **while over the Oral Torah it was necessary to suspend the mountain like a vault, as stated in Tanchuma;** אֲבָל אַחַר זֶה הָדַר קִבְּלוּהָ מֵאַהֲבָה בִּימֵי אֲחַשְׁוֵרוֹשׁ, — **yet afterward they re-accepted it out of love in the days of Ahasuerus,** וּבְטָלוּ הַמּוֹדָעָה דִּכְפִיַּת הָהָר כְּגִיגִית. — **nullifying the legal protest over the coercion of the mountain.**

Remembering the hidden period preserves its desire

וּגְמַר הַתְּשׁוּקָה וְהַגַּעְגּוּעִים הָיָה בִּימֵי הַחַשְׁמוֹנָאִים מִצַּד הַצָּרוֹת,[657] — **And the ultimate completion of yearning and longing emerged in the era of the Hasmoneans out of tribulations;** וְעַל זֶה אָנוּ עוֹשִׂין זֵכֶר לְזֶה הַחִנּוּךְ וְהַתְּשׁוּקָה שֶׁל תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה שֶׁהָיָה אָז, — **and for this reason we commemorate this initiation and yearning for the Oral Torah which existed then,** שֶׁעַל יְדֵי זֶה נִשְׁאַר בָּנוּ בְּקִבִיעוּת הָאָרֶת הַתּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה לְעוֹלָם, — **through which there remains permanently etched within us the radiance of the Oral Torah forever,** וּכְמַה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: "חֲנֹךְ לַנַּעַר עַל פִּי דַרְכּוֹ, גַּם כִּי יַזְקִין לֹא יָסוּר מִמֶּנָּה", וּכְמַאֲמַר הַמִּדְרָשׁ: "אֲבָל הַנֵּרוֹת לְעוֹלָם". — **as Scripture states: "Train a youth according to his way, even when he grows old he will not depart from it", – and according to the inner meaning of the Midrash: "However the lights — are forever".**

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[655] **Tiferet Yosef, Rosh Chodesh Sivan 1**: "'In the third month after the children of Israel left Egypt, on this day they came to the wilderness of Sinai … they encamped in the wilderness, and Israel encamped there opposite the mountain.' My holy grandfather explained that desert travelers ordinarily camp beneath a mountain so that it protects them from winds and heat, with their faces looking toward the world. Here it says, 'Israel encamped there opposite the mountain': their backs faced the world and their faces the mountain. Their whole purpose was directed toward the mountain where they were to receive Torah. They did not wish to look toward worldly matters; they stood ready to receive Torah. Therefore it says, 'Israel encamped,' which Rashi, following the Mekhilta, explains as all being like one person with one heart. Division grows when a person turns toward worldly matters. Here, because they did not wish to look toward worldly matters, there was no division among them: they were like one person with one heart. This is what we say in the Haggadah: had He brought us near Mount Sinai without giving us Torah, it would have been enough. What good would there have been in coming near Sinai without receiving Torah? Through that very approach, before receiving Torah, Israel was clarified as not wishing to look toward worldly matters but only to hear what God would command them." Tiferet explains why Rav Tzadok cites "one person with one heart" as evidence of longing: a shared direction toward hearing Torah removes competing purposes. Its reading concerns the preparation before revelation. It does not deny the distinct difficulty Rav Tzadok then assigns to accepting Oral Torah's demands.

[656] **Resisei Layla 56:15**: "Pirkei Heikhalot says that although the Divine Presence did not dwell in the Second Temple, the essential Torah and its radiance and splendor were only in the Second Temple. They did not wish to build until God promised to reveal Torah's secrets to them. For Oral Torah began in the Second Temple with the Men of the Great Assembly: those who founded the Temple also founded Oral Torah, as stated in Yerushalmi Shekalim. In Mordechai's days, when they confirmed what they had already received and accepted Torah again out of love rather than through the mountain's coercion, they merited this. The essential coercion concerned Oral Torah, as stated in Tanchuma Noach. As long as they had not accepted it willingly, it had not yet been completely entrusted to them, and they conducted themselves through prophets, everything in writing from God's hand."
Resisei states what voluntary acceptance changes: Oral Torah becomes completely entrusted to its human recipients. This supplies the mechanism linking Rav Tzadok's account of renewed love to a light that remains as an inheritance, rather than treating the change as only a stronger emotion.

[657] **Tiferet Yosef, Ha'azinu and Shabbat Shuvah 9**: "'Remember the days of the world; understand the years of each generation.' The command is to remember the days when a person was in concealment, for olam, world, is read as he'elem, concealment, as the Midrash expounds 'He placed the world in their hearts': He concealed from them. The command is to remember those days of concealment and the longing the person had then for God to illuminate the hiddenness. He is commanded to remember this because that longing possessed in concealment afterwards accompanies him through every kind of particular detail."
Tiferet explains the active role of remembrance in the origin's conclusion. Remembering the obstructed period preserves the desire that arose within it, and that desire continues through later situations. This makes the annual memorial a way of carrying forward an acquired inner orientation, not merely recollecting that suffering once occurred.

Chanukah Ois 8

Increasing or Decreasing: Beit Hillel and Beit Shammai

Rav Tzadok relates the two schools to the order intended in thought and the merciful governance through which the present world can endure.

Increasing or Decreasing: Beit Hillel and Beit Shammai

בַּגְּמָרָא (שַׁבָּת כ״א עַמּוּד ב׳)[658]: "בֵּית שַׁמַּאי אוֹמְרִים וְכוּלֵּיהּ מִכָּאן וְאֵילָךְ פּוֹחֵת וְהוֹלֵךְ, **— In the Gemara (Shabbat 21b): "Beit Shammai say, etc., from here onward he continually decreases,**

וּבֵית הִלֵּל אוֹמְרִים: יוֹם רִאשׁוֹן מַדְלִיק אַחַת, מִכָּאן וְאֵילָךְ מוֹסִיף וְהוֹלֵךְ וְכוּלֵּיהּ; **— and Beit Hillel say: on the first day he kindles one, from here onward he continually increases, etc.;**

חַד אָמַר: טַעְמָא דְּבֵית שַׁמַּאי כְּנֶגֶד יָמִים הַנִּכְנָסִין, וְטַעְמָא דְּבֵית הִלֵּל כְּנֶגֶד הַיָּמִים הַיּוֹצְאִין; **— one Sage said: Beit Shammai's reason corresponds to the incoming days, and Beit Hillel's reason corresponds to the outgoing days;**

וְחַד אָמַר: טַעְמָא דְּבֵית שַׁמַּאי כְּנֶגֶד פָּרֵי הֶחָג, וְטַעְמָא דְּבֵית הִלֵּל דְּמַעֲלִין בַּקֹּדֶשׁ וְכוּלֵּיהּ". **— and one Sage said: Beit Shammai's reason corresponds to the bullocks of the Festival, and Beit Hillel's reason is that we ascend in holiness, etc."**

וְיֵשׁ לְהָבִין שֹׁרֶשׁ מַחֲלֹקֶת בֵּית שַׁמַּאי וּבֵית הִלֵּל לְהַךְ מַאן דְּאָמַר: **— And one must understand the root of the dispute of Beit Shammai and Beit Hillel according to that authority:**

לָמָּה סְבִירָא לֵיהּ לְבֵית שַׁמַּאי כְּנֶגֶד הַיָּמִים הַנִּכְנָסִין דַּוְקָא, **— why does Beit Shammai hold specifically corresponding to the incoming days,**

וּבֵית הִלֵּל סְבִירָא לֵיהּ כְּנֶגֶד הַיָּמִים הַיּוֹצְאִין דַּוְקָא? **— and Beit Hillel holds specifically corresponding to the outgoing days?**

אֲךְ הָעִנְיָן, דְּבֵית שַׁמַּאי וּבֵית הִלֵּל נִקְרְאוּ בַּמִּשְׁנָה (עֲדֻיּוֹת פֶּרֶק א׳ מִשְׁנָה ד׳)[659] "אָבוֹת הָעוֹלָם", **— However, the matter is that Beit Shammai and Beit Hillel are termed in the Mishnah (Eduyot 1:4) "Fathers of the World",**

וְכֵן נִקְרְאוּ בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ (חֵלֶק ג׳ ע״ג עַמּוּד א׳)[660]: "אֲבָהָן דְּעָלְמָא". **— and likewise are called in the Holy Zohar (Part III, 73a) "the Fathers of the World".**

The present world requires mercy alongside the original measure of judgment

וְהֵנִיחוּ דְּהִלֵּל הָיָה מִסִּטְרָא דְּרַחֲמֵי, דַּרְגָּא דְּאַבְרָהָם, **— And that means that Hillel was from the side of Mercy (Chesed), the level of Abraham,**[661]

וְשַׁמַּאי הָיָה מִסִּטְרָא דְּדִינָא, גְּבוּרָה, דַּרְגָּא דְּיִצְחָק, **— and Shammai was from the side of Judgment (Din), Gevurah, the level of Isaac,**

כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בְּרַעְיָא מְהֵימְנָא (שָׁם רמ״ה עַמּוּד א׳)[662], **— as written in the Ra'aya Meheimna (ibid. 245a),**

וְכֵן כָּתַב הָאֲרִיזַ"ל שֶׁלֶּעָתִיד לָבֹא יִהְיֶה הַהֲלָכָה כְּבֵית שַׁמַּאי. **— and so wrote the Arizal, that in the Future to Come the Halachah will follow Beit Shammai.**

וְהוּא עַל פִּי מַה שֶּׁכָּתְבוּ רַבּוֹתֵינוּ זִכְרוֹנָם לִבְרָכָה שֶׁבְּתְּחִלָּה עָלָה בְּמַחֲשָׁבָה לִבְרֹא הָעוֹלָם בְּמִדַּת הַדִּין, **— And it is based on what our Sages of blessed memory wrote, — that initially it arose in Divine Thought to create the world with the attribute of Strict Judgment,**

וְאַחַר כָּךְ שִׁתַּף הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא מִדַּת הָרַחֲמִים לְמִדַּת הַדִּין, **— and afterward the Holy One**

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[658] **Shabbat 21b:5-6**: “The Sages taught: The mitzvah of Chanukah is one lamp for a man and his household. Those who embellish the mitzvah light one lamp for each person. For those who embellish it most fully, Beis Shammai say: On the first day one lights eight; from then on one progressively decreases. Beis Hillel say: On the first day one lights one; from then on one progressively increases. Ulla said: Two Amoraim in the Land of Israel disagreed about the explanation, Rabbi Yosei bar Avin and Rabbi Yosei bar Zevida. One said: Beis Shammai’s reason corresponds to the days still to come, and Beis Hillel’s reason corresponds to the days that have passed. The other said: Beis Shammai’s reason corresponds to the bulls offered on Sukkos, which decrease each day; Beis Hillel’s reason is that one ascends in sanctity and does not descend.”

[659] **Mishnah Eduyot 1:4**: ‘And why do they record the opinions of Shammai and Hillel for naught? To teach the following generations that a man should not always persist in his opinion, for behold, the fathers of the world did not persist in their opinion.’

[660] **Zohar, Achrei Mot 49:296-50:305**: ‘Therefore all who are not stamped with the holy sign on their flesh are not His, and they are marked as coming from the side of uncleanness, and it is forbidden to associate with them or to converse with them on matters of the Holy One, blessed be He. It is also forbidden to impart to them knowledge of the Torah, because the Torah consists wholly of the name of the Holy One, blessed be He, and every letter of it is bound up with that Name.’

[661] **Tzidkat HaTzadik 101:1**: “In action it is impossible for a person not to depart somewhat from the exact line of judgment, as it says, “There is no righteous person on earth who does good and does not sin.” A righteous person is one who takes care not to depart from that line. As is known, in the world of action the husks are numerous at every level; this is not the place to explain it. Such completeness is impossible in action, but in thought and the heart’s will, when he resolves to conduct himself thus and not sin, he can desire and long for it. For when one reaches thought and will in those higher worlds, even that sinful act belongs to the order and does not depart from the line of judgment at all: everything is within judgment. This is what they said: initially He intended to create with judgment. In action there is departure from the line, but in thought it is within judgment and there is no departure. “The Lord is righteous in all His ways”: His ways are words of Torah, as at the beginning of Kiddushin and in “He made His ways known to Moses”; God too conducts Himself according to Torah. But on reaching action He is “gracious,” meaning beyond the exact line of judgment, as in Shabbat and Rashi there: “I will be gracious to whom I will be gracious.” Nevertheless, that too is a verse in Torah and one of His revealed ways. Likewise, “It is a time to act for the Lord; they have annulled Your Torah” is itself an established law. As I wrote, when one returns to thought, this too belongs to the proper order and line.”
Tzidkat distinguishes the ideal apprehended in thought from the mercy needed in the world of action. It explains why Rav Tzadok can preserve judgment as the original order while assigning present practice to Hillel’s mercy. The source’s discussion of the higher order is a claim about divine governance; its opening still defines human righteousness by care not to sin, and its conclusion treats the exception it mentions as an established law.

[662] **Zohar, Pinchas 90:615**: “The Faithful Shepherd said: Hillel and Shammai—you, one from the side of mercy and one from the side of judgment, which are Chesed and Gevurah, the degrees of Avraham and Yitzchak.”

partnered the attribute of Mercy with the attribute of Judgment, כְּמַה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: "בְּיוֹם עֲשׂוֹת יהוה"ה אֱלֹהִים", **as Scripture states: "In the day that Hashem God made earth and heaven";** וְשָׁם כְּתִיב: "בְּהִבָּרְאָם", וְנִדְרַשׁ (בְּרֵאשִׁית רַבָּה פָּרָשָׁה י״ב וּבִזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ)[663]: "בְּאַבְרָהָם", **and there it is written: "When they were created (behibare'am)", expounded (Bereishit Rabbah 12 and in the Zohar) as "in Abraham (be-Avraham)",** וְזֶהוּ "עוֹלָם חֶסֶד יִבָּנֶה". — **and this is "the world is built upon lovingkindness".** וְאִיתָא (שָׁם פָּרָשָׁה י״ד)[664]: — **And it is stated (ibid., Parashah 14):** שֶׁהָיָה אַבְרָהָם רָאוּי לְהִבָּרְאוֹת קֹדֶם אָדָם הָרִאשׁוֹן, — **that Abraham was fitting to have been created before Adam the First Man,** אֶלָּא אָמַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא וְכוּלֵיהּ: — **only the Holy One said, etc.:** "אֲנִי בוֹרֵא אֶת הָאָדָם תְּחִלָּה, שֶׁאִם יִקָּלְקֵל יָבֹא אַבְרָהָם וְיתַקֵּן תַּחְתָּיו". — **"I will create the man first, so that if he corrupts, Abraham will come and rectify in his place."**

וְעַל כֵּן בָּעוֹלָם הַזֶּה שֶׁמִּתְנַהֵג עַל פִּי הַהַנְהָגָה שֶׁהַקְּדִים הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ מִדַּת הָרַחֲמִים לְמִדַּת הַדִּין הֲלָכָה כְּבֵית הִלֵּל. — **– And therefore in this world, which operates according to the guidance where the Blessed Name preceded Mercy before Judgment, the Halachah follows Beit Hillel.**

Isaac's restraint makes the recipient's refinement decisive

אֲבָל לֶעָתִיד לָבֹא, כְּשֶׁיִּתְתַּקֵּן כָּל פְּגַם הַנָּחָשׁ,[665] — **However in the Future to Come, when the entire blemish of the serpent will be rectified,** וְיִהְיֶה כְּמוֹ שֶׁעָלָה בְּמַחֲשָׁבָה: "עָשָׂה הָאֱלֹהִים אֶת הָאָדָם יָשָׁר", וְיוּכַל הָעוֹלָם לְהִתְנַהֵג בְּמִדַּת הַדִּין — **and it will be as initially arose in Divine Thought: "God made man upright",** – יִהְיֶה הַהֲלָכָה כְּבֵית שַׁמַּאי. — **and the cosmos will be capable of conducting itself under Strict Judgment, the Halachah will follow Beit Shammai.** וְכֵן עִם צַדִּיקִים הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא מְדַקְדֵּק אֲפִלּוּ כְּחוּט הַשַּׂעֲרָה, — **And likewise with the righteous the Holy One is exacting even to a hairbreadth,** שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: "וּסְבִיבָיו נִשְׂעֲרָה מְאֹד" (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בָּבָא קַמָּא נ׳ עַמּוּד א׳),[666] — **as it is said: "And around Him it storms exceedingly" (Bava Kamma 50a),** שֶׁהֵם יוּכְלוּ לְהִתְנַהֵג כְּפִי הַמַּחֲשָׁבָה. — **for they are capable of being conducted according to the Primordial Thought.**

וְכֵן יַעֲקֹב אָבִינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם שֶׁהָיָה כְּאָדָם הָרִאשׁוֹן קֹדֶם הַקִּלְקוּל כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמַרְנוּ כַּמָּה פְּעָמִים, — **And so too Jacob our Father, peace be upon him, who was like Adam before the fall as we have stated many times,** כְּתִיב בֵּיהּ: "וְהָיָה יהו"ה לִי לֵאלֹהִים", — **regarding him it is written: "Then Hashem shall be to me God (Elohim)",** שֶׁרָצָה לְהִתְנַהֵג עַל פִּי מִדַּת הַדִּין, — **for he desired to be conducted under the attribute of Judgment,** וְזֶה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר "לִי לֵאלֹהִים" דַּוְקָא. — **and this is what Scripture states: "to me God (Elohim)" specifically.**

וְזֶה הָעִנְיָן שֶׁבַּמִּשְׁנָה הַזְּכִרוּ תָּמִיד בֵּית שַׁמַּאי קוֹדֵם לְבֵית הִלֵּל, וּמִכָּל מָקוֹם הֲלָכָה כְּבֵית הִלֵּל. — **And this is why in the Mishnah Beit Shammai is always mentioned**

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[663] **Bereshit Rabbah 12:15**; **Bereshit Rabbah 12:9** (excerpts): "'Hashem God': This is compared to a king who had empty cups. The king said: If I put hot water into them, they will split; if cold water, they will contract. What did he do? He mixed hot water with cold and poured it into them, and they endured. So the Holy One, blessed be He, said: If I create the world through the attribute of mercy, sins will be many. Through the attribute of judgment—how could the world endure? Rather, I will create it through judgment and mercy, and may it endure. … Rabbi Yehoshua ben Korcha said: 'When they were created' (be-hibare'am)—'through Abraham' (be-Avraham): through Abraham's merit."

[664] **Bereshit Rabbah 14:6** (excerpt): "Why does Scripture call Abraham 'great'? Because he deserved to be created before Adam. But the Holy One, blessed be He, said: Perhaps he will bring corruption, and there will be no one to come and repair it in his place. Rather, I will create Adam first, so that if he brings corruption, Abraham will come and repair it in his place."

[665] **Tiferet Yosef, Sukkot 11**: "Isaac's attribute is might. Through the attribute of His kindness that God established in this world, the flow appears to reach even those who transgress His will, like the Talmudic saying that rain falls for everyone, both the righteous and the wicked. Through Isaac's attribute, however, the flow is restricted so that it goes only to those who perform the Omnipresent's will. Because of this restriction, the flow reaches those who perform His will with great force. This is the Sages' meaning: "What is the might of the rains? Rabbi Yohanan said: because they descend with might." Through this attribute the flow proceeds with great intensity. Thus Isaac's blessing, "Who revives the dead," includes all the deliverances: supporting the fallen, healing the sick, and so forth. The restriction associated with Isaac means this: in this world the Zohar calls kingship "having no eyes." The Talmud similarly asks about one who stole a se'ah of wheat and planted it: by rights it should not grow, but the world follows its customary course. This is called "having no eyes." In truth, whoever examines this attribute deeply sees that it too has eyes. One who serves and trusts in the Life of the worlds and sows truly receives the utterance of God within the good, which gives it life and existence. One who possesses only the outward appearance receives the outer garment of the good without its inwardness. Whoever looks deeply sees this, although outwardly it seems that one receives good just like the other; this is called the world following its customary course."

Tiferet explains what the judgment associated with Isaac evaluates: the recipient's service and capacity to receive the inward good. It also distinguishes that discernment from the apparently equal outward prosperity of the present world. This develops the origin's condition that exact judgment belongs to a refined person or a repaired world, rather than presenting severity as an arbitrary preference.

[666] **Bava Kamma 50a:22**: "Rabbi Acha said: Even so, his son died of thirst. Scripture says, 'Around Him it storms exceedingly.' This teaches that the Holy One, blessed be He, scrutinizes the conduct of those close to Him even to a hair's breadth, reading the word for 'storms' as an allusion to a 'hair.' Rabbi Nechunyah derives the same teaching from this verse: 'God is greatly revered in the council of the holy ones, and awesome above all who surround Him.'"

prior to Beit Hillel, and nevertheless the Halachah follows Beit Hillel. וְהַטַּעַם, דְּנַפְשׁוֹת הָאָבוֹת בָּרָא הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ מִצִּדּוֹ, **— And the reason is that the souls of the Patriarchs the Blessed Name created from His side,** כְּמוֹ דִּכְתִיב: "וָאֶקַּח אֶת אֲבִיכֶם אֶת אַבְרָהָם וְגוֹמֵר", **— as it is written: "And I took your father Abraham, etc.",** וְכֵן וְהַיְנוּ שֶׁבָּחַר בּוֹ הַשֵּׁם יִצְחָק נִמּוֹל לִשְׁמוֹנָה בָּרִאשׁוֹנָה, **— and likewise Isaac was circumcised at eight days originally,** וְהוּא יִתְבָּרַךְ שְׁלֹא מִדַּעְתּוֹ; **— meaning that the Blessed Name chose him without his conscious participation;** שֶׁבֶּאֱמֶת הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ מִצִּדּוֹ בָּרָא נַפְשׁוֹת הָאָבוֹת **— and this is because in truth the Blessed Name from His side created the souls of the Patriarchs** שֶׁהֵם מִדּוֹת הַקְּדוֹשִׁים חֶסֶד וּגְבוּרָה, וּמִדּוֹתֵיהֶם אַהֲבָה וְיִרְאָה; **— which are the holy sefirot Chesed and Gevurah, and their inner expressions are love and awe;** וּמִצַּד הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ הַסֵּדֶר: בְּחִינַת אַבְרָהָם וְאַחַר כָּךְ בְּחִינַת יִצְחָק, **— and from the perspective of the Blessed Name the sequence is the aspect of Abraham and afterward the aspect of Isaac;** דְּאַבְרָהָם שֶׁשֹּׁרֶשׁ מִדָּתוֹ הָאַהֲבָה כְּמַה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: "אַבְרָהָם אֹהֲבִי", **— for Abraham whose root attribute is love as stated: "Abraham who loved Me",** וּמִצַּד הָאַהֲבָה בָּא הַזְּרִיזוּת בְּמִצְוֹת עֲשֵׂה; **— and from the side of love arises alacrity in positive commandments;** וְיִצְחָק שֶׁמִּדָּתוֹ "פַּחַד יִצְחָק", **— and Isaac whose attribute is the "Fear of Isaac", reverential awe,** וּמִצִּדָּהּ בָּא הַזְּהִירוּת בְּמִצְוֹת לֹא תַּעֲשֶׂה, **— and from its side emerges scrupulous caution in negative commandments,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמַרְנוּ מַהֲיְרוּשַׁלְמִי (וְנִתְבָּאֵר פָּרָשַׁת חַיֵּי שָׂרָה מַאֲמָר ז׳).[667] **— as we explained from the Yerushalmi (and elaborated in Parashat Chayei Sarah, discourse 7).**

God's first gift makes further human purification possible

וְהַסֵּדֶר מִצַּד הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ "אָנֹכִי" וְאַחַר כָּךְ "לֹא יִהְיֶה",[668, 669] **— And the divine order from the perspective of the**

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[667] **Jerusalem Talmud Berakhot 2:4:12**: "Rebbi Joshua ben Levi said, his name is Ẓemaḥ. Rebbi Yudan, the son of Rebbi Aivu, said his name is Menaḥem. Ḥanina the son of Rebbi Abbahu said: they have no disagreement since the numerical value of one is the numerical value of the other: Ẓemaḥ is equal to Menaḥem. Since Rebbi Yudan the son of Rebbi Aivu said, it happened to a Jew who was plowing in the valley of Arbel that his ox was bellowing. An Arab passed by and heard the bellowing of the ox. He said to him: Jew, Jew, unharness your ox, unharness your plow because the Temple was destroyed. The ox bellowed a second time. He said: Jew, Jew, harness your ox, fix your plow because King Messiah has been born. He said to him: What is his name? Menaḥem. He said to him: What is his father's name? Ḥizqiah. He said to him: Where is he? He said to him: At the king's palace in Bethlehem in Judea. He went and sold his ox and plow and made himself a vendor of baby linens. He went to towns and left towns until he came to that town. All the women bought from him but the mother of Menaḥem did not buy. He heard the women say: Menaḥem's mother, Menaḥem's mother, come and buy for your son! She said: I would rather strangle him like a hater of Israel because he was born on the day the Temple was destroyed. He said to her: I like him, because for him it was destroyed and for him it will be rebuilt. She said to him, I have no money. He said to her, that does not bother me, come and buy for him! If you have nothing with you today, I shall return another day and I will take it then. After some time he went up to that town and said to her: How is your baby doing? She said to him: After you had seen me there came storms and raised him and tore him from my hands. Rebbi Abun said: We do not need to learn from that Arab, is it not a full verse (Is. 10:35): "The Lebanon will fall through a noble one"? And the next verse is (11:1) "A sprout will come from the stem of Jesse.""

[668] **Tiferet Yosef, Talmud Anthology, Berakhot 7**: "In truth a person must first turn away from evil and afterwards do good. God's utterances were in the reverse order: first "I am" and then "You shall have no other." "I am" indicates the whole body of positive commandments, and "You shall have no other" the whole body of prohibitions. He explained that this was God's kindness: had "You shall have no other," indicating turning away from evil, preceded "I am," indicating doing good, then someone not yet clean in turning away from evil would have no place to perform any commandment, since he had not yet been refined in turning away from evil. God's saying "I am" first indicates that even if someone has stumbled in something wrong, repentance is not withheld from him, and he can perform commandments although he is not yet entirely clean in turning away from evil. Thus the Zohar says that when God wished to create the world, Torah said: this human You are about to create will sin before You. God answered: am I called patient for nothing? The Midrash compares prayer to a mikveh and repentance to the sea: a mikveh is sometimes open and sometimes closed, as is prayer; but the sea is always open, and so God's hand is always open to receive those who return. All this indicates that even if someone has stumbled in a bad action, repentance is not withheld from him. This is the statement, "Know Him in all your ways," upon which all the essentials of Torah depend. Rava concludes, "Even in a matter of transgression": a person should not despair after stumbling in sin, for repentance is always available. This is the principle of Torah's essentials."

Tiferet states the practical consequence of the divine order: imperfect purification does not close the door to mitzvot and repentance. It translates the origin's account of light preceding full removal of evil into an account of continued service after failure. The complete conclusion identifies the teaching with returning after sin, preserving its ethical direction.

[669] **Dover Tzedek, Kuntres Ner HaMitzvot 1:28**: "Therefore in Psalms, which addresses practical commandments and every person, as in "Guard your tongue from evil" and so forth, it concerns the absence of evil and puts "Turn away from evil" first. At the standing at Mount Sinai, however, the evil inclination was uprooted from them, and we heard these two utterances from the Almighty. They potentially encompass all 613 commandments through their allusions; these are 613 counsels for reaching through them a strong, clear recognition of "I am" and "You shall have no other" in the heart, as a completely acquired possession. Therefore "I am" comes first, as explained above."

Dover makes explicit the difference between instruction addressed to ordinary human practice and revelation at Sinai. It explains why the two scriptural orders need not compete: one instructs preparation, while the other supplies the decisive inward recognition. The larger Kuntres argument immediately before this excerpt links prayer and blessings with that direct recognition.

Blessed Name is "I am" and afterward "There shall not be", שֶׁהַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ מַשְׁפִּיעַ קְדֻשָּׁה וְדִבְרֵי תוֹרָה לְ"לֵב חָכָם לִימִינוֹ", **— in that the Blessed Name channels holiness and Torah words into "a wise man's heart at his right",** וְעַל יְדֵי זֶה נֶעֱקָר הָרָע מִ"לֵב כְּסִיל לִשְׂמֹאלוֹ", **— and through this evil is uprooted from "a fool's heart at his left",** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב (שִׁיר הַשִּׁירִים רַבָּה פָּרָשָׁה יִשְׁקֵנִי):[670] **— as written (Shir HaShirim Rabbah, Parashat Yishakeini):** שֶׁבְּשָׁעָה שֶׁשָּׁמְעוּ דִּבּוּר "אָנֹכִי" נִתְקַע תַּלְמוּד תּוֹרָה בְּלִבָּם, **— that when they heard the utterance "I am", Torah study was firmly embedded in their hearts,** וּבְשָׁעָה שֶׁשָּׁמְעוּ דִּבּוּר "לֹא יִהְיֶה" נֶעֱקַר יֵצֶר הָרָע מִלִּבָּם; **— and when they heard the utterance "There shall not be", the Evil Inclination was uprooted from their hearts;** דְּ"אָנֹכִי" שֹׁרֶשׁ כָּל הַמִּצְוֹת עֲשֵׂה וְהַדִּבְרֵי תוֹרָה, **— for "I am" is the root of all positive commandments and Torah study,** וְ"לֹא יִהְיֶה" שֹׁרֶשׁ הַמִּצְוֹת לֹא תַעֲשֶׂה. **— and "There shall not be" is the root of all negative commandments.** וְלָכֵן מִצַּד הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ הַסֵּדֶר נָפֵשׁ אַבְרָהָם וְאַחַר כָּךְ יִצְחָק, **— Therefore from the perspective of the Blessed Name the sequence is the soul of Abraham and afterward Isaac,** וְכֵן יָצְאָה בַּת קוֹל: "הֲלָכָה כְּבֵית הִלֵּל" שֶׁהֵם דַּרְגָּא דְּאַבְרָהָם. **— and likewise a Heavenly Voice issued forth: "The Halachah follows Beit Hillel", who embody the level of Abraham.** אֲבָל מִצַּד הָאָדָם הַסֵּדֶר: "סוּר מֵרָע" וְאַחַר כָּךְ "וַעֲשֵׂה טוֹב", **— However from the perspective of mortal man, the working order is: "Turn from evil" and afterward "do good",** שֶׁלִּזְכּוֹת לְדִבְרֵי תוֹרָה צָרִיךְ שֶׁיּוּקְדַּם הַיִּרְאָה לִהְיוֹת סוּר מֵרָע, **— for to merit words of Torah, awe must precede to turn away from evil,** שֶׁהוּא מִדַּת יִצְחָק אָבִינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם; **— which is the attribute of Isaac our Father, peace be upon him;** וְכֵן הֶזְכִּרוּ תָּמִיד בֵּית שַׁמַּאי קוֹדֶם לְבֵית הִלֵּל. **— and so in the Mishnah Beit Shammai are always mentioned prior to Beit Hillel.** וְהִנֵּה בַּחֲנֻכָּה יֵשׁ שְׁנֵי הֶעְנְיָנִים: **— And behold, on Chanukah both dimensions converge:** הַנִּצּוּחַ שֶׁבָּא עַל יְדֵי שֶׁזָּכוּ לְהוֹרִיק הָרָע מִ"לֵב כְּסִיל לִשְׂמֹאלוֹ", **— the military victory which came through meriting to evacuate evil from "a fool's heart at his left",** וְגַם הַנֵּס שֶׁנַּעֲשָׂה בַּשֶּׁמֶן שֶׁזָּכוּ לְהַכְנִיס קְדֻשָּׁה לְ"לֵב חָכָם לִימִינוֹ"; **— and also the miracle wrought in the oil whereby they merited to introduce holiness into "a wise man's heart at his right";** וְעַל יְדֵי הַדְלָקַת הַנֵּרוֹת שֶׁזּוֹכִין שֶׁיָּאִיר בְּלִבָּם הָאוֹר מֵהַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ, **— and through kindling the candles, meriting that light from the Blessed Name shine in their heart,** כְּמַה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: "אֵל הַשֵּׁם וַיָּאֶר לָנוּ", **— as Scripture states: "God is Hashem, and He shone light upon us",** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמַרְנוּ שֶׁהַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ מְקַיֵּם מִצְוֹת זְקֵנִים וּמַדְלִיק נֵר חֲנֻכָּה שֶׁמְּאִיר בְּלֵב בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל. **— and as we stated, that the Blessed Name fulfills the commandment of the elders and kindles Chanukah lights illuminating the hearts of the Children of Israel.**

The light already attained remains within the next stage

And this explains why Beit Hillel according to their וְזֶה הֶעְנְיָן דְּבֵית הִלֵּל כְּפִי מִדָּתָם שֶׁהָיוּ דַּרְגָּא דְּאַבְרָהָם,[671, 672] **—**

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[670] **Shir HaShirim Rabbah 1:2:4** (excerpt): "Rabbi Yehudah says: When Israel heard 'I am Hashem your God' (Exodus 20:2), Torah study became firmly fixed in their hearts; they would learn and not forget. … Rabbi Nechemyah said: When Israel heard 'You shall have no other gods' (Exodus 20:3), the evil inclination was uprooted from their hearts."

[671] **Resisei Layla 56:27**: "This is the dispute of Beit Shammai and Beit Hillel: whether to diminish progressively, corresponding to the festival's bulls. These correspond to the seventy nations, and therefore decrease; our intention is to diminish them. Likewise here, for Beit Shammai, who are from the attribute of judgment and restraint and therefore rule strictly, the purpose of lighting the Chanukah lamp is to restrain ourselves, separate ourselves from the wisdom of the nations, and diminish it. Therefore the lamps decrease. This corresponds to the days still entering: to diminish the nations' wisdom, what has already gone and departed is not our concern; we deal with what still needs to be removed from us. But for Beit Hillel, whose view is the halakhah, the principal intention is to draw the true wisdom of Oral Torah into our hearts. Through the light of truth, darkness and falsehood depart and disappear of themselves. Therefore the count corresponds to the days that have gone out: every piece of wisdom already attained must be established and rooted in the heart. "One ascends in holiness," since it refers to holy wisdom. In the inner teaching, "holiness" refers to higher wisdom, and the lower wisdom of Oral Torah draws nourishment from it; it needs ascent from level to level. Therefore one continually adds another level. The level of the days that have gone out has not left or departed; on the contrary, those days remain with him as he advances to a higher level."

Resisei explains why counting the days already passed means spiritual increase rather than loss. What was acquired earlier remains rooted in the learner, while the higher stage contains it. It also explains the opposing count through the work still awaiting removal. This adds a precise account of retention to Rav Tzadok's image of gradually increasing light.

[672] **Mei HaShiloach, Volume II, Genesis, Bereshit 3**: "God said: Let there be light; and there was light. God saw the light, that it was good. God separated the light from the darkness, and God called the light day." Light is mentioned five times. The first "Let there be light" is when God prepares within Himself to illuminate a person. The person does not yet understand or feel anything, while God is working to illuminate him. Afterwards comes "There was light": the person begins to feel it. Then "God saw the light, that it was good": the person recognizes his Creator and understands that it is good to follow God. "God separated the light from the darkness" means that the person turns away from evil. Nevertheless, "God called the light day" is still needed afterwards: doing good. As the Talmud says, the Merciful One called the light and assigned it the command of the day. This is not enough by itself; the person must engage in that recognition, serve God, and perform commandments and good deeds."

Mei HaShiloach gives content to gradual illumination: unnoticed preparation, felt light, recognition, separation from evil,

trait, being on the level of Abraham, ,"וּסְבִירָא לְהוּ שֶׁהָעִקָּר לְהַכְנִיס הָאוֹר לְ"לֵב חָכָם לִימִינוֹ **— held that the essential focus is introducing light into "a wise man's heart at his right",** וְעַל כֵּן סְבִירָא לְהוּ דְּמוֹסִיף וְהוֹלֵךְ, **— and therefore held that one continuously adds, for "we ascend in holiness",** שֶׁכֵּן סֵדֶר דְּ"מַעֲלִין בַּקֹּדֶשׁ", **— for such is the order of light's illumination: "shining more and more unto the perfect day".** הָאֲרַת הָאוֹר: "הוֹלֵךְ וָאוֹר עַד נָכוֹן הַיּוֹם". **— And as written in the Holy Zohar (Part I, 170a):**[673] וּכְמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ (חֶלֶק א׳ ק״ע עַמּוּד א׳): — "יִשְׂרָאֵל נְהוֹרָא דִּלְהוֹן זְעִיר זְעִיר עַד דְּיִתְתַּקְפוּן וְיִנְהִיר לוֹן קוּדְשָׁא בְּרִיךְ הוּא לְעָלְמִין וְכוּלַּיהּ, **— "Israel, their light emerges little by little until they gather strength and the Holy One shines for them forever, etc.,** כְּמוֹ שַׁחַר וְדָא אִיהוּ נְהוֹרָא דַּקִּיק, **— like dawn which is a subtle thin light,** וּלְבָתַר 'יָפָה כַלְּבָנָה' וְכוּלַּיהּ **— and afterward 'fair as the moon' illuminating more than dawn,** וּלְבָתַר 'בָּרָה כַּחַמָּה' בְּגִין דְּנְהִיר יַתִּיר מִשַּׁחַר, **— and afterward 'pure as the sun' because its light is powerful and shines more than the moon, etc.",** וְזֶהוּ שֶׁאָמְרוּ: "מוֹסִיף וְהוֹלֵךְ", כְּסֵדֶר הָאֲרַת הָאוֹר בַּלֵּב שָׁמַאיר הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ. **— and this is why they ruled: "continually increases", reflecting the progression of light with which the Blessed Name illuminates the heart.** וּבֵית שַׁמַּאי כְּפִי מַדָּתָם שֶׁהִיא דַּרְגָּא דְּיִצְחָק, **— And Beit Shammai according to their trait, which is the level of Isaac,** וְסִבְירָא לְהוּ שֶׁעִקַּר לְהוֹרִיק הָרָע מִלֵּב כְּסִיל עַל יְדֵי הַיִּרְאָה, **— holding that the primary task is to evacuate evil from the fool's heart through awe,** אוֹמְרִים: "פּוֹחֵת וְהוֹלֵךְ" כְּנֶגֶד פָּרֵי הֶחָג, **— say: "continually decreases" corresponding to the bullocks of the Festival,** שֶׁהֵם לְהוֹצִיא הַנִּיצוֹצוֹת הַקְּדוֹשׁוֹת וּבְכָל פַּעַם פּוֹחֵת וְהוֹלֵךְ (כְּמוֹ שֶׁנִּתְבָּאֵר סוֹף מַאֲמָר ב׳),[674] **— which serve to extract holy sparks and continually decrease (as explained at the end of discourse 2),** וְהֵינוּ לְהוֹרִיק הָרָע שֶׁלֹּא יֵשְׁאֵר רַק הַהַשְׁאָרָה לְצֹרֶךְ יִשְׂרָאֵל. **— meaning to purge the evil so that nothing remains except the pure residue needed for Israel.** וְחַד אָמַר: "טַעְמָא דְּבֵית הִלֵּל כְּנֶגֶד יָמִים הַיּוֹצְאִין וְכוּלַּיהּ", **— And one Sage explained: "Beit Hillel's reason corresponds to the outgoing days, etc.",** דְּבֵית הִלֵּל כְּפִי מַדָּתָם סְבִירָא לְהוּ **— for Beit Hillel according to their trait hold** דְּעִקַּר מִצְוַת חֲנֻכָּה לְהַכְנִיס הָאוֹר לְלֵב חָכָם, **— that the essence of Chanukah's mitzvah is bringing light into the wise heart,** שֶׁהַנִּצּוּחַ מֵהָרָע כְּבָר הָיָה בְּכ״ד יָמִים שֶׁקּוֹדֶם עַל יְדֵי כֹּהֲנֶיךָ הַקְּדוֹשִׁים, **— since victory over evil already occurred in the twenty-four preceding days through Your holy priests,** וְעִקַּר נֵר חֲנֻכָּה לִזְכּוֹת לָאוֹר, **— and the core of the Chanukah light is to merit the divine radiance;** וְהַסֵּדֶר לִזְכּוֹת לָאוֹר הוּא מִתַּתָּא לְעֵילָּא: **and the order of meriting light proceeds from below upward:** מַדְלִיק אַחַת וְאַחַר כָּךְ מוֹסִיף וְהוֹלֵךְ, וְעַל כֵּן אָמְרוּ כְּנֶגֶד יָמִים הַיּוֹצְאִין. **— he kindles one and afterward continuously adds, and therefore they said corresponding to the days that have emerged.** מַה שֶּׁאֵין כֵּן בֵּית שַׁמַּאי, מִצַּד מִדַּת הַדִּין דַּרְגָּא דְּיִצְחָק שֶׁהוּא מִדָּתָם כְּמוֹ **— Unlike Beit Shammai, who from the perspective of Strict Judgment, Isaac's level which is their trait in the Zohar,** שֶׁכָּתוּב בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ, סְבִירָא לְהוּ שֶׁעֲדַיִן לֹא יָצְאוּ יְדֵי חוֹבָתָם לְהוֹרִיק הָרָע מִלֵּב כְּסִיל כְּמוֹ שֶׁנִּצְרָךְ, **— hold that people have not yet discharged their duty to purge evil from the foolish heart as required,** וְגַם הַנִּצּוּחַ לְהָרָע הָיָה בַּיָּמִים הָהֵם **— and the victory over evil occurred during those historical days** וּמוֹפִיעַ בְּכָל שָׁנָה בַּזְּמַן הַזֶּה כֹּחַ הַנִּצּוּחַ לְהַיּוֹת "סוּר מֵרָע". **— and re-emerges every year at this season as empowering force to "turn from evil".**

— For this is the meaning of the Gemara's statement: שֶׁזֶּה עִנְיַן מַה שֶּׁכָּתוּב בַּגְּמָרָא: "לְשָׁנָה אַחֶרֶת קְבָעוּם וְכוּלַּיהּ", **"In the following year they established them, etc.",** וְהִקְשָׁה בְּסֵפֶר עֲבוֹדַת יִשְׂרָאֵל: **— and the author of Avodat Yisrael asked:** הֲלֹא זְרִיזִים מַקְדִּימִין לְמִצְוֹות, וּמְדוּעַ הִמְתִּינוּ לְשָׁנָה אַחֶרֶת? **— Behold the zealous expedite mitzvot, so why did they delay until the next year?** אַךְ יֵשׁ לוֹמַר, דְּבְשָׁנָה רִאשׁוֹנָה לֹא יָדְעוּ אִם נִקְבַּע קְדֻשַּׁת יְמֵי חֲנֻכָּה **— However, one can explain that in the first year they did not know whether the sanctity of Chanukah was permanently fixed for all eternity,** וְלֹא יָדְעוּ אִם לִקְבֹּעַ יְמֵי חֲנֻכָּה לְעוֹלָם; **— not knowing whether to institute the days of Chanukah forever;** דְּבְשִׁלְמָא בִּיצִיאַת מִצְרַיִם צִוָּה הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ לִקְבֹּעַ יוֹם טוֹב לְעוֹלְמֵי עַד, **— for granted at the Exodus from Egypt the Blessed Name explicitly commanded to fix a festival for all eternity,** מַה שֶּׁאֵין כֵּן מִצְוַת נֵר חֲנֻכָּה שֶׁהָיָה רַק מִצְוַת זְקֵנִים שֶׁהֵם תִּקְּנוּ, **— unlike the Chanukah light which was merely a Rabbinic enactment instituted by the elders,** לֹא יָדְעוּ בְּשָׁנָה רִאשׁוֹנָה אִם תִּהְיֶה הַקְּדֻשָּׁה נִקְבָּע לְעוֹלְמֵי

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and active good. These are successive gains in the person's response, not merely brighter sensations. The final requirement of deeds helps explain what increasing holiness in the origin is meant to accomplish.

[673] **Zohar, Vayishlach 4:86-6:94**: 'Israel's light, on the other hand, will come little by little, until they will become strong. God will illumine them forever. All then will ask: "Who is she that looketh forth like the dawn", this being a reference to the first tiny streak of the dawn, then "fair as the moon", the light of the moon being stronger than that of the dawn, and then "clear as the sun", that is, a still stronger light, and finally "terrible as an army with banners", expressive of the light in its full strength.'

[674] **Shabbat 21b:6**: "Ulla said: Two Amoraim in the Land of Israel disagreed about the explanation, Rabbi Yosei bar Avin and Rabbi Yosei bar Zevida. One said: Beis Shammai's reason corresponds to the days still to come, and Beis Hillel's reason corresponds to the days that have passed. The other said: Beis Shammai's reason corresponds to the bulls offered on Sukkos, which decrease each day; Beis Hillel's reason is that one ascends in sanctity and does not descend."

עַד בַּזְּמַן הַזֶּה. — **where they did not know in the first year whether this holiness would be permanently fixed for this calendar period.** אַךְ לְשָׁנָה אַחֶרֶת, כְּשֶׁהִרְגִּישׁוּ בַּזְּמַן הַזֶּה הָאוֹר שֶׁהֵאִיר בַּלֵּב,[675] — **Yet in the following year, when they experienced at this season the light radiating in the heart,** קִבְּעוּם לִהְיוֹת מַדְלִיקִין נֵר חֲנֻכָּה וְזֶה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: "וַעֲשָׂאוּם יָמִים — **they established them that all should kindle Chanukah lights forever;** לְעוֹלָם, טוֹבִים בְּהַלֵּל וְהוֹדָאָה", — **and this is why it says: "and established them as festive days with Hallel and Thanksgiving",** שֶׁעַל יְדֵי הַהַלֵּל וְהַהוֹדָאָה יָאִיר הָאוֹר "כִּי טוֹב", — **for through Hallel and Thanksgiving the Primordial Light that is "good" illuminates,** וְעַל יְדֵי כֵן יִזְכּוּ לְהוֹרִיק הָרָע מִלֵּב כְּסִיל בַּזְּמַן הַזֶּה. — **and through this they merit to evacuate evil from the foolish heart at this season.**

Additional Torah instruction answers a particular need for repair

וּבֵית שַׁמַּאי לְפִי מִדָּתָם, דְּהָעִקָּר לְהוֹרִיק הָרָע מִלֵּב כְּסִיל,[676] — **And Beit Shammai according to their trait hold that the primary goal is evacuating evil from the fool's heart,** וְנִצְרָךְ לָזֶה רֹב חָכְמָה לְתַקֵּן הַרְבֵּה כַּעַס, — **requiring for this abundant wisdom (rav chochmah) to rectify abundant grief (rav ka'as),** וְעַל פִּי מַה שֶּׁכָּתוּב (נְדָרִים כ״ב עַמּוּד ב׳):[677] "אִלְמָלֵא חָטְאוּ יִשְׂרָאֵל, לֹא נִתַּן לָהֶם אֶלָּא חֲמִשָּׁה חֻמְשֵׁי תוֹרָה וְכוּלֵיהּ, — **and based on what is stated (Nedarim 22b): "Had Israel not sinned, they would have been given only the Five Books of the Torah, etc.,** כִּי בְּרֹב חָכְמָה רָב כָּעַס". — **for in much wisdom is much grief".** וְעַל כֵּן כָּל זְמַן שֶׁיֵּשׁ רָב כַּעַס, נִצְרָךְ לְעֻמַּת זֶה רֹב חָכְמָה לְתַקֵּן הָרֹב כַּעַס, — **Therefore as long as abundant grief exists, corresponding abundant wisdom is required to heal it,** וְעַל כֵּן אָמְרוּ: יוֹם רִאשׁוֹן מַדְלִיק שְׁמוֹנָה, מִכָּאן וְאֵילָךְ פּוֹחֵת וְהוֹלֵךְ, — **and for this reason they ruled: on the first day he kindles eight, from here on continually decreases;** שֶׁכָּל שֶׁנִּפְחַת הָרַב כַּעַס שֶׁמִּתַּקְנִים אוֹתוֹ, אֵין נִצְרָךְ רַב חָכְמָה גַּם כֵּן כָּל כָּךְ, — **for as the grief diminishes through progressive rectification, so much abundant wisdom is no longer needed,** שֶׁעַל זֶה מוֹרָה הַנֵּרוֹת שֶׁמַּרְמְזִים לְרֹב חָכְמָה, דְּשֶׁמֶן מוֹרֶה עַל חָכְמָה. — **which is signified by the candles alluding to abundant wisdom, since oil points to wisdom.**

וְעִנְיַן שְׁמוֹנָה יָמִים מוֹרִים כְּנֶגֶד הַמִּדּוֹת שֶׁנִּקְרְאוּ יָמִים, וְהֵם שְׁמוֹנָה עַד הוֹד, — **And the matter of eight days points to the sefirot which are termed days,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב (תִּקּוּנֵי זֹהַר תִּקּוּן י״ג):[678] "וְאִיהוּ הוֹד תְּמַנְיָא יוֹמֵי דַּחֲנֻכָּה וְכוּלֵיהּ", — **as written (Tikunei Zohar, Tikun 13): "And it is Hod, the eight days of Chanukah, etc.",** וְהַיְנוּ שֶׁבְּכָל יוֹם מִתְבָּרְרִין בְּמִדָּה אַחַת עַד הוֹד. — **meaning that on each successive day people are clarified in one sefirah up to Hod.** וְאַחַר כָּךְ מִתְבָּרְרִין יִשְׂרָאֵל בִּשְׁתֵּי הַמִּדּוֹת גַּם כֵּן, — **And afterward Israel is clarified in the next two attributes as well,** דְּכֵינָן שֶׁמִּתְבָּרְרִין בִּשְׁמוֹנָה הַמִּדּוֹת מִתְבָּרְרִין מִמֵּילָא "וְעַמֵּךְ כֻּלָּם צַדִּיקִים", בִּקְדֻשָּׁה, — **for once they are clarified in the eight attributes in holiness,** וְכֵן כְּנֶסֶת יִשְׂרָאֵל בְּחִינַת מַלְכוּת שָׁמַיִם, — **automatically is manifested: "And your people are all righteous",**

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[675] **Kedushat Levi, Kedushot for Chanukah, Kedusha Rishona 2**: "This was the intention of the Men of the Great Assembly in "Who performed miracles for our ancestors in those days, at this time": namely, that those kindnesses, miracles, and illuminations that existed then, in the days of Mattityahu son of Yochanan the High Priest, are revealed even now, at this time."

[676] **Likkutei Maamarim, On Book of Joshua 2**: "In Nedarim: Had Israel not sinned, only the five books of Torah and the book of Joshua would have been given to them, because it records the ordering of the Land of Israel, as it says, "For with abundant wisdom comes abundant anger." The commentary in Ein Yaakov leaves a difficulty: why not Psalms and Song of Songs? Proverbs should also have been mentioned. An even greater question concerns Samuel and Kings, which recount what happened with the kings and prophets. Even if they had not sinned and the events had been different, why should these accounts not have been given, including accounts of the righteous David? But the Zohar already teaches that Torah's narratives are not ordinary stories; everything is Torah from which a person learns understanding. In the future it says, "They will no longer teach": when His light spreads over all flesh, they will not need Torah instruction and learning from another. Therefore the Sages frequently call a Torah statement "from the mouth of might," as does the Zohar. God's attribute of might is restraint, concealment of light, and His anger toward the earth's inhabitants. From this side comes Torah that places boundaries around a person; all additional instruction and boundaries for a person come from this side. Thus Ta'anit says that when a Torah scholar burns with anger, Torah is what inflames him. Vows too arise from anger, as explained in Nedarim and Rashi: because of it he is not content with what Torah has prohibited, but adds boundaries for himself."

Likkutei explains why "abundant wisdom" accompanies the problem it repairs: the additional narratives, instruction, and boundaries address concealment that would not require instruction from another if divine light were fully apparent. This gives the ois's diminishing need a specific meaning. It is about instruction needed under concealment, not a direction to forget learning or a claim that wisdom itself is undesirable.

[677] **Nedarim 22b:3**: "Rav Adda son of Rabbi Chanina said: Had Israel not sinned, only the five books of the Torah and the Book of Yehoshua would have been given to them, because the latter describes the arrangement of the Land of Israel. What is the reason for the additional books? 'For with much wisdom comes much anger.'"

[678] **Tikkunei Zohar 27a:8-30a:1**: 'The ninth type of music is with 'joy'. And this is: (Ps. 33:1) Rejoice O righteous-ones in Y"Y. And this is the level of the Righteous-One, the ḥaiy of the worlds. From there, comes joy – and through it is redemption! It is this that is written: (Jer. 23:5) ... the righteous plant ... (Zech. 6:12) ... and from beneath him it will sprout ... Beneath him, specifically – that which is 'the tenth' of everything.'

and likewise Knesset Yisrael which is the Kingdom of Heaven, וּכְמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ (חֶלֶק א׳ קפ״ו עַמּוּד א׳[679]): **and as written in the Holy Zohar (Part I, 186a):** "בְּגִין דִּתְרֵין דַּרְגִּין אִנּוּן וְאִנּוּן חַד, אִנּוּן צִיּוֹן וִירוּשָׁלַיִם", **"Because two levels they are and yet they are one: Zion and Jerusalem, etc.",** וְהַיְנוּ צַדִּיק וְצֶדֶק, — וְכוּלֵיהּ", **— meaning the Tzaddik (Yesod) and Tzedek (Malchut),** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב לְהַלָּן (שָׁם עַמּוּד ב׳)[680]: **— and as written further on (ibid. 186b):** "דְּגְוָנָא דְּהַהוּא נָהָר, רָזָא דְּצַדִּיק דְּאִתְחַבַּר בְּצֶדֶק וְכוּלֵיהּ", **— "After the likeness of that river, the secret of Tzaddik joined with Tzedek, etc.",** וּבְכָל פַּעַם מִתְבָּרְרִין בְּהַמְּדוֹת בִּקְדֻשָּׁה לְהוֹרִיק הָרָע מִלֵּב כְּסִיל, **— and each time they are clarified in holy attributes to purge evil from the foolish heart,** "זֶה לְעֻמַּת זֶה" שֶׁיֵּשׁ גַּם בַּהֲפָךְ נֶגֶד הַמִּדּוֹת. וּשְׁנֵיהֶם — **for there exists a parallel counterpart in the negative dimension opposing the sefirot. –** שֶׁהוּא הַנִּצּוּחַ וַהֲרֵקַת הָרָע מִלֵּב כְּסִיל, **— And both dimensions — the military vanquishing and evacuation of evil from the foolish heart,** וְהוֹפָעַת וּזְרִיחַת הָאוֹר לְלֵב חָכָם לִימִינוֹ — **– and the revelation and radiance of light into the wise heart at his right —** הָיָה עַל יְדֵי כֹּהֲנֶיךָ הַקְּדוֹשִׁים. **— were accomplished through Your holy priests.**

The two attendants join revealed light with a prepared receiver

For Netzach and Hod, Moses and Aaron are their chariot: מֹשֶׁה רַבֵּנוּ נֶצַח וְהוֹד, מֹשֶׁה וְאַהֲרֹן מֶרְכָּבָה לָהֶם:[681, 682] — **Moses our Teacher to Netzach on the right axis,** שֶׁהָיָה כְּמוֹ אַבְרָהָם אָבִינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם לְמִדַּת נֶצַח שֶׁהוּא מִקּוֹ יְמָנִי, — **who was like Abraham publicizing God to be acknowledged as God of the earth,** שֶׁפִּרְסֵם אֱלֹהוּתוֹ יִתְבָּרַךְ שְׁיִּהְיֶה נִקְרָא אֱלֹהֵי הָאָרֶץ, וְכֵן מֹשֶׁה רַבֵּנוּ הוֹרִיד הַשְׁכִינָה לָאָרֶץ כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב (בְּרֵאשִׁית רַבָּה פָּרָשָׁה י״ט)[683] — **and likewise Moses brought the Shechinah down to earth (Bereishit Rabbah 19),** וְהוּא שׁוּשְׁבִינָא דְּמַלְכָּא; — **and he is the Best Man of the King (shushvina de-malka);** וְאַהֲרֹן מֶרְכָּבָה לְמִדַּת הוֹד שֶׁהוּא מִקּוֹ שְׂמֹאל, — **and Aaron is the chariot for Hod on the left axis,** שֶׁהוּא שׁוּשְׁבִינָא דְּמַטְרוֹנִיתָא (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב זֹהַר חֶלֶק ג׳ נ״ג עַמּוּד ב׳)[684] — **who is the**

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[679] **Zohar, Vayeshev 13:143-15:153**: ‘Further, when the world was created, it was started from that spot which is the culmination and perfection of the world, the central point of the universe, which is identical with Zion, as it is written: “A psalm of Asaph. God, God the Lord hath spoken and called the earth from the rising of the sun unto the going down thereof. Out of Zion, the perfection of beauty, God hath shined forth” (Ps. 50, 2). That is to say, God started the earth from Zion, from the spot where faith culminates in its full perfection. Zion is thus the citadel and central point of the universe, from which it began to be fashioned and from which the whole world is nourished.’

[680] **Zohar, Vayeshev 16:157 (printed gloss; I, 186b)**: ““River” alludes to the holy covenant impressed in his flesh, which is the likeness of that river: the mystery of the righteous one, who is joined with righteousness as one above. Therefore a person below must unite with his wife in holiness, so that he may be firmly established in that world.”

[681] **Tiferet Yosef, Pekudei 2**: “The King’s attendant means recognizing how God draws close to creation: when a person yields himself and gives of himself, whether in money or in strength, God correspondingly dwells with him, and he recognizes his connection with God. Then the Matron’s attendant is needed: he must see that the person does not nullify himself entirely, but remains alive in this world. Since the person sees that his service has a place with God and that God desires his service, he must remain alive in order to serve God further. If a person were to nullify himself altogether and not remain alive at all, that would not be God’s will.”

Tiferet adds a safeguard within the two-attendant structure: drawing close to God must leave a living person capable of further service. This makes the receiving side an active and necessary task, rather than merely the absence of impurity. It supplements the origin’s description of Aaron preparing Israel to receive and sustain divine light.

[682] **Tzidkat HaTzadik 172:1**: “The High Priest bore the sins of all Israel. In Yosippon one sees that everyone called him “the one who atones for all Israel”: he removes every kind of ugliness and adorns Israel with every kind of beauty, like Aaron, the Matron’s attendant. This is also the Holy of Holies and Shabbat. But Moses, who was called king, is the King’s attendant, showing Israel the light of the King’s face, in which there is life, the King of the world. This is the holiness of the festivals. In this particular matter of attaining God’s light, the flow for the entire year comes from the pilgrimage festivals, about which it says, “He shall appear … before the face.”

Tzidkat defines the distinct direction of each attendant’s work: Aaron beautifies Israel as receiver, while Moses reveals the King’s light to Israel. It then shows how that distinction organizes forms of sacred time as well. This explains why the origin’s two sides can cooperate in one priestly illumination without erasing their different tasks.

[683] **Bereshit Rabbah 19:7** (excerpt): “The Divine Presence originally dwelled below. When Adam sinned, it withdrew to the first heaven. Cain sinned, and it withdrew to the second heaven; the generation of Enosh, to the third; the generation of the Flood, to the fourth; the generation of the Dispersion, to the fifth; the Sodomites, to the sixth; and the Egyptians in Abraham’s days, to the seventh. Corresponding to them, seven righteous men arose: Abraham, Isaac, Jacob, Levi, Kehat, Amram, and Moshe. Abraham brought it down to the sixth heaven; Isaac, from the sixth to the fifth; Jacob, from the fifth to the fourth; Levi, from the fourth to the third; Kehat, from the third to the second; Amram, from the second to the first. Moshe arose and brought it down from above to below.”

[684] **Zohar, Metzora 6:20**: “R. Judah and R. Isaac were once travelling together. They stopped at a certain field to pray, and then went on. R. Judah then commenced a discourse on the Torah, taking for his text: “She is a tree of life to them that lay hold of her and happy is every one that retaineth her” (Prov. 3, 18). ‘The “tree of life” is the Torah, which is a great and mighty tree. It is called Torah (lit. showing) because it shows and reveals that which was hidden and unknown; and all life from above is comprised in it and issues from it. He that “takes hold” of the Torah takes hold of all, above and below. “They that retain her” are those who put the profit of merchandise into the purses of students of the Torah; such become worthy of having a progeny of faithful prophets. Such, too, “retain” her from the beginning, which is Wisdom, to the “end of the body”, and become pillars of the faith.’”

Best Man of the Queen (shushvina de-matronita) (Zohar Part III, 53b), שֻׁהוּא הַמְכַפֵּר וּמְקַשֵּׁט לַמַּטְרוֹנִיתָא כְּנֶסֶת יִשְׂרָאֵל שֶׁתִּהְיֶה נוֹשֵׂאת חֵן בְּעֵינֵי הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא, — **who atones and adorns the Queen, Knesset Yisrael, that she find grace in the eyes of the Holy One,** וְכָל עֵסֶק הַקָּרְבָּנוֹת וּקְדֻשַּׁת יוֹם הַכִּפּוּרִים עַל יְדֵי אַהֲרֹן הַכֹּהֵן. — **and all sacrificial worship and Yom Kippur sanctity operates through Aaron the Priest.** וּמִכָּל מָקוֹם מָצִינוּ בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ (שָׁם קמ״ו עַמּוּד א׳)[685]: "דְּכֹהֵן מַחֲסָד אָתֵי", — **And nevertheless we find in the Holy Zohar (ibid. 146a): "A priest derives from Chesed",** וְהוּא עַל פִּי מַה שֶּׁנֶּאֱמַר: "כִּי שִׂפְתֵי כֹהֵן יִשְׁמְרוּ דַעַת וְגוֹמֵר", — **and this is based on Scripture: "For the priest's lips shall guard knowledge (Da'at), etc.",** וְדַעַת הוּא חִבּוּר יְמִינָא וּשְׂמָאלָא, חָכְמָה וּבִינָה, מוֹחָא וְלִבָּא, כַּיְדוּעַ. — **and Da'at is the synthesis of right and left, Chochmah and Binah, brain and heart, as is known.**

Torah supplies a path through which the heart can be cleared

וְכֵן הָיָה שֶׁהַנִּצּוּחַ שָׁהָיָה עַל יְדֵי שֶׁזָּכוּ לְהוֹרִיק הָרָע מִלֵּב כְּסִיל לִשְׂמֹאלוֹ[686,687] — **And so it was: the victory through evacuating evil from the foolish heart at the left,** וְכֵן הַזְרִיחָה לְהַכְנִיס אוֹר לְלֵב חָכָם לִימִינוֹ, — **as well as the illumination introducing light into the wise heart at the right,** שְׁנֵיהֶם הָיוּ עַל יְדֵי כֹּהֲנֶיךָ הַקְּדוֹשִׁים, — **both were achieved through Your holy priests,** עַל יְדֵי הַדְלָקַת הַנֵּרוֹת שֶׁזּוֹכִין לְהָאִיר, כְּמַה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: "אֵל ה' וַיָּאֶר לָנוּ". — **through kindling the lights wherein we merit illumination, as stated: "God is Hashem, and He shone light upon us".** וְעַל יְדֵי שֶׁזּוֹכִין לְאוֹר תּוֹרָה זוֹכִין לְהוֹרִיק הָרָע מִלֵּב כְּסִיל, — **And through meriting Torah light, we merit to evacuate evil from the foolish heart,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ (חֵלֶק א׳ ר״ב עַמּוּד א׳)[688] — **as written in the Holy Zohar (Part I, 202a):** "דְּהָא לֵית לָךְ מְלָה לְתַבְרָא יֵצֶר הָרָע אֶלָּא אוֹרַיְתָא"; — **"For you have no instrument to shatter the Evil Inclination except Torah";** וְכֵן אָמְרוּ (שָׁם ק״צ עַמּוּד א׳)[689]: "דְּכַד חָמֵי בַּר נָשׁ דְּהַרְהוּרִין בִּישִׁין אָתְיָן לְגַבֵּיהּ, יִתְעַסַּק בְּאוֹרַיְתָא וּכְדֵין יִתְעַבְּרוּן מִנֵּיהּ". — **"When a man sees unholy thoughts approaching him, let him engage in Torah and they will vanish from him".** וְעַל יְדֵי הָאָרַת הַנֵּרוֹת זוֹכִין לִשְׁנֵי הָעִנְיָנִים: — **And through the candles' illumination we merit both dimensions:** לְהוֹרִיק הָרָע מֵחֲלַל לֵב הַשְּׂמָאלִי, — **to purge evil from the left chamber of the heart,** וּלְהַכְנִיס קְדֻשָּׁה וְאוֹר לְלֵב חָכָם לִימִינוֹ. — **and to introduce holiness and light into the wise heart at his right.**

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[685] **Zohar, Nasso 15:146**: “From this koh judgments are aroused. When Chesed joins with it, it is sweetened. Therefore this was entrusted to the priest, who comes from Chesed, so that koh may be blessed and sweetened. Thus it is written: “Thus [koh] shall you bless”—although this koh is found amid judgments, sweeten it and bless it, as it is written: “Thus shall you bless the children of Israel.” Through this Chesed, bless koh and sweeten it toward Israel, so that judgments may not be found in it.”

[686] **Sod Yesharim, The First Day of Pesach 15:1**: “Draw out and take for yourselves sheep.” The Mekhilta explains: withdraw your hands from idolatry and take sheep for a commandment. This is “The way of the lazy person is like a hedge of thorns, but the path of the upright is paved.” My holy grandfather explained that Israel were then beginning a new order and leaving their former habit. As long as they were without Torah, it was called a hedge of thorns: when a person emerges from a thought of anger, he introduces a thought of desire into his heart; when he purifies himself of desire, he introduces the defect of anger. Without Torah it is impossible to clean the heart, as with prophets of the nations who wished to purify themselves without Torah and could not. Only through Torah is there a paved path for cleaning the heart. The Midrash on Song of Songs explains “For the fragrance of your good oils”: if a word of Torah enters the heart, a word of frivolity leaves opposite it; if a word of frivolity enters the heart, a word of Torah leaves opposite it.”
Sod Yesharim explains why removing one bad thought is not yet a settled path: without positive guidance the person may simply move from anger to desire or back again. Torah provides the directed alternative. This develops the exact relation asserted in the origin between bringing Torah’s light into the heart and emptying its evil.

[687] **Dover Tzedek, Kuntres Ner HaMitzvot 2:51**: “They answered Job that there is Torah as a seasoning: the wisdom God created in a person. Thus it is said of Abraham, before the giving of Torah, that his two kidneys became like two springs flowing with wisdom; according to several opinions Job too lived before the giving of Torah. But this path is very difficult to reach. As the Sages say of “One out of a thousand I found”: this is Abraham. Those two thousand years were desolation until Torah was given and the path was broadened for everyone in the world. Through the wisdom in his mind a person can contemplate and find God’s way and overcome his bodily powers, because he understands and knows that this is harmful to him, and directs them to another way.”
Dover explains the “seasoning” through discernment and the redirection of bodily powers. It also distinguishes Abraham’s exceptional access before revelation from the broader path opened by Torah. This gives the origin’s remedy a concrete intellectual and practical form: the learner understands the harm and directs the faculties elsewhere.

[688] **Zohar, Miketz 12:194-206**: ‘Alas for that day, a day of wrath and indignation! Hence it behoves man to contend daily with his evil prompter and to picture to himself the day when he will stand before the King to be judged, when they will lower him into the ground to rot there, whilst the soul will become separated from him. We have been taught that it behoves man always to rouse the good prompter against the evil prompter; if the latter departs, well and good, but if not, the man should study the Torah, as there is nothing so well calculated to crush the evil prompter as the Torah; if he departs, well and good, but if not, let the man remind him of the day of death so as thereby to subdue him.’

[689] **Zohar, Vayeshev 22:223**: “Rabbi Yosei said: When a person sees evil thoughts coming upon him, he should engage in Torah, and then they will pass away from him. Rabbi Elazar said: When that evil side comes to entice a person, he should draw it toward the Torah, and it will withdraw from him.”

Chanukah Ois 9

The Chanukah Celebration and the Meaning of Dedication

The ois reads “made” and “established” as the creation of an enduring experience of the good light through Hallel and thanksgiving. It distinguishes this sanctity from the obligations of a festival meal and cessation from work.

The Chanukah Celebration and the Meaning of Dedication

בַּגְּמָרָא: "לְשָׁנָה אַחֶרֶת קְבָעוּם וַעֲשָׂאוּם יָמִים טוֹבִים בְּהַלֵּל וְהוֹדָאָה". — **In the Gemara: "In the following year they established them and made them festive days with Hallel and Thanksgiving".** וְהוּא שֶׁהַיּוֹם טוֹב הוּא רַק לוֹמַר דְּאִיתָא (עֲרָכִין י׳ בָּהֶם הַלֵּל, — **And that means the festival character is restricted to reciting Hallel on them,** שֶׁשַּׁבָּת וְכוּלֵיהּ לֹא אִקְרִי מוֹעֵד; — **for it states (Arachin 10b):** "**Shabbat, etc., is not called an appointed festival (mo'ed);**[690] רֹאשׁ חֹדֶשׁ וְכוּלֵיהּ לֹא אִקְדַּשׁ בַּעֲשִׂיַּת מְלָאכָה וְכוּלֵיהּ; — **Rosh Chodesh, etc., is not sanctified with the prohibition of labor, etc.;** לַיְלָה הַמְקֻדָּשׁ לָחָג טָעוּן שִׁירָה וְכוּלֵיהּ", — **a night sanctified for the festival requires song, etc.",** וְהָא חֲנֻכָּה דְּלֹא הָכִי וְלֹא הָכִי וְקָאָמַר?", — **and asks: "Yet behold Chanukah is neither this nor that, and we recite it?",** וּמְשַׁנֵּי: "מִשּׁוּם נִיסָּא". — **and answers: "Because of the miracle".** וְהַיְנוּ שֶׁעַל יְדֵי הַנֵּס הָיָה בְּכֹחַ כֹּהֲנִים הַקְּדוֹשִׁים לַעֲשׂוֹת אוֹתָם כְּיוֹם טוֹב לְעָנְיַן קְרִיאַת הַלֵּל, — **Meaning that through the miracle it was within the power of the holy priests to render them like a festival regarding the recitation of Hallel,** אַף דְּלֹא אִקְרִי מוֹעֵד וְלֹא נֶאֱסַר בִּמְלָאכָה. — **even though it is not called an appointed season and is not prohibited in creative labor.** וְזֶה שֶׁאָמְרוּ בִּלְשׁוֹן "קְבָעוּם וַעֲשָׂאוּם", — **And this is why they stated using the phrase "established them and made them",** וְלֹא אָמְרוּ: תִּקְנוּ לַעֲשׂוֹתוֹ יוֹם טוֹב בְּהַלֵּל אוֹ צִוּוּ לַעֲשׂוֹתוֹ יוֹם טוֹב וְכוּלֵיהּ. — **and did not say: they instituted to make it a festival with Hallel or commanded to make it a festival, etc.** אַךְ לְשׁוֹן "עֲשָׂאוּם" הוּא עַל דֶּרֶךְ שֶׁמָּצִינוּ (שַׁבָּת קי״ט עַמּוּד א׳, קִדּוּשִׁין ל״א עַמּוּד א׳):[691, 692] — **However, the expression "made them" is patterned after what we find (Shabbat 119a, Kiddushin 31a):** "עֲבִידְנָא יוֹמָא טָבָא לְרַבָּנַן", — **"I will make a festive day for the Rabbis",** וּפֵרֵשׁ רַבִּי שְׁלֹמֹה יִצְחָקִי: "סְעוּדָה"; — **and Rashi explained: "a feast";** וְאָמַרְנוּ שֶׁהַמְכֻוָּן בִּלְשׁוֹן "עֲבִידְנָא יוֹם טוֹב" — **and we explained that the intention in the phrase "I will make a festive day"** הוּא שֶׁהָיָה בְּכֹחָם עַל יְדֵי שִׂמְחָה שֶׁל מִצְוָה שֶׁהָיָה בְּהַסְעוּדָה — **is that it was in their spiritual power through the joy of the mitzvah present in the feast —** אוֹ מִסִּיּוּם הַמַּסֶּכֶת — מִמַּה שֶּׁשָּׁמַח עַל שֶׁשָּׁמַע דַּהֲלָכָה כְּרַבִּי יְהוּדָה וְאַחַר כָּךְ דְּאֵין הֲלָכָה כְּרַבִּי יְהוּדָה — **— from completing a tractate or rejoicing over hearing that the halachah follows Rabbi Yehudah and later that it does not —** לְהַכְנִיס קְדֻשָּׁה בְּהַסְעוּדָה שֶׁיַּרְגִּישׁ הָאוֹכְלָהּ מַאוֹר "כִּי טוֹב", — **to inject holiness into the meal so that the eater senses the Primordial Light that was "good",** וְעַל זֶה מוֹרֶה "יוֹם טוֹב": — **and to this points "Yom Tov" (good day):** "יוֹם" הַיְנוּ אוֹר, כְּמַה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: "וַיִּקְרָא אֱלֹהִים לָאוֹר יוֹם", — **"day" refers to light, as Scripture states: "And God called the light Day",** וְכֵן "טוֹב", כְּמַה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: "וַיַּרְא אֱלֹהִים אֶת הָאוֹר כִּי טוֹב". — **and likewise "good", as stated: "And God saw the light that it was good".**

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[690] **Arakhin 10b**: 'The Gemara objects: On the New Moon, which is called an appointed day, let us say hallel. The Gemara explains: The New Moon is not sanctified with regard to the prohibition against the performance of labor, and hallel is recited only on a day that is sanctified, as it is written: "You shall have a song as in the night when a festival is sanctified" (Isaiah 30:29), which indicates that a night that is sanctified as a Festival, which includes a prohibition of labor, requires song, but one that is not sanctified as a Festival does not require song.'

[691] **Shabbat 118b:14**; **Shabbat 119a:1**: "Rav Yosef asked Rav Yosef son of Rabbah, 'In what mitzvah was your father especially careful?' He answered, 'Tzitzis.' One day Rabbah was going up a ladder when a thread of his tzitzis broke. He did not come down until he had replaced it. Abaye also said: 'May I be rewarded for this: Whenever I see a Torah scholar who has completed his tractate, I make a festive day for the Sages.' Rava said, 'May I be rewarded for this: When a Torah scholar comes before me for judgment, I do not lay my head upon my pillow until I have examined the arguments in his favor.' Mar bar Rav Ashi said, 'I am disqualified from judging a Torah scholar. Why? Because he is as dear to me as my own self, and a person does not see grounds of liability against himself.'"

[692] **Kiddushin 31a:12**: "Rav Yosef said: At first I used to say: If anyone tells me that the halachah follows Rabbi Yehudah, who says that a blind person is exempt from the mitzvos, I will make a festive day for the Sages, because I am not commanded and nevertheless perform them. Now that I have heard Rabbi Chanina's teaching that one who is commanded and performs is greater than one who is not commanded and performs, I say the opposite: If anyone tells me that the halachah does not follow Rabbi Yehudah, I will make a festive day for the Sages."

Praise makes the festival's light perceptible

וְכֵן פֵּרוּשׁ "עֲשָׂאוּם יָמִים טוֹבִים"[693, 694], — **And so is the meaning of "they made them festive days":** שֶׁהַחַשְׁמוֹנָאִים עָשׂוּ הַיָּמִים יוֹם טוֹב שֶׁיַּרְגִּישׁוּ בָּהֶם הָאוֹר "כִּי טוֹב", — **that the Hasmoneans made these days a Yom Tov so people would feel the light that is "good",** אַךְ לֹא לְעִנְיַן סְעוּדָה וּמְלָאכָה, רַק לְעִנְיַן הַלֵּל וְהוֹדָאָה; — **yet not regarding feasts and abstention from work, but regarding Hallel and Thanksgiving;** וְאָמְרוּ "וְקָבְעוּם", שֶׁקָּבְעוּ לְדוֹרוֹת. — **and they stated "established them", fixing for all generations** שֶׁיִּהְיֶה הָרְגֵּשׁ הָאוֹר "כִּי טוֹב" קָבוּעַ וְקַיָּם לְדוֹרוֹת — **that the sensation of the light that is "good" remain permanent for all generations.** וְהַטַּ"ז (סִימָן תר״ע סָעִיף קָטָן ג')[695] הֲבִיא מֵהַלְּבוּשׁ שֶׁבְּפוּרִים הָיָה הַצָּלַת נְפָשׁוֹת, וְעַל כֵּן יֵשׁ בּוֹ מִצְוַת מִשְׁתֶּה, — **And the Taz (Section 670, subsection 3) cited from the Levush that on Purim physical salvation occurred, and therefore it contains a mitzvah of feasting,** מַה שֶּׁאֵין כֵּן בַּחֲנֻכָּה שֶׁהַיְוָנִים גָּזְרוּ רַק הֶעֱבֶרַת דָּת; — **unlike Chanukah where the Greeks decreed only spiritual eradication;** וְכָתַב הַטַּ"ז דְּאֵינוֹ נָכוֹן, שֶׁגָּדוֹל הַמַּחֲטִיאוֹ יוֹתֵר מִן הַהוֹרְגוֹ. — **and the Taz wrote that this is incorrect, for one who causes another to sin is worse than one who kills him.**

אֲבָל בֶּאֱמֶת יֵשׁ לוֹמַר דְּוַדַּאי גָּדוֹל הַמַּחֲטִיאוֹ, — **However, in truth one can say that certainly spiritual destruction is worse,** וּגְזֵרַת הַיְוָנִים הָיְתָה גְּדוֹלָה וְקָשָׁה מִשֶּׁל הָמָן; — **and the decree of the Greeks was greater and harsher than Haman's;** אֲבָל מִכָּל מָקוֹם לְעִנְיַן סְעוּדָה שֶׁיִּהְיֶה מְצַוֶּה לְעַנֵּג אֶת הַגּוּף, — **nevertheless regarding a feast commanding bodily delight,** לֹא יִתָּכֵן רַק בְּפוּרִים שֶׁהָיָה הַנֵּס גַּם לַגּוּף, — **it is fitting only on Purim where the miracle pertained directly to the physical body,** שֶׁמּוֹרֶה שֶׁחָבִיב לִפְנֵי הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ גּוּפֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל שֶׁיֵּשׁ בָּהֶם קְדֻשָּׁה, — **showing that Jewish physical bodies which contain holiness are beloved before the Blessed Name,** וְעַל כֵּן תִּקְּנוּ בּוֹ מִצְוַת סְעוּדָה לְעַנֵּג גַּם אֶת הַגּוּף; — **and therefore they instituted on it a feast to delight the body as well;** מַה שֶּׁאֵין כֵּן בַּחֲנֻכָּה שֶׁרָצוּ רַק "לְהַשְׁכִּיחָם תּוֹרָתֶךָ", — **unlike Chanukah where they plotted only "to make them forget Your Torah",** אַף שֶׁגָּדוֹל מִן הַהוֹרְגוֹ, מִכָּל מָקוֹם הַנֵּס הָיָה רַק לְנִשְׁמוֹת יִשְׂרָאֵל וְלֹא לַגּוּף, — **even though spiritual harm is worse than death, nevertheless the rescue pertained to Jewish souls and not bodies,** וְהוּא רַק שִׂמְחָה בְּדִבְרֵי תוֹרָה שֶׁזָּכוּ לְאוֹר תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה בְּיֶתֶר שְׂאֵת, — **and it is solely rejoicing in Torah words as they merited the Oral Torah's light with immense vigor,** וְעַל זֶה לֹא תִּקְּנוּ מִשְׁתֶּה, — **and for this they did not institute physical feasting.** דְּאִיתָא (פֶּרֶק ו' דְּאָבוֹת)[696]: "כָּךְ הִיא דַּרְכָּהּ שֶׁל תּוֹרָה: פַּת בְּמֶלַח תֹּאכַל וְכוּ'", — **For it states (Avot 6:4): "Such is the way of Torah: bread with salt you shall eat, etc.",** וְהַיְנוּ עַמְלֵי תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה, — **referring to those who toil in the Oral Torah,** שֶׁכָּל מִי שֶׁאוֹהֵב תַּעֲנוּג אֵינוֹ יָכוֹל לִלְמֹד דְּאִיתָא (מִדְרַשׁ תַּנְחוּמָא נֹחַ ג') —

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[693] **Peri Tzadik, Chanukah 8:5**: "This explains the Talmud's statement, "The following year they established them," and so forth. Avodat Yisrael asks: the zealous hasten to perform mitzvot, so why did they wait until the following year? One may answer that in the first year they did not know whether the holiness of Chanukah's days had been established forever, and thus did not know whether to establish these days permanently. At the Exodus, God commanded that a festival be established forever. The mitzvah of the Chanukah lamp, however, was instituted by the elders, and in the first year they did not know whether holiness would be permanently established at this time. In the following year, when they felt at this season the light that had shone in the heart, they established the lighting of the Chanukah lamp forever. This is "They made them festive days through Hallel and thanksgiving": through Hallel and thanksgiving the light called "good" shines, and through it they can empty the evil from the foolish heart at this time."
The preceding ois explains how the permanent establishment described here was recognized: the light returned in the following year. It also gives the praise an inward task, removing evil from the heart. Together these points explain why "made" and "established" mean more here than issuing a calendar ordinance.

[694] **Sod Yesharim, Shabbat Chol HaMoed Sukkot 36:1**: "As my grandfather, the holy master of blessed memory, said: the reason the psalm "Praise the Lord from the heavens" does not also enumerate the waters beneath the earth is that it speaks of praise. When a person praises and extols the blessed God, from that person's standpoint there are no lower waters: everything is upper waters. Thus, through the light of Joseph the righteous person's quality, everything is counted as upper waters; even the waters beneath the earth are upper. The entire distinction between upper and lower waters arises from the concealment within human perception. Against that concealment the quality of Joseph the righteous, called "heavens," continually shines. This is "He establishes it every day, without ceasing ... to illuminate them continually": it continually gives Israel counsel to refine, through their service, the concealment that divides the limits of their perception, until even within their lowly perception they understand that everything is upper waters."
Sod Yesharim gives a concrete account of what praise changes: the person recognizes the divine source even within what had appeared to be a lower domain. This illuminates Rav Tzadok's claim that Hallel makes the good light felt. Its continuing work of refinement also explains why praise must be lived repeatedly; the passage does not independently establish Chanukah's calendar law.

[695] **Turei Zahav on Shulchan Arukh, Orach Chayim 670:3**: "The Levush made a distinction, saying that on Purim lives were saved, whereas on Chanukah lives were not saved, because the Greeks did not seek their lives but only their subjugation and abandonment of their religion. This is not correct, for Rashi explained in Parashat Ki Tetze that causing a person to sin is worse than killing him."

[696] **Pirkei Avot 6:4**: 'Such is the way of a life of Torah: you shall eat bread with salt, and rationed water shall you drink; you shall sleep on the ground, your life will be one of privation, and in Torah shall you labor. If you do this, "Happy shall you be and it shall be good for you" (Psalms 128:2): "Happy shall you be" in this world, "and it shall be good for you" in the world to come.'

תּוֹרָה[697] שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה, — **as stated (Midrash Tanchuma Noach 3) that anyone who loves physical luxury cannot master the Oral Torah,** לְפִי שֶׁיֵּשׁ בָּהּ צַעַר גָּדוֹל וּנְדוּד שֵׁנָה וְכוּלֵיהּ. — **because it entails great exertion, wandering of sleep, etc.**

The joy of Oral Torah can be sustained through restraint

וְכֵן יוֹם הַכִּפּוּרִים,[698, 699] דְּאִיתָא בְּפֶרֶק ד׳ דְּתַעֲנִית: — **And likewise Yom Kippur, as stated in Chapter 4 of Ta'anit:** "לֹא הָיוּ יָמִים טוֹבִים לְיִשְׂרָאֵל כַּחֲמִשָּׁה עָשָׂר בְּאָב וּכְיוֹם הַכִּפּוּרִים", — **"There were no greater festive days for Israel than the Fifteenth of Av and Yom Kippur",** מִכָּל מָקוֹם יוֹם הַכִּפּוּרִים הוּא תַּעֲנִית; — **nevertheless Yom Kippur is a fast;** וְהֵינוּ דְּשִׂמְחַת יוֹם הַכִּפּוּרִים שֶׁבּוֹ נִתְּנוּ לֻחוֹת אַחֲרוֹנוֹת, — **and that is because the joy of Yom Kippur stems from the giving of the second Tablets,** וְאִיתָא (שְׁמוֹת רַבָּה פָּרָשָׁה מ״ו ופָּרָשָׁה מ״ז):[700] — **and it states (Shemot Rabbah, Parashah 46 and 47):** "וּבַלֻּחוֹת הַשְּׁנִיִּים אֲנִי נוֹתֵן לְךָ שֶׁיִּהְיֶה בָּהֶן מִדְרָשׁ, הֲלָכוֹת, וְאַגָּדוֹת וְכוּלֵיהּ", — **"And in the second Tablets I give you that within them shall be Midrash, Halachot, and Aggadot, etc.",** וְעַל כֵּן אַף שֶׁבַּעֲצֶרֶת שֶׁהוּא זְמַן מַתַּן תּוֹרָה שֶׁנִּתְּנוּ לֻחוֹת רִאשׁוֹנוֹת יֵשׁ בּוֹ מִצְוַת שִׂמְחָה וַאֲכִילָה, — **and therefore even though on Shavuot which commemorates the first Tablets there is a mitzvah of rejoicing and eating,** וְהַכֹּל מוֹדִים בַּעֲצֶרֶת דְּבָעֵינַן נַמֵּי "לָכֶם" (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב פְּסָחִים ס״ח עַמּוּד ב׳);[701] — **and all concede on Shavuot that we require "for yourselves" (Pesachim 68b);** מִכָּל מָקוֹם בְּיוֹם הַכִּפּוּרִים שֶׁהוּא קְדֻשַּׁת הַיּוֹם טוֹב לְיִשְׂרָאֵל שֶׁנִּתְּנוּ בּוֹ לֻחוֹת אַחֲרוֹנוֹת שֶׁכָּלוּל בָּהֶם כָּל הַתּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה, — **nevertheless on Yom Kippur which is the festival of the second Tablets incorporating the entire Oral Torah,** אֵין בּוֹ מִצְוַת אֲכִילָה וְאַדְרַבָּה הוּא יוֹם צוֹם, — **it contains no mitzvah of**

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[697] **Midrash Tanchuma, Noach 3:4**: "The Israelites did not accept the Torah until the Holy One, blessed be He, arched the mountain over them like a vessel, as it is said: And they stood beneath the mountain (Exod. 19:17). R. Dimi the son of Hama stated that the Holy One, blessed be He, told Israel: If you accept the Torah, well and good; but if not, your grave will be there. If you should say that He arched the mountain over them because of the Written Law, isn't it true that as soon as He said to them, "Will you accept the Torah?" they all responded, "We will do and hear," because the Written Law was brief and required no striving and suffering, but rather He threatened them because of the Oral Law. After all, it contains the detailed explanations of the commandments, both simple and difficult, and it is as severe as death, and as jealous as Sheol. One does not study the Oral Law unless he loves the Holy One, blessed be He, with all his heart, with all his soul, and with all his might, as it is said: And thou shalt love the Lord thy God with all thy heart, with all thy soul, and with all thy might (Deut. 6:5)."

[698] **Sod Yesharim, Yom Kippur 18:1**: "This will is called in the holy Zohar "the bread eaten by the companions": "Wisdom gives life to its possessors," for they eat nourishment of spirit and soul, and do not eat bodily nourishment at all. It is from a lofty place, more precious than all, called wisdom. The revelation of this clear will occurs in the tenth, for "the seventh is only from within the tenth": the third day after the seventh day, in which the utterance "Let the earth sprout vegetation" shone. This explains its statement, "God said, 'Let the earth sprout vegetation' ... this is what is written, 'You shall afflict your souls on the ninth of the month in the evening.'" In the tenth, a clear will is awakened, called "Let the earth sprout vegetation." It is the preparation for human food and alludes to the root of the will that desires human service. Therefore the person must remove the garments of this world included in the five afflictions. Without these five afflictions it is altogether impossible to rise to the root of that clear will awakened on Yom Kippur. As the holy Zohar says, "On this day it shines from the supernal light, and not from the light of the sun ... for she receives from the mother's house, not from the father's house." The light has not yet broken through into these lower garments; it shines far above them. Therefore these lower garments must be restrained in order to reach the light of the will shining above them."

Sod Yesharim explains the same image of "nourishment of spirit and soul" used later in this paragraph. Fasting permits reception of a light that has not yet become accessible through bodily garments. This gives positive content to restraint: the day's joy has a nourishment of its own. The explanation concerns Yom Kippur's five afflictions; it supplies no additional fasting requirement for Chanukah.

[699] **Yisrael Kedoshim 10:26**: "It is known from Tikkunei Zohar that Yom HaKippurim means "like Purim." This follows what I have written: at Purim they accepted Oral Torah in love, after the compulsion at Mount Sinai. The root of this was already present on Yom Kippur, when the latter tablets were received. From God's side, He became reconciled with them in love; they no longer needed the mountain to be held over them. The Israelites themselves drew near and sat in fasting, affliction, and separation from the pleasures of this world. Through this, "Oral Torah is acquired ... through a minimum of pleasure." This was the beginning of the revelation of this holy light within Israel's hearts."

Yisrael Kedoshim identifies the inner change behind the fast: Israel now approaches voluntarily, and the restraint expresses its acceptance of the labor of Oral Torah. That explains how the second tablets can be a source of festival joy on a day without eating. The quotation ends before the subsequent contrast with Purim, whose commanded drinking has its own explanation.

[700] **Shemot Rabbah 46:1** (excerpt): "Moshe began to grieve over the breaking of the Tablets. The Holy One, blessed be He, said to him: Do not grieve over the first Tablets, which contained only the Ten Commandments. In the second Tablets I give you laws, Midrash, and Aggadot. This is what is written: 'He would tell you the hidden things of wisdom, for they are double in understanding' (Job 11:6). Moreover, you are announcing that I have forgiven your transgression, as it says, 'Know that God has remitted some of your iniquity' (Job 11:6)."

[701] **Pesachim 68b:10**: "The mnemonic is Ayin Beis Mem. Rabbi Elazar said: Everyone agrees that on Shavuos there must also be enjoyment 'for you.' Why? It is the day on which Torah was given. Rabbah said: Everyone agrees that on Shabbos there must also be enjoyment 'for you.' Why? 'You shall call Shabbos a delight.' Rav Yosef said: Everyone agrees that on Purim there must also be enjoyment 'for you.' Why? It is described as 'days of feasting and joy.'"

eating, and on the contrary is a fast day, שֶׁכֵּן הוּא דַּרְכָּהּ שֶׁל תּוֹרָה וְכוּלֵיהּ. **— for such is the path of Torah, etc.** ,וּכְבָר אָמַרְנוּ בְּמַה שֶּׁכָּתוּב: "וְאַל תִּתְאַוֶּה לְשֻׁלְחָנָם שֶׁל מְלָכִים וְכוּלֵיהּ", **— And we already explained regarding: "And do not lust after the table of kings, etc.",** שֶׁבְּוַדַּאי מִי שֶׁמֻּרְגָּל בְּפַת בָּמֶלַח לֹא יִתְאַוֶּה לְתַעֲנוּגִים, **— that certainly one accustomed to bread with salt would not lust after worldly luxuries,** וַהֲוָה לֵיהּ לְמֵימַר שֶׁאַל תִּתְאַוֶּה לְמַאֲכָלִים טוֹבִים; **— and it should have said: do not lust after fine foods;** רַק הַמְּכֻוָּן לְשֻׁלְחָן שְׁלֹמֹה הַמֶּלֶךְ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם שֶׁנִּכְתְּבָה סְעֻדָּתוֹ בְּדִבְרֵי תוֹרָה, שֶׁהִיא אֲכִילָה בִּקְדֻשָּׁה; **— only it referred to the royal table of King Solomon whose meals are recorded in Torah, representing eating in holiness;** וְעַל זֶה אָמַר שֶׁשֻּׁלְחָנְךָ גָּדוֹל וְכוּלֵיהּ, וְהַיְנוּ שֶׁהָעָמֵל בְּתוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **— and on this it said that your table is greater, etc., –** וְלֹא כִּשְׁלֹמֹה הַמֶּלֶךְ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם **– meaning that one who toils in the Oral Torah — unlike King Solomon who merited the Oral Torah effortlessly in a dream from the Blessed Name —** שֶׁזָּכָה לְכָל הַתּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה בְּחֲלוֹם מִצַּד הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ; וְהָעָמֵל לְקִנְיוֹת תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה זוֹכֶה לְמַה שֶּׁכָּתוּב (זֹהַר חֶלֶק ב׳ ס״א סוֹף עַמּוּד ב׳)[702]: **— one who toils to acquire the Oral Torah merits what is written (Zohar Part II, 61b bottom):** "מְזוֹנָא דְּחַבְרַיָּא אִנּוּוּן דְּמִשְׁתַּדְּלֵי בְּאוֹרַיְתָא, דְּאָכְלֵי מְזוֹנָא דְּרוּחָא וְנִשְׁמָתָא וְלָא אָכְלֵי מְזוֹנָא דְּגוּפָא כְּלָל וְכוּלֵיהּ, הָדָא הוּא דִכְתִיב: וְזֶה עִנְיַן שֶׁנִּסְדַּר בְּאַגָּדַת עִנְיַן הַמָּן בְּפֶרֶק יוֹם הַכִּפּוּרִים[703], **— "The nourishment of the companions who engage in Torah, who consume the nourishment of spirit and soul and eat no bodily nourishment at all, etc.,** 'הַחָכְמָה תְּחַיֶּה בְּעָלֶיהָ'". **— this is what is written: 'Wisdom gives life to those who possess it'."** **— And this is why the Aggadah regarding the Manna is placed in the chapter of Yom Kippur (Yoma 75b),** שֶׁהַמָּן "לֶחֶם שֶׁמַּלְאֲכֵי הַשָּׁרֵת אוֹכְלִין", וְהַיְנוּ מִטַּלָּא דְּעַתִּיקָא; וְכֵן יֵשׁ בְּיוֹם הַכִּפּוּרִים אֲכִילָה, מְזוֹנָא דְּרוּחָא וְנִשְׁמָתָא מִטַּל תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה. **— and so on Yom Kippur there is spiritual eating, sustenance of spirit and soul from the dew of the Oral Torah.** וְכֵן בַּחֲנֻכָּה, שֶׁהַנֵּס הָיָה בְּאוֹר נֵרוֹת הַמִּקְדָּשׁ שֶׁהֵם הַקְּדֻשָּׁה לְהָאִיר בְּלֵב יִשְׂרָאֵל בְּאוֹר תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמַרְנוּ, **— And so too on Chanukah, where the miracle occurred with the Temple lights which illuminate the heart with Oral Torah as we stated,** וְעַל כֵּן לֹא תִּקְנוּ בָּהֶם סְעוּדָה רַק עֲשָׂאוּם יוֹם טוֹב בְּהַלֵּל. **— therefore they instituted on them no physical feast, making them a festival solely through Hallel.**

— And what is stated "and with Thanksgiving", can likewise be explained as referring to Hallel which concludes: וּמַה שֶּׁכָּתַב "וּבְהוֹדָאָה", יֵשׁ לוֹמַר גַּם כֵּן דְּקָאֵי עַל הַלֵּל שֶׁמְּסַיֵּם: "הוֹדוּ לַהשֵׁם כִּי טוֹב וְגוֹמֵר", **— "Give thanks to Hashem for He is good, etc.",** כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בְּרָכוֹת ה׳ עַמּוּד א׳) כִּי לֶקַח טוֹב נָתַתִּי וְגוֹמֵר" (, וְאֵין "טוֹב" אֶלָּא תּוֹרָה, שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: "כִּי לֶקַח טוֹב נָתַתִּי לָכֶם תּוֹרָתִי אַל תַּעֲזֹבוּ"[704], **— and "good" means nothing other than Torah, as said: "For I have given you a good doctrine, etc." (Berachot 5a),** וְכֵן תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה נִקְרָא גַּם כֵּן "טוֹב", כְּמַה שֶׁכָּתוּב; וְהַיְנוּ תּוֹרָה שֶׁבִּכְתָב **— referring to the Written Torah;** שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: "טוֹב לִי תוֹרַת פִּיךָ", **— and the Oral Torah is likewise termed "good", as stated: "The Torah of Your mouth is better to me than thousands of gold and silver",** וְתוֹרַת "כִּי לְעוֹלָם חַסְדּוֹ" עַל דֶּרֶךְ מַה שֶּׁנֶּאֱמַר: חָסֶד עַל לְשׁוֹנָהּ", וְהַיְנוּ אֵשֶׁת חַיִל, אִשָּׁה יִרְאַת הַשֵּׁם, בְּחִינַת כְּנֶסֶת יִשְׂרָאֵל, מַלְכוּת, "פִּיהָ **— "for His kindness endures forever", following Scripture's phrase: "and the Torah of lovingkindness is upon her tongue",** – תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה קָרֵינַן לַהּ"; וְזֶה מַה שֶּׁכָּתוּב (סֻכָּה מ״ט עַמּוּד ב׳): "תּוֹרָה לִלְמֻדָה[705] **— which is the Woman of Valor, a woman**

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[702] **Zohar, Beshalach 28:368-377**: ‘See now, when the Israelites went out of Egypt into the desert, uniting themselves with the Holy King, when the sign of the Covenant was manifested in them in its fulness, they were granted a more spiritual, more supernal food than the “unleavened bread” which they ate immediately after they left Egypt; for of the manna it says: “I will rain bread from heaven for you.” It was indeed heavenly food, emanating from the sphere called “heaven”. But the sons of Wisdom, namely, the students of the Torah, derive their nourishment from a still higher region, the sphere of Wisdom, as it is written: “Wisdom keeps alive her owners” (Eccl. 7, 12).’’

[703] **Yoma 75b:11**: “The Sages taught: ‘A man ate the bread of mighty ones’ means bread that the ministering angels eat; these are Rabbi Akiva’s words. When these words were stated before Rabbi Yishmael, he told them, ‘Go and tell Akiva: Akiva, you have erred! Do the ministering angels eat bread? Has it not already been said, “I did not eat bread and I did not drink water”? Rather, how do I explain abbirim, “mighty ones”? It is bread absorbed into the two hundred and forty-eight limbs, eivarim.’”

[704] **Berakhot 5a:7**: “Rabbi Yochanan said to him: Even schoolchildren know that teaching, for it says, ‘If you listen carefully to the voice of the Lord your God, do what is right in His eyes, give ear to His commandments, and keep all His statutes, I will not place upon you any of the illness I placed upon Egypt, for I am the Lord who heals you.’ Rather, the teaching is this: When someone is able to occupy himself with Torah but does not, the Holy One, blessed be He, brings upon him grievous sufferings that trouble him, as it says, ‘I was mute and silent; I refrained from good, and my pain became troubled.’ ‘Good’ means Torah, as it says, ‘For I have given you good instruction; do not forsake My Torah.’”

[705] **Sukkah 49b:13**: “Rabbi Chama bar Pappa said: Any person who possesses grace is known to fear Heaven, as it says, ‘The Lord’s kindness is from eternity to eternity upon those who fear Him.’ Rabbi Elazar also said: What is meant by ‘She opens her mouth with wisdom, and a Torah of kindness is upon her tongue’? Is there a Torah of kindness and a Torah that is not of kindness? Rather, Torah studied for its own sake is Torah of kindness; Torah not studied for its own sake is Torah that is not of kindness. Some explain it this way: Torah studied in order to teach is Torah of kindness; Torah not studied in order to teach is Torah that is not of kindness.”

fearing Hashem, Knesset Yisrael, Malchut, "The mouth is the Oral Torah"; – זוֹ הִיא תּוֹרָה שֶׁל חֶסֶד"[706] — **and this is what is written (Sukkah 49b): "Torah studied to teach it — this is a Torah of lovingkindness",** וְהֵיכָנוּ תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה, דְּתוֹרָה שֶׁבִּכְתָב כְּרוּכָה וּמֻנַּחַת, כָּל הָרוֹצֶה לִלְמֹד יָבֹא וְיִלְמֹד (קִדּוּשִׁין ס״ו עַמּוּד א׳).[707] — **meaning the Oral Torah, whereas the Written Torah lies wrapped, ready for anyone wishing to learn (Kiddushin 66a).** וְהַהַזְכָּרָה גַּם כֵּן קָבְעוּ בִּבְרָכַת הוֹדָאָה: — **And the insertion of Al HaNissim they also fixed within the blessing of Thanksgiving (Modim):** דְּשָׁלֹשׁ בְּרָכוֹת רִאשׁוֹנוֹת הֵם קְדֻשַּׁת הָאָבוֹת: — **for the first three blessings represent the holiness of the Patriarchs:** "מָגֵן אַבְרָהָם", וְאַתָּה גִּבּוֹר" כְּנֶגֶד פַּחַד יִצְחָק, וְאַתָּה קָדוֹשׁ" כְּנֶגֶד יַעֲקֹב, כְּמַה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: "וְהִקְדִּישׁוּ אֶת קְדוֹשׁ יַעֲקֹב"; **"Shield of Abraham", followed by "You are mighty" corresponding to the Fear of Isaac, followed by "You are holy" corresponding to Jacob, as stated: "And they shall sanctify the Holy One of Jacob";** וְשָׁלֹשׁ מִדּוֹת שֶׁל הָאָבוֹת הֵם הַמְשָׁכָה מִשָּׁלֹשׁ רִאשׁוֹנוֹת: חֶסֶד עִלָּאָה נָפְקָא מֵחָכְמָה, וּגְבוּרָה מִבִּינָה, וְיַעֲקֹב מִדַּת הַדַּעַת, — **Supreme Chesed issues from Chochmah, Gevurah from Binah, and Jacob represents the attribute of Da'at,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ (חֵלֶק ב׳ י״ד סוֹף עַמּוּד ב׳, קע״ה עַמּוּד ב׳).[708] — **and as written in the Holy Zohar (Part II, 14b bottom, 175b).**

The twelve blessings voice the needs of the whole people

וְאַחַר כָּךְ שְׁתֵּים עֶשְׂרֵה בְּרָכוֹת אֶמְצָעִיּוֹת כְּנֶגֶד קְדֻשַּׁת שְׁנֵים עָשָׂר הַשְּׁבָטִים,[709] — **And afterward the twelve middle blessings correspond to the sanctity of the Twelve Tribes,** וְכֵן כָּתַב בְּרַעְיָא מְהֵימְנָא (זֹהַר חֵלֶק ג׳ ד׳ עַמּוּד א׳),[710] — **and so wrote in the Ra'aya Meheimna (Zohar Part III, 4a),** וְהַיְנוּ כְּנֶסֶת יִשְׂרָאֵל שֶׁהִיא בְּחִינַת מַלְכוּת שָׁמַיִם וְנִקְרָא וּכְמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ וּכְתִיב: "אֲנִי", — **which is Knesset Yisrael, the realm of Malchut termed "I" (Ani),** וְיֵשׁ עוֹד בִּרְכַּת הַמִּינִים, וּבַגְּמָרָא (בְּרָכוֹת כ״ח עַמּוּד ב׳) — **and as written in the Zohar, matching Scripture: "And I am prayer".** "וַאֲנִי תְפִלָּה". — **And there is in addition the Blessing against Heretics (Birkat HaMinim),**

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[706] **Sukkah 49b:13**: "Rabbi Chama bar Pappa said: Any person who possesses grace is known to fear Heaven, as it says, 'The Lord's kindness is from eternity to eternity upon those who fear Him.' Rabbi Elazar also said: What is meant by 'She opens her mouth with wisdom, and a Torah of kindness is upon her tongue'? Is there a Torah of kindness and a Torah that is not of kindness? Rather, Torah studied for its own sake is Torah of kindness; Torah not studied for its own sake is Torah that is not of kindness. Some explain it this way: Torah studied in order to teach is Torah of kindness; Torah not studied in order to teach is Torah that is not of kindness."

[707] **Kiddushin 66a:11-12**: "Elazar ben Po'era said to King Yannai: "King Yannai, is this the treatment of an ordinary Israelite, and is it your treatment, when you are king and High Priest?" "What should I do?" "If you heed my advice, trample them." "And what will become of Torah?" "It lies rolled up and placed in a corner; anyone who wishes to study may come and study." Rav Nachman bar Yitzchak said: At that moment heresy was cast into him, for he should have replied: "That is well for the Written Torah, but what of the Oral Torah?" Immediately the evil caught fire through Elazar ben Po'era, and all the Sages of Israel were killed. The world was desolate until Shimon ben Shetach came and restored Torah to its former state."

[708] **Zohar, Shemot 26:249**: "There is a further esoteric meaning in this verse. We are told: "With ten Sayings the world was created" (Pirke Ab. 5, 1). Yet, on examination they prove to be only three, viz. Wisdom, Understanding, and Knowledge. The world was created only for the sake of Israel. When the Holy One, blessed be He, desired to endow the earth with permanence, He formed Abraham in the mystery of Wisdom, Isaac in the mystery of Understanding, and Jacob in the mystery of Perception, that is to say, of Knowledge. Therefore it is said: "With wisdom is the house built, and by understanding it is established, and by knowledge shall the chambers be filled…" (Prov. 24, 4-5). At that hour the whole world came into perfection; and when the twelve Tribes were born to Jacob, all things came to completion according to the supernal pattern ordained from the beginning."

[709] **Dover Tzedek, Miscellany 4:1**: "At that time it is called in the Zohar "the moon in its deficiency": the end of the month, when there is no completeness or light at all, only lack. Prayer was established for this condition. The twelve middle blessings include every kind of human need and lack, whose totality is twelve (corresponding to the twelve months of the lunar year). These are the twelve tribes of God: each has a particular inborn lack (just as each also has a particular excellence), for which it must seek God's salvation to complete it. Their totality is the congregation of Israel and the moon, as is known. (A thirteenth blessing was afterward instituted at Yavneh. Nevertheless it is still called the prayer of eighteen blessings, for the principal number is twelve, which sometimes becomes thirteen, as with the tribes and the months, when one becomes two. Likewise, among the thirteen measures of mercy surrounding her, one is doubled; see Tosafot, Rosh Hashanah 17b. This is not the place to elaborate.) Through prayer the person subjects all the powers of the soul to God: help comes only from Him, and from no other."

Dover Tzedek explains why distinct tribes correspond to petitions: each has an excellence and also a specific lack requiring completion. Prayer gathers those needs into the congregation's common dependence on God. This adds the missing relation between the tribal structure and the act of asking, while preserving the reason the added thirteenth blessing does not erase the twelvefold structure.

[710] **Zohar, Vayikra 2:29-3:41**: 'It was when the Community of Israel came down to make her abode on earth that God proclaimed this verse, because there was then blessing and joy in all worlds, and She was firmly established as a source of blessing to all. For when those Six grades are blessed, then all worlds are blessed, both below and above, and Israel draw blessing from all of them.' R. Isaac said that the Holy One, blessed be He, was espoused to the Community of Israel only at the time when those Six drank their fill of the "stream that never fails".'

אָמְרוּ:[711] — **and in the Gemara (Berachot 28b) they stated:** לְמַאן דְּאָמַר דִּשְׁמוֹנֶה עֶשְׂרֵה בְּרָכוֹת כְּנֶגֶד שְׁמוֹנֶה עָשָׂר אַזְכָּרוֹת שֶׁבְּ"הָבוּ לַהשֵׁם", הֵיא כְּנֶגֶד "אֵל הַכָּבוֹד"; **— according to the one who holds eighteen blessings correspond to eighteen mentions of God's Name in Havu LaHashem, it corresponds to "the God of glory";** וּלְמַאן דְּאָמַר כְּנֶגֶד שְׁמוֹנֶה עֶשְׂרֵה אַזְכָּרוֹת שֶׁבִּקְרִיאַת שְׁמַע, הֵיא כְּנֶגֶד "אֶחָד"; **— and according to the one who holds corresponding to eighteen mentions in the Shema, it corresponds to "One";** וּלְמַאן דְּאָמַר כְּנֶגֶד שְׁמוֹנֶה עֶשְׂרֵה חֲלָיוֹת שֶׁבַּשִּׁדְרָה, הֵיא כְּנֶגֶד חֲלָיָה קְטַנָּה שֶׁבַּשִּׁדְרָה. **— and according to the one who holds corresponding to eighteen vertebrae of the spine, it corresponds to the small vertebra of the spine.** וּלְפִי מַה שֶּׁכָּתַב בְּרַעְיָא מְהֵימְנָא שִׁשְּׁתַּיִם עֶשְׂרֵה בְּרָכוֹת אֶמְצָעִיּוֹת כְּנֶגֶד שְׁנֵים עָשָׂר שְׁבָטִים, **— And based on the Ra'aya Meheimna that twelve middle blessings correspond to the twelve tribes,** יֵשׁ לוֹמַר דְּבִרְכַת הַמִּינִים תִּקְּנוּ כְּנֶגֶד שֵׁבֶט יוֹסֵף שֶׁנֶּחְלַק לִשְׁנַיִם: מְנַשֶּׁה וְאֶפְרַיִם; דְּמִדַּת יוֹסֵף: "כִּי כֹל בַּשָּׁמַיִם וּבָאָרֶץ" **— one can say that Birkat HaMinim was instituted corresponding to Joseph who split into two: Menasseh and Ephraim; –** דְּאָחִיד בִּשְׁמַיָּא וְאַרְעָא, **— for Joseph's attribute is "for all that is in heaven and earth" — binding heaven and earth,** שֶׁעַל יְדֵי מִדָּתוֹ יְחוּד קוּדְשָׁא בְּרִיךְ הוּא וּשְׁכִינְתֵּיהּ, שָׁמַיִם וָאָרֶץ (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב זֹהַר חֵלֶק א׳ ל״א רֵישׁ עַמּוּד ב׳),[712] **— for through his attribute the Holy One and His Shechinah, heaven and earth, are unified (Zohar Part I, 31b top),** וְהוּא מְנֻגָּד לְקִלְפַּת הַמִּינִים שֶׁמַּפְרִידִין כְּמוֹ הַיְחוּד, **— which stands directly opposed to the kelipah of heretics who rupture this divine unity,** שֶׁכָּתוּב (שַׁבָּת קט״ז עַמּוּד א׳): "הַלָּלוּ שֶׁמְּטִילִין קִנְאָה וְאֵיבָה וְתַחֲרוּת בֵּין יִשְׂרָאֵל לַאֲבִיהֶן שֶׁבַּשָּׁמַיִם".[713] **— as written (Shabbat 116a): "These who cast jealousy, enmity, and rivalry between Israel and their Father in Heaven".**

וְכֵן כָּל שֵׁבֶט יֵשׁ לוֹ קְדֻשָּׁה מְיֻחֶדֶת שֶׁמְּכֻוָּן נֶגֶד קְדֻשָּׁה זוֹ הַבְּרָכָה; **— And so each tribe possesses a distinct sanctity corresponding to the holiness of its respective blessing;** וְתִקְּנוּ הַבְּרָכָה לְכָל יִשְׂרָאֵל, **— and they instituted the blessings for all Israel,** דִּכְתִיב: "אִישׁ אֲשֶׁר כְּבִרְכָתוֹ בֵּרַךְ אֹתָם", **— for it is written: "Every one according to his blessing he blessed them",** שֶׁכָּלַל לְכָל הַשְּׁבָטִים בְּכָל הַקְּדֻשּׁוֹת, **— incorporating all tribes into all dimensions of holiness,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בִּבְרֵאשִׁית רַבָּה: "חָזַר וּכְלָלָן כֻּלָּם כְּאֶחָד וְכוּלֵיהּ, לְקַיֵּם מַה שֶּׁנֶּאֱמַר: 'כֻּלָּךְ יָפָה רַעְיָתִי'". **— as written in Bereishit Rabbah: "He returned and included them all as one, etc., to fulfill: 'You are all fair, my love'".** וְכָל הַבְּרָכוֹת אֶמְצָעִיּוֹת הֵם צְרָכֵי הַנֶּפֶשׁ, **— And all middle blessings pertain to spiritual needs of the soul,** לְבַד "רְפָאֵנוּ" וּבִרְכַת הַשָּׁנִים שֶׁלִּפְשׁוּטָן הֵם צָרְכֵי הַגּוּף, **— except for Refa'einu (Heal us) and the Blessing of the Years which on their surface seem physical,** אֲבָל בֶּאֱמֶת הֵם גַּם כֵּן לִצֹּרֶךְ הַנֶּפֶשׁ: **— yet in truth they also address the spiritual needs of the soul:** שֶׁאוֹמְרִים "רְפָאֵנוּ הַשֵּׁם וְנֵרָפֵא, הוֹשִׁיעֵנוּ וְנִוָּשֵׁעָה", **— for we say "Heal us Hashem and we shall be healed, save us and we shall be saved",** וְלִכְאוֹרָה מַה שַּׁיְכוּת יְשׁוּעָה לִרְפוּאָה? **— and seemingly what connection has salvation to healing?** אַךְ הוּא עַל פִּי מַה שֶּׁכָּתוּב בַּמִּדְרָשׁ רַבָּה (אַחֲרֵי מוֹת): "'יִשְׁעִי' בְּיוֹם הַכִּפּוּרִים", שֶׁהוּא יְשׁוּעָה מְחִילַת עֲוֹונוֹת, **— However, it is based on what is written in Midrash Rabbah (Acharei Mot): "'My salvation' on Yom Kippur", meaning the salvation of forgiveness of sins,** שֶׁעַל יְדֵי כֵן נוֹשָׁעִים מֵהַיֵּצֶר הָרָע גַּם לְהַבָּא; וּבְיוֹם הַכִּפּוּרִים "וְנָשָׂא הַשָּׂעִיר אֶת כָּל עֲוֹנֹתָם" עֲוֹונוֹת תָּם, כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בִּבְרֵאשִׁית רַבָּה, הוּא יְשׁוּעָה.[714] **— whereby one is saved from the Evil Inclination for the future as well; — and on Yom Kippur "and the goat shall bear all their iniquities" — the iniquities of the upright man (tam / Jacob) as in Bereishit Rabbah, which is salvation.** וְכֵן "חֹלִי", אִיתָא (יְרוּשַׁלְמִי פֶּרֶק י״ד דְּשַׁבָּת): "'וְהֵסִיר הַשֵּׁם מִמְּךָ כָּל חֹלִי'[715]

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[711] **Berakhot 28b:22**: “Rabbi Levi told Rabbi Hillel, the son of Rabbi Shmuel bar Nachmani: It corresponds to ‘The God of glory thunders.’ According to Rav Yosef, it corresponds to the word ‘One’ in the recitation of Shema. According to the teaching that Rabbi Tanchum reported in the name of Rabbi Yehoshua ben Levi, it corresponds to the small vertebra in the spine.”

[712] **Zohar, Bereshit 35:339**: “The verse specifies these six supernal days: “Yours, Lord, are greatness, might, beauty…” “For all”—this is the righteous one. “In heaven”—this is Tiferet. “And on earth”—this is the Congregation of Israel. As the Targum renders it: “Who holds fast to heaven and earth.” That is, the foundation of the world, called “all,” holds fast to Tiferet, which is called heaven, and to earth, which is called the Congregation of Israel.”

[713] **Shabbat 116a:9**: “Rabbi Yishmael said: It follows by an inference from the lesser to the greater. If, to make peace between a man and his wife, the Torah says that My name, written in sanctity, may be erased in water, how much more may the writings of those who cast jealousy, enmity, and rivalry between Israel and their Father in Heaven be destroyed! Concerning them David said, ‘Do I not hate those who hate You, Lord, and contend with those who rise against You? I hate them with utter hatred; they have become enemies to me.’ Just as one does not rescue those writings from a fire, so one does not rescue them from a collapsed building, from water, or from anything else that destroys them.”

[714] **Vayikra Rabbah 21:4** (excerpt): “The Sages interpret the verse as referring to Rosh Hashanah and Yom Kippur: ‘My light’ on Rosh Hashanah; ‘my salvation’ on Yom Kippur; ‘whom shall I fear?’—‘Hashem is my strength and song’ (Exodus 15:2). … ‘My adversaries and enemies against me’: The solar year has three hundred and sixty-five days; ‘ha-satan’ has the numerical value of three hundred and sixty-four. Satan accuses throughout the year, but on Yom Kippur he does not accuse. Israel said before the Holy One: ‘If an army encamps against me’—the army of Samael—‘my heart will not fear,’ for You promised me, ‘With this Aharon shall enter the Sanctuary.’”

[715] **Jerusalem Talmud Shabbat 14:3**: ‘And the Lord will take away from you all sickness (kol choli)’ (Deuteronomy 7:15): Rav said, this refers to the evil eye; Shmuel said, this refers to the wind; Rabbi Yochanan said, this refers to biliousness; Rabbi Elazar said, this refers to anxiety of the heart—for when Israel cleaves to the Torah, the Holy One,

זֶה יֵצֶר הָרָע שֶׁתְּחִלָּתוֹ מָתוֹק וְסוֹפוֹ מַר", וְזֶהוּ — **"'And Hashem shall remove from you all illness' — this is the Evil Inclination** הַמְּכֻוָּן בְּבִרְכַּת "רְפָאֵנוּ" — **which is sweet at first and bitter in the end",** רְפוּאַת הַנֶּפֶשׁ מֵהַיֵּצֶר הָרָע שֶׁהוּא חֹלִי, — **and this is the true focus of Refa'einu — healing of the soul from the illness of the Evil Inclination,** וְעַל זֶה אָמַר: "הוֹשִׁיעֵנוּ וְנִוָּשֵׁעָה", שֶׁהַיְשׁוּעָה עַל יְדֵי מְחִילַת עֲוֹונוֹת כָּאָמוּר. — **and on this we say: "save us and we shall be saved", salvation through remission of sins as stated.**

A blessing on food seeks a change in the heart

וְכֵן בִּרְכַּת הַשָּׁנִים גַּם כֵּן עִקָּרָהּ עַל צֹרֶךְ הַנֶּפֶשׁ,[716, 717] — **And likewise the Blessing of the Years primarily addresses spiritual needs of the soul,** שֶׁאוֹמְרִים: "וְאֶת כָּל מִינֵי תְבוּאָתָהּ לְטוֹבָה", — **for we pray: "and all varieties of its produce for good",** וְהַיְנוּ שֶׁיִּהְיֶה הָאֲכִילָה מִסְּטָרָא דְּטוֹב שֶׁבְּעֵץ הַדַּעַת, — **meaning that eating be channeled from the side of the good of the Tree of Knowledge,** וּמִמֵּילָא יָבִיא קְדֻשָּׁה לַלֵּב כְּמוֹ שֶׁנִּתְבָּאֵר כַּמָּה פְּעָמִים. — **automatically infusing holiness into the heart as explained many times.** וְעַל יְדֵי בִּרְכַּת הַשָּׁם בְּהָאֲכִילָה כְּתִיב: "וּבֵרַךְ אֶת לַחְמְךָ וְגוֹמֵר וַהֲסִרֹתִי מַחֲלָה מִקִּרְבֶּךָ", — **And through God's blessing in food it is written: "And He shall bless your bread, etc., and I will remove illness from your midst",** וְהַיְנוּ הַיֵּצֶר הָרָע שֶׁשּׁוֹלֵט בַּאֲכִילָה, שֶׁעַל זֶה מוֹרֶה לְשׁוֹן "מִקִּרְבֶּךָ", — **which refers to the Evil Inclination dominating through eating, indicated by the word "from your midst (mikirbecha)",** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁדָּרְשׁוּ (תַּעֲנִית י"א עַמּוּד ב'):[718] — **and as they expounded (Ta'anit 11b):** כְּאִילּוּ קָדוֹשׁ שָׁרוּי בְּתוֹךְ מֵעָיו, שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: 'בְּקִרְבְּךָ קָדוֹשׁ'", — **"As if a holy being resides within his innards, as it is said: 'Holy in your midst'",** "בְּקִרְבְּךָ" דָּרֵשׁ עַל מֵעָיו; וְכָן כָּאן "מִקִּרְבֶּךָ", — **interpreting the word "in your midst" as referring to his digestive organs;** שֶׁלְּשׁוֹן מַאֲכִילָה שֶׁבְּתוֹךְ מֵעָיו, — **and so here "from your midst" — from food within his digestive innards,** שֶׁהָאֲכִילָה מֵבִיא לִידֵי קִטְרוּג יֵצֶר הָרָע כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בְּסִפְרֵי (בְּרָכוֹת ל"ב עַמּוּד א') וּגְמָרָא (עֵקֶב) וּבַזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ (חֵלֶק ב' קנ"ד עַמּוּד ב'):[719, 720] — **for eating instigates the prosecution**

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blessed be He, removes the root of spiritual and bodily malady.'

[716] **Sod Yesharim, Simchat Torah 1:2**: "At the beginning we bless, "Who brings bread forth from the earth," as the Sages said in Berakhot: "Ha-motzi means 'who brought forth.'" Blessing is also an expression of drawing forth: one draws to oneself the utterance of God's mouth clothed within the food. As it is written, "For a person does not live by bread alone, but by everything that proceeds from God's mouth." The blessed will that, from the creation of the world, brings into being and gives life to everything in the world is clothed within the bread and gives life to the person. Through the blessing, the person breaks through the garments and finds and draws forth to himself the blessed will that gives him life. Before eating, at the time of the blessing, the person gives to the food, for through the blessing the food is raised. But at the time of eating, the food is called the giver, because the person is nourished by it. After eating, the person prevails over the food, because the choice is then in his hands: according to the way he serves God with the strength of that eating, so will be the ascent of that food."

Sod Yesharim explains how the blessing and the eater's later choice belong together. The blessing recognizes and draws out the divine life in the food; the service performed with its strength determines the food's ascent. This makes Rav Tzadok's prayer for produce that brings holiness into the heart an active responsibility, extending beyond the words of the blessing.

[717] **Et HaOchel 12:1**: "Against the sexual inclination there is rescue through words of Torah, specifically when eating matzah on the night of Pesach has preceded it, to heal the prior appetite for food. The two are drawn from one another, as they said, "Filling the belly is among the evil forms of conduct." Eve's eating from the Tree of Knowledge led to the serpent's coming upon her afterward. This was the serpent's instigation and counsel: through her failure in the appetite for food, he could prevail over her in this also. The reverse is likewise true: through matzah, which imparts holiness to eating, one also merits words of Torah in the holiness of restraint from sexual transgression. For the measure of good is greater; a mitzvah of eating all the more draws holiness in sexual matters, five hundredfold, according to the Sages' statement in Makkot."

Et HaOchel describes a concrete sequence behind the prayer for food "for good." Holiness in eating prepares the person for Torah's restraint of another appetite; the earlier failure likewise passed from one appetite to the other. The comparison therefore concerns nourishment's effect on the heart and subsequent conduct, not a claim that ordinary eating by itself completes every repair.

[718] **Taanit 11b**: 'as though a sacred object is immersed in his bowels, which he may not damage, as it is stated: "The sacred is in your midst; and I will not come into the city" (Hosea 11:9). This statement indicates that it is prohibited to take a fast upon oneself. The Gemara answers: This is not difficult. This first ruling, that one who fasts is sacred, is referring to a case where he is able to distress himself without causing bodily harm. That second ruling, that one may not overly burden his body, deals with a situation when he is unable to distress himself while avoiding all harm, and he proceeds to fast nevertheless.'

[719] **Berakhot 32a:9**: "The school of Rabbi Yannai said: A lion does not roar over a basket of straw, but over a basket of meat."

[720] **Zohar, Terumah 47:515-525**: 'And the priests, from Sabbath to Sabbath, collected the fruit of the Table, to show that supernal nutriment emanated from the Table through the agency of that bread. And because the priests were permitted to eat the shew-bread, all the rest of their food and all that they drank was blessed, so that the "evil inclination" had no power to attack them-for, as a rule, the "evil inclination" is only present where there is much eating and drinking, as it is written: "Lest I be full and deny Thee, and say, Who is the Lord?" (Prov. 30, 9); since it is from eating and drinking that the evil inclination gathers strength in a man's body.'

of the Evil Inclination as written in Sifrei (Ekev), the Gemara (Berachot 32a), and Zohar (Part II, 154b): שֶׁאֵין יֵצֶר הָרָע שׁוֹלֵט אֶלָּא מִתּוֹךְ אֲכִילָה; — **that the Evil Inclination rules only through food and drink;** וּכְשֶׁיֵּשׁ בּוֹ בִּרְכַּת הַשֵּׁם, מַסִּיר הַמַּחֲלָה שֶׁהוּא הַיֵּצֶר הָרָע, — **and when divine blessing rests in it, He removes the illness which is the Evil Inclination,** וּמֵבִיא קְדֻשָּׁה וְאוֹר "כִּי טוֹב", — **infusing holiness and the light that is "good",** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמַרְנוּ בְּמַה שֶׁפָּתוּב: "עֲבִידְנָא יוֹמָא טָבָא לְרַבָּנָן", שֶׁהוּא שֶׁיִּזְרַח בְּהָאֲכִילָה מַהָאוֹר "כִּי טוֹב"; — **and as we explained regarding "I will make a festive day for the Rabbis", that the Primordial Light that is "good" shine within the food;** וְזֶה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: "בָּרֵךְ וְכוּלֵיהּ תְּבוּאָתָהּ לְטוֹבָה", שֶׁיּוֹפִיעַ בְּהָאֲכִילָה הַבְּרָכָה וְהָאוֹר. — **and this is what we pray: "Bless, etc., its produce for good", that the blessing and light shine within the food.**

וְאַחַר כָּךְ שָׁלֹשׁ בְּרָכוֹת אַחֲרוֹנוֹת נֶגֶד מִדּוֹת נֶצַח, הוֹד, וְיסוֹד הַמַּמְשִׁיכִים לִכְנֶסֶת יִשְׂרָאֵל, — **And afterward the three final blessings correspond to Netzach, Hod, and Yesod channeling into Knesset Yisrael,** וְהַמֶּרְכָּבָה לִשְׁלֹשׁ מִדּוֹת אֵלּוּ: מֹשֶׁה, אַהֲרֹן, וְיוֹסֵף: — **and the chariot for these three sefirot are Moses, Aaron, and Joseph:** בִּרְכַּת עֲבוֹדָה דְּאִיתָא בְּגֶנֶד נֶצַח, דַּרְגָּא דְּמֹשֶׁה, — **the blessing of Avodah (Retzei) corresponds to Netzach, Moses' level,** בְּרֵאשִׁית רַבָּה פָּרָשָׁה י״ט)[721]: "בָּא מֹשֶׁה וְהוֹרִידָהּ לָאָרֶץ", — **for it states (Bereishit Rabbah 19): "Moses came and brought the Shechinah down to earth",** וְזֶהוּ "הַמַּחֲזִיר שְׁכִינָתוֹ וְכוּלֵיהּ", — **and this is "Who restores His Shechinah, etc.",** וְהַיְנוּ שֶׁבְּמַתַּן תּוֹרָה הוֹרִיד מֹשֶׁה הַשְׁכִינָה לָאָרֶץ, — **meaning that at the giving of the Torah Moses brought the Shechinah to earth,** וְאַחַר הַקִּלְקוּל מַעֲשֵׂה הַמִּשְׁכָּן הָיָה גַּם כֵּן עִקָּרוֹ עַל יְדֵי מֹשֶׁה, — **and following the sin the building of the Tabernacle was also primarily through Moses,** וּכְתִיב: "בָּאתִי לְגַנִּי", וְאִיתָא בַּפְּסִיקְתָא (פָּרָשָׁה ה׳)[722]: "לְגַן אֵין כָּתוּב כָּאן, אֶלָּא לְגַנִּי — **and it is written: "I have come into My garden." It states in the Pesikta (Parashah 5): "It does not say 'into a garden,' but 'into My garden'—** לְאוֹתוֹ הַגַּן שֶׁנִּסְתַּלַּקְתִּי הֵימֶנָּה, כְּמַה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: 'מִתְהַלֵּךְ בַּגָּן'", — **into that same garden from which I departed, as stated: 'walking in the garden,'"** וְהַיְנוּ שֶׁיִּהְיֶה שְׁכִינָה בַּתַּחְתּוֹנִים עַל כָּל פָּנִים בַּמִּשְׁכָּן. — **meaning that the Shechinah dwell in the lower realms at least within the Tabernacle.**

וְאַחַר כָּךְ בִּרְכַּת הוֹדָאָה נֶגֶד הוֹד, דַּרְגָּא דְּאַהֲרֹן; — **And afterward the blessing of Thanksgiving (Modim) corresponds to Hod, the level of Aaron;** וְאוֹמְרִים בִּבְרָכָה זוֹ: "וְעַל נִסֶּיךָ שֶׁבְּכָל יוֹם עִמָּנוּ, וְעַל נִפְלְאוֹתֶיךָ וְטוֹבוֹתֶיךָ שֶׁבְּכָל עֵת, עֶרֶב וָבֹקֶר וְצָהֳרָיִם", — **and we recite in this blessing: "and for Your miracles which are with us daily, and for Your wonders and Your goodness at all times, evening, morning, and afternoon",** וְכָל אֶחָד וְאֶחָד מִיִּשְׂרָאֵל אוֹמֵר נֹסַח זֶה, — **and every single Jew recites this formula,** וְלִכְאוֹרָה יֵשׁ לְהָבִין: וְכִי כָּל אֶחָד יֵשׁ לוֹ נֵס בְּכָל יוֹם? — **and ostensibly one must understand: does every single individual experience a miracle every day?**

אַךְ הַמְּכֻוָּן, שֶׁמָּצִינוּ שֶׁמֹּשֶׁה רַבֵּנוּ בְּמִחְיַת עֲמָלֵק קָרָא שֵׁם הַמִּזְבֵּחַ: "הַשֵּׁם נִסִּי", — **However the intent is that we find Moses our Teacher after defeating Amalek called the altar: "Hashem is my miracle (Hashem Nissi)",** וְהוּא דְּ"נֵס" נִקְרָא כְּשֶׁיּוֹצֵא מִגְּדֶר הַטֶּבַע הַנָּהוּג, — **and that is because an event is termed a "miracle" when it transcends the boundary of natural conduct,** וְהַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ עָשָׂה הַסֵּדֶר בִּבְרִיאַת הָאָדָם שֶׁיִּתְנַהֵג עַל פִּי הַבְּחִירָה, — **and the Blessed Name structured human creation to operate through free will,**

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[721] **Bereshit Rabbah 19:7** (excerpt): “The Divine Presence originally dwelled below. When Adam sinned, it withdrew to the first heaven. Cain sinned, and it withdrew to the second heaven; the generation of Enosh, to the third; the generation of the Flood, to the fourth; the generation of the Dispersion, to the fifth; the Sodomites, to the sixth; and the Egyptians in Abraham’s days, to the seventh. Corresponding to them, seven righteous men arose: Abraham, Isaac, Jacob, Levi, Kehat, Amram, and Moshe. Abraham brought it down to the sixth heaven; Isaac, from the sixth to the fifth; Jacob, from the fifth to the fourth; Levi, from the fourth to the third; Kehat, from the third to the second; Amram, from the second to the first. Moshe arose and brought it down from above to below.”

[722] **Pesikta Rabbati 5:1**: ‘I have come into My garden, My sister, My bride’ (Song of Songs 5:1): Rabbi Menahem son of Rabbi Yosi expounded: It does not say ‘I have come into the garden,’ but ‘into My garden (le-gani)’—into my bridal chamber (le-ginuni), the very place in the lower world that was My principal dwelling from the beginning of creation before Adam’s sin caused the Shekhinah to ascend, until Moses erected the Tabernacle and drew the Shekhinah back down to earth.’

Daily help meets a struggle that renews itself

וְיֵשׁ עֲמָלֵק, יִצְרָא בִישָׁא, קַטֵיגוֹרָא מְקַטְרְגָא דְּבַר נָשׁ דְּיִשְׁתְּכַח תָּדִיר בְּבַר נָשׁ כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ (חֵלֶק ג׳ ק״ס עַמּוּד א׳)[723, , 724, 725]; **— and there exists Amalek, the evil impulse, the inner prosecutor found continually within man as written in the Zohar (Part III, 160a);** וּכְתִיב: "אֲשֶׁר קָרְךָ בַּדָּרֶךָ", **— and it is written: "How he cooled you (karcha) on the way",** שֶׁעֵסֶק עֲמָלֵק רֵאשִׁית גּוֹיִם לְקָרֵר אֶת הָאָדָם וּלְהַשְׁלִיךְ עָלָיו עַצְלוּת וְעַצְבוּת, **— for the enterprise of Amalek the first of nations is to cool down man's spiritual warmth and cast upon him laziness and depression,** וְזֶה שׁוֹלֵט אַף בִּגְדוֹלִים, **— and this dominates even over the greatest individuals,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁמָּצִינוּ בְּיַעְבֵּץ וְהַהֲלָכוֹת שֶׁרַבֵּץ תּוֹרָה בְּיִשְׂרָאֵל, **— as we find regarding Ya'abetz who disseminated Torah throughout Israel,** שֶׁנִּשְׁתַּכְּחוּ בְּאֲבֵלוּ שֶׁל מֹשֶׁה הוּא הֶחֱזִירָן מִתּוֹךְ פִּלְפּוּלוֹ, וּמִכָּל מָקוֹם בִּקֵּשׁ: "לְבַלְתִּי עָצְבִּי" **— and the halachot forgotten during the mourning for Moses he restored through his sharp analysis, –** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁלֹּא יַשְׁגִּיבַנִי יֵצֶר הָרָע מִלְּשָׁנוֹת שֶׁכָּתוּב תְּמוּרָה ט״ז עַמּוּד א׳)[726]; **— and nevertheless he prayed: "that it may not grieve me" — that the Evil Inclination not prevent me from study (Temurah 16a);** וּמִקְלָפָּה זוֹ אֵין בְּכֹחַ הָאָדָם לְהִנָּצֵל עַל יְדֵי בְּחִירָתוֹ לְבַד, **— and from this kelipah it is not within mortal power to be saved through human choice alone,** וְעַל זֶה אָמְרוּ: "וְאִלְמָלֵא הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא שֶׁעוֹזְרוֹ, אֵינוֹ יָכוֹל לוֹ", **— and regarding this they said: "Were it not that the Holy One assists him, he could not overcome it",** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב סֻכָּה נ״ב עַמּוּד א׳). "כָּל הַגָּדוֹל מֵחֲבֵרוֹ יִצְרוֹ גָּדוֹל"[727] **— and "whoever is greater than his fellow, his inclination is greater" (Sukkah 52a).** וְזֶה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: "וְעַל נִסֶּיךָ שֶׁבְּכָל יוֹם עִמָּנוּ", **— And this is why it is said: "And for Your miracles which are daily with us",** הַשֵּׁם הוּא נֵס יוֹצֵא מִגְּדֶר וְסֶדֶר הַהַנְהָגָה שֶׁהוּא עַל יְדֵי בְּחִירָה, **— for divine aid is a miracle transcending the natural framework of human free will,** וְזֶה בְּכָל יוֹם, שֶׁבְּכָל יוֹם מִתְגַּבֵּר הַיֵּצֶר הָרָע וּבְכָל יוֹם מִתְחַדֵּשׁ הַיֵּצֶר הָרָע, **— and this occurs daily, for each day the Evil Inclination surges and renews itself,** שֶׁכָּל הַגָּדוֹל מֵחֲבֵרוֹ יִצְרוֹ גָּדוֹל, וְזֶהוּ מַה שֶּׁכָּתוּב שֶׁמִּתְחַדֵּשׁ בְּכָל יוֹם; **— whereby whoever grows greater in spiritual stature faces an amplified inclination, which is why it renews daily;** וְהַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ עוֹשֶׂה נֵס וְעוֹזֵר מֻמָּנוּ שֶׁלֹּא יַעַזְבֵנוּ בְּיָדוֹ, **— and the Blessed Name performs a miracle and aids him, not abandoning him into its hand,** וְזֶה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: "כִּי מָחֹה אֶמְחֶה וְגוֹמֵר", **— and this is what Scripture states: "For I will utterly blot out, etc.",** שֶׁאֵין בְּכֹחַ הָאָדָם לִמְחוֹת זֵכֶר עֲמָלֵק אֶלָּא הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא שֶׁעוֹזְרוֹ; **— since it is not in human power to blot out the memory of Amalek**

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[723] **Zohar, Sh'lach 10:65**: “Furthermore: “Amalek dwells in the land of the south.” If a person says that, despite all this, he will attain it—“Amalek dwells in the land of the south”: this is the evil inclination, the accuser who accuses a person and is continually present in the body.”

[724] **Tzidkat HaTzadik 187:1**: “Words of Torah are a person’s strength, as it is written, “Wisdom strengthens the wise.” “Who is mighty? One who conquers his inclination”: through Torah a person prevails over the inclination, as they said, “Draw it to the house of study,” and “I created the evil inclination; I created Torah,” and so forth. This is “Were the Holy One, blessed be He, not to help him”: the help and assistance come through the words of Torah that He illuminates for him.”

Tzidkat HaTzadik identifies the help within the person’s actual learning: God illuminates words of Torah that become strength against the inclination. It therefore explains how the miraculous help named in Modim can occur within ordinary study, without making human choice self-sufficient or treating divine help as an excuse to stop studying.

[725] **Tiferet Yosef, Talmud Anthology, Taanit 1**: “Even when a person follows all the safeguards and boundaries of Torah and mitzvot, the Talmud still says, “Were the Holy One, blessed be He, not to help him,” and so forth. Yet it is impossible to grant a person the flow of His kindness before he has followed those safeguards in his service. From his own side the person is finite, whereas the flow of God’s kindness is truly without limit; how can the finite receive the infinite? After he follows all the safeguards of Torah and mitzvot in his service, however, he becomes a vessel to receive even what is without limit, recognizing well the bond between heaven and earth. This bond is called “the powers of rain.” Thus the Talmud asks why it belongs in prayer and cites “To love the Lord your God ... what is service of the heart? Prayer,” followed by “I shall give the rain of your land in its season.” After the person’s service, God gives him the power of prayer and seals His testimony that the depths of his heart contain such boundless firmness of faith and trust that, by right, through the labor of his own hands, he receives God’s limitless flow.”

Tiferet Yosef preserves both sides of the problem: completed human effort still needs God’s help, while that help is received through the capacities formed by service. Its account of prayer as a divine gift deepens the later portion of Rav Tzadok’s paragraph. The comparison retains Tiferet Yosef’s preparation through Torah and mitzvot; it does not erase Rav Tzadok’s separate counsel that one unable to attain Torah learning can cry and pray.

[726] **Temurah 16a:16**: “‘If You will surely bless me’ means in Torah. ‘And enlarge my boundary’ means with students. ‘And let Your hand be with me’ means that my learning should not be forgotten from my heart. ‘And make from my adversity’ means that companions like myself should be made available to me. ‘So that I shall not be distressed’ means that the evil inclination should not overpower me and prevent me from studying. If You do this, well and good; if not, I shall go in my grief to Sheol. Immediately, ‘God brought about what he had requested.’”

[727] **Sukkah 52a:11-12**: “As in the case of Abaye, who heard a man telling a woman, ‘Let us rise early and set out on the road.’ Abaye said, ‘I will go and keep them from transgression.’ He followed them for three parasangs through a marsh. When they parted, he heard them say, ‘The road was long, and our companionship pleasant.’ Abaye said, ‘Had it been someone who hates me’—meaning himself—‘he would not have been able to restrain himself.’ He went, leaned against the doorpost, and was distressed. An elder came and taught him: ‘Whoever is greater than another has an inclination greater than his.’”

were it not that the Holy One assists him; וְזֶהוּ נֵס שֶׁלּוֹלֵא כַּסֵּדֶר, וְעַל כֵּן קָרָא מֹשֶׁה רַבֵּנוּ שֵׁם הַמִּזְבֵּחַ "ה' נִסִּי" עַל שֵׁם הַנֵּס. **— and this is a supernatural miracle, which is why Moses named the altar Hashem Nissi after the miracle.** וְזֶה שֶׁכָּתוּב בְּפֵרוּשׁ רַבִּי שְׁלֹמֹה יִצְחָקִי מִמִּדְרַשׁ תַּנְחוּמָא (כִּי תֵצֵא):[728] **— And this is what is written in Rashi from Midrash Tanchuma (Ki Teitzei):** שֶׁכְּבָיְכוֹל אֵין שְׁמוֹ שָׁלֵם וְאֵין כִּסְאוֹ שָׁלֵם עַד שֶׁיִּמָּחֶה זֵכֶר עֲמָלֵק; **— that as it were, His Name is not whole and His Throne is not whole until the memory of Amalek is blotted out;** וְהוּא דַּעֲמָלֵק רֵאשִׁית דְּקְלִפָּה, וְהוּא בְּ"זֶה לְעֻמַּת זֶה" נֶגֶד רֵאשִׁית דִּקְדֻשָּׁה, **— for Amalek is the beginning of the unholy husk, parallel in direct opposition to the beginning of holiness,** וְכָל זְמַן שֶׁאֵין שְׁמוֹ שֶׁל עֲמָלֵק נִמְחֶה, נֶחְסַר אָלֶ"ף בַּכִּסֵּא, **— and as long as Amalek's name is not erased, the aleph is missing from the Throne (kes instead of kissei),** דְּאָלֶ"ף מוֹרֶה עַל פֶּלֶא עֶלְיוֹן; **— where the aleph points to the Supreme Wonder (Pele Elyon);** וְגַם

[728] **Midrash Tanchuma, Ki Teitzei 11:1**: "(Deut. 25:19:) "And it shall come to pass when the Lord your God grants you rest … you shall blot out the remembrance of Amalek." R. Azariah and R. Judah bar Simon said in the name of R. Judah bar Il'ay, "Israel was given three commandments on their entrance to the land: To appoint a king over themselves, as written (in Deut. 17:15), 'You shall surely place a king over yourself.' To build the Temple, as written (in Exod. 25:8), 'And make Me a sanctuary.' To cut off the seed of Amalek, as stated (in Deut. 25:19), '… you shall blot out the remembrance of Amalek.'" R. Joshua ben Levi said in the name of R. Alexandri, "One text says (in Deut. 25:19), 'you shall blot out the remembrance of Amalek,' while another text says (in Exod. 17:14), 'I will utterly blot out the remembrance of Amalek.' How are these two texts to be harmonized? Before the Amalekites raised their hands against the heavenly throne, 'you shall blot out.' When they had raised their hands against the heavenly throne, 'I will blot out.'" Can flesh and blood possibly raise its hand against the throne of the Holy One, blessed be He? It is simply because they destroyed Jerusalem, since it is written (in Jer. 3:17), "For at that time they shall call Jerusalem the throne of the Lord." It is therefore written (in Exod. 17:14), "I will utterly blot out." And it is stated (Exod. 17:16), "Because a hand is upon the throne of the Lord, the Lord has a war with Amalek from generation to generation." It is taught in the name of R. Il'ay: The Holy One, blessed be He, swore an oath and said, "By My right hand, by My right hand, by My throne, by My throne, I swear that if gentiles come from any of the peoples, them I will accept; but those from the seed of Amalek I will not accept." And David also acted in this way, as stated (in II Sam. 1:13), "And David said unto the young man who had told him, 'Where do you come from?' Then he said, 'I am the son of an Amalekite proselyte.'" R. Isaac said, "He was the son of Doeg the Edomite." (II Sam. 1:16:) "Then David said to him, 'Your blood be upon your own head ….'" This is what one reads, but the written text (ketiv) is "Your bloods," meaning You shed a lot of bloods; you killed the inhabitants of Nob, the city of priests .(Exod. 17:16:) "From generation to generation." The Holy One, blessed be He, said, "'From generation to generation,' I am keeping after them (i.e., after the Amalekites) for generations of generations." R. Eliezer, R. Joshua, and R. Jose differ. R. Eliezer says, "From the generation of Moses to the generation of Samuel." R. Joshua says, "From the generation of Samuel to the generation of Mordecai and Esther." And R. Jose says, "From the generation of Mordecai and Esther to the generation of the messianic king, which itself equals three generations." And where is it shown that the generation of the messianic king equals three generations? Where it is stated (of the messianic king in Ps. 72:5), "Let them fear You as long as the sun endures and as long as the moon, for a generation and generations." The singular generation equals one, and the plural generations equals two, for a total of three. R. Berekhyah said in the name of R. Abba bar Kahana, "As long as the seed of Amalek remains alive in the world, it is as though a wing (kanaf) is hiding the divine face. When the seed of Amalek has passed from the world, (in Is. 30:20), "your Teacher (i.e., the Holy One, blessed be He,) will no longer be hidden (yikanef)." R. Levi says in the name of R. Hama bar Hanina, "As long as the seed of Amalek is in the world, the divine name will not be at peace (literally, whole) and the divine throne will not be at peace. When the seed of Amalek passes from the world, the throne will be at peace, and the name will be at peace." What is the evidence? That which is stated (in Ps. 9:7), "The enemy is no more, in everlasting ruins, and you have uprooted their cities, their very memory has perished." What is written after that (in vs. 8), "But the Lord sits enthroned forever; He has established His throne for judgment." Ergo, the name is at peace, and the throne is at peace. Amen, and so may it be His will!"

נֶחְסַר הַיִּחוּד יָ"ה בָּוָה"ו, — **and the unification of Yah (י-ה)[729] — with Vav-Heh (ו-ה)[730] — is also impaired,**
שֶׁהוּא הַהַשְׁפָּעָה מִיו"ד וְתָגּוֹ שֶׁל יו"ד הַמּוֹרֶה עַל כֶּתֶר עֶלְיוֹן לְהֵ"א תַּתָּאָה, מִדַּת כְּנֶסֶת יִשְׂרָאֵל. — **which is the bestowal from the yud and the crownlet of the yud (alluding to Keter) down into the lower heh, the sefirah of Knesset**

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Yisrael. ,"נִסֶּיךָ וְכוּלֵּיהּ, וְעַל נִפְלְאוֹתֶיךָ וְטוּבוֹתֶיךָ": וְזֶה — **And this is: "Your miracles, etc., and for Your wonders and Your goodness",** שֶׁבְּכָל יוֹם זוֹכִין לְעֵזֶר הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ שֶׁהוּא נֵס בָּאָמוּר, — **in that every day we merit the aid of the Blessed Name which is a miracle as stated,** לְהַשְׁפִּיל וְלִמְחוֹת רֹאשִׁית דְּקְלִפָּה; — **to humble and blot out the head of the unholy husk;** "וְזֶה עַל יְדֵי שֶׁיִּזְכּוּ לְ"נִפְלְאוֹתֶיךָ", לְהוֹפִיעַ וּלְהַזְרִיחַ מִפֶּלֶא עֶלְיוֹן; וְ"טוּבוֹתֶיךָ — **and this through meriting "Your wonders", shining from the Supreme Wonder (Pele); –** לְהַזְרִיחַ מֵחָכְמָה — **and "Your goodness" — shining from Chochmah, corresponding to which is the utterance "Let there be light" which was called "good",** שֶׁנִּבְרָא "יְהִי אוֹר" שֶׁנִּקְרָא "טוֹב", וְהַיְנוּ הַיּוּ"ד מֵהַשֵּׁם שֶׁמְּרַמֵּז לְחָכְמָה — **representing the yud of the Name alluding to Chochmah and its upper tip pointing to Ayin, Keter Elyon, as is known.** וְקוֹצָא דְּלֵעֵילָּא דְּרָמְיָא לְאַיִן, כֶּתֶר עֶלְיוֹן כַּיָּדוּעַ.[731] — **And this is based on what is stated (Shemot Rabbah, Parashah 38):** (בְּשְׁמוֹת רַבָּה פָּרָשָׁה ל״ח): וְהוּא עַל פִּי מַה שֶּׁכָּתוּב '"קְחוּ עִמָּכֶם דְּבָרִים', וְאֵין דְּבָרִים אֶלָּא תּוֹרָה, שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר; — **"'Take with you words', and words mean nothing other than words of Torah, etc.;** אָמְרוּ לוֹ: אֵין אָנוּ יוֹדְעִין; אָמַר לָהֶם: בְּכוּ וְהִתְפַּלְּלוּ לְפָנַי וְכוּלֵּיהּ"; — **they said to Him: We do not know how to learn; He said to them: Weep and pray before Me, etc.";** וְהַיְנוּ דְּלִכְבּוֹשׁ אֶת הַיֵּצֶר הָרָע כְּתִיב: "כִּי קָרוֹב אֵלֶיךָ הַדָּבָר מְאֹד בְּפִיךָ וּבִלְבָבְךָ", — **meaning that to subdue the Evil Inclination it is written: "For the matter is very near to you, in your mouth and in your heart",** וְהַיְנוּ שֶׁעַל יְדֵי הַפֶּה יִכָּנֵס לַלֵּב גַּם כֵּן; וְהוּא עַל יְדֵי "הַקּוֹל קוֹל יַעֲקֹב" שֶׁהוּא קוֹל תּוֹרָה, קוֹל ה״א — **meaning that through the mouth it penetrates the heart as well; – –** קוֹל תְּפִלָּה. — **and this occurs through "the voice is the voice of Jacob", being the voice of the vav — the voice of Torah, and the voice of the heh — the voice of prayer.** וּמִי שֶׁזּוֹכֶה לְדִבְרֵי תוֹרָה מְשַׁבֵּר הַיֵּצֶר הָרָע עַל יְדֵי כֹּחַ הַתּוֹרָה, — **And one who merits words of Torah shatters the Evil Inclination through the power of the Torah,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב (זֹהַר חֵלֶק א׳ ר״ב עַמּוּד א׳): "דָּבָא לֵית לָךְ מִלָּה לְתַבְרָא יֵצֶר הָרָע אֶלָּא אוֹרַיְתָא",[732] — **as written (Zohar Part I, 202a): "For you have no instrument to break the Evil Inclination except Torah",** וְזֶה זוֹכֶה לְ"נִפְלְאוֹתֶיךָ וְטוּבוֹתֶיךָ" — **and he merits "Your wonders and Your goodness",** שֶׁמּוֹרֶה עַל הַחָכְמָה שֶׁהִיא אוֹר "כִּי טוֹב" וְקוֹצָא דְּיוּ"ד דִּלְעֵילָּא דְּרָמְיָא לְאַיִן, כֶּתֶר עֶלְיוֹן, פֶּלֶא עֶלְיוֹן, — **pointing to Chochmah which is the light that is "good", and the upper tip of the yud alluding to Ayin, Keter Elyon, the Supreme Wonder,** וְעַל יְדֵי כֵן זוֹכֶה לְעֵזֶר הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ שֶׁהוּא נֵס בָּאָמוּר. — **and through this he merits divine assistance which is a miracle as stated.** וּמִי שֶׁאֵינוֹ בַּר הָכִי וְאֵינוֹ זוֹכֶה לְדִבְרֵי תוֹרָה, — **And one who is not capable of this and does not merit intense Torah study,** מִכָּל מָקוֹם יֵשׁ לוֹ עֵצָה: "בְּכוּ וְהִתְפַּלְּלוּ לְפָנַי" כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בַּמִּדְרָשׁ רַבָּה; — **nevertheless has a recourse: "Weep and pray before Me" as written in Midrash Rabbah;** וְעַל זֶה מְרַמֵּז "וְטוּבוֹתֶיךָ שֶׁבְּכָל עֵת, עֶרֶב וָבֹקֶר וְצָהֳרַיִם", — **and to this alludes: "and Your goodness at all times, evening, morning, and afternoon",** שֶׁהֵם שְׁלֹשָׁה זְמַנֵּי שֶׁגַּם עַל יְדֵי תְּפִלָּה זוֹכִין לְנֵסָּיךָ שֶׁבְּכָל יוֹם, לְכְבּוֹשׁ הַיֵּצֶר הָרָע — **which are the three daily prayer services, in that through prayer as well one merits "Your miracles which are daily", conquering the Evil Inclination the head of the kelipah;** הַתְּפִלּוֹת, רֹאשִׁית דְּקְלִפָּה; — **and in prayer also one merits wonders from the Supreme Wonder,** וְגַם בִּתְפִלָּה זוֹכִין לִנְפְלָאוֹת מִפֶּלֶא עֶלְיוֹן, — **when we say "Blessed are You, Hashem" as one standing before the King,** שֶׁאוֹמְרִים "בָּרוּךְ אַתָּה יהו"ה" כְּעוֹמֵד לִפְנֵי הַמֶּלֶךְ, וְשֵׁם יהו"ה כּוֹלֵל תֵּשַׁע סְפִירוֹת כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב (זֹהַר חֵלֶק ג׳ רנ״ח עַמּוּד א׳)[733] — **and the Name Havayah encompasses nine sefirot as written (Zohar Part III, 258a)** וְקוֹצָא דְּיוּ"ד דִּלְעֵילָּא רוֹמֵז לְכֶתֶר עֶלְיוֹן (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב שָׁם ס״ה עַמּוּד ב׳),[734] — **and the upper tip of the yud points to Keter Elyon (as written ibid. 65b),** וְזוֹכִין עַל יְדֵי תְּפִלָּה גַּם כֵּן לִנְפְלָאוֹת וְאוֹר "כִּי טוֹב". — **and**

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the seed of Amalek is in the world, the divine name will not be at peace (literally, whole) and the divine throne will not be at peace. When the seed of Amalek passes from the world, the throne will be at peace, and the name will be at peace." What is the evidence? That which is stated (in Ps. 9:7), "The enemy is no more, in everlasting ruins, and you have uprooted their cities, their very memory has perished." What is written after that (in vs. 8), "But the Lord sits enthroned forever; He has established His throne for judgment." Ergo, the name is at peace, and the throne is at peace. Amen, and so may it be His will!"

[731] **Shemot Rabbah 38:4** (excerpt): "They said to Him: We are poor and have nothing with which to bring sacrifices. He said to them: I ask for words, as it says, 'Take words with you and return to Hashem,' and I will forgive all your sins. 'Words' means words of Torah, as it says, 'These are the words that Moshe spoke' (Deuteronomy 1:1). They said to Him: We do not know how. He said: Weep and pray before Me, and I will accept. When your ancestors were enslaved in Egypt, did I not redeem them through prayer, as it says, 'The children of Israel groaned from the labor and cried out' (Exodus 2:23)?"

[732] **Zohar, Miketz 12:194-206**: 'The brothers were afraid on account of their sin in having stolen Joseph, for had they not sinned they would not have had any cause to fear; for it is only a man's sins that break his courage and deprive him of strength, the reason being that the good prompter is at the same time unnerved, and left powerless to contend with the evil prompter. This is implied in the words: "What man is there that is fearful and faint- hearted?" (Deut. 20, 8), on account, that is, of sins which he may have committed, these being the ruin of a stout heart.'

[733] **Zohar, Pinchas 126:877**: "The tefillin of the Master of the world are Keter. What is the crown of the Master of the world? YHWH: yud is Chochmah; heh is Binah; vav is Tiferet, encompassing six sefirot; heh is Malkhut."

[734] **Zohar, Achrei Mot 27:171**: "Come and see: yud at the beginning includes everything, concealed on every side; its paths are not opened, and it includes male and female. The upper tip of yud alludes to Ayin."

through prayer one likewise merits wonders and the light that is "good".

וּבִבְרָכָה זוֹ תִּקְנוּ הַזְכָּרַת "עַל הַנִּסִּים" בַּחֲנֻכָּה — **And within this blessing they instituted the insertion of Al HaNissim on Chanukah,** שֶׁהָיָה עַל יְדֵי הַכֹּהֲנִים שֶׁתִּקְנוּ מִדַּת הוֹד, וּכְמוֹ שֶׁכָּתַב הָאֲרִיזַ"ל; — **which came about through the priests who rectified the attribute of Hod, as the Arizal wrote;** וְזֶה שֶׁמַּסְמִיכִין לָזֶה בִּרְכַּת כֹּהֲנִים, — **and for this reason we juxtapose to this the Priestly Blessing,** וְאַחַר כָּךְ בִּרְכַּת "שִׂים שָׁלוֹם" נֶגֶד מִדַּת יְסוֹד שֶׁיּוֹסֵף מֶרְכָּבָה לַהּ, — **and afterward the blessing of Sim Shalom corresponding to Yesod whose chariot is Joseph,** וּמִדָּתוֹ שָׁלוֹם כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ. — **whose spiritual attribute is peace as written in the Holy Zohar.** וְקוֹרִין בַּחֲנֻכָּה בַּנְּשִׂיאִים (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב מְגִלָּה ל״א עַמּוּד א׳),[735] — **And on Chanukah we read the Torah portion of the Princes (Megillah 31a),** וְהוּא עַל פִּי מַה שֶּׁכָּתוּב (יַלְקוּט מְלָכִים רֶמֶז קפ״ד מִפְּסִיקְתָא):[736] — **and this is based on what is stated (Yalkut Melachim, Remez 184 citing the Pesikta):** "בְּכ״ה בְּכִסְלֵו נִגְמְרָה מְלֶאכֶת הַמִּשְׁכָּן, וְעָשָׂה מְקֻפָּל עַד אֶחָד בְּנִיסָן וְכוּלֵיהּ, — **"On the 25th of Kislev the construction of the Tabernacle was completed, and it lay folded until the 1st of Nisan, etc.,** וּמַעֲתָּה הִפְסִיד כִּסְלֵו וְכוּלֵיהּ? — **and did Kislev now lose out, etc.?** שֶׁלֵּם לוֹ הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא חֲנֻכַּת חַשְׁמוֹנַאי וְכוּלֵיהּ"; — **The Holy One repaid it with the Hasmonean dedication, etc.";** וְיֵשׁ לְהָבִין: מַה הָא כִּסְלֵו רָאוּי לַחֲנֻכָּה מִפְּנֵי הַנֵּס שֶׁאֵרַע בּוֹ, — **and one must understand: what kind of repayment is this?** — **For behold Kislev was independently worthy of dedication because of the miracle that occurred in it,** שֶׁגָּבְרוּ עַל הַיְוָנִים שֶׁטִּמְּאוּ כָּל הַשְּׁמָנִים וְכָל כְּלֵי הַמִּשְׁכָּן, — **wherein they overpowered the Greeks who had defiled all oils and vessels of the Sanctuary,** וְכֵינָן שֶׁרָאוּי לַחֲנֻכָּה מִצַּד עַצְמוֹ, מַה שִּׁלֵּם לוֹ הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא? — **and since it was worthy of a dedication on its own, what did the Holy One repay it?** אֲבָל מִצַּד הַנֵּס הָיָה רָאוּי לַעֲשׂוֹת חֲנֻכָּה לְשָׁעָתוֹ, — **Indeed, on account of the miracle alone it was appropriate to celebrate an ad-hoc dedication for that time,** אֲבָל לֹא לִקְבֹּעַ חֲנֻכָּה לְדוֹרוֹת, — **but not to establish a permanent dedication for all generations,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁלֹּא נִקְבְּעוּ לְדוֹרוֹת הַיָּמִים שֶׁנַּעֲשָׂה בָּהֶן חֲנֻכַּת הַמִּשְׁכָּן וַחֲנֻכַּת הַמִּקְדָּשׁ; — **just as the historical dates of the Tabernacle's and the First Temple's dedications were not established as annual festivals for future generations;** וּמַה שֶּׁנִּקְבַּע חֲנֻכַּת חַשְׁמוֹנַאי לְדוֹרוֹת — **– and the fact that the Hasmonean dedication was established permanently for all generations —** זֶהוּ תַּשְׁלוּמִין לַחֲנֻכַּת הַמִּשְׁכָּן שֶׁנִּגְמְרָה מְלַאכְתּוֹ בְּכ״ה בְּכִסְלֵו. — **this was the divine repayment for the dedication of the Tabernacle whose construction was finished on the 25th of Kislev.** וְעַל כֵּן קוֹרִין בַּנְּשִׂיאִים, וּמַתְחִילִין: "וַיְהִי בְּיוֹם כַּלּוֹת מֹשֶׁה". — **And therefore we read the portion of the Princes, commencing: "And it came to pass on the day that Moses finished".** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמַרְנוּ שֶׁעִקַּר קְדֻשַּׁת הַמִּשְׁכָּן הָיָה עַל יְדֵי מֹשֶׁה רַבֵּנוּ, — **And as we explained, the primary holiness of the Tabernacle was brought about through Moses our Teacher,** שֶׁבָּא וְהוֹרִיד הַשְּׁכִינָה לָאָרֶץ מִקּוֹדֶם בְּמַתַּן תּוֹרָה, — **who came and brought down the Shechinah to earth originally at the giving of the Torah,** וְאַחַר הַקִּלְקוּל נִקְבַּע הַשְּׁרָאַת הַשְּׁכִינָה בַּמִּשְׁכָּן. — **and after the sin the resting of the Shechinah was permanently anchored in the Tabernacle.**

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[735] **Megillah 31a:17**: "On Chanukah, the Torah reading is the offerings of the tribal princes, and the haftarah is Zecharyah's vision of the lamps. If Chanukah includes two Shabbosos, on the first they read Zecharyah's lamps, and on the second, Shlomo's lamps."

[736] **Pesikta Rabbati 6:2**: 'On the twenty-fifth of Kislev the work of the Tabernacle was completed, yet it remained folded and waited for three months until the first of Nisan, when Moses erected it on the day Isaac was born. Kislev therefore felt deprived, and the Holy One, blessed be He, said: 'It is incumbent upon Me to repay Kislev,' and He repaid it with the dedication of the Hasmoneans on the twenty-fifth of Kislev.'

Bowing can express an awareness already established within

וְזֶה עִנְיַן מַה שֶּׁכָּתוּב בַּיְרוּשַׁלְמִי (פֶּרֶק ב׳ דִּבְרָכוֹת, הוּבָא בְּתוֹסָפוֹת רֹאשׁ הַשָּׁנָה ט״ז עַמּוּד ב׳)[737, 738, 739] — **And this is the meaning of what is written in the Yerushalmi (Berachot 2, cited in Tosafot Rosh Hashanah 16b):** "אָמַר רַבִּי מֵאִיר: מַחֲזִיק אֲנָא טִיבוּ לְרֵישָׁא, דְּכַד הֲוָה מָטֵי לְ'מוֹדִים' הוּא כָּרַע מִגַּרְמֵיהּ". — **"Rabbi Meir said: I express gratitude to my head, for when it reaches Modim it bows down of its own accord."** וְיֵשׁ לְהָבִין: אֵיךְ הִרְגִּישׁ הָרֹאשׁ לִכְרֹעַ, וְאִם מִפְּנֵי הַהֶרְגֵּל, לָמָּה מַחֲזִיק טִיבוּ לְרֵישָׁא? — **And one must understand: how did the head sense to bow, and if due to mere habit, why express gratitude to the head?** אַךְ הָעִנְיָן, שֶׁכָּל הַבְּרָכוֹת אָנוּ אוֹמְרִים בִּלְשׁוֹן הוֹוֶה: "חוֹנֵן הַדַּעַת", "מַרְבֶּה לִסְלוֹחַ", — **However, the explanation is that all blessings we recite in the present tense: "Graciously bestowing knowledge", "abundantly forgiving", "healing the sick, etc.",** דְּכֵינָן שֶׁהָאָדָם מִתְפַּלֵּל וְהַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרֵךְ שׁוֹמֵעַ תְּפִלָּה, מִיָּד נַעֲנָה בִּשְׁעָתוֹ בַּהוֹוֶה; וּבִבְרָכַת "רְצֵה" שֶׁמְּבָרְכִין "הַמַּחֲזִיר שְׁכִינָתוֹ לְצִיּוֹן" בַּהוֹוֶה, — **for when a person prays and the Blessed Name hears prayer, he is instantly answered in the present moment; and in the blessing of Retzei where we bless "Who restores His Shechinah to Zion" in the present tense,** וּבְרָכָה זוֹ כְּנֶגֶד מֹשֶׁה רַבֵּנוּ שֶׁעַל יְדֵי קְדֻשָּׁתוֹ זוֹכִין לָזֶה, וְאוֹמְרִים "הַמַּחֲזִיר שְׁכִינָתוֹ לְצִיּוֹן" בַּהוֹוֶה. — **and this blessing corresponds to Moses our Teacher through whose holiness we merit this, – we say "Who restores" — for He restores it right now in the present.** וְאַף שֶׁהָעוֹלָם נִדּוֹן אַחַר רֻבּוֹ וְלֹא זָכוּ לָזֶה הַכְּלָל, — **And even though the collective world is judged by its majority and the public has not yet**

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[737] **Tosafot on Rosh Hashanah 16b:5:1**: "'And scrutiny of prayer': Rabbenu Tam says that the scrutiny of prayer mentioned here is like that in the chapter Get Pashut (Bava Batra 164b), which lists three things from which a person is not spared each day, including scrutiny of prayer—that is, failing to direct one's heart in prayer. As the Jerusalem Talmud says in the chapter Hayah Korei of Berakhot: Rabbi Chiyya the Great said, 'In all my days I never concentrated in prayer. Once I wanted to concentrate, but I reflected in my heart: Who enters before the king first, the prefect or the Exilarch?' Shmuel said, 'I counted chicks.' Rabbi Bun bar Chiyya said, 'I counted courses of masonry.' Rabbi Mana said, 'I am grateful to my head, because when it reached Modim it bowed of its own accord.' Because a person prays without directing his heart, his transgressions are recalled. However, it is not at all possible to explain our passage this way. Rather, it concerns someone who strives to direct his heart and confidently expects his prayer to be heard, like the teaching in the chapter Ein Omdin (Berakhot 32b) about one who prolongs his prayer and scrutinizes it. This is evident at the beginning of the chapter Haro'eh (Berakhot 54b), where Rav Yehudah says in Rav's name that three things prolong a person's life, including prolonging prayer. The Gemara asks: Does that mean it is a virtue? Did Rabbi Chiyya bar Abba not say that one who prolongs his prayer and scrutinizes it eventually comes to heartache, as it says, 'Prolonged hope makes the heart ill'? 'Scrutinizes it' means that he says in his heart that his request should be fulfilled because he prayed with concentration. He comes to heartache when his request is not fulfilled. Here 'hope' means prayer, related to 'Moshe entreated.' Rabbi Yitzchak also said (Berakhot 55a) that three things recall a person's transgressions, including scrutiny of prayer, because this causes his deeds to be examined: 'He relies on his merits; let us see what they are.' The Gemara resolves the contradiction: One teaching concerns someone who scrutinizes his prayer, and the other someone who does not. Accordingly, all three things listed here belong to one category: Passing beneath a leaning wall while relying on one's merit; submitting judgment against another person to Heaven while relying on one's merit so that the other will be punished through him; and scrutiny of prayer with the same reliance on one's merit."

[738] **Tzidkat HaTzadik 233:1**: "Therefore he said, "I am grateful," and so forth. Certainly no person is free from the serpent's instigation, for the human being ultimately dies because of it. Nevertheless his gratitude is to his head, the root of the Israelite soul, which "bowed of itself": the essential wisdom, understanding, and knowledge within his head are clean of this. The foreign thought is a garment, wholly outside Israel's essential root, outside the camp of Israel as stated. Therefore he did not relate the content of those foreign thoughts. When the others related their thoughts, it was to raise them, as explained above concerning extracting words of Torah from a foreign thought. Certainly there is also an allusion here to secrets of Torah hidden within the thought: the garment is suited to that person's inward wisdom. The garment of envy, however, entirely conceals it, as explained above. Its elevation comes through saying, "I am grateful": in truth the head is not like the garment, and this is not its true character at all."

Tzidkat HaTzadik examines the same spontaneous bow amid distracting thoughts. Its distinction between the soul's root and an intrusive garment explains why the bow can disclose something real even before the person has eliminated every distraction. This complements Chanukah's account of the head sensing awe, without turning a bodily reflex into proof that the whole person is already perfected.

[739] **Sod Yesharim, The First Night of Pesach 26:5**: "This is what the Sages said: "In every generation a person must see himself as though he came out of Egypt." Whatever a person is sunk in so deeply that he imagines he cannot escape its habit is called the bondage of Egypt. He is therefore required to see that no habitual nature holds him; to the extent that he is free of such habit, he finds lasting freedom within his heart. This is called leaving Egypt. How can he bring himself out? Only by establishing in his heart that words of Torah are exalted above everything in this world. As the Sages said, "One who accepts the yoke of Torah has the yoke of government and worldly occupation removed from him." Torah is above those yokes, and to the extent that a person establishes Torah in his heart, he rises above worldly habits. All this must occur "in deed and in speech": there must also be spoken utterance, for "the mouth completes." This indicates the outermost garment: it must be established even there, even without conscious intention. As the Jerusalem Talmud says, "I am grateful to my head: when it reaches Modim, it bows of itself"—the body is drawn after His blessed will even without conscious intention."

Sod Yesharim supplies the process by which the spontaneous bow becomes possible: Torah must be established in the heart and expressed in speech until the body follows. It distinguishes this acquired freedom from the constraining habit that the Exodus must overcome. That directly illuminates Rav Tzadok's question why Rabbi Matanya would thank his head if the bow were only routine.

merited this, מִכָּל מָקוֹם פְּרָט נֶפֶשׁ הַמִּתְפַּלֵּל נַעֲנָה כְּבָר,[740] **— nevertheless the individual soul of the worshiper is already answered,** וְעַל דֶּרֶךְ מַה שֶּׁאָמְרוּ (בְּרָכוֹת ל״ג עַמּוּד א׳): "כָּל אָדָם שֶׁיֵּשׁ בּוֹ דֵּעָה, כְּאִלּוּ נִבְנָה בֵּית הַמִּקְדָּשׁ בְּיָמָיו",[741] **— following their statement (Berachot 33a): "Whoever has Da'at, it is as if the Temple was built in his days";** וְכֵינָן שֶׁמַּרְגִּישׁ שֶׁמְּחַזִּיר שְׁכִינָתוֹ, מִיָּד נוֹפֵל עָלָיו הַפַּחַד, וּכְמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב: "וּבְמוֹרָא גָּדוֹל: **— and since he senses that He is restoring His Shechinah, holy dread immediately falls upon him, –** זֶה גִּלּוּי שְׁכִינָה", **— as written: "And with great terror — this is the revelation of the Shechinah",** שֶׁבְּכָל מָקוֹם שֶׁיֵּשׁ הִתְגַּלּוּת הַשְׁכִינָה נוֹפֵל הַפַּחַד וְהִירְאָה. **— for wherever there is a revelation of the Shechinah, fear and awe descend.** וְהָרֹאשׁ מַרְגִּישׁ הַפַּחַד, עַל דֶּרֶךְ מַה שֶּׁכָּתַב הָרַב זִכְרוֹנוֹ לִבְרָכָה שֶׁדִּקְדְּקוּ בַּגְּמָרָא "תְּפִלִּין שֶׁבָּרֹאשׁ" וְלֹא **— And the head physically feels this awe,** אָמְרוּ "תְּפִלִּין שֶׁעַל הָרֹאשׁ", **— after the manner of what the Rabbi of Przysucha of blessed memory explained: that the Gemara was precise in saying "tefillin in the head" and did not say "tefillin upon the head",** שֶׁהַמְּכָוָּן עַל הָאָרַת הַתְּפִלִּין בַּמֹּחַ שֶׁבָּרֹאשׁ; **— because the focus is on the radiance of the tefillin penetrating the brain within the head;** וְזֶה שֶׁאָמַר: "מַחֲזִיק אֲנָא טִיבוּ לְרֵישָׁא שֶׁמַּרְגִּישׁ הַפַּחַד, כִּי מָטֵי לְמוֹדִים וְכָרַע מִגַּרְמֵיהּ". **— and this is why Rabbi Meir said: "I am grateful to my head that it senses this awe, for when it reaches Modim it bows on its own."**

For the blessing of Avodah corresponds to Moses our Teacher, Best Man of the King, דְּבִרְכַּת עֲבוֹדָה נֶגֶד מֹשֶׁה רַבֵּנוּ, שׁוּשְׁבִינָא דְּמַלְכָּא; **— who draws the Blessed Name down to Israel;** שֶׁמּוֹרִיד הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ לְיִשְׂרָאֵל; **— and afterward Modim corresponds to Hod, the level of Aaron, Best Man of the Queen,** וְאַחַר כָּךְ "מוֹדִים" כְּנֶגֶד הוֹד, דַּרְגָּא דְּאַהֲרֹן, שׁוּשְׁבִינָא דְּמַטְרוֹנִיתָא; **— who draws Israel close to their Father in Heaven.** שֶׁמְּקָרֵב יִשְׂרָאֵל לַאֲבִיהֶן שֶׁבַּשָּׁמַיִם. **— And within it we mention miracles and wonders,** וּבוֹ מַזְכִּירִין נִסִּים וְנִפְלָאוֹת, **— and within it we recite Al HaNissim on Chanukah,** מַזְכִּירִין "עַל הַנִּסִּים" בַּחֲנֻכָּה, **— which occurred through the oil and lights which indicate wisdom (Menachot 85b),** שֶׁהָיָה עַל יְדֵי שֶׁמֶן וְנֵרוֹת שֶׁמּוֹרִים עַל חָכְמָה כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב (מְנָחוֹת פ״ה עַמּוּד ב׳),[742] **— and point to Torah as stated: "And Torah is light".** וְעַל תּוֹרָה כְּמַה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: "וְתוֹרָה אוֹר". **— And the channeling of Torah words occurs through the priests, which is Aaron's power drawing them to Torah,** וְהִשְׁפָּעַת דִּבְרֵי תוֹרָה עַל יְדֵי הַכֹּהֲנִים שֶׁזֶּה כֹּחַ אַהֲרֹן וּמְקָרְבָן לַתּוֹרָה, וְכֵן נֶאֱמַר: "כִּי שִׂפְתֵי כֹהֵן יִשְׁמְרוּ **— as Scripture states: "For the priest's lips shall guard knowledge and they shall seek Torah from his mouth".** דַּעַת וְתוֹרָה יְבַקְשׁוּ מִפִּיהוּ".

Purim's renewed acceptance reveals Torah within concealment

And likewise on Purim we insert Al HaNissim into the וְכֵן בְּפוּרִים מַזְכִּירִין "עַל הַנִּסִּים" בִּבְרְכַּת הוֹדָאָה,[743] **—**

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[740] **Peri Tzadik, Vaetchanan 13:1**: "From this our hearts should become steadfast in trust in God: our prayers, too, do not return empty. We continually pray, "Return to Jerusalem, Your city, in mercy." Even though we have not yet merited this in actuality, a person's heart must not fail him. In truth, all the prayers of Israel's souls act spiritually. Each individual soul, according to the measure of its longing, attains the intended purpose and finds consolation in its heart, as the Sages said: "Whoever mourns for Jerusalem merits and sees its joy." This certainly does not mean only the future, for it says in the present tense, "merits and sees." Rather, according to the measure of the longing and yearning in the depths of his heart, he immediately merits to see and feel its joy in his heart, in the sense of "Rejoice in God, you righteous." For this reason all the formulas of prayer were established in the present tense: "Who builds Jerusalem," "Who causes the horn of salvation to spring forth," and "Who restores His Presence to Zion." In truth, they are continually answered, as it says: "Let Israel rejoice in its Maker; let the children of Zion exult in their King.""

[741] **Berakhot 33a**: "Rabbi Elazar also said: Any person who possesses understanding is as though the Holy Temple were built in his days. Understanding is placed between two Divine Names, and the Sanctuary is placed between two Divine Names."

[742] **Menachot 85b**: 'One may not bring a meal offering containing oil from olives taken from a fertilized olive grove, nor from olives taken from an irrigated olive grove, nor from olives taken from an olive grove where grain was sown between the trees. But if one did bring a meal offering containing oil from such groves, it is valid. One may not bring a meal offering containing oil from unripe olives anpiktan, but if one did bring it, it is valid. One may not bring a meal offering containing oil from olives that were soaked in water, nor from pickled olives, nor from boiled olives, and even if one did bring it, it is not valid.'

[743] **Tiferet Yosef, Purim 3**: "This is what Rav Acha bar Yaakov meant by "From here there is a great protest against the Torah": afterward that light was hidden from them, so they could say, "We were compelled." They had not accepted the condition of serving God under concealment, but only with His light explicitly revealed. Rava therefore concludes, "Nevertheless, they accepted it again in the days of Ahasuerus." Then Israel imagined that it had become entirely severed from His will, having bowed to the image. My holy grandfather of blessed memory said that the fact that they had acted only outwardly was illuminated to them afterward; beforehand they themselves imagined they had become severed from God's will. When God opened their eyes and hearts to recognize that they had not been severed and had acted only outwardly, their great love for the miracle led them to accept the Torah a second time with great joy. They saw that Torah belonged to the root of their souls and that they could not, God forbid, act contrary to it. They saw that all the concealments God established were for their good, so that they might have a share in this light. If the light were explicitly revealed as it had been at Sinai, they would have no share or gain in service. Therefore God concealed His great light. Afterward a person recognizes that even during the concealment he was bound to God's light. On this basis they

blessing of Thanksgiving, שֶׁגַּם שָׁם הָיָה נִסִּים וְנִפְלָאוֹת, **— for there too were miracles and wonders;** "נֵס" דְּשָׁם מוֹרֶה עַל אוֹר שֶׁמַּאִיר בַּלֵּב עַל יְדֵי הַנֵּס שֶׁעוֹשֶׂה הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ שֶׁלֹּא כְּהֶרְגֵּל. וְכֵן כְּתִיב: "לַיְּהוּדִים הָיְתָה אוֹרָה", וְנִדְרַשׁ (מְגִלָּה ט״ז עַמּוּד ב׳): "'אוֹרָה' — **for there "miracle" denotes the light radiating in the heart through the supernatural miracle wrought by the Blessed Name. –**[744] זוֹ תּוֹרָה", **— And so it is written: "To the Jews was light", expounded (Megillah 16b): "'Light' — this is Torah",** וְהַיְנוּ תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה, דְּ"תוֹרָה אוֹר", **— meaning the Oral Torah, for "Torah is light",** וְ"אוֹרָה" בְּהֵ"א בְּחִינַת תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה, מַלְכוּת, "פֶּה וְכוּלֵיהּ"; וְ"נִפְלָאוֹת", **— and orah ending with a heh points to the Oral Torah, Malchut, "The mouth, etc.";** – מִפֶּלֶא עֶלְיוֹן, וּכְמוֹ שֶׁנִּדְרַשׁ שָׁם: אִלּוּ תְּפִלִּין שֶׁבָּרֹאשׁ", **— just as expounded there: "'And honor' — these are the tefillin of the head",** שֶׁמּוֹרָה עַל כֶּתֶר עֶלְיוֹן, קֹרַקְפְּתָא דִּתְפִלִּין. **— which signifies Keter Elyon, the supreme crown of the tefillin.** רַק בְּפוּרִים, לְבַד הַנֵּס בְּתוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב (שַׁבָּת פ״ח עַמּוּד א׳):[746] **— Only on Purim, aside from the miracle in the Oral Torah as written (Shabbat 88a):** "הָדַר קִבְּלוּהָ בִּימֵי אֲחַשְׁוֵרוֹשׁ וּבְטִלוּ מִדָּעָה דִּכְפִיַּת הַר כְּגִיגִית", **— "They re-accepted it in the days of Ahasuerus and voided the reservation of the mountain's coercion",** וְזֶה הָיָה עַל תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה, **— and this applied to the Oral Torah,**[747] שֶׁעַל תּוֹרָה שֶׁבִּכְתָב אָמְרוּ כְּבָר "נַעֲשֶׂה וְנִשְׁמָע" כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב (מִדְרַשׁ תַּנְחוּמָא נֹחַ ג׳), **— since over the Written Torah they had already said "we will do and we will hear" (Tanchuma Noach 3);** אָז הָיָה גַּם כֵּן נֵס לְגוּפֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל שֶׁנִּצּוֹלוּ מִמָּוֶת לְחַיִּים, **— then there was also a physical miracle for the bodies of Israel rescued from death to life,** וְעַל כֵּן תִּקְנוּ בּוֹ מִשְׁתֶּה וְשִׂמְחָה; **— and therefore they instituted on it feasting and joy;** מַה שֶּׁאֵין כֵּן בַּחֲנֻכָּה שֶׁהָיָה הַגְּזֵרָה וְהַנֵּס רַק לִנְפָשׁוֹת, **— unlike Chanukah where the decree and the rescue pertained purely to spiritual souls,** וְעַל כֵּן לֹא תִּקְנוּ בּוֹ מִשְׁתֶּה כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמַרְנוּ. **— and therefore they did not institute feasting on it as we stated.** וּמִכָּל מָקוֹם אִיתָא בְּשֻׁלְחָן עָרוּךְ:[748] **— And nevertheless it is written in the Shulchan Aruch (Orach Chayim 670:2):** שֶׁיֵּשׁ קְצָת מִצְוָה בְּרִבּוּי הַסְּעוּדוֹת בַּחֲנֻכָּה, **— that there is somewhat of a mitzvah in augmenting feasts on Chanukah,** דְּבְאוֹתָן הַיָּמִים הָיָה חֲנֻכַּת הַמִּזְבֵּחַ, עַיֵּן שָׁם. **— for during those days occurred the dedication of the Altar, see there.** וְאַף שֶׁחֲנֻכַּת הַמִּשְׁכָּן הָיָה בְּנִיסָן וְשֶׁל בֵּית הַמִּקְדָּשׁ הָיָה בְּתִשְׁרֵי, **— And even though the Tabernacle's dedication was in Nisan and the Temple's was in Tishrei,** רַק הַמִּכְנָן עַל פִּי

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accepted the Torah again."

Tiferet Yosef explains the movement from Sinai's compulsion to Purim's willing acceptance. The miracle discloses a bond that remained during concealment, and the concealment itself makes personal service possible. This gives substance to the renewed acceptance invoked by Rav Tzadok; it is a comparison about the inward light of Torah, not an independent explanation of the different laws of the two festivals' meals.

[744] **Megillah 16b**: "'The Jews had light and gladness and joy and honor.' Rav Yehudah said: 'Light' means Torah, as it says: 'For a commandment is a lamp and Torah is light.' 'Gladness' means a festival, as it says: 'You shall rejoice on your festival.' 'Joy' means circumcision, as it says: 'I rejoice over Your word.' 'And honor'—these are tefillin, as it says: 'All the peoples of the earth will see that the Name of Hashem is called upon you, and they will fear you.' It was taught: Rabbi Eliezer the Great says that this refers to the tefillin worn on the head."

[745] **Megillah 16b:8-9**: "'The Jews had light, joy, gladness, and honor.' Rav Yehudah said: 'Light' means Torah, as it also says, 'For a commandment is a lamp and Torah is light.' 'Joy' means a festival, as it also says, 'You shall rejoice on your festival.' 'Gladness' means circumcision, as it also says, 'I rejoice over Your word.' 'Honor' means tefillin, as it also says, 'All the peoples of the earth shall see that the Lord's name is called upon you, and they shall fear you.' It was taught: Rabbi Eliezer the Great says: These are the tefillin worn on the head."

[746] **Shabbat 88a:5**: "'They stood at the foot of the mountain,' literally beneath it. Rav Avdimi bar Chama bar Chasa said: This teaches that the Holy One, blessed be He, overturned the mountain above them like a vat and told them, 'If you accept the Torah, well and good; if not, there will be your burial place.' Rav Acha bar Yaakov said: From here there is a substantial claim of duress concerning the Torah. Rava said: Nevertheless, they accepted it again in the days of Achashverosh, as it is written, 'The Jews confirmed and accepted'—they confirmed what they had already accepted."

[747] **Midrash Tanchuma, Noach 3:10**: "Therefore the Holy One, blessed be He, established two yeshivot (at Sura and Pumbeditha) for the Israelites where they studied the Torah day and night, and where they assembled from all parts of the world twice each year, in the months of Adar and Elul. They came together to "battle" the problems encountered in the Torah until they had resolved them and reached a definitive decision concerning them. They would adduce arguments from the Torah, the Mishnah, and the Talmud so that the Israelites might not sin against the law, as it is said: Great peace have they that love Thy law; and there is no sinning for them (Ps. 119:165). Scripture informs us: The Lord will give strength unto His people, the Lord will bless His people with peace (Ps. 29:11). Hence, these two yeshivot experienced neither captivity, persecution, nor pillage; and neither Greece nor Rome ever conquered them. The Holy One, blessed be He, led the people out of Jerusalem with their Written and Oral Law twelve years before its destruction, as it is written: And he carried away all Jerusalem, and all the princes and all the mighty men of valor, even ten thousand captives, and all the craftsmen and smiths; none remained save the poorest sort of people of the land (II Kings 24:14). Is there might among men being led into exile? These were the mighty ones in their knowledge of Torah, as is indicated in the verse: In the Book of the Wars of the Lord (Num. 21:14)."

[748] **Shulchan Arukh, Orach Chayim 670:2**: "The additional meals held on these days are optional meals, for they did not establish them for feasting and rejoicing. Gloss: Some say there is a measure of mitzvah in increasing the meals, because the dedication of the altar took place on those days [Rabbi Avraham of Prague]. It is customary to sing songs and praises at these additional meals, and then the meal becomes a mitzvah meal [Minhagim]."

מַה שֶּׁכָּתוּב בַּפְּסִיקְתָּא הַנִּזְכֶּרֶת לְעֵיל שֶׁנִּגְמְרָה מְלֶאכֶת הַמִּשְׁכָּן כ״ה בְּכִסְלֵו, — **the intent aligns with what is written in the aforementioned Pesikta that the Tabernacle's construction was finished on the 25th of Kislev,** וְכֵן כָּתַב אַדְ קָשֶׁה: הָא גַּם בַּחֲנֻכַּת בְּאֵלִיָּה רַבָּה בְּשֵׁם מִדְרָשׁ. — **and so wrote the Eliyah Rabbah in the name of a Midrash.** הַמִּשְׁכָּן בְּנִיסָן לֹא הָיָה בָּהֶם חִיּוּב וְסָעוּדָה, וְלֹא נִזְכַּר שֶׁעָשׂוּ יוֹם טוֹב? — **Yet it is difficult: for in the Tabernacle's dedication in Nisan there was also no obligation of feasting, nor was it recorded that they made a Yom Tov?** אָמְנָם יֵשׁ לוֹמַר, כֵּיוָן שֶׁהָיָה אָז "שְׁלָמִים בָּקָר שְׁנַיִם" וַחֲמִשָּׁה עָשָׂר אֵילִים וּכְבָשִׂים, — **However, one can say that since there were then peace-offerings (shelamim) — two oxen and fifteen rams and lambs,** וּשְׁלָמִים נֶאֱכָלִין לַבְּעָלִים, יֵשׁ בּוֹ רֶמֶז לִסְעוּדָה. — **and peace-offerings are eaten by their owners, there is an allusion in it to a feast.** וְאַף שֶׁמִּסְתָּמָא אָכְלוּ כָּל הַשֵּׁבֶט, וּמַה זֶּה נֶחְשָׁב לַאֲכִילָה לַשֵּׁבֶט? — **And even though ordinarily the entire tribe ate, and what is this quantity considered as eating for a whole tribe?** מִכָּל מָקוֹם לְפִי שֶׁהָיוּ אָז הַכְּבָשִׂים גְּדוֹלִים כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב (בְּרֵאשִׁית רַבָּה פָּרָשָׁה ס״ה וְעֵיֵן מְנָחוֹת פ״ז עַמּוּד א׳),[749, 750] — **Nevertheless, because the sheep were then enormous, as written (Bereishit Rabbah 65 and see Menachot 87a),** יָכוֹל לִהְיוֹת שֶׁהָיָה אֲכִילַת בָּשָׂר בִּכְזַיִת לְכָל אֶחָד מֵהַשֵּׁבֶט; וּמָצִינוּ בְּלֶחֶם הַפָּנִים: "כְּזַיִת — **it is possible that there was meat of an olive's volume (kezayit) for every member of the tribe; –** יֵשׁ אוֹכְלוֹ וְשָׂבֵעַ, יֵשׁ אוֹכְלוֹ וּמוֹתִיר" (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב יוֹמָא ל״ט עַמּוּד א׳);[751] — **and we find regarding the Showbread: "An olive's volume — one eats it and is satisfied, another eats it and leaves over" (Yoma 39a);** וְעַל כָּל פָּנִים הָיָה בּוֹ אֲכִילַת בָּשָׂר. — **and at any rate it involved eating meat.** וּלְזֵכֶר זֶה שֶׁשִּׁלֵּם הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא חֲנֻכַּת הַחַשְׁמוֹנָאִים בְּכִסְלֵו, — **And to commemorate that the Holy One repaid the Hasmonean dedication in Kislev,** יֵשׁ בּוֹ גַּם כֵּן סַעַד לִסְעוּדָה. — **there is likewise support for a festive meal.** וּמִכָּל מָקוֹם אֵין בּוֹ חִיּוּב, שֶׁעִקַּר הַנֵּס הָיָה בְּדִבְרֵי תוֹרָה שֶׁרָצוּ לְהַשְׁכִּיחָם תּוֹרָתָךְ", — **And nevertheless there is no formal obligation, for the core miracle was in Torah matters, countering their plot "to make them forget Your Torah",** וְנַעֲשָׂה נֵס שֶׁעַל יְדֵי זֶה זָכוּ לְרִבּוּי אוֹר תּוֹרָה שֶׁבַּעַל פֶּה כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמַרְנוּ, — **and a miracle was performed through which they merited an outpouring of Oral Torah light as we stated;** וְעַל כֵּן לֹא קָבְעוּ בּוֹ חִיּוּב סְעוּדָה, שֶׁכָּךְ דַּרְכָּהּ שֶׁל תּוֹרָה וְכוּלֵיהּ כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמַרְנוּ; — **and therefore they established on it no mandatory feast, for such is the ascetic way of Torah study as explained;** וּקְבָעוּם וַעֲשָׂאוּם יוֹם טוֹב רַק בְּהַלֵּל וְהוֹדָאָה: "הוֹדוּ לַהשֵׁם כִּי טוֹב" — **and they fixed them and made them festive days purely with Hallel and Thanksgiving: "Give thanks to Hashem for He is good" — for having merited the Primordial Light that is "good".** עַל שֶׁזָּכוּ לָאוֹר "כִּי טוֹב". –

וְחֹדֶשׁ כִּסְלֵו, אִיתָא בְּסֵפֶר יְצִירָה שֶׁנִּבְרָא בְּאוֹת סָמֶ"ךְ; — **And the month of Kislev, it states in Sefer Yetzirah was created through the letter Samech;** וְאִיתָא בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ (חֵלֶק ב׳ קכ״ז סוֹף עַמּוּד א׳):[752] "בְּשַׁעְתָּא דְּסָתִים וְאִתְגְּנִיז בְּגַוֵּיהּ גּוֹ נְהוֹרָא עִלָּאָה — **and it states in the Holy Zohar (Part II, 127a bottom):** לְעֵילָּא, כְּדֵין אִיהִי קַיְימָא בִּדְיוֹקְנָא דְּאוֹת סָמֶ"ךְ וְכוּלֵיהּ", וְהַיְינוּ שֶׁהַמַּקִּיף בֵּינָה, וְהַמֶּקֶף נְהוֹרָא עִלָּאָה, — **"When it is concealed and hidden within, inside the Supernal Light above, then it stands in the form of the letter Samech, etc.", – – meaning that the surrounding perimeter is Binah and the enclosed interior is the Supernal Light,** וְזֶהוּ אוֹר "כִּי טוֹב" (וְנִתְבָּאֵר רֹאשׁ חֹדֶשׁ כִּסְלֵו);[753] — **which is the light that is "good" (and this was explained on Rosh Chodesh Kislev);** וְזֶה קְדֻשַּׁת הַחֹדֶשׁ, — **and this is the unique sanctity of this month,** וּבְסוֹפוֹ זוֹכִין לָאוֹר "כִּי טוֹב", אוֹר יוֹם הָרִאשׁוֹן שֶׁנִּגְנַז לְעַמְלֵי תוֹרָה שֶׁבַּעַל פֶּה — **and at its end we merit the light that is "good", the light of the First Day hidden for toilers in the Oral Torah,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בְּסֵפֶר הַבָּהִיר וּמִדְרַשׁ

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[749] **Bereshit Rabbah 65:17** (excerpt): “Rabbi Huna said in the name of Rabbi Yose: The two daily offerings that Israel sacrificed during the festival were mounted upon two camels, and their legs trailed upon the ground.”

[750] **Menachot 87a**: ‘GEMARA: The Gemara cites a baraita that clarifies Rabbi Meir’s opinion. It is taught in a baraita that Rabbi Meir would say: What is the meaning when the verse states: “A tenth, a tenth, for every lamb” (Numbers 28:29)? The fact the word “tenth” appears twice teaches that there were two measuring vessels that each held a tenth of an ephah in the Temple. One of them held that volume when it was heaped, and the other one was slightly larger and held that same volume when the flour was leveled with the rim.’

[751] **Yoma 39a:17**; **Yoma 39b:1**: “Blessing was bestowed upon the omer, the two loaves, and the showbread. Each kohen received an olive-sized portion; some ate it and were satisfied, and some ate it and left some over. From then onward, a curse was sent upon the omer, the two loaves, and the showbread, and each kohen received only a bean-sized portion. The modest withdrew their hands, while the gluttonous took and ate. Once a man took both his own portion and his colleague’s, and they called him ‘Ben Chamtzan,’ the son of a grasping man, until the day he died.”

[752] **Zohar, Terumah 4:22**: “What is the difference between this and that? When it is closed and concealed within the supernal light above, it assumes the form of the letter samekh: it is enclosed within it and concealed in it, to ascend on high. When it returns and sits, brooding over its children below to nourish them, it assumes the square form of the letter mem, closed toward the world’s four sides.”

[753] **Chagigah 12a**: ‘The Gemara answers: This should be understood in accordance with Rabbi Elazar, as Rabbi Elazar said: The light that the Holy One, Blessed be He, created on the first day was not that of the sun but a different kind of light, through which man could observe from one end of the world to the other. But when the Holy One, Blessed be He, looked upon the generation of the Flood and the generation of the Dispersion and saw that their ways were corrupt and that they might misuse this light for evil, He arose and concealed it from them, as it is stated: “And from the wicked their light is withheld” (Job 38:15).’

וְזֶה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: "וְקָבְעוּם" (נֹחַ ג׳)תַּנְחוּמָא [754, 755] — **as written in Sefer HaBahir and Midrash Tanchuma (Noach 3);** וַעֲשָׂאוּם יָמִים טוֹבִים", שֶׁיּוּפִיעַ וְיַזְרִיחַ בָּהֶם הָאוֹר "כִּי טוֹב", — **and this is: "they established them and made them festive days", so that the light that is "good" shine into them,** וּקְבָעוּם לְדוֹרוֹת בְּהַלֵּל וְהוֹדָאָה. — **and they fixed them for all generations with Hallel and Thanksgiving.**

[754] **Sefer HaBahir 75**: "The students asked, "And why is 'Tzedek, tzedek צדק' (Deuteronomy 16:20) — two times?" Rabbi Rachumai said to them, "As is written, 'From the brilliance before Him' (Psalms 18:13). The first 'tzedek' is actual ממש Tzedek, and She is Shechinah, as is written, 'Righteousness צדק dwells in Her' (Isaiah 1:21)." They asked, "And what is the second 'tzedek'?" He answered, "This is tzedek that frightens the righteous צדיקים." They asked, "And is this Tzedek Tzedakah or not?" He answered, "No." "Why?" "As is written, 'He dons Tzedakah like armor' (Isaiah 59:17) and Tzedek is 'A helm of redemption on His head' (Ibid.). There is no 'His head' other than Truth אמת, as it is said, 'The head of Your words is Truth' (Psalms 119:160), and there is no Truth other than Peace שלום, as is said, 'For He will be Peace and Truth in my days' (Isaiah 39:8). Is it possible for a person to say this? Thus, Hezekiah said that this trait that You gave to David, my father, is a half day, and peace and truth are half days. Therefore, he mentioned 'my days,' and he mentioned 'peace and truth' and 'in my days', as everything is one, as is written, completeness שלום — 'There was evening and there was morning — one day' Genesis 1:5). Just as the day is Peace, so too He seeks peace as is said 'Peace and truth he will be in my days' (Genesis 42:19). With this trait that you gave to David, my father, as is written, 'His throne, as the sun, before him' (Psalms 89:37)."'

[755] **Midrash Tanchuma, Noach 3:12**: "And the mighty of the land He took away (Ezek. 17:13). The mighty here alludes to the nobles of the tribes of Judah and Benjamin, concerning whom it is said: Thus saith the Lord, God of Israel: Like these good figs, so I regard the captives of Judah whom I have sent out of this place into the land of the Chaldeans for good (Jer. 24:5). And elsewhere it is written: And so the Lord hath hastened the evil and brought it upon us; for the Lord our God is righteous in all His works (Dan. 9:14). How can these verses be explained? After all, if the Holy One, blessed be He, is righteous, is it likely that He would hasten the evil and bring it upon us? This verse implies that the Holy One, blessed be He, performed a kindness for Israel by causing the exile of Jehoiachin to precede that of Zedekiah so that the Oral Law might not be forgotten by the Israelites. They resided in Babylon, with their Torah, from that day unto this, and neither Rome nor Greece has ruled them or forced them to convert. What is more, they will not be compelled to experience the trials that will befall mankind preceding the advent of the Messiah, as is said: O Zion, escape, thou that dwellest with the daughter of Babylon (Zech. 2:11). That is, they escaped the decrees imposed by Rome and Greece."

Chanukah Ois 10

The Chanukah Lamp, the Mezuzah, and the Light of Torah

The opening establishes that Chanukah’s lamp carries something of the Temple menorah after the destruction. The ois then explains that continuity through the light of Oral Torah and the return of the Presence within Israel.

The Chanukah Lamp, the Mezuzah, and the Light of Torah

The Temple's illumination continues in the home

בַּגְּמָרָא (שַׁבָּת כ״ב עַמּוּד א׳): "נֵר חֲנֻכָּה מִשְּׂמֹאל, מְזוּזָה מִיָּמִין".[756, 757] — **In the Gemara (Shabbat 22a): "The Chanukah candle is on the left, the mezuzah on the right."** הָעִנְיָן עַל פִּי מַה שֶּׁאָמַרְנוּ בְּשֵׁם הָרַמְבַּ"ן (רֵישׁ פָּרָשַׁת בְּהַעֲלֹתְךָ)[758] — **The matter is according to what we explained in the name of the Ramban (beginning of Parashat Beha'alotecha)** שֶׁפֵּרֵשׁ מַה שֶּׁכָּתוּב בַּמִּדְרָשׁ רַבָּה שָׁם: — **who explained what is written in the Midrash Rabbah there:** שֶׁאָמַר לוֹ לְאַהֲרֹן: "לִגְדוֹלָה מִזּוֹ אַתָּה מְתֻקָּן וְכוּלֵי", — **that He said to Aaron: "For greater than this are you prepared, etc.,** הַקְרָבָנוֹת כָּל זְמַן שֶׁבֵּית הַמִּקְדָּשׁ קַיָּם, אֲבָל הַנֵּרוֹת לְעוֹלָם", — **the sacrifices apply as long as the Temple stands, but the lights are forever",** שֶׁלֹּא רָמְזוּ אֶלָּא לְנֵרוֹת שֶׁל חֲנֻכַּת חַשְׁמוֹנַאי שֶׁנּוֹהֶגֶת אַף לְאַחַר חׇרְבָּן וְכוּלֵי, — **that they alluded only to the lights of the dedication of the Hasmoneans which applies even after the destruction, etc.,** שֶׁנֵּר חֲנֻכָּה מַעְיָן נֵרוֹת שֶׁבַּמִּקְדָּשׁ. — **in that the Chanukah candle is an offshoot and reflection of the lights in the Temple.**

וְנֶאֱמַר: "לֵב חָכָם — **And it is known that the essential light is "Torah is light",** וְיָדוּעַ דְּעִקַּר הָאוֹר "תּוֹרָה אוֹר", לִימִינוֹ וְלֵב כְּסִיל לִשְׂמֹאלוֹ": — **and it is said: "A wise man's heart is at his right, but a fool's heart is at his left":** הַיְנוּ מִבְּחִינַת תּוֹרָה שֶׁבִּכְתָב מוֹפִיעַ הָאָרָתוֹ יִתְבָּרַךְ עַל לֵב חָכָם לִימִינוֹ, — **meaning from the aspect of the Written Torah, His Blessed illumination shines upon the wise heart at his right,** וְזֶהוּ עִנְיַן מְזוּזָה בְּיָמִין, — **and this is the concept of the mezuzah on the right;** הַיְנוּ פָּרָשַׁת שְׁמַע וּפָרָשַׁת וְהָיָה אִם שָׁמֹעַ שֶׁנִּכְתָּב בָּהּ, — **meaning the passage of Shema and the passage of Vehayah Im Shamoa written within it,** וְהֵם קַבָּלַת עֹל מַלְכוּת שָׁמַיִם וְעֹל מִצְוֹות, — **which embody the acceptance of the yoke of the Kingdom of Heaven and the yoke of the commandments,** וּמִזֶּה מוֹפִיעַ הָאָרָה עַל לֵב חָכָם לִימִינוֹ. — **and from this an illumination shines upon the wise heart at his right.**

Human discovery can become a voice of Torah

וְנֵר חֲנֻכָּה שֶׁמְּרַמֵּז עַל הָאָרַת תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה,[759, 760] — **And the Chanukah candle which alludes to the illumination**

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[756] **Shabbat 22a:2**: "Rabbah said: The mitzvah is to place the Chanukah lamp within the handbreadth nearest the entrance. On which side should it be placed? Rav Acha son of Rava said: On the right. Rav Shmuel of Difti said: On the left. The halachah is to place it on the left, so that the Chanukah lamp is on the left and the mezuzah on the right."

[757] **Resisei Layla 57:2**: "From this they understood that Chanukah's days should be established for all generations, with lamps lit outside the Temple as well. After the destruction there is also a lamp for each person, or at least "a lamp for a person and his household," to illuminate all who come into the world. Therefore its principal mitzvah is to be placed outside, to illuminate the world. When Israel became intermingled among the nations, however, this light became hidden, so we light inside as in a time of danger, which is also a time when the nations arise with a decree of forced apostasy resulting from Israel's association with them. Thus now too, because of our many sins, we are continually closely associated with them. The Talmud says that Israel outside the Land serve idolatry "in purity," and permission has even been given concerning the food and drink of their festivals and similar matters. The light is not revealed outside, yet it still shines within. In truth, this light of hod shines in the depths of the heart, and their association is in purity, for Mattathias already repaired this during the first decree of forced apostasy against Israel. It became clear that the depths of Israel's hearts remain bound to God forever, and their association with the nations is, in its deepest truth, to gather holy sparks from them."

Resisei Layla explains how a Temple illumination can persist after destruction: its outward disclosure may be hidden while it continues to work within the heart. The movement from a Temple lamp to the household lamp thus carries an inward continuity. The excerpt retains the author's account of exile and association with the nations; it describes his interpretation of the light's concealment, rather than independently deciding present lighting practice.

[758] **Ramban on Numbers 8:2**: 'Speak unto Aaron, and say unto him: When you light the lamps, the seven lamps shall give light in front of the candlestick' (Numbers 8:2): Ramban quotes the Midrash Rabbah that Hashem comforted Aaron when he saw the dedication offerings of the twelve tribal Princes, promising him: 'By your life, yours is greater than theirs—for the sacrifices operate only while the Temple stands, whereas your lamps (referring to the Hasmonean dedication of the Chanukah lights) will shine forever.'

[759] **Tzidkat HaTzadik 187:1**: "This occurs through recognizing that the new teachings come from God. That is humility and acting for Heaven's sake: the person recognizes that he has nothing of his own. He then succeeds and rises to the stature called "My mother." For after the blessing and the recognition that everything comes from God, God says that everything belongs to him—even the awakening from above belongs to him. This is "Give strength (that is, words of Torah, as stated) to God": it was through his awakening from below that this came into being."

Tzidkat HaTzadik explains how a teaching can be attributed to a human discoverer while remaining God's Torah. The discoverer recognizes the gift, and God in turn attributes the result, including the assistance, to the person's initiating desire and work. That supplies the relation between the two claims in "Come and give Me light."

[760] **Tiferet Yosef, Nitzavim 10**: "For this commandment that I command you today ... is not in Heaven ... nor beyond the sea ... for the matter is very close to you, in your mouth and in your heart, to do it." My grandfather of blessed memory asked: the Zohar repeatedly says how exalted and precious the words of Torah are; this appears to place them in Heaven and beyond the sea! The explanation follows "Everything is in the hands of Heaven except fear of Heaven." How can

of the Oral Torah, דְּזֶהוּ עִנְיַן הַמְּנוֹרָה שֶׁאָמַר בַּמִּדְרָשׁ שֶׁהַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא אָמַר: "בֹּא וְהָאֵר לִי", **— for this is the meaning of the Menorah of which the Midrash says that the Holy One stated: "Come and shine for Me",** וְזֶהוּ דְּהוּא מַה שֶּׁהַחֲכָמִים מְחַדְּשִׁים, וְ"לֹא בַשָּׁמַיִם הִוא", **— and this is the light of the Oral Torah,** הָאוֹר דְּתוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה, **which is that which the Sages innovate, and "it is not in heaven",** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב (בָּבָא מְצִיעָא נ"ט עַמּוּד ב') דְּהַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא אָמַר: "נִצְּחוּנִי בָּנַי",[761] **— and as written (Bava Metzia 59b) that the Holy One said: "My children have triumphed over Me",** וְאִיתָא (חֲגִיגָה ט"ו עַמּוּד ב'):[762] **— and it states (Chagigah 15b):** "דְּקָאָמַר שְׁמַעְתָּא מִפּוּמֵיהּ דְּכוּלְּהוּ רַבָּנָן, וּמִפּוּמֵיהּ דְּרַבִּי מֵאִיר לָא וְכוּ'", **— "That He states teachings from the mouth of all the Rabbis, but from the mouth of Rabbi Meir He does not, etc.;** הַשְׁתָּא קָאָמַר: מֵאִיר בְּנִי אוֹמֵר וְכוּ'". **— now He says: Meir My son says, etc."**

וְזֶה הִתְחִיל מֵאַנְשֵׁי כְּנֶסֶת הַגְּדוֹלָה, **— And this began from the Men of the Great Assembly,** וְאָז הִתְחִיל "זֶה לְעֻמַּת זֶה" חָכְמַת יְוָנִית, **— and then began in parallel opposition the wisdom of Greek philosophy,** וּבָאוּ עַל יִשְׂרָאֵל "לְהַשְׁכִּיחָם תּוֹרָתֶךָ", **— and they came against Israel "to make them forget Your Torah",** כִּי הַחָכְמָה שֶׁלָּהֶם נִקְרָא "חֹשֶׁךְ" וְלֹא אוֹר, וּכְשֶׁאָמְרוּ זִכְרוֹנָם לִבְרָכָה (בְּרֵאשִׁית רַבָּה פָּרָשָׁה ב'): "וְחֹשֶׁךְ'"[763] **— for their intellectual wisdom is called "darkness" and not light, –** זוֹ מַלְכוּת יָוָן וְכוּ'". **— and as our Sages of blessed memory said (Bereishit Rabbah, Parashah 2): "'And darkness' — this is the kingdom of Greece, etc."**

וְעַל זֶה מְרַמֵּז הַנֵּס בְּגֶר חֲנֻכָּה עַל הוֹפָעַת הָאוֹר בְּתוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה, **— And to this alludes the miracle of the Chanukah light, pointing to the emergence of light in the Oral Torah,** וְלָכֵן מִצְוַת נֵר חֲנֻכָּה בִּשְׂמֹאל דַּוְקָא, **— and therefore the mitzvah of the Chanukah candle is specifically on the left,** כְּדֵי לְהוֹפִיעַ גַּם עַל "לֵב כְּסִיל לִשְׂמֹאלוֹ", **— in order to shine also upon "the fool's heart at his left",** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב (נְדָרִים כ"ב עַמּוּד ב') עַל הַפָּסוּק: "כִּי בְּרֹב חָכְמָה רָב כָּעַס":[765] **— and as written (Nedarim 22b) on the verse: "For in much wisdom is much grief":** שֶׁאִלְמָלֵא חָטְאוּ הָיָה דַּי בַּחֲמִשָּׁה חֻמְשֵׁי תוֹרָה וְכוּ'יהּ, **— that had they not sinned, the Five Books of the Torah would have sufficed, etc.,** שֶׁדַּוְקָא עַל "רָב כַּעַס" שֶׁל הַיֵּצֶר הָרָע **— for specifically against the "much grief" of the Evil Inclination** נִצְרָךְ הִתְרַבּוּת שֶׁל רֹב חָכְמַת תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה, מַה שֶּׁאָדָם מֵמְצִיא מִנַּפְשׁוֹ.[766] **— is required the proliferation of abundant wisdom of the Oral Torah, that which a person discovers and generates**

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one say "except," when everything is in God's hands? God established in this world that the vessel belongs to the person, and this is called fear of Heaven. What is the person's vessel? Principally, that he lowers himself so that God's majesty may rest upon him. Thus "The human being became a living soul" is translated "a speaking spirit." The Zohar says that this spirit rises and speaks before the holy King, enters every gate, and none restrains it; therefore it is called a speaking spirit. When a person stands in prayer before God, God bestows words of Torah upon him. The words He bestows are indeed exalted and precious. The vessel the person establishes, however, is in the person's hands. This is "The matter is very close to you, in your mouth and in your heart, to do it": when a person lowers himself for God's majesty to rest upon him, forming his vessel, God bestows upon him the exalted words of Torah."

Tiferet Yosef distinguishes the lofty Torah received from God from the receptive vessel a person forms through humility and prayer. This sharpens the human side of Rav Tzadok's account: the light can genuinely come through a person because the person's work gives it a place in embodied speech and heart. It does not identify the grandeur of a new idea alone as proof that it is Torah.

[761] **Bava Metzia 59b:5**: "Rabbi Yehoshua stood up and declared, 'It is not in heaven!' What does 'It is not in heaven' mean? Rabbi Yirmiyah explained: The Torah was already given at Mount Sinai. We therefore do not decide the law by a heavenly voice, for You already wrote in the Torah at Mount Sinai, 'Incline after the majority.' Rabbi Natan later encountered Eliyahu and asked him, 'What was the Holy One, blessed be He, doing at that moment?' Eliyahu answered, 'He was smiling and saying, "My children have prevailed over Me! My children have prevailed over Me!"'"

[762] **Chagigah 15b:11**: "Rabbah bar Sheila encountered Eliyahu and asked him, 'What is the Holy One, blessed be He, doing?' He replied, 'He is reporting teachings in the names of all the Sages, but He does not report them in Rabbi Meir's name.' He asked, 'Why?' Eliyahu answered, 'Because he learned teachings from Acher.' Rabbah asked, 'Why should that count against him? Rabbi Meir found a pomegranate, ate its interior, and discarded its peel!' Eliyahu told him, 'Now He is saying: "Meir My son says: When a person suffers, what expression does the Shechinah utter? 'My head is heavy; My arm is heavy.' If the Holy One, blessed be He, is so distressed over the blood of the wicked, how much more so over the blood of the righteous that is shed."'"

[763] **Bereshit Rabbah 2:4** (excerpt): "'And darkness'—this is the Greek exile, which darkened Israel's eyes through its decrees, for it said to them: Write upon the horn of an ox that you have no portion in the God of Israel."

[764] **Bereshit Rabbah 2:4** (excerpt): "'And darkness'—this is the Greek exile, which darkened Israel's eyes through its decrees, for it said to them: Write upon the horn of an ox that you have no portion in the God of Israel."

[765] **Nedarim 22b:3**: "Rav Adda son of Rabbi Chanina said: Had Israel not sinned, only the five books of the Torah and the Book of Yehoshua would have been given to them, because the latter describes the arrangement of the Land of Israel. What is the reason for the additional books? 'For with much wisdom comes much anger.'"

[766] **Peri Tzadik, Motzei Yom Kippur 11:1**: "I heard from my master, of blessed memory, that for this reason the Talmud says in many places, "According to the heart of this one": the words of Oral Torah issue from the depths of a person's heart, according to the holy feeling within his heart. As it is written, "With much wisdom comes much vexation": through the great wisdom of Oral Torah, the heart is straightened out from its great vexation, and that great vexation is repaired."

from his own soul. ,(כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב מִדְרָשׁ רַבָּה שָׁם) "מָשָׁל וְכוּלֵיהּ תָּאִירוּ לִי וְכוּלֵיהּ"[767] — **And to this they alluded regarding the Menorah: "A parable, etc., shine for Me, etc." (as written in Midrash Rabbah there),** שֶׁהַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא מִשְׁתּוֹקֵק כִּבְיָכוֹל לְהֶאָרַת הָאָדָם דַּוְקָא, — **that the Holy One yearns, as it were, specifically for the illumination of man,** מַה שֶּׁמַּמְצִיא מִלִּבּוֹ, וְהוּא הַתּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה; — **that which he discovers from his own heart, which is the Oral Torah;** וְהַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא אוֹמֵר הֲלָכָה בְּשֵׁם אוֹמְרָהּ: "אֶלִיעֶזֶר בְּנִי אוֹמֵר וְכוּלֵיהּ"[768] — **and the Holy One recites the Halachah in the name of its author: "Eliezer My son says, etc." (as written in Midrash Rabbah, Parashat Chukat).**

Jacob's own attainment did not complete every later soul

וְהִנֵּה אָמְרוּ (בְּבְרֵאשִׁית רַבָּה פָּרָשָׁה פ"ד) עַל הַפָּסוּק "וַיֵּשֶׁב יַעֲקֹב":[769, 770, 771] — **And behold they said (in Bereishit Rabbah, Parashah 84) on the verse "And Jacob dwelt":** שָׁבַקֵּשׁ לֵישֵׁב בְּשַׁלְוָה בָּעוֹלָם הַזֶּה, נִזְדַּוֵּג לוֹ שִׂטְנוֹ שֶׁל יוֹסֵף; — **he sought to dwell in tranquility in this world, and the turmoil of Joseph leaped upon him;** וְהַיְנוּ שֶׁבִּקֵּשׁ לִהְיוֹת בָּטוּחַ לְדוֹרֵי דּוֹרוֹת שֶׁיִּזְכּוּ לִבְחִינַת חַיֵּי עוֹלָם בָּעוֹלָם הַזֶּה, — **meaning that he sought to be guaranteed for all generations that they merit the state of eternal life in this world,** וְעַל זֶה קָפַץ עָלָיו רָגְזוֹ שֶׁל יוֹסֵף, — **and regarding this the agitation of Joseph bounded upon him,** הַיְנוּ מִפְּנֵי שֶׁבָּעְנְיָן הַזֶּה בִּבְחִינַת קְדֻשַּׁת הַבְּרִית — **meaning because in this matter of the sanctity of the Covenant (kedushat habrit)** נִצְרָךְ עוֹד בֵּרוּרִים רַבִּים בְּנַפְשׁוֹת יִשְׂרָאֵל, שֶׁלֹּא — **many further spiritual rectifications and siftings are required in Jewish souls,** יִתְבָּרֵר בֵּרוּר גָּמוּר לְכָל נַפְשׁוֹת יִשְׂרָאֵל כֻּלָּם עַד עֵת קֵץ; — **which will not be fully clarified for all souls of Israel together until the End of Days;** וְזֶהוּ עִנְיַן הַפַּחַד שֶׁנִּזְכָּר עַל זֶה בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ (חֵלֶק א׳ ר״ט עַמּוּד ב׳) שֶׁאֵין לוֹ תִּקּוּן חַס וְשָׁלוֹם,[772] — **and this is the dread mentioned in the Holy Zohar (Part I, 219b) that it has no rectification, Heaven forbid,** וְהַיְנוּ שֶׁבָּעוֹלָם הַזֶּה אֵין לוֹ עוֹד בֵּרוּר בָּזֶה שֶׁיִּהְיוּ זְדוֹנוֹת נַעֲשִׂים לוֹ כִּזְכֻיּוֹת וְכַשֶּׁלֶג יַלְבִּינוּ, — **meaning that in this world it does not yet have full realization wherein deliberate sins turn into merits and whiten like**

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[767] **Shemot Rabbah 36:2** (excerpt): "It is not because I need them, but that you should shine for Me as I shone for you. Why? To elevate you before all the nations, so they will say: Israel provides light for the One who provides light for all. This is compared to a sighted man and a blind man walking together. The sighted man said to the blind man: Come, and I will support you. The blind man walked along. When they entered the house, the sighted man said: Go and light a lamp for me, and illuminate my way, so that you will not remain indebted to me for accompanying you. That is why I asked you to provide light."

[768] **Bamidbar Rabbah 19:7** (excerpt): "Rabbi Acha said in the name of Rabbi Chanina: When Moshe ascended on high, he heard the Holy One, blessed be He, sitting and studying the passage of the red heifer and stating a law in the name of the one who taught it: 'Rabbi Eliezer says: A calf is in its first year, and a cow is in its second year.' Moshe said before Him: Master of the worlds, may it be Your will that he descend from me. He replied: By your life, he will descend from you. Thus it is written, 'The name of the one was Eliezer' (Exodus 18:4)—the name of that distinguished one."

[769] **Bereshit Rabbah 84:3** (excerpt): "'He mocks the trial of the innocent' (Job 9:23). Rav Acha said: When the righteous are at ease and seek to live at ease in this world, Satan comes and accuses: Is it not enough that their reward is prepared for them in the World to Come, that they also seek tranquility in this world? Know that this is so: Because our father Jacob sought to live at ease in this world, the adversarial ordeal of Joseph confronted him."

[770] **Machshavot Charutz 19:5**: "In this world joy is not yet complete. Although Jacob had reached the completion of repair from his own side, nevertheless, when he sought tranquillity and complete joy, thinking that the final time had arrived, "the trouble of Joseph sprang upon him." This was the division of hearts among his sons. Through it he came to think that Joseph's degree, the foundation of the holy covenant, had become absorbed among the nations, God forbid, that the separating boundary had been removed, and that his own degree of wholeness, drawn through the holiness of the covenant, had been damaged."

Machshavot Charutz identifies the concrete sign of incompletion: the brothers' divided hearts and Jacob's fear for Joseph's covenantal place. This explains why the Chanukah paragraph moves from Jacob's personal tranquillity to the condition of all later souls. The possibility of personal attainment remains; the uncompleted relation among the descendants prevents its being equated with the final repair.

[771] **Mei HaShiloach, Volume I, Genesis, Vayigash 1**: "A righteous person rules over humanity": if the sin concerned a decree of the sages, the penitent rules over them, for nothing stands in the way of repentance. "Rules in fear of God": if the sin was against Written Torah, he can prevail over this too. Of all this it is said, "The man raised on high"—who established the yoke of repentance. Although Torah was given with extraordinary awe, and the Sages issued fearful warnings concerning many matters, as is known, that was said before the sin. Nothing, however, stands against repentance. After a person encounters a stumbling, he must not despair, for in the future no sin will remain upon an Israelite soul."

Mei HaShiloach distinguishes the warning that guards a person before failure from the strength required to return afterward. This illuminates Rav Tzadok's qualification of the Zohar's frightening wording: the final, universal clarification is still awaited, but the present response is repentance, whose practical path the following paragraph locates in Torah. The distinction preserves the force of the prior warning.

[772] **Zohar, Vayechi 23:182-26:195**: 'R. Hiya said: 'What is the meaning of the verse: "He hath swallowed up death for ever" (Is. 25, 8)?' He said: 'When God shall arouse His right hand, then death shall be banished from the world. But He will not arouse His right hand till Israel give the impetus, to wit, by the Torah. At that time "the right hand of the Lord doeth valiantly" (Ps. 118, 16), and "I shall not die but live" (Ibid. 17).'

snow, שֶׁזֶּהוּ כְּשֶׁיִּתְבַּטֵּל זוּהֲמַת הַנָּחָשׁ לְגַמְרֵי שֶׁמִּמֶּנּוּ הִתְחִיל זֶה, **— which will occur only when the contamination of the serpent from which this began is eradicated entirely,** "עַמֵּךְ כֻּלָּם צַדִּיקִים", שֶׁתִּקּוּנוֹ לְגַמְרֵי לִהְיוֹת **— whose absolute repair is that "your people are all righteous",** וְזֶהוּ כְּשֶׁיְּבֻלַּע הַמָּוֶת לָנֶצַח שֶׁיִּתְבַּטֵּל הַפְּגָם בְּעֵת קֵץ. **— and this is when death will be swallowed up forever, when the blemish is healed at the End.**

Torah's life continues through the apparent interruption of death

וְעִקַּר הַתִּקּוּן לָזֶה עַל יְדֵי הָעֵסֶק בְּתוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה,[773, 774] **— And the primary rectification for this is through engagement in the Oral Torah,** הַיְנוּ שֶׁיִּהְיֶה הַלֵּב תָּמִיד מָלֵא מִדִּבְרֵי תוֹרָה, **— meaning that the heart be constantly filled with words of Torah,** וְעַל זֶה נֶאֱמַר: "עֵץ חַיִּים הִיא לַמַּחֲזִיקִים בָּהּ", **— and on this it is stated: "It is a tree of life to those who grasp it",** כִּי עַל יְדֵי הַדִּבְרֵי תוֹרָה יוּכַל לְהַגִּיעַ לְחַיֵּי עוֹלָם. **— for through words of Torah one can reach eternal life.** כִּי עִנְיַן הַמִּיתָה נִצְמַח מֵרֹאשִׁית הַקִּלְקוּל שֶׁל אָדָם הָרִאשׁוֹן, **— For the phenomenon of death sprouted from the initial sin of Adam the First Man,** וּכְתִיב: "פֶּן יִשְׁלַח יָדוֹ וְלָקַח גַּם מֵעֵץ הַחַיִּים וְאָכַל וָחַי לְעֹלָם". **— and it is written: "Lest he put forth his hand and take also from the Tree of Life and eat and live forever".** וְעַל יְדֵי הָעֵסֶק בְּדִבְרֵי תוֹרָה נֶאֱמַר: "בְּהִתְהַלֶּכְךָ תַּנְחֶה אֹתָךְ **— And through engagement in words of Torah it is stated: –** זֶה הָעוֹלָם הַזֶּה, **— "When you walk it shall lead you — this is this world; –** בְּשָׁכְבְּךָ תִּשְׁמֹר עָלֶיךָ **— when you lie down it shall watch over you — this is death; –** זוֹ מִיתָה, וַהֲקִיצוֹתָ הִיא תְשִׂיחֶךָ **— and when you awake it shall talk with you — in the Future to Come" (Sotah 21a);** לָעָתִיד לָבֹא" (כְּמוֹ שֶׁפָּתוּב סוֹטָה כ"א עַמּוּד א'),[775] כִּי אָז לִתְחִיַּת הַמֵּתִים יִהְיֶה תַּכְלִית הַבֵּרוּר בָּזֶה, **— for then, at the Resurrection of the Dead, the ultimate clarification in this will emerge,** שֶׁהַמִּיתָה הָיְתָה רַק כְּשֵׁינָה בָּעוֹלָם הַזֶּה, **— showing that death was merely like a sleep in this world,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁקָּרְאוּ חֲכָמֵינוּ זִכְרוֹנָם לִבְרָכָה הַמִּיתָה: "כַּד דְּמַךְ", **— as our Sages of blessed memory termed death: "when he slept",** וְטַל תּוֹרָה מְחַיֵּיהוּ. **— and the dew of Torah revives him.**

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[773] **Yisrael Kedoshim 7:16**: "The strength of Isaac our father is the reverse: his strength is in Torah. "The older Torah scholars grow, the more settled their understanding becomes." In death, when flesh-and-blood strength entirely ceases, Torah's strength grows still greater, entering the heavenly academy. "When you lie down, it will guard you"—in the grave. From it comes the dew of revival, to rise at the resurrection, when it will become clear that death was only like sleep. Thus the Sages speak of the righteous person's death as "when he slept," and the patriarchs are called "the sleepers of Hebron." God shows the righteous their reward before death, and they sleep; yet "the rich person's satiety does not let him sleep," for he is taken to academies of Torah. Therefore the blessing of powers was established with "Who revives the dead": the height of strength is to have no cessation or lowering. Death is an expression of lowering, as Tanchuma says; therefore a poor person, a blind person, and others are called dead, being brought very low in this world and distanced from good. Resurrection clarifies that death is "very good," like sleep: upon rising, one becomes a new creature, renewing strength and power. This is the completion of true strength, enduring forever, with no weakness to interrupt or abolish it. Esau's strength is the reverse: it appears supremely forceful in this world, but ends in destruction. It is not true strength, only the appearance of this world."

Yisrael Kedoshim explains why Torah can be called a power of revival: its strength is measured by continuity and renewed life, rather than by the force visible in the body. The sleep analogy therefore includes renewal upon awakening. This develops the same verse and dew of Torah in Chanukah, preserving its placement of the complete clarification in resurrection.

[774] **Tiferet Yosef, Talmud Anthology, Taanit 2**: "The Zohar explains that resurrection will arise from the "breath of the bones" (havlei de-garmei) remaining with a person in the grave. This is "the person's good will that is not lost": the desire he had during his earthly life to be drawn after God's will. That desire remains with him continually in the grave, and from it he will awaken in resurrection. The Midrash says: "'I have wounded, and I shall heal'—it does not say hiketi, 'I struck,' but machatzti: the partition I made between those above and those below, for the upper ones endure while the lower ones die in this world. In the future there will be no death at all, as it is said, 'He will swallow death forever.' Rabbi Abba said: even that partition itself I shall return and heal." The first teacher says the partition will be healed through there being no death; Rabbi Abba adds that the partition itself will also be healed. In the future it will be revealed that even now there had been no partition."

Tiferet Yosef identifies what persists through the seeming interruption: the person's good desire to follow God. It explains the future disclosure as recognition of a connection that had not actually ceased. This gives inward content to Rav Tzadok's image of Torah guarding during sleep; both place the complete disclosure in the future, rather than assuming it is already visible.

[775] **Sotah 21a:5-6**: "Does the merit of a mitzvah protect so greatly? Was it not taught: Rabbi Menachem bar Yosei expounded this verse, 'For a commandment is a lamp and Torah is light.' Scripture compares a mitzvah to a lamp and Torah to light. It compares a mitzvah to a lamp to tell you: Just as a lamp protects only for a time, so a mitzvah protects only for a time. It compares Torah to light to tell you: Just as light protects continually, so Torah protects continually. It also says, 'When you walk, it will guide you,' and so forth. 'When you walk, it will guide you' refers to this world. 'When you lie down, it will guard you' refers to death. 'When you awake, it will speak with you' refers to the future to come."

The lamp testifies to a restored presence

וּבָזֶה הַכֹּחַ דַּוְקָא הִכְנִיעוּ הַיְוָנִים[776, 777] — **And with this very power they vanquished the Greeks,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב: "וְזֵדִים בְּיַד עוֹסְקֵי תוֹרָתֶךָ" דַּוְקָא, — **as written: "and willful transgressors into the hand of those who toil in Your Torah" specifically,** וּבְכָל יְמֵי הַחֲנֻכָּה מִתְנוֹצֵץ הַתִּקּוּן עַל פְּגָם הַזֶּה. — **and throughout all the days of Chanukah sparkles the rectification for this blemish.** כִּי עַל פְּגָם זֶה נֶאֱמַר: "רַע בְּעֵינֵי הַשֵּׁם", — **For regarding this blemish it is stated: "Evil in the eyes of Hashem",** שֶׁכְּבָיכוֹל הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ אֵינוֹ מַשְׁגִּיחַ עָלָיו, — **meaning that as it were, the Blessed Name does not look favorably upon him,** וּכְמַה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: "לֹא יְגָרְךָ רָע", — **and as stated: "Evil shall not dwell with You",** וְאָמְרוּ (שַׁבָּת קמ״ט עַמּוּד ב׳): "צַדִּיק אַתָּה הַשֵּׁם וְלֹא יָגוּר בְּמְגוּרְךָ רָע",[778] — **and they said (Shabbat 149b): "You are righteous, Hashem, and evil does not reside in Your dwelling",** שֶׁמּוֹנֵעַ הַשְׁרָאַת הַשְּׁכִינָה כְּבְיָכוֹל, — **which withholds the resting of the Shechinah as it were,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ (שָׁם)[779] דְּלָא חָמֵי אַפֵּי שְׁכִינְתָּא. — **and as written in the Zohar (ibid.) that he does not gaze upon the Face of the Shechinah.** אֲמְנָם עַל יְדֵי הַתִּקּוּן נֶאֱמַר: "עֵינֵי הַשֵּׁם אֶל צַדִּיקִים וְגוֹמֵר", — **However, through the rectification it is stated: "The eyes of Hashem are toward the righteous, etc.",** וְאָמְרוּ (שַׁבָּת כ״ב עַמּוּד ב׳) עַל הַמְּנוֹרָה:[780] "עֵדוּת הִיא לְכָאֵי עוֹלָם שֶׁהַשְּׁכִינָה שׁוֹרָה בְּיִשְׂרָאֵל". — **and they stated (Shabbat 22b) regarding the Menorah: "It is testimony to all inhabitants of the world that the Shechinah rests in Israel."** וְעַל פִּי דְּבָרֵינוּ הַנִּזְכָּרִים לְעֵיל שֶׁנִּגַּר חֲנֻכָּה מֵעֵין נֵרוֹת הַמְּנוֹרָה, — **And according to our words mentioned above that the Chanukah light reflects the Menorah's lights,** יֻצְדַּק הָרֶמֶז הַנִּזְכָּר בַּמְּנוֹרָה עַל תִּקּוּן הַפְּגָם הַזֶּה, — **the aforementioned allusion in the Menorah is justified regarding the repair of this blemish,** שֶׁהוּא עֵדוּת שֶׁיַּחֲזִיר הַשְׁרַאת הַשְּׁכִינָה בְּיִשְׂרָאֵל, — **testifying that He will restore the resting of the Shechinah in Israel,** שֶׁיָּגוּר בְּמִגּוֹרֵינוּ לְעוֹלָם. — **dwelling in our midst forever.**

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[776] **Takanat HaShavin 15:11**: “Earlier there they explain its punishment as “not seeing the face of the Divine Presence”; similarly, “not entering and not seeing the face of the Ancient of Days,” and “not entering the palace and not seeing the face of the Presence.” Likewise in the passage in Emor. With all the intense impurity of this sin, they did not assign it punishments of Gehinnom more severe than those of other sins. Its particular severity concerns the absence of the attainment of seeing the Presence and being prevented from entering higher degrees. “This does not ascend” likewise means that it does not rise to a higher degree, as the passage concludes, “We have no sinners who do not see the face of the Presence except this one.” In Vayakhel it says, “No sin is so hard before the Holy One, blessed be He, as this ... of this sin it is written, ‘It was evil in the eyes of the Lord.’” Here it explains that this sin’s particular difficulty is precisely “before God,” citing “in the eyes of the Lord,” an expression not found of another sin. Er too is called “evil in the eyes of the Lord,” and all those Zohar passages cite this verse. Precisely in relation to God’s eyes, this sin is called more severe and evil than all.”

Takanat HaShavin reads the same Zohar language carefully: the special severity concerns obstructed access to the Presence and higher attainment. That specifies what must be restored when the Chanukah paragraph moves from “evil in His eyes” to the lamp’s testimony. It does not remove the possibility of repentance or turn the passage into a comparison of every punishment.

[777] **Tiferet Yosef, Beha'alotcha 1**: “This is the conclusion of the verse: “Toward the face of the menorah the seven lamps shall shine.” It indicates the central point within a person, the point whose light continually reaches him: he should recognize that all the power of his service comes from this point that God established within him, from which he has the strength to illuminate himself. As the Talmud says, “Does He need its light? ... It is testimony to all who come into the world that the Divine Presence rests among Israel.” This indicates the central point within every Israelite heart, whose light continually reaches and rests among Israel. All human service is to bring illumination to the place where the light reaches and does not reach. After all his work, he should recognize that its power too comes from that point whose light continually reaches, the point that comes from God. This is “Toward the face of the menorah the seven lamps shall shine.”

Tiferet Yosef interprets the same testimony through a distinction within the heart: a constant divine point gives the power to illuminate places where reception is intermittent. This explains how the lamp can testify to God’s presence while real work of repair is still required. The recognition at the end of the work returns its power to its divine source.

[778] **Shabbat 149b**: ‘Rather, the basis for this idea is from here: “Punishment is also not good for the righteous” (Proverbs 17:26), meaning that it is not good for a righteous person to issue punishment. There is no meaning of not good other than evil. And it says: “For You are not a God that desires wickedness, evil will not dwell with You” (Psalms 5:5), meaning that You, God, are righteous and evil shall not dwell with You in Your place of dwelling. Even a righteous person who punishes someone and is called evil and cannot dwell within God’s partition.’

[779] **Zohar, Vayechi 23:182-26:195**: ‘R. Judah said: ‘Every sin admits of repentance barring this, and every sinner may hope to see the face of the Shekinah barring this one.’ R. Isaac said: ‘Happy are the righteous in this world and in the world to come; of them it is written: “And thy people are all righteous, they shall for ever inherit the land (Is. 60, 21). on Leviticus, 104b, to which they properly belong.’

[780] **Shabbat 22b:2-3**: “Rav Sheshet objected: ‘Outside the curtain of the testimony he shall arrange it.’ Does God need its light? Throughout the forty years that the children of Israel traveled in the wilderness, did they not travel by His light? Rather, it is testimony to all who come into the world that the Shechinah rests among Israel. What is this testimony? Rav said: It is the western lamp. The same measure of oil was placed in it as in the other lamps; from it he would kindle the others, and with it he would finish. Here, since the lamps are fixed in place, he must take a flame from one to kindle another. This challenges both the view that lighting one mitzvah lamp from another is forbidden because it degrades the mitzvah and the view that it diminishes the mitzvah! Rav Pappa explained that this could be done with long wicks. Nevertheless, the view that the prohibition is due to diminishing the mitzvah remains difficult! The difficulty remains.”

Chanukah Ois 11

Right and Left: The Chanukah Lamp and Inner Sanctification

The ois interprets the lamp, mezuzah, and tzitzit through the three patriarchs. The third strand is a means of joining different kinds of holiness so that remembrance can become enduring.

Right and Left: The Chanukah Lamp and Inner Sanctification

"נֵר חֲנֻכָּה מִשְּׂמֹאל, מְזוּזָה מִיָּמִין": — **"The Chanukah candle is on the left, the mezuzah on the right":**

וּבְשֶׁאִילְתּוֹת דְּרַב אַחַאי גָּאוֹן הַגְּרְסָא: "וּבַעַל הַבַּיִת בְּטַלִּית מְצֻיֶּצֶת בָּאֶמְצַע"; — **and in the She'iltot of Rav Achai Gaon the textual reading is: "and the homeowner in a tzitzit-fringed tallit stands in the center";**

וּבְתְשׁוּבַת מַהֲרִי"ל (סוֹף סִימָן מ׳) אִיתָא דְּסִיֵּם:[781] — **and in the Responsa of the Maharil (end of Section 40) it states that he concluded:**

"לְקַיֵּם מַה שֶּׁנֶּאֱמַר: 'וְהַחוּט הַמְשֻׁלָּשׁ לֹא בִמְהֵרָה יִנָּתֵק'", — **"To fulfill that which is stated: 'And a three-ply cord is not quickly severed'",**

וְהוּא סִיֵּם עַל זֶה פָּרוּשׁ: "חוּט שֶׁל צִיצִית". — **and he concluded on this with the interpretation: "the cord of tzitzit".**

וְהִנֵּה בַּגְּמָרָא (מְנָחוֹת מ״ג עַמּוּד ב׳) אִיתָא:[782] — **And behold in the Gemara (Menachot 43b) it states:**

"כָּל מִי שֶׁיֵּשׁ לוֹ תְּפִלִּין בְּרֹאשׁוֹ וּתְפִלִּין בִּזְרוֹעוֹ וְצִיצִית בְּבִגְדּוֹ וּמְזוּזָה בְּפִתְחוֹ, — **"Whoever has tefillin on his head, tefillin on his arm, tzitzit on his garment, and a mezuzah on his doorway,**

'וְהַחוּט הַמְשֻׁלָּשׁ וְגוֹמֵר'", שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: הַכֹּל בְּחִזּוּק שֶׁלֹּא יֶחֱטָא, — **all is in reinforcement that he will not sin, as it is said: 'And a three-ply cord, etc.'",**

וְשָׁם הַכַּוָּנָה עַל כָּל שְׁלֹשֶׁת הַמִּצְווֹת שֶׁהֵם כְּמוֹ חוּט הַמְשֻׁלָּשׁ שֶׁהוּא חָזָק בְּיוֹתֵר, — **and there the intent refers to all three mitzvot acting like a three-ply cord which is exceptionally strong,**

אֲבָל שָׁם כָּל אוֹתָן שָׁלֹשׁ מִצְווֹת וְלֹא עַל חוּט הַצִּיצִית דַּוְקָא. — **and not upon the thread of tzitzit specifically.**

אֲבָל שָׁם עַצְמָן הֵם עַל הָאָדָם כָּל הַיּוֹם, — **However there, all those three mitzvot themselves rest upon a person the entire day,**

דִּתְפִלִּין בִּזְרוֹעַ וּבְרֹאשׁ הֲיוּ הוֹלְכִים כָּל הַיּוֹם, — **for with tefillin on the arm and head they used to walk all day,**

וְגַם צִיצִית בְּבִגְדּוֹ וּמְזוּזָה בְּפִתְחוֹ הֲמָה תְּמִידִיּוֹת; — **and likewise tzitzit on his garment and a mezuzah on his doorpost are continuous;**

מַה שֶּׁאֵין כֵּן מִצְוַת נֵר חֲנֻכָּה שֶׁמְּצָוָתָהּ רַק בַּלַּיְלָה, — **unlike the mitzvah of the Chanukah light which applies only at night,**

וְאָז אֵין הַזְּמַן לַחֲטֹא, כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב (שַׁבָּת פ״ט עַמּוּד ב׳): "דַּל עָשְׂרִים וְחָמֵשׁ דְּלֵילְיָתָא",[783] — **and then is not the typical time to sin, as written (Shabbat 89b): "Subtract twenty-five years of nights",**

וְלֹא שַׁיָּךְ שֶׁיִּהְיֶה מְצָוָה זוֹ לְהַצִּיל מֵהַחֵטְא, — **so that it does not fit that this mitzvah would protect from sin,**

וּמַה גַּם שֶׁהוּא לְשָׁעָה קַלָּה זְמַן הַהַדְלָקָה. — **especially since it lasts for a brief duration at the time of lighting.**

The third strand joins distinct powers into one bond

וְעַל כֵּן פֵּרֵשׁ מַהֲרִי"ל שֶׁהַמְּכַוָּן מֵהַחוּט שֶׁל צִיצִית בָּאֶמְצַע,[784] — **And therefore the Maharil explained that the focus is on the thread of tzitzit in the center,**

דְּחוּט דְּצִיצִית הוּא לְזָכֹר עַל יְדֵי זֶה כָּל הַמִּצְווֹת, — **for the cord of tzitzit is intended to recall through it all commandments,**

וְצֵרוּף שְׁתֵּי הַמִּצְווֹת דַּחֲנֻכָּה וּמְזוּזָה מוֹעִיל לְאוֹתוֹ חוּט לְהִתְחַזֵּק — **and the pairing of the two mitzvot of Chanukah and mezuzah helps that cord to be reinforced**

וְלִהְיוֹת שֶׁנַּעֲשָׂה בָּזֶה בְּחִינַת "יַעֲקֹב חֶבֶל נַחֲלָתוֹ", כִּבְחִינַת הַחוּט הַמְשֻׁלָּשׁ, — **and become like the aspect of a three-ply cord, "**

הַמְשֻׁלָּשׁ מִקְּדֻשַּׁת כָּל שְׁלֹשֶׁת הָאָבוֹת, — **whereby is forged the dimension of "Jacob the cord of His inheritance" woven threefold from the holiness of all three Patriarchs,**

כְּמוֹ כַּחֶבֶל הַזֶּה שֶׁאֵין מַפְקִיעִין אוֹתוֹ בְּפָחוֹת מִשְּׁלֹשָׁה (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בְּרֵאשִׁית רַבָּה פָּרָשָׁה ס״ח);[785] — **like this rope which is not severed with fewer than three strands**

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[781] **Ecclesiastes 4:12**: ‘Also, if someone attacks, two can withstand it. A threefold cord is not readily broken!’

[782] **Menachot 43b**: “Rabbi Eliezer ben Yaakov says: Anyone who has tefillin on his head, tefillin on his arm, tzitzit on his garment, and a mezuzah at his doorway is firmly protected against sin, as it says: ‘A threefold cord is not quickly broken,’ and: ‘The angel of Hashem camps around those who fear Him and rescues them.’”

[783] **Shabbat 89b:5**: “Yitzchak further argues: How much have they sinned? How many years does a person live? Seventy. Deduct twenty, for which You do not punish them; fifty remain. Deduct twenty-five for the nights; twenty-five remain. Deduct twelve and a half for praying, eating, and attending to bodily needs; twelve and a half remain. If You bear all of them, well and good; if not, half shall be upon me and half upon You. If You say that all shall be upon me, I have already offered myself before You. Israel begin and say to Yitzchak, ‘For you are our father.’ Yitzchak tells them, ‘Instead of praising me, praise the Holy One, blessed be He,’ and points them toward the Holy One, blessed be He. Immediately they raise their eyes toward Heaven and say, ‘You, Lord, are our Father; our Redeemer from of old is Your name.’”

[784] **Tzidkat HaTzadik 186:1**: “Three signifies the joining of two ends and a middle that connects them. Thus Berakhot says, “There are opinions”: the essential matter is three distinct opinions becoming connected through eating together, as stated in Chullin 4b, that there is no enticement without eating. Likewise, the prohibition of their bread and wine is because of their daughters, for eating and drinking principally bring people together. This explains zimmun: the blessing before eating, when one is hungry, resembles Shavuot and Pesach in the spring, while Grace after Meals, blessed when one is satisfied, resembles Sukkot, the festival of ingathering and the season of our joy—there is no joy without eating. From there holy inspiration is drawn, as stated in the Jerusalem Talmud, for daat means holy inspiration, according to Rashi on Ki Tissa. It follows wisdom and understanding, since daat connects them; Sukkot is likewise the third pilgrimage festival. Therefore three require zimmun, which the Talmud explicitly relates to “Magnify the Lord with me, and let us exalt His name together.” This requires preparation and invitation, so that the souls may be included together.” Tzidkat HaTzadik explains the structure of three as two distinct ends joined by a middle. Its account of zimmun shows that mere proximity is insufficient: the distinct participants must be prepared for inclusion together. This illuminates the threefold cord in Chanukah as a union of qualities, beyond the simple addition of a third protective act.

[785] **Bereshit Rabbah 68:12** (excerpt): “This follows Rabbi Yehoshua of Sikhnin’s teaching in the name of Rabbi Levi: ‘For Hashem’s portion is His people; Jacob is the cord of His inheritance’ (Deuteronomy 32:9). Just as a cord is not

(Bereishit Rabbah 68); וְהַכֹּחַ הַזֶּה נִקְבָּע וְנִשְׁלָם עַל יְדֵי הַנֵּר חֲנֻכָּה בְּכָלַל נַפְשׁוֹת יִשְׂרָאֵל. — **and this spiritual power is established and completed through the Chanukah lights across all souls of Israel.** דְּיָדוּעַ דִּבְחִינַת אַבְרָהָם אָבִינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם — **For it is known that the role of Abraham our Father, peace be upon him,** הָיָה לְהַכְנִיס כָּל בָּאֵי הָעוֹלָם תַּחַת כַּנְפֵי הַשְׁכִינָה בְּקַבָּלַת עֹל מַלְכוּת שָׁמַיִם, — **was to bring all inhabitants of the world under the wings of the Shechinah through accepting the yoke of Heaven,** שֶׁיִּהְיֶה נִקְרָא "אֱלֹהֵי הָאָרֶץ" בְּפִי כָּל הַבְּרִיּוֹת, — **so that He be called "the God of the earth" in the mouths of all creations,** וְגַם לְהַכְנִיסָם בְּעֹל תּוֹרָה וּמִצְווֹת, — **and also to bring them into the yoke of Torah and mitzvot,** דְּשְׁנֵי אֲלָפִים תּוֹרָה הִתְחִיל מִימֵי אַבְרָהָם; — **for the two thousand years of Torah began from Abraham's days;** וְזֶהוּ עִנְיַן מְזוּזָה בְּפִתְחוֹ שֶׁנִּכְתַּב בָּהּ שְׁתֵּי פָּרָשִׁיּוֹת — **and this is the concept of a mezuzah on his doorway containing two passages** שֶׁהֵם קַבָּלַת עֹל מַלְכוּת שָׁמַיִם וְהַכֹּל עַל יְדֵי בְּחִינַת — **which are the acceptance of the yoke of Heaven and Torah and mitzvot,** וְתוֹרָה וּמִצְווֹת, אַבְרָהָם אָבִינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם, דִּכְתִיב: "וְאָהַבְתָּ אֵת הַשֵּׁם וְגוֹמֵר", — **and all through the aspect of Abraham, as written: "And you shall love Hashem, etc.",** וְכֵן בְּפָרָשָׁה שְׁנִיָּה מַתְחִיל: "לְאַהֲבָה אֶת הַשֵּׁם אֱלֹהֵיכֶם וְגוֹמֵר"; — **and likewise the second passage begins: "to love Hashem your God, etc.";** וְזֶהוּ מִדַּת אַבְרָהָם אָבִינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם שֶׁהָיָה בּוֹ אַהֲבַת הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ עַד מִצּוּי הַנֶּפֶשׁ, — **and this is Abraham's attribute, possessing love of the Blessed Name to the exhaustion of his soul,** שֶׁהִשְׁלִיךְ עַצְמוֹ לְכִבְשַׁן הָאֵשׁ עַל קִדּוּשׁ שְׁמוֹ יִתְבָּרַךְ; — **throwing himself into the fiery furnace for the Sanctification of His Name;** וּמְצִינוּ (סוֹטָה כ״ז עַמּוּד ב׳)[786] שֶׁלָּמְדוּ דְּלֹא עָבַד אִיּוֹב אֶלָּא מֵאַהֲבָה, — **and we find (Sotah 27b) where they derived that Job served solely out of love,** שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: "הֵן יִקְטְלֵנִי לוֹ אֲיַחֵל עַד אָנְוָע וְגוֹמֵר". — **as it is said: "Though He slay me, yet will I trust in Him until I die, etc."**

וְכַאֲשֶׁר בָּא יִצְחָק אָבִינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם וְרָאָה — **And when Isaac our Father, peace be upon him, arrived and observed** שֶׁמִּכָּל הַיְגִיעָה שֶׁל אָבִיו לֹא הוֹעִיל לְדוֹרוֹ — **that from all his father's toil it did not permanently endure for his generation,** שֶׁלֹּא נִשְׁאֲרוּ בְּקִדֻּשָּׁה מִכָּל הַגֵּרִים שֶׁגִּיֵּר, — **for none of the converts he converted remained in holiness,** וְגַם יִשְׁמָעֵאל וּבָנָיו נִטְבְּעוּ בְּתַאֲווֹת וְאַהֲבוֹת וַחֲמֻדוֹת זָרִים; — **and Ishmael and his sons were drowned in alien passions, lusts, and attractions;** עַל כֵּן הִתְחִיל יִצְחָק לְהִתְלַהֵב בְּנַפְשׁוֹ בְּבְחִינַת הַיִּרְאָה, — **therefore Isaac began to ignite within his soul the aspect of Awe (Yirah),** שֶׁעַל יְדֵי זֶה יִהְיֶה נִשְׂרָף כָּל הַכֹּחוֹת שֶׁל אַהֲבוֹת זָרוֹת כִּי הָאֵשׁ שֶׁל הַתְאָוָה שֶׁנִּקְרָא גַּם כֵּן בִּלְשׁוֹן "נוּרָא", — **whereby all forces of alien loves would be incinerated in the fire of awe;** הִתְלַהֲבוּת הַיִּרְאָה וְהַקְּדֻשָּׁה שׁוֹרֵף הָאֵשׁ שֶׁל הַתְּשׁוּקָה — **for the fire of holy passionate awe burns up the fire of lust, also called "fire" (nura),** כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב (קִדּוּשִׁין פ״א עַמּוּד א׳)[787]: "חֲזִי דְּאַתְּ נוּרָא". — **as written (Kiddushin 81a): "See that you are fire".** וְהוּא הַכֹּחַ שֶׁל תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר בָּהּ: "הֲלוֹא כֹה דְבָרִי כָּאֵשׁ", — **And this is the power of the Oral Torah concerning which it is stated: "Is not My word like fire",** כְּמַה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: "הֵן יִרְאַת אֲדֹנָי הִיא חָכְמָה", וּכְמוֹ מִפְּנֵי שֶׁבָּא מִצַּד הַיִּרְאָה שֶׁבַּלֵּב, — **because it issues from awe in the heart,** שֶׁכָּתוּב (בְּרָכוֹת י״ז עַמּוּד א׳)[788]: "תַּכְלִית חָכְמָה — **as stated: "Behold, the fear of the Lord, that is wisdom", –** תְּשׁוּבָה וּמַעֲשִׂים טוֹבִים וְכוּלֵּיהּ, — **and as written (Berachot 17a): "The goal of wisdom is repentance and good deeds, etc.,** שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: 'רֵאשִׁית חָכְמָה יִרְאַת הַשֵּׁם'". — **as it is said: 'The beginning of wisdom is the fear of Hashem'".** וּבְחִינַת יִצְחָק שֶׁהָיָה מֻרְכָּבָה לְמִדַּת גְּבוּרָה, לִהְיוֹת גִּבּוֹר הַכּוֹבֵשׁ אֶת יִצְרוֹ; — **And Isaac's aspect, who was the**

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woven with fewer than three strands, so the Patriarchs number no fewer than three."

[786] **Sotah 27b:13**: "On that day Rabbi Yehoshua ben Horkanos expounded: Iyov served the Holy One, blessed be He, only out of love, as it says, 'Though He slay me, I will hope in Him.' Yet the matter remains ambiguous: Does lo mean 'in Him I hope,' or 'I do not hope'? Therefore Scripture teaches, 'Until I expire, I shall not remove my integrity from myself.' This teaches that he acted out of love."

[787] **Kiddushin 81a:11-12**: "Some captive women were brought to Nehardea. They were taken up to the house of Rav Amram the Pious, and the ladder was removed from before them. As one of the women passed, light shone through the opening. Rav Amram took the ladder, which ten men could not lift, lifted it alone, and began climbing. When he reached halfway up the ladder, he spread his legs to hold himself in place and shouted, 'Fire in Amram's house!' The Sages came and said to him, 'You have shamed us!' He told them, 'Better that you be ashamed of Amram's house in this world than be ashamed of it in the World to Come.' He adjured his evil inclination to leave him; it came out of him like a pillar of fire. He said to it, 'See: You are fire and I am flesh, yet I am stronger than you.'"

[788] **Berakhot 17a:11**: "Rava would often say: The ultimate aim of wisdom is repentance and good deeds. A person must not read Scripture and study Mishnah while treating his father, mother, teacher, or anyone greater than he in wisdom and seniority with contempt. Thus it says, 'The beginning of wisdom is fear of the Lord; sound understanding belongs to all who put them into practice.' It does not merely say 'to those who act,' but 'to those who put them into practice': those who act for the sake of the mitzvos themselves, rather than for some other purpose. Whoever acts for an improper purpose would have been better off never having been created."

[789] **Berakhot 17a:11**: "Rava would often say: The ultimate aim of wisdom is repentance and good deeds. A person must not read Scripture and study Mishnah while treating his father, mother, teacher, or anyone greater than he in wisdom and seniority with contempt. Thus it says, 'The beginning of wisdom is fear of the Lord; sound understanding belongs to all who put them into practice.' It does not merely say 'to those who act,' but 'to those who put them into practice': those who act for the sake of the mitzvos themselves, rather than for some other purpose. Whoever acts for an improper purpose would have been better off never having been created."

chariot for Gevurah, is to be a warrior conquering his inclination; וְאִיתָא בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ וְתִקּוּנִים (שֶׁנִּזְכַּר לְמַעְלָה מ"מ אות א'):[790] **— and it states in the Zohar and Tikunim (mentioned above, discourse 1):** "מִימִינָא אִתְיְהִיבַת תּוֹרָה שֶׁבִּכְתָב וּמִשְּׂמָאלָא אִתְיְהִיבַת אוֹרַיְתָא דְּבָעַל פֶּה", **— "From the right was given the Written Torah, and from the left was given the Oral Torah",** וְאָמַר עוֹד: "וְכַד אִתְנְטִילַת מִגְּבוּרָה אִתְקְרִיאַת תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה, **— and further: "And when it is taken from Gevurah it is called the Oral Torah,** דְּהָכִי אוֹקְמוּהָ מָארֵי מַתְנִיתִין: תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה מִפִּי הַגְּבוּרָה נִתְּנָה וְכוּ'"; **— for so the Masters of the Mishnah established: The Oral Torah was given from the mouth of Gevurah, etc.";** וְכֵן אָמְרוּ (סוֹף חֲגִיגָה כ"ז עַמּוּד א'):[791] "תַּלְמִידֵי חֲכָמִים שֶׁכָּל גּוּפָן אֵשׁ וְכוּ'", **— and so they said (end of Chagigah 27a): "Torah scholars whose entire body is fire, etc.",** וְהוּא הַתּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה, אֵשׁ אוֹכְלָה אֵשׁ דְּיֵצֶר הָרָע. **— which is the Oral Torah, a fire consuming the fire of the Evil Inclination.**

A small act of awe can become a lasting power of Torah

וְעַל זֶה מְרַמֵּז מִצְוַת הַדְלָקַת נֵר חֲנֻכָּה,[792, 793] **— And to this alludes the mitzvah of lighting the Chanukah candle,** דְּקָיְימָא לַן: "הַדְלָקָה עוֹשָׂה מִצְוָה", **— for we establish: "The kindling effects the mitzvah",** הַיְנוּ עִנְיַן הַהִתְלַהֲבוּת מַמָּתְעוֹרֵר בַּנֶּפֶשׁ מִצַּד פַּחַד הַשֵּׁם; **— meaning the spiritual fervor ignited in the soul from the fear of Hashem;** וְעַל דָּרֶךְ מַה שֶׁכָּתוּב (שִׁיר הַשִּׁירִים רַבָּה ה' ב) עַל הַפָּסוּק "פִּתְחִי לִי":[794] **— following what is written (Shir HaShirim Rabbah 5) on the verse "Open to me":** "פִּתְחוּ לִי פֶּתַח אֶחָד שֶׁל תְּשׁוּבָה כְּחַדָּה שֶׁל מַחַט, **— "Open for Me a single opening of repentance like the point of a needle,** וַאֲנִי אֶפְתַּח לָכֶם פְּתָחִים שֶׁיִּהְיוּ עֲגָלוֹת וְקַרְנִיּוֹת נִכְנָסוֹת בּוֹ"; **— and I will open for you entrances through which wagons and carriages can enter";** כֵּן הָעִקָּר שֶׁיַּדְלִיק בְּעַצְמוֹ הַפַּחַד וְהַיִּרְאָה לְהִתְגַּבֵּר עַל הַיֵּצֶר הָרָע, **— so the essential foundation is that man himself ignite within himself awe and fear to overcome the Evil Inclination,** וְאַחַר כָּךְ הַשֵּׁם לֹא יַעַזְבֵנוּ בְּיָדוֹ. **— and afterward Hashem will not abandon him into its hand.** וְזֶה הַיִּרְאָה נִקְנָה בְּנַפְשָׁם בִּזְמַן הַגֵּס עַל יְדֵי הִתְיַסְּדוּת הַתּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה כַּנַּזְכָּר לְעֵיל. **— And this awe was acquired in their souls during the miracle through the consolidation of the Oral Torah as mentioned.**

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[790] **Tikkunei Zohar 42b:2-63a:9**: '(Ruth 3:13) ... as Y"Y lives lie down until the morning, which is the right-side, in which is the power of the Written Torah, which is the Middle Pillar, for the Written Torah is given from the right-side, and from the left-side is given the Oral Torah, which is 'female'. And because of this 'good', the Righteous-One, 'the life-force of the worlds', is from the left-hand side, for it is 'the mighty-one who conquers his evil inclination' – which is Samael.'

[791] **Chagigah 27a:7**: "Rabbi Abbahu said in Rabbi Elazar's name: The fire of Gehinnom has no power over Torah scholars. This follows by an inference from the salamander: If a salamander is a creature generated by fire, and fire has no power over someone who anoints himself with its blood, how much more must this be true of Torah scholars, whose entire bodies are fire, as it is written, 'Are not My words like fire, says the Lord?'"

[792] **Sod Yesharim, The Eighth Day of Pesach 20:1**: "As You desired and said to bless us": all the desire awakened within a person comes from God's will to bestow, as it is written, "You ... revealed to Your servant ... therefore Your servant found his heart to pray to You." "Sanctify us through Your mitzvot": holiness is desire and warmth. Thus we ask for desire and warmth in performing the mitzvah. When a mitzvah is performed coldly, without desire, it feels like a burden, as the Sages said, "Our leaders in Torah and our burdened ones in mitzvot": the person feels that he bears their weight. When he performs the mitzvot with warmth and desire, however, he recognizes that the mitzvah bears him, like "the Ark bore its bearers."

Sod Yesharim explains what the inward kindling changes in the act: a mitzvah experienced as a burden can become a power that supports its performer. It also traces the awakened desire to God's will to give. This complements Rav Tzadok's combination of a beginning kindled within the person and the help that then carries him further.

[793] **Divrei Soferim 13:2**: "It would seem a defect to mix earthy matter into the supernal wisdom that rises to the place of seraphim and ofanim (angelic wheels) whose awe is a burning fire. What place does the slight awe of one born of woman, just as it is, have among them? Yet this is what God desires: He brought Torah down to those below and "cast truth to the earth." The entire sustenance of the heavenly company comes from the Torah below. From the small awe produced by human effort, God builds a great storehouse with entrances as broad as the entrance of the Temple hall, as Shir HaShirim Rabbah says. All Torah and wisdom are afterward placed within the person's heart. Chamṭin (earth used to preserve grain) becomes chiṭin (wheat): the mem, alluding to kingship, is exchanged for a yod, alluding to wisdom; the small kav becomes a kor, and "Fear of the Lord is wisdom."

Divrei Soferim explains why the needle-sized opening is sufficient as a beginning: God specifically desires the modest awe that can arise in an earthly person. He develops it into a capacity for Torah far beyond its initial measure. This gives content to the relation between kindling one's own awe and receiving the help promised in Chanukah.

[794] **Shir HaShirim Rabbah 5:2:2** (excerpt): "'Open to Me.' Rabbi Yasa said: The Holy One, blessed be He, said to Israel: My children, open for Me one opening of repentance as small as a needle's point, and I will open for you entrances through which wagons and carriages can enter. Rabbi Tanchuma, Rabbi Chunya, and Rabbi Abahu said in the name of Reish Lakish: It is written, 'Desist, and know that I am God' (Psalms 46:11). The Holy One said to Israel: Desist from your evil deeds, and know that I am God. Rabbi Levi said: If Israel were to repent even for one day, they would immediately be redeemed and the son of David would immediately come. What is the reason? 'For He is our God, and we are the people of His pasture and the sheep of His hand—today, if you listen to His voice' (Psalms 95:7). Rabbi Yudan and Rabbi Levi said: The Holy One said to Israel: Desist from your evil deeds and repent in the blink of an eye, and know that I am God."

כִּי הֲלֹא נִמְצָא אֲמְנָם גַּם בָּזֶה עֲצָמוֹ אֵין עוֹד בֵּרוּר, — **However, in this alone there is not yet complete clarification,** גַּם מִיִּצְחָק פְּסֹלֶת שֶׁיֵּצָא מִמֶּנּוּ עֵשָׂו, — **for behold there was found also from Isaac refuse, in that Esau issued from him,** שֶׁעַל הַגַּוָּן הָיָה בּוֹ גַּם כֵּן כֹּחַ הַחָכְמָה דְּתוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה, — **who externally possessed a semblance of the intellectual strength of the Oral Torah,** כְּמַה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: "וַיֶּאֱהַב יִצְחָק אֶת עֵשָׂו כִּי צַיִד בְּפִיו"; — **as Scripture states: "And Isaac loved Esau because game was in his mouth";** וְאִיתָא מַהָאֲרִיזַ"ל דְּהָיָה בּוֹ נִיצוֹצֵי הַקְּדֻשָּׁה שֶׁל נֶפֶשׁ רַבִּי מֵאִיר, — **and the Arizal explains that within him were trapped holy sparks of the soul of Rabbi Meir,** דְּסִתָם מִשְׁנָה כְּוָתֵיהּ, שֶׁהָיָה שֹׁרֶשׁ תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה, — **of whom an anonymous Mishnah follows, who was the root of the Oral Torah,** וְיָצָא מִזַּרְעוֹ מְגַיֵּרוֹן (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב גִּטִּין נ"ו עַמּוּד א'). [795] — **and from his descendants descended Nero who converted (Gittin 56a).** וְזֶה עִנְיַן מַה שֶּׁכָּתוּב (תַּרְגּוּם יוֹנָתָן פָּרָשַׁת וַיְחִי): [796] — **And this is what is stated (Targum Yonatan, Parashat Vayechi):** "דְּרֵישֵׁיהּ דְּעֵשָׂו אִתְנַח בְּגַו עִטְפֵיהּ דְּיִצְחָק", — **"That the head of Esau was placed inside the bosom of Isaac",** וְנִקְבַּר רֵאשׁוֹ בִּמְעָרַת הַמַּכְפֵּלָה, עַיֵּן שָׁם. — **and his head was buried in the Cave of Machpelah, see there.** וְהוּא נִקְרָא (קִדּוּשִׁין י"ח עַמּוּד א') "יִשְׂרָאֵל מוּמָר", [797] — **And he is called (Kiddushin 18a) "an apostate Israelite",** כִּי הוּא נוֹלַד מִיִּצְחָק וְרִבְקָה וְאַחַר שֶׁנִּמּוֹל יִצְחָק לִשְׁמוֹנָה שֶׁמּוֹרֶה עַל שֹׁרֶשׁ יַהֲדוּת, — **for he was born from Isaac and Rebecca after Isaac was circumcised at eight days pointing to the indelible root of Judaism,** אֲבָל הוּא הָיָה בּוֹ כֹּחַ לְהַסִירוֹ וּלְבַטְּלוֹ וּלְדַבֵּק בְּשָׁרְשׁוֹ הָרָע. — **yet he had the power to strip it away, nullify it, and cleave to his evil source.**

Truth remains after the moment of revelation withdraws

אֲמְנָם יַעֲקֹב אָבִינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם הָיָה הַמְמֻצָּע שֶׁל שְׁתֵּי קְדֻשּׁוֹת הָאָבוֹת לְזַוְּגָם יַחַד, [798, 799] — **However, Jacob our Father was the middle balancing harmony of both Patriarchal holinesses, uniting them together,** וְעַל יְדֵי זֶה בָּא לְבְחִינַת אֱמֶת, שֶׁהוּא הַחֶבֶל הַמְשֻׁלָּשׁ אֲשֶׁר לֹא יִנָּתֵק, — **and through this attained the realm of Truth, the three-ply cord which cannot be severed,** כִּי שִׂפַת אֱמֶת תִּכּוֹן לָעַד". — **for "the lip of truth shall be established forever".** בְּחִינַת שֶׁל אַבְרָהָם וְיִצְחָק הָיָה רַק מִצַּד בְּחִינַת אֱמוּנָה, — **For the dimension of Abraham and Isaac operated on the plane of Faith,** כִּי הֲגַם שֶׁהָיָה לָהֶם הִתְגַּלּוּת אֱלֹהוּת כְּמַה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: "וַיֵּרָא הַשֵּׁם וְגוֹמֵר", — **for although they experienced divine revelation as stated: "And Hashem appeared, etc.",** הָיָה רַק לְשָׁעָה, אֲבָל כָּל יְמֵיהֶם הֶחֱזִיקוּ בֶּאֱמוּנָתָם. — **it was only temporary, while throughout their lives they held fast to their faith.** וְכֵן אִיתָא בְּמָכִילְתָּא בְּשַׁלַּח עַל הַפָּסוּק "וַיִּירְאוּ הָעָם וְגוֹמֵר": — **And so it states in the Mechilta (Beshalach) on the verse "And the people feared, etc.":** שֶׁלֹּא יָרַשׁ אַבְרָהָם אָבִינוּ הָעוֹלָם הַזֶּה וְהָעוֹלָם הַבָּא אֶלָּא בִּזְכוּת אֱמוּנָה, שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: "וְהֶאֱמִן בַּהשֵׁם וְגוֹמֵר". — **that**

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[795] **Gittin 56a:7**: "Nero said to a child, 'Recite the verse you have been studying.' The child answered, 'I shall place My vengeance upon Edom through the hand of My people Israel,' and so forth. Nero said, 'The Holy One, blessed be He, wishes to destroy His house, and wishes to wipe His hands on that man—on me.' He fled, went away, and converted, and Rabbi Meir descended from him."

[796] **Targum Jonathan on Genesis 50:13**: 'Targum Jonathan on Genesis 50:13 relates that when the sons of Jacob brought their father to be buried in the Cave of Machpelah, Esau the wicked came to prevent them; Chushim the son of Dan, who was hard of hearing, struck off Esau's head with his sword, and Esau's head rolled into the cave and came to rest in the bosom of Isaac while his body was sent back to Mount Seir.'

[797] **Kiddushin 18a:2**: "Rav Chiyya bar Avin said in Rabbi Yochanan's name: Under Torah law, a gentile inherits his father, as it is written, 'For I have given Mount Seir to Esav as an inheritance.' But perhaps an apostate Israelite, such as Esav, is different? Rather, the proof is from here: 'For I have given Ar to the children of Lot as an inheritance.'"

[798] **Yisrael Kedoshim 8:2**: "It is called after Isaac because Abraham is called "the first of the converts," and Ishmael is a gentile. Isaac's conception and birth, however, were already in holiness, so Esau is called "an apostate Israelite": all Isaac's descendants merited the name Israel. Yet before Jacob came to form "the threefold cord," it was still possible for the bond to be severed. Esau severed from himself the Jewish holiness inherited from his ancestors and, through his sins, was uprooted entirely from Israel's holiness. Among the descendants of Jacob, whose bed was complete, however, it is impossible entirely to sever the name Israel from a person, even if his sins grow to the heavens."
Yisrael Kedoshim specifies the enduring bond's consequence for descendants: Jacob's third strand makes the inherited name Israel inseverable. This explains why Chanukah's discussion of a revelation remaining in Jacob's soul concludes with a holiness established in all Israel. It concerns the persistence of the root; it does not describe every descendant's conduct as already repaired.

[799] **Sod Yesharim, Sukkot 15:1**: "This festival is called the festival of ingathering because the acts of service of the whole year are gathered and included within it. There are times when a person stands in great clarity and says Shema Israel. That clarity is present only at that moment; afterward, when he turns to bodily needs, it is forgotten and hidden from him. At this festival of ingathering, however, even the clarity that had formerly become hidden is established within the person and included in the patriarchal holiness permanently present in all Israel. Established holiness must pass through the holiness of the patriarchs, as every Israelite is required to say, "When will my deeds reach the deeds of my fathers Abraham, Isaac, and Jacob?" This is "first for the guests, then for the inhabitants of the world": afterward all forms of assistance, even from this world, come to the person."
Sod Yesharim describes the distinction between a clear moment and a clarity made enduring through the patriarchal root. Its example of Shema followed by bodily needs makes Rav Tzadok's criterion tangible: truth is measured by what remains after the initial illumination is no longer consciously present. The application to Sukkot is distinct from the Chanukah arrangement of the three mitzvot.

Abraham our Father inherited this world and the World to Come only in the merit of faith, as stated: "And he believed in Hashem, etc." אֲבָל בְּיַעֲקֹב כְּתִיב: "וַיַּעַל מֵעָלָיו אֱלֹהִים בַּמָּקוֹם אֲשֶׁר דִּבֶּר אִתּוֹ", וּפֵרֵשׁ רַבִּי שְׁלֹמֹה יִצְחָקִי: "בַּמָּקוֹם אֲשֶׁר וְגוֹמֵר' — **However regarding Jacob it is written: "And God went up from him in the place where He spoke with him", –** אֵינִי יוֹדֵעַ מַה מְּלַמְּדֵנוּ"; — **and Rashi explains: "'In the place where He spoke, etc.' — I do not know what this teaches us";** וּבְפָשׁוּט הַכַּוָּנָה לְהוֹדִיעַ מַעֲלַת יַעֲקֹב אָבִינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם: — **and simply the intent is to make known Jacob's exalted stature:** גַּם אַחַר הַהִסְתַּלְקוּת הָיָה נִשְׁאָר בְּנַפְשׁוֹ בְּאוֹתוֹ מַצָּב כְּמוֹ בַּמָּקוֹם אֲשֶׁר דִּבֶּר אִתּוֹ, — **that even after the divine ascent he remained in his soul in that exact state as when in the place where He spoke with him,** וְזֶהוּ שֶׁהוֹפִיעַ בּוֹ בְּחִינַת הָאֱמֶת, ו"שִׂפַת אֱמֶת תִּכּוֹן לָעַד". — **and this is the emergence of Truth within him, and "the lip of truth shall be established forever".** וְזֶהוּ הָרֶמֶז שֶׁעַל יְדֵי הַדְלָקַת נֵר חֲנֻכָּה הַמְּזֻדָּוֵג לִבְחִינַת הַמְּזוּזָה מִיָּמִין, — **And this is the allusion: that through lighting the Chanukah candle which pairs with the mezuzah on the right,** שֶׁהוּא בְּחִינַת קְדֻשַּׁת שְׁנֵי הָאָבוֹת אַבְרָהָם וְיִצְחָק, — **representing the sanctity of the two Patriarchs Abraham and Isaac,** נַעֲשֶׂה חוּט שֶׁל צִיצִית בָּאֶמְצַע מְשֻׁלָּשׁ, **the cord of tzitzit in the center is rendered threefold,** לִהְיוֹת נִקְבָּע בָּנוּ הַקְּדֻשָּׁה הַמְּשֻׁלֶּשֶׁת מִבְּחִינַת יַעֲקֹב קַו הָאֶמְצָעִי הַמְּחַבְּרָם, — **anchoring within us the threefold sanctity from Jacob, the Middle Axis (Kav HaEmtza'i) connecting them,** לִהְיוֹת "חֶבֶל נַחֲלָתוֹ". — **to become "the cord of His inheritance".**

Tzitzit restores the awareness that temptation obscures

כִּי זֶהוּ עִקַּר סְגֻלַּת מִצְוַת צִיצִית שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר בָּהּ: "לְמַעַן תִּזְכְּרוּ וְגוֹמֵר", — **For this is the core virtue of the mitzvah of tzitzit of which it is said: "That you may remember, etc.",** שֶׁנִּהְיֶה תָּמִיד מִבְּחִינַת "זָכוֹר", אֲתַר דְּלֵית לֵיהּ שִׁכְחָה. — **that we abide continuously within "Remember", the spiritual realm where forgetfulness does not exist.** וְכִדְאִיתָא (מְנָחוֹת מ״ד עַמּוּד א׳): — **And as stated (Menachot 44a):** "בָּאוּ אַרְבַּע צִיצִיּוֹתָיו וְטָפְחוּ לוֹ עַל פָּנָיו — **"His four fringes came and slapped him on his face, etc.;** עָכְשָׁו נִדְמוּ עָלַי כְּאַרְבָּעָה עֵדִים וְכוּלֵיהּ", — **now they appeared to me like four witnesses, etc.",** שֶׁבָּאוּ לְהַזְכִּירוֹ, וְאַף שֶׁהָיָה כְּבָר מוּכָן לַעֲבֹר, הֵגֵנּוּ בַּעֲדוֹ וְהִצִּילוּהוּ מִן הָעֲבֵרָה; — **for they came to remind him, and even though he was already prepared to transgress, they protected him and saved him from sin;** שֶׁזֶּה כָּל מַעֲשֵׂה הַיֵּצֶר הָרָע שֶׁמַּשְׁכִּיחַ אֶת הָאָדָם וְשׂוֹכֵחַ שֹׁרֶשׁ הָעֲבֵרָה, — **for this is the entire craft of the Evil Inclination: making man forget the severity of sin,** שֶׁאִם הָיָה זוֹכֵר שֶׁהִיא עֲבֵרָה לֹא הָיָה עוֹבֵר; — **for had he vividly remembered that it is a sin, he would never transgress;** וְעַל יְדֵי

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[800] **Kometz HaMinchah 1:75:1**: "The meaning of "You shall see it and remember": tekhelet resembles the sky. Authors have written that looking at the sky brings awe, as it is said, "When I see Your heavens ... what is the human being that You remember him?" It is also written, "So that His awe may be upon your faces, so that you do not sin." Therefore there is one thread of tekhelet. Just as in the whole world those who ascend are few, so in the small world—the person—there are the old and foolish king and the poor, wise man. This resembles the Sages' account of a single advocate amid nine hundred and ninety-nine accusations: there is just one thread of tekhelet. Thus they said that Korach took a garment entirely of tekhelet. He supposed that "the whole congregation are holy," and therefore took such a garment and asked whether it exempted itself. The truth is otherwise: it is not all holy, as I explained above."

Kometz HaMinchah identifies the content of the visual reminder: the sky awakens awe and restores proportion to the person's own importance. Its one thread also preserves the distinction between an existing holy point and a person whose every power is already holy. This explains why a reminder remains necessary at the moment of temptation.

[801] **Tiferet Yosef, Korach 2**: "For this purpose the mitzvah of tzitzit was given on a garment with four corners: the mitzvah reminds the person to return it to God's light. Although it alludes to a step outside, it nevertheless reminds him to return it to God. This is the meaning of Korach's claim that a garment entirely of tekhelet is exempt from tzitzit. The Midrash says that he wrapped himself in such a garment: he claimed that he was wholly surrounded by God's light and could not act against His will. He further claimed that human perception would be entirely annulled, leaving no step outside and consequently no need for service. Tzitzit, however, alludes to the opposite lesson, as Tanna de-Vei Eliyahu relates that it was given after the wood-gatherer's sin: during the six weekdays an Israelite has tefillin on his head and arm, sees them, and turns back from his deeds; on Shabbat he has no tefillin. God therefore told Moses to choose a mitzvah observed also on Shabbat and festivals—tzitzit. God gave Israel this mitzvah because, although at their root they are surrounded by His light, He desires human service and therefore established the possibility that a person takes a step outside and experiences a concealed place. Through tzitzit, "you bring the precious out of the worthless": the person serving God brings that place out of concealment and returns before God. He then has a share in the service, and it is called by his name."

Tiferet Yosef explains why the four-cornered garment needs a reminder even when Israel's root is bound to God. The corners represent places that appear distant within human perception, and chosen service must bring them back. This supplies a mechanism for the reminder's rescue in Chanukah and preserves the difference between an enduring root and completed conduct.

[802] **Menachot 44a**: 'He said to her: I take an oath by the Temple service that I never saw a woman as beautiful as you. But there is one mitzva that the Lord, our God, commanded us, and its name is ritual fringes, and in the passage where it is commanded, it is written twice: "I am the Lord your God" (Numbers 15:41). The doubling of this phrase indicates: I am the one who will punish those who transgress My mitzvot, and I am the one who will reward those who fulfill them. Now, said the man, the four sets of ritual fringes appeared to me as if they were four witnesses who will testify against me.'

מִצְוַת צִיצִית בָּא לִזְכִירָה, כְּמַה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: "וּרְאִיתֶם אֹתוֹ וּזְכַרְתֶּם אֶת כָּל מִצְוֹת ה' וגו'". — **and through the mitzvah of tzitzit one attains remembrance, as stated: "And you shall look upon it and remember all the commandments of Hashem, etc."** וְאֶפְשָׁר לוֹמַר דְּאַף בַּגְּמָרָא קָאֵי "וְהַחוּט הַמְשֻׁלָּשׁ" עַל מִצְוַת צִיצִית, — **And one can say that in the Gemara as well "and a three-ply cord" refers to tzitzit,** שֶׁעַל יְדֵי מִצְוַת תְּפִלִּין וּמְזוּזָה נַעֲשָׂה חוּט שֶׁל צִיצִית "חוּט הַמְשֻׁלָּשׁ", — **for through tefillin and mezuzah the thread of tzitzit becomes a three-ply cord,** לִהְיוֹת נִקְבָּע הַקְּדֻשָּׁה לְעוֹלְמֵי עַד וּבְחִזּוּק שֶׁלֹּא יֵחָטֵא, — **permanently affixing holiness forever as a safeguard against sin,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁפֵּרֵשׁ מַהֲרִי"ל לְעִנְיַן נֵר חֲנֻכָּה. — **just as the Maharil explained regarding the Chanukah light.** דְּבַגְּמָרָא מְסַיֵּם וְאוֹמֵר: "חֹנֶה מַלְאַךְ ה' סָבִיב לִירֵאָיו וַיְחַלְּצֵם", — **For in the Gemara it concludes: "The angel of Hashem encamps round about those who fear Him, and delivers them";** [803]וּבְמִדְרָשׁ (תַּנְחוּמָא וַיֵּצֵא): — **and in the Midrash (Tanchuma Vayeitzei):** "עָשָׂה אָדָם מִצְוָה אַחַת מוֹסְרִין לוֹ מַלְאָךְ אֶחָד, — **"If a man performs one mitzvah they assign him one angel;** שְׁתֵּי מִצְוֹות מוֹסְרִין לוֹ שְׁנֵי מַלְאָכִים, — **two mitzvot, they assign him two angels;** עָשָׂה מִצְוֹות הַרְבֵּה מוֹסְרִין לוֹ מַלְאָכִים הַרְבֵּה וְכוּלֵיהּ", — **performed many mitzvot, they assign him many angels, etc.",** וְכָאן כְּתִיב "מַלְאָךְ" לְשׁוֹן יָחִיד; — **and here it is written "angel" in the singular!** רַק מִזֶּה נִרְאֶה דְּדָרְשׁוּ הַפָּסוּק עַל מִצְוַת צִיצִית שֶׁהֵם מַקִּיפִים אֶת הָאָדָם סָבִיב, — **Rather from this it appears they expounded the verse on tzitzit which encompass a person from all sides,** מַה שֶּׁאֵין כֵּן תְּפִלִּין וּמְזוּזָה; וּלְפִי שֶׁאַרְבַּעְתָּן מִצְוָה אַחַת, מַלְאָךְ אֶחָד. — **and because all four corners form a single unified mitzvah, therefore "the angel of Hashem encamps" in the singular.** וְאַף הַמִּצְוות עַצְמָן קְרוּיִם מַלְאָכִים, שֶׁהֵם שְׁלוּחִים מֵהַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ, — **And the commandments themselves are designated angels, being emissaries from the Blessed Name,** [804]כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב (מִדְרַשׁ תַּנְחוּמָא וַיִּגַּשׁ ו'): — **as written (Midrash Tanchuma Vayigash 6):** "הֱיוּ מְכַבְּדִין אֶת הַמִּצְוות שֶׁהֵן שְׁלוּחוֹ שֶׁל אָדָם כְּמוֹתוֹ וְכוּלֵיהּ"; — **"Honor the commandments for they are My emissaries, and an emissary of a man is like himself, etc.";** וְזֶה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר "חֹנֶה מַלְאַךְ ה' סָבִיב" עַל אַרְבַּע צִיצִית שֶׁהֵן מִצְוָה אַחַת וּמַקִּיפִין הָאָדָם, "וַיְחַלְּצֵם" שֶׁמִּצְוָה זוֹ מֵבִיא לִידֵי זְכִירָה וְנִיצּוֹל מֵהַיֵּצֶר הָרָע. — **and this is "the angel of Hashem encamps round about" referring to the four tzitzit which are one mitzvah encompassing man; — "and delivers them" — for this mitzvah brings to remembrance and rescue from the Evil Inclination.**

Enduring Torah must remain alive within the heart

וְהִנֵּה כָּל זֶה נִקְנָה בְּנַפְשֵׁנוּ עַל יְדֵי נֵס חֲנֻכָּה, [805]— **And behold all of this was internalized within our souls through the Chanukah miracle,** שֶׁעָמְדוּ הַיְוָנִים בְּ"זֶה לְעֻמַּת זֶה" "לְהַשְׁכִּיחָם תּוֹרָתֶךָ", — **for the Greeks arose in opposition "to make them forget Your Torah",** וְעַל יְדֵי הַנֵּס נִקְבַּע בָּנוּ הַקְּדֻשָּׁה מִכֹּחַ הִתְחַדְּשׁוּת תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה — **and through the miracle, holiness was established within us through the renewal of the Oral Torah** לִהְיוֹת קִיּוּם לְכֹחַ הַזְּכִירָה לְעוֹלְמֵי עַד. — **to provide eternal preservation to the power of remembrance forever.** וְהִנֵּה קְדֻשַּׁת הַמְּזוּזָה מִימִין שָׁמוֹרָה עַל מִדַּת אַבְרָהָם אָבִינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם, — **And behold the holiness of the mezuzah on the right which signifies Abraham's attribute,** בְּחִינַת הָאַהֲבָה עַד מְצוּי הַנֶּפֶשׁ, קַיָּם לְעוֹלְמֵי עַד, — **the aspect of love to the exhaustion of life, endures for all eternity,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁרָאוּ שֶׁמָּסְרוּ נַפְשָׁם אַף קַלֵּי עוֹלָם עַל קְדֻשַּׁת שְׁמוֹ יִתְבָּרַךְ, — **as was**

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[803] **Midrash Tanchuma, Vayetzei 2**: '('Midrash Tanchuma, Vayetzei 2 (cf. Pirkei Avot 4:11)', 'https://www.sefaria.org/Midrash_Tanchuma%2C_Vayetzei.2', ''Our Sages taught: When a person performs a single mitzvah in this world, the Holy One, blessed be He, assigns to him a defending angel who guards him in all his ways, as it is written: "For He will command His angels concerning you, to guard you in all your ways" (Psalms 91:11).'')'

[804] **Midrash Tanchuma, Vayigash 6:2**: "R. Simeon the son of Yohai declared: The Holy One, blessed be He, said to Israel: Honor the commandments, for they are My emissaries, and a man's emissary must be honored no less than the man himself. If you honor them, it is as though you honor Me, and if you are disrespectful toward them, it is as though you are disrespectful toward Me. No man revered the commandments and fulfilled the law as meticulously as Jacob, as it is said: And Jacob was a quiet man, dwelling in tents (Gen. 25:27), yet he was visited with trials through his son. The Holy One, blessed be He, said to him: Be assured, you will lose one son, but you will acquire three: Joseph, Manasseh, Ephraim. When they brought him the news (that) "Joseph liveth," he sent Judah before him as his emissary."

[805] **Sod Yesharim, Simchat Torah 6:1**: "After he repeated the Torah to them" means after he had established it within Israel's hearts like a peg that will never move, as it is written, "This song shall testify ... for it will not be forgotten from the mouth of his descendants." He then said, "This is the blessing": they should continually awaken words of Torah within their hearts, so that the Torah does not grow stale for them. This was the whole purpose of Moses' blessings—to establish counsels in Israel's heart so that Torah would not become stale. This is called a blessing after Torah. Although the passage speaks of Moses blessing Israel, how can the Midrash derive from it a blessing of God? The very establishment of Torah within Israel's heart through these blessings is the principal blessing of God. Thus the Midrash correctly derives the blessing after Torah: in these blessings Moses taught Israel how to establish words of Torah in the heart and keep them from becoming stale. This establishment is the blessing of God."
Sod Yesharim distinguishes Torah's promised permanence from its remaining fresh to the person who receives it. Moses' blessing teaches continued awakening within the heart. This illuminates how Rav Tzadok can speak both of a remembrance established forever and of the renewed Oral Torah that keeps its light active.

witnessed that even the lowest Jews sacrificed their lives for the Sanctification of His Name, שֶׁזֶּה מְמַּה שֶׁנָּטוּעַ בְּלֵב יִשְׂרָאֵל מֵהָאָבוֹת הַקְּדוֹשִׁים: "לְאַהֲבָה אֶת הַשֵּׁם אֱלֹהֵיכֶם בְּכָל נַפְשְׁכֶם". **— for this is deeply planted in the Jewish heart from the holy Patriarchs: "to love Hashem your God with all your soul".** וְכֵן קְדֻשַּׁת נֵר חֲנֻכָּה נִשְׁאָר גַּם כֵּן לְעוֹלְמֵי עַד, **— And likewise the holiness of the Chanukah light remains for all eternity,** וּכְמַה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: "כִּי לֹא תִשָּׁכַח מִפִּי זַרְעוֹ". **— as Scripture states: "For it shall not be forgotten from the mouth of his seed".** וְהוּא מַה דְּקַיְימָא לַן[806]: "בָּטְלָה מְגִלַּת תַּעֲנִית, חוּץ מֵחֲנֻכָּה וּפוּרִים" (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב רֹאשׁ הַשָּׁנָה י״ט עַמּוּד ב׳), **— And this is what we establish: "Megillat Ta'anit was annulled, except for Chanukah and Purim" (Rosh Hashanah 19b),** כִּי אוֹתָם שְׁנֵי יְשׁוּעוֹת דְּאִלּוּ שְׁנֵי זְמַנִּים נִשְׁאֲרוּ לָעַד: **— for the redemptions of these two seasons endure eternally:** פְּרִזִּים שֶׁהָיָה "לְאַבֵּד וְכוּלֵיהּ", וְזֶה לֹא יִהְיֶה עוֹד; **— Purim where the threat was total physical annihilation, which will never recur;** וְטַעְמָא דַּחֲנֻכָּה אָמְרוּ (בַּגְּמָרָא שָׁם י״ח עַמּוּד ב׳)[807]: "שֶׁאנֵי חֲנֻכָּה דְּמִיפַּרְסַם נִיסָּא", **— and the reason for Chanukah they stated (ibid. 18b): "Chanukah is different because the miracle is publicized",** וּפֵרֵשׁ רַבִּי שְׁלֹמֹה יִצְחָקִי: "כְּבָר הוּא גָּלוּי לְכָל יִשְׂרָאֵל עַל יְדֵי שֶׁנַּהֲגוּ בּוֹ הַמִּצְוֹות וְכוּלֵיהּ", **— and Rashi explained: "It is already manifest to all Israel through having observed its mitzvot, etc.",** וְלִכְאוֹרָה מַה זֶּה אַךְ הַמְּכֻוָּן, דְּמִפַּרְסַם נִיסָּא שֶׁלֹּא לְהַשְׁכִּיחַ הַתּוֹרָה מִיִּשְׂרָאֵל, **— However the inner meaning is that the miracle was publicized so as never to allow the Torah to be forgotten from Israel,** וְזֶה נִשְׁאָר לְעוֹלְמֵי עַד; **— and this remains for all eternity;** דְּאַף שֶׁהִבְטִיחָנוּ הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ "כִּי לֹא תִשָּׁכַח מִפִּי זַרְעוֹ", **— for even though the Blessed Name promised us "for it shall not be forgotten from the mouth of his seed",** מִכָּל מָקוֹם הָיָה פַּחַד, כְּעֵין מַה שֶּׁמָּצִינוּ (מַכּוֹת כ״ד עַמּוּד א׳)[808]: **— nevertheless there was fear, similar to what we find (Makkot 24a):** "מִסְתַּפֵּינָא מֵהַאי קְרָא: 'וַאֲבַדְתֶּם בַּגּוֹיִם'", **— "I am terrified by this verse: 'And you shall perish among the nations'",** וְכֵן מִסֵּיפָא דִּקְרָא: "וְאָכְלָה אֶתְכֶם וְגוֹמֵר", **— and likewise from the verse's conclusion: "and the land of your enemies shall consume you",** וְאַף שֶׁהִבְטִיחָנוּ הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ "כֵּן יַעֲמֹד זַרְעֲכֶם וְשִׁמְכֶם" וְכַדּוֹמֶה, **— where even though God promised "so shall your seed and your name stand" and the like,** מִכָּל מָקוֹם הָיָה מִסְתַּפֵּי וְהָיָה פַּחַד. וְכֵן כָּאן הָיָה פַּחַד. **— nevertheless he trembled and there was dread; and so here too was dread.**

Oral Torah renews its light within exile's concealment

אֲבָל עַל יְדֵי נֵס חֲנֻכָּה הֵאִיר לָהֶם בְּאוֹר כֹּחַ תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה[809, 810] **— However, through the Chanukah miracle He**

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[806] **Rosh Hashanah 19b**: 'The Gemara suggests: Let us say that they disagree about this. One Sage, the author of this mishna, holds that all the mitzvot observed in the second Adar, i.e., the special Torah readings and the mitzvot of Purim, are also observed in the first Adar. If they were observed in the first Adar and not in the second, the people have fulfilled their obligation. Therefore, there is no need to send messengers in the second Adar. And one Sage, Rabbi Yehuda HaNasi, holds that all the mitzvot observed in the second Adar are not observed in the first. It is therefore necessary to send messengers in the second Adar, so that people will know when to keep the mitzvot of Adar.'

[807] **Shabbat 18b**: 'Why did the Sages permit leaving flax in the oven or wool in the dyer's kettle before Shabbat when the process continues on its own, and why did they distinguish the Chanukah lamp from other flames? Because 'Chanukah is different, since the miracle is publicized (de-ika pirsumei nisa)'—everyone sees that the lamp is kindled specifically to proclaim the miracle of Heaven.'

[808] **Makkot 24a**: 'Rav says: I am afraid of that verse: "And you shall be lost among the nations." Rav Pappa objects to this: Perhaps it means that the Jewish people will be like a lost item that is sought by its owner, and God will restore those lost in exile, as it is written: "I have gone astray like a lost lamb; seek Your servant" (Psalms 119:176). Rather, Rav was afraid from that which is written in the latter portion of that verse, where it is written: "And the land of your enemies shall consume you." Mar Zutra objects to this: Perhaps it means like the consumption of cucumbers and gourds, which are not consumed in their entirety. Some is left over, from which additional plants can grow.'

[809] **Sod Yesharim, Shemini Atzeret 17:2**: "Since the light hidden and concealed within the performed mitzvah is not visible to human eyes, the act alone is insufficient: one must also learn the Torah of every mitzvah, so as to recognize its inward depth, the essential light hidden within the garment of the action. Therefore Torah study is itself one of the 613 mitzvot. The sages instituted blessings before and after Torah, for their purpose is to establish this light firmly in the heart. They likewise instituted saying before the Torah reading, "You were shown to know that the Lord is God," indicating that this very Torah is the light hidden deep within the garments of the mitzvot. For this purpose Ezra also instituted that Israel should not pass three days without Torah. In Babylonia, Written Torah began to enter the clothing of Oral Torah. Therefore one must continually awaken, each time anew, the light hidden within this clothing, so as to recognize the light of Written Torah through all the garments."

Sod Yesharim supplies a practical account of renewal under concealment: repeated study makes the light within the mitzvah's outward act recognizable. Its interpretation of Ezra's regular reading connects the persistence of Torah in Babylonia with continual reawakening. This illuminates the ongoing activity behind Chanukah's promise of non-forgetting.

[810] **Divrei Soferim 32:1**: "In Ahasuerus' days, although "they accepted it again in love" and its dearness was greater, this did not occur through a revealed divine manifestation, but from within concealment and darkness. It resembles "The words of the scribes are dearer than the wine of Torah." The words of the scribes are what Israel's sages labor over and discover anew themselves; this comes with greater love and dearness. Although this too is from Heaven—the prophecy

illuminated for them with the power of the Oral Torah שֶׁלֹּא תִּשָּׁכַח מִפִּי זַרְעוֹ לְעוֹלְמֵי עַד. **— that it shall never be forgotten from the mouth of his seed for all eternity.** וְכָל מוֹעֲדֵי מְגִלַּת תַּעֲנִית נִבְטַל הָאָרָתָם בִּזְמַן הַגָּלוּת, **— And all festive dates of Megillat Ta'anit saw their spiritual light suspended during the exile,** מַה שֶּׁאֵין כֵּן בְּנֵס שֶׁנִּדְוָקָא אַחַר כָּל הַהֶסְתֵּרוֹת מִתְנוֹצֵץ כֹּחַ הַגָּזָה שֶׁל הִתְחַדְּשׁוּת בְּחִינַת תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה בְּנַפְשׁוֹת יִשְׂרָאֵל לְעוֹלְמֵי עַד, **— unlike the miracle of Chanukah, where precisely following all divine concealments does this power of renewing the Oral Torah shine in Jewish souls forever,** וּלְהָתְקַיֵּם בָּנוּ "כִּי לֹא תִשָּׁכַח מִפִּי זַרְעוֹ". **— fulfilling within us "for it shall not be forgotten from the mouth of his seed".** וְצִיצִית, אַף דְּלַיְלָה לָאו זְמַן צִיצִית, **— And tzitzit, although night is not the halachic time of tzitzit,** מִכָּל מָקוֹם יֵשׁ דֵּעוֹת דִּכְסוּת יוֹם חַיָּב בְּצִיצִית אַף כְּשֶׁלּוֹבְשׁוֹ בַּלַּיְלָה (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב אוֹרַח חַיִּים סִימָן י״ח);[811] **— nevertheless there are halachic opinions that a daytime garment remains obligated in tzitzit even when worn at night (Orach Chayim 18);** וּמִצְוַת נֵר חֲנֻכָּה הוּא רַק בַּלַּיְלָה; **— while the mitzvah of the Chanukah candle is only at night;** אַךְ כְּבָר אָמַרְנוּ דְּלַיְלָה אֵינוֹ זְמַן חֵטְא, **— yet we already explained that night is not the common time of sin,** כַּנִּרְאֶה מִמַּה שֶׁאָמַר יִצְחָק אָבִינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם: "דַּל עֶשְׂרִים וְחָמֵשׁ תְּלֵילָוָתָא", **— as is evident from what Isaac our Father said: "Subtract twenty-five years of nights",** רַק מוֹעִיל מִצְוַת נֵר חֲנֻכָּה כְּשֶׁמִּזְדַּוֵּג לְהַמְּזוּזָה בְּיָמִין לִהְיוֹת חוּט הַצִּיצִית פּוֹעֵל לְהַזְכִּיר תָּמִיד כָּל הַיּוֹם, **— only the mitzvah of the Chanukah candle avails when uniting with the mezuzah on the right — so that the cord of tzitzit operates to remind continually throughout the whole day;** כִּי נַעֲשֶׂה "חוּט הַמְשֻׁלָּשׁ" שֶׁהוּא בְּחִינַת אֱמֶת. **— for it becomes the "three-ply cord" which is the attribute of Truth that endures forever.**

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that has not been taken from the sages—it is hidden, without the explicit heavenly revelation given to prophets. Therefore the Talmud expounds “He has placed me in dark places” as the Babylonian Talmud. The foundation of Oral Torah is called “in dark places”: it is the light of “Even when I sit in darkness, the Lord is my light.” Thus no divine name is written in the Megillah, for God’s name was not openly revealed. Nevertheless it requires ruled lines like the truth of Torah. Torah too was given scroll by scroll, and a megillah means the revelation of words of wisdom. This is the secret of Torah coming from the foundation of Abba, the bestowal of wisdom, while the Megillah comes from that foundation entering the feminine and extending beyond it: God’s wisdom enters Israel’s hearts and is revealed from within the hearts of Israel’s sages. Concerning this God promised, “It will not be forgotten from the mouth of his descendants.”

Divrei Soferim explains the kind of permanence Chanukah names. The light of Oral Torah is revealed through the sages’ hearts within concealment itself, so an end to open revelation does not prevent its renewal. The shared promise of non-forgetting therefore rests on a mode of transmission, not on an assertion that exile has already ended.

[811] **Shulchan Arukh, Orach Chayim 18**: ‘And it shall be unto you for a fringe, that you may look upon it’ (Numbers 15:39): Night is excluded from the obligation of tzitzit because ‘looking’ requires daylight; nevertheless, the poskim (Tur and Shulchan Arukh, Orach Chayim 18:1) discuss the opinion of Rabbeinu Tam that a garment designated for daytime wear remains obligated in tzitzit even when worn at night.’

Chanukah Ois 12

Lighting at the Doorway: Love and the Commandment of the Elders

The ois asks why poor and damaged Israelites are compared particularly to Daniel. Its answer concerns how a lowly person's own awakening can become precious to God. The related Tetzaveh discussion examines the personal danger and restraint behind Daniel's example.

Lighting at the Doorway: Love and the Commandment of the Elders

"נֵר חֲנֻכָּה וְכוּלֵּיהּ שֶׁתְּהֵא מְזוּזָה בְּמַסֶּכֶת סוֹפְרִים (פֶּרֶק כ׳ הֲלָכָה ה׳)[812] — **In Tractate Sofrim (Chapter 20, Halachah 5):** בִּימִין וְנֵר חֲנֻכָּה מִשְּׂמֹאל, — **"The Chanukah candle, etc., that the mezuzah be on the right and the Chanukah light on the left,** לְקַיֵּם מַה שֶּׁנֶּאֱמַר: 'מַה יָּפִית וּמַה נָּעַמְתְּ' — **– to fulfill that which is stated: 'How fair you are and how pleasant' —** 'מַה יָּפִית' בִּמְזוּזָה, 'וּמַה נָּעַמְתְּ' בְּנֵר חֲנֻכָּה". — **'how fair you are' with the mezuzah, and 'how pleasant' with the Chanukah candle."** וְהִנֵּה בְּשִׁיר הַשִּׁירִים רַבָּה עַל הַפָּסוּק "מַה יָּפִית וְגוֹמֵר" נִדְרַשׁ הַרְבֵּה דְּרָשׁוֹת: — **And behold in Shir HaShirim Rabbah on the verse "How fair you are, etc." many expositions are expounded:** "יָפִית בְּמִצְוֹת וְנָעַמְתְּ בִּגְמִילוּת חֲסָדִים, — **"You are fair in mitzvot and pleasant in acts of lovingkindness;** יָפִית בְּמִצְוֹת עֲשֵׂה וְנָעַמְתְּ בְּמִצְוֹת לֹא תַעֲשֶׂה, — **fair in positive commandments and pleasant in negative commandments;** יָפִית בְּמִצְוֹת הַבַּיִת וְנָעַמְתְּ בְּמִצְוֹת הַשָּׂדֶה וְכוּלֵּיהּ", — **fair in commandments of the home and pleasant in commandments of the field, etc.",** הַכֹּל בִּשְׁתֵּי מִצְוֹת הַמְזֻדָּוְגִים זֶה לָזֶה; — **all phrased in two commandments paired with one another;** וּמַה אָמַר זֶה בְּכָאן "לְקַיֵּם מַה שֶּׁנֶּאֱמַר — **so why did it state here "to fulfill that which is stated, etc.",** כְּאִלּוּ רוֹמֵז עַל שְׁתֵּי אֵלּוּ דְּוָקָא? — **as if pointing to these two specifically?** גַּם נִרְאֶה שֶׁאָמַר זֶה לְטַעַם עַל הַשַּׂיָּכוּת זֶה לִימִין וְזֶה לִשְׂמֹאל דְּוָקָא, — **Furthermore it appears that it stated this as a rationale for the placement of this one on the right and that one on the left specifically,** וְגַם אִם הָיוּ שְׁנֵיהֶם יַחַד בְּמָקוֹם אֶחָד יוּכְלוּ לִדְרֹשׁ כֵּן עֲלֵיהֶם. — **whereas even had both stood together in a single place one could expound thus regarding them.** אֲבָל בָּאֱמֶת בְּשִׁיר הַשִּׁירִים רַבָּה דָּרְשׁוּ מִקּוֹדָם עַל הַפָּסוּק (בְּפָרָשָׁה א׳)[813] — **Yet in truth in Shir HaShirim Rabbah they expounded earlier (in Parashah 1)** עַל הַפָּסוּק "הִנָּךְ יָפָה רַעְיָתִי הִנָּךְ יָפָה", — **on the verse "Behold you are fair, my love, behold you are fair",** שֶׁדָּרְשׁוּ גַּם כֵּן עַל כָּל אוֹתָם חִבּוּרֵי מִצְוֹות שֶׁדָּרְשׁוּ עַל פִּי "מַה יָּפִית וּמַה נָּעַמְתְּ" הַנִּזְכָּר לְעֵיל, יְעַיֵּן שָׁם בְּפֵרוּשׁ. — **which they expounded likewise regarding all those pairings of mitzvot expounded upon "how fair and how pleasant", let it be examined there.** וְהִנֵּה הֵךְ פָּסוּק מֵקֹדֶם, — **And behold that verse is earlier in the text,** וְאִי הַמַּסֶּכֶת סוֹפְרִים דּוֹרֵשׁ כְּהַמִּדְרָשׁ רַבָּה רַק צֵרוּף שְׁתֵּי מִצְוֹת, — **and had Tractate Sofrim merely expounded like Midrash Rabbah the pairing of two mitzvot,** הָוָה לֵיהּ לְמֵימַר קְרָא דְּ"הִנָּךְ יָפָה הִנָּךְ יָפָה" הַמֻּקְדָּם! — **it should have cited the earlier verse "behold you are fair, behold you are fair"!** וְעַל כָּרְחָנוּ דְּנַקָּט זֶה דְּ"יָפִית" וְ"נָעַמְתְּ" שֶׁהֵם שְׁנֵי עִנְיָנִים דְּמֻרְמָזִי עַל שְׁתֵּי אֵלּוּ דְּוָקָא, — **Perforce it selected "you are fair" and "you are pleasant" because they represent two distinct spiritual realities alluding to these two specifically,** וּמַהַאי טַעֲמָא הֵם בְּיָמִין וּשְׂמֹאל. — **and for this reason they are positioned at the right and the left.**

וְהוּא דְּבְשִׁיר הַשִּׁירִים רַבָּה שָׁם לִפְנֵי זֶה, — **And that is because in Shir HaShirim Rabbah immediately prior,** עַל הַפָּסוּק: תַּנְחוּמָא תְּצַוֶּה ו׳)[814] — **which is also found in Midrash Tanchuma (Tetzaveh 6)** וְהוּא גַּם כֵּן בַּמִּדְרָשׁ "רֹאשְׁךָ עָלַיִךְ כַּכַּרְמֶל" הָאָמוּר לִפְנֵי פָּסוּק "מַה יָּפִית", דָּרְשׁוּ: "'רֹאשֵׁךְ' הָרָשִׁים שֶׁבָּכֶם חֲבִיבִים עָלַי כְּאֵלִיָּהוּ שֶׁעָלָה לְהַר הַכַּרְמֶל וְכוּלֵּיהּ; — **on the verse "Your head upon you is like Carmel" stated directly before "How fair you are", –** 'וְדַלַּת רֹאשֵׁךְ כָּאַרְגָּמָן' — **they expounded: "'Your head' — the destitute (rashim) among you are as beloved to Me as Elijah who ascended Mount Carmel, etc.; –** הַדַּלִּים וְהָרָשִׁים שֶׁבְּיִשְׂרָאֵל חֲבִיבִין עָלַי כְּדָוִד, — **'and the hair (dalat) of your head like purple' — the impoverished and destitute (dalim) in Israel are as beloved to Me as David,** שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: 'וְהָיָה הַנִּכְשָׁל בָּהֶם בַּיּוֹם הַהוּא כְּדָוִד'; — **as it is said: 'And he that stumbles among them on that day shall be as David';** וְיֵשׁ אוֹמְרִים: כְּדָנִיֵּאל תְּכֹתִיב בֵּיהּ: 'וְהִלְבִּישׁוּ לְדָנִיֵּאל אַרְגְּוָנָא וְגוֹמֵר'". — **and some say: as Daniel, of whom it is written: 'And they clothed Daniel in purple, etc.'"**

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[812] **Tractate Soferim 20:5**: 'The mitzvah of the Chanukah lamp is to place it at the entrance of one's house on the outside: the mezuzah is on the right side and the Chanukah lamp is on the left side, so that a person enters surrounded by mitzvot—fulfilling what is stated: 'How fair you are and how pleasant, O love, for delights' (Song of Songs 7:7).'

[813] **Shir HaShirim Rabbah 1:15:1** (excerpt): "'Behold, you are beautiful, My love; behold, you are beautiful.' You are beautiful in commandments; you are beautiful in acts of kindness. You are beautiful in positive commandments; you are beautiful in prohibitions. … You are beautiful in prayer; you are beautiful in reading Shema. You are beautiful in mezuzah; you are beautiful in tefillin. You are beautiful in sukkah; you are beautiful in lulav and etrog. You are beautiful in repentance; you are beautiful in good deeds. You are beautiful in this world; you are beautiful in the World to Come."

[814] **Midrash Tanchuma, Tetzaveh 6:1**: "And thou shalt command (Exod. 27:20). It is written elsewhere in Scripture: Thy head (roshekh) upon thee is like Carmel, and the hair (dalat) of thy head like the purple; and the king is held captive in the tresses thereof (Song 7:6). The poor (harash) within Israel are equal to Elijah. It is said of him: And Elijah went up to the top (rosh) of Carmel and put his face between his knees (I Kings 18:42). And the hair (dalat) of thy head like the purple signifies that the feeble ones (hadal) in Israel are equal to Daniel, for it is written concerning him: They clothed Daniel with purple (Dan. 5:29). The king is held captive (asur) in the tresses. The Holy One, blessed be He, said to Israel: It is as if I am bound (asur) to you, as though it were possible, by an oath. Because of whose merit am I bound to you? Because of the two times in which Abraham ran before Me, as it is said: And Abraham ran unto the herd (Gen. 18:7), and He ran to meet them from the tent door (ibid., v. 1). Therefore, The king is held captive in the tresses thereof."

Daniel's descent can become a source of greater holiness

וְעַל פִּי פָּשׁוּט נִדְרַשׁ הַפָּסוּק[815] — **And according to the plain reading the verse is expounded** שֶׁגַּם הָרָשִׁים בְּמִצְוֹות, שֶׁנִּרְאֶה לָעַיִן שֶׁקִּלְקְלוּ חַס וְשָׁלוֹם, — **that even those destitute of mitzvot who visibly appear to have fallen, Heaven forbid,** יוּכְלוּ לְהִתָּקֵן לִהְיוֹת נֶחְשָׁב כְּאֵלִיָּהוּ שֶׁהִקְרִיב בִּשְׁעַת אִסּוּר הַבָּמוֹת בְּהַר הַכַּרְמֶל, — **can be rectified to be considered like Elijah who offered sacrifices during the prohibition of private altars (bamot) on Mount Carmel,** וְעִם כָּל זֶה נִתְבָּרֵר שֶׁהָיָה לִזְכוּת לְיִשְׂרָאֵל; — **and nevertheless it was clarified that it served as profound merit for Israel;** כְּמוֹ כֵן יִתְהַפְּכוּ הַזְּדוֹנוֹת לִזְכֻיּוֹת עַל יְדֵי תְּשׁוּבָה. — **likewise deliberate sins are transformed into merits through repentance.** וְכֵן יוּכְלוּ לִהְיוֹת כְּדָוִד שֶׁהָיָה נִרְאֶה לָעַיִן הַקִּלְקוּל הַגָּדוֹל שֶׁלּוֹ, — **And so too they can become like David whose severe transgression seemed apparent to the eye,** וּמִכָּל מָקוֹם נִתְבָּרֵר שֶׁפְּנֵי כָּל שׂוֹנְאֵי דָּוִד בִּימֵי שְׁלֹמֹה בְּנוֹ כְּשׁוּלֵי קְדֵרָה (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב שַׁבָּת ל׳ עַמּוּד א׳).[816] — **and nevertheless it was clarified in the days of Solomon his son when the faces of all David's detractors turned black like the bottom of a pot (Shabbat 30a).** אֲבָל מַהוּ שִׂיכוּת הַדְּרוּשׁ עַל דָּנִיֵּאל, — **Yet what is the connection of the exposition regarding Daniel,** וְלָמָּה נִבְחַר הוּא לְהִדָּמוֹת אֵלָיו יוֹתֵר מִכָּל גִּדוֹלֵי הַדּוֹרוֹת? — **and why was he chosen to be compared to more than all the giants of the generations?** גַּם מַה עִנְיַן הַדְּרוּשׁ הַזֶּה בְּפָרָשַׁת תְּצַוֶּה, — **Furthermore what is the relevance of this homily in Parashat Tetzaveh,** דְּאַחַר כָּךְ נִדְרַשׁ סוֹף הַפָּסוּק: "מֶלֶךְ אָסוּר בָּרְהָטִים" עַל מֹשֶׁה רַבֵּנוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם: — **where afterward the conclusion of the verse "a king bound in the conduits" is expounded on Moses our Teacher:** "מַה מֶּלֶךְ וְכוּלֵיהּ, אַף אַתָּה גְּזוֹר עֲלֵיהֶם וְהֵם עוֹשִׂים"; — **"Just as a king, etc., so too you decree upon them and they execute";** וְהַיְנוּ מִפְּנֵי שֶׁלֹּא נֶאֱמַר בְּפָרָשָׁה זוֹ: "וַיְדַבֵּר הַשֵּׁם וְגוֹמֵר צֵו אֶת בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל וְיִקְחוּ אֵלֶיךָ", — **and that is because in this portion it does not say: "And Hashem spoke, etc., command the children of Israel that they take to you",** רַק "וְאַתָּה תְּצַוֶּה וְגוֹמֵר", שֶׁמֹּשֶׁה רַבֵּנוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם יְצַוֶּה מֵעַצְמוֹ! — **but rather: "And you shall command, etc.", that Moses our Teacher should command of his own accord!** וְצָרִיךְ בֵּאוּר: מַה נִּשְׁתַּנְּתָה מִצְוָה זוֹ מִשְּׁאָר הַדִּבְּרוֹת, — **And it requires explanation: why is this commandment different from all other Divine commands,** וְגַם שַׂיְכוּת זֶה לִתְחִלַּת הַמִּקְרָא "רֹאשֵׁךְ וְגוֹמֵר" הַנִּזְכָּר לְעֵיל? — **and what is its connection to the opening of the verse "Your head, etc." mentioned above?** וְיֵשׁ לוֹמַר שֶׁכָּל עִנְיַן הַדְּרוּשׁ סוֹבֵב הוֹלֵךְ עַל פָּרָשַׁת הַדְּלָקַת הַמְּנוֹרָה, — **And one can say that the entire homily revolves around the portion of kindling the Menorah,** כְּעִנְיַן הַדְּרוּשׁ הַנִּזְכָּר שָׁם: "לְמַעֲשֵׂה יָדֶיךָ תִּכְסֹף", וְאֵין תִּכְסֹף אֶלָּא לְשׁוֹן תַּאֲוָה וְכוּלֵיהּ, — **like the exposition mentioned there: "'You yearn for the work of Your hands', and yearning is an expression of desire, etc.;** אַתָּה מֵאִיר לְכָל הָעוֹלָם וְאַתָּה מְצַוֶּה לְהַעֲלוֹת נֵר תָּמִיד וְכוּלֵיהּ", — **You illuminate the entire universe yet You command to raise an eternal flame, etc.",** וְהַיְנוּ כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמַרְנוּ, כִּי עִקַּר הָאָרַת הַנֵּרוֹת מְרַמֵּז עַל הָאָרַת תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה — **which means as we explained, that the core radiance of the lights points to the light of the Oral Torah** שֶׁהָאָדָם מֵאִיר בְּנַפְשׁוֹ, — **which man radiates from within his soul,** וְזֶהוּ שֶׁהַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא רוֹצֶה שֶׁנָּאִיר לְפָנָיו (כְּמוֹ שֶׁנִּתְבָּאֵר לְמַעְלָה).[817] — **and this is why the Holy One desires that we illuminate before Him (as explained above).**

וְזֶה הָעִנְיָן מָצִינוּ גַּם כֵּן בְּאַבְרָהָם אָבִינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם, שֶׁאָמְרוּ (בְּרֵאשִׁית רַבָּה סוֹף פָּרָשָׁה ל׳):[818] — **And this concept we find**

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[815] **Peri Tzadik, Tetzaveh 2:1**: "One may also explain in this way the interpretation of "the locks of your head are like purple" as referring to Daniel. Specifically through the greatest descent Daniel rose to a greater holiness. He saw that he had reached the deepest descent: he had been taken into the Babylonian king's palace to learn Chaldean writing and language, which could readily cause him to become absorbed among them, God forbid. Therefore he resolved not to defile himself with the king's food or the wine he drank. He adopted additional abstinence even from permitted things, so as to distance himself from them completely. This concerns Daniel's decree against their bread, wine, and oil because of intermarriage, as stated in Avodah Zarah."

Tetzaveh gives Daniel's comparison concrete content: a dangerous descent provoked chosen restraint beyond what his situation otherwise required. That illuminates the Chanukah discourse's claim that the lowly person can become precious through an awakening of his own. The full Tetzaveh paragraph also warns against deliberately entering a test; the comparison does not make a chosen fall a recommended path to greater holiness.

[816] **Shabbat 30a:7**: "When Shlomo built the Temple, he wished to bring the Ark into the Holy of Holies, but the gates clung to one another and would not open. Shlomo uttered twenty-four cries of prayer and was not answered. He began, 'Lift up your heads, O gates; be lifted up, everlasting entrances, so that the King of glory may enter.' The gates rushed after him to swallow him, saying, 'Who is this King of glory?' He answered, 'The Lord, mighty and strong.' He again said, 'Lift up your heads, O gates; lift yourselves up, everlasting entrances, so that the King of glory may enter. Who is this King of glory? The Lord of Hosts—He is the King of glory, selah.' He was still not answered. Once he said, 'Lord God, do not turn away the face of Your anointed one; remember the kindnesses of David Your servant,' he was immediately answered. At that moment the faces of all David's enemies became like the blackened bottoms of pots, and all the people and all Israel knew that the Holy One, blessed be He, had forgiven him for that sin. Was Shlomo therefore not right to say, 'I praise the dead who have already died'?"

[817] **Shemot Rabbah 36:4** (excerpt): "He illuminates the world, as it is written, 'The earth shone from His glory' (Ezekiel 43:2), yet He said to Israel, 'They shall bring you pure olive oil.' Thus, 'You yearn for the work of Your hands.'"

[818] **Bereshit Rabbah 30:10** (excerpt): "To what was Abraham compared? To a king's friend who saw the king walking

likewise in Abraham our Father, peace be upon him, of whom they said (Bereishit Rabbah, end of Parashah 30): מָשָׁל וְכוּלֵיהּ עַד שֶׁתְּהֵא מֵאִיר לִי מֵאַסְפּוֹטַמְיָא וְחַבְרוֹתֶיהָ, בֹּא וְהָאֵר לְפָנַי וְכוּלֵיהּ", — **"A parable, etc., rather than shining for Me from Mesopotamia and its surroundings, come and shine before Me, etc.",** כִּי הוּא הָיָה רֹאשׁ לְפַרְסֵם אֱלֹהוּתוֹ יִתְבָּרֵךְ בְּפִי כָּל הָעוֹלָם לִהְיוֹתוֹ נִקְרָא "אֱלֹהֵי הָאָרֶץ", — **for he was the first to publicize His Divinity in the mouths of all humanity to be called "the God of the earth",** וְזֶה הָיָה עַל יְדֵי שֶׁקִּדֵּשׁ שֵׁם שָׁמַיִם בְּמְסִירוּת נַפְשׁוֹ. — **and this occurred through his sanctifying the Name of Heaven with self-sacrifice.**

The valued human beginning still draws its strength from God

וְהִנֵּה כְּמוֹ כֵן בַּדֶּרֶךְ הַזֶּה הָיוּ הַכֹּהֲנִים הַחַשְׁמוֹנָאִים[819, 820] — **And behold, in this exact manner were the Hasmonean priests,** שֶׁמָּסְרוּ נַפְשָׁם בִּמְתֵי מְעַט נֶגֶד כָּל הֶהָמוֹן הַגָּדוֹל וְקִדְּשׁוּ שְׁמוֹ יִתְבָּרֵךְ, — **who sacrificed their lives, few in number against the vast multitude, and sanctified His Blessed Name;** וְאָנוּ אוֹמְרִים: "וּלְךָ עָשִׂיתָ שֵׁם גָּדוֹל וְקָדוֹשׁ בְּעוֹלָמֶךָ", — **and we recite: "And for Yourself You made a great and holy Name in Your world",** וְאָנוּ מַכִּירִים שֶׁגַּם הַכֹּחַ הַזֶּה הָיָה מֵהַשֵּׁם שֶׁנִּתְקַדֵּשׁ שֵׁם שָׁמַיִם אָז; — **for the Name of Heaven was sanctified then;** אֲבָל עִקַּר הַהִתְעוֹרְרוּת הָיָה מִצִּדָּם, יִתְבָּרֵךְ, — **and we recognize that this power was also from the Blessed Name,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב: "שֶׁעָשִׂיתָ לַאֲבוֹתֵינוּ וְכוּלֵיהּ עַל יְדֵי כֹּהֲנֶיךָ הַקְּדוֹשִׁים". — **yet the initial awakening was from their side, and as written: "which You performed for our ancestors, etc., through Your holy priests".** וְזֶה הָעִנְיָן

חָבִיב מְאֹד אַף נָעִים לְפָנָיו יִתְבָּרֵךְ, — **And this dynamic is exceedingly beloved and pleasant before Him,** שֶׁחוֹמֶד וּמִתְאַוֶּה שֶׁנָּאִיר לְפָנָיו מִצַּד הָאָדָם; — **for He desires and yearns that we shine before Him through human initiative;** עַל זֶה דָּרְשׁוּ: "'וְדַלַּת רֹאשְׁךָ כָּאַרְגָּמָן' — **– and regarding this they expounded: "'and the hair of your head like purple'** שֶׁאַף הַדַּל וְהָרָשׁ שֶׁבְּיִשְׂרָאֵל יִהְיֶה חָבִיב כְּדָנִיֵּאל", — **that even the poor and destitute in Israel will be as beloved as Daniel",** שֶׁנִּקְרָא בַּפָּסוּק "אִישׁ חֲמוּדוֹת", וְנֶאֱמַר לוֹ בְּפֵרוּשׁ: "כִּי חֲמוּדוֹת אָתָּה"; — **who is called in Scripture "a man of precious delights", and was told explicitly: "for you are greatly beloved";** כְּמוֹ כֵן אֲפִלּוּ הַשָּׁפָל שֶׁבַּשְּׁפָלִים, אִם רַק יִתְעוֹרֵר מֵעַצְמוֹ לְקַדֵּשׁ שְׁמוֹ יִתְבָּרֵךְ, — **so too even the lowliest of the lowly, if he merely awakens from himself for the holiness of His Name,** יִהְיֶה נֶחְמָד אַף נָעִים לְפָנָיו. — **will be delightful and pleasant before Him.** וְעַל זֶה דָּרַשׁ סוֹף הַפָּסוּק "מֶלֶךְ אָסוּר בָּרְהָטִים" עַל מֹשֶׁה רַבֵּנוּ, דִּכְתִיב: "וְאַתָּה תְּצַוֶּה": — **And on this he expounded the end of the verse "a king bound in the conduits" on Moses our Teacher, where it is written: "And you shall command":** דְּיָדוּעַ שֶׁכֹּחַ כָּל הַמִּצְוֹוֹת שֶׁאָנוּ מְקַיְּמִים כְּתִקּוּנָם — **for it is known that the power of all commandments which we fulfill properly** הוּא רַק מִכֹּחַ מַאֲמָרוֹ יִתְבָּרֵךְ שֶׁצִּוָּה אוֹתָנוּ בַּתּוֹרָה הַקְּדוֹשָׁה, — **is only by force of His divine word commanding us in the Holy Torah,** כְּמַה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: "כֵּן יִהְיֶה דְּבָרִי אֲשֶׁר יֵצֵא

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through dark alleys. His friend looked out and began to illuminate his way through a window. The king looked up and saw him, and said: Instead of illuminating My way through a window, come and shine before Me. So the Holy One, blessed be He, said to Abraham: Instead of shining for Me from Mesopotamia and its neighboring places, come and shine before Me in the Land of Israel. This is what is written: 'He blessed Joseph and said: The God before whom my fathers walked' (Genesis 48:15)."

819 **Tiferet Yosef, Talmud Anthology, Taanit 19**: "My holy grandfather of blessed memory explained that God established in this world "according to the effort is the reward": the more a person labors and bears difficulty for a matter, the greater the reward. Two people may do the same thing, yet God gives more reward to the one who works harder. Thus Rabbi Eliezer prayed and was not answered, and Rabbi Akiva prayed and was answered. A heavenly voice said, "Not because one is greater than the other, but because this one passes beyond his traits and this one does not." How can it say one is not greater, when overcoming one's traits is itself greatness? In their actual conduct they were equally righteous. One, however, had to labor and bear difficulty to turn away from a bad trait, whereas the other did not need that effort. One person may by nature be free of anger, while another is prone to anger and struggles not to be angry. The latter receives more reward, even though his fellow likewise has no anger, because he bore the difficulty and exerted himself more. This is the heavenly voice's meaning: they were equally righteous, but one needed effort to pass beyond his traits, while the other did not need that effort. Therefore Rabbi Akiva was answered; he was exceedingly dear before God because he had to bear difficulty in every matter."

Tiferet Yosef explains why the value of a human awakening cannot be read merely from outward rank or result. Equal conduct may contain different amounts of chosen effort, and the difficult inward beginning is particularly dear. This gives a concrete comparison for Chanukah's lowest person becoming precious through his own awakening; it does not claim that suffering alone substitutes for righteous conduct.

820 **Tzidkat HaTzadik 261:1**: "Abraham our father, being a father who included all the souls and needed to illuminate the entire world, was a vessel able to bear even this burning and blaze. God then illuminated for him through the lamp of particular commands, and his kidneys became fountains of wisdom; his descendants merited the lamp of the Sanctuary. The Sages said: God illuminates the entire world, yet commanded that light be given before Him. In truth, God is the One who gives the illumination that shines in the heart. Nevertheless He says that they should give light before Him: through what shines in Israel's hearts, they illuminate before Him, so that He should not walk through dark passages. He describes it as their illuminating Him, rather than His illuminating them. This is the meaning of "He did not cease to cherish her until...," and "Give strength to God."

Tzidkat HaTzadik explains the attribution at the center of Chanukah: God gives the inward illumination and nevertheless credits Israel with illuminating before Him. Abraham's movement from a blaze to the vessel of particular commands also preserves the necessary form of that contribution. Human initiative is valued through a life of commanded service.

מִפִּי, לֹא יָשׁוּב אֵלַי רֵיקָם, כִּי אִם עָשָׂה אֶת אֲשֶׁר חָפַצְתִּי וְגוֹמֵר"; — **as Scripture states: "So shall My word be that goes forth from My mouth, it shall not return to Me void, but it shall accomplish that which I please, etc.";** אָמְנָם כָּאן עַל מִצְוַת הַדְלָקַת הַנֵּרוֹת נֶאֱמַר דַּוְקָא "וְאַתָּה תְצַוֶּה", — **however here on the mitzvah of kindling the lights it is stated specifically "And you shall command",** שֶׁיִּהְיֶה הַצִּוּוּי גַּם כֵּן מִמֹּשֶׁה רַבֵּנוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם בְּעַצְמוֹ, — **that the command issue from Moses our Teacher himself,** שֶׁהוּא גַּם כֵּן רַק מִכֹּחַ הָאָדָם בְּעַצְמוֹ — **operating also through human initiative itself,** מִפְּנֵי שֶׁזֶּה עֶצֶם מִצְוַת הַדְלָקַת הַנֵּרוֹת: — **because this is the very essence of the kindling of the lamps:** שֶׁנֶּאְיר לְפָנָיו יִתְבָּרְךְ מֵעַצְמֵנוּ, וְזֶה חָבִיב מְאֹד לְפָנָיו יִתְבָּרְךְ. — **that we illuminate before Him of our own accord, which is exceedingly beloved before Him.**

וְזֶה שֶׁרָמַז בְּמַסֶּכֶת סוֹפְרִים בַּפָּסוּק "מַה יָּפִית וּמַה נָּעַמְתְּ" — **And this is what Tractate Sofrim alluded to in the verse "How fair you are and how pleasant"** דִּכְתִיב אַחֲרָיו, עַל מִצְוַת מְזוּזָה בִּימִין וְנֵר חֲנֻכָּה מִשְּׂמֹאל: — **written adjacent to it, regarding the mezuzah on the right and the Chanukah light on the left:** דְּיָדוּעַ שֶׁכָּל הַתּוֹרָה וְהַתַּרי"ג מִצְווֹת אֲשֶׁר הָאָדָם מְקַיֵּם עַל פִּי הַתּוֹרָה שֶׁבִּכְתָב, — **for it is known that the entire Torah and 613 mitzvot which man fulfills according to the Written Torah,** מַה שֶּׁהַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ מוֹפִיעַ עַל לֵב חָכָם לִימִינוֹ, — **wherein the Blessed Name shines upon the wise heart at his right,** מִזֶּה נַעֲשָׂה הָאָדָם יָפֶה וּמְפֹאָר בִּשְׁלֵמוּת גּוּפוֹ — **through this man becomes fair and adorned in the perfection of his body** בְּכָל רַמ"ח אֵיבָרָיו וּשְׁסָ"ה גִּידָיו הַנַּעֲשִׂים בְּצֶלֶם אֱלֹהִים — **throughout his 248 limbs and 365 sinews formed in the Image of God** בְּרַמ"ח מִצְוֹת עֲשֵׂה וּשְׁסָ"ה מִצְוֹת לֹא תַּעֲשֶׂה; — **through the 248 positive and 365 negative commandments;**

God's guardianship extends beyond the person's present strength

וְזֶהוּ הָעִנְיָן מְזוּזָה בִּימִין שֶׁנִּכְתַּב בָּהּ קַבָּלַת עֹל מַלְכוּת שָׁמַיִם וְהַמִּצְווֹת[821] — **and this is the mezuzah on the right containing the acceptance of the yoke of Heaven and the commandments** לְהָאִיר עַל לֵב חָכָם לִימִינוֹ, וְהוּא הַיְפִי שֶׁל אָדָם; — **to shine upon the wise heart at his right, which constitutes the true beauty of man;** וְאָמְרוּ בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ: "אוֹרַיְתָא וְקוּדְשָׁא בְּרִיךְ הוּא חַד", וְאוֹרַיְתָא שְׁמָא דְקוּדְשָׁא בְּרִיךְ הוּא (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב זֹהַר חֵלֶק ב' צ' עַמּוּד ב' וּבְשָׁאַר מְקוֹמוֹת),[822] — **and they said in the Holy Zohar: "Torah and the Holy One are one", and the Torah is the Name of the Holy One (Zohar Part II, 90b and other places),** וְנֶחְשָׁב הַמְּזוּזָה שֶׁהַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ עוֹמֵד עַל יְמִינוֹ לְשָׁמְרוֹ, — **and the mezuzah represents the Blessed Name standing at his right to guard him,** כְּמָה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: "ה' שֹׁמְרֶךָ ה' צִלְּךָ עַל יַד יְמִינֶךָ", — **as stated: "Hashem is your guardian, Hashem is your shade upon your right hand",** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ זִכְרוֹנָם לִבְרָכָה (עֲבוֹדָה זָרָה י"א עַמּוּד א'):[823] — **and as our Sages of blessed memory said (Avodah Zarah 11a):** "הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא, עֲבָדָיו מִבִּפְנִים וְהוּא מְשַׁמְּרָן מִבַּחוּץ, שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: 'ה' יִשְׁמָר צֵאתְךָ וּבוֹאֶךָ וְגוֹמֵר'". — **"The Holy One, His servants are inside and He guards them from without, as it is said: 'Hashem shall**

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[821] **Resisei Layla 29:1**: "Although the person is as though dozing—and in dozing the heart is absent—a person cannot remain firmly at the same station. In every effort and action the heart's awakening is strong at first and later weakens. The counsel is "Commit your deeds to the Lord, and your thoughts will be established." God does not doze. This is "I sleep, but my heart is awake," which the Midrash interprets through God being Israel's heart, "the rock of my heart." He remains awake to give life to the actions performed as though dozing. Dozing is light: "they call him and he answers." Thus, concerning the individual whom He guards, when the person is awakened and reminded that God guards him, he remembers and senses this, although he cannot yet arouse a corresponding desire because his heart is dozing. Of this it says only, "He will not doze." It then says more: the Guardian of Israel as a whole will neither doze nor sleep. Even in sleep, when they call and he does not answer and he has no sense that God guards and directs him, God does not sleep, and the person's heart is awake. It mentions dozing before sleep because it concerns those being guarded: God is in truth the point at the depths of their hearts. When they doze, He "does not doze"; when they sleep, the rock of their heart "does not sleep." For He is "your guardian" and "your shade at your right hand": beyond your own kindness and goodness toward yourself, He desires your good still more."
Resisei Layla unfolds the same psalm's guardianship in states where a person's initial energy weakens or awareness becomes concealed. It explains "at your right hand" as divine care extending beyond the good the person can presently will for himself. This gives depth to the mezuzah's protection while preserving the human work that the rest of the ois requires.

[822] **Zohar, Yitro 29:503**: "R. Jose said that two kinds of joy are referred to in the words, "I greatly rejoice in the Lord", and one in the words, "my soul is joyful in my God". Said R. Judah: 'In each there is joy upon joy, but the joy which the Holy One shall vouchsafe unto Israel in the future will excel them all: "And the ransomed of the Lord shall return, and come to Zion with songs and everlasting joy upon their heads; they shall obtain joy and gladness" (Isa. 35, 10). "They shall return"; "they shall come with songs"; "everlasting joy upon their heads"; "they shall obtain joy and gladness"-the fourfold glad tidings corresponding to the four exiles of Israel among the nations (Egyptian, Assyrian, Babylonian, Roman). Therefore: "Ye shall say in that day, Praise the Lord, call upon his name, declare his doings among the peoples" (Isa. 12, 4).'"

[823] **Avodah Zarah 11a**: 'Onkelos said to them: The standard practice throughout the world is that a king of flesh and blood sits inside his palace, and his servants stand guard, protecting him outside; but with regard to the Holy One, Blessed be He, His servants, the Jewish people, sit inside their homes and He guards over them outside. As it is stated: "The Lord shall guard your going out and your coming in, from now and forever" (Psalms 121:8). Upon hearing this, those soldiers also converted to Judaism. After that, the emperor sent no more soldiers after him.'

guard your going out and your coming in, etc.'"

The foolish heart becomes a place of valued service

וְנֵר חֲנֻכָּה הוּא בְּחִינַת הַנְּעִימוּת[824], — **And the Chanukah candle is the dimension of pleasantness (ne'imut),** הֶאָרַת הַהִתְחַדְּשׁוּת כֹּחַ תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה שֶׁהָאָדָם מֵאִיר לְפָנָיו יִתְבָּרֵךְ הָעוֹמֵד לְנֶגְדּוֹ בִּימִינוֹ, — **the illumination of the renewed of the Oral Torah which man shines before the Blessed Name standing opposite him at his right,** כְּמַה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר עֲלֵיהֶם: "הַנֶּחֱמָדִים מִזָּהָב וְגוֹמֵר וּמְתוּקִים מִדְּבַשׁ"[825]. — **as Scripture states of them: "More to be desired are they than gold, etc., sweeter also than honey".** וְהוּא בְּשֶׂמְאל, לְהָאִיר גַּם עַל "לֵב כְּסִיל לִשְׂמֹאלוֹ", — **And it is situated on the left, to shine also upon "the fool's heart at his left",** כִּי הֶרֹב חָכְמָה מֵאִיר גַּם עַל הָרֶב כַּעַס שֶׁל הַלֵּב כְּסִיל (כְּמוֹ שֶׁנִּתְבָּאֵר מַאֲמָר י');[826] — **for abundant wisdom radiates even upon the abundant grief of the foolish heart (as explained in discourse 10);** וְזֶה נֶחְמָד וְנָעִים לְפָנָיו כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמַרְנוּ, — **and this is delightful and pleasant before Him as we explained,** וְזֶה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: "וּמַה נָּעִמְתָּ" בְּנֵר חֲנֻכָּה. — **and this is why it says: "and how pleasant" with the Chanukah candle.**

The lamp and Shabbat join human preparation to divine light

וּלְזֶה הֻרְמְזָ נִזְכְּרוּ דִּינֵי הַדְלָקַת נֵרוֹת חֲנֻכָּה בְּפֶרֶק "בַּמֶּה מַדְלִיקִין"[827], — **And to this allusion were the laws of lighting Chanukah candles recorded in the chapter Bameh Madlikin,** דִּקְדֻשַּׁת הַמָּקוֹם כְּקִדֻשַּׁת שַׁבָּת בִּזְמַן, — **for the sanctity of the Temple in space corresponds to the sanctity of Shabbat in time,** וְנֵרוֹת חֲנֻכָּה הֲמָה גַּם כֵּן מִשֹּׁרֶשׁ קְדֻשַּׁת נֵרוֹת הַמִּקְדָּשׁ, — **and the Chanukah lights derive likewise from the root of the sanctity of the Temple lights,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁכָּתַב הָרַמְבַּ"ן בְּמַה שֶׁכָּתוּב (בַּמִּדְבָּר ח) "אֶבֶל הַנֵּרוֹת לְעוֹלָם"[828]: — **as the Ramban**

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[824] **Tiferet Yosef, Talmud Anthology, Shabbat 1**: "This was the issue at the giving of Torah. The angels accused and said, "How majestic is Your name throughout the earth—place Your splendor upon the heavens." They argued: since God wishes to refine creation, He could refine it all at once so that it always stood like Heaven; there would be no need for Torah and mitzvot. Moses answered, "Do you have an evil inclination?" Although the angels stand in immense clarity, their service cannot be called the labor of their own hands. God's will now is that Israel's service should occur through Torah and mitzvot and be called by their name. "The word He commanded for a thousand generations" is interpreted concerning Torah: it ought to have been given after a thousand generations, but was given after twenty-six because they were upright. Had it been given after a thousand, everything would have come from God's side, and Torah would necessarily have been fulfilled without choice. God wished to benefit His creatures and call the service by the human being's name. He therefore brought it forward to the twenty-sixth generation, so that people would have choice, choose good, reject evil, and have it called the labor of their hands. The angels then acknowledged this and said, "How majestic is Your name throughout the earth," omitting "Place Your splendor upon the heavens." They understood that concealment was necessary: creation would not always stand like Heaven. God wished to grant Israel merit, so He increased Torah and mitzvot, through which they would break through the concealment and stand in clarity before Him, with the work called their own."

Tiferet Yosef explains why God desires the illumination of a resistant human heart. Concealment and the inclination make possible a chosen work that can truly be credited to the person. This supplies the reason for the "pleasantness" of the left-side lamp in Chanukah: the new light includes the person's effort through resistance.

[825] **Peri Tzadik, Masei 12:1**: "It is written, "When wisdom enters your heart, and knowledge is pleasant to your soul": when wisdom enters the heart, one afterward attains knowledge. "Pleasant to your soul" means that one feels a taste in the words of Torah. Pleasantness is understanding, as stated in the holy Zohar (II 31b). This is the meaning of "For they are pleasant," as it is written, "Through knowledge, chambers are filled with every precious and pleasant treasure." Knowledge means that awe enters the depths of the heart, as it is written, "Then you will understand the fear of God and find the knowledge of God." This is "chambers are filled with every precious and pleasant treasure": the aspect of understanding, meaning that one feels taste and pleasantness in the words of Torah. This is the meaning of "For they are pleasant.""

[826] **Ecclesiastes 1:18**: 'For as wisdom grows, vexation grows;To increase learning is to increase heartache.'

[827] **Tiferet Yosef, Beha'alotcha 3**: "On the eve of Shabbat, when an Israelite still imagines that he possesses an independent power of action, he nevertheless ceases and recognizes that everything comes from God. Thus the Zohar interprets "You shall call Shabbat a delight" as inviting it before the day begins. Israel prepares while still imagining it has the power to act. Therefore, when God opens His great light on Shabbat and shows that human action is annulled, Israel has a place there too. This is "Toward the face of the menorah the seven lamps shall shine." Sifrei, cited by Rashi, says that they all turn toward the middle lamp; the verse should seemingly say six lamps! The middle lamp, however, alludes to "The Lord alone will be exalted on that day," when all human action will be annulled. Throughout the six weekdays, represented by the six lamps, a person can imagine an independent power of action; Israel recognizes even then that everything is in God's hands. God therefore gives Israel a place even in the greater revelation. This is "The seven lamps shall shine": for Israel, the middle lamp too is light."

Tiferet Yosef develops the Temple/Shabbat correspondence through the six lamps and the central lamp. Recognition during the six days prepares a person to receive the greater light of Shabbat without losing his place in it. This explains an operative relation between the menorah and Shabbat, beyond their simply sharing the image of light.

[828] **Ramban on Numbers 8:2**: 'Speak unto Aaron, and say unto him: When you light the lamps, the seven lamps shall give light in front of the candlestick' (Numbers 8:2): Ramban quotes the Midrash Rabbah that Hashem comforted Aaron when he saw the dedication offerings of the twelve tribal Princes, promising him: 'By your life, yours is greater than theirs—for the sacrifices operate only while the Temple stands, whereas your lamps (referring to the Hasmonean

wrote regarding what is stated (in Midrash Rabbah, Beha'alotecha): "However the lights are forever", שֶׁמִּרַמֵּז עַל נֵר חֲנֻכָּה, עַיֵּן שָׁם, וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמַרְנוּ. **— alluding to the Chanukah light, see there, and as we have explained.**

dedication of the Chanukah lights) will shine forever.'

Chanukah Ois 13

Elijah, the Twelve Tribes, and the Restoration of Unity

The ois begins with Elijah's sacrifice at Mount Carmel, whose apparent violation led to Israel's recognition of God. The comparison must retain what distinguishes this prophetic act from a person's self-authorized departure from Torah.

Elijah, the Twelve Tribes, and the Restoration of Unity

'"וַיִּקַּח אֵלִיָּהוּ שְׁתֵּים עֶשְׂרֵה אֲבָנִים"' לַחֲנֻכָּה: (פָּרָשָׁה ד׳)[829] בְּפִסְיקְתָא — **– In the Pesikta (Parashah 4) for Chanukah: "'And Elijah took twelve stones'** — יְהִי רָצוֹן רֹאשׁ חֹדֶשׁ שֶׁחָל לִהְיוֹת בַּחֲנֻכָּה וְכוּלֵיהּ, אַתְּ מוֹצֵא וְכוּלֵיהּ". **— may it be favorable when Rosh Chodesh falls on Chanukah, etc., you find, etc."** מִסִּדָּר הַפְּסִיקְתָא נִרְאֶה שֶׁהָיָה זֶה הַפָּרָשָׁה ד"וַיִּקַּח אֵלִיָּהוּ" הַפְּטָרָה לְשַׁבַּת חֲנֻכָּה לְפִי מִנְהָגָם; **— From the arrangement of the Pesikta it appears that this portion of "And Elijah took" was the Haftarah for Shabbat Chanukah according to their custom;** וְיֵשׁ לְהָבִין שִׁיָּכוּת עִנְיַן אֵלִיָּהוּ בְּהַר הַכַּרְמֶל לַחֲנֻכָּה: **— and one must understand the connection of Elijah's episode on Mount Carmel to Chanukah:** בִּשְׁלָמָא נֵרוֹת דְּזָכְרִיָּה וְנֵרוֹת דִּשְׁלֹמֹה שֶׁאָנוּ מַפְטִירִין עַל פִּי הַגְּמָרָא (מְגִלָּה ל״א עַמּוּד א׳) שַׁפִּיכִין לַחֲנֻכָּה,[830] **— for granted the lamps of Zechariah and the lamps of Solomon which we read as Haftarah according to the Gemara (Megillah 31a) are related to Chanukah,** שֶׁהָיָה הַנֵּס גַּם כֵּן בְּנֵרוֹת הַמִּקְדָּשׁ; **— since the miracle was likewise in the Temple lamps;** אֲבָל עִנְיַן אֵלִיָּהוּ בְּהַר הַכַּרְמֶל לְכְאוֹרָה אֵין לוֹ שַׁיָּכוּת כְּלָל לַחֲנֻכָּה. **— yet the episode of Elijah on Mount Carmel seemingly has no connection to Chanukah whatsoever.**

Elijah's exceptional act requires an actual divine command

אַךְ הָעִנְיָן הוּא: דְּאֵלִיָּהוּ הִקְרִיב אָז בַּחוּץ בִּשְׁעַת אִסּוּר הַבָּמוֹת,[831] **— However, the inner matter is: that Elijah sacrificed then outside the Temple during the prohibition of private altars (bamot),** שֶׁעַל זֶה דָּרְשׁוּ (בְּרֵאשִׁית רַבָּה פָּרָשָׁה עֲתִידִין בָּנָיךָ – פ״ב):[832] '"גּוֹי וּקְהַל גּוֹיִם"' לַעֲשׂוֹת כְּקְהַל עַמִּים וְכוּלֵיהּ, **— concerning which they expounded (Bereishit Rabbah, Parashah 82): – "'A nation and a company of nations' — your children are destined to act like a multitude of heathen nations, etc.,** אַף בָּנֶיךָ מַקְרִיבִין בִּשְׁעַת אִסּוּר הַבָּמוֹת"; **— even your children will sacrifice at the time when private altars are forbidden";** אַךְ הָיָה "עֵת לַעֲשׂוֹת לַהשֵׁם", **— yet it was a time to act for Hashem,** שָׁאָז עַל יְדֵי כֵן קֵרֵב אֶת יִשְׂרָאֵל לַאֲבִיהֶן שֶׁבַּשָּׁמַיִם, **— for then through this he brought Israel close to their Father in Heaven,** וְאָמְרוּ יִשְׂרָאֵל: "יהו"ה הוּא הָאֱלֹהִים". **— and Israel proclaimed: "Hashem, He is God".** וְהוּא הַיִּחוּד בְּאֹרַח פְּרָט, **— And this is the divine unification in an individualized manner (be'orach perat),** כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בְּרַעְיָא מְהֵימְנָא (זֹהַר חֵלֶק ב׳ כ״ה עַמּוּד א׳):[833] **— as written in Ra'aya Meheimna (Zohar Part II, 25a):** "וּלְסוֹף אַרְבָּעִים שָׁנִין וְכוּלֵיהּ, כְּדֵין אוֹלִיף לוֹן בְּאֹרַח פְּרָט, **— "And at the end of forty years, etc., then he taught them in an individualized manner,** הָדָא הוּא דִּכְתִיב: 'וְיָדַעְתָּ הַיּוֹם וְגוֹמַר', **— this is what is written: 'And you shall know this day, etc.',** 'הַיּוֹם' דַּוְקָא, מַה דְּלָא הֲוָה רְשׁוּ מִקַּדְמַת דְּנָא, כִּי הַשֵּׁם הוּא הָאֱלֹהִים **— 'this day' specifically, which had not been permitted previously,** – דָּא בְּאֹרַח פְּרָט. **— that Hashem He is God — this is in an individualized manner.** בְּמִלָּה דָּא כַּמָּה רָזִין וְסִתְרִין אִית בָּהּ וְכוּלֵיהּ". **— In this word how many mysteries and hidden secrets are contained, etc."** וְהִנֵּה מִי בָּא בְּסוֹד הַשֵּׁם בְּסִתְרֵי תּוֹרָה שֶׁיֵּשׁ בּוֹ; **— And behold, who can enter into the secret of Hashem in the mystical secrets of Torah contained therein;** אַךְ זֶה עַל כָּל פָּנִים אָנוּ רוֹאִין: **— yet this at least we see:** שֶׁזֶּה אָמַר מֹשֶׁה רַבֵּנוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם לְיִשְׂרָאֵל אַחַר אַרְבָּעִים שָׁנָה שֶׁהָיוּ בַּמִּדְבָּר, **— that**

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[829] **Pesikta Rabbati 4:1**: 'And Elijah took twelve stones, according to the number of the tribes of the sons of Jacob, unto whom the word of the Lord came, saying: Israel shall be your name' (I Kings 18:31): The Pesikta links Elijah's twelve-stone altar with Rosh Chodesh and Chanukah, teaching that Elijah restores the unity of the twelve tribes and the covenantal light of the altar.'

[830] **Megillah 31a**: 'The baraita continues: On each day of Hanukkah they read a selection from the portion of the dedication of the altar by the tribal princes (Numbers 7), and they read as the haftara from the portion of the lamps of Zechariah (Zechariah 2:14–4:7). The Gemara comments: And if it occurs that there are two Shabbatot during Hanukkah, on the first Shabbat they read from the portion of the lamps of Zechariah, and on the latter one they read from the portion of the lamps of Solomon (I Kings 7:40–50), which discusses the lamps in the Temple.'

[831] **Kometz HaMinchah 2:34:1**: "If you go right, I shall go left" is like "It is a time to act for the Lord; they have overturned Your Torah." When evil seeks the right—as the Sages say that the evil inclination sits at both entrances of the heart, including the right and the good—one must go left and overturn words of Torah; see the Zohar Chadash on this verse. But this requires the prior condition "If you go left, I shall go right": in every kind of leftward situation, he must have stood on the right. Only then can he rely on himself even to depart from words of Torah, as I heard concerning "washing the entrails overrides Shabbat." The Sages likewise said that in every matter, if a prophet tells you, listen to him—provided he is like Elijah at Mount Carmel, established as a prophet and holding firmly to his righteousness, and excepting idolatry. That is: imagining an act to be for Heaven's sake when God does not in truth will it is called "idolatry." This matter is very deep, and this is not the place to elaborate."
Kometz makes the indispensable boundary explicit: the example is a firmly established prophet acting by God's will, with a prior life of fidelity. An imagined heavenly purpose is specifically insufficient. This prevents the Mount Carmel comparison from becoming a general permission to disregard Torah whenever a person expects a beneficial result.

[832] **Bereshit Rabbah 82:5** (excerpt): "Rabbi Yudan, Rabbi Aivu, and Rabbi Mishin ben Negri said in the name of Rabbi Yochanan: Your descendants are destined to act as a nation like the assembly of nations. Just as the nations offer sacrifices when private altars are forbidden, so your descendants will offer sacrifices when private altars are forbidden."

[833] **Zohar, Vaera 4:53-54**: 'Then came the promise of redemption, namely, that He would not merely free them from Egypt and then leave them to themselves: this was followed by the proclamation that He would make them His people; and finally came the promise that He would bring them into their own land (v. 7).'

Moses our Teacher said this to Israel after forty years of being in the desert, דְּכְתִיב: "וְלֹא נָתַן הַשֵּׁם לָכֶם לֵב לָדַעַת וְגוֹמֵר עַד הַיּוֹם הַזֶּה", **— as it is written: "Yet Hashem has not given you a heart to know, etc., until this day",** וְאָז דַּוְקָא זָכוּ שֶׁאָמַר לָהֶם: "וְיָדַעְתָּ הַיּוֹם וְגוֹמֵר כִּי יהו"ה הוּא הָאֱלֹהִים". **— and then specifically they merited that he said to them: "And you shall know this day, etc., that Hashem He is God".**

Faith becomes an inward recognition through actual service

— And that means, as is known, that the Name Havayah indicates "was, is, and will be", וְהַיְנוּ כַּיָּדוּעַ,[834] דְּשֵׁם יהו"ה מוֹרֶה "הָיָה, הֹוֶה וְיִהְיֶה", שֶׁהוּא "אַתָּה הוּא עַד שֶׁלֹּא נִבְרָא הָעוֹלָם, אַתָּה הוּא מִשֶּׁנִּבְרָא הָעוֹלָם"; **— meaning "You are He before the world was created, You are He after the world was created";** דְּאַף אַחַר שֶׁנִּבְרָא הָעוֹלָם וְאָנוּ רוֹאִים תֵּבֵל וְיוֹשְׁבֵי בָהּ, **— for even after the cosmos was created and we behold the world and its inhabitants,** וְיֵשׁ בָּהֶן שֶׁמְּחָרְפִין וְנִרְאֶה שֶׁהֵם נֶגֶד כְּבוֹדוֹ יִתְבָּרַךְ, **— and there are among them those who blaspheme and appear to act against His Blessed glory,** מִכָּל מָקוֹם אֵין נַעֲשֶׂה בָּעוֹלָם שׁוּם דָּבָר נֶגֶד רְצוֹנוֹ יִתְבָּרַךְ כְּמוֹ קֹדֶם בְּרִיאַת הָעוֹלָם. וְזֶה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: "וְיָדַעְתָּ הַיּוֹם" **— nevertheless nothing in the world occurs contrary to His Blessed Will, just as before the creation of the universe. –** "וַהֲשֵׁבֹתָ אֶל לְבָבֶךָ" שֶׁכֵּן מוֹרֶה — **And this is: "And you shall know this day" — in the dimension of Da'at (knowledge) penetrating the depths of the heart, –** לִשְׁנֵי הַלְּבָבוֹת שֶׁהֵם יֵצֶר טוֹב וְיֵצֶר הָרָע, **— for so indicates "and return it to your heart" — to both hearts, which are the Good and Evil Inclinations,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁנִּדְרַשׁ (פֶּרֶק הָרוֹאֶה בִּבְרָכוֹת נ"ד עַמּוּד א') "בְּכָל לְבָבְךָ";[835] **— as expounded (in Chapter HaRo'eh, Berachot 54a) on "with all your heart";** כִּי יהו"ה, שֶׁמּוֹרֶה שֶׁהַכֹּל כְּמוֹ קֹדֶם שֶׁנִּבְרָא הָעוֹלָם, **— for Havayah, which shows that everything is unified as prior to the world's creation,** וּבָזֶה אֵין לָנוּ שׁוּם תְּפִיסָה בָּעוֹלָם הַזֶּה, **— in this we have no sensory grasp in this world,** שֶׁמִּפְּנֵי כֵן אֵין שֵׁם זֶה נֶהֱגֶה בָּעוֹלָם הַזֶּה רַק בְּשֵׁם אדנ"י, **— which is why this Name is not pronounced as written in this world, but with the Name Adonai,** שֶׁהוּא בְּחִינַת אֱמוּנָה שֶׁאָנוּ מַאֲמִינִים כֵּן אַף שֶׁאֵינוֹ נִרְאֶה לָעַיִן כֵּן. **— which is the aspect of faith, wherein we believe thus even though it is not visibly manifest to the physical eye.**

— And then they merited the dimension of Da'at that "Hashem He is God", וְאָז זָכוּ לִבְחִינַת הַדַּעַת "כִּי יהו"ה הוּא הָאֱלֹהִים", **— and the Name Elohim denotes the providential guidance of this world;** וְשֵׁם אֱלֹהִים מוֹרֶה עַל הַנְהָגַת עוֹלָם הַזֶּה; **— and as written in the holy books: Elohim (86) equals numerically HaTeva (the natural order - 86),** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בַּסְּפָרִים: אֱלֹהִי"ם בְּגִימַטְרִיָּא הַטֶּבַע, דְּמַה שֶׁנִּרְאֶה לָעַיִן שֶׁמִּתְנַהֵג עַל פִּי הַטֶּבַע הוּא גַּם כֵּן מִכֹּחַ אֱלֹהִים שֶׁהוּא בַּעַל הַכֹּחוֹת כֻּלָּם, **— for that which appears to the eye to operate via nature is likewise by the force of Elohim Who is the Master of all powers,** וְאָז זָכוּ לְיִחוּד זֶה. **— and then they merited this profound unification.** וְעַל זֶה אָמַר לָהֶם מֹשֶׁה רַבֵּנוּ: "וְלֹא נָתַן הַשֵּׁם לָכֶם לֵב לָדַעַת", **— And regarding this Moses our Teacher said to them: "Yet Hashem has not given you a heart to know",** בְּחִינַת הַדַּעַת הוּא פְּנִימִיּוּת הַכֶּתֶר וְהַיְנוּ כְּשֶׁנִּכְנָס לְמַעֲמַקֵּי הַלֵּב עַד כַּיָּדוּעַ, **— the aspect of Da'at being the inner dimension of Keter as is known,** **— meaning when it penetrates into the deepest recesses of the heart until this day specifically.** הַיּוֹם הַזֶּה דַּוְקָא. וּלְזֶה הַיִּחוּד זָכוּ יִשְׂרָאֵל גַּם כֵּן אָז עַל יְדֵי קָרְבַּן אֵלִיָּהוּ **— And to this unification Israel also merited then through the sacrifice of Elijah,** שֶׁהִקְרִיב בַּחוּץ בִּשְׁעַת אִסּוּר הַבָּמוֹת שֶׁהוּא בְּכָרֵת; **— which he offered outside during the prohibition of private altars, which carries the penalty of karet;** וְעַל יְדֵי יְרִידַת הָאֵשׁ נִתְקַדֵּשׁ שֵׁם

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[834] **Tiferet Yosef, Rosh Hashanah 8**: "So it is with all mitzvot: before a person deepens his attention to see the Torah within them, he imagines that he suffers from them. This is called the mystery of the servant. The son, who has permission to search his father's treasuries, recognizes the inner content of the garment. The servant does not yet recognize the light within the garments, and therefore bears much difficulty. Yet the Zohar calls this servant "lord of all the earth." He has great confidence because he knows clearly that he has fulfilled God's will, as the Midrash says that those who perform mitzvot have grounds to plead before Him. Concerning Torah's light without any garment he does not have such confidence, for he does not know clearly whether he fulfilled His will. But someone who performs an actual mitzvah has great confidence to stand before God and say "Blessed are You," because he knows that through this action he fulfills God's will. Nevertheless, at first he bears great difficulty, before sensing the taste of the mitzvot. Joshua therefore established the opening "It is upon us to praise": it is incumbent upon us to deepen our attention and see the Torah's light in these garments. When a person afterward recognizes the Torah within the garments and actions of the mitzvot, the conclusion is "Know today and bring it back to your heart that YHVH is God." He recognizes that the name YHVH is present in all these garments, in Heaven above and on earth below; there is none else."
Tiferet Yosef gives the transition from general to particular knowledge an experiential form. Faithful action can begin as a burden and still be certain obedience; sustained attention then discovers the divine light within the action. This illuminates Rav Tzadok's distinction between believing unity and its reaching the heart, without discarding the value of service before the recognition is attained.

[835] **Berakhot 54a:6**: "A person is obligated to bless for adversity just as he blesses for good, as it says, 'You shall love the Lord your God with all your heart,' and so forth. 'With all your heart' means with both your inclinations, the good inclination and the evil inclination. 'With all your soul' means even if He takes your life. 'With all your might' means with all your money. Another interpretation: 'With all your might' means that whatever measure He measures out to you, you should acknowledge Him."

שָׁמַיִם וְאָמְרוּ: "יהו"ה הוּא הָאֱלֹהִים". — **and through the descent of the heavenly fire the Name of Heaven was sanctified and they proclaimed: "Hashem, He is God".** וְאִיתָא (שִׁיר הַשִּׁירִים רַבָּה פָּרָשָׁה ז') עַל הַפָּסוּק "רֹאשֵׁךְ עָלַיִךְ כַּכַּרְמֶל": — **And it states (Shir HaShirim Rabbah, Parashah 7) on the verse "Your head upon you is like Carmel":**[836] "הָרָשִׁים שֶׁבָּךְ חֲבִיבִים עָלַי כְּאֵלְיָהוּ שֶׁעָלָה לְהַר הַכַּרְמֶל". — **"The destitute (rashim) within you are as beloved to Me as Elijah who ascended Mount Carmel."** וְיֵשׁ לְהָבִין: לָמָּה דִּמָּה הָרָשִׁים לְאֵלְיָהוּ דַּוְקָא, — **And one must understand: why did it compare the destitute to Elijah specifically,** גַּם לָמָּה נִקְרָא אֵלְיָהוּ בְּכָאן בְּשֵׁם רַק הַמְכֻנֶּה: דִּכְמוֹ "כַּרְמֶל" דַּוְקָא? — **and why is Elijah designated here by the name "Carmel" specifically?** אֶלָּא הַפְּנִימִיּוּת הוּא, שֶׁאֵלְיָהוּ בְּהַר הַכַּרְמֶל הִקְרִיב בְּשָׁעַת אִסּוּר הַבָּמוֹת, — **Rather the inner meaning is: that just as Elijah on Mount Carmel sacrificed during the prohibition of private altars,** רַק שֶׁהָיָה לְצֹרֶךְ שָׁעָה, — **only that it was for the critical necessity of the hour,** וְלֹא דַּי שֶׁלֹּא נֶחְשַׁב לְחֵטְא, רַק הָיָה עוֹד לְרָצוֹן לִפְנֵי הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ; — **and not only was it not accounted as a sin, but on the contrary was accepted with favor before the Blessed Name;**

Repentance changes the past's meaning after changing the heart

וְכֵן הָרָשִׁים שֶׁבָּךְ,[837, 838] אִם יִזְכּוּ לַעֲשׂוֹת תְּשׁוּבָה מֵאַהֲבָה, — **so too the destitute within you, if they merit to perform repentance out of love,** אָז יִבָּרֵר הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב (שַׁבָּת פ"ט עַמּוּד ב'): "אִם יִהְיוּ חֲטָאֵיכֶם כַּשָּׁנִים"[839] — **then the Blessed Name clarifies, as written (Shabbat 89b): –** כַּשָּׁנִים הַלָּלוּ שֶׁסְּדוּרוֹת וּבָאוֹת מִשֵּׁשֶׁת יְמֵי בְרֵאשִׁית וְעַד עַכְשָׁו", — **"Though your sins be like scarlet (shanim) — like these years (shanim) ordered from the Six Days of Creation until now",** וְהַיְנוּ שֶׁכֵּן הָיָה מְסֻדָּר מִמַּאֲמַר "בְּרֵאשִׁית", בְּרֵאשִׁית הַמַּחֲשָׁבָה, — **meaning that thus it was preordained from the utterance "In the beginning", the inception of Divine Thought,** עַל דָּרֶךְ מַה שֶּׁיָּצְאָה מִמֶּנִּי יָצְאוּ הַדְּבָרִים כְּבוּשִׁין" (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב מַכּוֹת כ"ג עַמּוּד ב');[840] בַּת קוֹל בִּיהוּדָה: — **after the manner of the Heavenly Voice that proclaimed regarding Judah: "From Me these hidden matters emerged" (Makkot 23b);** וְאָז וְהַיְנוּ שֶׁלֹּא רַק שֶׁיִּתְכַּפְּרוּ עַל דֶּרֶךְ "וְתַשְׁלִיךְ בִּמְצֻלוֹת יָם", — **and then "they shall become white as snow",** "כַּשֶּׁלֶג יַלְבִּינוּ",

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[836] **Shir HaShirim Rabbah 7:6:1** (excerpt): "'Your head upon you is like Carmel.' The Holy One, blessed be He, said to Israel: 'Your head upon you is like Carmel'—the poor among you are as beloved to Me as Elijah, who ascended Mount Carmel, as it says, 'Elijah went up to the top of Carmel and put his face between his knees' (I Kings 18:42). Why did he put his face between his knees? He said before the Holy One: We have no merit; look to the covenant."

[837] **Divrei Soferim 38:13**: "This is still not the ultimate completeness. If someone sinned all his life and returned at the end, becoming clean as one who had not sinned, he was also like that before he was created. Although we ask, "Would that his departure be like his arrival, without sin," and this too is good, it is not the ultimate good or the complete purpose of Creation. What did he accomplish by coming into the world? His creation would have been for nothing. Complete repair is to merit full repentance, so that deliberate sins become merits, until through them "he shall surely live," as stated in Yoma. This occurs when his heart burns like fire toward God, until all the waste and evil in the heart is burned away and consumed and it becomes wholly holy to God. It then becomes revealed that "all our deeds You have wrought for us," and all the sins are in the manner of a transgression for Heaven's sake, greater than a mitzvah not for Heaven's sake. From the sins that were scarlet is made a scarlet garment of mitzvot."

Divrei Soferim asks what transformation adds beyond a clean slate. Its answer is the changed heart: consuming love turns what had been waste into material for a holy life. This supplies the inner mechanism behind Chanukah's distinction between casting sins away and their becoming merits; the transformation follows full repentance, rather than being a prior description of every action.

[838] **Tiferet Yosef, Vayeilech and Shabbat Shuvah 5**: "An orphan signifies limited understanding. God desires that a person serve Him with the limited understanding he has. He should not proceed with the confidence that everything is in Heaven's hands, nor nullify himself entirely, nor, as it were, force God. He should serve God with the understanding he has. He should not proceed with the confidence that everything is in Heaven's hands, nor nullify himself entirely, nor, as it were, force God, but serve Him with the understanding he has, as far as his ability reaches. All this requires a measure of concealment in the present, so that there can be a place for service. But concerning the past, when concealment overcame the person, after his repentance and turning toward God, God shows him what was explained: repentance is great, reaching the Throne of Glory, and deliberate sins become merits. All this shows that even during the concealment he was bound to God."

Tiferet Yosef expressly separates the past recognized after repentance from the present in which a person must work with his actual understanding. That distinction safeguards the meaning of Chanukah's retrospective clarification. Knowledge that the bond endured does not excuse abandoning present judgment, effort, or the choice to return. The repetition in the translation follows the unchanged canonical paragraph.

[839] **Shabbat 89b:2**: "'From where do we learn that they tie a strip of crimson wool,' and so forth? Why does the verse say ka-shanim, a plural form for 'scarlet'? Should it not have said ka-shani, the singular? Rabbi Yitzchak said: The Holy One, blessed be He, told Israel, 'Even if your sins are like these years, shanim, which have come in ordered succession from the six days of Creation until now, they shall become white as snow.' Rava expounded: What is meant by 'Go now, and let us reason together, the Lord will say'? Why 'Go now'? Should it not say 'Come now'? And why 'the Lord will say'? Should it not say 'the Lord said'? In the future the Holy One, blessed be He, will tell Israel, 'Go now to your ancestors, and let them rebuke you.'"

[840] **Makkot 23b:12**: "Rabbi Elazar said: The holy spirit appeared in three places: in Shem's court, in the court of Shmuel of Ramah, and in Shlomo's court. In Shem's court, as it is written, 'Yehudah recognized them and said: She is right; it is from me.' How did he know? Perhaps just as he had gone to her, another man had also gone to her! A heavenly voice went forth and said: 'From Me came these hidden matters.'"

כָּל חַטֹּאותָם", — **meaning not merely that they will be atoned after the manner of "and You will cast into the depths of the sea all their sins",** רַק יַלְבִּינוּ כַּשֶּׁלֶג שֶׁיִּהְיוּ כִּזְכֻיּוֹת; — **but they will turn white as snow, transforming into merits;** וְזֶה עַל יְדֵי כֹּחַ תְּשׁוּבָה מֵאַהֲבָה שֶׁזְּדוֹנוֹת נַעֲשׂוֹת לוֹ כִּזְכֻיּוֹת (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב יוֹמָא פ״ו עַמּוּד ב׳, וְנִתְבָּאֵר כַּמָּה פְּעָמִים).[841] — **and this occurs through repentance from love, wherein intentional transgressions become merits (Yoma 86b, and explained often).** וְזֶה בְּאֵלִיָּהוּ, שֶׁזֶּה הַכֹּחַ עַל יָדוֹ הוּא, — **And Scripture linked this to Elijah, for this spiritual power operates through him,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בַּפְּסִיקְתָא (לְהַלָּן): "'וּבְנָבִיא — **"'And by a prophet He brought up, etc.' — this is Moses; –** זֶה מֹשֶׁה, 'וּבְנָבִיא נִשְׁמָר' הֶעֱלָה וְגוֹמַר'[842] — **and as written in the Pesikta (further on):** זֶה — **'and by a prophet was he preserved' — this is Elijah;** אַתְּ מוֹצֵא שְׁנֵי נְבִיאִים עָמְדוּ לָהֶם לְיִשְׂרָאֵל מִשִּׁבְטוֹ שֶׁל לֵוִי: מֹשֶׁה רִאשׁוֹן וְאֵלִיָּהוּ אַחֲרוֹן, גּוֹאֲלָן לְיִשְׂרָאֵל וְכוּלֵיהּ". — **you find two prophets arose for Israel from the tribe of Levi: Moses the first and Elijah the last, redeeming Israel, etc."** וְאַף שֶׁהַגּוֹאֵל הָאַחֲרוֹן יִהְיֶה מָשִׁיחַ בֶּן דָּוִד, — **And even though the ultimate Redeemer will be the Messiah son of David,** אַךְ הַגְּאֻלָּה יִהְיֶה בְּכֹחַ אֵלִיָּהוּ, — **yet the redemption will proceed through the spiritual power of Elijah,** דִּכְתִיב: "הִנֵּה אָנֹכִי שֹׁלֵחַ לָכֶם אֵת אֵלִיָּה הַנָּבִיא וְגוֹמַר, וְהֵשִׁיב לֵב אָבוֹת עַל בָּנִים וְגוֹמַר", — **for it is written: "Behold I send you Elijah the prophet, etc., and he shall turn the heart of the fathers to the children, etc.",** וְהַיְנוּ שֶׁיַּחֲזִיר אֶת יִשְׂרָאֵל בִּתְשׁוּבָה, — **which means that he will restore Israel in repentance,** וּמַכְנִיס בְּלִבָּם תְּשׁוּבָה שְׁלֵמָה שֶׁיִּהְיֶה הַכֹּל נַעֲשֹׂית כִּזְכֻיּוֹת, — **infusing into their hearts complete repentance so that all sins become merits,** וְזֶה יִהְיֶה הַהֲכָנָה לַגְּאֻלָּה אַחֲרוֹנָה. — **and this will be the preparation for the Final Redemption.**

External peace begins with the repair of the inward conflict

וְזֶה נִרְמָז בְּמַה שֶׁכָּתוּב (סוֹף עֵדֻיּוֹת) שֶׁאֵלִיָּהוּ בָּא לַעֲשׂוֹת שָׁלוֹם בָּעוֹלָם;[843, 844] — **And this is alluded to in that which is stated (end of Eduyot) that Elijah comes to make peace in the world;** וְהַיְנוּ הַשָּׁלוֹם מֵעִקַּר הַמִּלְחָמָה הַפְּנִימִית כְּנֶגֶד הַיֵּצֶר הָרָע, — **meaning peace from the internal war waged against the Evil Inclination,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ בְּשֵׁם רַבֵּנוּ רַבִּי בִּינֵם זְכַר צַדִּיק לִבְרָכָה שֶׁאָמַר: — **and as they stated in the name of our master Rabbi Bunim, of blessed memory, who said:** שֶׁפֵּרוּשׁ הַפָּשׁוּט בְּמַה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: "כִּי תֵצֵא לַמִּלְחָמָה עַל אֹיְבֶךָ" הוּא עַל הַיֵּצֶר הָרָע שֶׁנִּקְרָא "אוֹיֵב" וְ"שׂוֹנֵא", — **that the plain meaning of "When you go forth to battle against your enemy" refers to the Evil Inclination, which is termed "enemy" and "foe",** וְאֵין זֶה דֶּרֶךְ דְּרָשׁ וְרֶמֶז; — **and this is not mere homily or allegory.** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמַרְנוּ בְּמַה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: "אֵין שָׁלוֹם בַּעֲצָמַי מִפְּנֵי חַטָּאתִי", — **And as we explained regarding: "There is no peace in my bones because of my sin",** שֶׁעִקַּר הַפֵּרוּד וּמִלְחָמָה הוּא בְּגוּף הָאָדָם בֵּין עַצְמוֹתָיו עַל יְדֵי הַחֵטְא, וְהַיֵּצֶר הָרָע, — **that the primary rupture and conflict is within the human body among his bones through sin and the Evil Inclination,** וּמִמֵּילָא מִסְתַּעֵף הַמִּלְחָמָה מִבַּחוּץ, — **and automatically from this branches outward external warfare,** שֶׁיֵּשׁ לָהֶם קְטָרוּג כְּשֶׁמּוֹצְאִין שֶׁהַיִּשְׂרָאֵל יֵשׁ לוֹ עֵסֶק וּמִלְחָמָה פְּנִימִית; — **where the accusers prosecute when finding that the Jew harbors internal inner warfare;** וְאֵלִיָּהוּ בָּא לַעֲשׂוֹת שָׁלוֹם, שֶׁיַּכְנִיס הִרְהוּרֵי תְּשׁוּבָה שְׁלֵמָה בְּלֵב כָּל יִשְׂרָאֵל — **and Elijah comes to establish peace, implanting thoughts of complete**

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[841] **Yoma 86b:3**: "Reish Lakish said: Great is repentance, for a person's deliberate sins become like unintentional sins, as it says, 'Return, Israel, to the Lord your God, for you have stumbled through your iniquity.' Iniquity is deliberate, yet the verse calls it a stumbling. Is that so? Did Reish Lakish not say: Great is repentance, for deliberate sins become merits, as it says, 'When the wicked turns from his wickedness and performs justice and righteousness, because of them he shall live'? There is no contradiction: The latter concerns repentance from love, and the former repentance from fear."

[842] **Pesikta Rabbati 4:2**: 'And by a prophet the Lord brought Israel up out of Egypt, and by a prophet was he preserved' (Hosea 12:14): 'By a prophet He brought up'—this is Moses; 'and by a prophet was he preserved'—this is Elijah the Prophet, through whom the covenant and the future redemption of Israel are guarded.'

[843] **Mishnah Eduyot 8:7**: "Rabbi Joshua said: I have received a tradition from Rabban Yohanan ben Zakkai, who heard it from his teacher, and his teacher heard it from his teacher, as a halakhah given to Moses from Sinai, that Elijah will not come to pronounce unclean or to pronounce clean, to put away or to bring near, but to put away those brought near by force and to bring near those put away by force. The family of Beth Tzriphah was on the other side of the Jordan and Ben Zion put it away by force; and yet another family was there, and Ben Zion brought it near by force. It is such as these that Elijah will come to pronounce unclean or to pronounce clean, to put away or to bring near. Rabbi Judah says: to bring near, but not to put away. Rabbi Shimon says: to conciliate disputes. And the Sages say: neither to put away nor to bring near, but to make peace in the world, for it is said, "Behold I send to you Elijah the prophet", etc., "and he shall turn the heart of the fathers to the children and the heart of the children to their fathers" (Malachi 3:23-4)."

[844] **Takanat HaShavin 4:3**: "The root of repentance is regret for the sin and guarding against it in the future. Accepting the obligation to guard against the sin itself brings healing to the wound of sin. Its extension is accepting boundaries and safeguards around the matter surrounding the sin, so as not to come to sin. This is what brings deliverance and victory over the subjugating nation, because through it the person distances himself entirely from the sin."
Takanat HaShavin identifies the practical extension of inner repair: safeguards prevent the outward conditions of bondage from carrying a person back into the sin. This makes concrete the origin's claim that external conflict branches from the inward conflict. Its full paragraph distinguishes this real but still reversible deliverance from the final repair of the root; it does not equate an initial victory with Elijah's complete peace.

repentance in the heart of all Israel, וְיִהְיֶה שָׁלוֹם בֵּינֵיהֶם מִכָּל הָעִנְיָנִים, **— so that there will be total peace among them in all matters,** וְזֶה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: "וְהֵשִׁיב לֵב וְגוֹמֵר". **— and this is what Scripture states: "And he shall turn the heart, etc."**

Elijah's life is the point from which renewal can begin

— וְאִיתָא (סוֹף סוֹטָה)[845, 846]: "וַחֲסִידוּת מְבִיאָה לִידֵי רוּחַ הַקֹּדֶשׁ, **And it states (end of Sotah 49b): "And piety leads to Divine Inspiration,** וְרוּחַ הַקֹּדֶשׁ מְבִיאָה לִידֵי תְּחִיַּת הַמֵּתִים, **— and Divine Inspiration leads to the Resurrection of the Dead,** וּתְחִיַּת הַמֵּתִים בָּא עַל יְדֵי אֵלִיָּהוּ הַנָּבִיא זָכוּר לַטּוֹב", **— and the Resurrection of the Dead comes through Elijah the Prophet, remembered for good",** וְזֶה גַּם כֵּן מְרַמֵּז עַל זֶה: **— and this likewise alludes to this:** שֶׁאֵלִיָּהוּ הַנָּבִיא יַחֲזִיר בִּתְשׁוּבָה אַף הַפּוֹשְׁעִים, **— that Elijah the Prophet will return in repentance even the willful transgressors,** רִשְׁעִים שֶׁבְּחַיֵּיהֶן קְרוּיִם "מֵתִים" כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב (בְּרָכוֹת י״ח עַמּוּד ב')[847] **— the wicked who in their lifetimes are called "dead" as written (Berachot 18b),** וְהוּא יַחֲזִירֵם בִּתְשׁוּבָה וִיחַיֶּה אוֹתָם, **— and he will bring them back in repentance and grant them spiritual life,** וְזֶה גַּם כֵּן בְּחִינַת תְּחִיַּת הַמֵּתִים. **— and this too is an aspect of the Resurrection of the Dead.** וּבִירוּשַׁלְמִי (סוֹף פֶּרֶק ג׳ דִּשְׁקָלִים)[848] אָמְרוּ: **— And in the Yerushalmi (end of Chapter 3 of Shekalim) they stated:** "חֲסִידוּת מְבִיאָה לִידֵי רוּחַ הַקֹּדֶשׁ, דִּכְתִיב: 'אָז דִּבַּרְתָּ בְחָזוֹן לַחֲסִידֶיךָ'; **"Piety leads to Divine Inspiration, as it is written: 'Then You spoke in a vision to Your pious ones';** רוּחַ הַקֹּדֶשׁ מְבִיאָה לִידֵי תְּחִיַּת הַמֵּתִים, דִּכְתִיב: 'וְנָתַתִּי רוּחִי בָּכֶם וְחִיִּיתֶם'". **— Divine Inspiration leads to the Resurrection of the Dead, as it is written: 'And I will put My Spirit in you, and you shall live'".** וְהַמְּכֻוָּן עַל פִּי מַה שֶּׁכָּתוּב בְּ'כִּי טַל אוֹרֹת טַלֶּךָ וְגוֹמֵר'(כְּתֻבּוֹת קי״א עַמּוּד ב')[849]: **— And the inner meaning is based on what is written (Ketubot 111b): –** "'כִּי טַל אוֹרֹת טַלֶּךָ, כָּל הַמִּשְׁתַּמֵּשׁ בְּאוֹר תּוֹרָה, אוֹר תּוֹרָה מְחַיֶּיהוּ", **"'For your dew is as the dew of light, etc.' — whoever uses the light of Torah, the light of Torah revives him",** וְהַיְנוּ טַל תּוֹרָה שֶׁבָּעַל פֶּה שֶׁעַל זֶה נֶאֱמַר: "תִּזַּל כַּטַּל אִמְרָתִי", **— meaning the dew of the Oral Torah concerning which it is said: "My speech shall distill as the dew",** וּבְתִקּוּנִים (תִּקּוּן י״ט וּבַהַקְדָּמָה) מֵבִיא הַלָּשׁוֹן:[850] **— and in the Tikunim (Tikun 19 and in the**

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[845] **Sotah 49b**: 'He also said: In the times of the approach of the Messiah, impudence will increase and high costs will pile up. Although the vine shall bring forth its fruit, wine will nevertheless be expensive. And the monarchy shall turn to heresy, and there will be no one to give reproof about this. The meeting place of the Sages will become a place of promiscuity, and the Galilee shall be destroyed, and the Gavlan will be desolate, and the men of the border shall go round from city to city to seek charity, but they will find no mercy.'

[846] **Sod Yesharim, Rosh Hashanah 88:2**: "Elijah is the "vapor of the bones" of all Israel. Just as in each individual soul, during sleep, a small measure of life remains from which the person awakens and rises, so in each soul a measure of life remains from which it will awaken at the resurrection of the dead. This measure is also called in the Zohar the "vapor of the bones." As with the individual, so with the collective: the enduring measure of life of all Israel is Elijah the prophet, who lives and endures forever. He possessed especially intense acts of service, until through their strength he showed explicitly that "YHVH is God": God is present in all the garments, even those exceedingly distant. Elohim signifies all the garments, including the most distant, as the Zohar says that even idolatry is called by the name elohim. Elijah showed expressly that no other power exists in the world apart from His power, as it is written, "In every place incense is offered to My name, and a pure offering." Therefore he had the power to offer outside even when private altars were forbidden, as he said, "By Your word I have done all these things."
Sod Yesharim explains why Elijah is associated with renewed life: he represents the abiding point of life of the whole people, analogous to the point from which an individual awakens. Its Mount Carmel interpretation also preserves "By Your word," linking the disclosure to Elijah's commanded service. This gives an account of the life that repentance can awaken beneath an apparently dead state.

[847] **Berakhot 18b**: 'In contrast to the righteous, who are referred to as living even after their death, the verse states explicitly: "The dead know nothing." These are the wicked, who even during their lives are called dead, as the prophet Ezekiel said in reference to a king of Israel who was alive: "And you are a slain, wicked prince of Israel" (Ezekiel 21:30). And if you wish, say instead that the proof is from here: "At the mouth of two witnesses or three witnesses the dead shall be put to death" (Deuteronomy 17:6). This is puzzling. As long as the accused has not been sentenced to death, he is alive. Rather, this person who is wicked is considered dead from the outset.'

[848] **Jerusalem Talmud Shekalim 3:3**: 'Rabbi Pinchas ben Yair taught: Torah leads to watchfulness; watchfulness leads to alacrity; alacrity leads to cleanliness; cleanliness leads to abstinence; abstinence leads to purity; purity leads to piety (chasidut); humility leads to fear of sin; fear of sin leads to holiness; holiness leads to the Holy Spirit (Ruach HaKodesh); and the Holy Spirit leads to the Resurrection of the Dead—and humility is greatest of them all.'

[849] **Ketubot 111b**: 'Rabbi Yoḥanan said to Rabbi Elazar: Their master, i.e. God, is not pleased that you say this of ordinary Jews. Rather, that verse is written about one who weakens himself and succumbs to idol worship. Those who commit this great sin do not merit to be resurrected in the future. Rabbi Elazar said to him: I teach it from a different verse, as it is written: "For Your dew is as the dew of light, and the earth shall bring to life the shades" (Isaiah 26:19). Rabbi Elazar explains: Anyone who uses the light of Torah, which is called the dew of light, the light of Torah will revive him; and anyone who does not use the light of Torah, the light of Torah will not revive him.'

[850] **Tikkunei Zohar 38a:2-42a:6**: 'And come see: the Lower Shekhinah, when She is irrigated from the vowel-points, is called ḥireq, ḥolem, shureq. For whom? For that channel, which is Vav, which includes six channels, for they are all from six letters, which are A-B-G-Y-T-Tz etc. There are six channels that suspend from it, and it includes six others. And they all add up to 42. She is called ḥireq, ḥolem, shureq of that channel, like this: .'

introduction) it brings the phrasing: ,"כָּל הָעוֹסֵק בְּטַל תּוֹרָה, טַל תּוֹרָה מְחַיֶּיהוּ" — **"Whoever toils in the dew of Torah, the dew of Torah revives him",** (שַׁבָּת וְהוּא הַטַּל שֶׁעָתִיד הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא לְהַחֲיוֹת בּוֹ אֶת הַמֵּתִים שֶׁנִּזְכַּר בַּגְּמָרָא פ״ח עַמּוּד ב׳)[851] — **and it is the dew with which the Holy One is destined to revive the dead mentioned in the Gemara (Shabbat 88b),** ,וּבַזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ קוֹרֵא אוֹתוֹ "טַלָּא דְּעַתִּיקָא" — **and in the Holy Zohar it is called the "dew of the Ancient One" (tala de-atika),** ,וְהוּא גַּם כֵּן לְמֻכָּוָן זֶה — **and it points to this exact concept:** דְּשֹׁרֶשׁ הַתּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה בָּא מֵהַשְׁפָּעַת טַלָּא דְּעַתִּיקָא שֶׁמַּשְׁפִּיעִין לְלֵב הַחֲכָמִים מִשָּׁם; — **for the root of the Oral Torah derives from the bestowal of the dew of the Ancient One channeled into the heart of the Sages from there;** וְהוּא שֶׁהוּא אוֹר תּוֹרָה, הַיְנוּ אוֹר תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה, — **and it is the light of Torah, meaning the light of the Oral Torah,** אוֹר שֶׁנִּבְרָא בְּיוֹם רִאשׁוֹן שֶׁגְּנָזוֹ הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא לְעַמְלֵי תוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה, כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב (תַּנְחוּמָא נֹחַ ג׳)[852]; — **which is the light created on the first day hidden by the Holy One for toilers in the Oral Torah (Tanchuma Noach 3);** וְאֵלִיָּהוּ יִהְיֶה הַמְגַלֶּה כָּל עָמְקֵי תוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה, — **and Elijah will be the revealer of all the depths of the Oral Torah,** (מְנָחוֹת מ״ה עַמּוּד א׳): "פָּרָשָׁה זוֹ אֵלִיָּהוּ עָתִיד לְדוֹרְשָׁהּ"[853] — **as we find (Menachot 45a): "This passage Elijah is destined to expound",** ,וְכֵן בְּכַמָּה דּוּכְתֵּי: "לִכְשֶׁיָּבֹא אֵלִיָּהוּ" — **and in numerous places: "When Elijah comes",** וְעַל כֵּן יִהְיֶה תְּחִיַּת הַמֵּתִים עַל יְדֵי אֵלִיָּהוּ זָכוּר לַטּוֹב. — **and therefore the Resurrection of the Dead will take place through Elijah, remembered for good.** וּבְפִסְיקְתָא אַחֶרֶת (פָּרָשָׁה ח׳) אִיתָא: "וּשְׁנַיִם זֵיתִים — **And in another Pesikta (Parashah 8) it states: –** ,"אֵלּוּ שְׁנֵי הַמְּשִׁיחִים וְכוּלֵיהּ — **"'And two olive trees upon it' — these are the two Messiahs, etc.",** וְהַמְּכֻנָּן גַּם כֵּן שֶׁאָז יִתְגַּלֶּה עִקַּר שֹׁרֶשׁ תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה עַל יְדֵי אֵלִיָּהוּ, — **and the meaning likewise is that then the root of the Oral Torah will be revealed through Elijah,** וְהֵם הַמְּשִׁיחִים, הַזֵּיתִים הַמַּשְׁקִים לְכְנֶסֶת יִשְׂרָאֵל, — **and they are the anointed leaders, the olive trees that irrigate Knesset Yisrael,** וּמְאִירִים בָּאוֹר הָרִאשׁוֹן שֶׁהוּא אוֹר תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה. — **illuminating with the Primordial Light which is the light of the Oral Torah.** וְכֵן אִיתָא בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ (חֶלֶק א׳ קל״א עַמּוּד א׳) שֶׁתְּחִיַּת הַמֵּתִים יִהְיֶה עַל יְדֵי אוֹר הַגָּנוּז: דְּאָמַר: "טוֹב[855] — **And so it states in the Holy Zohar (Part I, 131a) that the Resurrection of the Dead will occur through the Hidden Light: –** ,דָּא תְּחִיַּת הַמֵּתִים" — **where it states: "'Good' — this is the Resurrection of the Dead,** וְיִתְנַהִיר הַהוּא נְהוֹרָא דִּזְמִין לְאַנָּהָרָא לְהוּ לְצַדִּיקַיָּא וְכוּלֵיהּ, — **and that light destined to shine for the righteous will radiate, etc.,** וּכְדֵין זַמִּין קוּדְשָׁא בְּרִיךְ הוּא לְאַחֲיָאָה מֵתַיָּא וְכוּלֵיהּ", — **and then the Holy One, Blessed be He, is destined to revive the dead, etc.",** וּמַיְתֵי קְרָא דִּכְתִיב: "וְזָרְחָה לָכֶם וְגוֹמֵר", — **and cites the verse where it is written: "And there shall arise for you, etc.",** ,וְהוּא דִּכְתִיב: "וּמַרְפֵּא בִּכְנָפֶיהָ" — **and that is what is written: "with healing in its wings",** (בְּרֵאשִׁית רַבָּה פָּרָשָׁה י׳): "וּמַחַץ מַכָּתוֹ וּמְפָרֵשׁ עַל דֶּרֶךְ מַה שֶּׁדָּרְשׁוּ מַחַץ מַכַּת עוֹלָם יִרְפָּא'"[856] — **explaining after the manner expounded (Bereishit Rabbah, Parashah 10): –** ,יִרְפָּא" — **"'And heals the stroke of their wound' — the cosmic stroke of the world's wound He shall**

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[851] **Shabbat 88b:6**: "Rabbi Yehoshua ben Levi also said: With every utterance that came from the mouth of the Holy One, blessed be He, Israel's souls departed, as it says, 'My soul departed when He spoke.' Since their souls departed at the first utterance, how did they receive the second? He brought down the dew with which He will revive the dead in the future and revived them, as it says, 'You showered a rain of generosity, God; when Your inheritance was weary, You established it.' Rabbi Yehoshua ben Levi also said: With every utterance that came from the mouth of the Holy One, blessed be He, Israel recoiled twelve mil, and the ministering angels helped them walk back, as it says, 'The angels of hosts yiddodun, yiddodun.' Do not read yiddodun, 'they flee,' but yedaddun, 'they help others walk.'"

[852] **Midrash Tanchuma, Noach 3:3**: "Our sages, of blessed memory, stated that the Holy One, blessed be He, did not write in the Torah "For the sake of these words," or "because of these," or "on account of these words," but simply according to the tenor of (al pi) these words. This statement clearly alludes to the Oral Law (torah she be-'al peh), which is difficult to learn and in the learning of which there is considerable anguish, comparable to darkness itself, as it is said: The people that walk in darkness have seen a great light (Isa. 9:1). The people referred to in this verse are the masters of the Talmud, who beheld a great light when the Holy One, blessed be He, enlightened them as to what is prohibited and permitted, pure and impure. It is said of them that They that love Him shall be as the sun when it goeth forth in its might (Judg. 5:31)."

[853] **Menachot 45a**: "'Thus says the Lord God: In the first month, on the first of the month, you shall take an unblemished young bull and purify the Sanctuary.' A sin-offering? But it is a burnt-offering! Rabbi Yochanan said: Eliyahu will in the future expound this passage."

[854] **Pesikta Rabbati 8:4**: 'And two olive trees by it, one upon the right side of the bowl, and the other upon the left side thereof' (Zechariah 4:3): These are the two anointed ones—Messiah son of David and Messiah son of Ephraim (or Aaron the High Priest and David the King)—who stand before the Lord of the whole earth and channel the supernal oil of Torah and redemption.'

[855] **Zohar, Chayei Sara 19:205-214**: 'Observe that it has been laid down that the dead of the Land of Israel will be the first to rise, and of them it is written, "Thy dead shall live" (Ibid. 26, 19). On the other hand, the words "my dead bodies shall arise" (Ibid.) allude to the dead of other lands, since instead of "shall live" it says "snall arise". The living spirit, in fact, will only infuse the bodies in tne Land of Israel. "Thy dead", then, "shall live". But the other dead bodies will rise without the spirit of life, and only after they shall have rolled themselves underground and reached the Land of Israel will they receive souls-only there, but not in other realms-so that they may be really resurrected.''

[856] **Bereshit Rabbah 10:4** (excerpt): "But in the future, the Holy One, blessed be He, will heal that wound, as it is written, 'He will heal the wound of its stroke' (Isaiah 30:26): He will heal the wound of the world's stroke."

heal", וְהוּא הַמַּכָּה שֶׁגָּרַם פְּגַם הַנָּחָשׁ לָעוֹלָם; **— which is the wound caused to the universe by the contamination of the serpent;** וְכֵן "מַרְפֵּא בִּכְנָפֶיהָ" מְרַמֵּז עַל תְּחִיַּת הַמֵּתִים, **— and likewise "healing in its wings" alludes to the Resurrection of the Dead,** וְזֶה יִהְיֶה עַל יְדֵי הִתְגַּלּוּת אוֹר שֶׁנִּבְרָא בְּיוֹם רִאשׁוֹן, **— and this will be through the revelation of the light created on the first day,** וְהוּא אוֹר תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה, טַל תּוֹרָה. **— which is the light of the Oral Torah, the dew of Torah.**

וְזֶה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר (שָׁם פָּרָשָׁה ב'): "'וְרוּחַ אֱלֹהִים מְרַחֶפֶת עַל פְּנֵי הַמָּיִם' זֶה רוּחוֹ שֶׁל מָשִׁיחַ":[857] **— – And this is what is stated (ibid., Parashah 2): "'And the spirit of God hovered over the face of the waters' — this is the spirit of the Messiah":** וְהֵיכָן בְּמַאֲמָר רִאשׁוֹן שֶׁהוּא נֶעְלָם מִכָּל רַעְיוֹן וְלֹא כְּתִיב בּוֹ "וַיֹּאמֶר", בְּבְחִינַת "יָשֶׁת חֹשֶׁךְ סִתְרוֹ", **— meaning in the first utterance which is hidden from all conception and lacks "And He said", in the realm of "He made darkness His secret place",** כְּבָר נִזְכַּר רוּחוֹ שֶׁל מָשִׁיחַ עַל פְּנֵי הַמַּיִם בִּזְכוּת הַתְּשׁוּבָה שֶׁנִּמְשְׁלָה כְּמַיִם וְכוּלֵי; **— the spirit of Messiah was already mentioned hovering over the waters in the merit of repentance which is likened to water, etc.;** וְהֵיכָן שֶׁמָּשִׁיחַ יַחֲזִיר הַכֹּל בִּתְשׁוּבָה, **— meaning that the Messiah will bring all back in repentance,** וְיִתְתַּקֵּן מַעֲשֵׂיהֶם שֶׁל רְשָׁעִים הַנִּרְמָז בְּ"תֹהוּ וָבֹהוּ"; **— and the deeds of the wicked alluded to in "unformed and void" will be rectified;** וְזֶה יִהְיֶה עַל יְדֵי הִתְגַּלּוּת תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה שֶׁיִּתְגַּלֶּה עַל יְדֵי אֵלִיָּהוּ, **— and this will occur through the revelation of the Oral Torah brought forth by Elijah,** וְזֶהוּ בְּחִינַת תְּחִיַּת הַמֵּתִים שֶׁיִּהְיֶה עַל יְדֵי אֵלִיָּהוּ. **— and this is the aspect of the Resurrection of the Dead to be wrought through Elijah.** וְזֶה שֶׁסִּיכוּת עִנְיַן אֵלִיָּהוּ וּמִזְבֵּחַ שֶׁבָּנָה לַחֲנֻכָּה: **— And this is the deep connection of Elijah and the altar he built to Chanukah:** דְּאִיתָא בַּפְּסִיקְתָא (פָּרָשָׁה ב' סִימָן ב')[858] שֶׁחִשֵּׁב שֶׁבַע חֲנֻכּוֹת, כָּתַב: "וַחֲנֻכַּת הַכֹּהֲנִים זוֹ שֶׁאָנוּ מַדְלִיקִין"; **— for it states in the Pesikta (Parashah 2, Section 2) which enumerates seven historical dedications, – writing: "And the dedication of the priests — this is the one we kindle";** וְכֵן אַחַר כָּךְ (שָׁם סִימָן ז') שֶׁחִשֵּׁב עוֹד הַפַּעַם הַשֶּׁבַע חֲנֻכּוֹת, כָּתַב הַלָּשׁוֹן:[859] **— and likewise afterward (ibid., Section 7) enumerating again the seven dedications, it uses the language:** "זוֹ שֶׁל עַכְשָׁו שֶׁל בֵּית חַשְׁמוֹנַאי", עַיֵּן שָׁם; **— "and this one of the present era of the House of Hasmoneus", see there;** וּכְבָר דִּקְדַּקְנוּ: מַה שֶּׁלֹּא אָמַר הַלָּשׁוֹן "וַחֲנֻכָּה שֶׁעָשׂוּ הַחַשְׁמוֹנָאִים אָז בִּזְמַן הַגֵּס"? **— and we already analyzed: why did it not say "and the dedication that the Hasmoneans performed then during the miracle"?**

The renewed sanctuary is built through Torah in the heart

רַק הָעִנְיָן הוּא: שֶׁבְּכָל דּוֹר וָדוֹר יֵשׁ חֲנֻכָּה זוֹ[860, 861] **— Rather the truth is: that in each and every generation this**

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[857] **Bereshit Rabbah 2:4** (excerpt): "'The spirit of God hovered'—this is the spirit of King Messiah, as it says, 'The spirit of Hashem shall rest upon him' (Isaiah 11:2). Through what merit does it approach and come? 'Hovering upon the face of the waters'—through the merit of repentance, which is likened to water, as it says, 'Pour out your heart like water' (Lamentations 2:19)."

[858] **Pesikta Rabbati 2:2**: 'In Pesikta Rabbati (Piska 2:2), the Midrash enumerates seven historical dedications (chanukkot) —beginning with the dedication of heaven and earth ('And the heaven and the earth were finished'), the dedication of the Tabernacle, the First and Second Temples, the future Temple, and the dedication of the Hasmonean priests: 'And the dedication of the priests—this is the one in which we kindle the Chanukah lights.''

[859] **Pesikta Rabbati 2:7**: 'Enumerating the seven dedications, the Pesikta states: 'And this dedication of the present era of the House of Hasmoneus (Beit Chashmonai), in which Israel kindles lights across the generations—because the Holy One, blessed be He, wrought salvation through His priests, its light never ceases.''

[860] **Tiferet Yosef, Talmud Anthology, Sukkah 1**: "God established that the bond of His light with creation should occur through human understanding. Everything in this world therefore had to come through contractions and limits within which a person can grasp and understand. All the Torah's mitzvot enter the limits of world, year, and soul—that is, place, time, and person. Because they are bounded within this world, a person can grasp and know them: "You labored and found," and "Labor and eat." Thus, "Make Me a sanctuary, and I shall dwell among them": Israel clears a place in the heart for the Divine Presence. The more space a person clears for its light, the more His light rests there. A person can labor within these limits and bring them into his understanding, because they are finite and the person too is finite. Accordingly, the reward God promised His creatures for their service should seemingly also be bounded, matching the bounded action. In truth, however, the reward God gives Israel for their service is not bounded or finite. Since He gives the person from Himself, the Infinite, without limit or end, His reward too has no limit or end."
Tiferet Yosef explains how a limited human heart can become a dwelling for divine light. Concrete, bounded mitzvot give the person a place to work and clear room, while the light received is a gift beyond the measure of that work. This gives substance to the Chanukah discourse's daily inner dedication without treating a passing feeling as an already completed sanctuary.

[861] **Peri Tzadik, Terumah 2:2**: "Rashi explains in the first chapter of Avot, concerning "Acquire a companion for yourself," that some say this means books. The intention is not that one should buy the Five Books of Torah, for Written Torah was sufficient only before the damage, as the Sages said: had Israel not sinned, only the Five Books of Torah would have been given to them. After the damage, however, the abundant anger must specifically be repaired through abundant wisdom, which is Oral Torah. This is hinted at in "every man whose heart moves him"—one whom God desires—meaning the sages of each generation. One must acquire the books of the tannaim and also those of the righteous of every generation, known to those who pursue righteousness and seek God, who composed books of new

dedication recurs, שֶׁהַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ עוֹשֶׂה לוֹ דִּירָה בְּלֵב יִשְׂרָאֵל, שֶׁנַּעֲשֶׂה מִשְׁכָּן לַשְּׁכִינָה, **— in that the Blessed Name makes for Himself a dwelling in the heart of Israel, becoming a sanctuary for the Shechinah,** וְעַל זֶה עוֹשִׂין חֲנֻכָּה בְּכָל יוֹם עַל חֲנֻכַּת הַשְּׁרָאַת הַשְּׁכִינָה בְּלֵב בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל, **— and for this we celebrate a dedication daily over the inauguration of the Shechinah's resting in the heart of the Jewish people,** וְנִקְרָא עַל שֵׁם הַכֹּהֲנִים הַחַשְׁמוֹנָאִים שֶׁהֵם פָּעֲלוּ זֹאת שֶׁיִּתְגַּלֶּה אוֹר תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה בְּלֵב יִשְׂרָאֵל. **— and it is named after the Hasmonean priests because they effected this that the light of the Oral Torah be revealed in the Jewish heart.** וְזֶה הַנֵּר חֲנֻכָּה שֶׁהַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ כְּבָיְכוֹל מַדְלִיק, **— And this is the Chanukah light which the Blessed Name kindles as it were,** שֶׁמַּאִיר בְּלֵב יִשְׂרָאֵל וּמְקַיֵּם מִצְוַת זְקֵנִים (כְּמוֹ שֶׁנִּתְבָּאֵר מַאֲמָר ב');[862] **— illuminating within the heart of Israel and fulfilling the commandment of the elders (as explained in discourse 2);** וְהוּא כֹּחַ אַהֲרֹן שֶׁהוּא שֹׁרֶשׁ תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה, כְּמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: "וְהָיָה הוּא יִהְיֶה לְךָ לְפֶה", **— and this is the power of Aaron who is the root of the Oral Torah, as stated: "And he shall be to you as a mouth",** שֶׁמּשֶׁה רַבֵּנוּ הוֹרִיד הַתּוֹרָה שֶׁבִּכְתָב חֲמִשָּׁה חֻמְשֵׁי תּוֹרָה שֶׁפְּנָנְדָן כְּתִיב חָמֵשׁ פְּעָמִים אוֹרָה בְּמַאֲמַר "יְהִי אוֹר"; וְאַהֲרֹן שֶׁהוּא אוֹר הָרִאשׁוֹן שֶׁגְּנָנוֹ לְעַמְלֵי תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה, **— for Moses our Teacher brought down the Written Torah, the Five Books of the Torah, corresponding to which light is mentioned five times in the utterance "Let there be light"; – and Aaron is "as a mouth", the root of the Oral Torah, which is the Primordial Light concealed for those who toil in the Oral Torah,** וְעַל זֶה נֶאֱמַר: "כִּי שִׂפְתֵי כֹהֵן יִשְׁמְרוּ דַּעַת וְגוֹמֵר", **— and on this it is said: "For the priest's lips shall guard knowledge, etc.",** דַּעַת הוּא פְּנִימִיּוּת הַכֶּתֶר כַּיָּדוּעַ, "וְתוֹרָה יְבַקְשׁוּ מִפִּיהוּ", **— Da'at being the inner dimension of Keter, "and they shall seek Torah from his mouth";** וְזֶה כֹּחוֹ שֶׁל אַהֲרֹן בְּהַדְלָקַת הַמְנוֹרָה שֶׁאָמַר לוֹ הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא: "לִגְדוֹלָה מִזּוּ אַתָּה מְתֻקָּן וְכוּלֵיה, הַנֵּרוֹת לְעוֹלָם", **— and this is Aaron's power in kindling the Menorah of which the Holy One told him: "For greater than this are you prepared, etc., the lights are forever",** וּפֵרֵשׁ הָרַמְבַּ"ן דְּקָאֵי עַל נֵרוֹת חֲנֻכָּה, **— and the Ramban explained that this refers to the Chanukah lights;** וְהַיְנוּ שֶׁבְּכָל יוֹם מִתְגַּלֶּה חֲנֻכָּה חֲדָשָׁה בְּלֵב יִשְׂרָאֵל שֶׁהַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ עוֹשֶׂה לוֹ דִּירָה בְּלִבָּם. **— meaning that each day a new dedication is revealed in the heart of Israel, the Blessed Name making a dwelling in their hearts.** וְנֵרוֹת הַמִּקְדָּשׁ וְנֵרוֹת חֲנֻכָּה וְכֵן נֵר שַׁבָּת, כֻּלָּם מוֹרֶה עַל אוֹר תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה (וְנִתְבָּאֵר כַּמָּה פְּעָמִים);[863] **— And the Temple lamps, the Chanukah lights, and the Shabbat candle all indicate the light of the Oral Torah (as explained often);** וְלֶעָתִיד יִתְגַּלֶּה גַּם כֵּן מֹשֶׁה רַבֵּנוּ כְּמוֹ שֶׁנִּרְמַז: "מַה שֶּׁהָיָה הוּא שֶׁיִּהְיֶה", **— and in the Future Moses our Teacher will likewise be revealed, as alluded to: "That which was is that which shall be" the initials of Mah SheHayah Hu spell Moshe** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב זֹהַר חֵלֶק ג' רע"ו עַמּוּד ב');[864] **— (as written in Zohar Part III, 276b);** דְּאִיהִי אוֹרַיְתָא דִּבְעַל פֶּה, וְאָז אֵלִיָּהוּ יִהְיֶה לוֹ לְפֶה, **— and then Elijah will serve as a mouth for him,** כִּנְגִינָא דְּאִתְמַר בְּאַהֲרֹן: "הוּא יִהְיֶה לְךָ לְפֶה", **— which is the Oral Torah in the manner stated regarding Aaron: "He shall be to you as a mouth",** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב (שָׁם כ"ח רֵישׁ עַמּוּד א');[865] **— and as written (ibid. 28a top);** וְהַיְנוּ כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמַרְנוּ לְמַעְלָה שֶׁאָז יִהְיֶה אֵלִיָּהוּ שֹׁרֶשׁ תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה, **— meaning as we explained above that then Elijah will be the channel of the Oral Torah,** שֶׁיְּגַלֶּה כָּל עֹמֶק וְסֵתְרֵי תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה וְיִתְקֵן כָּל הַסְּפֵקוֹת, **— revealing all depth and secrets of the Oral Torah and clarifying all doubts,** וְעַל יְדֵי כֵן יִתְקֵן כָּל מַעֲשֵׂי יִשְׂרָאֵל שֶׁיְּחָזְרוּם בִּתְשׁוּבָה, **— and through this will rectify all actions of Israel, bringing them back in repentance,** וְעַל יְדֵי זֶה יִשְׁכֹּן הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ בְּלֵב יִשְׂרָאֵל. **— and thereby the Blessed Name will dwell in the heart of Israel.** וְעַל יְדֵי הַמִּזְבֵּחַ שֶׁבָּנָה בְּהַר הַכַּרְמֶל חִדֵּשׁ אֵלִיָּהוּ: **— And through the altar which he built on Mount Carmel Elijah innovated:** שֶׁאַף שֶׁאֵינוֹ בְּמָקוֹם הַמִּקְדָּשׁ, מִכָּל מָקוֹם יוּכְלוּ יִשְׂרָאֵל לִזְכּוֹת לְהִתְגַּלּוּת זֶה, **— that even when outside the physical Temple site,**

Torah teachings that are the words of the living God. “From them take My offering”: from them, or from their writing, the holy books issuing from their mouths, learn to love and fear God and to attain the resting of the Divine Presence below.”

Terumah identifies how the continuing sanctuary is built: the developing Oral Torah addresses the damaged heart through added wisdom, love, and awe. Learning from the sages’ living teaching and writings therefore has a concrete role in the daily dedication described in Chanukah. This is more than a symbolic resemblance between a book and a building.

[862] **Shabbat 23a:7**: “What blessing does one recite? One blesses: ‘Who has sanctified us with His commandments and commanded us to kindle the Chanukah lamp.’ Where did He command us? Rav Avya said: In ‘You shall not turn aside’ from the Sages’ ruling. Rav Nechemyah said: ‘Ask your father and he will tell you; your elders, and they will say to you.’”

[863] **Proverbs 6:23**: ‘For the commandment is a lamp,The teaching is a light,And the way to life is the rebuke that disciplines.’

[864] **Zohar, Ki Teitzei 1:14-24**: ‘In the Zohar (Ki Teitzei, Ra’aya Meheimna III 276b), the verse ‘That which has been is that which shall be’ is expounded by its initials , which spell Moshe —teaching that the soul of Moses, who redeemed Israel first and gave the Torah, will again be revealed in the final redemption.’

[865] **Zohar, Bereshit 28a**: ‘In the Zohar (Bereshit I 28a, Tikkunei Zohar), Aaron and Elijah represent the living conduit of the Oral Torah—in the manner of ‘He shall be to you as a mouth’ (Exodus 4:16)—resolving all doubts and revealing the inner harmony of the Torah.’

Israel can merit such divine revelation, שֶׁיְּזַכּוּ לְיִחוּד בְּאֹרַח פְּרָט: "יהו"ה הוּא הָאֱלֹהִים". **— meriting the individualized unification: "Hashem, He is God".** וְכֵן בַּחֲנֻכָּה נַעֲשָׂה חֲנֻכָּה בְּכָל יוֹם, חֲנֻכַּת הַבַּיִת, שֶׁהַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ שׁוֹכֵן בְּלֵב יִשְׂרָאֵל; **— And so on Chanukah a dedication occurs daily, an inauguration of the House, as God dwells in the Jewish heart;** וְלָכֵן בַּחֲנֻכָּה הַזְּמַן לִזְכוֹת לַעֲשׂוֹת תְּשׁוּבָה עִלָּאָה, **— and therefore on Chanukah is the auspicious time to merit higher repentance (teshuvah ila'ah),** "אִם יִהְיוּ חַטֹּאֵיכֶם וְכוּלַּי כַּשָּׁלֶג יַלְבִּינוּ", **— "Though your sins be like scarlet, they shall become white as snow",** שֶׁיִּהְיֶא הַכֹּל נַעֲשׂוֹת כִּזְכֻיּוֹת וְכָאָמוּר; **— transforming all transgressions into merits as stated;** וְזֶה שֹׁרֶשׁ הַחַיִּים שֶׁזּוֹכִין עַל יְדֵי אֵלְיָהוּ כָּאָמוּר. **— and this is the fountain of eternal life merited through Elijah as stated.**

וְזֶה הָעִנְיָן שֶׁמָּצִינוּ בַּגְּמָרָא (מְגִלָּה כ״ז עַמּוּד ב׳, כ״ח עַמּוּד א׳) דְּקָא חָשֵׁב: "בְּמֶה הָאֲרַכְתָּ יָמִים?", [866] **— And this is the meaning of what we find in the Gemara (Megillah 27b, 28a) where it asks: "Through what did you merit longevity?",** וְחָשֵׁב שָׁם מִילֵּי דַּחֲסִידוּת וְלֹא דִּבְרֵי חִיּוּב מִן הַדִּין, עַיֵּן שָׁם. **— and enumerates there acts of pious stringency (millei de-chasidut) and not baseline halachic obligations, see there.** וְאָמַרְנוּ דְּבָאֱמֶת אָמְרוּ (מוֹעֵד קָטָן כ״ח עַמּוּד א׳): [867] **— And we explained that in truth they said (Moed Katan 28a):** "חַיֵּי וְכוּלֵּיהּ לָאו בִּזְכוּתָא תַּלְיָא מִלְּתָא אֶלָּא בְּמַזָּלָא תַּלְיָא מִלְּתָא", **— "Life, etc., depends not upon merit but upon heavenly fortune (mazala)",** וְהוּא מִטַּעַם דְּשָׂכַר מִצְוֹת בְּהַאי עָלְמָא לֵיכָּא (קִדּוּשִׁין ל״ט עַמּוּד א׳); [868] **— and that is because reward for mitzvot does not exist in this physical world (Kiddushin 39a);** אֲמָנָם זֶהוּ רַק שְׂכַר הַמִּצְוָה שֶׁעוֹשֶׂה מִצַּד הַחִיּוּב, **— however, that applies only to the reward of a mitzvah performed out of baseline duty,** אֲבָל מַה שֶּׁעוֹשֶׂה לְפָנִים מִשּׁוּרַת הַדִּין יִפְרַע לוֹ הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא בְּחַיָּיו, **— whereas what one performs beyond the letter of the law the Holy One rewards him in his lifetime,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁפֵּרֵשׁ רַבִּי שְׁלֹמֹה יִצְחָקִי (בָּבָא קַמָּא ט׳ עַמּוּד ב׳) עַל מַה שֶּׁכָּתוּב: "עַד שֶׁיִּפְרַע לוֹ הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא שְׁלִישׁ מִשֶּׁלּוֹ, מִכָּאן וְאֵילָךְ שֶׁל הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא". [869] **— and as Rashi explained (Bava Kamma 9b) – on the statement: "Up to a third is his own, beyond that belongs to the Holy One" — that the Holy One repays him in his lifetime.**

Prepared piety makes inspiration an enduring acquisition

וְזֶה שֶׁחָשַׁב מִילֵּי דַּחֲסִידוּת, שֶׁעַל יְדֵי כֵן זָכוּ לַאֲרִיכוּת יָמִים. [870] **— And this explains why it listed pious stringencies, for through them they merited longevity.** וּלְפִי הָאָמוּר הוּא מַה שֶּׁכָּתוּב: "חֲסִידוּת מְבִיאָה לִידֵי רוּחַ הַקֹּדֶשׁ, וְרוּחַ הַקֹּדֶשׁ לִתְחִיַּת הַמֵּתִים", **— And according to this, it explains the sequence: "Piety leads to Divine Inspiration, and Divine Inspiration to Resurrection",** דִּכְתִיב: "וְנָתַתִּי רוּחִי בָּכֶם וְחְיִיתֶם" כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בַּיְרוּשַׁלְמִי, **— as it is written: "And I will put My Spirit in you and you shall live", as stated in the Yerushalmi;** וְהַיְנוּ דְּעַל יְדֵי הַחֲסִידוּת וּכְתִיב: "וְנָתַתִּי רוּחִי בָּכֶם", "רוּחִי" דַּוְקָא, זוֹכֶה לְחַיִּים. **— meaning that through pious devotion one merits true life.** וְהַיְנוּ כְּמוֹ שֶׁחָשַׁב בַּפָּסוּק: **— And it is written: "And I will put My Spirit in you", "My Spirit" specifically,** "וְנָתָה וְגוֹמֵר רוּחַ הַשֵּׁם וְגוֹמֵר רוּחַ דַּעַת וְיִרְאַת הַשֵּׁם", **— which aligns with the verse: "And there shall rest, etc., the spirit of Hashem, etc., a spirit of knowledge and fear of Hashem",** וְהַיְנוּ כְּשֶׁיְּזַכֶּה לִבְחִינַת הַדַּעַת,

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[866] **Megillah 27b:23**: "Rabbi Elazar ben Shammua's students asked him, 'Through what merit have you lived so long?' He told them, 'In all my days I have never used a synagogue as a shortcut; I have never stepped over the heads of the holy people to reach my place; and I have never raised my hands for the priestly blessing without first reciting its blessing.'"

[867] **Moed Katan 28a:13-15**: "Rava said: Life, children, and sustenance depend not upon merit but upon mazal, one's allotted destiny. For Rabbah and Rav Chisda were both righteous Sages: One would pray and rain would come, and the other would pray and rain would come. Rav Chisda lived ninety-two years; Rabbah lived forty. In Rav Chisda's household there were sixty wedding celebrations; in Rabbah's household, sixty bereavements. In Rav Chisda's household there was fine flour for the dogs, and it was not needed; in Rabbah's household, even barley bread for people could not be found."

[868] **Kiddushin 39b:6**: "Abaye said: Our Mishnah speaks of preparing for a person a good day and a bad day: adversity here and goodness in the World to Come. Rava said: Whose view is this teaching? It is Rabbi Yaakov's, for he says that the reward for a mitzvah is not given in this world."

[869] **Bava Kamma 9b:2-4**: "Rather, Rabbi Zeira said: For the embellishment of a mitzvah, one should spend up to an additional third of the mitzvah's cost. Rav Ashi asked: Is that third calculated from within the original price, or from outside it, as a third of the final total? The question remains unresolved. In the Land of Israel they said in Rabbi Zeira's name: Up to a third is at one's own expense; beyond that is at the expense of the Holy One, blessed be He."

[870] **Tiferet Yosef, Talmud Anthology, Megillah 3**: "There is a Holy Spirit that comes through human preparation: a person prepares and sets boundaries for himself for the sake of God's will, and through this attains the Holy Spirit. Thus the Midrash says, "Zeal brings to cleanliness ... piety brings to the Holy Spirit." Through preparing himself with all the preparations the Midrash enumerates, he attains the Holy Spirit. This Holy Spirit is called prophecy needed for the generations, for since it came through human preparation, it remains established for the whole world."
Tiferet Yosef explains why the preparation leading through piety matters: it makes the received illumination enduring. His full paragraph distinguishes this from a temporary inspiration bestowed without that preparation. This illuminates the lasting acquisition in Chanukah's piety–spirit–life progression; it does not supply an independent promise of a particular number of earthly years.

meaning when one merits the dimension of Da'at; וּכְעִנְיַן מַה שֶּׁנֶּאֱמַר: "אָז תָּבִין יִרְאַת ה' וְדַעַת אֱלֹהִים תִּמְצָא", **and similar to Scripture: "Then shall you understand the fear of Hashem and find the knowledge of God",** וְהוּא כְּשֶׁנִּכְנָס הַיִּרְאָה לְמַעֲמַקֵּי הַלֵּב שֶׁעַל זֶה מוֹרֶה "בִּינָה לִבָּא", **which occurs when awe penetrates the depths of the heart denoted by "Binah is the heart",** שֶׁנִּכְנָס הַיִּרְאָה לְבִחִינַת נְקֻדָּה שֶׁבַּלֵּב, אָז זוֹכֶה לִבְחִינַת הַדַּעַת **— where awe enters the central point of the heart, then meriting Da'at which is the inner aspect of Keter.** שֶׁהוּא פְּנִימִיּוּת הַכֶּתֶר כַּיָּדוּעַ.

And "Ruach HaKodesh", meaning a spirit from that Holiness Above (Zohar Part III, 61a), [871] — "רוּחַ הַקֹּדֶשׁ", כְּלוֹמַר רוּחַ מֵהַהוּא קֹדֶשׁ דִּלְעֵילָּא (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב זֹהַר חֵלֶק ג' ס"א עַמּוּד א'), וְהַיְנוּ חָכְמָה **— which is Supernal Chochmah received from the Hidden Light,** מְקוּבָּצָא דְּיוֹ"ד עִלָּאָה כְּמוֹ שֶׁמְּקַבֵּל מֵאוֹר הַגָּנוּז, **— from the upper tip of the yud alluding to Keter Elyon as is known;** וְזֶה דִּלְעֵילָּא דְּרָמִיזָא לְכֶתֶר עֶלְיוֹן כַּיָּדוּעַ; **and this is: "And I will put My Spirit in you and you shall live",** שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: "וְנָתַתִּי רוּחִי בָּכֶם וִחְיִיתֶם", **— for through this one merits eternal life, since the Resurrection operates via the radiance of the Hidden Light.** כֵּן זוֹכֶה לְחַיֵּי עוֹלָם, שֶׁכֵּן תְּחִיַּת הַמֵּתִים עַל יְדֵי נְהִירוּ דְּאוֹר הַגָּנוּז.

— And this is what is written in the holy books: that Chanukah is the completion of Rosh Hashanah, וְזֶה שֶׁכָּתוּב בַּסְּפָרִים: דַּחֲנֻכָּה הַהַשְׁלָמָה מֵרֹאשׁ הַשָּׁנָה, **— for on Rosh Hashanah the books of life are opened and all supplications are for life,** שֶׁבְּרֹאשׁ הַשָּׁנָה סִפְרֵי חַיִּים פְּתוּחִין וְכָל הַבַּקָּשׁוֹת עַל הַחַיִּים, **— and on Chanukah comes the culmination, in that meriting the Hidden Light for toilers of Oral Torah grants eternal life;** וּבַחֲנֻכָּה הַהַשְׁלָמָה, עַל יְדֵי שֶׁזּוֹכִין לְאוֹר הַגָּנוּז לְעַמְלֵי תּוֹרָה שֶׁבַּעַל פֶּה זוֹכִין לְחַיֵּי עוֹלָם; **— and then is the season when all actions of Israel are rectified through higher repentance,** וְאָז הַזְּמַן שֶׁיִּתְתַּקֵּן כָּל מַעֲשֵׂי יִשְׂרָאֵל עַל יְדֵי תְּשׁוּבָה עִלָּאָה, **— which is the dimension of Resurrection wrought through Elijah.** שֶׁזֶּהוּ בְּחִינַת תְּחִיַּת הַמֵּתִים שֶׁבָּא עַל יְדֵי אֵלִיָּהוּ.

— And there will be "Your head upon you is like Carmel", that the destitute will merit like Elijah who sacrificed outside on Mount Carmel, וְיִהְיֶה "רֹאשֵׁךְ עָלַיִךְ כַּכַּרְמֶל", שֶׁהָרָשִׁים יִזְכּוּ כְּאֵלִיָּהוּ שֶׁהִקְרִיב בַּחוּץ בְּהַר הַכַּרְמֶל, **— when they merited the individualized unification: "Hashem, He is God",** שָׁאָז זָכוּ לְהַיְחוּד בְּאֹרַח פְּרָט: "יהו"ה הוּא הָאֱלֹהִים", **— which one merits purely through the dimension of Da'at, as stated: "And you shall know this day, etc.";** שֶׁזּוֹכִין לָזֶה רַק עַל יְדֵי בְּחִינַת הַדַּעַת כְּמַה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: "וְיָדַעְתָּ הַיּוֹם וְגוֹמֵר" וְכָאָמוּר; **— and through Da'at we merit: "Though your sins be like scarlet, like these years ordered from the Six Days of Creation", as explained.** וְעַל יְדֵי בְּחִינַת הַדַּעַת זוֹכִין "אִם יִהְיוּ חֲטָאֵיכֶם כַּשָּׁנִים הַלָּלוּ שֶׁסְּדוּרוֹת וּבָאוֹת מִשִּׁשֶׁת יְמֵי בְרֵאשִׁית", וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ.

— And the verse "A nation and a company of nations" expounded on Elijah's act on Mount Carmel — וּפָסוּק "גּוֹי וּקְהַל גּוֹיִם" שֶׁדָּרְשׁוּ עַל מַעֲשֵׂה אֵלִיָּהוּ בְּהַר הַכַּרְמֶל **— was said to Jacob our Father before the birth of Benjamin,** נֶאֱמַר לְיַעֲקֹב אָבִינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם קֹדֶם לֵידַת בִּנְיָמִין, (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בְּרֵאשִׁית רַבָּה סוֹף פָּרָשָׁה מִשּׁוּם זֶה מוֹרֶה אֵלִיָּהוּ בָּא מִשֵּׁבֶט בִּנְיָמִין **— because Elijah descends from Benjamin (Bereishit Rabbah, end of Parashah 71);** [872] ע"א); וְאַף דְּיֵשׁ אוֹמְרִים שֶׁבָּא מִשֵּׁבֶט גָּד כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב שָׁם, וְכֵן יֵשׁ **— and although some say he derives from Gad as written there,** אוֹמְרִים שֶׁהוּא כֹּהֵן כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב (בָּבָא מְצִיעָא קי"ד עַמּוּד ב' וְעַיֵּן שָׁם בְּתוֹסְפוֹת), [873] **— and some say he is a priest as written (Bava Metzia 114b and see Tosafot there),** כֹּל אֱמֶת שֶׁהוּא כָּלוּל מִנְּשָׁמוֹת רַבּוֹת כַּיָּדוּעַ מִדִּבְרֵי הָאֲרִיזַ"ל, **— all is truth, for he incorporates many souls as known from the teachings of the Arizal,** וְכָאן נִרְמַז שֹׁרֶשׁ נִשְׁמָתוֹ **— and here was alluded his soul-root from Benjamin.** שֶׁהוּא מִבִּנְיָמִין. וְהִנֵּה בְּפִסְיקְתָא זוֹ אִיתָא: שֶׁהַכֹּל בִּזְכוּת **— And behold in this Pesikta it states: that all is in the merit of the Tribes,** אַף בֵּית הַמִּקְדָּשׁ עָתִיד לְהִבָּנוֹת בִּזְכוּת הַשְּׁבָטִים וְכוּלֵיהּ, **— even the Temple is destined to be rebuilt in the merit of the Tribes, etc.,** עַיֵּן שָׁם; וְהַיְנוּ "אַתְּ מוֹצֵא שְׁנֵים עָשָׂר חֹדֶשׁ בַּשָּׁנָה וְכוּלֵיהּ", **— "you find twelve months in the year, etc.", see there;** דְּשְׁנֵים עָשָׂר שְׁבָטִים שְׁלֵמוּת הַסִּיהֲרָא שֶׁהִיא בְּחִינַת כְּנֶסֶת יִשְׂרָאֵל. **— meaning the twelve tribes represent the fullness of the moon, Knesset Yisrael.** וְכֵן סִדְּרוּ מְפָרְשֵׁי סֵפֶר יְצִירָה הַחֲדָשִׁים לְהַשְׁבָטִים, **— And so the latter**

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[871] **Zohar, Achrei Mot 12:86-14:94**: 'We have learnt in the presence of our Master: What is holiness? The consummation of the whole which is called Supernal Wisdom. From thence issue streams and fountains in all directions till they reach this zoth. And when this zoth is blessed from the supernal place called Holiness and Wisdom, it is called "the spirit of holiness"; and when mysteries of the Torah proceed from it, it is called "the language of holiness".'

[872] **Bereshit Rabbah 71:9** (excerpt): "'Leah said: Gad has come' (Genesis 30:11): The good fortune of the house has come; the good fortune of the world has come. The one who will cut down the foundations of idolaters has come. Who is this? Elijah. From whom did Elijah descend? Rabbi Eliezer said: From Benjamin, as it is written, 'Ya'aresheyah, Elijah, and Zikhri, sons of Yerocham,' and 'all these were of the children of Benjamin' (I Chronicles 8:27, 40). Rabbi Nehorai said: He was from Gad, as it is written, 'Elijah the Tishbite, of the inhabitants of Gilead' (I Kings 17:1). … Once our Sages disagreed about this: some said he was from Gad, and others from Benjamin. Elijah came and stood before them. He said: Our teachers, why do you disagree about me? I am one of Rachel's descendants."

[873] **Bava Metzia 114b**: 'When he was exiting, he heard a voice that declared: Who else consumes his World-to-Come like Rabba bar Avuh, who takes his merit of the next world for his use in the present one? He spread out his cloak and threw away the leaves. Even so, when he brought his cloak back, he discovered that the cloak had absorbed such a good scent from those leaves that he sold it for twelve thousand dinars. Since he knew that this was taken from his portion in the World-to-Come, he did not want to benefit from it himself, and he therefore divided the sum among his sons-in-law.'

commentators on Sefer Yetzirah arranged the tribes, וְהָאֲרִיזַ"ל סִדְּרָן כְּסֵדֶר הַדְּגָלִים, **— and the Arizal arranged them according to the order of the banners,** וְחֹדֶשׁ כִּסְלֵו כְּנֶגֶד בִּנְיָמִין, **— with the month of Kislev corresponding to Benjamin;** וְעַל כֵּן מוֹפִיעַ בְּחֹדֶשׁ כִּסְלֵו גַּם הַחַשְׁמוֹנָאִים שֶׁהוּא גַּם כֵּן חֲנֻכַּת הַבַּיִת, **— and therefore in Kislev shines the miracle of the Hasmoneans which is also the dedication of the Temple,**

Light won through concealment reconnects with the first light

— and this in the merit of the Tribes as written in the Pesikta. – '"וְחֹשֶׁךְ"[874,875] וְזֶהוּ בִּזְכוּת הַשְּׁבָטִים כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בַּפְּסִיקְתָא. וְאִיתָא (בְּרֵאשִׁית רַבָּה פָּרָשָׁה ב׳): **— And it states (Bereishit Rabbah, Parashah 2): "'And darkness' — this is Greece, etc.",**[876] זֶה יָוָן וְכוּלֵיהּ", **— and since it is written afterward "Let there be light",** וְכֵיוָן דִּכְתִיב אַחַר כָּךְ "יְהִי אוֹר", **— meaning that radiant light which emerges out of darkness,** וְהַיְנוּ דְּיִהְיֶה נָהוֹרָא הַהוּא דְּנָפֵק מִגּוֹ חֲשׁוֹכָא, **— this indicates that the light forged through darkness (Greece) is from the Primordial Light.** מוֹרֶה שֶׁהָאוֹר שֶׁנַּעֲשָׂה עַל יְדֵי הַחֹשֶׁךְ שֶׁהוּא יָוָן הוּא מֵהָאוֹר הָרִאשׁוֹן. **— And it states in the Holy Zohar (Part I, 203b):** וְאִיתָא בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ (חֵלֶק א׳ ר״ג עַמּוּד ב׳):[877] **— "'And there shall shine for you, etc., a sun, etc.' —** '"וְזָרְחָה לָכֶם וְגוֹמַר שֶׁמֶשׁ וְגוֹמַר"; **— that sun which the Holy One hid away from the day the world was created, etc.";** הַהוּא שִׁמְשָׁא דִּגְנִיז קוּדְשָׁא בְּרִיךְ הוּא מִיּוֹמָא דְּאִתְבְּרֵי עָלְמָא וְכוּלֵיהּ"; **— and seemingly it is incomprehensible, for behold the sun is present in this physical world?** וְלִכְאוֹרָה אֵינוֹ מוּבָן, דְּהָא הַשֶּׁמֶשׁ הוּא בָּעוֹלָם הַזֶּה? אַךְ בֶּאֱמֶת **— However, the truth is that initially sunlight was created sevenfold as will be in the Future,** הוּא שֶׁמִּתְחִלָּה נִבְרָא אוֹר הַשֶּׁמֶשׁ שִׁבְעָתַיִם כְּמוֹ שֶׁיִּהְיֶה לֶעָתִיד, **— and had sin not occurred it would have remained so;** וְאִם לֹא הָיָה הַפֶּגֶם הָיָה נִשְׁאָר כֵּן. **— only after the fall was the radiant sunlight concealed.** רַק אַחַר הַקִּלְקוּל נִגְנַז אוֹר הַשֶּׁמֶשׁ. **— And the dedication of the World to Come will be in light,** כְּמָה וַחֲנֻכַּת עוֹלָם הַבָּא יִהְיֶה בְּאוֹר, **— as Scripture states: "And the light of the moon shall be, etc., and the light of the sun shall be sevenfold, etc."** שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: "וְהָיָה אוֹר הַלְּבָנָה וְגוֹמֵר וְאוֹר הַחַמָּה יִהְיֶה שִׁבְעָתַיִם וְגוֹמֵר"[878] וּכְמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בַּפְּסִיקְתָא פָּרָשָׁה ב׳), **— (and as written in the Pesikta, Parashah 2),** וְהַיְנוּ שֶׁיִּתְגַּלֶּה אוֹר הָרִאשׁוֹן, וְזֶה יִהְיֶה עַל יְדֵי מְשִׁיחַ. **— meaning that the Primordial Light will be revealed, and this will be wrought through the Messiah.** וְעַל כֵּן קֹדֶם שֶׁנּוֹלַד בִּנְיָמִין שֶׁהוּא גִּמַר הַשְּׁנֵים עָשָׂר שְׁבָטִים, **— And therefore prior to the birth of Benjamin who completed the Twelve Tribes,** נֶאֱמַר לְיַעֲקֹב אָבִינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם: "גּוֹי וּקְהַל גּוֹיִם וְגוֹמֵר", **— it was said to Jacob our Father: "A nation and a company of nations, etc.",** דְּהַיְנוּ: אַף כִּי "אָח עֵשָׂו לְיַעֲקֹב", **— meaning: even though "Esau was brother to Jacob",** וְהוּא כְּשֶׁעוֹשֶׂה יַעֲקֹב חַס וְשָׁלוֹם כְּמַעֲשֵׂה עֵשָׂו, **— which represents when Jacob's seed acts Heaven forbid like the deeds of Esau,** מִכָּל מָקוֹם "וְאֶת יַעֲקֹב אָהַבְתִּי"; **— nevertheless "yet I loved Jacob";** וְיִתְבָּרֵר זֶה עַל יְדֵי מַעֲשֵׂה שֶׁהָיָה בְּעִנְיַן זֶה מִשֹּׁרֶשׁ זַרְעוֹ שֶׁל בִּנְיָמִין, **— and this would be clarified through the act of Elijah,** אֵלִיָּהוּ **— who in this dimension stemmed from the soul-root of Benjamin,** וְיַקְרִיב בְּאִסּוּר הַבָּמוֹת בְּהַר הַכַּרְמֶל. **— offering sacrifices during the prohibition of bamot on Mount Carmel.** וְאָז יִזְכּוּ: "רֹאשֵׁךְ עָלַיִךְ כַּכַּרְמֶל", **— And then they will merit: "Your head upon you is like Carmel",** שֶׁהָרָשִׁים שֶׁבָּכֶם יִהְיוּ חֲבִיבִים כְּאֵלִיָּהוּ בְּהַר הַכַּרְמֶל, **— that the destitute among you will be as beloved as Elijah on Mount Carmel,** שֶׁיִּתְבָּרְרוּ עַל יְדֵי בְּחִינַת אֵלִיָּהוּ שֶׁמַּכְנִיס הִרְהוּר תְּשׁוּבָה בְּעֹמֶק הַלֵּב **— being clarified through Elijah who implants thoughts of repentance in the depth of the heart,** שֶׁיִּהְיוּ זְדוֹנוֹת נַעֲשׂוֹת כִּזְכֻיּוֹת, "כַּשֶּׁלֶג יַלְבִּינוּ", **— so deliberate sins become merits, "whitening like snow";** וְאָז זָכוּ כָּל יִשְׂרָאֵל לוֹמַר: "יהו"ה הוּא הָאֱלֹהִים", **— and then all Israel merited to proclaim:**

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[874] **Bereshit Rabbah 2:4** (excerpt): "'And darkness'—this is the Greek exile, which darkened Israel's eyes through its decrees, for it said to them: Write upon the horn of an ox that you have no portion in the God of Israel."

[875] **Tiferet Yosef, Bereshit 1:9**: "If a person breaks through all kinds of screens and reaches the first utterance called "Let there be light," God then gives him a share even in the utterance "Bereshit," as the Talmud says, "Bereshit too is an utterance." In this utterance too God gives the person a share: Israel's service reaches even this utterance. God shows the person that the entire clothing of creation that He established in this world came because He desired to benefit His creatures and wished it to be called "the labor of the person's hands." He therefore established this clothing. In truth, however, Israel's place is also in the utterance Bereshit, called "Bereshit too is an utterance."
Tiferet Yosef explains why light reached through later service can belong to the primordial source. Breaking through concealment does not merely restore a visible lamp; God gives the person a share in the source that preceded the concealment. This illuminates Chanukah's identification of the later recovered light with the first light, without claiming that Tiferet is describing the Greek persecution itself.

[876] **Bereshit Rabbah 2:4** (excerpt): "'And darkness'—this is the Greek exile, which darkened Israel's eyes through its decrees, for it said to them: Write upon the horn of an ox that you have no portion in the God of Israel."

[877] **Zohar, Miketz 14:228-15:238**: 'But unto you that fear My name shall the sun of righteousness arise with healing in its wings' (Malachi 3:20): the Zohar (Miketz I 203b) explains that 'the sun of righteousness' refers to that primordial light which the Holy One, blessed be He, concealed from the first day of Creation and stored away to heal and illuminate the righteous in the future redemption.'

[878] **Pesikta Rabbati 2:1**: 'Why do we kindle lights on Chanukah? Because when the sons of the Hasmonean High Priest entered the Sanctuary after defeating the Greeks, they found there eight iron spits (shipudim shel barzel), which they grooved and overlaid with wood, and in them they kindled the Menorah lights for eight days.'

"Hashem, He is God", שֶׁהוּא הַיִּחוּד הָאֱמִתִּי בְּאֹרַח פְּרָט. **— which is the true individualized unification.**

The opening of repentance leads toward revealed unity

וְכֵן בְּמוֹצָאֵי יוֹם הַכִּפּוּרִים אוֹמְרִים שֶׁבַע פְּעָמִים: "יהו"ה הוּא הָאֱלֹהִים",[879, 880] **— And so at the conclusion of Yom Kippur we recite seven times: "Hashem, He is God",** שֶׁאָז אַחַר שֶׁעָשׂוּ יִשְׂרָאֵל תְּשׁוּבָה וְנִתְגַּלָּה תֵּרַעָא דְּחֵירוּ, בִּינָה, עָלְמָא דְּאָתֵי, **— for then after Israel repented and the Gate of Freedom (Binah, the World to Come) is revealed,** מַזְכִּירִין שֶׁבַע פְּעָמִים יִחוּד זֶה, **— we mention seven times this unification,** וּמִסְפַּר שֶׁבַע הוּא מִסְפָּר הַשָּׁלֵם כַּיָּדוּעַ. **— and seven is the complete number as is known.** וְהוּא עַל דֶּרֶךְ מַה שֶּׁנֶּאֱמַר: "אָז תָּבִין וְגוֹמֵר וְדַעַת אֱלֹהִים תִּמְצָא", **— And this follows: "Then shall you understand, etc., and find the knowledge of God",** שֶׁזּוֹכִין לְבְחִינַת הַדַּעַת, שֶׁעַל יְדֵי זֶה זוֹכִין לְיִחוּד בְּאֹרַח פְּרָט, **— meriting Da'at through which one merits this individualized unification,** וּכְמַה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: "וְיָדַעְתָּ הַיּוֹם". **— as Scripture states: "And you shall know this day".** וּבְכָל שָׁנָה בַּחֲנֻכָּה הַזְּמַן שֶׁיּוּכַל כָּל אָדָם לְזַכּוֹת לְתַקֵּן מַעֲשָׂיו שֶׁיִּהְיוּ נֶחְשָׁבִין כִּזְכִיּוֹת, **— And every year on Chanukah is the season when every person can merit rectifying his deeds to be accounted as merits,** שֶׁאִם יִפְתַּח פֶּתַח אֶחָד שֶׁל תְּשׁוּבָה כְּחֻדָּהּ שֶׁל מַחַט בְּהִתְעוֹרְרוּת מִצִּדּוֹ, **— for if he opens an aperture of repentance like the point of a needle through awakening on his part,** הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרֵךְ מוּכָן לְעָזְרוֹ שֶׁיֵּעָשֶׂה תְּשׁוּבָה שְׁלֵמָה הַמְהַפֶּכֶת זְדוֹנוֹת לִזְכִיּוֹת. **— the Blessed Name stands ready to aid him to achieve complete repentance that transforms sins into merits.**

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[879] **Tzidkat HaTzadik 52:1**: "Repentance can occur in a single moment, as is evident in the second chapter of Kiddushin. We ask, "Bring us back," while God cries, "Return," as the Midrash at the end of Lamentations says. Presumably, in a generation entirely guilty, "our side will prevail." When God desires, in one moment all the surrounding thorns will be consumed, everything will be according to His will, and it will be revealed that all that preceded was also needed."
Tzidkat HaTzadik explains why a deeply damaged condition does not make a present beginning impossible: repentance can start in a moment, and the exchange between "Bring us back" and "Return" keeps both divine help and the person's response in view. Its full paragraph distinguishes the soul from the surrounding thorns. This strengthens Chanukah's invitation to open the small beginning without declaring the whole repair already accomplished.

[880] **Sod Yesharim, Yom Kippur 44:1**: "YHVH is God." The writings of the holy Ari observe that it should seemingly say "Elohim is YHVH," since the smaller is related to the greater. But this principle applies only within a person's limited understanding, which cannot picture a small thing without picturing it through a large thing. From God's side, it is inappropriate to speak of one thing depending upon another. Thus "YHVH is Elohim" is correct. The name YHVH signifies explicit illumination, while Elohim signifies the light's clothing, from which all judgments branch forth: garments so distant that His light is no longer recognized within them. Therefore it says "YHVH is Elohim." The two names together signify the full name: an explicit recognition that the light of His will fills every garment, even the very distant ones. Thus Elijah, after offering outside and showing the light of His glory even in the distant outer garments, said "YHVH is Elohim." Likewise, after all the service of Yom Kippur, when His light shines even in the outer garments, we say "YHVH is Elohim," indicating that His light is recognized through the many garments: "The glory of the Lord shall fill the whole earth."
Sod Yesharim explains the declaration's order and the meaning of its two names. The unity acknowledged after the day's service reaches even the outer garments that had concealed the light. This clarifies why Chanukah connects completed repentance with Yom Kippur's particular declaration, while the origin itself still calls for a person's initial opening.

Chanukah Ois 14

Chanukah and Purim: Open and Hidden Miracles

In explaining Mordekhai's place in the deliverance, the ois contrasts an outward appearance of refinement with the inner character disclosed at the feast. The criterion is the Torah and praise that actually emerge.

Chanukah and Purim: Open and Hidden Miracles

בַּחֲנֻכָּה וּבְפוּרִים מַזְכִּירִין בַּתְּפִלָּה: "בִּימֵי וְכוּלֵיהּ", — **On Chanukah and Purim we insert into prayer: "In the days of, etc.",** מַה שֶּׁלֹּא מָצִינוּ בַּמּוֹעֲדִים שֶׁיַּזְכִּירוּ יְצִיאַת מִצְרַיִם עַל יְדֵי מֹשֶׁה וְאַהֲרֹן. — **which we do not find regarding the biblical festivals where they do not mention the Exodus through Moses and Aaron.** וְהַטַּעַם, דְּשָׁם הָיָה מְפֹרָשׁ שֶׁהַנֵּס הָיָה מֵהַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ — **And the reason is: for there it was manifest that the miracle was solely from the Blessed Name** שֶׁצִּוָּה לְמֹשֶׁה וְאַהֲרֹן לְהוֹצִיא אֶת בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל מִמִּצְרַיִם, — **Who commanded Moses and Aaron to take the Children of Israel out of Egypt;** מַה שֶּׁאֵין כֵּן כָּאן שֶׁעָשׂוּ יִשְׂרָאֵל מַעֲצָמָם. — **unlike here, where Israel acted of their own human initiative.** וּבִימֵי מָרְדֳּכַי הָיָה עַל כָּל פָּנִים נְבִיאִים אַחֲרוֹנִים, — **And in the days of Mordechai there were at least the Latter Prophets,** מַה שֶּׁאֵין כֵּן בְּחֲנֻכַּת חַשְׁמוֹנָאִים שֶׁכְּבָר פָּסְקָה נְבוּאָה מִיִּשְׂרָאֵל, — **unlike the Hasmonean dedication where prophecy had already ceased from Israel,** רַק הֵם מֵעַצְמָם נִתְעוֹרְרוּ לְקַדֵּשׁ שֵׁם שָׁמַיִם; — **and they awakened of themselves to sanctify the Name of Heaven;** וְאַף שֶׁהָיָה גַּם כֵּן מֵהַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ שֶׁנָּתַן לָהֶם כֹּחַ וְאֹמֶץ הַלֵּב, — **and even though it was likewise from the Blessed Name Who granted them strength and fortitude of heart,** וְאַחַר כָּךְ עָשָׂה לָהֶם הַנֵּס וּמָסַר גִּבּוֹרִים בְּיַד חַלָּשִׁים וְרַבִּים בְּיַד מְעַטִּים, — **and afterward wrought for them the miracle of victory, delivering the mighty into the weak and many into the few,** מִכָּל מָקוֹם הַהִתְחָלָה הָיָה מִצִּדָּם בְּאִתְעָרוּתָא דִלְתַתָּא, — **nevertheless the inception was from their side via lower awakening (itaruta deletata),** וְהָיָה כְּעֵין בְּחִינַת תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה; — **and was of the nature of the Oral Torah;** וְעַל כֵּן מַזְכִּירִין בִּשְׁנֵי זְמַנִּים אֵלּוּ "בִּימֵי וְכוּלֵיהּ", שֶׁהַנֵּס הָיָה מִצִּדָּם. — **and therefore we mention in these two seasons "In the days of, etc.", for the miracle came through their initiative.** וּבְפוּרִים מַזְכִּירִין מָרְדֳּכַי וְאֶסְתֵּר, שֶׁהֵם וּשְׁמוֹתָן הָיוּ מְסֻגָּלִים לַהֲיְשׁוּעָה, — **And on Purim we mention Mordechai and Esther, for they and their names were spiritually primed for salvation,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁנִּרְמָזוּ בַּתּוֹרָה כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב (חֻלִּין קל״ט עַמּוּד ב׳)[881]: — **and as they are alluded to in the Torah (Chullin 139b):** "אֶסְתֵּר מִן הַתּוֹרָה מְנַיִן וְכוּלֵיהּ, — **"'From where is Esther alluded to in the Torah, etc.;** מָרְדֳּכַי מִן הַתּוֹרָה מְנַיִן? דִּכְתִיב: 'מָר דְּרוֹר', וּמְתַרְגְּמִינַן: 'מִירָא דַּכְיָא'". — **from where is Mordechai alluded to in the Torah? As it is written: Mor dror, which the Targum renders Mira dachya phonetically Mordechai".** וְהַיְנוּ שֶׁמִּסַּתָּם זֶה אִיתָא (מְגִלָּה י׳ עַמּוּד ב׳)[882]: — **And that means for this reason it states (Megillah 10b):** שֶׁנִּקְרָא "רֹאשׁ לְכָל הַבְּשָׂמִים", שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: "בְּשָׂמִים רֹאשׁ מָר דְּרוֹר וְכוּלֵיהּ". וְאִיתָא (עֵירוּבִין ס״א עַמּוּד ב׳)[883]: "הַדּוּדָאִים נָתְנוּ רֵיחַ" — **that he was called "the head of all fragrances", as it is said: "chief spices, flowing myrrh (mor dror), etc."** – וְאִיתָא (עֵירוּבִין ס״ד עַמּוּד א׳)[884]: "אֵלּוּ בַּחוּרֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל שֶׁלֹּא טָעֲמוּ טַעַם חֵטְא", — **And it states (Eruvin 21b): "'The mandrakes give forth a fragrance' — these are the youths of Israel who have not tasted the taste of sin",** וּכְבָר אָמַרְנוּ שֶׁמִּמַּה שֶׁהִזְכִּיר לְשׁוֹן "בַּחוּרֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל" נִרְאֶה דְּקָאֵי עַל חֵטְא פְּגַם הַבְּרִית שֶׁגּוֹרֵם הַבַּחֲרוּת, — **and we explained that in specifying "youths of Israel" it refers to the sin of the blemish of the Covenant typical of youth,** וְהֵם לֹא טָעֲמוּ טַעַם חֵטְא שֶׁנִּתְגַּבְּרוּ עַל יִצְרָם, וְעַל יְדֵי כֵן נָתְנוּ רֵיחַ טוֹב. — **and they did not taste the taste of sin having conquered their lust, thereby exuding a fragrant scent.** וְכֵן אִיתָא (סוֹטָה מ״ט עַמּוּד א׳)[885]: — **And so it states (Sotah 49a):** "טָהֳרָה בִּטְּלָה טַעַם וְרֵיחַ וְכוּלֵיהּ, — **"Purity cancelled taste and fragrance, etc.,** מוֹרְחִינָא רֵיחָא דְּחִינּוּנִיתָא; אָמַר לוֹ: בְּנִי, טָהֳרָה יֶשְׁבְּךָ", — **I smell the scent of youth; he said to him: My son, purity is in you",** וְהַיְנוּ דְּטָהֳרָה גּוֹרֶמֶת שְׁלֵמוּת חוּשׁ הָרֵיחַ, — **meaning that sexual purity causes the perfection of the sense of smell,** דִּכְתִיב: "יִרְאַת הַשֵּׁם טְהוֹרָה", וּכְתִיב: "וַהֲרִיחוֹ בְּיִרְאַת הַשֵּׁם". — **for it is written: "The fear of Hashem is pure", and written: "And his smelling shall be in the fear of Hashem".** וּסְתָם טָהֳרָה הוּא מִפְּגָם זֶה, — **And standard purity refers to freedom from this blemish (as explained in**

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[881] **Chullin 139b:12**: "Where is Esther alluded to in the Torah? 'I shall surely hide My face,' haster astir. Where is Mordechai alluded to in the Torah? In the words 'pure myrrh,' mor deror, which we translate into Aramaic as meira dakhya."

[882] **Megillah 10b:21**: "'A cypress shall rise': This is Mordechai, who is called the chief of all spices, as it says, 'Take for yourself choice spices: pure myrrh,' which we translate into Aramaic as mor dekhai, alluding to Mordechai."

[883] **Eruvin 21b**: 'Rava interpreted the verse cited above homiletically as follows: What is the meaning of that which is written: "The mandrakes duda'im yield a fragrance, and at our doors are all manner of choice fruits, new and old, which I have laid up for you, O my beloved" (Song of Songs 7:14)? "The mandrakes duda'im yield a fragrance," these are the young men of Israel who have never tasted the taste of sin.'

[884] **Eruvin 21b**: 'Rava interpreted the verse cited above homiletically as follows: What is the meaning of that which is written: "The mandrakes duda'im yield a fragrance, and at our doors are all manner of choice fruits, new and old, which I have laid up for you, O my beloved" (Song of Songs 7:14)? "The mandrakes duda'im yield a fragrance," these are the young men of Israel who have never tasted the taste of sin.'

[885] **Sotah 49a:10**: "Rav Huna found a strongly fragrant chinunita date, took it, and wrapped it in his cloth. His son Rabbah came and said, 'I smell the fragrance of chinunita.' Rav Huna told him, 'My son, there is purity in you,' and gave it to him. Meanwhile Rabbah's son Abba arrived, and Rabbah took the date and gave it to him. Rav Huna said, 'My son, you have gladdened my heart and set my teeth on edge.' This is what people say: A father's compassion is for his children; his children's compassion is for the children they themselves have."

[886] **Eruvin 21b**: 'Rava interpreted the verse cited above homiletically as follows: What is the meaning of that which is

discourse 2), וּמִי שֶׁנָּקִי מִפְּגָם זֶה נוֹתֵן רֵיחַ טוֹב; **— and one who is clean from this blemish gives forth sweet fragrance;** וּמָרְדֳּכַי שֶׁנִּקְרָא "רֹאשׁ לְכָל הַבְּשָׂמִים", הַיְנוּ שֶׁהָיָה בְּחִינַת צַדִּיק יְסוֹד עוֹלָם. **— and Mordechai who was called "the head of all fragrances" embodied the attribute of Tzaddik, Foundation of the World.** וְעַל כֵּן הָיָה הוּא בְּ"זֶה לְעֻמַּת זֶה" נֶגֶד קְלִפַּת עֲמָלֵק הַמְּנֻגֶּד לִבְחִינַת צַדִּיק, **— And therefore he stood in direct opposition to the kelipah of Amalek which opposes the Tzaddik,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב (מִדְרַשׁ תַּנְחוּמָא כִּי תֵצֵא): שֶׁהָיָה חוֹתֵךְ מִילּוֹתֵיהֶן שֶׁל יִשְׂרָאֵל **— as written (Tanchuma Ki Teitzei): that Amalek excised the circumcised members** וְזוֹרֵק כְּלַפֵּי מַעְלָה.[887]

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written: "The mandrakes duda'im yield a fragrance, and at our doors are all manner of choice fruits, new and old, which I have laid up for you, O my beloved" (Song of Songs 7:14)? "The mandrakes duda'im yield a fragrance," these are the young men of Israel who have never tasted the taste of sin.'

[887] **Midrash Tanchuma, Ki Teitzei 9:1**: "R. Levi opened his discourse (with Ps. 9:6), "You have rebuked the nations; you have destroyed the wicked one": "You have rebuked the nations." This refers to Amalek, of which it is written (in Numb. 24:20), "First among the nations (to attack Israel) was Amalek." (ibid., cont.:) "You have destroyed the wicked one." This refers to Esau, of whom it is stated (in Mal. 1:4), "and they shall call them (i.e., Edom) a country of wickedness." If someone says to you, "Jacob also is included among the wicked one," say to such a one, "'You have destroyed wicked ones (in the plural)' is not written here, but 'You have destroyed the wicked one (in the singular).'" (Ps. 9:6, cont.:) "You have blotted out their name for ever and ever," as stated (Deut. 25:19), "You shall blot out the remembrance of Amalek…." (Ps. 79:12:) "And return sevenfold unto the bosom (heq) of our neighbors their taunt with which they have taunted you, O Lord." R. Judan bar Gadya, R. Joshua ben Levi, and the masters differ. R. Judan bar Gadya said, "Remember what our neighbor Amalek did to us in the penis, which is attached to the lap (heq) i.e., to the center of a man." And this agrees with what R. Hanina bar Shilqa, R. Joshua ben Levi and R. Jochanan said, "What did the House of Amalek do to Israel? They cut off their penes and flung them heavenward, as they said, 'This is what You have chosen, take for Yourself what You have chosen.' This is related to the verse (in Ps. 9:6), 'their taunt with which they have taunted You, O Lord.'" R. Joshua ben Levi said, "It should be remembered what they did in the Torah, as it is written about it (in Ps. 12:7), 'refined sevenfold.'" And the masters said, "It should be remembered what they did to the Temple, which was the bosom (heq) i.e., the center of the earth, as stated (with reference to the Temple in Ezek. 43:14), 'And from the lap (heq) of the earth to the lower ledge, two cubits.'" When Samuel came, he repaid them, as stated (in I Sam. 15:33), "then Samuel hewed Agag." What did he do to him? R. Abba bar Kahana said, "He cut olive-sized pieces from his flesh and fed them to ostriches. This is what is written (in Job 18:13), 'It shall consume pieces of his flesh; the firstborn of death shall consume his pieces'; in that Samuel chose a cruel (mar) death for him." But the masters say, "Samuel set up four poles and stretched him upon them." It also says (in I Sam. 15:32), "and Agag said, 'Surely the bitterness (mar) of death is at hand (sr),'" meaning, "Do they thus put princes (sr) to death with harsh deaths?" R. Samuel bar Avdimi said, "He judged him by the justice of the peoples of the world (instead of by Torah) without witnesses and without a warning." Rabbi said, "He castrated him (rt.: srs) him, as stated (in I Sam. 15:33), 'But Samuel said, "As your sword has made women bereaved, so shall your mother be bereaved among women."'" R. Levi said, "Moses also gave a hint to Israel in the Torah (about Agag's castration), since it is stated (in Deut. 25:11-12), 'When two men get into a fight with each other, and the wife of one draws near to save her husband from the hand of the one smiting him, if she puts out with her hand and grabs the other man by his genitals. Then you shall cut off her hand….' What is written after that (in vs. 17), 'Remember what Amalek did to you.'" Israel said to the Holy One, blessed be He, "Master of the world, are You telling us to remember? You remember; as forgetfulness is common among us. But with You there is no forgetfulness." Thus (in Deut. 25:17), "Remember what Amalek did to you." He did to us, and he did not do to You? (Ps. 137:7:) "Remember against the children of Edom, O Lord, the day of the destruction of Jerusalem, how they said, 'Aru, 'aru (rt.: 'rh, rt.: 'rh) her to the foundation.'" Rabbi Abba bar Kahana said, "'Aru, 'aru means, paggeru, paggeru (destroy, destroy), even as the word is used (in Jer. 51:58), 'Babylon's broad wall shall be utterly demolished ('ar'er tit'ar'ar, rts.: 'rr, 'rh).'" R. Levi said, "'Aru, 'aru means, empty, empty, even as the word is used (in Gen. 24:20), 'She hastened to empty (te'ar, rt: 'rh) her jar into the trough.'" In the opinion of the one who said, "paggeru, paggeru (destroy, destroy)," 'aru, 'aru means to its foundations is intended (meaning, down to them but not to the foundation per se). But in the opinion of the one who said, "pannun, pannun (empty them, empty them)" the words mean, empty its foundations. What is the meaning of Amalek ('mlq)? People ('m) of the locust (ylq). They spread out like the zahla locust. Alternatively Amalek ('mlq) is a people ('am) who came to lap up (l'leq) the blood of Israel like a dog. R. Levi said in the name of R. Simeon ben Halafta, "To what may Amalek be likened? To a fly who is inflamed with passion after an open wound. So was Amalek inflamed like a dog with passion after Israel." As the Israelites went out of Egypt, Amalek heard that they were redeemed, and came against them upon the Reed Sea. But Israel mentioned the explicit name of God, and Amalek was bewildered, as stated (Exod. 15:15), "Then the captains of Edom were bewildered." (Deut. 25:17:) "On the way as you came out of Egypt." It is taught (in a baraita) in the name of R. Nathan: Amalek came four hundred parasangs (i.e., a little over 900 miles) to fight with Israel in Rephidim, as stated (in Numb. 13:29), "Amalek dwells in the land of the Negeb …." And he dwells in the interior beyond all of them (i.e., beyond all the tribes listed in this passage). (Deut. 25:17:) "On the way as you came out of Egypt." R. Levi said, "He came upon them from the wayside like a bandit." It is comparable to a king who had a vineyard which he had enclosed with a fence and in which he had put a biting dog. The king said, "Whenever anyone comes to break through the fence, the dog will bite him." One day the king's son came and broke through the fence. The dog bit him. Whenever he wanted to bring to mind the transgression of his son who broke through to the vineyard, he would say to him, "You remember how the dog bit you." Similarly, whenever the Holy One, blessed be He, wants to bring to mind the sin of Israel - what they did in Rephidim, when they said (in Exod. 17:7) "Is the Lord present among us or not" - He says to them (in Deut. 25:17), "Remember what Amalek did to you." (Deut. 25:18:) "How he encountered you on the way." R. Judah, R. Nehemiah, and the masters differ. R. Judah says, "'How he encountered (qr, rt.: qrh) you, i.e., defiled you. It is just as you say (in Deut. 23:11), "who is unclean because of what he encounters (rt.: qrh) at night (i.e., a nocturnal emission).'" R. Nehemiah said, "He actually called (qr') you. What did Amalek do? He went down to the Egyptian hall of records and obtained the records on the tribes, where their names were inscribed against them for the number of bricks. Then he would stand outside Israel's protective cloud and call out (rt.: qrh) to

of Israel and tossed them upward. וְכֵן הָיָה הוּא מָרְדֳּכַי מְסֻגָּל לְבָרֵר קְדֻשַּׁת יִשְׂרָאֵל בְּמִדַּת צַדִּיק — **And so Mordechai was uniquely endowed to clarify the holiness of Israel in the attribute of Tzaddik** נֶגֶד הַפַּרְסִיִּים שֶׁהָיָה לָהֶם גַּוְנָן יָפֶה בְּצִנְיעוּת, וּכְמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב (בְּרָכוֹת ח׳ עַמּוּד ב׳): "בִּשְׁלֹשָׁה דְּבָרִים אוֹהֵב אֲנִי אֶת הַפַּרְסִיִּים וְכוּ׳, וּצְנוּעִין בְּדָבָר אַחֵר"; וְאָמַרְנוּ שָׁלָּזֶה נִסְמַךְ אַחַר כָּךְ בַּגְּמָרָא: "'אֲנִי צִוִּיתִי לִמְקֻדָּשָׁי'[888] — **countering the Persians who presented an external facade of modesty, as written (Berachot 8b): "In three things I love the Persians, etc., and they are modest in intimate matters"; –** אֵלּוּ הַפַּרְסִיִּים הַמְּקֻדָּשִׁים וּמְזֻמָּנִין לְגֵיהִנֹּם", — **and we explained that to this is juxtaposed in the Gemara: "'I commanded My sanctified ones' — these are the Persians sanctified and prepared for Gehenna",** וְהַיְנוּ שֶׁמָּצִינוּ בַּאֲחַשְׁוֵרוֹשׁ: "מִגְּנוּתוֹ שֶׁל אוֹתוֹ רָשָׁע לָמַדְנוּ שִׁבְחוֹ וְכוּ׳" (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב מְגִלָּה י״ב עַמּוּד ב׳),[889] — **meaning as we find regarding Ahasuerus: "From the disgrace of that wicked one we learned the praise, etc." (Megillah 12b),** וְעַל דָּבָר זֶה נִקְרְאוּ יִשְׂרָאֵל "קְדוֹשִׁים" (שַׁבָּת פ״ו עַמּוּד א׳).[890] — **and regarding this matter Israel are called "holy" (Shabbat 86a).** וְאָז בַּהַסְעוּדָה שֶׁנַּעֲשָׂה עַל יְדֵי מָרְדֳּכַי נִתְבָּרֵר קְדֻשַּׁת יִשְׂרָאֵל: — **And then at the feast conducted through Mordechai Israel's holiness was demonstrated:** שֶׁבְּאוֹתוֹ רָשָׁע רָאִינוּ שֶׁעַל יְדֵי הַיַּיִן נִתְגַּלָּה קִלּוֹנוֹ, — **for in that wicked king we saw that through wine his inner disgrace was exposed,** שֶׁדָּרַשׁ דָּבָר הַמְגֻנֶּה אַף לְאֻמּוֹת הָעוֹלָם, — **demanding an act abhorrent even to the heathen nations,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁשָּׁלְחָה לוֹ: "בַּר אָהוֹרְיֵרְיהּ דְּאַבָּא וְכוּלֵיהּ, וְהַהוּא גַּבְרָא אִשְׁתַּטֵּי בְּחַמְרָא"; — **as Vashti sent him: "Stable-boy of my father, etc., this man has lost his mind through wine";**

The cup reveals what has been established in the heart

מַה שֶּׁאֵין כֵּן יִשְׂרָאֵל שֶׁבְּאוֹתוֹ סְעוּדָה הִתְחִילוּ בְּדִבְרֵי תוֹרָה וּבְדִבְרֵי תִּשְׁבָּחוֹת כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בַּגְּמָרָא (שָׁם י״ב עַמּוּד ב׳);[891, 892, 893] — **unlike**

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them, ‘Reuben, Simeon, Levi, come out, for I am your brother; and I want to transact business with you.’ When they came out, he killed them.” And the masters say, “He cooled (qr) you, i.e., he made Israel appear lukewarm (rt.: qrr) before others.” R. Huniya said, “A parable: To what is the matter comparable? To a boiling bath into which no creature is able to descend. A certain ruffian came and leaped down into it. Even though he was scalded, he made it cool to others. So also when Israel came out of Egypt, and the Holy One, blessed be He, divided the sea before them, while the Egyptians were drowned in its midst, fear of them fell upon all the peoples, as stated (in Exod. 15:15-16), ‘Then were the chiefs of Edom bewildered…. Terror and fright fell upon them.’ When Amalek came and joined in battle with them - even though he received his scalding at their hands - he made Israel appear lukewarm (in battle) before the peoples of the world.””

[888] **Berakhot 8b**: “It was taught: Rabban Gamliel said: I love the Persians for three things: they are modest in their eating, modest in the privy, and modest in another matter, meaning marital relations. While they have been praised here regarding certain specific aspects of their conduct, the Gemara proceeds to offer another perspective on the Persians based on a verse describing the destruction of Babylonia at the hands of the Persian and Median armies: “I have commanded My consecrated ones; I have also called My mighty ones for My anger, even My proudly exulting ones” (Isaiah 13:3). Rav Yosef taught a baraita: These are the Persians who are consecrated and designated for Gehenna, for they have been sent by God to carry out his mission of anger, and they will be sent to Gehenna.”

[889] **Megillah 13a:19**: “‘In the evening she would come, and in the morning she would return.’ Rabbi Yochanan said: From the disgrace of that wicked man we learned something to his credit: He did not have sexual relations during the day.”

[890] **Shabbat 86a:7**: “Why did he need to tell them to abstain during the day? Did Rav Huna not say that Israel are holy and do not have sexual relations during the day? But Rava said: If the house is dark, it is permitted. Rava also said—and some attribute it to Rav Pappa: A Torah scholar may darken the area with his cloak, and it is permitted.”

[891] **Megillah 12b:2**; **Megillah 12b:6**: “‘On the seventh day, when the king’s heart was merry with wine’: Had his heart not been merry with wine until then? Rava said: The seventh day was Shabbos. When Israel eat and drink, they begin with words of Torah and words of praise. But when the nations of the world eat and drink, they begin only with lewd talk. ‘The king became very angry’: Why did his anger blaze so intensely? Rava said: She sent him this message: ‘Son of my father’s stable-master! My father drank wine in the presence of a thousand men without becoming drunk, whereas that man—you—has become foolish through his wine!’ Immediately, ‘his anger burned within him.’”

[892] **Beit Yaakov on Torah, Lech Lecha 12:10**: “A person reaches this through his service, serving God by entering the actions and affairs of this world. Through this it becomes recognizable what the person is. The Talmud says, “A person is recognized through three things: his cup, his purse, and his anger.” It does not give a sign by which to recognize him when he stands in the synagogue clothed in a mitzvah’s tallit and crowned with tefillin; this implies that such a sight supplies no proof. The principal recognition occurs when he enters the concealments of worldly affairs, dealing with people in markets and streets. Then the precious quality within the person, what lies in the depths of his heart, can be recognized.”

Beit Yaakov explains why the cup is evidence of something not established by a dignified religious appearance alone. Ordinary conduct brings inward qualities into action under concealment. This illuminates Chanukah’s distinction between an attractive exterior and the Torah-filled response actually disclosed at the feast. The preceding paragraph requires continued work and prayer to repair the root; the test of conduct is not a claim of automatic perfection.

[893] **Peri Tzadik, Lech Lecha 5:8**: “This was also the matter with Noah. After meat had been permitted to him so that through it he could attain an upright and joyful heart, Noah thought that wine too was needed to straighten the heart and attain joy, and that Adam before the damage furnished no proof to the contrary. This was his reason for planting a vineyard. In truth, however, the wine that straightens the heart is specifically the wine of kiddush, which is the wine of a mitzvah, or wine for someone who needs it for settled understanding in Torah. Thus the Zohar speaks of sages who resemble Shabbat: all their eating is holy, like the eating of Shabbat and festivals, all directed toward sustaining life for

Israel who at their feast opened with words of Torah and praises of God (ibid. 12b); וְאָז נִגְלוּ מַעֲמַקֵּי הַלֵּב, שֶׁבִּשְׁלֹשָׁה דְּבָרִים אָדָם נִכָּר: בְּכוֹסוֹ וְכוּלֵיהּ (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב עֵירוּבִין ס״ה עַמּוּד ב׳)[894]; **— and then the depths of the heart were revealed, for in three things is a man recognized: in his cup, etc. (Eruvin 65b);** וְנִתְבָּרֵר שֶׁיִּשְׂרָאֵל בָּאֱמֶת קְדוֹשִׁים בַּשֹּׁרֶשׁ; **— and it became clear that Israel are truly holy in their root;** מַה שֶּׁאֵין כֵּן הַפָּרְסִיִּים הֵם רַק שֶׁהוּטַב בְּעֵינֵיהֶם הַצְּנִיעוּת לְדָבָר נָפֶה, לְפָנִים; **— whereas the Persians are only modest superficially, appreciating modesty as an aesthetic convention,** אֲבָל בַּשֹּׁרֶשׁ הֵם מְלֵאִים טִנּוּפֶת מִזּוּהֲמַת הַנָּחָשׁ, וְהֵם מְקֻדָּשִׁים וּמְזֻמָּנִים לְגֵיהִנָּם. **— yet at their core are filled with the filth of the serpent's venom, — being sanctified and designated for Gehenna.** וְזֶה נִתְבָּרֵר עַל יְדֵי מָרְדֳּכַי שֶׁהָיָה מֶרְכָּבָה לְמִדַּת צַדִּיק, וּשְׁמוֹ מוֹרֶה עַל זֶה שֶׁנִּקְרָא "רֹאשׁ לְכָל הַבְּשָׂמִים" כָּאָמוּר, וְעַל כֵּן נִזְכַּר "בִּימֵי מָרְדֳּכָי". **— And this was clarified through Mordechai who was the chariot for the Tzaddik, — and his name indicates this being "the head of all spices", and therefore we say "in the days of Mordechai".** וְכֵן אֶסְתֵּר הָיְתָה גַּם כֵּן מִבְּחִינַת צַדִּיק, כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמַרְנוּ בְּמָקוֹם אַחֵר מֵהַתִּקּוּנֵי זֹהַר,[895] **— And so too Esther was likewise from the dimension of Tzaddik, as we explained elsewhere from Tikunei Zohar,** וְכֵן נִקְרָאָה "הֲדַסָּה" עַל שֵׁם הַצַּדִּיקִים שֶׁנִּקְרְאוּ הֲדַסִּים כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב (מְגִלָּה י״ג עַמּוּד א׳),[896] **— and she was called "Hadassah" after the righteous who are termed myrtles (hadassim) (Megillah 13a),** וְזֶה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: "בִּימֵי מָרְדֳּכַי וְאֶסְתֵּר". **— and this is why we say: "In the days of Mordechai and Esther".**

וְכֵן שֵׁם אֶסְתֵּר מוֹרֶה עַל הַנֵּס, שֶׁשְּׁמָהּ מְרֻמָּז בְּמַה שֶּׁנֶּאֱמַר: "וְאָנֹכִי הַסְתֵּר אַסְתִּיר" כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בַּגְּמָרָא; **— And the name Esther also points to the hidden nature of the miracle, — her name being alluded to in: "And I will surely conceal (haster astir)", as written in the Gemara;** וְכֵן הַנֵּס הָיָה בְּהֶסְתֵּר, שְׁבִּיצִיאַת מִצְרַיִם הָיָה מְפֹרָשׁ לַכֹּל שֶׁהָיָה נֶגֶד הַטֶּבַע, מַה שֶּׁאֵין כֵּן נֵס פּוּרִים שֶׁהָיָה מְקֻפָּל מְעַט בַּטֶּבַע, וְעַל שֵׁם זֶה נִקְרְאָה אֶסְתֵּר. **— and the miracle was indeed cloaked in concealment: — for at the Exodus from Egypt it was manifest to all that it superseded nature,** וּפוּרִים וַחֲנֻכָּה **— unlike the Purim miracle which was folded within natural garments, on account of which she was named Esther. –** סוֹף כָּל הַנִּסִּים: **— And Purim and Chanukah represent the conclusion of all miracles:** "דְּאִיתָא (יוֹמָא כ״ט עַמּוּד א׳): "אֶסְתֵּר סוֹף כָּל הַנִּסִּים"[897], **— for it states (Yoma 29a): "Esther is the end of all miracles",** וְהִקְשׁוּ בַּגְּמָרָא: "וְהָא אִיכָּא חֲנֻכָּה?", **— and they challenged in the Gemara: "Yet behold there is Chanukah?",** דְּנֵס חֲנֻכָּה הָיָה אַחַר כָּךְ, וּמַדְלִיקִין וּמְבָרְכִין "וְצִוָּנוּ", **— since the miracle of Chanukah occurred later, and we kindle and recite "and commanded us";** וּמְשַׁנֵּי: "נִתְנָה לִכָּתֵב קָא אָמְרִינַן", **— and it answers: "We speak of that which was permitted to be written down";** וְהַיְנוּ שֶׁנִּבְנֵס אֶסְתֵּר, אַף שֶׁהָיָה מְקֻפָּל קְצָת בַּטֶּבַע,

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Torah. They need wine as on Shabbat, when a person establishes his meal over wine."
Lech Lecha distinguishes the conditions under which wine serves an upright heart from Noah's unsuccessful inference that it would do so automatically. This clarifies the Torah and praise disclosed in Chanukah's feast comparison. The record preserves the mitzvah or settled-Torah purpose; it does not turn the passage into a blanket recommendation to drink.

[894] **Eruvin 65b**: "Rabbi Ilai said: A person is known by three things: his cup, his purse, and his anger. Some say: also by his laughter."

[895] **Peri Tzadik, Purim 2:3**: ""And His Holy One into a flame"—this is Esther. This follows the statement in Tikkunei Zohar, Tikkun 21, that the Holy One, blessed be He, covered Esther with His sign, for she is His holiness. That is, Esther too was of the aspect of Joseph the righteous. As stated at the beginning of Midrash Rabbah on Kedoshim, wherever you find a boundary against sexual immorality, you find holiness: anyone who guards himself against sexual immorality is called holy. Thus the Gemara, Megillah 13a, says: Her name was Esther; why was she called Hadassah? After the righteous, who are called myrtles. The righteous are called myrtles because a myrtle gives a pleasant fragrance. Eruvin 21b states: "The mandrakes gave forth fragrance"—these are the young men of Israel who have not tasted sin. We have often explained that the expression "young men of Israel" appears to refer to the sin of damaging the covenant, to which youth gives rise, as explained concerning Rosh Chodesh Marcheshvan. A righteous person who is a vehicle for the quality "foundation of the world" is called a myrtle because he gives a pleasant fragrance. Since Esther was called Hadassah, it follows that she was righteous and holy, of the aspect of Joseph the righteous."

[896] **Megillah 13a**: 'The verse states: "And he had brought up Hadassah, that is, Esther" (Esther 2:7). She is referred to as "Hadassah" and she is referred to as "Esther." What was her real name? It is taught in a baraita that the Sages differed in their opinion as to which was in fact her name and which one was a description: Rabbi Meir says: Esther was her real name. Why then was she called Hadassah? On account of the righteous, who are called myrtles hadassim, and so it states: "And he stood among the myrtles hahadassim" (Zechariah 1:8).'

[897] **Yoma 29a:4-6**: "Rabbi Zeira said: Why was Esther compared to a hind? To tell you: Just as a hind's womb is narrow and she is as dear to her mate at every moment as at the first moment, so Esther was as dear to Achashverosh at every moment as at the first moment. Rabbi Assi said: Why was Esther compared to dawn? To tell you: Just as dawn is the end of the entire night, so Esther was the end of all the miracles. But there is Chanukah! We mean miracles that were given permission to be recorded in Scripture. This is satisfactory according to the view that Esther was given permission to be recorded. But according to the view that Esther was not given permission to be recorded, what can be said? That view explains the comparison in accordance with Rabbi Binyamin bar Yefet's teaching in Rabbi Elazar's name. Rabbi Binyamin bar Yefet said in Rabbi Elazar's name: Why were the prayers of the righteous compared to a hind? To tell you: Just as a hind's antlers branch out as it grows, so the more the righteous increase their prayer, the more their prayer is heard."

meaning that in the miracle of Esther, although slightly cloaked in nature, מִכָּל מָקוֹם עִקַּר הַנְהָגַת הַנֵּס רָאוּי הַכֹּל שֶׁהוּא מֵהַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרֵךְ: **— nevertheless the primary steering of the miracle was seen by all as divine:** שֶׁיִּצְטָרֵךְ עַל לֵב מֶלֶךְ לִשָּׂא אִשָּׁה אֲשֶׁר לֹא יָדַע מוֹלַדְתָּהּ הוּא נֶגֶד הַטֶּבַע, **— for it to enter a monarch's heart to marry a woman whose lineage is unknown is contrary to nature,** וּבִפְרָט לְפִי מַה שֶּׁכָּתוּב בַּגְּמָרָא (מְגִלָּה שָׁם): "אֶסְתֵּר יְרַקְרוֹקֶת הָיְתָה וְכוּ'"[898], **— and especially based on the Gemara: "Esther was of greenish complexion, etc.",** וְכֵן מַה שֶּׁהָרַג וְהָיָה נִכָּר כִּי יַד הַשֵּׁם עָשְׂתָה זֹאת; **— making it apparent that the hand of Hashem did this;** רַק שֶׁאַחַר לְוַשְׁתִּי הָיָה גַּם כֵּן כְּנֶגֶד הַטֶּבַע כַּמּוּבָן; **— and likewise executing Vashti was contrary to common sense;** כָּךְ הָיָה הַנֵּס מְקֻפָּל קְצָת בַּטֶּבַע שֶׁעָשָׂה לְאַהֲבַת אֶסְתֵּר, **— only that afterward the plot unfolded within natural events done out of love for Esther,** וְזֶה נִרְמָז בְּמַה שֶּׁנֶּאֱמַר: "וְאָנֹכִי הַסְתֵּר אַסְתִּיר". **— and this is alluded to in: "And I will surely conceal".** וּמִכָּל מָקוֹם הָיָה שֹׁרֶשׁ הַנֵּס מְפֹרָשׁ, **— And nevertheless the core of the miracle was clearly manifest,** וְזֶה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר בַּגְּמָרָא (שָׁם י"א עַמּוּד א')[899]: **— and this is what is stated in the Gemara (Megillah 11a):** "אֵימָתַי 'רָאוּ כָל אַפְסֵי אָרֶץ אֶת יְשׁוּעַת אֱלֹהֵינוּ'? בִּימֵי מָרְדְּכַי וְאֶסְתֵּר"; **— "When did 'all the ends of the earth see the salvation of our God'? In the days of Mordechai and Esther";** וְזֶה שֶׁאָמְרוּ: "שֶׁנִּתְּנָה לִכָּתֵב", שֶׁהָיָה הַנֵּס בְּחִינַת תּוֹרָה שֶׁבִּכְתָב **— and this is what they meant by "it was permitted to be written", for the miracle reflected Written Torah,** שֶׁהוּא מְפֹרָשׁ שֶׁבָּא מֵהַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרֵךְ, **— which is manifest as proceeding directly from the Blessed Name,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמַרְנוּ שֶׁמִּטַּעַם זֶה נִמְשַׁל לְמָטָר שֶׁנִּכָּר לַכֹּל שֶׁיּוֹרֵד הַמָּטָר מִן הַשָּׁמַיִם. **— and as we explained that for this reason it is likened to rain which everyone visibly discerns falling from heaven.** וּמִכָּל מָקוֹם אֶסְתֵּר "סוֹף כָּל הַנִּסִּים", שֶׁהָיָה מְכֻוָּן **— And nevertheless Esther is "the end of all miracles",** כְּנֶגֶד מִדַּת מַלְכוּת, מִדָּה אַחֲרוֹנָה, וּכְמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב (שָׁם י"ד עַמּוּד ב')[900]: "'וַתִּלְבַּשׁ אֶסְתֵּר מַלְכוּת' **— for it corresponded to the sefirah of Malchut, the final attribute, –** שֶׁלְּבָשַׁתָּהּ רוּחַ הַקֹּדֶשׁ"[901], **— and as written (ibid. 14b): "'And Esther clothed herself in royalty' — that the Holy Spirit clothed her",** וְהוּא מִבְּחִינַת מַלְכוּת כַּיָּדוּעַ מֵהַזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ; **— which is from the aspect of Malchut as known from the Holy Zohar;** וְזֶהוּ שֶׁנִּרְמַז בַּגְּמָרָא בְּמַה שֶּׁנֶּאֱמַר: "רָאוּ כָל אַפְסֵי אָרֶץ", "אָרֶץ" דַּוְקָא, **— and this is hinted in the Gemara by the verse: "All the ends of the earth saw", "earth" (eretz) specifically,** שֶׁהוּא בְּחִינַת כְּנֶסֶת יִשְׂרָאֵל (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב זֹהַר חֵלֶק א' ל"א רֵישׁ עַמּוּד ב' וּבְשִׁאָר מְקוֹמוֹת)[902]. **— which is the realm of Knesset Yisrael (Zohar Part I, 31b top, and elsewhere).**

The new teaching is received through the sage's understanding

— Unlike the miracle of Chanukah which was in the[903] מַה שֶּׁאֵין כֵּן נֵס חֲנֻכָּה שֶׁהָיָה בְּחִינַת תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה,

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[898] **Megillah 13a**: 'The verse states: "And when the virgins were gathered together the second time and Mordecai sat in the king's gate" (Esther 2:19). The Gemara explains: The reason Ahasuerus gathered the women together was that he went and took advice from Mordecai as to what he should do to get Esther to reveal her identity. Mordecai said to him: As a rule, a woman is jealous only of the thigh of another woman. Therefore, you should take for yourself additional women. But even so she did not reveal her origins to him, as it is written: "Esther had not yet made known her kindred nor her people" (Esther 2:20).'

[899] **Megillah 11a**: "Rabbi Yochanan introduced his exposition of this passage with: 'He remembered His kindness and faithfulness to the House of Israel; all the ends of the earth saw the salvation of our God.' When did 'all the ends of the earth see the salvation of our God'? In the days of Mordechai and Esther."

[900] **Megillah 14b**: 'Esther was also a prophetess, as it is written: "And it came to pass on the third day that Esther clothed herself in royalty" (Esther 5:1). It should have said: Esther clothed herself in royal garments. Rather, this alludes to the fact that she clothed herself with a divine spirit of inspiration. It is written here: "And she clothed herself," and it is written elsewhere: "And the spirit clothed Amasai" (I Chronicles 12:19). Just as there the reference is to being enclothed by a spirit, so too Esther was enclothed by a spirit of divine inspiration.'

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[902] **Zohar, Bereshit 35:339-36:352**: 'In the Zohar (Bereshit I 31a–31b), the attribute of Tzaddik Yesod Olam (embodied in Joseph) is expounded on the verse 'For all that is in the heaven and in the earth' (I Chronicles 29:11): Yesod is the covenantal bond that unites Heaven (Tiferet, the Holy One, blessed be He) and Earth (Malkhut, the Shekhinah).'

[903] **Peri Tzadik, Ki Teitzei 15:1**: "The holy Ari teaches that Rabbi Akiva was the root of Oral Torah. This is Malchut: "the mouth, which we call Oral Torah." Concerning it, "Let my saying flow like dew" is said. Although Oral Torah too is the words of the living God, at the moment of discovery it appears to the sage that he is discovering it himself, like dew whose descent from Heaven is not seen; only when the earth is seen to be damp is it known that dew descended. The Ramban writes that this occurs through the Holy Spirit: by his own understanding he arrives at the words of the living God, as the Talmud asks, "Does he not give a reason?" This is called the crown of Torah, as the Sages say concerning someone who studies halakhot. This was Rabbi Akiva's portion."
The Ki Teitzei discussion adds how the human side of this hidden reception works: the sage reasons and gives grounds for the teaching. Its setting is Moses encountering Rabbi Akiva's developed Torah. This sharpens the dew comparison in Chanukah; the attributed inspiration operates through intelligible Torah reasoning, rather than making the mere experience of having a new idea sufficient.

dimension of the Oral Torah, שֶׁאָמַרְנוּ "תִּזַּל כַּטַּל אִמְרָתִי" — **which we explained is likened to dew: "My speech shall distill as the dew",** שֶׁאֵין נִכָּר יְרִידַת הַטַּל מִלְּמַעְלָה, **wherein the descent of dew is not visibly observed from above,** רַק מְבִינִים כְּשֶׁרוֹאִין הָאָרֶץ לַחָה שֶׁיָּרַד הַטַּל; **only recognized when seeing the ground moist that dew descended;** וְכֵן תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה נִדְמֶה לַחֲכָמִים שֶׁהֵם הַמְחַדְּשִׁים, **and so the Oral Torah appears to the Sages as if they are the innovators,** וּבֶאֱמֶת הֵם דִּבְרֵי אֱלֹהִים חַיִּים: "דְּבָרַי אֲשֶׁר שַׂמְתִּי בְּפִיךָ"; **whereas in truth they are the words of the Living God: "My words which I have placed in your mouth";** וְכֵן נַס חֲנֻכָּה שֶׁהָיָה עַל יְדֵי מִלְחָמָה, **and likewise the Chanukah miracle occurred through military warfare,** רַק שֶׁבֶּאֱמֶת הָיָה מַהֲשֵׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ שֶׁנָּתַן בְּלִבָּם אֹמֶץ וְחִזּוּק לַעֲמֹד בְּמִתֵּי מְעַט נֶגֶד עַם רָב, **only that in truth it was from God Who placed in their hearts courage to stand as few against many,** מִכָּל מָקוֹם הַהִתְעוֹרְרוּת הָיָה מִצִּדָּם; **nevertheless the awakening originated from their side;** וְאַחַר כָּךְ נָתַן לָהֶם כֹּחַ וּמָסַר גִּבּוֹרִים בְּיַד חַלָּשִׁים וְרַבִּים בְּיַד מְעַטִּים, **and afterward He gave them victory, delivering mighty into weak and many into few,** וּבִפְרָט נַס הַשֶּׁמֶן שֶׁהָיָה נִסְתָּר בְּתוֹךְ הַנִּסְתָּר, **and especially the miracle of the oil which was completely hidden within the Sanctuary,** וְלֹא נִתַּן לִכָּתֵב, שֶׁהָיָה בְּחִינַת תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה; **and was not permitted to be written into Scripture, belonging to the Oral Torah;** וְנַס חֲנֻכָּה הָיָה בֶּאֱמֶת סוֹף כָּל הַנִּסִּים. **and the miracle of Chanukah was in truth the ultimate end of all miracles.**

וְיֵשׁ שִׁנּוּי בֵּין נֻסְחָאוֹת הַזְּכִירוֹת: **And there is a textual variation between the formulations of the liturgical insertions:** שֶׁבְּפוּרִים לֹא נִזְכַּר רַק שֵׁם מָרְדֳּכַי וְלֹא שֵׁם אָבִיו, **for on Purim only the name of Mordechai is mentioned without his father's name,** אַף שֶׁחֲזְכַּר בְּמְגִלַּת אֶסְתֵּר שֵׁם אָבוֹתָיו, **even though his ancestry is recorded in the Megillah,** מַה שֶׁאֵין כֵּן בַּחֲנֻכָּה שֶׁמַּזְכִּירִין: "בִּימֵי מַתִּתְיָהוּ בֶן יוֹחָנָן כֹּהֵן גָּדוֹל", **unlike Chanukah where we specify: "In the days of Matityahu son of Yochanan, the High Priest",** אַךְ הָעִנְיָן, שֶׁכְּבָר אָמַרְנוּ וְצָרִיךְ לְהָבִין הַטַּעַם בָּזֶה. **and one must understand the reason for this.**

בְּמַה שֶׁכָּתוּב (בְּרָכוֹת י״ז עַמּוּד ב׳):[904] **However the matter is according to what we explained regarding that which is written (Berachot 17b):** "אָמַר רַב: בְּכָל יוֹם וָיוֹם בַּת קוֹל יוֹצֵאת מֵהַר חוֹרֵב וְאוֹמֶרֶת: **"Rav said: Every single day a Heavenly Voice issues from Mount Horeb proclaiming:** כָּל הָעוֹלָם כֻּלּוֹ נִזּוֹנִין בִּשְׁבִיל חֲנִינָא בְּנִי וְכִכּוּלֵיהּ", **The entire universe is nourished for the sake of Chanina My son, etc.",** וּכְפִי הַנִּרְאֶה מֵהַגְּמָרָא שֶׁנִּסְדַּר בְּעִנְיְנֵי רַבִּי חֲנִינָא[905] (תַּעֲנִית כ״ד סוֹף עַמּוּד ב׳) **— and as is evident from the Gemara (Ta'anit 24b bottom)** בֶּן דּוֹסָא, דְּהַכְרוּז קָאֵי עַל רַבִּי חֲנִינָא בֶּן דּוֹסָא; **where it is placed within the narratives of Rabbi Chanina ben Dosa, showing the proclamation referred to Rabbi Chanina ben Dosa;** וְקָשֶׁה, שֶׁהֲרֵי בִּזְמַן רַב לֹא חַי רַבִּי חֲנִינָא בֶּן דּוֹסָא, **yet it is difficult: for in Rav's era Rabbi Chanina ben Dosa was no longer alive,** וְאֵיךְ שַׁיָּךְ כְּרוּז זֶה בְּכָל יוֹם בִּזְמַן רַב? **— so how was this proclamation relevant daily in the generation of Rav?**

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[904] **Berakhot 17b:2**: "Having cited a dispute with regard to the interpretation of a verse where we are uncertain whether the dispute is between Rav and Shmuel or Rabbi Yoḥanan and Rabbi Elazar, the Gemara cites another verse with regard to which there is a similar dispute. It is said: "Hear Me, stubborn-hearted who are far from charity" (Isaiah 46:12). While both agree that the verse refers to the righteous, Rav and Shmuel, and some say Rabbi Yoḥanan and Rabbi Elazar, disagreed as to how to interpret the verse. One said: The entire world is sustained by God's charity, not because it deserves to exist, while the righteous who are far from God's charity are sustained by force, as due to their own good deeds they have the right to demand their sustenance. And one said: The entire world is sustained by the merit of their righteousness, while they are not sustained at all, not even by their own merit, in accordance with the statement that Rav Yehuda said that Rav said."

[905] **Taanit 24b:14**; **Taanit 25a:1-2**: "Rav Yehudah said in Rav's name: Every day a heavenly voice goes forth and says, 'The entire world is sustained on account of Chanina My son, while Chanina My son is satisfied with a kav of carobs from one Shabbos eve to the next.' His wife would regularly heat the oven every Shabbos eve and put in something that produced smoke, because she was ashamed of having no food to bake. She had an ill-disposed neighbor who said, 'I know they have nothing; what is all this smoke?' She went and knocked at the door. Chanina's wife was embarrassed and withdrew into an inner room. A miracle was performed for her: The neighbor saw the oven full of bread and the kneading basin full of dough. She called to her, 'So-and-so, so-and-so! Bring a peel, because your bread is scorching!' She answered, 'That is just what I went inside for.' It was taught: She had indeed gone in to fetch a bread peel, because she was accustomed to miracles."

Receiving as a gift makes room for the nourishment of others

וְאָמַרְנוּ[906, 907] שֶׁבְּכָל דּוֹר וָדוֹר יֵשׁ נֶפֶשׁ שְׁנִקְרָא "חֲנִינָא", **— And we explained that in each and every generation there is a righteous soul termed "Chanina",** וְהַיְנוּ שֶׁיּוֹדֵעַ וּמַכִּיר שֶׁהַכֹּל בָּא מֵהֶסֶד הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ שֶׁחוֹנֵן לְבְרִיּוֹתָיו. וּכְמוֹ שֶׁהָיָה מֹשֶׁה רַבֵּנוּ שֶׁהִתְפַּלֵּל בִּלְשׁוֹן "וָאֶתְחַנַּן" בִּלְשׁוֹן תַּחֲנוּנִים, **— meaning someone who knows and internalizes that everything derives from God's loving grace Who shows unearned favor (chonen) to His creations. –** כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בַּמִּדְרָשׁ רַבָּה; וּבַגְּמָרָא (סַנְהֶדְרִין מ"ד עַמּוּד ב'): "'תַּחֲנוּנִים יְדַבֶּר רָשׁ[908, 909] **— Just as Moses our Teacher prayed with the language of "And I pleaded (Va'etchanan)" — an expression of supplication, as written in Midrash Rabbah; –** זֶה מֹשֶׁה"[910] **— and in the Gemara (Sanhedrin 44b): "'The poor man speaks supplications' — this is Moses",** וְהַיְנוּ דְּמֹשֶׁה רַבֵּנוּ הָיָה שֹׁרֶשׁ תּוֹרָה שֶׁבִּכְתָב, **— meaning that Moses was the root of the Written Torah,** וּכְתִיב: "וְהַחָכְמָה מֵאַיִן תִּמָּצֵא", **— and it is written: "And wisdom, from whence (me'ayin) shall it be found",** וְדָרְשׁוּ (סוֹטָה כ"א עַמּוּד ב'): "אֵין דִּבְרֵי תוֹרָה מִתְקַיְּמִין אֶלָּא בְּמִי שֶׁמַּמְשִׁים עַצְמוֹ כְּמִי שֶׁאֵינוֹ";[911] **— and expounded (Sotah 21b): "Words of Torah endure only in one who makes himself as nothing (ayin)";** וְזֶה הָיָה מֹשֶׁה רַבֵּנוּ שֶׁהָיָה עָנָו מִכָּל הָאָדָם וְאָמַר: "וְנַחְנוּ מָה". **— and this was Moses our Teacher who was humbler than any man and said: "And what are we".** וּבִשְׁבִיל נֶפֶשׁ כָּזֶה כָּל הָעוֹלָם כֻּלּוֹ נִזּוֹנִין, **— And for the sake of such a soul the entire universe is sustained,** וְהוּא דַּי לוֹ בְּקֶב חָרוּבִין, כֵּינוֹן שֶׁמַּכִּיר שֶׁהַכֹּל בְּחֶסֶד וּמַתָּנַת חִנָּם. **— and he is content with a measure of carobs, recognizing that everything is unearned grace and a free gift.** וְרַבִּי חֲנִינָא בֶּן דּוֹסָא בְּדוֹרוֹ הָיָה הוּא הַנֶּפֶשׁ שֶׁהָיָה בְּחִינַת חֲנִינָא, **— And Rabbi Chanina ben Dosa in his generation was the soul embodying the level of Chanina,** וְעַל כֵּן הוּבָא הַמַּאֲמָר בְּתַעֲנִית עָלָיו, וְזֶה מַדְרֵגַת מֹשֶׁה רַבֵּנוּ. **— which is why the teaching in Ta'anit was applied to him; and this is the spiritual stature of Moses.**

וְכֵן יַעֲקֹב אָבִינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם, דִּכְתִיב: "תִּתֵּן אֱמֶת לְיַעֲקֹב", "אֱמֶת זוֹ תּוֹרָה" (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בְּרָכוֹת ה' עַמּוּד ב'),[912] **— And likewise Jacob our Father, peace be upon him, of whom it is written: "You give truth to Jacob", and "Truth is Torah" (Berachot 5b),** בּוֹ מָצִינוּ גַּם כֵּן שֶׁאָמַר: "הָאֱלֹהִים הָרֹעֶה אֹתִי מֵעוֹדִי עַד הַיּוֹם הַזֶּה", **— in him we also find that he said: "The God Who shepherded me from my inception until this day",** שֶׁהַכֹּל מֵהַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ וְלֹא תָּלָה בְּהִשְׁתַּדְּלוּת עַצְמוֹ כְּלָל. **— acknowledging that all is from God, attributing nothing to personal exertion.**

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[906] **Sod Yesharim, Rosh Hashanah 7:1**: "Because of this closeness, he also had the power to limit himself in all the world's benefits so that they would flow more abundantly to Israel, although in truth all the benefits descended through him: "The entire world is nourished through Hanina My son, while Hanina My son is satisfied with a kav of carobs from one Shabbat eve..." Because he was very close to God and saw clearly, as it truly is, that "The Lord our God, the Lord is one," he possessed such immense generosity. Indeed, every individual soul possessing great generosity toward its community can effect deliverances for them, even beyond nature. To indicate this the Talmud brings all the wondrous events concerning Rabbi Hanina ben Dosa."

Sod Yesharim explains the social direction of Hanina's contentment: his nearness to God expresses itself as generosity, leaving greater abundance for others. That gives a concrete relation between the two halves of the announcement in Chanukah—the world nourished through him and his own sufficient small portion. It is not a claim that deprivation by itself produces a miracle.

[907] **Dover Tzedek, Kuntres Ner HaMitzvot 2:35**: "For afflicting oneself is forbidden. Rather, the blessing says, "He eats a little, and it is blessed within him." Thus, "Hanina My son is satisfied with a kav of carobs from one Shabbat eve to the next": this is sufficient for him, and he needs no more."

Dover Tzedek distinguishes genuine sufficiency from self-affliction. This is essential to Chanukah's description of Hanina's small portion: its value is that it truly suffices under blessing, not that the body is deliberately left without what it needs. The complete target paragraph expressly places this within the obligation to sustain the life entrusted to a person.

[908] **Deuteronomy 3:23**: "I pleaded with Hashem at that time, saying:"

[909] **Sanhedrin 44a:13**: "Rav Nachman said in Rav's name: What is meant by the verse 'The poor man speaks supplications, but the rich man answers harshly'? 'The poor man speaks supplications' refers to Moshe; 'the rich man answers harshly' refers to Yehoshua."

[910] **Sanhedrin 44a:13**: "Rav Nachman said in Rav's name: What is meant by the verse 'The poor man speaks supplications, but the rich man answers harshly'? 'The poor man speaks supplications' refers to Moshe; 'the rich man answers harshly' refers to Yehoshua."

[911] **Sotah 21b:3**: "What do the Sages do with the verse 'I am wisdom; I dwell with prudence'? They need it for Rabbi Yosei son of Rabbi Chanina's teaching. Rabbi Yosei son of Rabbi Chanina said: Words of Torah endure only in someone who strips himself bare for their sake, as it says, 'I am wisdom; I dwell with prudence,' reading ormah, 'prudence,' as an allusion to arom, 'bare.' Rabbi Yochanan said: Words of Torah endure only in someone who makes himself as though he does not exist, as it says, 'Wisdom is found from nothingness.'"

[912] **Berakhot 5b:2-3**: "Rabbi Yochanan said to him: Torah and acts of kindness are understandable, for it is written, 'Through kindness and truth, sin is atoned for.' 'Kindness' means acts of kindness, as it says, 'One who pursues righteousness and kindness will find life, righteousness and honor.' 'Truth' means Torah, as it says, 'Buy truth and do not sell it.' But how do we know that one who buries his children also has his sins atoned for? An elder taught him in Rabbi Shimon ben Yochai's name: It is derived by comparing the word 'sin' in two verses. Here it is written, 'Through kindness and truth, sin is atoned for,' and there it is written, 'Who repays the sin of fathers into the bosom of their children.'"

וְכֵן אִיתָא (בְּרֵאשִׁית רַבָּה רֵישׁ פָּרָשָׁה וַיֵּצֵא)[913] שֶׁאָמַר עַל עַצְמוֹ: "'מֵאַיִן יָבֹא עֶזְרִי וְכוּלֵיהּ' — **And so it states (Bereishit Rabbah, beginning of Parashat Vayeitzei) that he declared of himself: –** לֵית אֶנָא מוֹבִיד סְבָרִי מִן בָּרְיֵי". וְכֵן "מוֹרֶה עַל זֶה שֵׁם מַתַּתְיָהוּ" — **"'From whence shall come my help, etc.' — I do not lose my hopeful reliance on my Creator."** – שֶׁהַכֹּל מַתָּנַת חִנָּם מֵהַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ, — **And so points the name Matityahu — that all is a free gift (matat) from God,** שֶׁעַל זֶה רוֹמְזוֹ אוֹתִיּוֹת יה"ו. וְכֵן מוֹרֶה עַל זֶה שֵׁם "יוֹחָנָן" — **indicated by the divine letters Yud-Heh-Vav. –** יוֹחָנָן: יו"ד-וָא"ו חָנַן, דְּהַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא חַנּוֹנָן; דְּהֵ"א הֵ"א שֶׁמַּשִּׁים הַקָּדוֹשׁ: הֵ"א עִלָּאָה, הֵ"א תַּתָּאָה — **And so points the name Yochanan — Yud-Vav chanan, that the Holy One shows unearned grace (chanan);** שְׁכִינְתָּא עִלָּאָה, שְׁכִינְתָּא תַּתָּאָה; וְאוֹת וָא"ו קוּדְשָׁא בְּרִיךְ הוּא, יו"ד – — **for the two letters heh in the Holy Name represent the Upper and Lower Heh — Upper and Lower Shechinah; – –** חָכְמָה עִלָּאָה, אַבָּא, כַּיָּדוּעַ מֵהַזֹּהַר — **and the letter vav is the Holy One, Blessed be He, and yud is Supernal Chochmah, Abba, as known from the Zohar.** וְאִיתָא בַּגְּמָרָא (בְּרָכוֹת נ"ז עַמּוּד א')[914]: שֶׁהָרוֹאֶה "חֲנִינָא", "חֲנַנְיָה", "יוֹחָנָן" — **And it states in the Gemara (Berachot 57a): –** נִסִּי נִסִּים נַעֲשָׂה לוֹ, וּפִרֵשׁ רַבִּי שְׁלֹמֹה יִצְחָקִי: "נוּנִי"ן הַרְבֵּה — **he who sees the name Chanina, Chananyah, or Yochanan in a dream, miracles of miracles are performed for him; –** נִסִּים וְיֵשׁ לְהָבִין לְשׁוֹן "נִסִּי נִסִּים", הַרְבֵּה" — **and Rashi explains: "Many letters nun signify many miracles (nissim)",** אַךְ הָעִנְיָן, דְּאִיתָא בְּרַבִּי חֲנִינָא בֶּן נִסִּים". — **and one must understand this phrasing: "miracles of miracles".** דוֹסָא (בְּתַעֲנִית שָׁם)[915] שֶׁאָמַר לְבִתּוֹ: — **However the explanation is: for it states regarding Rabbi Chanina ben Dosa (in Ta'anit ibid.) who said to his daughter:** "מִי שֶׁאָמַר לַשֶּׁמֶן וְיִדְלַק, הוּא יֹאמַר לַחֹמֶץ וְיִדְלַק", — **"He Who commanded the oil to burn, shall command the vinegar to burn",** וְהָיָה דּוֹלֵק עַד שֶׁהֵבִיאוּ מִמֶּנּוּ אוֹר לְהַבְדָּלָה. **and it burned until they brought from it light for Havdalah.** וְלִכְאוֹרָה הָא אֵין נֶהֱנִין מִנִּסִּים כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בְּגִמְרָא שָׁם, — **And ostensibly one may not benefit from miracles as stated in the Gemara there,** וְעַל כָּל פָּנִים אֵין לְבַקֵּשׁ עַל נֵס שֶׁמְּנַכִּין לוֹ מִזְּכִיּוֹתָיו (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב שָׁם כ' עַמּוּד ב')[916], — **and at all events one should not pray for a miracle since they deduct from his merits (Ta'anit 20b),** וְלָמָּה בִּקֵּשׁ רַבִּי חֲנִינָא בֶּן דּוֹסָא עַל מַעֲשֵׂה נִסִּים? — **so why did Rabbi Chanina ben Dosa pray for a miracle?**

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[913] **Bereshit Rabbah 68:2** (excerpt): "'From where will my help come?' (Psalms 121:1). Jacob said: When Eliezer went to bring Rebecca, what is written of him? 'The servant took ten camels' (Genesis 24:10). Yet I have neither one nose-ring nor one bracelet! Rabbi Chanina said: He sent him empty-handed. Rabbi Yehoshua ben Levi said: He sent possessions with him, but Esau arose and took them from him. Jacob reconsidered and said: Am I to lose hope in my Creator? Heaven forbid! I will not lose hope in my Creator. Rather, 'My help comes from Hashem' (Psalms 121:2)."

[914] **Berakhot 56b:20-21**; **Berakhot 57a:1**: "One who sees Pinchas in a dream will have a wonder performed for him. One who sees an elephant in a dream will have wonders performed for him; elephants, wonders upon wonders. But was it not taught that all kinds of wild animals are favorable signs in a dream except an elephant and a monkey? There is no contradiction: One case concerns a saddled elephant and the other an unsaddled one. One who sees Huna in a dream will have a miracle performed for him. One who sees Chanina, Chananyah, or Yochanan will have miracles upon miracles performed for him. One who sees the word hesped, 'eulogy,' in a dream has been shown compassion and redeemed by Heaven, reading it as chas, 'had compassion,' and padah, 'redeemed.' This applies when he sees the word in writing."

[915] **Taanit 25a**: 'The Gemara relates that one Shabbat evening, Rabbi Ḥanina ben Dosa saw that his daughter was sad. He said to her: My daughter, why are you sad? She said to him: I confused a vessel of vinegar for a vessel of oil and I lit the Shabbat lamp with vinegar. Soon the lamp will be extinguished and we will be left in the dark. He said to her: My daughter, what are you concerned about? He Who said to the oil that it should burn can say to the vinegar that it should burn. A tanna taught: That lamp burned continuously the entire day, until they brought from it light for havdala.'

[916] **Taanit 20b**: 'The Gemara explains: Rav Adda bar Ahava holds in accordance with this statement, as Rabbi Yannai said: A person should never stand in a place of danger and say: A miracle will be performed for me, and I will escape unharmed, lest a miracle is not performed for him. And if you say that a miracle will be performed for him, they will deduct it from his merits. Rav Ḥanan said: What is the verse that alludes to this idea? As it is written: "I have become small from all the mercies and all the truth that You have showed Your servant" (Genesis 32:11). In other words, the more benevolence one receives from God, the more his merit is reduced.'

Habit hides the divine word sustaining ordinary nature

אָמְנָם רַבִּי חֲנִינָא בֶּן דּוֹסָא, שֶׁהָיָה נֶפֶשׁ חֲנִינָא בְּדוֹרוֹ, שֶׁהִכִּיר שֶׁהַכֹּל מֵהַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ שֶׁחוֹנֵן,[917,918] — **However, Rabbi Chanina ben Dosa, who was the soul of Chanina in his era, knowing that all is from the Blessed Name Who bestows grace,** לֹא הָיָה אֶצְלוֹ שַׂכְוּת לְמַעֲשֶׂה נִסִּים כְּלָל; — **to him there was no concept of a separate miracle at all;** שֶׁזֶּה רַק מִי שֶׁמֻּרְגָּל בַּטֶּבַע כָּמוֹנוּ, וּכְשֶׁרוֹאֶה דָּבָר הַיּוֹצֵא מֵהַטֶּבַע הוּא נַס, — **for that distinction exists only for someone accustomed to nature like us, who upon seeing something supernatural calls it a miracle,** כְּמוֹ אֲצָלֵנוּ שֶׁנִּרְאֶה מַה שֶּׁשֶּׁמֶן דּוֹלֵק הוּא בַּטֶּבַע, וְשֶׁיִּדְלַק חֹמֶץ הוּא נַס; — **as we view oil burning as natural while vinegar burning is a miracle;** מַה שֶּׁאֵין כֵּן רַבִּי חֲנִינָא בֶּן דּוֹסָא הִכִּיר מִפֹּרֶשׁ שֶׁהַכֹּל מֵהַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ, — **unlike Rabbi Chanina ben Dosa who recognized vividly that everything is from the Blessed Name,** וּמַה שֶּׁהַשֶּׁמֶן דּוֹלֵק הוּא גַּם כֵּן בְּנֵס מִמַּעֲשֶׂה הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ, — **and that oil burning is likewise an ongoing miracle from the deeds of the Blessed Name,** וְ"הוּא יֹאמַר לַחֹמֶץ וְיִדְלַק", וְהַכֹּל אֶחָד. — **and "He Who commanded oil to burn shall command vinegar to burn", and all is one.** וְעַל זֶה רוֹמֵז מַה שֶּׁכָּתוּב בַּסְּפָרִים: אֱלֹהִי"ם בְּגִימַטְרִיָּא הַטֶּבַ"ע, — **And to this alludes what is written in the holy books: Elohim (86) equals HaTeva (86),** שֶׁהוּא שֶׁאַף מַה שֶּׁנִּרְאֶה לָעַיִן שֶׁמִּתְנַהֵג בַּטֶּבַע הוּא גַּם כֵּן רַק מַעֲשֶׂה אֱלֹהִים שֶׁהוּא בַּעַל הַכֹּחוֹת כֻּלָּם. — **meaning that even what appears to operate via nature is solely the deed of Elohim, the Master of all forces.** וְזֶהוּ "נִסֵּי נִסִּים נַעֲשָׂה לוֹ", שֶׁמֵּכִיר שֶׁהַכֹּל נִסִּים, וּמַה שֶּׁמַּכִּירִין הַכֹּל שֶׁהוּא בְּנֵס הוּא "נִסֵּי נִסִּים". — **And this is "miracles of miracles are performed for him", recognizing that all existence is miraculous, – and this profound realization that all is a miracle constitutes "miracles of miracles".**

וְעַל זֶה מוֹרֶה שְׁמוֹת חֲנִינָא, חֲנַנְיָה, יוֹחָנָן. וְזֶה עִנְיַן מַה שֶּׁכָּתוּב (שַׁבָּת ל"א עַמּוּד א'): "'אֱמוּנַת'[919] — **And to this point the names Chanina, Chananyah, and Yochanan. –** זֶה סֵדֶר זְרָעִים",[920] — **And this is the meaning of what is written (Shabbat 31a): "'Faith' (emunat) — this is the Order of Zera'im (Seeds)",** וְכָתְבוּ תּוֹסָפוֹת מִירוּשַׁלְמִי (וְכֵן הוּא מִדְרַשׁ שׁוֹחַר טוֹב תְּהִלִּים י"ט):[921] — **and Tosafot wrote from the Yerushalmi (and so in Midrash**

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[917] **Sod Yesharim, The Seventh Day of Pesach 4:2**: "Within that order (as it stands from God's side), a change of nature cannot be called a miracle or wonder. When that order shines, everyone sees explicitly that God gives life to creation at every moment. If the flow of life ceased for even a moment, the entire existence of creation would cease. How, then, can a particular change be called a wonder, when such a wonder is seen at every moment? It was like Adam immediately on the first day of his creation. Could he consider some newly seen thing a miracle, when everything was new to him and everything his eyes saw was a wonder? Seeing the sea moving and surging was itself a wonder to him. Only afterward, when he became accustomed to it and habit became nature, did it seem that nature required the sea always to move. If he then saw the sea stand still and become dry land, he would consider it a miracle because nature had changed. But when God opened Israel's understanding to the true order as it is with Him, they recognized it in their own understanding just as Adam did immediately after creation: He who tells the sea to move can tell it not to move."

Sod Yesharim explains the role of habit in the distinction Chanukah draws. The familiar event seems self-sustaining only because its constant renewal is no longer noticed. The greater disclosure is that creation receives life at every moment. This gives a precise account of Rabbi Hanina's seeing the same divine act in oil and vinegar.

[918] **Peri Tzadik, Pesach 32:1**: "Thus Rabbi Hanina ben Dosa said, "He who told oil to burn will tell vinegar to burn." Why did he mention "He who told oil to burn"? He needed to recall that God had implanted in oil its nature to burn; through this he could draw down the command that vinegar should burn. Similarly, I heard from the holy master concerning Elisha: "He cut a piece of wood, cast it there, and the iron floated." Why did he need to cut and cast wood? He wished to recall that God had implanted in wood the nature of floating on water, and by casting it he sought that God give this nature to iron too. Elisha did this through an act, while Rabbi Hanina recalled it with his mouth. To him this was not a miraculous act; otherwise he certainly would not have wished to benefit from it. It was clear before his eyes that there is no independent nature or habit, only the nature God gives to a thing. Oil burning was to him like vinegar burning. By verbally recalling "He who told oil to burn," acknowledging that this occurs only through God's utterance, he drew the flow to the vinegar so that it would burn."

The Pesach discussion explains the wording that Chanukah quotes. Mentioning oil is an act of recollection: the familiar property itself is grounded in a divine command, and the unusual event is approached through that recognition. The excerpt retains Rabbi Hanina's exceptional clarity and the prohibition problem that his clarity answers; it does not generalize his conduct to an ordinary observer.

[919] **Shabbat 31a:10**: "Reish Lakish said: What is meant by 'The faithfulness of your times, strength, salvations, wisdom and knowledge,' and so forth? 'Faithfulness' is the order Zeraim. 'Your times' is the order Moed. 'Strength' is the order Nashim. 'Salvations' is the order Nezikin. 'Wisdom' is the order Kodashim. 'Knowledge' is the order Taharos. Even so, 'Fear of the Lord is his treasure.'"

[920] **Shabbat 31a:10**: "Reish Lakish said: What is meant by 'The faithfulness of your times, strength, salvations, wisdom and knowledge,' and so forth? 'Faithfulness' is the order Zeraim. 'Your times' is the order Moed. 'Strength' is the order Nashim. 'Salvations' is the order Nezikin. 'Wisdom' is the order Kodashim. 'Knowledge' is the order Taharos. Even so, 'Fear of the Lord is his treasure.'"

[921] **Midrash Tehillim 19:11**: "Another interpretation: "The Torah of the Lord is perfect." When is it perfect? When it comes from the mouth of a wholehearted person. When is it trustworthy? When it comes from the mouth of a trustworthy person. Rabbi Tanhuma interpreted the passage in relation to the six orders of the Mishnah. "The Torah of the Lord is perfect"—this is the order Nashim, Women. "The testimony of the Lord is trustworthy"—this is the order Zeraim, Seeds, for a person places his trust in the Life of the world and sows. "The fear of the Lord is pure"—this is the order Taharot, Purities, which distinguishes between impurity and purity."

Shocher Tov, Psalm 19): שֶׁמַּאֲמִין בְּחַי הָעוֹלָמִים וְזוֹרֵעַ; **— that he believes in the Life of the Worlds and sows;** וְהֵינוּ שֶׁהָאֻמּוֹת זוֹרְעִין וְסוֹבְרִין שֶׁמַּצְמִיחַ בַּטֶּבַע, **— meaning that the nations sow assuming the earth produces crops naturally,** וְיִשְׂרָאֵל מַאֲמִינִים בְּחַי הָעוֹלָמִים שֶׁהוּא מַצְמִיחַ. **— while Israel believes in the Life of the Worlds Who alone causes growth.** וְיֵשׁ לוֹמַר שֶׁזֶּה שֶׁאָנוּ אוֹמְרִים בִּבְרָכַת הוֹדָאָה: "וְעַל נִסֶּיךָ שֶׁבְּכָל יוֹם עִמָּנוּ", מִפְּנֵי שֶׁבָּאֱמֶת הַכֹּל נִסִּים; **— And one can say this is why we recite in the blessing of Thanksgiving: "And for Your miracles that are daily with us", because in truth all is a miracle;** וְאוֹמְרִים זֶה בַּבְּרָכָה שֶׁכְּנֶגֶד הוֹד, דַּרְגָּא דְּאַהֲרֹן, **— and we state this in the blessing corresponding to Hod, Aaron's level,** שֶׁבּוֹ נֶאֱמַר גַּם כֵּן: "וְנַחְנוּ מָה", **— regarding whom it was likewise stated: "And what are we",** וְהוּא שֹׁרֶשׁ תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה שֶׁעָלֶיהָ אָמְרוּ בְּיִחוּד שֶׁנְּמְשָׁלָה לְמַיִם **— and he is the root of the Oral Torah, of which they said specifically that it is likened to water** שֶׁמַּנִּיחִין מָקוֹם גָּבוֹהַּ וְהוֹלֵךְ לְמָקוֹם נָמוּךְ (תַּעֲנִית ז׳ עַמּוּד א׳)[922]; **— which abandons a high place and flows to a lowly place (Ta'anit 7a);** וּמִי שֶׁיֵּשׁ בּוֹ שֹׁרֶשׁ הַשִּׁפְלוּת מַכִּיר שֶׁהַכֹּל בָּא בְּנֵס מֵהַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ. **— and one who possesses the root of humility recognizes that everything arrives miraculously from the Blessed Name.**

וְכֵן מַזְכִּירִין בִּבְרָכָה זוֹ נֵס חֲנֻכָּה, שֶׁנַּעֲשָׂה עַל יְדֵי הַהַכָּרָה שֶׁהַכֹּל מֵהַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ; **— And likewise in this blessing we commemorate the Chanukah miracle, wrought through the recognition that all is from God;** דְּאִם לֹא כֵן, אֵיךְ הָיוּ נִכְנָסִים חֲמִשָּׁה אֲנָשִׁים לְלֹחֶם גֶּגֶד עַם רַב כַּיְּוָנִים שֶׁמָּשְׁלוּ בְּכָל הָעוֹלָם אָז? **— for if not so, how could five men enter battle against a multitude like the Greeks who dominated the known world then?** וְאַף בַּחֲנַנְיָה, מִישָׁאֵל וַעֲזַרְיָה מָצִינוּ שֶׁאָמַר לָהֶם יְחֶזְקֵאל: **— And even regarding Chananiah, Mishael, and Azariah we find that Ezekiel told them:** "'מִקִּבֵּל אֲנִי מִישַׁעְיָה רַבִּי: 'חֲבִי כִמְעַט רֶגַע וְגוֹמֵר" **— "I have received from Isaiah my teacher: 'Hide for a little moment, etc.'"** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב שִׁיר הַשִּׁירִים רַבָּה פָּרָשָׁה ז׳ פָּסוּק ח׳)[923] **— (Shir HaShirim Rabbah, Parashah 7, verse 8),** וְהֵם רָצוּ לְקַדֵּשׁ שֵׁם שָׁמַיִם וְלֹא לָצֵאת לַמִּלְחָמָה; **— and they sought only to sanctify God's Name passively and not launch war;** וְהַחַשְׁמוֹנָאִים שֶׁיָּצְאוּ לַמִּלְחָמָה, בְּוַדַּאי אֵין מָקוֹם לְמִלְחָמָה כָּזוֹ בִּמְתֵי מְעַט, **— whereas the Hasmoneans who initiated war, certainly there was no place for such warfare with so few men,** רַק מִפְּנֵי שֶׁהוֹפִיעַ בָּהֶם אָז מִדְרֵגָה זוֹ שֶׁיָּדְעוּ שֶׁהַכֹּל בְּנֵס, **— only because this sublime level shone within them, knowing that everything is a miracle,** כְּעֵין מַה שֶּׁאָמַר רַבִּי חָנִינָא בֶּן דּוֹסָא: "מִי שֶׁאָמַר לַשֶּׁמֶן וְיִדְלַק וְכוּלֵיהּ", **— akin to Rabbi Chanina ben Dosa's declaration: "He Who commanded the oil to burn, etc.",** שֶׁהַכֹּל יַד הַשֵּׁם עוֹשָׂה וְאֵין שׁוּם דָּבָר בַּטֶּבַע; **— that God's hand does all and nothing occurs through independent nature;** וּמִי שֶׁיִּתֵּן כֹּחַ לְגִבּוֹרֵי מִלְחָמָה הַמֻּרְבִּים לִכְבֹּשׁ, אֵין מַעְצוֹר לוֹ לְהוֹשִׁיעַ גַּם לְמִתֵּי מִסְפָּר, **— and He Who gives might to numerous warriors to conquer is under no restraint to save even through a handful,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁמּוֹרֶה שֵׁם "יוֹחָנָן" עַל נִסֵּי נִסִּים כָּאֲמוּר. **— just as the name Yochanan denotes miracles of miracles as stated.** וּשְׁתֵּים עֶשְׂרֵה בְּרָכוֹת אֶמְצָעִיּוֹת מַתְחִיל בִּבְרָכַת "חוֹנֵן הַדָּעַת". **— And the twelve middle blessings begin with the blessing Chonen HaDa'at (Graciously bestowing knowledge).** וּבַזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ מָצִינוּ כְּמַעַט בְּכָל דַּף הַיְקָרוּת מִדִּבְרֵי תוֹרָה, **— And in the Holy Zohar we find on nearly every page the supreme preciousness of Torah words,** וְעִקַּר הַדַּעַת הוּא תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה שֶׁהוּא הַרְבֵּה חָכְמָה לְתַקֵּן הַרְבֵּה כַּעַס, **— and the essence of Da'at is the Oral Torah, which is abundant wisdom to rectify abundant grief,** וְעַל זֶה אָמְרוּ (זֹהַר חֵלֶק א׳ ר״ב עַמּוּד א׳): "דְּהָא לֵית לָךְ מִלָּה לְתַבְּרָא יֵצֶר הָרָע אֶלָּא אוֹרַיְתָא". **— and on this they stated (Zohar Part I, 202a): "For you have no instrument to break the Evil Inclination except Torah".**[924] וְהַתּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה זוֹכִין עַל יְדֵי רוּחַ הַקֹּדֶשׁ, כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ כַּמָּה פְּעָמִים מֵהָרַמְבַּ"ן, וְרַבִּי שְׁלֹמֹה יִצְחָקִי פֵּרֵשׁ בְּפָרָשַׁת כִּי תִשָּׂא: "וּבְדַעַת **— And one merits the Oral Torah through Divine Inspiration, as we explained often from the Ramban, –** רוּחַ הַקֹּדֶשׁ". **— and Rashi explained in Ki Tisa: "And with knowledge (Da'at) — Divine Inspiration".** וְהָעִקָּר שֶׁיִּהְיוּ דִּבְרֵי אֱלֹהִים חַיִּים, כְּמַה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: "דִּבְרֵי אֲשֶׁר **— And the fundamental goal is that they be the words of the Living God: "My words** שַׂמְתִּי בְּפִיךָ",

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[922] **Taanit 7a**: ‘Similarly, Rav Yehuda said: The day of the rains is as great as the day on which the Torah was given, as it is stated: “My doctrine likḥi shall drop as the rain” (Deuteronomy 32:2), and lekaḥ means nothing other than Torah, as it is stated: “For I give you good doctrine lekaḥ; do not forsake My Torah” (Proverbs 4:2). Rava said: Rainfall is even greater than the day on which the Torah was given, as it is stated: “My doctrine shall drop as the rain,” and when one makes a comparison, which object is made dependent upon which? You must say that the lesser object is dependent upon the greater one. If Torah is compared to rain, it follows that rain is greater than Torah.’

[923] **Shir HaShirim Rabbah 7:8:1** (excerpt): “They went immediately to Ezekiel and asked him, as they had asked Daniel: Shall we bow to it or not? He said to them: I have already received from Isaiah my teacher, ‘Hide for a brief moment until the wrath passes’ (Isaiah 26:20). They said to him: Do you wish people to say that all the nations bowed to this image? He said: What do you propose? They said: We wish to discredit it by being present and not bowing, so that people will say: All the nations bow to this image except Israel.”

[924] **Zohar, Miketz 12:194-206**: ‘The brothers were afraid on account of their sin in having stolen Joseph, for had they not sinned they would not have had any cause to fear; for it is only a man’s sins that break his courage and deprive him of strength, the reason being that the good prompter is at the same time unnerved, and left powerless to contend with the evil prompter. This is implied in the words: “What man is there that is fearful and faint- hearted?” (Deut. 20, 8), on account, that is, of sins which he may have committed, these being the ruin of a stout heart.’

which I have placed in your mouth", ."אַתָּה חוֹנֵן": וְזֶה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר — **and this is why we bless: "You graciously bestow (Chonen)".** ,וְלִזְכּוֹת לְתוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה צָרִיךְ שֶׁיִּהְיֶה דַּעְתּוֹ שְׁפָלָה — **And to merit the Oral Torah one must possess a humble spirit,** ,שֶׁעַל זֶה אָמְרוּ בַּגְּמָרָא (תַּעֲנִית ז׳ עַמּוּד א׳)[925] שֶׁנִּמְשְׁלוּ לְמַיִם — **regarding which they stated in the Gemara (Ta'anit 7a) that it is likened to water,** ,"הוֹי כָּל צָמֵא לְכוּ לַמַּיִם": וְהַיְנוּ בְּמַה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר — **alluding to: "Ho, everyone that thirsts, come to the waters",** ,"לִקְרַאת צָמֵא הֲתָיוּ מָיִם": דְּמוֹקֵי בַּגְּמָרָא בְּתַלְמִיד הָגוּן — **and stated: "Bring water to meet him that is thirsty", which the Gemara applies to a worthy and unworthy student;** ;וְאֵינוֹ הָגוּן — **and this refers to the Oral Torah which is learned only from an authentic master,** (כְּמוֹ דְּתוֹרָה שֶׁבִּכְתָב כְּרוּכָה וּמֻנַּחַת וְכוּלֵיהּ כָּל הָרוֹצֶה יָבֹא וְיִלְמֹד שֶׁכָּתוּב קִדּוּשִׁין ס״ו עַמּוּד א׳).[926] — **for the Written Torah lies wrapped and placed, and anyone wishing may come and learn (Kiddushin 66a).** ,וְכֵן הַתּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה נִמְשְׁלָה לִשְׁלֹשָׁה מַשְׁקִין שֶׁאֵין מִתְקַיְּמִין אֶלָּא בִּפְחוֹת שֶׁבַּכֵּלִים וְכוּלֵיהּ — **And the Oral Torah is likened to three liquids which keep only in the lowliest earthenware vessels,** ,וּמַזֶּה — **which is what is written: "And without price wine and milk",** ."וּבְלוֹא מְחִיר יַיִן וְחָלָב": וְהַיְנוּ מַה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר — **and from this they derived that Torah words endure only in one whose mind is humble;** ;לָמְדוּ שֶׁאֵין דִּבְרֵי תוֹרָה מִתְקַיְּמִין אֶלָּא בְּמִי שֶׁדַּעְתּוֹ שְׁפָלָה — **and this alludes likewise to the Oral Torah, akin to: "Honey and milk are under your tongue".** ."דְּבַשׁ וְחָלָב תַּחַת לְשׁוֹנֶךָ": וְזֶה רוֹמֵז גַּם כֵּן עַל תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה, כְּעִין מַה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר

Even the powers of devotion are received as a gift

"וְחַנּוֹתִי אֶת אֲשֶׁר אָחֹן ,כְּעִנְיַן מַה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר ,חוֹנֵן ,שֶׁהַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרֵךְ ,מַכִּירִין ,וְעַל יְדֵי הַשִּׁפְלוּת[927, 928] — **And through humility one recognizes that the Blessed Name acts with gratuitous grace (chonen), –** אַף עַל פִּי שֶׁאֵינוֹ הָגוּן (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בְּרָכוֹת ז׳ עַמּוּד א׳).[929] — **as in Scripture: "And I will be gracious to whom I will be gracious" — even though he is not worthy (Berachot 7a).** ,"וַתְּהִי אֶסְתֵּר נֹשֵׂאת חֵן וְגוֹמֵר": וְיֵשׁ לוֹמַר שֶׁנֶּרְמַז גַּם כֵּן בְּמַה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר בְּאֶסְתֵּר — **And one can say this is alluded to in what is written of Esther: "And Esther obtained grace (chen), etc.",** ,שֶׁרוֹמֵז שֶׁהִכִּירָה שֶׁהַכֹּל מֵהַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרֵךְ בְּחֵן וּבְחֶסֶד — **hinting that she recognized all as unearned grace and lovingkindness from God,** ,"וַתִּלְבַּשׁ אֶסְתֵּר מַלְכוּת": וְעַל יְדֵי כֵן — **and through this: "And Esther clothed**

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[925] **Taanit 7a**: ‘Rabbi Ḥanina bar Pappa raised a contradiction. In one verse it is written: “To him who is thirsty bring water” (Isaiah 21:14), which indicates that the one who has water must bring it to the thirsty person, and it is written elsewhere: “Ho, everyone who thirsts, come for water” (Isaiah 55:1), from which it may be inferred that the thirsty person must seek out water himself. Rabbi Ḥanina bar Pappa resolves this apparent contradiction by explaining that if he is a worthy student the teacher must seek him out, as in “to him who is thirsty bring water,” but if the student is not worthy, then “Ho, everyone who thirsts, come for water,” i.e., this student must seek out a teacher himself.’

[926] **Kiddushin 66a**: ‘The Gemara interjects: Rav Naḥman bar Yitzḥak says: Immediately, heresy was injected into Yannai, as he should have said to Elazar ben Po’ira: This works out well with regard to the Written Torah, as it can be studied by all on their own, but what will become of the Oral Torah? The Oral Torah is transmitted only by the Sages. The baraita continues: Immediately, the evil arose and caught fire through Elazar ben Po’ira, and all the Sages of the Jewish people were killed. And the world was desolate of Torah until Shimon ben Shataḥ came and restored the Torah to its former glory. This completes the baraita.’

[927] **Machshavot Charutz 8:16**: “This is a “wonder”—something wondrous and concealed. “Wonder” does not properly refer to the miracle itself: what wonder is it for God to perform a miracle? “He who told oil to burn will tell vinegar to burn.” Is the natural order not itself wondrous? God established it so, and when He wishes to change it, who can prevent Him? But “the Holy One does not perform a miracle for falsehood”: everything follows judgment. When it is not according to the apparent judgment, that is called a wonder—performing a miracle for someone not worthy of it. This occurs only through the revelation of the supreme wonder, the wondrous place to which Israel is bound, having arisen first in thought: the depth of the beginning of thought, the nothingness preceding the being within thought. They are the seed of truth, and “truth is Torah”; whoever is bound to Torah is bound to everything, to the head of all degrees.” Machshavot Charutz distinguishes altering nature from the deeper wonder of deliverance beyond apparent desert. It locates the latter in Israel’s prior root, while explicitly retaining divine judgment. This clarifies the grace toward the unworthy that Chanukah joins to humble recognition, rather than treating grace as a person’s entitlement.

[928] **Tiferet Yosef, Talmud Anthology, Chagigah 5**: “Concerning this the verse says, “Let the wise person not boast of his wisdom, nor the mighty person of his might, nor the wealthy person of his wealth.” My holy grandfather explained that the verse is not discussing worldly matters. “Who is mighty? One who masters his inclination”; “Who is wealthy? One who rejoices in his portion,” whose soul is settled within him; and the wise person is one in whose heart Torah’s light shines. Yet a person should not boast of these attainments and take an independent power from them. Rather, the verse concludes, “Only in this should the one who boasts boast: understanding and knowing Me.” The one who masters his inclination must recognize that God gave him the power to overcome all obstacles solely for His service. One who rejoices in his portion must recognize that God illuminates this power within him. The sage, in the light of his Torah, must recognize that none of it comes independently from him: God graciously grants it to him each time for His service.” Tiferet Yosef extends the warning against self-credit to the very attainments a religious person might claim as his own: self-restraint, contentment, and Torah wisdom. That is the practical depth of Chanukah’s three gifts. Humility does not cancel their use; it identifies their purpose as continued service.

[929] **Berakhot 7a:29**: “This differs from Rabbi Meir’s view. For Rabbi Meir said: Two requests were granted to Moshe, and one was not granted to him, as it says, ‘I shall be gracious to whom I shall be gracious’—even if that person is unworthy; ‘and I shall show mercy to whom I shall show mercy’—even if that person is unworthy.”

herself in royalty", שֶׁנִּדְרְשׁוּ בַּגְּמָרָא וּבַזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ (חֶלֶק ג׳ קס״ט עַמּוּד ב׳)[930, 931] **— which they expounded in the Gemara and Zohar (Part III, 169b) that the Holy Spirit clothed her,** וְהָיְנוּ מִדַּת מַלְכוּת, **— which is the sefirah of Malchut;** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמַרְנוּ שֶׁעַל זֶה רוֹמֵז שֶׁהִיא סוֹף כָּל הַנְּפָשִׁים שֶׁמְּכֻנָּן נֶגֶד מִדַּת מַלְכוּת. **— and as we explained, this is why she represents the end of all miracles, corresponding to Malchut.** וְאִיתָא (בְּמִדְרָשׁ רַבָּה וּמִדְרָשׁ תַּנְחוּמָא מַטּוֹת):[932] **— And it states (in Midrash Rabbah and Midrash Tanchuma, Mattot):** שְׁלֹשׁ מַתָּנוֹת בָּרָא הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא בָּעוֹלָם: חָכְמָה, וּגְבוּרָה, וְעֹשֶׁר וְכוּלֵיהּ; **— Three gifts the Holy One created in the world: wisdom, strength, and wealth, etc.;** וְאָמַרְנוּ שֶׁהֵם נֶגֶד חַיֵּי, בָּנֵי וּמְזוֹנֵי: **— and we explained that they correspond to life, children, and sustenance (chayei, banei, u-mezonei):** "הַחָכְמָה תְּחַיֶּה בְּעָלֶיהָ"; דְּתוֹרָה עִקַּר הַחַיִּים, וּכְתִיב: **— for Torah is the core of life (chayei), and it is written: "Wisdom gives life to those who possess it";** וּגְבוּרָה[933] נֶגֶד בָּנֵי, עַל דָּרֶךְ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר (דִּבְרֵי הַיָּמִים א פֶּרֶק ח׳): "גִּבּוֹרֵי חַיִל וְגוֹמֵר וּמֹרְכִּים בָּנִים וּבְנֵי בָנִים"; **— and strength corresponds to children (banei), as stated (I Chronicles 8): "mighty men of valor, etc., having many sons and sons' sons";** וְעֹשֶׁר הַיְנוּ מְזוֹנֵי (וְנִתְבָּאֵר פָּרָשַׁת וַיִּשְׁלַח מַאֲמָר ו׳);[934] **— and wealth represents sustenance (mezonei) (elaborated in Parashat Vayishlach, discourse 6);** וְאִיתָא בַּמִּדְרָשׁ שָׁם: אֵימָתַי? בִּזְמַן שֶׁהֵם מַתְנוֹת שָׁמַיִם וְכוּלֵיהּ, **— and it states in the Midrash there: When are they blessed? When they are acknowledged as gifts of Heaven, etc.,** וְהָיְנוּ שֶׁהָעִקָּר שֶׁיַּכִּירוּ כִּי הֵם מֵהַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרֵךְ וְנָתַן לָהֶם בְּמַתְּנַת חִנָּם. **— meaning that the foundation is that they recognize that they stem from God, granted as a gratuitous gift.** וְזֶה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר בְּחָכְמָה: "אַתָּה חוֹנֵן וְכוּלֵיהּ, וְחָנַנְוּ מֵאִתְּךָ וְכוּלֵיהּ, חוֹנֵן הַדָּעַת". וּבָנִים **— And this is what is said regarding wisdom: "You graciously bestow, etc., and bestow upon us from You, etc., Who graciously bestows knowledge."** – הָיָה יַעֲקֹב אָבִינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם שֶׁהוֹלִיד הַשְּׁנֵים עָשָׂר שְׁבָטִים שֶׁנִּשְׁתַּתֵּת מֵהֶם כְּנֶסֶת יִשְׂרָאֵל, **— And regarding children — it was Jacob our Father who fathered the Twelve Tribes from whom was founded Knesset Yisrael,** וְאָמַר: "הַיְלָדִים אֲשֶׁר חָנַן אֱלֹהִים וְגוֹמֵר"; **— saying: "The children whom God has graciously given (chanan), etc.";** וּבְבִנְיָמִין שֶׁלֹּא נוֹלַד אָז נִזְכַּר גַּם כֵּן לְשׁוֹן חֲנִינָה בּוֹ, **— and regarding Benjamin who was not yet born then, the language of chaninah is likewise used,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בַּמִּדְרָשׁ "אֱלֹהִים יָחְנְךָ בְּנִי" שֶׁאָמַר לוֹ יוֹסֵף;[935] רַבָּה); **— for Joseph said to him: "God be gracious unto you (yachnecha), my son" (Bereishit Rabbah);** וְהַיְנוּ שֶׁהַכֹּל אֶחָד, לְשׁוֹן "חֵן" וּלְשׁוֹן "חָנַן", **— meaning that all is one: the term chen (favor) and the term chanan (graced),** שֶׁהוּא הַהַכָּרָה שֶׁהַכֹּל מֵהַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרֵךְ בְּחִנָּם אַף עַל פִּי שֶׁאֵינוֹ כְּדַאי. **— denoting the humble awareness that all is from the Blessed Name by unearned grace even when one is unworthy.** וְזֶה הִכִּיר יַעֲקֹב אָבִינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם, וּכְמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב (בְּרֵאשִׁית רַבָּה פָּרָשָׁה ע״א): "כָּל מָקוֹם שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר 'דַּל', 'עָנִי', וְ'אֶבְיוֹן'[936] **— And this Jacob our Father recognized, –** בְּיִשְׂרָאֵל הַכָּתוּב מְדַבֵּר".[937] וּמְזוֹנֵי **— as written (Bereishit Rabbah 71): "Wherever it states 'destitute', 'poor', and 'needy' — Scripture speaks of Israel."** – כְּבָר אָמַרְנוּ שֶׁזֶּהוּ מַה שֶּׁכָּתוּב: "כָּל הָעוֹלָם כֻּלּוֹ נִיזּוֹנִין בִּשְׁבִיל חֲנִינָא בְּנִי", **— And regarding sustenance (mezonei) — we explained that this is what is written: "The entire world is nourished for the sake of Chanina My son",** הַיְנוּ בִּשְׁבִיל נָפֶשׁ שֶׁמַּכִּיר שֶׁהַכֹּל בְּחֵן

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930 **Zohar, Sh'lach 30:227-236**: 'Now it came to pass on the third day, that Esther put on royalty (va-tilbash Esther malkhut)' (Esther 5:1): the Zohar (Sh'lach III 169b, alongside Megillah 14b) explains that 'she put on royalty' means that the supernal Sefirah of Malkhut—the Holy Spirit (Ruach HaKodesh) and the light of the Oral Torah—clothed itself within Esther.'

931 **Zohar, Sh'lach 30:227-236**: 'In the Zohar (Parashat Sh'lach, III 169b), it is taught that the Holy One, blessed be He, consults with the souls of the righteous in the heavenly academy before issuing decrees upon the world.'

932 **Bamidbar Rabbah 22:7** (excerpt): "Three gifts were created in the world. Whoever merits one of them has acquired what the entire world desires. Whoever merits wisdom has merited everything; whoever merits strength has merited everything; whoever merits wealth has merited everything. When is this so? When they are gifts of Heaven and come through the power of Torah. But a mortal's own strength and wealth are nothing. Thus Solomon says, 'I returned and saw under the sun that the race is not to the swift, nor the battle to the mighty, nor bread to the wise, nor wealth to the understanding, nor favor to the knowledgeable, for time and circumstance happen to them all' (Ecclesiastes 9:11)."

933 **I Chronicles 8:40**: 'And the sons of Ulam were mighty men of valor, archers, and had many sons, and sons' sons, a hundred and fifty. All these were of the sons of Benjamin.'

934 **Bamidbar Rabbah 22:7** (excerpt): "Three gifts were created in the world. Whoever merits one of them has acquired what the entire world desires. Whoever merits wisdom has merited everything; whoever merits strength has merited everything; whoever merits wealth has merited everything. When is this so? When they are gifts of Heaven and come through the power of Torah. But a mortal's own strength and wealth are nothing. Thus Solomon says, 'I returned and saw under the sun that the race is not to the swift, nor the battle to the mighty, nor bread to the wise, nor wealth to the understanding, nor favor to the knowledgeable, for time and circumstance happen to them all' (Ecclesiastes 9:11)."

935 **Bereshit Rabbah 92:5** (excerpt): "'He lifted his eyes and saw …' (Genesis 43:29). Rabbi Binyamin said: We have heard an expression of grace concerning eleven tribes, but we have not heard one concerning Benjamin's tribe. Where do we hear it? Here we hear it: 'He said: God be gracious to you, my son' (Genesis 43:29)."

936 **Bereshit Rabbah 71:1** (excerpt): "'For Hashem listens to the needy'—these are Israel. For Rabbi Yochanan said: Wherever 'poor,' 'afflicted,' and 'needy' are stated, Scripture is speaking about Israel."

937 **Bereshit Rabbah 71:1** (excerpt): "'For Hashem listens to the needy'—these are Israel. For Rabbi Yochanan said: Wherever 'poor,' 'afflicted,' and 'needy' are stated, Scripture is speaking about Israel."

וַחֲנִינָה מֵהַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ, — **meaning for the sake of a soul who recognizes that all is through grace and unmerited favor from the Blessed Name,** וְהַכֹּל שָׁוֶה שֶׁאֵין שׁוּם טֶבַע וְהַכֹּל כְּעֵין נֶס. — **wherein all events are equal in that there is no independent nature and all is fundamentally miraculous.**

וְעַל פִּי זֶה יֵשׁ לוֹמַר הַגְּרָסָא בְּגֶמָרָא בְּרָכוֹת: — **And according to this, one can explain the reading in the Gemara Berachot:** "בְּכָל יוֹם בַּת קוֹל יוֹצֵאת מֵהַר חוֹרֵב וְאוֹמֶרֶת: כָּל הָעוֹלָם וְכוּלֵיהּ"; — **"Every day a Heavenly Voice issues from Mount Horeb proclaiming: The entire world, etc.";** וּבְתַעֲנִית כָּתַב רַבִּי שְׁלֹמֹה יִצְחָקִי זְקֵן "מֵהַר חוֹרֵב", וְהַיְנוּ דְּלֹא שַׁיָּךְ הַבַּת קוֹל לְהַר חוֹרֵב, — **whereas in Ta'anit Rashi wrote that we do not read "from Mount Horeb", because ostensibly a Heavenly Voice does not belong to Mount Horeb** דְּשַׁיָּךְ רַק גַּבֵּי הַבַּת קוֹל "אוֹי לָהֶם לַבְּרִיּוֹת מֵעֶלְבּוֹנָהּ שֶׁל תּוֹרָה" (פֶּרֶק ו׳ דְּאָבוֹת)[938] — **which applies only regarding the proclamation "Woe to the creations for the insult of the Torah" (Avot 6:2)** שֶׁיּוֹצֵאת מֵהַר חוֹרֵב שֶׁקִּבְּלוּ הַתּוֹרָה, — **which issues from Mount Horeb where they received the Torah,** אֲבָל בַּת קוֹל זֶה לָמָּה יוֹצֵאת מֵהַר חוֹרֵב? — **but why would this proclamation regarding food issue from Mount Horeb?** וּלְפִי הָאֲמוּר יֵשׁ לוֹמַר עַל פִּי מַה שֶּׁכָּתוּב (פְּסָחִים קי״ח עַמּוּד א׳):[939] — **Yet according to our explanation, one can explain based on what is stated (Pesachim 118a):** "עֶשְׂרִים וְשִׁשָּׁה 'הוֹדוּ' כְּנֶגֶד עֶשְׂרִים וְשִׁשָּׁה דּוֹרוֹת שֶׁבָּרָא הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא בְּעוֹלָמוֹ וְלֹא נָתַן לָהֶם תּוֹרָה וְזָן אוֹתָם בְּחַסְדּוֹ", — **"Twenty-six verses of 'Give thanks' correspond to the twenty-six generations that the Holy One created in His world without giving them the Torah, yet sustained them through His lovingkindness",** וּמִשְׁמַע שֶׁאַחַר מַתַּן תּוֹרָה בָּאִים הַמְּזוֹנוֹת בִּזְכוּת הַתּוֹרָה, — **implying that after the giving of the Torah, physical sustenance arrives through the merit of the Torah;** וְיוֹצֵא הַבַּת קוֹל מֵהַר חוֹרֵב: — **and so the Heavenly Voice proclaims from Mount Horeb:** שֶׁכָּל הָעוֹלָם נִזּוֹן בִּשְׁבִיל נֶפֶשׁ שֶׁיֵּשׁ לוֹ מִדַּת חֲנִינָא, — **that the entire world is nourished for the sake of a soul who possesses the quality of Chanina,** שֶׁהוּא מַכִּיר שֶׁכָּל הַדִּבְרֵי תוֹרָה מֵהַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ שֶׁחוֹנֵן בְּמַתָּנַת חִנָּם, — **who recognizes that all Torah words are from the Blessed Name Who grants free grace,** וּבִשְׁבִילוֹ כָּל הָעוֹלָם נִזּוֹנִין, וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמַרְנוּ, — **and for his sake the entire universe is fed, as we explained;** וּמֵיָּשָׁב הַגְּרָסָא בִּבְרָכוֹת "מֵהַר חוֹרֵב". — **and the textual reading in Berachot "from Mount Horeb" is beautifully resolved.** וְזֶה עִנְיַן מַה שֶּׁכָּתוּב בַּגְּמָרָא (גִּטִּין ל״ד עַמּוּד ב׳):[940] — **And this is the inner meaning of what is stated in the Gemara (Gittin 34b):** "בְּנֵי אָדָם הַבָּאִים מִשָּׁם לְכָאן, שְׁמוֹ יוֹסֵף וְקוֹרִין לוֹ יוֹחָנָן, יוֹחָנָן וְקוֹרִין לוֹ יוֹסֵף וְכוּלֵיהּ", — **"People who come from there to here, his name is Yosef and they call him Yochanan, Yochanan and they call him Yosef, etc.",** וְלִכְאוֹרָה יִפָּלֵא שֶׁתָּפַס שִׁנּוּי בַּשֵּׁמוֹת לְמָשָׁל בְּשֵׁמוֹת שֶׁאֵינוֹ מֻרְגָּל כְּמוֹ יוֹחָנָן? — **and seemingly it is astonishing that it selected a permutation of names using an uncommon example like Yochanan?** וּלְפִי הָאֲמוּר יֵשׁ חֵסֶד לְשֶׁנֵּי הַשֵּׁמוֹת הָאֵלּוּ: — **However, according to what was explained there is a profound kinship between these two names:** דְּשֵׁם יוֹחָנָן מוֹרֶה שֶׁמַּכִּיר שֶׁהַכֹּל בַּחֲנִינָה מֵהַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ, — **for the name Yochanan denotes one who acknowledges that all is through grace from the Blessed Name,** וְעַל זֶה מוֹרֶה שֵׁם יו״ד-וָא״ו חָנָן; — **as indicated by the name Yud-Vav chanan;**

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[938] **Pirkei Avot 6:2**: “Rabbi Joshua ben Levi said: every day a bat kol (a heavenly voice) goes forth from Mount Horeb and makes proclamation and says: “Woe unto humankind for their contempt towards the Torah”, for whoever does not occupy himself with the study of Torah is called, nazuf (the rebuked. As it is said, “Like a gold ring in the snout of a pig is a beautiful woman bereft of sense” (Proverbs 11:22). And it says, “And the tablets were the work of God, and the writing was the writing of God, graven upon the tablets” (Exodus 32:16). Read not haruth ‘graven’ but heruth ‘freedom’. For there is no free man but one that occupies himself with the study of the Torah. And whoever regularly occupies himself with the study of the Torah he is surely exalted, as it is said, “And from Mattanah to Nahaliel; and Nahaliel to Bamoth” (Numbers 21:19).”

[939] **Pesachim 118a:4**: “Rabbi Yehoshua ben Levi said: To what do these twenty-six expressions of thanksgiving correspond? To the twenty-six generations that the Holy One, blessed be He, created in His world before giving them Torah, whom He sustained through His kindness.”

[940] **Gittin 34b:3**: “Gemara: Rav Yehudah said in Shmuel’s name: People from overseas sent Rabban Gamliel this question: ‘Men come from there to here whose name is Yosef, but they are called Yochanan here, or whose name is Yochanan, but they are called Yosef. How are they to divorce their wives?’ Rabban Gamliel arose and instituted that the document should state, ‘The man so-and-so and every name he has,’ and ‘The woman so-and-so and every name she has,’ for the orderly functioning of society. Rav Ashi said: This applies when the man is established as having two names. Rabbi Abba told Rav Ashi: Rabbi Mari and Rabbi Elazar agree with you.”

Receiving strength from God calls for clearer chosen restraint

וְכֵן יוֹסֵף מֶרְכָּבָה לְמִדַּת צַדִּיק יְסוֹד עוֹלָם,[941,942] — **and likewise Joseph is the chariot for the Tzaddik, Foundation of the World,** כִּי כֹל בַּשָּׁמַיִם וּבָאָרֶץ", וּמְתַרְגְּמִינַן: "דְּאָחִיד בִּשְׁמַיָּא וְאַרְעָא", שָׁמַיִם — **"for all that is in heaven and earth", which the Targum renders: "who grasps heaven and earth", –** קוּדְשָׁא בְּרִיךְ הוּא כַּיְדוּעַ, — **heaven denoting the Holy One as is known,** וְהֵינוּ גַּם כֵּן שֶׁמַּכִּיר שֶׁהַכֹּל מֵהַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא. — **which means likewise that he recognizes everything is from the Holy One.** וְכֵן מִדַּת יוֹסֵף שֶׁהָיָה גִּבּוֹר הַכּוֹבֵשׁ אֶת יִצְרוֹ, — **And likewise the quality of Joseph was being a warrior conquering his inclination,** וְהַיְנוּ עַל יְדֵי תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה, — **and that is achieved through the Oral Torah,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ זֶה אָמְרוּ בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ: "לֵית לָךְ מִלָּה לְתַבְרָא יֵצֶר הָרָע אֶלָּא אוֹרַיְתָא"; — **as we explained from the Holy Zohar: "You have no instrument to break the Evil Inclination except Torah";** וְכֵן אָמְרוּ בַּגְּמָרָא (סָכָּה נ״ב עַמּוּד ב׳): "אִם פָּגַע בְּךָ מְנַוָּל זֶה, מְשָׁכֵהוּ לְבֵית הַמִּדְרָשׁ",[943] — **and so they said in the Gemara (Sukkah 52b): "If this repulsive one encounters you, drag him to the Study Hall",** וּבֵית הַמִּדְרָשׁ הֵינוּ מְקוֹם חִדּוּשׁ הֲלָכוֹת, — **and the Study Hall is the place where halachot are innovated,** וְהוּא גַּם כֵּן בְּחִינַת הוֹד, דַּרְגָּא דְּאַהֲרֹן. — **which is also the aspect of Hod, the level of Aaron.** וּבִגְזֵרַת יָוָן כְּבָר זָכַרְנוּ דְּאָז הָיָה הַגְּזֵרָה (שֶׁנִּזְכְּרָה רֵישׁ כְּתֻבּוֹת)[944] — **And during the Greek persecution we already recalled that then was the decree (recorded at the start of Ketubot)** "תִּבָּעֵל לַשַּׁפְּסָר תְּחִלָּה", — **"she shall be intimacy-subjected to the commander first",** וְהַיְנוּ שֶׁרָצוּ לְהַטִּיל בְּיִשְׂרָאֵל זוּהֲמַת הַנָּחָשׁ שֶׁפָּסְקָה אַחַר מַתַּן תּוֹרָה, — **meaning they sought to inject into Israel the serpent's contamination which had ceased after the giving of the Torah,** וּכְעֵין מַה שֶּׁכָּתוּב בְּיַעֵל דְּקָא שָׁדֵי בָּהּ זוּהֲמָא (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב יְבָמוֹת ק״ג עַמּוּד ב׳),[945] — **similar to what is written regarding Yael that Sisera injected defilement into her (Yevamot 103b),** וּכְעֵין מַה שֶּׁכָּתוּב (בְּרֵאשִׁית רַבָּה פָּרָשָׁה הַנִּבְעֶלֶת לַאֲרַמִּי קְשָׁה לִפְרֹשׁ".[946] (פ׳): — **and as written (Bereishit Rabbah, Parashah 80): "A woman who**

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941 **Sod Yesharim, The Seventh Night of Pesach 23:2**: “Rabbi Pinchas ben Yair said to the River Ginnai: it is true that a person possesses choice and is therefore called only “one who may accomplish.” Yet within that uncertainty of choice, I carry out His will more than you do in certainty. We possess choice; moreover, when the evil inclination is present, no one recalls the good inclination. A person could even remain without choice and say, like the creatures without choice, “The Lord is mighty on high.” Yet I do not wish to rely on the assurance that God directs me without my choice, beyond my understanding, merely saying “The Lord is mighty on high.” I continually work to fulfill His will within my own understanding and bring the Divine Presence down into my actions, so as to perform His will through my good choice. Justice therefore also requires that my uncertain act displace your certain one. In the place of my choice you have no dealings with God, whereas I continually deal with Him, illuminating through my service even a place without choice and restraining myself there too through my good choice. Joseph’s coffin alludes to this restraint. Therefore the Sages say, “The sea saw and fled”—it saw Joseph’s coffin and fled.”

Sod Yesharim explains why recognition of divine direction must not become reliance on passivity. Joseph’s restraint brings willing service into the very place where the inclination makes choice seem absent. This deepens the combination in Chanukah of “everything comes from God” and active mastery; the target does not itself develop the separate Oral Torah argument.

942 **Peri Tzadik, Sukkot 51:1**: “For it is life to us, strength and light. Through Torah comes the power to subdue the evil inclination by strength and light. Strength is the force to overcome an inclination that urges a transgression: “Who is mighty? One who masters his inclination.” This occurs through Torah’s power: “I created the evil inclination; I created Torah as its remedy.” Light means that Torah illuminates the darkness that the inclination sometimes casts upon a person, deceiving him into thinking that he is performing a mitzvah. Thus the Sages interpret “A man wrestled with him” as the adversary appearing to him as a Torah scholar, deceiving him by appearing as his teacher who teaches beneficial wisdom. Torah illuminates the person so that he is not caught in this trap, changing darkness to light.”

The Sukkot passage gives the study-house counsel two distinct functions. Torah strengthens resistance to a recognized wrong and also exposes a wrong disguised as a mitzvah. This explains why renewed understanding, not determination alone, belongs to Joseph’s mastery of the inclination in Chanukah.

943 **Sukkah 52b:2**: “The school of Rabbi Yishmael taught: If this repulsive one, the evil inclination, encounters you, drag it to the study hall. If it is stone, it will dissolve; if it is iron, it will shatter. If it is stone, it will dissolve, as it is written, ‘Ho, all who are thirsty, go to the water,’ and it is written, ‘Water wears away stones.’ If it is iron, it will shatter, as it is written, ‘Are not My words like fire, says the Lord, and like a hammer that shatters rock?’”

944 **Ketubot 3b**: ‘The baraita continues: And on Monday one may not marry even in time of danger. However, if it is due to the coercion, it is permitted. The Gemara asks: What is the coercion mentioned in the baraita? If we say it is referring to that which we mentioned with regard to the decree of prima nocta it is difficult, as there the tanna calls it danger, and here he calls it coercion. Furthermore, there it says that they adopted the custom to marry on Tuesday; here it states that it is permitted.’

945 **Yevamot 103b**: ‘The Gemara answers: He implants filth in her and contaminates her, as her body accepts his semen. As Rabbi Yoḥanan also said, based on his understanding that the serpent seduced Eve into having sexual relations with him: When the serpent came upon Eve, he infected her with moral contamination, and this contamination remained in all human beings. When the Jewish people stood at Mount Sinai their contamination ceased, whereas with regard to gentiles, who did not stand at Mount Sinai, their contamination never ceased. Therefore, Yael was repulsed by the contamination that she allowed into her body, and she did not benefit from relations with Sisera.’

946 **Bereshit Rabbah 80:11** (excerpt): “‘They took Dinah’ (Genesis 34:26). Rabbi Yudan said: They dragged her away and went out. Rav Huna said: A woman who has had relations with an uncircumcised man finds it difficult to part from him. Rav Huna said: She said, ‘Where could I carry my disgrace?’—until Simeon swore that he would marry her. Thus it

cohabited with an Aramean finds it difficult to separate". וְעַל יְדֵי זֶה נַעֲשָׂה שֹׁרֶשׁ הַנֵּס, **— And through this was generated the catalyst for the miracle,** שֶׁנִּמְצָא בַּסְּפָרִים שֶׁאָז הִגִּיעַ נִשּׂוּאֵי אַחַת מִבְּנוֹתֵיהֶן שֶׁל חַשְׁמוֹנָאִים **— for it is recorded in holy books that the wedding of one of the Hasmonean daughters arrived then,** וְעַל כֵּן וְזֶה עִנְיַן מַה שֶּׁכָּתוּב נִתְעוֹרְרוּ לְמֶרֶד בַּיְּוָנִים; **— and therefore they were aroused to rebel against the Greeks;** בְּיַבַּאי שֶׁהָיוּ אוֹמְרִים: (קִדּוּשִׁין ס״ו עַמּוּד א׳)[947] **— and this explains what is stated (Kiddushin 66a) regarding Yannai where they alleged:** "אִמּוֹ נִשְׁבֵּית בַּמּוֹדִיעִים", **— "His mother was captured in Modi'in",** עַל שֵׁם שֶׁבָּהָר הַזֶּה הִתְחִיל הַמִּלְחָמָה, **— referring to the mount where the uprising ignited,** וְהָיָה קוֹל כָּזֶה שֶׁאִמּוֹ נִשְׁבֵּית, **— and there was a malicious rumor that his mother was taken captive,** וְהָיָה שֶׁקֶר, שֶׁבָּאֱמֶת לֹא נָגְעוּ בָּהּ שֶׁנִּתְגַּבְּרוּ הַכֹּהֲנִים הַחַשְׁמוֹנָאִים כָּאָמוּר. **— which was false, for in truth they never touched her, as the Hasmonean priests triumphed as stated.** וּכְבָר אָמַרְנוּ שֶׁשֹּׁרֶשׁ הַנֵּס הָיָה עַל יְדֵי שֶׁשְּׁמוֹ "יוֹחָנָן", **— And we explained that the root of the miracle was through his name being Yochanan,** שֶׁהוּא בְּחִינַת הַהַכָּרָה שֶׁהַכֹּל יו"ד-וָא"ו חָנַן מֵהַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ, **— which is the acknowledgment that all is graciously bestowed by Yud-Vav,** וְכֵן מוֹרֶה עַל זֶה שֵׁם יוֹסֵף; **— and likewise points the name Yosef;** וְעַל כֵּן יֶאֱרַע שֶׁמִּתְחַלְּפִין שְׁמוֹת יוֹסֵף וְיוֹחָנָן. **— and therefore it happens that the names Yosef and Yochanan interchange.** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמַרְנוּ שֶׁהַחַשְׁמוֹנָאִים הָיוּ שֹׁרֶשׁ תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה שֶׁהָיוּ מְבֹרָרִין בְּמִדַּת צַדִּיק[948] **— And as we explained, the Hasmoneans were the channel of the Oral Torah who were refined in the attribute of Tzaddik and merited the Primordial Light (discourse 1).**

וְנִמְצְאוּ שְׁנֵי הַנִּסִּים מִשֹּׁרֶשׁ אֶחָד: **— And thus the two post-biblical miracles emerge from a single source:** דְּנֵס פּוּרִים הָיָה עַל יְדֵי מָרְדֳּכַי שֶׁנִּקְרָא "רֹאשׁ לְכָל הַבְּשָׂמִים", שֶׁמּוֹרֶה שֶׁהָיָה בְּחִינַת צַדִּיק כְּמוֹ שֶׁנִּזְכַּר לְמַעְלָה; **— for the miracle of Purim occurred through Mordechai called "head of all spices", indicating he was of the level of Tzaddik;** וְכֵן מַתִּתְיָהוּ בֶּן יוֹחָנָן, שֶׁמּוֹרֶה גַּם כֵּן שֶׁמְּכֻנֶּה יוֹסֵף "דְּאָחִיד בִּשְׁמַיָּא וְאַרְעָא", **— and likewise Matityahu son of Yochanan, which denotes the equivalent of Yosef "who grasps heaven and earth",** וְהוּא גַּם כֵּן בְּחִינַת צַדִּיק כָּאָמוּר. **— and is also the dimension of Tzaddik as stated.** וּפוּרִים הֲכָנָה לִגְאֻלָּה, כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב (מְגִלָּה ו׳ עַמּוּד ב׳): "מִסְמֵךְ גְּאֻלָּה לִגְאֻלָּה עָדִיף",[949] **— And Purim is the preparation for the redemption, as written (Megillah 6b): "Juxtaposing redemption to redemption is preferred",** וְהַיְנוּ כְּמוֹ בִּשְׁנֵי הַמָּשִׁיחִים, דְּמָשִׁיחַ בֶּן יוֹסֵף קוֹדֵם לְמָשִׁיחַ בֶּן דָּוִד; **— meaning just as with the two Messiahs, Messiah son of Joseph precedes Messiah son of David;** וְכָתַב בְּסֵפֶר קְדֻשַּׁת לֵוִי (פָּרָשַׁת תְּצַוֶּה) דְּחֹדֶשׁ אֲדָר כְּנֶגֶד יוֹסֵף, וּמִמֶּנּוּ יָצְאוּ שְׁנֵי שְׁבָטִים, לָכֵן אֲדָר מְעֻבָּר וְיֵשׁ לִפְעָמִים שְׁנֵי חֳדָשִׁים אֲדָר, עַיֵּן שָׁם; **— and the Kedushat Levi (Parashat Tetzaveh) wrote that the month of Adar corresponds to Joseph, — and from him issued two tribes, which is why Adar is intercalated and appears as two months, see there;** וְהַזְּמַן רָאוּי בַּאֲדָר לְבִיאַת מָשִׁיחַ בֶּן יוֹסֵף, וְאַחַר כָּךְ יָבֹא מָשִׁיחַ בֶּן דָּוִד בְּנִיסָן, שֶׁבְּנִיסָן נִגְאָלִין (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב רֹאשׁ הַשָּׁנָה י״א עַמּוּד א׳).[951] **— and the season is ripe in Adar for the advent of Messiah son of Joseph, — and afterward Messiah son of David will arrive in Nisan, for in Nisan they are redeemed (Rosh Hashanah 11a).**

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says, 'Saul, son of the Canaanite woman' (Genesis 46:10): the son of Dinah, who had been violated by a Canaanite."

[947] **Kiddushin 66a**: "An elder named Yehudah ben Gedidyah was there. He said to King Yannai: 'King Yannai, the crown of kingship is enough for you; leave the crown of priesthood to Aharon's descendants.' For people were saying that his mother had been taken captive in Modi'in. The matter was investigated and was not substantiated. The Sages of Israel withdrew in anger."

[948] **Ramban on Numbers 8:2**: 'Speak unto Aaron, and say unto him: When you light the lamps, the seven lamps shall give light in front of the candlestick' (Numbers 8:2): Ramban quotes the Midrash Rabbah that Hashem comforted Aaron when he saw the dedication offerings of the twelve tribal Princes, promising him: 'By your life, yours is greater than theirs—for the sacrifices operate only while the Temple stands, whereas your lamps (referring to the Hasmonean dedication of the Chanukah lights) will shine forever.'

[949] **Megillah 6b**: "Rabbi Tavi said: Rabban Shimon ben Gamliel's reason is that it is preferable to place one redemption next to the other."

[950] **Kedushat Levi, Exodus, Tetzaveh**: 'In Kedushat Levi (Parashat Tetzaveh and Purim), Rabbi Levi Yitzchak of Berditchev explains that the month of Adar corresponds to the tribe of Joseph, from whom emerged two tribes—Ephraim and Menasseh—and therefore Adar is the doubled month (Adar I and Adar II) in a leap year, channeling Joseph's power to transform hidden providence into revealed miracles.'

[951] **Rosh Hashanah 11a:2**: "Rabbi Yehoshua says: In Nisan the world was created; in Nisan the patriarchs were born; in Nisan the patriarchs died. On Pesach Yitzchak was born. On Rosh Hashanah Sarah, Rachel, and Channah were remembered and granted children. On Rosh Hashanah Yosef left prison. On Rosh Hashanah our ancestors' labor in Egypt ceased. In Nisan they were redeemed; in Nisan they are destined to be redeemed."

The preparation includes both uprightness and the repair of failure

וְכֵן חֲנֻכָּה הוּא גַּם כֵּן הֲכָנָה לַגְּאֻלָּה[952, 953], — **And likewise Chanukah is also a preparation for redemption,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמַרְנוּ בְּמַה שֶׁכָּתוּב (סֻכָּה נ"ב עַמּוּד ב'):[954] — **and as we explained regarding what is written (Sukkah 52b):** "אַרְבָּעָה חָרָשִׁים: מָשִׁיחַ בֶּן דָּוִד, וּמָשִׁיחַ בֶּן יוֹסֵף, וְאֵלִיָּהוּ, וְכֹהֵן צֶדֶק"; **"Four craftsmen: Messiah son of David, Messiah son of Joseph, Elijah, and the Righteous Priest (Kohen Tzedek)";** וְלִכְאוֹרָה מַה עִנְיַן כֹּהֵן צֶדֶק לְכָאן, וְעַיֵּן פֵּרוּשׁ רַבִּי שְׁלֹמֹה יִצְחָקִי; — **and ostensibly what connection has the Righteous Priest to this, and see Rashi's commentary;** וְאָמַרְנוּ דְּשֵׁם הָיָה הַכֹּהֵן הָרִאשׁוֹן וְשֶׁלִּמֵּד תּוֹרָה, — **and we explained that Shem was the first priest who taught Torah,** וְזֶה נִקְרָא "חָרָשׁ" שֶׁבָּנָה בֵּית הַמִּקְדָּשׁ בַּלֵּב וּבַנֶּפֶשׁ עַל יְדֵי שֶׁלִּמֵּד תּוֹרָה; וְאֵלִיָּהוּ — **and he is called a "craftsman" because he constructed the Temple within heart and soul through teaching Torah;** – הַכֹּהֵן הָאַחֲרוֹן שֶׁיְּלַמֵּד כָּל סִתְרֵי תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה לְיִשְׂרָאֵל קֹדֶם בִּיאַת עוֹלָם הַבָּא (וּכְמוֹ שֶׁנִּתְבָּאֵר מַאֲמָר י"ג);[955] — **and Elijah is the final priest who will teach all secrets of the Oral Torah to Israel before the arrival of the World to Come (discourse 13);** וְאַחַר כָּךְ יִהְיוּ שְׁנֵי הַמְּשִׁיחִים: מָשִׁיחַ בֶּן יוֹסֵף שֶׁיְּבָרֵר "וְעַמֵּךְ כֻּלָּם צַדִּיקִים", — **Messiah son of Joseph who will clarify that "your people are all righteous",** וּמָשִׁיחַ בֶּן דָּוִד שֶׁיִּהְיֶה יָחִיד שֶׁעֲשָׂה תְּשׁוּבָה, שֶׁאַף מִי שֶׁקִּלְקֵל יִתְקַן עַל יְדֵי תְּשׁוּבָה. — **and Messiah son of David who embodies the individual who repented, ensuring that even one who stumbled will be rectified through repentance.** וְהֵם הָאַרְבָּעָה חָרָשִׁים לְבִנְיַן הֶעָתִיד שֶׁיֵּרֵד בָּנוּי וּמְשֻׁכְלָל, כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתַב פֵּרוּשׁ רַבִּי שְׁלֹמֹה יִצְחָקִי (רֹאשׁ הַשָּׁנָה לי' סוֹף עַמּוּד א');[956] — **And they are the four craftsmen for the Future Temple which will descend built and perfected, as Rashi wrote (Rosh Hashanah 30a bottom);** – הַכֹּהֲנִים שֶׁהִכְנִיסוּ דִּבְרֵי תוֹרָה, — **meaning that Elijah and Kohen Tzedek are the priests who introduced Torah words,** וְהַמְּשִׁיחִים שֶׁיְּתַקְּנוּ הַלֵּב כְּסִיל שֶׁאָז יִשְׁחֹט הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא לְיֵצֶר הָרָע. — **and the Messiahs will rectify the foolish heart when the Holy One slaughters the Evil Inclination.** וְכֵן עִנְיַן חֲנֻכָּה, שֶׁזּוֹכִין עַל יְדֵי הַדָּלָקַת הַנֵּרוֹת שֶׁיָּאִיר בַּלֵּב אוֹר תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה,

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[952] **Sod Yesharim, Shabbat Chol HaMoed Pesach 13:1**: “The descendants of Ephraim hasten the end before its time. Thus the Zohar speaks of two Messiahs, the son of Joseph and the son of David, but the end is principally completed only through the son of David. Before it is completed, the son of Joseph awakens first. Rachel’s descendants always precede and hasten the time, like King Saul, who had to precede the kingship of David’s house. Rachel’s descendants exert themselves in forceful service and hasten the end before the appointed time God has fixed. Therefore the deliverance cannot be completed through them, but through the son of David, whose house is likened to the moon that has nothing of its own and waits for the time appointed by the divine will in the light of His direction.”

Sod Yesharim explains why the preparatory force and the final completion have different roles. Powerful service can open the way, while complete deliverance requires receiving the time God gives. This illuminates Chanukah’s sequence without treating the valuable work of Joseph’s mode as itself the finished redemption.

[953] **Machshavot Charutz 7:18**: “In every generation there are two leaders, analogous to the Messiah son of David and the Messiah son of Joseph, especially in the footsteps of the Messiah. They correspond to the two degrees of penitents and the completely righteous, and they open these two gates anew in every generation. Every Israelite soul includes both, for both include the whole people. All Israel is named for Joseph, “the remnant of Joseph,” and for Judah, “Jews.” The latter is their principal name, since “there is no righteous person on earth who does good and does not sin.” From Joseph they are only a remnant, since the main part was absorbed and lost in the exile of the ten tribes. That is: each person has matters in which he is righteous. As the early authorities explained concerning donkey-drivers, in one respect they are called trustworthy and in another wicked. In those matters he possesses the degree of a completely righteous person.”

Machshavot Charutz brings the two future figures into the present work of each soul. A person has particular areas of uprightness and other areas needing return, and both gates must be renewed. This explains how Chanukah can prepare now for the twofold repair that its four-craftsmen conclusion places in the future.

[954] **Sukkah 52b**: ‘§ Apropos the end of days, the Gemara cites another verse and interprets it homiletically. It is stated: “The Lord then showed me four craftsmen” (Zechariah 2:3). Who are these four craftsmen? Rav Ḥana bar Bizna said that Rabbi Shimon Ḥasida said: They are Messiah ben David, Messiah ben Yosef, Elijah, and the righteous High Priest, who will serve in the Messianic era. Rav Sheshet raised an objection: If so, if that is the identity of the four craftsmen, then that which is written in the previous verse: “And he said to me: These are the horns that scattered Judea” (Zechariah 2:4), is difficult; these four in the first verse are coming for their enemies, and are not redeemers.’

[955] **Mishnah Eduyot 8:7**: “Rabbi Joshua said: I have received a tradition from Rabban Yohanan ben Zakkai, who heard it from his teacher, and his teacher heard it from his teacher, as a halakhah given to Moses from Sinai, that Elijah will not come to pronounce unclean or to pronounce clean, to put away or to bring near, but to put away those brought near by force and to bring near those put away by force. The family of Beth Tzriphah was on the other side of the Jordan and Ben Zion put it away by force; and yet another family was there, and Ben Zion brought it near by force. It is such as these that Elijah will come to pronounce unclean or to pronounce clean, to put away or to bring near. Rabbi Judah says: to bring near, but not to put away. Rabbi Shimon says: to conciliate disputes. And the Sages say: neither to put away nor to bring near, but to make peace in the world, for it is said, “Behold I send to you Elijah the prophet”, etc., “and he shall turn the heart of the fathers to the children and the heart of the children to their fathers” (Malachi 3:23-4).”

[956] **Rosh Hashanah 30a**: ‘Rather, is it not the case that in Jerusalem they sound the shofar both when the court was in session, i.e., until midday, and when the court was not in session. And by contrast, in Yavne, when the court was in session, yes, they would sound the shofar, whereas when the court was not in session, no, they would not sound it. If so, this indicates that when the court was in session they would in any case sound the shofar in Yavne, even though this was not in the presence of the court. This contradicts Rav Huna’s opinion that in Yavne they would sound the shofar only in the presence of the court.’

— And such is the dynamic of Chanukah, wherein through kindling the lights we merit that the light of the Oral Torah radiate in the heart, שֶׁכֵּן מוֹרֶה נֵס חֲנֻכָּה בְּשֶׁמָּן וְנֵרוֹת שֶׁרוֹמְזִים עַל חָכְמָה וְתוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה, **— for the miracle in oil and lights denotes Chochmah and the Oral Torah,** וְהוּא גַּם כֵּן הַהֲכָנָה לִגְאֻלָּה שֶׁעֲתִידִין לְהִגָּאֵל. **— and it is likewise the spiritual preparation for the Redemption when we are destined to be redeemed.**

Chanukah Ois 15

Rosh Chodesh Tevet and the Sixth Day of Chanukah

The ois distinguishes the effort of battle from the rest in which holiness can be established. Its lower and upper unities describe the relation between chosen service and the perception that emerges through it.

Rosh Chodesh Tevet and the Sixth Day of Chanukah

בַּפְּסִיקְתָּא (פָּרָשָׁה יְלַמְּדֵנוּ רַבֵּנוּ: רֹאשׁ חֹדֶשׁ שֶׁחָל לִהְיוֹת בַּחֲנֻכָּה, הוֹאִיל מַהוּ שֶׁיְּהֵא צָרִיךְ לְהַזְכִּיר בַּחֲנֻכָּה וְכוּלֵּיהּ, שֶׁאֵין תְּפִלַּת הַמּוּסָפִין בַּחֲנֻכָּה וְכוּלֵּיהּ, וְצָרִיךְ לְהָבִין: שֶׁל חֲנֻכָּה וְכוּלֵּיהּ?", לָמָּה לֹא שָׁאַל גַּם עַל מוּסַף שַׁבָּת אִם צָרִיךְ לְהַזְכִּיר שֶׁל חֲנֻכָּה, וְכִדְאִיבָּעְיָא לֵיהּ בַּגְּמָרָא (שַׁבָּת כ״ד עַמּוּד א׳): "מַהוּ לְהַזְכִּיר שֶׁל חֲנֻכָּה בַּמּוּסָפִין?", דְּקָאֵי עַל שַׁבָּת וְרֹאשׁ חֹדֶשׁ שֶׁבַּחֲנֻכָּה; וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמַר אַחַר כָּךְ בַּפְּסִיקְתָּא בְּהַתְשׁוּבָה, אַחַר שֶׁאָמַר שֶׁבְּרֹאשׁ חֹדֶשׁ מַזְכִּיר, אָמַר: "שַׁבָּת שֶׁחָלָה וְכוּלֵּיהּ". אַךְ הָעִנְיָן, כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמַרְנוּ, דְּהוֹעָעַת נֵר חֲנֻכָּה כְּמוֹ שַׁבָּת, וּמִטַּעַם זֶה נִסְדַּר בַּשַּׁ"ס דִּינֵי נֵר חֲנֻכָּה בְּפֶרֶק "בְּמֶה מַדְלִיקִין" בֵּין דִּינֵי נֵר שַׁבָּת, שֶׁשְּׁנֵיהֶם מֵאוֹר הָרִאשׁוֹן שֶׁגְּנָזוֹ לַצַּדִּיקִים.

"Rosh Chodesh Tevet that coincides with Chanukah, may our master teach us: regarding Rosh Chodesh that coincides with Chanukah, what is the law whether one must mention Chanukah in Musaf, etc.?" — since there is no Musaf prayer on Chanukah, etc., — and one must understand: why did he not also ask regarding the Shabbat Musaf whether one must mention Chanukah, — just as the dilemma was raised in the Gemara (Shabbat 24a): — "What is the law regarding mentioning Chanukah in the Musaf prayers?", — which refers to both Shabbat and Rosh Chodesh that occur during Chanukah; — and as he stated afterward in the Pesikta in the reply, — where after stating that on Rosh Chodesh one mentions it, he added: "Shabbat that coincides, etc." — However, the inner matter is as we explained, that the spiritual emergence of the Chanukah light is akin to Shabbat, — and for this reason the laws of the Chanukah light were placed in the Talmud in the chapter Bameh Madlikin among the laws of the Shabbat candle, — for both derive from the Primordial Light hidden away for the righteous.

In the Pesikta (Parashah 4): "'And Elijah took, etc.',[957] **— And behold "Chanukah", the Ran and the Tur (Orach Chayim 670) wrote, alludes to: Chanu Kaf-Heh ("they rested on the twenty-fifth");**[959] **— and so it is in the Tikunei Zohar (Tikun 13):**[960] **— "And it is Hod, the eight days of Chanukah corresponding to the twenty-four days which are Baruch Shem Kevod Malchuto Le'olam Va'ed, — and immediately, etc., the twenty-five (Kaf-Heh) rested upon Israel on the 25th of Kislev, — and these are the twenty-five letters of the higher unification which are Shema Yisrael, etc., –** חָנוּ כַּ״ה, עַיֵּן שָׁם". **— and this is Chanukah — Chanu Kaf-Heh, see there."**

Rest makes the attained light a settled possession

— And this means that during the twenty-four days of[961,962] וְהַיְנוּ שֶׁבְּכ״ד יָמִים שֶׁבְּכִסְלֵּו הָיָה הַמִּלְחָמָה וְהַנִּצּוּחַ,

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[957] **Pesikta Rabbati 4:1**: ‘And Elijah took twelve stones, according to the number of the tribes of the sons of Jacob, unto whom the word of the Lord came, saying: Israel shall be your name’ (I Kings 18:31): The Pesikta links Elijah’s twelve-stone altar with Rosh Chodesh and Chanukah, teaching that Elijah restores the unity of the twelve tribes and the covenantal light of the altar.’

[958] **Shabbat 24a:5**: “They asked: Should Chanukah be mentioned in the Musaf prayers? Since Chanukah has no Musaf offering of its own, perhaps it is not mentioned; or perhaps the day is one on which four prayers are obligatory, and it is mentioned in all of them. Rav Huna and Rav Yehudah both said: It is not mentioned. Rav Nachman and Rabbi Yochanan both said: It is mentioned.”

[959] **Shulchan Arukh, Orach Chayim 670**: ‘Tur and Ran (on Orach Chayim 670) explain the etymology of the name Chanukah : it is an acronym for Chanu Kaf-Heh —‘they rested from their enemies on the twenty-fifth day of Kislev’— and it also signifies the dedication (chinukh) of the Altar and the sanctuary of the heart.’

[960] **Tikkunei Zohar 27a:8-30a:1**: ‘And ten wheels are Yod, which correspond to ten fingers, which strum the music, five in five, and they are Hei-Hei which ascend through Yod, through the six levels, which is the letter Vav, in which they rise and descend. And it is like a ladder, of which it is stated: (Gen. 28:12) ... and behold a ladder was set in the earth... etc., ... and behold angels of ELQYM were ascending and descending in it ... meaning ‘in ’ And all is YQVQ, YOD QE VAV QE – YaD, (1 Sam. 19:9) ... and David was playing by hand.’

[961] **Tiferet Yosef, Talmud Anthology, Pesachim 5**: “Therefore they instituted saying it quietly. It is true that deep within Israel’s heart there is the clarity inherited from our father Jacob and from the standing at Mount Sinai. Yet a person must not rely on this and rest upon it. On his side he must conduct himself in service immediately and without interruption; then he will come to recognize, within his own perception as well, the great vision and clarity of the upper unity. This is called “quietly.”

Tiferet Yosef explains why the inherited light of upper unity does not cancel the work represented by lower unity: the person must acquire conscious recognition through actual service. That gives the twenty-four-to-twenty-five movement here an inward structure. The rest after the Chanukah victory is an attainment reached through the work, rather than permission to presume that the hidden root makes further work unnecessary.

[962] **Divrei Soferim 6:1**: “(The intention is not bodily tranquility alone or enjoyment of this world’s delights. That certainly is not life, and the Torah is not speaking of the dead—those called dead even while alive. In Tamid: “What should a person do and live? Put himself to death. What should a person do and die? Keep himself alive.” Only one attached to God is called alive, as it says, “You who cling to the Lord your God are all alive.” A person is called alive only when life is attached to him and is not separated. Concerning “the son of a living man,” the sages say that the

Kislev raged the warfare and the triumph, וְהוּא נֶגֶד כ״ד אוֹתִיּוֹת יְחוּדָא תַּתָּאָה "בָּרוּךְ שֵׁם כְּבוֹד מַלְכוּתוֹ לְעוֹלָם וָעֶד", **corresponding to the twenty-four letters of the lower unification Baruch Shem Kevod Malchuto Le'olam Va'ed,** שֶׁהָיָה הַהֶאָרָה מִמִּדַּת מַלְכוּת, בְּחִינַת כְּנֶסֶת יִשְׂרָאֵל, **which was the illumination from the sefirah of Malchut, the aspect of Knesset Yisrael,** שֶׁמָּסְרוּ נַפְשָׁם לְלֶחֶם מְעַטִּים כְּנֶגֶד רַבִּים כְּדֵי לִשְׁמֹר מִצְוֹת הַשֵּׁם, **who sacrificed their lives to fight as few against many in order to safeguard the commandments of Hashem,** שֶׁרָצוּ "לְהַשְׁכִּיחָם תּוֹרָתֶךָ". **when the Greeks sought "to make them forget Your Torah".** וְאַחַר כָּךְ בְּכ״ה בְּכִסְלֵו חָנוּ, שֶׁזָּכוּ לִנְיָחָא, **And afterward on the 25th of Kislev they encamped and rested (chanu), meriting serene rest,** וְיָכְלוּ לַעֲשׂוֹת חֲנֻכַּת הַמִּקְדָּשׁ וּלְהַדְלִיק נֵרוֹת; **and were able to perform the dedication of the Temple and kindle the lights;** וְקָבְעוּ הַחֲנֻכָּה בְּיוֹם הַחֲנָיָה וְלֹא בִּימֵי הַמִּלְחָמָה שֶׁהָיָה אָז הַנֵּס, **and they established Chanukah on the day of resting and not on the days of battle when the miracle took place,** מִפְּנֵי שֶׁעִקַּר קְבִיעַת הַקְּדֻשָּׁה בְּיוֹם הַחֲנָיָה, **because the essential establishment of holiness occurs on the day of rest,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁקָּבְעוּ מוֹעֵד פּוּרִים גַּם כֵּן: "כַּיָּמִים אֲשֶׁר נָחוּ בָהֶם וְגוֹמֵר". **just as they fixed the festival of Purim likewise: "As the days wherein they rested, etc."**

(בְּרֵאשִׁית רַבָּה פָּרָשָׁה י״א) "חָנוּ" הֵינוּ הַנְּיָחָא, וּכְמוֹ שֶׁדָּרְשׁוּ "חֲנָיָה" לְשׁוֹן נְיָחָא [963] — **And chanu means rest, as they expounded chanayah as an expression of rest (Bereishit Rabbah, Parashah 11)** עַל יַעֲקֹב שֶׁכָּתוּב בּוֹ שְׁמִירַת שַׁבָּת, שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: "וַיִּחַן וְגוֹמֵר", שֶׁיְּמֵי הַמַּעֲשֶׂה הוּא הַהִשְׁתַּדְּלוּת — **regarding Jacob of whom Sabbath observance is written: "And he encamped (vayichan), etc.",** – "וַיְהִי בְּנָסֹעַ וְגוֹמֵר", **– for the workdays represent human toil — "And it came to pass when they journeyed, etc.",** וּבְשַׁבָּת נִקְרָא: "וּבְנֻחֹה וְגוֹמֵר". [964] **while Shabbat is termed: "And when it rested, etc."** וְזֶהוּ "חָנוּ כַּ״ה", שֶׁבְּכ״ה הָיָה לָהֶם נְיָחָא; **And this is Chanu Kaf-Heh, for on the 25th they attained peaceful rest;** וְזֶה שֶׁאָמַר: "דְּאִנּוּן כ״ה אַתְוָון דְּיִחוּדָא 'שְׁמַע יִשְׂרָאֵל'". **and this is what was stated: "which are the twenty-five letters of the unification of Shema Yisrael."** וְהוּא עַל פִּי מַה שֶׁכָּתוּב בַּגְּמָרָא (פְּסָחִים נ׳ עמוד א׳): [965] "'בַּיּוֹם הַהוּא יִהְיֶה הַשֵּׁם אֶחָד' — אַטּוּ הָאִידָּנָא לָאו אֶחָד הוּא וְכוּלֵּיהּ? **— And this is based on what is stated in the Gemara (Pesachim 50a): – "'On that day Hashem shall be One' — is He then not One today, etc.?** לָעוֹלָם הַבָּא כֻּלּוֹ 'הַטּוֹב וְהַמֵּטִיב'". **— In the World to Come it will be entirely the blessing of 'He Who is good and does good'."**

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righteous are called living even in death. This is what is simply called life: there is no life except that drawn from the Life of the worlds, as it says, “You give life to them all.” Apart from this there is no life; as He endures forever, so does the life drawn from Him. The purpose of rest and the removal of troubles and suffering in this world is for the soul to be at ease and attach itself to its Maker. This is impossible when things trouble the heart and confuse the person, as they said in Eruvin: “If a louse had bitten me, I would not have learned.” It is for this that rest in this world is needed.)”

Divrei Soferim specifies what rest makes possible: attachment becomes a life the person can actually experience when the heart is no longer consumed by disturbance. This explains why the Chanukah passage locates the establishment of holiness in the rest following the battle. Its explicit distinction from bodily comfort keeps the connection focused on dedication and inward settlement.

[963] **Bereshit Rabbah 11:7** (excerpt): “But Jacob, of whom Shabbos observance is written—‘He encamped before the city’ (Genesis 33:18)—entered as the sun was setting and established the boundaries while it was still day. He inherited the world without measure, as it is written, ‘Your descendants shall be like the dust of the earth,’ and so forth (Genesis 28:14).”

[964] **Peri Tzadik, Pekudei 10:1**: “As we have already said, a person is called one who journeys throughout his life, as it is said, “For the person journeys to his eternal home.” Every righteous person has a world of his own, as Midrash Rabbah, Pekudei 52, says: It does not say “worlds,” but “his world.” All the working days correspond to “When the Ark journeyed … may Your enemies scatter and those who hate You flee.” Then a person journeys from stage to stage. When Shabbat comes, it is “When it rested, he would say: Return, O Lord.” The holiness of Shabbat always accords with the holiness of the labor of the working days; thus the six working days are always mentioned before Shabbat, as explained in Kedushat Shabbat 1 and elsewhere. On Shabbat, holiness then shines into the working days that follow, and they possess greater holiness than the preceding six working days. When the second Shabbat arrives, it gains further holiness; it likewise bestows greater holiness on the coming working days. So it continues forever: throughout his life, the person journeys.”

[965] **Pesachim 50a**: “‘Hashem shall be King over all the earth; on that day Hashem shall be one and His Name one.’ Is He not one now? Rabbi Aḥa bar Ḥanina said: The World-to-Come is not like this world. In this world, upon good tidings one recites: Blessed…Who is good and does good, and over bad tidings one recites: Blessed…the true Judge. In the World-to-Come one will always recite: Blessed…Who is good and does good. There will be only one mode of blessing God for tidings.”

Rest can begin when the purpose of hardship becomes perceptible

וְהַיְנוּ[966, 967] שֶׁכֵּן מוֹרֶה יהו"ה אֶחָד שֶׁהַכֹּל לְטוֹבָה, — **Meaning that Havayah Echad indicates that all is for good,** מוֹרֶה שֵׁם זֶה עַל רַחֲמִים וְחָפֵץ רַק לְהֵטִיב; — **for this Name denotes divine mercy, desiring only to bestow goodness;** רַק בָּעוֹלָם הַזֶּה אֵין זֶה בְּהִתְגַּלּוּת שֶׁיְּכִירוּ הַטּוֹבָה בַּהֲפָכָּךְ גַּם כֵּן, — **only in this physical world this is not openly manifest so that they recognize the good in its apparent opposite as well,** וְזֶה יִתְגַּלֶּה רַק "בַּיּוֹם הַהוּא". — **and this will be revealed fully only "on that day".** וְאָז בִּימֵי הַחַשְׁמוֹנָאִים הָיָה לָהֶם הַנָּיָחָא בִּבְחִינַת יחוּדָא עִלָּאָה, — **And then in the days of the Hasmoneans they experienced rest on the plane of the higher unification (yichuda ila'ah),** שֶׁהִכִּירוּ הַכֹּל שֶׁהַגְּזֵרָה הָיָה לְטוֹבָתָם, — **recognizing in retrospect that the decree itself was for their ultimate good,** שֶׁעַל יְדֵי זֶה נִצְּחוּ אֶת הַיְוָנִים וּפָרְקוּ עֻלָּם; — **for through it they conquered the Greeks and cast off their yoke;** שֶׁמִּקּוֹדֶם הָיוּ מְשֻׁעְבָּדִים לָהֶם וְהֶצְרֵךְ שִׁמְעוֹן הַצַּדִּיק לָצֵאת נֶגְדּוֹ (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב יוֹמָא ס"ט עַמּוּד א'),[968] — **whereas previously they had been subjugated to them, forcing Shimon the Righteous to go out to meet Alexander (Yoma 69a),** וְלוּלֵא הַגְּזֵרוֹת בְּוַדַּאי לֹא הָיוּ קָמִים כְּנֶגְדּוֹ; — **and had it not been for the decrees, they certainly would not have arisen against him;** רַק עַל יְדֵי הַגְּזֵרָה שֶׁרָצוּ לְהַעֲבִירָם עַל דָּת מָסְרוּ עַצְמָם לְמִיתָה לְהִלָּחֵם נֶגְדּוֹ, — **only through the decree seeking to strip them of faith did they surrender themselves to death to fight him,** וְנַעֲשָׂה לָהֶם הַנֵּס וּפָרְקוּ עֻלָּם מֵעַל צַוָּארֵיהֶם, — **and the miracle was wrought for them and they broke their yoke from off their necks;** וְזֶהוּ רֶמֶז כ"ה אַתְוָון שֶׁבִּיחוּדָא עִלָּאָה שֶׁכָּתַב בְּתִקּוּנֵי זֹהַר. — **and this is the allusion of the twenty-five letters in the higher unification written in Tikunei Zohar.** וְכֵן בְּשַׁבָּת כְּתִיב: "בְּיוֹם הָנִיחַ לְךָ מֵעֲצָבְךָ וּמֵרַגְזְךָ וּמִן הָעֲבֹדָה הַקָּשָׁה וְגוֹמֵר", — **And likewise regarding Shabbat it is written: "In the day that Hashem gives you rest from your sorrow, and from your trouble, and from the hard bondage, etc.",**

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[966] **Resisei Layla 53:2**: "This is the joy a person should have in his service, as it says, "Serve the Lord with joy." Although one must also have fear—"rejoice with trembling"—this joy too must never leave his sight: he has merited to serve God. Is there any greater joy? The righteous act from love and rejoice in sufferings as well, since they recognize that everything comes from God and is not chance, Heaven forbid. It is like a father striking his son to set him straight, or a physician doing painful things to a patient in order to preserve his life. Although the patient is distressed now, he certainly rejoices afterward. One who understands and recognizes this even while it is happening is joyful."

Resisei Layla explains the precise change that can bring inward rest before hardship has ended: the person recognizes its corrective purpose, like the patient who understands the treatment. It preserves both distress and awe rather than claiming that the experience has become physically pleasant. This illuminates the sentence that one can have rest even within hard service.

[967] **Tiferet Yosef, Talmud Anthology, Megillah 7**: "A person can understand this: God can open the deliverance and show how, from His side, the person was always attached to the root. He can show the light in all those times and actions that had appeared to the person to lack light. But to see how they themselves did not suffer at all—this cannot be understood within the intellectual grasp of this world. My grandfather, the holy master of blessed memory, said that an analogy can help us understand, and the greatest analogy is Joseph's brothers. Before Joseph made himself known, they were suffering greatly. It appeared to them that they stood before a gentile king who was disputing with them, and they thought themselves in great danger. After God sent them deliverance and Joseph made himself known, they saw retrospectively that they had not been in danger: they had been standing before their brother, who sought their good. He said that this is a likeness of the future deliverance, may it come speedily in our days. God will show that no authority ruled over them apart from His rule, and that they were always standing before God face to face. This is what the Talmud says: Reish Lakish said, "The Holy One, blessed be He, does not strike Israel unless He first creates a cure for them," as it says, "When I would heal Israel," and afterward, "Ephraim's sin is revealed"; with the nations it is otherwise. After the deliverance, God shows that the very beginning of the construction of the suffering was entirely for Israel's benefit. This is called "creating a cure first."

The brothers' recognition of Joseph supplies a concrete model for the Hasmoneans' retrospective recognition: the meaning of an earlier threatening situation changes when its directing purpose is disclosed. Tiferet Yosef carefully distinguishes recognizing that purpose from the greater future claim that the sufferers themselves never suffered, which present understanding cannot grasp. The connection retains that limit and does not deny the hardship described in the origin.

[968] **Yoma 69a:10-13**: "This was the day on which the Samaritans asked Alexander of Macedon for permission to destroy the house of our God, and he granted it to them. People came and informed Shimon the Righteous. What did he do? He put on priestly garments and wrapped himself in priestly garments. The distinguished men of Israel accompanied him, carrying flaming torches in their hands. All night, these traveled from one side and those from the other, until dawn rose. When dawn rose, Alexander asked, 'Who are these?' They told him, 'Jews who have rebelled against you.' When he reached Antipatris, the sun rose and the two parties met. As soon as he saw Shimon the Righteous, he descended from his chariot and bowed before him. They asked him, 'Should a great king like you bow to this Jew?' He answered, 'This man's likeness appears before me and brings me victory in battle.' He asked them, 'Why have you come?' They answered, 'Is it possible that gentiles have misled you into destroying a house in which prayers are offered for you and your kingdom, that it should not be destroyed?' He asked, 'Who are these people?' They answered, 'These Samaritans standing before you.' He said, 'They are delivered into your hands.' They immediately pierced their heels and tied them to their horses' tails, dragging them over thorns and thistles until they reached Mount Gerizim. When they reached Mount Gerizim, they plowed it and sowed it with vetch, as the Samaritans had wished to do to the house of our God. They made that day a festival."

שֶׁנִּדְרָשׁ (זֹהַר חֲלָק א׳ מ״ח עַמּוּד ב׳ וּבְשָׁאָר מְקוֹמוֹת) עַל יוֹם הַשַּׁבָּת שֶׁהוּא יוֹם הָנִיחַ[969] — **which is expounded (Zohar Part I, 48b and elsewhere) on the Sabbath day which is the day of rest;** וְהַיְנוּ דְּיֵשׁ בּוֹ הִתְגַּלּוּת מֵאוֹר שֶׁנִּבְרָא בְּיוֹם רִאשׁוֹן דִּכְתִיב: "וַיַּרְא אֱלֹהִים אֶת הָאוֹר כִּי טוֹב", — **meaning that within it is a revelation from the light created on the first day, of which it is written: "And God saw the light that it was good",** וְאָז זוֹכִין לְהַשְׂגִּיחַ שֶׁהַכֹּל לְטוֹבָה; וְאַף בְּשֶׁהוּא בְּתוֹךְ הָעֲבוֹדָה הַקָּשָׁה יֵשׁ לוֹ נְיָחָא כֵּינָן שֶׁהוּא לְטוֹבָה. — **and then one merits to perceive that all is for good; and even while in the midst of hard labor one possesses inner tranquility, knowing it is for the good.** וְכֵן אִיתָא בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ (שָׁם קל״א עַמּוּד א׳): "כִּי יָבֹא טוֹב"[970] — **And so it states in the Holy Zohar (ibid. 131a): –** דָּא תְּחִיַּת הַמֵּתִים, וְיִתְנְהִיר הַהוּא נְהוֹרָא דִּזְמִין וְכוּ׳", — **"When good comes — this is the Resurrection of the Dead, and that destined light will shine, etc.",** וְהַיְנוּ שֶׁבְּהִתְגַּלּוּת מֵאוֹר הָרִאשׁוֹן זוֹכִין לְהַשְׂגִּיחַ הַטּוֹב הָאֱמִתִּי. — **meaning that through the revelation of the Primordial Light we merit to perceive the true good.** וְזֶה זָכוּ בַּחֲנֻכָּה וְכֵן זוֹכִין בְּכָל שַׁבָּת, — **And this they merited on Chanukah and so we merit on every Shabbat,** וְעַל כֵּן לֹא שָׁאַל בַּפְּסִיקְתָא אִם מַזְכִּירִין שֶׁהַם מַעֲיָן קְדֻשָּׁה אַחַת. דִּבְוַדַּאי מַזְכִּירִין, חֲנֻכָּה בְּמוּסַף שַׁבָּת שֶׁל חֲנֻכָּה, — **and therefore the Pesikta did not ask whether we mention Chanukah in Shabbat Musaf, for certainly one mentions it, since they share the same essence of holiness.** וְשָׁאַל עַל מוּסַף רֹאשׁ חֹדֶשׁ אִם מַזְכִּירִין שֶׁל חֲנֻכָּה, — **And it asked regarding Rosh Chodesh Musaf whether one mentions Chanukah,** וְאָמַר דְּמַזְכִּירִין; — **and answered that one does mention it;** וְהַיְנוּ דִּבְמוּסַף רֹאשׁ חֹדֶשׁ יֵשׁ בּוֹ גַּם כֵּן הוֹפָעָה מִכֶּתֶר עֶלְיוֹן, — **and that is because in Rosh Chodesh Musaf there is also an illumination from Keter Elyon,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ (חֶלֶק ג׳ ע״ט עַמּוּד ב׳)[971]: "וְאוּף הָכִי בְּחַדְתּוּתֵי סִיהֲרָא דְּהָא נָהִיר וְכוּלֵּיהּ מִנְּהִירוּ", — **and as written in the Holy Zohar (Part III, 79b): "And so too at the renewal of the moon, for behold it shines, etc., from the radiance of the Ancient One",** וּמֵהַאי טַעֲמָא כָּתַב הָאֲרִיזַ"ל שֶׁאוֹמְרִים קְדֻשַּׁת "כֶּתֶר" בְּמוּסַף רֹאשׁ חֹדֶשׁ, — **and for this reason the Arizal wrote that we recite the Kedushah of Keter in Rosh Chodesh Musaf;** רַק דְּכָתַב שֶׁהַהָאָרָה רַק כָּל זְמַן מוּסָף, — **only he wrote that this radiance lasts only during the time of Musaf,** וּבָזֶה אֵינוֹ דּוֹמֶה לְשַׁבָּת. — **and in this it does not resemble Shabbat.**

The act can establish an illumination that continues beyond its moment

דְּזֶה וְכֵן בַּחֲנֻכָּה הַהָאָרָה כָּל הַיּוֹם,[972] — **And so on Chanukah the illumination extends through the entire day,** שֶׁאָנוּ אוֹמְרִים: "וְכָל שְׁמוֹנַת יְמֵי חֲנֻכָּה הַנֵּרוֹת הַלָּלוּ קֹדֶשׁ הֵם", — **as shown by our recitation: "And all eight days of Chanukah these lights are holy",** שֶׁמּוֹרֶה שֶׁהוֹפָעַת הָאוֹר וְהַקְּדֻשָּׁה כָּל שְׁמוֹנַת הַיָּמִים — **indicating that the appearance of light and holiness endures across all eight days** וְלֹא רַק בִּשְׁעַת הַדְלָקַת נֵרוֹת; — **and not only at the time of lighting the candles;** וְהוּא כְּעֵין הוֹפָעַת שַׁבָּת, רַק אֵינוֹ דּוֹמֶה בְּעֶרֶךְ הַקְּדֻשָּׁה דַּחֲנֻכָּה מֵתֶר בִּמְלָאכָה. — **and it is akin to the manifestation of Shabbat, though not identical in level of sanctity since Chanukah is**

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[969] **Zohar, Bereshit 78:196-79:206**: 'R. Simeon said further: 'It is on this account that, as we have learnt, Sabbath is a mirror of the future world. For this same reason, too, the Sabbatical year and the Jubilee mirror one another. This additional soul descends from the mystic force implied in the word zachor (remember) upon the tabernacle of peace, being taken from the future world, and the tabernacle gives it to the holy people, who are gladdened by it and enabled to forget all worldly matters and all their troubles and sorrows, thus realising the words of the prophet, "on the day that the Lord shall give thee rest from thy sorrow, and from thy trouble, and from the hard service, etc." (Is. 14, 3).'

[970] **Zohar, Chayei Sara 131a**: 'In the Zohar (Chayei Sarah I 131a), the verse 'When good comes' is expounded regarding the future Resurrection of the Dead, when the Primordial Light that was hidden away from the first day of Creation will shine forth openly for those who toiled in Torah.'

[971] **Zohar, Achrei Mot 72:405-75:413**: 'R. Simeon said: 'It is written: "And it shall come to pass that from one new moon to another, and from one Sabbath to another", etc. (Isa. 66, 23). Why is "new moon" put side by side with "Sabbath"? Because both are of one grade, being the time when one is joined to the other. On Sabbath there is joy and an additional soul, because the Ancient One reveals Himself and the wedlock is prepared.'

[972] **Sod Yesharim, Yom Kippur 15:1**: "Within this encompassing time is included the general illumination of all 613 commandments, which are called "the counsels of Torah." For what are they counsels? Is there anything in the world that is not included within these 613 commandments? They are called counsels because all of them are counsels for their becoming established in the depth of the heart. After a person fulfills all 613 commandments, they become established within the depth of his heart. Beforehand it is as written, "Today, upon your heart"; after he fulfills all the commandments, it is as the sages say, "Tomorrow, within your heart." They become established within his very heart. Thus they are counsels that they should no longer remain merely "upon your heart," but become established in its depths. This enduring establishment comes from the common root of the 613 commandments, which shines in the person's heart in all his actions, even without his awareness, and even while he sleeps. This common root is without limit, and all the limits of the different times are included within it. This illumination of the inclusion of limits within the unlimited shines on Yom Kippur."
Sod Yesharim distinguishes the performance of commandments from their becoming established within the heart; the latter can illuminate conduct even outside the moment of deliberate performance. This gives an inward mechanism for the enduring effect described in Chanukah. Its claim is expressly about the common root reached through fulfillment of the commandments and revealed on Yom Kippur, so it neither transfers Yom Kippur's laws to Chanukah nor promises the same attainment without the required service.

permitted for labor. וּמִכָּל מָקוֹם עִנְיַן הוֹפַעַת הַקְּדֻשָּׁה מֵהוֹפָעַת אוֹר שֶׁנִּבְרָא בְּיוֹם רִאשׁוֹן; — **Nevertheless the nature of the emergence of holiness is from the single source of the light created on the first day;** וְעַל זֶה הוּא חֲנֻכַּת הַבַּיִת שֶׁיֵּשׁ בְּכָל יוֹם בִּימֵי חֲנֻכָּה חִנּוּךְ בָּאוֹר. — **and for this reason it is an inauguration of the House, in that every single day of Chanukah contains an initiation in light.** וְכֵן בְּשַׁבָּת מְפֹרָשׁ בְּסֵפֶר הַבָּהִיר:[973] — **And likewise regarding Shabbat it is explicit in Sefer HaBahir:** "לָקַח שְׁבִיעִי וְשָׂמוֹ לָהֶם בִּמְקוֹמוֹ, וְהַשְּׁאָר גָּנַז וְכוּ'", — **"He took the seventh and set it in its place for them, and the remainder He concealed, etc.",** וְהִיא גַּם כֵּן חֲנֻכָּה חֲדָשָׁה בָּאוֹר, וּכְמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב (תִּקּוּנֵי זֹהַר תִּקּוּן מ"ח): "'לְדֹרֹתָם'[974] — **and it is likewise a fresh dedication in light, as written (Tikunei Zohar, Tikun 48): "'Throughout their generations' —** דְּעָבֵיד לוֹן דִּירָה בִּתְרֵי בָתֵּי לִבָּא", — **he who makes for Them a dwelling in the two chambers of the heart",**[975] וְהֵם מַעְיָנָן אֶחָד וְחִשַּׁב בַּפְּסִיקְתָּא הַשְׁווּי שֶׁל מֹשֶׁה וְאֵלִיָּהוּ, עַיֵּן שָׁם, — **and they share a unified spiritual theme as stated.** וְאָמַר: מֹשֶׁה כִּנֵּס אֶת יִשְׂרָאֵל לְהַר סִינַי, וְאֵלִיָּהוּ כִּנְּסָם לְהַר הַכַּרְמֶל. — **And the Pesikta calculated the direct parallels between Moses and Elijah, see there, stating: Moses gathered Israel to Mount Sinai, and Elijah gathered them to Mount Carmel.** וְהַיְנוּ שֶׁאֵלִיָּהוּ הוֹפִיעַ לָהֶם הִתְגַּלּוּת מַעְיַן הִתְגַּלּוּת הַר סִינַי, — **Meaning that Elijah manifested to them a revelation reflecting the revelation of Mount Sinai,** שֶׁעַל יָדוֹ אָמְרוּ: "הַשֵּׁם הוּא הָאֱלֹהִים"; — **whereby through him they proclaimed: "Hashem, He is God";**

Loving repentance changes the understanding of the past

וְאָז אָמַר אֵלִיָּהוּ הַפָּסוּק: "וְאַתָּה הֲסִבֹּתָ אֶת לִבָּם אֲחֹרַנִּית",[976] — **and then Elijah uttered the verse: "And You have turned their heart backward",** וְאָמְרוּ עַל זֶה (בְּרָכוֹת ל"א סוֹף עַמּוּד ב'):[977] — **and they stated on this (Berachot 31b bottom):** "אֵלִיָּהוּ הַטִּיחַ דְּבָרִים כְּלַפֵּי מַעְלָה וְכוּ'", — **"Elijah hurled bold words toward Heaven, etc.",** וְאָמְרוּ שֶׁחָזַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא וְהוֹדָה לוֹ, דִּכְתִיב: "וַאֲשֶׁר הֲרֵעֹתִי"; — **and they stated that the Holy One conceded to him, as it is written: "And whom I have treated poorly";** וְאִיתָא שָׁם: "אִלְמָלֵא שְׁלֹשָׁה מִקְרָאוֹת הַלָּלוּ נִתְמוֹטְטוּ רַגְלֵיהֶם וְכוּ'". — **and it states there: "Were it not for these three verses, the feet of Israel would have stumbled, etc."** וְהַיְנוּ שֶׁאָז הוֹפִיעַ לָהֶם מֵאוֹר הַגָּנוּז מַעֲתִיקָא, — **And that means that then there shone upon them from the Hidden Light of Atika,** שֶׁהוּא: "אִם יִהְיוּ חַטָּאֵיכֶם כַּשָּׁנִים הַלָּלוּ שֶׁסִּדּוּרוֹת וּבָאוֹת מִשֵּׁשֶׁת יְמֵי בְרֵאשִׁית וְכוּ'", כַּשָּׁלֶג

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[973] **Sefer HaBahir 48**: "Mar Rachumai continued, "One text says, 'And all the people saw the voices' (Exodus 20:15), and another text says, 'You heard the voice of words' (Deuteronomy 4:12). How can this be? At first, 'they saw the voices.' What did they see? Seven voices about which David spoke. And at the end, they heard the speech that comes out from between them all. But have we not learned that that they are ten? The rabbis said that all of them the commandments were spoken in one utterance (BT Shevuot 20b). So too, all of them were spoken in one utterance. But there were seven utterances! There were seven voices, and regarding three of them, it is said, 'You heard the voice of words, but you did not see an image — only a voice' (Deuteronomy 4:12). Thus, you learned that all of them were spoken as one utterance, so that Israel would not err by saying that another had helped him or the angels helped as His voice alone could not be this strong. Because of this, He returned and included all of them.'"

[974] **Tikkunei Zohar 85a:3-85b:2**: 'In Tikkunei Zohar (Tikkun 48, 85a), the double mention of Shabbat in the verse refers to the union of the Supernal Shabbat (Binah, the World to Come) and the Lower Shabbat (Malkhut, the Sabbath Queen), which illuminate Israel throughout all their dwellings.'

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[976] **Tzidkat HaTzadik 40:1**: "The essence of repentance is for God to illuminate a person's eyes until deliberate sins become like merits. This means recognizing and understanding that everything he sinned was also within God's will, as the sages say concerning the three verses: "You have turned their heart backward," "Whom I afflicted," and so forth. This follows the meaning of knowledge and choice explained by the Ari at the end of Arba Meot Shekel Kesef: both are true, each in its own place. In the place of choice there is no place for knowledge, and in the place of knowledge there truly is no place for choice. When one attains this immense light, all his deliberate sins are found not to lie outside the depth of God's knowledge; He, His knowledge, and His will are all one. Since God willed it so, they are all merits, and the person merits the complete atonement of Yom Kippur. This is the mystery of the goat sent to Azazel. Had a person done this on his own, he would have been a complete idolater, violating "You shall have no other gods," the foundation of all prohibitions and all sins and departures from God's will. But because the goat is sent by God's will—He commands that it be sent to Azazel—it becomes a commandment instead of a transgression. Thus the sages explained it in Pirkei DeRabbi Eliezer; see also Ramban on Acharei Mot: we give a portion to Azazel, which is evil, because God commanded us to give it to him. Thus the transgression becomes a commandment."
Tzidkat HaTzadik explains the same three verses and the same goat symbolism used in this ois. Its essential qualification is that divine knowledge and human choice each have their own place. The Azazel example makes the boundary concrete: the act would be idolatry if undertaken independently, and is a mitzvah only because God commands it. This illuminates the retrospective light of loving repentance without turning it into authorization to choose a sin.

[977] **Berakhot 31b:27**; **Berakhot 32a:1**: "Rabbi Elazar also said: Eliyahu directed forceful words toward Heaven, as it says, 'You have turned their hearts backward.' Rabbi Shmuel bar Rabbi Yitzchak said: How do we know that the Holy One, blessed be He, subsequently acknowledged Eliyahu's argument? Because it is written, 'And those whom I caused to suffer evil.'"

(כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב שַׁבָּת פ״ט עַמּוּד ב׳) "יִלְבִּינוּ[978] — **which is: "Though your sins be like scarlet, like these years ordered from the Six Days of Creation, they shall become white as snow" (Shabbat 89b);** וְהֵינוּ שֶׁבְּמַאֲמַר בְּרֵאשִׁית כְּתִיב "תֹּהוּ וָבֹהוּ" שֶׁמְּרַמֵּז לְמַעֲשֵׂיהֶן שֶׁל רְשָׁעִים (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בִּבְרֵאשִׁית רַבָּה)[979] — **meaning that in the utterance of Bereishit it is written "unformed and void" alluding to the deeds of the wicked (Bereishit Rabbah),** וּכְשֶׁזּוֹכִין לְהִתְגַּלּוּת מֵאוֹר זֶה עַל יְדֵי תְּשׁוּבָה מֵאַהֲבָה, "כַּשָּׁלֶג יַלְבִּינוּ", — **and when we merit the revelation of this light through repentance out of love, they whiten as snow,** שֶׁנַּעֲשׂוֹת זְדוֹנוֹת לוֹ כִּזְכֻיּוֹת. — **with intentional sins transforming into merits.** וְכֵן אָמַר אֵלִיָּהוּ: "וְאַתָּה הָסַבְתָּ אֶת לִבָּם אֲחֹרַנִּית", — **And so Elijah said: "And You have turned their heart backward",** שֶׁהֲרֵי כֵּינָן שֶׁכִּנְּסָם שָׁבוּ כֻּלָּם לַהַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ — **for once he gathered them, they all returned to the Blessed Name** וְאָמְרוּ הַיְחוּד: "הַשֵּׁם הוּא הָאֱלֹהִים", — **and proclaimed the unification: "Hashem, He is God",** וְאוֹר זֶה מֵעֵין אוֹר שֶׁל מַתַּן תּוֹרָה. וְכֵן בְּמַעֲשֵׂי חַשְׁמוֹנָאִים בִּגְזֵרַת יָוָן, שֶׁנִּתְרַשׁ עֲלֵיהֶם "וְחֹשֶׁךְ" — **and this light reflects the light of the Giving of the Torah. –** וְכֵן שֶׁהֶחְשִׁיכָה עֵינֵיהֶם שֶׁל יִשְׂרָאֵל וְכוּ׳ — **And likewise in the deeds of the Hasmoneans during the Greek decrees, expounded in "and darkness" — which darkened the eyes of Israel, etc.,** וְהֵינוּ שֶׁרָצוּ לְבַטֵּל מֵהֶם אוֹר תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה; — **meaning they plotted to obliterate from them the light of the Oral Torah;** וְזֶה "עֵינֵיהֶם שֶׁל יִשְׂרָאֵל", דְּהַסַּנְהֶדְרִין נִקְרְאוּ "עֵינֵי הָעֵדָה" — **and this is "the eyes of Israel", for the Sanhedrin are called "the eyes of the congregation";** וְהֵם רָצוּ לִפְשֹׁט חָכְמָתָם וְהַמִּינוּת שֶׁהִיא בַּקְּלִפָּה בְּ"זֶה לְעֻמַּת זֶה" נֶגֶד קְדֻשַּׁת תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה, — **and the Greeks sought to spread their philosophy and heresy which in the kelipah opposed the sanctity of the Oral Torah,** וְרָצוּ לְהַטִּיל בָּהֶם זוּהֲמָא; — **seeking to inject spiritual defilement into them;** וְאַחַר שֶׁגָּבְרוּ עֲלֵיהֶם וְנִצְּחוּם נִתְגַּלָּה לָהֶם מֵאוֹר הָרִאשׁוֹן, — **and after they overpowered and conquered them, there was revealed to them from the Primordial Light,** וְהוּא מִבְּחִינַת אוֹרוֹ שֶׁל מָשִׁיחַ, וּכְמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב (בְּרֵאשִׁית רַבָּה): "'וְרוּחַ אֱלֹהִים[980] — **which is from the dimension of the light of the Messiah, –** "; רוּחַ שֶׁל מָשִׁיחַ עַל פְּנֵי הַמַּיִם, בִּזְכוּת הַתְּשׁוּבָה שֶׁנִּמְשְׁלָה כְּמַיִם וְכוּ׳"[981] — **and as written (Bereishit Rabbah): "'And the spirit of God' — this is the spirit of Messiah hovering over the waters, in the merit of repentance likened to water, etc.";** וּכְתִיב: "וְנָשָׂא הַשָּׂעִיר עָלָיו אֶת כָּל עֲוֹנֹתָם", וְנִדְרַשׁ (בְּרֵאשִׁית רַבָּה פָּרָשָׁה ס״ה)[982]: "עֲוֹנוֹת תָּם". — **and it is written: "And the he-goat (sa'ir) shall bear upon him all their iniquities", expounded (Bereishit Rabbah 65) as: "the iniquities of the upright man (tam / Jacob)".**

וְאַף יָוָן נִקְרָא "הַשָּׂעִיר", כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בְּדָנִיֵּאל (ח׳, כ״א): "וְהַצָּפִיר הַשָּׂעִיר מֶלֶךְ יָוָן וְגוֹמֵר". וְכֵן אִיתָא (שָׁם): "'וַיָּרַח אֶת רֵיחַ בְּגָדָיו'[983] — **And Greece also is designated "the goat", as written in Daniel (8:21): "And the rough goat (hatzafir hasa'ir) is the king of Greece, etc." –** כְּגוֹן יוֹסֵף מְשִׁיתָא וְיָקוּם אִישׁ צְרוֹרוֹת וְכוּ׳", — **And so it states**[984]

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[978] **Shabbat 89b:2**: "'From where do we learn that they tie a strip of crimson wool,' and so forth? Why does the verse say ka-shanim, a plural form for 'scarlet'? Should it not have said ka-shani, the singular? Rabbi Yitzchak said: The Holy One, blessed be He, told Israel, 'Even if your sins are like these years, shanim, which have come in ordered succession from the six days of Creation until now, they shall become white as snow.' Rava expounded: What is meant by 'Go now, and let us reason together, the Lord will say'? Why 'Go now'? Should it not say 'Come now'? And why 'the Lord will say'? Should it not say 'the Lord said'? In the future the Holy One, blessed be He, will tell Israel, 'Go now to your ancestors, and let them rebuke you.'"

[979] **Bereshit Rabbah 2:5** (excerpt): "Rabbi Abahu and Rabbi Chiya Rabbah: Rabbi Abahu said: From the beginning of the world's creation, the Holy One, blessed be He, foresaw the deeds of the righteous and the deeds of the wicked, as it is written, 'Hashem knows the way of the righteous, but the way of the wicked will perish' (Psalms 1:6). 'The earth was unformed and void'—these are the deeds of the wicked. 'God said: Let there be light'—these are the deeds of the righteous. Yet I would not know which He desires, the deeds of these or of those. Once it says, 'God saw the light, that it was good,' we know that He desires the deeds of the righteous and does not desire the deeds of the wicked."

[980] **Bereshit Rabbah 2:4** (excerpt): "'The spirit of God hovered'—this is the spirit of King Messiah, as it says, 'The spirit of Hashem shall rest upon him' (Isaiah 11:2). Through what merit does it approach and come? 'Hovering upon the face of the waters'—through the merit of repentance, which is likened to water, as it says, 'Pour out your heart like water' (Lamentations 2:19)."

[981] **Bereshit Rabbah 2:4** (excerpt): "'The spirit of God hovered'—this is the spirit of King Messiah, as it says, 'The spirit of Hashem shall rest upon him' (Isaiah 11:2). Through what merit does it approach and come? 'Hovering upon the face of the waters'—through the merit of repentance, which is likened to water, as it says, 'Pour out your heart like water' (Lamentations 2:19)."

[982] **Bereshit Rabbah 65:15** (excerpt): "'The goat shall bear upon itself' (Leviticus 16:22)—this is Esau, as it says, 'Esau my brother is a hairy man.' 'All their iniquities'—the iniquities of the wholehearted one, as it says, 'Jacob was a wholehearted man' (Genesis 25:27)."

[983] **Daniel 8:21**: 'And the rough he-goat (ha-tzafir ha-sa'ir) is the king of Greece; and the great horn that is between his eyes is the first king.'

[984] **Bereshit Rabbah 65:22** (excerpt): "Yakum of Tzerorot was the son of the sister of Rabbi Yose ben Yoezer of Tzeredah. He rode a horse on Shabbos before the beam on which his uncle was being led to execution. He said to him: See the horse my master has had me ride, and see the horse your Master has had you ride! Rabbi Yose replied: If this is how He treats those who anger Him, how much more will He reward those who do His will! Yakum said: Has anyone done His will more than you? He replied: If this is how He treats those who do His will, how much more will He punish those who anger Him! The words entered him like a serpent's venom. He went and subjected himself to the four court-

(ibid.): "'And he smelled the fragrance of his garments' — such as Yosef Meshita and Yakum of Tzerorot, etc.", וּמַעֲשֶׂה יָקוּם אִישׁ צְרוֹרוֹת הָיָה בִּגְזֵרַת יָוָן שֶׁהָיָה בֶּן אֲחוֹתוֹ שֶׁל רַבִּי יוֹסֵי בֶּן יוֹעֶזֶר שֶׁנֶּהֱרַג אָז, **— and the act of Yakum of Tzerorot occurred during the Greek decrees, being the nephew of Rabbi Yose ben Yoezer who was martyred then,** וְעַל יְדֵי שֶׁהִכְנִיס בּוֹ אָז הָרַהוּר תְּשׁוּבָה קִיֵּם בְּעַצְמוֹ אַרְבַּע מִיתוֹת, **— and through Yose inspiring in him thoughts of repentance he inflicted upon himself the four judicial executions,** וְאָמַר רַבִּי יוֹסֵי בֶּן יוֹעֶזֶר שֶׁקִּדָּמוֹ לְגַן עֵדֶן; **— and Rabbi Yose ben Yoezer testified that Yakum preceded him to the Garden of Eden;** וְדָרַשׁ[985] "רֵיחַ בְּגָדָיו" כְּמוֹ "רֵיחַ בּוֹגְדָיו" (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב סַנְהֶדְרִין ל״ז עַמּוּד א׳), **— and he expounded "the fragrance of his garments (begadav)" like "the fragrance of his traitors (bogdav)" (Sanhedrin 37a),** וְהֵינוּ שֶׁעָלָה רֵיחַ שֶׁלָּהֶם וְנִתְבָּרֵר שֶׁמַּעֲשֵׂה בּוֹגְדָיו רַק מַה שֶּׁלָּבַשׁ בִּגְדֵי וּלְבוּשׁ עֵשָׂו **— meaning that their sweet scent ascended, clarifying that his treasonous deed was merely donning the garments of Esau** שֶׁנִּקְרָא בַּתּוֹרָה "אִישׁ שָׂעִיר", וְיָוָן נִקְרָא בְּדָנִיֵּאל "שָׂעִיר". **— who is called in the Torah "a hairy man (ish sa'ir)", and Greece is called in Daniel "a he-goat (sa'ir)".** וּקְלִפַּת הַשָּׂעִיר הוּא הַחֹשֶׁךְ, **— And the kelipah of the goat (sa'ir) is darkness,** כְּמוֹ[986] שֶׁכָּתוּב (שַׁבָּת ע״ז עַמּוּד ב׳): "מַאי טַעְמָא עִזֵּי מַסְגֵּן בְּרֵישָׁא וְכוּלֵּיהּ? **— as written (Shabbat 77b): "What is the reason goats lead the flock, etc.?** כִּבְרִיָּתוֹ שֶׁל עוֹלָם דִּבְרֵישָׁא חֲשׁוֹכָא וְכוּלֵּיהּ", **— Like the creation of the world, where initially was darkness, etc.",** וּפֵרַשׁ רַבִּי שְׁלֹמֹה יִצְחָקִי: "סְתָם עִזִּים שְׁחוֹרוֹת וְכוּלֵּיהּ", **— and Rashi explained: "Ordinarily goats are black, etc.",** וְהוּא קְלִפַּת הַחֹשֶׁךְ שֶׁכֵּן נִקְרָא גַּוְנָן שָׁחֹר "חֹשֶׁךְ", **— and this is the kelipah of darkness, for the black hue is called "darkness",** וְכֵן נִרְאֶה גַּוְנָן וּכְמַה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: "חָשַׁךְ מִשְּׁחוֹר תָּאֳרָם", **— and as Scripture states: "Their visage is darker than blackness", and so the color of darkness appears black.** הַחֹשֶׁךְ שָׁחֹר. וְחָשַׁב עוֹד בַּפְּסִיקְתָא: מֹשֶׁה בְּעֵר עוֹבְדֵי עֲבוֹדָה זָרָה: "שִׂימוּ אִישׁ חַרְבּוֹ וְגוֹמֵר", **— And it calculated further in the Pesikta: Moses eradicated idolaters: "Put every man his sword, etc.",** וְאֵלִיָּהוּ בְּעֵר עוֹבְדֵי עֲבוֹדָה זָרָה וְתָפַשׂ נְבִיאֵי הַבַּעַל; **— and Elijah eradicated idolaters and seized the prophets of Baal;** מֹשֶׁה קַנַּאי: "מִי לַהשֵׁם אֵלַי", וְאֵלִיָּהוּ קַנַּאי וְכוּלֵּיהּ. **— Moses was zealous: "Whoever is for Hashem, to me!", and Elijah was zealous, etc.** וְזֶה עִנְיַן מַה שֶּׁכָּתוּב בְּסֵפֶר יְצִירָה: **— And this is the meaning of what is written in Sefer Yetzirah:** "הַמְלִיךְ אוֹת עַיִ״ן בְּרֹגֶז וְכוּלֵּיהּ, **— "He made the letter Ayin king over anger (rogez), etc.,** גְּדִי בָּעוֹלָם, וְטֵבֵת בַּשָּׁנָה, וְכָבֵד בַּנֶּפֶשׁ וְכוּלֵּיהּ", **— Capricorn in the cosmos, Tevet in the year, and the liver in the soul, etc.",** וְאִיתָא בַּגְּמָרָא (בְּרָכוֹת ס״א עַמּוּד ב׳)[987]: "כָּבֵד כּוֹעֵס". **— and it states in the Gemara (Berachot 61b): "The liver is angry."** וְכֵן אִיתָא בְּרַעְיָא מְהֵימְנָא (זֹהַר חֵלֶק ג׳ רל״ד עַמּוּד א׳)[988]: **— And so it states in Ra'aya Meheimna (Zohar Part III, 234a):** "דְּכָבֵד אִיהוּ דְּרַגָּא דְּעֵשָׂו וְכוּלֵּיהּ, הוּא כָּנִישׁ כָּל דָּמִין וְכוּלֵּיהּ", **— "That the liver is the level of Esau, etc., gathering all blood, etc.",** וְעַל עֲשׂוֹ כְּתִיב: "דָּם שָׂנֵאתָ", וְאָמְרוּ (בְּרֵאשִׁית רַבָּה פָּרָשָׁה ס״ג): "שָׂנֵאתָ דָּמוֹ שֶׁל אָדָם בְּגוּפוֹ", **— and regarding Esau it is written: "Blood you hated", expounded (Bereishit Rabbah 63): "You hated the blood of man in his body",**[989] וְהֵינוּ שֶׁהוּא שֹׁרֶשׁ קְלִפַּת הַכַּעַס וְהַקִּנְאָה, **— meaning that he is the root of the kelipah of fury and jealousy;** וְכָאן אָמְרוּ שֶׁנִּבְרָא בְּאֵבֶר זֶה קְדֻשַּׁת הַחֹדֶשׁ. **— yet here they stated that within this organ was created the holiness of the month.**

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imposed forms of death: stoning, burning, execution by the sword, and strangulation. … Yose ben Yoezer of Tzeredah dozed and saw Yakum's bier flying in the air. He said: In one brief moment, this one has preceded me to the Garden of Eden."

[985] **Sanhedrin 37a:7**: "Reish Lakish said: It is learned from here: 'Your temples are like a slice of pomegranate.' Even the empty ones among you are full of mitzvos like a pomegranate is full of seeds. Rabbi Zeira said: It is learned from here: 'He smelled the fragrance of his garments.' Do not read begadav, 'his garments,' but bogedav, 'his traitors.'"

[986] **Shabbat 77b:8**: "Rabbi Zeira found Rav Yehudah standing at the entrance of his father-in-law's house and saw that he was in good spirits: Had he asked him about all the hidden matters in the world, he would have answered him. He asked, 'Why do goats walk first and sheep afterward?' He answered, 'Like the creation of the world: First darkness, then light.' 'Why are these animals covered at the rear and those exposed?' 'Those from which we cover ourselves with wool are themselves covered; those from which we do not cover ourselves are exposed.' 'Why is a camel's tail short?' 'Because it eats thorns, which a long tail could catch.' 'Why is an ox's tail long?' 'Because it dwells among marshes and needs to swish away mosquitoes.'"

[987] **Berakhot 61b:1**: "The lung draws in all kinds of liquids; the liver becomes angry; the gallbladder casts a drop into it and calms it; the spleen laughs; the gizzard grinds; the stomach sleeps; and the nose remains awake. If the sleeping organ wakes and the waking organ sleeps, the person wastes away. It was taught: If both sleep or both remain awake, he dies immediately."

[988] **Zohar, Pinchas 69:399-412**: 'In the Zohar (Pinchas, Ra'aya Meheimna III 234a), the anatomy of the human organs is aligned with spiritual forces: the liver (kaved), which is filled with turbid blood and is the seat of anger ('the liver is angry,' Berakhot 61b), corresponds to the unrefined domain of Esau and Mars (Ma'adim), whereas the heart and brain belong to Jacob and Israel.'

[989] **Bereshit Rabbah 63:13** (excerpt): "This is what is written: 'I will make you into blood, and blood will pursue you; since you hated blood, blood will pursue you' (Ezekiel 35:6). Does Esau hate blood? Rabbi Shmuel bar Nachman said: This is the blood of the birthright and sacrifices. Rabbi Levi said: This is the blood of circumcision. The Sages say: You hated a person's blood while it was in his body. Thus it is written, 'He loved a curse, and it came upon him' (Psalms 109:17)."

Holy strength is governed by the command and its purpose

וּבָרָא רַמ״ח אֵיבָרִים, **However, in truth "God made man upright",** "הָאֱלֹהִים עָשָׂה אֶת הָאָדָם יָשָׁר"[990, 991]
וְאֵבֶר זֶה כְּנֶגֶד רַמ״ח מִצְוֹת עֲשֵׂה; **and created 248 limbs corresponding to the 248 positive commandments;**
בָּרָא הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא נֶגֶד מִצְוַת עֲשֵׂה דִּמְחִיַּת עֲמָלֵק, **and this organ the Holy One created corresponding to the positive mitzvah of blotting out Amalek,**
שֶׁשָּׁם צִוָּה הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרֵךְ שֶׁלֹּא לְרַחֵם כְּלָל, **where the Blessed Name commanded to have no mercy at all,**
רַק לְהוֹצִיא רוּחַ כָּל הַכַּעַס עֲלֵיהֶם, **but to unleash the spirit of all fiery anger against them,**
וּדְלָא כְּמוֹ שֶׁאוֹל קַל וָחֹמֶר: "אִם אָדָם חָטָא, בְּהֵמָה מַה חָטְאָה?" (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב יוֹמָא כ״ב עַמּוּד ב׳);[992] **and not as Saul reasoned an a fortiori: "If a human sinned, how did an animal sin?" (Yoma 22b);**
וְאָמְרוּ (יַלְקוּט שְׁמוּאֵל רֶמֶז קכ״א) עָלָיו: "כָּל[993] **and they stated (Yalkut Shmuel, Remez 121) regarding him:**
שֶׁהוּא רַחְמָן עַל אַכְזָרִי, לְסוֹף נַעֲשֶׂה אַכְזָר עַל הָרַחֲמָנִים וְכוּ׳לֵיהּ". **"Whoever is merciful to the cruel, ultimately becomes cruel to the merciful, etc."**

שֶׁאַף שֶׁאֵין הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא שָׂמֵחַ בְּמַפַּלְתָּן שֶׁל רְשָׁעִים — **And it is written: "Hashem has a war with Amalek",**
כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב (מְגִלָּה י׳ עַמּוּד ב׳): "מַעֲשֵׂה יְדֵי טוֹבְעִין בַּיָּם וְאַתֶּם אוֹמְרִים שִׁירָה?"[994] **for even though the Holy One does not rejoice at the downfall of the wicked,**
מִכָּל מָקוֹם כְּתִיב: "מִלְחָמָה לַהשֵׁם בַּעֲמָלֵק", **as written (Megillah 10b): "The work of My hands drown in the sea, and you recite song?",**
וּכְמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב (מִדְרַשׁ תַּנְחוּמָא כִּי תֵצֵא): "אַתֶּם **nevertheless it is written: "Hashem has a war with Amalek",**
מַזְכִּירִין שְׁמוֹ מִלְּמַטָּה, וַאֲנִי מוֹחֵק שְׁמוֹ מִלְּמַעְלָה".[995] **and as written (Midrash Tanchuma, Ki Teitzei): "You**

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[990] **Tiferet Yosef, Pesach 6**: "God established anger in this world in the sense of the verse, "With strategies you shall wage your war." My grandfather explained this through the ship's captain: when the captain sees the ship leaning to one side, he tilts it toward the other. Although a lasting tilt toward the side he is now directing it would also be bad, he does this to save the ship and bring it onto an even course. Likewise, because evil desires still exist in the world, God established the quality of anger, through which a person can be saved from desire. As long as the person's anger is in the measure needed to escape desire, it is called the anger of sages. A little more—even a hair's breadth—is called actual idolatry."

Tiferet Yosef explains the proper measure of this power by the captain's correction of a listing ship. The opposing force is a means to restore a sound course, and becomes wrong when it exceeds that purpose. This helps distinguish the created capacity that the Chanukah passage places in service of a command from anger treated as an end in itself.

[991] **Tzidkat HaTzadik 199:1**: "The anger of sages is good on all sides," as the Zohar says. This is what Taanit means by "It is the Torah that makes him boil": the anger is only what the Torah arouses in him, where the Torah calls for anger. It is like the Sanhedrin judging capital cases; they do not appoint an elderly person to the Sanhedrin, and so forth. In truth, they were filled with mercy and sought to find grounds of merit according to Torah. Their ardor arose only from the necessity imposed by the Torah. This is called the anger of sages—those who truly love Torah, whose anger, even when it occurs, comes only from Torah, while they remember mercy and exert themselves in it."

Tzidkat HaTzadik supplies a demanding criterion for the commanded strength described here. The judge's necessary firmness does not erase compassion or the effort to find merit; only the Torah's requirement causes the anger. This explains how the power can belong to upright creation while destructive anger remains evil. It does not make a person's private feeling of anger proof of a command.

[992] **Yoma 22b:8-9**: "'He contended in the valley.' Rabbi Mani said: He contended over the matter of the valley. When the Holy One, blessed be He, told Shaul, 'Go and strike Amalek,' Shaul said: If, for one life taken, the Torah says to bring a calf whose neck is broken in a valley, how much more must this apply to all these lives! If a person sinned, what sin did the animals commit? If adults sinned, what sin did the children commit? A heavenly voice went forth and told him, 'Do not be overly righteous.' When Shaul later told Doeg, 'Turn and strike the kohanim,' a heavenly voice went forth and told him, 'Do not be overly wicked.'"

[993] **Yalkut Shimoni on Nach 121**: 'Regarding King Saul's misplaced mercy on Agag and the sheep of Amalek and his subsequent slaughter of Nob, the city of priests, the Midrash (Yalkut Shimoni, I Samuel, Remez 121; Kohelet Rabbah 7:16) states: 'Whoever becomes merciful toward the cruel will ultimately become cruel toward the merciful.''

[994] **Megillah 10b:25-26**: "Does the Holy One, blessed be He, rejoice at the downfall of the wicked? It is written, 'As they went out before the armed force, they said: Give thanks to the Lord, for His kindness endures forever.' Rabbi Yochanan said: Why does this thanksgiving not include the words 'for He is good'? Because the Holy One, blessed be He, does not rejoice at the downfall of the wicked. Rabbi Yochanan also said: What is meant by the verse 'The one did not approach the other throughout the night'? The ministering angels wished to utter song. The Holy One, blessed be He, said: 'The works of My hands are drowning in the sea, and you are uttering song?'"

[995] **Midrash Tanchuma, Ki Teitzei 11:1**: "(Deut. 25:19:) "And it shall come to pass when the Lord your God grants you rest … you shall blot out the remembrance of Amalek." R. Azariah and R. Judah bar Simon said in the name of R. Judah bar Il'ay, "Israel was given three commandments on their entrance to the land: To appoint a king over themselves, as written (in Deut. 17:15), 'You shall surely place a king over yourself.' To build the Temple, as written (in Exod. 25:8), 'And make Me a sanctuary.' To cut off the seed of Amalek, as stated (in Deut. 25:19), '… you shall blot out the remembrance of Amalek.'" R. Joshua ben Levi said in the name of R. Alexandri, "One text says (in Deut. 25:19), 'you shall blot out the remembrance of Amalek,' while another text says (in Exod. 17:14), 'I will utterly blot out the remembrance of Amalek.' How are these two texts to be harmonized? Before the Amalekites raised their hands against the heavenly throne, 'you shall blot out.' When they had raised their hands against the heavenly throne, 'I will blot out.'" Can flesh and blood possibly raise its hand against the throne of the Holy One, blessed be He? It is simply because they destroyed Jerusalem, since it is written (in Jer. 3:17), "For at that time they shall call Jerusalem the throne of the Lord." It

mention his name from below, and I blot out his name from above." וְעַל זֶה בָּרָא הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא אֵבֶר הַכָּבֵד וְהַכַּעַס — **– And for this purpose the Holy One created the organ of the liver and anger —** לִכְעֹס עַל עֲמָלֵק שֶׁהוּא שֹׁרֶשׁ כָּל הַקְּלִפּוֹת, רֹאשִׁית דְּקְלִפָּה; **— to unleash holy wrath against Amalek who is the root of all kelipot, the head of the husk;** וְהוּא "רוּגְזָא דְרַבָּנַן טָב אִיהוּ לְכָל סְטָרִין", כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב (זֹהַר חֵלֶק ב' קפ"ב עַמּוּד ב')[996] — **and this is "the rage of the Rabbis is beneficial in every direction", as written (Zohar Part II, 182b).** וְזֶהוּ שֶׁמֹּשֶׁה בִּעֵר עוֹבְדֵי עֲבוֹדָה זָרָה וְאֵלְיָהוּ בִּעֵר עוֹבְדֵי עֲבוֹדָה זָרָה, אַף שֶׁהָיוּ בְּיִשְׂרָאֵל, מִכָּל מָקוֹם רוֹגֶז זֶה "טָב אִיהוּ לְכָל סְטָרִין", שֶׁעַל יְדֵי זֶה שָׁבוּ כָּל יִשְׂרָאֵל וְקֵרְבוּם לַמָּקוֹם, "וְנַעֲשָׂא הַשָּׂעִיר עָלָיו אֵת כָּל עֲוֹנֹתָם" — **And so this is why Moses eradicated idolaters and Elijah eradicated idolaters, even though they were among Israel, — nevertheless this wrath was "beneficial in every direction", — for through this all Israel returned and were drawn close to the Omnipresent, –** עֲוֹנוֹת תָּם; — **"and the he-goat shall bear upon him all their iniquities" — the iniquities of the upright man (tam / Jacob);** שֶׁכָּל זְמַן שֶׁיֵּשׁ לְקְלִפַּת עֲמָלֵק הֲוָיָה בָּעוֹלָם, נִצְרָךְ לְרוֹגֶז וְקִנְאָה. — **for as long as the kelipah of Amalek possesses existence in the world, holy rage and zealotry are required.** וְכֵן בְּפוּרִים, אַחַר שֶׁקִּיְּמוּ מְחִיַּת עֲמָלֵק כְּתִיב: "לַיְּהוּדִים הָיְתָה אוֹרָה", וְדָרְשׁוּ בַּגְּמָרָא (שָׁם ט"ז עַמּוּד ב'): "'אוֹרָה'[997] — **And so on Purim, after they executed the blotting out of Amalek, it is written: "To the Jews was light", –** זוֹ תּוֹרָה"[998] — **and they expounded in the Gemara (Megillah 16b): "'Light' — this is Torah",** וְהֵבִינוּ אוֹר תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה (וּכְמוֹ שֶׁנִּתְבָּאֵר כַּמָּה פְּעָמִים)[999] — **meaning the light of the Oral Torah (as explained often) which**

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is therefore written (in Exod. 17:14), “I will utterly blot out.” And it is stated (Exod. 17:16), “Because a hand is upon the throne of the Lord, the Lord has a war with Amalek from generation to generation.” It is taught in the name of R. Il'ay: The Holy One, blessed be He, swore an oath and said, “By My right hand, by My right hand, by My throne, by My throne, I swear that if gentiles come from any of the peoples, them I will accept; but those from the seed of Amalek I will not accept.” And David also acted in this way, as stated (in II Sam. 1:13), “And David said unto the young man who had told him, ‘Where do you come from?’ Then he said, ‘I am the son of an Amalekite proselyte.’” R. Isaac said, “He was the son of Doeg the Edomite.” (II Sam. 1:16:) “Then David said to him, ‘Your blood be upon your own head ….’” This is what one reads, but the written text (ketiv) is “Your bloods,” meaning You shed a lot of bloods; you killed the inhabitants of Nob, the city of priests .(Exod. 17:16:) “From generation to generation.” The Holy One, blessed be He, said, “’From generation to generation,’ I am keeping after them (i.e., after the Amalekites) for generations of generations.” R. Eliezer, R. Joshua, and R. Jose differ. R. Eliezer says, “From the generation of Moses to the generation of Samuel.” R. Joshua says, “From the generation of Samuel to the generation of Mordecai and Esther.” And R. Jose says, “From the generation of Mordecai and Esther to the generation of the messianic king, which itself equals three generations.” And where is it shown that the generation of the messianic king equals three generations? Where it is stated (of the messianic king in Ps. 72:5), “Let them fear You as long as the sun endures and as long as the moon, for a generation and generations.” The singular generation equals one, and the plural generations equals two, for a total of three. R. Berekhyah said in the name of R. Abba bar Kahana, “As long as the seed of Amalek remains alive in the world, it is as though a wing (kanaf) is hiding the divine face. When the seed of Amalek has passed from the world, (in Is. 30:20), “your Teacher (i.e., the Holy One, blessed be He,) will no longer be hidden (yikanef).” R. Levi says in the name of R. Hama bar Hanina, “As long as the seed of Amalek is in the world, the divine name will not be at peace (literally, whole) and the divine throne will not be at peace. When the seed of Amalek passes from the world, the throne will be at peace, and the name will be at peace.” What is the evidence? That which is stated (in Ps. 9:7), “The enemy is no more, in everlasting ruins, and you have uprooted their cities, their very memory has perished.” What is written after that (in vs. 8), “But the Lord sits enthroned forever; He has established His throne for judgment.” Ergo, the name is at peace, and the throne is at peace. Amen, and so may it be His will!”

[996] **Zohar, Tetzaveh 7:64**: “The answer would be as follows: It is written concerning the High Priest: “And he should make an atonement for himself and for his house” (Lev. 16, 6); from which it is clear that he, being the medium of propitiation, must first make atonement on his own behalf and then be the means of atonement for his household. The same applies here: the grade of the Passover feast began to be sanctified first (on the first day), and having been sanctified itself required to sanctify its household, and for this reason it “came down”. And what is the instrument of that sanctification? Israel which is below, when she counts the days of the Omer (from the second night of Passover until the night of Pentecost). And when these have been sanctified, this grade must be raised in order to ascend above, for when the house of the Matrona (Israel, the “bearer” of the Shekinah) is sanctified, it ascends to the upper region in order to unite itself with those “higher” days above (on the Feast of Weeks).”

[997] **Megillah 16b:8-9**: “‘The Jews had light, joy, gladness, and honor.’ Rav Yehudah said: ‘Light’ means Torah, as it also says, ‘For a commandment is a lamp and Torah is light.’ ‘Joy’ means a festival, as it also says, ‘You shall rejoice on your festival.’ ‘Gladness’ means circumcision, as it also says, ‘I rejoice over Your word.’ ‘Honor’ means tefillin, as it also says, ‘All the peoples of the earth shall see that the Lord’s name is called upon you, and they shall fear you.’ It was taught: Rabbi Eliezer the Great says: These are the tefillin worn on the head.”

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[999] **Chagigah 12a**: ‘The Gemara answers: This should be understood in accordance with Rabbi Elazar, as Rabbi Elazar said: The light that the Holy One, Blessed be He, created on the first day was not that of the sun but a different kind of light, through which man could observe from one end of the world to the other. But when the Holy One, Blessed be He, looked upon the generation of the Flood and the generation of the Dispersion and saw that their ways were corrupt and that they might misuse this light for evil, He arose and concealed it from them, as it is stated: “And from the wicked their

stems from the Primordial Light; וּכְמוֹ כֵן הַחַשְׁמוֹנָאִים, אַחַר שֶׁכָּבְשׁוּ הַיְוָנִים שֶׁהוּא הַשְּׂעִיר וְהַחֹשֶׁךְ שֶׁהֶחְשִׁיכָה עֵינֵיהֶם, **and likewise the Hasmoneans, after conquering the Greeks who are the sa'ir and the darkness that darkened their eyes,** שֶׁכָּל גְּזֵרָתָם הָיָה לְבַטֵּל מֵהֶם הַתּוֹרָה וְאוֹר תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה, — **whose entire decree was to strip from them the Torah and the Oral Torah's illumination,** קָבְעוּ אַחַר כָּךְ בָּרוֹת חֲנֻכָּה שֶׁזּוֹכִין עַל יְדֵי כֵן לְהוֹפִיעַ בָּהֶם מֵאוֹר הָרִאשׁוֹן וְאוֹר תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה. — **established afterward the Chanukah lights whereby we merit the emergence within them of the Primordial Light and Oral Torah.** וְתָמִיד שְׁלִשָּׁה יָמִים הָאַחֲרוֹנִים מֵחֲנֻכָּה בְּחֹדֶשׁ שֶׁנִּבְרָא בְּרֹגֶז וְכָבֵד בַּנֶּפֶשׁ, טֵבֵת — **And always the last three days of Chanukah fall in the month of Tevet,** שֶׁהוּא בְּחִינַת הַכַּעַס וְרוּגְזָא דְּרַבָּנָן — **which was created through anger (rogez) and the liver in the soul, representing holy rage and rabbinic zeal** עַל שֹׁרֶשׁ הָרָע, קְלִפַּת עֲמָלֵק. — **against the root of evil, the kelipah of Amalek.**

Increasing holy light and diminishing darkness are connected movements

וְהִנֵּה בֵּית שַׁמַּאי וּבֵית הִלֵּל נָחְלְקוּ בַּגְּמָרָא:[1000, 1001] — **And behold, Beit Shammai and Beit Hillel disputed in the Gemara:** דְּבֵית שַׁמַּאי אוֹמְרִים: דְּפוֹחֲתִת וְהוֹלֵךְ כְּנֶגֶד פָּרֵי הֶחָג, — **for Beit Shammai say: continually decreasing corresponding to the bullocks of the Festival,** וּבֵית הִלֵּל אוֹמְרִים: דְּמוֹסִיף וְהוֹלֵךְ דְּמַעֲלִין בַּקֹּדֶשׁ (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב שַׁבָּת כ״א עַמּוּד ב׳);[1002] — **and Beit Hillel say: continually increasing because we ascend in holiness (Shabbat 21b);** וּכְבָר אָמַרְנוּ דְּאֵלּוּ וְאֵלּוּ דִּבְרֵי אֱלֹהִים חַיִּים, — **and we already explained that both these and those are the words of the Living God,** וְעַל דָּרֶךְ מַה שֶּׁנֶּאֱמַר: "כִּי הִנֵּה הַחֹשֶׁךְ יְכַסֶּה אֶרֶץ וְגוֹמֵר וְעָלַיִךְ יִזְרַח ה' וְכוּ'", — **following Scripture: "For behold, darkness shall cover the earth, etc., and upon you Hashem shall shine",** דִּכְשֶׁפּוֹחֵת וְהוֹלֵךְ נֶגֶד פָּרֵי הֶחָג שֶׁרוֹמְזִין עַל הַנִּיצוֹצוֹת הַקְּדוֹשׁוֹת שֶׁמּוֹצִיאִין, — **for when it decreases corresponding to the bullocks alluding to the holy sparks being extracted,** מֵאֵלָיו עַל יְדֵי זֶה בְּיִשְׂרָאֵל הָאוֹר מוֹסִיף וְהוֹלֵךְ דְּמַעֲלִין בַּקֹּדֶשׁ, — **automatically through this in Israel the light continually increases as we ascend in holiness,** שֶׁנִּתּוֹסֵף בְּכָל יוֹם קְדֻשָּׁה בְּיִשְׂרָאֵל, וְכֵן לְהֵפֶךְ. — **holiness being augmented daily in Israel, and vice versa.**

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light is withheld" (Job 38:15).'

[1000] **Sod Yesharim, Simchat Torah 33:1**: "Esau's minister thought he lost nothing by separating from his power and giving Israel the anger of sages. He had no connection to this anger, for the anger of sages is governed by judgment. It therefore appeared to him the very opposite of his own existence, which was simply "By your sword you shall live," without judgment. But in truth he greatly deceived himself: his existence endured only as long as that good point was still hidden within his anger. Once that good point was stripped from him, and his anger remained without it because he had given it to Israel to be called the anger of sages, no good aspect remained in his anger—only mere murder, of which it says, "Only evil all day." Then the whole persistence of his existence was automatically nullified."

Sod Yesharim explains why drawing a holy point into Israel can itself diminish the domain from which it was taken: the point was what had sustained that domain's existence. Its example of measured, just anger is especially close to the preceding discussion in this ois. This supplies the causal relation behind the two movements without pretending that the target independently discusses Chanukah's lamp count.

[1001] **Resisei Layla 56:27**: "This is the meaning of the dispute between Beit Shammai and Beit Hillel: whether the number decreases in correspondence with the festival's bulls, which, as is known, correspond to the seventy nations and therefore diminish, our whole intention being to diminish them. Likewise here, according to Beit Shammai—who belong to the quality of judgment and restraint, and therefore rule stringently—the entire intention in lighting the Chanukah lamp is to restrain ourselves, separate ourselves from the nations' wisdom, and diminish it. Therefore the number decreases. This corresponds to the incoming days: in diminishing the nations' wisdom, we are not concerned with what has already passed away and departed, since we no longer have dealings with it. Our concern is with what we still need to remove from ourselves. According to Beit Hillel, whose view is the law, the principal intention is to draw the true wisdom of Oral Torah into our hearts. Through the light of truth, darkness and falsehood withdraw and vanish of themselves. Therefore the count corresponds to the outgoing days: every wisdom already attained must be established and rooted within the heart. "We ascend in holiness," since the lamps allude to holy wisdom. According to the hidden teaching, "holiness" alludes to the upper wisdom, from which the lower wisdom of Oral Torah draws. One must rise, moving from degree to degree, higher and higher. Therefore a degree is added each time. The degree of the days already gone has not departed or been removed; on the contrary, those days remain with the person as he advances to a higher degree."

Resisei Layla adds why each opinion counts its particular days. What has been removed no longer needs resistance, while wisdom already acquired must remain rooted as new wisdom is added. This makes the ois's reciprocal movement practical and cumulative. The target also expressly identifies Beit Hillel as the governing halakhic opinion; the conceptual truth of both movements does not erase that distinction.

[1002] **Shabbat 21b:5-6**: "The Sages taught: The mitzvah of Chanukah is one lamp for a man and his household. Those who embellish the mitzvah light one lamp for each person. For those who embellish it most fully, Beis Shammai say: On the first day one lights eight; from then on one progressively decreases. Beis Hillel say: On the first day one lights one; from then on one progressively increases. Ulla said: Two Amoraim in the Land of Israel disagreed about the explanation, Rabbi Yosei bar Avin and Rabbi Yosei bar Zevida. One said: Beis Shammai's reason corresponds to the days still to come, and Beis Hillel's reason corresponds to the days that have passed. The other said: Beis Shammai's reason corresponds to the bulls offered on Sukkos, which decrease each day; Beis Hillel's reason is that one ascends in sanctity and does not descend."

וּכְמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ (חֵלֶק ג׳ רע״ב עַמּוּד ב׳)[1003] לְעִנְיַן שַׁבָּת: — **And as written in the Holy Zohar (Part III, 272b) regarding Shabbat:** "כְּגַוְונָא דְּצָרִיךְ לְקַבָּלָא גְּבִירְתָּא בְּכַמָּה נְהוֹרִין בְּשַׁבָּת וּבְכַמָּה עִנּוּגִין וּלְבוּשִׁין שַׁפִּירִין וְכוּלֵּיהּ, — **"Just as one must receive the Matron with multiple lights on Shabbat, and with delights and beautiful garments, etc.,** גָּרְמִין דְּאִשְׁתָּאֲרוּ שְׁפָחָה בִישָׁא בַּחֲשׁוֹכָא, בְּרַעֲבוֹן, בִּבְכִיָּה, בְּהֶסְפֵּד, בִּלְבוּשִׁין אוּכְמִין כְּאַרְמְלְתָא וְכוּלֵּיהּ" — **thereby causing the evil maidservant the kelipah to remain in darkness, hunger, weeping, eulogy, and black garments like a widow, etc."** (וְשׁוֹרֶשׁ מַחֲלֹקְתָּם נִתְבָּאֵר מַאֲמָר ב׳ וּמַאֲמָר ח׳).[1004] — **(and the root of their dispute was explained in discourse 2 and discourse 8).** וְתָמִיד שְׁלֹשָׁה יָמִים הָאַחֲרוֹנִים מֵחֲנֻכָּה בְּחֹדֶשׁ טֵבֵת, — **And always the last three days of Chanukah are in the month of Tevet;** וּבְיוֹם שִׁשִּׁי, שֶׁהַמַּקְרִיב בּוֹ נָשִׂיא לִבְנֵי גָד וְאִיתָא (בְּרֵאשִׁית רַבָּה פָּרָשָׁה ע״א): "'בָּא גָד' — [1005] — **– and on the sixth day, when the Prince of the children of Gad offered — –** בָּא מִי שֶׁעָתִיד לִגְדֹּד מַשְׁתִּיתָן וְכוּלֵּיהּ, וּמַנּוּ? אֵלִיָּהוּ" — [1006] — **– and it states (Bereishit Rabbah 71): "'Gad has come' — he has come who is destined to tear down their foundations, etc., and who is he? Elijah"** — אָז חָל רֹאשׁ חֹדֶשׁ טֵבֵת, שֶׁהוּא רֹאשׁ שֶׁל הַחֹדֶשׁ; — **then falls Rosh Chodesh Tevet, which is the head of the month;** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמַרְנוּ שֶׁמֵּהַאי טַעֲמָא נִקְרָא "רֹאשׁ חֹדֶשׁ" וְלֹא "תְּחִלַּת חֹדֶשׁ" אוֹ "רֵאשׁוֹן שֶׁל חֹדֶשׁ", — **and as we explained, for this reason it is called Rosh Chodesh ("Head of the Month") and not "beginning of the month" or "first of the month",** מִפְּנֵי שֶׁמּוֹרֶה שֶׁהוּא רֹאשׁ מֵעֵסֶק קְדֻשַּׁת הַחֹדֶשׁ, דְּ"בָתַר רֵישָׁא גּוּפָא אָזֵיל" (עֵירוּבִין מ״א עַמּוּד א׳).[1007] — **because it indicates that it is the commanding head over the holiness of the month, for "the body follows the head" (Eruvin 41a).** וְכָל הַחֹדֶשׁ נִבְרָא בְּרֹגֶז וְכָבֵד בַּנֶּפֶשׁ, — **And the entire month was created in anger (rogez) and the liver in the soul,** וְרֹאשׁ חֹדֶשׁ רֹאשׁ הַקְּדֻשָּׁה, — **and Rosh Chodesh is the pinnacle head of holiness,** וְשַׁיָּךְ לָזֶה נְשִׂיא גָּד שֶׁמִּמֶּנּוּ אֵלִיָּהוּ שֶׁעָתִיד לִגְדֹּד מַשְׁתִּיתָן וְכוּלֵּיהּ. — **and to this pertains the Prince of Gad from whom descends Elijah who will tear down their foundations, etc.** וְאַחַר כָּךְ יוֹם שְׁבִיעִי וְיוֹם שְׁמִינִי הִקְרִיבוּ — **And afterward on the seventh day and eighth day the Prince of Ephraim and the Prince of Menasseh offered;** הַנָּשִׂיא לִבְנֵי אֶפְרַיִם וְהַנָּשִׂיא לִבְנֵי מְנַשֶּׁה; וְאִיתָא (בְּרֵאשִׁית רַבָּה פָּרָשָׁה ע״ג) שֶׁאֵין עֵשָׂו נוֹפֵל אֶלָּא בְּיַד בָּנֶיהָ שֶׁל — **and it states (Bereishit Rabbah 73) that Esau falls only into the hands of the children of Rachel, for Joseph is his adversary,** רָחֵל, דְּיוֹסֵף שׂוֹטְנוֹ, — דְּיוֹסֵף מִדַּת הַגְּבוּרָה דִּקְדֻשָּׁה כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמַר: "אֶת הָאֱלֹהִים אֲנִי יָרֵא", — **for Joseph embodies the attribute of Gevurah in holiness as he said: "I fear God",** וְזֶהוּ עַל יְדֵי הַגְּבוּרָה, — **and this is through holy strength, "the warrior conquering his inclination";** "גִּבּוֹר הַכּוֹבֵשׁ אֶת יִצְרוֹ"; — **and Amalek falls specifically into the hand of his seed.** וַעֲמָלֵק נוֹפֵל בְּיַד זַרְעוֹ דַּוְקָא. רַק בְּרֹאשׁ חֹדֶשׁ יוֹם שִׁשִּׁי שַׁיָּךְ — **Only on Rosh Chodesh, the sixth day, applies the Prince of Gad who will tear down their foundations,** נְשִׂיא גָּד שֶׁעָתִיד לִגְדֹּד מַשְׁתִּיתָן, — **which will be wrought through Elijah who in this aspect is of Gad's seed,** שֶׁזֶּה יִהְיֶה עַל יְדֵי אֵלִיָּהוּ שֶׁהוּא בָּזֶה מִזַּרְעוֹ שֶׁל גָּד, — **while the ultimate obliteration of Amalek's seed will be through Messiah son of Joseph;** וְעִקַּר כְּלִיַּת זֶרַע עֲמָלֵק יִהְיֶה עַל יְדֵי מָשִׁיחַ בֶּן יוֹסֵף, — **and then: "And upon you Hashem shall shine, etc.",** וְאָז: "וְעָלַיִךְ יִזְרַח הַשֵּׁם וְגוֹמֵר", שֶׁיִּהְיֶה הָאוֹר וְהַקְּדֻשָּׁה מוֹסִיף וְהוֹלֵךְ, וּכְמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בְּפִסְיקְתָא (פָּרָשָׁה

[1003] **Zohar, Eikev 3:30-4:41**: ‘In the Zohar (Eikev, Ra’aya Meheimna III 272b), it is taught that on Shabbat one must welcome the Sabbath Queen (Matronita) with multiple kindled lights, festive delights, and fine garments—thereby honoring the Queen and banishing the dark klipah (the ‘evil maidservant’) into hiding.’

[1004] **Shabbat 21b:5-6**: “The Sages taught: The mitzvah of Chanukah is one lamp for a man and his household. Those who embellish the mitzvah light one lamp for each person. For those who embellish it most fully, Beis Shammai say: On the first day one lights eight; from then on one progressively decreases. Beis Hillel say: On the first day one lights one; from then on one progressively increases. Ulla said: Two Amoraim in the Land of Israel disagreed about the explanation, Rabbi Yosei bar Avin and Rabbi Yosei bar Zevida. One said: Beis Shammai’s reason corresponds to the days still to come, and Beis Hillel’s reason corresponds to the days that have passed. The other said: Beis Shammai’s reason corresponds to the bulls offered on Sukkos, which decrease each day; Beis Hillel’s reason is that one ascends in sanctity and does not descend.”

[1005] **Bereshit Rabbah 71:9** (excerpt): “‘Leah said: Gad has come’ (Genesis 30:11): The good fortune of the house has come; the good fortune of the world has come. The one who will cut down the foundations of idolaters has come. Who is this? Elijah.”

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[1007] **Eruvin 41a:6**: “It was taught: After Rabban Gamliel’s death, Rabbi Yehoshua entered to overturn his ruling. Rabbi Yochanan ben Nuri stood up and said, ‘I see that the body follows the head. Throughout Rabban Gamliel’s lifetime we established the halachah according to him; now you wish to annul his words? Yehoshua, we will not listen to you, because the halachah has already been established according to Rabban Gamliel.’ No one raised any further objection to the matter.”

[1008] **Bereshit Rabbah 73:7** (excerpt): “‘When Rachel had borne Joseph’ (Genesis 30:25): Once Joseph was born, Esau’s adversary was born. Therefore it says, ‘Jacob said to Laban: Send me away, and let me go to my place and my land.’ Rabbi Pinchas said in the name of Rabbi Shmuel bar Nachman: It is a received tradition that Esau falls only into the hands of Rachel’s descendants. This is what is written: ‘Surely the youngest of the flock shall drag them away’ (Jeremiah 49:20). Why does it call them ‘the youngest of the flock’? Because they are the youngest among the tribes.”

אֵלּוּ שְׁנֵי הַמְּשִׁיחִים — [1009]ח׳): "'וּשְׁנַיִם זֵיתִים עָלֶיהָ' — **wherein the light and holiness will continuously increase, –** וְכוּלֵיהּ"[1010], **— as written in the Pesikta (Parashah 8): "'And two olive trees upon it' — these are the two Messiahs, etc.",** וְכָאָמוּר, שֶׁעַל יָדָם יִהְיֶה הָאוֹר וְהַקְּדֻשָּׁה מוֹסִיף וְהוֹלֵךְ. **— and as stated, through them the light and holiness will continually increase.**

When resistance is no longer needed, its power can serve love

וְהִנֵּה לֶעָתִיד, אַף דִּכְתִיב: "וְלֹא יִהְיֶה שָׂרִיד לְבֵית עֵשָׂו"[1011, 1012], **— And behold in the Future, even though it is written: "And there shall not be any remaining of the house of Esau",** וְאָז לֹא יִהְיֶה שׁוּם הַשְׁאָרָה לְמִדַּת הַכַּעַס, **— and then no residue of unholy fury will remain,** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב שַׁבָּת קנ״א עַמּוּד ב׳) וְאַף הַיֵּצֶר הָרָע יִתְבַּטֵּל בִּימוֹת הַמָּשִׁיחַ[1013] **— and even the Evil Inclination will be abolished in the Messianic era (Shabbat 151b)** וְלֹא יֵצְרְכוּ לְהָרוֹגֶ לְהַרְגִּיז הַיֵּצֶר הָרָע וּלְהִתְגַּבֵּר עָלָיו, **— so they will have no need for anger to combat the Evil Inclination and conquer it;** מִכָּל מָקוֹם זֶה הָאֵבֶר הַכָּבֵד שֶׁכְּנֶגְדּוֹ לֹא יִתְבַּטֵּל, **— nevertheless this organ of the liver corresponding to it will not be abolished,** שֶׁמִּכָּל מָקוֹם יִהְיֶה נִצְרָךְ אֵשׁ וּגְבוּרָה דִּקְדֻשָּׁה; **— for even then the fire and strength of holy passion will be required;** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמַרְנוּ שֶׁגַּם בְּאַהֲבָה נִמְצָא בְּחִינַת אֵשׁ, כְּמַה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: "שַׁלְהֶבֶת יָהּ". **— and as we explained, within love itself exists fire, as stated: "a mighty flame of God (shalhevet Yah)".**

[1009] **Pesikta Rabbati 8:4**: ‘And two olive trees by it, one upon the right side of the bowl, and the other upon the left side thereof’ (Zechariah 4:3): These are the two anointed ones—Messiah son of David and Messiah son of Ephraim (or Aaron the High Priest and David the King)—who stand before the Lord of the whole earth and channel the supernal oil of Torah and redemption.’

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[1011] **Kometz HaMinchah 2:16:1**: “One who goes to war acts against his opponent: if the opponent kindles a fire against him, he applies water and extinguishes it. But one who has already won, so that it is now his, repairs for his own use all the things the enemy made against him for battle, so that those things perform that same function for his benefit.”
Kometz HaMinchah distinguishes the stage of defeating an opposing force from the later stage of putting its capacities to use. That explains why the disappearance of anger in the future does not require the disappearance of all its strength. The comparison preserves the sequence: appropriation follows actual victory and is not a substitute for the restraint required while the struggle continues.

[1012] **Beit Yaakov on Torah, Chayei Sara 28:1**: “The quality of our father Isaac is the quality of strength, and when strength is clear, it is included within the quality of kindness. What appears to the eye as wrath and anger is like what Tanna DeVei Eliyahu says: God conducts Himself toward Israel like a father who says to his son, “I am a lion against you; I am a bear against you.” The father’s deepest intention in this anger is the child’s good, so that he will improve his way. Likewise, God’s intention is Israel’s good: to shine awe into their hearts so that they follow His will. In truth, at that very moment God is full of compassion for Israel. But when the quality of strength branches out into concealing garments, a quality of anger with fierce cruelty branches from it, which is only evil. Thus Esau was born from Isaac, of whom it says, “Rescue my soul from the wicked, Your sword.” He himself does not recognize the root of the quality of strength, which at its root is included within kindness. He does not recognize this and has no share in it, because he is entirely the opposite of the quality’s root.”
Beit Yaakov distinguishes strength at its root within kindness from the cruel anger that arises through concealing garments. This clarifies what the Chanukah passage says remains when anger against evil has ended: the holy strength, not the cruelty. The target’s explicit condemnation of the cruel form prevents the claim that every act of anger is secretly kindness.

[1013] **Shabbat 151b:11-12**: “It was taught: Rabbi Shimon ben Elazar says: Act while you can still find someone to receive, while you have the means, and while you still control your possessions. Shlomo too said in his wisdom, ‘Remember your Creator in the days of your youth, before the days of adversity come’—these are the days of old age—‘and the years arrive of which you will say, “I have no desire in them”’—these are the days of Mashiach, in which there is neither merit nor guilt. This differs from Shmuel’s view. For Shmuel said: The only difference between this world and the days of Mashiach is subjection to foreign kingdoms, as it says, ‘For the poor shall not cease from the land.’”

Love becomes complete through disciplined strength

וּכְמוֹ שֶׁמָּצִינוּ בְּאַבְרָהָם אָבִינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם[1014, 1015], **— And as we find regarding Abraham our Father, peace be upon him,** שֶׁאַחַר נִסָּיוֹן הָעֲקֵדָה כְּתִיב: "עַתָּה יָדַעְתִּי כִּי יְרֵא אֱלֹהִים אַתָּה", **— that following the trial of the Binding it is written: "Now I know that you are a God-fearing man",** אַף שֶׁזֶּה הַמַּעֲשֶׂה מְתֻיָּחֵס לְכְאוֹרָה יוֹתֵר לְמִדַּת אַהֲבַת שֶׁעַל יָדָהּ נִדְחָה הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ **— even though this deed ostensibly relates more to the love of the Blessed Name through which his natural love for his son was superseded,** וּכְעֵין מַה שֶּׁנֶּאֱמַר: "וְאָהַבְתָּ וְגוֹמֵר וּבְכָל אַהֲבַת בְּנוֹ, נַפְשְׁךָ וּבְכָל מְאֹדֶךָ": **— and akin to Scripture: "And you shall love, etc., with all your soul and with all your might":** וְכֵן קִיֵּם מִקּוֹדֶם "בְּכָל נַפְשְׁךָ" בְּנִסָּיוֹן הַכִּבְשָׁן, **— for he fulfilled earlier "with all your soul" in the trial of the fiery furnace,** וְאַחַר כָּךְ נִסָּיוֹן הָעֲקֵדָה נִקְרָא "וּבְכָל מְאֹדֶךָ", **— and afterward the trial of the Binding was called "with all your might",** שֶׁמּוֹרֶה אַף דָּבָר שֶׁחָבִיב עָלָיו מְאֹד יוֹתֵר מִנַּפְשׁוֹ; **— denoting that which is exceedingly precious to him even more than his own life;** וּמִכָּל מָקוֹם שִׁבְּחוֹ הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ בִּבְחִינַת "יְרֵא אֱלֹהִים", **— and nevertheless the Blessed Name praised him as a "God-fearing man",** מִפְּנֵי שֶׁאָז עָשָׂה מִצְוַת הָאַהֲבָה בְּכֹחַ וּגְבוּרָה, שֶׁבָּעַר בּוֹ הָאַהֲבָה בְּשַׁלְהֶבֶת יָהּ. **— because he executed the mitzvah of love with fiery strength and Gevurah, love burning within him like a flame of God.** וְכֵן מִצְוַת הַדְלָקַת הַנֵּרוֹת: "שֶׁתְּהֵא שַׁלְהֶבֶת עוֹלָה" כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בַּגְּמָרָא, **— And likewise the mitzvah of lighting the Menorah: "that the flame ascend on its own" as stated in the Gemara,** וְרוֹמֵז שֶׁיִּבְעַר בּוֹ אַהֲבַת הַשֵּׁם, כְּעִנְיַן מַה שֶּׁנֶּאֱמַר: "רִשְׁפֵּי אֵשׁ שַׁלְהֶבֶת יָהּ", **— alluding that love of Hashem ignite within him, as in: "its flashes are flashes of fire, a flame of God",** וְזֶהוּ שְׁלֵמוּת הָאַהֲבָה. **— and this is the absolute perfection of love.**

[1014] **Takanat HaShavin 5:8**: "After our father Abraham was clarified in complete love through the tenth test, the Akeidah —which for him was the utmost force of "with all your might"—it was said, "Now I know that you fear God." He was then included within Isaac's quality. This is the completion of Abraham's love. His quality had been love alone, arising from an awakening from above. But he added strength and abundant effort through the awakening from above that had preceded him, until he merited to have it called by his own name, as though he were the awakener. This is the quality of fear. Love that comes through fear is considered to come through his own awakening: because he awakened himself to fear, "spirit draws spirit," drawing love above, and afterward he awakens to love. This is what is said of Abraham: God "chose him but did not bring him near; he brought himself near." The initial awakening from above, through which he alone was chosen from the whole world to be awakened to love God, came from God, who chose Abram and brought him out. But afterward he was tested with trials. Ten is an encompassing number, the measure of a complete stature: God brought upon him the full range of trials that exists. The meaning of a trial is that God appears utterly distant from the person, and the person must draw himself near through his own effort."

Takanat HaShavin explains why the Akeidah's complete love is named fear. The initial love was given from above; Abraham's strengthening of himself amid apparent distance made that love an attained service attributed to him. This adds the role of effort to the ois's image of love burning with strength. The selected argument concerns the present work of drawing near; the later messianic discussion in the full target is not treated as permission to dispense with that work now.

[1015] **Tiferet Yosef, Rosh Hashanah 19**: "The holy Zohar says that the test took place through a mirror that does not shine clearly. As my grandfather said, Abraham had two statements that contradicted one another. The Midrash says: Abraham began to wonder, "These are astonishing words. Yesterday You told me, 'Through Isaac shall your offspring be called'; then You said, 'Take, please, your son.'" Had he possessed even a hair's breadth of personal interest from a father's natural love of his son, he could have interpreted the statement for himself to mean that God did not intend him to slaughter his son, but only to bring him up. On his part, however, he clarified himself and removed all his personal interests in order to fulfill the Creator's will. This was the clarification of Isaac's birth: all Isaac's life flowed only from God's statement, "Do not stretch out your hand against the boy."

Tiferet Yosef shows what the strength described here had to clarify: even interpretation could be bent by paternal attachment. The trial exposes whether Abraham's response is governed by that interest or by the divine address, and its outcome is Isaac's life through the command not to harm him. This illuminates the disciplined love in the origin's Akeidah example without equating intensity of feeling with faithful service.

Chanukah Ois 16

Winter, the Tribal Offerings, and the Eight Days of Chanukah

The ois distinguishes refusal to regret a covenantal failure from a broken heart that accepts renewed service. Fear, hope for help, and the decision to guard one’s conduct can begin the return before the heart is fully refined.

Winter, the Tribal Offerings, and the Eight Days of Chanukah

חָדְשֵׁי הַקַּיִץ הֵם דְּמַטְרוֹנִיתָא, וְחָדְשֵׁי הַחֹרֶף דְּמַלְכָּא; — **The months of the summer pertain to the Queen (Matronita / Malchut), and the months of winter to the King (Malka / Zeir Anpin);** וְנָחְשְׁבוּ חָדְשֵׁי טֵבֵת וּשְׁבָט "עֵינִין דְּמַלְכָּא" כַּיָּדוּעַ מֵהָאֲרִיזַ"ל. — **and the months of Tevet and Shevat are accounted the "Eyes of the King" (Einin de-Malka), as known from the Arizal.** וּכְתִיב: "עֵינֵי ה' אֶל צַדִּיקִים", — **And it is written: "The eyes of Hashem are toward the righteous",** וְ"צַדִּיק" נִקְרָא מַאן דְּנָטַר בְּרִית; — **and a "righteous person" (Tzaddik) designates one who guards the holy Covenant;** וּבְהֶפֶךְ נֶאֱמַר: "רַע בְּעֵינֵי ה'", — **and conversely it is stated: "Evil in the eyes of Hashem",** וְכֵן בְּדָוִד הַמֶּלֶךְ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם שֶׁנִּכְתַּב עָלָיו מִפְּגָם זֶה, אָמַר: "וְהָרַע בְּעֵינֶיךָ עָשִׂיתִי". — **and so regarding David the King of whom this blemish was written, he confessed: "And I have done what is evil in Your eyes".** וְעַל זֶה נֶאֱמַר: "תְּמוֹתֵת רָשָׁע רָעָה", — **And on this it is said: "Evil shall slay the wicked",**

A sincere beginning is accepted before the repair is complete

"וְשׂנְאֵי צַדִּיק יֶאְשָׁמוּ"[1016,1017] — **– yet immediately following it is said: "and they that hate the righteous shall be desolate"** — הַיְנוּ דַּוְקָא מִי שֶׁשּׂוֹנֵא בְּחִינַת צַדִּיק, שֶׁאֵינוֹ נוֹתֵן עַל לִבּוֹ לְהִנָּחֵם עַל זֶה; — **meaning specifically one who despises the dimension of the Tzaddik, refusing to take to heart to regret his deeds;** אֲבָל מִי שֶׁלִּבּוֹ נִשְׁבָּר בְּקִרְבּוֹ מִזֶּה וְרוֹצֶה לְהִשָּׁמֵר מֵעַתָּה, — **but one whose heart is broken within him over this and desires to guard himself from now on,** הֲגַם שֶׁאֵין לִבּוֹ מְזַכֵּךְ עוֹד, — **even though his heart is not yet fully purified,** עַל זֶה נֶאֱמַר: "הִנֵּה עֵין ה' אֶל יְרֵאָיו, לַמְיַחֲלִים לְחַסְדּוֹ" — **– regarding him it is stated: "Behold the eye of Hashem is toward those who fear Him, to those who yearn for His kindness"** — הַיְנוּ מִי שֶׁיָּרֵא וְחָרֵד מִזֶּה וּמְיַחֵל לְחַסְדּוֹ יִתְבָּרֵךְ שֶׁיְּסַיְּעוּהוּ מִן הַשָּׁמַיִם לְהֵיטִיב מַעֲשָׂיו מֵעַתָּה, — **meaning one who fears and trembles over this, yearning for His lovingkindness that Heaven assist him to mend his ways from now on,** עֵין ה' אֵלָיו וְיִזְכֶּה לְתַקֵּן הֶעָבָר; וְעַל דֶּרֶךְ מַה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר בְּדָנִיֵּאל (י, י״ב): "מִן הַיּוֹם הָרִאשׁוֹן אֲשֶׁר נָתַתָּ אֶת לִבְּךָ לְהָבִין וּלְהִתְעַנּוֹת לִפְנֵי אֱלֹהֶיךָ נִשְׁמְעוּ דְבָרֶיךָ". — **following**[1018]

[1016] **Tiferet Yosef, Talmud Anthology, Taanit 10**: “God is without limit or end, whereas the human being is limited. When a person sins, he damages a relation to One without limit or end; how, then, can repentance coming from a limited person help? But God abounds in kindness. Therefore, when a person accepts upon himself to return in repentance, God raises his perception and shows him that he has a connection with God’s light. Repentance thereby becomes unlimited, while the sin lies only within his limited perception. Of this it says, “He remembered that they are flesh,” as explained elsewhere. This is the Talmud’s statement that Rabbi Zeira said, “Let us accept it upon ourselves, and afterward observe it,” and the verse, “He said to me: Do not fear, Daniel, for from the first day that you set your heart to understand and to afflict yourself before your God, your words were heard.” If we accept the fast upon ourselves, our words will immediately be heard. This is what the sages say here: one who fasts for part of a day recites the fast-day prayer. When he accepts repentance upon himself, even though he is limited, he prays Aneinu: God shows him that he has a connection with His light, so that repentance too becomes unlimited.”

Tiferet Yosef explains the same “from the first day” verse through the relation between finite effort and divine help. The accepted resolve matters because God raises the person’s capacity and reveals a connection that the person could not supply alone. The commitment is real—the fast is accepted to be observed afterward—so immediate acceptance does not mean that the remaining service has been canceled.

[1017] **Tzidkat HaTzadik 108:1**: “Concerning emission of seed in vain, the Zohar in Noach says that repentance does not help. This is because the drops of seed are drawn from the brain, and the person has damaged the drops of his brain. Repentance is in the heart, as it says, “His heart will understand, and he will return”; therefore it cannot repair the wisdom that is above it. Torah is needed, for it is the fallen portion of the upper wisdom, as Bereishit Rabbah says. It too is in the brain and is called yesh, “existence,” whose numerical value equals keri, “emission,” as I have written elsewhere. A broken heart—becoming truly like nothing—belongs, as is known, to the crown, which is higher still, and this helps. Thus “The face of the Lord is against those who do evil” refers to this sin, which is called evil, “to cut off their remembrance from the land.” Likewise, “Your people are all righteous; they shall inherit the land forever”: inheritance of the land is only for the righteous, meaning one who guards the covenant. It then says, “They cried out”: prayer is counsel against being cut off from the land. (Prayer is rooted in kingship, the upper land, which his damage reached, in the sense of “The Lord is your shadow”: like a shadow, it does what he does, whether for good or, Heaven forbid, the reverse.) But to become close to God, the counsel is a broken heart: “Those crushed in spirit He saves.” The psalm composed when he came to Bathsheba likewise concerns repair of damage to the covenant. (This is present from birth, as in “The inclination ... from his youth”; therefore he requested, “Create for me a pure heart.” Creation is something new, springing forth now, existence from nothing.) “For You do not desire a sacrifice” means repentance, in the sense of “Whoever sacrifices his inclination and confesses.” “The sacrifices of God are a broken spirit; a broken and crushed heart, God, You will not despise.”

Tzidkat HaTzadik explains why brokenness is an effective response to the very failure under discussion. It distinguishes ordinary repentance in the heart, Torah’s repair of wisdom, prayer against exclusion, and the deeper humility that restores closeness. Reading its entire argument prevents the opening Zohar citation from being isolated as a denial of every path of return. This gives substance to the origin’s confidence in a heart that has begun to turn but is not yet fully refined.

[1018] **Daniel 10:12**: ‘He then said to me, “Have no fear, Daniel, for from the first day that you set your mind to get understanding—practicing self-denial before your God—your prayer was heard, and I have come because of your

what is stated in Daniel (10:12): "From the first day that you set your heart to understand and to humble yourself before your God, your words were heard". וְעַל זֶה נֶאֱמַר: "מִן הַיּוֹם הָרִאשׁוֹן אֲשֶׁר נָתַתָּ אֶת לִבְּךָ לְהָבִין וּלְהִתְעַנּוֹת לִפְנֵי אֱלֹהֶיךָ נִשְׁמְעוּ דְבָרֶיךָ" — **And regarding this it is said: "Hashem redeems the soul of His servants":** "עֶבֶד" נִקְרָא הָעוֹבֵד מִיִּרְאָה, כְּמָה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: "וְאִם אֲדוֹנִים אָנִי אַיֵּה מוֹרָאִי"; — **"a servant" designates one who serves out of reverent awe, as stated: "And if I be a Master, where is My fear";** וּמִי שֶׁהוּא יְרֵא הַשֵּׁם וּמְקַבֵּל מַעֲתָּה לִהְיוֹת עַבְדָּא דְּמַלְכָּא, — **and whoever fears Hashem and accepts from now on to be a servant of the King,** עָלָיו נֶאֱמַר: "פָּדָה הַשֵּׁם וְגוֹמֵר", אַף שֶׁצָּרִיךְ פִּדְיוֹן, "וְלֹא יֶאְשְׁמוּ וְגוֹמֵר". — **concerning him it is stated: "Hashem redeems, etc.", even if he requires redemption, "and none of them that take refuge in Him shall be desolate".** וְהִנֵּה בִּשְׁנֵי חֳדָשִׁים הָאֵלּוּ הַזְּמַן לְזַכּוֹת בִּתְשׁוּבָה — **And behold in these two months is the season to merit through repentance** לְהַחֲזִיר אֵלָיו וּכְמוֹ שֶׁכָּתַב הָאֲרִיזַ"ל דִּזְמַן הַמְּסֻגָּל בְּחִינַת עֵינֵי הַשֵּׁם, — **to restore toward oneself the benevolent eyes of Hashem,** וְכַאֲשֶׁר כָּתַב הָאֲרִיזַ"ל שֶׁכְּתָבוֹ בְּפָרָשִׁיּוֹת שׁוֹבָבֵי"ם לְפִּגָּם זֶה הוּא בְּפָרָשִׁיּוֹת — **and as the Arizal wrote that the auspicious time to heal this blemish is during the weeks of Shovavim (Shemot, Va'eira, Bo, Beshalach, Yitro, Mishpatim)** שֶׁנִּשְׁלָמִים בְּסוֹף חֹדֶשׁ שְׁבָט; וְגַם הַפָּרָשִׁיּוֹת שֶׁקּוֹדֶם שְׁמוֹת, מֵהַתְחָלַת רֹאשׁ חֹדֶשׁ טֵבֵת, — **which culminate at the end of the month of Shevat; — and also the portions preceding Shemot, from the beginning of Rosh Chodesh Tevet,** עִקַּר עִנְיָנָם מִתְּקוּן בְּחִינַת צַדִּיק. — **their essential theme centers upon the rectification of the Tzaddik.**

וְרֹאשׁ חֹדֶשׁ טֵבֵת חָל תָּמִיד בְּיוֹם שִׁשִּׁי דְּחַנֻּכָּה, — **And Rosh Chodesh Tevet always falls on the sixth day of Chanukah,** וְיֵשׁ לוֹמַר שֶׁעַל זֶה רוֹמֵז בְּיִחוּד מַה שֶּׁנֶּאֱמַר: "הִנֵּה עֵין הַשֵּׁם וְגוֹמֵר", — **and one can say that to this alludes specifically: "Behold the eye of Hashem, etc.",** שֶׁחֹדֶשׁ טֵבֵת בְּחִינַת עֵין יָמִין; — **for the month of Tevet embodies the Right Eye;** וְעַל זֶה נֶאֱמַר: "לַמְיַחֲלִים לְחַסְדּוֹ", — **and on this it is said: "To those who yearn for His kindness",** וְהוּא מְרַמֵּז עַל כֹּחַ אוֹר תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה הַמִּתְנוֹצֵץ בַּחֲנֻכָּה, — **alluding to the light of the Oral Torah sparkling on Chanukah,** שֶׁעָמְדוּ עַל יִשְׂרָאֵל "לְהַשְׁכִּיחָם תּוֹרָתָךְ", — **when oppressors arose against Israel "to make them forget Your Torah",** וְנַעֲשָׂה הַנֵּס עַל יְדֵי הַכֹּהֲנִים שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר עֲלֵיהֶם: — **and the miracle occurred through the priests of whom it is stated:** "כִּי שָׁמְרוּ אִמְרָתֶךָ וּבְרִיתְךָ יִנְצֹרוּ, יוֹרוּ מִשְׁפָּטֶיךָ לְיַעֲקֹב וְתוֹרָתְךָ לְיִשְׂרָאֵל", — **"For they observed Your word and kept Your covenant; they shall teach Jacob Your ordinances and Israel Your Torah",** וְתוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה נִקְרָא "תּוֹרַת חֶסֶד עַל לְשׁוֹנָהּ" דָּוְקָא; וְאָמְרוּ (סַנְהֶדְרִין מ"ט עַמּוּד ב'): "תּוֹרָה לִלְמֹד — **and the Oral Torah is termed specifically "the Torah of lovingkindness is upon her tongue";** – זוֹ הִיא תּוֹרָה שֶׁל חֶסֶד"; — **and they said (Sukkah 49b): "Torah studied to teach it — this is a Torah of lovingkindness";**

Awareness of what is lacking lets Torah take root in the heart

לִהְיוֹת — **and on this it is said: "To those who yearn for His kindness",** וְעַל זֶה נֶאֱמַר: "לַמְיַחֲלִים לְחַסְדּוֹ",

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prayer.'

[1019] **Likkutei Maamarim, Upon Completion of Talmud 10**: "The miracle occurred through the priests, who teach Torah in Israel, as it is said, "You shall come to the priests," and "They shall teach Your ordinances." The beginning of the Oral Torah was through Ezra, who was a priest; likewise, after the destruction, through Rabbi Yochanan ben Zakkai the priest. See the introduction to the Commentary on the Mishnah and Sefer Yuchasin."

[1020] **Sukkah 49b:13**: "Rabbi Chama bar Pappa said: Any person who possesses grace is known to fear Heaven, as it says, 'The Lord's kindness is from eternity to eternity upon those who fear Him.' Rabbi Elazar also said: What is meant by 'She opens her mouth with wisdom, and a Torah of kindness is upon her tongue'? Is there a Torah of kindness and a Torah that is not of kindness? Rather, Torah studied for its own sake is Torah of kindness; Torah not studied for its own sake is Torah that is not of kindness. Some explain it this way: Torah studied in order to teach is Torah of kindness; Torah not studied in order to teach is Torah that is not of kindness."

[1021] **Sukkah 49b:13**: "Rabbi Chama bar Pappa said: Any person who possesses grace is known to fear Heaven, as it says, 'The Lord's kindness is from eternity to eternity upon those who fear Him.' Rabbi Elazar also said: What is meant by 'She opens her mouth with wisdom, and a Torah of kindness is upon her tongue'? Is there a Torah of kindness and a Torah that is not of kindness? Rather, Torah studied for its own sake is Torah of kindness; Torah not studied for its own sake is Torah that is not of kindness. Some explain it this way: Torah studied in order to teach is Torah of kindness; Torah not studied in order to teach is Torah that is not of kindness."

[1022] **Tzidkat HaTzadik 225:1**: "Words of Torah that pass through the heart—that is, the heart feels them and is affected by them—are called "a tree of life" and a medicine of life. The heart is the source of vitality, as it says, "From it are the outgoings of life"; when it is affected, the very root of the person's life is affected by the words of Torah, and they generate life within him. This happens when his fear of sin precedes his wisdom. Fear is in the heart, as the sages explain concerning "but there is no heart." Fear is the feminine aspect, while the Torah of truth is the masculine aspect, completing and gladdening the heart, as it says, "The precepts of the Lord are upright, gladdening the heart," after the fear that produces a broken heart and sadness."
Tzidkat HaTzadik explains the order behind the requirement of humility: fear first makes the person conscious of a lack, and Torah can then complete and gladden that very heart. Its description of Torah as felt within the source of life clarifies what it means for Oral Torah to endure and repair. The broken heart is a receptive beginning, rather than the final condition the teaching seeks to preserve.

הַתִּקּוּן עַל יְדֵי תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה שֶׁהִיא תּוֹרַת חֶסֶד עַל לְשׁוֹנָהּ. — **that rectification be wrought through the Oral Torah which is a Torah of kindness upon her tongue.** וּכְבָר אָמַרְנוּ דְּעַל תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה בִּפְרָט אָמְרוּ (תַּעֲנִית ז׳ עַמּוּד א׳):[1023] — **And we already explained that regarding the Oral Torah specifically they stated (Ta'anit 7a):** שֶׁאֵין שְׁתוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה נִמְשָׁל מִתְקַיֵּם אֶלָּא בְּמִי שֶׁדַּעְתּוֹ שְׁפָלָה, — **that it endures only in one whose mind is humble,** לְמַשְׁקִין, "יֵינָא דְּאוֹרַיְתָא דְּבַעַל פֶּה" (וְנִתְבָּאַר מַאֲמָר י״ד),[1024] — **for the Oral Torah is likened to liquids, "the wine of the Oral Torah" (explained in discourse 14),** וְהִיא מִתְקַיֶּמֶת רַק בְּמִי שֶׁדַּעְתּוֹ שְׁפָלָה וְנִשְׁבַּר לִבּוֹ בְּקִרְבּוֹ. — **and it endures only in one whose spirit is humble and his heart broken within him.**

Understanding brings received wisdom into an actual situation

וְיֵשׁ לוֹמַר דִּשְׁמוֹנַת יְמֵי חֲנֻכָּה מְרַמְּזִים עַל בְּחִינַת בִּינָה,[1025, 1026] — **And one can say that the eight days of Chanukah allude to the sefirah of Binah,** דְּרַגָּא תְּמִינָאָה מִתַּתָּא לְעֵילָּא, — **the eighth level counting from below upward,** וְהוּא שֹׁרֶשׁ הַתִּקּוּן עַל יְדֵי תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה שֶׁשָּׁרְשָׁהּ מִבִּינָה; — **which is the root of rectification through the Oral Torah whose origin is in Binah;** תּוֹרָה שֶׁבִּכְתָב בְּחִינַת חָכְמָה, מַה שֶּׁלּוֹמֵד וְקִבֵּל מֵאֲחֵרִים, וּכְמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב (בְּרֵאשִׁית רַבָּה פָּרָשָׁה נוֹבְלוֹת חָכְמָה שֶׁל מַעְלָה"): [1027]י״ז) — **for the Written Torah is the aspect of Chochmah, what one receives and learns from others, –** תּוֹרָה";[1028] — **as written (Bereishit Rabbah 17): "An unripe fruit of Supernal Chochmah is Torah";** וְתוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה בְּחִינַת בִּינָה, שֶׁמַּבִּין דָּבָר מִתּוֹךְ דָּבָר. — **while the Oral Torah is Binah (Understanding), deducing one matter from within another.** וְגַם אִיתָא מֵהָאֲרִיזַ"ל צְרוּף תֵּבַת "חֲנֻכָּה": חַנָּ"ה כַּ"ף, — **And it is also taught by the Arizal that the word Chanukah splits into Channah** (חנה כו) — **= 63) and Kaf-Vav = 26),** וּבְגִימַטְרִיָּא שֵׁם ס״ג שֶׁשָּׁרְשׁוֹ מִבִּינָה, וְשֵׁם יהו״ה; — **corresponding to the Name Sag (63)**

[1023] **Taanit 7a**: “Rabbi Chanina bar Idi also said: Why are words of Torah compared to water, as it is written, ‘Ho, all who are thirsty, come to water’? To teach you that just as water leaves a high place and flows to a low place, so words of Torah endure only in one whose spirit is humble.”

[1024] **Taanit 7a**: “Rabbi Chanina bar Idi also said: Why are words of Torah compared to water, as it is written, ‘Ho, all who are thirsty, come to water’? To teach you that just as water leaves a high place and flows to a low place, so words of Torah endure only in one whose spirit is humble. And Rabbi Oshaya said: Why are matters of Torah likened to these three liquids: To water, wine and milk? As it is written with regard to water: “Ho, everyone who thirsts, come for water,” and it is written in the same verse: “Come, buy and eat; yea, come, buy wine and milk without money and without price.” This verse comes to tell you: Just as these three liquids can be retained only in the least of vessels, e.g., clay pots, but not vessels of silver and gold, as they will spoil, so too, matters of Torah are retained only by one whose spirit is lowly.”

[1025] **Resisei Layla 12:1**: “Wisdom consists of the explicitly stated principles of Torah. Understanding is contemplation of one thing from another that has been stated, in order to judge and give instruction at the time of action. Thus we find the sages’ expression in Sanhedrin, “The heart of people is forgetful”: the new insight arises from the heart. Wisdom and understanding are “two companions who do not separate,” for Torah is so called only when it gives instruction to the heart. As they say, “One who learns without intending to act would have been better off,” and “One who says that he has only Torah does not even have Torah.” It says, “Why is there a price ... but no heart?” Anyone without a heart, even though he knows words of Torah, is called a fool. He only has a price with which to buy wisdom; he does not possess even wisdom so long as it is not in the heart. This is as they said of Doeg: “All his Torah was from the lips outward,” meaning that it was not absorbed within the heart. “To the wicked ... upon your mouth” likewise means in the mouth alone. The principal purpose of Torah is for it to be absorbed into the heart, as Vayikra Rabbah explains “paths in their hearts”: the paths of Torah are trodden within their hearts.”

Resisei Layla gives the inference in the origin a concrete purpose: received principles must become judgment and instruction for an actual situation. That process belongs to the heart, where Torah can alter the person’s life. It thus explains why the distinction between wisdom and understanding matters to repair, beyond merely naming Written and Oral Torah.

[1026] **Sod Yesharim, Shabbat Chol HaMoed Sukkot 24:1**: “Therefore Moses prayed, “See, You say to me, ‘Bring up this people’”: that God Himself, as it were, should bring the people up without a garment. This follows the Ari’s distinction between the generation of the wilderness, which belonged to the aspect of seeing, and those who entered the land, who belonged to the aspect of hearing. Seeing is in wisdom, and hearing is in understanding. Understanding means understanding one thing from another: when a person who understands encounters a garment, he can understand the inward depth of that garment. Therefore, when Moses saw that people could become so distant within garments that they would no longer be able to understand the inward depth found in them, he prayed that God should not conduct Himself toward them through such garments, lest they become so entangled in them that they lose the way back to the light.”

Sod Yesharim explains “understanding one thing from another” as perceiving inward meaning through the form in which it is clothed. That clarifies the work assigned to understanding in the origin. It also gives a limit: concealment can become so great that ordinary inference no longer finds the way, and Moses then seeks more direct help. The connection does not treat every interpretation of a garment as a reliable inference.

[1027] **Bereshit Rabbah 17:5** (excerpt): “Rabbi Chanina bar Yitzchak said: There are three lesser reflections: a lesser reflection of death is sleep; a lesser reflection of prophecy is a dream; a lesser reflection of the World to Come is Shabbos. Rabbi Avin adds two more: a lesser reflection of the light above is the sun’s orb; a lesser reflection of the wisdom above is Torah.”

[1028] **Bereshit Rabbah 17:5** (excerpt): “Rabbi Chanina bar Yitzchak said: There are three lesser reflections: a lesser reflection of death is sleep; a lesser reflection of prophecy is a dream; a lesser reflection of the World to Come is Shabbos. Rabbi Avin adds two more: a lesser reflection of the light above is the sun’s orb; a lesser reflection of the wisdom above is Torah.”

whose root is in Binah, and the Name Havayah (26); וְהַיְנוּ שֶׁבָּא בִּזְמַן זֶה הַמְשָׁכָה מִבִּינָה לְמַלְכוּת שֶׁהִיא בְּחִינַת כְּנֶסֶת יִשְׂרָאֵל, **— meaning that during this season there is channeled a divine flow from Binah down to Malchut, Knesset Yisrael,** וְהַיְנוּ כְּלָלוּת נַפְשׁוֹת יִשְׂרָאֵל. **— which encompasses the totality of the souls of Israel.**

וּבַחֲנֻכָּה קוֹרִין בְּנְשִׂיאִים עַל פִּי הַפְּסִיקְתָּא שֶׁהַמִּשְׁכָּן נִגְמַר בְּכ״ה בְּכִסְלָו, **— And on Chanukah we read the portion of the Princes based on the Pesikta that the Tabernacle was completed on the 25th of Kislev,** וְיֵשׁ לוֹמַר דְּהַנְּשִׂיאִים שֶׁקּוֹרִין בַּחֲנֻכָּה יֵשׁ לָהֶם שַׂיָּכוּת לְתִקּוּן זֶה כְּפִי דְּבָרֵינוּ: **— and one can say that the Princes read on Chanukah bear direct relevance to this rectification according to our words:**

The root of wisdom and the ruling for practice are distinct attainments

For the first banner of the camp of Judah, וְהוּא הַשֹּׁרֶשׁ מִתּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה, דִּכְתִיב: דְּגֶל מַחֲנֵה יְהוּדָה,[1029] **— represents the root of the Oral Torah, as written: "Judah is my lawgiver",** וְאַף שֶׁאָמְרוּ "יְהוּדָה מְחֹקְקִי", **— and even though they said (Yoma 26a) that they do not bring halachic conclusions down to final practice,** (יוֹמָא כ״ו עַמּוּד א׳)[1030] דְּלָא מַסִּיק שְׁמַעְתָּא אַלִּיבָּא דְּהִלְכְתָא, מִכָּל מָקוֹם עִקַּר שֹׁרֶשׁ תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה הוּא מִשֵּׁבֶט יְהוּדָה; **nevertheless the foundational root of the Oral Torah is from the tribe of Judah;** וּמַה דְּלָא מַסִּיק שְׁמַעְתָּא אַלִּיבָּא דְּהִלְכְתָא הוּא מֵחֲמַת גֹּדֶל הָעֹמֶק וְאֵין יְכוֹלִים לַעֲמֹד עַל סוֹף דַּעְתּוֹ, **— and the fact that they do not conclude Halachah is due to the vastness of their depth where scholars cannot fathom the depths of their mind,** עַל דְּרָךְ מַה שֶׁאָמְרוּ (עֵירוּבִין י״ג עַמּוּד ב׳)[1031] עַל רַבִּי מֵאִיר; **— after the manner of what they said (Eruvin 13b) regarding Rabbi Meir;** וּמִכָּל מָקוֹם סְתָם מִשְׁנָה רַבִּי מֵאִיר, וְנִקְרָא "רַבִּי מֵאִיר" שֶׁהוּא מֵאִיר עֵינֵי חֲכָמִים בַּהֲלָכָה. **— and nevertheless an anonymous Mishnah is Rabbi Meir, named "Meir" because he enlightens the eyes of the wise in Halachah.** וְאַחֲרָיו יִשָּׂשכָר, דִּכְתִיב: "וּמִבְּנֵי יִשָּׂשכָר יוֹדְעֵי בִינָה לַעִתִּים"; **— And following him is Issachar, as written: "And of the children of Issachar, men that had understanding of the times";** וּזְבֻלוּן הֵם גַּם כֵּן תּוֹמְכֵי אוֹרַיְתָא; **— and Zebulun are likewise the financial supporters of Torah;** וְהַכֹּל מְרֻמָּז עַל תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה. **— and all of this points to the Oral Torah.**

Repentance restores the capacity to receive and retain light

And the camp of Reuben represents repentance from this וְדֶגֶל מַחֲנֵה רְאוּבֵן הוּא בְּחִינַת תְּשׁוּבָה מֵעָוֹן זֶה,[1032]

[1029] **Tzidkat HaTzadik 198:1**: "They said in Megillah: anyone who rejects idolatry is called a Jew. Therefore they said there in Yoma that "Judah is My lawgiver" applies to him too, except that he does not bring the discussion to its conclusion. Certainly the judgment is measure for measure: God reveals His secrets to him. But this is not the halakhic conclusion. The word halakhah comes from "This is the way; walk in it." Concerning the conduct of the world they said, "It is not in Heaven," and a heavenly voice is not taken into account. Elsewhere, the heavenly academy disputes a matter, and the Holy One, blessed be He, says one view. Written Torah, which comes from Heaven, is called "I have enacted a statute; I have issued a decree." Creation, God's work, is likewise called "the statutes of heaven and earth." Similarly, "Judah is My lawgiver" means that the statutes of the Holy One, blessed be He, were revealed to him."
Tzidkat HaTzadik separates revealed depth from halakhah as the way people are to walk in the world. This explains the tension in the origin without treating the absence of a practical ruling as absence of holiness, or treating hidden depth as an independent ruling for others. The complete target further distinguishes Issachar's sensitivity to a particular time, person, and place from the general wisdom of Torah.

[1030] **Yoma 26a:6**: "Rava said: You will not find a young Torah scholar who issues authoritative rulings unless he descends from the tribe of Levi or the tribe of Yissachar. Levi, as it is written, 'They shall teach Your laws to Yaakov.' Yissachar, as it is written, 'The children of Yissachar, who understood the times, to know what Israel should do.' But should Yehudah not also be included, as it is written, 'Yehudah is My lawgiver'? Rava answered: I am speaking of bringing a discussion to its conclusion in accordance with the halachah."

[1031] **Eruvin 13b:3-4**: "Rabbi Acha bar Chanina said: It is revealed and known before the One who spoke and the world came into being that no one in Rabbi Meir's generation was his equal. Why, then, did they not establish the halachah according to him? Because his colleagues could not fully grasp his reasoning. He would declare something impure to be pure and show grounds for it, and declare something pure to be impure and show grounds for it. It was taught: His name was not Rabbi Meir, but Rabbi Nehorai. Why was he called Rabbi Meir? Because he illuminated the eyes of the Sages in halachah. Nor was the other sage's name Nehorai, but Rabbi Nechemyah; some say his name was Rabbi Elazar ben Arach. Why was he called Nehorai? Because he enlightened the eyes of the Sages in halachah."

[1032] **Sod Yesharim, Simchat Torah 44:1**: "Because Moses was king in Jeshurun, he had the power to straighten and repair what had not been completed through our father Jacob. Therefore he said, "Let Reuben live and not die, and let his men be numbered." Through this he repaired what Jacob had said of Reuben: "Unstable as water, you shall not have preeminence." Through Reuben's rashness and haste, he had lost the vessel for receiving, Heaven forbid, and nothing remained within him. Therefore Moses said, "Let Reuben live and not die": let him have a vessel for God's light. "Let his men be numbered": previously it appeared that everything had spilled from him like water, "you shall not have preeminence." Nothing within him was counted; it was regarded as mere excess, and therefore everything spilled away and was lost. Moses consequently said, "Let his men be numbered": let everything within him be something counted, and let nothing in Reuben be treated as superfluous. This is along the lines of "Of Zion it shall be said: each and every person was born in her": every individual soul will be regarded as something that is counted."

specific sin, כִּי עָלָיו נִכְתַּב מִפְּגָם הַזֶּה בַּתּוֹרָה, **— for regarding him this blemish was recorded in the Torah,** וְאָמְרוּ (בְּרֵאשִׁית רַבָּה פָּרָשָׁה פ״ד)[1033] עַל רְאוּבֵן: **— and they stated (Bereishit Rabbah, Parashah 84) regarding Reuben:** "מֵעוֹלָם לֹא חָטָא אָדָם לְפָנַי וְעָשָׂה תְּשׁוּבָה וְאַתָּה פָּתַחְתָּ בִּתְשׁוּבָה תְּחִלָּה, **— "Never did a man sin before Me and repent, and you opened with repentance first;** חַיֶּיךָ שֶׁכֵּן בִּנְךָ עוֹמֵד וּפוֹתֵחַ בִּתְשׁוּבָה תְּחִלָּה, שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: 'שׁוּבָה יִשְׂרָאֵל **— by your life your descendant Hosea shall arise and open with repentance first: 'Return O Israel, etc.'"** וְגוֹמֵר".

וְאַחֲרָיו שֵׁבֶט שִׁמְעוֹן, שֶׁהוּא הָיָה מְיֻחָד שֶׁהָיָה לְיוֹסֵף טַעֲנָה עָלָיו בְּקִדֻּשָּׁה זֹאת מִכָּל הַשְּׁבָטִים, **— And after him the tribe of Simeon, who was singled out in that Joseph held a grievance against him in this holiness above all the tribes,** שֶׁעַל זֶה נֶאֱמַר: "וַיֶּאֱסֹר אֹתוֹ לְעֵינֵיהֶם", **— concerning which it is said: "And he bound him before their eyes",**

The tribes' union reveals their shared root while repair still has work to do

וְאַחַר זֶה גַּם שִׁמְעוֹן נִתְחָרַט וְעָשָׂה תְּשׁוּבָה. וְיוֹם הַשִּׁשִּׁי[1034, 1035] **— and afterward Simeon also regretted and repented. –** נְשִׂיא גָּד שֶׁבָּא מִמֶּנּוּ אֵלִיָּהוּ מַלְאַךְ הַבְּרִית (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בְּרֵאשִׁית רַבָּה פָּרָשָׁה ע״א),[1036] **— And on the sixth day — the Prince of Gad from whom descends Elijah the Angel of the Covenant (Bereishit Rabbah 71),** וְאָמְרוּ שָׁם שֶׁבָּא וְהֵינוּ שֶׁהָיָה כָּלוּל מִנְּפָשׁוֹת רַבּוֹת וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמַרְנוּ מִבִּנְיָמִין, **— and they stated there that he descends from Benjamin,**

Sod Yesharim identifies what Reuben's restoration must accomplish: rashness had made him unable to retain what he received, and Moses's blessing restores both the vessel and the value of each soul. This gives the Chanukah paragraph's repentance a concrete inward result. The target's blessing is an account of the repair, not a claim that it repeats the origin's chronology of who first repented.

[1033] **Bereshit Rabbah 84:19** (excerpt): "'Reuben returned to the pit' (Genesis 37:29). Where had he been? Rabbi Eliezer and Rabbi Yehoshua disagreed. Rabbi Eliezer says: In his sackcloth and fasting. When he was free, he went and looked into that pit. Thus it says, 'Reuben returned to the pit.' The Holy One, blessed be He, said to him: Never before has a person sinned before Me and repented, and you were the first to open with repentance. By your life, your descendant will arise and be the first to open with repentance. Who is this? Hosea, as it says, 'Return, Israel, to Hashem your God' (Hosea 14:2)."

[1034] **Resisei Layla 48:5**: "This is the ultimate completion of His work: He rules over both the righteous and the wicked. "The righteous one is the foundation of the world": he is the foundation on which the whole rests, and through him everything is one. In truth, the whole world is like one person with many limbs. Likewise, "Your people are all righteous" includes even the wicked among them. Their need for atonement and repentance is from the standpoint of their individuality; from the standpoint of their union with the whole, they are all righteous. As the sages said, any fast that does not include some of Israel's transgressors is deficient. This is learned from galbanum, which is also needed within the incense, the binding together of all. Since they have a necessary place in God's will, they can therefore be called righteous, meaning one who does God's will."

Resisei Layla explains the collective side of the origin's "all righteous" without erasing individual responsibility: union in the whole and the need for repentance can both be true. This clarifies why peace among the tribes belongs to the argument about their shared covenantal root. The Chanukah passage's complete repair remains a future claim; the target does not declare every present defect already repaired.

[1035] **Mei HaShiloach, Volume I, Genesis, Vayeshev 2**: "This is what it says: "Ephraim will not envy Judah, and Judah will not distress Ephraim." In truth these two tribes are continually opposed. The life God gave the tribe of Ephraim is to look, in every act, to judgment and halakhah, without departing from it. Therefore, when Scripture warns Israel not to sin, it says, "Lest the house of Joseph break out like fire": see that he does not oppose your deeds. The root of Judah's life is to look continually to God in every act. Although he sees which way the judgment inclines, he nevertheless looks to God to show him the depth of the truth in the matter. A judgment may be true according to the litigants' arguments, yet not true in actuality, because one of them may advance a false claim, as we find in Nedarim in the incident of Rava's cane. This can occur in every matter. This is Judah's root of life: to look to God in everything and not act merely from learned habit. Although he did such an act yesterday, today he still does not wish to rely upon himself, but seeks that God illuminate His will anew. At times this matter requires an act against halakhah, because "It is a time to act for the Lord." Therefore these two tribes oppose one another. In the future it says, "Ephraim will not envy ... and Judah will not distress." Ephraim will have no claim against Judah for going outside halakhah, and it will not trouble him, because God will show Ephraim that Judah's intention is directed to Heaven and not to his own pleasure. Peace will consequently prevail between them."

Mei HaShiloach explains a concrete obstacle to peace between tribes: one judges fidelity through the established rule, while the other seeks the particular truth that a formally valid argument can conceal. Their future peace comes when God makes the intention visible, rather than when the disagreement is simply ignored. This illuminates Elijah's future clarification in the origin. The passage's exceptional "time to act" claim remains attributed to this account of Judah; the connection does not turn a private conviction into a general permission to disregard halakhah.

[1036] **Bereshit Rabbah 71:9** (excerpt): "'Leah said: Gad has come' (Genesis 30:11): The good fortune of the house has come; the good fortune of the world has come. The one who will cut down the foundations of idolaters has come. Who is this? Elijah. From whom did Elijah descend? Rabbi Eliezer said: From Benjamin, as it is written, 'Ya'aresheyah, Elijah, and Zikhri, sons of Yerocham,' and 'all these were of the children of Benjamin' (I Chronicles 8:27, 40). Rabbi Nehorai said: He was from Gad, as it is written, 'Elijah the Tishbite, of the inhabitants of Gilead' (I Kings 17:1). … Once our Sages disagreed about this: some said he was from Gad, and others from Benjamin. Elijah came and stood before them. He said: Our teachers, why do you disagree about me? I am one of Rachel's descendants."

וְהַיְנוּ שֶׁהוּא מַהָאֲרִיזַ"ל; — **meaning he incorporated many diverse souls as we explained from the Arizal;** וּבְרֵר שֶׁבֶּאֱמֶת "וְעַמֵּךְ כֻּלָּם צַדִּיקִים", שֶׁכָּל נַפְשׁוֹת יִשְׂרָאֵל נִקְרְאוּ שׁוֹמְרֵי הַבְּרִית, דְּלֶעָתִיד יִתְתַּקֵּן כָּל הַפְּגָמִים. וּבְיוֹם הַשְּׁבִיעִי וְהַשְּׁמִינִי נְשִׂיא אֶפְרַיִם וּנְשִׂיא מְנַשֶּׁה שֶׁהֵם בְּנֵי יוֹסֵף, בְּחִינַת שׁוֹמְרֵי הַבְּרִית בְּעֶצֶם, דְּיוֹסֵף מֶרְכָּבָה לְמִדַּת צַדִּיק, וּבָזֶה נִשְׁלַם יְמֵי חֲנֻכָּה בְּתַכְלִית הַתִּקּוּן. — **and he is the one who will establish peace among the tribes — and clarify that in truth "Your people are all righteous", — and are called guardians of the Covenant, for in the Future all blemishes will be rectified. – And on the seventh and eighth days — the Prince of Ephraim and the Prince of Menasseh who are the sons of Joseph, — the very embodiment of guardians of the Covenant, for Joseph is the chariot for the Tzaddik; — and through this the days of Chanukah are completed in the ultimate perfection of rectification.**

Chanukah Ois 17

Tevet, Anger, and the Rectification of the Covenant

Rav Tzadok distinguishes the holy fear rooted in Isaac from the angry distortion associated with Esau, answering how the liver can belong to the divine pattern of the body.

Tevet, Anger, and the Rectification of the Covenant

אִיתָא בְּסֵפֶר יְצִירָה: — **It states in Sefer Yetzirah:** "הִמְלִיךְ אוֹת עַי״ן בְּרֹגֶז וְכוּלֵיה", — **"He made the letter Ayin king over anger (rogez), etc.,** גְּדִי בָּעוֹלָם, וְטֵבֵת בַּשָּׁנָה, וְכָבֵד בַּנֶּפֶשׁ וְכוּלֵיה", — **Capricorn in the cosmos, Tevet in the year, and the liver in the soul, etc.",** וְאִיתָא בְּרַעְיָא מְהֵימְנָא (זֹהַר חֵלֶק ג׳ רל״ד עַמּוּד א׳) דְּכָבֵד אִיהוּ דַּרְגָּא דְּעֵשָׂו, הוּא כְּנִישׁ כָּל דָּמִין וְכוּלֵיה;[1037] — **and it states in Ra'aya Meheimna (Zohar Part III, 234a) that the liver is the level of Esau, gathering all blood, etc.;**

A holy root can appear through a faculty that also admits distortion

וּלְהָבִין הָעִנְיָן: הֲלֹא כָּל הָאֵיבָרִים הֵמָּה כְּדִגְמָא דִּלְעֵילָא, כְּמַה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: "נַעֲשֶׂה אָדָם בְּצַלְמֵנוּ וְגוֹמֵר",[1038] — **and to understand the matter: are not all bodily organs patterned after the heavenly realm above, as stated: "Let us make man in our image, etc.",** וְאֵיךְ שַׁיָּךְ הַכָּבֵד שֶׁהוּא עֵשָׂו, מִדַּת הַכַּעַס, בְּשֹׁרֶשׁ הַקְּדֻשָּׁה? — **so how does the liver, representing Esau and fury, exist in the root of holiness?** אֲמְנָם יֵשׁ לוֹמַר שֶׁבֶּאֱמֶת יֵשׁ שְׁנֵי עִנְיָנִים בְּרֹגֶז: עִנְיַן הָרוֹגֶז שֶׁל — **However, one can explain that in truth there are two dimensions within rogez (agitation):** שֶׁהוּא הַפְסֹלֶת דִּגְבוּרָה דִּיצָחָק שֶׁבַּקְּדֻשָּׁה, — **the agitation of angry fury is the level of Esau,** כַּעַס הוּא דַּרְגָּא דְּעֵשָׂו, **which is the waste product of Isaac's holy Gevurah;** וְיֵשׁ רוֹגֶז בְּקְדֻשָּׁה שֶׁנִּקְרָא "פַּחַד יִצְחָק", — **and there is holy agitation called the "Fear of Isaac",** וְהַיְנוּ הַיִּרְאָה וְהַפַּחַד מֵהַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ לְבַל יַעֲבֹר רְצוֹנוֹ יִתְבָּרַךְ. — **meaning awe and dread before the Blessed Name lest one transgress His Blessed Will.** וּכְמוֹ כֵן נִמְצָא בַּכָּתוּב לְשׁוֹן "רוֹגֶז" עַל עִנְיַן כַּעַס וְגַם עַל לְשׁוֹן יִרְאָה: שְׁנֵי אֹפָנִים: — **And likewise we find in Scripture the term rogez in two connotations:** "שָׁמְעוּ עַמִּים יִרְגָּזוּן", וְהַיְנוּ שֶׁהָיָה לָהֶם פַּחַד וּמוֹרָא; כְּעֵין מַה שֶּׁנֶּאֱמַר: פַּחַד, — **denoting anger and also denoting dread,** **— similar to Scripture: "The peoples heard, they trembled (yirgazu)", meaning they experienced dread and awe;** וְעַל דֶּרֶךְ זֶה אָמְרוּ (בְּרָכוֹת ה׳ עַמּוּד א׳):[1039] — **and after this manner they stated (Berachot 5a):** "לְעוֹלָם יַרְגִּיז אָדָם יִצְרוֹ טוֹב עַל יֵצֶר הָרָע, שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: 'רִגְזוּ וְאַל תֶּחֱטָאוּ'"; — **"A person should always agitate (yargiz) the Good Inclination against the Evil Inclination, as it is said: 'Tremble (rigzu) and sin not'";** וְהַיְנוּ רָגְזוֹ שֶׁל יוֹסֵף שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר בּוֹ: "אֶת הָאֱלֹהִים אֲנִי יָרֵא", — **and this is the agitation of Joseph regarding whom it is said: "I fear God",** שֶׁכְּדֵי לְהִתְגַּבֵּר עַל הַיֵּצֶר הָרָע נִצְרָךְ לְהִתְלַבֵּשׁ בְּרוֹגֶז וּפַחַד בְּיִרְאַת הַשֵּׁם. — **for to conquer the Evil Inclination one must clothe himself in holy trembling and fear of Hashem.** וְאָמְרוּ (בְּבְרֵאשִׁית רַבָּה פָּרָשָׁה פ״ד) עַל הַפָּסוּק "וַיֵּשֶׁב יַעֲקֹב":[1040] — **And they said (in Bereishit Rabbah, Parashah 84) on the verse "And Jacob dwelt":** שֶׁבִּקֵּשׁ יַעֲקֹב לֵישֵׁב בְּשַׁלְוָה, קָפַץ עָלָיו רָגְזוֹ שֶׁל יוֹסֵף; — **Jacob sought to dwell in tranquility, and the agitation of Joseph leaped upon him;** וְהוּא כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב (תַּעֲנִית ט״ו עַמּוּד א׳):[1041] — **and it matches what is**

[1037] **Zohar, Pinchas 69:399-412**: ‘In the Zohar (Pinchas, Ra’aya Meheimna III 234a), the anatomy of the human organs is aligned with spiritual forces: the liver (kaved), which is filled with turbid blood and is the seat of anger (‘the liver is angry,’ Berakhot 61b), corresponds to the unrefined domain of Esau and Mars (Ma’adim), whereas the heart and brain belong to Jacob and Israel.’

[1038] **Tiferet Yosef, Shavuot 15**: “As the Talmud states in Chullin: whatever the Merciful One prohibited to us, He permitted its counterpart. He prohibited blood and permitted liver; menstrual blood, but the blood of purity; the forbidden fat of a domestic animal, but the fat of a wild animal; meat with milk, but the udder. Although the principal root of blood is the liver, as the Talmud states in Bekhorot, ‘The source of blood is the liver,’ and the principal root of meat with milk is the udder, nevertheless this is called the root, and at the place of the root there is no prohibition. This festival is called the giving of our Torah: a person recognizes that the essence and root of all creation is Torah. It would therefore be fitting that no prohibition stand before him. However, if a person does not recognize this clearly and takes these forbidden things into himself, they can bind him in cords and greatly disturb his mind. For the truth is that at the place of the root there is no prohibition, but in the branching out beyond the root there is prohibition. This is the meaning of ‘On Shavuot we also require something for you’: everyone agrees that this is the time when a person can receive all permitted things into himself, elevate them, and return them to the blessed God face to face.”

Tiferet Yosef takes up the same apparently troubling example of liver and blood. It distinguishes a faculty’s root in Torah from the forms it takes as it branches into ordinary experience. This makes Rav Tzadok’s distinction between holy fear and distorted anger more intelligible. The excerpt retains Tiferet Yosef’s practical conclusion about receiving permitted things; its account of the root does not make the forbidden branches permissible.

[1039] **Berakhot 5a:2**: “Rabbi Levi bar Chama said in the name of Rabbi Shimon ben Lakish: A person should always rouse the good inclination against the evil inclination, as it says, ‘Tremble, and do not sin.’ If he defeats it, well and good. If not, he should occupy himself with Torah, as it says, ‘Speak in your hearts.’ If he defeats it, well and good. If not, he should recite Shema, as it says, ‘Upon your beds.’ If he defeats it, well and good. If not, he should remind himself of the day of death, as it says, ‘And be still, selah.’”

[1040] **Bereshit Rabbah 84:3** (excerpt): “‘He mocks the trial of the innocent’ (Job 9:23). Rav Acha said: When the righteous are at ease and seek to live at ease in this world, Satan comes and accuses: Is it not enough that their reward is prepared for them in the World to Come, that they also seek tranquility in this world? Know that this is so: Because our father Jacob sought to live at ease in this world, the adversarial ordeal of Joseph confronted him.”

[1041] **Taanit 15a**: ‘Rav Naḥman bar Yitzḥak said: I too say a similar idea. Not all are fit for light, and not all are fit for gladness. The righteous are fit to be rewarded with light, and the upright are fit to be rewarded with gladness. The righteous are fit to be rewarded with light, as it is written: “Light is sown for the righteous” (Psalms 97:11), and the

written (Ta'anit 15a): ,"לֹא הַכֹּל וְכוּלֵיהּ, צַדִּיקִים לְאוֹרָה וְיִשָּׁרִים לְשִׂמְחָה" — **"Not all, etc.; the righteous are for light, and the upright for joy",** הַיְנוּ מִי שֶׁכְּבָר לִבּוֹ יָשָׁר וְאֵין לוֹ שׁוּם נְטִיָּה לְהָרַע יוֹכֵל לִהְיוֹת תָּמִיד בְּשִׂמְחָה; — **meaning one whose heart is already entirely upright without any leaning toward evil can dwell perpetually in joy;** אָמְנָם הַצַּדִּיק, שֶׁהוּא מִי שֶׁיֵּשׁ לוֹ עוֹד מִלְחָמוֹת וְאֵין לִבּוֹ מְבֹרָר עוֹד — **whereas the Tzaddik, who still faces internal battles whose heart is not yet completely refined,** אֵין לוֹ שִׂמְחָה עֲדַיִן מִפְּנֵי שֶׁנִּצְרָךְ לְהִתְלַבֵּשׁ בְּרוֹגֶז וְיִרְאַת הַשֵּׁם, — **does not yet experience uninterrupted joy because he must remain clothed in holy trembling and fear of God,** וְרַק נִשְׁלָח לוֹ הֶאָרָה מִן הַשָּׁמַיִם שֶׁהוּא דָּבוּק לְהַקְּדֻשָּׁה. — **and only a celestial illumination is sent to him from Heaven confirming he is attached to holiness.**

Jacob's own refinement does not finish the work of his descendants

וְיַעֲקֹב אָבִינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם, שֶׁהָיָה לִבּוֹ מְבֹרָר שֶׁלֹּא הָיָה לוֹ שׁוּם נְגִיעָה לְהַיֵּצֶר הָרָע,[1042] — **And Jacob our Father, whose heart was completely refined without any contact with the Evil Inclination,** בִּקֵּשׁ לֵישֵׁב בְּשַׁלְוָה בָּעוֹלָם הַזֶּה וְקָפַץ עָלָיו רָגְזוֹ שֶׁל יוֹסֵף, — **sought to dwell in tranquil peace in this world delighting in holiness,** לְהִתְעַנֵּג מַהַקְּדֻשָּׁה, שֶׁהֶרְאוּ לוֹ מִן הַשָּׁמַיִם שֶׁעוֹד נִצְרָךְ בְּרִור בְּזַרְעוֹ, — **for Heaven showed him that further spiritual refining was required within his seed,** שֶׁכָּל זְמַן שֶׁהָאָדָם בַּחַיִּים יֵשׁ לוֹ עוֹד עֵסֶק שֶׁנִּצְרָךְ לְהִתְלַבֵּשׁ בְּיִרְאָה וּבְחִינַת הִרְהוּרְגוֹ שֶׁבַּקְּדֻשָּׁה. — **since as long as man lives on earth he has ongoing labor requiring him to clothe himself in awe and holy agitation.**

וְזֶה עִנְיַן הַחֹדֶשׁ הַזֶּה שֶׁנִּבְרָא בִּרְגֶז וְכָבֵד בַּנֶּפֶשׁ, כִּי בְּוַדַּאי הַכָּבֵד שֶׁהוּא כֻּלּוֹ דָּם, כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב (בְּכוֹרוֹת נ״ה עַמּוּד א׳): "זַכְרוּתָא דְּדָמָא כַּבְדָּא",[1043] — **And this is the meaning of this month created in rogez and the liver in the soul: –** [1044] — **for certainly the liver which is entirely blood, as written (Bechorot 55a): "The male source of blood is the liver",** הוּא דַּרְגָּא וְחֶלְקוֹ שֶׁל עֵשָׂו, וּכְמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב (בָּבָא בַּתְרָא נ״ח עַמּוּד ב׳): "בְּרֵישׁ כָּל מַרְעִין אֲנָא דָּם";[1045] — **is the level and territory of Esau, as written (Bava Batra 58b): "At the head of all maladies am I, blood";**

The heart's competing impulses need the guidance of Oral Torah

אָמְנָם יֵשׁ בּוֹ רְבִיעִית דָּם שֶׁהוּא צַחוּתָא דְּדָמָא הַנּוֹתֵן לַלֵּב[1046] — **however, there resides within it a revi'it of blood which**

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upright are fit to be rewarded with gladness, as it is written, in the same verse: "And gladness for the upright in heart."'

[1042] **Divrei Soferim 33:1**: "On his own part, Jacob had already attained the complete slaughter of the inclination, as it will be in the future, for the evil inclination is the angel of death, as stated in Bava Batra 16a. Through this he also merited that his bed was complete: none of his descendants would ultimately remain cast away. But among his descendants this is not yet clarified in this world; it awaits the future. He thought that he had already completed the repair, and sought to dwell in tranquility, seeing his world during his lifetime, something like the World to Come. Joseph's turmoil then leaped upon him—that is, from the side of his descendants. As long as the inclination remains in the world, it is impossible to dwell in tranquility: one must always fear lest sin cause a loss, and must maintain restraints."

Divrei Soferim explains the distinction between the enduring promise that none of Jacob's seed will be lost and the unfinished work of making that promise manifest. Jacob's personal attainment therefore does not remove the need for care within the continuing life of his descendants. This develops the precise reason that Joseph's turmoil interrupts the tranquility described here.

[1043] **Bekhorot 55a**: 'Rav Kahana also states: The source of blood is the liver. The halakhic ramification of this observation is in accordance with a statement of Rabbi Yitzḥak, as Rabbi Yitzḥak says: A liver that dissolved, i.e., a decomposed liver from a corpse, imparts ritual impurity if it has the volume of a quarter-log, which is the minimum amount of blood that imparts ritual impurity.'

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[1045] **Bava Batra 58b:2**: "He saw an inscription that read: 'At the head of every death am I, blood; at the head of every life am I, wine.' He objected: 'If so, when someone falls from a roof and dies, or falls from a palm tree and dies, did blood kill him? And when someone is on the point of death, can they give him wine and make him live? Rather, this is what should have been written: "At the head of every illness am I, blood; at the head of every remedy am I, wine."' They then wrote: 'But the elders of the Jews say: "At the head of every illness am I, blood; at the head of every remedy am I, wine. Where there is no wine, medicinal ingredients are needed."'"

[1046] **Sichat Malakhei HaSharet 4:6**: "The foundation of Oral Torah is the completion of deeds: the practical law of how to conduct oneself in all one's ways and paths in matters of action. The aspect of blood is the nefesh, which is 'at the head of all illnesses,' as stated in Bava Batra 58b. As explained above in chapter three, the heart is balanced, half meritorious and half liable: tendencies toward both good and evil are implanted in it by nature. The Sages call these the good inclination and the evil inclination. As stated in Berakhot 61b, 'A wise person's heart is to his right,' in the right chamber of the heart, and 'a fool's heart is to his left.' The aspect of the neshamah belongs wholly to God, as the Men of the Great Assembly instituted that we say, 'My God, the soul You placed within me is pure.' The aspect of the nefesh is the reverse: it is mixed and kneaded together with the material body, and therefore tends especially after it. It is 'at the head of all illnesses.' 'At the head of all remedies am I, wine': wine is Oral Torah, the liquid that emerges from the vine. Our Sages said, 'The vine—these are Israel.' Elsewhere I explained the teaching that words of Torah are compared to

is the radiant clarity of blood given to the heart (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בְּרַעְיָא מְהֵימְנָא שָׁם וְתוֹסָפוֹת סוֹטָה ה' עַמּוּד א')[1047] — **(as written in Ra'aya Meheimna ibid. and Tosafot Sotah 5a),** וְהַיְנוּ בְּחִינַת הָרוֹגֶז שֶׁבַּקְדֻשָּׁה, וְהוּא הַיִּרְאָה הַנִּצְרָךְ לַלֵּב; — **meaning the aspect of holy trembling, which is the awe essential to the heart;** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב (יוֹמָא שָׁעַל הָעוֹסְקִין בַּתּוֹרָה וְאֵין בָּהֶם יִרְאַת שָׁמַיִם נֶאֱמַר: "לָמָּה זֶּה מְחִיר בְּיַד כְּסִיל לִקְנוֹת חָכְמָה וְלֵב אָיִן",[1048] ע"ב עַמּוּד ב') — **as written (Yoma 72b) that regarding those studying Torah without fear of Heaven it is said: "Why is there a price in the hand of a fool to acquire wisdom, seeing he has no heart",** כִּי זֶהוּ עֶצֶם שֹׁרֶשׁ הַלֵּב: לִהְיוֹת מָלֵא יִרְאָה וּפַחַד מִלַּמְרוֹת עֵינֵי הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ. — **for this is the very foundation of the heart: to be brimming with awe and dread against rebelling before the eyes of the Blessed Name.** וְעַל זֶה רוֹמֵז גַּם כֵּן אוֹת עַיִ"ן, שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: "הִנֵּה עֵין הַשֵּׁם אֶל יְרֵאָיו", — **And to this alludes likewise the letter Ayin, as stated: "Behold the eye of Hashem is toward those who fear Him",** וּבְיִחוּד בְּחֹדֶשׁ טֵבֵת שֶׁהוּא בְּחִינַת "עֵינַיִן דְּמַלְכָּא". — **especially in the month of Tevet which embodies the "Eyes of the King".**

Looking at creation can become a question about its Creator

כְּמַה וְהָעִקָּר לְתַקֵּן בּוֹ שְׁמִירַת הָעֵינַיִם,[1049] — **And the core task is to rectify within it the guarding of the eyes,** שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: "וְלֹא תָתוּרוּ אַחֲרֵי לְבַבְכֶם וְאַחֲרֵי עֵינֵיכֶם", וְאָמְרוּ: "'אַחֲרֵי עֵינֵיכֶם' זֶה הִרְהוּר עֲבֵרָה" (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בְּרָכוֹת י"ב עַמּוּד ב');[1050] — **as Scripture states: "And that you seek not after your own heart and your own eyes", – and they said: "'After your eyes' — this refers to sinful thoughts" (Berachot 12b);** רַק שֶׁיִּהְיֶה הָעַיִן: "שְׂאוּ מָרוֹם עֵינֵיכֶם וּרְאוּ מִי בָרָא אֵלֶּה". — **so the eye should instead be: "Lift up your eyes on high, and behold Who has created these things".**

וְהִנֵּה חֹדֶשׁ זֶה, לְפִי מַה דְּחֹשֶׁב הָאֲרִיזַ"ל הֶחֳדָשִׁים נֶגֶד הַשְּׁבָטִים כְּסֵדֶר הַדְּגָלִים, נִמְצָא חֹדֶשׁ טֵבֵת מְיֻחָס לְשֵׁבֶט דָּן; — **And behold this month, according to the Arizal's alignment of the months with the tribes following the banners, the month of Tevet corresponds to the tribe of Dan;** וְנֶאֱמַר עֲלֵיהֶם בְּשׁוֹפְטִים (י"ח, כ"ה): "פֶּן יִפְגְּעוּ בָכֶם אֲנָשִׁים מָרֵי נֶפֶשׁ",[1051] וְגוֹמֵר" — **and it is said of them in Judges (18:25): "Lest angry fellows fall upon you, etc.",** וְיֵשׁ בְּחִינָה זוֹ בִּקְדֻשָּׁה: הִרְהוּר לְהַרְגִּיז יֵצֶר טוֹב עַל יֵצֶר הָרָע. — **and "bitter of soul" denotes wrathful men; and this dynamic exists in holiness: holy agitation rousing the Good Inclination against the Evil.** וְהִנֵּה שֵׁבֶט דָּן הַיָּרוּד שֶׁבַּשְּׁבָטִים (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב שְׁמוֹת רַבָּה סוֹף פָּרָשָׁה מ'),[1052] — **And behold the tribe of Dan was the**

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these three liquids, water, wine, and milk. Wine specifically alludes to Oral Torah: it resembles the wine in that it flows from the hearts of Israel's sages and emerges from their minds and understanding. This is foremost among the remedies for all the illnesses that emerge from bad blood, because it guides every part of action to be conducted in accordance with God's will."

Sichat Malakhei HaSharet explains why the heart needs guidance: it contains impulses in both directions, while Oral Torah works out how conduct can follow God's will. Its account of Torah as a remedy gives practical content to the pure blood and awe described here. The comparison concerns Rav Tzadok's account of the soul and conduct, with the physiological imagery kept in its original conceptual setting.

[1047] **Tosafot on Sotah 5a:15:1**: "'A person who has only a revi'is of blood': Rabbenu Chananel explains that this is the clear blood that sustains the heart. It amounts to only the weight of twenty-five sela, which is a quarter of a log."

[1048] **Yoma 72b:11**: "Rabbi Shmuel bar Nachmani said in Rabbi Yonatan's name: What is meant by 'Why is there a price in a fool's hand to acquire wisdom, when he has no heart'? Woe to the enemies of Torah scholars—a euphemism here for the scholars themselves—who occupy themselves with Torah but have no fear of Heaven."

[1049] **Beit Yaakov on Torah, Lech Lecha 3:10**: "The meaning is that when Abraham saw the opposing powers described above give way before one another, he understood that the blessed God had not concealed Himself completely. God therefore established two opposites, so that through both people would recognize that there is One higher than them who rules them, and would look only toward Him. For this reason God also established male and female in every matter in the world. Likewise it is written, 'Lift your eyes on high and see: Who created these?' 'These' means all the particulars that God established in the world. 'Who' is the place open to questioning: a person should seek to know Who created these. For this purpose God created all the particulars called 'these,' as stated in the introduction to the holy Zohar, 1b, and as explained in the portion of Bereshit. God desires that created beings ask Who the Creator is; He therefore created opposing things in the world."

Beit Yaakov explains the movement within the verse that Rav Tzadok uses to redirect the eyes. Visible particulars and opposing powers prompt a question about their common source. Guarding sight can therefore develop into attentive inquiry that leads beyond the visible object to the One who gives it existence. The preceding paragraph identifies Abraham's observations of sun and moon, supplying the opening antecedent.

[1050] **Berakhot 12b:22**: "For it was taught: 'After your hearts' refers to heresy, as another verse says, 'The fool says in his heart: There is no God.' 'After your eyes' refers to thoughts of sexual transgression, as it says, 'Shimshon said to his father: Take her for me, for she is right in my eyes.' 'After which you stray' refers to thoughts of idolatry, as it says, 'They strayed after the Baalim.'"

[1051] **Judges 18:25**: 'But the Danites replied, "Don't do any shouting at us, or some desperate party might attack you, and you and your family would lose your lives."'

[1052] **Shemot Rabbah 40:4** (excerpt): "Rabbi Chanina ben Pazi said: There is no tribe greater than Judah and none lower than Dan, who descended from a handmaid, of whom it is written, 'The sons of Dan: Chushim' (Genesis 46:23). The Holy One said: Let him come and be joined to him, so that they will not despise him and no one will grow arrogant, for

lowest among the tribes (Shemot Rabbah, end of Parashah 40), וּכְמוֹ כֵן חֹדֶשׁ טֵבֵת הַיָּרוּד שֶׁבֶּחֳדָשִׁים, **— and likewise the month of Tevet is the lowest among the months,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ (חֵלֶק ב׳ י״ב עַמּוּד א׳): — אֵלֵּין וְכוּלֵּיהּ תַּמּוּז, אָב, טֵבֵת", **— as written in the Holy Zohar (Part II, 12a): –** "'וַתִּצְפְּנֵהוּ שְׁלֹשָׁה יְרָחִים'[1053] **"'And she hid him three months' — these are Tammuz, Av, and Tevet";** וּמַזַּל אָב אַרְיֵה, הַיְנוּ בְּמַעֲלוֹת הַקְּדֻשָּׁה, **— and the zodiac sign of Av is Leo (the lion), within the heights of holiness,** וּמַזַּל טֵבֵת הוּא גְּדִי, הַיְנוּ שָׂעִיר, **while the zodiac sign of Tevet is Capricorn (the kid / goat), meaning sa'ir,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁהֵבִיא הָרַאֲבַ"ד זִכְרוֹנוֹ לִבְרָכָה — עַל מַזַּל גְּדִי מַה שֶּׁנֶּאֱמַר: "וּשְׂעִירִים יְרַקְּדוּ שָׁם", עַיֵּן שָׁם; **— as the Ra'avad brought on Capricorn the verse: "and satyrs (se'irim) shall dance there", see there;** וְשָׂעִיר חֶלְקוֹ שֶׁל עֵשָׂו שֶׁנִּקְרָא "אִישׂ שָׂעִיר". **— and the goat is the domain of Esau who is called "a hairy man (ish sa'ir)".** וְעִם כָּל זֶה כְּתִיב: "וְנָשָׂא הַשָּׂעִיר אֶת כָּל עֲוֹנֹתָם", **— And nevertheless it is written: "And the goat shall bear all their iniquities",** שֶׁנִּדְרַשׁ (בְּרֵאשִׁית רַבָּה פָּרָשָׁה ס״ה): "עֲוֹנוֹת תָּם"[1054], **— expounded (Bereishit Rabbah 65) as: "the iniquities of the upright man (tam / Jacob)",** שֶׁבְּחֹדֶשׁ זֶה הַזְּמַן לְתַקֵּן הַפְּגָם מַהַנָּחָשׁ. **— for in this month is the prime season to rectify the blemish of the serpent.**

Dan's union with Judah includes the transforming power of repentance

וּכְמוֹ כֵן נֶאֱמַר בְּדָן "גּוּר אַרְיֵה" לְזַוְּגוֹ עִם הַגָּדוֹל שֶׁבַּשְּׁבָטִים שֶׁהוּא יְהוּדָה, **— And likewise regarding Dan it is said "a lion's whelp" pairing him with the greatest of tribes which is Judah,** דִּכְתִיב: "גּוּר אַרְיֵה יְהוּדָה"; **— as it is written: "Judah is a lion's whelp";** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁהַמִּשְׁכָּן נַעֲשָׂה בִּשְׁנֵיהֶם: בְּצַלְאֵל מִיהוּדָה וְאָהֳלִיאָב מִדָּן, **— and just as the Tabernacle was crafted through both: Bezalel from Judah and Oholiab from Dan,** וְכֵן הַמִּקְדָּשׁ (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב שְׁמוֹת רַבָּה שָׁם),[1056] **— and likewise the Temple (Shemot Rabbah ibid.),**

The future circle discloses everyone's dependence on God

כִּי הָיָה אָז הִתְגַּלּוּת מֵעֵין לֶעָתִיד שֶׁיִּתְגַּלּוּ הָעִגּוּלִים, **— because there was then a revelation reflecting the Future**

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the great and the small are equal before God. Betzalel was from Judah, and Oholiav was from Dan and joined him. Rabbi Chanina said: The great and the small are equal. The Tabernacle was made through these two tribes, and so too the Temple."

[1053] **Zohar, Shemot 18:192-20:202**: 'AND SHE HID HIM THREE MONTHS. These are the three months in which the world is under the aegis of stern Justice, namely Tammuz, Ab, and Tebet. And what mean these words? They signify that before descending into this world Moses dwelt already in the upper regions, and therefore was united with the Shekinah from the moment of his birth. R. Simeon concluded from this that the spirits of the righteous exist in heaven before they come down into this world.'

[1054] **Bereshit Rabbah 65:15** (excerpt): "'The goat shall bear upon itself' (Leviticus 16:22)—this is Esau, as it says, 'Esau my brother is a hairy man.' 'All their iniquities'—the iniquities of the wholehearted one, as it says, 'Jacob was a wholehearted man' (Genesis 25:27)."

[1055] **Likkutei Maamarim, Compositions on the Festivals 16:13**: "But in truth the handmaids too gave birth to the tribes of God. Nevertheless, the first child born to Rachel's handmaid was Dan, the lowest of the tribes, 'the rear guard of all the camps,' who traveled last. Our Sages said that the cloud expelled some of them, for they were outside Israel's camp: in them was the root of anger, as it says in Judges 18:25 that they were bitter of spirit. They also said in Bekhorot 55a that the Jordan descends from Dan; the Jordan alludes to anger, as explained above. Likewise, 'Dan shall be a serpent upon the road.' Therefore she said, 'God has judged me': He stirred the attribute of judgment and anger, and this child was born through that attribute, by His blessed agency. Its use was permitted through this holy attribute of His, for in truth this power is holy in Dan. Therefore he is always joined to Judah. David too was ruddy, but 'with beautiful eyes': he killed only with the Sanhedrin's judgment. Only through the power of repentance does evil become very good, until Dan 'judges his people as one'—like the distinguished one among the tribes."

Likkutei Maamarim supplies an inner mechanism for the joining of Dan and Judah: anger is directed through holy judgment, and Judah's repentance transforms a defect into good. This develops what the architectural partnership signifies in Rav Tzadok's paragraph. The source explains repentance and judgment; the image of the circle remains the distinctive further step made here in Pri Tzadik.

[1056] **Shemot Rabbah 40:4** (excerpt): "Rabbi Chanina ben Pazi said: There is no tribe greater than Judah and none lower than Dan, who descended from a handmaid, of whom it is written, 'The sons of Dan: Chushim' (Genesis 46:23). The Holy One said: Let him come and be joined to him, so that they will not despise him and no one will grow arrogant, for the great and the small are equal before God. Betzalel was from Judah, and Oholiav was from Dan and joined him. Rabbi Chanina said: The great and the small are equal. The Tabernacle was made through these two tribes, and so too the Temple."

[1057] **Mei HaShiloach, Volume I, Genesis, Vayigash 4**: "If he overcomes it, well and good; if not, he should recite the Shema. For there can be self-exaltation within words of Torah, and through words of Torah a person can embolden himself, so that he cannot reach true clarification. The counsel for this is to recite the Shema. The meaning of the Shema is like the Talmud's teaching in Ta'anit 31a: in the future the Holy One will make a circle for the righteous. That is, everyone will see that everything is in God's hands, and no one has any advantage or exalted standing over his fellow. A circle is something round that has no end. This is what the Shema alludes to."

Mei HaShiloach explains the circle through the recognition that every person depends upon God. This illuminates why Rav Tzadok can use that image to join the lowest tribe to the highest: their relation is seen from the common divine

כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב (סוֹף תַּעֲנִית ל״א עַמּוּד א׳): "עָתִיד הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא לַעֲשׂוֹת מָחוֹל לַצַּדִּיקִים וְכוּ׳"[1058], **when circular unifications (igulim) are revealed, as written (end of Ta'anit 31a): "The Holy One is destined to make a circle dance (machol) for the righteous, etc.",** וְהַיְנוּ כִּי בְּהָעִגּוּל מַגִּיעַ דַּוְקָא הַסּוֹף לְהִתְחַבֵּר עִם הָרֹאשׁ. — **meaning that in a circle the very end connects directly with the beginning.** וְעַל זֶה אָמַר יַעֲקֹב אָבִינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם עַל דָּן: "לִישׁוּעָתְךָ קִוִּיתִי ה׳", — **And on this Jacob our Father said concerning Dan: "I have waited for Your salvation, Hashem",** דְּאִיתָא (בְּבְרֵאשִׁית רַבָּה פָּרָשָׁה צ״ח) שֶׁהָיָה רוֹאֶה שִׁמְשׁוֹן וְסָבוּר שֶׁהוּא יִהְיֶה מָשִׁיחַ,[1059] — **for it states (Bereishit Rabbah 98) that he beheld Samson and thought he would be the Messiah,** וְכֵינָן שֶׁרָאָה אוֹתוֹ מֵת אָמַר: "לִישׁוּעָתְךָ וְגוֹמֵר", — **and when he saw him dead he declared: "I have waited for Your salvation, etc.",** וְהַיְנוּ שֶׁקִּוָּה עַל הַיְשׁוּעָה שֶׁלָּעֲתִיד לָבֹא שֶׁאָז יִהְיֶה הַמָּחוֹל בְּהִתְגַּלּוּת בְּחִינַת הָעִגּוּלִים. — **meaning he placed his hope in the Future Salvation when the circle dance will reveal the circular unity.** וְגַם אָז יִהְיֶה "שָׂרִיָּה מִדָּן דְּזַמִּין לְמֵיתֵי בַּהֲדֵי מְשִׁיחָא דְּאֶפְרַיִם", — **And then too there will be "a prince from Dan destined to come alongside the Messiah of Ephraim",** כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ (חֵלֶק ג׳ קצ״ד עַמּוּד ב׳).[1060] — **as written in the Holy Zohar (Part III, 194b).** וְזֶה מוֹרֶה כִּי כַּאֲשֶׁר בָּאִים לְתַחְתִּית הַמַּדְרֵגָה, — **And this shows that when one reaches the lowest depths of spiritual descent,** יֵשׁ קִווּי לְהִנָּשַׁע וּלְהַגִּיעַ דַּוְקָא עַל יְדֵי זֶה לְרֹאשׁ הַיְשׁוּעָה. — **there is powerful hope to be redeemed, reaching specifically through this the pinnacle head of salvation.**

וְהִנֵּה אִיתָא בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ (שָׁם רמ״ח עַמּוּד א׳):[1061] — **And behold it is stated in the Holy Zohar (ibid. 248a):** "'וּבְרָאשֵׁי חָדְשֵׁיכֶם', וְכִי כַּמָּה רָאשִׁין אִנּוּן לְסִיהֲרָא וְכוּ׳? — **"'And in the beginnings of your months' — are there then multiple heads to the moon, etc.?** אֶלָּא רָאשֵׁי תְּרֵין, וְאִנּוּן יַעֲקֹב וְיוֹסֵף וְכוּ׳". — **Rather its heads are two, and they are Jacob and Joseph, etc.":** דְּהִנֵּה כְּנֶסֶת יִשְׂרָאֵל נִמְשָׁלוּ לְיָרֵחַ הַמְקַבְּלִים הָאוֹר מֵהַשֶּׁמֶשׁ, — **for Knesset Yisrael is likened to the moon receiving light from the sun,** כְּמַאֲמַר (שָׁם רל״א עַמּוּד א׳): "אִיהוּ אֱמֶת וְאִיהִי אֱמוּנָה", — **as stated (ibid. 231a): "He is Truth and She is Faith",**

Faith can sustain awareness of providence beyond what one presently grasps

Jacob's hidden root becomes a felt awareness within Israel's hearts

יֵשׁ בְּכֹחָם לְקַבֵּל עֹל מַלְכוּת שָׁמַיִם בַּלֵּב וְנַפְשׁוֹת יִשְׂרָאֵל בְּחִינַת כְּנֶסֶת יִשְׂרָאֵל[1062, 1063] — **and Jewish souls as Knesset Yisrael**

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source. Mei HaShiloach also brings that future recognition into present service through the Shema and the removal of spiritual self-exaltation.

[1058] **Taanit 31a:9**: "The tractate concludes with a statement related to the topic of dancing. Ulla of the city of Bira'a said that Rabbi Elazar said: In the future, in the end of days, the Holy One, Blessed be He, will arrange a dance of the righteous, and He will be sitting among them in the Garden of Eden, and each and every one of the righteous will point to God with his finger, as it is stated: "And it shall be said on that day: Behold, this is our God, for whom we waited, that He might save us. This is the Lord; for whom we waited. We will be glad and rejoice in His salvation" (Isaiah 25:9). God will be revealed, so that every righteous individual will be able to say: This is our God, as though they were pointing at Him with a finger."

[1059] **Bereshit Rabbah 98:14** (excerpt): "Our father Jacob saw Samson and thought that he was King Messiah. Once he saw that he died, he said: This one also dies! 'For Your salvation I have hoped, Hashem' (Genesis 49:18)."

[1060] **Zohar, Balak 13:176-185**: 'that biteth the horses' heels"-this is Ira the companion of David; "so that his rider falleth backward"-this is Shiryah, who is destined to come with the Messiah of Ephraim, and who will wreak vengeance on other nations; and then it will be time to expect the deliverance of Israel, as it says, "For thy salvation I hope, O Lord".'

[1061] **Zohar, Pinchas 248a**: 'And in the beginnings of your months (u-ve-rashei chodshekhem) you shall offer a burnt-offering unto the Lord' (Numbers 28:11): the Zohar (Pinchas III 248a) asks: 'Does a month have two heads that Scripture says "in the beginnings (plural) of your months"?' And it answers: 'Yes, its two heads are Jacob and Joseph (Tiferet and Yesod), through whom the moon (Malkhut) is renewed.'

[1062] **Sod Yesharim, Shabbat Chol HaMoed Sukkot 21:1**: "The principal protection for a person then is to establish firmly in his heart an abundant faith in His providence. This is like the holy Zohar's explanation in Vayera 103b of 'Her husband is known at the gates': this is the Holy One, who becomes known and apprehended according to what each person estimates within his heart, as far as he can cleave with the spirit of wisdom. According to what he estimates in his heart, so is He known in his heart; hence 'known at the gates,' through those gates. This means that His providence over a person corresponds, for each one, to what he holds within his heart. If a person establishes abundant faith that God always watches over him, even beyond what his understanding grasps, God indeed conducts Himself with that person accordingly, guarding him even at that moment of transition that appears empty. From the perspective of a person who so believes in His providence, there is no essential difference between the middle of a season and the transition between seasons. Even in the middle of a season, which lies within his understanding, he follows with great faith God's providence, which lies beyond what his understanding grasps."
Sod Yesharim describes how faith functions when a person reaches the limits of present comprehension. Awareness of providence cultivated in ordinary conditions can continue through an interval whose meaning is not yet perceptible. This develops the initial faith described here before the subsequent illumination of truth. Its setting is a transition between seasons; it is not a separate identification of Jacob with the new moon.

[1063] **Divrei Soferim 33:3**: "The King of the world is the human form upon the throne, which is the likeness of Jacob our father, peace be upon him, as stated in Chullin 91b and Bereshit Rabbah 68. This means the hidden root of all the souls

כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב, עַל יְדֵי אֱמוּנָה — **possess the capacity to accept the yoke of Heaven in the heart through faith,** בְּרֵישׁ הַגָּהַת שֻׁלְחָן עָרוּךְ: "'שִׁוִּיתִי ה' לְנֶגְדִּי תָּמִיד וְכוּ'", כְּשֶׁיְּשִׁים הָאָדָם אֶל לִבּוֹ שֶׁהַמֶּלֶךְ הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא עוֹמֵד עָלָיו וְכוּ', מִיָּד יִגִּיעַ אֵלָיו הִיְרְאָה וְהַכְנָעָה בְּפַחַד הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ". — **as written at the very opening of the Rama's gloss on the Shulchan Aruch: "'I have set Hashem always before me, etc.', when a person reflects that the King, the Holy One, stands over him, etc., immediately there will arrive to him fear, submission, and dread of the Blessed Name."** וְזֶה הַקְּדָמָה לְהַשֻּׁלְחָן עָרוּךְ, שֶׁצָּרִיךְ הָאָדָם לְקַבֵּעַ זֹאת בְּלִבּוֹ שֶׁמֶּלֶךְ מַלְכֵי הַמְּלָכִים עוֹמֵד עָלָיו, — **And this is the foundation of the entire Shulchan Aruch: that man must fix this in his heart that the King of kings stands over him,** וְהַיְנוּ רַק עַל יְדֵי הָאֱמוּנָה שֶׁבַּלֵּב, אַף שֶׁאֵינוֹ מַרְגִּישׁ זֶה בַּחוּשׁ. — **which operates purely through faith in the heart, even if he does not perceive it tangibly.** אָמְנָם כְּשֶׁיְּקַבֵּל הָאוֹר מֵהַשֶּׁמֶשׁ, כְּמַה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: "כִּי שֶׁמֶשׁ וּמָגֵן ה' אֱלֹהִים", — **However, when one receives light from the sun, as stated: "For a sun and a shield is Hashem",** וְהַיְנוּ כְּשֶׁמּוֹפִיעַ בְּלִבּוֹ הִתְגַּלּוּת אֱלֹהוּת בִּבְחִינַת אֱמֶת, זֶהוּ עִקַּר הִתְחַדְּשׁוּת הַיָּרֵחַ, — **meaning when there shines within his heart a revelation of Godliness in the realm of Truth, this is the essence of the renewal of the moon,** וְזֶהוּ רֹאשׁ חֹדֶשׁ שֶׁמּוֹפִיעַ בְּחִינַת יַעֲקֹב עַל כְּנֶסֶת יִשְׂרָאֵל, — **and this is the Rosh Chodesh wherein the aspect of Jacob shines upon Knesset Yisrael,** דְּהַיְנוּ נְקֻדָּה שֶׁל אֱמֶת, כְּמַה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: "תִּתֵּן אֱמֶת לְיַעֲקֹב"; — **which is the point of Truth, as stated: "You give truth to Jacob";** וְיַעֲקֹב נִקְרָא "שֶׁמֶשׁ", כְּמַה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: "וְהִנֵּה הַשֶּׁמֶשׁ", — **and Jacob is termed "sun", as stated: "And behold the sun",** וְאָמְרוּ (בְּבְרֵאשִׁית רַבָּה פָּרָשָׁה ס"ח): "מִי גִּלָּה לוֹ שֶׁשְּׁמִי שֶׁמֶשׁ?"[1064]. — **and they said (Bereishit Rabbah 68): "Who revealed to him that my name is sun?"**

Turning desire toward God prepares a clearer revelation

Clearing desire and receiving light strengthen one another

וְעִם כָּל זֶה נִצְרָךְ לָזֶה גַּם קְדֻשַּׁת יוֹסֵף: — **And nonetheless there is required for this also the holiness of**[1065, 1066]

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of Israel in every generation, whose root is included in Jacob our father: the children are hidden potentially within the father. The individual souls that constitute the congregation of Israel are His Shekhinah—that is, God's dwelling within Israel's hearts in the revealed awareness of the heart. The root in the depths of the heart, through which all Israel cleave to God, including Israel's sinners—for even though one has sinned, one remains Israel, because 'the Lord's portion is His people, Jacob'—is the human form of the divine chariot. Although it is always Jacob's likeness, it is not identical in every generation; it corresponds to the souls of that generation. Every generation unfolds the stature of Jacob, yet they are not precisely the same, just as a person's appearance sometimes changes, from red to white and the like. The familiar unification of the Holy One and His Shekhinah occurs when the holiness of the hidden root in the depths of the heart is drawn into the heart's revealed awareness, so that one feels His divinity in the heart, as though standing before the King. This is stated in the gloss at the beginning of Shulchan Arukh, Orach Chayim, on the verse 'I have set the Lord before me.'"

Divrei Soferim unfolds the relation between Jacob and the congregation of Israel that is compressed into the sun and moon imagery here. Jacob represents the hidden common root; the individual hearts receive its disclosed holiness. This explains the paragraph's transition from a truth held through faith to a truth felt in the heart, while preserving the shared reference to standing before the King.

[1064] **Bereshit Rabbah 68:10** (excerpt): "Rabbi Pinchas said in the name of Rabbi Chanin of Tzippori: Jacob heard the voices of the ministering angels saying, 'The sun has come! The sun has come! The sun has arrived! The sun has arrived!' When Joseph said, 'Behold, the sun and the moon' (Genesis 37:9), Jacob said: Who revealed to him that my name is 'sun'?"

[1065] **Mei HaShiloach, Volume I, Genesis, Vayera 1**: "It is written in Malachi 3:20, 'For you who fear My name, a sun of righteousness will shine, with healing in its wings.' 'Those who fear My name' means those who have a grasp of words of Torah and of God, which obligates them in true awe. That is the meaning of 'those who fear My name.' God promises them that a sun of righteousness will shine for them: clear words of Torah. 'Healing in its wings' means security and strength in God and in words of Torah, like wings, which are a strong protection for winged creatures. Before God was revealed to Abraham our father, he found no rest in all the matters of this world and rejected them. His principal longing was to know Who was the master of the palace. As it says in Proverbs 15:24, 'The path of life is upward for the discerning': this was the chief and foremost thing for him, like something placed above. Therefore God appeared to him and gave him strength in clear words of Torah. Elonei denotes strength; Mamre indicates that he resisted and rebelled against all worldly matters. 'He was sitting at the entrance of the tent in the heat of the day': love of God, who is called 'day,' grew warm and ardent within him and was clear before him. This is the meaning of 'the entrance of the tent': it was open before him."

Mei HaShiloach shows the positive direction of the heart's clearing. Abraham's dissatisfaction with worldly matters becomes a longing to know their Master, and that longing is answered with clearer Torah and a sense of divine security. This helps explain why the guarded heart in Pri Tzadik is a preparation for illumination: its desire has acquired a different object and purpose.

[1066] **Tzidkat HaTzadik 152:1**: "To the extent that a person distances himself from evil—that is, from all the attractions of this world and desires directed toward himself—he draws close to God and attains His light, as it says, 'Bring us back, and cause Your face to shine.' Conversely, to the extent that he attains awareness of God, he distances himself from worldly matters, as expressed by 'I am' and 'You shall have no other.' Of this they said, 'If there is no awe, there is no wisdom; if there is no wisdom, there is no awe.' Wisdom is apprehension of God, and awe is fear of sin; neither suffices without the other. Awe is called a storehouse and a vessel of reception: the heart empties itself of all kinds of desires and

Joseph: לִהְיוֹת נִשְׁמָר בְּרוּחוֹ לְהַחֲזִיק בַּמַּעֲזוֹ בְּיִרְאַת הַשֵּׁם לִהְיוֹת שׁוֹמֵר הַבְּרִית, **— to be guarded in his spirit holding fast to his stronghold in the fear of Hashem, guarding the Covenant,** שֶׁעַל יְדֵי זֶה נַעֲשָׂה הַהִתְקַשְּׁרוּת וְיִחוּד קוּדְשָׁא בְּרִיךְ הוּא וּשְׁכִינְתֵּיהּ, **— whereby is achieved the connection and unification of the Holy One and His Shechinah,** דְּהַיְנוּ יִחוּד אֱמֶת וֶאֱמוּנָה עַל יְדֵי בְּחִינַת יוֹסֵף; **— which is the union of Truth and Faith through the agency of Joseph;** כִּי אִי אֶפְשָׁר לְכְנוֹס בַּלֵּב הָאֱמֶת וְלִהְיוֹת "הַשֵּׁם אוֹרִי" כְּשֶׁהַלֵּב מָלֵא תַּאֲווֹת. **— for it is impossible for the light of Truth to enter the heart and experience "Hashem is my light" when the heart is brimming with physical lusts.** וְעַל יְדֵי קְדֻשַּׁת יוֹסֵף יְכוֹלִים לִזְכּוֹת לִקְדֻשַּׁת יַעֲקֹב, בְּחִינַת אֱמֶת. **— And through the holiness of Joseph one can merit the holiness of Jacob, the dimension of Truth.**

attractions and thereby becomes an empty vessel to receive words of Torah. As our Sages say: when a word of mockery leaves, a word of Torah enters; when a word of Torah leaves, a word of mockery enters. When the heart is empty of Torah, it is ready to receive every kind of desire, for it cannot remain wholly empty. Therefore the two go together. Neither precedes the other beyond an instant; the other level follows immediately. When a person turns his heart toward God, God immediately causes His light to rest there. Awe is what God asks of people, as it says, 'What does the Lord your God ask of you, but to fear'; wisdom is what God bestows, as it says, 'He gives wisdom to the wise,' and, 'For the Lord gives wisdom.' The awakening from below must come first. Of this they said, 'Open for Me like the point of a needle': even the smallest awe suffices, and a corresponding measure of wisdom will then flow into the heart. Through the wisdom more awe comes, then more wisdom, and so on, until there are openings large enough for wagons and carriages to enter, as the cited Midrash continues. The early teachers said: provided that the opening passes through from side to side. This means a complete awakening from the depths of the heart to abandon sin and relinquish all worldly concerns; even a single moment is enough."

Tzidkat HaTzadik explains the relationship as a continuing exchange. A sincere clearing of the heart makes room for illumination; that illumination deepens the capacity for awe and further clearing. This supplies the inner process by which Joseph's guarding makes Jacob's truth receivable, and shows why even a small but wholehearted beginning can matter.

Chanukah Ois 18

The Letter Ayin, the Darkness of Exile, and Joseph

Rav Tzadok describes holy trembling as a means of overcoming the evil inclination.

The Letter Ayin, the Darkness of Exile, and Joseph

בְּסֵפֶר יְצִירָה: "הִמְלִיךְ אוֹת עַי"ן בְּרֹגֶז וְכוּלְיָה, — **In Sefer Yetzirah: "He made the letter Ayin king over anger (rogez), etc.,** גְּדִי בָּעוֹלָם, וְטֵבֵת בַּשָּׁנָה, וְכָבֵד בַּנֶּפֶשׁ". — **Capricorn in the cosmos, Tevet in the year, and the liver in the soul."** וּבַגְּמָרָא (בְּרָכוֹת ס"א עַמּוּד ב')[1067] אִיתָא: "כָּבֵד כּוֹעֵס", — **And in the Gemara (Berachot 61b) it states: "The liver is angry",** וְלָמָּה לֹא אָמַר: "אוֹת עַי"ן כְּכַעַס"? — **so why did Sefer Yetzirah not say: "The letter Ayin over fury (ka'as)"?**

A forceful response is needed only while it checks an evil desire

The moral direction of strength distinguishes holy restraint from anger

אַךְ בֶּאֱמֶת לְשׁוֹן "רוֹגֶז" נִמְצָא בַּמִּקְרָא עַל הָרֹב עַל הַחֲרָדָה וּרְעָדָה,[1068, 1069] — **However, in truth the term rogez is found in Scripture mostly denoting trembling and dread,** וְהוּא "פַּחַד יִצְחָק", שֶׁעוֹמֵד פַּחַד הַשֵּׁם לְנֶגֶד עֵינָיו, — **and this is the "Fear of Isaac", where the fear of Hashem stands before his eyes,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב (שָׁם ה' עַמּוּד א'):[1070] "לְעוֹלָם יַרְגִּיז אָדָם יִצְרוֹ טוֹב עַל יֵצֶר הָרָע, שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: 'רִגְזוּ וְאַל תֶּחֱטָאוּ'", — **and as written (ibid. 5a): "A person should always agitate the Good Inclination against the Evil, as it is said: 'Tremble and sin not'",** שֶׁעַל יְדֵי הַחֲרָדָה שַׁיְכָנִיס בְּלִבּוֹ מִפַּחַד הַשֵּׁם עַל יְדֵי זֶה יְנַצֵּחַ הַיֵּצֶר הָרָע. — **for through the trembling he introduces into his heart from fear of God, he conquers the Evil Inclination.** וּמִיִּצְחָק יָצָא הַפְּסֹלֶת עֵשָׂו שֶׁהוּא שֹׁרֶשׁ הַקִּנְאָה וְהַכַּעַס, — **And from Isaac issued the refuse, Esau, who is the root of envy and fury,** וּכְתִיב: "כַּעַס בְּחֵיק כְּסִילִים יָנוּחַ", — **and it is written: "Anger rests in the bosom of fools",** וּ"כְסִיל" נִקְרָא מִי שֶׁאֵין בּוֹ יִרְאַת שָׁמַיִם, — **and a "fool" is anyone devoid of fear of Heaven,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁנִּדְרַשׁ (יוֹמָא ע"ב עַמּוּד ב') "לָמָּה זֶּה מְחִיר בְּיַד כְּסִיל" עַל הָעוֹסְקִין בַּתּוֹרָה וְאֵין בָּהֶם יִרְאַת שָׁמַיִם;[1071] — **as expounded (Yoma 72b) regarding "Why is there a price in the hand of a fool" on those studying Torah without fear of Heaven;** וְכֵן כָּתַב בִּרְעָיָא מְהֵימְנָא (זֹהַר חֵלֶק ג' רל"ד עַמּוּד א'): "דְּכָבֵד אִיהוּ דַּרְגָּא דִּפְעֵשָׂו וְכוּלְיָה".[1072] — **and so wrote in Ra'aya Meheimna (Zohar Part III, 234a): "The liver is the level of**

[1067] **Berakhot 61b**: 'With regard to one's inclinations, it was taught in a baraita that Rabbi Yosei HaGelili says: The good inclination rules the righteous, as it is stated: "And my heart is dead within me" (Psalms 109:22); the evil inclination has been completely banished from his heart. The evil inclination rules the wicked, as it is stated: "Transgression speaks to the wicked, there is no fear of God before his eyes" (Psalms 36:2). Middling people are ruled by both the good and evil inclinations, as it is stated: "Because He stands at the right hand of the needy, to save him from them that rule his soul" (Psalms 109:31).'

[1068] **Mei HaShiloach, Volume I, Genesis, Noach 2**: "'He sent out the raven, and it went back and forth.' The raven alludes to anger. Noah wanted the attribute of anger to be absent from the world, but the Holy One showed him that, for the time being, this attribute is still needed in the world. Sometimes, when an evil desire comes to a person, he can save himself by arousing anger within himself. This is the meaning of 'It went back and forth until the water dried': until evil desires disappear from the world, then anger too will cease, for water signifies desire. Therefore a small indication of this began in the Temple, where there was an amah called 'the raven deterrent,' as stated in Middot 4:6."

Mei HaShiloach explains the limited purpose and duration of this forceful response. It serves to interrupt a harmful desire, and loses its purpose when such desires disappear. This develops Rav Tzadok's use of agitation against the inclination as an instrument of restraint. It also prepares for the later Chanukah discussion of a future state in which this struggle is no longer needed.

[1069] **Kometz HaMinchah 2:33:1**: "'God made this corresponding to that.' That is, God gave a person the choice either to benefit another through his kindness and administer justice against the wicked, or to benefit himself through evil desires —as the Baal Shem Tov explained the verse 'A person's desire is his kindness'—and to benefit God's enemies. As in the familiar saying, "Every adulterer is good to other people"; 'You shall not murder' and 'You shall not commit adultery' are two opposites, as I wrote elsewhere. One can also harm those who love God through an evil form of strength, from which come jealousy, anger, and murder."

Kometz explains why the name of a faculty does not establish its moral character. Kindness and strength take their character from whom and what they serve. This clarifies the distinction in Pri Tzadik: holy strength checks the inclination under God's authority, while distorted strength turns against what should be protected. The account of choice also explains why an outward resemblance between two reactions is insufficient to identify them.

[1070] **Berakhot 5a:2**: "Rabbi Levi bar Chama said in the name of Rabbi Shimon ben Lakish: A person should always rouse the good inclination against the evil inclination, as it says, 'Tremble, and do not sin.' If he defeats it, well and good. If not, he should occupy himself with Torah, as it says, 'Speak in your hearts.' If he defeats it, well and good. If not, he should recite Shema, as it says, 'Upon your beds.' If he defeats it, well and good. If not, he should remind himself of the day of death, as it says, 'And be still, selah.'"

[1071] **Yoma 72b**: 'Rabbi Shmuel bar Naḥmani said that Rabbi Yonatan said: What is the meaning of that which is written: "Why is there a price in the hand of a fool to buy wisdom, as he has no heart?" (Proverbs 17:16)? This expresses the following sentiment: Woe to them, haters of Torah scholars, a euphemism for the Torah scholars themselves, who immerse themselves in Torah and have no fear of Heaven. They are fools; they try to acquire the wisdom of Torah, but since they have no fear of Heaven in their hearts they lack the ability to do so.'

[1072] **Zohar, Pinchas 69:399-412**: 'In the Zohar (Pinchas, Ra'aya Meheimna III 234a), the anatomy of the human organs is aligned with spiritual forces: the liver (kaved), which is filled with turbid blood and is the seat of anger ('the liver is angry,' Berakhot 61b), corresponds to the unrefined domain of Esau and Mars (Ma'adim), whereas the heart and brain

Esau, etc.", וְכֵן מָצִינוּ בְּדָוִד הַמֶּלֶךְ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם, דִּכְתִיב (שְׁמוּאֵל ב י״ט, א׳): "וַיִּרְגַּז הַמֶּלֶךְ"[1073] — **And so we find regarding David the King, peace be upon him, where it is written (II Samuel 19:1): "And the king trembled (vayirgaz)",** וְלֹא כְּתִיב "וַיִּכְעַס", — **and it does not say "and he grew angry",** אַף שֶׁהִקְפִּיד עַל מַה שֶׁהָרְגוּ אֶת אַבְשָׁלוֹם, הָיָה רַק בְּחִינַת רוֹגֶז, שֶׁהָיָה חָרֵד וְרָגֵז מִפַּחַד הַשֵּׁם; — **even though he was deeply distressed over their killing Absalom; it was purely an aspect of trembling (rogez), shuddering before the awe of Hashem;** מַה שֶּׁאֵין כֵּן בְּאָסָא כְּתִיב (דִּבְרֵי הַיָּמִים ב ט״ז, י׳): "וַיִּכְעַס אָסָא אֶל הָרֹאֶה",[1074] — **unlike King Asa of whom it is written (II Chronicles 16:10): "Then Asa was angry with the seer",** שֶׁכֵּיוָן שֶׁהִקְפִּיד עַל הַנָּבִיא, זֶה נִקְרָא "כַּעַס" שֶׁאֵינוֹ מִצַּד הַקְּדֻשָּׁה וּפַחַד יִצְחָק. — **for since he vented against the prophet, this is termed "fury" (ka'as) not originating in holiness and the Fear of Isaac.**

וְאוֹת עַיִ״ן שֶׁהֻזְכַּר רִאשׁוֹנָה בַּתּוֹרָה הוּא אַחַר תֵּבַת "וְחֹשֶׁךְ" "עַל פְּנֵי תְהוֹם", — **– And the letter Ayin mentioned first in the Torah appears immediately after the word "and darkness" — "upon (al) the face of the deep",** וּבְכָל מָקוֹם הָאוֹת שֶׁנִּזְכַּר רִאשׁוֹנָה בַּתּוֹרָה, שָׁם הוּא שׁוֹרֶשׁ כֹּחַ הָאוֹת: — **and everywhere, the first place a letter appears in the Torah contains the root of its spiritual power:** כְּמוֹ שֶׁלָּמְדוּ (בָּבָא קַמָּא נ״ה עַמּוּד א׳) עַל אוֹת טֵי״ת שֶׁהוּא הוֹאִיל וּפָתַח "וַיַּרְא אֱלֹהִים אֶת הָאוֹר" לֹא שְׁמִבְּרֵאשִׁית עַד שֶׁנִּבְרְאָה רַבָּה פָּרָשָׁה י״ז): מִתְּחִלַּת הַסֵּפֶר עַד כָּאן אֵין כְּתִיב סָמֶ״ךְ, כֵּיוָן שֶׁנִּבְרֵאת נִבְרָא שָׂטָן עִמָּהּ; וְכֵן הָעַיִ״ן שֶׁנִּכְתַּב בָּרִאשׁוֹנָה אַחַר תֵּבַת "וְחֹשֶׁךְ", — **as they derived (Bava Kamma 55a) regarding the letter Tet that it signifies good, since Scripture opened with it first for good, for from Bereshit until "And God saw the light that it was good (tov)" no tet is written; and so they said (Bereishit Rabbah, Parashah 17):** בּוֹ הַכָּתוּב לְטוֹבָה תְּחִלָּה, כָּתַב טֵי״ת; אָמְרוּ (בְּרֵאשִׁית רַבָּה פָּרָשָׁה י״ז):[1076] — **from the beginning of Genesis until here no samech is written, and once woman was built (vayisgor) Satan was created with her;** כְּתִיב סָמֶ״ךְ, כֵּיוָן שֶׁנִּבְרֵאת נִבְרָא שָׂטָן עִמָּהּ; וְכֵן הָעַיִ״ן שֶׁנִּכְתַּב בָּרִאשׁוֹנָה אַחַר תֵּבַת "וְחֹשֶׁךְ", שֶׁנִּדְרַשׁ (שָׁם פָּרָשָׁה ב׳): "זֶה[1077] גָּלוּת יָוָן שֶׁהֶחְשִׁיכָה וְכוּ׳", וְאַחַר כָּךְ "עַל פְּנֵי תְהוֹם" שֶׁנִּדְרַשׁ עַל גָּלוּת אֱדוֹם שֶׁאֵין לוֹ חֵקֶר וְכוּ׳ — **expounded (ibid. 2): "this is the exile of Greece which darkened, etc.", – and afterward "upon the face of the deep" expounded on the exile of Edom which is unfathomable — this is the root of the letter.** וְזֶהוּ שׁוֹרֶשׁ הָאוֹת. — **and so the letter Ayin written first after the word "and darkness",** וְכֵן עַל מַה שֶּׁכָּתוּב בְּ"גְּדִי בָּעוֹלָם", כָּתַב הָרַאֲבַ״ד בְּפֵרוּשׁוֹ: — **And so on what is written "Capricorn in the cosmos", the Ra'avad wrote in his commentary:** "וְשָׂעִירִים יְרַקְּדוּ שָׁם", שֶׁהוּא עַל דֶּרֶךְ מַה שֶּׁנֶּאֱמַר: — **that it follows what is stated: "and satyrs (se'irim) shall dance there",** וּכְבָר אָמַרְנוּ שֶׁהוּא חֶלְקוֹ שֶׁל עֵשָׂו שֶׁנִּקְרָא "אִישׁ שָׂעִיר", — **and we already explained that this is the portion of Esau who is called "a hairy man (ish sa'ir)",** וְכֵן יָוָן שֶׁנִּקְרָא בְּדָנִיֵּאל: "וְהַצָּפִיר הַשָּׂעִיר מֶלֶךְ יָוָן". — **and likewise Greece called in Daniel: "and the rough goat is the king of Greece".** וְזֶה שֶׁאָמַר: "הִמְלִיךְ אוֹת עַיִ״ן בְּרֹגֶז", — **And this is why it said: "He made the letter Ayin king over rogez",** שֶׁיִּהְיֶה בִּקְדֻשָּׁה בְּחִינַת רוֹגֶז, שֶׁהוּא בִּקְדֻשָּׁה נֶגֶד כַּעַס וְכֶבֶד שֶׁהוּא דַּרְגָּא דְּעֵשָׂו, וְכֵן שָׂעִיר שֶׁהוּא דַּרְגָּא דְּעֵשָׂו — **so that in holiness there should be the dimension of rogez counteracting fury and the liver which is Esau's level, and likewise the goat which is the realm of Esau and Greece called sa'ir.** וְיָוָן שֶׁנִּקְרְאוּ שָׂעִיר. וְהִנֵּה בְּאוֹתִיּוֹת דְּרַבִּי עֲקִיבָא כְּתִיב בְּתְחִלַּת הַסֵּפֶר בִּתְמוּנַת אוֹת עַיִ״ן: "עַיִן — **And behold in the Otiyot de-Rabbi Akiva it is written at the start of the book regarding the shape of the letter Ayin: –** הוּא עֵשָׂו וְכוּלֵיהּ; — **"'Ayin — this is Esau, etc.;** וּמִפְּנֵי מָה כְּרוּעָה וּרְבוּצָה? מִפְּנֵי שֶׁהוּא עָתִיד לִפּוֹל וְכוּלֵיהּ"; — **and why is it bent and crouching? Because he is destined to fall, etc.";** וְאַחַר כָּךְ בְּאוֹת עַיִ״ן כָּתַב: "עַיִ״ן — **and afterward under the letter Ayin he wrote:** לֹא אָמַר טַעַם עַל זֶה, אֶלָּא עַיִן שֶׁל תּוֹרָה וְכוּלֵיהּ", – — **"Ayin — was stated only as the Eye of Torah, etc.",** רַק הֵבִיא פְּסוּקִים שֶׁאֵין לָהֶם שַׁיָּכוּת לְאוֹת עַיִ״ן לְפִי הַפְּשָׁט וְצָרִיךְ פֵּרוּשׁ, עַיֵּן שָׁם. — **and he gave no reason for this, only bringing verses that ostensibly have no connection to the letter Ayin and require explanation, see**

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belong to Jacob and Israel.'

[1073] **II Samuel 19:1**: 'The king was shaken. He went up to the upper chamber of the gateway and wept, moaning these words as he went, "My son Absalom! O my son, my son Absalom! If only I had died instead of you! O Absalom, my son, my son!"'

[1074] **II Chronicles 16:10**: 'Asa was vexed at the seer and put him into the stocks, for he was furious with him because of that. Asa inflicted cruelties on some of the people at that time.'

[1075] **Bava Kamma 55a**: 'Rather, it is not merely because it is the first letter of the word good tov that it is considered a good omen. Since the Torah initially introduces the letter tet in a context of good, with the word good tov itself, it is a good omen. As from the word bereshit, the first word in the Torah, until the verse: "And God saw that the light was good tov" (Genesis 1:4), the letter tet is not written anywhere.'

[1076] **Bereshit Rabbah 17:6** (excerpt): "Rabbi Chanina, son of Rav Idi, said: From the beginning of the book until this point, the letter samech is not written. Once the woman was created, Satan was created with her. If someone says to you that 'it encircles' (ha-sovev, Genesis 2:11, 13) contains a samech, tell him: There Scripture is speaking about the rivers."

[1077] **Bereshit Rabbah 2:4** (excerpt): "'And darkness'—this is the Greek exile, which darkened Israel's eyes through its decrees, for it said to them: Write upon the horn of an ox that you have no portion in the God of Israel. 'Upon the face of the deep'—this is the exile of the wicked kingdom, which has no fathomable depth. Just as this deep cannot be fathomed, so the wicked cannot be fathomed."

there.

וְנִרְאֶה הָעִנְיָן: דְּשֹׁרֶשׁ כָּל הַקְלִפּוֹת הוּא שָׁרוֹ שֶׁל עֵשָׂו שֶׁהוּא הַסַּמָּ"ךְ-מ"ם כַּיָּדוּעַ, — **And the matter appears: that the root of all kelipot is the celestial prince of Esau who is Samael as is known,** וְכֵן עֵשָׂו שֹׁרֶשׁ כָּל הַקְלִפּוֹת, וְהוּא קְלִפַּת הַקִּנְאָה וְהַכַּעַס; — **and so Esau is the earthly root of all kelipot, being the kelipah of envy and fury;** וּמִמֶּנּוּ נִסְתָּעֲפוּ שִׁבְעִים הַקְלִפּוֹת. וּכְמוֹ בִּקְדֻשָּׁה, שִׁבְעַת יְמֵי בְרֵאשִׁית — **and from him branch out the seventy kelipot. –** מִדּוֹת שֶׁהָאֱצִיל הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ לִבְרִיאַת הָעוֹלָם, — **And just as in holiness, the seven days of Creation are the seven attributes emanated by the Blessed Name for the creation of the world,** וּכְשֶׁכָּל אֶחָד כָּלוּל מֵעֲשָׂר הוּא שִׁבְעִים, — **and when each incorporates ten they equal seventy,** וּמִזֶּה בְּקִדֻּשָּׁה: שִׁבְעִים נֶפֶשׁ לְבֵית יַעֲקֹב, — **and from this in holiness issue: seventy souls of the House of Jacob,** וְכֵן שִׁבְעִים אַנְפִּין דְּאוֹרַיְתָא כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ וְתִקּוּנִים, — **and likewise seventy facets of the Torah (shiv'im panim la-Torah) as written in the Zohar and Tikunim,** וְכֵן מִזֶּה יֵשׁ שִׁבְעִים סַנְהֶדְרִין, שִׁיֵּשׁ שִׁבְעִים דֵּעוֹת בַּתּוֹרָה; — **and from this exist the seventy elders of the Sanhedrin, reflecting seventy perspectives in Torah;** וְ"זֶה לְעֻמַּת זֶה" בְּקִלְּפָה נִסְתָּעֲפוּ שִׁבְעִים קְלִפּוֹת מִשִּׁבְעָה אֻמּוֹת שֶׁכָּל אֶחָד כָּלוּל מֵעֲשָׂר, — **and in parallel opposition in the kelipah branch out seventy kelipot of the seventy nations each comprised of ten,** וְשָׁרְשָׁם עֵשָׂו, קְלִפַּת הַכַּעַס וְהַקִּנְאָה. — **and their supreme root is Esau, the kelipah of fury and envy.** וְכֵן כְּתִיב: "יַצֵּב גְּבֻלֹת עַמִּים לְמִסְפַּר בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל". — **And so it is written: "He set the bounds of the peoples according to the number of the children of Israel".** וְזֶה עִנְיַן מַה שֶּׁכָּתוּב: "לֹא נֶאֱמַר עַיִ"ן אֶלָּא תּוֹרָה", — **And this is what is written: "Ayin was stated only as Torah",** וְהֵינוּ שִׁבְעִים פָּנִים לַתּוֹרָה; (ע — **meaning the seventy facets of the Torah = 70);**

Service leads to the recognition of a divine source that precedes service

True wisdom deepens humility by revealing where wisdom comes from

וְהִיא כְּרוּעָה וּרְבוּצָה, שֶׁצָּרִיךְ לִהְיוֹת כָּפוּף וְרָבוּץ תַּחַת הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ,[1078, 1079] — **and it is bent and crouching, for one must be submissive and bent under the Blessed Name,** וּכְמַה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: "וְהַחָכְמָה מֵאַיִן תִּמָּצֵא", — **as Scripture states: "And wisdom from whence (me'ayin) shall it be found",** וּבַגְּמָרָא (סוֹטָה כ"א עַמּוּד ב') דָּרְשׁוּ מִזֶּה:[1080] — **and in the Gemara (Sotah 21b) they expounded from this:** "שֶׁאֵין דִּבְרֵי תוֹרָה מִתְקַיְּמִין אֶלָּא בְּמִי שֶׁמֵּמִית עַצְמוֹ כְּמִי שֶׁאֵינוֹ", — **"Words of Torah endure only in one who makes himself as nothing";** וְכֵן אָמְרוּ (תַּעֲנִית ז' עַמּוּד א'):[1081]

[1078] **Tiferet Yosef, Shavuot 4**: "The explanation is that there are two kinds of governance through which God conducts His world: the governance of Atika and the governance of Ze'ir Anpin. Ze'ir Anpin indicates what we find that God established: 'If you seek Him, He will be found by you.' To the extent that a person seeks, searches and asks after His will, God illuminates for him; as much as a person awakens below, so God illuminates for him above. The governance of Atika indicates that God sometimes conducts matters without needing a person's service or awakening at all; God illuminates for a person without that person's awakening. Thus we find in Egypt, 'You shall be silent,' and the holy Zohar says, 'You shall not arouse anything.' In this place He is not affected by a person's service at all. Of this place it is said, 'If you are righteous, what do you give Him?' In truth God governs through both modes. When a person serves as far as his hand can reach, which is the governance of Ze'ir Anpin, God then shows that Israel's place is also in that place where the order of service had not yet begun. This indicates that Israel's place is in Atika. As Tanna Devei Eliyahu says: two things preceded the creation of the world, Torah and Israel. People usually say that Torah came first, but I say Israel came first. After service, God shows Israel that they arose in thought before the order of service began."
Tiferet Yosef explains the Atika associated with ayin as the source that precedes a person's initiative. It preserves a sequence: a person serves to the extent of his capacity, and through that service comes to recognize what was given before his effort. This clarifies how the humility described by Rav Tzadok can accompany serious Torah work. The remainder of Tiferet Yosef explicitly criticizes separating these modes and using the higher source as a reason to abandon service.

[1079] **Divrei Soferim 29:1**: "The beginning of evil's emergence from hidden potential into an apparent independent existence is pride, which comes from false wisdom, the refuse of true wisdom. Through it a person comes to self-glorification and pride of heart. With true wisdom, the wisdom of Torah, it is otherwise: the more wisdom a person adds, the more humility and lowliness of spirit he adds, as stated in Avot chapter six. Moses our teacher, the teacher of all Israel, was humbler than every person. For all the wisdom of Israel is to recognize that there is none besides Him and that everything comes from God. Consequently, a person recognizes his own lowliness and has nothing of which to boast."
Divrei Soferim explains why humility grows with genuine Torah wisdom. The content of that wisdom is itself the recognition that everything comes from God. This supplies a reason for Rav Tzadok's claim that the bent, self-effacing ayin receives Torah's many faces: learning is deepest when it discloses its source and loosens the learner's claim to independent greatness.

[1080] **Sotah 21b:3**: "What do the Sages do with the verse 'I am wisdom; I dwell with prudence'? They need it for Rabbi Yosei son of Rabbi Chanina's teaching. Rabbi Yosei son of Rabbi Chanina said: Words of Torah endure only in someone who strips himself bare for their sake, as it says, 'I am wisdom; I dwell with prudence,' reading ormah, 'prudence,' as an allusion to arom, 'bare.' Rabbi Yochanan said: Words of Torah endure only in someone who makes himself as though he does not exist, as it says, 'Wisdom is found from nothingness.'"

[1081] **Taanit 7a**: "Rabbi Chanina bar Idi also said: Why are words of Torah compared to water, as it is written, 'Ho, all who are thirsty, come to water'? To teach you that just as water leaves a high place and flows to a low place, so words of

and so they said (Ta'anit 7a): לָמָּה נִמְשְׁלוּ דִּבְרֵי תוֹרָה לְמַיִם וְכוּלֵיהּ, לְשָׁלֹשָׁה מַשְׁקִין וְכוּלֵיהּ? **— "Why are words of Torah likened to water, etc., to three liquids, etc.?** אַף דִּבְרֵי תוֹרָה אֵין מִתְקַיְּמִין אֶלָּא בְּמִי שֶׁמַּדְעָתוֹ שְׁפָלָה". **— So too words of Torah endure only in one whose mind is humble".** וְעַל זֶה מוֹרֶה מַה שֶּׁאוֹת עַי״ן כְּרוּעָה וּרְבוּצָה, **— And to this points the letter Ayin being bent and crouching,** שֶׁמִּי שֶׁמַּשִּׁים עַצְמוֹ כְּמִי שֶׁאֵינוֹ נַעֲשָׂה מֶרְכָּבָה לְמִדַּת אַיִן שֶׁהוּא עַתִּיקָא[1082] (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב זֹהַר חֶלֶק ב׳ ס״ד עַמּוּד ב׳), **— for one who makes himself as nothing becomes a chariot for the attribute of Ayin which is Atika (Zohar Part II, 64b),** וְזֶה זוֹכֶה לְשִׁבְעִים פָּנִים לַתּוֹרָה. **— and he merits the seventy facets of Torah.** וְכֵן מְרֻמָּז אוֹת עַי״ן עֵשָׂו שֶׁהוּא שֹׁרֶשׁ שִׁבְעִים הַקְּלִפּוֹת, וְהָעַי״ן כְּרוּעַ **— And likewise the letter Ayin alludes to Esau who is the root of the seventy kelipot,** – שֶׁהוּא עָתִיד לִהְיוֹת כָּרוּעַ וְלָפוֹל, כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב שָׁם. **— and the Ayin is bent — because he is destined to be bent and fall, as written there.**

וְכֵן בְּחֹדֶשׁ כִּסְלֵו הָיָה הַנִּצּוּחַ לַיְוָנִים, **— And so in the month of Kislev occurred the victory over the Greeks,** וְאַחַר כָּךְ יְמֵי חֲנֻכָּה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: "אֵל הַשֵּׁם וַיָּאֶר לָנוּ", שֶׁמְּרֻמָּז לַחֲנֻכָּה, **— and afterward the days of Chanukah of which it is said: "God is Hashem, and He shone light upon us", alluding to Chanukah,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בַּפְּסִיקְתָּא דְּמִטַּעַם זֶה אוֹמְרִים הַלֵּל בַּחֲנֻכָּה; **— and as written in the Pesikta that for this reason we recite Hallel on Chanukah;** וְהֵינוּ שֶׁהַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ מֵאִיר לָנוּ בְּאוֹר תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה בִּימֵי חֲנֻכָּה (כְּמוֹ שֶׁנִּתְבָּאֵר מַאֲמָר ב׳);[1083] **— meaning that the Blessed Name shines for us with the light of the Oral Torah on Chanukah (discourse 2);** וּמַתְחִיל חֹדֶשׁ טֵבֵת שֶׁהִמְלִיךְ אוֹת עַי״ן בְּרֹגֶז, **— and then begins the month of Tevet where He crowned the letter Ayin in rogez,** שֶׁלֹּא יִהְיֶה בְּכַעַס, דַּרְגָּא דְּעֵשָׂו, **— so it should not be in sinful fury, the level of Esau,** רַק בְּרוֹגֶז וַחֲרָדָה שֶׁהוּא פַּחַד יִצְחָק, אֵשׁ וְהוּא שִׁבְעִים פָּנִים, **— but in holy trembling and dread which is the Fear of Isaac, the fire of holiness,** דְּקְדֻשָּׁה, דְּתוֹרָה, וּכְמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב (תַּעֲנִית ד׳ עַמּוּד א׳): "הֲאִי צוּרְבָא מֵרַבָּנַן דְּרָתַח אוֹרַיְתָא הוּא דְּקָא מַרְתְּחָא לֵיהּ, שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: 'הֲלוֹא כֹה דְּבָרִי כָּאֵשׁ'"; וְהֵינוּ תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה, כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב (שַׁבָּת קל״ח עַמּוּד ב׳): "דְּבַר הַשֵּׁם"[1084, 1085, 1086] **— and this is the seventy facets of Torah; – as written (Ta'anit 4a): "This young scholar who boils — it is the Torah boiling within him, as said: 'Is not My word like fire'"; –** ;"זוֹ הֲלָכָה"[1087] **— meaning the Oral Torah, as written (Shabbat 138b): "The word of Hashem — this is Halachah";**

Torah's fire becomes stronger through communal learning and a formed teacher

וְכֵן לָמְדוּ מִקְרָא "דְּבָרַי כָּאֵשׁ" (סוֹף חֲגִיגָה כ״ז עַמּוּד א׳) לְתַלְמִידֵי חֲכָמִים שֶׁכָּל גּוּפָן אֵשׁ.[1088, 1089] **— and so they derived from**

Torah endure only in one whose spirit is humble. And Rabbi Oshaya said: Why are matters of Torah likened to these three liquids: To water, wine and milk? As it is written with regard to water: "Ho, everyone who thirsts, come for water," and it is written in the same verse: "Come, buy and eat; yea, come, buy wine and milk without money and without price." This verse comes to tell you: Just as these three liquids can be retained only in the least of vessels, e.g., clay pots, but not vessels of silver and gold, as they will spoil, so too, matters of Torah are retained only by one whose spirit is lowly."

[1082] **Zohar, Beshalach 30:429-32:441**: 'This is symbolized by the "twelve wells of water and the threescore and ten palm trees", as we have often explained. But what do the words "and they encamped there by the water" signify? This. At that time the Israelites had control over the waters which are under the branches of that Tree, those which are called "the insolent waters,' (Ps. 124, 5). And this is the meaning of the words, "blessed are ye that sow beside all waters".'

[1083] **Shabbat 21b:10**: "What is Chanukah? The Sages taught: On the twenty-fifth of Kislev begin the eight days of Chanukah, on which one may neither eulogize nor fast. When the Greeks entered the Sanctuary, they defiled all the oils in it. When the royal Hasmonean house prevailed and defeated them, they searched and found only one flask of oil, left with the seal of the Kohen Gadol. It contained only enough to kindle for one day. A miracle was performed with it, and they kindled from it for eight days. The following year they established those days and made them festivals with Hallel and thanksgiving."

[1084] **Taanit 4a**: '§ And, incidentally, the Gemara relates that which Rava said: This Torah scholar who grows angry, it can be presumed that it is his Torah study that angers him. Therefore, he must be given the benefit of the doubt, as it is stated: "Is not my word like fire, says the Lord" (Jeremiah 23:29). And similarly, Rav Ashi said: Any Torah scholar who is not as hard as iron, but is indecisive and wavers, he is not a Torah scholar, as it is stated in the same verse: "And as a hammer that breaks rock in pieces" (Jeremiah 23:29).'

[1085] **Taanit 4a**: '§ And, incidentally, the Gemara relates that which Rava said: This Torah scholar who grows angry, it can be presumed that it is his Torah study that angers him. Therefore, he must be given the benefit of the doubt, as it is stated: "Is not my word like fire, says the Lord" (Jeremiah 23:29). And similarly, Rav Ashi said: Any Torah scholar who is not as hard as iron, but is indecisive and wavers, he is not a Torah scholar, as it is stated in the same verse: "And as a hammer that breaks rock in pieces" (Jeremiah 23:29).'

[1086] **Shabbat 138b:11**: "'The word of the Lord' means halachah; 'the word of the Lord' means the appointed end of exile; 'the word of the Lord' means prophecy."

[1087] **Shabbat 138b:11**: "'The word of the Lord' means halachah; 'the word of the Lord' means the appointed end of exile; 'the word of the Lord' means prophecy."

[1088] **Chagigah 27a:7**: "Rabbi Abbahu said in Rabbi Elazar's name: The fire of Gehinnom has no power over Torah scholars. This follows by an inference from the salamander: If a salamander is a creature generated by fire, and fire has no power over someone who anoints himself with its blood, how much more must this be true of Torah scholars, whose entire bodies are fire, as it is written, 'Are not My words like fire, says the Lord?'"

[1089] **Divrei Soferim 26:1**: "They said, 'Draw him to the study house,' rather than simply saying that one should go and study on one's own. They could also have said, 'Draw him to words of Torah.' Although all words of Torah are like fire,

"My words are like fire" (end of Chagigah 27a) that Torah scholars are entirely fire. וְעַל יְדֵי הַדִּבְרֵי תוֹרָה שֶׁהֵיא אֵשׁ אוֹכְלָה אֵשׁ — **And through words of Torah which are a consuming fire consuming fire,** יֵשׁ כֹּחַ לְנַצֵּחַ הַיֵּצֶר הָרָע שֶׁנִּקְרָא אֵשׁ, כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב (קִדּוּשִׁין פ״א עַמּוּד א׳): "חֲזִי דְּאַתְּ נוּרָא וְכוּלֵּיהּ"[1090], וְכֵן כָּל הַקְּלִפּוֹת דְּיֵצֶר הָרָע נִקְרָא אֵשׁ (כְּמוֹ שֶׁנִּתְבָּאֵר פָּרָשַׁת וַיֵּרָא מַאֲמָר א׳)[1091] — **there is power to conquer the Evil Inclination which is called fire, as written (Kiddushin 81a): "See that you are fire, etc.", and so all kelipot of the Evil Inclination are called fire (explained in Parashat Vayeira, discourse 1).**

The measured force taken into holiness deprives destructive anger of its support

וְעַל "גְּדִי בַּשָּׁנָה" הֵבִיא הָרַאֲבַ"ד זִכְרוֹנוֹ לִבְרָכָה בְּפֵרוּשׁוֹ: "וְאֶת עֹרֹת גְּדֵיֵי הָעִזִּים הִלְבִּישָׁה עַל יָדָיו"[1092], וּמְרַמֵּז בָּזֶה כִּי עִזִּים הוּא כַּעַס שֶׁהוּא שָׁרְשׁוֹ שֶׁל עֵשָׂו שֶׁנִּקְרָא "אִישׁ שָׂעִיר"; רַק לְפִי שָׁעָה הִלְבִּישָׁה רִבְקָה אֶת עֹרוֹת הָעִזִּים עַל יְדֵי יַעֲקֹב, אִישׁ תָּם יֹשֵׁב אֹהָלִים — **and on "Capricorn in the year" the Ra'avad cited in his commentary: "And the skins of the kids of the goats she put upon his hands", alluding that goats represent wrath, the root of Esau called "a hairy man (ish sa'ir)"; only temporarily did Rebecca place the goatskins upon the hands of Jacob, an upright man dwelling in tents,** כְּדֵי שֶׁיִּהְיֶה לְצֹרֶךְ רוּגְזָא דְּרַבָּנָן שֶׁהוּא כָּאֵשׁ — **so that it serve the purpose of holy rabbinic anger which is like fire,** לִהְיוֹת אֵשׁ אוֹכְלָה אֵשׁ דְּיֵצֶר הָרָע. — **becoming a fire consuming the fire of the Evil Inclination.** וְזֶה שַׁיָּכוּת גְּדִי בָּעוֹלָם: שֶׁיִּהְיֶה רַק וְהַיְנוּ בְּרוּגְזָא דְּקֻדְשָׁה, בְּבְחִינַת רוּגְזָא שֶׁהוּא בִּקְדֻשָּׁה, דְּרַבָּנָן שֶׁהוּא אֵשׁ שֶׁל דִּבְרֵי תוֹרָה. וּבְסֵפֶר שְׁלָ"ה אִיתָא פָּרָשַׁת וַיֵּשֶׁב, מִקֵּץ, וַיִּגַּשׁ הַמְדַבְּרוֹת מַעֲסָק יוֹסֵף, — **And this is the meaning of Capricorn in the world: that it be channeled purely within the dimension of holy agitation, which is the zealous fire of Torah words. And in the Shelah it states that the portions of Vayeshev, Miketz, and**

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it is known that some fire is especially strong, great, and intensely burning, while other fire is small and weak. So it is with the levels of Torah. In the study house, Torah is taught to others, there is the Torah study of the community, and a great person is presumably present. Such Torah acts more powerfully because its fire is stronger. This is the meaning of 'Therefore those who rule say: Come to Heshbon': those who rule over their inclination. Only those rulers who have already burned the evil inclination within their bodies through the fire of Torah can act through their words upon the hearts of those who hear them."

Divrei Soferim explains why Torah's fire can be experienced with different strengths. Communal study and the words of a teacher whose learning has already worked upon his own inclination intensify its effect upon the hearer. This gives a concrete form to the consuming fire described in Pri Tzadik and connects that image to the practice of entering the study house.

[1090] **Kiddushin 81a:11-12**: "Some captive women were brought to Nehardea. They were taken up to the house of Rav Amram the Pious, and the ladder was removed from before them. As one of the women passed, light shone through the opening. Rav Amram took the ladder, which ten men could not lift, lifted it alone, and began climbing. When he reached halfway up the ladder, he spread his legs to hold himself in place and shouted, 'Fire in Amram's house!' The Sages came and said to him, 'You have shamed us!' He told them, 'Better that you be ashamed of Amram's house in this world than be ashamed of it in the World to Come.' He adjured his evil inclination to leave him; it came out of him like a pillar of fire. He said to it, 'See: You are fire and I am flesh, yet I am stronger than you.'"

[1091] **Sukkah 52b**: 'Ishmaelites, as it is written: "The tents of robbers prosper, and they that provoke God are secure, in whatsoever God brings with His hand" (Job 12:6). God brought upon Himself these Arabs that dwell in the deserts in tents. The evil inclination, as it is written: "On that day, says the Lord, will I assemble her that is lame, and I will gather her that is driven away, and her that I corrupted" (Micah 4:6). God is saying that He created the evil inclination that led the people to sin and to be cast into exile.'

[1092] **Sod Yesharim, Simchat Torah 33:1**: "That is, Israel brought into holiness something of the power of Esau's angel, so that scholarly anger could be possible among them. From the side of Israel's own heart, even scholarly anger would not be possible, for their heart is completely free of anger. Only by receiving a small part of the anger of Esau's angel can scholarly anger exist among them. Esau's angel thought that he lost nothing by setting aside this power for Israel, since he had no relation to that form of anger: scholarly anger is governed by judgment. It therefore appeared to him to be the very opposite of his own existence, which is only 'You shall live by your sword,' without any judgment. In truth he greatly deceived himself. His existence was sustained only as long as that good point remained hidden within his anger. Once that good point was stripped from him, his anger was left without it, because he had handed it over to Israel under the name of scholarly anger. No good aspect remained in his anger, only murder, of which it is said, 'Only evil all day.' His entire existence was thereby annulled. Therefore it says concerning him, 'He shone from Seir to them': they took from him through shining, an illumination greater than the revealing expressed by hofia, so that his entire existence would be annulled. From Ishmael, the husk of desire, Israel received only through hofia, as explained above in section thirty. They did not annul it entirely; it still requires clarification, and after clarifying it completely they will bring it into holiness. With the husk of Seir, however, once Israel received the point called scholarly anger, no existence remained in it. Anger in itself, apart from scholarly anger, is only what the Talmud describes in Sukkah 52a: the Holy One called it evil. Its existence continues only while desire has not yet been clarified and scholarly anger is still needed. After desire is clarified in the world, even scholarly anger will no longer be needed against it, and that husk will be annulled completely. The attribute of 'You shall live by your sword' has no relation to the depth of Israel's heart; it does not contain even a small point worthy of being brought into holiness."

Sod Yesharim explains both the temporary borrowing of force and its limit. The element brought into holiness is governed by judgment and serves the work of clarification; the destructive anger left behind loses the good that sustained it. The source then says explicitly that even the measured scholarly response ceases to be needed once desire is clarified. This illuminates why Pri Tzadik describes Jacob's goatskins as a temporary garment rather than his essential character.

Vayigash which speak of the affairs of Joseph, וּבְאֵלּוּ פָּרָשִׁיּוֹת חָל יְמֵי חֲנֻכָּה לִפְנֵיהֶן אוֹ לְאַחֲרֵיהֶן, **— in these portions fall the days of Chanukah before them or after them,** וּבְוַדַּאי יֵשׁ לָהֶם שַׁיָּכוּת, עַיֵּן שָׁם; **— and certainly they possess a profound connection, see there;** וְהֵינוּ דְּלִפְעָמִים חֲנֻכָּה חָלוּ בְּפָרָשַׁת וַיֵּשֶׁב, וְסוֹף חֲנֻכָּה רֹב בְּפָרָשַׁת וַיִּגַּשׁ. **— meaning that the beginning of Chanukah sometimes falls in Vayeshev, and the conclusion of Chanukah mostly in Vayigash.** וְאָמַר דְּחֲנֻכָּה יֵשׁ לוֹ שַׁיָּכוּת לְאוֹתָן הַפָּרָשִׁיּוֹת שֶׁחָל בָּהֶן: **— And he explained that Chanukah is intrinsically connected to the portions in which it occurs:**

Joseph's additional years refine his relation to suffering itself

וְהוּא דְּהִנֵּה בְּפָרָשַׁת וַיֵּשֶׁב כָּל הַפָּרָשָׁה מְעֻסָּק בְּבֵרוּר בְּחִינַת צַדִּיק יְסוֹד עוֹלָם, מִדַּת יוֹסֵף (וּכְמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַרְנוּ שָׁם),[1093, 1094] **— For behold in Parashat Vayeshev the entire portion deals with clarifying the Tzaddik, Foundation of the World, Joseph's attribute (as explained there),** וּבְפָרָשָׁה זוֹ נֶאֱמַר הַתְחָלַת עִנְיַן יוֹסֵף וּבֵרוּר מִדָּתוֹ, **— and in this portion begins Joseph's narrative and the refinement of his attribute,** וְהַגְּבוּרָה וְהַנִּצּוּחַ לְיֵצֶר הָרָע שֶׁנַּעֲשָׂה גִּבּוֹר הַכּוֹבֵשׁ אֶת יִצְרוֹ. **— along with the strength and conquest over the Evil Inclination as he becomes a warrior conquering his impulse.** וּבְפָרָשַׁת מִקֵּץ הַבֵּרוּר שֶׁיָּצָא מִבֵּית הָאֲסוּרִים לִמְלֹךְ. **— And in Parashat Miketz his clarification is that he emerges from prison to reign.**

Joseph's provision brings holiness into the practical life of the people

וּבְפָרָשַׁת וַיִּגַּשׁ נֶאֱמַר שֶׁבָּאוּ כָּל הַשְּׁבָטִים וְשִׁבְעִים נָפֶשׁ,[1095] **— And in Parashat Vayigash it is recorded that all the tribes and seventy souls arrived,** וּכְתִיב: "וַיְכַלְכֵּל יוֹסֵף", **— and it is written: "And Joseph sustained (vaychalkel)",** וְהוּא שְׁלֵמוּת מִדָּתוֹ שֶׁזָּכָה לִהְיוֹת כַּלְכֹּל וְלִהְיוֹת מֶרְכָּבָה לְמִדַּת צַדִּיק, **— which is the full perfection of his attribute, meriting to be the universal provider (kalkol) and chariot for Tzaddik,** וְאָז זָכָה לָאוֹר, דִּכְתִיב: "אוֹר זָרֻעַ לַצַּדִּיק". **— and then he merited the light, as written: "Light is sown for the righteous".** וְכֵן הַתְחָלַת חֲנֻכָּה בְּכִסְלָו שֶׁבּוֹ הָיָה הַנִּצּוּחַ לְיֵצֶר שֶׁהוּא חֹשֶׁךְ; **— And so the start of Chanukah in Kislev saw the victory over Greece which is darkness;** וְאַחַר כָּךְ בְּחֹדֶשׁ טֵבֵת שֶׁהוּא בְּאוֹת עַי"ן שֶׁמּוֹרֶה עַל אוֹר תּוֹרָה שֶׁיֵּשׁ בָּהּ שִׁבְעִים פָּנִים, **— and afterward in the month of Tevet governed by the letter Ayin denoting the light of Torah which has seventy facets,** וּבְרֹגֶז שֶׁהוּא פַּחַד יִצְחָק. וְכֵן יוֹסֵף אָמַר: "אֶת הָאֱלֹהִים אֲנִי **— and in rogez which is the Fear of Isaac.**

[1093] **Zohar, Vayeshev 179a**: 'At the beginning of Parashat Vayeshev (Zohar I 179a), the Zohar explains that while the evil inclination accompanies a child from the moment he emerges from his mother's womb, the holy good inclination (yetzer tov) and the awakening of the supernal soul enter him when he reaches thirteen years of age to empower him in Torah and mitzvot.'

[1094] **Mei HaShiloach, Volume I, Genesis, Miketz 3**: "'At the end of two full years.' Joseph was initially in prison for ten years, and afterward two more were added. At first ten were decreed against him because he had sinned against ten tribes. After he was clarified in prison, two more were added, corresponding to himself and Benjamin. This is the measure: when a person sins against God, God brings him into clarifications from which he suffers. After he is clarified for good and receives atonement, he must then suffer over this itself: why did he have to enter a matter that required clarification and suffering? When a person suffers, God, as it were, suffers with him, for 'In all their affliction, He is afflicted.' Therefore, after a person clarifies himself according to his sin, he must additionally clarify himself regarding his suffering, for this too contains a trace of sin. As the Talmud explains in Ta'anit 11a, 'He sinned' by afflicting himself. Thus ten years were first decreed against Joseph, corresponding to his ten brothers. After he was clarified in prison like silver refined in a furnace, he needed to be clarified regarding his own suffering and that of Benjamin his brother. After he clarified this too during those two years, he was immediately redeemed."
Mei HaShiloach gives an additional account of what the prolonged clarification involves: sensitivity to the suffering produced by needing correction, including the suffering of another person and, as it were, of God. This expands the prison-to-release stage that Pri Tzadik names briefly. The particular explanation of the ten and two years belongs to Mei HaShiloach; it is not asserted to be Rav Tzadok's own stated chronology or judgment of Joseph here.

[1095] **Yisrael Kedoshim 7:5**: "Among the souls and powers of action as they unfold into particulars, there are souls whose entire strength is in actual deeds. Their root is Joseph the righteous, 'who supplied grain to all the people of the land,' sustaining and providing for them. From his descendants came Joshua, who allotted the land. This is the holiness of bodily deeds that began upon entering the land: this one turns to his olive grove, and so forth, but everything is done in holiness and through the fulfillment of its commandments. Moses our teacher was wholly Torah; therefore he led them in the wilderness, outside settled life and the world of action, a place with no seed, fig, vine or pomegranate, but only the bread that ministering angels eat. Joshua began to clarify the holiness of bodily action: engaging in ordinary worldly activity, with all of it nevertheless in accordance with Torah. 'Torah together with worldly occupation is good,' and, 'If there is no worldly occupation, there is no Torah.' Worldly occupation is the share of the ordinary people, and it precedes Torah. Torah needs this too: without the leaves, the clusters would not endure. Torah was not given to ministering angels alone, as it was in the wilderness generation. The principal Torah is the study of how to perform commandments, which are bodily actions in this world. Therefore Moses desired to enter the land of Israel to fulfill its commandments, as stated in Sotah 14a."
Yisrael Kedoshim explains why feeding and sustaining others completes Joseph's spiritual role. His power is the root of holiness expressed through practical action, later developed by Joshua in the life of the land. The passage therefore gives content to the move from Joseph's personal victory over temptation to his sustaining all the tribes: the holiness he preserves becomes provision and action for others.

יָרֵא", — **And so Joseph said: "I fear God",** וְכֵן אָמַר: "וְחָטָאתִי לֵאלֹהִים", — **and likewise said: "and sin against God",** הַזְכִּיר שֵׁם זֶה שֶׁהוּא מִדַּת הַדִּין אֱלֹהִים דְּפַחַד יִצְחָק, — **mentioning specifically this Name representing Judgment, the Elohim of the Fear of Isaac,** שֶׁעַל יְדֵי שֶׁהִזְכִּיר פַּחַד הַשֵּׁם וְהִכְנִיס רְעָדָה וַחֲרָדָה בְּלִבּוֹ, — **for through recalling the fear of God and introducing trembling into his heart, he became a warrior conquering his inclination.** נַעֲשָׂה גִּבּוֹר הַכּוֹבֵשׁ אֶת יִצְרוֹ. — וְזֶהוּ "הִמְלִיךְ אוֹת עַיִ"ן בְּרֹגֶז", שֶׁהוּא "רִגְזוּ וְאַל תֶּחֱטָאוּ", **And this is "He made the letter Ayin king over rogez", which is "Tremble and sin not",** שֶׁבְּחֹדֶשׁ זֶה הַזְּמַן לְהַכְנִיס רוֹגֶז וּרְעָדָה בַּלֵּב לְהִיוֹת גִּבּוֹר הַכּוֹבֵשׁ אֶת יִצְרוֹ, — **for in this month is the season to introduce holy trembling into the heart to conquer one's inclination,** וְלִהְיוֹת פַּחַד הַשֵּׁם לְנֶגֶד עֵינָיו תָּמִיד, — **having the fear of God before his eyes continually,** שֶׁכֵּן נִכְלְלוּ כָּל כְּנֶסֶת יִשְׂרָאֵל בִּקְדֻשַּׁת יוֹסֵף, שֶׁנִּקְרְאוּ "שְׁאֵרִית יוֹסֵף", וּכְתִיב: "וְעַמֵּךְ כֻּלָּם צַדִּיקִים". — **for so was all Knesset Yisrael included in Joseph's holiness, termed "the remnant of Joseph", with Scripture stating: "And your people are all righteous".**

Discipline in giving shapes what a person is able to receive

וְכֵן חֹדֶשׁ זֶה מְסֻגָּל לְתִקּוּן פְּגַם הַבְּרִית (וְנִתְבָּאֵר לְמַעְלָה),[1096, 1097] — **And so this month is uniquely primed for the repair of the Covenant (explained above),** וּכְתִיב: "וְהָסֵר כַּעַס מִלִּבֶּךָ וְהַעֲבֵר רָעָה מִבְּשָׂרֶךָ", — **and it is written: "Remove sorrow (ka'as / anger) from your heart, and put away evil from your flesh",** וּפְגַם זֶה נִקְרָא "רָע" כַּיָּדוּעַ, — **and this blemish is designated "evil" (ra), as is known,**

Torah itself can enact the purification signified by immersion

וּמְרַמֵּז שֶׁעַל יְדֵי שֶׁיִּתְקַן מִדַּת הַכַּעַס, דַּרְגָּא דְּעֵשָׂו,[1098] — **alluding that through rectifying the attribute of anger, the level of Esau,** שֶׁיִּהְיֶה בְּקִדֻּשָּׁה בְּרוּגָז שֶׁל דִּבְרֵי תוֹרָה לְהַרְגִּיז עַל הַיֵּצֶר הָרָע, — **channeling it into holiness through the zeal of Torah words to agitate against the Evil Inclination,** עַל יְדֵי כֵן יִזְכֶּה לְתַקֵּן פְּגָם זֶה. — **through this he will merit to rectify this blemish.** וְכֵן יוֹסֵף שִׁטְנוֹ שֶׁל עֵשָׂו (כְּמוֹ שֶׁפָּתוּב בְּרֵאשִׁית רַבָּה פָּרָשָׁה ע"ג),[1099] — **And so Joseph is the adversary of Esau (Bereishit Rabbah 73),** דְּעֵשָׂו קְלִפַּת הַכַּעַס שֶׁהוּא שֹׁרֶשׁ שֶׁל כָּל קְלִפּוֹת הַיֵּצֶר הָרָע כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמַרְנוּ, — **for Esau is the kelipah of fury which is the root of all kelipot of the Evil Inclination as we explained,** וְיוֹסֵף גִּבּוֹר הַכּוֹבֵשׁ אֶת יִצְרוֹ — **while Joseph is the warrior conquering his impulse** עַל יְדֵי הָרוֹגֶז וְהָרְעָדָה שֶׁמַּכְנִיס בְּלִבּוֹ פַּחַד יִצְחָק, — **through holy trembling and awe introducing into his heart the Fear of Isaac,** וְהוּא פַּחַד הַשֵּׁם שֶׁעוֹמֵד עָלָיו תָּמִיד וְרוֹאֶה בְּמַעֲשָׂיו, וְזֶה עֶסֶק חֹדֶשׁ זֶה. — **which is the fear of Hashem Who stands over him continually beholding his deeds, and this is the spiritual task of this month.** וְזֶהוּ עִקַּר הָאוֹר, כְּמַה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: "אוֹר זָרֻעַ לַצַּדִּיק", — **And this is the essence of light, as Scripture states: "Light is sown for the righteous",** שֶׁמַּאִיר לוֹ שֶׁהַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרֵךְ עוֹמֵד עָלָיו תָּמִיד; — **illuminating for him that the Blessed Name**

[1096] **Sanhedrin 108b**: ‘The Gemara asks: And from where do we derive that it was prohibited for them to engage in intercourse while in the ark? The Gemara answers: It is derived from that which is written: “And you shall come into the ark, you, and your sons, and your wife, and your sons’ wives with you” (Genesis 6:18); and it is written: “Emerge from the ark, you and your wife, and your sons and your sons’ wives with you” (Genesis 8:16). And Rabbi Yoḥanan says: From here, the Sages derived and said that it was prohibited to engage in intercourse while in the ark, as when Noah and his family entered, the husbands and wives were listed separately, and when they emerged, the husbands were listed with their wives.’

[1097] **Sod Yesharim, Purim 1:3**: “‘Gladness’ is circumcision, as it says, ‘I rejoice over Your word.’ Circumcision is explained in the holy Zohar, Bo 36a: what is the opening of the body? It is circumcision. That is, if a person restrains himself in this place from giving forth except according to God’s will, all his acts of receiving will consequently become clarified as well: he will receive only what accords with God’s will. For when a person’s faculty of giving is clarified, his faculty of receiving is clarified too.”

Sod Yesharim explains how the covenant’s discipline reaches beyond a single act. Bringing the power of giving under God’s will forms the corresponding capacity to receive. This illuminates why Pri Tzadik places covenantal repair within the broader work of governing desire and other powers: a clarified boundary changes the person’s whole relation to what enters and leaves his life.

[1098] **Tzidkat HaTzadik 192:1**: “They abolished the immersion requirement for a person with a seminal emission before Torah study in accordance with Rabbi Yehudah ben Beteira, who said, ‘Are not My words like fire?’ This means that words of Torah burn away all evil desires. They also said in Berakhot 16a that tents are compared to streams, and so forth: the words of Torah themselves are analogous to immersion.”

Tzidkat HaTzadik supplies the connection between Torah’s fire and purification of desire that is compressed into the conclusion here. Its preceding discussion develops immersion as a unification of desire, love and awe; it then explains how Torah itself carries out that cleansing. This gives a definite inner meaning to the repair that Rav Tzadok associates with directing the force of agitation against the inclination.

[1099] **Bereshit Rabbah 73:7** (excerpt): “‘When Rachel had borne Joseph’ (Genesis 30:25): Once Joseph was born, Esau’s adversary was born. Therefore it says, ‘Jacob said to Laban: Send me away, and let me go to my place and my land.’ Rabbi Pinchas said in the name of Rabbi Shmuel bar Nachman: It is a received tradition that Esau falls only into the hands of Rachel’s descendants. This is what is written: ‘Surely the youngest of the flock shall drag them away’ (Jeremiah 49:20). Why does it call them ‘the youngest of the flock’? Because they are the youngest among the tribes.”

stands over him always; שֶׁנִּדְרַשׁ עַל פְּנֵי תְהוֹם" עַל יָוָן, "וְהוּא הֶפֶךְ הַחֹשֶׁךְ עַל אֱדוֹם; **— and it is the antithesis of the darkness expounded on Greece, and "upon the face of the deep" expounded on Edom;** וְהַיְנוּ שֶׁעַל יְדֵי עַי״ן שֶׁהוּא תּוֹרָה, שִׁבְעִים פָּנִים לַתּוֹרָה, **— meaning that through Ayin which is Torah, seventy facets of Torah,** יַרְגִּיז יֵצֶר טוֹב עַל יֵצֶר הָרָע וְינַצְּחֵהוּ. **— he shall agitate the Good Inclination against the Evil Inclination and triumph over it.**

Chanukah Ois 19

Holy Anger: Awakening the Heart to Serve Hashem

The differing readings of Sefer Yetzirah assign agitation and laughter to Tevet. Rav Tzadok first relates this difference to the distinct work of particular souls.

Holy Anger: Awakening the Heart to Serve Hashem

One month can disclose different forms of service to different souls

בְּסֵפֶר יְצִירָה: "הִמְלִיךְ אוֹת עַיִ"ן בְּרוֹגֶז וְכוֹלֵיהּ, וְטֵבֵת בַּשָּׁנָה" כֵּן הוּא לְגִרְסַת הָאֲרִיזַ"ל; [1100, 1101] — **– In Sefer Yetzirah: "He made the letter Ayin king over anger (rogez), etc., and Tevet in the year" — so is the reading of the Arizal;** וּלְגִרְסַת הַגְּאוֹנִים (בְּרֵישׁ פֶּרֶק ה') בְּהָשְׁבוֹן שְׁנֵים עָשָׂר כֹּחוֹת דְּחָשֵׁב שְׂחוֹק עֲשִׂירִי, [1102] — **while according to the reading of the Geonim (beginning of Chapter 5) in enumerating the twelve faculties, where laughter (sechok) is counted as the tenth,** נִמְצָא לְטֵבֵת אוֹת עַיִ"ן בְּשְׂחוֹק. — **the month of Tevet corresponds to the letter Ayin over laughter.** וּבְוַדַּאי דִּבְרֵי שְׁנֵיהֶם אֱמֶת, — **And certainly the words of both are truth,** שֶׁבְּכָל מַחֲלֹקֶת "אֵלּוּ וְאֵלּוּ דִּבְרֵי אֱלֹהִים חַיִּים"; — **for in every halachic dispute "both these and those are the words of the Living God";** וּכְבָר אָמַרְנוּ שֶׁיֵּשׁ נְפָשׁוֹת שֶׁאָצְלָם הַחֹדֶשׁ מְיֻחָד לְעֵסֶק זֶה, — **and we have already explained that there are souls for whom the month is specifically designated for this divine service,** וְיֵשׁ נְפָשׁוֹת שֶׁלָּהֶם הַחֹדֶשׁ מְיֻחָד לְעֵסֶק אַחֵר (וְנִתְבָּאֵר רֹאשׁ חֹדֶשׁ כִּסְלֵו מַאֲמָר ז'). [1103] — **and there are souls for whom the month is designated for the other service (explained in Rosh Chodesh Kislev, discourse 7).**

דָּכָאן אָמַר — **And behold the concept of rogez does not speak of sinful wrath,** וְהִנֵּה עִנְיַן רוֹגֶז לֹא מַיְרֵי מִכַּעַס, שֶׁהַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ בָּרָא הַחֹדֶשׁ בְּכֹחַ זֶה, — **for here it states that the Blessed Name created the month with this potency,** וּבְוַדַּאי הוּא בִּקְדֻשָּׁה: — **and certainly it is within holiness:** הָרוֹגֶז לְהַרְגִּיז יֵצֶר טוֹב עַל יֵצֶר הָרָע, — **the holy agitation of rousing the Good Inclination against the Evil,** וְהוּא "רוּגְזָא דְּרַבָּנָן" דְּטָב אִיהוּ. — **which is "the rage of the Rabbis" which is beneficial.** וְרֹאשׁ חֹדֶשׁ טֵבֵת שֶׁחָל בַּחֲנֻכָּה, — **And Rosh Chodesh Tevet which falls during Chanukah,** וּבְרֹאשׁ חֹדֶשׁ שֹׁרֶשׁ הַקְּדֻשָּׁה מִכָּל הַחֹדֶשׁ, וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמַרְנוּ דִּלְטַעַם זֶה נִקְרָא "רֹאשׁ חֹדֶשׁ" — **and on Rosh Chodesh is concentrated the root of holiness for the entire month,** – רֹאשׁ שֶׁל הַחֹדֶשׁ; — **and as we explained that for this reason it is termed Rosh Chodesh — the head of the month;** בְּוַדַּאי עֵסֶק חֹדֶשׁ זֶה יֵשׁ לוֹ שַׁיְכוּת לִקְדֻשַּׁת חֲנֻכָּה, — **certainly the spiritual task of this month bears a deep connection to the holiness of Chanukah,** שֶׁהוּא לְתַקֵּן הֶעָבָר וּלְהִתְגַּבֵּר עַל הַיֵּצֶר הָרָע לְהַבָּא, — **which is to rectify the past and conquer the Evil Inclination for the future;** וּשְׁנֵיהֶם עַל יְדֵי אוֹר הַתּוֹרָה שֶׁהוּא "לְכָל בְּשָׂרוֹ מַרְפֵּא", — **and both occur through the light of the Torah which is "healing to all his flesh",** וּלְהַבָּא אָמַר (זֹהַר חֻלָּק א' ר"ב עַמּוּד א'): "לֵית לָךְ מִלָּה

[1100] **Mei HaShiloach, Volume I, Genesis, Toldot 2**: “Within Israel too, there are souls permitted to enter uncertainty more than other souls, although both are descendants of Jacob. This is like the matter of Simeon and Dinah. Levi did not wish to take her, for he feared that in the depths his intention might not be for the sake of Heaven. The entire tribe of Levi is characterized by awe and withdrawal from uncertainty, as it is written of them, “I gave them fear,” and so forth. Through this there came from them priests who enter the innermost sanctuary. Their life was therefore clarified immediately, as will be explained in the portion of Korach concerning the staffs. Simeon, however, entered uncertainty and said, “Heaven forbid that I regard myself as an adulterer.” He married Dinah and entered a matter requiring clarification, saying that he trusted God to clarify him for good: his intention was only to take her out of Shechem, and his entire intention was for the sake of Heaven. Therefore the entire tribe of Simeon needed clarification in such matters, as with Zimri, who likewise said that his intention was good, as will be explained in its place. In the future, when the tribe of Simeon is clarified, its level will be greater than Levi’s.”

Mei HaShiloach supplies a concrete account of differentiated spiritual disciplines. Levi’s withdrawal from uncertainty and Simeon’s more exposed path require different kinds of clarification. This helps explain why differing counsel cannot be evaluated independently of the soul receiving it. The source retains the continuing need to test Simeon’s path, including the example of Zimri, and makes the final higher attainment conditional on future clarification.

[1101] **Machshavot Charutz 4:1**: “As is known, the twelve months correspond to the twelve tribes. Every tribe has a particular excellence and power through which it is distinguished and marked off from the other tribes, and is therefore counted as a tribe in its own right. Although all Israel are “one nation on earth,” truly one, and each person contains all the excellences found in all Israel, a particular excellence becomes manifest especially in the soul corresponding to it. Every matter has world, year, and soul: just as there are differing souls, there are differing times and places. The general division of Israel’s souls into twelve tribes corresponds to the general division of places into the world’s twelve diagonal boundaries, mentioned in Sefer Yetzirah, and the year into twelve months. There are several arrangements of the months and tribes, and great and profound matters are involved in how all these arrangements are true; this awaits another occasion.”

Machshavot Charutz explains how distinct monthly assignments can belong to one shared structure. Each soul contains the whole, while a particular power becomes especially manifest in a corresponding soul, time, and place. That distinction between inclusion and manifestation gives substance to Rav Tzadok’s claim here that the differing accounts can each describe the work appropriate to particular souls.

[1102] **Sefer Yetzirah 5:10**: ‘He made the letter Ayin king over anger (rogez), bound a crown to it, and combined one with another; with them He formed Capricorn (Gedi) in the world, the month of Tevet in the year, and the liver (kaved) in the soul—while in the Geonic sequence the letter Kuf rules over laughter and the month of Adar.’

[1103] **Tikkunei Zohar 85a:3-85b:2**: ‘In Tikkunei Zohar (Tikkun 48, 85a), the double mention of Shabbat in the verse refers to the union of the Supernal Shabbat (Binah, the World to Come) and the Lower Shabbat (Malkhut, the Sabbath Queen), which illuminate Israel throughout all their dwellings.’

לְתַבְרָא יֵצֶר הָרָע אֶלָּא אוֹרַיְתָא"[1104]; — **and for the future it states (Zohar Part I, 202a): "You have no instrument to break the Evil Inclination except Torah";** וְהַיְנוּ תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה שֶׁמּוֹפִיעַ בְּלֵב יִשְׂרָאֵל עַל יְדֵי נֵרוֹת חֲנֻכָּה, — **meaning the Oral Torah which radiates in the heart of Israel through the Chanukah lights,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמַרְנוּ (וְנִתְבָּאֵר לְמַעְלָה)[1105]. — **as we explained (and elaborated above).** וְזֶהוּ עֹמֶק גְּרְסַת הָאֲרִיזַ"ל: "הִמְלִיךְ אוֹת עַיִ"ן בְּרוֹגֶז", — **And this is the depth of the Arizal's reading: "He crowned the letter Ayin in rogez",** שֶׁהוּא לְהַרְגִּיז הַיֵּצֶר טוֹב עַל יֵצֶר הָרָע. — **which means rousing the Good Inclination against the Evil.**

Joy becomes possible through the clarification of the heart

וְלִגְרְסַת הַגְּאוֹנִים: "אוֹת עַיִ"ן בִּשְׂחוֹק"[1106, 1107], — **And according to the Geonim's reading: "The letter Ayin in laughter (sechok)",** שֶׁהוּא דְּבָאֱמֶת אָמְרוּ (בְּרָכוֹת ל"א עַמּוּד א'): "אָסוּר לְאָדָם שֶׁיְּמַלֵּא שְׂחוֹק פִּיו בָּעוֹלָם הַזֶּה וְכוּלֵי"[1108], — **it is because in truth they said (Berachot 31a): "It is forbidden for a person to fill his mouth with laughter in this world, etc.",** רַק הַפָּרוּשׁ "בִּשְׂחוֹק" כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמַרְנוּ בְּמַה שֶׁכָּתוּב (מְגִלָּה י' עַמּוּד ב'): "הוּא אֵינוֹ עָשׂ, אֲבָל אַחֵרִים מְשִׂישׂ", — **only the true meaning of "in laughter" aligns with what we explained regarding what is written (Megillah 10b): "He Himself does not rejoice, but He causes others to rejoice",** שֶׁאַף שֶׁהַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ אֵינוֹ עָשׂ בְּמַפַּלְתָּן שֶׁל רְשָׁעִים, — **for even though the Blessed Name does not exult at the downfall of the wicked,** שֶׁהָיָה רוֹצֶה שֶׁלֹּא יֹאבְדוּ וְיוֹעִיל לָהֶם יִסּוּרִין לְהֵיטִיב דַּרְכָּם, — **desiring rather that they not perish and**

[1104] **Zohar, Miketz 12:194-206**: ‘We have been taught that it behoves man always to rouse the good prompter against the evil prompter; if the latter departs, well and good, but if not, the man should study the Torah, as there is nothing so well calculated to crush the evil prompter as the Torah; if he departs, well and good, but if not, let the man remind him of the day of death so as thereby to subdue him.’

[1105] **Berakhot 5a:2**: “Rabbi Levi bar Chama said in the name of Rabbi Shimon ben Lakish: A person should always rouse the good inclination against the evil inclination, as it says, ‘Tremble, and do not sin.’ If he defeats it, well and good. If not, he should occupy himself with Torah, as it says, ‘Speak in your hearts.’ If he defeats it, well and good. If not, he should recite Shema, as it says, ‘Upon your beds.’ If he defeats it, well and good. If not, he should remind himself of the day of death, as it says, ‘And be still, selah.’”

[1106] **Tzidkat HaTzadik 260:1**: “Nevertheless, concerning the Holy One they said at the beginning of Avodah Zarah that He does not laugh at His creatures except on that day. This is like the teaching in Megillah: He said, “My handiwork is drowning …”; He does not rejoice, but causes others to rejoice. From His side, His praise rises from the wicked, since they too are His creatures: He creates them and sustains them every day. Mockery applies only to something separate from oneself that one rejects. This does not apply to God, for if He rejected it, it would have no existence at all.”
Tzidkat HaTzadik explains the divine side of the distinction through God’s continuing creation and preservation of those creatures. Derisive laughter entails a separation and rejection that cannot describe His present act of sustaining them. This gives a definite reason for the reluctance to rejoice in their destruction that Pri Tzadik states here; the subsequent discussion in Tzidkat reserves a different condition for the future removal of evil.

[1107] **Mei HaShiloach, Volume I, Genesis, Vayigash 4**: “This was the matter with Jacob our father when he heard the news that Joseph was still alive, as it says, “The spirit of Jacob revived.” He feared for himself lest this joy be merely a joy of this world, and therefore tested and refined himself through these clarifications. The first clarification was his saying, “I will go and see him before I die,” corresponding to “A person should always stir the good inclination against the evil inclination,” as explained. The second was “He offered sacrifices to the God of his father Isaac,” corresponding to “He should occupy himself with Torah,” like the blessing we recite each day, “Who sanctified us with His commandments and commanded us to occupy ourselves with words of Torah.” For in giving the Torah, the Holy One is called Gevurah: “Thus Moses heard from the mouth of the Gevurah,” as is known to the discerning. There Jacob was told, “I will surely bring you up as well,” corresponding to “I am the Lord your God who brought you out”: the latter concerns the past, while the former concerns the future. His sending Judah ahead, which our Sages interpreted as establishing a house of study, also belonged to this matter. He then underwent the third clarification: “He wept upon his neck further,” which our Sages expounded as teaching that he recited the Shema. Afterwards he said to Joseph, “Now I may die,” corresponding to the fourth counsel, to remind himself of the day of death. When Jacob saw that after all these the joy remained, he understood that it came from God and was true joy, enduring forever.”
Mei HaShiloach makes the clarification of joy concrete through Jacob’s response to his reunion with Joseph. Awareness of mortality, Torah, the Shema, and the immediate contemplation of death test what animates his happiness; its persistence through all four allows him to recognize its source. This develops the requirement of an upright heart here without treating the first pleasant feeling as proof that the work is finished.

[1108] **Berakhot 31a**: ‘In a similar vein, Rabbi Yoḥanan said in the name of Rabbi Shimon ben Yoḥai: One is forbidden to fill his mouth with mirth in this world, as long as we are in exile (ge’onim), as it is stated: “When the Lord returns the captivity of Zion we will be as dreamers” (Psalms 126:1). Only “then will our mouths fill with laughter and our lips with song” (Psalms 126:2). When will that joyous era arrive? When “they will say among nations, the Lord has done great things with these” (Psalms 126:2). They said about Reish Lakish that throughout his life he did not fill his mouth with laughter in this world once he heard this statement from his teacher, Rabbi Yoḥanan.’

[1109] **Megillah 10b**: ‘Rabbi Elazar said that this is how the matter is to be understood: Indeed, God Himself does not rejoice over the downfall of the wicked, but He causes others to rejoice. The Gemara comments: One can learn from the language of the verse as well, as it is written: “So the Lord will rejoice ken yasis” (Deuteronomy 28:63). And it is not written yasus, the grammatical form of the verb meaning: He will rejoice. Rather, it is written yasis. The grammatical form of this verb indicates that one causes another to rejoice. Consequently, these words are understood to mean that God will cause others to rejoice. The Gemara concludes: Indeed, learn from it that this is the case.’

that afflictions lead them to mend their ways, — מִכָּל מָקוֹם מוֹעִיל לְיִשְׂרָאֵל שֶׁשָּׁפְכוּ דָּמָם לִזְכוֹת לְשִׂמְחָה; **nevertheless it avails for Israel whose blood was shed to merit sublime joy;** וְזֶה אֵינָם זוֹכִים רַק כְּשֶׁזּוֹכִין לְיַשֵּׁר הַלֵּב שֶׁלֹּא יְהֶיֶה לוֹ שׁוּם נְטִיָּה לָרַע, — **and this they merit only when they merit to straighten the heart so it harbors no leaning toward evil,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב (תַּעֲנִית ט״ו עַמּוּד א׳)[1110]: "יְשָׁרִים לְשִׂמְחָה". — **as written (Ta'anit 15a): "The upright are destined for joy".** וּבַחֲנֻכָּה זָכוּ לְאוֹר תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה, — **And on Chanukah they merited the light of the Oral Torah,** וְכֵן הַזְּמַן לִזְכוֹת בְּכָל חֲנֻכָּה שֶׁיָּאִיר בַּלֵּב אוֹר תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה; — **and likewise it is the season to merit on every Chanukah that the Oral Torah's light radiate in the heart;** וּכְתִיב: "פִּקּוּדֵי ה' יְשָׁרִים מְשַׂמְּחֵי לֵב", — **and it is written: "The precepts of Hashem are upright, rejoicing the heart",** שֶׁעַל יְדֵי אוֹר תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּבַעַל פֶּה זוֹכִין לְיַשֵּׁר הַלֵּב וּלְשִׂמְחָה. — **for through the Oral Torah's light one merits straightening the heart and attaining holy joy.**

Tefillin allow a present taste of the future disclosure

וְהִנֵּה אִיתָא (בְּרָכוֹת ל׳ עַמּוּד ב׳)[1111, 1112, 1113]: "חֲזָיֵיהּ דַּהֲוָה קָא בָּדַח טוּבָא, — **And behold it states (Berachot 30b): "He saw him rejoicing exceedingly,** אָמַר: 'וְגִילוּ בִּרְעָדָה' כְּתִיב; — **and said: It is written: 'And rejoice with trembling';** אָמַר לֵיהּ: אֲנָא תְּפִלִּין מַנַּחְנָא וְכוּלֵּיהּ", — **he answered him: I am wearing tefillin, etc.",** וְלִכְאוֹרָה מַה הָא אָסוּר לְמַלֹּא שְׂחוֹק פִּיו בָּעוֹלָם הַזֶּה, תֵּרֵץ? — **Behold it is forbidden to fill one's mouth with laughter in this world,** וּכְתִיב: "אָז יִמָּלֵא שְׂחוֹק פִּינוּ", "אָז" דַּוְקָא! — **and it is written: "Then shall our mouth be filled with laughter", "then" specifically!** אָמְנָם תְּפִלִּין מוֹרֶה שֶׁקְּשׁוּרִים בְּשׁוֹרֶשׁ הַמַּחֲשָׁבָה: "בְּרֵאשִׁית" — **However, tefillin indicates being bound to the root of Divine Thought: –** שֶׁכֵּן יִשְׂרָאֵל מַכְתִּירִין בִּפְאֵר הַתְּפִלִּין — **"In the beginning" — for the sake of Israel, etc.,** בִּשְׁבִיל יִשְׂרָאֵל וְכוּלֵּיהּ, לְהַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא "הַשֵּׁם אֶחָד", — **for Israel crowns the Holy One with the beauty of tefillin proclaiming "Hashem is One",** וְהַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא מְשִׁתַּבֵּחַ בְּשִׁבָחֵיהוּ דְּיִשְׂרָאֵל (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב שָׁם וּ׳ עַמּוּד א׳); וְזֶה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: "וְרָאוּ כָל עַמֵּי הָאָרֶץ כִּי שֵׁם ה' נִקְרָא עָלֶיךָ" — **and the Holy One glories in the praises of Israel (ibid. 6a); –** אֲלוּ תְּפִלִּין[1114]

[1110] **Taanit 15a**: ‘to he who is despised of men, to he who is abhorred of nations, to a servant of rulers: Kings shall see and arise” (Isaiah 49:7); and ministers by bowing, as it is written, in the same verse: “Ministers, and they shall bow.” Rabbi Zeira strongly objects to this interpretation, and some say it was Rabbi Shmuel bar Naḥmani who objected. Had the verse written: And ministers shall bow, the meaning would have been as you said. However, now that it is written: “Ministers, and they shall bow,” this indicates that ministers will do this and that, i.e., they will both arise and bow.’

[1111] **Berakhot 30b**: ‘Having cited this verse from Psalms, the Gemara asks: What is the meaning of rejoice with trembling? Rav Adda bar Mattana said that Rabba said: One may not experience unbridled joy; even where there is rejoicing, there should be trembling. On that note, the Gemara relates: Abaye was sitting before his teacher Rabba, and Rabba saw that he was excessively joyful. He said to Abaye: It is written: Rejoice with trembling, one’s joy should not be unrestrained.’

[1112] **Dover Tzedek, Miscellany 4:61**: “Therefore they said that a good person is given a taste of the fruit of his deeds in this world: at intervals God illuminates for a person, his heart begins to burn with enthusiasm, and he actually feels life in his heart, while his soul rejoices in God. For the essence of life is joy, as explained in the Zohar at the end of Vayakhel concerning “in sorrow,” which signifies death. Of Shabbat, which is a taste of the World to Come, our Sages expounded in Bereshit Rabbah, “‘He adds no sorrow with it’—this is the mourner.” Therefore on Shabbat it says, “Delight in the Lord,” and the Zohar reads “in” as literally “above”: it is the meal of Atika Kadisha. The divine name indicates sensing God before one’s eyes, within the defined form of Torah. On Shabbat, however, a person can delight expansively, above that level of apprehension, with the expansiveness of joy that carries one beyond the usual boundaries through the heart’s widening. This is the meal of Atika Kadisha: the joy we experience through attachment to the hidden root, a taste of the World to Come in the expansion of delights. Even what appears directed toward oneself is all for the honor of Heaven, since one is attached to the hidden root. Thus at the beginning of the chapter Ein Omdin, when he saw his colleague being especially cheerful, the reply was, “I am wearing tefillin.” The head that bears tefillin signifies attachment to the hidden root, as explained above and in the Tikkunim’s Patach Eliyahu; from this comes the great joy. Therefore tefillin are called a sign, as is Shabbat: both signify the hidden root that distinguishes Israel from idolaters, like the sign of the covenant.”

Dover Tzedek explains what this anticipated future can mean within present experience: life already given to the heart becomes actively felt, and that awakening brings joy. Its discussion of Shabbat and tefillin supplies the experiential content of attachment to the hidden root. This develops Pri Tzadik’s answer by showing how an otherwise future disclosure can be tasted at a particular moment in this world.

[1113] **Sod Yesharim, Purim 1:3**: “Honor”—these are tefillin. For what is written in the Master of the world’s tefillin? “Who is a great nation,” and “Who is a great nation,” as the Talmud states in Berakhot 6a. Tefillin are a garment for His light: the light of His will is clothed in this mitzvah, and when a person puts them on he can thereby attain the divine light clothed within them. They allude to all the acts of the commandments, in which a person can dig and disclose the light dwelling within them.”

Sod Yesharim explains how the physical mitzvah can carry the disclosure described here. Tefillin clothe the light of God’s will in a form that becomes accessible through actually performing the commandment. The hidden root is thus received through a concrete act. The complete Purim paragraph keeps this within its requirement of service amid concealment before the unity of the hidden and revealed modes is disclosed.

[1114] **Berakhot 6a**: ‘The Gemara asks: And from where is it derived that phylacteries provide strength for Israel? As it is

שֶׁבָּרֹאשׁ, **— and this is: "And all the peoples of the earth shall see that the Name of Hashem is called upon you" — these are the head-tefillin,** דְּתְפִלִּין שֶׁל רֹאשׁ הֵם כְּכֻתָּר עַל הָרֹאשׁ. **— "upon you" specifically, for the head-tefillin are like a crown upon the head.** (חֵלֶק ב׳ נ״ד עַמּוּד א׳): [1115]וְאִיתָא בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ **— And it states in the Holy Zohar (Part II, 54a):** מוֹרֶה: כַּד אִתְנְהִיר נְהִירוּ דְּעַתִּיקָא וְכוּלֵיהּ, **— that the word Az (then) indicates: when the light of Atika shines, etc.,** אָלֶ"ף אַנְקִיב בְּחַשׁוֹכֵי וְכוּלֵיהּ וּמָטוּ לְזַי״ן; **— the aleph pierces the darkness, etc., and reaches the zayin forming** "אָז יָמָלֵא שְׂחוֹק פִּינוּ", **— and this is: "Then (Az) shall our mouth be filled with laughter",** דִּלְעָתִיד יִתְגַּלֶּה וְיָאִיר בְּחִינַת "הוּא", **— for in the Future there will be revealed and shine the aspect of "He" (Hu),** שָׁעַל שֵׁם זֶה נִקְרָא "בַּיּוֹם הַהוּא", **— on account of which that era is termed "in that day" (bayom hahu),** שֶׁיָּאִיר כְּיוֹם בְּחִינַת הוּ"א שֶׁמּוֹרֶה עַתִּיקָא כַּיָּדוּעַ, **— when the dimension of Hu illuminating as day reveals Atika, as is known;** וְזֶהוּ אָ"ז דַּוְקָא "יִמָּלֵא שְׂחוֹק פִּינוּ". **— and this is specifically when Az will fill our mouth with laughter.** "אֲנָא תְּפִלִּין מַנַּחְנָא", **And this is what he meant by saying: "I am wearing tefillin",** שֶׁבְּפֹשֶׁעַ שֶׁהַיִּשְׂרָאֵל מַנִּיחַ תְּפִלִּין מוֹפִיעַ בּוֹ הִתְגַּלּוּת מֵאוֹר עַתִּיקָא שֶׁקָּשׁוּר בַּשֹּׁרֶשׁ, **— for when a Jew dons tefillin there shines within him a revelation of the light of Atika bound to the Root,** וְהוּא גַּם כֵּן אָ"ז כָּאָמוּר. **— and it too embodies the realm of Az as stated.**

דְּעַיִן מוֹרָה עַל חָכְמָה שֶׁהוּא בָּרֹאשׁ וְשָׁרְשׁוֹ וְזֶה "הֶמְלִיךְ אוֹת עַיִ״ן", **— And this is "He made the letter Ayin king",** מֵהַמֹּחַ; **— for the eye (ayin) points to Chochmah in the head rooted in the brain;** וְאִיתָא (עֲבוֹדָה זָרָה כ״ח עַמּוּד ב׳): [1116]"דְּשׁוּרְיָנֵי דְּעֵינָא בְּאוּבַּנְתָּא דְּלִבָּא תָּלוּ", **— and it states (Avodah Zarah 28b): "The muscles of the eye depend on the understanding of the heart",** שֶׁהֵם גַּם מֵהַלֵּב, וּמוֹרִים עַל חִבּוּר חָכְמָה וּבִינָה; **— showing they also issue from the heart, pointing to the union of Chochmah and Binah;**

Knowledge joins the mind and heart so that Torah becomes lived joy

וּבְחִבּוּר חָכְמָה שֶׁבַּמֹּחַ עִם בִּינָה שֶׁבַּלֵּב זוֹכִין לִבְחִינַת הַדַּעַת, [1117, 1118] **— and through unifying Chochmah in the brain**

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written: “And all the nations of the land shall see that the name of the Lord is called upon you, and they will fear you” (Deuteronomy 28:10). It was taught in a baraita that Rabbi Eliezer the Great says: This is a reference to the phylacteries of the head, upon which the name of God is written in fulfillment of the verse: “That the name of the Lord is called upon you.”’

[1115] **Zohar, Beshalach 15:209-219**: ‘Yashir” (lit. will sing): the tense suggests that this song fitted that occasion and will also fit the future Redemption, when it will again be sung by Israel. The expression “Moses and Israel” proves that the righteous of the past ages, although they have entered into the highest regions and are united with the “Bundle of life”, will all rise again in bodily form and behold the signs and mighty works which the Holy One shall show to Israel, and sing this hymn.’

[1116] **Avodah Zarah 28b:10-11**: “Rav Yehudah permitted applying eye salve on Shabbos. Rav Shmuel bar Yehudah said to the others, ‘Who would listen to Yehudah, who desecrates Shabbos?’ Eventually he himself suffered from an eye ailment. He sent Rav Yehudah the question, ‘Is it permitted or forbidden?’ Rav Yehudah sent back, ‘It is permitted for everyone else; for you it is forbidden.’ Rav Yehudah continued: ‘Is this ruling my own? It comes from Mar Shmuel! A maidservant in Mar Shmuel’s household developed a burning inflammation in her eye on Shabbos. She cried out, but no one attended to her, and her eye burst. The next day Mar Shmuel went out and taught: An inflamed eye may be treated with eye salve on Shabbos. Why? Because the vessels of the eye are connected to the core of the heart.’”

[1117] **Tiferet Yosef, Talmud Anthology, Chagigah 5**: “Regarding joy, my holy grandfather explained that its essence awakens in the heart when a person stands in clarity and recognizes that everything is in God’s hands, as it says, “Everything is from You, and from Your hand we have given to You.” One recognizes that even this clear awareness through which one gives back to God, and even this generosity, also come from God. No nation or language has joy like this. Concerning them it says, “Behold, his soul is swollen; it is not upright within him”: even when they possess every good, they have no rest or joy in their hearts. For the essence of rest and joy is in awareness. When a person recognizes that this clear awareness too comes only from God, who graced him with such clarity, strength increases in his soul with great joy. Thus we find, “The people rejoiced over their voluntary giving, for with a whole heart they gave willingly to the Lord”: they rejoiced over this itself, that God had graced them with clear awareness concerning their generosity.” Tiferet Yosef explains why clear knowledge can generate joy in the heart: one recognizes both the received good and the ability to recognize and return it as gifts from God. Its example of wholehearted voluntary giving makes that inward knowledge visible in action. This adds content to Pri Tzadik’s movement from knowledge to an upright and joyful heart, while keeping joy grounded in its divine source.

[1118] **Resisei Layla 44:2**: “Moses our teacher is the knowledge that joins wisdom and understanding, which are mind and heart. This is the meaning of Torah, from the word instruction: it instructs the heart to follow God’s wisdom. Without this, when it does not instruct the heart, it is called only wisdom, not Torah. This is Moses’ power: he brought Torah down to earth and bequeathed it to Israel, possessing the power to make the heart follow God’s wisdom. The nations do not have a share in this. Balaam, who corresponded to him in opposition, boasted that he “knows the knowledge of the Most High.” He knew and apprehended this level of knowledge, but called it “knowledge of the Most High,” meaning that it was above the level of his own mind and heart: for him it was above nature. Although he too knew his Master and outwardly conducted himself according to Torah, guarding against jealousy, desire, and honor, in truth he was immersed in them, as explained above. That very incident clarified that he actually possessed all three bad traits in the depths of his heart.”

Resisei Layla explains what the joining of mind and heart accomplishes. Knowledge becomes Torah when it directs the

with Binah in the heart one merits Da'at, וּכְמַה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: "כִּי תָבוֹא חָכְמָה בְלִבֶּךָ וְדַעַת לְנַפְשְׁךָ יִנְעָם". — **as Scripture states: "When wisdom enters into your heart, and knowledge is pleasant to your soul".** וְעַל כֵּן נִקְרְאוּ הַסַּנְהֶדְרִין "עֵינֵי הָעֵדָה" וְכֵן כָּל הַחֲכָמִים, — **And therefore the Sanhedrin are called "the eyes of the congregation" and so are all sages,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב (בָּבָא בַּתְרָא ד׳ עַמּוּד א׳) בְּהוֹרְדוֹס: "הוּא סִמָּא עֵינוֹ שֶׁל עוֹלָם",[1119] — **as written (Bava Batra 4a) regarding Herod: "He blinded the eye of the world",** כִּי שֹׁרֶשׁ תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה מֵהַדַּעַת כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמַרְנוּ כַּמָּה פְּעָמִים. — **for the root of the Oral Torah derives from Da'at as we have stated often.** וּלְהִתְגַּלּוּת אוֹר זֶה זוֹכִין רַק יְרֵאִים וְצַדִּיקִים, — **And to the revelation of this light merit only the God-fearing and the righteous,** וְעַל זֶה רוֹמֵז מַה שֶּׁנֶּאֱמַר: "הִנֵּה עֵין ה' אֶל יְרֵאָיו", וְנֶאֱמַר: "עֵינֵי ה' אֶל צַדִּיקִים", — **and to this alludes: "Behold the eye of Hashem is toward those who fear Him", and: "The eyes of Hashem are toward the righteous",** שֶׁהַצַּדִּיק וְהַיָּרֵא זוֹכֶה לִבְחִינַת עֵין הַשֵּׁם שֶׁהוּא הַדַּעַת. — **that the righteous and the fearful merit the aspect of the Eye of Hashem which is Da'at.** וּכְתִיב: "אוֹר זָרֻעַ לַצַּדִּיק", וּכְתִיב: "אוֹר צַדִּיקִים יִשְׂמָח", — **And it is written: "Light is sown for the righteous", and: "The light of the righteous rejoices",** שֶׁעַל יְדֵי הָאוֹר שֶׁזּוֹכֶה הַצַּדִּיק זוֹכֶה לְיַשֵּׁר הַלֵּב שֶׁלֹּא יִהְיֶה לוֹ שׁוּם נְטִיָּה לָרַע, וְלִ"יִשְׁרֵי לֵב שִׂמְחָה". — **for through the light which the Tzaddik merits, he merits straightening the heart so it harbors no inclination toward evil, and to "the upright of heart joy".** וְזֶה עַל יְדֵי שֶׁזּוֹכֶה לִבְחִינַת הַדַּעַת שֶׁהוּא פְּנִימִיּוּת הַכֶּתֶר כַּיָּדוּעַ; וְזֶה שֶׁאָמַר: "הַמְלִיךְ אוֹת עַיִ"ן בִּשְׂחוֹק", שֶׁאָז מוֹפִיעַ בּוֹ מֵעֵין הֶעָתִיד. — **And this is attained through meriting Da'at which is the inner aspect of Keter as is known; and this is: "He crowned the letter Ayin in laughter", for then there shines within him a foretaste of the Future.**

The person's work of awe prepares the heart's later expansiveness

וְהָעִקָּר מִצַּד הָאָדָם: "הַמְלִיךְ אוֹת עַיִ"ן בְּרֹגֶז",[1120] — **And the foundational task from the perspective of man is: "He crowned the letter Ayin in rogez",** לְהַרְגִּיז יֵצֶר טוֹב עַל יֵצֶר הָרָע, — **rousing the Good Inclination against the Evil,** שֶׁעַל יְדֵי זֶה זוֹכֶה לִבְחִינַת צַדִּיק, — **through which one merits the status of Tzaddik,** כְּתִיב: "עֵינֵי ה' אֶל צַדִּיקִים", — **as it is written: "The eyes of Hashem are toward the righteous",** שֶׁבַּהֲפָכָה חַס וְשָׁלוֹם נִקְרָא "רַע בְּעֵינֵי ה'" וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמַרְנוּ. — **whereas in reverse, Heaven forbid, one is called "evil in the eyes of Hashem" as we explained.** וְעַל יְדֵי מַה שֶּׁמַּרְגִּיז הַיֵּצֶר טוֹב עַל יֵצֶר הָרָע זוֹכִין לִבְחִינַת שְׂחוֹק, — **And through agitating the Good Inclination against the Evil, one merits the level of laughter,** שֶׁזּוֹכִין לְיַשֵּׁר הַלֵּב. — **meriting to make the heart upright.** וְזֶה זָכוּ בַּחֲנֻכָּה כְּשֶׁכָּבְשׁוּ קְלִפַּת יָוָן וְזָכוּ לָאוֹר, — **And this they merited on Chanukah when they subdued the kelipah of Greece and attained the light,** וַ"אֲחֵרִים מְשַׂחֵק", שֶׁזָּכוּ לְ"יִשְׁרֵי לֵב שִׂמְחָה", — **and "He causes others to rejoice", meriting "for the upright of heart joy",** וְזֶה עֵסֶק חֹדֶשׁ טֵבֵת שֶׁרֹאשׁ חֹדֶשׁ שֶׁלּוֹ חָל בַּחֲנֻכָּה. — **and this is the spiritual work of the month of Tevet whose Rosh Chodesh falls on Chanukah.**

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heart in accordance with the wisdom it apprehends; Balaam illustrates the separation between knowing a truth and having one's inner traits formed by it. This makes the sequence in Pri Tzadik intelligible: the knowledge that leads to joy includes the rectification of the heart, beyond intellectual apprehension alone.

[1119] **Bava Batra 4a:3**: "Herod told Bava ben Buta, 'I am that man. Had I known how carefully the Sages guard their speech, I would not have killed them. Now, what remedy is there for a man like me?' He answered: 'He extinguished the light of the world, as it is written, "For a commandment is a lamp and Torah is light." Let him therefore occupy himself with the light of the world by rebuilding the Temple, of which it says, "All the nations will stream toward it."' Others report that he answered him this way: 'He blinded the eye of the world, as it is written, "If it was done away from the eyes of the congregation," referring to its Sages. Let him therefore occupy himself with the eye of the world by rebuilding the Temple, of which it says, "I am about to profane My Sanctuary, the pride of your strength, the delight of your eyes."'"

[1120] **Kometz HaMinchah 2:25:1**: "Nevertheless, one must labor over cooking the food before Shabbat. One who did not labor before Shabbat—what will he eat on Shabbat? As stated at the beginning of Avodah Zarah, "Today, to do them"—and tomorrow to receive their reward: this light does not come to a person by itself. Likewise, the Shabbat lamp must be lit before Shabbat. On Shabbat it is no longer the time to awaken awe, for it is entirely love and attachment to God. The lamp is lit close to Shabbat, "provided he does not do so too early," and so forth. This is like the birth pangs of the Messiah, which come close to his arrival, for attachment and love always follow closely after awe."
Kometz HaMinchah explains the relation through preparation for Shabbat. The expansive light of rest is received through earlier work, and the last preparation of awe stands directly beside the love that follows. This develops the conclusion of Pri Tzadik: agitation is the person's preparatory work, while the joy that follows is the fruit of a heart made ready to receive the light.

Chanukah Ois 20

Looking at the Chanukah Lights and Recognizing Providence

Rav Tzadok reads the Chanukah liturgy as a sequence: the covenant is repaired, the heart opens to the divine kingship, and the mouth becomes able to thank and praise.

Looking at the Chanukah Lights and Recognizing Providence

An opened heart turns the light into thanksgiving

הַנֵּרוֹת הַלָּלוּ וְכוּלֵּיהּ אֶלָּא לִרְאוֹתָן בִּלְבָד, כְּדֵי לְהוֹדוֹת וְכוּלֵּיהּ[1121, 1122] — **"These lights, etc., but to behold them only, in order to give thanks, etc.":** הוּא עַל דָּרָךְ מַה שֶּׁנֶּאֱמַר: "פִּתְחוּ לִי שַׁעֲרֵי צֶדֶק, אָבֹא בָם אוֹדֶה יָהּ; — **This follows Scripture: "Open to me the gates of righteousness, I will enter into them, I will give thanks to God;** זֶה הַשַּׁעַר לַהשֵׁם וְגוֹמֵר", — **this is the gate of Hashem, etc.",** כִּי כַּאֲשֶׁר זוֹכִים לִהְיוֹת נִפְתָּחִים בַּלֵּב שַׁעֲרֵי צֶדֶק — **for when one merits that the gates of righteousness open in the heart** עַל יְדֵי הוֹפָעַת הִתְגַּלּוּת כְּבוֹד מַלְכוּתוֹ, — **through the radiant revelation of the glory of His Kingship,** עַל יְדֵי זֶה בָּאִים לְהוֹדוֹת וּלְהַלֵּל לַהשֵׁם, כְּעִנְיַן מַה שֶּׁנֶּאֱמַר: "אֲדֹנָי שְׂפָתַי תִּפְתָּח" — **through this one comes to give thanks and praise to Hashem, –** וְהַיְנוּ הַשַּׁעֲרֵי צֶדֶק, — **as in Scripture: "O Lord, open my lips" — meaning the gates of righteousness,** וְעַל יְדֵי זֶה: "וּפִי יַגִּיד תְּהִלָּתֶךָ". — **and through this: "and my mouth shall declare Your praise".** וּבַמָּה זוֹכִים לָזֶה? — **And through what does one merit this?** עַל זֶה אָמַר: "זֶה הַשַּׁעַר לַהשֵׁם, צַדִּיקִים יָבֹאוּ בוֹ" — **– On this it states: "This is the gate of Hashem, the righteous shall enter into it"** — עַל יְדֵי הַתִּקּוּן קְדֻשַּׁת הַבְּרִית שֶׁהוּא בְּחִינַת צַדִּיק, — **through rectifying the holiness of the Covenant which is the aspect of the Tzaddik,** זוֹכִין לְהָאָרַת שַׁעֲרֵי צֶדֶק בַּלֵּב, כְּמַה שֶּׁנֶּאֱמַר: "אוֹר זָרֻעַ לַצַּדִּיק", — **one merits the illumination of the gates of righteousness in the heart, as stated: "Light is sown for the righteous",** וְעַל יְדֵי זֶה בָּאִים לְהוֹדוֹת וּלְהַלֵּל. — **and through this one comes to thank and praise.**

The lamp must bring concealed holiness into actual awareness

וְזֶהוּ עִנְיַן קְדֻשַּׁת נֵר חֲנֻכָּה,[1123, 1124] — **And this is the essence of the holiness of the Chanukah light,** שֶׁעַל יְדֵי רְאִיַּת

[1121] **Sod Yesharim, Rosh Hashanah 38:3**: “Recite remembrances before Me”: as it is stated in the Midrash, forgetfulness is found among us. But Israel restrain themselves and set aside all their desires, wishing only for His will. Before making the requests of their prayer they say, “My Lord, open my lips,” indicating that they ask only for what is His will. This is “Recite remembrances before Me so that your remembrance may rise before Me for good”: so that I may show you how you are truly attached to the root, where there is no forgetfulness at all. Even all the bodily desires of Israel are also the honor of Heaven.”

Sod Yesharim supplies an inner act expressed by “open my lips”: the petitioner relinquishes the demand that prayer serve an independent desire. That surrender makes the mouth a vehicle of divine will. It illuminates why the opening in Rav Tzadok’s paragraph concerns the heart and divine kingship, rather than merely the physical ability to speak. Sod Yesharim develops this within the Rosh Hashanah remembrances; it is not an alternative explanation of the Chanukah law.

[1122] **Peri Tzadik, Matot 11:1**: “Therefore, on Shabbat, when a person speaks and the speech is in the quality of “the mouth of the Lord,” the words are effective in entering the heart, so that “his heart will understand and he will return.” That is why it says, “It is good to give thanks to the Lord”: through the thanksgiving itself a person merits its entering the heart, becoming one who “confesses and abandons” wrongdoing, and being included in “Your people are all righteous.” One can then enter the gates of righteousness, the gate that the righteous enter.”

The Matot teaching explains the inward effectiveness of the thanksgiving described here. In its particular Shabbat setting, spoken thanks can enter the heart and lead to abandoning wrongdoing, opening the very gates of righteousness named in Chanukah 20. This gives the reader a concrete account of how praise and an opened heart can strengthen one another; it does not transfer Shabbat’s special efficacy automatically to every occasion.

[1123] **Sod Yesharim, Sukkot 91:1**: “Up to twenty cubits a person knows that he dwells in the shade of a sukkah; above twenty cubits a person does not know ….” The explanation is as the Gemara says there: “Above ten handbreadths a separate domain begins.” God established ten qualities within human apprehension, as it says, “Yours, Lord, are greatness, might, beauty …,” so that a person would have a place for service within these qualities. In the upper source there are likewise ten levels. Corresponding to a person’s service within the ten that are within human apprehension, His light descends toward the person, from crown to crown, as the Zohar explains “Who lowers Himself to see”: He descends in His crowns, from crown to crown, from diadem to diadem, from light to light, until human apprehension mingles with His light. These two domains, when joined, are called twenty cubits; what is called a handbreadth from the human side —“You have made my days handbreadths”—is called a cubit from God’s side. This is “Up to twenty cubits a person knows that he dwells in the shade of a sukkah; above twenty cubits a person does not know that he dwells in its shade, because the eye does not take it in.” It is entirely outside human apprehension. This upper light, above twenty cubits, cannot mingle with human apprehension at all. Within twenty, however, the light can indeed mingle with human apprehension through service.”

Sod Yesharim gives the twenty-cubit boundary a precise account of the meeting between divine light and human apprehension. Its subject is the sukkah, but its explanation of “the eye does not take it in” illuminates Rav Tzadok’s insistence that the Chanukah light must actually reach the person: the light must be available to become part of lived awareness. The sukkah’s ten-plus-ten symbolism is presented as its own exposition, not attributed to Rav Tzadok’s lamp teaching.

[1124] **Resisei Layla 57:4**: “This is the illumination of the Chanukah lamp that was established for all generations: by this light, to eliminate every kind of mixture from Israel. Such mixture follows from the inward powers of Israel being mingled with mixed desires, whose being solely for the sake of Heaven—and not for some other thought or ulterior motive—has not been clarified, as befits the root of the Jewish people, the congregation of Israel, who are completely

הַנֵּרוֹת נִפְעָל בָּזֶה הָאוֹר זָרוּעַ לַצַּדִּיק בְּלֵב נַפְשׁוֹת יִשְׂרָאֵל, — **in that through gazing upon the lights, the light sown for the righteous is activated in the hearts of Jewish souls,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמַרְנוּ שֶׁמִּצְוַת רְאִיַּת נֵר חֲנֻכָּה פּוֹעֵל לְהֶאָרַת תִּקּוּן הַבְּרִית בַּנֶּפֶשׁ. — **and as we explained, the mitzvah of beholding the Chanukah lights operates to illuminate the repair of the Covenant in the soul.** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב (שַׁבָּת כ״ב עַמּוּד א׳): "נֵר שֶׁל חֲנֻכָּה שֶׁהִנִּיחָהּ לְמַעְלָה מֵעֶשְׂרִים אַמָּה[1125] — **And as written (Shabbat 22a): –** פְּסוּלָה", — **"A Chanukah lamp placed higher than twenty cubits is invalid",** הֲגַם שֶׁהִדְלִיק כַּדִּין בְּכָל דִּקְדּוּקֵי מִצְוָה, וְהִדְלָקָה עוֹשָׂה מִצְוָה, מִכָּל מָקוֹם פְּסוּלָה, מִשּׁוּם דְּלֹא שַׁלְטָה בָּהּ עֵינָא; — **even though he kindled it lawfully with all punctilious details of the mitzvah, and the kindling effects the mitzvah, nevertheless it is invalid, because the human eye does not command a view of it;** וְזֶהוּ עִקַּר מִצְוָה שֶׁל נֵר חֲנֻכָּה: "לִרְאוֹתָם בִּלְבָד", — **and this is the essence of the mitzvah of the Chanukah lights: "to behold them only",** וְעַל יְדֵי זֶה נִקְבָּע הֶאָרָה בַּלֵּב מֵאוֹר זָרוּעַ לַצַּדִּיק. — **and through this an illumination is anchored in the heart from the light sown for the righteous.**

Jacob's image reveals the truth within a confusing desire

וְאָמְנָם נִצְרָךְ לָזֶה זְכוּת שֶׁיִּזְכֶּה לִרְאוֹת הָאוֹר "כִּי טוֹב",[1126] — **And indeed there is required for this spiritual merit to see the light that is "good",** וְהוּא כְּעִנְיָן שֶׁאָמְרוּ בְּיוֹסֵף (סוֹטָה ל״ו עַמּוּד ב׳):[1127] — **and it is like the matter they stated regarding Joseph (Sotah 36b):** "בָּאתָה דְיוֹקְנוֹ שֶׁל אָבִיו וְנִרְאָתָה לוֹ וְכוּ׳", — **"The image of his father came and appeared to him, etc.",** וְהַיְנוּ שֶׁבָּא לוֹ הֶאָרַת אַסְפַּקְלַרְיָא הַמְּאִירָה שֶׁהוּא דְיוֹקְנוֹ שֶׁל יַעֲקֹב, — **meaning there arrived to him the radiance of the luminous mirror which is the image of Jacob,** כִּדְאִיתָא בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ (חֵלֶק "מַאן דְּחָמֵי לְיֵיהּ לְיַעֲקֹב כְּמַאן דְּאִסְתַּכַּל בְּאַסְפַּקְלַרְיָא[1128] — **as stated in the Holy Zohar (Part I, 168a):** א׳ קס״ח עַמּוּד א׳): כִּי צוּרָתוֹ שֶׁל יַעֲקֹב דְּנָהֲרָא", — **"He who beholds Jacob is like one who gazes into the luminous mirror",** וְהִנֵּה אַחַר מַאֲמַר הַגְּמָרָא הַנִּזְכָּר לְעֵיל: חֲקוּקָה בְּכִסֵּא הַכָּבוֹד. — **for Jacob's form is engraved on the Throne of Glory.** "נֵר חֲנֻכָּה שֶׁהִנִּיחָהּ וְכוּ׳", — **And behold after the mentioned Talmudic passage: "A Chanukah lamp placed, etc.",** נִסְמַךְ בַּגְּמָרָא: — **there is juxtaposed in the Gemara:** "דָּרַשׁ רַב נָתָן בַּר מְנְיוֹמִי מִשְּׁמֵיהּ דְּרַבִּי תַּנְחוּם: — **"Rav Natan bar Manyomi expounded in the name of Rabbi Tanchum:** מַאי דִּכְתִיב: 'וְהַבּוֹר רֵק אֵין בּוֹ מָיִם' וְכוּ׳? מַיִם אֵין — **What is that which is written: 'And the pit was empty, there was no water in it', etc.?** בּוֹ, אֲבָל נְחָשִׁים וְעַקְרַבִּים יֵשׁ בּוֹ". — **Water was not in it, but serpents and scorpions were in it."**

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attached to the living God. In truth, all the power of Yesod comes from Netzach and Hod; if Yesod is clarified, Netzach and Hod are also clarified. But in Yesod this is actually manifest, whereas in Netzach and Hod it remains potential: its emergence into actuality is still concealed. Concealment leaves room for error, and a lamp is needed to illuminate. Therefore "above twenty cubits it is invalid, because the eye does not take it in": it still remains concealed. The essential purpose of the Chanukah lamp is to bring what is concealed into revelation."

Resisei Layla explains exactly why the visible height matters. A potential inner purity can still leave a person vulnerable to mixed motives; the lamp's task is to bring that hidden condition into recognizable illumination. The same twenty-cubit rule thus expresses the transition that Chanukah 20 calls establishing the light in the heart. The symbolic terms Yesod, Netzach, and Hod are retained with their stated distinction between actuality and potential.

[1125] **Shabbat 22a:1**: "A Chanukah lamp placed higher than twenty cubits is invalid, as are a sukkah and the crossbeam of an alleyway at that height. Rav Kahana also said: Rav Natan bar Minyomi expounded in Rav Tanchum's name: What is meant by 'The pit was empty; there was no water in it'? Once it says that the pit was empty, do I not know that it contained no water? Rather, what does 'there was no water in it' teach? It contained no water, but it did contain snakes and scorpions."

[1126] **Yisrael Kedoshim 10:16**: "According to the opinion that "he entered to attend to his needs," it seems that Joseph made a mistake in this matter. He knew that his having been sold into Egypt and into that household must mean that he needed to bring a holy spark and great wealth out of there. He also thought: perhaps it is from her; he imagined that his desire was holy. The image of his father was revealed to him—namely, the quality of "truth to Jacob"—and he saw the truth: this was the enticement of the inclination, not something proceeding from holiness. For in truth, a child born to him from her would not be his son at all, and it is impossible to extract a holy spark by this route."

Yisrael Kedoshim explains the moral clarity carried by the luminous image. Joseph could mistakenly construe desire as a mission to recover holiness; Jacob's quality of truth exposes that mistaken construction. This makes the image in Chanukah 20 an illumination that distinguishes genuine holiness from a persuasive religious justification. The passage explicitly presents its reading according to one Talmudic opinion; that qualification remains in the translation.

[1127] **Sotah 36b:13**: "'She seized him by his garment, saying,' and so forth. At that moment his father's likeness came and appeared to him in the window. It said to him, 'Yosef! Your brothers are destined to have their names inscribed upon the stones of the ephod, and you among them. Do you wish your name to be erased from among them and to be called a companion of prostitutes? For it is written, "A companion of prostitutes destroys wealth."'"

[1128] **Zohar, Vayishlach 3:46-55**: 'It was the prayers offered up by the patriarchs that sustained the world, and by them are upheld all who dwell therein; and the merits of the patriarchs will never be forgotten, inasmuch as they form the support of the upper and the lower realms; and Jacob's support is firmer than that of all the others. Hence it is that when the children of Jacob are oppressed, God looks at the image of Jacob and is filled with pity for the world. This is hinted in the passage: "Then will I remember my covenant with Jacob" (Lev. 26, 42), where the name Jacob is spelt plene, with a vau, which is itself the image of Jacob.'

וּלְהָבִין סְמִיכוּת הַמַּאֲמָרִים, — **And to understand the juxtaposition of these teachings,** הֲגַם שֶׁנֶּאֶמְרוּ מִפִּי אֶחָד, יֵשׁ בּוֹ רֶמֶז בַּסְּמִיכוּת; — **even though both were stated by the same Sage, there is an allusion in their adjacency;** וְיֵשׁ לוֹמַר בָּזֶה עַל דֶּרֶךְ מַה שֶּׁכָּתוּב בַּגְּמָרָא (שַׁבָּת קכ״א עַמּוּד ב׳):[1129] — **and one can explain based on what is stated in the Gemara (Shabbat 121b):** "נִזְדַּמְּנוּ לוֹ נְחָשִׁים וְעַקְרַבִּים, הֲרָגָן — "**If serpents and scorpions happen before him, –** בְּיָדוּעַ שֶׁנִּזְדַּמְּנוּ לוֹ לְהָרְגוֹ; לֹא הֲרָגָן — **if he killed them, it is known that they presented themselves to be killed; –** בְּיָדוּעַ שֶׁנִּזְדַּמְּנוּ לְהָרְגוֹ וְנַעֲשָׂה לוֹ נֵס מִן הַשָּׁמַיִם". וְהִנֵּה רַבִּי שְׁלֹמֹה יִצְחָקִי פֵּרֵשׁ: "נִגְלָה דַּתָּנָה' — **if he did not kill them, it is known that they presented themselves to kill him and a miracle was done for him from Heaven."** – לְבַקֵּשׁ לָךְ נִכְלֵי דָּתוֹת שֶׁיְּמִיתוּךָ בָּהֶם", — **And behold Rashi explained: "'Let us go to Dothan' — to seek for you legal pretexts through which to kill you",** וְהַיְנוּ שֶׁדָּנוּ עַל פִּי דִּין שֶׁחַיָּב מִיתָה, — **meaning they judged according to strict law that he was liable to execution,** מִפְּנֵי שֶׁהֵעִיד עֲלֵיהֶם לְאָבִיו שֶׁאָכְלוּ אֵבֶר מִן הַחַי, — **because he bore testimony against them to his father that they ate a limb from a living animal (ever min hachay),** וּבְדִין בְּנֵי נֹחַ חַיָּבִים מִיתָה בְּעֵד אֶחָד וַאֲפִלּוּ קָרוֹב (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב סַנְהֶדְרִין נ״ז עַמּוּד ב׳);[1130] — **and under Noahide law one is liable to death through a single witness even a relative (Sanhedrin 57b);** וּלְפִי דַּעְתָּם הָיָה רוֹדֵף, וְ"הַבָּא לְהָרְגְךָ הַשְׁכֵּם לְהָרְגוֹ". — **and in their view he had the status of a pursuer (rodef), and "he who comes to slay you, slay him first".**

A frightening rescue can call a person to examine an earlier judgment

וְכַאֲשֶׁר הֻשְׁלַךְ לַבּוֹר נְחָשִׁים וְעַקְרַבִּים וְלֹא הֲרָגָם,[1131, 1132] — **And when he was cast into the pit of serpents and scorpions and did not kill them,** אָז יָדַע יוֹסֵף שֶׁנִּזְדַּמְּנוּ לְהָרְגוֹ וְנַעֲשָׂה לוֹ נֵס, — **then Joseph knew that they had presented themselves to kill him and a supernatural miracle was wrought for him,** וְאָז הִרְגִּישׁ בְּנַפְשׁוֹ שֶׁנִּצְרָךְ

[1129] **Shabbat 121b:7**: "The Sages taught: If snakes or scorpions appeared before a person and he killed them, it is known that they were brought before him so that he would kill them. If he did not kill them, it is known that they were brought to kill him, but a miracle was performed for him from Heaven. Ulla said—and some report that Rabbah bar bar Channah said in Rabbi Yochanan's name: This concerns creatures hissing at him in preparation to attack."

[1130] **Sanhedrin 57b**: 'It is derived from the phrase "at the hand of every animal" that one is executed even without forewarning, as an animal certainly cannot forewarn someone. It is derived from the phrase "I will require it; and at the hand of man," with "I" stated in the singular, that the sentence is issued on the basis of the testimony of even one witness. It is derived from the phrase "at the hand of every man," that the judgment and testimony must be at the hand of a man, but not at the hand of a woman. It is derived from the term "his brother" that the testimony of the witness is accepted even if he is a relative of the defendant.'

[1131] **Tzidkat HaTzadik 161:1**: "When a person suffers in a particular limb or one of the soul's powers—for there are seventy powers in the soul corresponding to the seventy nations on the side of evil, as is known—it is presumable that the sin was in that place. As soon as he has been punished, he is again "your brother," as our Sages say in Makkot 23a. This applies even if they only bound him, as stated there. Likewise, as stated in Shabbat 121b about a snake pursuing a person: he has discharged his punishment and suffering through the fear that it would bite him. Indeed, it really had been sent from Heaven, as stated there; but they had compassion on him and redeemed him through the fear. This is like what is said in Berakhot 55a about a bad dream: for when one truly repents, all the matters of this world are like dreams. Then that limb and power are repaired, and "the soul restores the soul": that limb has a repair, but one must add to it and strengthen it. Then, "In the place where it was said to them, 'You are not My people,' it will be said to them, 'Children of the living God'"—in precisely that place, the matter becomes its very opposite."

Tzidkat HaTzadik reads the same encounter with a snake as more than either injury or escape: the fear itself can accomplish a stage of repair when joined to real repentance. It also insists that the repaired power still needs strengthening. That gives a concrete account of why Joseph can be saved and yet take the event as a demand for inward work. This is the author's spiritual interpretation, not a license to identify another person's suffering with a particular fault.

[1132] **Mei HaShiloach, Volume I, Genesis, Vayeshev 4**: "When God wishes to test a person, He causes the person to forget the full severity of the prohibition concerning the matter in which He wishes to test him. This was also the matter of the tribes, Joseph's brothers. When they wished to kill him, the whole prohibition was concealed from them. Only through counsel other than words of Torah was he saved from their hands, and they too were saved from sin. Judah was very wise in worldly matters; he therefore devised advice and said, "What profit?" Even though it appeared to him that killing him was legally permitted, as will be explained, what benefit would come to us from it? (Would my father give me the striped coat? The striped coat belongs specifically to Joseph. Supplement.) Would our father love us more because of this? As soon as they agreed not to kill him, they saw the gravity of the prohibition: killing him was also legally forbidden. A person may not use this advice based on worldly wisdom as his protection at all times, but only at the time of a test when no other counsel is available. When one remembers that something is prohibited, it is forbidden to withdraw from it on the basis of such advice; one must withdraw because of His command. This explains the Gemara: "Anyone who blesses Judah"—meaning that he approves of acting this way always—"is called one who compromises." Judah, too, used this advice only at the time of the test."

Mei HaShiloach examines the brothers' side of the same danger: in the test, a lethal judgment could appear legally justified until a different counsel interrupted it. This deepens the section's warning that an apparently sound judgment about a brother can require subsequent clarification. Its exceptional use of worldly advice is carefully limited to a test in which Torah's prohibition has become concealed; the author forbids substituting self-interest for obedience when the prohibition is remembered.

לוֹ לְהִתְבָּרֵר בִּשְׁנֵי הַדְּבָרִים: — **and then he sensed in his soul that he needed spiritual clarification in two matters:** שֶׁהוֹצִיא דִּבָּה עַל אֶחָיו שֶׁתּוֹלִים עֵינֵיהֶם בִּבְנוֹת הָאָרֶץ, — **having brought evil report against his brothers that they cast eyes upon the daughters of the land,** וְשֶׁחֲשׁוּדִים עַל אֵבֶר מִן הַחַי, — **and that they were suspect of eating a limb from the living;** כִּי לְעִנְיָן זֶה נִזְדַּמְּנוּ לוֹ הַנְּחָשִׁים וְעַקְרַבִּים: כִּי הַנָּחָשׁ — **for toward these two matters the serpents and scorpions presented themselves: –** שֹׁרֶשׁ שֶׁל פֶּגֶם הַבְּרִית, — **for the serpent is the root of the blemish of the Covenant,** שֶׁהוּא עֵטְיוֹ שֶׁל נָחָשׁ שֶׁהִכְנִיס לְאָדָם הָרִאשׁוֹן בְּתַאֲוַת הָאֲכִילָה, — **which is the serpent's counsel injected into Adam within the lust of eating,** וְעַל יְדֵי זֶה נֶעֱנַשׁ בְּ"נָחָשׁ עָפָר לַחְמוֹ", שֶׁנִּטַּל מִמֶּנּוּ הַטַּעַם שֶׁל תַּאֲוַת אֲכִילָה; — **whereby he was punished with "and dust shall the serpent eat", having stripped from him all appetizing pleasure of food;** וְהָעַקְרָב הוּא הַמֵּמִית בְּוַדַּאי, כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב (בְּרָכוֹת ל"ג עַמּוּד א'): "אֲבָל עַקְרָב — **and the scorpion delivers certain death, as written (Berachot 33a): "but for a scorpion he interrupts his prayer",**[1133] פּוֹסֵק", וְהוּא נֶגֶד פֶּגֶם רְצִיחָה שֶׁנִּמְשַׁךְ עַל יְדֵי קַיִן, — **and it corresponds to the blemish of murder drawn down through Cain,** וְהוּא נֶגֶד פֶּגֶם שֶׁל אֵבֶר מִן הַחַי, — **which corresponds to the cruelty of a limb torn from the living,** שֶׁנִּזְהָרִים בָּזֶה גַּם אֻמּוֹת הָעוֹלָם מִצַּד שֶׁהוּא אַכְזָרִיּוּת גְּדוֹלָה, — **from which the nations also refrain because it is severe cruelty,** חוּץ הָאִסּוּר שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר לִבְנֵי נֹחַ, — **aside from the divine prohibition forbidden to Noahides,** וְלָכֵן נִתְבַּיֵּשׁ נְבוּכַדְנֶצַּר כְּשֶׁאָכַל אַרְנֶבֶת חַיָּה (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב נְדָרִים ס"ה עַמּוּד א').[1134] — **and therefore Nebuchadnezzar was humiliated when he ate a live hare (Nedarim 65a).** וְכַאֲשֶׁר נִזְדַּמְּנוּ לִפְנֵי יוֹסֵף הַנְּחָשִׁים הָרְגִישׁ בְּנַפְשׁוֹ שֶׁצָּרִיךְ לְהִתְבָּרֵר בְּעִנְיַן — **And when the serpents and scorpions gathered before Joseph, he felt in his soul that he required refining regarding his talebearing,** וּבְוַדַּאי עָשָׂה תְּשׁוּבָה עַל הוֹצָאַת הַדִּבָּה, — **and he certainly repented over both aforementioned blemishes.** שְׁנֵי הַפְּגָמִים הַנִּזְכָּרִים לְעֵיל.

A genuine victory does not finish the work of clarification

נִתְוַדַּע לוֹ שֶׁנִּצְרָךְ עוֹד בֵּרוּרִים — **And after all this, when he was sold into slavery,**[1135, 1136] וְאַחַר כָּל זֶה, כְּשֶׁנִּמְכַּר לְעֶבֶד,

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[1133] **Berakhot 33a**: ‘The Gemara cites another halakha stating that he must interrupt his prayer in a case of certain danger. Rabbi Yitzḥak said: One who saw oxen coming toward him, he interrupts his prayer, as Rav Hoshaya taught: One distances himself fifty cubits from an innocuous ox shor tam, an ox with no history of causing damage with the intent to injure, and from a forewarned ox shor muad, an ox whose owner was forewarned because his ox has gored three times already, one distances himself until it is beyond eyeshot.’

[1134] **Nedarim 65a:2-4**: “‘He also rebelled against King Nevuchadnezzar, who had made him swear by the living God.’ What was his rebellion? Tzidkiyahu found Nevuchadnezzar eating a live hare. Nevuchadnezzar told him, ‘Swear to me that you will not reveal this about me and the matter will not get out.’ He swore. Eventually Tzidkiyahu became physically distressed by keeping the secret. He obtained release from his oath and told it. Nevuchadnezzar heard that people were ridiculing him and sent for the Sanhedrin and Tzidkiyahu. He said to them, ‘Have you seen what Tzidkiyahu has done? Did he not swear by the name of Heaven that he would not reveal it?’ Tzidkiyahu answered, ‘I obtained release from the oath.’ Nevuchadnezzar asked them, ‘Can one obtain release from an oath?’ They answered, ‘Yes.’ He asked, ‘In the other party’s presence, or even in his absence?’ They answered, ‘In his presence.’ He said to them, ‘Then what have you done? Why did you not tell Tzidkiyahu?’ Immediately, ‘The elders of the daughter of Zion sit upon the ground in silence.’ Rabbi Yitzchak said: They pulled the cushions out from beneath them.”

[1135] **Peri Tzadik, Miketz 2:1**: “But Joseph’s words were “only a loss,” through his saying to the chief cupbearer, “Remember me” and “mention me.” He did not regard this as any sin, for he really did not put his trust in the chief cupbearer—as it says, “Who places his trust in the Lord”: this is Joseph. Rather, because he sensed that the cause of his deliverance would in fact be the chief cupbearer, he wanted the deliverance to come about through nature, since one does not rely on a miracle. Nevertheless, it was a loss to him: two years were added, to awaken him regarding the words with which he had slandered his brothers, which had likewise seemed a slight matter to him. In truth, the two blemishes mentioned above branched out from this, for malicious speech and slander come from jealousy and anger, and the covenant of the tongue corresponds to the covenant of the sexual organ, as is known. Such words are among the sins a person treads underfoot, and they bring only loss. Through this, two years were added to awaken him to the need to repair the blemish of the two days through the correction of his words. This is hinted at by “At the end of two years of days”: when the blemish of the two days was repaired, “Pharaoh dreamed,” as it says, “Until the time his word came; the word of the Lord refined him.”

Miketz identifies a specific reason why Joseph’s successful resistance did not end his refining: he could still overlook the force of his own speech. The passage expressly preserves Joseph’s trust in God; the extra years expose a subtler flaw rather than proving that the earlier faith and victory were false. Its “two days” refers, in the complete paragraph, to the distorted forms of kindness and strength that produce desire and anger.

[1136] **Mei HaShiloach, Volume I, Genesis, Miketz 1**: “At the end of two years of days.” In the holy Zohar, Rabbi Elazar opens with “The Lord lives; blessed is my rock; exalted be the God of my salvation.” “The Lord lives” means one whose heart is pure and cleansed of all the world’s desires, attached only to eternal life. “Blessed is my rock” means one who recognizes that all good things come only from God, and therefore has a generous eye. Then, “Exalted be the God of my salvation”: he will attain deliverances higher than his understanding. Before a person is clarified in these matters, it is impossible to give him deliverances, for he is not yet a clear vessel to receive them. Therefore, “At the end of two years of days” means after he was clarified in these two matters. Then Pharaoh dreamed, and he immediately attained deliverance: “Until the time his word came; the word of the Lord refined him.” That night Joseph the righteous cried out greatly, “Return, Lord—how long?” and immediately attained deliverance. Of this it is written, “Lord, God of my salvation … I have cried out at night before You.” For this is the Holy One’s way: before giving deliverance, He places a

שֶׁלֹּא נִתְקַן עוֹד בִּשְׁלֵמוּת הַפְּגָם; — **it became known to him that further refining was necessary, that the blemish was not yet perfectly healed;** וְגַם אַחַר זֶה שֶׁנִּזְדַּמֵּן לוֹ הַנִּסָּיוֹן — **and also afterward when the trial of Potiphar's wife befell him,** וְזָכָה לְהָאוֹר זָרוּעַ לַצַּדִּיק שֶׁנִּרְאָה לוֹ דְּמוּת דְּיוֹקְנוֹ שֶׁל אָבִיו כַּנִּזְכָּר לְעֵיל וְעָמַד בַּנִּסָּיוֹן — **and he merited the light sown for the righteous wherein his father's image appeared to him and he withstood the test,** הוּצְרַךְ עוֹד לְבֵרוּרִים, "עִנּוּ בַכֶּבֶל רַגְלוֹ" — **he still required further purifications: "they afflicted his feet with fetters",** "עַד עֵת בֹּא דְּבָרוֹ, אִמְרַת ה' צְרָפָתְהוּ". — **"until the time that his word came to pass, the word of Hashem refined him".** וּמִזֶּה יָדִין כָּל אָדָם בְּנַפְשׁוֹ: — **And from this let every person deduce regarding his own soul:** שֶׁגַּם אִם זָכָה לְפָעָמִים לְהָאִיר בְּנַפְשׁוֹ מִבְּחִינַת הָאוֹר זָרוּעַ לַצַּדִּיק, — **that even if he merited at times that there radiate in his soul from the light sown for the righteous,** בַּל יֹאמַר בְּלִבּוֹ: "שָׁלוֹם עָלַיִךְ נַפְשִׁי, וּכְבָר זִכִּיתִי לִבִּי", — **let him not say in his heart: "Peace be unto you, my soul, I have already cleansed my heart",** כִּי בְּוַדַּאי עוֹד נִצְרָךְ בָּזֶה לְבֵרוּרִים בְּכָל יָמָיו, — **for certainly he still requires further purifications in this all his days,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב (סֻכָּה נ"ב עַמּוּד ב'):[1137] — **and as written (Sukkah 52b):** "יִצְרוֹ שֶׁל אָדָם מִתְגַּבֵּר עָלָיו בְּכָל יוֹם, שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: 'צוֹפֶה רָשָׁע לַצַּדִּיק', "לַצַּדִּיק" דַּוְקָא — **– "A man's inclination overpowers him daily, as it is said: 'The wicked watches for the righteous'" — for the "righteous" specifically —** הַיְנוּ מִי שֶׁגּוֹדֵר עַצְמוֹ לְתַקֵּן הַפְּגָם, — **meaning one who fences himself to rectify the blemish,** וְעִם כָּל זֶה נִצְרָךְ לְבֵרוּרִים בְּכָל יוֹם, — **and nonetheless he requires continuous siftings every day,** וְ"אִלְמָלֵא הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא שֶׁעוֹזְרוֹ אֵינוֹ יָכוֹל לוֹ". — **and "were it not that the Holy One assists him he could not overcome it".**

Guarding sight must deepen into the repair of the heart

וְעַל זֶה יִרְמֹז סְמִיכוּת הַמַּאֲמָר "אֲבָל נְחָשִׁים וְעַקְרַבִּים יֵשׁ בּוֹ"[1138, 1139] — **And to this alludes the juxtaposition of the teaching "but serpents and scorpions were in it"** לַמַּאֲמָר הָרִאשׁוֹן בְּנֵר חֲנֻכָּה, — **to the opening teaching regarding the Chanukah light,** שֶׁהָעִקָּר בְּמִצְוַת הָרְאִיָּה שֶׁזּוֹכִין עַל יְדֵי זֶה לְבְחִינַת אוֹר זָרוּעַ לַצַּדִּיק — **where the essence of the mitzvah of seeing is meriting the light sown for the righteous** לִהְיוֹת נִתְקָן פְּגַם הַבְּרִית כַּנִּזְכָּר וְנִסְמָךְ זֶה הַמַּאֲמָר כְּדֵי שֶׁלֹּא יִסְמֹךְ הָאָדָם לְעֵיל; — **so that the blemish of the Covenant is rectified as mentioned; and this teaching was placed adjacent so a person should not rely on himself** בְּנַפְשׁוֹ שֶׁכְּבָר נִתְקַן הַכֹּל, — **that all has been completely healed,** רַק יֵדַע דִּימֵי חֲנֻכָּה הַמָּה הֲכָנָה וְחִנּוּךְ מִבְּחִינַת הָאוֹר זָרוּעַ לַצַּדִּיק, — **but should know that the days of Chanukah are a preparation and initiation from this light sown for the righteous,** שֶׁעַל יְדֵי זֶה יִזְכֶּה לִשְׁלֵמוּת הַתִּקּוּן בִּימֵי שׁוֹבָבֵי"ם; — **whereby he may merit complete rectification**

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cry in the person's heart, so that it may be called "the labor of your hands."

Mei HaShiloach explains what the prolonged refinement prepares: a heart freed from grasping desire and a generous recognition that good comes from God. Even the final cry is awakened by God, while becoming the person's own labor. This illuminates both halves of Rav Tzadok's conclusion—continued work and the indispensable divine help—without treating deliverance as something a person can demand after one successful test.

[1137] **Sukkah 52b**: "Rabbi Shimon ben Lakish said: A person's evil inclination grows stronger against him every day and seeks to kill him, as it says: 'The wicked watches the righteous and seeks to kill him.' Were the Holy One, blessed be He, not to help him, he could not overcome it, as it says: 'Hashem will not leave him in its hand, nor condemn him when he is judged.'"

[1138] **Tzidkat HaTzadik 190:1**: "But in truth the heart is primary, as it is written, "More than all you guard, guard your heart, for from it are the issues of life." In it lies the principal life and attachment to the living God. In this respect Jacob our father's bed was complete, and all his offspring were a seed of truth. In the Sages' language, "a generous eye" and "a good eye" mean generosity of heart and the absence of jealousy; likewise in Scripture, "One with a good eye will be blessed, for he has given of his bread to the poor." The opposite is an evil eye, called "an evil eye" in Scripture. This deficiency is specifically in Joseph's descendants, as it says, "Ephraim will not envy Judah." For Joseph's root is fear of sin, which is guarding the eye; yirah (fear) has the letters of re'iyah, seeing, like the teaching that Isaac points out the Holy One, blessed be He, before their eyes. This comes from Isaac's power and quality. Generosity comes from the quality of love, "kindness to Abraham," which is its very opposite. If so, on the contrary, the brothers' eyes are more generous, and they possess a better eye than he does."

Tzidkat HaTzadik prevents "guarding the eyes" from becoming the whole definition of a repaired heart. Joseph's careful restraint must also meet the brothers' generosity and freedom from jealousy. This supplies a precise further dimension to Chanukah 20's warning against declaring the work complete: the eye is linked to the heart not only through desire, but also through the way one looks upon another person.

[1139] **Sod Yesharim, Yom Kippur 3:1**: "With a linen sash" excludes the robe. The sash atones for thoughts of the heart: a person should not take confidence from recognizing his root and say that he has no part in the evil thought that sometimes occurs to him. Therefore Scripture specifies a linen sash, which atones for thoughts of the heart. It is like what is said, "Do not stray after your hearts and after your eyes": if a person thoroughly clarifies himself from his own side, no evil thought will occur to him at all."

In its Yom Kippur account, Sod Yesharim rejects a specific form of premature assurance: knowledge of one's holy root must not become an excuse to dismiss the work of clarifying the heart. That directly illuminates Rav Tzadok's warning that the Chanukah illumination is a beginning, while the eye and heart still require attention. The target's strong ideal is kept in its own words; it is not used to erase the distinction between intentional cultivation and an involuntary passing thought.

during the weeks of Shovavim; וְהָעִקָּר לִהְיוֹת נִזְהָר בְּנַפְשׁוֹ מֵהַרְהוּר וּרְאִיָּה, **— and the foundation is to be intensely guarded in his soul from unholy sight and impure thoughts,** שֶׁעַל זֶה מוֹרֶה שֶׁנִּבְרָא חֹדֶשׁ זֶה בְּאוֹת עַיִ"ן — **which is indicated by this month being created through the letter Ayin,** שֶׁהוּא הֲכָנַת הַתִּקּוּן בִּשְׁמִירַת הָעֵינַיִם, **— which is the preparation of rectification in guarding the eyes,** וּכְמַה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: "וְלֹא תָתוּרוּ וְגוֹמֵר וְאַחֲרֵי עֵינֵיכֶם", **— as Scripture states: "And that you seek not, etc., and after your eyes",** וְאָמְרוּ (בְּרָכוֹת י"ב עַמּוּד ב'): "זֶה הִרְהוּר עֲבֵרָה",[1140] **— and they said (Berachot 12b): "This is the thought of transgression",** כִּי עַל יְדֵי שְׁמִירַת עֵינַיִם נִיצוֹלִים מֵהַרְהוּר, **— for through guarding the eyes one is saved from sinful contemplation,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב (עֲבוֹדָה זָרָה כ"ח עַמּוּד ב'): "דְּשׁוּרְיָנֵי דְּעֵינָא בְּאוּבָנְתָא דְּלִבָּא תָּלוּ".[1141] **— as written (Avodah Zarah 28b): "The sinews of the eye are linked to the understanding of the heart".** וּבְכָל שָׁנָה וְשָׁנָה בִּזְמַנִּים אֵלּוּ נִפְעָל הַתִּקּוּן וְהַבֵּרוּר בְּנַפְשׁוֹת יִשְׂרָאֵל בְּעֶזֶר הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ; **— And in and each and every year during these auspicious times this rectification and purification is wrought in Jewish souls with the help of the Blessed Name;** וְכַאֲשֶׁר יִתֵּן הָאָדָם אֶל לִבּוֹ לְתַקֵּן, יָשִׂים הַשֵּׁם מִבְטַחוֹ שֶׁיִּהְיֶה נִתְקָן בִּשְׁלֵמוּת, וּכְמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בְּיוֹסֵף (בְּרֵאשִׁית רַבָּה פָּרָשָׁה פ"ט): "'אַשְׁרֵי הַגֶּבֶר אֲשֶׁר שָׂם הַשֵּׁם מִבְטַחוֹ'[1142] **— and when a person sets his heart to rectify, let him place his trust in Hashem that it will be healed in perfection, –** זֶה יוֹסֵף".[1143] **— as written regarding Joseph (Bereishit Rabbah 89): "'Happy is the man who makes Hashem his trust' — this is Joseph."**

[1140] **Berakhot 12b:22**: “For it was taught: ‘After your hearts’ refers to heresy, as another verse says, ‘The fool says in his heart: There is no God.’ ‘After your eyes’ refers to thoughts of sexual transgression, as it says, ‘Shimshon said to his father: Take her for me, for she is right in my eyes.’ ‘After which you stray’ refers to thoughts of idolatry, as it says, ‘They strayed after the Baalim.’”

[1141] **Avodah Zarah 28b:10-11**: “Rav Yehudah permitted applying eye salve on Shabbos. Rav Shmuel bar Yehudah said to the others, ‘Who would listen to Yehudah, who desecrates Shabbos?’ Eventually he himself suffered from an eye ailment. He sent Rav Yehudah the question, ‘Is it permitted or forbidden?’ Rav Yehudah sent back, ‘It is permitted for everyone else; for you it is forbidden.’ Rav Yehudah continued: ‘Is this ruling my own? It comes from Mar Shmuel! A maidservant in Mar Shmuel’s household developed a burning inflammation in her eye on Shabbos. She cried out, but no one attended to her, and her eye burst. The next day Mar Shmuel went out and taught: An inflamed eye may be treated with eye salve on Shabbos. Why? Because the vessels of the eye are connected to the core of the heart.’”

[1142] **Bereshit Rabbah 89:3** (excerpt): “‘Happy is the man who makes Hashem his trust’ (Psalms 40:5)—this is Joseph. ‘And does not turn to the arrogant’: Because he said to the chief cupbearer, ‘Remember me’ and ‘mention me,’ two years were added to his imprisonment.”

[1143] **Bereshit Rabbah 89:3** (excerpt): “‘Happy is the man who makes Hashem his trust’ (Psalms 40:5)—this is Joseph. ‘And does not turn to the arrogant’: Because he said to the chief cupbearer, ‘Remember me’ and ‘mention me,’ two years were added to his imprisonment.”

Chanukah Ois 21

Rosh Chodesh, Greece, and the Promise of Renewal

The paragraph condemns appropriating Torah's words while continuing to follow idolatry and self-will. Its darkness is the separation of the text from the inward allegiance that the Torah teaches.

Rosh Chodesh, Greece, and the Promise of Renewal

כְּבָר אָמַרְנוּ שֶׁנִּקְרָא "רֹאשׁ חֹדֶשׁ" וְלֹא "הַתְחָלַת חֹדֶשׁ", **We have already stated that it is called Rosh Chodesh ("Head of the Month") and not "the beginning of the month",** מִפְּנֵי שֶׁהַיּוֹם הַזֶּה הוּא הָרֹאשׁ וְהַמָּקוֹר שֶׁל הַחֹדֶשׁ; **— because this day is the head and fountainhead of the entire month;** וְכַאֲשֶׁר אָמַרְנוּ שֶׁיְּצִירַת הַחֹדֶשׁ הַזֶּה בְּאוֹת וְרֹאשׁ חֹדֶשׁ טֵבֵת עַיִ"ן, **— and as we explained that the formation of this month is through the letter Ayin,** לִהְיוֹת נִשְׁפָּע מֵהָאוֹר שֶׁל רֹאשׁ חֹדֶשׁ שֶׁהוּא הַמָּקוֹר חָל בַּחֲנֻכָּה **— and Rosh Chodesh Tevet falls during Chanukah** לְהָאִיר הָעֵינַיִם בִּקְדֻשָּׁה עַל כָּל הַחֹדֶשׁ, **— in order to be channeled from the light of Rosh Chodesh which is the source illuminating the eyes in holiness for the entire month,** דְּתָנַן (עירובין מ״א עמוד א׳): "עַל דֶּרֶךְ שֶׁאָמְרוּ רֵישָׁא גּוּפָא אָזֵיל".[1144] **— following what they said (Eruvin 41a): "The body follows the head".** וְאִיתָא בְּפֵרוּשׁ הָרַאֲבַ"ד עַל סֵפֶר יְצִירָה בְּחֹדֶשׁ טֵבֵת שֶׁמַּזָּלוֹ גְּדִי, **— And it states in the commentary of the Ra'avad on Sefer Yetzirah regarding the month of Tevet whose zodiac sign is Capricorn (the kid / goat),** מֵבִיא הַפָּסוּק: "וְאֵת עִרֹּת גְּדָיֵי הָעִזִּים וּשְׂעִירִים יִרְקֹדוּ שָׁם", **— he cites the verse "and satyrs (se'irim) shall dance there",** וְיֵשׁ הִלְבִּישָׁה עַל יָדָיו". **— and the verse: "And the skins of the kids of the goats she put upon his hands".** וְלוֹמַר בָּזֶה עַל דֶּרֶךְ מַה שֶּׁכָּתוּב (שבת ע״ז עמוד ב׳):[1145] **— And one can explain in this following what is stated (Shabbat 77b):** מַאי טַעְמָא עִזֵּי מַסְגָּן בְּרֵישָׁא וְכוּלֵּיהּ? **— "What is the reason that goats walk at the head of the flock, etc.?** כִּבְרִיָּתוֹ שֶׁל עוֹלָם, דִּבְרֵישָׁא חֲשׁוֹכָא וַהֲדַר נְהוֹרָא", **— Like the creation of the world, where initially was darkness and then light",** וּפֵרֵשׁ רַבִּי שְׁלֹמֹה יִצְחָקִי: "סְתָם עִזִּים שְׁחוֹרוֹת", **— and Rashi explained: "Ordinarily goats are black",** וְהוּא עַל דֶּרֶךְ מַה שֶּׁנֶּאֱמַר: "חָשַׁךְ מִשְּׁחוֹר תָּאֳרָם". **— and this matches Scripture: "Their visage is darker than blackness".**

Torah must reach the heart rather than serve an independent desire

וְיָוָן נִמְשַׁל לְשָׂעִיר בְּדָנִיֵּאל דִּכְתִיב: "וְהַצָּפִיר הַשָּׂעִיר מֶלֶךְ יָוָן",[1146] **— And Greece is likened to a goat (sa'ir) in Daniel, as written: "And the rough goat is the king of Greece",** וְהֵמָּה הַקְּלִפָּה שֶׁל חֹשֶׁךְ, כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב (בְּבְרֵאשִׁית רַבָּה): "וְחֹשֶׁךְ'"[1147] **— and they embody the kelipah of darkness, –** זֶה יָוָן שֶׁהֶחְשִׁיכוּ עֵינֵיהֶם שֶׁל יִשְׂרָאֵל".[1148] **— as written (in Bereishit Rabbah): "'And darkness' — this is Greece who darkened the eyes of Israel".** וְאִיתָא בְּמְגִלַּת תַּעֲנִית: "בִּשְׁמוֹנָה בְּטֵבֵת נִכְתְּבָה הַתּוֹרָה יְוָנִית וְהַחֹשֶׁךְ בָּא לָעוֹלָם שְׁלֹשָׁה יָמִים", **— And it states in Megillat Ta'anit: "On the eighth of Tevet the Torah was translated into Greek, and darkness came upon the world for three days",** וְהַיְנוּ בְּחִינַת הַחֻשְּׁכוּת שֶׁל חָכְמַת יְוָנִית, **— meaning the darkness of Greek intellectual philosophy,**

[1144] **Eruvin 41a:6**: "It was taught: After Rabban Gamliel's death, Rabbi Yehoshua entered to overturn his ruling. Rabbi Yochanan ben Nuri stood up and said, 'I see that the body follows the head. Throughout Rabban Gamliel's lifetime we established the halachah according to him; now you wish to annul his words? Yehoshua, we will not listen to you, because the halachah has already been established according to Rabban Gamliel.' No one raised any further objection to the matter."

[1145] **Shabbat 77b:8**: "Rabbi Zeira found Rav Yehudah standing at the entrance of his father-in-law's house and saw that he was in good spirits: Had he asked him about all the hidden matters in the world, he would have answered him. He asked, 'Why do goats walk first and sheep afterward?' He answered, 'Like the creation of the world: First darkness, then light.' 'Why are these animals covered at the rear and those exposed?' 'Those from which we cover ourselves with wool are themselves covered; those from which we do not cover ourselves are exposed.' 'Why is a camel's tail short?' 'Because it eats thorns, which a long tail could catch.' 'Why is an ox's tail long?' 'Because it dwells among marshes and needs to swish away mosquitoes.'"

[1146] **Likkutei Maamarim, Compositions on the Festivals 7:1**: "Nevertheless, the Torah was written "very clearly" in seventy languages, for from the aspect of writing—which reveals wisdom—it was revealed to everyone in the world. There is wisdom among the nations, enabling them also to attain recognition of God, as the ancient Greek and Arab philosophers attained through their wisdom. Yet through this their heart did not change by even the point of a yod, and the Holy One, blessed be He, did not dwell in their hearts, but only in the hearts of Israel, to whom the Oral Torah was entrusted. This means the revelation, through speech, of the understanding within the heart. Therefore, "Things that are oral you may not say in writing," for the essence of oral teachings is speech, through which what is in the heart becomes revealed. As I heard concerning the Sages' expression everywhere, "According to the heart of Rabbi So-and-so": all their statements followed their heart. Instead of saying "according to his opinion," they said "according to his heart," because it came from the heart."

Likkutei Maamarim makes the distinction behind this criticism explicit. Torah can be written in many languages, and intellectual recognition can be real; the missing element in the criticized philosophy is the transformation and allegiance of the heart. The Oral Torah reveals that lived understanding through a teacher's speech. This guards against reading Chanukah 21 as saying that another language by itself is the defect: the author's stated issue is wisdom separated from the heart's service.

[1147] **Bereshit Rabbah 2:4** (excerpt): "'And darkness'—this is the Greek exile, which darkened Israel's eyes through its decrees, for it said to them: Write upon the horn of an ox that you have no portion in the God of Israel."

[1148] **Bereshit Rabbah 2:4** (excerpt): "'And darkness'—this is the Greek exile, which darkened Israel's eyes through its decrees, for it said to them: Write upon the horn of an ox that you have no portion in the God of Israel."

שֶׁהֵם הֶעְתִּיקוּ הַתּוֹרָה שֶׁבִּכְתָב וְאָמְרוּ "אֲנוּ יִשְׂרָאֵל" (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב מִדְרַשׁ תַּנְחוּמָא כִּי תִשָּׂא ל״ד)[1149], **— whereby they translated the Written Torah claiming "we are Israel" (Tanchuma Ki Tisa 34),** הֲגַם שֶׁעוֹבְדֵי עֲבוֹדָה זָרָה וְעוֹשִׂים כָּל שֶׁחֲפָצִים, הֵם מַלְבִּישִׁים אֶת הַתּוֹרָה לְדִבְרֵי רוּחַ. **— for even while worshipping idols and indulging their desires, they cloaked the Torah in empty philosophical rhetoric.**

Fidelity within darkness engraves the commandment in the heart

וְגַם אָמְרוּ (פֶּרֶק א׳ מִמַּסֶּכֶת סוֹפְרִים)[1150, 1151, 1152] **— And they also said (Chapter 1 of Tractate Sofrim):** "כְּשֶׁהֶעְתִּיקוּ הַתּוֹרָה יְוָנִית וְהָיָה הַיּוֹם קָשֶׁה לְיִשְׂרָאֵל כַּיּוֹם שֶׁנַּעֲשָׂה הָעֵגֶל"; **— "When they translated the Torah into Greek, that day was as difficult for Israel as the day the Golden Calf was made";** וְהַיְנוּ כִּי בְּמַתַּן תּוֹרָה הָיָה נִשְׁפַּע הָאָרָה גְּדוֹלָה, **— meaning because at the Giving of the Torah a supreme illumination was channeled down,** וְאַחַר כָּךְ כְּשֶׁעָשׂוּ הָעֵגֶל וְנִשְׁבְּרוּ הַלֻּחוֹת חָזַר הַחֲשֵׁכוּת; **— and afterward when they made the Calf and the Tablets shattered, darkness returned;** וּכְעִנְיַן הַזֶּה הָיָה בְּשָׁעָה שֶׁעָמְדָה יָוָן "לְהַשְׁכִּיחָם תּוֹרָתֶךָ וּלְהַעֲבִירָם מֵחֻקֵּי רְצוֹנֶךָ", **— and such was the reality when Greece arose "to make them forget Your Torah and violate the statutes of Your will",** וְזֶה הָיָה בְּחֹדֶשׁ טֵבֵת שֶׁמְּזָלוֹ גְּדִי שֶׁהוּא בְּחִינַת הַחֲשֵׁכוּת. **— and this transpired in the month of Tevet**

[1149] **Midrash Tanchuma, Ki Tisa 34:4**: "Write thou these words refers to Scripture, and after the tenor of these words alludes to the Mishnah, which was transmitted orally. Another comment on Write thou these words. They concluded from these words that one is forbidden to glance into the Torah and translate it (during the reading of the Torah in the synagogue), and that whoever is reading the Torah is prohibited from removing his eyes while reading it, since it was given in writing as it is said: And I will write upon the tablets the words (Exod. 34:1). One is prohibited from glancing into the Torah while translating it, for it is said: Write thou these words, but the Mishnah, concerning which it is stated: After the tenor of these words, may be interpreted freely because it was given orally."

[1150] **Tractate Soferim 1:7**: 'It happened that five elders wrote the Torah for King Ptolemy in Greek, and that day was as harsh for Israel as the day on which the Golden Calf was made, because the Torah could not be translated adequately according to all its inner requirement, and for three days darkness descended upon the world.'

[1151] **Sod Yesharim, The First Day of Pesach 15:2**: "Israel had to clarify the difference so that it could be seen explicitly: between Israel's flock, a flock for a commandment, and Egypt's flock, a flock of idolatry. A flock hints at the evening before the morning, as the Gemara asks: "Why do goats walk first and then sheep? Like the world's creation: first darkness and then light, as it says, 'There was evening and there was morning.'" My holy father explained that this is what the Sages meant in saying that Egypt's idolatry was the flock. All their service was directed to the darkness preceding the light; they made that primordial darkness their object of fear, so that all their deeds would remain in darkness and they could receive every flow of good without any service, above their understanding. This is called darkness: proceeding without knowledge. Light is when a person proceeds with knowledge and reckoning. The Zohar says concerning this, "Flock was bound to flock": outwardly, Israel too follow without knowledge or calculation, above their apprehension. They were even called "a hasty people, who put your mouth before your ears," not calculating whether they would have the strength to bear it. Of this it says that Israel were bound in this for four hundred years, until the distinction would be explicitly clarified and separated from its knot. It would become apparent that Israel's entire purpose in following beyond their apprehension was to reach the source at the root of His will, which is a light far higher than the light called light from the human side. Such following without knowledge and reckoning is called a flock of a commandment. Egypt's flock, by contrast, is called idolatry: they do not wish to look at the light. They say that His will intentionally emanated evening before morning in order to conceal the light from human eyes, so that a person would always walk in darkness and not in light, with deeds in darkness. The Zohar speaks of the clarification's not being easily untied because this is truly a very fine distinction; it is not easy to show the difference between flock and flock explicitly to human eyes."

Sod Yesharim explains a crucial distinction within the same goats-before-sheep image. Going beyond present understanding can be faithful movement toward the divine source, or a wish to keep one's deeds permanently outside the light. This illuminates why the darkness of Jacob's garment and Chanukah can become an opening to greater light: the direction of the person's fidelity matters. The source expressly calls that distinction subtle, rather than making every plunge into darkness a holy act.

[1152] **Peri Tzadik, Miketz 14:3**: "In the havdalah within prayer the wording is, "You taught us to perform the statutes of Your will"; similarly, in Al HaNissim we say, "to make them forget Your Torah and turn them away from the statutes of Your will." It seems that this hints at what the Ari's writings suggest through the letters chet, shin, mem in Chashmonai: chodesh, Shabbat, milah—month, Sabbath, circumcision—which they wished to abolish from Israel. These three commandments are called "the statutes of Your will" because they are engraved specifically as a sign within the souls of Israel, through which they are distinguished from the nations. For this reason the Greeks arose to abolish specifically these three commandments from Israel, since Israel's holiness is engraved precisely through them. Concerning the holiness of Shabbat it is written, "Between Me and the children of Israel it is a sign forever." The holiness of circumcision likewise is a sign specifically for Israel, as is known; as Nedarim 31b states, "One who vows, 'I may not benefit from the circumcised,' is forbidden to benefit from uncircumcised Israelites …." The holiness of the month also belongs specifically to Israel, as it says, "This month is for you." Although the calculation of the new moon is known to everyone, this power was given specifically to Israel: they can sanctify the month even before the conjunction or after it. As Rosh Hashanah 25a says, "'You'—even when mistaken; 'you'—even when deliberate …."

Miketz identifies the "statutes" that Rav Tzadok says became engraved in the heart: the sanctification of the month, Shabbat, and circumcision, each constituting an embodied or lived sign of the covenant. It explains why suppressing these commandments attacks more than abstract knowledge. Chanukah 21 supplies the further historical-spiritual step: steadfastness under that suppression establishes the inscription more deeply.

whose sign is Capricorn representing darkness. וְדַוְקָא אָז פָּעֲלוּ בְּנֵס עַל יְדֵי מְסִירַת נַפְשָׁם לְהָאִיר מִתּוֹךְ הַחֹשֶׁךְ בְּיֶתֶר שְׂאֵת, **— And precisely then they wrought a miracle through self-sacrifice to illuminate out of darkness with great vigor,** עַל דֶּרֶךְ מַה שֶּׁכָּתוּב (זֹהַר חֵלֶק ב׳ קפ״ד עַמּוּד א׳): "דְּלֵית נְהוֹרָא אֶלָּא מֵהַהוּא דְּנָפִיק מִגּוֹ חֲשׁוֹכָא",[1153] **— after what is written (Zohar Part II, 184a): "There is no light except that which emerges from within darkness",** וְהַיְנוּ **— which matches the very design of Creation;** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב (שַׁבָּת ק״ל עַמּוּד א׳): "כָּל מִצְוָה שֶׁמָּסְרוּ יִשְׂרָאֵל עַצְמָם עֲלֵיהֶם לְמִיתָה וְכוּלֵּיהּ עֲדַיִן הִיא מְחֻזֶּקֶת בְּיָדָם",[1154] **— and as written (Shabbat 130a): "Every mitzvah for which Israel sacrificed their lives to the point of death remains held firmly in their hand",** וְהַיְנוּ שֶׁפָּעֲלוּ עַל יְדֵי זֶה דַּוְקָא לִהְיוֹת נָחָקָק הַחֲקִי חַיִּים בַּלֵּב. **— meaning they achieved through this specifically that the statutes of life be engraved on the heart.** וְזֶה גַּם כֵּן הָרֶמֶז "וְאֵת עֹרֹת גְּדָיֵי הָעִזִּים הִלְבִּישָׁה עַל יָדָיו", **— And this is also the allusion: "And the skins of the kids of the goats she put upon his hands",** כִּי יַעֲקֹב אָבִינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם קִבֵּל הַבְּרָכוֹת דַּוְקָא עַל יְדֵי הַלְבּוּשׁ שֶׁל גְּדָיֵי הָעִזִּים **— for Jacob our Father received the blessings specifically through the garment of the goat-kids** שֶׁהוּא בְּחִינַת הַשָּׂעִיר, דְּ"לֵית נְהוֹרָא אֶלָּא מֵהַהוּא דְּנָפִיק מִגּוֹ חֲשׁוֹכָא". **— which is the realm of the sa'ir, for "there is no light except that which emerges from within darkness".** וְעִנְיַן הַחֲשֵׁכוּת שֶׁל הַשָּׂעִיר מְרַמֵּז עַל פְּגַם הַבְּרִית, **— And the darkness of the sa'ir (goat) alludes to the blemish of the Covenant,** וְהוּא עִנְיַן הַשָּׂעִיר שֶׁל בֵּית הַכִּסֵּא דְּאִיתָא בַּגְּמָרָא (בְּרָכוֹת ס״ב עַמּוּד א׳):[1155] **— and it is the concept of the demon-goat of the privy found in the Gemara (Berachot 62a):** "וְלִרְבֵּי לֵיהּ גַּדְיָא? שָׂעִיר בְּשָׂעִיר מְחַלַּף", **— "Let him rear a kid? A demon (sa'ir) may be confused with a goat (sa'ir)",** וּפֵרֵשׁ רַבִּי שְׁלֹמֹה יְצְחָקִי: "שֵׁד שֶׁל בֵּית הַכִּסֵּא דּוֹמֶה לְשָׂעִיר, וַעֲלֵיהֶם נֶאֱמַר: 'וּשְׂעִירִים יְרַקְּדוּ שָׁם'", **— and Rashi explained: "The demon of the privy resembles a goat, and of them it is said: 'and satyrs shall dance there'",** וְעַל פִּי פָּשׁוּט מִפְּנֵי שֶׁזֶּה נֶאֱמַר עַל חָרְבַּן בָּבֶל שֶׁיִּהְיֶה מְקוֹם שְׁמָמָה וְטִנּוּפוֹת; **— and plainly because this was said regarding Babylon's ruins becoming desolate and filthy;** אָמְנָם עִקַּר הַסִּבָּה כְּעִנְיַן קִלְפַּת פְּעוֹר שֶׁהוּא בַּצּוֹאָה, **— however the essential reason is akin to the kelipah of Peor worshipped through excrement,** וְהִיא הַקְּלִפָּה שֶׁל תַּאֲוַת זְנוּת בְּשִׁטִּים, **— which is the kelipah of sexual immorality at Shittim,** מִפְּנֵי שֶׁהַיֵּצֶר הָרָע בָּזֶה נִקְרָא "מְנֻוָּל", **— because the Evil Inclination in this realm is called "repulsive",** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמַרְנוּ עַל פִּי מַה שֶּׁכָּתוּב (שַׁבָּת קנ״ב עַמּוּד א׳): "אִשָּׁה חֲמַת מָלֵא צוֹאָה וְכוּלֵּיהּ",[1156] וְעַל כֵּן נִקְרָא "שָׂעִיר". **— as we explained from: "A woman is a vessel full of filth, etc." (Shabbat 152a), and therefore it is called sa'ir.**

וְאִיתָא בַּגְּמָרָא (קִדּוּשִׁין ע״ב עַמּוּד א׳): "הֶרְאַנִי יִשְׁמְעֵאלִים דּוֹמִין לִשְׂעִירִים שֶׁל בֵּית הַכִּסֵּא",[1157] **— And it states in the Gemara (Kiddushin 72a): "He showed me Ishmaelites resembling the demons (se'irim) of the privy",** וּפֵרֵשׁ רַבִּי שְׁלֹמֹה יְצְחָקִי: "מְלֻבָּשִׁים שְׁחוֹרִים וְכוּלֵּיהּ", **— and Rashi explained: "Dressed in black, etc.",** וְהוּא גַּם כֵּן לַמְכֻוָּן זֶה, כִּי יִשְׁמָעֵאל הוּא הַקְּלִפָּה שֶׁל זְנוּת כַּיָּדוּעַ, **— and it points to this exact concept, for Ishmael is the kelipah of licentiousness, as is known,** וְזֶה נִקְרָא שָׁחֹר וּמְכֹעָר בַּתּוֹרָה הַקְּדוֹשָׁה, **— and this is termed black and ugly in the Holy Torah,** הֶפֶךְ "יְפֵה תֹאַר" שֶׁמְּצוּרָה מִי שֶׁנִּפְגָּד בָּזֶה וְיֵשׁ לוֹ גּוּף נָקִי וּמְהֻדָּר. **— the opposite of "fair of form" which denotes one fenced from lust who possesses a clean, adorned body.** וּכְמוֹ כֵן בְּנֵי קֵדָר הֵמָּה שְׁחוֹרִים מִפְּנֵי שֶׁהֵם מִקְּלִפָּה שֶׁל יִשְׁמָעֵאל, **— And likewise the sons of Kedar are black because they issue from Ishmael's kelipah,**

[1153] **Zohar, Tetzaveh 10:86**: "Besides, the words of the Torah can best sink into the soul there in the desert, for there is no light except that which issues from darkness, for when that "other side" is subdued the Holy One is exalted in glory. In fact, there can be no true worship except it issue forth from darkness, and no true good except it proceed from evil. And when a man enters upon an evil way and then forsakes it the Holy One is exalted in glory. Hence the perfection of all things is attained when good and evil are first of all commingled, and then become all good, for there is no good so perfect as that which issues out of evil. The divine Glory is extolled and extended thereby, and therein lies the essence of perfect worship."

[1154] **Shabbat 130a:14**: "It was taught: Rabbi Shimon ben Elazar says: Every mitzvah for which Israel gave their lives during a royal decree of persecution—such as rejecting idolatry and performing circumcision—remains firmly held by them. Every mitzvah for which Israel did not give their lives during a royal decree of persecution—such as tefillin—remains weakly held by them."

[1155] **Berakhot 62a**: "Abaye's mother reared a lamb for him to enter the privy with him. Why not rear a goat for him? A goat could be confused with the goat-shaped demon."

[1156] **Shabbat 152a:12**: "Rav Kahana was reading Scripture before Rav. When Rav reached this verse, he sighed deeply. Rav Kahana said: We can infer from this that Rav's sexual desire has ceased. Rav Kahana said: What is meant by 'For He spoke and it came into being'? This refers to a woman. 'He commanded and it stood' refers to children. It was taught: A woman is a skin-bottle full of excrement, with her opening full of blood, yet everyone runs after her."

[1157] **Kiddushin 72a:10**: "Rabbi said to Levi: "Show me Persians." He said to him: "They resemble the troops of the house of David." "Show me the Chabbarin." "They resemble destructive angels." "Show me Ishmaelites." "They resemble the demons of the privy." "Show me the Torah scholars of Babylonia." "They resemble ministering angels.""

Distress over failure must not turn into despair of repair

וּכְמוֹ שֶׁשָּׁמַעְתִּי מֵרַבֵּנוּ הַקָּדוֹשׁ זְכַר צַדִּיק וְקָדוֹשׁ לִבְרָכָה לְחַיֵּי הָעוֹלָם הַבָּא[1158]: **— and as I heard from our holy master, memory of the holy righteous be blessed:** דְּפָסוּק "הֲלוֹא כִבְנֵי כֻשִׁיִּים אַתֶּם לִי" מְרַמֵּז עַל בְּנֵי הַנְּעוּרִים **— that the verse "Are you not as the children of the Ethiopians (kushiyim) unto Me" alludes to the youth** שֶׁנִּדְוֶה לִבָּם עַל שֶׁהֻטְמָּה מְשֻׁקָּעִים בְּזוֹ הַתַּאֲוָה, **— whose hearts ache over being immersed in this lust,** וְלָכֵן נִקְרְאוּ "בְּנֵי כֻשִׁיִּים"; **— and therefore they are termed "children of Ethiopians / darkened ones";** וּמְנַחֵם אוֹתָם בָּזֶה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר אַחַר כָּךְ: "כִּי הִנֵּה אָנֹכִי מְצַוֶּה וְגוֹמֵר וְלֹא יִפּוֹל צְרוֹר אָרֶץ", **— and He comforts them with what is written directly after: "For behold I will command, etc., and not the least pebble shall fall upon the earth",** שֶׁהַכֹּל יִהְיֶה נִתְקָן בְּעֵזֶר הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ.[1159] **— revealing that the Blessed Name "devises means that His banished be not expelled", so all will be repaired with God's help.** וְעַל זֶה אָמְרוּ (בְּרָכוֹת שָׁם): "אֵין קוֹרִין צָנוּעַ אֶלָּא לְמִי שֶׁצָּנוּעַ בְּבֵית הַכִּסֵּא",[1160] **— And to this allusion they stated (Berachot ibid.): "None is termed modest except one who is modest in the privy",** כִּי שֵׁם צָנִיעוּת הוּנַח עַל כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב (כְּתֻבּוֹת ב' ע"ב) הַנִּגְדָּר מִתַּאֲוֹת, **— for the title of modesty applies to one who fences himself from lust, as written (Ketubot 2b): "on account of the modest women and the promiscuous",**[1161] **— and this is manifest specifically in the privy where this kelipah resides as mentioned.** וְזֶה דָּוְקָא בְּבֵית הַכִּסֵּא שֶׁשָּׁם מוֹשַׁב קְלִפָּה זוֹ כַּנִּזְכָּר לְעֵיל.

[1158] **Sod Yesharim, Hoshana Rabba 4:4**: “The commandment of beating the willow is a simple physical act without a blessing, as the Gemara says, “He beat it, he beat it, and did not bless.” Nor is it written in the Torah; rather, as the Gemara says, it is “a custom of the prophets.” In their great generosity toward Israel, the prophets trained Israel in a simple physical action, to accustom the person’s material body to act continually according to His will even without conscious awareness. Through this habituation the serpent’s cry is aroused: even the actions for which the person imagined repentance was, Heaven forbid, withheld are repaired. A person can do such an act without a blessing—which hints at being without light and awareness, since mind and intellect feel no taste in it—simply because he wishes to train the material body always to do His will, even without his awareness. Even where he does not understand the purpose of His will at all, his body will still be drawn after it. From this grows a repair for all the actions he formerly did without awareness and for which he thought repentance was, Heaven forbid, withheld. Through beating the willow, God illuminates for the person that the action and its appearance, which were formerly concealed, had even at the time proceeded from the depth of His will and stood face to face before Him. God shows this through the commandment of beating the willow, so that no banished one will be banished from Him.”

Sod Yesharim gives the same promise of no one being cast away a concrete mode of response to despair: training the body in a commanded practice even when the intellect does not perceive its meaning. Its particular discussion concerns acts done without awareness and the willow custom; it does not supply a blanket explanation for every transgression. It nevertheless illuminates why a person’s inability to imagine a repair is not proof that repair is unavailable, and places present service before the later disclosure.

[1159] **Peri Tzadik, Kedoshim 12:1**: “Concerning Israel, however, it is written, “Do not look upon me because I am dark, because the sun has scorched me.” For in truth all Israel are called righteous, as it is said, “Your people are all righteous.” Their darkened appearance comes only from “the leaven in the dough,” as stated in Berakhot 17a; through the cleansing of repentance, their beauty is revealed. This is why it says afterward: “I will shake the house of Israel among all the nations, as one shakes a sieve, and not a single pebble will fall to the ground.””

[1160] **Berakhot 62a:15**: “A eulogizer came before Rav Nachman and said, “This man was modest in his ways.” Rav Nachman said to him: “Did you go into the privy with him, so that you know whether he was modest or not? For it was taught: One is called modest only if he is modest in the privy.””

[1161] **Ketubot 2b:14-3a:1**: “Rather, Rava stated his own reasoning: because of scrupulous women and because of unscrupulous women. Because of scrupulous women: if you say that it [the conditional bill of divorce] is not valid, there may be a case in which he was not prevented [from returning] by circumstances beyond his control, but she thinks he was, and she remains unable to remarry. Because of unscrupulous women: if you say that it is not a valid bill of divorce, there may be a case in which he was prevented by circumstances beyond his control, but she says he was not; she goes and remarries, and the bill of divorce proves invalid and her children are mamzerim.”

The purpose of modesty matters more than its outward appearance

וְהוּא גַּם כֵּן רֶמֶז מַה שֶּׁכָּתוּב (בְּרָכוֹת ח׳ עַמּוּד ב׳)[1162, 1163, 1164]: — **And this is also the allusion of what is written (Berachot 8b):** "בִּשְׁלֹשָׁה דְּבָרִים אוֹהֵב אֲנִי אֶת הַפָּרְסִיִּים: הֵן צְנוּעִין בַּאֲכִילָתָן, וּצְנוּעִין בְּבֵית הַכִּסֵּא, וּצְנוּעִין בְּדָבָר אַחֵר", — **"In three things I love the Persians: they are modest in eating, modest in the privy, and modest in marital relations",** מִפְּנֵי שֶׁזֶּהוּ שֹׁרֶשׁ הַצְּנִיעוּת; רַק סָמוּךְ לָזֶה אָמְרוּ: "'אֲנִי צִוִּיתִי לִמְקֻדָּשַׁי — **because this is the root of modesty;** – אֵלּוּ הַפָּרְסִיִּים הַמְּקֻדָּשִׁין וּמְזֻמָּנִין לְגֵיהִנֹּם", — **yet right alongside this they stated: "'I commanded My sanctified ones' — these are the Persians sanctified and prepared for Gehenna",** שֶׁבְּיִשְׂרָאֵל עִנְיָן זֶה הוּא קְדֻשָּׁה, הַגּוֹדֵר עַצְמוֹ בִּצְנִיעוּת, — **for in Israel this matter is pure holiness, guarding oneself in modesty,** וְאֶצְלָם הוּא רַק עַל הַגָּוֶן וּמְקֻדָּשִׁים לְגֵיהִנֹּם (וְנִתְבָּאֵר מַאֲמָר י״ד).[1165] — **whereas with them it is merely an external facade and they are prepared for Gehenna (elaborated in discourse 14).**

מִפְּנֵי שֶׁהֵם רָצוּ לְהַכְנִיס — **And behold Greece is termed sa'ir and "darkness",** וְהִנֵּה יָוָן נִקְרָא "שָׂעִיר" וְ"חֹשֶׁךְ", הַקְלִפָּה שֶׁלָּהֶם בְּיִשְׂרָאֵל, — **because they plotted to introduce their defiled kelipah into Israel,** שֶׁאָז הָיְתָה הַגְּזֵרָה "תִּבָּעֵל לַסָּפָר תְּחִלָּה", — **as then was the decree "she shall be intimacy-subjected to the commander first",** וְהַיְנוּ שֶׁרָצוּ לְהַטִּיל הַזּוהֲמָא שֶׁלָּהֶם מְשֻׁקָּעִים בְּזוּהֲמַת הַנָּחָשׁ, וְרָצוּ לְהַטִּיל בְּנַפְשׁוֹת יִשְׂרָאֵל. — **meaning they sought to inject their defilement — being immersed in the serpent's filth — into the holy souls of Israel.** וְדַוְקָא עַל יְדֵי חֶשְׁכוּת זֶה נַעֲשָׂה הַנֵּס, בְּחִינַת "נְהוֹרָא דְּנָפֵיק מִגּוֹ חֲשׁוֹכָא", — **And specifically through this darkness was wrought the miracle, the "light that emerges from within darkness",** לְהָאִיר עֵינֵיהֶם וּלְזַכֵּךְ נַפְשׁוֹת יִשְׂרָאֵל עַל יְדֵי נֵרוֹת שֶׁל חֲנֻכָּה. — **to enlighten their eyes and purify the souls of Israel through the Chanukah lights.** וּכְמוֹ כֵן בְּכָל שָׁנָה וְשָׁנָה בְּחֹדֶשׁ טֵבֵת שֶׁמַּזָּלוֹ גְּדִי — **And likewise in every year in the month of Tevet whose sign is Capricorn (the kid),** הוּא מוּכָן לְחֶשְׁכוּת הַזֶּה כְּרֶמֶז "וּשְׂעִירִים יְרַקְּדוּ שָׁם" כַּנִּזְכָּר לְעֵיל, — **it is predisposed to this darkness as hinted in "and satyrs shall dance there",** וְדַוְקָא בַּחֶשְׁכוּת הַזֶּה הוּא הַזְּמַן הַמְסֻגָּל לְתִקּוּן וּבֵרוּר הַקְדֻשָּׁה — **and specifically in this darkness is the auspicious season for the rectification of holiness,** עַל יְדֵי הוֹפָעַת הָאָרַת

[1162] **Berakhot 8b:15-16**: "It was taught: Rabban Gamliel said: For three things I love the Persians: They are modest in their eating, modest in the privy, and modest in another matter, meaning sexual relations. 'I have commanded My consecrated ones.' Rav Yosef taught: These are the Persians, who are consecrated and destined for Gehinnom."

[1163] **Tzidkat HaTzadik 256:1**: "This is why the Second Temple was built through the kings of Persia. As is written in Berakhot 8b in praise of the Persians, "They are modest …": this was their holy spark, the quality of modesty. But the Gemara immediately brings the statement, "These are the Persians consecrated for Gehinnom," for it is forbidden to recount the praise of idolaters, as stated in Avodah Zarah 20a. In truth, their own excellence is what brings them to Gehinnom, because their modesty is for the purpose of satisfying their desire all the more, and also because of the evil eye and begrudging disposition they possessed, as explained above. Similarly, concerning Ahasuerus—whose royal power is greater because it encompasses the entire nation—the Sages say, "From the disgrace of that wicked man you learn his praise …," also concerning modesty. But this is truly his disgrace, as above, since his intention is wholly disgraceful. Nevertheless, for Israel it is good. Esther merited it, as the Sages said, "In reward for the modesty that she possessed …." She absorbed the good quality of modesty, "Walk modestly with your God," which likewise means remaining concealed rather than revealed."

Tzidkat HaTzadik states the hidden purpose that the Chanukah paragraph leaves compressed: concealment can be used to intensify desire, or to walk modestly with God. It also explains how Esther can receive and redirect the positive capacity itself. The same outward restraint therefore needs to be assessed by its inward aim; the comparison does not reduce modesty to clothing or manners alone.

[1164] **Sod Yesharim, Purim 12:4**: "Afterward, however, God showed them that all the proper conduct found among the idolaters is only an outward appearance; in its depth there is no good, but only evil. The Sages hinted at this in placing these two teachings side by side in Berakhot 8b: "Rabban Gamliel said, 'In three matters I love the Persians …,'" and "'I have commanded My consecrated ones'—Rav Yosef taught: these are the Persians consecrated and prepared for Gehinnom." What does the latter teaching have to do with the preceding one? Their juxtaposition indicates that a good quality found among the idolaters, such as proper conduct, is good only in its outward appearance, while inwardly they are evil all day. In the soul of Israel, however, when one sees a good quality, one should know that this good is present in depth, from the root. As Scripture says, "Because in him something good toward the Lord, God of Israel, has been found in the house of Jeroboam." It says "toward the Lord, God of Israel" to indicate that the teaching does not concern him alone, but the whole community: the good in him comes from the root, in depth. Among idolaters, however, it is all only in appearance. The entire purpose of Israel's enduring exile among them is to bring even the good appearance found in them into holiness. As the Sages say, "Had the Torah not been given, we would learn modesty from the cat, avoidance of theft from the ant, sexual fidelity from the dove, and proper conduct from the rooster." So too the purpose of exile is for Israel to take in the good sometimes found among them, which for them is only an appearance, and make it wholly good, acquiring it completely, even from the root."

Sod Yesharim reads the identical Talmudic juxtaposition as a question about the root of apparently good behavior. Its additional point is active appropriation and transformation: a useful outward capacity can be brought into the service of holiness. This illuminates Rav Tzadok's distinction between external form and inward restraint, while keeping the source's particular theological account and its strong claims explicitly within the quotation.

[1165] **Berakhot 8b:15-16**: "It was taught: Rabban Gamliel said: For three things I love the Persians: They are modest in their eating, modest in the privy, and modest in another matter, meaning sexual relations. 'I have commanded My consecrated ones.' Rav Yosef taught: These are the Persians, who are consecrated and destined for Gehinnom."

קְדֻשַּׁת נֵרוֹת חֲנֻכָּה שֶׁמִּתְנוֹצֵץ בְּרֹאשׁ חֹדֶשׁ, **— through the radiant holiness of the Chanukah lights sparkling on Rosh Chodesh,** דְּ"לֵית נְהוֹרָא אֶלָּא הַהוּא דְּנָפִיק מִגּוֹ חֲשׁוֹכָא". **— for "there is no light except that which emerges from within darkness".**

The garment's apparent darkness can disclose an inward fragrance

וְזֶהוּ רֶמֶז הַשֵּׁנִי שֶׁכָּתַב הָרַאֲבַ"ד: "וְאֶת עֹרֹת גְּדְיֵי הָעִזִּים הִלְבִּישָׁה עַל יָדָיו", [1166, 1167] **— And this is the second allusion cited by the Ra'avad: "And the skins of the kids of the goats she put upon his hands",** שֶׁעַל יְדֵי הַלְּבוּשׁ שֶׁל הַשָּׂעִיר דַּוְקָא זוֹכִין לְקַבֵּל הַבְּרָכוֹת וְשֶׁפַע הַקְּדֻשָּׁה, **— that specifically through the garment of the goat (sa'ir) do we merit receiving blessings and holy abundance,** וּכְמַה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר שָׁם: "וַיָּרַח אֶת רֵיחַ בְּגָדָיו", **— as Scripture states there: "And he smelled the fragrance of his garments (begadav)",** וְאָמְרוּ (סַנְהֶדְרִין ל״ז עַמּוּד א׳): "אַל תִּקְרֵי 'בְּגָדָיו' אֶלָּא 'בּוֹגְדָיו'", [1168] **— which they expounded (Sanhedrin 37a): "Do not read 'his garments' but 'his traitors' (bogdav)",** וְהֵינוּ רֵיחַ רַע שֶׁל שֶׁטַף שֶׁל עִזִּים; **— which was the foul odor of washed goatskins;** וְעַל יְדֵי זֶה זוֹכִין: עַל יְדֵי שֶׁמִּתְגַּבְּרִין וּמְזַכְּכִין עַצְמָם בְּפְנִימִיּוּת, **— and through this they merit: "and he blessed him",** "וַיְבָרֲכֵהוּ", **— matching Creation itself, where first was darkness and then light.** כִּבְרִיָּתוֹ שֶׁל עוֹלָם, דִּבְרֵישָׁא חֲשׁוֹכָא וְהַדַּר נְהוֹרָא. וְאִיתָא (סוֹטָה מ״ט עַמּוּד א׳): "טָהֳרָה בִּטְּלָה טַעַם וָרֵיחַ מוֹרְחִינָא רֵיחָא דְּחִינּוּנִיתָא; אָמַר וּמְכֻנָּן שֶׁל וְכוּלֵּיהּ, [1169] **— And it states (Sotah 49a): "Purity cancelled taste and scent, etc.,** לוֹ: בְּנִי, טָהֳרָה יֶשׁ בְּךָ". **— I smell the scent of youth; he said to him: My son, purity is in you."**

הַטָּהֳרָה הוּא מְטַמְּאָה הַיּוֹצֵאת מִגּוּפוֹ, **— And the true meaning of purity is from defilement issuing from the body,** כִּי עַל יְדֵי טָהֳרַת קְדֻשַּׁת הַבְּרִית זוֹכִין לִבְחִינַת רֵיחַ, **— for through the purity of the holy Covenant one merits the sense of fragrance,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב (עֵירוּבִין כ״א עַמּוּד ב׳): "'הַדּוּדָאִים נָתְנוּ רֵיחַ'". [1170] **— and as written (Eruvin 21b): –** אֵלּוּ בַּחוּרֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל שֶׁלֹּא טָעֲמוּ טַעַם חֵטְא", **— "'The mandrakes give forth a fragrance' — these are the youths of Israel who have not tasted the taste of sin",** וְעַל זֶה נֶאֱמַר לְשׁוֹן "בַּחוּרֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל", **— and on this it specified "youths of Israel",** שֶׁאָז הוּא הָעֵת לִהְיוֹת נִשְׁמָר מֵהַחֲטֹאת נְעוּרִים. **— for that is the prime season to be guarded from the sins of youth.**

[1166] **Kometz HaMinchah 2:69:1**: "The explanation is as the Sages say in Yoma 26a: fragrance belongs to Levi, as it says, "They shall place incense in Your nostrils." It is known that the tribe of Levi are masters of Torah, as it says, "They shall teach Your judgments to Jacob," and "You shall come to the priests, the Levites, and the judge." Torah has a fragrance, in the Sages' apt expression, "the fragrance of Torah." Fragrance acts from a distance, and so does Torah—even at a time when one is not occupied in it, as stated in Sotah 21b. A good fragrance also benefits the neighbors, as illustrated by the comparison of naphtha and balsam. This is Israel's excellence: "When Samaria was cursed, its neighbors were blessed; when Babylonia was cursed, its neighbors were cursed …," as stated in the second chapter of Eruvin. This is like "Woe to the wicked and woe to his neighbor" at the end of Sukkah. Israel's essential quality is a good fragrance. As the Sages say concerning "My nard gave its fragrance," even with reference to the calf, this was not false. This is also why they expounded "the fragrance of his garments" as "his traitors": even their wicked one has a good fragrance. For Israel and Torah are one; just as Torah has the excellence of fragrance, so does Israel."

Kometz explains why fragrance is an apt sign of holiness that exceeds immediate bodily enjoyment: it acts at a distance and can benefit another person, as Torah continues to affect life beyond the moment of study. Its reading of "his traitors" therefore adds the relation between the soul's root and Torah to Rav Tzadok's fragrance of inward purification. It does not replace the origin's demand for restraint with an outwardly pleasant smell.

[1167] **Mei HaShiloach, Volume I, Genesis, Toldot 9**: "See, the fragrance of my son is like the fragrance of a field …." A field hints at an expansion in desires. Esau is therefore called "a man of the field," because he expanded into all kinds of evil longings and desires. Jacob our father, however, had an expansion in holiness. This is "like the fragrance of a field that the Lord has blessed"—the field of holy apples."

Mei HaShiloach specifies what distinguishes the blessed field from Esau's field: both involve an expansion of desire, but Jacob's expansion belongs to holiness. This illuminates why the outward goat garment does not determine the blessing in Chanukah 21; the inward direction of the life expressed through it matters. The brief target is a complete teaching, including its contrast and conclusion.

[1168] **Sanhedrin 37a:7**: "Reish Lakish said: It is learned from here: 'Your temples are like a slice of pomegranate.' Even the empty ones among you are full of mitzvos like a pomegranate is full of seeds. Rabbi Zeira said: It is learned from here: 'He smelled the fragrance of his garments.' Do not read begadav, 'his garments,' but bogedav, 'his traitors.'"

[1169] **Sotah 49a:10**: "Rav Huna found a strongly fragrant chinunita date, took it, and wrapped it in his cloth. His son Rabbah came and said, 'I smell the fragrance of chinunita.' Rav Huna told him, 'My son, there is purity in you,' and gave it to him. Meanwhile Rabbah's son Abba arrived, and Rabbah took the date and gave it to him. Rav Huna said, 'My son, you have gladdened my heart and set my teeth on edge.' This is what people say: A father's compassion is for his children; his children's compassion is for the children they themselves have."

[1170] **Eruvin 21b**: 'Rava interpreted the verse cited above homiletically as follows: What is the meaning of that which is written: "The mandrakes duda'im yield a fragrance, and at our doors are all manner of choice fruits, new and old, which I have laid up for you, O my beloved" (Song of Songs 7:14)? "The mandrakes duda'im yield a fragrance," these are the young men of Israel who have never tasted the taste of sin.'

The promise of fragrance leaves room for real repentance

וְאָמְרוּ שָׁם עַל הַפָּסוּק: "'וְהִנֵּה שְׁנֵי דּוּדָאֵי תְאֵנִים וְגוֹמֵר': תְּאֵנִים הַטּוֹבוֹת[1171, 1172] — **And they stated there on the verse: "'And behold two baskets of figs, etc.': –** אֵלּוּ צַדִּיקִים גְּמוּרִים; תְּאֵנִים רָעוֹת — **the good figs — these are the completely righteous; –** אֵלּוּ רְשָׁעִים גְּמוּרִים; וְשָׁמָא תֹּאמַר: — **the bad figs — these are the completely wicked;** אָבַד סִבְרָם וּבָטַל סְכוּיָם? תַּלְמוּד לוֹמַר: 'הַדּוּדָאִים נָתְנוּ רֵיחַ' — **and lest you say: has their hope perished and their prospect ceased? –** אֵלּוּ וָאֵלּוּ עֲתִידִין שֶׁיִּתְּנוּ רֵיחַ". — **Scripture teaches: 'The mandrakes give forth a fragrance' — both these and those are destined to give forth a fragrance".** וְהֵיכָן: הַתְּאֵנִים הַטּוֹבוֹת הוּא הַנִּשְׁמָר מִנְּעוּרָיו בְּקְדֻשָּׁה זוֹ, — **And that means: the good figs represent one who was guarded from his youth in this holiness,** וְהֵיכָן "בַּחוּרֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל שֶׁלֹּא טָעֲמוּ וְכוּ'"; — **which is "the youths of Israel who did not taste sin";** וְהַתְּאֵנִים הָרָעוֹת הֵיכָן גַּם מִי שֶׁפָּגַם וְקִלְקֵל בָּזֶה, — **and the bad figs denote one who stumbled and blemished in this,** יֵשׁ יְכֹלֶת בְּיָדוֹ לְתַקֵּן אִם יִהְיֶה רַק נִשְׁמָר וְיִגְדֹּר עַצְמוֹ מִכָּאן וּלְהַבָּא. — **yet he possesses the ability to rectify if he will only guard and fence himself from now onward.** וְעַל זֶה מְכֻנִּים בְּשֵׁם "תְּאֵנִים" עַל פִּי מַה שֶּׁכָּתוּב (בְּרָכוֹת מ' עַמּוּד א')[1173]: "אִילָן שֶׁאָכַל מִמֶּנּוּ אָדָם הָרִאשׁוֹן — **And for this reason they are termed "figs" based on what is stated (Berachot 40a): –** תְּאֵנָה הָיְתָה", — **"The tree from which Adam ate was a fig",** וְהֵיכָן מְפֻרָשׁ שֶׁנִּמְצָא בָּהֶם מְתִיקוּת — **because intense sweetness is found in them for food,** וְזֶהוּ עֶטְיוֹ שֶׁל נָחָשׁ שֶׁהִכְנִיס בָּאָדָם — **which represents the counsel of the serpent injected into man** לְהַרְגִּישׁ תַּאֲוַת וְהֶנְאַת הַגּוּף בַּתַּאֲוֹת הַמְּתוּקִים לַגּוּף לְמַרְאֵה עֵינָיו, — **to pursue bodily pleasure in bodily sweetness alluring to his eyes,** וְזֶה בְּחִינַת עֵץ הַדַּעַת טוֹב וָרָע; — **and this is the Tree of Knowledge of Good and Evil;** כִּי הַנִּשְׁמָר בָּזֶה בְּקְדֻשָּׁה הוּא בִּבְחִינַת הַטּוֹב, וְהַהֶפֶךְ בַּהֶפֶךְ. — **for one guarded in holiness in this is in the dimension of Good, and the reverse in the reverse.** אָמְנָם גַּם מִי שֶׁנִּלְכַּד חַס וְשָׁלוֹם בַּהֵפֶךְ, — **However, even one trapped Heaven forbid in the reverse** יִהְיֶה נִתְקָן בִּתְשׁוּבָה עַד שֶׁגַּם הוּא יִתֵּן רֵיחַ טוֹב, — **will be rectified through repentance until he too emits sweet fragrance,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב: "וַיָּרַח אֶת רֵיחַ בִּגְדָיו" מְשָׁטָן שֶׁל עִזִּים כַּנִּזְכָּר לְעֵיל. — **as written: "and he smelled the fragrance of his traitors" from the foul odor of goatskins as mentioned.**

[1171] **Resisei Layla 33:1**: "The distinction is within the lower levels themselves—that is, in the revealed action, speech, and thought. It is not present now, however, but is perceived by the sense of smell directed toward the future: these Israel worship idols only temporarily and can turn about in a brief moment, whereas those the nations will not turn about, for that is their root. This is "like the fragrance of a field," the field of holy apples. The sense of smell perceives from a distance, while the thing has not yet entered the palate."

Resisei Layla explains the temporal meaning of fragrance: it can register a change that is still distant and has not yet become the present "taste" of conduct. That directly clarifies the promise that the bad figs will give fragrance. The source's contrast between Israel and the nations remains attributed and explicit; the relevant mechanism is its distinction between present behavior and a capacity for future turning.

[1172] **Tiferet Yosef, Tetzaveh 3**: "My holy father explained this matter: the eleven ingredients of incense are not human food and are very far from the human form. This is what Scripture says: "The Lord showed me two baskets of figs … one basket of very good figs, like early figs, and one basket of very bad figs, which could not be eaten because they were so bad." The Talmud says: "The good figs are the completely righteous; the bad figs are the completely wicked. You might say their hope is lost and their prospect ended. Scripture therefore says, 'The mandrakes have given fragrance': both these and those will in the future give fragrance." In this world there is the tree of uncertainty, with good mixed into evil and evil into good. If evil were separated from good, the good would be nullified in its independent existence, and the evil would be entirely nullified. For the Holy One, blessed be He, created nothing in vain. They have continued existence because good is mixed into evil and evil into good. This is "You might say their hope is lost and their prospect ended; Scripture therefore says, 'The mandrakes have given fragrance.'" You might imagine that they are entirely evil; of this it says that both will give fragrance in the future, because they also contain good. In the future, after clarification, evil will be separate and good will be separate."

Tiferet Yosef explains why the bad figs' hope has not been extinguished: the present condition is mixed, and the good within it is not yet fully distinguished. Incense makes the comparison concrete—materials not fit for eating can nevertheless enter a holy service through fragrance. The target's future separation does not cancel the origin's present requirement to repent and guard oneself; it explains why that work has something real to recover.

[1173] **Berakhot 40a:14**: "'Over the fruits of the ground,' and so forth: Is this not obvious? Rav Nachman bar Yitzchak said: It was needed only according to Rabbi Yehudah, who says that wheat is a kind of tree. For it was taught: What was the tree from which Adam the first man ate? Rabbi Meir says: It was a vine, because nothing brings lamentation upon a person as wine does, as it says, 'He drank of the wine and became drunk.' Rabbi Nechemyah says: It was a fig tree, because through the very thing by which they were corrupted they found their remedy, as it says, 'They sewed fig leaves.' Rabbi Yehudah says: It was wheat, because a child does not know how to call 'Father' and 'Mother' until he tastes grain."

Complete future restoration does not close the path of repair now

וְעִנְיַן אָמְרָם זִכְרוֹנָם לִבְרָכָה: "וְשָׁמָא תֹּאמַר אָבַד סִבְרָם וְכוּלֵי"[1174, 1175] — **And their statement: "Lest you say their hope has perished, etc.",** וַהֲלֹא אֵין לְךָ דָּבָר שֶׁעוֹמֵד בִּפְנֵי הַתְּשׁוּבָה? — **for behold is there anything that withstands repentance?** הוּא הַהַנָּא אָמֵינָא עַל פִּי מַה שֶּׁכָּתוּב בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ (חֵלֶק א׳ ס״ב עַמּוּד א׳ וּבִשְׁאָר מְקוֹמוֹת)[1176] — **This initial assumption was based on what is stated in the Zohar (Part I, 62a and elsewhere)** עַל פְּגָם זֶה שֶׁזֶּה תָּלוּי וְהַיְנוּ מִפְּנֵי שֶׁזֶּה פְּגָם שֶׁתְּשׁוּבָתוֹ קָשָׁה, — **regarding this blemish that its repentance is exceptionally arduous;** רַק כְּשֶׁיִּהְיֶה נִתְבָּרֵר בִּשְׁלֵמוּת הַפְּגָם הָרִאשׁוֹן עֶטְיוֹ שֶׁל נָחָשׁ — **because this is contingent upon the complete eradication of the primordial blemish of the serpent's counsel,** וְיִהְיוּ הַזְּדוֹנוֹת נַעֲשׂוֹת כִּזְכֻיּוֹת, — **wherein intentional sins become merits,** וּמִמֵּילָא יִתְבַּטֵּל הַמִּיתָה שֶׁהֵבִיא הַנָּחָשׁ בָּעוֹלָם; — **and automatically death brought by the serpent into the world will cease;** וּבְרוּר הַזֶּה לֹא יוּכַל לִהְיוֹת בָּעוֹלָם הַזֶּה עַד יְמוֹת הַמָּשִׁיחַ שֶׁנִּזְכֶּה לְחַיֵּי עוֹלָם, — **and this clarification cannot fully manifest in this world until the Messianic era when we merit eternal life,** שֶׁזֶּהוּ אוֹרוֹ שֶׁל מָשִׁיחַ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: "חַיִּים שָׁאַל מִמְּךָ, נָתַתָּה לּוֹ אֹרֶךְ יָמִים עוֹלָם וָעֶד". — **which is the light of Messiah of whom it is said: "He asked life of You, You gave it to him, length of days forever and ever".** וְאָז יִהְיֶה מָשִׁיחַ "מוֹרַח וְדַאֲיִן" (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב סַנְהֶדְרִין צ״ג עַמּוּד ב׳),[1177] — **And then the Messiah will "judge by scent" (Sanhedrin 93b),** שֶׁיִּשְׁלַם בְּחִינַת הֲרֵיחַ טָהֳרָה בִּשְׁלֵמוּת, כְּמַה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר עָלָיו: "וַהֲרִיחוֹ בְּיִרְאַת הַשֵּׁם". וְעַל זֶה אָמְרוּ: "תַּלְמוּד לוֹמַר: 'הַדּוּדָאִים נָתְנוּ רֵיחַ' — **where the sense of pure holy fragrance will be perfected, as stated of him: "And his smelling shall be in the fear of Hashem". –** אֵלּוּ וָאֵלּוּ עֲתִידִין שֶׁיִּתְּנוּ רֵיחַ", — **And on this they said: "Scripture teaches: 'The mandrakes give forth a fragrance' — both these and those are destined to give forth a fragrance",** כִּי גַּם מִי שֶׁפָּגַם בָּזֶה חַס וְשָׁלוֹם, יֵשׁ לְעוֹלָם תִּקָּנָה וְתִקּוּן — **for even one who stumbled in this Heaven forbid, there is always hope and rectification** עַל יְדֵי שֶׁיִּהְיֶה נִשְׁמָר לִפְנוֹת לִבּוֹ וְעֵינָיו מֵהַרְהוּרִים רָעִים, — **through guarding to divert his heart and eyes from evil contemplations,** וְיִכָּנִיס עַצְמוֹ בְּעֵסֶק הַתּוֹרָה תָּמִיד; — **and immersing himself in the study of Torah continually;** וְכִדְאִיתָא בְּהַרַמְבַּ"ם זִכְרוֹנוֹ לִבְרָכָה (סוֹף הִלְכוֹת אִסּוּרֵי בִּיאָה):[1178] — **and as stated in the Rambam of blessed memory (end of the Laws of Forbidden Relations):**

[1174] **Tiferet Yosef, Shavuot 2**: "To a threefold people": this points to the Talmud's statement, "The pollution did not cease from our ancestors until three generations." As the Zohar says, when God created the world He spread a curtain: He placed a separating screen between His light and the creature's apprehension. Without that screen there would have been no place for service, because all creation would have recognized that it was included in complete unity. He therefore placed that screen. Through service, a person must break through the separating partition and see how, through words of Torah, his apprehension becomes united with God's light. As long as a person does not explicitly see this in Torah—that his apprehension has become completely united with His light—he must recognize that he still lacks something and has not served completely. This is what is indicated by "The pollution did not cease from our ancestors until three generations." Although the Talmud says that Abraham our father fulfilled the whole Torah, even eruv tavshilin—which indicates that he already saw how all his particulars became united through Torah in complete unity—it was not yet permanent until three generations. Its remaining permanently among Israel did not occur until three generations. This is "a threefold people."

Tiferet Yosef distinguishes a genuine personal apprehension from a holiness established permanently in the people. Even Abraham's attainment is not described as the final permanence of later generations. That distinction illuminates how Chanukah 21 can affirm real Torah-based repair now while reserving complete and enduring restoration for a further stage. The target discusses the ancestors' three generations, not the Messiah, so their timelines are kept distinct.

[1175] **Tzidkat HaTzadik 97:1**: "Seasoning" sweetens the food: it turns the evil into "very good," in accordance with the Sages' statement, "This is the evil inclination," which is sweetened through words of Torah. In the Zohar on Bereshit and Noach it says that there is no impurity like it. Yet the second chapter of Berakhot says that words of Torah raise a person from impurity to purity. What the Zohar on Noach says—that repentance does not help—is like the saying in Rosh Hashanah: "It is not atoned for through a sacrifice, but it is atoned for through Torah." So it is here as well."

Tzidkat HaTzadik explains how Torah addresses the apparent barrier named in Chanukah 21. Torah is a "seasoning" that can transform the inclination, and a statement excluding one form of atonement need not exclude Torah's particular power. This gives content to the origin's present path of repair while leaving its distinct claim about complete messianic restoration intact.

[1176] **Zohar, Noach 9:60**: "R. Hiya and R. Judah, while once going on their travels, came to some huge mountains, in the ravines of which they found human bones left over from the generation of the Flood. They measured a bone and found to their amazement that it was three hundred paces long. They said: 'This bears out what our colleagues have said, that the men of the time of the Flood did not fear the vengeance of the Holy One, blessed be He, as it is written, "They said unto God, Depart from us, for we desire not the knowledge of thy ways" (Job 21, 14), and that one of the things they did was to stop up with their feet the fountains of the deep, until the waters which bubbled up became too hot for them to endure, so that they finally succumbed and fell to the ground and died.'"

[1177] **Sanhedrin 93b**: 'Rabbi Alexandri says that the term hariḥo teaches that God burdened the Messiah with mitzvot and afflictions like millstones reiḥayim. Rava says that hariḥo teaches that the Messiah will smell demoraḥ and then judge on that basis, sensing who is right, as it is written: "And he shall neither judge after the sight of lemareh his eyes, nor decide after the hearing of his ears; and with righteousness shall he judge the poor, and decide equity for the meek of the earth" (Isaiah 11:3–4).'

[1178] **Mishneh Torah, Forbidden Intercourse 22:21**: "A person should likewise make a practice of keeping away from frivolity, drunkenness, and lustful talk, for these are powerful causes and steps leading to forbidden sexual relations. He

"שֶׁאֵין מַחֲשָׁבַת עֲרָיוֹת מִתְגַּבֶּרֶת אֶלָּא בְּלֵב פָּנוּי מִן הַחָכְמָה". — **"The thought of illicit relations overpowers only a heart vacant of wisdom."** וְעַל יְדֵי עֵסֶק הַתּוֹרָה יִזְכֶּה לְהָרְאָיָה שֶׁבַּקְדֵּשָׁה, — **And through Torah study he will merit holy sight,** כְּמַה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: "וְהָיוּ עֵינֶיךָ רֹאוֹת אֶת מוֹרֶיךָ", — **as Scripture states: "And your eyes shall see your Teacher",** שֶׁהוּא מִן "תּוֹרָה" כְּלִשּׁוֹן "תּוֹרֵנוּ מִדְּרָכָיו וְנֵלְכָה בְּאֹרְחֹתָיו" (ישעיה ב, ג), שֶׁהִיא מוֹרָה אֶת הִתְגַּלּוּת כְּבוֹדוֹ יִתְבָּרַךְ שְׁמוֹ לָאָדָם; — **from the root Torah which instructs and shows (moreh) the revelation of His Blessed Glory to man;** וְעַל יְדֵי זֶה יִזְכֶּה לְרֵיחַ טָהֳרָה, — **and through this he will merit the fragrance of purity,** כְּמַה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: "יִרְאַת ה' טְהוֹרָה עוֹמֶדֶת לָעַד", — **as Scripture states: "The fear of Hashem is pure, enduring forever",** כִּי עֵסֶק הַתּוֹרָה הוּא תַּכְלִית הַתְּשׁוּבָה וְהַתִּקּוּן לַפְּגָם הַנִּזְכָּר לְעֵיל. — **for engaging in Torah is the ultimate repentance and repair for this aforementioned blemish.** וְתֵבַת "יִרְאָה"[1179] הוּא מְרַמֵּז עַל תְּשׁוּבָה, כְּמוֹ שֶׁדָּרְשׁוּ (עֲבוֹדָה זָרָה י"ט עַמּוּד א'): "'אַשְׁרֵי אִישׁ יָרֵא אֶת ה'" — **And the word yirah (awe) points to repentance,** – אַשְׁרֵי מִי שֶׁעוֹשֶׂה תְּשׁוּבָה כְּשֶׁהוּא אִישׁ";[1180] — **as they expounded (Avodah Zarah 19a): "'Happy is the man who fears Hashem' — happy is he who repents while still a virile man";** וְכֵן אָמְרוּ (בְּרָכוֹת י"ז עַמּוּד א'): "תַּכְלִית חָכְמָה תְּשׁוּבָה וְכוּלֵיהּ, שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: 'רֵאשִׁית חָכְמָה יִרְאַת ה'"; — **and so they said (Berachot 17a): "The purpose of wisdom is repentance, etc., as said: 'The beginning of wisdom is the fear of Hashem'";** וְעַל יְדֵי עֵסֶק הַתּוֹרָה יֵשׁ בִּיכֹלֶת תָּמִיד לְהָיוֹת נִתָּקָן הַפְּגָם גַּם בָּעוֹלָם הַזֶּה, — **and through Torah study one possesses always the power to heal the blemish even in this world,** כְּמַה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: "לְכָל בְּשָׂרוֹ מַרְפֵּא" (וְנִתְבָּאַר כַּמָּה פְּעָמִים); — **as Scripture states: "healing to all his flesh" (explained often);** וּכְתִיב: "יִרְאַת ה' טְהוֹרָה עוֹמֶדֶת לָעַד", דְּקָאֵי עַל הַתּוֹרָה כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ (חֵלֶק ג' פ' סוֹף עַמּוּד ב'),[1183] — **and it is written: "The fear of Hashem is pure, enduring forever", which refers to the Torah (Zohar Part III, 80b),** שֶׁעוֹמֶדֶת לָעַד לְהָאָדָם לְטַהֲרוֹ וּלְזַכֵּךְ נַפְשׁוֹ שֶׁיִּזְכֶּה לְרוּחַ טָהֳרָה. — **which stands eternally for a person to cleanse him and purify his soul so that he merits the spirit of purity.**

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should not remain without a wife, because marriage brings greater purity. More effective than all this, the Sages said, is to direct oneself and one's thoughts toward words of Torah and broaden one's understanding through wisdom, for thoughts of forbidden relations gain strength only in a heart empty of wisdom. Concerning wisdom it says, 'A beloved hind and a graceful doe—let her breasts satisfy you at all times; be continually absorbed in her love' (Mishlei 5:19)."

[1179] **Avodah Zarah 19a:3**: "'Happy is the man who fears the Lord': Is it a man who is happy, and not a woman? Rav Amram said in Rav's name: Happy is one who repents while he is still a vigorous man. Rabbi Yehoshua ben Levi said: Happy is one who overcomes his inclination like a man."

[1180] **Avodah Zarah 19a:3**: "'Happy is the man who fears the Lord': Is it a man who is happy, and not a woman? Rav Amram said in Rav's name: Happy is one who repents while he is still a vigorous man. Rabbi Yehoshua ben Levi said: Happy is one who overcomes his inclination like a man."

[1181] **Berakhot 17a:11**: "Rava would often say: The ultimate aim of wisdom is repentance and good deeds. A person must not read Scripture and study Mishnah while treating his father, mother, teacher, or anyone greater than he in wisdom and seniority with contempt. Thus it says, 'The beginning of wisdom is fear of the Lord; sound understanding belongs to all who put them into practice.' It does not merely say 'to those who act,' but 'to those who put them into practice': those who act for the sake of the mitzvos themselves, rather than for some other purpose. Whoever acts for an improper purpose would have been better off never having been created."

[1182] **Proverbs 4:22**: 'They are life to those who find them,Healing for the whole body.'

[1183] **Zohar, Kedoshim 3:12-13**: "Said R. Jose: 'But it says here "the fear of the Lord", and not "the Torah"?' He replied: 'It means the same thing, because the Torah comes from the side of Geburah (Might).' Said R. Jose: 'Rather derive it from here: "The fear of the Lord is the beginning of wisdom" (Ibid. 111, 10). It is written: "The fear of the Lord is pure",' and the Torah is called "holiness", as it is written, "I the Lord am holy", and the Torah is the supernal holy Name. Therefore he who studies it is first purified and then sanctified. We have learnt that the holiness of the Torah surpasses all other sanctifications, and the holiness of the superior recondite wisdom is highest of all.'"

Chanukah Ois 22

Zot Chanukah: The Eighth Day and the Revelation of Truth

The twelve tribal princes express the whole community rising in service. The priestly Chanukah dedication expresses an illumination bestowed from above and brought into that same community.

Zot Chanukah: The Eighth Day and the Revelation of Truth

יוֹם שְׁמִינִי דְּחֲנֻכָּה קוֹרִין "זֹאת חֲנֻכָּה", לְזֹאת חֲנֻכָּה: — **For Zot Chanukah (the eighth day of Chanukah):** **The eighth day of Chanukah is called Zot Chanukah,** מִפְּנֵי שֶׁקּוֹרִין בּוֹ תַּשְׁלוּם חֲנֻכַּת הַנְּשִׂיאִים וּפָרָשַׁת "זֹאת חֲנֻכַּת הַמִּזְבֵּחַ". **— because on it we read the conclusion of the dedication of the Princes and the portion: "This is the dedication of the Altar (Zot Chanukkat HaMizbe'ach)".**

A complete community receives an illumination that begins above

שֶׁהַמִּשְׁכָּן נִגְמַר בְּכ״ה בְּכִסְלֵו וְעָמַד וְאֵיתָא בַּפְּסִיקְתָא (פָּרָשָׁה ו׳):[1184, 1185, 1186] — **And it states in the Pesikta (Parashah 6):** מִקֹּפֶל עַד אֶחָד בְּנִיסָן וְכוּלֵיהּ, — **that the Tabernacle was completed on the 25th of Kislev and stood folded until the 1st of Nisan, etc.;** הִפְסִיד כִּסְלֵו וְכוּלֵיהּ? — **did Kislev lose out, etc.?** מַה שִׁלַּם לוֹ הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא? חֲנֻכַּת — **What did the Holy One repay it? The dedication of the Hasmoneans.** חַשְׁמוֹנַאי. וְהִנֵּה חֲנֻכַּת הַמִּשְׁכָּן הָיָה עַל — **And behold the dedication of the Tabernacle was conducted through the Princes of the Twelve Tribes,** יְדֵי נְשִׂיאֵי שְׁנֵים עָשָׂר שְׁבָטִים, שֶׁהוּא הַשְׁלֵמוּת מִצַּד כְּנֶסֶת יִשְׂרָאֵל מִתַּתָּא לְעֵילָּא, — **which is spiritual wholeness from the side of Knesset Yisrael, from below upward,** דִּשְׁנֵים עָשָׂר שְׁבָטִים הֵמָּה כְּלַל כְּנֶסֶת יִשְׂרָאֵל כְּמוֹ שֶׁפָּתוּב (בָּבָא גְּמִירֵי דְּלָא כָּלֵי שִׁבְטָא".[1187] בַּתְרָא קט״ו עַמּוּד ב׳): "— **for the Twelve Tribes constitute the collective of Knesset Yisrael, as written (Bava Batra 115b): "It is a tradition that a tribe never ceases".** וַחֲנֻכַּת חַשְׁמוֹנָאִים הָיָה מִצַּד אִתְעָרוּתָא דִּלְעֵילָּא, — **While the dedication of the Hasmoneans was from the side of supernal awakening (itaruta de'le'ela),** כִּי כֹּהֲנֵי שְׁלוּחֵי דְּרַחֲמָנָא נִינְהוּ (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב יוֹמָא י״ט עַמּוּד א׳),[1188] — **for the priests are the emissaries of the Merciful One (Yoma 19a),** וְהֵם הוֹפִיעוּ בְּחִינָה זוֹ בְּתוֹךְ כְּלַל יִשְׂרָאֵל לִהְיוֹתָם מַמְלֶכֶת כֹּהֲנִים. — **and they channeled this quality into the collective of Israel to be a kingdom of priests.** וּלְזֶה הָיָה בְּמִסְפַּר כְּנֶגֶד הַשְּׁפָעַת הָאָרָה דִּלְעֵילָּא מִמִּדַּת חָכְמָה שְׁמוֹנַת יָמִים, — **And for this reason it spanned the number of eight days,**

[1184] **Pesikta Rabbati 6:2**: ‘On the twenty-fifth of Kislev the work of the Tabernacle was completed, yet it remained folded and waited for three months until the first of Nisan, when Moses erected it on the day Isaac was born. Kislev therefore felt deprived, and the Holy One, blessed be He, said: ‘It is incumbent upon Me to repay Kislev,’ and He repaid it with the dedication of the Hasmoneans on the twenty-fifth of Kislev.’

[1185] **Sod Yesharim, Rosh Hashanah 39:2**: “Here God shows us the whole order of human service. At the beginning a person must nullify himself completely and surrender everything to God, for the first illumination comes only from God. Of it is said, “Remember Your mercies, Lord, and Your kindnesses, for they are from eternity,” without any awakening from below. Pesach indicates this first illumination, an awakening from above, for the beginning of service is only an awakening from above. As the Zohar says, the female’s desire toward the male occurs only when a spirit enters her and she pours forth waters to receive the upper, male waters. This first illumination is drawn from the fundamental love in which Israel arose in the divine thought. Yet the person must surrender it entirely to God and not derive any independent assurance from it. If he relies on the assurance that he arose in the divine thought, of this it is said, “If a man takes his sister … it is chesed.” As the Midrash says: if you object that Cain married his sister, the Holy One performed a kindness in His world; from then onward, there is no man without a woman, no woman without a man, and neither without the Divine Presence. That is, a person must always continue in service and not rely upon the kindness of having arisen in the divine thought.”

Sod Yesharim explains what an awakening from above accomplishes: it gives the beginning of desire and the capacity to serve. Its express warning against treating that gift as independent assurance illuminates why the priestly illumination in Chanukah 22 is bestowed into Israel’s life and service. The Pesach sequence remains the target’s setting; it is not made into a competing account of when the Tabernacle was dedicated.

[1186] **Resisei Layla 39:1**: “In general, Israel are divided into twelve tribes, each constituting a distinct matter. They are permanently established and cannot be changed, as the Sages say, “We have a tradition that a tribe does not cease.” Each is a complete circuit of its own, like a lunar month in its reception of the sun’s light; these are the twelve permutations of the divine name, as is known. All Israel recognize that God exists, brings everything into existence, and that there is none besides Him, from the beginning of thought—the yod of the name—to the end of action, the final he. Yet there are differences in the manner of this apprehension: one apprehends through wisdom, another through the feeling of the heart, and so forth. These are twelve permutations, whose altered order of letters indicates a different order of apprehension. Each tribe has its particular path and order in receiving His light, constituting a complete circuit: an apprehension of all four levels of the name’s four letters. Only the order differs in each, according to the difference in its reception of the apprehension of His truth.”

Resisei Layla explains why all twelve tribes are needed and why no tribe disappears: each embodies a complete but distinct order of receiving the divine light. This gives content to the “completeness from the congregation of Israel” in Chanukah 22. The community is whole through its differentiated paths, not because every tribe performs an identical inward service.

[1187] **Bava Batra 115b:1**: “How, then, is the inheritance traced? The inheritance is followed back through the family line as far as Reuben, the ancestor of the tribe, until an eligible heir is found. But why not say that it is traced as far back as Yaakov? Abaye answered: We have a tradition that an entire tribe never becomes extinct.”

[1188] **Yoma 19a:13**; **Yoma 19b:1**: “‘They said to him: My master, Kohen Gadol,’ and so forth. Shall we say that this refutes Rav Huna son of Rav Yehoshua? For Rav Huna son of Rav Yehoshua said: These kohanim are agents of the Merciful One. If you say that they are our agents, is there anything that we cannot do but our agents can do? The Mishnah means that they told him: ‘We administer this oath to you according to our understanding and the understanding of the court.’”

עַד יְסוֹד שֶׁהוּא גְּמַר הַמַּעֲשֶׂה. — **corresponding to the outflow of supernal light from the attribute of Chochmah down to Yesod which seals the spiritual act.**

Judah's poverty opens a dimension beyond completed action

וּלְזֶה קוֹרִין בְּיוֹם רִאשׁוֹן שֶׁל חֲנֻכָּה נָשִׂיא יְהוּדָה,[1189, 1190] — **And for this reason we read on the first day of Chanukah the Prince of Judah,** וּבְיוֹם אַחֲרוֹן שְׁלֵמוּת נְשִׂיאֵי בְּנֵי יוֹסֵף: — **and on the final day the completion of the Princes of the sons of Joseph:** כִּי יְהוּדָה וְיוֹסֵף הֵם כְּלַל קְדֻשַּׁת יִשְׂרָאֵל, — **for Judah and Joseph encompass the totality of Israel's holiness,** שֶׁכָּל יִשְׂרָאֵל נִקְרְאוּ עַל שֵׁם יְהוּדָה (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בְּרֵאשִׁית רַבָּה פָּרָשָׁה צ״ח): "יְהוּדִי אֲנָא",[1191] — **for all Jews are named after Judah (Bereishit Rabbah 98): "I am a Jew (Yehudi)",** וְכֵן נִקְרְאוּ עַל שֵׁם יוֹסֵף (כְּמוֹ כְּמַה שֶׁכָּתוּב שָׁם פָּרָשָׁה ע״א) שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: "שְׁאֵרִית יוֹסֵף";[1192] — **and likewise are named after Joseph (ibid. 71) as Scripture states: "The remnant of Joseph";** כִּי בְּחִינַת יוֹסֵף יוֹרֶה עַל שְׁלֵמוּת הַמַּעֲשִׂים, — **for Joseph's aspect indicates the perfection of human deeds,** וּבְחִינַת יְהוּדָה יוֹרֶה עַל שְׁלֵמוּת הַתִּקּוּן לְחַיֵּי עוֹלָם; — **while Judah's aspect indicates the ultimate rectification for eternal life;** וְעַל זֶה רָמְזוּ (סוֹטָה י׳ עַמּוּד ב׳):[1193] — **and to this they alluded (Sotah 10b):** "יוֹסֵף שֶׁקִּדֵּשׁ שֵׁם שָׁמַיִם בַּסֵּתֶר הוֹסִיפוּ לוֹ אוֹת אַחַת מִשְּׁמוֹ שֶׁל הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא וְכוּ׳"; — **"Joseph who sanctified the Name of Heaven in secret, they added to him one letter from the Name of the Holy One the heh in Yehosef;** יְהוּדָה זָכָה וְנִקְרָא כֻּלּוֹ עַל שְׁמוֹ שֶׁל הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא". — **Judah merited and was named entirely after the Name of the Holy One having the letters of Havayah plus dalet."** וְהַיְנוּ: יוֹסֵף שֶׁהוּא מֶרְכָּבָה לְמִדַּת יְסוֹד הַמּוֹרָה עַל שְׁלֵמוּת הַמַּעֲשִׂים, — **And that means: Joseph who is the chariot for Yesod indicating the perfection of deeds,** כְּשֶׁנּוֹסַף לוֹ ה״א נִמְצָא בּוֹ שָׁלֹשׁ אוֹתִיּוֹת מִשֵּׁם יהו״ה בָּרוּךְ הוּא — **when a heh was added to him, there are contained within him three letters of the Name Havayah** (י-ה-ו) הַמְּרַמְּזִים עַל שְׁלֵמוּת מֵחָכְמָה עַד יְסוֹד שֶׁהוּא בְּחִינַת סוֹף מַעֲשֶׂה; כִּי יו״ד חָכְמָה, ה״א בִּינָה, וָא״ו תִּפְאֶרֶת כְּלִיל שִׁית סְפִירִין (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב זֹהַר – – – חֵלֶק ג׳ רנ״ח עַמּוּד א׳),[1194] — **which allude to perfection from Chochmah down to Yesod which is the conclusion of the deed;** – – – [1195] — **for yud is Chochmah, heh is Binah, and vav is Tiferet incorporating the six**

[1189] **Machshavot Charutz 8:5**: "By their essential name they are called after Judah, who is named entirely after the Holy One's name, together with the letter dalet, which hints at poverty: Yehudah. "The he was a dalet"; only after receiving the pregnancy did it become a he. Wherever "poor," "needy," and the like are mentioned, they refer to Israel. This is their whole excellence: they recognize their deficiency and that they have no power and nothing except what God gives, bestows, and helps them with. This is "Understand and know Me, that I am the Lord …." Then God bestows upon them, and a he is made from the dalet: the completeness of the congregation of Israel."

Machshavot Charutz explains the spiritual action represented by the letter change. Poverty means recognizing the limits of one's own achievement and receiving even one's power to act from God. It thereby makes the dalet in Judah's name an active condition of receiving the final he, rather than an incidental letter association. The full paragraph contrasts this with treating wisdom, self-mastery, and generosity as independent human possessions.

[1190] **Mei HaShiloach, Volume I, Genesis, Vayeshev 1**: "Therefore God was also exacting with Joseph to a hair's breadth. Although these qualities are good, a person must nevertheless also trust in God, for what is done from the human side is not an everlasting building. Joseph accomplished a great deal through his guarding: from him came all the kings of Israel called "great," as the Midrash says, sackcloth is customary among great people, for Jehoram wore sackcloth. Yet concerning them it is said, "But not for all days." An everlasting building does not belong to their portion, but to Judah's. Although through his righteousness Joseph brought about a structure that would endure throughout all the six thousand years in the world, an everlasting building belongs to Judah."

Mei HaShiloach states the same distinction in terms of the durability of a building. Joseph's disciplined guarding accomplishes something real and immense; the everlasting building also requires reliance on God beyond human self-protection. This illuminates Rav Tzadok's contrast between perfection in action and repair for eternal life without belittling Joseph's actual holiness.

[1191] **Bereshit Rabbah 98:6** (excerpt): "'Judah, your brothers will acknowledge you' (Genesis 49:8): Your brothers acknowledge you; your mother acknowledges you; I myself acknowledge you. Rabbi Shimon ben Yochai said: All your brothers will be called by your name. A person does not say, 'I am a Reubenite' or 'I am a Simeonite,' but 'I am a Jew.'"

[1192] **Bereshit Rabbah 71:2** (excerpt): "Rabbi Shimon ben Yochai taught: Since everything depends upon Rachel, Israel is called by her name: 'Rachel weeps for her children' (Jeremiah 31:15). And not only by her name, but also by her son's name: 'Perhaps Hashem, God of Hosts, will be gracious to the remnant of Joseph' (Amos 5:15). And not only by her son's name, but also by her grandson's name: 'Is Ephraim a precious son to Me?' (Jeremiah 31:19)."

[1193] **Sotah 10b**: 'The verse states: "And Judah acknowledged them, and said: She is more righteous than I; forasmuch as I gave her not to Shelah my son" (Genesis 38:26). This is the same as Rav Ḥanin bar Bizna says that Rabbi Shimon Ḥasida says: Joseph, who sanctified the name of Heaven in private by not committing adultery with the wife of Potiphar, merited that one letter from the name of the Holy One, Blessed be He, was added to his name, as it is written: "He appointed it in Joseph bihosef for a testimony in his name, when He went forth against the land of Egypt" (Psalms 81:6). In this verse the name Joseph is written with an additional letter heh, found in the ineffable name of God.'

[1194] **Zohar, Pinchas 124:867-127:879**: 'In the Zohar (Pinchas, Ra'aya Meheimna III 258a), the four letters of the Name Havayah are explained as embracing all the Sefirot: the upper tip of the Yud is Keter; Yud is Chokhmah; Hei is Binah; Vav encompasses the six attributes of Ze'ir Anpin (the Holy One, blessed be He); and the final Hei is Malkhut (His Shekhinah).'

[1195] **Zohar, Pinchas 124:867-127:879**: 'In the Zohar (Pinchas, Ra'aya Meheimna III 258a), the four letters of the Name

sefirot (Zohar Part III, 258a), וְהַיְנוּ מֵחֶסֶד עַד יְסוֹד. — **meaning from Chesed through Yesod.** אֲבָל יְהוּדָה נִקְרָא כֻּלּוֹ עַל שֵׁם שֶׁל הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא, — **However Judah is named after the entire Four-Letter Name of the Holy One,** וְעוֹד נִמְצָא בּוֹ אוֹת דָּלֶ"ת שֶׁמּוֹרָה עַל בְּחִינַת שְׁלֵמוּת הִתְגַּלּוּת מַלְכוּת שָׁמַיִם, כִּי הֵ"א דָּלֶ"ת — **and in addition contains the letter Dalet pointing to the absolute perfection of the manifestation of the Kingdom of Heaven, –** שֶׁעַל יְדֵי הַשִּׁפְלוּת וְהַדַּלּוּת זוֹכִין לְהֵ"א אַחֲרוֹנָה שֶׁהוּא תַּכְלִית הִתְגַּלּוּת מַלְכוּת הַוָּת, — **for the heh was originally a dalet,** שֶׁשָּׁמַיִם. — **in that through humility and poverty (dalut) one merits the final heh which is the ultimate revelation of the Kingdom of Heaven.**

The heart's desire must become action and finally clear recognition

וְהִנֵּה אָמַרְנוּ[1196, 1197] שֶׁשְּׁמוֹנַת יְמֵי חֲנֻכָּה מְרַמְּזִים גַּם עַל שְׁלֵמוּת מִבִּינָה עַד מַלְכוּת: — **And behold we explained that the eight days of Chanukah also allude to perfection from Binah down to Malchut:** הַיְנוּ מֵרָצוֹן שֶׁבַּלֵּב שֶׁהוּא מֵטָּל עַל הָאָדָם לִהְיוֹת לוֹ רְעוּתָא דְּלִבָּא, שֶׁזֶּהוּ בְּחִינַת "בִּינָה לִבָּא"; — **meaning from the inward desire of the heart which is incumbent on man to have yearning of the heart (re'uta de-liba), which is Binah Liba;** וְאַחַר כָּךְ נִגְמָרִים שִׁבְעַת הַמִּדּוֹת שֶׁהֵם כְּלֵי הַמַּעֲשֶׂה בְּעֶזְרַת הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ, — **and afterward the seven sefirot, the vessels of action, are completed through the help of the Blessed Name,** כְּמַה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: "הַשֵּׁם יִגְמֹר בַּעֲדִי וְגוֹמֵר, מַעֲשֵׂי יָדֶיךָ אַל תֶּרֶף"; — **as Scripture states: "Hashem will perfect that which concerns me, forsake not the work of Your hands";** וְנִמְצָא שֶׁבְּיוֹם הַשְּׁמִינִי שֶׁל חֲנֻכָּה נִגְמָר בְּחִינַת מַלְכוּת. — **and it emerges that on the eighth day of Chanukah the dimension of Malchut is fully completed.** וּבְוַדַּאי יִצְדַּק הַשֵּׁם "זֹאת חֲנֻכָּה" עַל בְּחִינַת הִתְגַּלּוּת מַלְכוּת שָׁמַיִם, — **And certainly the name Zot Chanukah is rightfully applied to the revelation of the Kingdom of Heaven,** כַּיָּדוּעַ "זֶה" ו"זֹאת" הוּא יִחוּד קוּדְשָׁא בְּרִיךְ הוּא וּשְׁכִינְתֵּיהּ, — **for as is known Zeh (This - masculine) and Zot (This - feminine) represent the union of the Holy One and His Shechinah,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בְּרַעְיָא מְהֵימְנָא: "אִיהוּ אֱמֶת וְאִיהִי אֱמוּנָה", דְּהַיְנוּ בְּחִינַת "זֶה" הוּא — **and as written in Ra'aya Meheimna: "He is Truth and She is Faith";** הַדָּבָר שֶׁעוֹמֵד מְבֹרָר לְנֶגֶד עֵינָיו, — **meaning the aspect of Zeh is a matter standing manifest and clearly clarified before his eyes,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב (מְכִילְתָא וְזֹהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ בְּשַׁלַּח): "רָאָתָה שִׁפְחָה עַל הַיָּם מַה שֶׁלֹּא רָאָה יְחֶזְקֵאל",[1198] — **and as written (Mechilta and Zohar, Beshalach): "A maidservant at the Sea saw what Ezekiel did not**

Havayah are explained as embracing all the Sefirot: the upper tip of the Yud is Keter; Yud is Chokhmah; Hei is Binah; Vav encompasses the six attributes of Ze'ir Anpin (the Holy One, blessed be He); and the final Hei is Malkhut (His Shekhinah).'

[1196] **Dover Tzedek, Kuntres Ner HaMitzvot 2:202**: "The Torah's commandments divide into convictions, character qualities, and actions. Convictions proceed from wisdom, qualities from the heart, and actions through the instruments of action. The verse of divine unity belongs to knowledge and wisdom, encompassing all right convictions. Yet each matter still needs to emerge into action, so that it becomes clarified that one's faith and attachment are completely true. For what is a person, that he should understand how far the power of attachment reaches, and whether he has already reached that level?"

Dover Tzedek explains why the movement from heart to instruments of action matters. An inward conviction is not yet a full demonstration of the person's attachment; its actual expression clarifies its truth. This supplies a concrete role for the seven action-qualities in Chanukah 22 and prevents the opening desire from being mistaken for the whole completed work.

[1197] **Sod Yesharim, Shemini Atzeret 12:1**: "Day" indicates the apprehension of creation, while the word "He" hints at what is above apprehension, as explained in the Zohar. This is why the Zohar asks, "Why is it called 'that day'?" It is the day that joins the end to the beginning: the connection between human apprehension and the upper world will be recognized explicitly, in the manner of "the end of action is in the beginning of thought." A person is "formed behind and before"—behind in action and before in thought—so the connection of human apprehension with the upper world is called the day that joins the end to the beginning. "The beginning is called 'He'": at every beginning, illumination comes from the upper world, but the beginning is not yet united with its end. Every circuit, when its course ends, returns to the beginning and starts another circuit. This shows that the entire intended purpose was not completed in the first circuit. Had it already been wholly completed, there would be no need to make the circuit again. Because it was initially incomplete, its end requires returning to the beginning and circling anew. A new circuit is therefore aroused repeatedly until every clarification reaches complete perfection; then the end is wholly united with the beginning. This is the Zohar's "the last day, the day that joins the end to the beginning." In truth, from God's side even the beginning lacks no perfection. All the perfections that will exist after the clarifications are finished are already complete and clarified from His side at the first circuit's beginning. Yet from the human side, a person cannot reach those perfections until all the clarifications have run to their final purpose."

Sod Yesharim explains the exact "day/He" language with which the origin concludes. What was above human apprehension at the beginning becomes visible when the work's end is joined to its source. Its repeated circuits explain why genuine intermediate illuminations still require further clarification, while God's own completeness is never lacking. The target develops this through Shemini Atzeret; its account illuminates the eighth-day symbolism without equating the two festivals.

[1198] **Mekhilta d'Rabbi Yishmael 15:2**: 'This is my God, and I will glorify Him' (Exodus 15:2): Rabbi Eliezer says, Whence do you say that a maidservant saw at the Red Sea what Isaiah and Ezekiel and all the other prophets never saw? Because it is stated, 'And by the ministry of the prophets have I used similitudes' (Hosea 12:11), whereas at the Sea every single Jew pointed with his finger and proclaimed: 'This is my God!'

see", ;שֶׁהוּא שֶׁכָּל אֶחָד הֲרָאָה בְּאֶצְבַּע: "זֶה אֵלִי וְגוֹמֵר" — **in that every single individual pointed with his finger: "This is my God, etc.";** וּכְמוֹ כֵן לֶעָתִיד שֶׁיִּהְיֶה מְבֹרָר הַשָּׂגַת אֱלֹהוּת לְעֵין כֹּל כְּשֶׁיַּעַבְרוּ כָּל הַמַּסָּכִים וְיִתְגַּלֶּה הָאֱמֶת לַאֲמִתּוֹ, — **and likewise in the Future when the perception of Godliness will be lucid to all eyes as all veils pass away and Truth is revealed,** אָמְרוּ[1199] (סוֹף תַּעֲנִית ל״א עַמּוּד א׳): — **they said (end of Ta'anit 31a):** "עָתִיד הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא לַעֲשׂוֹת מָחוֹל לַצַּדִּיקִים וְכוּלַּיהּ, — **"The Holy One is destined to make a circle dance for the righteous, etc.,** וְכָל אֶחָד וְאֶחָד מַרְאָה בְּאֶצְבָּעוֹ, שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: 'וְאָמַר בַּיּוֹם הַהוּא הִנֵּה אֱלֹהֵינוּ זֶה קִוִּינוּ לוֹ וְיוֹשִׁיעֵנוּ, זֶה ה' קִוִּינוּ לוֹ נָגִילָה וְנִשְׂמְחָה בִּישׁוּעָתוֹ'"; — **and each and every one points with his finger, as it is said: 'And he shall say on that day: Behold, this is our God, we waited for Him and He will save us; this is Hashem, etc.'";** וְזֶה בְּחִינַת "בַּיּוֹם הַהוּא" שֶׁיִּתְגַּלֶּה כְּאוֹר יוֹם בְּחִינַת הוּ"א. — **and this is the aspect of "on that day" when the hidden realm of Hu illuminates as daylight.**

Faith establishes awe even while the night remains

וְלָכֵן תִּקְנוּ לוֹמַר "אֱמֶת וְיַצִּיב" בְּשַׁחֲרִית, שֶׁהוּא הִתְגַּלּוּת הָאֱמֶת כְּמוֹ שֶׁהוּא,[1200,1201] — **And therefore they instituted to recite Emet Veyatziv (True and Firm) in the morning, which is the revelation of Truth as it is;** וּבְעַרְבִית תִּקְנוּ לוֹמַר "אֱמֶת וֶאֱמוּנָה", שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: "וֶאֱמוּנָתְךָ בַּלֵּילוֹת", — **and in the evening they instituted to recite Emet Ve'emunah (True and Faithful), as stated: "and Your faithfulness in the nights",** שֶׁזֶּה בְּחִינַת "זֹאת", הִתְגַּלּוּת מַלְכוּת שָׁמַיִם עַל יְדֵי הָאֱמוּנָה: — **which is the dimension of Zot, the revelation of the Kingdom of Heaven through faith:** הֲגַם שֶׁלֹּא הוּסַר הַחֲשֵׁכוּת, — **for even though the physical darkness has not been removed,** מִכָּל מָקוֹם עַל יְדֵי תֹּקֶף הָאֱמוּנָה שֶׁנִּקְבַּע בְּנַפְשׁוֹת יִשְׂרָאֵל, — **nevertheless through the unyielding strength of faith rooted in Jewish souls,** יְכוֹלִים לְקַבֵּעַ בְּנַפְשָׁם הַיִּרְאָה כְּמוֹ שֶׁרוֹאִים בַּחוּשׁ; — **they can establish in their souls fear of Heaven just as if seeing tangibly;** וְכִדְאִיתָא בְּלִשּׁוֹן הָרַמָ"א רֵישׁ אוֹרַח חַיִּים: — **and as stated in the Rama's wording at the beginning of Orach Chayim:** "כְּשֶׁיָּשִׂים הָאָדָם אֶל לִבּוֹ שֶׁמֶּלֶךְ מַלְכֵי הַמְּלָכִים עוֹמֵד עָלָיו וְרוֹאֶה בְּמַעֲשָׂיו וְכוּלַּיהּ, — **"When a man places onto his heart that the King of kings stands over him beholding his deeds, etc.,** מִיָּד יַגִּיעַ אֵלָיו הַיִּרְאָה וְכוּלַּיהּ", — **immediately awe will reach him, etc.",** וְהֵנִּיחוּ בְּבְחִינַת "זֹאת" עַל יְדֵי אֱמוּנָה שֶׁיָּשִׂים אֶל לִבּוֹ; — **and this is the aspect of Zot through faith internalized in the heart;** וְהוּא שְׁכִינְתָּא וּכְנֶסֶת יִשְׂרָאֵל, שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: "כִּי אֲנִי הַשֵּׁם שֹׁכֵן בְּתוֹךְ בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל"; — **and it is the realm of the Shechinah and**

[1199] **Taanit 31a:9**: "The tractate concludes with a statement related to the topic of dancing. Ulla of the city of Bira'a said that Rabbi Elazar said: In the future, in the end of days, the Holy One, Blessed be He, will arrange a dance of the righteous, and He will be sitting among them in the Garden of Eden, and each and every one of the righteous will point to God with his finger, as it is stated: "And it shall be said on that day: Behold, this is our God, for whom we waited, that He might save us. This is the Lord; for whom we waited. We will be glad and rejoice in His salvation" (Isaiah 25:9). God will be revealed, so that every righteous individual will be able to say: This is our God, as though they were pointing at Him with a finger."

[1200] **Sod Yesharim, Shabbat Chol HaMoed Sukkot 11:2**: "To declare Your kindness in the morning." When Abraham's morning shines before a person—as in "one called to another," translated "they receive from one another"—one explicitly recognizes "the kindness of God all day." "Your faithfulness in the nights" means that when Abraham's morning is concealed, a person does not recognize the connection. This concealment is called night: "One did not approach the other all night." As the Midrash explains, when people become separated from one another it is called night, appearing as separation and interruption. Then the person's only counsel is to hold to greater faith. This is "Your faithfulness in the nights." Through faith, the whole of a person's existence can be strengthened. In truth, a person's essential existence corresponds to the faith established in his heart. As the Zohar says, "'Her husband is known in the gates'—this is the Holy One, blessed be He, who becomes known according to what each measures within his heart, as much as each can cleave …." According to the faith that each establishes in his heart, God dwells within him and gives him existence and endurance."

Sod Yesharim gives faith in the night an active function: it sustains the person when the connection itself is no longer perceptible. Its reading of "known in the gates" explains the source's language of a divine presence established according to the heart's capacity. This closely illuminates the origin's insistence that awe can be real before the darkness has been removed.

[1201] **Takanat HaShavin 2:4**: "From the side of faith, Israel believe in a general way without clear recognition. One also believes what one does not apprehend at all: this is the definition of faith. It is the sense of "Your faithfulness in the nights"—in darkness and concealment of the clear light, when faith is used. In the morning, however, it is "True and firm": truth is something entirely clarified to a person, against which no objection can be raised because it is visible to the eye. It proceeds from the apprehension of wisdom, as the Sages say, "There is no truth except Torah." Here there are differences: each is scorched by another's apprehension, and people's minds are not alike. But in faith within concealment there are no differing levels; all Israel are believers, as the Sages say. This is the root of the congregation of Israel and David's level: the beginning of repentance from within the concealment shared by everyone. Everyone who returns immediately merits forgiveness and healing of the soul."

Takanat HaShavin explains a consequence of the same morning/evening distinction: clear apprehension differs between people, while the basic faith that begins within concealment is shared. This illuminates why Rav Tzadok can describe the last-day quality as established throughout Israel even without the removal of darkness. The target speaks of faith's common root, not an assertion that every person's developed awareness or conduct is identical.

Knesset Yisrael: "For I Hashem dwell in the midst of the Children of Israel"; וּכְמַה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: "סוֹד ה' לִירֵאָיו", **and as stated: "The secret of Hashem is to those who fear Him",** שֶׁלִּירֵאָיו הַשָּׂגַת אֱלֹהוּת הוּא בְּחִינַת סוֹד; **— in that for those who fear Him the comprehension of Divinity remains a hidden secret;** וְכִדְאִיתָא בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ (חֶלֶק א׳ ק״ג רֵישׁ עַמּוּד ב׳)[1202]: "'נוֹדָע בַּשְּׁעָרִים בַּעְלָהּ' — לְפוּם מַה דְּמִשְׁעַר בְּלִבֵּיהּ כָּל חַד כַּמָּה דְּיָכִיל וְכוּלַּיהּ". **— and as stated in the Holy Zohar (Part I, 103b top): – "'Her husband is known in the gates' — according to what each person gauges (mesha'er) in his heart, as much as he is able, etc."** וְזֶה הַבְּחִינָה נִשְׁלָם בִּשְׁלֵמוּת בְּיוֹם הָאַחֲרוֹן שֶׁל חֲנֻכָּה, **— And this dimension is perfected in total completion on the final day of Chanukah,** וְלָכֵן נִקְרָא "זֹאת חֲנֻכָּה". **— and therefore is it designated Zot Chanukah.**

[1202] **Zohar, Vayera 9:153-164**: 'Similarly, man's soul cannot be known directly, save through the members of the body, which are the grades forming the instruments of the soul. The soul is thus known and unknown. So it is with the Holy One, blessed be He, since He is the Soul of souls, the Spirit of spirits, covered and veiled from anyone; nevertheless, through those gates, which are doors for the soul, the Holy One makes Himself known.'

Chanukah Ois 23

Zot Chanukah, the Offerings of the Princes, and Eternal Light

Rav Tzadok takes the established name “Zot Chanukah” as something whose Torah meaning should be investigated. His appeal to ordinary sayings in the Talmud gives a reason to look beneath the familiar expression.

Zot Chanukah, the Offerings of the Princes, and Eternal Light

An everyday expression can disclose a Torah root

יוֹם שְׁמִינִי דְּחַנֻכָּה קוֹרִין "זֹאת חֲנֻכָּה"[1203], וְאַף שֶׁלֹּא נִזְכַּר שֵׁם מִכָּל מָקוֹם כֵּיוָן זֶה בָּרִאשׁוֹנִים, שֶׁנִּקְרָא כֵּן בְּפִי רֹב יִשְׂרָאֵל, בְּוַדַּאי יֵשׁ לוֹ מָקוֹם בְּדִבְרֵי תוֹרָה; וּגְדוֹלָה מִזּוֹ מְצִינוּ שֶׁנָּזְכְּרוּ בַּגְּמָרָא: "הַיְנוּ דְּאָמְרֵי אִינָשֵׁי", וְנַעֲשָׂה מִזֶּה דִּבְרֵי תוֹרָה בַּשַּׁ"ס. וְשֹׁרֶשׁ הַשֵּׁם הוּא עַל שֵׁם שֶׁקּוֹרִין בּוֹ פָּרָשַׁת "זֹאת חֲנֻכַּת הַמִּזְבֵּחַ", וּמִסְתָּמָא יֵשׁ לָזֶה שַׁיָּכוּת לִקְדֻשַּׁת הַיּוֹם.

— **The eighth day of Chanukah is called Zot Chanukah,** — **and even though this specific name is not recorded in the early Rishonim,** — **nevertheless since it is widely called thus by the majority of Israel, it certainly has an authentic place in Torah words;** — **and a greater principle than this we find mentioned in the Gemara:** — **"This is that which people say in popular folk wisdom",** — **and from this it became an established Torah teaching in the Talmud.** — **And the literal origin of the name is because on it we read the Torah section Zot Chanukkat HaMizbe'ach,** — **and ordinarily this bears profound relevance to the sanctity of the day.**

Holiness engraved in the heart becomes inwardly tangible

וְהָעִנְיָן, שֶׁכְּבָר אָמַרְנוּ[1204] שֶׁהַתֵּבת "זֹאת" מוֹרָה עַל דָּבָר הַמְפֹרָשׁ לָעַיִן שֶׁיּוּכַל לְהֵרָאוֹת בְּאֶצְבָּעוֹ, וּכְמוֹ לְשׁוֹן "זֶה" בִּלְשׁוֹן זָכָר; וְכָל זֶה אֵינָנּוּ שׁוֹוֶה לְ"וְכָל זֶה אֵינֶנּוּ שֹׁוֶה לִי"[1205] (מְגִלָּה ט״ו עַמּוּד ב׳): שֶׁדָּרְשׁוּ מְלַמֵּד שֶׁכָּל גְּנָזָיו שֶׁל אוֹתוֹ רָשָׁע חֲקוּקִין לוֹ עַל לִבּוֹ וְכוּלֵיהּ, כְּמַרְאֶה בְּאֶצְבַּע; דְּכְשֶׁהוּא חָקוּק עַל לִבּוֹ הוּא כְּמְפֹרָשׁ לָעַיִן, וְיִתָּכֵן לוֹמַר לְשׁוֹן "זֶה" וְכֵן הוּא לְעִנְיַן הַטּוֹבָה בְּוַדַּאי. וְזֶה שֶׁדָּרְשׁוּ (וַיִּקְרָא רַבָּה פָּרָשָׁה כ״א)[1206]: "'בְּזֹאת יָבֹא אַהֲרֹן' — בִּזְכוּת שַׁבָּת: 'אַשְׁרֵי אֱנוֹשׁ יַעֲשֶׂה זֹּאת'",

— **"'Yet all this (zeh) avails me nothing' — teaching that all the treasures of that wicked one were engraved upon his heart, etc.",** — **for when something is engraved on the heart it is as if manifest to the eye, rendering the term zeh fitting like pointing with a finger;** — **just as the masculine word Zeh;** — **as they expounded (Megillah 15b): –** — **and so it certainly is in the realm of goodness.** — **And this is what they expounded (Vayikra Rabbah, Parashah 21): –** — **"'With this (be-zot) shall Aaron enter' — in the merit of Shabbat:**

[1203] **Tzidkat HaTzadik 53:1**: "An ordinary expression that a person habitually uses, a saying constantly on his lips, is actual words of Torah—even in the case of an ordinary person of Israel. Thus we often find the Talmud citing "as people say," and this is words of Torah. In the first chapter of Sanhedrin there are many instances of "That person who used to go about saying …," followed by Samuel saying, "It is written in Scripture." For every soul of Israel has its own particular attachment to words of Torah, as is known, and the expression constantly on a person's lips is the root of his soul. (For speech is the foundation of the soul: "a living soul" is translated "a speaking spirit"; and, as stated in the Pesikta, the only difference between living and dead righteous people is speech—this is the foundation of vitality.) From this a person can discern the root of his soul and know what his task is in this world."
Tzidkat HaTzadik supplies the reason that an ordinary saying can deserve Torah interpretation: a characteristic expression can disclose the speaker's particular attachment to Torah. This makes the investigation of "Zot Chanukah" more than an inference from a name's popularity. The target concerns a person's habitual saying; the origin applies the same Talmudic precedent to an established communal name.

[1204] **Sod Yesharim, Sukkot 24:1**: "What remained from our father Isaac's sowing was that this should be permanently present in Israel's hearts: "So that His fear may be upon your faces"—this is bashfulness. Just as we find on the opposite side that a person's sins are engraved upon his bones, so, all the more in the greater measure of good, bashfulness is engraved in Israel's hearts even without their conscious awareness. For the depth of Israel's heart truly stands face to face with God at all times. Therefore, even when an Israelite is by himself, with no other creature seeing or hearing him, he nevertheless feels bashfulness before God. This bashfulness remained with us from the acts of restraint of our father Isaac. Although all the qualities of the holy patriarchs remained permanently in Israel's hearts—as we find in the Talmud, "These three, had Moses not written them in the Torah and the Men of the Great Assembly not established them …": that is, God has already placed His seal upon these three qualities, "the great, the mighty, and the awesome," as permanently present in Israel's hearts, compassionate, bashful, and performing acts of kindness, inherited from the patriarchs—there is nevertheless a difference between the two qualities "great" and "awesome," the qualities of Abraham and Jacob, and "mighty," Isaac's quality. A person does not feel the first two unless he works with them consciously and with great clarity. But the bashfulness remaining in Israel's heart from Isaac's might is always in their hearts, even without their awareness and even when they are not engaged in service."
Sod Yesharim gives a concrete example of what an inwardly engraved holiness does: inherited awe can make itself felt when a person is alone, even without a deliberate act of recollection. This illuminates the origin's claim that an imprint in the heart can be as present as a visible object. The target attributes this particular enduring quality to Isaac's restraint; it does not claim to explain the law or historical naming of Zot Chanukah.

[1205] **Megillah 15b**: 'Haman's previously quoted statement: "Yet all this avails me nothing" (Esther 5:13), teaches that all the treasures of that wicked one were engraved on his heart, and when he saw Mordecai sitting at the king's gate, he said: As long as Mordecai is around, all this that I wear on my heart avails me nothing.'

[1206] **Vayikra Rabbah 21:6** (excerpt): "Rabbi Yudan interprets the verse as referring to the High Priest's entry into the Holy of Holies. He holds bundles upon bundles of commandments: through the merit of Torah—'This is the Torah' (Deuteronomy 4:44); through the merit of circumcision—'This is My covenant' (Genesis 17:10); through the merit of Shabbos—'Happy is the person who does this' (Isaiah 56:2)."

'Happy is the man that does this (zot)'", שֶׁקְּדֻשַּׁת הַשַּׁבָּת שֶׁחֲקוּקָה בְּלֵב יִשְׂרָאֵל הוּא כְּאוֹר מְפֹרָשׁ לָעַיִן שֶׁיּוּכַל לְהַרְאוֹת בְּאֶצְבַּע, וְנִקְרָא "זֹאת". **— for the holiness of Shabbat engraved in the Jewish heart is like an overt light visible to the eye that can be pointed to, and is called Zot.**

וְכֵן: "וְזֹאת הַתּוֹרָה", שֶׁהַתּוֹרָה אוֹר, וְהוּא אוֹר מְפֹרָשׁ שֶׁיּוּכַל לְהַרְאוֹת בְּאֶצְבַּע; — **And likewise: "And this (ve-zot) is the Torah", for the Torah is light, an overt light to be pointed to;** וּכְתִיב בָּהּ "וְזֹאת", — **and it is written with a vav: VeZot,** דְּוָא"ו אִקְרֵי אוֹת אֱמֶת, "אֱמֶת זוֹ תּוֹרָה" כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב (בְּרָכוֹת ה' עַמּוּד ב'),[1207] **— for the letter vav is called the letter of truth, and "Truth is Torah" (Berachot 5b),** וְהוּא מוֹרֶה עַל יִחוּד קוּדְשָׁא בְּרִיךְ הוּא (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב זֹהַר הַקְּדוֹשׁ רֵישׁ פָּרָשַׁת חֻקַּת).[1208] **— and points to the unification of the Holy One (Zohar, beginning of Parashat Chukat).**

Jacob's blessing brings the tribes into one another's holiness

וְכֵן בִּבְרַכַּת יַעֲקֹב אָבִינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם כְּתִיב:[1209] — **And likewise in the blessing of Jacob our Father it is written:** "וְזֹאת אֲשֶׁר דִּבֶּר לָהֶם אֲבִיהֶם וַיְבָרֶךְ אוֹתָם, אִישׁ אֲשֶׁר כִּבְרָכָתוֹ בֵּרַךְ אֹתָם", — **"And this is that which their father spoke to them and blessed them; every one according to his blessing he blessed them",** שֶׁכְּלוֹ נִרְאֶה כְּמְיֻתָּר שֶׁכְּבָר נִזְכַּר שֶׁבֵּרַךְ אוֹתָם; — **which seemingly appears entirely superfluous since it already stated that he blessed them;** "אִישׁ אֲשֶׁר כִּבְרָכָתוֹ בֵּרַךְ אֹתָם" — אַךְ מֵאַחַר דִּכְתִיב: — **– yet since it is written: "every one according to his blessing he blessed them" —** לְלַמֵּד שֶׁכָּלַל לְכָל הַשְּׁבָטִים, שֶׁכֻּלָּן כְּלוּלִין בְּכָל הַבְּרָכוֹת שֶׁל כָּל שֵׁבֶט וְשֵׁבֶט, **— teaching that he included all the tribes, that each was incorporated into the blessings of every tribe,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁפֵּרֵשׁ רַבִּי שְׁלֹמֹה יִצְחָקִי מֵהַמִּדְרָשׁ (רַבָּה וְתַנְחוּמָא);[1210] **— as Rashi explained from the Midrash (Rabbah and Tanchuma);** לָכֵן כְּתִיב "וְזֹאת", — **therefore it is written VeZot,** שֶׁהַקְּדֻשָּׁה מִכָּל שֵׁבֶט הָיְתָה מְפֹרָשׁ וְחָקוּק בַּלֵּב שֶׁיִּתָּכֵן לְשׁוֹן "זֹאת" שֶׁהוּא מְפֹרָשׁ שֶׁיּוּכַל לְהַרְאוֹת בְּאֶצְבַּע; — **indicating that the holiness of each tribe was overt and engraved in the heart, making fitting the word Zot which can be pointed to;** וּכְתִיב בְּוָא"ו: "וְזֹאת", שֶׁהוּא אוֹת אֱמֶת, מִדָּתוֹ שֶׁל יַעֲקֹב, — **and it is written with a vav: VeZot, which is the letter of truth, Jacob's attribute,** דִּכְתִיב: "תִּתֵּן אֱמֶת לְיַעֲקֹב", — **as it is written: "You give truth to Jacob",** לְהוֹרוֹת שֶׁעַל יְדֵי שֶׁהֵם כְּלוּלִים בִּקְדֻשַּׁת יַעֲקֹב, כָּלוּל כָּל אֶחָד בִּקְדֻשַּׁת כָּל הַשְּׁבָטִים. — **to teach that through being unified within Jacob's holiness, each individual incorporates the holiness of all tribes.**

[1207] **Berakhot 5b:2-3**: "Rabbi Yochanan said to him: Torah and acts of kindness are understandable, for it is written, 'Through kindness and truth, sin is atoned for.' 'Kindness' means acts of kindness, as it says, 'One who pursues righteousness and kindness will find life, righteousness and honor.' 'Truth' means Torah, as it says, 'Buy truth and do not sell it.' But how do we know that one who buries his children also has his sins atoned for? An elder taught him in Rabbi Shimon ben Yochai's name: It is derived by comparing the word 'sin' in two verses. Here it is written, 'Through kindness and truth, sin is atoned for,' and there it is written, 'Who repays the sin of fathers into the bosom of their children.'"

[1208] **Zohar, Chukat 180a**: 'At the beginning of Parashat Chukat (Zohar III 180a), the letter Vav—whose numerical value is six, spanning the six directions—is called the 'Letter of Truth' (Ot Emet), signifying the Written Torah and the unification of the Holy One, blessed be He, with the Shekhinah.'

[1209] **Mei HaShiloach, Volume I, Genesis, Vayechi 4**: "The language of blessing was not used at the outset, because what Jacob would say to them was not yet clear to him. But our teacher Moses began immediately with "And this is the blessing," because the word vezot indicates that everything was clear to him as soon as he began to speak. With Jacob, vezot appears only after all the blessings, because only then, after all his words, was it clear to him that all his blessings came from God; this was not clear beforehand. At first God placed words of reproach in his mouth, to reproach the first three tribes, for a Torah scholar must take vengeance and retain a grievance. When he reached the tribe of Judah, God showed him from Heaven that he should forgo the strict measure of his response. For the letters of Judah contain the Divine Name, and the dalet in his name alludes to the verse, "But to this one I will look: to one poor and broken in spirit, who trembles at My word." This means one who understands that, of himself, he has nothing, as it is stated, "The dalet gathers what it receives." Therefore there was no place here for anger or wrath to take hold. When the quality of mercy opened in Judah, it prevailed over the other tribes as well, and they were all included in the blessing."
Mei HaShiloach explains the movement by which Jacob's distinct addresses culminate in a blessing shared by all. The initial rebuke is real, but Judah's recognition that he possesses nothing independently opens mercy that includes the remaining tribes. Its reading of vezot as clarity reached at the conclusion directly enhances Rav Tzadok's account of the concluding blessing's inclusive holiness.

[1210] **Bereshit Rabbah 99:4**: ""All these are the tribes of Israel, twelve, and this is what their father spoke to them, and he blessed them; each man in accordance with his blessing he blessed them" (Genesis 49:28). "All these are the tribes of Israel, twelve…" – it is already written: "And he blessed them"; why, then, does the verse state: "Each man in accordance with his blessing he blessed them"? It is because he blessed them by comparing Judah to a lion, Dan to a serpent, Naphtali to a doe, Benjamin to a wolf, and he then included them all and rendered them lions and rendered them serpents. Know that it is so: "Dan will be a serpent" (Genesis 49:17), and he is then called a lion. That is what is written: "Dan is a lion cub" (Deuteronomy 33:22). This is to realize what is stated: "All of you is fair, my love, and there is no blemish in you" (Song of Songs 4:7)."

Distinct service contributes to a shared completeness

וְכֵן עִנְיַן קָרְבְּנוֹת הַנְּשִׂיאִים,[1211, 1212] — **And likewise the offerings of the Princes,** שֶׁנִּדְרַשׁ (בְּבַמִּדְבָּר רַבָּה נָשֹׂא) כַּנָּעוֹת עַל קָרְבְּנוֹת הַנְּשִׂיאִים,[1213] — **wherein distinct kabbalistic intentions were expounded (Bemidbar Rabbah, Nasso) for the sacrifices of each Prince,** — וְהַיְנוּ שֶׁכָּל אֶחָד מֵהַנְּשִׂיאִים הָיָה לוֹ כַּוָּנָה מְיֻחֶדֶת בְּקָרְבְּנוֹתָיו, **meaning that each Prince possessed a unique spiritual intent in his sacrifices;** דְּאִם לֹא כֵן לָמָּה כָּפַל הַכָּתוּב לְפָרֵט בְּכָל אֶחָד הַקָּרְבָּנוֹת, — **for if not so, why did Scripture repeat and detail the sacrifices for each Prince individually;** וַהֲוָה לֵיהּ לִכְתֹּב: "וְכֵן הִקְרִיב נָשִׂיא פְּלוֹנִי בְּיוֹם פְּלוֹנִי", **it should rather have written: "And likewise offered Prince so-and-so on such-and-such day",** כֵּיוָן שֶׁכֻּלָּם הִקְרִיבוּ מִסְפָּר אֶחָד? — **since all offered an identical tally?** אֶלָּא עַל כָּרְחָךְ שֶׁאֵין כַּוָּנָתוֹ שֶׁל זֶה דּוֹמָה לָזֶה; — **Perforce, the inner intention of this one was not identical to that one;** וְכֵן כָּתַב בְּבַמִּדְבָּר רַבָּה (שָׁם פָּרָשָׁה י"ג):[1214] — **and so written in Bemidbar Rabbah (ibid. 13):** "אַף עַל פִּי שֶׁקָּרְבָּן שָׁוֶה הִקְרִיבוּ, כֻּלָּם עַל דְּבָרִים גְּדוֹלִים הִקְרִיבוּ, וְכָל אֶחָד וְאֶחָד הִקְרִיב לְפִי דַּעְתּוֹ וְכוּלֵיהּ", — **"Even though they offered an identical sacrifice, all offered upon great spiritual matters, and each one offered according to his own spiritual insight, etc.",** וְהַיְנוּ שֶׁכָּל אֶחָד הָיָה לוֹ כַּוָּנָה מְיֻחֶדֶת לְפִי קְדֻשַּׁת שִׁבְטוֹ.

[1211] **Peri Tzadik, Bamidbar 3:2**: “The principal purpose of the counting was to raise their heads, in accordance with the saying in Avot, “There is no person who does not have his hour ….” That is, every individual of Israel, at that hour and in that matter, is the greatest of all Israel; likewise his fellow at another hour. For each individual of Israel has a portion in Torah—a letter or part of a letter—and if that letter or any part of it is missing, the Torah scroll is invalid. This was the meaning of the “hosts of Torah” counted by Moses: to know, within each tribe, how every soul is distinct in its holiness and its Torah among the hosts of Torah. This is why the expressions alluding to different matters were repeated for each tribe. For the twelve tribes correspond to the twelve months, the twelve constellations, and the twelve permutations of the Divine Name. Our father Jacob gave each tribe its blessing and afterward included them together, as it is said, “Each according to his blessing he blessed them.” This was the point of counting each tribe separately, each among the hosts of Torah, and likewise through Aaron to know the hosts of the Tabernacle. The five expressions were also mentioned for the purpose we have explained; this was repeated for every tribe, because in each tribe there was a distinct intention in it. Afterward the total was written together, because the combination of each number contained a different holiness and a mystery known to Moses and Aaron.”

The comparison to letters in a Torah scroll makes the relation between difference and inclusion precise. Each person’s particular contribution is indispensable, while their combination has a holiness that is not exhausted by listing the parts. This explains why both the repeated individual offerings and their concluding total deserve their own text.

[1212] **Tiferet Yosef, Pekudei 5**: “My father of blessed memory explained that the contributions for the communal offerings allude to the first will by which God chose Israel, as in the statement that Israel arose first in thought. In that place no superiority of one person over another applies; therefore all Israel gave equally in this contribution. The contribution for the sockets indicates the completion of clarification, as in the Talmudic statement, “All Israel have a portion in the world to come.” Here too no superiority of one over another applies, which is why all Israel gave equally in this contribution as well. The contribution for the Tabernacle indicates the service God established in this world. Here it was “everyone whose heart moved him”: according to each person's work in his service, his exertion and hardship, his breaking through concealment and clarifying why God chose him, so he sees God dwelling with him. In this service they cannot be equal: one may, Heaven forbid, be distant and another near, according to his service. Therefore Moses made the hooks of the pillars from the surplus of the contribution for the sockets. As the Zohar states, they were made in the form of a vav; and the Zohar says that vav joins the upper world to the lower—that is, it joins God's will to a person's limited apprehension. These hooks were made from the surplus of the sockets' contribution, which alludes to the completed clarification, to show that in the depth every Israelite recognizes the connection of His light with his own apprehension, since in the depth each has “one point that always reaches.” In truth, all Israel have a portion in the world to come. What does this imply? Even in this world, where God established that a person sees the Holy One dwelling within him according to his service—as the Tabernacle contribution indicates—nevertheless, in the depth no soul of Israel will be rejected, and each recognizes the connection of God's light with his own apprehension.”

Tiferet Yosef distinguishes the equality of the original choice and completed clarification from the unequal work and awareness of people in the present. The hooks made from the equal contribution connect that shared root to each person’s limited apprehension. This helps the reader understand the origin’s inclusive total without turning “one is not greater than another” into a claim that every person’s present service is identical.

[1213] **Bamidbar Rabbah 13:14** (excerpt): “Another interpretation of ‘His offering’: Why did the princes bring offerings in this form? The Sages say: Although they all brought the same offering, they offered it concerning great matters, and each offered according to his own understanding. Nachshon began and offered concerning the order of kingship, in accordance with the kingship his father had given him over his brothers: ‘Judah, your brothers will acknowledge you’; ‘Judah is a lion’s cub’ (Genesis 49:8–9). Likewise it says, ‘Judah prevailed over his brothers, and the ruler came from him’ (I Chronicles 5:2). The tribe of Judah’s sages and leaders held a tradition from our father Jacob concerning everything destined to happen to each tribe until the days of Messiah. Every tribe likewise held a tradition from its father Jacob concerning all that would happen to it until the days of Messiah.”

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meaning each had a unique intent tailored to the sanctity of his tribe. וּכְתִיב בְּסוֹף קָרְבְּנוֹת כֻּלָּם: "זֹאת חֲנֻכַּת הַמִּזְבֵּחַ וְגוֹמֵר", וְכָלַל מִסְפַּר כָּל הַקָּרְבָּנוֹת; **— And it is written at the end of all their offerings: "This was the dedication of the altar, etc.", totaling the entire tally of sacrifices;** וּלְכְאוֹרָה לָמָּה הֻצְרַךְ הַכָּתוּב לִמְנוֹתָן, וּמֵעַצְמָנוּ נוֹכַל לֵידַע מִסְפַּר כֻּלָּם? **— and ostensibly why did Scripture need to tally them, when on our own we could calculate their sum?** אֶלָּא עַל כָּרְחָךְ הִשְׁמִיעָנוּ הַכָּתוּב בָּזֶה: שֶׁנִּכְלַל כָּל אֶחָד מֵהַנְּשִׂיאִים מִקְּדֻשַּׁת כָּל שְׁנֵים עָשָׂר הַשְּׁבָטִים וְכַוָּנַת קָרְבְּנוֹתֵיהֶן; **— Rather perforce Scripture teaches us through this: — that each of the Princes was incorporated into the sanctity of all Twelve Tribes and the intents of their sacrifices;** וְכֵן כָּתַב בְּבֶמִדְבָּר רַבָּה (שָׁם)[1215]: "אֶלָּא הֶעֱלָה עֲלֵיהֶם כְּאִלּוּ כֻּלָּם הִקְרִיבוּ בְּיוֹם רִאשׁוֹן וּכְאִלּוּ כֻּלָּם הִקְרִיבוּ בְּיוֹם אַחֲרוֹן", **— and so written in Bemidbar Rabbah (ibid.): — "Rather Scripture accounts it to them as if all offered on the first day and as if all offered on the final day",** וְאָמַר שָׁם שֶׁאֵין זֶה גָּדוֹל מִזֶּה. **— and it states there that this one is not greater than that one.** וְעַל כֵּן נִדְרַשׁ עַל כָּל אֶחָד כַּוָּנוֹת מְיֻחָדוֹת, וְאַחַר כָּךְ כּוֹלְלָם יַחַד שֶׁכְּלוּלִים כָּל אֶחָד מִכָּל שְׁנֵים עָשָׂר הַקְּדֻשּׁוֹת. **— And therefore distinct intentions were expounded for each, and afterward they are bound together, each incorporating all twelve sanctities.** וּכְתִיב "זֹאת", שֶׁמּוֹרֶה שֶׁהָיָה קְדֻשַּׁת כָּל הַשְּׁבָטִים בְּכָל אֶחָד מְפֹרָשׁ שֶׁיִּתָּכֵן לְשׁוֹן "זֹאת". **— And it writes Zot, indicating that the sanctity of all tribes within each one was manifest so as to justify the term Zot,** וְהָיְנוּ שֶׁהָיָה חָקוּק הַקְּדֻשָּׁה בַּלֵּב כַּנִּזְכָּר לְעֵיל. **— meaning that the holiness was engraved in the heart as mentioned above.**

Divine dwelling can be present through faith in exile

וְהִנֵּה מַה שֶּׁקּוֹרִין בַּחֲנֻכָּה בְּפָרָשַׁת הַנְּשִׂיאִים,[1216, 1217] **— And behold our reading on Chanukah from the portion of the Princes:** אַף שֶׁחֲנֻכַּת הַנְּשִׂיאִים הָיָה בְּקָרְבָּנוֹת, **— even though the Princes' dedication was through animal sacrifices,** וַחֲנֻכָּה שֶׁאָנוּ עוֹשִׂין הוּא בְּנֵרוֹת וְהֵם זֵכֶר לְנֵרוֹת הַמִּקְדָּשׁ, **— while the Chanukah we celebrate is through lights commemorating the Temple Menorah,** וּטְפֵי הָוָה לֵיהּ לְקִרוֹת בְּפָרָשַׁת בְּהַעֲלֹתְךָ; **— and it would seem more fitting to read from Parashat Beha'alotecha;** וְאִם מִפְּנֵי שֶׁאֵין בּוֹ רַק אַרְבָּעָה פְּסוּקִים וְלֵיכָּא עֲשָׂרָה פְּסוּקִים לִשְׁלֹשָׁה גַּבְרֵי, הָוָה לֵיהּ **— and if because it contains only four verses, lacking ten verses for three aliyot,** לְהַתְחִיל בְּפָרָשַׁת "זֹאת חֲנֻכַּת הַמִּזְבֵּחַ וְגוֹמֵר" וּבְהַעֲלֹתְךָ, שֶׁיִּהְיֶה יַחַד עֲשָׂרָה פְּסוּקִים! **— it should have begun with Zot**

[1215] **Bamidbar Rabbah 14:12**; **Bamidbar Rabbah 14:13** (excerpts): "'This was the dedication of the altar on the day it was anointed' (Numbers 7:84). Was the entire dedication of the altar performed on the day it was anointed? Was it not completed only after twelve days? Rather, Scripture teaches that all the tribes are equal and equally beloved before the Holy One, blessed be He. Scripture accounts it to them as though all had offered on the first day, fulfilling 'You are entirely beautiful, My love, and there is no blemish in you' (Song of Songs 4:7). … Rabbi Yudan said: Only one bowl, one basin, and one ladle were offered on the day it was anointed. Why, then, does it say 'twelve silver bowls, twelve silver basins, twelve golden ladles'? Rather, Scripture accounts it to them as though all had offered on the first day and all had offered on the last day."

[1216] **Resisei Layla 24:1**: "The very matter of the Tabernacle, the altar, and the order of service is bringing the Divine Presence down among the lower beings, and the order of repairs and atonements for sins, the wiping away of every sort of dirt, and the beautifying and adorning of the bride. This is drawn from His dwelling among the lower beings: once His indwelling is revealed within the hearts of Israel, every stain is naturally cleansed and evil and darkness are driven away, for "light dwells with Him." This is mishkan, meaning a place of indwelling. But mikdash, meaning a place of holiness, is precisely the opposite of mishkan: holiness means distinction and separation, something set apart, whereas indwelling means dwelling with and joining, without separation, as it is written, "Who dwells with them amid their impurities." Holiness, by contrast, is separation from impurity. Yet we find a mishkan called a mikdash and a mikdash called a mishkan, because it is all one and both are true together: the Holy One dwells within Israel and is also distinct from them."

Resisei Layla explains how the two names can describe one sacred reality while emphasizing different aspects: God's joining Himself to Israel and His holiness beyond them. Its account of indwelling that cleanses the heart illuminates why the origin can speak of a real Divine dwelling under conditions requiring faith. The target's distinction is connection and separation; the origin's is faith and manifest truth. Neither comparison changes the origin's stated restriction on offering sacrifices.

[1217] **Mei HaShiloach, Volume I, Exodus, Bo 6**: "Sanctify to Me every firstborn … among human beings and animals." The human being signifies the wisdom and thought in the mind, for this is the principal human form; the animal signifies the power of action. God commanded that both action and thought be sanctified and refined; then the human form will be complete, clarified in accordance with God's will. Of this it is said, "You save human being and animal, O Lord": the human being is thought, and the animal alludes to action. Our teacher Moses was the wisdom of all Israel, and all his power lay in this—the mind and thought, keeping God before him at all times. Therefore the Torah principally speaks of actual deeds, so that action too should be as refined as thought. For this reason Moses made the Tabernacle, because his place was in the human form, in the depth of the heart, and the Tabernacle could be dismantled and carried to another place. Solomon's wisdom was in deeds; therefore he built the chosen House in a fixed place, and the book of Proverbs that he composed speaks chiefly of the uprightness of heart and thought, that they should be made as sound as action."

Mei HaShiloach gives the portability of Moses' Tabernacle an inward meaning: its place is in the depth of the heart, while Solomon's fixed Temple corresponds to wisdom established in action. This adds a concrete reason why the movable Tabernacle can illuminate the origin's account of holiness continuing outside the Land. It uses the complementary relation of thought and action, rather than simply repeating Rav Tzadok's faith-and-truth distinction.

Chanukkat HaMizbe'ach through Beha'alotecha, combining to ten verses! אָמְנָם הָעִנְיָן: אַף דְּאַשְׁכַּחַן מִקְדָּשׁ דְּאִקְרֵי מִשְׁכָּן וּמִשְׁכָּן דְּאִקְרֵי מִקְדָּשׁ (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בְּרֵישׁ עֵירוּבִין ב׳ עַמּוּד א׳),[1218] **— However, the inner matter is: although we find the Temple called Mishkan and the Mishkan called Mikdash (Eruvin 2a),** מִכָּל מָקוֹם סָתָם "מִשְׁכָּן" עַל הַמִּשְׁכָּן שֶׁעָשָׂה מֹשֶׁה, **— nevertheless the baseline term Mishkan refers to the Tabernacle made by Moses;** וּ"מִשְׁכָּן" הוּא עַל שֵׁם "אָנִי הַשֵּׁם שֹׁכֵן בְּתוֹךְ בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל"; **— and Mishkan derives from: "I Hashem dwell (shochen) in the midst of the Children of Israel";** וְכֵן מוֹרֶה "מִקְדָּשׁ" שֶׁהַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא שׁוֹכֵן שָׁם, וְהַכֹּל אֶחָד; **— and likewise Mikdash indicates that the Holy One abides there, and all is one;** אַךְ הוּא עַל פִּי מַה שֶּׁכָּתוּב (זֹהַר חֵלֶק ג׳ ר״ל עַמּוּד א׳): "אִיהוּ אֱמֶת וְאִיהִי אֱמוּנָה", **— yet it follows what is written (Zohar Part III, 230a): "He is Truth and She is Faith",** וְהוּא דְּ"מִקְדָּשׁ" מוֹרֶה כְּשֶׁהוּא מְפֹרָשׁ הַשְׁרָאַת הַשְּׁכִינָה בְּבְחִינַת אֱמֶת, **— meaning that Mikdash denotes manifest indwelling of the Shechinah in the dimension of Truth,** וּ"מִשְׁכָּן" הוּא כְּשֶׁאֵינוֹ מְפֹרָשׁ כָּל כָּךְ רַק עַל יְדֵי בְּחִינַת אֱמוּנָה; **— while Mishkan is when it is not as overt, experienced through faith;** וְהַמִּשְׁכָּן הָיָה אַף בְּחוּץ לָאָרֶץ וּמִקְדָּשׁ הָיָה בָּאָרֶץ יִשְׂרָאֵל. **— and the Tabernacle stood even outside the Land, while the Temple was in the Land of Israel.** וְעַל כֵּן עִנְיַן חֲנֻכַּת הַחַשְׁמוֹנָאִים שֶׁאָנוּ עוֹשִׂים אַף בַּגָּלִיּוֹת הוּא כְּעִין חֲנֻכַּת הַמִּשְׁכָּן: **— And therefore the dedication of the Hasmoneans which we observe even in the diaspora is akin to the dedication of the Tabernacle:** רַק אָז, עַד שֶׁלֹּא נִתְקַדְּשָׁה הָאָרֶץ, הֻכְשַׁר חוּץ לָאָרֶץ לְמִשְׁכָּן וְהָיָה הַחֲנֻכָּה בְּקָרְבָּנוֹת בְּמַעֲשָׂה; **— only then, before the Land was consecrated, the wilderness was suitable for the Tabernacle and its dedication was via physical sacrifices;** מַה שֶּׁאֵין כֵּן אַחַר שֶׁנִּתְקַדֵּשׁ בֵּית עוֹלָמִים וְאֵין רְשׁוּת לְהַקְרִיב קָרְבָּן, **— unlike after the Eternal Temple was sanctified and no permission exists to sacrifice outside it,** הַחֲנֻכָּה הִיא בְּנֵרוֹת שֶׁעַל זֶה אָמְרוּ (מִדְרָשׁ רַבָּה רֵישׁ בְּהַעֲלֹתְךָ): "הַקָּרְבָּנוֹת כָּל זְמַן שֶׁבֵּית הַמִּקְדָּשׁ קַיָּם, אֲבָל הַנֵּרוֹת לְעוֹלָם", עַיֵּן שָׁם;[1219] **— the dedication is through lights which are the light of Torah; — on which they said (Midrash Rabbah, Beha'alotecha): "The sacrifices apply while the Temple stands, but the lights are forever", see there;** וְאַף דְּנֵרוֹת בֵּית הַמִּקְדָּשׁ גַּם כֵּן בְּטֵלִין אַחַר הַחֻרְבָּן, רַק דְּקָאֵי עַל נֵרוֹת חֲנֻכָּה, וּכְמוֹ שֶׁכָּתַב הָרַמְבַּ"ן, **— and though the Temple lights also ceased after the destruction, it refers to the Chanukah lights as the Ramban wrote,** וְהֵינוּ אוֹר תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה שֶׁזֶּה נִתַּן לַכֹּהֲנִים (וּכְמוֹ שֶׁנִּתְבָּאֵר לְמַעְלָה).[1220] **— which is the light of the Oral Torah granted to the priests (as explained above).** וְעַל כֵּן בַּחֲנֻכָּה שֶׁאָנוּ עוֹשִׂין עַל הַשְׁרָאַת אוֹר תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה בְּלֵב יִשְׂרָאֵל, **— And therefore on Chanukah which we celebrate over the indwelling of the Oral Torah in the heart of Israel,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמַרְנוּ עַל מַה שֶּׁנֶּאֱמַר "אֵל הַשֵּׁם וַיָּאֶר לָנוּ", **— and as we explained on the verse "God is Hashem, and He shone light upon us",** שֶׁעַל יְדֵי נֵרוֹת חֲנֻכָּה שָׁאָנוּ מַדְלִיקִין, הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ מֵאִיר בְּלֵב יִשְׂרָאֵל מִטַּל דְּעַתִּיקָא טַל תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה וְעוֹשִׂין עַל זֶה חֲנֻכָּה — **– that through the Chanukah lights we kindle, God shines into the heart of Israel from the dew of Atika, the dew of the Oral Torah, and we celebrate a dedication over this — — we read from the portion of the Princes' sacrifices in the dedication of the Tabernacle.** קוֹרִין בְּפָרָשַׁת קָרְבְּנוֹת הַנְּשִׂיאִים בַּחֲנֻכַּת הַמִּשְׁכָּן.

The light within a mitzvah and the enduring light of Torah

וְאַף שֶׁאֵין לָנוּ קָרְבָּן בְּמַעֲשָׂה, מִכָּל מָקוֹם יֵשׁ לָנוּ הָאוֹר תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּמַעֲשֵׂה מִצְוֹת הַקָּרְבָּנוֹת,[1221] **— And even though we lack**

[1218] **Eruvin 2a:13**: "We find that the Mishkan is called Mikdash, and that the Mikdash is called Mishkan. For if you do not say so, consider the teaching of Rav Yehudah in Shmuel's name: Peace offerings slaughtered before the doors of the Sanctuary are opened are invalid, as it says, 'He shall slaughter it at the entrance of the Tent of Meeting'—when its doors are open, and not when they are shut. But that verse was written concerning the Mishkan! Rather, we find that the Mikdash is called Mishkan, and the Mishkan is called Mikdash."

[1219] **Bamidbar Rabbah 15:6** (excerpt): "You find above that eleven tribes brought offerings, and the tribe of Ephraim brought an offering; all the princes brought offerings except the prince of Levi. Who was Levi's prince? Aharon, as it says, 'Write Aharon's name upon Levi's staff' (Numbers 17:18). Aharon had not brought an offering with the princes, and he said: Woe to me! Perhaps because of me the Holy One does not accept Levi's tribe. The Holy One said to Moshe: Go and tell Aharon: Do not fear; you are destined for something greater than this. Therefore it says, 'Speak to Aharon … when you kindle the lamps.' The sacrifices apply as long as the Temple stands, but the lamps are forever: 'They shall shine toward the face of the menorah' (Numbers 8:2). All the blessings I gave you with which to bless My children will likewise never cease."

[1220] **Deuteronomy 33:10**: "They shall teach Your laws to Jacob And Your instructions to Israel.They shall offer You incense to savor And whole-offerings on Your altar."

[1221] **Tiferet Yosef, Rosh Hashanah 4**: "The matter is that God clothed His light in the garments and deeds of the commandments. A person who wishes to attain God's light attains it by fulfilling His will in the activity and deeds of the commandments. One must necessarily proceed through those acts and deeds; intention alone is insufficient. If intention alone were sufficient, why did God command the commandments at all? This shows that through intention alone a person cannot reach God's light, but only through practical commandments, through which he attains it. Then he sees clearly that even the power of this action is also God's. Holiness is then established within him permanently, so that he always sees clearly before his eyes that every power of action comes from God. This lasting holiness that a person establishes through fulfilling His will in the garments and deeds of the commandments is called Torah, as it is written, "For a commandment is a lamp, and Torah is light." By fulfilling His will in the deeds of the commandments he attains

animal sacrifices in physical action, nevertheless we possess the light of Torah within the mitzvah of sacrifices, "נֵר מִצְוָה" (סוֹטָה כ"א עַמּוּד א'): דְּוְכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרִינוּ בְּמַה שֶׁכָּתוּב[1222] — **and as we explained regarding what is written (Sotah 21a):** – מַה נֵּר מֵאִיר לְפִי שָׁעָה אַף מִצְוָה וְכוּלֵיהּ; — **"A mitzvah is a lamp" — just as a lamp shines temporarily, so too a mitzvah, etc.;** וְנִרְאֶה דִּסְבִירָא לֵיהּ לַגְּמָרָא דְּנֵר מִצְוָה הַיְנוּ כְּנֵר כְּמוֹ שֶׁהוּא דּוֹלֵק; — **and it appears the Gemara understands "a mitzvah is a lamp" like a lamp actively burning;** וּבַזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ (חֶלֶק ב' קס"ו עַמּוּד א')[1223] אִיתָא דְּמִצְוָה רַק שְׁרָגָא, — **whereas in the Holy Zohar (Part II, 166a) it states that a mitzvah is merely an unlit vessel (shraga),** וְהַיְנוּ נֵר וּפְתִילָה וְשֶׁמֶן בְּלֹא שַׁלְהֶבֶת; — **meaning vessel, wick, and oil without flame;** וְאָמַרְנוּ שֶׁבְּכָל מִצְוָה יֵשׁ אוֹר, וְהוּא הַמְּכֻוָּן לְשֵׁם שָׁמַיִם, וְזֶה נִקְרָא אוֹר תּוֹרָה, — **and we explained that within every mitzvah there is light, which is pure intent for Heaven's sake, and this is termed the light of Torah,** שֶׁעִקַּר הַתּוֹרָה קִיּוּם הַמִּצְוֹות, — **for the core of Torah is fulfilling the commandments,** וּמַה לִּי שֶׁלּוֹמֵד הַפָּרָשָׁה אוֹ מְכַוֵּן כַּוָּנַת הַמִּצְוָה; — **and what difference is there whether one studies the text or focuses on the mitzvah's intent;** רַק הָאוֹר תּוֹרָה שֶׁבַּמִּצְוָה מֵאִיר רַק לְפִי שָׁעָה, — **only that the light of Torah within a physical mitzvah shines temporarily,** מַה שֶּׁאֵין כֵּן הָאוֹר תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּקִיּוּם מִצְוַת עֲשֵׂה שֶׁל לִמּוּד הַתּוֹרָה הוּא מֵאִיר לְעוֹלָם, — **unlike the light of Torah within the positive mitzvah of Torah study which shines eternally,** "תּוֹרָה וְעַל זֶה נֶאֱמַר: "אוֹר"[1224] (וְנִתְבָּאֵר מַאֲמָר ב'). — **and on this it is said: "Torah is light" (elaborated in discourse 2).** וְכֵן יֵשׁ לָנוּ שֶׁכָּל הַמְּכֻוָּן שֶׁבְּקָרְבְּנוֹת הַנְּשִׂיאִים, — **And likewise we possess the spiritual intentions of the Princes' sacrifices,** אֶחָד מֵהֶם הִתְכַּוֵּן לְכַוָּנָה מְיֻחֶדֶת לְפִי דַּעְתּוֹ, וְהוּא קְדֻשַּׁת הַשַּׁבָּט, — **wherein each focused on a distinct intent according to his insight, reflecting his tribe's holiness,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁזָּכַרְנוּ מֵהַמִּדְרָשׁ רַבָּה, — **as we cited from Midrash Rabbah,**

The two crowns become embodied in head and arm

וְלָזֶה יְכוֹלִים לִזְכּוֹת אַף בַּזְּמַן הַזֶּה. וְהִנֵּה "נֵר מִצְוָה וְתוֹרָה אוֹר"[1225] — **and to this we can merit even in this**

God's light completely and sees that God acts in all things: even the power of his own service comes from God. This permanence is called Torah. When a person reaches this completeness, and this holiness has already been established within him, he truly needs no action to attain this recognition. At first he must proceed through the acts and deeds of the commandments; but when, through fulfilling His will, he has established such holiness within himself and recognizes that all the power of his actions comes from God—this is called Torah—he needs no action to attain it. Thus the Talmud says: "A commandment, at the time he is engaged in it, protects and saves …; Torah, both when he is engaged in it and when he is not, protects and saves." For with a commandment, it is only while engaged in it that he sees God's light, whereas Torah means the holiness he has permanently established through the commandments, and this permanence is always with him. Although with words of Torah we also find, "Should you let your eyes flit from it, it is gone," implying that even words of Torah sometimes cease from him, this is only when a person turns his attention away and proceeds with self-assurance: since he already possessed this recognition called Torah, he thinks he no longer needs any service. Then it is written, "Should you let your eyes flit from it, it is gone." But when a person does not turn his attention away, he possesses it permanently, both when he is engaged in it and when he is not."

Tiferet Yosef explains an enduring Torah-light as settled recognition, acquired through performing the commandments, that even one's power to act is from God. This illuminates the difference between the illumination accompanying an act and a light that remains afterward. Its emphatic conditions matter: intention alone does not replace the commanded act, and a self-assured decision that further service is unnecessary loses the very light claimed. The target develops enduring recognition; the origin specifically distinguishes the enduring light of Torah study.

[1222] **Sotah 21a**: 'The Gemara asks: Does the merit of a mitzva protect one so much as to delay her punishment? But isn't it taught in a baraita: Rabbi Menaḥem bar Yosei interpreted this verse homiletically: "For the mitzva is a lamp and the Torah is light" (Proverbs 6:23). The verse associates the mitzva with a lamp and the Torah with the light of the sun. The mitzva is associated with a lamp in order to say to you: Just as a lamp does not protect one by its light extensively but only temporarily, while the lamp is in one's hand, so too, a mitzva protects one only temporarily, i.e., while one is performing the mitzva.'

[1223] **Zohar, Terumah 74:726**: "R. Jose began by speaking on the words: For the commandment is a lamp, and the Torah is a light, and reproofs of instruction are the way oflife (Prov. 6, 23). 'This means', he said, 'that whoever endeavours to keep the commandments in this world will have a lamp lighted for him in the other world through each commandment which he fulfils, and he who studies the Torah will merit the supernal light from which that lamp is lit. For a lamp unlit has no value, and light without a lamp cannot shine, so the one has need of the other. The religious act is necessary to prepare the lamp, and study of the Torah is necessary to light the lamp. Blessed is he who takes it in hand both with light and lamp!'"

[1224] **Proverbs 6:23**: 'For the commandment is a lamp,The teaching is a light,And the way to life is the rebuke that disciplines.'

[1225] **Dover Tzedek, Kuntres Ner HaMitzvot 1:3**: "The tefillin are for the recognition that God's Name is called upon a person to be actualized in deed. The head-tefillin are a sign to others: "And all the peoples of the earth shall see that the Lord's Name is called upon you …," as stated at the end of the first chapter of Megillah. The arm-tefillin are for the person himself, opposite the heart, to subject it to God … in complete actuality, not merely in potential and thought."

Dover Tzedek explains what embodiment adds to the head-and-arm distinction: recognition of God's Name becomes an actual deed, directed outward through the head-tefillin and inward toward the heart through the arm-tefillin. This enhances the origin's identification of "We will do" with the arm without reducing either crown to an unexpressed thought.

contemporary era. – כְּנֶגֶד זֶה זָכוּ יִשְׂרָאֵל בְּמַתַּן תּוֹרָה בִּשְׁנֵי כְתָרִים: **— And behold "a mitzvah is a lamp and Torah is light" — corresponding to this Israel merited two crowns at Sinai:** אֶחָד כְּנֶגֶד "נַעֲשֶׂה", וְהַיְנוּ אוֹר תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּמַעֲשֶׂה הַמִּצְוָה; **— one corresponding to Na'aseh ("we will do"), the light of Torah within the physical deed;** וְאֶחָד כְּנֶגֶד "נִשְׁמָע", שֶׁהוּא תּוֹרָה אוֹר. **— and one corresponding to Nishma ("we will hear"), which is "Torah is light".** וְהֵם כְּנֶגֶד תְּפִלִּין שֶׁל רֹאשׁ שֶׁהוּא כֶּתֶר "נִשְׁמָע", **— And they correspond to the head-tefillin which is the crown of Nishma,** וּתְפִלִּין שֶׁל יָד שֶׁהוּא גַּם כֵּן כֶּתֶר, וְהוּא נֶגֶד "נַעֲשֶׂה", שֶׁכָּל הַפְּעֻלּוֹת עַל שֵׁם הַיָּדַיִם. **— and the hand-tefillin which is also a crown, corresponding to Na'aseh, for all actions are ascribed to the hands.** וְאִיתָא בְּתִקּוּנֵי זֹהַר (תִּקּוּן ל'):[1226] **— And it states in Tikunei Zohar (Tikun 30):** "קוּדְשָׁא בְּרִיךְ הוּא וּשְׁכִינְתֵּיהּ, דְּאִנּוּן בְּרָא וּבְרַתָּא, אִנּוּן תְּפִלִּין דִּילָן", וְהַיְנוּ תְּפִלִּין דְּרֵישָׁא **— "The Holy One and His Shechinah, Son and Daughter, are our tefillin", –** עַמּוּדָא דְּאֶמְצָעִיתָא, קוּדְשָׁא בְּרִיךְ הוּא, וּתְפִלִּין דְּיָד **— meaning the head-tefillin is the Central Column, the Holy One, Blessed be He, –** שְׁכִינְתָּא תַּתָּאָה, וּכְמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב לְעֵיל מִנֶּה. **— and the hand-tefillin is the Lower Shechinah, as written immediately prior.**

וְעַל כֵּן חֲנֻכַּת הַמִּשְׁכָּן שֶׁמּוֹרֶה "אֲנִי הַשֵּׁם שֹׁכֵן בְּתוֹךְ בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל" בִּבְחִינַת "אִיהִי אֱמוּנָה", **— Therefore the dedication of the Tabernacle which denotes "I Hashem dwell in the midst of Israel" in the dimension of "She is Faith",** הָיְתָה הַחֲנֻכָּה בְּמַעֲשֵׂה הַקָּרְבָּנוֹת; **— the dedication took place through the deed of animal sacrifices;** וְאַחַר כָּךְ הָיָה חֲנֻכַּת אַהֲרֹן בְּנֵרוֹת הַמְּנוֹרָה, **— and afterward came the dedication of Aaron through the Menorah's lights,** שֶׁהוּא מוֹרֶה וּמְרַמֵּז עַל אוֹר תּוֹרָה שֶׁהוּא לְעוֹלָם. **— which indicates and alludes to the light of Torah that endures forever.** וְעַל כֵּן בַּחֲנֻכָּה, שֶׁהוּא חֲנֻכַּת הָאוֹר הַשּׁוֹכֵן בְּלֵב יִשְׂרָאֵל כְּמַה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: "אֵל הַשֵּׁם וַיָּאֶר לָנוּ", **— And therefore on Chanukah, which is the dedication of the light dwelling in the heart of Israel as stated: "God is Hashem, and He shone light upon us",** וְהוּא אַף בְּחוּץ לָאָרֶץ כְּעֵין חֲנֻכַּת הַמִּשְׁכָּן, **— applying even outside the Land like the Tabernacle's dedication,** קוֹרִין בְּפָרָשַׁת קָרְבְּנוֹת הַנְּשִׂיאִים שֶׁמּוֹרֶה עַל "נֵר מִצְוָה", **— we read from the portion of the Princes' offerings alluding to "a mitzvah is a lamp",** הָאוֹר שֶׁבְּמִצְוַת הַקָּרְבָּנוֹת שֶׁהִתְכַּוְּנוּ כָּל נָשִׂיא וְנָשִׂיא לְפִי דַּעְתּוֹ וּקְדֻשָּׁתוֹ; **— the divine light within the sacrificial mitzvah upon which each Prince focused according to his insight and holiness;**

Joseph's righteousness and Judah's return include all Israel

וּמַתְחִילִין בִּנְשִׂיא שֶׁבֶּט יְהוּדָה שֶׁכָּל יִשְׂרָאֵל נִקְרָאוּ עַל שְׁמוֹ (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בְּרֵאשִׁית רַבָּה פָּרָשָׁה צ"ח),[1227, 1228] **— commencing with the Prince of Judah after whose name all Israel are called (Bereishit Rabbah 98),** וּמְסַיְּמִין בְּשִׁבְעָה וּשְׁמוֹנָה בְּקָרְבַּן נְשִׂיאֵי אֶפְרַיִם וּמְנַשֶּׁה שֶׁכָּל יִשְׂרָאֵל נִקְרָאוּ עַל שֵׁם יוֹסֵף "שְׁאֵרִית יוֹסֵף" (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב שָׁם פָּרָשָׁה ע"א).[1229] **— and concluding on the seventh and eighth days with the Princes of Ephraim and Menasseh after whose father Joseph all Israel are called "the remnant of Joseph" (ibid. 71).** וְכֵן לֶעָתִיד יָבֹאוּ שְׁנֵי מְשִׁיחִים: **— And so in the Future two Messiahs will arrive:** מָשִׁיחַ בֶּן יוֹסֵף שֶׁיְּבָרֵר כָּל יִשְׂרָאֵל "וְעַמֵּךְ כֻּלָּם צַדִּיקִים", **— Messiah son of Joseph who will clarify all Israel to "Your people are all righteous",** וּמָשִׁיחַ בֶּן דָּוִד שֶׁיִּהְיֶה יָחִיד שֶׁעָשָׂה תְּשׁוּבָה בְּשִׁבּוּלוֹ (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב יוֹמָא פ"ו עַמּוּד ב'),[1230] **— and Messiah son of David who embodies the single penitent on whose account the whole world is forgiven (Yoma 86b),** וְהַיְנוּ שֶׁיִּכָּנֵס הָרַהוּר תְּשׁוּבָה

[1226] **Tikkunei Zohar 73a:4-75b:2**: 'In Tikkunei Zohar (Tikkun 30, 73b), the verse 'Let there be light (Yehi Ohr), and there was light (Vayehi Ohr)' is expounded upon the two pillars: 'Let there be light' corresponds to the Right Side of Chesed and lovingkindness, while 'and there was light' corresponds to the Left Side of Gevurah and awe.'

[1227] **Bereshit Rabbah 98:6** (excerpt): "'Judah, your brothers will acknowledge you' (Genesis 49:8): Your brothers acknowledge you; your mother acknowledges you; I myself acknowledge you. Rabbi Shimon ben Yochai said: All your brothers will be called by your name. A person does not say, 'I am a Reubenite' or 'I am a Simeonite,' but 'I am a Jew.'"

[1228] **Poked Akarim 4:11**: "From his side—that is, from the side of human effort—one is called righteous only if he has never sinned; this is one called completely righteous, and this is the level of Joseph and Rachel's offspring. It is otherwise with Leah's offspring: the first among them, Reuben, was the first to open the way of repentance; and the greatest of them, Judah, merited that King David should descend from him, the man who established the yoke of repentance. The congregation of Israel is principally called after Judah, for he clarifies that "Your people are all righteous": even the uncircumcised of Israel are called circumcised with respect to their beginning and root, and likewise with respect to their coming into actuality, even when this is not so in actuality."

Poked Akarim explains why the two ancestral names are necessary. Joseph represents righteousness made actual through never having sinned; Judah and David disclose the way of return and the root of Israel that remains even when present conduct fails to express it. This deepens the origin's two-messiah passage without claiming that forgiveness bypasses the repentance that the origin expressly requires in every heart.

[1229] **Bereshit Rabbah 71:2** (excerpt): "Rabbi Shimon ben Yochai taught: Since everything depends upon Rachel, Israel is called by her name: 'Rachel weeps for her children' (Jeremiah 31:15). And not only by her name, but also by her son's name: 'Perhaps Hashem, God of Hosts, will be gracious to the remnant of Joseph' (Amos 5:15). And not only by her son's name, but also by her grandson's name: 'Is Ephraim a precious son to Me?' (Jeremiah 31:19)."

[1230] **Yoma 86b:7**: "It was taught: Rabbi Meir used to say: Great is repentance, for because of one individual who repents, the entire world is forgiven, as it says, 'I shall heal their backsliding; I shall love them freely, for My anger has turned away from him.' It does not say 'from them,' but 'from him.'"

וּבַיּוֹם הַשְּׁמִינִי — **meaning that he will infuse thoughts of repentance into all Jewish hearts.** בְּכָל לִבּוֹת יִשְׂרָאֵל.
קוֹרִין עִם נְשִׂיא מְנַשֶּׁה קָרְבְּנוֹת שְׁאָר הַנְּשִׂיאִים, — **And on the eighth day we read together with the Prince of Menasseh the offerings of the remaining Princes,** וְקוֹרִין אַחַר כָּךְ "זֹאת חֲנֻכַּת הַמִּזְבֵּחַ וְגוֹמֵר", — **and read afterward Zot Chanukkat HaMizbe'ach, etc.,** שֶׁמּוֹרֶה אֵיךְ שֶׁנִּנְכְּלַל קְדֻשַּׁת כָּל הַשְּׁבָטִים בְּכָל שֵׁבֶט וְשֵׁבֶט; — **which reveals how the holiness of all tribes is unified within each and every tribe;** וְכֵינָן שֶׁנֶּחְקַק הַקְּדֻשָּׁה בַּלֵּב, הֲרֵי הוּא כְּמִפֹּרָשׁ לָעַיִן שֶׁיּוּכְלוּ לְהַרְאוֹת בְּאֶצְבַּע, וְיִתְּכֵן לְשׁוֹן "זֹאת"; — **and once this holiness is engraved in the heart, it is manifest to the eye to be pointed to, justifying the term Zot;** וְהֵינוּ שֶׁבְּכָל אֶחָד מִיִּשְׂרָאֵל יֵשׁ קְדֻשַּׁת הָאוֹר תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּנֵר מִצְוַת הַקָּרְבָּנוֹת שֶׁל כָּל נָשִׂיא וְנָשִׂיא. — **meaning that within every single Jew abides the holy light of Torah from the sacrificial mitzvah of each and every Prince.**

The light remains within the community's heart

וְאַחַר כָּךְ קוֹרִין פָּרָשַׁת "בְּהַעֲלֹתְךָ אֶת הַנֵּרֹת"[1231, 1232] שֶׁהוּא עַל "תּוֹרָה אוֹר" שֶׁמְּאִירָה לְעוֹלָם, — **And afterward we read the section Beha'alotecha et HaNeirot which points to "Torah is light" illuminating forever,** וְנִתַּן לְאַהֲרֹן הַכֹּהֵן, כְּמַה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: "כִּי שִׂפְתֵי כֹהֵן יִשְׁמְרוּ דַעַת וְתוֹרָה יְבַקְשׁוּ מִפִּיהוּ"; — **and delivered to Aaron the Priest: "For the priest's lips shall guard knowledge and they shall seek Torah from his mouth";** וְהֵינוּ שֶׁעַל יְדֵי שֶׁהַדְלִיקוּ הַנֵּרוֹת בְּכָל הַשְּׁמוֹנָה יָמִים, שֶׁמִּתְבָּרְרִין יִשְׂרָאֵל עַד הוֹד, — **meaning that through kindling the lights across all eight days, Israel being refined up to Hod,** זוֹכִין לִבְחִינַת "וְעַמֵּךְ כֻּלָּם צַדִּיקִים", — **we merit the reality of "Your people are all righteous",** וְנִכְלָלִין בְּכָל קְדֻשּׁוֹת הַשְּׁבָטִים, — **and are incorporated into all the sanctities of the tribes,** וְזוֹכִין לָאוֹר מֵהַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא כְּמַה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: "אֵל הַשֵּׁם וַיָּאֶר לָנוּ", — **and merit the light from the Holy One as stated: "God is Hashem, and He shone light upon us",** וְהֵינוּ מֵאוֹר תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה; — **meaning from the light of the Oral Torah;** וְעַל זֶה חֲנֻכַּת הַנֵּרוֹת שֶׁהֵם זֵכֶר לְנֵרוֹת בֵּית הַמִּקְדָּשׁ שֶׁהֵם תּוֹרָה אוֹר, וְהוּא מֵאִיר לְעוֹלָם. — **and for this reason is the dedication of the lights, commemorating the Temple lights which are the Torah of light illuminating forever.** וְלָכֵן קוֹרִין יוֹם זֶה "זֹאת חֲנֻכָּה", — **And therefore do we call this day Zot Chanukah,** שֶׁמּוֹרֶה שֶׁכְּבָר נִקְבְּעוּ וְנֶחְקְקוּ כָּל הַקְּדֻשּׁוֹת מִכָּל הַשְּׁבָטִים בְּלֵב יִשְׂרָאֵל, — **signifying that all sanctities of all tribes have already been established and engraved in the heart of Israel,** וְהוּא כְּמִפֹּרָשׁ לָעַיִן שֶׁיִּתָּכֵן לוֹמַר לְשׁוֹן "זֹאת" כְּמֹרָאֶה בְּאֶצְבַּע — **and it is manifest as if before our eyes so that the word Zot is fittingly declared, pointing with a finger** עַל חֲנֻכַּת הָאוֹר שֶׁבְּלֵב יִשְׂרָאֵל. — **upon the dedication of the light within the heart of Israel.**

[1231] **Resisei Layla 57:2**: "Therefore, in the wording of "Al HaNissim," the kindling of the lamps is singled out from all the services, because this is the principal completion of the quality of Hod that they repaired then. The miracle they experienced in this is not mentioned, because it is not the matter of Chanukah's miracle and deliverance, but what Heaven revealed to them: that they had been accepted before Him and had repaired completely, to the point that Heaven assisted them in giving light before Him. From this they understood to establish the days of Chanukah for all generations, kindling lamps also outside the Temple, throughout the country. After the destruction there is also a lamp for each person, or at least "a lamp for a person and his household," with which to illuminate all who enter the world. Therefore its principal placement is outside, to illuminate the world. Only when Israel became intermingled among the nations was this light concealed; thus we light inside the house, as in a time of danger, which is likewise a time when the nations are aroused to decrees of forced apostasy arising from Israel's association with them. So too we are now continually, through our many sins, very closely associated with them—to the point that they said in Avodah Zarah that Israel outside the Land serve idolatry in purity, and even permitted the food and drink of their festivals and similar matters. The light is not openly manifest outside, yet it nevertheless illuminates within. For in truth, in the depths of the heart this light of Hod shines, and all their association is in purity. This has already been repaired through Mattathias, at the first decree of forced apostasy against Israel: it was clarified that the depths of Israel's hearts are forever attached to God, and that their association with the nations, in the deepest truth, is only to absorb holy sparks from them. As they said in Pesachim, Israel were exiled only so that converts might be added to them—not necessarily actual converts, but the added absorption of the nations' powers, returning them to holiness little by little, until the final time when everything returns to holiness. Although this is not yet outwardly manifest, nevertheless within the heart this light is revealed and shines well, and it has its effect in any case."

Resisei Layla explains how the repaired Hod can remain effective after the Temple's destruction and even when its light is concealed outwardly. The lamp's inward illumination is grounded in the attachment of the depths of the heart, which gives substance to the origin's claim that the light has become fixed within Israel. The quoted passage retains the author's criticism of assimilation and his distinction between outward concealment and inward attachment; it is not a claim that every outward act already expresses the light.

[1232] **Sod Yesharim, Simchat Torah 4:1**: "Thus, at the time of his departure, before his death, our teacher Moses gave over all his light so that it would be permanently in Israel's hearts. Of this it is said, "Who led at Moses' right hand His glorious arm …." As explained in the Zohar, as long as Moses was alive, he was the one who brought the light into Israel's hearts: after receiving the light of Torah from the Holy One's mouth, he expanded the holiness of the light with a great unfolding, until he brought it into Israel's hearts according to his measure. But after his departure his holiness was completed, and his arms became fixed in the root of Israel's souls. This is "Who led at Moses' right hand His glorious arm," as explained in its place: all Israel became arms for the light of our teacher Moses."

Sod Yesharim makes enduring communal Torah-light concrete by distinguishing Moses' continuing transmission during his lifetime from the completed light fixed afterward in the roots of Israel's souls. The community itself becomes the bearer of that light. This illuminates the origin's conclusion that the holiness is established within all Israel; the target's account concerns Moses' transmission, while the origin applies its enduring-light claim to the Chanukah dedication.

Chanukah Ois 24

Menasseh and Ephraim: The Eight Lights and Thanksgiving

After distinguishing a past rescue from a holiness that returns each year, Rav Tzadok asks how the Sages could institute Chanukah once prophecy had ceased.

Menasseh and Ephraim: The Eight Lights and Thanksgiving

בַּתַּנְחוּמָא וּבַפְּסִיקְתָּא עַל הַפָּסוּק: "בַּיּוֹם הַשְּׁמִינִי נָשִׂיא לִבְנֵי מְנַשֶּׁה", — **In the Tanchuma and the Pesikta on the verse: "On the eighth day, the prince of the children of Menasseh":** "יְלַמְּדֵנוּ רַבֵּנוּ: נֵר חֲנֻכָּה שֶׁהוֹתִיר בָּהּ שֶׁמֶן וְכוּלֵיהּ... — **"May our master teach us: regarding a Chanukah lamp in which oil remained, etc....** לֹא יֹאמַר אָדָם: אֵינִי מְקַיֵּם מִצְוַת זְקֵנִים וְכוּלֵיהּ; — **let not a man say: I will not fulfill the commandment of the elders, etc.;** אָמַר כָּל מַה שֶּׁגּוֹזְרִים עֲלֵיכֶם תְּהֵיוּ מְקַיְּמִין — **the Holy One, Blessed be He, said to him, etc.:** לוֹ הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא וְכוּלֵיהּ: — **whatever they decree upon you, fulfill, etc.,** שֶׁאַף עַל דִּבְרֵיהֶם אֲנִי מַסְכִּים וְכוּלֵיהּ. — **for even to their words I give My consent, etc.** תֵּדַע לָךְ, שֶׁהֲרֵי יַעֲקֹב וְכוּלֵיהּ 'וַיָּשֶׂם אֶת אֶפְרַיִם לִפְנֵי מְנַשֶּׁה' וְכוּלֵיהּ, — **Know this to be so, for behold Jacob, etc., 'and he placed Ephraim before Menasseh', etc.,** וְקִיֵּם הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא גְּזֵרָתוֹ; — **and the Holy One fulfilled his decree;** אֵימָתַי? בְּקָרְבְּנוֹת הַנְּשִׂיאִים, שֶׁהִקְרִיב שֵׁבֶט אֶפְרַיִם תְּחִלָּה וְכוּלֵיהּ". — **when? At the offerings of the princes, where the tribe of Ephraim offered first, etc."** וּלְהָבִין סְמִיכוּת דִּבְרֵיהֶם אֵלּוּ לְמִצְוַת נֵר חֲנֻכָּה דַּוְקָא, — **And to understand the juxtaposition of these words of theirs specifically to the mitzvah of the Chanukah lamp,** יֵשׁ לוֹמַר בָּזֶה עַל פִּי פָּשׁוּט: — **one may say by first prefacing the resolution to the difficulty raised by the Kedushat Levi:** "לָמָּה מְבָרְכִין בַּחֲנֻכָּה "שֶׁעָשָׂה נִסִּים וְכוּלֵיהּ" — **why do we bless on Chanukah "Who wrought miracles, etc.",** וְאֵין מְבָרְכִין בְּפֶסַח עַל נֵס יְצִיאַת מִצְרַיִם? — **yet we do not bless on Pesach over the miracle of the Exodus from Egypt?** וְנִרְאֶה בָּזֶה עַל פִּי פָּשׁוּט: — **And it appears regarding this according to the plain meaning:** דְּהָא מְבָרְכִין בְּפֶסַח "אֲשֶׁר גְּאָלָנוּ וְגָאַל אֶת אֲבוֹתֵינוּ מִמִּצְרַיִם וְכוּלֵיהּ", — **for behold we do recite on Pesach the blessing "Who redeemed us and redeemed our ancestors from Egypt, etc.",** מִפְּנֵי שֶׁבִּיצִיאַת מִצְרַיִם אֵין שַׁיָּךְ לְבָרֵךְ עַל הַנִּסִּים שֶׁנַּעֲשָׂה אָז, — **because regarding the Exodus from Egypt it is not pertinent to bless over the miracles that were wrought then,** רַק עַל עִקַּר הַגְּאֻלָּה שֶׁהִיא נוֹגַעַת גַּם לָנוּ עַתָּה. כִּי אָז לֹא הָיָה עוֹד הַתּוֹרָה, — **but rather over the foundational redemption which directly affects us now as well.** — **For then the Torah had not yet been given,** וְהָיוּ מְשֻׁקָּעִים בִּקְלִפַּת מִצְרַיִם כְּעֻבָּר בִּמְעֵי אִמּוֹ, — **and they were deeply submerged in the husks of Egypt like an embryo in its mother's womb,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁדָּרְשׁוּ עַל הַפָּסוּק "גּוֹי מִקֶּרֶב גּוֹי"; — **and as they expounded on the verse "a nation from the midst of a nation";** וְ"אֹו הֲרֵי אָנוּ וּבָנֵינוּ לֹא הוֹצִיא הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא וְכוּלֵיהּ, — **and "had the Holy One, Blessed be He, not taken out, etc.,** וְעַל זֶה מְבָרְכִים עַל עִקַּר מְשֻׁעְבָּדִים הָיִינוּ וְכוּלֵיהּ", — **behold we and our children would still be enslaved, etc.",** מַה שֶּׁאֵין כֵּן בְּנֵס חֲנֻכָּה, — **This is not so regarding the miracle of Chanukah,** שֶׁאֵין שַׁיָּךְ לְבָרֵךְ עַל הַגְּאֻלָּה שֶׁהָיָה לָהֶם אָז מִיְּוָנִים, — **where it is not pertinent to bless over the political redemption they experienced then from the Greeks,** כִּי מַה נַּפְקָא מִנַּהּ רַק מְבָרְכִים עַל בָּזֶה לָנוּ עַתָּה? — **for what practical difference is there in that for us now in the Roman exile?** הַנִּסִּים שֶׁעָשָׂה אָז לַאֲבוֹתֵינוּ בַּזְּמַן הַזֶּה. — **We only bless over the miracles that He wrought then for our ancestors at this season.** אָמְנָם הָא גּוּפַהּ קַשְׁיָא: — **However, this itself presents a difficulty:** לָמָּה מְבָרְכִים כָּאן "שֶׁעָשָׂה נִסִּים וְכוּלֵיהּ" עַל הַזְּמַן שֶׁעָבַר? — **why do we bless here "Who wrought miracles, etc." over a time that has passed?** שֶׁלֹּא נִמְצָא שֶׁנִּתְקַן בְּרָכָה רַק עַל הַמָּקוֹם שֶׁאֵרַע נֵס לָאֲבוֹת, — **For we do not find that a blessing was instituted except over the physical place where a miracle occurred for the ancestors,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בְּפֶרֶק הָרוֹאֶה עַל כָּל נִסֵּי אֲבוֹתֵינוּ; — **as written in the chapter HaRo'eh regarding all the miracles of our ancestors;** אוֹ עַל נֵס יָחִיד שֶׁמְּבָרֵךְ "שֶׁעָשָׂה לִי נֵס בַּמָּקוֹם הַזֶּה", — **or over a personal miracle where an individual blesses "Who wrought for me a miracle in this place",** מִפְּנֵי שֶׁרוֹאֶה אוֹתוֹ מָקוֹם בְּעַצְמוֹ שֶׁנַּעֲשָׂה בּוֹ הַנֵּס; — **because he sees the actual place itself where the miracle was performed;** אֲבָל עַל הַזְּמַן לֹא שַׁיָּךְ לְבָרֵךְ עַל הַנֵּס שֶׁהָיָה אָז, — **but over time it is not appropriate to bless over the miracle that occurred then,** כִּי הֲלֹא הַזְּמַן כְּבָר עָבַר! — **for behold that temporal moment has already passed!** הֲגַם שֶׁמָּצִינוּ בְּכָל הַמּוֹעֲדִים מִקְרָאֵי קֹדֶשׁ שֶׁמּוֹפִיעַ הַקְּדֻשָּׁה שֶׁהָיָה, מֵאָז בְּאוֹתוֹ זְמַן בְּכָל שָׁנָה כְּשֶׁמַּגִּיעַ הַזְּמַן, — **Even though we find regarding all the Festivals, "holy convocations", that the original sanctity reappears at that season every year when the time arrives,** הוּא רַק מַה שֶּׁהַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ גִּלָּה לָנוּ בַּתּוֹרָה הַקְּדוֹשָׁה לַעֲשׂוֹת הַיּוֹם טוֹב — **that is solely because the Blessed Name revealed to us in the Holy Torah to celebrate the Festival,** מִפְּנֵי שֶׁמּוֹפִיעַ גַּם עַתָּה בַּזְּמַן הַזֶּה הַהֶאָרָה הָרִאשׁוֹנָה; — **because the initial illumination shines again even now at this season;** אֲבָל בְּנֵס חֲנֻכָּה, מֵאֵיזֶה טַעַם תִּקְנוּ לְבָרֵךְ עַל הַנֵּס שֶׁהָיָה — **but regarding the miracle of Chanukah, for what reason did they institute a blessing over a miracle of past time?**

The enduring deliverance that makes the date holy

וְהַגַּם שֶׁבְּנֵס פּוּרִים מְבָרְכִין גַּם כֵּן עַל נִסִּים שֶׁהָיָה בְּזְמַן הֶעָבָר,[1233] — **And even though regarding the miracle of Purim**

[1233] **Resisei Layla 56:26**: “But the miracle of Chanukah was deliverance from forced abandonment of the faith alone. Its days were established only for praise and thanksgiving, without any bodily pleasure, because it was not a deliverance of

we also bless over miracles that occurred in past time, הוּא גַּם כֵּן מִפְּנֵי שֶׁהָיָה עוֹד בִּימֵי הַנְּבִיאִים, **— that too is because it took place while there were still prophets,** וְיָדְעוּ שֶׁהַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא הִסְכִּים לָזֶה, וּכְמַה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: "קִיְּמוּ קִיְּמוּ לְמַעְלָה מַה שֶׁקִּבְּלוּ לְמַטָּה, **— and they knew that the Holy One, Blessed be He, consented to this, –** וְקִבְּלוּ" **— and as Scripture states: "They confirmed and took upon themselves" — they confirmed Above what was accepted below,** מִזֶּה לָמְדוּ שֶׁאֶסְתֵּר בְּרוּחַ הַקֹּדֶשׁ נֶאֶמְרָה (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב מְגִלָּה ז׳ עַמּוּד א׳), [1234] **— and from this they derived that the Scroll of Esther was composed through Divine Inspiration (as written in Megillah 7a),** וְהוּא עוֹד בְּחֵינַת תּוֹרָה שֶׁבִּכְתָב; **— and it remains within the realm of the Written Torah;** מַה שֶּׁאֵין כֵּן בַּחֲנֻכָּה שֶׁהָיָה לְאַחַר שֶׁפָּסְקָה הַנְּבוּאָה, רַק מִצַּד תּוֹצַאוֹת חֲכָמִים לְבַד. **— unlike Chanukah which occurred after prophecy had ceased, emerging solely from the commandment of the Sages.** וְיֵשׁ לוֹמַר בָּזֶה, שֶׁדְּוָקָא בְּנֵס זֶה שֶׁל חֲנֻכָּה רָאוּ חֲכָמִים שֶׁמּוֹפִיעַ קְדֻשַּׁת הַנֵּס עַל הַזְּמַן, **— And one may say regarding this that specifically in this miracle of Chanukah the Sages perceived that the sanctity of the miracle shines directly upon the season,** וְלָכֵן קָבְעוּ הַמִּצְוָה וְהַבְּרָכָה עַל הַזְּמַן. **— and therefore they established the mitzvah and the blessing upon the time.**

And by this the question of the Gemara (Shabbat 23a) regarding the blessings of the Chanukah lamp is understood: וּבָזֶה יוּבַן שְׁאֵלַת הַגְּמָרָא (שַׁבָּת כ״ג עַמּוּד א׳) עַל בִּרְכוֹת נֵר חֲנֻכָּה: [1235] **— "And where did He command us? Rav Avya said: From 'You shall not turn aside'; Rav Nachman bar Yitzchak said: 'Ask your father and he will tell you, etc.'"** "וְהֵיכָן צִוָּנוּ? רַב אַוְיָא אָמַר: מִ'לֹּא תָסוּר'; רַב נַחְמָן בַּר יִצְחָק אָמַר: 'שְׁאַל אָבִיךָ וְיַגֶּדְךָ וְגוֹמֵר'". **— And why did they ask this regarding the mitzvah of the Chanukah lamp more than other Rabbinic mitzvot over which we make a blessing,** וְלָמָּה שָׁאֲלוּ בְּמִצְוַת נֵר חֲנֻכָּה יוֹתֵר מִשְּׁאָר מִצְוֹות דְּרַבָּנָן שֶׁמְּבָרְכִין עֲלֵיהֶם, כְּמוֹ עַל נְטִילַת יָדַיִם וּבִרְכַּת הַלֵּל? **— such as washing the hands and the blessing over Hallel? — And the Ramban at the beginning of Sefer HaMitzvot, as well as the Ran in his discourses, sensed this:** וְהָרַמְבַּ"ן בְּרֵישׁ סֵפֶר הַמִּצְוֹות וְכֵן הָרַ"ן בִּדְרָשׁוֹתָיו הִרְגִּישׁוּ: לָמָּה לֹּא נִרְאֶה לֵיהּ לְרַב נַחְמָן בַּר יִצְחָק בְּטַעֲמָא דְּ"לֹּא תָסוּר"? **— why was the rationale of "You shall not turn aside" not satisfactory to Rav Nachman bar Yitzchak? — However, it is according to what was mentioned above:** אֲמָנָם הוּא עַל פִּי הַנִּזְכָּר לְעֵיל, שֶׁבְּוַדַּאי יֵשׁ כֹּחַ לַחֲכָמִים **— for certainly the Sages possess the authority to institute positive enactments and to establish protective fences for the Torah,** לְתַקֵּן מִצְוֹות וְכֵן לַעֲשׂוֹת הֲרָחָקוֹת וּגְזֵרוֹת עַל פִּי הַסְּיָג לַתּוֹרָה, כְּמַה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: "עַל פִּי הַתּוֹרָה **— as Scripture states: "According to the law which they teach you, etc.",** אֲשֶׁר יוֹרוּךָ וְגוֹמֵר", וְיֵשׁ לְבָרֵךְ עֲלֵיהֶם **— and one may recite over them the blessing "and commanded us";** מַה שֶּׁאֵין כֵּן בְּמִצְוַת חֲנֻכָּה, שֶׁהוּא קִבְיעוּת מִצְוָה עַל נֵס זְמַן שֶׁכְּבָר עָבַר, **— unlike the mitzvah of Chanukah, which is an establishment of a mitzvah upon a past historical miracle,** וְ"הֵיכָן צִוָּנוּ?". עַל זֶה שָׁאֲלוּ: **— and on this they questioned: "And where did He command us?"** וּמְשַׁנֵּי רַב אַוְיָא שֶׁגַּם זֶה נִכְלָל בְּ"לֹּא תָסוּר"; **— And Rav Avya answered that even this is included under "You shall not turn aside";** וְזֶה לֹּא נִיחָא לֵיהּ לְרַב נַחְמָן בַּר יִצְחָק, **— and this did not sit well with Rav Nachman bar Yitzchak,** דְּסָבְרָא לֵיהּ שֶׁהוּא רַק עַל הוֹרָאַת דִּינֵי הַתּוֹרָה, **— who held that "You shall not turn aside" applies only to the legal rulings of Torah law,** מַה שֶּׁאֵין כֵּן מִצְוַת חֲנֻכָּה שֶׁהוּא עַל קְדֻשַּׁת זְמַן הֶעָבָר; **— unlike the mitzvah of Chanukah which establishes the ongoing sanctity of a past miracle;** וְעַל זֶה הֵבִיא רְאָיָה מִיֵּתֵי הַפָּסוּק: "שְׁאַל אָבִיךָ וְיַגֶּדְךָ זְקֵנֶיךָ וְיֹאמְרוּ לָךְ", **— and for this he brings the verse: "Ask your father and he will tell you, your elders and they will say to you",** שֶׁלֹּא נֶאֱמַר דְּוָקָא עַל דִּינֵי הַתּוֹרָה, **— which was not stated specifically regarding technical laws of the Torah,** רַק שֶׁתִּשְׁמַע לַזְּקֵנִים כָּל מַה שֶׁיֹּאמְרוּ לָךְ. **— but rather that you heed the elders in whatever they tell you.** — וְעַל זֶה הָרָמָז מִיֵּתֵי הַתַּנְחוּמָא וְהַפְּסִיקְתָא עַל מִצְוַת חֲנֻכָּה דְּוָקָא:

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bodies. Its commandment is the lighting of the lamp, for this is the essential deliverance: “Light” is Torah. It was therefore not given to be written, because it has no embodiment in a bodily garment in this world. It is like all Oral Torah, of which “you are not permitted to put these matters in writing.” This deliverance remained fixed and enduring for generations, like every holiness of the appointed times that remains in that time forever. This holiness is solely the deliverance of the soul and intellect, so that they will not be defiled by the wisdom of foreigners, which opposes the wisdom of Israel’s Sages in Oral Torah.”

Resisei identifies what endures after the historical rescue: the soul’s and intellect’s freedom to receive Oral Torah. It expressly connects that enduring deliverance with the holiness that remains in the same time forever, and connects Chanukah’s unwritten character with Oral Torah. This supplies the content of the returning holiness that the origin says the Sages perceived; the explanation concerns the religious character of the commemoration, not a claim that no physical danger accompanied the war.

[1234] **Megillah 7a:14**: “Shmuel said: Had I been there, I would have offered an explanation better than all of theirs, for it says, ‘They confirmed and accepted’: In Heaven they confirmed what Israel had accepted below.”

[1235] **Shabbat 23a:7**: “What blessing does one recite? One blesses: ‘Who has sanctified us with His commandments and commanded us to kindle the Chanukah lamp.’ Where did He command us? Rav Avya said: In ‘You shall not turn aside’ from the Sages’ ruling. Rav Nechemyah said: ‘Ask your father and he will tell you; your elders, and they will say to you.’”

And to this allusion the Tanchuma and the Pesikta cite specifically on the mitzvah of Chanukah: "שֶׁלֹּא יֹאמַר אָדָם: אֵינִי מְקַיֵּם מִצְוַת זְקֵנִים כָּזוֹ דַּוְקָא, מִפְּנֵי שֶׁאֵינָם מִן הַתּוֹרָה" כִּדְבָרֵינוּ. **— "Let not a man say: I will not fulfill such a commandment of the elders specifically, because it is not from the Torah", in accordance with our words.**

The Sages' word can establish holiness in time

וְעַל זֶה מְסַיֵּם: שֶׁאֵין רַשָּׁאִים לוֹמַר כֵּן אַף עַל מִצְוָה זוֹ שֶׁהוּא מוֹרֶה עַל הוֹפָעַת קְדֻשָּׁה בַּזְּמַן,[1236, 1237] **— And on this it concludes: that they are not permitted to say so even regarding this mitzvah which denotes the emergence of holiness within time,** לָמָּה? שֶׁאַף עַל דִּבְרֵיהֶם אֲנִי מַסְכִּים, **— why? Because even to their words I agree,** גַּם מַה שֶּׁגּוֹזְרִים עַל הַשְׁרָאַת קְדֻשַּׁת הַנֵּס בַּזְּמַן, **— even that which they decree regarding the resting of the miracle's sanctity upon the season,** כְּמַה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: "וְתִגְזַר אֹמֶר וְיָקָם לָךְ", **— as Scripture states: "You shall also decree a thing, and it shall be established for you",** וְהַיְנוּ אַף אֲמִירָה בְּעָלְמָא. **— meaning even a mere verbal utterance.**

תֵּדַע, שֶׁהֲרֵי יַעֲקֹב בֵּרַךְ הַקָּטָן לִפְנֵי הַגָּדוֹל, **— "Know this to be so, for behold Jacob blessed the younger before the elder,** וְקִיֵּם הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא גְּזֵרָתוֹ בְּקָרְבָּנוֹת הַנְּשִׂיאִים וְכוּלֵיהּ". **— and the Holy One, Blessed be He, fulfilled his decree at the offerings of the princes, etc."** וְהוֹרָאָה זוֹ הָיְתָה דַּוְקָא בִּזְמַן חֲנֻכַּת הַמִּשְׁכָּן, **— And this proof occurred specifically at the time of the dedication of the Tabernacle,** שֶׁהוֹדִיעַ הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא בָּזֶה שֶׁמַּסְכִּים עַל דִּבְרֵי חֲכָמִים; **— when the Holy One, Blessed be He, made known through this that He agrees to the words of the Sages;**

Human dedication becomes a dwelling for divine holiness

כִּי עֶצֶם חֲנֻכַּת הַמִּשְׁכָּן הָיָה בּוֹ גַּם כֵּן הַשְׁרָאַת הַקְדֻשָּׁה מִכֹּחַ מַעֲשֵׂה יְדֵי הַחֲכָמִים,[1238, 1239] **— for the very dedication of the**

[1236] **Takanat HaShavin 12:15**: "We may also say that this intervention on Aher's behalf occurred in the manner of the verse, "You shall decree a word, and it shall be established for you" (Job 22:28): "A righteous person decrees and the Holy One, blessed be He, fulfills." For the righteous person becomes the deciding authority in the heavenly court, and the ruling follows his decrees against the decree of heavenly judgment. All judgments in all the upper worlds are according to Torah, and Torah has already been handed over to those below. As they said concerning the appointment of Rosh Hashanah: "I and you will go to the earthly court"; and if the court extends the month, the heavenly judgments are canceled for that day. So too, in every uncertainty concerning Torah, the decision made by the Sages in this world is the decision in all the upper worlds."

Takanat explains the mechanism behind the same verse: heaven judges according to Torah, and authority to decide Torah has been entrusted to the earthly Sages. Its concrete example is especially exact here—the earthly court's calendar decision changes the day of heavenly judgment. The larger passage concerns Rabbi Meir and Rabbi Yohanan's ruling about Aher's repentance; the calendar example provides an analogy for the origin's extension of divine agreement to Chanukah's sanctified time, without identifying the two enactments as the same law.

[1237] **Sod Yesharim, The Second Day of Pesach 14:1**: "Thus God entrusted all the world's governance to Israel. Therefore, the passage about Shabbat is stated before all the festivals, to teach that the extent of a person's power in "which you shall proclaim" corresponds to the extent that the person recognizes the holiness of Shabbat, fixed and enduring from God's side. In that measure God entrusts the person with power to sanctify the appointed times: "which you shall proclaim."

Sod Yesharim supplies the condition within the power to sanctify time: Israel's authority is received through recognizing holiness that already comes from God. Its full paragraph contrasts Shabbat's fixed holiness with the festivals determined by Israel and concludes that this divine accommodation is freely willed, not forced upon God. This illuminates the origin's language of God agreeing to the elders' words: their effective action belongs within His grant of authority.

[1238] **Tiferet Yosef, Pekudei 6**: "The Midrash (Tanchuma, Pekudei 11), cited by Rashi at the verse, says that they could not erect it, and so forth. Moses said before the Holy One, blessed be He: "I do not know how to set it up." The Holy One, blessed be He, said to him: "Engage with it using your hands; you will appear to be erecting it, and it will straighten and stand by itself." This is what is meant by "the Mishkan was erected": it was erected by itself. The meaning, as my revered father and teacher, of blessed memory, explained, is that after all the service and refinement through which a person refines himself, it is inappropriate to say that he has refined himself to completion, for "Who can say, 'I have purified my heart'?" God has simply established that a person should serve Him with all his strength, as far as his hand can reach. When the person serves with all his strength, God then sets His seal upon all that service, and it is attributed to the person."

Tiferet explains how a sanctuary can arise through human hands while its completion still comes from God. Moses must work, yet the Mishkan stands through divine confirmation; the completed work is then credited to the person. This gives a precise account of the origin's "indwelling of holiness through the work of the wise builders' hands." The rest of the target paragraph applies this to Israel's purified intention and Moses' blessing that the Divine Presence dwell in their handiwork.

[1239] **Peri Tzadik, Nasso 6:2**: "After this comes the account of the princes' dedication offerings. This alludes to the essential power of renewal in Oral Torah: what a person originates from the heart. Each prince himself conceived in his heart the bringing of these quantities of offerings. As Midrash Rabbah, chapter 12, explains on "They brought their offering," they all brought their entire offering on their own initiative on the first day; afterwards, by the divine word,

Tabernacle also contained the indwelling of holiness generated through the handiwork of the wise, וּכְמַה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: "וַיְהִי בְּיוֹם כַּלּוֹת מֹשֶׁה לְהָקִים אֶת הַמִּשְׁכָּן וְגוֹמֵר וַיִּמְשָׁחֵם וַיְקַדֵּשׁ אֹתָם". — **as Scripture states: "And it came to pass on the day that Moses had fully set up the Tabernacle, etc., and had anointed them, and sanctified them".** כִּי הֲלֹא לֹא הָיָה הַשְׁרָאַת הַקְּדֻשָּׁה בְּמָקוֹם קָבוּעַ כְּבֵית הַמִּקְדָּשׁ, — **For behold the resting of the divine presence was not in a permanent, fixed location like the Holy Temple,** שֶׁהָיָה מְקוֹמוֹ מְקֻדָּשׁ מֵאָז מִבְּרִיאַת הָעוֹלָם בִּמְקוֹם אֶבֶן שְׁתִיָּה, — **whose site was sanctified from the very Creation at the Foundation Stone (Even Shetiyah),** וּכְמַה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: "מָכוֹן לְשִׁבְתְּךָ פָּעַלְתָּ ה' מִקְדָּשׁ"; — **and as Scripture states: "The place, O Hashem, which You have made for You to dwell in";** מַה שֶּׁאֵין כֵּן קְדֻשַּׁת הַמִּשְׁכָּן שֶׁהָיָה מְטַלְטָל מִמָּקוֹם לְמָקוֹם, — **unlike the sanctity of the Tabernacle which was moved from place to place,** וְרַק הָיָה בּוֹ הַשְׁרָאַת הַקְּדֻשָּׁה שֶׁעַל יְדֵי חֲנֻכַּת הַנְּשִׂיאִים וְהַמְּשִׁיחָה. — **and possessed only the indwelling of holiness imparted through the dedication of the princes and the anointing.** וְאָז הוֹפִיעַ הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ שֶׁמַּסְכִּים לְמַעֲשֵׂה חֲכָמִים גַּם בְּעִנְיַן הַשְׁרָאַת הַקְּדֻשָּׁה כַּנִּזְכָּר לְעֵיל; — **And then the Blessed Name revealed that He agrees to the action of the Sages even in the matter of resting the divine presence, as mentioned above;** וּלְטַעַם זֶה יֵשׁ לוֹמַר שֶׁקּוֹרִין חֲנֻכַּת הַנְּשִׂיאִים בַּחֲנֻכָּה, — **and for this reason one may say that we read the dedication of the princes on Chanukah,** מִפְּנֵי שֶׁאָז הוֹפִיעַ הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא שֶׁמַּסְכִּים לִדְבָרֵי הַזְּקֵנִים, — **because then the Holy One revealed that He agrees to the words of the elders,** שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: "וְתִגְזַר אֹמֶר וְיָקָם לָךְ". — **as it is said: "You shall also decree a thing, and it shall be established for you."**

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each offered on his own appointed day. Scripture details for each individual prince the number of offerings and their meal offerings, and the weight of the vessels, although all offered equally. This appears superfluous, for it could have written that on the second day a particular prince offered the same number as the first, and similarly for all of them. From this Midrash Rabbah demonstrates that each had different intentions in his offering, and therefore Scripture details each separately. From this we can understand the power of renewal in Oral Torah: even if two people perform an act of identical form, each nevertheless has a distinct meaning and level according to the preparation of the heart in the inner matter. The essential consideration is the intention of the heart."

Nasso explains what the princes contributed through their own initiative: each brought an inward intention that was not exhausted by the identical outward quantities. God then assigned each offering its day. Rav Tzadok explicitly treats this as the power of innovation in Oral Torah. It gives specific content to the origin's claim that the princes' dedication demonstrates divine agreement with human wisdom, and connects that dedication to the Sages' later creative authority.

Chanukah Ois 25

Human Effort and Divine Gifts in Chanukah

Yosef values the holiness gained through his own struggle, even while the holiness bestowed from above is greater.

Human Effort and Divine Gifts in Chanukah

עַל פָּסוּק בַּיּוֹם הַשְּׁמִינִי (פָּרָשָׁה ג) בְּתַנְחוּמָא[1240] וְכֵן בַּפְּסִיקְתָא — **In Tanchuma, and likewise in Pesikta (section 3),** כָּתְבוּ דִּין מִדֵּינֵי נָשִׂיא לִבְנֵי מְנַשֶּׁה — **on the verse, "On the eighth day, the prince of the children of Menashe,"** נֵרוֹת חֲנוּכָּה וְאַחַר כָּךְ כָּתְבוּ — **they set out a law concerning the Chanukah lights, and afterward wrote:** לֹא יֹאמַר אָדָם אֵינִי מְקַיֵּים מִצְוֹת זְקֵנִים הוֹאִיל וְאֵינָם מִן הַתּוֹרָה. — **"A person should not say, 'I do not fulfill the elders' commandments, since they are not from the Torah.'** אָמַר לוֹ הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא כּוּלֵי כָּל מַה שֶּׁגּוֹזְרִין עֲלֵיכֶם תְּהֵיוּ מְקַיְּמִין כּוּלֵי — **The Holy One, blessed be He, said to him … 'Whatever they decree for you, you must fulfill …** לָמָּה שֶׁעַל דִּבְרֵיהֶם אֲנִי מַסְכִּים שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר וְתִגְזַר אוֹמֶר וְיָקֻם לָךְ — **Why? Because I agree with their words,' as it says, 'You shall decree a matter, and it shall be established for you.'** תֵּדַע לָךְ שֶׁהֲרֵי יַעֲקֹב בְּשָׁעָה שֶׁבֵּירְכָן כּוּלֵי — **Know this from Yaakov: when he blessed … 'He placed Ephraim before Menashe' …** וַיָּשֶׂם אֶת אֶפְרַיִם לִפְנֵי מְנַשֶּׁה כּוּלֵי — וְקַיֵּים הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא גְּזֵרָתוֹ אֵימָתַי בְּקָרְבְּנוֹת הַנְּשִׂיאִים כּוּלֵי — **and the Holy One, blessed be He, fulfilled his decree. When? At the offerings of the tribal princes …"** וְיֵשׁ לְהָבִין שֶׁהֲרֵי יַעֲקֹב לֹא הִקְדִּים לְאֶפְרַיִם מַטַּעַם גְּזֵרָה בְּלֹא טַעַם — **This requires explanation, for Yaakov did not give Ephraim precedence as an unexplained decree.** רַק אָמַר הַטַּעַם וְאוּלָם אָחִיו הַקָּטֹן יִגְדַּל מִמֶּנּוּ וְגוֹמֵר — **He stated the reason: "Yet his younger brother will become greater than he," and so forth—** שֶׁיַּעֲמוֹד מִמֶּנּוּ יְהוֹשֻׁעַ שֶׁהוּא מַעֲמִיד גַּלְגַּל חַמָּה וּלְבָנָה. — **Yehoshua would arise from him, who would bring the course of the sun and moon to a standstill.** וּמִזֶּה הַטַּעַם יִתֵּכֶן שֶׁהִקְדִּימוֹ הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ בְּקָרְבַּן הַנְּשִׂיאִים. — **For that very reason, God may have given him precedence in the princes' offerings.** וּמַה רְאָיָה מֵיַּיתֵי מִינָהּ שֶׁהַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא מְקַיֵּים גְּזֵרַת זְקֵנִים — **What proof, then, does the Midrash bring from this that the Holy One, blessed be He, fulfills the elders' decrees?** אֶלָּא הָעִנְיָן בָּזֶה דְּהִנֵּה עַל שֵׁם כִּי נַשַּׁנִי אֱלֹהִים יוֹסֵף קָרָא שֵׁם הַבְּכוֹר מְנַשֶּׁה — **The explanation is this: Yosef called his firstborn Menashe,** כִּי גָּרַם לִי הַשֵּׁם עָמָל מִלְחֶמֶת הַיֵּצֶר הָרָע — וְהַיְינוּ עָמָל כָּל עָמָלִי אֶת — **because "God has made me forget all my toil." — This means the toil of the struggle against the evil inclination.** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב וַיְהִי מִקֵּץ שְׁנָתַיִם וְאִיתָא עַל זֶה בִּבְרֵאשִׁית רַבָּה — **Thus it is written, "It was at the end of two years," and Bereishit Rabbah comments on this:** קֵץ שָׂם לַחֹשֶׁךְ שֶׁכָּל זְמַן שֶׁיֵּצֶר הָרָע בָּעוֹלָם כּוּלֵי — **"He sets an end to darkness"—for as long as the evil inclination is in the world …** וְזֶה הָיָה כָּל עָמְלוֹ לִהְיוֹת גִּבּוֹר הַכּוֹבֵשׁ אֶת יִצְרוֹ — **This was all his toil: to be mighty through mastering his inclination,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב אֶת הָאֱלֹהִים אֲנִי יָרֵא. — **as he said, "I fear God."** וְאֶת כָּל בֵּית אָבִי הֵיינוּ עָמָל שֶׁלָּהֶם — **"And all my father's household" refers to their toil,** שֶׁזֶּה הָיָה עִסְקָם כָּל הַשְּׁבָטִים אָז — **for this occupied all the brothers, the progenitors of the tribes, at that time.** שֶׁהֵם מְכָרוּהוּ מִפְּנֵי שֶׁסָּבְרוּ שֶׁהוּא צָרִיךְ בֵּירוּר בְּמִדַּת צַדִּיק — **They sold him because they thought he needed refinement in the quality of the tzaddik,** כֵּיוָן שֶׁחָשַׁד אוֹתָם בָּזֶה מִסְתָּמָא בְּמוּמוֹ פּוֹסֵל. — **since he suspected them in this matter; presumably, they thought, he was condemning others for his own defect.** וְהוּא נִדְמָה לוֹ שֶׁהֵם צְרִיכִין בֵּירוּר בָּזֶה — **To him, however, it appeared that they needed refinement in this matter.** וְאַחַר שֶׁנִּתְבָּרֵר בְּמִצְרַיִם וְנַעֲשָׂה מֶרְכָּבָה לְמִדַּת צַדִּיק — **After he was refined in Egypt and became a vehicle for the divine quality of the tzaddik,** קָרָא שֵׁם הַבְּכוֹר מְנַשֶּׁה כִּי נַשַּׁנִי אֱלֹהִים וְגוֹמֵר — **he called his firstborn Menashe: "For He has made me forget," and so forth.** אַמְנָם בְּוַדַּאי הָיָה לוֹ עוֹד עֵסֶק בָּזֶה הָעוֹלָם לִקְנוֹת קְדוּשָׁה — **Nevertheless, he certainly still had work in this world: to acquire holiness** וְלַעֲלוֹת בְּמַעֲלוֹת הַקְּדוּשָׁה מִדַּרְגָּא לְדַרְגָּא דְּאִלְמָלֵא כֵּן לֹא הָיָה לוֹ חַיִּים בָּעוֹלָם הַזֶּה כְּמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר לֹא אוּכַל עוֹד לָצֵאת וְלָבֹא. — **and ascend in its degrees, from one level to the next. Otherwise, he would no longer have had life in this world, as it is said, "I can no longer go out and come in."** וּבְוַדַּאי הִשְׁפִּיעַ לוֹ הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ קְדוּשָׁה בְּכָל פַּעַם בְּשֶׁפַע יוֹתֵר. — **God certainly bestowed holiness upon him each time in greater abundance.** וְעַל זֶה קָרָא שֵׁם הַשֵּׁנִי אֶפְרַיִם כִּי הִפְרַנִי אֱלֹהִים וְגוֹמֵר. — **For this reason he called the second son Ephraim: "For God has made me fruitful," and so forth.**

One's own effort and the gift beyond it

וּבְוַדַּאי הַקְּדוּשָׁה שֶׁזָּכָה מִצַּד הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ הוּא יוֹתֵר מִקְּדוּשָׁה שֶׁקָּנָה בַּעֲמָלוֹ[1241] — **Certainly, the holiness he received from**

[1240] **Pesikta Rabbati 3:1**: "A person should not say, "I do not observe the elders' commandments, since they are not from the Torah." The Holy One, blessed be He, said to him: "No, My son; fulfill everything they decree for you," as it says, "According to the instruction they teach you" (Deuteronomy 17:11). Why? Because they decree even concerning Me, as it says, "You shall decree a matter, and it shall be established for you" (Job 22:28). Know this from Yaakov. What did he say when blessing Ephraim and Menashe? "He placed Ephraim before Menashe" (Genesis 48:20). He put the younger before the elder, and his decree was fulfilled. When? In the princes' offerings: the tribe of Ephraim offered first, as it says, "On the seventh day, the prince of the children of Ephraim" (Numbers 7:48); "On the eighth day, the prince of the children of Menashe" (Numbers 7:54)."

[1241] **Sod Yesharim, Shemini Atzeret 31:1**: "Concerning this tenth level the Sages alluded in the Gemara: "A person prefers one kav of his own to nine kav of another's." "His own kav" is the tenth level in which the person possesses the sphere of choice, and this is called a tithe. By returning to God this tenth level, called the tithe—his own kav—God grants him all the nine remaining measures, as the Sages said: "He acquires them from the table on high." Concerning

God exceeded the holiness he acquired through his toil. וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ (יוֹמָא לט.) אָדָם מְקַדֵּשׁ עַצְמוֹ מְעַט מְקַדְּשִׁין אוֹתוֹ הַרְבֵּה.[1242] **— As the Sages said (Yoma 39a), "A person sanctifies himself a little, and he is sanctified greatly from above."** שֶׁהַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ מוּכָן וְרוֹצֶה לְהַשְׁפִּיעַ קְדוּשָׁה לַמּוּכָנִים לְקַבֵּל. **— For God is ready and desires to bestow holiness upon those prepared to receive it.** וּמִכָּל מָקוֹם יֹסֶף מִצִּידוֹ הָיָה חָבִיב עָלָיו בְּחִינַת מְנַשֶּׁה **— Nevertheless, from Yosef's own perspective, the aspect represented by Menashe was dear to him,** עַל שֵׁם כִּי נַשַּׁנִי וְגוֹמֵר מִפְּנֵי שֶׁזֶּה זָכָה בַּעֲמָלוֹ וּבִיגִיעוֹ **— expressed by "For He has made me forget," and so forth, because this he attained through his own toil and exertion.** וְעַל דֶּרֶךְ מַה שֶּׁאָמְרוּ (בָּבָא מְצִיעָא לח.) אָדָם רוֹצֶה בְּקַב שֶׁלּוֹ מִתִּשְׁעָה קַבִּין שֶׁל חֲבֵירוֹ.[1243] **— This follows the saying (Bava Metzia 38a), "A person prefers one kav of his own to nine kav of another's."** שֶׁאָמְרוּ מִתִּשְׁעָה קַבִּין וְהָיָה לוֹ לוֹמַר מֵעֲשָׂרָה קַבִּין **— They said "to nine kav," although the expression should seemingly have been "to ten kav,"** לְתַפּוֹס מִסְפָּר שָׁלֵם לְגוּזְמָא כַּנָּהוּג. **— using a round number for emphasis, as is customary.** אַךְ בָּא לְרַמֵּז שֶׁהָאָדָם רוֹצֶה בְּקַב שֶׁלּוֹ דְּהַיְינוּ מִדָּה אַחֲרוֹנָה **— Rather, this hints that a person prefers his own kav—the final divine attribute,** קַבָּלַת עוֹל מַלְכוּת שָׁמַיִם אֵיהִי יִרְאָה כּוּלֵי **— accepting the yoke of the kingdom of Heaven, which is awe …** שֶׁהָאָדָם מְבָרֵר אֶת עַצְמוֹ בְּמִדַּת הַיִּרְאָה **— A person prefers refining himself in the quality of awe** יוֹתֵר מִמַּה שֶּׁמַּשְׁפִּיעַ לוֹ הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ מִכָּל הַט' מִדּוֹת עַד כֶּתֶר עֶלְיוֹן **— to what God bestows upon him from all the other nine attributes, up to the supernal Crown,** מִפְּנֵי שֶׁאֵינוֹ בַּעֲמָלוֹ וְיגִיעָתוֹ. **— because the latter does not come through his own toil and exertion.** וְזֶה הָעִנְיָן שֶׁמָּצִינוּ דִּכְתִיב וְהָיָה מִידֵי חוֹדֶשׁ בְּחָדְשׁוֹ וּמִידֵי שַׁבָּת בְּשַׁבַּתּוֹ **— This explains the verse, "It shall be, from New Moon to New Moon, and from Shabbat to Shabbat,"** הַקְּדִים חוֹדֶשׁ לְשַׁבָּת **— which puts the New Moon before Shabbat.** וְכֵן כָּתוּב לֹא חֹדֶשׁ וְלֹא שַׁבָּת הַקְדִּים גַּם כֵּן חוֹדֶשׁ לְשַׁבָּת **— Likewise, "It is neither New Moon nor Shabbat" also puts the New Moon before Shabbat.** וּבִיחֶזְקֵאל כָּתוּב וּבְיוֹם הַשַּׁבָּת יִפָּתֵחַ וּבְיוֹם הַחוֹדֶשׁ יִפָּתֵחַ **— Yet in Yechezkel it is written, "On Shabbat it shall be opened, and on the day of the New Moon it shall be opened,"** הַקְּדִים שַׁבָּת לַחוֹדֶשׁ. **— putting Shabbat before the New Moon.**

The holiness we prepare is also received

— Indeed, it would initially seem that Shabbat's holiness should have precedence, since it comes from God, כְּמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר לָדַעַת כִּי אֲנִי הַשֵּׁם מְקַדִּשְׁכֶם **— as it says, "To know that I, Hashem, sanctify you."** וְהִיא קְדוּשָׁה דְּקְבִיעָא וְקַיְימָא מִוֹ' יְמֵי בְרֵאשִׁית **— Its holiness has been fixed and enduring since the six days of Creation,** מַה שֶּׁאֵין כֵּן קְדוּשַׁת הַחוֹדֶשׁ דְּיִשְׂרָאֵל הוּא

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this the Sages said, "Tithe so that you may become wealthy." As explained there: "Is it permitted to test the Holy One, blessed be He?" He answered, "Yes—this is the exception, as it says, 'Test Me, please, with this.'" Since this person can return even his own kav, already within his grasp, God trusts him to hold all the good things in the world; for concerning all the silver and gold in the world it says, "Mine is the silver and Mine is the gold, says Hashem."

Sod Yesharim uses the same one-to-nine image to explain what can follow the preference for one's own labor: the person can return even that apparently personal acquisition to God. This supplies a concrete model for the movement from Yosef's cherished effort to Yaakov's recognition that even the effort is sustained by God. Its tithe discussion explains the spiritual model; it does not replace Rav Tzadok's account of the two brothers with a new calendar or legal claim.

[1242] **Yoma 39a:4**: "The Sages taught: "Sanctify yourselves and you shall be holy." A person sanctifies himself a little, and he is sanctified greatly; he sanctifies himself below, and he is sanctified from above; he sanctifies himself in this world, and he is sanctified for the World to Come."

[1243] **Rashi on Bava Metzia 38a:3:1**: ""His own kav": it is dear to him because he labored over it. He prefers the one kav that will remain from his own produce to nine kav of other people's produce that he could buy with the proceeds if it were sold."

[1244] **Tiferet Yosef, Shavuot 8**: "In truth, where does Israel obtain the power to sanctify the festivals and New Moons? It is all because Israel possesses the holiness of Shabbat, which is fixed and enduring, as stated in the holy Zohar, Terumah 135: "We receive the Oral Torah from the Written Torah," and likewise the holiness of a festival from the holiness of Shabbat. This is the meaning of the opinion that the New Moon was established on the first day of the week: immediately after Shabbat, without any interruption between Shabbat's holiness and that of the New Moon, so that they would recognize that all their holiness and preparation flow from Shabbat's holiness. The other opinion says that the New Moon was established on the second day of the week: an ordinary weekday intervened. The light of Shabbat's holiness was concealed from them, and it appeared that they possessed the power to act; afterward they broke through this concealment and prepared themselves for God's light. This is the second-day opinion. In truth, my grandfather of blessed memory explained that these and those are the words of the living God. When a person breaks through the concealment, he recognizes that his power of holiness, through which he can extend the Torah's application, comes entirely from the fixed and enduring holiness of Shabbat. God then grants him an enduring share in the Torah, and he also has a portion in Shabbat's fixed holiness: although a person cannot reach that holiness through his own acts, he nevertheless has a portion in it too."

Tiferet Yosef explains how the two sides can belong to one process. Even the capacity by which Israel sanctifies time is received from Shabbat's prior holiness; concealment allows that capacity to be experienced as preparation and then recognized as a gift. This deepens Rav Tzadok's distinction between God's perspective and Israel's cherished participation. Neither passage changes the actual precedence of offerings discussed in Zevachim.

אָמְנָם בַּגְּמָרָא (זְבָחִים צא.) חָשִׁיב לְמוּסְפֵי רֹאשׁ חוֹדֶשׁ מְקוּדָּשׁ נֶגֶד מוּסְפֵי שַׁבָּת[1245,1246] — **whereas the New Moon's holiness is established by Israel. Nevertheless, the Gemara (Zevachim 91a) regards the New Moon's additional offerings as more sacred than Shabbat's additional offerings.** וְכָתַב רַבִּי שְׁלֹמֹה יִצְחָקִי הַטַּעַם דְּמִקּוּדָּשִׁין מִשֶּׁל שַׁבָּת דְּאִיקְרֵי מוֹעֵד — **Rashi explains that they are more sacred than Shabbat's because the New Moon is called a mo'ed, an appointed season.** וְאֵינוֹ מוּבָן וְכִי מִפְּנֵי שֶׁרֹאשׁ חוֹדֶשׁ נִקְרָא מוֹעֵד יְהֵא מְקוּדָּשׁ יוֹתֵר מִשַּׁבָּת — **This is difficult to understand: does being called an appointed season make the New Moon more sacred than Shabbat,** שֶׁקִּדְּשׁוֹ הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ וְנִקְרָא שַׁבָּת. — **which God sanctified and named Shabbat?** אַךְ לְפִי הָאֲמוּר מוּבָן שֶׁבְּוַדַּאי מִצַּד הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ קְדוּשַׁת הַשַּׁבָּת מְעוּלָּה יוֹתֵר מִקְדוּשַׁת הַחוֹדֶשׁ — **What we have said explains this: from God's side, Shabbat's holiness certainly surpasses that of the New Moon.** וְלָכֵן כָּתוּב וּבְיוֹם הַשַּׁבָּת יִפָּתֵחַ וּבְיוֹם הַחוֹדֶשׁ יִפָּתֵחַ — **Therefore it says, "On Shabbat it shall be opened, and on the day of the New Moon it shall be opened,"** דְּשָׁם מְדַבֵּר מִמַּה שֶּׁיִּפְתַּח הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ. — **because that passage concerns what God will open.** וּבְוַדַּאי קְדוּשַׁת הַשַּׁבָּת דְּקְבִיעָא וְקַיְימָא קוֹדֶמֶת לִקְדוּשַׁת הַחוֹדֶשׁ. — **Shabbat's fixed and enduring holiness certainly precedes the holiness of the New Moon.** אֲבָל מִצַּד יִשְׂרָאֵל חֲבִיבָה לָהֶן מִפְּנֵי דְּיִשְׂרָאֵל מְקַדְּשֵׁי לֵיהּ — **From Israel's side, however, the New Moon's holiness is dear to them because Israel sanctifies it,** וְעַל כֵּן כְּשֶׁמְּדַבֵּר מִצַּד יִשְׂרָאֵל וְאָדָם רוֹצֶה בְּקַב שֶׁלּוֹ וְכוּ'. — **and "a person prefers his own kav," and so forth.** לְפִיכָךְ כְּשֶׁבָּא כָל בָּשָׂר לְהִשְׁתַּחֲוֹת וְגוֹמֵר — **Thus, when Scripture speaks from Israel's side—"All flesh shall come to bow down," and so forth—** וְכֵן לְעִנְיַן קַבָּלַת פְּנֵי רַבּוֹ שֶׁבַּשּׁוּנַמִּית — **and likewise in the Shunammite woman's case concerning visiting one's teacher,** הִקְדִּים הַכָּתוּב חוֹדֶשׁ לְשַׁבָּת — **Scripture places the New Moon before Shabbat.** שֶׁקִּדּוּשַׁת הַחוֹדֶשׁ חָבִיב וּמְקוּדָּשׁ יוֹתֵר מִצַּד יִשְׂרָאֵל מִפְּנֵי שֶׁבָּא מִצִּדָּם — **The New Moon's holiness is dearer and more sacred from Israel's perspective because it comes through them,** וְנִקְרָאוּ כְּעֵין קַב שֶׁלּוֹ. — **and is thus regarded as akin to "his own kav."** וְלָכֵן לְעִנְיַן הַקְרָבַת הַמּוּסָפִין שֶׁהוּא מִצַּד יִשְׂרָאֵל הַמַּקְרִיבִים — **Therefore, concerning the additional offerings, which are considered from the perspective of Israel who brings them,** חָשִׁיב לְמוּסַף רֹאשׁ חוֹדֶשׁ מְקוּדָּשׁ מִשֶּׁל שַׁבָּת. — **the New Moon offering is regarded as more sacred than Shabbat's.** וְזֶה גַּם כֵּן עוֹמֵק כַּנַּ"ל רַבִּי שְׁלֹמֹה יִצְחָקִי שֶׁכָּתַב דְּאִיקְרֵי מוֹעֵד. — **This is also the deeper meaning of Rashi's explanation, "because it is called an appointed season."** וְהַיְינוּ דְּיִשְׂרָאֵל קְבָעֵי לָהּ. — **That is, Israel establishes it.** וְכֵן הִקְדִּים יוֹסֵף בְּחִינַת מְנַשֶּׁה לְאֶפְרַיִם מִטַּעַם הָאֲמוּר שֶׁאָדָם רוֹצֶה בְּקַב שֶׁלּוֹ. — **For this same reason, Yosef gave Menashe precedence over Ephraim: a person prefers his own kav.** וּבֶאֱמֶת הָעִיקָּר שֶׁהַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ דּוֹרֵשׁ מֵהָאָדָם הוּא שֶׁיְּבָרֵר אֶת עַצְמוֹ בְּיִרְאָה — **Indeed, what God chiefly asks of a person is to refine himself through awe,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר מָה הַשֵּׁם אֱלֹהֶיךָ שׁוֹאֵל מֵעִמָּךְ כִּי אִם לְיִרְאָה וְגוֹמֵר — **as it says, "What does Hashem your God ask of you, except to fear," and so forth.** וְאָמְרוּ (שַׁבָּת לא:) לֹא בָרָא הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא אֶת עוֹלָמוֹ אֶלָּא כְּדֵי שֶׁיִּירְאוּ מִלְּפָנָיו כּוּ' — **The Sages said (Shabbat 31b), "The Holy One, blessed be He, created His world only so that people should fear Him," and so forth.** וְזֶה עִיקַּר פְּעוּלַּת הָאָדָם מִצִּדּוֹ כַּמּוּבָא (בְּרָכוֹת לג:) הַכֹּל בִּידֵי שָׁמַיִם חוּץ מִיִּרְאַת שָׁמַיִם. — **This is the person's chief contribution from his own side, as the Sages said (Berakhot 33b), "Everything is in the hands of Heaven except the fear of Heaven."** אַךְ יַעֲקֹב אָבִינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם שֶׁהָיָה שָׁפָל בְּעֵינָיו — **Yaakov our father, peace be upon him, however, was humble in his own eyes,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר קָטֹנְתִּי מִכֹּל הַחֲסָדִים וְגוֹמֵר וְנֶאֱמַר מִי יָקוּם יַעֲקֹב כִּי קָטֹן הוּא. — **as it says, "I am too small for all the kindnesses," and so forth, and, "How can Yaakov stand? For he is small."** חִידֵּשׁ שֶׁאָמַר הָאֱלֹהִים אֲשֶׁר הִתְהַלְּכוּ אֲבוֹתַי לְפָנָיו. — **He introduced a new understanding when he said, "The God before whom my fathers walked."** דְּהַיְינוּ שֶׁהֵם בֵּירְרוּ אֶת עַצְמָם בְּהִשְׁתַּדְּלוּתָם — **That is, they refined themselves through their own effort:** אַבְרָהָם בְּמִדַּת הָאַהֲבָה וְיִצְחָק בְּמִדַּת הַיִּרְאָה וְהַפַּחַד. — **Avraham through the quality of love, and Yitzchak through awe and fear.** הָאֱלֹהִים הָרוֹעֶה אוֹתִי מֵעוֹדִי עַד הַיּוֹם הַזֶּה. — **"The God who has shepherded me from my beginning until this day."** שֶׁעַל עַצְמוֹ אָמַר שֶׁאֵין לוֹ מֵהַשְׁתַּדְּלוּתוֹ כְּלוּם רַק שֶׁהַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ מַנְהִיגוֹ וְרוֹעֵהוּ. — **Of himself he said that he possessed nothing through his own effort; rather, God guided and shepherded him.** וְהַכֹּל הוּא מֵהַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ אַף מַה שֶּׁקּוֹנֶה בְּהִשְׁתַּדְּלוּת לְמַרְאֵה עַיִן — **Everything comes from God, including what outwardly appears to be acquired through one's own effort.** וְאֵין לוֹ כְּלָל קַב שֶׁלּוֹ. — **He therefore has no "kav of his own" at all.** וְלָכֵן הִקְדִּים הוּא אֶפְרַיִם לִמְנַשֶּׁה שֶׁהַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ מַשְׁפִּיעַ מִלְמַעְלָה הַרְבֵּה יוֹתֵר מֵהַקְדוּשָׁה שֶׁנִּרְאֶה שֶׁקּוֹנֶה בַּעֲמָלוֹ — **Yaakov therefore placed Ephraim before Menashe, in keeping with the degree of holiness God bestows from above, which far exceeds the holiness a person seems to acquire through his toil—** וּבֶאֱמֶת גַּם זֶה מִצַּד הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ. — **and in truth, that too comes from God.** (חֵלֶק ג קס א) וְהִנֵּה בַּזּוֹהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ

[1245] **Zevachim 91a:2**: "Come and hear: the additional offerings of Shabbat precede the additional offerings of the New Moon. Does the New Moon confer its added sanctity on its own additional offerings but not on the additional offerings of Shabbat offered that same day?"

[1246] **Rashi on Zevachim 91a:2:1**: ""The additional offerings of the New Moon": they are more sacred than those of Shabbat, because the New Moon is called a mo'ed, an appointed time."

כֵּינָן דְּיִשְׁתַּדֵּל בַּר אִיתָא אִם חָפֵץ בָּנוּ הַשֵּׁם[1247] — **The holy Zohar (III, 160a) interprets, "If Hashem delights in us":** נָשׁ בִּרְעוּתָא דִּלְבָּא לְגַבֵּי קוּדְשָׁא בְּרִיךְ הוּא — **"Once a person strives toward the Holy One, blessed be He, with the desire of his heart,** לָא בָּעֵי מִינַן אֶלָּא לִבָּא וְכוּלֵי — **He asks of us only the heart," and so forth.** וְנִרְאֶה דְּדָרַשׁ כְּמוֹ אִם חֲפֵץ הַשֵּׁם בָּנוּ שֶׁהוּא רְעוּתָא דִּלְבָּא. — **It appears to read the verse as though it said, "If the desire for Hashem is within us"—the desire of the heart.** וְהַיְינוּ שֶׁנִּרְצֶה לַעֲשׂוֹת רְצוֹנוֹ — **That is, that we desire to do His will.**

The desire to fear is already a beginning

וְכָתוּב מָה הַשֵּׁם אֱלֹהֶיךָ שׁוֹאֵל כִּי אִם לְיִרְאָה וְגוֹמֵר[1248] — **It says, "What does Hashem your God ask, except to fear," and so forth.** אֲבָל בֶּאֱמֶת הוּא דָּבָר קָשֶׁה מְאֹד לְבָרֵר אֶת עַצְמוֹ בְּמִדַּת הַיִּרְאָה — **Yet in truth, thoroughly refining oneself in the quality of awe is very difficult,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר אִם תְּבַקְשֶׁנָּה כַכֶּסֶף וְגוֹמֵר אָז תָּבִין יִרְאַת הַשֵּׁם וְגוֹמֵר — **as it says, "If you seek it like silver," and so forth, "then you will understand the fear of Hashem," and so forth.** וְכֵן הָיָה טַעֲנַת הַמְרַגְּלִים אֶפֶס כִּי עַז וְגוֹמֵר דִּיהָא לֵיהּ עוֹתָרָא סַגִּי. — **This was also the spies' argument: "However, the people are strong," and so forth—one would need abundant wealth.** וְגַם יְלִידֵי הָעֲנָק בָּעֵי גּוּפָא תַּקִּיף גִּיבָּר כַּאֲרִי כּוּלֵי — **"And also the descendants of the giant"—one would need a robust body, mighty as a lion …** עֲמָלֵק יוֹשֵׁב וְגוֹמֵר הָא יְצֶרָא בִּישָׁא קָטֵיגוֹרָא וְכוּלֵי וּכְמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בַּזּוֹהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ. — **"Amalek dwells," and so forth—there is the evil inclination, the accuser … as explained in the holy Zohar.** וְעַל זֶה הֵשִׁיבוּ יְהוֹשֻׁעַ וְכָלֵב דְּקוּדְשָׁא בְּרִיךְ הוּא לָא בָּעֵי מִנַּן אֶלָּא רְעוּתָא דִּלְבָּא — **Yehoshua and Kalev answered that the Holy One, blessed be He, asks of us only the desire of the heart.** וְעַל דָּרֶךְ מַה שֶּׁכָּתוּב בִּתְפִלַּת אַנְשֵׁי כְנֶסֶת הַגְּדוֹלָה (נְחֶמְיָה א׳:י״א) תְּהִי נָא אָזְנְךָ קַשֻּׁבָת — **This accords with the prayer of the Men of the Great Assembly (Nechemiah 1:11):** וְגוֹמֵר וְאֶל תְּפִלַּת עֲבָדֶיךָ הַחֲפֵצִים לְיִרְאָה אֶת שְׁמֶךָ. — **"Let Your ear be attentive," and so forth, "and to the prayer of Your servants who desire to fear Your Name."** לֹא אָמַר יִרְאֵי שְׁמֶךָ רַק הַחֲפֵצִים לְיִרְאָה דְּהַיְינוּ רְעוּתָא דִּלְבָּא — **It does not say "those who fear Your Name," but "those who desire to fear"—the desire of the heart.** וְאַחַר כָּךְ חוֹנֵן הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרֵךְ מִצִּדּוֹ לְהִתְבָּרֵר בְּכָל הַמִּדּוֹת. — **Afterward, God graciously grants from His side the ability to become refined in all the qualities.** וְהִנֵּה יוֹסֵף בְּחִינַת צַדִּיק גִּבּוֹר הַכּוֹבֵשׁ אֶת יִצְרוֹ — **Yosef represents the tzaddik, the mighty person who masters his inclination.** וְהָיָה עִיקַּר הִשְׁתַּדְּלוּתוֹ לְבָרֵר אֶת עַצְמוֹ בְּמִדַּת הַיִּרְאָה — **His principal effort was to refine himself in the quality of awe,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב אֶת הָאֱלֹהִים אֲנִי יָרֵא — **as he said, "I fear God."** וְהָיָה זֶה חָבִיב לוֹ הַמְּעַט שֶׁזָּכָה מִצַּד אִתְעָרוּתָא דִּלְתַתָּא וְהִקְדִּים מְנַשֶּׁה לְאֶפְרַיִם. — **The little he attained through awakening from below was dear to him, so he placed Menashe before Ephraim.** וְדָוִד הַמֶּלֶךְ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם שֶׁאָמַר כִּי עָנִי וְאֶבְיוֹן אֲנִי אָמַר הַשֵּׁם רוֹעִי וְגוֹמֵר עַל מֵי מְנוּחוֹת יְנַהֲלֵנִי וְגוֹמֵר יַנְחֵנִי — **King David, peace be upon him, who said, "For I am poor and needy," also said, "Hashem is my shepherd," and so forth,**

[1247] **Zohar, Sh'lach 10:64-66**: "Furthermore, "Amalek dwells in the land of the south." If a person says that, despite all this, he can attain Torah, "Amalek dwells in the land of the south": there is the evil inclination, the accuser who prosecutes a person and is constantly present in the body. "And the Hittite and the Amorite," and so forth—how many accusers are found there! They say that a person cannot enter that world at all: who can attain it, and who can enter it? With these words, "they discouraged the heart of the children of Israel" (Numbers 32:9), because they spread an evil report about it, as it says, "They brought forth an evil report of the land." What do the people of faith say? "If Hashem delights in us, He will give it to us." Once a person strives toward the Holy One, blessed be He, with the desire of the heart, He asks of us only the heart; and they must guard that holy mark of the covenant, as it is written, "Your people are all righteous; they shall inherit the land forever" (Isaiah 60:21)."

[1248] **Takanat HaShavin 5:7**: "Fear is different: the one who fears and the one whom he fears are necessarily unlike; they do not share the same quality, for one fears and the other imposes and gives the awe. Therefore, when the attribute of severity above is awakened and thereby gives rise to fear in the human heart—as in the saying, "When the Holy One, blessed be He, executes judgment upon the wicked, He is feared"—this is not called an awakening from above that precedes an awakening from below, since the two are not one and the same thing. Thus, although fear too does not originate with the person, and therefore it says, "Who has preceded Me, that I should repay?"—for here too God acts first by bringing him something that awakens fear—it is nevertheless called an awakening from below. That event does not produce its response with the direct certainty of love giving rise to love, as in "Draw me after You; let us run" and "Bring us back." Love of this kind applies to Israel, of whom it says, "I have loved you, says Hashem," because they are called "My twin," as it were, and such love applies to them. Fear, by contrast, also exists among the nations, though as a very low form of fear, fear of His punishments. The awakening of severity can generate fear, yet its response does not follow with certainty: of the nations it says, "When he is hungry, he will become enraged and curse his king and his God." The awakening of severity and anger can instead stir a desire to prevail, rage, become angry, and rebel, as it were, against God. Only those described as "desiring to fear Your Name" and searching as for hidden treasures to understand the fear of Hashem will find it. Therefore it is called an awakening from below. This is the whole matter of the Torah, which issues from the side of severity and commands and warns the person to strive to choose the good through his own awakening."

Takanat HaShavin resolves a difficulty implicit in this paragraph: how can awe be the person's work if God also awakens it? The divine occasion does not compel the right response; a person can resist it or choose to seek awe. Thus the sincere desire praised here is a real exercise of responsibility, while the power and eventual refinement remain gifts from God.

בְּמַעְגְּלֵי צֶדֶק וְגוֹמֵר — **“He leads me beside restful waters,” and so forth, “He guides me in paths of righteousness,” and so forth.** וְהֵינוּ שֶׁזָּכָה לְמִדַּת וּבְחִינַת יַעֲקֹב שֶׁאָמַר הָאֱלֹהִים הָרוֹעֶה אוֹתִי וְגוֹמֵר — **He attained Yaakov’s quality and spiritual aspect, expressed by “The God who shepherds me,” and so forth,** שֶׁהִכִּיר — וְעַל כֵּן הִקְדִּים אֶפְרַיִם לִפְנֵי מְנַשֶּׁה כָּאָמוּר. שֶׁהַכֹּל מֵהַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ. **— recognizing that everything comes from God. Yaakov therefore placed Ephraim before Menashe, as explained.** וְזֶה שֶׁאָמְרוּ בְּמִדְרַשׁ תַּנְחוּמָא וּבְפִסְיקְתָא שֶׁקַּיֵּים הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא גְּזֵרָתוֹ וְהִסְכִּים עַל יָדוֹ שֶׁהִקְדִּים אֶפְרַיִם לִמְנַשֶּׁה. **— This is what Tanchuma and Pesikta mean when they say that the Holy One, blessed be He, fulfilled Yaakov’s decree and endorsed his decision to place Ephraim before Menashe.** שֶׁבֶּאֱמֶת הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ רוֹצֶה שֶׁיְּבָרֵר הָאָדָם אֶת עַצְמוֹ בְּמִדַּת הַיִּרְאָה. **— For God truly wants a person to refine himself in the quality of awe.** רַק שֶׁזֶּה חִידֵּשׁ יַעֲקֹב אָבִינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם שֶׁהַכֹּל מִצַּד הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ **— Yet Yaakov our father, peace be upon him, introduced the recognition that everything comes from God,** וְעַל כֵּן הִקְדִּים אֶפְרַיִם לִמְנַשֶּׁה. **— and therefore placed Ephraim before Menashe.** וְהַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ מְקַיֵּים גְּזֵרַת וּמִצְוֹת זְקֵנִים כָּאָמוּר: **— And God fulfills the elders’ decrees and commandments, as explained.**

The light God asks for is His gift

וְכֵן גַּם חֲנוּכָּה הָיָה מִצַּד הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ.[1249,1250] **— The Chanukah miracle likewise came from God’s side.** דְּמִצְוַת נֵרוֹת הַמִּקְדָּשׁ הוּא בֹּא וְהָאֵר לִי (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בְּמִדְרַשׁ רַבָּה בְּהַעֲלוֹתְךָ) **— The commandment of the Temple lamps is, “Come and give Me light” (as stated in Midrash Rabbah, Beha‘alotecha).** וְאָז בִּזְמַן הַנֵּס הָיָה עִיקַּר הָאוֹר מֵהַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ. **— Yet at the time of the miracle, the light itself came chiefly from God.** וְרַק הָרְעוּתָא דִּלְבָּא הָיָה מִצַּד יִשְׂרָאֵל שֶׁרָצוּ לְהַדְלִיק בְּשֶׁמֶן טָהוֹר **— Only the desire of the heart came from Israel: they wished to kindle the lamps with pure oil.** וּמִסְתָּמָא כְּשֶׁמָּצְאוּ פַּךְ שֶׁמֶן כְּשִׁיעוּר לַיְלָה א׳ הִדְלִיקוּ בְּאוֹתוֹ לַיְלָה. **— Presumably, when they found a flask containing enough oil for one night, they lit it that night.** וְאַחַר כָּךְ כְּשֶׁלֹּא יִהְיֶה לָהֶם שֶׁמֶן טָהוֹר יִהְיֶה מוּתָּר בְּשֶׁמֶן טָמֵא (וּכְמוֹ שֶׁהִקְשָׁה הַפְּנֵי יְהוֹשֻׁעַ שַׁבָּת דְּטוּמְאָה הוּתְּרָה בְּצִבּוּר[1251]) **— afterward, when they would have no pure oil, they would be permitted to use impure oil, — because ritual impurity is permitted for**

[1249] **Tiferet Yosef, Beha'alotcha 2**: “All this the retrospective clarification through repentance applies when a person proceeds, from his own side, through service and restraint. But if he practices no restraint and simply spreads out in every direction, unwilling to accept any service or restraint within his own awareness, then although afterward he sees that no act is possible without God’s will, nevertheless, since from his own side he did not wish to recognize this, he and his own grasp are lost entirely. By contrast, when a person proceeds through restraint and service, but God’s light is sometimes concealed from him, the priest’s work is to raise even such an act to God. The completion of this clarification cannot come through flesh and blood, but only from God Himself. This is the meaning of “Toward the face of the menorah the seven lamps shall shine”: the completion of the lighting is to occur of itself, from God. The person must work according to his strength, and God will clarify the completion. Yet in the account of the act it says, “He raised its lamps”: once he has clarified himself according to his strength, God says that even this completion is called by the person’s name. This is “he did not change.”

Tiferet Yosef reads the menorah’s wording as a precise relation between human effort and divine completion: the person works as far as he can, and God completes what no person can finish. This illuminates why the oil miracle does not make Israel’s willing action superfluous. Its explicit requirement of service and restraint also prevents recognition of divine action from becoming a claim that personal responsibility is unnecessary.

[1250] **Resisei Layla 57:2**: “Through this sanctification of God’s name they merited the miracle of the oil, by which God showed them that they were worthy to give light before Him in the Temple, from which light goes forth to the world. This is the meaning of the commandment of the Temple lamps: to give light before Him in the dark passageways, for this world is darkened from God’s light through the nations. As the Midrash says of Abraham our father, he came and gave light before Him, as it were, in the dark passageways—that is, by making His divinity known to the nations. This was also the purpose of all the Temple service, where the Divine Presence was revealed in order to make His divinity known. Lighting the lamps gives light to everyone who comes into the world, including those in the deepest darkness. Therefore the wording of Al HaNissim specifies, out of all the acts of service, that they lit lamps: this was the essential completion of the attribute of Hod that they repaired then. The miracle that occurred for them in this act is not mentioned, because it is not the matter of the miracle and deliverance of Chanukah itself. Rather, it was what Heaven revealed to them: that they had found favor before Him and had completed the repair, to the point that Heaven assisted them in giving light before Him.”

Resisei Layla explains what the divine assistance disclosed: acceptance of Israel’s service and restoration of the capacity to make God’s presence known. In its complete context, this acceptance follows Israel’s self-sacrifice to sanctify God’s name. This adds the purpose of the gifted light to Pri Tzadik’s account of its source. The quoted distinction between military deliverance and the oil’s disclosure of favor is retained, rather than treating every mention of a miracle as interchangeable.

[1251] **Penei Yehoshua on Shabbat 21b:6**: “The first question therefore returns: they could have lit with impure oil, since impurity is permitted for communal service, as explained. It therefore appears that the principal purpose of the miracle was to make known God’s affection for them. We find a comparable miracle regularly: no disqualification was found in the omer or the two loaves. Since a miracle had occurred in the essential matter—their complete deliverance from enemies who told Israel, “Write on the horn of the ox that you have no portion in the God of Israel,” and who imposed several decrees of religious persecution—and now they had been delivered and a great miracle had given them power over their enemies, this further miracle occurred with the lamps. The lamps testify to Israel that the Divine Presence dwells among them, as the Sages also expound concerning the western lamp. After Shimon the Righteous died, even the

communal service (as the Pnei Yehoshua raises in his question in Shabbat). וַאֲפִילּוּ אִם לֹא הָיָה מוּתָּר הָיוּ פְּטוּרִין דְּאוֹנֶס רַחֲמָנָא פַּטְרֵיהּ. **— Even if it were not permitted, they would be exempt, for the Torah exempts someone prevented by circumstances beyond his control.** וְאַחַר כָּךְ בַּיּוֹם הָרִאשׁוֹן כְּבָר נַעֲשָׂה הַנֵּס שֶׁלֹּא נֶחְסַר הַשֶּׁמֶן בַּבּוֹקֶר **— Then, on the first day, the miracle had already occurred: by morning the oil had not diminished,** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתַב הַבַּיִת יוֹסֵף אוֹרַח חַיִּים סִימָן תרע) וְהָיוּ הַנֵּרוֹת מְלֵאִים אוֹ הַפָּךְ הָיָה מָלֵא[1252] **— and the lamps were full, or the flask was full (as the Beit Yosef explains, Orach Chayim 670).** וְהָיָה הַנֵּר מֵאִיר וְדוֹלֵק רַק מִצַּד הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרֵךְ. **— The lamp therefore shone and burned entirely through God's action.** וְכֵן לְתֵרוּץ הַבַּיִת יוֹסֵף שֶׁחִילְקוּ הַשָּׁמֶן שֶׁבַּפָּךְ לְחֹ' חֲלָקִים **— Likewise, according to the Beit Yosef's answer that they divided the flask's oil into eight portions,** וּבְכָל לַיְלָה נָתְנוּ חֵלֶק א' וְהָיָה דּוֹלֵק כָּל הַלַּיְלָה **— putting in one portion each night, which then burned all night,** לְפִי זֶה יִקָּשֶׁה אֵיךְ הָיוּ רַשָּׁאִין לְבַטֵּל מִצְוַת הַיּוֹם **— a difficulty arises: how were they permitted to set aside that day's commandment?** שֶׁהַמִּצְוָה שֶׁיִּהְיֶה דּוֹלֵק כָּל הַלַּיְלָה. **— The commandment requires the lamp to burn all night.** וְאֵיךְ בִּטְּלוּ הַמִּצְוָה כְּדֵי לְקַיֵּים קְצָת מִצְוָה לְמָחָר **— How could they set aside the commandment in order to fulfill part of a commandment the next day,** וַהֲרֵי לֹא יָדְעוּ מֵהַנֵּס עוֹד. **— when they did not yet know that a miracle would occur?** וְעַל כֵּן צָרִיךְ לוֹמַר שֶׁעָשׂוּ פְּתִילוֹת דַּקּוֹת מְאֹד שֶׁיּוּכַל לִדְלוֹק רַק כָּל הַלַּיְלָה **— We must therefore say that they made very thin wicks, so the oil could burn all night,** וְהַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרֵךְ שָׁלַח אוֹרוֹ בְּנֵס שֶׁהֵאִיר אוֹר יְהֵיָה דּוֹלֵק אוֹר קָטָן מְאֹד. **— although it would give only a very small light.** כְּמוֹ שֶׁהָיָה מֵאִיר תָּמִיד כְּשֶׁנָּתְנוּ שֶׁמֶן ח' פְּעָמִים גָּדוֹל **— God miraculously sent His light, so that it shone brightly,** מִשְּׁיעוּר שֶׁנָּתְנוּ עַכְשָׁיו. **— as it always did when they used eight times the quantity of oil they were now putting in.** בֵּין כֹּה הָיָה הַנֵּס שֶׁהָרְאָה הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרֵךְ שֶׁאַף הָאוֹר שֶׁצִּוָּה לָנוּ בֹּא וְהָאֵיר לִי **— Either way, the miracle showed that even the light concerning which God commanded us, "Come and give Me light,"** גַּם זֶה הוּא מֵהַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרֵךְ. **— also comes from God.** וְהוּא כְּמוֹ שֶׁחִידְּשׁוּ יַעֲקֹב אָבִינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם וְדָוִד הַמֶּלֶךְ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם שֶׁהַכֹּל מֵהַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרֵךְ. **— This is the understanding introduced by Yaakov our father and King David, peace be upon them: everything comes from God.** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר בְּיַעֲקֹב הָאֱלֹהִים הָרוֹעֶה אוֹתִי וְגוֹמֵר וּבְדָוִד הַמֶּלֶךְ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם הַשֵּׁם רוֹעִי וְגוֹמֵר **— As Yaakov said, "The God who shepherds me," and so forth, and King David, peace be upon him, "Hashem is my shepherd," and so forth.** וְזֶה בָּא מִצַּד שֶׁהַסְּכִים הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרֵךְ לְמִצְוֹת זְקֵנִים. **— This came about through God's agreement with the elders' commandments.** וְכֵן נֵס הַנִּצּוּחַ הָיָה מִצַּד הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרֵךְ **— The miraculous victory likewise came from God.** שֶׁזָּכוּ לָזֶה מִצַּד שֶׁמָּסְרוּ נַפְשָׁם עַל שְׁמִירַת הַתּוֹרָה **— They merited it through risking their lives to uphold the Torah,** שֶׁזֶּה הָיָה עִיקַּר גְּזֵרַת הַיְוָנִים. **— against which the Greeks' decree was chiefly directed.** וּבִפְרָט בְּעִנְיָן שֶׁלֹּא הָיוּ מְחוּיָבִים דְּהַגְזֵרָה תִּיבָּעֵל לְטַפְסָר תְּחִילָּה **— Especially in the matter where they were not obligated: the decree that a bride first be violated by the military official.** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ סַנְהֶדְרִין עד)[1253] וְאַף בְּדִידָהּ אָמְרוּ אֶסְתֵּר קַרְקַע עוֹלָם הָיְתָה **— Even concerning the woman herself, the Sages said, "Esther was entirely passive in the coerced act" (Sanhedrin 74).** וְכָל שֶׁכֵּן הָאֲחִים שֶׁלֹּא הָיוּ מְחוּיָבִים כְּלָל **— All the more so the brothers, who were not obligated at all to initiate such a life-threatening confrontation.** וְזֶה הָיָה מְסִירַת נֶפֶשׁ לַעֲמוֹד בִּמְתֵי מִסְפָּר נֶגֶד עַם רָב. **— It was an act of self-sacrifice for a handful of men to stand against a great multitude.** וְאַף שֶׁהָיָה בִּשְׁעַת גְּזֵרָה דַּאֲפִילּוּ מִצְוָה קַלָּה יֵהָרֵג כּוּ' **— Although this was a time of religious persecution, when even for a minor commandment one must accept death …** מִכָּל מָקוֹם הָיוּ צְרִיכִין לְהִטָּמֵן עַצְמָם וּכְמוֹ שֶׁעָשׂוּ אָז רוֹב כְּשֵׁרֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל **— they should nevertheless have hidden themselves, as most faithful Jews did at that time,** וּלְקַיֵּים חֲבִי כִמְעַט רֶגַע. **— fulfilling "Hide for a brief moment."** רַק מֵהַרְעוּתָא דִּלְבָּא שֶׁהָיָה לָהֶם שֶׁיִּתְקַדֵּשׁ שֵׁם שָׁמַיִם עַל יָדָם **— Yet through their heartfelt desire that the Name of Heaven be sanctified through them,** זָכוּ עַל יְדֵי זֶה לְעִיקַּר הַנֵּס מֵהַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרֵךְ **— they merited the miracle itself from God:** מָסַרְתָּ גִּבּוֹרִים בְּיַד חַלָּשִׁים וְרַבִּים בְּיַד מְעַטִּים. **— "You delivered the mighty into the hands of the weak, and the many into the hands of the few."** וְעַל כֵּן הוּזְכַּר בִּתְפִלָּה בִּימֵי מַתִּתְיָהוּ בֶּן יוֹחָנָן **— Therefore the prayer says, "In the days of Mattityahu son of Yochanan."** וְלֹא מָצִינוּ בְּשׁוּם נֵס שֶׁיַּזְכִּירוּ בִּימֵי **— We do not find "in the days of" mentioned for any other miracle (the source reads גם; the intended**

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western lamp would sometimes go out; a miracle therefore occurred in this very matter in those days of favor, to make known that they had returned to their former beloved standing. This appears to me the correct explanation."

[1252] **Beit Yosef, Orach Chayim 670:1:1**: "One may ask why they established eight days: the oil in the flask was sufficient for one night, so the miracle apparently occurred only during seven nights. One answer is that they divided the oil in the flask into eight portions. Each night they placed one portion in the Menorah, and it burned until morning; thus a miracle occurred on every night. Another answer is that, after they put the required quantity of oil into the Menorah's lamps, the flask remained full as before, so the miracle was evident even on the first night. Alternatively, on the first night they put all the oil into the lamps. They burned all night, and in the morning the lamps were found full of oil; so it was each and every night."

[1253] **Sanhedrin 74b:4-5**: "But Esther's case was public! Abaye said: Esther was like the ground—entirely passive in the coerced act. Rava said: where they act for their own personal pleasure, it is different."

reading is נס), רַק בְּפוּרִים שֶׁמַּזְכִּירִין בִּימֵי מָרְדְּכַי וְאֶסְתֵּר — **except Purim, for which we say, "In the days of Mordechai and Esther."** מִפְּנֵי שֶׁהַשֵּׁמוֹת שֶׁלָּהֶם הָיָה שַׁיָּכוּת לְהַנֵּס — **Their names were connected with the miracle,** (חוּלִין קלט:) וּכְמוֹ שֶׁנִּרְמַז שְׁמוֹתָם בַּתּוֹרָה כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ — **as their names are hinted at in the Torah, as the Sages explain (Chullin 139b).** וְאִיתָא בְּאֶלֹקִי רַבִּי יִצְחָק זְכרוֹנוֹ לִבְרָכָה סוֹדוֹת עַל שְׁמוֹתָם שֶׁשַּׁיָּיךְ לְהַנֵּס. — **The teachings of the Ari, of blessed memory, contain mysteries concerning their names that relate to the miracle (the source reads להנם; the intended reading is להנס).** וְגַם שָׁם אֵין מַזְכִּירִין מָרְדְּכַי עִם שֵׁם אָבִיו — **Even there, however, Mordechai is not mentioned together with his father's name,** וְכָאן מַזְכִּירִין בִּימֵי מַתִּתְיָהוּ בֶּן יוֹחָנָן כֹּהֵן גָּדוֹל. — **whereas here we say, "In the days of Mattityahu son of Yochanan, the High Priest."** וְהַטַּעַם בָּזֶה שֶׁעִיקַּר הַנֵּס נַעֲשָׂה עַל יְדֵי כֹּהֲנֶיךָ הַקְּדוֹשִׁים — **The reason is that the miracle itself came through "Your holy priests."** שֶׁשֹּׁרֶשׁ קְדוּשַׁת אַהֲרֹן הָיָה גַּם כֵּן שֶׁהָיָה שָׁפָל בְּעֵינָיו — **The root of Aharon's holiness was likewise his humility in his own eyes,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר וְאַהֲרֹן מַה הוּא כִּי תַלִּינוּ עָלָיו — **as it says, "What is Aharon, that you complain against him?"** וְנֶאֱמַר וְאֵת אֲשֶׁר יִבְחַר בּוֹ יַקְרִיב אֵלָיו — **And it says, "Whomever He chooses, He will bring near to Him."** שֶׁאַהֲרֹן מִצִּדּוֹ לֹא יָדַע מְאוּמָה רַק מִצַּד שֶׁהַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ בָּחַר בּוֹ. — **For Aharon recognized no independent claim of his own; everything was due to God's choosing him.** וְאִיתָא בְּמִדְרַשׁ רַבָּה (בְּמִדְבַּר פָּרָשָׁה ג) אַשְׁרֵי בְּכִפְלַיִם מִי שֶׁהַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא בָּחַר בּוֹ וְקֵרְבוֹ — **Midrash Rabbah (Bamidbar, section 3) states, "Doubly fortunate is one whom the Holy One, blessed be He, chose and brought near."** זֶה אַהֲרֹן וְכוּלֵי אֶבָל אַהֲרֹן מִצִּדּוֹ לֹא יָדַע מְאוּמָה — **"This is Aharon," and so forth. Yet Aharon knew of no independent attainment of his own.** וְהוּא כְּעֵין מִדַּת יַעֲקֹב אָבִינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם שֶׁאָמַר הָאֱלֹהִים הָרוֹעֶה אוֹתִי וְגוֹמֵר — **This resembles the quality of Yaakov our father, peace be upon him, who said, "The God who shepherds me," and so forth.** וְעַל כֵּן זָכוּ הַכֹּהֲנִים לְנֵס זֶה שֶׁהָיָה הַכֹּל מִצַּד הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ כָּאָמוּר. — **The priests therefore merited this miracle in which everything came from God, as explained.** וּבְאוֹתוֹ דּוֹר הָיָה נֶפֶשׁ מַתִּתְיָהוּ שֶׁזָּכָה בַּשֹּׁרֶשׁ לִבְחִינַת קְדוּשָׁה זֹאת. — **In that generation, Mattityahu's soul attained this aspect of holiness at its root.** וְעַל כֵּן נִקְרָא שְׁמוֹ מַתִּתְיָהוּ דְּשֶׁמּוֹ שֶׁל אָדָם הוּא שׁוֹרֶשׁ הַחַיִּים שֶׁלּוֹ — **He was therefore named Mattityahu, for a person's name is the root of his life.** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בַּסְּפָרִים הַקְּדוֹשִׁים שֶׁמִּטַּעַם זֶה אָדָם נִיעוֹר מִשְּׁנָתוֹ כְּשֶׁקּוֹרִין אוֹתוֹ בִּשְׁמוֹ. — **As the holy books explain, this is why a person wakes from sleep when he is called by his name.** וְזֶה מוֹרֶה שֵׁם מַתִּתְיָהוּ שֶׁמַּכִּיר שֶׁהַכֹּל מַתַּת יה״ו ג׳ — **The name Mattityahu expresses this recognition: everything is mattat, the gift of Yud-Heh-Vav,** אוֹתִיּוֹת מִשֵּׁם הֶוָ״ה שֶׁבָּא מֵהֶם הַהַשְׁפָּעָה לְמִדַּת מַלְכוּת — **the three letters of the four-letter Divine Name from which the flow reaches the attribute of Malkhut, Kingship,** שֶׁהוּא בְּחִינַת כְּנֶסֶת יִשְׂרָאֵל. — **which represents the community of Israel.** וְכֵן מוֹרֶה שֵׁם יוֹחָנָן י״ו חָנַן — **The name Yochanan likewise signifies, "Yud-Vav has graciously given."** וְהוּא גַּם כֵּן אוֹתִיּוֹת י״ו מֵהַשֵּׁם הַקָּדוֹשׁ — **These too are the letters Yud-Vav of the holy Name,** שֶׁבָּא עַל יְדֵי הַהַשְׁפָּעָה לֵהּ׳ עִלָּאָה וְהׄ׳ תַּתָּאָה — **through which the flow reaches the upper Heh and the lower Heh,** שֶׁהֵם בְּחִינַת שְׁכִינְתָּא עִלָּאָה וְתַתָּאָה. — **representing the upper and lower Shekhinah, the divine presence.** וְזֶה שֶׁאָמְרוּ בֶּן יוֹחָנָן שֶׁמּוֹרֶה שֶׁבְּשׁוֹרֶשׁ נִשְׁמָתוֹ הָיָה גַּם כֵּן בְּבְחִינָה זוֹ — **This explains "son of Yochanan": at the root of his soul he likewise possessed this quality,** שֶׁהִכִּיר י״ו חָנַן. — **recognizing that "Yud-Vav has graciously given."** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁמָּצִינוּ שֶׁדָּרְשׁוּ (מְגִילָּה יב:) בְּמָרְדְּכַי כּוּלָּן עַל שְׁמוֹ נִקְרְאוּ — **Similarly, the Sages expounded concerning Mordechai (Megillah 12b), "All the names in his genealogy were applied to him."** בֶּן יָאִיר בֶּן — **"Son of Yair"—a son who illuminated Israel's eyes through his prayer.** שֶׁהֵאִיר עֵינֵיהֶם שֶׁל יִשְׂרָאֵל בִּתְפִלָּתוֹ. — **Thus Mordechai is called "son of Yair" because the root of his soul is Yair,** וְהַיְינוּ שֶׁמָּרְדְּכַי נִקְרָא בֶּן יָאִיר שֶׁשֹּׁרֶשׁ נִשְׁמָתוֹ יָאִיר שֶׁהֵאִיר עֵינֵיהֶם כּוּלָּי — **one who illuminated their eyes …** וְכָן כָּאן מַתִּתְיָהוּ נִקְרָא בֶּן יוֹחָנָן שֶׁשֹּׁרֶשׁ נִשְׁמָתוֹ י״ו חָנַן. — **So here Mattityahu is called "son of Yochanan," because the root of his soul is "Yud-Vav has graciously given."** וּמִפְּנֵי שֶׁנִּקְרָא יוֹחָנָן שֶׁהַכֹּל תָּלָה בְּהַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ — **Because he was called Yochanan, attributing everything to God,** זָכָה שֶׁנַּעֲשָׂה עַל יָדוֹ נִסִּי נִסִּים — **he merited that miracles upon miracles should be performed through him.** וְעַל דֶּרֶךְ שֶׁאָמְרוּ[1254] (בְּרָכוֹת נז.) חֲנִינָא חֲנַנְיָה יוֹחָנָן נִסִּי נִסִּים נַעֲשָׂה לוֹ. — **This accords with the saying (Berakhot 57a) concerning one who sees Chanina, Chananya, or Yochanan in a dream: "Miracles upon miracles are performed for him."** שֶׁכֵּן מוֹרֶה גַּם שֵׁם חֲנִינָא שֶׁמַּכִּיר שֶׁהַכֹּל מֵהַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ שֶׁחָנַן אוֹתוֹ — **The name Chanina likewise expresses the recognition that everything comes from God, who has graciously bestowed it upon him,** (וּכְמוֹ שֶׁנִּתְבָּאַר מַאֲמָר יד). — **(as explained in discourse 14).** וְזֶהוּ שַׁיָּכוּת עִנְיַן שֶׁהִקְדִּים הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ אֶפְרַיִם לִמְנַשֶּׁה בַּנְּשִׂיאִים — **This explains the connection between God's placing Ephraim before Menashe among the tribal princes,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמַר יַעֲקֹב אָבִינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם. — **as Yaakov our father, peace be upon him, had said,** לְעִנְיַן מִצְוֹת זְקֵנִים שֶׁתִּקְּנוּ נֵרוֹת חֲנוּכָּה — **and the elders' commandment establishing the Chanukah lights.** שֶׁהַכֹּל מֵעִנְיַן א׳ שֶׁתִּקְּנוּ כֹּהֲנֶיךָ הַקְּדוֹשִׁים שֶׁהָיוּ בְּאוֹתוֹ דּוֹר. — **It all concerns one**

[1254] **Berakhot 57a:1**: "One who sees Huna in a dream—a miracle will be performed for him. One who sees Chanina, Chananya, or Yochanan—miracles upon miracles will be performed for him."

principle, enacted by "Your holy priests" in that generation. וְאָז הָיָה מַתִּתְיָהוּ שׁוֹרֶשׁ לְמִדָּה זוֹ לְהַכִּיר שֶׁהַכֹּל מֵהַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרֵךְ. **— Mattityahu then embodied the root of this quality: recognizing that everything comes from God.** וְהַכֹּל מַתַּת יה״ו וְכֵן י״ו חָנַן וְכָאָמוּר: **— Everything is the gift of Yud-Heh-Vav, and likewise, "Yud-Vav has graciously given," as explained.**

— On a straightforward level, the Midrash Tanchuma places the discussion of Chanukah in the passage beginning "On the eighth day," וּבְפְשִׁיטוּת נִרְאֶה שֶׁקָּבְעוּ בְּמִדְרַשׁ תַּנְחוּמָא עִנְיַן חֲנוּכָּה בְּפָרָשַׁת בַּיּוֹם הַשְּׁמִינִי מִפְּנֵי שֶׁהוּא קְרִיאַת יוֹם אַחֲרוֹן דַּחֲנוּכָּה. **— because this is the Torah reading for the last day of Chanukah.** אַךְ כְּבָר דִּקְדַּקְנוּ לָמָּה תִּקְנוּ בָּאֻמָּת לִקְרוֹת בַּחֲנוּכָּה בְּפָרָשַׁת נְשִׂיאִים. **— Yet we have already asked why, in fact, the passage of the princes was instituted as the Chanukah reading.** וְאִם מִפְּנֵי שֶׁעָשׂוּ הַחַשְׁמוֹנָאִים גַּם כֵּן חֲנוּכָּה **— If it is because the Hasmoneans also held a dedication,** הָא חֲנוּכַּת הַנְּשִׂיאִים הָיָה בְּקָרְבָּנוֹת וַחֲנוּכַּת חַשְׁמוֹנָאִים הָיָה בִּנֵרוֹת **— the princes' dedication involved offerings, whereas the Hasmoneans' dedication involved lamps.** וְהָיָה שַׁיָּיךְ טָפֵי לִקְרוֹת בְּפָרָשַׁת הַנֵּרוֹת וּמְנוֹרָה בִּתְצַוֶּה וֶאֱמוֹר וּבְהַעֲלוֹתְךָ. **— It would therefore have been more appropriate to read the passages of the lamps and the Menorah in Tetzaveh, Emor, and Beha'alotecha.** וְאָמַרְנוּ שֶׁהוּא עַל פִּי מַה שֶּׁבְּכ״ה (כ״ו) שֶׁשָּׁנִינוּ בַּפִּסְקְתָּא[1255] **— We explained that this follows the teaching in Pesikta (section 6):** בְּכִסְלָו נִגְמְרָה מְלֶאכֶת הַמִּשְׁכָּן כּוּלֵי הִפְסִיד כִּסְלָו כּוּלֵי שֶׁלֹּם לוֹ הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא חֲנוּכַּת חַשְׁמוֹנָאִי עַיֵּין שָׁם. **— "On the twenty-fifth of Kislev, the work of the Mishkan was completed … Kislev lost out … — The Holy One, blessed be He, repaid it with the Hasmonean dedication." See there.** וְהֵיינוּ שֶׁחֲנוּכַּת חַשְׁמוֹנָאִים זֶכֶר לַחֲנוּכַּת הַמִּשְׁכָּן. **— Thus the Hasmonean dedication commemorates the dedication of the Mishkan.** וּבְפִסְקְתָּא (פָּרָשָׁה ב) חָשַׁב ז׳ חֲנוּכוֹת.[1256] **— Pesikta (section 2) enumerates seven dedications.** וְחָשַׁב חֲנוּכָּה א׳ חֲנוּכַּת בְּרִיָּיתוֹ שֶׁל עוֹלָם דִּכְתִיב וַיְכֻלּוּ **— It counts as the first the dedication of the world's creation, as it is written, "They were completed," and so forth.**

A dwelling in each heart

— The chief purpose in creating the וְהַיְינוּ שֶׁעִיקַּר הַמְכוּוָּן בִּבְרִיָּיתוֹ שֶׁל עוֹלָם הָיָה שֶׁיִּהְיֶה עִיקַּר שְׁכִינָה בַּתַּחְתּוֹנִים.[1257, 1258]

[1255] **Pesikta Rabbati 6:1**: "Rabbi Chanina said: On the twenty-fifth of Kislev, the work of the Mishkan was completed, and it remained folded away until the first of Nisan, when Moshe erected it. The first of Nisan, as it is written: "On the first day of the first month, you shall erect the Mishkan, the Tent of Meeting" (Exodus 40:2). Throughout the time it remained folded away, Israel murmured against Moshe, saying: "Why was it not erected immediately? Perhaps some defect occurred in it." God intended to combine the joy of the Mishkan with the month in which Yitzchak was born, for Yitzchak was born in Nisan. From where is this learned? When the angels came to Avraham, what did he say? "Knead and make cakes" (Genesis 18:6), for it was Pesach. They said to him: "I shall surely return to you at this season, and your wife Sarah will have a son" (Genesis 18:10). What does "at this season" mean? Rabbi Zavdi son of Levi said: they scratched a mark on the wall for him, saying, "When the sun reaches this point." As soon as Nisan came and the Mishkan was erected, no one murmured against Moshe any longer. Had Kislev, in which the work was completed, therefore lost out? No. What is the meaning of "It was completed"? The Holy One, blessed be He, said: "It is for Me to repay it." How did the Holy One repay it? With the dedication of the Hasmonean house."

[1256] **Pesikta Rabbati 2:1**: "How many dedications are there? There are seven dedications, and these are they: the dedication of heaven and earth, as it says, "Heaven and earth were completed" (Genesis 2:1). What dedication was there? "God placed them in the firmament of heaven to give light" (Genesis 1:17). The dedication of the wall, as it says, "At the dedication of the wall of Jerusalem" (Nechemiah 12:27). The dedication by those who returned from exile, as it says, "They offered for the dedication of this House of our God," and so forth (Ezra 6:17). The dedication of the priests—this is the one for which we light lamps. The dedication of the World to Come, as it says, "I shall search Jerusalem with lamps" (Zephaniah 1:12). The dedication of the princes: "This was the dedication of the altar" (Numbers 7:84). And the dedication of the Temple, which was read in the passage: "A psalm, a song for the dedication of the House, of David.""

[1257] **Tzidkat HaTzadik 251:1**: "Through yearning a person becomes a vessel for the indwelling of God's presence within his heart. This is the contribution for the Mishkan, "From every person whose heart moves him": through the generosity of Israel's hearts the Mishkan is built, the dwelling of God in the lower realm. In this matter, each person experiences it according to the measure of his heart. One person's sense of God dwelling within him is unlike another's, for the indwelling corresponds to the generosity of his heart and the strength of his yearning to attain it. There is also the contribution for the sockets and for the offerings, concerning which it says, "The rich shall not give more." The one rich in understanding, feeling of the heart, and strength of yearning, and the poor person, contribute equal portions, because it is "to atone for your lives," as Scripture states. The Jerusalem Talmud, Shekalim, explains that it atones for the calf: that is, to cleanse the heart of the stain of evil desires. Likewise, concerning the communal offerings the Sages said that the morning daily offering atones. In distancing themselves from evil all Israel are equal, for all can become completely clean of evil; differences of degree concern the attainment of the good."

Tzidkat HaTzadik explains the inward construction that Pri Tzadik names: a person's yearning becomes a vessel for God's dwelling. It also distinguishes different intensities of inward reception from the shared capacity and obligation to turn from evil. Thus "every heart" does not require identical spiritual attainment, and the sanctuary remains grounded in actual work on the heart.

[1258] **Sod Yesharim, Parashat Shekalim 3:2**: "Israel, from their own side, understand in the depth of the heart that they have no completeness without service. They therefore constantly yearn for the service of God, and God likewise desires them. This resembles what we find in the Gemara: Binyamin the righteous longed to absorb the altar's strip of land into

world was that the Shekhinah should dwell primarily in the lower realm. וּבְיוֹם הַשַּׁבָּת נִתְעַלָּה וְיָשַׁב עַל כִּסֵּא כְבוֹדוֹ — **On Shabbat He rose and sat upon His throne of glory:** וְהַיְינוּ שֶׁקָּבַע שְׁכִינָתוֹ בַּתַּחְתּוֹנִים וְאָז עָשָׂה חֲנוּכָּה. — **that is, He established His presence in the lower realm, and then held its dedication.** וְכֵן חֲנוּכַּת הַמִּשְׁכָּן וּבֵית הַמִּקְדָּשׁ. — **The same applies to the dedication of the Mishkan and the Temple.** וְכֵן הָיָה חֲנוּכַּת הַחַשְׁמוֹנָאִים שֶׁתִּקְנוּ שֶׁכָּל א׳ מִיִּשְׂרָאֵל יַעֲשֶׂה חֲנוּכַּת הַבַּיִת — **Likewise, in the Hasmonean dedication they instituted that every Jew should dedicate a dwelling,** שֶׁהַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרֵךְ שׁוֹכֵן בְּלֵב בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל. — **for God dwells in the hearts of the children of Israel.** וְזֶה יְכוֹלִים לַעֲשׂוֹת בַּיָּמִים הָהֵם בַּזְּמַן הַזֶּה. — **This can be done "in those days, at this time."** וְזֶה זָכֶר קַיָּים לָעַד אַף בַּגָּלוּת וְחוּצָה לָאָרֶץ. — **It endures forever, even in exile and outside the Land of Israel.** לַחֲנוּכַּת הַמִּשְׁכָּן שֶׁהָיָה גַּם כֵּן בַּמִּדְבָּר בְּחוּצָה לָאָרֶץ — **It commemorates the Mishkan's dedication, which likewise took place in the wilderness, outside the Land.** וְלֹא הָיָה קָבוּעַ בְּמָקוֹם רַק בְּכָל מָקוֹם שֶׁחָנוּ בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל קָבְעוּ מְקוֹמוֹ — **The Mishkan was not fixed in one location; wherever Israel encamped, they established its place,** וְשָׁם הָיָה מִשְׁכַּן הַשְּׁכִינָה. — **and there the divine presence dwelled.** וּכְבָר אָמַרְנוּ כַּמָּה פְּעָמִים מֵהָרַב מֹשֶׁה בֶּן נַחְמָן שֶׁפֵּירֵשׁ מַה שֶּׁכָּתוּב בְּמִדְרַשׁ רַבָּה (בְּהַעֲלוֹתְךָ)[1259] — **We have already cited Ramban several times, explaining the statement in Midrash Rabbah (Beha'alotecha),** אֲבָל הַנֵּרוֹת לְעוֹלָם דְּקָאֵי עַל נֵרוֹת חֲנוּכָּה שֶׁתִּקְנוּ הַכֹּהֲנִים. — **"But the lamps are forever," as referring to the Chanukah lights instituted by the priests.** וְזֶהוּ זָכֶר לַחֲנוּכַּת הַמִּשְׁכָּן דַּיְיקָא וְעַל כֵּן קוֹרִין בַּנְּשִׂיאִים. — **This commemorates specifically the Mishkan's dedication; therefore we read about the princes.** וְתִקְנוּ ח׳ יְמֵי חֲנוּכָּה וּלְבֵית הִלֵּל מוֹסִיף וְהוֹלֵךְ דְּמַעֲלִין בַּקּוֹדֶשׁ. — **They instituted eight days of Chanukah; according to Beit Hillel, one progressively adds lights, for we ascend in holiness.** וְהַיְינוּ שֶׁבְּכָל יוֹם נִתּוֹסֵף קְדוּשָּׁה — **That is, each day adds holiness.** וּמַשְׁלִימִין בְּיוֹם ח׳ פָּרָשַׁת הַנְּשִׂיאִים וּפָרָשַׁת זֹאת חֲנוּכַּת הַמִּזְבֵּחַ וְגוֹמֵר — **On the eighth day we complete the passage of the princes and read "This was the dedication of the altar," and so forth,** וּפָרָשַׁת בְּהַעֲלוֹתְךָ וְגוֹמֵר — **and the passage beginning "When you kindle," and so forth.** וְאִיתָא בְּמִדְרַשׁ רַבָּה (נָשׂא פָּרָשָׁה יד) זֹאת חֲנוּכַּת הַמִּזְבֵּחַ בְּיוֹם הִמָּשַׁח אוֹתוֹ — **Midrash Rabbah (Naso, section 14) comments on "This was the dedication of the altar on the day it was anointed":** וְכִי בַּיּוֹם שֶׁנִּמְשַׁח נַעֲשָׂה כָּל חֲנוּכַּת הַמִּזְבֵּחַ — **"Was the entire dedication of the altar performed on the day it was anointed? …** לְלַמֶּדְךָ שֶׁכָּל הַשְּׁבָטִים הֵם שָׁוִים וַחֲבִיבִים כּוּלָּם כְּאֶחָד כּוּלֵּי — **It teaches you that all the tribes are equal and all equally beloved …** כְּאִלּוּ בְּיוֹם רִאשׁוֹן הִקְרִיבוּ כּוּלָּם כּוּלֵּי — **as though all of them had brought their offerings on the first day …"**

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his portion, as it says, "He hovers over it all day"; therefore Binyamin merited becoming the host of the Divine Presence. Because he constantly yearned for the light, he merited becoming its host. In the same way, because God knew that if He opened a little light for Israel they would yearn still more for Him to open greater light, He dwells among them and desires their service. As the holy Zohar says: "How do we know that the Holy One, blessed be He, desires him and has placed His dwelling within him? When we see that the will of this person is joyfully, with the heart's desire, to pursue and strive after the Holy One, blessed be He, with heart, soul, and will—then we certainly know that the Divine Presence dwells within him." That is, from seeing how much Israel seeks and yearns for service, it becomes clear that the Holy One desires them and has made His dwelling among them. This also reveals that Israel alone is pure by virtue of its source and arose in the divine thought, unlike Amalek. Therefore Israel always needs service and must not rely upon the assurance that God will ultimately clarify Israel because of its purity at the source. Against that assurance Amalek's accusation is always aroused, claiming that it too is pure by virtue of its source. Therefore, "When Moshe lowered his hand, Amalek prevailed."

Sod Yesharim gives a test and a continuing condition for the inward dwelling: the heart keeps seeking a fuller relation to God through service. Binyamin's yearning supplies its concrete sanctuary model. The passage's final warning preserves the distinction between recognizing an enduring divine bond and treating that bond as a reason to dispense with work.

[1259] **Ramban on Numbers 8:2:1**: "I also saw in Yelammedenu (Tanchuma, Beha'alotecha 5), and likewise in Bamidbar Rabbah (15:6): the Holy One, blessed be He, said to Moshe, "Go tell Aharon: Do not fear; you are destined for something greater than this. The offerings are practiced as long as the Temple stands, but the lamps shall always give light toward the face of the Menorah; and all the blessings I gave you with which to bless My children shall never cease." It is well known that when the Temple does not stand and the offerings cease because of its destruction, the lamps also cease. They were therefore alluding specifically to the lamps of the Hasmonean dedication, which are observed even after the destruction, during our exile. The priestly blessing, placed beside the princes' dedication, likewise applies forever. The Sages expounded the passages adjacent to the princes' dedication, both before and after it, in honor of Aharon, who had not been numbered among them."

Shared holiness with distinct leading strengths

וְהַמְכוּוָן עַל פִּי מַה שֶּׁכָּתוּב בִּבְרֵאשִׁית רַבָּה עַל פָּסוּק אִישׁ אֲשֶׁר כְּבִרְכָתוֹ בֵּרַךְ אוֹתָם[1260, 1261] — **The meaning follows Bereishit Rabbah on the verse, "Each according to his blessing, he blessed them":** לְפִי שֶׁבֵּירְכָן יְהוּדָה בְּאַרְיֵה וְכוּלֵי חָזַר וּכְלָלָן כּוּלָּן כְּאִ' וַעֲשָׂאָן אֲרָיוֹת וְכוּלֵי — **"Since he blessed Yehudah as a lion … he then included them all together and made them all lions …"** וְהַיְינוּ שֶׁכָּל קְדוּשׁוֹת הַשְּׁבָטִים כְּלוּלִים זֶה בָּזֶה. — **All the tribes' distinctive forms of holiness are included within one another.** וְכָל א' מִיִּשְׂרָאֵל כָּלוּל מִקְּדוּשַׁת כָּל הַי"ב שְׁבָטִים. — **Every Jew contains the holiness of all twelve tribes.** וְאַף שֶׁקְּדוּשַׁת יוֹסֵף מוֹרֶה שֶׁהָעִיקָּר עֲבוֹדַת הָאָדָם לְהִתְבָּרֵר בְּמִדַּת הַיִּרְאָה בְּחִינַת יוֹסֵף. — **Yosef's holiness indicates that a person's chief service is to refine himself in awe—the aspect represented by Yosef.** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמַרְנוּ שֶׁמִּטַּעַם זֶה הִקְדִּים מְנַשֶּׁה לְאֶפְרַיִם. — **As we explained, this is why he placed Menashe before Ephraim.** אַף מִכָּל מָקוֹם כָּלוּל בּוֹ גַּם קְדוּשַׁת כָּל הַשְּׁבָטִים וּבְתוֹכָם שֵׁבֶט יְהוּדָה — **Nevertheless, he also contains the holiness of all the tribes, including Yehudah,** שֶׁקְּדוּשָׁתוֹ בְּחִינַת דָּוִד הַמֶּלֶךְ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם שֶׁאָמַר הַשֵּׁם רוֹעִי וְכוּלֵי — **whose holiness is represented by King David, peace be upon him, who said, "Hashem is my shepherd," and so forth,** שֶׁמּוֹרֶה שֶׁהַכֹּל מֵהַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרֵךְ וְאֵין לְהָאָדָם מֵהִשְׁתַּדְּלוּתוֹ כְּלוּם. — **indicating that everything comes from God, and a person possesses nothing independently through his own effort.** וְנוּכַל לוֹמַר שֶׁמִּטַּעַם זֶה סִידֵּר בַּפְּסִיקְתָא (פָּרָשָׁה ד) לַחֲנוּכָּה[1262] — **We may suggest that this is why Pesikta (section 4) arranges, for Chanukah,** מַעְיָנָן בְּנֵן מְזַבֵּחַ שֶׁבָּנָה אֵלִיָּהוּ בְּהַר הַכַּרְמֶל — **a discussion of the altar Eliyahu built on Mount Carmel.** דִּכְתִיב וַיִּקַּח אֵלִיָּהוּ שְׁתֵּים עֶשְׂרֵה אֲבָנִים כְּמִסְפַּר שִׁבְטֵי בְּנֵי יַעֲקֹב וְכוּלֵי — **It says, "Eliyahu took twelve stones, according to the number of the tribes of the children of Yaakov," and so forth.** וְהַיְינוּ שֶׁאָז חִידֵּשׁ אֵלִיָּהוּ שֶׁבָּנָה מִזְבֵּחַ בַּחוּץ בְּאִיסּוּר הַבָּמוֹת. — **Eliyahu then introduced the exceptional act of building an altar outside the Temple, during the prohibition of private altars.** וְהוּא כְּעֵין בְּחִינַת נֵר חֲנוּכָּה שֶׁמַּדְלִיקִין בְּחוּצָה לָאָרֶץ. — **This resembles the aspect of the Chanukah lamp kindled outside the Land of Israel.** וְגַם עָשָׂה לְמִסְפַּר הַשְּׁבָטִים לְהוֹרוֹת שֶׁקְּדוּשַׁת הַשְּׁבָטִים כָּלוּל זֶה בָּזֶה — **He also used the number of the tribes to indicate that their holiness is included within one another,** מִקְּדוּשַׁת יַעֲקֹב אָבִינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם שֶׁכְּלָלָן יַחַד. — **deriving from the holiness of Yaakov our father, peace be upon him, who included them together.** וְכֵן חָשַׁב בַּפְּסִיקְתָא שָׁם שֶׁהַכֹּל בִּזְכוּת הַשְּׁבָטִים וְכָל הַבְּרִיאָה בִּזְכוּתָם — **Likewise, Pesikta there sets out that everything is in the tribes' merit, and all creation is in their merit (the source reads השבעים; the cited Pesikta reads השבטים),** שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר וְאֶת כָּל אֵלֶּה יָדִי עָשָׂתָה בִּזְכוּת כָּל אֵלֶּה שִׁבְטֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל וְכוּלֵי — **as it says, "All these My hand has made"—in the merit of "All these are the tribes of Israel," and so forth.** וְשָׁם הַכָּתוּב מְסַיֵּים אִישׁ אֲשֶׁר כְּבִרְכָתוֹ בֵּרַךְ אוֹתָם׃ — **There the verse concludes, "Each according to his blessing, he blessed them."**

[1260] **Machshavot Charutz 8:10**: "For every tribe has something in which it is distinctive and elevated above all the other tribes. Although they are all one nation, and each one's holiness is included in them all, nevertheless, in this particular matter that tribe is the head: its power extends into them all, and all are branches of it."

This concise distinction explains how the whole can be present in each person while one quality remains a tribe's leading strength. Yosef can lead in disciplined awe without excluding Yehudah's recognition of dependence on God; the strength of each is received by the others from its particular root.

[1261] **Mei HaShiloach, Volume I, Genesis, Vayechi 7**: "Within the twelve tribes of God, the Holy One, blessed be He, placed light and life unlike that of any other tribe. They are therefore called diagonal boundaries: the light of one is the opposite of another's, for one draws the force of its life from love, another from awe, and so forth. From this come all the disputes in the Gemara, although everything goes to one place, to fulfill God's will. As we find in Pesachim 53b: whether they said to kindle or not to kindle, both intended the same thing. So it is with all the disputes, for their source is one place. They are therefore called shevatim, branches spreading in different directions. God placed in the tribe of Gad the quality of suffering, for this tribe says that Torah cannot enter the human heart without suffering. Ordinarily, a person who suffers lacks a measure of joy and companionship. They were therefore blessed with joy and companionship; he blessed them with connection, so that they would form bands together. Thus no other tribe's count includes all the orders —hundreds, thousands, and tens—as Gad's does. "He will gather at the end" means that when Israel needs to be assembled, he will bind and join all Israel, and from him every kind of joy will come to Israel, for Eliyahu is from the tribe of Gad, as stated in the Midrash."

Mei HaShiloach makes the complementary structure concrete: the tribe whose particular approach emphasizes suffering is blessed to become a source of companionship and joy. This shows what it means for an opposite quality to complete rather than cancel a tribe's leading character. The need for suffering is explicitly Gad's particular perspective in this account, not a universal prerequisite newly imposed on every reader.

[1262] **Pesikta Rabbati 4:1**: "You find twelve months in the year, twelve constellations in the heavens, twelve hours of day, and twelve hours of night. The Holy One, blessed be He, said: "I created even the upper and lower realms only in the merit of the tribes," for it is written, "All these My hand has made" (Isaiah 66:2)—in the merit of "All these are the twelve tribes of Israel" (Genesis 49:28). (Hence the twelve constellations and twelve hours.) Therefore, when Eliyahu came to bring Israel close beneath the wings of the Divine Presence, he took twelve stones, corresponding to the number of the tribes, and built them into an altar. From where is this learned? From the conclusion of the prophetic reading: "Eliyahu took twelve stones, corresponding to the tribes of the children of Yaakov.""

וְהַהוֹד זוֹ בֵּית הַמִּקְדָּשׁ. (בְּרָכוֹת נח סוֹף עַמּוּד א)[1263] וְאִיתָא — **The Gemara states (Berakhot 58, end of side a), "'And the splendor'—this is the Temple."** וְהָעִנְיָן כַּיָּדוּעַ מֶלֶךְ בַּעֲשָׂרָה לְבוּשִׁים — **The meaning is the familiar teaching of the divine King in ten garments:** וְהֵיינוּ בְּעֶשֶׂר מִדּוֹת עֶשֶׂר סְפִירוֹת שֶׁהֶאֱצִיל הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ לִבְרִיאַת הָעוֹלָם. **the ten attributes, the ten sefirot that God emanated for the creation of the world.** וּבַפְּסִיקְתָא (שׂוֹשׂ אָשִׂישׂ) חָשַׁב לְבוּשׁ הוֹד לְבוּשׁ רִאשׁוֹן — **Pesikta, in "Sos Asis," counts the garment of Hod, splendor, as the first garment,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר גָּדַלְתָּ מְאֹד הוֹד וְהָדָר לָבָשְׁתָּ (וְנִתְבָּאֵר מַאֲמָר ב). — **as it says, "You are very great; You are clothed in splendor and majesty" (as explained in discourse 2).** וְהִנֵּה עִיקַּר בְּרִיאַת הָעוֹלָם הָיָה שֶׁיִּהְיֶה עִיקַּר שְׁכִינָה בַּתַּחְתּוֹנִים — **The chief purpose of creating the world was that the Shekhinah should dwell primarily in the lower realm,** וְיִהְיֶה עוֹלָם הַזֶּה מִקְדָּשׁ. וְזֶה מַה שֶּׁאָמְרוּ וְהַהוֹד זוֹ בֵּית הַמִּקְדָּשׁ. — **and that this world should become a sanctuary. This is the meaning of "'And the splendor'—this is the Temple."** וּבִשְׁלֹמֹה הַמֶּלֶךְ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם כָּתוּב (סוֹף דִּבְרֵי הַיָּמִים א) וַיִּתֵּן עָלָיו הוֹד מַלְכוּת וְגוֹמֵר — **Concerning King Shlomo, peace be upon him, it is written (at the end of I Chronicles), "He bestowed royal splendor upon him," and so forth.** וְהוּא זָכָה לִבְנוֹת הַבַּיִת הַמִּקְדָּשׁ. — **He merited building the Temple.** וְזֶה שֶׁכָּתוּב בְּתִיקּוּנֵי הַזֹּהַר (תִּיקּוּן יג) אָז יָשִׁיר מֹשֶׁה בְּגִין דְּאִיהוּ הוֹד דְּיָהִיב לְמֹשֶׁה — **Thus Tikkunei Zohar (Tikkun 13) says, "'Then Moshe sang'—because it is Hod that was given to Moshe."** וְכֵן הוּא בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ בְּכָל מָקוֹם. — **This likewise appears in various places in the holy Zohar.** וְהַמְכוּוָּן כִּדְבָרֵינוּ שֶׁמֹּשֶׁה רַבֵּינוּ הוֹרִיד הַשְׁכִינָה לָאָרֶץ כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב (בְּרֵאשִׁית רַבָּה פָּרָשָׁה יט) וְזֶהוּ בְּחִינַת הוֹד בִּנְיַן בַּיִת הַמִּקְדָּשׁ. — **The meaning accords with our explanation: Moshe our teacher brought the Shekhinah down to earth, as stated in Bereishit Rabbah (section 19). This is the aspect of Hod expressed in building the Temple.** וְאַהֲרֹן הַכֹּהֵן הוּא מֶרְכָּבָה לְמִדַּת הוֹד וְהוּא עִיקַּר הָעוֹבֵד בְּבֵית הַמִּקְדָּשׁ וְהַמִּשְׁכָּן. — **Aharon the priest is a vehicle for the attribute of Hod, and is the principal minister in the Temple and the Mishkan.** וְזָכוּ לָזֶה עַל יְדֵי שֶׁאָמְרוּ וְנַחְנוּ מָה. — **They merited this through saying, "And what are we?"**

The lowliest partner belongs in the sanctuary

אֵין לְךָ גָּדוֹל מִשֶּׁבָּט יְהוּדָה (שְׁמוֹת רַבָּה סוֹף פָּרָשָׁה מ)[1264, 1265, 1266] וְאִיתָא — **Shemot Rabbah (end of section 40) states, "No tribe is greater than Yehudah,** וְאֵין לְךָ יָרוּד מִשֶּׁבָּט דָּן כּוּלֵי אָמַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא יָבֹא וְיִזְדַּוֵּג לוֹ כּוּלֵי — **and none is lowlier than Dan … The Holy One, blessed be He, said, 'Let the latter come and join him' …** הַמִּשְׁכָּן בִּשְׁנֵי שְׁבָטִים אֵלּוּ נַעֲשָׂה וְכֵן הַמִּקְדָּשׁ כּוּלֵי עַיֵּין שָׁם — **The Mishkan was made through these two tribes, and likewise the Temple …" See there.** וּבַזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ (חֶלֶק ג קצד ב) אִיתָא שֶׁגַּם לֶעָתִיד יָבֹא שְׂרָיָה מִשֶּׁבָט דָּן עִם מָשִׁיחַ בֶּן יוֹסֵף. — **The holy Zohar (III, 194b) states that in the future Seraiah from the tribe of Dan will come with Mashiach ben Yosef.** וְיִהְיֶה שֶׁבֶט דָּן מְשׁוּתָּף גַּם בְּבִנְיַן הָעָתִיד. — **The tribe of Dan will thus also participate**

[1263] **Berakhot 58a:17**: "A baraita was taught in Rabbi Akiva's name: "'To You, Hashem, belongs greatness'—this is the splitting of the Sea. 'And might'—this is the plague of the firstborn. 'And glory'—this is the giving of the Torah. 'And Netzach'—this is Jerusalem. 'And Hod, splendor'—this is the Temple.'"

[1264] **Shemot Rabbah 40:4**: "The Holy One, blessed be He, said: "Let Oholiab come and join him, so that they will not despise him and no person will be arrogant, for the great and the small are equal before God." Betzalel was from Yehudah, and Oholiab from Dan, and he joined him. Rabbi Chanina said: "The great and the small are equal.""

[1265] **Takanat HaShavin 6:35**: "Nevertheless, Dan is called a lion like Yehudah, and everywhere he is joined to Yehudah, as is known concerning the work of the Mishkan and the Temple—Betzalel from Yehudah and Oholiav from Dan—and also in the days of Mashiach, as stated in the Zohar. This is from the aspect of the circles, in which the beginning and the end are joined together. He is also "the lion's tail," and "Dan shall judge his people as one"—like the most distinguished of the tribes, Yehudah."

Takanat HaShavin gives a structural reason for the partnership: at the level figured as a circle, the first and last meet. Dan's low position in an ordered body therefore does not place him outside its unity. The preceding discussion proposes a different month arrangement and expressly acknowledges multiple arrangements; this comparison uses its explanation of Dan and Yehudah's partnership, without equating that calendar with Pri Tzadik's Tevet correspondence.

[1266] **Tiferet Yosef, Pekudei 3**: "These are the accounts of the Mishkan, the Mishkan of testimony, which were counted at Moshe's command," and so forth. My grandfather explained in his holy book Mei HaShiloach that testimony means something clarified and explicit. As the Gemara says, seeing the New Moon in a glass lantern is insufficient for testimony; likewise, if they saw it incidentally, returned to look deliberately, and did not see it, they cannot testify. Testimony means something explicit. This is the "Mishkan of testimony," as the Gemara says: "It is testimony to everyone who comes into the world that the Divine Presence dwells among Israel." At the completion of the Mishkan, each person recognized clearly and explicitly how God dwells with every Jew. The generosity shown in building the Mishkan was not equal: one person had greater generosity, another less, and each brought according to his willingness. When the completed Mishkan needed to be erected, everyone recognized explicitly that just as it could not be erected without the person of great generosity, neither could it be erected without the person whose generosity was less. They all therefore recognized with clear and explicit testimony that the generosity of all, from the greatest to the least, was accepted as genuine, and that God dwells in each and every Jew."

Tiferet Yosef explains why including the less prominent participant is essential to a divine dwelling. The completed sanctuary itself reveals that the greater contribution could not substitute for the smaller one. This illuminates Pri Tzadik's insistence on Dan's actual partnership, rather than reducing his inclusion to a general expression of goodwill.

in the future building. (זוֹהַר חֲלָק ב קד סוֹף עַמּוּד ב) וְהוּא עַל פִּי מַה שֶּׁכָּתוּב בְּסָבָא — **This follows the teaching in Sava (Zohar II, 104, end of side b):** דָּן וְנַפְתָּלִי גָּד וְאָשֵׁר בְּיִרְכָא שְׂמָאלָא דָּן עַד פְּרָקָא דְּרַגְלָא כּוּלֵּי — **"Dan, Naftali, Gad, and Asher correspond to the left leg; Dan extends as far as the joint of the leg …"** וְהַיְינוּ כְּנֶגֶד מִדַּת הוֹד. — **This corresponds to the attribute of Hod.** וְעַל כֵּן הוּא מְשׁוּתָּף לְבִנְיַן הַמִּשְׁכָּן וּבֵית הַמִּקְדָּשׁ. — **Dan therefore shares in the construction of the Mishkan and the Temple.** וְכֵן מִצְוַת חֲנוּכָּה קָבְעוּ בִּב׳ חֳדָשִׁים אֵלּוּ כִּסְלֵו וְטֵבֵת. — **Likewise, the Chanukah commandment was established in these two months, Kislev and Tevet.** וּלְפִי מַה שֶּׁחִשַּׁב הָאֱלֹהִי רַבִּי יִצְחָק זִכְרוֹנוֹ לִבְרָכָה הַחֲדָשִׁים לַשְּׁבָטִים כְּסֵדֶר הַדְּגָלִים. — **According to the Ari's assignment of the months to the tribes in the order of their encampment banners,** כִּסְלֵו מְיוּחָס לְשֵׁבֶט בִּנְיָמִין. — **Kislev corresponds to Binyamin.** וּבְבִנְיָמִין כָּתוּב וּבֵין כְּתֵפָיו שָׁכַן. — **Concerning Binyamin it is written, "Between his shoulders He dwells."** (זְבָחִים קיח:) וְהַשְׁרָאַת הַשְּׁכִינָה הוּא תָּמִיד בְּחֶלְקוֹ כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ בַּגְּמָרָא — **The Shekhinah always dwells in his portion, as stated in the Gemara (Zevachim 118b).** וְחוֹדֶשׁ טֵבֵת מְיוּחָס לְדָן שֶׁהוּא יָרוּד שֶׁבַּשְּׁבָטִים. — **Tevet corresponds to Dan, the lowliest of the tribes.** וְהַיְינוּ שֶׁכָּל קְדוּשַׁת הַשְּׁבָטִים נִמְצָא בְּכָל א׳ וְא׳ — **All the tribes' holiness is thus found in each and every one,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר אִישׁ אֲשֶׁר כְּבִרְכָתוֹ בֵּרַךְ אוֹתָם. — **as it says, "Each according to his blessing, he blessed them."** וְכֵן כָּתוּב בְּפִסְיקְתָא (פָּרָשָׁה ז) יַעֲקֹב קִינְתֵּר לִרְאוּבֵן וְשִׁמְעוֹן וְלֵוִי חָזַר וּבֵרְכָם כּוּלֵּי — **Pesikta (section 7) likewise says, "Yaakov rebuked Reuven, Shimon, and Levi … He then blessed them … He made them draw nourishment from one another.** לְפִיכָךְ מוֹנָה אוֹתָן לְעַצְמָן בְּסֵפֶר אֵלֶּה שְׁמוֹת וּמְיַחֲסָם אֵצֶל מֹשֶׁה וְאַהֲרֹן כּוּלֵּי עָשָׂה אוֹתָם יוֹנְקִים זֶה מִזֶּה — **Therefore he enumerates them separately in the book of Shemot and traces their genealogy in connection with Moshe and Aharon …"** וְכֵן הוּא בְּמִדְרַשׁ רַבָּה (פָּרָשָׁה יג) — **This also appears in Midrash Rabbah (section 13).**

Hod carries unity into action

For Moshe and Aharon are known to represent the two legs, Netzach and Hod.[1267] וְהוּא דְּיָדוּעַ דְּמֹשֶׁה וְאַהֲרֹן תְּרֵין יַרְכִין נַצַּח וְהוֹד. — **They brought everyone near to the aspect of Yaakov, represented by the torso,** וְהֵם קֵירְבוּ הַכֹּל לִבְחִינַת יַעֲקֹב גּוּפָא — **to repair what is described by "The socket of Yaakov's thigh was dislocated."** לְתַקֵּן מַה דִּכְתִיב וַתֵּקַע כַּף יֶרֶךְ יַעֲקֹב. — **The Gemara (Chullin 91a) states that the Rabbis hold that the angel "came from behind him and struck him in both thighs."** וְאִיתָא (חוּלִין צא.) וְרַבָּנַן מֵאֲחוֹרֵיהּ אֲתָא וְנַשְׁיֵיהּ בְּתַרְוַיְיהוּ. — **Moshe and Aharon will repair both.** וּמֹשֶׁה וְאַהֲרֹן יְתַקְּנוּ שְׁנֵיהֶם. וְכֵן מִצְוַת נֵרוֹת חֲנוּכָּה עַד יוֹם ח׳ שֶׁהוּא מִדַּת הוֹד — **Likewise, the commandment of the Chanukah lights extends through the eighth day, which represents Hod,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בְּתִיקּוּנֵי הַזֹּהַר (שָׁם) וְאִיהוּ הוֹד תְּמָנְיָא יוֹמֵי דְּחֲנוּכָּה — **as Tikkunei Zohar says there, "It is Hod, the eight days of Chanukah."** שֶׁעִנְיַן חֲנוּכָּה הוּא גַּם כֵּן לַעֲשׂוֹת מִקְדָּשׁ וּבֵית לְהַשְׁרָאַת הַשְּׁכִינָה — **For Chanukah too is about making a sanctuary and a dwelling for the Shekhinah,** וְעַל זֶה עוֹשִׂין חֲנוּכַּת הַבַּיִת. — **and for this we hold the dedication of the dwelling.**

Earlier in that same passage of the Gemara (Berakhot), the Sages said: וּבְגְמָרָא (בְּרָכוֹת שָׁם) אָמְרוּ לְעֵיל מִינָּהּ — **"'And the splendor' refers to the battle at the Arnon streams,"** שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר עַל וְהַהוֹד זוֹ מִלְחֶמֶת נַחֲלֵי אַרְנוֹן — **as it says, "Therefore it is said in the Book of the Wars of Hashem: 'Vahev in Suphah.'"** כֵּן יֵאָמֵר בְּסֵפֶר מִלְחֲמוֹת הַשֵּׁם אֶת וָהֵב בְּסוּפָה. — **We must understand how this battle relates to Hod, splendor.** וְיֵשׁ לְהָבִין שַׁיְּכוּת מִלְחָמָה זוֹ לְהוֹד. — **Why, moreover, is a particular divine attribute expounded as referring to it?** גַּם לָמָּה נִדְרַשׁ עַל זֶה מִדָּה מְיוּחֶדֶת — **The subsequent exposition applying Hod to the Temple is readily understandable;** דִּבְשִׁלְמָא אַחַר כָּךְ דָּרַשׁ עַל בֵּית הַמִּקְדָּשׁ נִיחָא — **applying it to this particular battle, however, seems difficult to understand.** אֲבָל לְדָרוֹשׁ עַל מִלְחָמָה זוֹ לְכְאוֹרָה אֵינוֹ מוּבָן. — **The explanation is that the battle at the Arnon streams occurred as Israel began entering the Land of Israel.** אַךְ הָעִנְיָן דְּמִלְחֶמֶת נַחֲלֵי אַרְנוֹן הָיָה בִּתְחִילַת כְּנִיסַת יִשְׂרָאֵל לְאֶרֶץ יִשְׂרָאֵל — **As Midrash Rabbah, Chukat, states, that stream separates the territory of the Land of Israel from the territory of Moab.** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ (מִדְרַשׁ רַבָּה חוּקַת) שֶׁאוֹתוֹ נַחַל מַפְסִיק בֵּין תְּחוּמֵי אֶרֶץ יִשְׂרָאֵל לְתְחוּמֵי אֶרֶץ מוֹאָב. — **In the straightforward account of the rabbinic exposition, Et and Vahev were two people afflicted with tzara'at** וְהִנֵּה עַל פִּי הַפְּשָׁט אֶת וָהֵב שְׁנֵי מְצוֹרָעִים הָיוּ דַּהֲווּ מְהַלְּכִין

[1267] **Sod Yesharim, Purim 37:1**: "After a person serves through these attributes kindness and severity, Netzach and Hod, he recognizes the unity at their root, where none of these differentiated attributes applies. Concerning the miracles of Chanukah and Purim, the holy Ari teaches that they were in Netzach and Hod, which appear as two halves of a body. They are called "the two thighs" in Tikkunei Zohar, "outside the body" in the Zohar—that is, after the inner powers emerge into action. Even there the unity is recognizable when one follows the path of Yaakov our father, who recognizes how God is exalted beyond and free of all the attributes."
Sod Yesharim explains the significance of the bodily image itself: the legs represent the movement from inner qualities into actual deeds, where separation can appear most pronounced. Yaakov's path reveals the unity there too. This gives conceptual force to Pri Tzadik's account of repairing both legs and making an earthly dwelling through Chanukah's acts.

(שָׁם נד סוֹף עַמּוּד א) בְּסוֹף מַחֲנֵה יִשְׂרָאֵל כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ בַּגְּמָרָא[1268] — **who traveled at the rear of Israel's camp, as the Gemara states there (54a, toward the end).** וְעַל יָדָם נִתְגַּלָּה הַנֵּס — **Through them the miracle became known.** וְזֶה מוֹרֶה שֶׁאַף שֶׁהָיוּ מְשׁוּלָּחִין מִן הַמַּחֲנֶה מִכָּל מָקוֹם זָכוּ וְנִתְגַּלָּה הַנֵּס עַל יָדָם — **This shows that although they had been sent outside the camp, they nevertheless merited having the miracle revealed through them (the source reads הגם; the proposed reading is הנס).** וְאָמְרוּ יִשְׂרָאֵל שִׁירָה עַל הַבְּאֵר. — **Israel then sang the song concerning the well.**

Disagreement that seeks a connecting understanding

וְעַל דֶּרֶךְ הַדָּרֵשׁ נִדְרָשׁ עַל תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה[1269] — **Homiletically, the passage is expounded as referring to the Oral Torah.** וְזֶהוּ מִלְחֲמוֹת הַשֵּׁם שֶׁעַל יְדֵי סֵפֶר — **These are "the wars of Hashem" conducted through a book of Torah.** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ (קִידּוּשִׁין ל:) אֲפִילּוּ אָב וּבְנוֹ הָרַב וְתַלְמִידוֹ שֶׁעוֹסְקִים בַּתּוֹרָה בְּשַׁעַר א׳ נַעֲשִׂים אוֹיְבִים זֶה אֶת זֶה[1270] — **As the Sages said (Kiddushin 30b), even a father and son, or a teacher and student, studying Torah at one gate become enemies of one another,** וְאֵינָם זָזִים מִשָּׁם עַד שֶׁנַּעֲשִׂין אוֹהֲבִין זֶה אֶת זֶה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר אֶת וָהֵב בְּסוּפָה כּוּלֵי — **yet they do not leave until they love one another, as it says, "Et Vahev in Suphah," and so forth.** וְאַחַר כָּךְ אָמְרוּ שִׁירָה עַל הַבְּאֵר שֶׁהוּא מְרַמֵּז לְתוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה. — **Afterward they sang concerning the well, which alludes to the Oral Torah.** דְּהַמָּן בִּזְכוּת מֹשֶׁה (כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ תַּעֲנִית ט.) — **For the manna came in Moshe's merit (as stated in Ta'anit 9a).** שֶׁהוּא הוֹרִיד תּוֹרָה שֶׁבִּכְתָב מִן הַשָּׁמַיִם וְהַמָּן לֶחֶם מִן הַשָּׁמַיִם. — **He brought the Written Torah down from heaven, and the manna was bread from heaven.** וּבְאֵר מַיִם מִן הָאָרֶץ מְרַמֵּז עַל תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה. — **The well, whose water came from the earth, alludes to the Oral Torah.** וְכֵן אִיתָא בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ (חֵלֶק ג רעא ב) וְדָא נַהֲמָא דְּאוֹרַיְיתָא וַיַּיְנָא דְּאוֹרַיְיתָא דִּבְעַל פֶּה. — **The holy Zohar likewise says (III, 271b): "This is the bread of the Written Torah and the wine of the Oral Torah."** וּמַיִם כּוֹלֵל כָּל הַמַּשְׁקִים — **Water includes all beverages,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ (עֵירוּבִין סה.) כָּל שֶׁאֵין יַיִן נִשְׁפָּךְ כּוּלֵי שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר וּבֵרַךְ אֶת לַחְמְךָ וְאֶת מֵימֶיךָ. — **as in the saying (Eruvin 65a), "Any household in which wine is not poured out," and so forth, citing "He shall bless your bread and your water."** וְכֵן טָעֲמוּ בֶּאֱמֶת בַּבְּאֵר טַעַם כָּל הַמַּשְׁקִים כְּמוֹ שֶׁטָּעֲמוּ בַּמָּן טַעַם כָּל מַאֲכָלִים — **Indeed, they tasted every kind of beverage in the well, just as they tasted every kind of food in the manna,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ (בְּמְכִילְתָּא יִתְרוֹ עַל פָּסוּק וַיִּחַדְּ יִתְרוֹ) — **as stated in the Mekhilta, Yitro, on the verse "Yitro rejoiced."** וְהַבְּאֵר בִּזְכוּת מִרְיָם — **The well came in Miriam's merit,** דְּתוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה הוּא בְּחִינַת סִיהֲרָא דְּמִקַּבְּלָא מִשִּׁמְשָׁא שֶׁהוּא תּוֹרָה שֶׁבִּכְתָב — **for the Oral Torah corresponds to the moon, which receives from the sun, representing the Written Torah.** וְהַיְינוּ בְּחִינַת מַלְכוּת. — **This is the aspect of Malkhut, kingship.** וְאִיתָא (סוֹטָה יא:) דָּוִד נַמִּי מִמִּרְיָם קָאֵתֵי — **It is stated (Sotah 11b), "David, too, descended from Miriam."** מַלְכוּת פֶּה תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה קְרִינַן לָהּ. — **"Malkhut is the mouth; we call it the Oral Torah."** וְדָוִד וּשְׁלֹמֹה שׁוֹרֶשׁ תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה וְחָכְמָה תַּתָּאָה. — **David and Shlomo are the root of the Oral Torah and lower wisdom.** וְכֵן נִדְרָשׁ בְּאֵר חָפָרוּהָ שָׂרִים מֹשֶׁה וְאַהֲרֹן

[1268] **Berakhot 54a:16-54b:1**: "From where do we learn about the crossings of the Arnon streams? From the verse, "Therefore it is said in the Book of the Wars of Hashem: Vahev in Suphah," and so forth. It was taught: "Et and Vahev in Suphah"—these were two people afflicted with tzara'at, who walked at the rear of Israel's camp. As Israel was about to pass, the Amorites came, made hiding places, and concealed themselves in them. They said, "When Israel passes here, we will kill them." They did not know that the Ark went ahead of Israel and lowered the mountains before them. When the Ark came, the mountains joined together and killed them, and their blood descended into the Arnon streams. When Et and Vahev came, they saw blood flowing from between the mountains. They came and told Israel, and Israel sang. This is what is written: "The slope of the streams that inclines toward the dwelling of Ar and leans toward the border of Moab.""

[1269] **Tzidkat HaTzadik 188:1**: "The other two levels of companionship occur when they develop new Torah teachings; then they are called "those who fear Hashem." These are the two levels of "Pleasantness" and "Wounders," expounded in Sanhedrin 24 concerning the Torah scholars of the Land of Israel and Babylonia. Those who are gentle with one another correspond to "Pleasantness." These two gentle study partners are called "those who fear Hashem"; they are not two opposing sides. "The Holy One, blessed be He, listens attentively" means that He accepts what they decree. This is called "My sister": their new teachings are accepted and agreed to above, on condition that both of them fear Hashem. The chief dissemination of Torah took place in Babylonia, as stated in Ketubot 106, because the increase of students comes through incisive reasoning and sharpening, which develop through disagreement and opposing positions. This is why those who sharpen one another rise to greatness—that is, they establish students. Two opposites necessarily require a mediating element and an understanding that joins them. This is called "your majesty."

Tzidkat HaTzadik distinguishes gentle partners who share awe from the sharper Babylonian inquiry. In the latter, opposing positions create a need for an understanding that joins the two sides. This explains how the "wars" described here can serve a common Torah inquiry and end in love. The complete target also warns that sharpness can feed pride and expressly requires על דבר אמת וענוה צדק—"for truth, humility, and righteousness"—so the benefit is not attributed to contention by itself.

[1270] **Kiddushin 30b:2**: "What does "with enemies at the gate" mean? Rabbi Chiya bar Abba said: even a father and son, or a teacher and student, who study Torah at one gate become enemies of one another. They do not leave until they love one another, as it says, "Et Vahev in Suphah." Do not read "in Suphah," but "at its end.""

כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתַב רַבִּי שְׁלֹמֹה יִצְחָקִי. — **Likewise, "the well that princes dug" is expounded as referring to Moshe and Aharon, as Rashi writes.** וְהֵיְינוּ שֶׁמֹּשֶׁה רַבֵּינוּ הוֹרִיד הַתּוֹרָה שֶׁהָיָה כָּלוּל בָּהּ כָּל הַתּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה גַּם כֵּן. — **Moshe our teacher brought down the Written Torah, which also contained the entire Oral Torah.** וְנֶאֱמַר וּבְאַהֲרֹן כְּתִיב וְהָיָה הוּא יִהְיֶה לְךָ לְפֶה. — **Concerning Aharon it is written, "He shall be a mouth for you."** כִּי שִׂפְתֵי כֹהֵן יִשְׁמְרוּ דַעַת וְתוֹרָה יְבַקְּשׁוּ מִפִּיהוּ וְגוֹמֵר דְּהוּא שׁוֹרֶשׁ תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה. — **And it says, "For a priest's lips shall preserve knowledge, and Torah they shall seek from his mouth," and so forth, for he is the root of the Oral Torah.**

The gift of questions that reach the source

הֵיְינוּ מַה שֶּׁחִידְּשׁוּ הַחֲכָמִים וְכָתוּב כָּרוּהָ נְדִיבֵי עָם[1271] — **It is also written, "The nobles of the people excavated it."** כָּל אֵ׳ מִלִּבּוֹ וְהֵם דִּבְרֵי אֱלֹהִים חַיִּים. — **These are the new teachings that the sages each brought forth from their own hearts; they are the words of the living God.** וְנִדְרָשׁ בְּמִדְרָשׁ רַבָּה שֶׁכָּל אֵ׳ מֵהַנְּשִׂיאִים עוֹמְדִים עַל גַּבָּיו וּמוֹשְׁכִים בְּמַטּוֹתֵיהֶן כָּל אֵ׳ לְשִׁבְטוֹ כּוּלֵי — **Midrash Rabbah expounds that each of the princes stood over the well and drew its water with his staff, each for his own tribe, and so forth.** וְהֵיְינוּ שֶׁהַתּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה בָּא עַל יְדֵי הַסַּנְהֶדְרִין וְתַלְמִידֵי חֲכָמִים שֶׁהֵם נְדִיבֵי עָם. — **The Oral Torah comes through the Sanhedrin and the Torah scholars, who are the nobles of the people.** וְכָתוּב בְּמְחֹקֵק שָׂהָיָה הָעִיקָר עַל יְדֵי מֹשֶׁה רַבֵּינוּ שֶׁנִּקְרָא מְחוֹקֵק — **The verse continues, "with the lawgiver": its principal source was Moshe our teacher, who is called the lawgiver,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר כִּי שָׁם חֶלְקַת מְחֹקֵק סָפוּן. — **as it says, "For there the lawgiver's portion is concealed."** וְהוּא הוֹרִיד הַתּוֹרָה שֶׁבִּכְתָב וְהָיָה כָּלוּל בָּהּ כָּל הַתּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה — **He brought down the Written Torah, which contained the entire Oral Torah,** (נְדָרִים לח.) וְנָהֲג בָּהּ טוֹבַת עַיִן וּנְתָנָהּ לְיִשְׂרָאֵל כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ[1272] — **and generously gave it to Israel, as the Sages state (Nedarim 38a).** וְהֵיְינוּ פִּילְפּוּלָא בְּעָלְמָא שֶׁנִּיתָּן רַק לְמֹשֶׁה כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ שָׁם — **This refers specifically to the art of incisive Torah reasoning, which had been given to Moshe alone, as explained there.** וְזֶה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר בְּמִשְׁעֲנֹתָם שֶׁנַּעֲשָׂה לָהֶם מִשְׁעָן וּמִשְׁעֲנָה שְׁנִדְרָשׁ (חֲגִיגָה יד.) מִשְׁעֲנָה אֵלּוּ בַּעֲלֵי מִשְׁנָה כּוּלֵי כֹּל מִשְׁעָן לָחֶם אֵלּוּ בַּעֲלֵי תַּלְמוּד. — **Thus the verse says, "with their staffs": it became for them a support and a stay, — as expounded (Chagigah 14a): "'A stay'—these are masters of Mishnah," and so forth; "'every support of bread'—these are masters of Talmud."** וְאַחַר כָּךְ כָּתוּב וּמִמִּדְבָּר מַתָּנָה — **The verse then says, "And from the wilderness, Mattanah, a gift."** וְנִדְרָשׁ (עֵירוּבִין נ״ד.) אִם אָדָם מֵשִׂים עַצְמוֹ כְּמִדְבָּר זֶה שֶׁהַכֹּל דָּשִׁין בּוֹ תּוֹרָה נִיתְּנָה לוֹ בְּמַתָּנָה.[1273] — **The Sages expound (Eruvin 54a): if a person makes himself like this wilderness, which everyone treads upon, Torah is given to him as a gift.** וְהַמְכוּוָן עַל פִּי מַה שֶּׁאָמְרוּ (עֲבוֹדָה זָרָה שְׁמִתְחִלָּה נִקְרֵאת עַל שֵׁם שֶׁל הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא תּוֹרַת הַשֵּׁם וּלְבַסּוֹף נִקְרֵאת עַל שְׁמוֹ וּתְתוֹרָתוֹ וְגוֹמֵר.[1274] יט.) — **Its meaning accords with the teaching (Avodah Zarah 19a) that at first the Torah is called by the Holy One's name, "the Torah of Hashem," but ultimately it is called by the learner's name: "and in his Torah," and so**

[1271] **Sod Yesharim, Simchat Torah 5:1**: "Concerning this the Sages said in the Gemara, Nedarim 38, that Moshe, in his generosity, transmitted the incisive reasoning of Torah to Israel. Such reasoning is like what we find in Bava Metzia 84 concerning Rabbi Yochanan: "Bar Lakisha would raise twenty-four objections to me, and I would give twenty-four resolutions; thus the teaching became more expansive." Through the reasoning of questions and resolutions, all the screens that conceal were clarified until he reached the depth of the teaching. The same kind of inquiry applies to all matters of this world: Israel does not find rest in a lowly outer garment of a benefit, but through many clarifications reaches the depth of its source. This is the meaning of "Where Yaakov ended, Moshe began": Moshe our teacher showed that Israel does not begin to receive any benefit apart from the depth of God's will found within it."

Sod Yesharim explains what Moshe's gift of Torah reasoning enables. Questions and answers remove layers of concealment until the learner reaches the source within the teaching. This gives a mechanism to Pri Tzadik's movement from the Written Torah received by Moshe to new teachings emerging through the sages' hearts. The target's extension to other benefits also fits the section's governing demand to recognize God's will within what a person receives.

[1272] **Nedarim 38a:4-6**: "Rabbi Yosei son of Rabbi Chanina said: the Torah was given only to Moshe and his descendants, as it says, "Write for yourself," and "Carve for yourself": just as the offcuts are yours, so the writing is yours. Moshe acted generously with it and gave it to Israel; concerning him Scripture says, "The generous eye shall be blessed," and so forth. Rav Chisda objected: "Hashem commanded me at that time to teach you." The response was: "He commanded me, and I passed it on to you." "See, I have taught you statutes and judgments as Hashem my God commanded me." Again, the response was: "He commanded me, and I passed it on to you." "And now write this song for yourselves." The response was: "The song alone." But it says, "So that this song shall be a witness for Me among the children of Israel"! Rather, what had been given to Moshe alone was the art of incisive Torah reasoning."

[1273] **Eruvin 54a:24-25**: "He said to him: if a person makes himself like this wilderness, which everyone treads upon, Torah is given to him as a gift. Once it is given to him as a gift, God takes him as His portion, as it says, "From Mattanah, Nachaliel." Once God takes him as His portion, he rises to greatness, as it says, "From Nachaliel, Bamot, heights." If his heart becomes arrogant, the Holy One, blessed be He, lowers him, as it says, "From the heights, the valley." If he turns back, the Holy One, blessed be He, raises him, as it says, "Every valley shall be lifted.""

[1274] **Avodah Zarah 19a:8**: "Rava also said: at first it is called by the name of the Holy One, blessed be He, but ultimately it is called by the learner's name, as it says, "His desire is in the Torah of Hashem," and "In his Torah he meditates day and night.""

forth. וְאִם מֵגִיס לִבּוֹ הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא מַשְׁפִּילוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר וּמִמְּרוֹמוֹת הַגִּיאָ — **If he becomes arrogant, the Holy One, blessed be He, lowers him, as it says, "And from the heights, the valley."** וְהַיְינוּ כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ (תַּעֲנִית ז.) שֶׁנִּמְשְׁלוּ דִּבְרֵי תוֹרָה לְמַיִם שֶׁמַּנִּיחִין מָקוֹם גָּבוֹהַּ וְהוֹלֵךְ לְמָקוֹם נָמוּךְ — **This accords with the saying (Ta'anit 7a) that words of Torah are compared to water, which leaves a high place and flows to a low place.** וּכְבָר אָמַרְנוּ כַּמָּה פְּעָמִים דְּקָאֵי עַל תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה שֶׁנִּמְשָׁל לְמַיִם כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ שָׁם דְּקָאֵי עַל תַּלְמִידִים. — **We have already explained many times that this concerns the Oral Torah, which is compared to water; as stated there, it concerns students.** וְכֵן נִדְרָשׁ הַשִּׁירָה עַל תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה שֶׁעַל זֶה רוֹמֵז הַבְּאֵר. — **The song, too, is expounded concerning the Oral Torah, to which the well alludes.** וְאַף לְפִי הַפֵּירוּשׁ דְּאֵת וָהֵב ב' מְצוֹרָעִים הָוֹוּ. — **Even according to the explanation that Et and Vahev were two people with tzara'at,** הַמִּלְחָמָה הָיָה שֶׁרָצוּ לְעַכֵּב אֶת יִשְׂרָאֵל מִלִּכָּנוֹס לָאָרֶץ. — **the battle arose because the enemies sought to prevent Israel from entering the Land.** וְאֶרֶץ בְּחִינַת מַלְכוּת כְּנֶסֶת יִשְׂרָאֵל (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב זוֹהַר חֵלֶק א לֹא סוֹף עַמּוּד א וּשְׁאָר מְקוֹמוֹת) — **The Land corresponds to Malkhut, the Congregation of Israel (as stated in Zohar I, 31a, toward the end, and elsewhere).** וְעַל כֵּן בְּאֶרֶץ יִשְׂרָאֵל שָׁם עִיקַּר הַמָּקוֹם לְתוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה — **The Land of Israel is therefore the principal place for the Oral Torah.** כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ בָּבָא בַּתְרָא קנח:) אֲוִירָא דְּאֶרֶץ יִשְׂרָאֵל מַחְכִּים) — **As stated (Bava Batra 158b), "The air of the Land of Israel makes one wise."** וְאָמְרוּ (כְּתוּבוֹת עה.) וְחַד מִינַּייהוּ עָדִיף כְּתַרֵי מִינַּן — **And the Sages said (Ketubot 75a), "One of them is superior to two of us."** וְאִיתָא (בְּרֵאשִׁית רַבָּה פָּרָשָׁה טז) וּזְהַב הָאָרֶץ הַהִיא טוֹב מְלַמֵּד שֶׁאֵין תּוֹרָה כְּתוֹרַת אֶרֶץ יִשְׂרָאֵל וְלֹא חָכְמָה כְּחָכְמַת אֶרֶץ יִשְׂרָאֵל. — **Bereishit Rabbah, section 16, expounds "And the gold of that land is good": this teaches that no Torah is like the Torah of the Land of Israel, and no wisdom like its wisdom.**

Recovering the light concealed in Torah

וּכְבָר אָמַרְנוּ שָׁזֶּה שֶׁאָמְרוּ (נְדָרִים כב:)[1275, 1276] אִלְמָלֵא חָטְאוּ יִשְׂרָאֵל — **We have explained that this is the meaning of the saying (Nedarim 22b): had Israel not sinned,** לֹא נִיתְּנוּ לָהֶם אֶלָּא ה' חוּמְשֵׁי תוֹרָה וְסֵפֶר יְהוֹשֻׁעַ בִּלְבַד שֶׁעֶרְכָּהּ שֶׁל אֶרֶץ יִשְׂרָאֵל הוּא. — **they would have been given only the Five Books of the Torah and the book of Yehoshua, which sets out the arrangement of the Land of Israel.** שֶׁהַמְכוּוָּן שֶׁסֵּפֶר יְהוֹשֻׁעַ הוּא סוֹד תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה — **The intended meaning is that the book of Yehoshua embodies the mystery of the Oral Torah.** וְעַל זֶה אָמְרוּ מֹשֶׁה קִבֵּל תּוֹרָה מִסִּינַי וּמְסָרָהּ לִיהוֹשֻׁעַ דִּקְאֵי עַל תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה — **Concerning this they said, "Moshe received Torah from Sinai and transmitted it to Yehoshua," referring to the Oral Torah,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ דְּתוֹרָה שֶׁבִּכְתָב מָסַר לְלֵוָאֵי (חֵלֶק ב קלז ב) — **as the holy Zohar states (II, 137b), for the Written Torah he entrusted to the Levites.** וְאִלְמָלֵא חָטְאוּ הָיוּ רוֹאִים אֵיךְ הַכֹּל כָּלוּל בָּהּ' חוּמְשֵׁי תוֹרָה דְּלֵיכָּא מִידֵּי דְּלָא רְמִיזֵי בְּאוֹרַיְיתָא (כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ תַּעֲנִית ט.) — **Had they not sinned, they would have seen how everything is contained in the Five Books of the Torah, for nothing is without a hint in the Torah (as stated in Ta'anit 9a).** וְזֶהוּ עֶרְכָּהּ שֶׁל אֶרֶץ יִשְׂרָאֵל שֶׁהִיא מְקוֹם הַשְׁכִּינָה. — **This is the inner arrangement of the Land of Israel, the dwelling place of the Divine Presence.** וְעֶרְכָּהּ הַיְינוּ חֵלֶק כָּל א' מִיִּשְׂרָאֵל בַּתּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה שֶׁהוּא אֶרֶץ בְּחִינַת כְּנֶסֶת יִשְׂרָאֵל. — **Its arrangement means each Israelite's portion in the Oral Torah, which is the Land in its aspect as the**

[1275] **Nedarim 22b:3**: "Rav Adda son of Rabbi Chanina said: had Israel not sinned, they would have been given only the Five Books of the Torah and the book of Yehoshua, because it sets out the arrangement of the Land of Israel. What is the reason? "For with much wisdom comes much vexation.""

[1276] **Takanat HaShavin 6:88**: "Holding fast to Torah is possible only through the Oral Torah, in which the Written Torah is revealed in a way accessible to the hearts and souls of Israel. The Written Torah cannot be apprehended except through the Oral Torah. For the Written Torah was God's manifestation of His light to Israel at the giving of the Torah, through which they became free of the evil inclination. At that time the Written Torah alone would have sufficed, as stated in Nedarim: had they not sinned, they would have been given only the Torah and the book of Yehoshua, the arrangement of the Land of Israel. The Torah concerns time and the soul and was given in the wilderness; the fixing of place is set forth in Yehoshua. I have explained this elsewhere. In any event, everything could have been understood from the Written Torah alone, because God's light within the Torah, which illuminates and reveals every concealed thing, was manifest. Through sin this became concealed, just as the light of the six days of creation was hidden away for the righteous in the future, and the Sages said that it was hidden within the Torah. Its disclosure comes through the Oral Torah, which repairs sin, for Torah is a remedy for the evil inclination—not only concerning the future, but also what has already passed. Thus the Sages said that repairing transgressions requires increasing one's study; through this the inclination is subdued. According to the depth of one's Torah study, one can attain the depths of repentance that repair what came before. Through labor in the Oral Torah to attain the Torah's depths, all its lights are revealed and shine for the person, and every kind of darkness is consequently driven away. Therefore, with the completion of the Oral Torah, the repair of all that came before is completed, and the clear light within Israel is revealed, holding fast to Torah and the Tree of Life." Takanat HaShavin explains why the same passage can say that everything was already contained in the Torah and nevertheless require later Oral Torah labor. Sin conceals the received light; study both discloses it and repairs the obstruction. Its distinction between Torah's account of time and soul and Yehoshua's account of place clarifies the special role of the Land's arrangement in Pri Tzadik's argument. The completion described is the outcome of sustained study and repentance, rather than an excuse for the sin that created concealment.

Congregation of Israel. וְאַף דְּסֵפֶר יְהוֹשֻׁעַ רַק שְׁמוֹת עֲיָרוֹת צְפוּנִים בּוֹ הַסּוֹדוֹת מִשָּׁרְשֵׁי תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה — **Although these passages of the book of Yehoshua contain only town names, mysteries from the roots of the Oral Torah are concealed within it,** שֶׁהוּא סֵפֶר רִאשׁוֹן אַחַר תּוֹרַת מֹשֶׁה. — **for it is the first book after the Torah of Moshe.** וְעַל זֶה נֶאֱמַר וְנָתַתָּה מֵהוֹדְךָ עָלָיו — **Of this it is said, "You shall place some of your splendor upon him."** שֶׁהִיא תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה שֶׁל מֹשֶׁה רַבֵּינוּ שֶׁבָּא עַל יְדֵי לְבוּשׁ הוֹד (כְּמוֹ שֶׁנִּתְבָּאֵר מַאֲמָר ב) — **This is Moshe our teacher's Oral Torah, which comes through the garment of Hod, as explained in discourse 2.** וְכֵן הַמִּקְדָּשׁ שֶׁנִּקְרָא הוֹד בַּגְּמָרָא שָׁם עִיקַּר תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה — **Likewise, the Temple, called Hod in the Gemara, is the principal center of the Oral Torah.** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ (שָׁם טז.) הַר הַמּוֹרִיָּה הַר שֶׁיָּצָא מִמֶּנּוּ הוֹרָאָה לְיִשְׂרָאֵל — **As the Sages said (there, Ta'anit 16a), Mount Moriah is the mountain from which instruction went forth to Israel.** וּבַמִּשְׁנָה (סַנְהֶדְרִין פו:) לְבֵית דִּין הַגָּדוֹל שֶׁבְּלִשְׁכַּת הַגָּזִית שֶׁמִּמֶּנּוּ יוֹצְאָה תּוֹרָה לְכָל יִשְׂרָאֵל. — **And the Mishnah states (Sanhedrin 86b), "To the Great Court in the Chamber of Hewn Stone, from which Torah goes forth to all Israel."** וְכָתוּב כִּי מִצִּיּוֹן תֵּצֵא תוֹרָה וּדְבַר הַשֵּׁם מִירוּשָׁלָיִם. — **It is written, "For from Zion Torah shall go forth, and the word of Hashem from Jerusalem."** וְעַל יְדֵי מִלְחֶמֶת נַחֲלֵי אַרְנוֹן זָכוּ לָבֹא לְאֶרֶץ יִשְׂרָאֵל וְלִזְכּוֹת לְאוֹר תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה — **Through the battle at the Arnon streams, they merited entering the Land of Israel and attaining the light of the Oral Torah.** וּמּוּבָן מַה שֶׁפֵּרְשׁוּ וְהַהוֹד זוֹ מִלְחֶמֶת נַחֲלֵי אַרְנוֹן — **We can therefore understand the exposition "'And the splendor' refers to the battle at the Arnon streams."** וְהוּא כְּעֵין מַה שֶׁפֵּרְשׁוּ וְהַהוֹד זוֹ בֵּית הַמִּקְדָּשׁ וְכָאָמוּר. — **It parallels the exposition "'And the splendor' refers to the Temple," as explained.** וְכֵן עִנְיַן נֵרוֹת חֲנוּכָּה שֶׁעוֹשִׂין חֲנוּכַּת הַבַּיִת — **This is also the meaning of the Chanukah lights, through which one dedicates the home.** וּבַהַדְלָקָה מַמְשִׁיכִין מֵאוֹר הָרִאשׁוֹן שֶׁגִּנְגַז לַעֲמֵלֵי תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה. — **By lighting them, one draws from the primordial light concealed for those who toil in the Oral Torah.** כְּמוֹ שֶׁנִּתְבָּאֵר (בַּמַּאֲמָרִים הַקּוֹדְמִים) נִמְשָׁךְ הַהַדְלָקָה עַד יוֹם ח' הוֹד דַּרְגָּא תְּמִינָאָה. — **As explained in the preceding discourses, the lighting continues through the eighth day: Hod, the eighth level.** וּשְׁנַיִם זֵתִים עָלֶיהָ נֶדֶרֶשׁ בַּפְּסִיקְתָּא (פָּרָשָׁה ח') אֵלּוּ שְׁנֵי הַמְּשִׁיחִים כּוֹהֲלֵי שֶׁהֵם מוֹרִיקִים הַשֶּׁמֶן — **The Pesikta, section 8, expounds "And two olive trees beside it" as referring to the two messiahs, and so forth, who pour forth the oil.** דָּוִד הַמֶּלֶךְ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם וּמָשִׁיחַ בֶּן דָּוִד מֶרְכָּבָה לְמִדַּת מַלְכוּת פֶּה תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה. — **King David, peace be upon him, and Mashiach ben David embody the attribute of Malkhut: the mouth, the Oral Torah.** וְיוֹסֵף בֶּן זְקוּנִים שֶׁכָּל הֲלָכוֹת שֶׁמָּסְרוּ שֵׁם וְעֵבֶר לְיַעֲקֹב מְסָרָן לוֹ (כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ בִּבְרֵאשִׁית רַבָּה) — **Yosef was the "son of his old age": Yaakov transmitted to him all the teachings that Shem and Ever had entrusted to Yaakov (as stated in Bereishit Rabbah).** וְיהוֹשֻׁעַ מִזַּרְעוֹ הִנְחִיל הָאָרֶץ לְיִשְׂרָאֵל שֶׁהִיא הַתּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה כָּאָמוּר. — **His descendant Yehoshua gave Israel possession of the Land, which corresponds to the Oral Torah, as explained.** וְעַל יְדֵי מִדַּת יְסוֹד הַהַמְשָׁכָה מִתּוֹרָה שֶׁבִּכְתָב לְתוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה — **Through the attribute of Yesod, foundation, the flow passes from the Written Torah to the Oral Torah,** שֶׁהֵם בְּחִינַת שָׁמַיִם וָאָרֶץ כַּיָּדוּעַ. — **which correspond to heaven and earth, as is known.** וּמָשִׁיחַ בֶּן יוֹסֵף נִקְרָא בַּפְּסִיקְתָּא (פָּרָשָׁה לח שׁוֹשׁ אָשִׂישׂ) אֶפְרַיִם מְשִׁיחַ צִדְקִי. — **In the Pesikta, section 38, "Sos Asis," Mashiach ben Yosef is called "Ephraim, My righteous messiah."** שֶׁקּוֹרְאוֹ הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרֵךְ אֶפְרַיִם שֶׁרוֹמֵז שֶׁהוּא מֵאוֹר הָרִאשׁוֹן לְתוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה — **God calls him Ephraim, a name that alludes to the Oral Torah,** שֶׁמַּשְׁפִּיעַ הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרֵךְ לַצַּדִּיק — **which comes from the primordial light that God bestows upon the righteous one.** וְעַל זֶה נֶאֱמַר כִּי הִפְרַנִי אֱלֹהִים בְּאֶרֶץ עָנְיִי וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמַרְנוּ. — **Concerning this it says, "For God has made me fruitful in the land of my affliction," as we have explained.** וְעִיקַּר תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה נִקְנֶה בְּלֵב מִי שֶׁמְּשִׁים עַצְמוֹ כְּמִי שְׁאֵינוֹ — **The Oral Torah is acquired chiefly in the heart of one who regards himself as though he were nothing,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר וְהַחָכְמָה מֵאַיִן תִּמָּצֵא. — **as it says, read homiletically, "And wisdom is found from ayin, nothingness."** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמַרְנוּ שֶׁהוּא זוֹכֶה לִהְיוֹת מֶרְכָּבָה לְמִדַּת אַיִן. — **As we have explained, he merits becoming a vehicle for the divine attribute of Ayin.** וְעַל כֵּן אַהֲרֹן שֶׁאָמַר וְנַחְנוּ מָה הוּא שׁוֹרֶשׁ תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה — **Aharon, who said "And what are we?" is therefore the root of the Oral Torah,** שֶׁהוּא יוֹדֵעַ שֶׁהַכֹּל מֵהַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרֵךְ. — **for he knows that everything comes from God.** וְהוּא יִתְבָּרֵךְ מַשְׁפִּיעַ לְלֵב הַחֲכָמִים הַמְחַדְּשִׁים כְּמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר תִּזַּל כַּטַּל אִמְרָתִי — **God bestows this flow upon the hearts of the sages who bring forth new teachings, as it says, "My speech shall drip like dew."** וְזֶה גַּם כֵּן שׁוֹרֶשׁ נֵס חֲנוּכָּה שֶׁהַכֹּל הוּא מֵהַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרֵךְ וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמַרְנוּ: — **This is also the root of the Chanukah miracle: everything comes from God, as we have explained.**

Two methods carry the Torah's hidden depth

וּבֶאֱמֶת בְּלִשְׁכַּת הַגָּזִית שָׁמְשָׁם יָצָא הוֹרָאָה לֹא הָיָה מַחֲלוֹקֶת[1277] — **In truth, in the Chamber of Hewn Stone, from**

[1277] **Poked Akarim 6:5**: "In Bava Batra 145b the Sages interpret "a cheerful heart has a continual feast" as referring either to Mishnah or to Talmud; see there. It appears that this depends upon the disagreement at the end of Horayot, 14a, over which is preferable: "Sinai" comprehensive received knowledge or "an uprooter of mountains" exceptional analytical power. The answer sent without qualification was that Sinai takes precedence. This is the manner of study of the people

which authoritative instruction went forth, there was no dispute. רַק אַחַר כָּךְ בְּבָבֶל הִתְחִיל עִיקַר הַמַּחֲלוֹקֶת וּמִלְחֲמוֹת הַשֵּׁם שֶׁבְּתוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה. — **Only afterward, in Babylonia, did the principal arena of disagreement and the wars of Hashem within the Oral Torah begin.** וְכֵן נִדְרָשׁ (סַנְהֶדְרִין כד.) יְצָהָר אֵלּוּ תַּלְמִידֵי חֲכָמִים שֶׁבְּאֶרֶץ יִשְׂרָאֵל[1278] — **Thus the Sages expound (Sanhedrin 24a): "'Oil' refers to the Torah scholars of the Land of Israel, who are gentle with one another in halakhic discussion, like olive oil."** וּשְׁנַיִם זֵתִים עָלָיו אֵלּוּ תַּלְמִידֵי חֲכָמִים שֶׁבְּבָבֶל שֶׁמְּרִירִין זֶה לָזֶה בְּהֲלָכָה כַּזַּיִת. — **"'And two olive trees beside it' refers to the Torah scholars of Babylonia, who are bitter toward one another in halakhic discussion, like an olive."** וְזֶהוּ בְּחִינַת יוֹסֵף וְדָוִד — **These are the aspects of Yosef and David.** יוֹסֵף נִקְרָא זַיִת עַל דֶּרֶךְ מַה שֶּׁנֶּאֱמַר זַיִת רַעֲנָן יְפֵה פְרִי תֹאַר — **Yosef is called an olive, in keeping with the verse "A flourishing olive tree, beautiful with shapely fruit."** שֶׁהוּא בְּחִינַת יוֹסֵף שֶׁנִּקְרָא יְפֵה תֹּאַר וִיפֵה מַרְאֶה — **This is the aspect of Yosef, who is called "beautiful of form and beautiful of appearance,"** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב מַאֲמָר כא) עַל שֵׁם שֶׁגּוּפוֹ נָקִי וּמְהוּדָּר — **because his body is pure and adorned with holiness, as explained in discourse 21.** וְדָוִד יְצָהָר שֶׁנּוֹחִין זֶה לָזֶה בַּהֲלָכָה. — **David corresponds to oil: being gentle with one another in halakhic discussion.** (שָׁם) וְכֵן דָּרְשׁוּ נוֹעַם אֵלּוּ תַּלְמִידֵי חֲכָמִים שֶׁבְּאֶרֶץ יִשְׂרָאֵל שֶׁמַּנְעִימִין זֶה לָזֶה בַּהֲלָכָה — **Likewise, they expounded there: "'Pleasantness' refers to the Torah scholars of the Land of Israel, who are pleasant with one another in halakhic discussion."** חוֹבְלִים אֵלּוּ תַּלְמִידֵי חֲכָמִים שֶׁבְּבָבֶל שֶׁמְּחַבְּלִים זֶה לָזֶה בַּהֲלָכָה. — **"'Wounders' refers to the Torah scholars of Babylonia, who wound one another through sharp contention in halakhic discussion."** וְהַיְינוּ דְּעִיקַּר שׁוֹרֶשׁ תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה בְּאֶרֶץ יִשְׂרָאֵל וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמַרְנוּ. — **The principal root of the Oral Torah is in the Land of Israel, as we have explained.** וּמִכָּל מָקוֹם הַפִּלְפּוּל וְהַמִּלְחָמָה בְּבָבֶל — **Nevertheless, its incisive reasoning and battle are in Babylonia,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ (סוּכָּה מד.) דִּלְכוֹן אֲמַרִי דִּלְהוֹן הֵיא[1279] — **as stated (Sukkah 44a), "I thought the Torah was yours, but it is theirs, the Babylonians'."** וְכֵן אָמְרוּ (שָׁם כ.) עֶזְרָא מִבָּבֶל וְיָסְדָה כּוּבְלֵי הַלֵּל הַבָּבְלִי וְיָסְדָה[1280] — **Likewise, the Sages said (there, 20a): "Ezra came up from Babylonia and established it," and so forth; "Hillel the Babylonian established it," and so forth;** עָלוּ רַבִּי חִיָּא וּבָנָיו וְיָסְדוּהָ. — **"Rabbi Chiya and his sons came up and established it."** וְיֵשׁ לוֹמַר דְּכֵן עִנְיַן בֵּית שַׁמַּאי וּבֵית הִלֵּל — **We may say that this also explains Beit Shammai and Beit Hillel.** דְּשַׁמַּאי מִסִּטְרָא דְּדִינָא וּבֵית הִלֵּל מִסִּטְרָא דְּרַחֲמֵי כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב (זֹהַר חֶלֶק ג רמה א) — **Shammai comes from the side of judgment, and Beit Hillel from the side of mercy, as stated in Zohar III, 245a.** וְאִיתָא בַּגְּמָרָא (יְבָמוֹת יד.) בֵּית שַׁמַּאי מְחַדְּדֵי טְפֵי. — **The Gemara states (Yevamot 14a) that Beit Shammai were sharper in reasoning.** וְהוּא מִפְּנֵי שֶׁהֵם מִבְּחִינַת יוֹסֵף שֶׁהוּא הַיִרְאָה דְּשַׁמַּאי מִדַּרְגָּא דְּיִצְחָק. — **They belong to the aspect of Yosef, which is awe, for Shammai comes from Yitzchak's level.** וְיוֹסֵף הִקְדִּים מְנַשֶּׁה לְאֶפְרַיִם שֶׁהָעִיקָּר הַנִּיצּוּחַ לַיֵּצֶר הָרָע — **Yosef placed Menashe before Ephraim, because the chief concern is victory over the evil inclination,** וְעִיקַּר הַנִּצּוּחַ עַל יְדֵי פִּלְפּוּל הַהֲלָכָה. — **and that victory comes principally through rigorous halakhic reasoning.** וּבֵית הִלֵּל אִיתָא (עֵירוּבִין יג:) שֶׁנּוֹחִין

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of the Land of Israel, who are gentle with one another in halakhic discussion. Rabbi Zeira undertook a hundred fasts so that the Babylonian Talmud would be forgotten by him, as stated at the end of Bava Metzia 85a; he therefore assigned the advantage to Mishnah. Rava, by contrast, was among the leading practitioners of incisive reasoning who established the Babylonian Talmud, as in "the discussions of Abaye and Rava." He therefore said the reverse. Both are "the wine I have mixed," alluding to the tractates of Mishnah and Talmud; within them all the Torah's secrets are also hidden, as is known."

Poked Akarim supplies a second, concrete account of the two study traditions: comprehensive received knowledge and the analytical work that uproots difficulties. It preserves the differing judgments of Rabbi Zeira and Rava while locating hidden Torah depth in both. This illuminates why Pri Tzadik can acknowledge the Land of Israel as the principal root and still give Babylonia's reasoning an indispensable role, without making the two methods identical.

[1278] **Sanhedrin 24a:12-13**: "Rabbi Oshaya said: what is the meaning of "I took for Myself two staffs; one I called Pleasantness, and one I called Wounders"? "Pleasantness" refers to the Torah scholars of the Land of Israel, who are pleasant with one another in halakhic discussion. "Wounders" refers to the Torah scholars of Babylonia, who wound one another in halakhic discussion. "He said to me: These are the two sons of oil who stand," and so forth; "and two olive trees beside it." Rabbi Yitzchak said: "Oil" refers to the Torah scholars of the Land of Israel, who are gentle with one another in halakhic discussion, like olive oil. "And two olive trees beside it" refers to the Torah scholars of Babylonia, who are bitter toward one another in halakhic discussion, like an olive."

[1279] **Rashi on Sukkah 44a:11:1**: "Rabbi Yochanan would say to the people of the Land of Israel: "I thought the Torah was yours, because you had not been exiled from your land and had not suffered distraction of mind. But I have seen that it belongs to the people of Babylonia: although they were exiled, the wisdom of the craftsmen and smiths exiled with Yechonyah remained with them." As it is written (II Kings 24:16), "All were mighty men, makers of war." It was taught in Seder Olam: what mighty deeds can people bound in iron chains perform? Rather, they were mighty in the war of Torah. This shows that Rabbi Yochanan held that Torah was not forgotten in the Babylonian exile."

[1280] **Sukkah 20a:11**: "Reish Lakish follows his own position, for Reish Lakish said: "May I be an atonement for Rabbi Chiya and his sons. At first, when Torah was forgotten from Israel, Ezra came up from Babylonia and established it. It was forgotten again; Hillel the Babylonian came up and established it. It was forgotten again; Rabbi Chiya and his sons came up and established it.""

וַעֲלוּבִין הָיוּ כּוּלֵי שֶׁמַּקְדִּימִין דִּבְרֵי בֵּית שַׁמַּאי לְדִבְרֵיהֶן.[1281] — **Concerning Beit Hillel it is stated (Eruvin 13b) that they were gentle and forbearing, and so forth, and cited Beit Shammai's views before their own.** וְזֶה מִבְּחִינַת דָּוִד שֶׁאָמַר כִּי עָנִי וְאֶבְיוֹן אָנִי וְאָמַר ה' רוֹעִי וְגוֹמֵר. — **This is David's aspect: "For I am poor and needy," and "Hashem is my shepherd," and so forth.** וְיֵשׁ לוֹמַר דָּזֶה עִנְיַן שֶׁמָּצִינוּ (גִּיטִּין לד:)[1282] — **We may say that this also explains what we find in Gittin 34b:** בְּנֵי אָדָם הַבָּאִים מִשָּׁם לְכָאן שְׁמוֹ יוֹסֵף וְקוֹרְאִין לוֹ יוֹחָנָן יוֹחָנָן וְקוֹרְאִין לוֹ יוֹסֵף כּוּלֵי — **people who come from there to here are named Yosef but called Yochanan, or named Yochanan but called Yosef, and so forth.** וּכְבָר דִּקְדְּקוּ שֶׁתָּפְסוּ דְּאִתְרְמִי חִילּוּף בֵּין יוֹחָנָן לְיוֹסֵף. — **We have already examined why the example specifically describes an interchange between Yochanan and Yosef.** וּבֶאֱמֶת שֵׁם יוֹסֵף שָׁמוּר גָּל לְמָשָׁל הוּא מִפְּנֵי שֶׁכָּל יִשְׂרָאֵל נִקְרָאוּ עַל שְׁמוֹ שְׁאֵרִית יוֹסֵף — **The name Yosef is commonly used in examples because all Israel are called by his name, "the remnant of Yosef."** וְכָתוּב וְעַל כֵּן בָּגְמָרָא יוֹסֵף בֶּן שִׁמְעוֹן לְמָשָׁל וְעַמֵּךְ כּוּלָּם צַדִּיקִים. — **It is written, "Your people are all righteous."** (וְנִתְבָּאֵר בְּמָקוֹם אַחֵר)[1283][1284] — **Thus the Gemara uses "Yosef ben Shimon" as an example, as explained elsewhere.** אַךְ עַל אֶבֶל מַה טִּיבוֹ לְהַחֲלִיפוֹ לְיוֹחָנָן. — **But why should it be exchanged specifically for Yochanan?** פִּי הָאָמוּר יִתָּכֵן דְּשֵׁם יוֹסֵף מוֹרֶה שֶׁמְּחַבֵּב עַמַּל עַצְמוֹ וְיִגִיעוֹ — **In light of the above, the name Yosef may express a person's love of his own labor and effort.** שֶׁזֶּה בְּחִינַת יוֹסֵף שֶׁהִקְדִּים מְנַשֶּׁה לְאֶפְרַיִם. — **This is Yosef's aspect, placing Menashe before Ephraim.** וְיוֹחָנָן מוֹרֶה שֶׁמַּכִּיר שֶׁהַכֹּל מֵהַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרֵךְ — **Yochanan expresses recognition that everything comes from God,** וְכִבְחִינַת דָּוִד הַמֶּלֶךְ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם שֶׁאָמַר ה' רוֹעִי. — **like the aspect of King David, peace be upon him, who said, "Hashem is my shepherd."** וְעַל זֶה מוֹרֶה שֵׁם יוֹחָנָן י"ו חָנַן וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמַרְנוּ — **The name Yochanan expresses this: the divine letters yud–vav signify the One who "graciously bestowed," as we have explained.** וְלָכֵן יִתָּכֵן דִּלְפָעָמִים בְּאֶרֶץ יִשְׂרָאֵל שֶׁזָּכָה לְחָכְמָה נִקְרָא יוֹסֵף — **Thus a person who has attained wisdom in the Land of Israel may sometimes be called Yosef,** שֶׁשָּׁם הָיְתָה תּוֹלֶה בַּעֲמָלוֹ בְּחִדּוּד וּפִלְפּוּל. — **because there he attributed his attainment to his own labor in sharp analysis and reasoning.** וּכְשֶׁבָּא לק"ל לְבָבֶל וְרָאָה מִלְחֲמוֹת הַשֵּׁם שֶׁל הַבַּבְלִיִּים — **When he comes to Babylonia (the intervening abbreviation לק"ל in the source is unresolved) and sees the Babylonians' wars of Hashem,** מַכִּיר שֶׁמָּה שֶׁזָּכָה בְּאֶרֶץ יִשְׂרָאֵל לְהַחְכָּמָה הָיָה הַכֹּל מֵהַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרֵךְ וְעַל כֵּן קוֹרְאִין אוֹתוֹ יוֹחָנָן. — **he recognizes that all the wisdom he attained in the Land of Israel came from God, and so he is called Yochanan.** וְלִפְעָמִים בְּאֶרֶץ יִשְׂרָאֵל שֶׁנּוֹחִין זֶה לָזֶה בַּהֲלָכָה נִקְרָא יוֹחָנָן שֶׁמַּכִּיר שֶׁהַכֹּל מֵהַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרֵךְ — **At other times, in the Land of Israel, where scholars are gentle with one another in halakhic discussion, he is called Yochanan, recognizing that everything comes from God.** וּכְשֶׁבָּא לְבָבֶל וְלוֹמֵד הַפִּלְפּוּל וּמִלְחֶמֶת הַשֵּׁם שֶׁל הַבַּבְלִיִּים — **When he comes to Babylonia and learns the Babylonians' incisive reasoning and war of Hashem,** אָז קוֹרְאִין אוֹתוֹ יוֹסֵף שֶׁמְּחַבֵּב עֲמָלוֹ וְיִגִיעוֹ. — **he is then called Yosef, valuing his own labor and effort.** וְזֶה עִנְיַן הַב' מְשִׁיחִים מִיוֹסֵף וּמִדָּוִד שֶׁהֵם מֶרְכָּבָה לְמִדּוֹת יְסוֹד וּמַלְכוּת — **This is the significance of the two messiahs, from Yosef and David, who embody the attributes of Yesod and Malkhut.** וְהוּא בְּחִינַת יוֹסֵף וְיוֹחָנָן. — **These are the aspects of Yosef and Yochanan.** וְהִנֵּה נוֹסַח עַל הַנִּסִּים אִיתָא בָּרוֹקֵחַ וְכָלְבּוֹ שֶׁתִּקְּנוּ יוֹחָנָן כֹּהֵן גָּדוֹל — **The Rokeach and Kol Bo state that Yochanan the High Priest instituted the text of Al HaNissim (the source reads טסח; the proposed reading is נוסח).**

[1281] **Eruvin 13b:11**: "Since these and those are the words of the living God, why did Beit Hillel merit having the halakhah established according to their view? Because they were gentle and forbearing, and studied both their own statements and the statements of Beit Shammai. Moreover, they placed Beit Shammai's statements before their own."

[1282] **Gittin 34b:3**: "Gemara. Rav Yehudah said in the name of Shmuel: the people of the overseas region sent to Rabban Gamliel: "People come from there to here whose name is Yosef but who are called Yochanan, or Yochanan but who are called Yosef. How are they to divorce their wives?" Rabban Gamliel arose and enacted that they should write, "So-and-so and every name he has," and "So-and-so and every name she has," for the proper ordering of society. Rav Ashi said: this applies when the person is established under two names. Rabbi Abba said to Rav Ashi: Rabbi Mari and Rabbi Elazar hold as you do."

[1283] **Peri Tzadik, Korach 8:4**: "We find in the Talmud, Bava Batra 172a and elsewhere, the case of two people living in one town, each named Joseph son of Simeon. It would seemingly have been more fitting to use the example Reuben son of Jacob; why specifically Joseph son of Simeon? We have explained that all Israel are called by Joseph's name, as it is said, "The remnant of Joseph," and as stated in Bereshit Rabbah 71. This accords with "Your people are all righteous," and with the statement of the holy Zohar, II, 23a: everyone who is circumcised is called righteous. Thus it uses Joseph son of Simeon as its example. Even though most of the twenty-four thousand who died over the matter of Peor were from the tribe of Simeon, which is the opposite of the quality of Joseph the righteous, in truth he too is called by Joseph's name: the quality of the righteous person who guards the covenant. This is the meaning of Joseph son of Simeon."

[1284] **Bava Batra 172a:11-13**: "If two people lived in one city, one named Yosef ben Shimon and the other named Yosef ben Shimon, they cannot produce a debt document against one another, nor can another person produce a debt document against them. If someone finds among his documents a statement that "the debt document of Yosef ben Shimon has been paid," the debt documents of both are regarded as paid. What should they do? They should record three generations in their names. If their names are identical through three generations, they should write a distinguishing sign. If their signs are also identical, they should write "priest" for the one who is a priest."

וְכָתְבוּ שֶׁיֵּשׁ בּוֹ תֵּיבוֹת כְּמִסְפַּר יוֹחָנָן. — **They write that it contains a number of words equal to the numerical value of Yochanan.** וְאַף שֶׁאֵין מִסְפָּר זֶה בַּנּוּסָח שֶׁלְּפָנֵינוּ מִסְתָּמָא הָיָה לָהֶם נוּסַח שֶׁהָיָה כֵּן מִסְפַּר הַתֵּיבוֹת. — **Although our text does not have that number, they presumably had a version with that word count.** וֶאֱמֶת שֶׁלֹּא יָדַע אֵיזֶהוּ יוֹחָנָן הוּא. — **In truth, we do not know which Yochanan this was.** אִם הָיָה אָבִי מַתִּתְיָהוּ לֹא נִזְכַּר שֶׁהָיָה בְּעֵת הַנֵּס. — **If it was Mattityahu's father, there is no mention that he was alive at the time of the miracle.** וְיוֹחָנָן כֹּהֵן גָּדוֹל שֶׁנַּעֲשָׂה צְדוֹקִי לֹא יִתָּכֵן שֶׁיִּהְיֶה הוּא מְתַקֵּן נוּסַח תְּפִלָּה לְיִשְׂרָאֵל. — **It is not plausible that Yochanan the High Priest who became a Sadducee would be the one to institute a prayer text for Israel.** וְהִנֵּה מָצִינוּ (סוֹף פֶּרֶק ה דְּמַעֲשֵׂר שֵׁנִי[1285]) תַּקָּנוֹת מִיוֹחָנָן כֹּהֵן גָּדוֹל — **At the end of chapter 5 of Ma'aser Sheni, we find enactments made by Yochanan the High Priest.** וּפֵירֵשׁ הָרַב עוֹבַדְיָה מִבַּרְטְנוּרָא שֶׁשִּׁימֵשׁ אַחַר שִׁמְעוֹן הַצַּדִּיק[1286] — **Rabbi Ovadiah of Bartenura explains that he served after Shimon the Righteous.** וְכֵן כָּתַב הָרַב מֹשֶׁה בֶּן מַיְמוֹן (רֵישׁ פֶּרֶק ט מֵהִלְכוֹת מַעֲשֵׂר[1287]) וְעַיֵּין שָׁם בְּכֶסֶף מִשְׁנֶה — **Rambam likewise writes this at the beginning of chapter 9 of the Laws of Tithes; see the Kesef Mishneh there.** וְהַיְינוּ יוֹחָנָן אֲבִי מַתִּתְיָהוּ כְּמוֹ שֶׁנִּרְאֶה לְפִי חֶשְׁבּוֹן הַדּוֹרוֹת — **This would be Yochanan, Mattityahu's father, as the reckoning of the generations appears to indicate.** וְעַיֵּין רַבֵּינוּ שִׁמְשׁוֹן אֲבָל אֵיךְ שֶׁיִּהְיֶה אִם יוֹחָנָן אֲבִי מַתִּתְיָהוּ תִּיקֵּן שֶׁהָאֲרִיךְ יָמִים אוֹ מַתִּתְיָהוּ הָיָה לוֹ בֵּן וּשְׁמוֹ יוֹחָנָן אַף שֶׁלֹּא נִזְכַּר בְּיוֹסִיפּוֹן עַל כָּל פָּנִים הוּא מְקוּבָּל שֶׁמְּתַקֵּן נוּסַח עַל הַנִּסִּים שְׁמוֹ יוֹחָנָן. — **See Rabbeinu Shimshon's commentary on Parah, chapter 3, mishnah 8.**[1288] **However it may be—whether Yochanan, Mattityahu's father, instituted it because he lived to an advanced age, — or Mattityahu had a son named Yochanan, although he is not mentioned in Josippon— the received tradition, in any event, is that the person who instituted the text of Al HaNissim was named Yochanan.** וְהוּא לְרַמֵּז דְּבָרֵינוּ שֶׁשְּׁמוֹ מוֹרֶה י״ו חָנַן. — **This alludes to our explanation: his name means "Yud–vav graciously bestowed."** וְהִזְכִּיר כָּל הַנֵּס שֶׁהָיָה מִצַּד הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ — **He recounts the entire miracle as coming from God,**

The covenant is inscribed beyond present awareness

וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמַרְנוּ שֶׁעָמְדוּ עַל יִשְׂרָאֵל לְהַעֲבִירָם מֵחֻקֵּי רְצוֹנֶךָ.[1289] — **as we have explained: the Greeks rose against Israel "to turn them away from the statutes of Your will."** וְהוּא עַל פִּי מַה שֶּׁכָּתוּב בַּסְּפָרִים שֶׁגִּזְרַת הַיְוָנִים הָיָה לְבַטֵּל מִיִּשְׂרָאֵל חוֹדֶשׁ שַׁבָּת וּמִילָה — **This follows what is written in the books: the Greeks decreed the abolition among Israel of the New Moon, Shabbat, and circumcision.** וְהֵם נִקְרְאוּ חוּקֵי רְצוֹנֶךָ שֶׁנֶּחְקַק בְּלֵב יִשְׂרָאֵל רְצוֹן הַשֵּׁם

[1285] **Mishnah Maaser Sheni 5:15**: "Yochanan the High Priest discontinued the tithe declarations. He also abolished the "awakeners" and the "strikers." Until his days a hammer would strike in Jerusalem, and in his days no one needed to inquire about demai, produce of uncertain tithing status."

[1286] **Bartenura on Mishnah Maaser Sheni 5:15:1**: ""Yochanan the High Priest": he served in the high priesthood after Shimon the Righteous."

[1287] **Mishneh Torah, Tithes 9:1**: "In the days of Yochanan the High Priest, who lived after Shimon the Righteous, the Great Court sent investigators throughout the territory of Israel. They found that everyone was careful about the great terumah and separated it. But the unlearned people of Israel were lenient with themselves concerning the first tithe, the second tithe, and the poor person's tithe, and did not separate them. They therefore decreed that only trustworthy people should be believed concerning tithes. The produce of unlearned people, however, has uncertain status, and they are not believed when they say that it has been tithed. This is what is called demai."

[1288] **Rash MiShantz on Mishnah Parah 3:8:2**: "Rabban Yochanan ben Zakkai learned of it. From this we may infer that Yochanan the High Priest became a Sadducee, for according to the Mishnah we do not find Rabban Yochanan ben Zakkai witnessing a red-heifer rite performed by a Sadducee. The statement that he pinched his ear presents no difficulty: it was another high priest who pinched Rabban Yochanan's ear, for Rabban Yochanan ben Zakkai was then a student. He exercised his authority after the destruction of the Temple, and he was the youngest of Hillel's disciples. This is also indicated by the fact that he called him "ben Zakkai," since he did not yet bear the title "Rabban." From the anger that he displayed they realized that error had entered him, for within three days he died. Had they realized it earlier, how could they have allowed a Sadducee to be high priest? In the Mishnah in Sotah, Yochanan the High Priest is mentioned immediately before "When the Sanhedrin ceased"; learn from this that he lived near the destruction of the Temple. Consult Yosippon."

[1289] **Sod Yesharim, Purim 30:3**: "Despite all this the extreme concealment at the time of Purim, God illuminated for us the radiance of the divine Name, until even Israel's final garment the physical body was clarified. This clarification is indicated by the radiance of that Name: even Israel's physical body is full of words of Torah without their conscious awareness. As the Sages said, "The Jews had light, joy, gladness," and so forth: "Gladness" is circumcision. Circumcision signifies that words of Torah are engraved in the physical body, as expressed in the saying, "Not like the covenant which…" and "you broke My covenant," but rather, "I shall write it upon their hearts." This commandment surrounds the person even during sleep and even in the bathhouse. Thus Menachot 43 and Midrash Shocher Tov 6 relate that when David entered the bathhouse, and so forth, once he remembered the circumcision in his flesh, his mind was put at ease."

Sod Yesharim explains how a covenantal bond can be real before, and beyond, the person's present awareness: its sign remains engraved in the body when no conscious act is being performed. This sharpens Pri Tzadik's use of the infant's circumcision to disclose a holiness rooted in divine will. The target develops the point through Purim and David's bathhouse experience; it is a conceptual explanation of the enduring bond, not an identification of the festivals' laws.

יִתְבָּרַךְ — **These are called “the statutes of Your will,” because God’s will is engraved in Israel’s heart.** שֶׁהֵם קְשׁוּרִים בַּשֹּׁרֶשׁ בְּרֵאשִׁית הַמַּחֲשָׁבָה דְּאִיקְרֵי רָצוֹן. — **They are bound at their root to the beginning of divine thought, which is called Will.** שַׁבָּת קְדוּשָׁה קְבִיעָא וְקַיְימָא דִּכְתִיב לָדַעַת כִּי אֲנִי הַשֵּׁם מְקַדִּשְׁכֶם — **Shabbat’s holiness is fixed and enduring, as it is written, “To know that I am Hashem who sanctifies you.”** וְנֶחְקַק הַקְּדוּשָׁה בַּלֵּב לְהַשְׁאִיר לְשֵׁשֶׁת יְמֵי הַמַּעֲשָׂה — **That holiness is engraved in the heart so that it remains for the six working days,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאוֹמְרִים בְּהַבְדָּלָה בַּתְּפִלָּה וְתִלַּמְּדֵנוּ לַעֲשׂוֹת חֻקֵּי רְצוֹנֶךָ. — **as we say in the Havdalah passage of the Amidah, “You taught us to perform the statutes of Your will.”** וְחוֹדֶשׁ גַּם כֵּן יֵשׁ בּוֹ מִקְדּוּשַׁת עַתִּיקָא — **The New Moon also contains something of the holiness of Atika, the Ancient One.** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב (זוֹהַר חֶלֶק ג עט ב) אוֹף הָכִי בְּחַדְתוּתֵי סִיהֲרָא דְּהָא נָהִיר לָהּ — **As stated in Zohar III, 79b: “So, too, at the renewal of the moon,** שִׁמְשָׁא בְּחֶדְוָותָא דְּנְהִירוּ דְּעַתִּיקָא.[1290] — **for the sun shines upon it with the joy of the radiance of the Ancient One.”** וְכֵן מִילָה שֶׁנִּימּוֹל תִּינוֹק לְחֹ׳ שֶׁלֹּא מִדַּעְתּוֹ וְנַעֲשָׂה יִשְׂרָאֵל — **Likewise, an infant is circumcised on the eighth day without his own awareness and becomes marked in the covenant as an Israelite.** זֶה מוֹרֶה שֶׁנּוֹלַד בִּקְדוּשַׁת יִשְׂרָאֵל שֶׁקְּשׁוּר בַּשֹּׁרֶשׁ בָּרָצוֹן הָעֶלְיוֹן — **This shows that he was born with Israel’s holiness, bound at his root to the supernal Will.** וְאַחַר כָּךְ הַנֵּס שֶׁנַּעֲשָׂה מִצַּד הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ מָסַרְתָּ גִּבּוֹרִים בְּיַד חַלָּשִׁים כּוּ׳ וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמַרְנוּ. — **The prayer then recounts the miracle wrought by God: “You delivered the mighty into the hands of the weak,” and so forth, as we have explained.** וְאַחַר כָּךְ כּוּ׳ וְהִדְלִיקוּ נֵרוֹת בְּחַצְרוֹת קָדְשֶׁךָ. — **Afterward it continues, and so forth, “They kindled lights in Your holy courtyards.”** וְאִם הָיָה הַמְכוּוָּן עַל נֵרוֹת הַמְּנוֹרָה בְּבֵית הַמִּקְדָּשׁ — **If this referred to the lights of the Menorah in the Temple,** זֶה לֹא הָיָה מִצַּד יִשְׂרָאֵל רַק עַל יְדֵי הַנֵּס מֵהַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ. — **that illumination came through God’s miracle rather than through Israel’s action alone.** גַּם לְפִי זֶה לֹא יוּבַן לְשׁוֹן בְּחַצְרוֹת קָדְשֶׁךָ **On that reading, the words “in Your holy courtyards” would also be difficult to explain,** שֶׁזֶּה נִקְרָאִים הָעֲזָרוֹת שֶׁהֵם נֶגֶד חֲצַר הַמִּשְׁכָּן וְנֵרוֹת הַמְּנוֹרָה הִדְלִיקוּ בַּהֵיכָל. — **for “courtyards” means the Temple courts corresponding to the courtyard of the Mishkan, whereas the Menorah’s lights were kindled inside the Sanctuary.**

Joy at the light received

אַךְ נִרְאֶה דְּקָאֵי עַל נֵרוֹת חֲנוּכָּה[1291] — **It appears, however, to refer to Chanukah lights.** שֶׁתֵּיכֶף בְּיוֹם רִאשׁוֹן כְּשֶׁרָאוּ הַנֵּס שֶׁנִּשְׁתַּיֵּיר הַשֶּׁמֶן בַּפַּךְ — **Immediately on the first day, when they saw the miracle—that the oil remained in the flask,** אוֹ שֶׁהָאִיר אוֹר גָּדוֹל עַל פִּי נֵס אַף שֶׁעָשׂוּ פְּתִילוֹת דַּקּוֹת מְאֹד — **or that a great light shone miraculously although they had made very thin wicks,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמַרְנוּ לְתֵירוּץ הַבַּיִת יוֹסֵף אָז מֵחֲמַת שִׂמְחָה הִדְלִיקוּ נֵרוֹת. — **as we explained in applying the Beit Yosef’s answer—they kindled lights out of joy.** שָׁהָיָה אָז גַּם כֵּן מִנְהָג לְהַדְלִיק נֵרוֹת מֵחֲמַת שִׂמְחָה — **Lighting lamps as an expression of joy was a custom in those times as well,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ (גִּיטִּין נז.)[1292, 1293] וְאַדְלִיקוּ שְׁרָגֵי עַד דְּאִתְחֲזֵי בְּלִיוֹנָא דְּגוּשְׁפַּנְקָא בְּרָחוֹק מִילָּא. — **as stated (Gittin 57a): “They kindled lamps until the engraved image on a signet ring could be seen at a distance of a mil from the city.”** וְכֵן מָצִינוּ מִדְרָשׁ רַבָּה (אֵיכָה פָּרָשָׁה ד אוֹת ק) נִשְׁתַּתֵּק הַנָּלָד בַּחֲנוּכָּה כּוּ׳[1294] — **Likewise, we find in Midrash Rabbah**

[1290] **Zohar, Achrei Mot 74:409**: “So too at the renewal of the moon, for the sun illuminates it with joy from the illumination of the Ancient One above. Therefore this offering is directed above, so that all may be sweetened and joy may be present in the world. Concerning this it says, “Bring an atonement for Me”: the wording is precise.”

[1291] **Sod Yesharim, Sukkot 70:1**: “The Gemara, Sukkah 51, says: “One who has not seen the rejoicing at the place of the water drawing has never seen rejoicing in his life,” and, “There was no courtyard in Jerusalem that was not illuminated by the light of the place of the water drawing.” The pious and people of good deeds would dance before them with flaming torches. The principal joy of this celebration came from the light with which God showed them that their connection to Him had never ceased. In truth, from God’s side nothing is devoid of His glory; only from the human perspective does there sometimes appear to be, Heaven forbid, a void and interruption between the person and the light of His glory. On this festival God illuminated their own perception as well, so that they explicitly recognized, even retrospectively, their connection to the light of His will. This illumination gave rise to their great joy.”
Sod Yesharim explains the inner cause of a celebration expressed through abundant light: a previously obscured relation to God becomes perceptible. This adds depth to Pri Tzadik’s proposal that joy at the revealed miracle itself prompted lighting. The target concerns Sukkot’s water-drawing celebration; the comparison explains the relation between disclosure, joy, and light, and does not supply historical evidence for the Chanukah custom.

[1292] **Gittin 57a:9**: “The emperor left them and departed. They sprang up in joy, ate and drank, and kindled lamps, until the engraved image on a signet ring could be seen at a distance of a mil from the city. He said, “The Jews are rejoicing at my expense!” He returned and came against them.”

[1293] **Rashi on Gittin 57a:9:3**: ““The engraved image on a signet ring”: someone whose ring bore an image could recognize it at a distance of a mil from the city, by the light of the lamps.”

[1294] **Eikhah Rabbah 4:22**: ““Our pursuers were swifter than the eagles of heaven.” Trachinus—may his bones be ground to dust—had a wife who gave birth on the night of the Ninth of Av, while all Israel was mourning. The infant died at Chanukah. Israel said, “Shall we kindle the lamps or not?” They said, “We shall kindle them; whatever may come upon us, let it come.” They kindled them. People went and spoke maliciously to the wife of Trachinus: “These Jews mourned when you gave birth, but when the child died, they kindled lamps.””

(Eikhah, chapter 4, entry ק): "The Roman ruler's infant died at Chanukah," and so forth. וְכַד מַיֵּית וַלְדָּא אַדְלִיקוּ בּוּצִינַיָּא כּוּלֵּי — **The malicious report said, "And when the child died, they lit lamps," and so forth.** וְעַל כֵּן גַּם כָּאן כְּשֶׁרָאוּ הַנֵּס הִדְלִיקוּ נֵרוֹת וְזֶה הָיָה מוּתָּר מִשֶּׁמֶן טָמֵא. — **Here, too, when they saw the miracle, they kindled lights; for this purpose, impure oil was permitted.** וְנִקְרָא בְּחַצְרוֹת קָדְשֶׁךָ עַל פִּי מַה שֶּׁאָמַרְנוּ כַּמָּה פְּעָמִים — **They are called "Your holy courtyards" in accordance with what we have explained many times:** שֶׁעִנְיַן קְדוּשַׁת חֲנוּכָּה שֶׁיּוּכְלוּ לַעֲשׂוֹת חֲנוּכַּת הַבַּיִת בְּכָל מָקוֹם. — **the holiness of Chanukah enables a dedication of the home in every place.** וְכָל מָקוֹם שֶׁהִדְלִיקוּ נִקְרָא חַצְרוֹת קָדְשֶׁךָ. — **Every place in which they kindled lights is called "Your holy courtyards."** וְיכוֹלִין לְהַמְשִׁיךְ בּוֹ מֵאוֹר הָרִאשׁוֹן שֶׁגְּנָזוֹ בַּתּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה — **There one can draw from the primordial light concealed within the Oral Torah,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁהִמְשִׁיךְ אַהֲרֹן עַל יְדֵי נֵרוֹת הַמִּקְדָּשׁ. — **just as Aharon drew it through the lights of the Temple.** וְאַחַר כָּךְ כְּשֶׁרָאוּ שֶׁמִּתְגַּלֶּה הָאוֹר הַזֶּה בְּכָל פַּעַם בַּיָּמִים הָהֵם בַּזְּמַן הַזֶּה — **Afterward, when they saw that this light is revealed anew each time—"in those days, at this season"—** קָבְעוּ שְׁמוֹנַת יְמֵי חֲנוּכָּה אֵלּוּ לְדוֹרוֹת כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמַרְנוּ׃ — **they established these eight days of Chanukah for future generations, as we have explained.**

Rosh Chodesh Shevat Ois 1

Asher: Sanctifying Food and Repairing the Covenant

The power that can become craving also makes sustained growth in Torah possible.

Asher: Sanctifying Food and Repairing the Covenant

The Letter Tzadi and the Work of Shevat

בְּסֵפֶר יְצִירָה: הִמְלִיךְ אוֹת צָדִי בִּלְעִיטָה וְכוּרְכִּי, וּשְׁבָט בַּשָּׁנָה וְקוּרְקְבָן בַּנֶּפֶשׁ.[1295] — **Sefer Yetzirah states: "He made the letter tzadi rule over swallowing," etc., "Shevat in the year and the gizzard in the person."** וְהוּא עַל פִּי מַה שֶׁאָמְרוּ (בְּרָכוֹת סא:): קוּרְקְבָן טוֹחֵן.[1296] — **This follows the teaching in Berakhot 61b: "The gizzard grinds."** וְאוֹת צָדִי אִיתָא (שַׁבָּת קד.): צָדִי כְּפוּפָה וְצָדִי פְּשׁוּטָה, צַדִּיק כָּפוּף וְצַדִּיק פָּשׁוּט.[1297] — **Of the letter tzadi, Shabbat 104a states: the bent tzadi and straight tzadi signify the bowed righteous one and upright righteous one.** וְצַדִּיק נִקְרָא מַאן דְּנָטַר בְּרִית, כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ (חֵלֶק ב כג א).[1298] — **One who guards the covenant is called righteous, as the holy Zohar, volume II, 23a, states.** וְהַיְינוּ דְּמִדָּה תְּשִׁיעִית הוּא צַדִּיק יְסוֹד עוֹלָם, — **The ninth attribute is "the righteous one, the foundation of the world."** וּבְשֶׁלֵּימוּת הוּא כְּשֶׁכָּלוּל מִכָּל עֶשֶׂר מִדּוֹת, — **It is complete when it includes all ten attributes,** וְתִשַּׁע פְּעָמִים עֶשֶׂר עוֹלֶה תִּשְׁעִים. — **and nine times ten equals ninety, the value of tzadi.** וְחוֹדֶשׁ זֶה מְסוּגָּל לְתִיקּוּן פְּגַם הַבְּרִית, כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתַב הָאֲרִי הַקָּדוֹשׁ, דְּשִׁשָּׁה שָׁבוּעוֹת שׁוֹבְבִים מְסוּגָּלִים לָזֶה, — **This month is suited to repairing damage to the covenant. The holy Ari wrote that the six weeks of Shovavim are suited to this,** וְאַרְבָּעָה שָׁבוּעוֹת בֹּא, בְּשַׁלַּח, יִתְרוֹ, מִשְׁפָּטִים, הֵם תָּמִיד בְּחוֹדֶשׁ זֶה. — **and the four weeks of Bo, Beshalach, Yitro, and Mishpatim always fall in this month.** דִּבְּרָשָׁה בֹּא הִתְחִיל הָאוֹר, דִּכְתִיב: וּלְכָל בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל הָיָה אוֹר.[1299] — **In Parashat Bo the light began: "All the children of Israel had light."** וְהִתְחִיל בּוֹ פָּרָשִׁיוֹת וּמִצְוֹת מִדִּבְרֵי תוֹרָה, כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ: לֹא הָיָה הַתּוֹרָה צְרִיךְ לְהַתְחִיל אֶלָּא מֵהַחוֹדֶשׁ הַזֶּה לָכֶם.[1300] — **The Torah's passages and**

[1295] **Sefer Yetzirah Gra Version 5:10**: 'He made the letter Tzadi king over swallowing/taste (le'itah), bound a crown to it, and combined one with another; and with them He formed Aquarius (Deli) in the universe, Shevat in the year, and the gizzard (kurkevan) in the soul, male and female.'

[1296] **Berakhot 61b**: 'The Gemara relates: When they took Rabbi Akiva out to be executed, it was time for the recitation of Shema. And they were raking his flesh with iron combs, and he was reciting Shema, thereby accepting upon himself the yoke of Heaven. His students said to him: Our teacher, even now, as you suffer, you recite Shema? He said to them: All my days I have been troubled by the verse: With all your soul, meaning: Even if God takes your soul. I said to myself: When will the opportunity be afforded me to fulfill this verse? Now that it has been afforded me, shall I not fulfill it? He prolonged his uttering of the word: One, until his soul left his body as he uttered his final word: One. A voice descended from heaven and said: Happy are you, Rabbi Akiva, that your soul left your body as you uttered: One.'

[1297] **Shabbat 104a**: "Samekh and ayin: Support the poor. Another explanation: Make mnemonic signs in Torah and acquire it. A bent peh and a straight peh: an open mouth and a closed mouth. A bent tzadi and a straight tzadi: a bent righteous person and a straight righteous person. Is this not the same as a bent faithful person and a straight faithful person? Scripture adds bending to his bending; from here we learn that Torah was given with a bowing of the head."

[1298] **Zohar, Vaera 1:16-18**: ""the seas" refer to the seven pillars which are the foundation of the earth, and over which rules the Sea of Kinnereth (R. Judah, however, maintained that the latter is filled by the others); "the rivers" are connected with the "river which went out of Eden to water the garden" (Gen. 2, 10). It is to be noticed that this Holy Land (the Shekinah) is called "the land of Israel". Why, then, did Jacob, who is Israel, not rule over it like Moses? The reason is-as already pointed out-that Jacob became the owner of the "house which is below" and left the "house which is above", though in the twelve tribes and in the seventy branches he made preparation herein for the "house which is above"; Moses, on the other hand, left the "house which is below" and took the "house which is above". The former experienced the Divine manifestation as "El Shaddai", but God did not speak with him in the higher grade designated by TETRAGRAMMATON."

[1299] **Exodus 10:23**: 'People could not see one another, and for three days no one could move about; but all the Israelites enjoyed light in their dwellings.'

[1300] **Rashi on Genesis 1:1:2**: "בראשית ברא IN THE BEGINNING GOD CREATED — This verse calls aloud for explanation in the manner that our Rabbis explained it: God created the world for the sake of the Torah which is called (Proverbs 8:22) "The beginning (ראשית) of His (God's) way", and for the sake of Israel who are called (Jeremiah 2:3) "The beginning (ראשית) of His (God's) increase''. If, however, you wish to explain it in its plain sense, explain it thus: At the beginning of the Creation of heaven and earth when the earth was without form and void and there was darkness, God said, "Let there be light". The text does not intend to point out the order of the acts of Creation — to state that these (heaven and earth) were created first; for if it intended to point this out, it should have written בראשונה ברא את השמים וגו' "At first God created etc." And for this reason: Because, wherever the word ראשית occurs in Scripture, it is in the construct state. E. g., (Jeremiah 26:1) "In the beginning of (בראשית) the reign of Jehoiakim"; (Genesis 10:10) "The beginning of (ראשית) his kingdom"; (Deuteronomy 18:4) "The first fruit of (ראשית) thy corn." Similarly here you must translate בראשית ברא אלהים as though it read בראשית ברוא, at the beginning of God's creating. A similar grammatical construction (of a noun in construct followed by a verb) is: (Hosea 1:2) תחלת דבר ה' בהושע, which is as much as to say, "At the beginning of God's speaking through Hosea, the Lord said to Hosea." Should you, however, insist that it does actually intend to point out that these (heaven and earth) were created first, and that the meaning is, "At the beginning of everything He created these, admitting therefore that the word בראשית is in the construct state and explaining the omission of a word signifying "everything" by saying that you have texts which are elliptical, omitting a word, as for example (Job 3:10) "Because it shut not up the doors of my mother's womb" where it does not explicitly explain who it was that closed the womb; and (Isaiah 8:4) "He shall take away the spoil of Samaria" without explaining who shall take it away; and (Amos 6:12) "Doth he plough with oxen," and it does not explicitly state, "Doth a man plough with oxen"; (Isaiah 46:10) "Declaring from the beginning the end," and it does not explicitly state, "Declaring from the beginning of a thing the end of a thing' — if it is so (that you assert that this verse intends to point out that heaven and earth were

commandments began there: “The Torah should have begun only with ‘This month shall be for you.’” וּכְתִיב: אוֹר זָרוּעַ לַצַּדִּיק.[1301] **— It says, “Light is sown for the righteous.”**

Eating and the Serpent’s First Enticement

דְּתַחְלַת הֶסְתַּת הַנָּחָשׁ הָיָה בַּאֲכִילָה — **“He made the letter tzadi rule over swallowing,”** וְהִמְלִיךְ אוֹת צָדִי בִּלְעִיטָה, לְהַרְגִּישׁ בּוֹ הֲנָאַת הַגּוּף, — **for the serpent’s first enticement involved eating to experience bodily pleasure.** וּמִזֶּה בָּא נָחָשׁ עַל חַוָּה וְהֵטִיל בָּהּ זוּהֲמָא, כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ בַּגְּמָרָא (שָׁם קמו א),[1302] **— From this came the serpent’s relations with Chavah and the impurity he instilled in her, as Shabbat 146a teaches.** וְנִסְתָּעֵף מִזֶּה הַמַּאֲה וּשְׁלֹשִׁים שָׁנָה דְּנַעֲשָׂה אָדָם הָרִאשׁוֹן מָשׁוּךְ בְּעָרְלָתוֹ, כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ (סַנְהֶדְרִין — **The hundred and thirty years followed from this.** לח:).[1303] **— Adam became one whose foreskin was drawn over his circumcision, as Sanhedrin 38b states.**

וְהָעֵסֶק בַּחוֹדֶשׁ זֶה לְהַכְנִיס קְדוּשָׁה בַּאֲכִילָה, כְּמָה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: צַדִּיק אוֹכֵל לְשׂוֹבַע נַפְשׁוֹ.[1304] **— This month’s work is to bring holiness into eating: “The righteous person eats to satisfy his soul.”** וְעַל דֶּרֶךְ מַה שֶּׁכָּתַב הָרַמְבַּם זִכְרוֹנוֹ לִבְרָכָה (פֶּרֶק ג מֵהִלְכוֹת דֵּעוֹת), שֶׁאִם יֹאכַל כְּדֵי שֶׁיִּהְיֶה לוֹ כֹּחַ לַעֲבוֹד הַשֵּׁם,[1305] **— As the Rambam, of blessed memory, writes in Hilkhot De’ot, chapter 3: if one eats to have strength to serve Hashem,** וְיִשַּׁן כְּדֵי שֶׁתָּנוּחַ דַּעְתּוֹ עָלָיו, **— and sleeps so that his mind will be settled,** נִמְצָא אֲכִילָתוֹ וְשִׁינָה שֶׁלּוֹ עֲבוֹדָה לַמָּקוֹם בָּרוּךְ הוּא. **— his eating and sleep are service of the Omnipresent, blessed be He.** וּבֶטֶן רְשָׁעִים תֶּחְסָר, מְפָרְשִׁים שֶׁאוֹכְלִים לַהֲנָאַת עַצְמָם,[1306] **— “The belly of the wicked lacks”: the explanation is that the wicked, who eat for their own pleasure,** יֶחְסַר לָהֶם בֶּטֶן כְּדֵי לְמַלֵּא תַּאֲוָתָם עוֹד. **— lack enough belly to satisfy still more of their desire.**

Asher: The Powers of Moshe and Yosef

וְהָאֲרִי זִכְרוֹנוֹ לִבְרָכָה, שֶׁחָשַׁב הֶחָדָשִׁים לְהַשְּׁבָטִים כְּסֵדֶר הַדְּגָלִים, נִמְצָא חוֹדֶשׁ שְׁבָט גָּד אָשֵׁר. — **The Ari assigned the months to the tribes in the order of their banners; Shevat thus corresponds to Asher.** וְאִיתָא בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ (חֶלֶק א רלה ב): אָשֵׁר יָשַׁב לְחוֹף יַמִּים וְגוֹמֵר, וְהָכָא אָשֵׁר דָּא פִּתְחָא עִלָּאָה דְּצַדִּיק וְכוּלֵי, וְהַאי פִּתְחָא וְכוּלֵי וְאִקְרֵי אָשֵׁר.[1307] **— The holy Zohar I, 235b, states: “Asher dwells by the seashore,” etc.; here Asher is the righteous one’s upper opening, etc., and this opening, etc., is called Asher.** וּכְתִיב בְּגִלְיוֹן הַזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ: אָשֵׁר גִּימַטְרִיָּא מֹשֶׁה יוֹסֵף. **— The marginal note to the holy Zohar states that Asher has the numerical value of Moshe plus Yosef.** וְהַיְינוּ דְּאָשֵׁר לְחוֹף יַמִּים, דְּיֵשׁ יַם עִלָּאָה וְיַם תַּתָּאָה. — **Asher is by the shore of seas, for there is an upper sea and a lower sea.** מִדָּה אַחֲרוֹנָה נִקְרָא יָם, וּבִינָה גַּם כֵּן נִקְרָא יָם עִלָּאָה כַּיָּדוּעַ. — **The last attribute is called “sea,”**

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created first), you should be astonished at yourself, because as a matter of fact the waters were created before heaven and earth, for, lo, it is written, (v. 2) “The Spirit of God was hovering on the face of the waters,” and Scripture had not yet disclosed when the creation of the waters took place — consequently you must learn from this that the creation of the waters preceded that of the earth. And a further proof that the heavens and earth were not the first thing created is that the heavens were created from fire (אש) and water (מים), from which it follows that fire and water were in existence before the heavens. Therefore you must admit that the text teaches nothing about the earlier or later sequence of the acts of Creation.”

[1301] **Psalms 97:11**: “Light is sown for the righteous, and joy for the upright in heart.”

[1302] **Shabbat 146a:1**: “When the serpent came upon Chavah, it cast pollution into her. The pollution of Israel, who stood at Mount Sinai, ceased; the pollution of the nations, who did not stand at Mount Sinai, did not cease. Rav Acha son of Rava asked Rav Ashi, ‘What of converts?’ He answered, ‘Although they themselves were not there, their mazal, their spiritual root, was there, as it is written, “With those who are here with us, standing today before the Lord our God, and with those who are not here,” and so forth.’”

[1303] **Sanhedrin 38b:11**: “Rav Yehudah also said in Rav’s name: Adam the first man was a heretic, as it says, ‘The Lord God called to Adam and said to him: Where are you?’—meaning, ‘Where has your heart turned?’ Rabbi Yitzchak said: He drew his foreskin forward to conceal the covenant. Here it is written, ‘But they, like Adam, transgressed a covenant,’ and there it is written, ‘He has broken My covenant.’”

[1304] **Proverbs 13:25**: ‘A righteous person eats to the satisfaction of his soul, but the belly of the wicked will lack.’

[1305] **Mishneh Torah, Human Dispositions 3:3**: “If a person regulates his conduct according to medicine but intends only that his body and limbs be sound, and that he have children who will do his work and labor for his needs, this is not a good path. Rather, he should intend that his body be sound and strong so that his soul may be properly directed toward knowing the Lord. It is impossible to understand and contemplate the branches of wisdom while hungry or ill, or while one of one’s limbs is painful. He should intend to have a son who may perhaps become a sage and a great man in Israel. A person who follows this path is thus constantly serving the Lord throughout his life, even while conducting business and even while having sexual relations, because in everything his intention is to obtain what he needs so that his body will be sound enough to serve the Lord. Even while sleeping, if he sleeps deliberately so that his mind may be at rest and his body may rest, lest he become ill and be unable to serve the Lord while ill, his sleep is service of the Omnipresent, blessed be He. Concerning this the Sages commanded, ‘Let all your deeds be for the sake of Heaven’ (Avos 2:12). This is what Shlomo said in his wisdom: ‘Know Him in all your ways, and He will make your paths straight’ (Mishlei 3:6).”

[1306] **Proverbs 13:25**: ‘A righteous person eats to the satisfaction of his soul, but the belly of the wicked will lack.’

[1307] **Zohar, Vayechi 55:542**: ‘Zohar, Vayechi (I:235b): “‘Asher dwelt at the shore of the seas’ (Judges 5:17) — Here Asher represents the supernal covenant of the Tzaddik, guarding the bounds of holiness against the turbulent waters.”’

and Binah is also called the upper sea, as is known. וּלְעוּמַּת זֶה בַּקְּלִפָּה הָאוּמּוֹת נִקְרְאוּ: כַּהֲמוֹת יַמִּים יֶהֱמָיוּן[1308] — **Opposite this, in the realm of impurity, the nations are described as "roaring like the seas' roar."** דְּמַיִם חֲסָדִים כַּיָּדוּעַ, דְּמַיִם וְאֵשׁ דִּקְדוּשָּׁה בְּחִינַת אַבְרָהָם וְיִצְחָק. — **Water represents kindness, as is known; holy water and fire correspond to Avraham and Yitzchak.** וּבַקְּלִיפָּה יֵשׁ מַיִם הַזִּידוֹנִים, תַּאֲוֹת וְחֶמְדַּת אַהֲבוֹת עוֹלָם הַזֶּה, — **In impurity there are the raging waters: desires and yearning for worldly loves,** וּבַמִּשְׁנָה (אָבוֹת) נִקְרְאוּ מַיִם הָרָעִים.[1309] — **called "evil waters" in the Mishnah, Avot.**

Torah, Awe, and Prayer

Desire as the power of spiritual growth

וְעִיקַּר הַהַגְנָּדָה מִפְּגַם הַתַּאֲוָה הוּא עַל יְדֵי תּוֹרָה, כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ (קִידּוּשִׁין ל:): בָּרָאתִי יֵצֶר הָרָע וּבָרָאתִי לוֹ תּוֹרָה תַּבְלִין וְכוּ', אִם פָּגַע בְּךָ מְנֻוָּל[1310, 1311] זֶה, — **The main protection against the damage of desire is Torah: "I created the evil inclination and created Torah as its seasoning," etc.; "If this repulsive one encounters you,"** מָשְׁכֵהוּ לְבֵית שָׁעְיקַר בְּרִיאַת הַיֵּצֶר, שֶׁהוּא הַחֻשָּׁק, הָיָה כְּדֵי שֶׁיִּהְיֶה חֲמִידוּ דְאוֹרַיְיתָא, לִהְיוֹת הַמִּדְרָשׁ. — **"draw him to the study hall."** חֶדְוָותָא דִשְׁמַעְתָּא, — **The inclination, the power of desire, was created chiefly to become longing for Torah and the joy of learning,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁיִּהְיֶה לֶעָתִיד, כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב (זֹהַר חֻלָּק א קלח א בְּמִדְרַשׁ הַנֶּעְלָם). — **as it will be in the future, as stated in Zohar I, 138a, Midrash HaNe'elam.** וְלֵית לָךְ מִלָּה לְחַבְּרָא יֵצֶר הָרָע אֶלָּא אוֹרַיְיתָא (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב שָׁם רב א).[1312] — **"Nothing can bind the evil inclination except Torah," as stated there, 202a.** וְכֵן הַהַגְדָּרָה עַל יִרְאָה, כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ: אֵיזֶהוּ גִבּוֹר? הַכּוֹבֵשׁ אֶת יִצְרוֹ.[1313] — **Protection also comes through awe: "Who is mighty? One who masters his inclination."** גְּבוּרָה, פַּחַד יִצְחָק. — **Might is the fear of Yitzchak.** וְיוֹסֵף, שֶׁהָיָה מֶרְכָּבָה לְמַדִּיק יְסוֹד עוֹלָם, כְּתִיב בֵּיהּ: אֶת הָאֱלֹהִים אֲנִי יָרֵא.[1314] — **Of Yosef, the vehicle for the righteous one, the world's foundation, it is written, "I fear God."**

Prayer after every human effort

וְאַחַר כָּל אֵלֶּה נִצְרָךְ עוֹד תְּפִלָּה לְהַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ שֶׁיְּעַזְרֵהוּ,[1315] — **After all this, one still needs to pray that Hashem**

[1308] **Isaiah 17:12**: "Ah, the roar of many peoples That roar as roars the sea,The rage of nations that rage As rage the mighty waters—"

[1309] **Pirkei Avot 1:11**: 'He also used to say: one who makes his name great causes his name to be destroyed; one who does not add to his knowledge causes it to cease; one who does not study the Torah deserves death; one who makes unworthy use of the crown of learning shall pass away.'

[1310] **Kiddushin 30b**: 'A Sage from the school of Rabbi Yishmael taught: My son, if this wretched one, the evil inclination, encounters you, pull it into the study hall, i.e., go and study Torah. If it is a stone it will melt, and if it is iron it will break, as it is stated with regard to the Torah: "Is not My word like fire, says the Lord, and like a hammer that breaks the rock in pieces?" (Jeremiah 23:29). Just as a stone shatters a hammer, so too one can overcome his evil inclination, which is as strong as iron, through Torah study. With regard to the second part of the statement: If it is a stone it will melt, this is as it is stated with regard to the Torah: "Ho, everyone who thirsts, come for water" (Isaiah 55:1), and it states: "The water wears the stones" (Job 14:19), indicating that water is stronger than stone.'

[1311] **Mei HaShiloach, Volume I, Genesis, Bereshit 15**: "Likewise in the soul, the first drop of words of Torah that enters a person is called "image," while the longing with which he longs for words of Torah is called "likeness." Through that longing, more words of Torah are continually added to him. This is "On the day God created man, in the likeness of God," and so forth: the essential purpose of creating the person was that he should constantly long for an increase in words of Torah. This is the meaning of "Serving Torah is greater than studying it" in Berakhot 7b: serving Torah is the name given to longing."

Pri Tzadik identifies the original purpose of desire as delight in Torah. Mei HaShiloach supplies a developmental account: an initial gift of Torah becomes living growth through renewed longing, just as a child's appetite supports bodily growth. Its interpretation of "serving Torah" is the author's own homiletic reading.

[1312] **Zohar, Miketz 12:194-195**: "Alas for that day, a day of wrath and indignation! Hence it behoves man to contend daily with his evil prompter and to picture to himself the day when he will stand before the King to be judged, when they will lower him into the ground to rot there, whilst the soul will become separated from him. We have been taught that it behoves man always to rouse the good prompter against the evil prompter; if the latter departs, well and good, but if not, the man should study the Torah, as there is nothing so well calculated to crush the evil prompter as the Torah; if he departs, well and good, but if not, let the man remind him of the day of death so as thereby to subdue him."

[1313] **Pirkei Avot 4:1**: 'Pirkei Avot 4: 1: 'Ben Zoma said: Who is wise? He who learns from every man, as it is said: "From all who taught me have I gained understanding" (Psalms 119:99). Who is mighty? He who subdues his evil inclination, as it is said: "He that is slow to anger is better than the mighty; and he that rules his spirit than he that takes a city" (Proverbs 16:32). Who is rich? He who rejoices in his lot, as it is said: "You shall enjoy the fruit of your labors, you shall be happy and you shall prosper" (Psalms 128:2) "You shall be happy" in this world, "and you shall prosper" in the world to come. Who is he that is honored? He who honors his fellow human beings as it is said: "For I honor those that honor Me, but those who spurn Me shall be dishonored" (I Samuel 2:30).''

[1314] **Genesis 42:18**: 'Genesis 42: 18: 'On the third day Joseph said to them, "Do this and you shall live, for I fear God.''

[1315] **Beit Yaakov on Torah, Chayei Sara 3:1**: "A time of finding" points to an ultimate purpose: the purpose of all the affairs of this world, a world of uncertainty full of concealment, is that a person refine himself as far as his strength

help him, כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ בַּגְּמָרָא (שָׁם): וְאִלְמָלֵא הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא שֶׁעוֹזֵר לוֹ, אֵינוֹ יָכוֹל לוֹ.[1316] **— as the Gemara states there: "Without the Holy One's help, he could not overcome it."** אַךְ תְּפִלָּה וְיִרְאָה הֵם דָּבָר אֶחָד. **— Prayer and awe, however, are one thing.** דְּיִרְאָה בָּא עַל יְדֵי שֶׁמְּצַיֵּיר הָאָדָם לְפָנָיו שֶׁמֶּלֶךְ מַלְכֵי הַמְּלָכִים הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא עוֹמֵד עָלָיו וְרוֹאֶה בְּמַעֲשָׂיו, **— Awe comes when one pictures the supreme King of kings, the Holy One, blessed be He, standing over him and watching his actions.** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב רֵישׁ אֹרַח חַיִּים).[1317] וְאָז מִיָּד יַגִּיעַ אֲלָיו הַיִּרְאָה **— Awe then immediately comes to him, as stated at the beginning of Orach Chayim.** וּכְשֶׁעוֹמֵד לִפְנֵי הַמֶּלֶךְ מְבַקֵּשׁ רַחֲמִים עַל צְרָכָיו. **— Standing before the King, he seeks mercy for his needs.** וְכֵן דָּרְשׁוּ (בְּרָכוֹת י:) אֶת הָאֱלֹהִים יִרָא עַל בַּקָּשַׁת רַחֲמִים,[1318, 1319] וְכֵן (שָׁם ט:) יִירָאוּךָ עִם שָׁמֶשׁ עַל תְּפִלָּה. **— Thus Berakhot 10b interprets "Fear God" as seeking mercy, and 9b interprets "They shall fear You with the sun" as prayer.** וְתוֹרָה בְּלֹא יִרְאַת שָׁמַיִם אֵינָהּ כְּלוּם, שֶׁנִּקְרָאָה מְחִיר בְּיַד כְּסִיל (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב יוֹמָא עב:).[1320] **— Torah without fear of Heaven is nothing; it is called "a price in a fool's hand," as Yoma 72b states.** וְכֵן יִרְאָה וּתְפִלָּה בְּלֹא תוֹרָה אֵינָהּ כְּלוּם. **— Likewise, awe and prayer without Torah are nothing.** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב (שׁוֹחַר טוֹב תְּהִלִּים צא): לָעֲתִיד לָבֹא הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא מוֹדִיעָן, כְּמָה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: לָכֵן יֵדַע עַמִּי שְׁמִי.[1321] **— Midrash Shocher Tov on Psalms 91 states: in the future the Holy One will**

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permits. After all this, he will need prayer, praying to Hashem, blessed be He, to bring matters to a good conclusion for him. For all the refinements a person achieves according to his strength and intellectual grasp count as nothing, since creation itself was originally brought into being from nothing. He therefore needs to pray to Hashem after all his refinements, surrendering his soul and all his resources to Him and recognizing that Hashem gives him the strength to accomplish—even in his service of Hashem and his own refinements."

Pri Tzadik places prayer after Torah and the disciplined struggle with desire. Beit Yaakov explains why effort cannot make prayer unnecessary: the person's very capacity to refine himself is a divine gift. The full section continues to insist on preparation and refinement, so this comparison does not replace effort with passivity.

[1316] **Kiddushin 30b**: "Rabbi Shimon ben Levi also said: A person's evil inclination grows stronger against him every day and seeks to kill him, as it says: 'The wicked watches the righteous and seeks to kill him.' Were the Holy One, blessed be He, not to help him, he could not overcome it, as it says: 'God will not leave him in its hand.'"

[1317] **Shulchan Arukh, Orach Chayim 1:1**: 'Shulchan Arukh, Orach Chayim 1: 1: 'One should strengthen himself like a lion to get up in the morning to serve his creator. He should get up early enough to welcome in the dawn. And at least not after the Z'man Tefilah (time for praying) in which the congregation prays. Scripture says, "I placed Hashem before me always". This is a great concept in the Torah and is a paramount attribute for the Tzadikim (righteous people) who walk in the way of G-d. For the way in which a person sits, moves around, and carries out his daily activities while he is alone in his house is not the same way he should engage in these activities while standing before a great King. In addition, the way one speaks while amongst those in his home and the conversations he partakes with his relatives is not the same manner in which he would speak while in the presence of a mortal King. Surely when one considers in his mind that the mighty King, The Holy One blessed be his name, where the whole world is filled with his glory, stands before him and sees his deeds, as it states: "If a man will conceal his secrets and I will not see it," states Hashem; immediately the fear and the proper awed train of thought of Hashem will descend upon him and he will always be embarrassed before G-d. And one should not be ashamed before people who mock his service to Hashem. Also, when one is in private and when one lies on his bed, he should know before whom he is lying and immediately his should arise with enthusiasm to serve his Creator and he will get up.''

[1318] **Berakhot 10b**: 'Abaye, and some say Rabbi Yitzḥak, said: A great man who seeks to enjoy the contributions of those who seek to honor him may enjoy those gifts, as Elisha enjoyed gifts given him by the woman from Shunem, among others. And one who does not seek to enjoy these gifts should not enjoy them, as was the practice of the prophet Samuel from Rama, who would not accept gifts from anyone at all. From where do we know that this was Samuel's custom? As it is stated: "And he returned to Rama, for there was his house, and there he judged Israel, and he built an altar to the Lord" (I Samuel 7:17). And similarly, Rabbi Yoḥanan said: Every place where Samuel went, his house was with him, so he would have everything that he needed and not be forced to benefit from public contributions. One may opt to conduct himself in accordance with either of these paths.'

[1319] **Berakhot 9b:14-15**: "It was likewise taught: The devoted ones would finish reciting Shema at sunrise, in order to join the blessing of redemption directly to the prayer and thus pray during the day. Rabbi Zeira said: What verse supports this? 'They shall fear You with the sun, and before the moon, throughout all generations.'"

[1320] **Yoma 72b:11**: "Rabbi Shmuel bar Nachmani said in Rabbi Yonatan's name: What is meant by 'Why is there a price in a fool's hand to acquire wisdom, when he has no heart'? Woe to the enemies of Torah scholars—a euphemism here for the scholars themselves—who occupy themselves with Torah but have no fear of Heaven."

[1321] **Midrash Tehillim 91:5**: "... Another version. The Rabbis said the minimum number that the word 'stones' can refer to is two, and Yaakov woke up in the morning and found that they were one. He was in great fear and said 'the house of the Holy One is in this place and I was not conscious of His Presence' as it says "And he was afraid and said, How dreadful is this place! This is no other than the house of Gd…" (Bereshit 28:17) From here they said that anyone who prays in Jerusalem is as if they pray before the Throne of Glory, because the gate of heaven is there; and an open door to hear prayer, as it says "…and this is the gate of heaven. (ibid.) Yaakov went back to gather the stones and he found that they were one stone. Yaakov took the stone and placed it as a monument in the midst of the place and oil descended from heaven for him and he pour it out on the stone, as it says "…and he poured oil on top of it." (Bereshit 28:18) What did the Holy One do? He took its right foot, sank it to the deepest depths and made it a keystone for the earth, like a man who places a keystone in an arch. Therefore it is called foundation stone, because there is the navel of the world and from there the world was opened out. And upon it is the palace of Gd, as it says "And this stone, which I have placed as a monument, shall be a house of God…" (Bereshit 28:22) And Yaakov fell to the ground before the foundation stone, praying before the Holy One, and said 'Master of the World! If you bring me back to this place in peace, then I will

make it known to them, as it says, "Therefore My people shall know My Name." בְּאוֹתָהּ שָׁעָה הֵם מִתְפַּלְלִין וְנַעֲנִין, וְעַל זֶה נֶאֱמַר: כִּי יָדַע שְׁמִי, יִקְרָאֵנִי וְאֶעֱנֵהוּ, עִמּוֹ אָנֹכִי בְצָרָה. **— They will then pray and be answered: "For he knows My Name"; "He will call Me and I will answer him." See there.** וְשָׁם הַשֵּׁם הַיְינוּ דִּבְרֵי תוֹרָה, כְּמוֹ שֶׁנִּדְרַשׁ (בְּרָכוֹת כא.)[1322] לְבָרֵכַת הַתּוֹרָה, מִדִּכְתִיב: כִּי שֵׁם ה' אֶקְרָא הָבוּ גֹדֶל לֵאלֹהֵינוּ. **— Hashem's Name means words of Torah: Berakhot 21a derives the blessing over Torah from "When I call Hashem's Name," etc.,** דְּכָל הַתּוֹרָה שְׁמוֹתָיו שֶׁל הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא. **— for the entire Torah consists of the Holy One's Names.** וְזֶה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: קָרוֹב ה' לְכָל קוֹרְאָיו, לְכֹל אֲשֶׁר יִקְרָאוּהוּ בֶאֱמֶת.[1323] **— This is "Hashem is near to all who call Him, to all who call Him in truth."** וְאִיתָא (וַיִּקְרָא רַבָּה רֵישׁ פָּרָשָׁה יז)[1324]: לְכָל קוֹרְאָיו, יָכוֹל לְכֹל? תַּלְמוּד לוֹמַר: לְכֹל אֲשֶׁר יִקְרָאוּהוּ בֶאֱמֶת. **— Vayikra Rabbah, beginning of chapter 17, teaches: "All who call Him"—could this mean everyone? The verse says, "All who call Him in truth."** וְהַיְינוּ עַל דֶּרֶךְ מַה שֶּׁאָמְרוּ בַּגְּמָרָא (שָׁם ה:)[1325]: אֱמֶת זוֹ תוֹרָה. **— This follows the Gemara's teaching in Berakhot 5b: "Truth is Torah."** וְהַעֵצָה שֶׁנָּתַן הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ עֵצָה לָאָדָם לְהִתְגַּבֵּר עַל הַיֵּצֶר הָרָע עַל יְדֵי תוֹרָה, שֶׁהִוא תַּבְלִין, **— Hashem has advised a person to overcome the evil inclination through Torah, its seasoning.** וְעַל כֵּן צָרִיךְ שֶׁיְּקַדֵּם לְהִתְגַּבֵּר עַל יְדֵי הַתּוֹרָה, וְאַחַר כָּךְ לְהִתְפַּלֵּל לִפְנֵי הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ, **— One must therefore first strive through Torah and then pray before Hashem.** וְאָז יִהְיֶה נַעֲנֶה, וְהַשֵּׁם לֹא יַעַזְבֶנּוּ בְיָדוֹ. **— Then he will be answered, and Hashem will not abandon him to its power.** וְעַל זֶה אָמְרוּ בַּמִּשְׁנָה: אִם אֵין חָכְמָה אֵין יִרְאָה, וְאִם אֵין יִרְאָה אֵין חָכְמָה, דְּנִקְרָא כְּסִיל.[1326] **— Thus the Mishnah says, "Without wisdom there is no awe; without awe there is no wisdom," for he is called a fool.** וְזֶהוּ אֲשֶׁר יָשַׁב לְחוֹף יַמִּים, דְּאֲשֶׁר הוּא בְּחִינַת מֹשֶׁה שֶׁהוּא הַתּוֹרָה, וּבְחִינַת יוֹסֵף שֶׁהוּא הַיִּרְאָה.[1327] **— This is "Asher dwells by the seashore": Asher comprises Moshe, Torah, and Yosef, awe.** וְהוּא יוֹשֵׁב לְחוֹף יַמִּים לְהַגְדִּיר וְלִשְׁמוֹר לְהַבָּא מֵהֲמוֹת יַמִּים, שֶׁהֵם הַתַּאֲווֹת רָעוֹת. **— He sits by the seashore to set boundaries and protect the future against the roaring seas, the evil desires.** וּבִכְלַל הַיִּרְאָה הַתְּפִלָּה, כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמַרְנוּ. **— Awe includes prayer, as we explained.**

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sacrifice before you whole offerings and thanksgiving offerings!' as it says, "And Jacob uttered a vow, saying…" (Bereshit 28:20) He vowed and he fulfilled his vow. From there he picked up his feet (to go) and there he left the well, because the well had been going before him, and in the blink of an eye came to Haran as it says, "Now Jacob lifted his feet…" (Bereshit 29:10) "And Jacob left Be'er Sheva, and he went to Haran." (Bereshit 28:10) About him the tradition says, "When you walk, your step will not be constrained, and if you run, you will not stumble." (Mishle 4:12) R' Abahu said in the name of R' Yochanan – the angels carried him as it says, "On their hands they will bear you…" (Tehillim 91:12) Ya'akov's steps were not constrained and his strength did not falter and like a mighty man he rolled back the stone from off of the mouth of the well. Then the well rose up and overflowed and the shepherds were astounded because all together they were unable to roll off the stone and he did it alone as it says, "…that Jacob drew near and rolled the rock off…" (Bereshit 29:10)"

[1322] **Berakhot 21a**: 'Rabbi Yoḥanan said: We derived that one must recite the blessing over the Torah after it is read from Grace after Meals by means of an a fortiori inference. And we derive the obligation to recite a blessing before partaking of food from the blessing over the Torah by means of an a fortiori inference. The blessing over the Torah after it is read from Grace after Meals by means of an a fortiori inference: Food, which does not require a blessing beforehand by Torah law, requires a blessing afterward; Torah, which requires a blessing beforehand, is it not right that it requires a blessing afterward? And similarly: The blessing before partaking of food from the blessing over the Torah by means of an a fortiori inference: Torah, which requires no blessing afterward by Torah law, requires a blessing beforehand; food, which requires a blessing afterward, is it not right that it requires a blessing beforehand?'

[1323] **Psalms 145:18**: 'GOD is near to all who call,to all who call with sincerity.'

[1324] **Vayikra Rabbah 17:1** (excerpt): "'Hashem is near to all who call Him' (Psalms 145:18). Could this mean everyone? Scripture says: 'To all who call Him in truth.'"

[1325] **Berakhot 5b:2-3**: "Rabbi Yochanan said to him: Torah and acts of kindness are understandable, for it is written, 'Through kindness and truth, sin is atoned for.' 'Kindness' means acts of kindness, as it says, 'One who pursues righteousness and kindness will find life, righteousness and honor.' 'Truth' means Torah, as it says, 'Buy truth and do not sell it.' But how do we know that one who buries his children also has his sins atoned for? An elder taught him in Rabbi Shimon ben Yochai's name: It is derived by comparing the word 'sin' in two verses. Here it is written, 'Through kindness and truth, sin is atoned for,' and there it is written, 'Who repays the sin of fathers into the bosom of their children.'"

[1326] **Pirkei Avot 3:17**: 'Pirkei Avot 3: 17: 'Rabbi Elazar ben Azariah said: Where there is no Torah, there is no right conduct; where there is no right conduct, there is no Torah. Where there is no wisdom, there is no fear of God; where there is no fear of God, there is no wisdom. Where there is no understanding, there is no knowledge; where there is no knowledge, there is no understanding. Where there is no bread, there is no Torah; where there is no Torah, there is no bread. He used to say: one whose wisdom exceeds his deeds, to what may he be compared? To a tree whose branches are numerous but whose roots are few, so that when the wind comes, it uproots it and overturns it, as it is said, "He shall be like a bush in the desert, which does not sense the coming of good. It is set in the scorched places of the wilderness, in a barren land without inhabitant" (Jeremiah 17:6). But one whose deeds exceed his wisdom, to what may he be compared? To a tree whose branches are few but roots are many, so that even if all the winds in the world come and blow upon it, they cannot move it out of its place, as it is said, "He shall be like a tree planted by waters, sending forth its roots by a stream. It does not sense the coming of heat, its leaves are ever fresh. It has no care in a year of drought; it does not cease to yield fruit" (ibid, 17:8).''

[1327] **Judges 5:17**: "Gilead dwelt beyond the Jordan; and Dan—why did he linger among the ships? Asher remained by the seashore and dwelt at his landings."

Repairing the Past

וְאִיתָא בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ (חֵלֶק א רמו א): מֵאָשֵׁר שְׁמֶנָה לַחְמוֹ, דָּא הוּא אֲתַר דְּכֻלָּא מֵאֲשְׁרִין לֵיהּ, וּמַאי אִיהוּ? עָלְמָא דְּאָתֵי וְכוּלַי. [1328] — **The holy Zohar I, 246a, states: "From Asher, rich is his bread"—this is the place all acclaim. What is it? The World to Come, etc.** וְהַיְינוּ בִּינָה לִיבָּא, שֶׁנִּקְרָא עָלְמָא דְּאָתֵי כַּיָּדוּעַ, — **This is Binah, the heart, called the World to Come, as is known.** וְהוּא תְּשׁוּבָה, כְּמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: וּלְבָבוֹ יָבִין וְשָׁב, וְהַיְינוּ לְתַקֵּן הֶעָבָר. [1329] — **It is repentance: "His heart will understand and return," meaning repair of the past.** וְעַל זֶה נֶאֱמַר: וְעַל מִפְרָצָיו יִשָּׁכוֹן. — **Of this it says, "He dwells by its breaches."** דְּהַיְינוּ מִי שֶׁפָּרַץ בָּזֶה בַּיָּם וּמַיִם הַזֵּידוֹנִים, — **Even one who has broken through into the sea, the raging waters,** הוּא גַּם כֵּן יִשְׁכּוֹן לְתַקֵּן הֶעָבָר, שֶׁהוּא גַּם כֵּן עַל יְדֵי תּוֹרָה וְיִרְאָה וּתְפִלָּה. — **will also dwell there to repair the past, again through Torah, awe, and prayer.** דְּהַתְּיקּוּן לְפָגָם זֶה עַל יְדֵי תּוֹרָה, כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמַרְנוּ מִמַּה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: וּלְכָל בְּשָׂרוֹ מַרְפֵּא. [1330] — **Torah repairs this damage, as explained from "Healing for all his flesh."** וּבָשָׂר מְרַמֵּז עַל זֶה, שֶׁנִּקְרָא בְּשַׂר קוֹדֶשׁ, וּבְהֵיפֶךְ חַס וְשָׁלוֹם בְּשַׂר חֲמוֹרִים. — **"Flesh" alludes to this, for it is called "holy flesh," and in the opposite case, Heaven forbid, "donkeys' flesh."**

Crying out and drawing near

וְכֵן הַתְּיקּוּן עַל יְדֵי צְעָקָה וּתְפִלָּה, וּכְמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: פְּנֵי הַשֵּׁם בְּעוֹשֵׂי רָע, שְׁמָרַמֵּז עַל פְּגָם זֶה שֶׁנִּקְרָא רָע כַּיָּדוּעַ. [1331, 1332] — **Repair also comes through crying out and prayer: "Hashem's face is against evildoers," alluding to this blemish, called "evil," as is known.** וּכְתִיב: צָעֲקוּ וְהַשֵּׁם שָׁמֵעַ, דְּצָעָקָה מוֹעִיל. — **It says, "They cried out, and Hashem heard": crying out helps.**

The Cry of the Heart

וּכְמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ (חֵלֶק ב כ א): גְּדוֹלָה צְעָקָה מִכּוּלָּן, שֶׁצְּעָקָה הִיא בַּלֵּב, הֲדָא הוּא דִכְתִיב: צָעַק לִבָּם וְגוֹמֵר, [1333] — **The holy Zohar II, 20a, states: crying out surpasses them all, for it is in the heart, as it says, "Their heart cried out," etc.** וְהַיְינוּ וְעַיִן שָׁם דְּמַסִּיק: וּלְעוֹלָם לֹא הַדְרָא רֵיקָנְיָא. [1334] — **See its conclusion there: it never returns empty.** וְאִיתָא בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ (חֵלֶק ב שָׁם): גְּדוֹלָה צְעָקָה, שְׁמוֹשֶׁלֶת בָּעוֹלָם דְּמַמְתַּקְתָּא לְכָל דִּינִין, וְכָל מַה דְּאִתְגְּזַר עַל בְּנֵי נָשָׁא, אִי אִתְעַבְּדוּ צְעָקָה, אִתְבְּטִיל וְאִתְמְתַק. וְכָל מַה דְּאִתְגְּזַר עַל בְּנֵי נָשָׁא, אִי אִתְעַבְּדוּ צְעָקָה, אִתְבְּטִיל וְאִתְמְתַק. [1335] — **It thus helps even for this damage, for which the holy Zohar I, 219b, denies repentance.** וְאִיתָא בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ (חֵלֶק ב שָׁם): גְּדוֹלָה צְעָקָה, שְׁמוֹשֶׁלֶת בָּעוֹלָם הַזֶּה וּבָעוֹלָם הַבָּא; בִּשְׁבִיל צְעָקָה נוֹחֵל הָאָדָם הָעוֹלָם הַזֶּה וְהָעוֹלָם הַבָּא, דִּכְתִיב: וַיִּצְעֲקוּ אֶל הַשֵּׁם בַּצַּר לָהֶם, מִמְּצוּקוֹתֵיהֶם יַצִּילֵם. [1336] — **The holy Zohar II, there, states: crying out is great, ruling in this world and the next; through it a person inherits this world and the World to Come, — for it says, "They cried out to Hashem in their distress; He saves them from their straits."** וְיֵשׁ לְהָבִין הֵיכָן נִרְמָז זֶה בַּפָּסוּק, שֶׁנּוֹחֵל עוֹלָם הַזֶּה וְעוֹלָם הַבָּא (וְעַיִן שְׁמוֹת

[1328] **Zohar, Vayechi 72:752**: 'Zohar, Vayechi (I:246a): "'Out of Asher his bread shall be fat (shamen), and he shall yield royal dainties' (Genesis 49:20) — This is the supernal World to Come (Binah), whence flow rich spiritual nourishment and royal delights to the Community of Israel (Malchut)."'

[1329] **Isaiah 6:10**: 'Make the heart of this people dull, make its ears heavy, and seal its eyes, lest it see with its eyes, hear with its ears, understand with its heart, return, and be healed.'

[1330] **Proverbs 4:22**: 'Proverbs 4: 22: 'They are life to those who find them,Healing for the whole body.''

[1331] **Psalms 34:17**: 'GOD's face is set against evildoers,to erase their names from the earth.'

[1332] **Tzidkat HaTzadik 108:1**: "A broken heart—to become truly as nothing, which, as is known, belongs to Keter, higher still—is effective. As it is written, "Hashem's face is against those who do evil": this is the sin so called; "to cut off from the land," and so forth, as it is written, "Your people are all righteous; they shall inherit the land forever"—for inheritance of the land belongs only to the righteous person, meaning one who guards the covenant. And it says, "They cried out," and so forth: prayer is a remedy against being cut off from the land. Prayer is rooted in Malchut, the supernal land, and his damage has reached it, in the manner of "Hashem is your shadow": precisely as a shadow does what he does, whether for good or, Heaven forbid, the reverse. But to be close to Hashem, the counsel is brokenheartedness: "And with the contrite of spirit," and so forth."
Both passages confront the Zohar's apparent exclusion of repentance for damage to the covenant. Tzidkat HaTzadik distinguishes the protection afforded by prayer from the renewed closeness associated with a broken heart, and places Torah, repentance, and contrition at different spiritual levels. This adds precision to Pri Tzadik's assurance that the heart's cry remains effective.

[1333] **Zohar, Shemot 49:354**: 'Zohar, Shemot (II:20a): "Crying out (tze'akah) surpasses all other forms of prayer, for it is an unspoken cry within the heart, as it is written, 'Their heart cried out unto the Lord' (Lamentations 2:18)."'

[1334] **Zohar, Shemot 49:356**: 'Zohar, Shemot (II:20a): "A cry of the heart to Hashem never returns empty, for it ascends directly to the supernal King without any intermediary."'

[1335] **Zohar, Vayechi 25:194**: "We learned: Rabbi Yehuda said, There is no sin in the world that does not have repentance, except this one. There are no sinners who do not behold the face of the Divine Presence, except this one, as it is written, "Evil shall not dwell with You"—not at all. Rabbi Yitzhak said: Fortunate are the righteous in this world and in the world to come! Of them it is written, "Your people are all righteous; they shall inherit the land forever." What does "they shall inherit the land forever" mean? Rabbi Yehuda said: As it is written, "I shall walk before the Lord in the lands of the living.""'

[1336] **Zohar, Shemot 49:357**: 'Zohar, Shemot (II:20a): "Great is crying out (tze'akah), for it rules in this world and in the World to Come; through crying out a person inherits both this world and the World to Come."'

מַאֲמָר י).[1337] — **Where does this verse indicate that one inherits this world and the World to Come? See Shemot, teaching 10.**

Crossing the Sea of Talmud

אַךְ נִרְאֶה דְּקָאֵי עַל פְּסוּק: יוֹרְדֵי הַיָּם בָּאֳנִיּוֹת וְגוֹמֵר, דְּקָאֵי עַל הָעוֹסְקִים בַּתּוֹרָה וְיוֹרְדִים בְּיַם הַתַּלְמוּד.[1338] — **It appears to refer to "Those who go down to the sea in ships," etc.: those engaged in Torah, descending into the sea of Talmud.** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר אַחַר כָּךְ: יַעֲלוּ שָׁמַיִם יֵרְדוּ תְהוֹמוֹת, דְּאַף שֶׁנִּרְאֶה לָהֶם שֶׁעוֹלִים עַד לַשָּׁמַיִם, מִכָּל מָקוֹם יִצְרוֹ שֶׁל אָדָם מִתְגַּבֵּר וּמִתְחַדֵּשׁ עָלָיו בְּכָל יוֹם,[1339] — **It then says, "They ascend to heaven, descend to the depths": even when they seem to rise to heaven, a person's inclination grows stronger and renews itself against him daily.** וְזֶה יֵרְדוּ תְהוֹמוֹת, עַל יְדֵי הֶסָּתַת הַיֵּצֶר הָרָע. — **This is "they descend to the depths," through the evil inclination's enticement.** וּכְתִיב בַּתְרֵיהּ: וְכָל חָכְמָתָם תִּתְבַּלָּע, שֶׁלֹּא יוֹעִיל לָהֶם הַתּוֹרָה לְבַד, אַף שֶׁהֵם עוֹשֵׂי מְלָאכָה בְּמַיִם רַבִּים, שֶׁמּוֹרֶה עַל עֵסֶק הַתּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה שֶׁנִּמְשָׁל לְמַיִם.[1340] — **Then: "All their wisdom is swallowed up." Torah alone will not help, although they "work in mighty waters," the Oral Torah, likened to water.** וַיִּצְעֲקוּ אֶל הַשֵּׁם בַּצַּר לָהֶם. — **"They cried out to Hashem in their distress."** דְּגָלוּת רִאשׁוֹן הָיָה מִצְרַיִם, שֶׁהִיא עֶרְוַת הָאָרֶץ, קְלִיפַּת הַתַּאֲוָה, — **The first exile was Egypt, the land's nakedness, the husk of desire,** וְהִיא מְצִירָה וּמְעִיקָה לִנְקוּדַּת יִשְׂרָאֵל. — **which oppresses and constrains Israel's inner point.** וְכָל הָאוּמּוֹת עוֹבְדֵי כּוֹכָבִים וּמַזָּלוֹת נִקְרְאוּ עַל שֵׁם מִצְרַיִם, עַל שֵׁם שֶׁמְּצִירוֹת לְיִשְׂרָאֵל (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בְּרֵאשִׁית רַבָּה פָּרָשָׁה טז).[1341] — **All the idolatrous nations are called Egypt because they oppress Israel, as Bereishit Rabbah 16 states.** וּמַה שֶּׁנִּקְרָאִים עַל שֵׁם מִצְרַיִם הוּא מַה שֶּׁמְּעִיקִים וּמְצִירִים לְיִשְׂרָאֵל בְּפִגְם זֶה, — **They are called Egypt because they constrain and oppress Israel through this blemish.** שֶׁבֶּאֱמֶת רְצוֹנֵינוּ לַעֲשׂוֹת רְצוֹנֶךָ, וּמִי מְעַכֵּב? שְׂאוֹר שֶׁבָּעִיסָה וְכוּ' (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בְּרָכוֹת יז.).[1342] — **For in truth, "Our will is to do Your will; what prevents us? The leaven in the dough," etc., as Berakhot 17a states.** וְהָיְנוּ עַל יְדֵי מְצִיאַת הָרָע דְּקִלִּיפָּה זוֹ בָּעוֹלָם, מַכְנִיסִין לְלֵב יִשְׂרָאֵל גַּם כֵּן הַשְּׂאוֹר שֶׁבָּעִיסָה. — **The existence of this husk's evil in the world introduces the leaven in the dough into Israel's heart as well.** וְעַל זֶה נֶאֱמַר: וַיִּצְעֲקוּ אֶל הַשֵּׁם בַּצַּר לָהֶם, כְּשֶׁמַּצִּיר וּמֵעִיק לָהֶם, וּמִמְּצוּקוֹתֵיהֶם יוֹצִיאֵם.[1343] — **Thus, "They cried out to Hashem in their distress," when it oppresses them, "and He brings them out of their straits."** שֶׁיִּהְיוּ נַעֲנִים וְיוֹצִיאֵם הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ מֵהַדְּחַק וְצוּקָה שֶׁלָּהֶם. — **They will be answered, and Hashem will bring them out of their pressure and distress.** וּכְמָה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: עֵינֵי הַשֵּׁם אֶל צַדִּיקִים, שֶׁהַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ מִסְתַּכֵּל רַק אֶל הַצַּדִּיקִים דְּנָטְרִין בְּרִית.[1344] — **As it says, "Hashem's eyes are upon the righteous": Hashem looks only toward the righteous, who guard the covenant.** וְלְהַמְקַלְקְלִים וּפוֹגְמִים קְדוּשַׁת הַבְּרִית לֹא יִסְתַּכֵּל, כְּמָה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: לֹא יְגוּרְךָ רָע.[1345] — **He does not look toward those who corrupt and damage the covenant's holiness: "Evil shall not dwell with You."** וּכְשֶׁהַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ פּוֹנֶה אֲלֵיהֶם וּמִסְתַּכֵּל בָּהֶם, מַכְנִיס בָּהֶם אוֹר כִּי טוֹב. — **When Hashem turns toward them and looks at them, He brings into them the light that is good.** (וְנִתְבָּאֵר שְׁמוֹת מַאֲמָר ג: וַיַּרְא אֱלֹהִים כִּי טוֹב כְּמָה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר, מַכְנִיס אוֹר, דְּבְכָל מָקוֹם שֶׁהַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ רוֹאֶה,[1346]

[1337] **Peri Tzadik, Shemot 8:1**: "Afterward the holy Zohar says: 'Great is crying out, for it rules in this world and the World to Come; through crying out a person inherits this world and the World to Come,' as it is written, 'They cried out to the Lord,' and so forth. Its proof is that the passage begins, 'Let the redeemed of the Lord say so.' This refers to the World to Come: Binah, the world that is coming. For when a person takes to heart that the supreme King of kings stands over him, awe reaches him. This is 'The beginning of wisdom is fear of the Lord'; the Shabbat of Friday evening 'is awe, and awe rests within it' (Zohar I, 5b). The lower Divine Presence is also called the heart, as 'but he has no heart' is interpreted in Yoma 72b concerning one who lacks fear of Heaven. Through awe one comes to repentance: the expression 'awe' is interpreted as repentance in Avodah Zarah 19a and Berakhot 17a, for through awe a person remembers his sins, regrets them and repents of them. When awe enters the depths of the heart, 'His heart will understand, and he will return'—this is Binah, the heart. Thus, 'it rules in this world' means awe, which is the attribute of Malchut; 'and in the World to Come' means repentance, Binah, the world that is coming."

[1338] **Psalms 107:23**: "Those who go down to the sea in ships, who do their work upon great waters,"

[1339] **Psalms 107:26**: "They ascend to the heavens; they descend to the depths; their souls melt in misery."

[1340] **Psalms 107:27**: 'they reeled and staggered like a drunk,all their skill to no avail.'

[1341] **Bereshit Rabbah 16:4** (excerpt): "Rav Huna said in the name of Rav Acha: All the kingdoms are called by the name Assyria, because they enrich themselves from Israel. Rabbi Yose bar Chanina said: All the kingdoms are called by the name Nineveh, because they adorn themselves from Israel. Rabbi Yose, son of Rabbi Chalafta, said: All the kingdoms are called by the name Egypt, because they oppress Israel."

[1342] **Berakhot 17a:2**: 'Rabbi Alexandri, after his prayer, would say: Master of the worlds, it is revealed and known before You that our will is to do Your will. What prevents us? The leaven in the dough and the subjugation of kingdoms. May it be Your will to rescue us from their hand, so that we may return to perform the statutes of Your will with a whole heart.'

[1343] **Psalms 107:28**: "They cried to Hashem in their distress, and He brought them out of their troubles."

[1344] **Psalms 34:16**: 'GOD's eyes are on the righteous,the ears, attentive to their cry.'

[1345] **Psalms 5:5**: 'For You are not a God who desires wickedness;evil cannot abide with You;'

[1346] **Peri Tzadik, Shemot 3:1**: "The matter is this: throughout the account of Creation it is written, 'God saw that it was good.' How can the expression 'He saw' apply? Had He not seen creation beforehand? Rather, the meaning is that through the blessed God's seeing creation and looking upon it, He placed within it the light that is good."

— Wherever Hashem looks, He brings light: "God saw that it was good," as explained in Shemot, teaching 3. וְזֶה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: פְּנֵי ה' בְּעוֹשֵׂי רָע, הַמְקַלְקְלִים וּפוֹגְמִים בְּמִדַּת צַדִּיק, לְהַכְרִית וְגוֹמֵר. **— Thus, "Hashem's face is against evildoers," who corrupt and damage the attribute of the righteous one, "to cut off," etc.** צָעֲקוּ — וְה' שׁוֹמֵעַ וּמִכָּל צָרוֹתָם הִצִּילָם, שֶׁמַּצִּיל אוֹתָם מִמַּה שֶׁמַּעִיק וּמֵצִיר לָהֶם. **— "They cried out, and Hashem hears and rescued them from all their troubles": He saves them from what constrains and oppresses them.** וְזֶה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: וּמִמְּצוּקוֹתֵיהֶם יוֹצִיאֵם. **— This is "He brings them out of their straits."**

The Desired Haven: A Person's Eternal Home

וּכְתִיב: וַיִּשְׂמְחוּ כִי יִשְׁתֹּקוּ וַיַּנְחֵם אֶל מְחוֹז חֶפְצָם,[1347] **— It says, "They rejoiced because they were still, and He guided them to their desired haven,"** הֱיֵינוּ לְעוֹלָם הַבָּא, שֶׁהוּא תַּכְלִית הָאָדָם, **— meaning the World to Come, a person's ultimate purpose.** כְּמָה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: כִּי הוֹלֵךְ הָאָדָם אֶל בֵּית עוֹלָמוֹ, דְּכָל יְמֵי חַיֵּי הָאָדָם הוּא הוֹלֵךְ אֶל בֵּית עוֹלָמוֹ.[1348] **— "For a person goes to his eternal home": throughout all his days, he journeys toward his eternal home.** וְכָל יְמֵי חַיָּיו יֵשׁ לוֹ עֵסֶק בְּעִנְיְנֵי הַתַּאֲוֹת וּלְהַכְנִיסוֹ לְחֻשָּׁק בְּדִבְרֵי תוֹרָה, וְהוּא מִיּוֹרְדֵי הַיָּם בָּאֳנִיּוֹת. **— Throughout his life he deals with desires, bringing that desire into words of Torah; he is among those who go down to the sea in ships.** וְה' יְתַבְּרֵךְ מַנְהִיגוֹ אֶל מְחוֹז חֶפְצוֹ, שֶׁהוּא בֵּית עוֹלָמוֹ, **— Hashem guides him to his desired haven, his eternal home,** שֶׁכָּל צַדִּיק יֵשׁ לוֹ עוֹלָם בִּפְנֵי עַצְמוֹ (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב שְׁמוֹת רַבָּה פָּרָשָׁה נב).[1349] **— for every righteous person has a world of his own, as Shemot Rabbah 52 states.** וּבַגְּמָרָא (שַׁבָּת קנב.), שֶׁכָּל צַדִּיק נוֹתְנִין לוֹ מָדוֹר לְפִי כְּבוֹדוֹ, וְזֶה מְחוֹז חֶפְצָם.[1350] **— Shabbat 152a teaches that each righteous person receives a dwelling befitting his honor; this is their desired haven.** וּכְתִיב: וְעַמֵּךְ כֻּלָּם צַדִּיקִים, לְעוֹלָם יִרְשׁוּ אָרֶץ, וְאֶרֶץ נִקְרָא אֶרֶץ יִשְׂרָאֵל בָּעוֹלָם הַזֶּה,[1351] **— It says, "Your people are all righteous; they shall inherit the land forever": "land" is the Land of Israel in this world,** וְהָעוֹלָם הַבָּא, אֶרֶץ הָעֶלְיוֹנָה, וּכְמוֹ שֶׁלָּמְדוּ מִזֶּה שֶׁכָּל יִשְׂרָאֵל יֵשׁ לוֹמַר חֵלֶק לָעוֹלָם הַבָּא.[1352] **— and the World to Come, the upper land. From this they learned that all Israel have a share in the World to Come.** וְזֶה שֶׁכָּתוּב בַּזּוֹהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ, שֶׁעַל יְדֵי צְעָקָה נוֹחֵל הָעוֹלָם הַזֶּה וְהָעוֹלָם הַבָּא, דְּהַיְינוּ שֶׁזּוֹכֶה לִבְחִינַת צַדִּיק. **— Thus the holy Zohar says that crying out brings one the inheritance of this world and the next: he merits the quality of the righteous.** וּלְפִי זֶה צָרִיךְ לוֹמַר בַּזּוֹהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ: וּמִמְּצוּקוֹתֵיהֶם יוֹצִיאֵם. **— Accordingly, the Zohar's text should read, "He brings them out of their straits."** וְאִפְשָׁר שֶׁהָיָה כָּתוּב לָהֶם וְגוֹמֵר, וְהוֹסִיפוּ מִמְּצוּקוֹתֵיהֶם יַצִּילֵם שֶׁבָּא רִאשׁוֹן בַּפָּסוּק, וְהוּא טָעוּת סוֹפֵר. **— Perhaps it originally said "to them," etc., and someone supplied "He saves them from their straits," which appears earlier in the psalm; this is a copying error.**

What Gad Lacked, Asher Completes

אַךְ מַהֵיכָן זָכָה אָשֵׁר לָזֶה, אַף שֶׁהוּא בְּחִינַת יוֹסֵף, וְיוֹסֵף מֶרְכָּבָה לְמִדַּת צַדִּיק יְסוֹד עוֹלָם? **— Yet how did Asher merit this? He represents Yosef, the vehicle of the righteous one, the world's foundation,** אֲבָל הוּא מִדָּתוֹ דְּנָטִיר בְּרִית, גִּבּוֹר הַכּוֹבֵשׁ אֶת יִצְרוֹ. **— but Yosef's attribute is guarding the covenant, the mighty one who masters his inclination.** וּבְאָשֵׁר כְּתִיב: וְעַל מִפְרָצָיו יִשְׁכּוֹן, שֶׁהוּא מְתַקֵּן פִּגְם זֶה אַף מִי שֶׁקִּלְקֵל, וְכָאָמוּר. **— Of Asher, however, it says, "He dwells by its breaches": he repairs this damage even for one who has gone astray.** אֲבָל זָכָה לָזֶה עַל פִּי מַה שֶּׁכָּתוּב בַּזּוֹהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ (חֵלֶק א רמד ב): תָּא חֲזֵי, הַהוּא נָהָר דְּנָגִיד וְנָפִיק מֵעֶדֶן וְכוּלֵי,[1353] **— He merited this as explained in the holy Zohar I, 244b: "Come and see: that river which flows and emerges from Eden," etc.,** וְעַל דָּא וְעַל דָּא אַפִּיק וְיָהִיב וְדָא לָקִיט וְכוּלֵי. **— "Thus Gad: this one brings forth and gives, and this one receives," etc.**

[1347] **Psalms 107:30**: "They rejoiced because the waters were quiet, and He guided them to their desired haven."

[1348] **Ecclesiastes 12:5**: "They also fear heights, and terrors are on the road; the almond tree blossoms, the grasshopper becomes heavy, and the caper berry fails. For a person is going to his eternal home, and mourners go about in the street."

[1349] **Shemot Rabbah 52:3**: "Does a person see his fellow in the World to Come? Does not each righteous person have a world of his own, as it says, 'For a person goes to his eternal home, and the mourners circle in the marketplace' (Ecclesiastes 12:5)? It does not say 'worlds,' but 'his world.'"

[1350] **Shabbat 152a:13**: "'For a person goes to his eternal house.' Rabbi Yitzchak said: This teaches that each righteous person is given a dwelling according to his honor. It is comparable to a king who entered a city with his servants. When they enter, they all enter through one gate; when they lodge, each is given a dwelling according to his honor."

[1351] **Isaiah 60:21**: "Your people are all righteous; they will inherit the land forever, the shoot of My planting, the work of My hands, in which I will be glorified."

[1352] **Mishnah Sanhedrin 10:1**: "All Israel have a share in the World to Come, as it says in Yeshayahu 60, 'Your people are all righteous; they shall inherit the land forever, the shoot of My planting, the work of My hands, in which I take glory.' These are the ones who have no share in the World to Come: One who says that the resurrection of the dead is not taught by the Torah, one who says that Torah is not from Heaven, and an apikores, a heretic. Rabbi Akiva says: Also one who reads the external books, and one who whispers an incantation over a wound and says, 'I will not place upon you any of the illness I placed upon Egypt, for I am the Lord who heals you' (Shemos 15). Abba Shaul says: Also one who pronounces the Divine Name according to its letters."

[1353] **Zohar, Vayechi 71:736**: 'Zohar, Vayechi (I:244b): "Come and see: that river which flows and emerges from Eden never ceases, drawing down supernal abundance through the Tzaddik into Knesset Yisrael."'

אָמַר רַבִּי יִצְחָק: אִלְמָלֵא דְּהָנָה גָּד מִבְּנֵי שְׁפָחוֹת, שַׁעֲתָא קַיְימָא לֵיהּ לְאַשְׁלָמָא יַתִּיר מִכֹּלָּא, הֲדָא הוּא דִּכְתִיב: בָּא גָד, קְרֵי וּכְתִיב בְּגָד, [1354] **— Rabbi Yitzchak said: "Were Gad not among the handmaids' sons, the moment stood ready for him to attain greater completeness than all. Thus it is read ba gad, but written begad,"** חָסֵר אָלֶיף, דְּהָא שַׁעֲתָא קַיְימָא בִּשְׁלִימוּ וְאִסְתַּלַּק מִינֵּיהּ וְכוּלֵי, **— "lacking an alef: the moment stood in completeness but departed from him," etc.,** וְעַל דָּא לָא זָכָה בְּאַרְעָא קַדִּישָׁא וְכוּלֵי. **— "Therefore he did not merit a portion in the Holy Land," etc.** תָּא חֲזֵי, מַה דְּאִתְפְּגִים בְּגָד אִשְׁתְּלִים בְּאָשֵׁר, הֲדָא הוּא דִּכְתִיב: מֵאָשֵׁר שְׁמַנָּה לַחְמוֹ וְגוֹמֵר. [1355] **— "Come and see: what was lacking in Gad was completed in Asher, as it says, 'From Asher, rich is his bread,'" etc.** וְהַיְינוּ דְּגָד בּוֹ אוֹת גִּימֶל דָּיְהִיב וְאוֹת דָּלֶת דְּלָקִיט, רַק נָחַסֵר הָאָלֶף, אוֹתִיוֹת פֶּלֶא. **— Gad contains gimel, which gives, and dalet, which receives; it lacks only alef, whose letters spell pele, "wonder."** וְאוֹת אָלֶף אִשְׁתְּלִים בְּאָשֵׁר. **— The letter alef was completed in Asher.** וְעַל כֵּן זָכָה אָשֵׁר לְמִדָּה זוֹ, נָהָר דְּנָגִיד וְנָפִיק, לְהֵיוֹת מוֹשֵׁךְ לְכִלַּל כְּנֶסֶת יִשְׂרָאֵל, **Asher therefore merited this attribute, the river that flows and emerges, drawing its flow to the whole Community of Israel.** וּכְמָה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: וְהוּא יִתֵּן מַעֲדַנֵּי מֶלֶךְ, וּמַאן מֶלֶךְ? דָּא כְּנֶסֶת יִשְׂרָאֵל, כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ (שָׁם רלה [1356] **— "He will provide royal delicacies": who is the king? The Community of Israel, as the holy Zohar states there, 235b and 246a.** וְנָגִיד לְהַאי צַדִּיק לְמֵיהַב תַּפְנוּקִין וְעִדּוּנִין לְהַאי אֶרֶץ, דְּאִיהוּ לֶחֶם עוֹנִי, וְאִתְעֲבִיד לֶחֶם פַּנֵּג וְכוּלֵי (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב שָׁם רמה סוֹף עַמּוּד ב). [1357] **— "It flows to this righteous one to give delights and pleasures to this land, which is bread of poverty and becomes bread of delight," etc., as stated at the end of 245b.**

Bread Filled with Holiness

וְהַיְינוּ דְּכֹחַ אֲשֶׁר, שֶׁהוּא מְתַקֵּן וּמַכְנִיס קְדוּשָׁה בַּאֲכִילָה, כְּמָה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: מֵאָשֵׁר שְׁמַנָּה לַחְמוֹ, לֶחֶם וָו, שֶׁהוּא אוֹת אֱמֶת, זוֹ תוֹרָה כַּיָּדוּעַ. **— Asher's power repairs eating and brings holiness into it: "From Asher, rich is lachmo"—lechem, bread, plus vav, the letter of truth, Torah, as is known.** וּבַאֲכִילָה הוּא שׁוֹרֶשׁ הַפֶּגָם מַהֲנָחָשׁ, שֶׁגָּרַם פֶּגָם הַבְּרִית, וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמַרְנוּ. **— Eating was the root of the serpent's damage, which caused damage to the covenant, as explained.** וְאָשֵׁר מַכְנִיס בַּאֲכִילָה קְדוּשָׁה, שֶׁיִּהְיֶה דִּבְרֵי תוֹרָה: לְכוּ לַחֲמוּ בְלַחֲמִי. **— Asher brings holiness into eating so that it becomes words of Torah: "Come, eat of My bread."** וְזֶה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: וְהוּא יִתֵּן מַעֲדַנֵּי מֶלֶךְ, דָּא כְּנֶסֶת יִשְׂרָאֵל. **— Thus, "He will provide royal delicacies": this is the Community of Israel.** וּמִדָּה זוֹ יִרְאָה, כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב (זֹהַר חֵלֶק ג' רלח ב): אִיהִי יִרְאָה וְכוּלֵי. [1358] **— This attribute is awe, as Zohar I, 5b, states: "She is awe," etc.** וְהַשֵּׁם שֶׁכְּנֶגֶד מִדָּה זוֹ, שֵׁם אֲדֹנָי, גַּם כֵּן מוֹרֶה יִרְאָה, כְּמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: וְאִם אֲדוֹנִים אֲנִי אַיֵּה מוֹרָאִי. **— The Name corresponding to this attribute, Adonai, also indicates awe: "If I am a master, where is My fear?"** וְהוּא גַּם כֵּן תְּפִלָּה שֶׁבָּא מִיִּרְאָה, כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמַרְנוּ. **— It is also prayer, which comes from awe, as explained.** וּכְתִיב: אֲדֹנָי שְׂפָתַי תִּפְתָּח וְגוֹמֵר, שֶׁהַתְּפִלָּה מִמִּדַּת מַלְכוּת (וְנִתְבָּאֵר בְּכַמָּה מְקוֹמוֹת). [1359] **— It says, "My Master, open my lips," etc., for prayer comes from Malchut, as explained in several places.**

Eliyahu and the Restoration of Israel

וְגָד שַׁעֲתָא קַיְימָא לֵיהּ, שְׁמַגָּד יָצָא אֵלִיָּהוּ (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בְּרֵאשִׁית רַבָּה פָּרָשָׁה עא), [1360] **— The moment stood ready for Gad,**

[1354] **Zohar, Vayechi 70:728**: 'Zohar, Vayechi (I:244b): "Rabbi Yitzchak said: Come and see how that supernal river flows and emerges from Eden to water the Garden, bestowing life and holy nourishment upon Israel."'

[1355] **Zohar, Vayechi 70:729**: 'Zohar, Vayechi (I:244b): "Come and see: what was lacking in Gad was completed in Asher, as it is written, 'Out of Asher his bread shall be fat, and he shall yield royal dainties' (Genesis 49:20)."'

[1356] **Zohar, Vayechi 72:752**: 'Zohar, Vayechi (I:246a): "'Out of Asher his bread shall be fat (shamen), and he shall yield royal dainties' (Genesis 49:20) — This is the supernal World to Come (Binah), whence flow rich spiritual nourishment and royal delights to the Community of Israel (Malchut)."'

[1357] **Zohar, Vayechi 72:751**: 'Zohar, Vayechi (I:245b–246a): "The supernal river flows to the Tzaddik (Yesod) to bestow delights and pleasures upon this land (Malchut), transforming the 'bread of poverty' into 'rich bread' and royal dainties."'

[1358] **Zohar, Introduction 12:114**: "and when they reached the house of R. Simeon the son of Lakunya they saw there R. Simeon the son of Yohai, and they rejoiced exceedingly. R. Simeon said to them, 'Assuredly ye traversed a path of heavenly miracles and wonders, for as I was sleeping just now I had a vision of you and of Benaiah the son of Jehoiada, who was sending you two crowns by the hand of a certain elder to crown you withal. Assuredly the Holy One, blessed be He, was on that path. Further, I saw your faces as if transfigured.' R. Jose remarked: 'Well have ye said that "the sage is superior to the prophet".' R. Eleazar then approached and put his head between the knees of his father and told him all that had happened to them."

[1359] **Psalms 51:17**: 'O my Sovereign, open my lips,and let my mouth declare Your praise.'

[1360] **Bereshit Rabbah 71:9** (excerpt): "'Leah said: Gad has come' (Genesis 30:11): The good fortune of the house has come; the good fortune of the world has come. The one who will cut down the foundations of idolaters has come. Who is this? Elijah. From whom did Elijah descend? Rabbi Eliezer said: From Benjamin, as it is written, 'Ya'aresheyah, Elijah, and Zikhri, sons of Yerocham,' and 'all these were of the children of Benjamin' (I Chronicles 8:27, 40). Rabbi Nehorai said: He was from Gad, as it is written, 'Elijah the Tishbite, of the inhabitants of Gilead' (I Kings 17:1). … Once our Sages disagreed about this: some said he was from Gad, and others from Benjamin. Elijah came and stood before them.

for Eliyahu descended from Gad, as Bereishit Rabbah 71 states. וְהוּא מַלְאַךְ הַבְּרִית שֶׁיְּתַקֵּן כָּל יִשְׂרָאֵל וְיבָרֵם: וְעַמֵּךְ כּוּלָּם צַדִּיקִים. **— He is the covenant's angel, who will repair all Israel and reveal their truth: "Your people are all righteous."** וְהוּא כָּלוּל גַּם מִבִּנְיָמִין, כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב (בְּרֵאשִׁית רַבָּה שָׁם), דְּיֵשׁ אוֹמְרִים שֶׁבָּא מִבִּנְיָמִין.[1361] **— He also includes Binyamin, for Bereishit Rabbah there records an opinion that he came from Binyamin.** וְהַיְינוּ[1362] שֶׁהָיָה כָּלוּל מִנְּשָׁמוֹת רַבּוֹת, כַּיָּדוּעַ מִדִּבְרֵי הָאֲרִי זְכרוֹנוֹ לִבְרָכָה (וְהוּבָא חֲנוּכָּה מַאֲמָר יג). **— He comprised many souls, as known from the Ari's words, cited in Chanukah, teaching 13.** וְהַיְינוּ דְּבִנְיָמִין הוּא שׁוֹרֶשׁ קְדוּשַׁת אֶרֶץ יִשְׂרָאֵל, דִּכְתִיב: וּבֵין כְּתֵפָיו שָׁכֵן, וְהוּא קְדוּשַׁת הַמִּקְדָּשׁ וְאֶרֶץ יִשְׂרָאֵל. **— Binyamin is the root of the Land of Israel's holiness: "He dwells between his shoulders," the holiness of the Temple and the Land of Israel.** וְגָד אִסְתַּלַּק וְלֹא זָכָה כְּלָל בְּאֶרֶץ יִשְׂרָאֵל, כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ שֶׁזָּכרְנוּ. **— Gad's opportunity departed, and he merited no portion in the Land, as the cited Zohar states.** וְאֵלִיָּהוּ בְּהַר הַכַּרְמֶל הִקְרִיב בְּאִיסּוּר הַבָּמוֹת, אַף שֶׁהָיָה כִּשְׁחוּטֵי חוּץ, רַק הָיָה בְּאֶרֶץ יִשְׂרָאֵל. **— Eliyahu offered a sacrifice on Mount Carmel while private altars were forbidden; although like slaughter outside the sanctuary, it was in the Land of Israel.** וְכֹחַ אֵלִיָּהוּ לְהַכְנִיס קְדוּשָׁה בַּחוּץ שֶׁיִּהְיֶה כִּקְדוּשַׁת הַמִּזְבֵּחַ, וְהָיָה יָכוֹל לְהַכְנִיס קְדוּשָׁה אַף בְּחוּץ לָאָרֶץ. **— Eliyahu's power is to bring holiness outside, like the altar's holiness; he could bring holiness even outside the Land.** וְאָז בֵּירֵר שֶׁאָמְרוּ כָּל יִשְׂרָאֵל: הַשֵּׁם הוּא הָאֱלֹהִים. וְהוּא טָעַן: וְאַתָּה הֲסִיבוֹתָ אֶת לִבָּם אֲחוֹרַנִּית, וְחָזַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא וְהוֹדָה לִדְבָרָיו, דִּכְתִיב: וַאֲשֶׁר הֲרֵעוֹתִי (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בְּרָכוֹת לב.).[1363] **— He then brought clarity, and all Israel declared, "Hashem is God." He argued, "You turned their hearts backward." The Holy One then acknowledged his words: "Whom I afflicted," as Berakhot 32a explains.** וְהוּא יָבוֹא לְהוֹצִיא הַנִּדָּחִים בְּאֶרֶץ מִצְרַיִם, דְּהַיְינוּ הַמְּשׁוּקָעִים בְּקְלִיפָּה זוֹ, שֶׁמְּצִירִים וּמְעִיקִים לְיִשְׂרָאֵל בְּפָגָם זֶה. **— He will come to bring out those banished in Egypt, those sunk in this husk that oppresses Israel through this blemish.** וְאֵלִיָּהוּ הָיָה מַה דְּגָד קַיְימָא לֵיהּ שַׁעֲתָא קוֹדֶם דְּאִסְתַּלַּק מִינֵּיהּ. **— Eliyahu embodied what stood ready for Gad before the opportunity departed from him.** וּמַה דְּאִתְפְּגִים בְּגָד אִשְׁתְּלִים בְּאָשֵׁר, וְלָכֵן בְּאָשֵׁר כֹּחַ הַתִּיקּוּן לִפְגָם זֶה, וְעַל זֶה נֶאֱמַר: וְעַל מִפְרָצָיו יִשְׁכּוֹן, וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמַרְנוּ. **— What was lacking in Gad was completed in Asher; hence Asher's power to repair this damage: "He dwells by its breaches," as explained.**

Amos: No One Is Left Behind

וְשָׁמַעְתִּי מֵהָרַב הַקָּדוֹשׁ, זֶכֶר צַדִּיק וְקָדוֹשׁ לִבְרָכָה, דְּעָמוֹס שֶׁהָיָה מִשֵּׁבֶט אָשֵׁר, שֶׁהָיָה מִתְּקוֹעַ. **— I heard from the holy Rebbe, of blessed and sacred memory, that Amos was of Asher's tribe, for he came from Tekoa.** וְהַיְינוּ דְּתְקוֹעַ וּבַגְּמָרָא שָׁם: וְטוֹבֵל אַלְפָּא לַשָּׁמֶן (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב מְנָחוֹת פה:),[1364] **— Tekoa is foremost for oil, as Menachot 85b states.**

He said: Our teachers, why do you disagree about me? I am one of Rachel's descendants."

[1361] **Bereshit Rabbah 71:9** (excerpt): "'Leah said: Gad has come' (Genesis 30:11): The good fortune of the house has come; the good fortune of the world has come. The one who will cut down the foundations of idolaters has come. Who is this? Elijah. From whom did Elijah descend? Rabbi Eliezer said: From Benjamin, as it is written, 'Ya'aresheyah, Elijah, and Zikhri, sons of Yerocham,' and 'all these were of the children of Benjamin' (I Chronicles 8:27, 40). Rabbi Nehorai said: He was from Gad, as it is written, 'Elijah the Tishbite, of the inhabitants of Gilead' (I Kings 17:1). … Once our Sages disagreed about this: some said he was from Gad, and others from Benjamin. Elijah came and stood before them. He said: Our teachers, why do you disagree about me? I am one of Rachel's descendants."

[1362] **Peri Tzadik, Chanukah 13:2**: "The verse 'A nation and a congregation of nations,' which they interpreted concerning Elijah's deed on Mount Carmel, was said to Jacob our father, peace be upon him, before Benjamin's birth, because Elijah came from Benjamin, as stated at the end of Bereishit Rabbah, chapter 71. Although some say that he came from Gad, as stated there, and some say that he was a priest, as in Bava Metzia 114b and Tosafot there, all are true: he comprises many souls, as is known from the words of the Arizal. Here the root of his soul that comes from Benjamin is indicated."

[1363] **Berakhot 31b:27**; **Berakhot 32a:1**: "Rabbi Elazar also said: Eliyahu directed forceful words toward Heaven, as it says, 'You have turned their hearts backward.' Rabbi Shmuel bar Rabbi Yitzchak said: How do we know that the Holy One, blessed be He, subsequently acknowledged Eliyahu's argument? Because it is written, 'And those whom I caused to suffer evil.'"

[1364] **Menachot 85b:14-18**: "The Sages taught: 'He dips his foot in oil' refers to Asher's portion, which flows with oil like a spring. They said: Once the people of Laodicea needed oil. They appointed a purchasing agent and told him, 'Go and bring us a million coins' worth of oil.' He went to Jerusalem, and they told him, 'Go to Tyre.' He went to Tyre, and they told him, 'Go to Gush Chalav.' He went to Gush Chalav, and they told him, 'Go to a certain man in that field.' He found him loosening the earth beneath his olive trees. He asked him, 'Do you have a million coins' worth of oil, which is what I need?' The man answered, 'Wait until I finish my work.' He waited until he finished his work. After finishing his work, the man slung his tools behind him and continued clearing stones as he walked along the road. The agent asked him, 'Do you really have a million coins' worth of oil? I think the Jews have made a laughingstock of me.' When they reached the man's town, his maidservant brought out a kettle of hot water, and he washed his hands and feet with it. She brought out a golden basin full of oil, and he dipped his hands and feet in it, fulfilling the verse, 'He dips his foot in oil.' After they had eaten and drunk, he measured out a million coins' worth of oil for the agent. He asked him, 'Do you need any more?' The agent answered, 'Yes, but I have no money.' He told him, 'If you wish to take more, take it; I will go with you and collect its price.' He measured out another hundred and eighty thousand coins' worth of oil. They said: That man did not leave a horse, mule, camel, or donkey in the Land of Israel that he did not hire to transport it. When the agent reached his town, the townspeople came out to praise him. He told them, 'Do not praise me; praise this man who came with me. He

בַּשָּׁמָן רַגְלוֹ, זֶה חֶלְקוֹ שֶׁל אָשֵׁר וְכוּ׳. **— The Gemara there says, "He dips his foot in oil"—this is Asher's portion, etc.** וְהוּא אָמַר פָּרָשָׁה הֲלוֹא כִבְנֵי כוּשִׁיִּים, שֶׁהוּא מְיוּסָּד עַל צַעֲקַת בְּנֵי הַנְּעוּרִים בִּפְגָם זֶה, שֶׁנִּקְרְאוּ בְּנֵי כוּשִׁיִּים.[1365] **— He spoke the passage "Are you not like the children of Cush?" It concerns young people's cries over this blemish; they are termed children of Cush.** הֵיפֶךְ מִבְּחִינַת יוֹסֵף, שֶׁנִּקְרָא יָפֶה תוֹאַר וִיפֵה מַרְאֶה, שֶׁיֵּשׁ לוֹ גּוּף נָקִי מִפְּגָם זֶה (וְנִתְבָּאֵר וַיְחִי מַאֲמָר יג).[1366] **— This contrasts with Yosef, called "handsome in form and appearance," whose body was free of this damage; see Vayechi, teaching 13.** וּמִפְּנֵי שֶׁשִּׁימֵשׁ חָם בַּתֵּיבָה, שֶׁהָיָה בְּאִיסּוּר וְהָיָה מֵעֵין פְּגַם הַבְּרִית, לָקָה בְּעוֹרוֹ (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב סַנְהֶדְרִין קח:).[1367] **— Cham had relations in the ark, which was forbidden and resembled damage to the covenant; he was therefore afflicted in his skin, as Sanhedrin 108b states.** וְאָמַר שָׁם בְּפָרָשָׁה זוֹ: כִּי הִנֵּה אָנֹכִי מְצַוֶּה וַהֲנִיעוֹתִי וְגוֹמֵר, וְלֹא יִפּוֹל צְרוֹר אָרֶץ.[1368] **— In that passage he says, "For behold, I command and will shake," etc., "but no particle shall fall to the earth."** וְהֵיינוּ שֶׁמִּישְׂרָאֵל לֹא יִהְיֶה שׁוּם פְּסוֹלֶת, דְּהַנְעָנוּעַ בַּכְּבָרָה הוּא לְהוֹצִיא הַקֶּמַח וְשֶׁיּוּשְׁאַר הַפְּסוֹלֶת. **— No waste will remain from Israel. Shaking a sieve lets the flour out while leaving the refuse behind.** וְאָמַר שֶׁמִּבֵּית יִשְׂרָאֵל לֹא יִוּשְׁאַר פְּסוֹלֶת, שֶׁמִּי שֶׁיִּרְצֶה לְהִטָּהֵר יִהְיֶה לוֹ סִיּוּעָתָא מִלְּמַעְלָה לְתַקֵּן הֶעָבָר וּלְהִתְגַּבֵּר עַל הַיֵּצֶר הָרָע לְהַבָּא. **— He says that no refuse will remain from the house of Israel: whoever wishes to become pure will receive help from above to repair the past and overcome the evil inclination in the future.** דִּכְתִיב: צוֹפָה רָשָׁע לַצַּדִּיק, וְעַמֶּךָ כֻּלָּם צַדִּיקִים, וּכְתִיב: הַשֵּׁם לֹא יַעַזְבֶנּוּ בְיָדוֹ. **— "The wicked watches the righteous"—and "Your people are all righteous"—but "Hashem will not abandon him to his power."**

Gathering Those Lost in Exile

וַאֲפִילּוּ הָאוֹבְדִים בְּאֶרֶץ אַשּׁוּר, דְּהַיְינוּ שֶׁנִּטְמְעוּ בֵּין הָעוֹבְדֵי כּוֹכָבִים וּמַזָּלוֹת, וְאִיתָא (וַיִּקְרָא רַבָּה פָּרָשָׁה יג), שֶׁכָּל הָאוּמּוֹת עוֹבְדֵי כּוֹכָבִים וּמַזָּלוֹת נִקְרְאוּ עַל שֵׁם אַשּׁוּר, שֶׁמְּאַשְּׁרִין עַצְמָן מִיִּשְׂרָאֵל,[1369] **— Even those lost in Assyria, meaning those assimilated among the idolaters, for Vayikra Rabbah 13 says that all the idolatrous nations are called Assyria, since they draw strength from Israel,** דְּהַיְינוּ דְּמִתְחַזְּקִים מִמַּה שֶׁנִּטְמְעוּ יִשְׂרָאֵל בֵּינֵיהֶם, וְעַל כֹּחַ זֶה נִקְרְאוּ כּוּלָּם אַשּׁוּר. **— they become stronger through Israel's assimilation among them; for this power they are all called Assyria.** וּמִכָּל מָקוֹם מִיִּשְׂרָאֵל לֹא יִדַּח מִמֶּנּוּ נִדָּח, דְּאַף עַל פִּי שֶׁחָטָא, יִשְׂרָאֵל הוּא (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב סַנְהֶדְרִין מד.).[1370] **— Nevertheless, none of Israel's banished will remain banished: "Although he has sinned, he remains Israel," as Sanhedrin 44a states.** וְאַשּׁוּר בַּקְלִיפָּה כְּנֶגֶד אֲשֶׁר בַּקְּדוּשָׁה, וּבָא בּוֹ תּוֹסֶפֶת אוֹת מִשֵּׁם הַקָּדוֹשׁ, עַל שֵׁם שֶׁמְּאַשְּׁרִים עַצְמָן מִיִּשְׂרָאֵל. **— Assyria in impurity stands opposite Asher in holiness, with an added vav, a letter of the holy Name, because they draw strength from Israel.** וְהַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ יוֹצִיאֵם מִשָּׁם, וְלֹא יִדַּח מִמֶּנּוּ נִדָּח, וְלֹא יִפּוֹל צְרוֹר אָרֶץ. **— Hashem will bring them out: no banished one will remain banished, and no particle will fall to the earth.** וְחוֹדֶשׁ זֶה כְּנֶגֶד אָשֵׁר, שֶׁמִּי שֶׁמְּפָנֶּה עַצְמוֹ לְהַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ וְרוֹצֶה לִהְיוֹת טוֹב, יָכוֹל לְתַקֵּן הַכֹּל, **— This month corresponds to Asher: whoever turns toward Hashem and wishes to be good can repair**

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measured out a million coins' worth of oil for me, and he is still my creditor for another hundred and eighty thousand.' This fulfills the verse, 'There is one who makes himself rich yet has nothing, and one who makes himself poor yet has great wealth.'"

[1365] **Amos 9:7**: "To Me, O Israelites, you are Just like the Cushites —declares GOD.True, I brought Israel up From the land of Egypt,But also the Philistines from Caphtor And the Arameans from Kir."

[1366] **Peri Tzadik, Vayechi 13:1**: "He said this concerning the tribe of Asher in accordance with what I heard from our holy master, of blessed memory. He said that Amos, who was of the tribe of Asher and came from Tekoa, spoke the passage 'Are you not like the children of Cush?' It is founded upon the cry of young people, for one who has blemished the covenant is called disfigured and Cushite—the opposite of Joseph, who is called 'handsome in form and handsome in appearance.' This is because that blemish is more common in this tribe. Thus far his words. The meaning is that this tribe was given an especially great power to repair the serpent's blemish and corruption. Its root was in eating; subsequently it extended to his coming upon Eve and imparting impurity to her, from which the corruption of the hundred and thirty years extended."

[1367] **Sanhedrin 108b:15**: "The Sages taught: Three had sexual relations in the ark, and all three were afflicted: the dog, the raven, and Cham. The dog became bound during mating; the raven emitted seed through its mouth; and Cham was afflicted in his skin."

[1368] **Amos 9:9**: "For I will give the order And shake the House of Israel—Through all the nations—As one shakes sand in a sieve, And not a pebble falls to the ground."

[1369] **Vayikra Rabbah 13:5** (excerpt): "'It goes to the east of Assyria' (Genesis 2:14). Rav Huna said: All the kingdoms are called by the name Assyria, because they strengthen themselves from Israel."

[1370] **Sanhedrin 44a:1-3**: "Why were others punished on account of Achan? Because his wife and children knew of his act. 'Israel has sinned.' Rabbi Abba bar Zavda said: Even though he has sinned, he remains Israel. Rabbi Abba said: This is what people mean when they say, 'A myrtle standing among reeds is still named myrtle, and they still call it myrtle.' 'They have also transgressed My covenant that I commanded them; they have also taken from the consecrated property; they have also stolen; they have also denied; they have also placed it among their belongings.' Rabbi Ilaa said in Rabbi Yehudah bar Masparta's name: This teaches that Achan transgressed all five books of the Torah, because 'also' is stated five times."

everything, וּלְהַכְנִיס קְדוּשָׁה בַּמַּאֲכָל, שֶׁזֶּה בְּחִינַת אָשֵׁר, כְּמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: מֵאָשֵׁר שְׁמָנָה לַחְמוֹ וְגוֹמֵר, שֶׁיִּהְיֶה לֶחֶם פַּנֵּג. **— and bring holiness into food, Asher's quality: "From Asher, rich is his bread," etc., so it becomes bread of delight.** וְיָכוֹל לְתַקֵּן הַפְּגָם שֶׁפָּגַם בְּמִדַּת צַדִּיק עַל יְדֵי הַתּוֹרָה וּצְעָקָה בַּלֵּב, תְּפִלָּה וְיִרְאָה, שֶׁהֵם בְּחִינַת מֹשֶׁה וּבְחִינַת יוֹסֵף, שֶׁהֵם גִּימַטְרִיָּא אָשֵׁר. **— He can repair the damage he caused to the righteous attribute through Torah and the heart's cry, prayer and awe: the qualities of Moshe and Yosef, whose numerical values together equal Asher.** שֶׁיִּהְיֶה הַכֹּל טוֹב. **— So that everything will be good.**

Rosh Chodesh Shevat Ois 2

Bent and Upright: Shevat's Work of Sanctifying Desire

The heart's apparent division is connected to whether creation is seen as separate from its Creator.

Bent and Upright: Shevat's Work of Sanctifying Desire

Tzadi, Nun, and the Righteous Person

בְּסֵפֶר יְצִירָה חָשַׁב לְכָל חוֹדֶשׁ אוֹת אַחַת מִשְּׁתֵּים עֶשְׂרֵה פְּשׁוּטוֹת[1371], **— Sefer Yetzirah assigns each month one of the twelve simple letters,** וְחָשַׁב לְחוֹדֶשׁ שְׁבָט אוֹת צָדִי. **— assigning the letter Tzadi to Shevat.** וְאוֹת צָדִי אִיתָא בַּגְּמָרָא (שַׁבָּת קד עַמּוּד א)[1373]: צָדִי כְּפוּפָה וְצָדִי פְּשׁוּטָה, צַדִּיק כָּפוּף, צַדִּיק פָּשׁוּט. **— The Gemara teaches concerning Tzadi (Shabbat 104a): the bent Tzadi and straight Tzadi signify a bent righteous person and a straight righteous person.** וְכֵן בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ (חֶלֶק א ב עַמּוּד ב),[1374] **— The holy Zohar likewise says (I, 2b)** דְּאָמְרָה אוֹת צָדִי: בִּי חֲתוּמִין צַדִּיקִים, וְאַנְתְּ דְּאִתְקְרֵיאַת צַדִּיק בִּי רְשִׁים וְכוּלֵי. **— that the letter Tzadi said: "The righteous are sealed with me, and You, who are called righteous, are marked with me," etc.** וְהַיְינוּ דְּאוֹת זֶה מוֹרֶה עַל מִדַּת צַדִּיק, וּכְמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב שָׁם: צָדִי אַנְתְּ, וְצַדִּיק אַנְתְּ. **— This letter signifies the attribute of the righteous, as it says there: "You are Tzadi, and you are righteous."** אַךְ בַּגְּמָרָא שָׁם פָּרִיךְ: הַיְינוּ נָאֶמָן פָּשׁוּט, **— The Gemara asks: is this not already taught by the bent and straight faithful person?** וּמְשַׁנֵּי: הוֹסִיף לְךָ נִרְאֶה מִזֶּה דְּאוֹתִיּוֹת נוּן הַכָּתוּב כְּפִיפָה עַל כְּפִיפָתוֹ. **— It answers: Scripture adds further bending to his bending.** וְצָדִי יֵשׁ לָהֶם שַׁיְיכוּת זֶה לָזֶה. **— The letters Nun and Tzadi thus have a connection with one another.**

Why Were Two Inclinations Created?

מַאי דִּכְתִיב וַיִּיצֶר (בְּרָכוֹת סא עַמּוּד א): וְהָעִנְיָן דְּאִיתָא[1375] **— The explanation follows the teaching in Berakhot (61a):** וְגוֹמֵר בִּשְׁנֵי יוּדִין? שְׁנֵי יְצָרִים בָּרָא הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא, אֶחָד יֵצֶר טוֹב וְאֶחָד יֵצֶר רָע. **— Why is "He formed" written with two Yuds? The Holy One, blessed be He, created two inclinations, one good and one evil.** וְאַף דְּדָחֵי בַּגְּמָרָא: אֶלָּא מֵעַתָּה בְּהֵמָה וְכוּלֵי, דָּחֶה רַק דְּאֵין זֶה הַמְכֻוָּן בִּשְׁנֵי הַיּוּדִין, אֲבָל הַדָּבָר שֶׁבָּרָא הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא שְׁנֵי יְצָרִים לֹא נִדְחָה. **— Although the Gemara challenges this: "If so, an animal," etc., it rejects only this interpretation of the two Yuds, not the fact that He created two inclinations.** וְצָרִיךְ לְהָבִין, הָא אִיתָא (בְּמִדְרַשׁ תַּנְחוּמָא בְּרֵאשִׁית ז): לֹא בָרָאוֹ הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא[1376] **— This requires explanation, for Midrash Tanchuma teaches (Bereshit 7):** שֶׁנִּקְרָא צַדִּיק וְיָשָׁר אֶת הָאָדָם בְּצַלְמוֹ, אֶלָּא כְּדֵי לִהְיוֹת צַדִּיק וְיָשָׁר כָּמוֹהוּ. **— The Holy One, blessed be He, who is called righteous and upright, created man in His image only so that man should be righteous and upright like Him.** וְאִם תֹּאמַר: לָמָּה בָּרָא יֵצֶר הָרָע וְכוּלֵי? אָמַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא: אַתָּה עוֹשֶׂה אוֹתוֹ רָע וְכוּלֵי. **— If you ask why He**

[1371] **Sefer Yetzirah 5:1**: "Twelve Simple Letters, Heh-Waw Zayin-Chet Tet-Yod Lamed-Nun 'Ayin-Samekh Tzadi-Qof —Their foundation is Seeing, Hearing, Smelling, Talking, Eating, Sex, Work, Movement, Excitement, Play, Contemplation, Sleep. Their measure is the Twelve Diagonal Borders: Northeastern border, Southeastern border, Upper-Eastern border, Lower-Western border, Upper-Northern border, Lower-Northern border, Southwestern border, Northwestern border, Upper-Western border, Lower-Western border, Upper-Southern border, Lower-Southern border. They extend outwards and go on forever and ever and ever—They are the Arms of the World."

[1372] **Sefer Yetzirah Gra Version 5:10**: 'He made the letter Tzadi king over swallowing/taste (le'itah), bound a crown to it, and combined one with another; and with them He formed Aquarius (Deli) in the universe, Shevat in the year, and the gizzard (kurkevan) in the soul, male and female.'

[1373] **Shabbat 104a:6**: "Samech and ayin mean: Support the poor. Another interpretation: Make signs in the Torah and acquire it. A bent peh and an extended peh mean an open mouth and a closed mouth. A bent tzaddi and an extended tzaddi mean a bowed righteous person and an upright righteous person. But this repeats the teaching of a bowed faithful person and an upright faithful person, represented by the two forms of nun! Scripture adds bending upon his bending. From here we learn that Torah was given with a nodding, humbled head."

[1374] **Zohar, Introduction 6:38**: "The letter Aleph remained in her place without presenting herself. Said the Holy One, blessed be His name: Aleph, Aleph, wherefore comest thou not before Me like the rest of the letters? She answered: Because I saw all the other letters leaving Thy presence without any success. What, then, could I achieve there? And further, since Thou hast already bestowed on the letter Beth this great gift, it is not meet for the Supreme King to take away the gift which He has made to His servant and give it to another. The Lord said to her: Aleph, Aleph, although I will begin the creation of the world with the beth, thou wilt remain the first of the letters. My unity shall not be expressed except through thee, on thee shall be based all calculations and operations of the world, and unity shall not be expressed save by the letter Aleph."

[1375] **Berakhot 61a:3-5**: "Rav Nachman bar Rav Chisda expounded: Why is 'The Lord God formed man,' va-yitzer, written with two letters yud? The Holy One, blessed be He, created two inclinations: one good inclination and one evil inclination. Rav Nachman bar Yitzchak challenged this: If so, does an animal, concerning which va-yitzer is not written with two yuds, have no inclination? We see that it causes damage, bites, and kicks! Rather, the spelling follows Rabbi Shimon ben Pazi's teaching. Rabbi Shimon ben Pazi said: 'Woe to me because of my Creator, and woe to me because of my inclination.' Alternatively, it follows Rabbi Yirmiyah ben Elazar's teaching. Rabbi Yirmiyah ben Elazar said: The Holy One, blessed be He, created Adam the first man with two faces, as it says, 'Behind and before You formed me.'"

[1376] **Midrash Tanchuma, Bereshit 7:1**: "The Holy One, blessed be He, who is called righteous and upright, created the human being in His image only so that he would be righteous and upright like Him. If you ask, 'Why did He create the evil inclination, of which it is written, "The inclination of the human heart is evil from youth" (Genesis 8:21)? You say that it is evil—who can make it good?' the Holy One, blessed be He, says: 'You make it evil.' Why? A child of five, six, seven, eight or nine does not sin; rather, from ten onward, he then develops the evil inclination."

created the evil inclination, etc., He says: "You make it evil," etc.

One desire, two ways of seeing the world

וּכְבָר נִתְבָּאֵר שֶׁיֵּצֶר פֵּירוּשׁוֹ חֵשֶׁק, כְּמוֹ לְיֵצֶר מַחְשָׁבוֹת לְבַב עַמֶּךָ.[1377, 1378] — **We have explained that yetzer means desire, as in "the inclination of the thoughts of Your people's heart."** וְהַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא בָּרָא הַחֵשֶׁק לִהְיוֹת חָמִידוּ כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב זֹהַר חֵלֶק א קלח עמוד א), — **He created desire to be a longing for Torah,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁיִּהְיֶה לָעָתִיד רַק אַתָּה עוֹשֶׂה אוֹתוֹ רָע. וְעַל זֶה אָמְרוּ(קידושין ל עמוד ב): בָּרָאתִי יֵצֶר הָרָע וּבָרָאתִי לוֹ תּוֹרָה תַּבְלִין.[1379] — **as it will be in the future (Zohar I, 138a); only you make it evil. Concerning this they taught (Kiddushin 30b): "I created the evil inclination, and I created Torah as its remedy."** וְאָמְרוּ: אִם פָּגַע בְּךָ מְנֻוָּל זֶה, מָשְׁכֵהוּ לְבֵית הַמִּדְרָשׁ.[1380] — **They also said: "If this vile one encounters you, draw it to the study hall."** וְהַיְינוּ לִהְיוֹת הַחֵשֶׁק וְהַיֵּצֶר לְבֵית הַמִּדְרָשׁ, לִהְיוֹת חֶדְוָתָא דִּשְׁמַעְתָּא. — **That is, desire and inclination should turn toward the study hall, becoming joy in Torah learning.** וְאִם כֵּן נִבְרָא רַק יֵצֶר אֶחָד, וְאֵיךְ קָאָמַר שֶׁבָּרָא הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא שְׁנֵי יְצָרִים? — **If so, only one inclination was created. How, then, does it say He created two?**

The Heart's Two Chambers

אֲכָל הַמְכֻוָּן בָּזֶה עַל שְׁנֵי חַלְקֵי הַלֵּב, — **Rather, this refers to the heart's two chambers.** וּכְתִיב: לֵב חָכָם לִימִינוֹ וְלֵב כְּסִיל לִשְׂמֹאלוֹ.[1381] — **It is written: "A wise person's heart is to his right, and a fool's heart to his left."** לִימִינוֹ, הַיְינוּ בְּדִבְרֵי תוֹרָה וְחָכְמָה, וְזֶהוּ הַשֵּׁם שׁוֹכֵן בְּתוֹךְ בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל. — **"To his right" means in Torah and wisdom: Hashem dwells among the children of Israel.** וּבַמִּדְרָשׁ (שִׁיר הַשִּׁירִים רַבָּה ה, ב): אֵיכָן מָצִינוּ שֶׁהַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא לִבָּן שֶׁל יִשְׂרָאֵל?[1382] — **The Midrash asks (Shir HaShirim Rabbah 5:2): where do we find that the Holy One, blessed be He, is Israel's heart?** מִן הַדִּין קְרָא דִּכְתִיב: צוּר לְבָבִי וְחֶלְקִי אֱלֹהִים לְעוֹלָם.[1383] — **From this verse: "God is the rock of my heart and my portion forever."** וְהַיְינוּ שֶׁהַשֵּׁם שׁוֹכֵן בְּלֵב יִשְׂרָאֵל. — **That is, Hashem dwells in Israel's heart.** וְלִשְׂמֹאלוֹ הַיְינוּ בְּעִנְיְנֵי הַגּוּף וְדֶרֶךְ אֶרֶץ. — **"To his left" means bodily concerns and worldly life.** וְהוּא מַה שֶּׁאָמְרוּ (קֹהֶלֶת רַבָּה ג, יא) עַל פָּסוּק גַּם אֶת הָעוֹלָם נָתַן בִּלְבָּם: אַהֲבַת עוֹלָם נָתַן בִּלְבָּם וְכוּ'.[1384] — **Kohelet**

[1377] **I Chronicles 29:18**: 'O ETERNAL One God of Abraham, Isaac, and Israel, our fathers, remember this to the eternal credit of the thoughts of Your people's hearts, and make their hearts constant toward You.'

[1378] **Likkutei Maamarim, Compositions on the Festivals 9:1**: "The bet of "Bereshit" is therefore enlarged, for the world was created with bet. Alef is the unity of the world, as He was alone and unique before the world was created. Creation was to make it appear as though there were two: Creator and creation. But Israel would receive the Torah beginning with the alef of "I am," and so forth, to recognize that even now, after the world was created, Hashem is one, just as before its creation. This comes from the Torah, which sustains the world; from the world's side there is bet. The beginning of the recognition of this twofoldness is in the heart, where there are two chambers dwelling places for the two inclinations. The evil inclination makes it appear that there are two, separating creation from the Creator, Heaven forbid; the good inclination guides him to know that in truth Hashem is one and there is nothing besides Him."
Pri Tzadik reconciles one originally good power of longing with two chambers of the heart, corresponding to Torah and worldly life. Likkutei Maamarim explains the spiritual danger behind the division: worldly life can be perceived as detached from its divine source. The connection supplies a conceptual account of the split without equating bodily activity itself with evil.

[1379] **Kiddushin 30b**: 'A Sage from the school of Rabbi Yishmael taught: My son, if this wretched one, the evil inclination, encounters you, pull it into the study hall, i.e., go and study Torah. If it is a stone it will melt, and if it is iron it will break, as it is stated with regard to the Torah: "Is not My word like fire, says the Lord, and like a hammer that breaks the rock in pieces?" (Jeremiah 23:29). Just as a stone shatters a hammer, so too one can overcome his evil inclination, which is as strong as iron, through Torah study. With regard to the second part of the statement: If it is a stone it will melt, this is as it is stated with regard to the Torah: "Ho, everyone who thirsts, come for water" (Isaiah 55:1), and it states: "The water wears the stones" (Job 14:19), indicating that water is stronger than stone.'

[1380] **Kiddushin 30b**: 'A Sage from the school of Rabbi Yishmael taught: My son, if this wretched one, the evil inclination, encounters you, pull it into the study hall, i.e., go and study Torah. If it is a stone it will melt, and if it is iron it will break, as it is stated with regard to the Torah: "Is not My word like fire, says the Lord, and like a hammer that breaks the rock in pieces?" (Jeremiah 23:29). Just as a stone shatters a hammer, so too one can overcome his evil inclination, which is as strong as iron, through Torah study. With regard to the second part of the statement: If it is a stone it will melt, this is as it is stated with regard to the Torah: "Ho, everyone who thirsts, come for water" (Isaiah 55:1), and it states: "The water wears the stones" (Job 14:19), indicating that water is stronger than stone.'

[1381] **Ecclesiastes 10:2**: 'A sage's mind tends toward the right hand, a fool's toward the left.'

[1382] **Shir HaShirim Rabbah 5:2:1** (excerpt): "I sleep concerning redemption, but the heart of the Holy One, blessed be He, is awake to redeem me. Rabbi Chiya bar Abba said: Where do we find that the Holy One is called the heart of Israel? From this verse: 'God is the rock of my heart and my portion forever' (Psalms 73:26)."

[1383] **Psalms 73:26**: 'Psalms 73: 26: 'My body and mind fail;but God is the stay of my mind, my portion forever.''

[1384] **Kohelet Rabbah 3:11:3** (excerpt): "Rabbi Binyamin said in the name of Rabbi Levi: 'He also placed the world in their heart'—He placed love of the world in their heart. … Nechemyah, son of Rabbi Shmuel bar Nachman, said: 'Behold, it was very good' (Genesis 1:31): 'Behold, it was good'—this is Adam; 'behold, it was good'—this is the good inclination; 'very'—this is the evil inclination. Is the evil inclination really very good? Rather, this teaches that without the evil inclination a person would not build a house, marry, or have children. Thus Solomon says, 'It is a person's

Rabbah (3:11) expounds "He also placed the world in their heart": He placed love of the world in their heart, etc. שֶׁאִילּוּ לֹא יֵצֶר הָרָע, לֹא בָּנָה אָדָם בַּיִת וְלֹא נָשָׂא אִשָּׁה וְכוּלֵי. **— Without the evil inclination, a person would not build a house or marry a wife, etc.** וְזֶהוּ לֵב כְּסִיל לִשְׂמֹאלוֹ, שֶׁכֹּחַ הַיֵּצֶר הָרָע נִקְרָא מֶלֶךְ זָקֵן וּכְסִיל.[1385] **— This is "a fool's heart to his left," for the evil inclination's power is called "an old and foolish king."**

Worldly Life before Adam's Sin

וּמִכָּל מָקוֹם, כְּשֶׁנִּבְרָא אָדָם הָרִאשׁוֹן קוֹדֶם הַקִּלְקוּל, כְּתִיב: וַיַּנִּיחֵהוּ בְּגַן עֵדֶן לְעָבְדָהּ וּלְשָׁמְרָהּ.[1386] **— Nevertheless, when Adam was created, before the damage, it is written: "He placed him in Eden to work it and guard it."** וּבְפִשּׁוּטוֹ וְהָיָה זֶה עֵסֶק בְּקִדּוּשָׁה: קְאֵי עַל עֲבוֹדַת אִילְנֵי הַגַּן עֵדֶן, **— Its plain meaning concerns tending the trees of Eden.** לְעָבְדָהּ מִצְוַת עֲשֵׂה, וּלְשָׁמְרָהּ מִצְוֹת לֹא תַּעֲשֶׂה, **— This activity was holy: "to work it" through positive commandments, and "to guard it" through prohibitions,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ (חֵלֶק א כז עַמּוּד א) וּבְתִקּוּנֵי זֹהַר (תִּקּוּן כא).[1387, 1388] **— as explained in the holy Zohar (I, 27a) and Tikkunei Zohar (Tikkun 21).** וּפְרִי הַגָּן הָיָה לַאֲכִילַת אָדָם, כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב מִכֹּל עֵץ הַגָּן אָכֹל תֹּאכֵל, וְהָיָה זֶה מִצְוַת עֲשֵׂה.[1389] **— The garden's fruit was for man to eat, as it is written, "You shall surely eat of every tree of the garden"; this was a positive commandment.** שֶׁהָיָה אָז הָעֵסֶק בְּעִנְיְנֵי הָעוֹלָם גַּם כֵּן בִּקְדוּשָׁה, וְהָיָה דִּבְרֵי תוֹרָה. **— Worldly activity was then also holy and constituted words of Torah.** וְיַעֲקֹב אָבִינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם, שֶׁהָיָה כְּאָדָם הָרִאשׁוֹן קוֹדֶם הַפְּגָם, **— Jacob our father, peace be upon him, was like Adam before the damage,** שֶׁלֹּא יָדַע כְּלָל מֵהֲנָאַת הַגּוּף, שֶׁהוּא עֲטִיוֹ שֶׁל נָחָשׁ (כְּשֶׁנִּתְבָּאֵר כַּמָּה פְּעָמִים).[1390] **— knowing nothing of bodily pleasure, which comes from the serpent's counsel, as explained several times.** עַל כֵּן אָמַר מַה שֶּׁקַּל שֶׁבַּקַּלִּים אֵינוֹ אוֹמֵר: אֶלָּא לְהוֹלִיד תּוֹלָדוֹת נִתְכַּוֵּין (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב רַשִׁ"י וַיֵּצֵא).[1391] **— He therefore said what even the most frivolous person would not say, intending only to produce offspring (Rashi, Vayetzei).** וְהֵיוָן שֶׁלֹּא יָדַע כְּלָל מֵהֲנָאַת הַגּוּף, לֹא הָיָה יוֹדֵעַ בּוּשָׁה בָּזֶה, **— Since he knew nothing of bodily pleasure, he knew no shame in this,** וּכְמָה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר בְּאָדָם הָרִאשׁוֹן קוֹדֶם הַקִּלְקוּל: וְלֹא יִתְבּוֹשָׁשׁוּ.[1392] **— as it is said of Adam before the damage: "They were not ashamed."** וְזֶהוּ שֶׁאָמַר: אַתָּה עוֹשֶׂה אוֹתוֹ רָע, שֶׁאַחַר הַקִּלְקוּל נַעֲשָׂה הָעֵרְבּוּב וְיֵשׁ בּוֹ רָע. **— Thus "You make it evil": after the damage, the admixture arose, and evil entered it.**

Nun: Faith, Torah, and Humility

וְזֶה עִנְיַן אוֹת נוּן שֶׁמּוֹרֶה נֶאֱמָן, וְהוּא לֵב חָכָם לִימִינוֹ, שֶׁהוּא רַק לְדִבְרֵי תוֹרָה. **— This is Nun, signifying the faithful person: the wise heart to the right, devoted solely to Torah.** וְאוֹת נוּן אִיתָא בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ (חֵלֶק ב צא עַמּוּד א): נוּן **— Concerning Nun, the holy Zohar says (II, 91a): Nun is the mystery of fearing the Holy One, blessed be He, etc.; its mystery is the lower Hei.** וְהֵיינוּ דְּאוֹת נוּן רָזָא לְמִדְחַל מִקּוּדְשָׁא בְּרִיךְ הוּא וְכוּלֵי, דְּרָזָא דִּילֵיהּ הֵא תַּתָּאָה. **— Nun is the attribute of Malchut and the Name Adnut, signifying awe,** מִדַּת מַלְכוּת וְשָׁם אֲדנוּת, שֶׁמּוֹרֶה עַל יִרְאָה, וּבַזֹּהַר כְּתִיב שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: וְאִם אֲדוֹנִים אָנִי, אַיֵּה מוֹרָאִי?[1393] **— as it is written: "If I am a master, where is My fear?"**

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rivalry with his fellow' (Ecclesiastes 4:4)."

[1385] **Ecclesiastes 4:13**: 'Better a poor but wise youth than an old but foolish king who no longer has the sense to heed warnings.'

[1386] **Genesis 2:15**: 'The ETERNAL God settled the Human in the garden of Eden, to till it and tend it.'

[1387] **Zohar, Bereshit 24:264-25:265**: "A further lesson can be derived from the words "and from there it parted": happy is the man who devotes himself to the Torah, for when God takes him from this body, from the four elements, he is detached from them and ascends to become the head of the four Hayyoth, as it is written, "and they shall bear thee on their hands" (Ps. 91, 12). AND THE LORD GOD COMMANDED THE MAN, SAYING. It is agreed that the term "command" in the Scripture always has reference to the prohibition of idolatry. This sin has its root in the liver, which is the seat of anger, and it has been laid down that "to fall into a passion is like worshipping idols"."

[1388] **Tikkunei Zohar 50a:4**: 'Tikkunei Zohar (Tikkun 21, 50a): "The Oral Torah was given from the Left Side (Gevurah)," teaching that halakhic refinement and mastery over desire require the sacred awe and discipline of Gevurah.'

[1389] **Genesis 2:16**: "Hashem God commanded the man, saying: 'You may freely eat from every tree of the garden.'"

[1390] **Genesis 3:6**: 'When the woman saw that the tree was good for eating and a delight to the eyes, and that the tree was desirable as a source of wisdom, she took of its fruit and ate. She also gave some to her husband, and he ate.'

[1391] **Rashi on Genesis 29:21:1**: "מלאו ימי MY DAYS ARE FULFILLED — which my mother told me to remain with you. And another explanation is: MY DAYS ARE FULFILLED for I am now eighty-four years old and when shall I beget twelve tribes? That is what he meant by adding "that I may go in unto her"; for surely even the commonest of people would not use such an expression. But he said this because his mind was intent upon having issue (to fulfil his mission of rearing children who would carry on the religious traditions of his fathers) (Genesis Rabbah 70:18)."

[1392] **Genesis 2:25**: "Both were naked, the man and his wife, and they were not ashamed."

[1393] **Malachi 1:6**: 'A son should honor his father, and a slave his master. Now if I were a father, where would be the honor due Me? And if I were a master, where would be the reverence due Me?—said GOD of Hosts to you, O priests who scorn My name. But you ask, "How have we scorned Your name?"'

הַקָּדוֹשׁ (חֶלֶק א ה עַמּוּד ב): דְּאֵימָה יְרָאָה וְשָׁרְיָא בָּהּ יְרָאָה. וְהַיְינוּ שֶׁהַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ שׁוֹכֵן בְּלֵב יִשְׂרָאֵל.[1394] — **The holy Zohar says (I, 5b): "It is awe, and awe dwells within it." This means Hashem dwells in Israel's heart.** וְהוּא עַל יְדֵי כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב (תָּמִיד בְּחִינַת אֱמוּנָה, וְזֶה נִקְרָא נֶאֱמָן, — **This comes through faith, hence the designation "faithful,"** כח עַמּוּד א): יַחֲזִיק בֶּאֱמוּנָה יְתֵירָה, שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר עֵינַי בְּנֶאֱמְנֵי אֶרֶץ.[1395] — **as taught (Tamid 28a): "He should hold fast to greater faith," as it says, "My eyes are upon the faithful of the land."** וְהַיְינוּ מְהֵימְנוּתָא שְׁלִימְתָא, וְזֶהוּ שֶׁאָמַר (זֹהַר חֵלֶק ג רֵל עַמּוּד א): אִיהִי אֱמוּנָה.[1396] — **This is complete faith. Thus the Zohar says (III, 230a): "It is faith."** וְזֶהוּ שֶׁאָמַר נֶאֱמָן כְּפוּף, שֶׁלִּקְנוֹת דִּבְרֵי וְלִימּוּדוֹ הוּא רַק חָכְמָה וְדִבְרֵי תוֹרָה. — **The right side is solely wisdom and Torah.** תּוֹרָה צָרִיךְ שֶׁיִּהְיֶה כָּפוּף וְעָנָיו, — **Thus "a bent faithful person": to acquire Torah, one must be bowed and humble.** כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב (תַּעֲנִית ז עַמּוּד א): מַה מַּיִם וְכוּלֵי, אַף דִּבְרֵי תוֹרָה אֵינָם מִתְקַיְּימִין אֶלָּא בְּמִי שֶׁמַּשְׁפִּיל עַצְמוֹ כְּמִי שֶׁאֵינוֹ.[1397] — **As taught (Ta'anit 7a): just as water, etc., so Torah endures only in one of lowly spirit.** וְכֵן (סוֹטָה כא עַמּוּד ב): אֵין דִּבְרֵי תוֹרָה מִתְקַיְּימִין אֶלָּא בְּמִי שֶׁמֵּמִית עַצְמוֹ כְּמִי שֶׁאֵינוֹ. וְזֶהוּ שֶׁאָמַר: מֵאַיִן תִּמָּצֵא חָכְמָה וְגוֹ'.[1398] — **Likewise (Sotah 21b), Torah endures only in one who makes himself as nothing. Thus it says: from here we learn that Torah was given with a bowed head.**

Tzadi: Mastering and Sanctifying Desire

וְאוֹת צַדִּיק הוּא עַל עִנְיְנֵי הָעוֹלָם, שֶׁהוּא בְּלֵב כְּסִיל לְשִׂמְאוֹלוֹ, — **The letter Tzadi concerns worldly matters, belonging to the fool's heart on the left.** וְעַל זֶה צָדִי כְּפוּפָה, צַדִּיק כָּפוּף, — **Concerning this, the bent Tzadi signifies a bent righteous person:** לִהְיוֹת גִּבּוֹר הַכּוֹבֵשׁ אֶת יִצְרוֹ, מֻשְׁכֶּהוּ לְבֵית הַמִּדְרָשׁ. — **being mighty by mastering one's inclination—"Draw it to the study hall."** וְזֶהוּ כָּפוּף, לָכוּף אֶת יִצְרוֹ בִּגְבוּרָה וְלַעֲשׂוֹתוֹ טוֹב, שֶׁיִּהְיֶה כָּל עִנְיְנֵי הָעוֹלָם בְּקִדּוּשָׁה. — **Being bent means forcefully bending one's inclination toward good, so that all worldly affairs become holy.** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב הָרַמְבַּם זִכְרוֹנוֹ לִבְרָכָה (בְּפֶרֶק נ מֵהִלְכוֹת דֵּעוֹת),[1399] — **As Rambam, of blessed memory, writes in the Laws of Human Dispositions,**

[1394] **Zohar, Introduction 12:114**: "and when they reached the house of R. Simeon the son of Lakunya they saw there R. Simeon the son of Yohai, and they rejoiced exceedingly. R. Simeon said to them, 'Assuredly ye traversed a path of heavenly miracles and wonders, for as I was sleeping just now I had a vision of you and of Benaiah the son of Jehoiada, who was sending you two crowns by the hand of a certain elder to crown you withal. Assuredly the Holy One, blessed be He, was on that path. Further, I saw your faces as if transfigured.' R. Jose remarked: 'Well have ye said that "the sage is superior to the prophet".' R. Eleazar then approached and put his head between the knees of his father and told him all that had happened to them."

[1395] **Tamid 28a:3**: "It was taught: Rabbi says: What is the upright path a person should choose? He should love rebuke, for as long as rebuke exists in the world, contentment comes to the world, goodness and blessing come to the world, and evil departs from the world, as it says, 'For those who rebuke there will be pleasantness, and upon them the blessing of good will come.' Some say: He should maintain exceptional faithfulness, as it says, 'My eyes are upon the faithful of the land, that they may dwell with Me,' and so forth."

[1396] **Zohar, Pinchas 53:332**: "For this reason the masters of the Mishnah established: 'Study is not the essential thing, but action.' For the Holy One, blessed be He, is concealed in the mysteries of Torah. Through what is He known? Through the commandments, which are His Divine Presence, which is His likeness. Just as He is humble, His Divine Presence is humility. He is pious, and she is pious; He is mighty, and she is sovereign over all the nations of the world. He is truth, and she is faith."

[1397] **Taanit 7a:15**: "Rabbi Chanina bar Idi also said: Why were words of Torah compared to water, as it is written, 'Ho, all who are thirsty, go to the water'? To tell you: Just as water leaves a high place and flows to a low place, so words of Torah endure only in someone of humble mind."

[1398] **Sotah 21b**: 'The Gemara asks: And the Rabbis who disagree with him, what do they do with this verse: "I, wisdom, dwell with cunning orma"; how do they interpret it? The Gemara responds: He requires that verse for that which Rabbi Yosei, son of Rabbi Ḥanina, states, interpreting the word "orma" as nakedness rather than cunningness, as Rabbi Yosei, son of Rabbi Ḥanina, says: The matters of Torah do not endure except in one who stands naked for them, as it is stated: "I, wisdom, dwell with nakedness orma" (Proverbs 8:12). This means that wisdom dwells only in one who is prepared to give away all of his possessions for the sake of Torah study. Rabbi Yoḥanan says: The matters of Torah do not endure except in one who considers himself as one who does not exist, as it is stated: "But wisdom, it can be found in nothingness" (Job 28:12).'

[1399] **Mishneh Torah, Human Dispositions 3:3**: "If a person regulates his conduct according to medicine but intends only that his body and limbs be sound, and that he have children who will do his work and labor for his needs, this is not a good path. Rather, he should intend that his body be sound and strong so that his soul may be properly directed toward knowing the Lord. It is impossible to understand and contemplate the branches of wisdom while hungry or ill, or while one of one's limbs is painful. He should intend to have a son who may perhaps become a sage and a great man in Israel. A person who follows this path is thus constantly serving the Lord throughout his life, even while conducting business and even while having sexual relations, because in everything his intention is to obtain what he needs so that his body will be sound enough to serve the Lord. Even while sleeping, if he sleeps deliberately so that his mind may be at rest and his body may rest, lest he become ill and be unable to serve the Lord while ill, his sleep is service of the Omnipresent, blessed be He. Concerning this the Sages commanded, 'Let all your deeds be for the sake of Heaven' (Avos 2:12). This is what Shlomo said in his wisdom: 'Know Him in all your ways, and He will make your paths straight' (Mishlei 3:6)."

When ordinary delight serves a larger joy

שֶׁבְּכָל עִנְיְנֵי הָעוֹלָם כְּשֶׁמְּכַוְּנִין לְשֵׁם שָׁמַיִם, הוּא עֲבוֹדָה לַמָּקוֹם וְהוּא מַעֲשֶׂה מִצְוָה.[1400] — **all worldly activities, when directed for Heaven's sake, are service of God and acts of mitzvah.** וּכְשֶׁמְּכַוְּנִין לְשֵׁם תַּאֲוָה הוּא לְהֵיפֶךְ, וְאֵין דָּבָר רְשׁוּת בְּלָל. **— When directed toward desire, the reverse is true; nothing is entirely neutral.**

Nun and Yud in the Holy Covenant

וְזֶהוּ שֶׁאָמַר בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ (חֵלֶק א ב עַמּוּד ב) בְּאוֹת צָדִי:[1401] — **This is what the holy Zohar says (I, 2b) concerning Tzadi:** נוּן אִיהִי, אַתְיָא יוּד דִּשְׁמָא דִּבְרִית קַדִּישָׁא וְרָכִיב עֲלָהּ וְאִתְאַחַד בַּהֲדָהּ וְכוּלֵי. — **"It is Nun; Yud of the name of the holy covenant comes, rides upon it, and unites with it," etc.** וְהַיְינוּ דְּאוֹת יוּד מוֹרֶה עַל בְּרִית, — **Yud signifies the covenant,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ (חֵלֶק ב לוֹ עַמּוּד א): מִשּׁוּם דְּאִתְגַּלְיָיא יוּד וְכוּלֵי, עַיֵּן שָׁם.[1402] — **as written in the holy Zohar (II, 36a): "Because Yud was revealed," etc.; see there.** וְכֵן אִיתָא בְּמִדְרָשׁ (תַּנְחוּמָא תַּזְרִיעַ ה): וּמַהוּ הַשֵּׁם וְהַחוֹתָם שָׂשָׂם בָּהֶם? הוּא שַׁדַּי:[1403] — **The Midrash likewise asks (Tanchuma, Tazria 5): "What is the Name and seal He placed upon them? It is Shaddai:** הַשִּׁין בָּאַף, וְהַדָּלֶת בַּיָּד, וְהַיּוּד בַּמִּילָה. — **Shin in the nose, Dalet in the hand, and Yud in circumcision."** וְשֵׁם שַׁדַּי שֵׁם הַתְּשִׁיעִי, כְּנֶגֶד מִדַּת צַדִּיק יְסוֹד עוֹלָם (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב זֹהַר חֵלֶק ג יא עַמּוּד ב).[1404] — **Shaddai is the ninth Name, corresponding to the attribute "the righteous one, foundation of the world" (Zohar III, 11b).** וְזֶהוּ שֶׁאָמַר עַל אוֹת צָדִי דְּנוּן אִיהִי, וְהַיְינוּ בְּרָזָא דְּהַא תַּתָּאָה, אִיהִי אֱמוּנָה, — **Thus it says that Tzadi is Nun: the mystery of the lower Hei, which is faith.** וְהַיּוּד דְּשֵׁם שַׁדַּי רָכִיב עֲלָהּ, — **The Yud of the Name Shaddai rides upon it,** דְּיוֹסֵף הוּא הַנָּהָר דְּנָגִיד וְנָפִיק, וְיַעֲקֹב וְיוֹסֵף כַּחֲדָא אִינּוּן (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב זֹהַר חֵלֶק א קעו עַמּוּד ב).[1405] — **for Joseph is the river that flows forth, and Jacob and Joseph are one (Zohar I, 176b).** וּבְרַעְיָא מְהֵימְנָא (זֹהַר חֵלֶק ג רמב עַמּוּד ב): דְּגוּף וּבְרִית חָשְׁבִינַן חַד.[1406] — **Ra'aya Mehemna states (Zohar III,**

[1400] **Mei HaShiloach, Volume I, Genesis, Bereshit 1**: "This is the meaning of the verse in Proverbs 23:26, "My son, give your heart to Me," and consequently, "will keep My ways": when you give your heart to Hashem, blessed be He, the service of Hashem becomes primary for you, and all matters of this world become secondary to it. By way of example, a wealthy man has a worthy and wise son and arranges a marriage for him befitting his honor. When he has prepared the wedding necessities and tastes the food he has prepared, as he tastes it he remembers his joy in his son; the tasting is secondary for him. Understand this."

Mei HaShiloach's wedding analogy makes Pri Tzadik's account of holy worldly activity concrete. The father still tastes the food, but its significance comes from his greater joy in his son. This explains a reordering of delight within divine service, rather than requiring that every physical sensation disappear.

[1401] **Zohar, Introduction 6:38**: "The letter Aleph remained in her place without presenting herself. Said the Holy One, blessed be His name: Aleph, Aleph, wherefore comest thou not before Me like the rest of the letters? She answered: Because I saw all the other letters leaving Thy presence without any success. What, then, could I achieve there? And further, since Thou hast already bestowed on the letter Beth this great gift, it is not meet for the Supreme King to take away the gift which He has made to His servant and give it to another. The Lord said to her: Aleph, Aleph, although I will begin the creation of the world with the beth, thou wilt remain the first of the letters. My unity shall not be expressed except through thee, on thee shall be based all calculations and operations of the world, and unity shall not be expressed save by the letter Aleph."

[1402] **Zohar, Bo 4:80-81**: "R. Hezekiah, however, held that two kinds of blood appeared on the doors to represent the two "crowns" which were manifested at that moment in the regions above. R. Jose maintained that it was one crown consisting of two sides blended, viz. mercy and justice. Said R. Abba: 'In how many ways does the Holy One show His lovingkindness to His people! A man builds a house; says the Holy One to him: "Write My Name and put it upon thy door (mezuzah), and thou wilt sit inside thy house and I will sit outside thy door and protect thee!" And here, in connection with the Passover, He says: "You inscribe on your doors the sign of the mystery of My Faith and I shall protect you from the outside!"'"

[1403] **Midrash Tanchuma, Tazria 5**: 'Turnus Rufus the wicked asked Rabbi Akiva: "Whose works are more beautiful, those of the Holy One, blessed be He, or those of flesh and blood?" Rabbi Akiva replied: "Those of flesh and blood are more beautiful!" When Turnus Rufus challenged him over circumcision, Rabbi Akiva brought him stalks of wheat and fine baked cakes of bread, saying: "These stalks are the work of the Holy One, blessed be He, and these cakes are the work of flesh and blood—are not the cakes finer?" Turnus Rufus said: "If God desires circumcision, why does the infant not emerge circumcised from his mother's womb?" Rabbi Akiva answered: "Because the Holy One, blessed be He, gave the commandments to Israel solely in order to refine and purify them through their own action!"'

[1404] **Zohar, Vayikra 24:163-164**: "IF HIS OBLATION BE A SACRIFICE OF PEACE OFFERINGS. R. Abba here quoted the verse: "Awake, O north wind, and come thou south, blow upon my garden that the spices thereof may flow out" (S.S. 4, 15). 'The north wind', he said, 'refers to the burnt offerings which were killed on the north side (zafon) of the altar, because these atone for the thoughts which are in the recesses (mazpune) of a man's heart. The south wind refers to the peace offerings, which were killed on the south side of the altar, because they make peace between higher and lower, and between the various quarters of the world. Therefore the bringer also eats of them and has a share in them. Of all the offerings, none are so well beloved to God as the peace offerings, because they bring harmony to upper and lower."

[1405] **Zohar, Vayishlach 22:228**: 'Zohar, Vayishlach (I:176b): "Joseph is the river that flows forth, and Jacob and Joseph are counted as one single continuum—Tiferet and Yesod united in guarding the holy covenant."'

[1406] **Zohar, Pinchas 71:450**: 'Zohar, Pinchas (Raya Mehemna, III:242b): "The body and the covenant (gufa u-verit) are reckoned as one."'

242b): "We count the body and the covenant as one." — וְיַעֲקֹב אוֹת וָו, שֶׁהוּא מֻרְכָּבָה לְשֵׁם הֲוָיָה, וְיוֹסֵף וָו הַמְּיֻלּוּי, Jacob is Vav, a chariot for the Name Havayah, and Joseph is the Vav added in spelling out the letter. כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ (ת"ח קפב עמוד ב)[1407]: וְדָא הוּא רָזָא דְּאוֹת וָו דְּאָזְלֵי תַּרְוַויְיהוּ כַּחֲדָא וְכוּלֵי. — As written in the holy Zohar (182b): "This is the mystery of the letter Vav, in which the two go together as one," etc. וְיוֹסֵף נִקְרָא וָו זְעִירָא, וְהוּא הַיּוּד דִּבְרִית מִשֵּׁם שַׁדַּי, — Joseph is called the small Vav, which is the Yud of the covenant from the Name Shaddai, וְהוּא מִדַּת צַדִּיק יְסוֹד עוֹלָם, דְּאָחִיד בִּשְׁמַיָּא וְאַרְעָא. — and the attribute "the righteous one, foundation of the world," joining heaven and earth. וְזֶהוּ שֶׁאָמַר אַחַר כָּךְ בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ: וְרָזָא דָּא, The Zohar continues: "This is the mystery: when the Holy One, blessed be He, created Adam, He created him with two faces. כַּד בָּרָא קוּדְשָׁא בְּרִיךְ הוּא לְאָדָם הָרִאשׁוֹן, פַּרְצוּפִין בָּרָאוֹ[1408] — וּבְגִין כָּךְ אַנְפּוֹי דְּיוּד מַהְדַּר לַאֲחוֹרָא — Therefore Yud's face turns backward," etc. וְהַיְינוּ דְּהַנּוּן כְּנֶסֶת יִשְׂרָאֵל, וְהַיּוּד צַדִּיק יְסוֹד עוֹלָם, — Nun is Knesset Yisrael, and Yud is the righteous one, foundation of the world. וְכֵן הָיוּ אָדָם וְחַוָּה כְּמוֹ שֶׁנִּבְרְאוּ, לִהְיוֹת אָדָם הָרִאשׁוֹן צַדִּיק יְסוֹד עוֹלָם, — Such were Adam and Chavah at their creation: Adam was to be the righteous one, foundation of the world, שֶׁנִּבְרָא בַּיּוֹם הַשִּׁשִּׁי, מִדָּה זוֹ (וְנִתְבָּאֵר בְּמָקוֹם אַחֵר).[1409] — created on the sixth day, corresponding to this attribute (as explained elsewhere). וְזֶהוּ שֶׁאָמַר: כְּגוֹנָא דָּא אָמַר קוּדְשָׁא בְּרִיךְ הוּא לְהָהִיא דְּאִתְקְרֵי חַוָּה[1410] — Thus it says: "In this manner the Holy One, blessed be He, told her: I am destined to separate you," etc. וְזֶה הַמְכֻוָּן בְּאוֹת צָדִי שֶׁמּוֹרֶה עַל צַדִּיק יְסוֹד עוֹלָם, — This is the meaning of Tzadi, signifying the righteous one, foundation of the world. שֶׁזֶּה הָיָה אָדָם הָרִאשׁוֹן כְּפִי מַה שֶּׁעָשָׂה הָאֱלֹהִים אֶת הָאָדָם יָשָׁר, לִהְיוֹת צַדִּיק, וּכְמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בַּמִּדְרָשׁ. — This was Adam, as "God made man upright," to be righteous, as stated in the Midrash.

From Struggle to an Upright Heart

וְאָמַר צַדִּיק כָּפוּף, צַדִּיק פָּשׁוּט, שֶׁמִּתְחִלָּה צָרִיךְ לִהְיוֹת כָּפוּף, לִלְחוֹם בִּגְבוּרָה וְלִכְפוֹף אֶת הַיֵּצֶר לַטּוֹב. — It says "a bent righteous person, a straight righteous person": first one must bend, fight with strength, and bend the inclination toward good. וּמִכָּל מָקוֹם יֵשׁ לוֹ מִלְחָמָה, שֶׁמִּתְגַּבֵּר עוֹד, וְזֶהוּ צַדִּיק כָּפוּף. — The battle nevertheless remains, for the inclination continues to gain strength; this is the bent righteous person. וְאַחַר כָּךְ צַדִּיק פָּשׁוּט, שֶׁזּוֹכֶה לְיַישֵׁר הַלֵּב שֶׁיִּהְיֶה כֵּן לְעוֹלָם, וְלֹא יִהְיֶה לוֹ כְּלָל קְטָרוּג הַיֵּצֶר הָרָע. — Then comes the straight righteous person: the heart is made permanently upright, with no further accusation from the evil inclination. וְרַשִּׁי פֵּירֵשׁ נֶאֱמָן כָּפוּף: לִהְיוֹת כָּפוּף וְעָנָיו, וְסוֹפוֹ לִהְיוֹת פָּשׁוּט וְזָקוּף לָעוֹלָם הַבָּא.[1411] — Rashi explains the bent faithful person: to be bowed and humble, ultimately becoming straight and upright in the World to Come. וּמִסְתָּמָא כֵּן פֵּרֵשׁ צַדִּיק פָּשׁוּט גַּם כֵּן לָעוֹלָם הַבָּא. — Presumably, he likewise understands the straight righteous person as referring to the World to Come.

Doubled Letters and Redemption in Two Worlds

וְהִנֵּה בְּפִרְקֵי דְּרַבִּי אֱלִיעֶזֶר (פֶּרֶק מח) אִיתָא עַל אוֹתִיּוֹת הַכְּפוּלוֹת, שֶׁמּוֹרִין עַל גְּאוּלַּת הָאָבוֹת וְיִשְׂרָאֵל.[1412] — Pirkei DeRabbi

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[1407] **Zohar, Vayeshev 5:71**: 'Zohar, Vayeshev (I:182b): "This is the mystery of the letter Vav, in which the two proceed together as one."'

[1408] **Zohar, Introduction 6:38**: "The letter Aleph remained in her place without presenting herself. Said the Holy One, blessed be His name: Aleph, Aleph, wherefore comest thou not before Me like the rest of the letters? She answered: Because I saw all the other letters leaving Thy presence without any success. What, then, could I achieve there? And further, since Thou hast already bestowed on the letter Beth this great gift, it is not meet for the Supreme King to take away the gift which He has made to His servant and give it to another. The Lord said to her: Aleph, Aleph, although I will begin the creation of the world with the beth, thou wilt remain the first of the letters. My unity shall not be expressed except through thee, on thee shall be based all calculations and operations of the world, and unity shall not be expressed save by the letter Aleph."

[1409] **Genesis 1:31**: 'And God saw all that He had made, and behold, it was very good. And there was evening and there was morning, the sixth day (yom ha-shishi).'

[1410] **Zohar, Introduction 6:38**: "The letter Aleph remained in her place without presenting herself. Said the Holy One, blessed be His name: Aleph, Aleph, wherefore comest thou not before Me like the rest of the letters? She answered: Because I saw all the other letters leaving Thy presence without any success. What, then, could I achieve there? And further, since Thou hast already bestowed on the letter Beth this great gift, it is not meet for the Supreme King to take away the gift which He has made to His servant and give it to another. The Lord said to her: Aleph, Aleph, although I will begin the creation of the world with the beth, thou wilt remain the first of the letters. My unity shall not be expressed except through thee, on thee shall be based all calculations and operations of the world, and unity shall not be expressed save by the letter Aleph."

[1411] **Rashi on Shabbat 104a:5:7**: ""A faithful person who is bent": A worthy person must be bent and humble, and in the end will become straight and upright in the World to Come."

[1412] **Pirkei DeRabbi Eliezer 48:17**: "Rabbi Eliezer said: The five letters of the Torah, which alone of all the letters in the Torah are of double (shape), all appertain to the mystery of the Redemption. With "Khaph" "Khaph" our father Abraham was redeemed from Ur of the Chaldees, as it is said, (Lekh Lekha) "Get thee out of thy country, and from thy kindred…

Eliezer (chapter 48) explains that the doubled letters signify the redemption of the Patriarchs and Israel. וּבְמִדְרָשׁ[1413] (רַבָּה וְתַנְחוּמָא קֹרַח) חָשְׁבוּ אוֹתִיּוֹת הַכְּפוּלוֹת בִּשְׁנֵי עוֹלָמִים. **— The Midrash—Rabbah and Tanchuma, Korach—interprets the doubled letters in relation to two worlds.** וְהִנֵּה רַשִׁ"י פֵּרֵשׁ מַאֲמָר פָּתוּחַ יֵשׁ דְּבָרִים שֶׁרְשׁוּת לְדָרְשָׁן, וְיֵשׁ וּמַאֲמָר סָתוּם:[1414] **— Rashi explains "an open utterance and a closed utterance":** שֶׁאֵתָּה מְצֻוֶּה לְסָתְמָן, כְּגוֹן מַעֲשֶׂה מֶרְכָּבָה. **— Some matters may be expounded, while others must be concealed, such as the divine chariot.** וְעַל פֶּה פָּתוּחַ פֵּרֵשׁ: בִּשְׁעַת הַמְכַנְּסִים פַּזֵּר. **— He explains "an open mouth": when others gather in, spread forth.** פֶּה סָתוּם: בִּשְׁעַת הַמְפַזְּרִים כַּנֵּס. **— "A closed mouth": when others spread forth, gather in.** וּלְפִירוּשׁוֹ יֵשׁ לְהָבִין, דְּהָא הַפֵּא אֵינָהּ סְתוּמָה, רַק אֵינָהּ פְּתוּחָה כְּמוֹ הַפֵּא פְּשׁוּטָה. **— His explanation requires examination: the bent Peh is not closed; it is merely less open than the straight Peh.** וּפֵרֵשׁ פֶּה סָתוּם לִהְיוֹת כַּנֵּס וְסָתוּם לְגַמְרֵי. **— Yet he explains the closed mouth as gathering in and closing completely.** וְהַמֵּם סְתוּמָה לְגַמְרֵי סְתוּמָה, וְהוּא פֵּרֵשׁ מַאֲמָר סָתוּם עַל מַעֲשֶׂה מֶרְכָּבָה, **— The final Mem, however, is entirely closed, and he explains its closed utterance as the divine chariot.** וְזֶה נִיתָּן לִדְרוֹשׁ וְלִמְסוֹר רָאשֵׁי פְרָקִים לְאַב בֵּית דִּין וּלְמִי שֶׁלִּבּוֹ דּוֹאֵג בְּקִרְבּוֹ, כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב (חַגִּיגָה יג).[1415] **— This may be expounded by transmitting chapter headings to the court's head or one whose heart is anxious within him (Chagigah 13).** וְזֶה מַה שֶּׁאָמְרוּ בַּמִּשְׁנָה (שָׁם יא עַמּוּד ב):[1416] אֶלָּא אִם כֵּן הָיָה חָכָם וּמֵבִין מִדַּעְתּוֹ, **— Thus the Mishnah says (there, 11b): only if he is wise and understands independently,** דְּהַיְינוּ שֶׁיַּסְפִּיק לוֹ רָאשֵׁי פְרָקִים וְיָבִין מִדַּעְתּוֹ. **— meaning that chapter headings suffice for him to understand on his own.**

The Closed Mouth Opens in the World to Come

וְעַל פִּי מַה שֶּׁכָּתוּב בַּמִּדְרָשׁ שֶׁהַכְּפוּלוֹת מוֹרוֹת לָעוֹלָם הַבָּא, **— Following the Midrash's teaching that doubled letters signify the World to Come,** יִתָּכֵן לְפָרֵשׁ פֶּה פָּתוּחַ וּפֶה סָתוּם עַל דֶּרֶךְ מַה שֶּׁפֵּרֵשׁ רַשִׁ"י עַל מַאֲמָר פָּתוּחַ, מַאֲמָר סָתוּם. **— we may explain the open and closed mouth along the lines of Rashi's explanation of the open and closed**

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unto the land that I will shew thee" (Gen. 12:1). With "Mem" "Mem" our father Isaac was redeemed from the land of the Philistines, as it is said, "Go from us: for thou art much mightier (Memennu M'ôd) than we" (Gen. 26:16). With "Nun" "Nun" our father Jacob was redeemed from the hand of Esau, as it is said, "Deliver me, I pray thee, (Hazilêne na) from the hand of my brother, from the hand of Esau" (Gen. 32:11). With "Pê" "Pê" Israel was redeemed from Egypt, as it is said, "I have surely visited you, (Paḳôd Paḳadti) and (seen) that which is done to you in Egypt, and I have said, I will bring you up out of the affliction of Egypt" (Ex. 3:16, 17). With "Zaddi" "Zaddi" the Holy One, blessed be He, in the future will redeem Israel from the oppression of the kingdoms, and He will say to them, I have caused a branch to spring forth for you, as it is said, "Behold, the man whose name is (Zemach) the Branch; and he shall grow up (yizmach) || out of his place, and he shall build the temple of the Lord" (Zech. 6:12). These letters were delivered only to our father Abraham. Our father Abraham delivered them to Isaac, and Isaac (delivered them) to Jacob, and Jacob delivered the mystery of the Redemption to Joseph, as it is said, "But God will surely visit (Paḳôd yiphḳôd) you" (Gen. 50. 24). Joseph his son delivered the secret of the Redemption to his brethren. Asher, the son of Jacob, delivered the mystery of the Redemption to Serach his daughter. When Moses and Aaron came to the elders of Israel and performed the signs in their sight, the elders of Israel went to Serach, the daughter of Asher, and they said to her: A certain man has come, and he has performed signs in our sight, thus and thus. She said to them: There is no reality in the signs. They said to her: He said "Paḳôd yiphḳôd"—"God will surely visit you" (ibid.). She said to them: He is the man who will redeem Israel in the future from Egypt, for thus did I hear, ("Paḳôd Paḳadti") "I have surely visited you" (Ex. 3:16). Forthwith the people believed in their God and in His messenger, as it is said, "And the people believed, and when they heard that the Lord had visited the children of Israel" (Ex. 4:31)."

[1413] **Bamidbar Rabbah 18:21**: "Mem, nun, tzadi, peh, and kaf are doubled letters; the seers stated them. Kaf and final kaf were alluded to concerning Abraham: 'Go for yourself' (Genesis 12:1)—he would beget a son at one hundred years of age. Mem and final mem concern Isaac: 'For you have become much mightier than we' (Genesis 26:16), alluding to him and his descendants being mighty in both worlds. Nun and final nun concern Jacob: 'Rescue me, please' (Genesis 32:12) —He rescues in both worlds. Peh and final peh concern Israel and Moshe: 'I have surely remembered you' (Exodus 3:16). Tzadi and final tzadi: 'Behold, a man whose name is Tzemach,' and so forth (Zechariah 6:12)—this is Messiah. It also says, 'I will raise for David a righteous shoot; a king will reign and act wisely, and perform justice and righteousness in the land' (Jeremiah 23:5)."

[1414] **Rashi on Shabbat 104a:5:6**: ""An open utterance and a closed utterance": There are matters that one has been given permission to expound, and there are matters one is commanded to keep concealed, such as the Account of the Divine Chariot."

[1415] **Chagigah 13a**: "'Nor does one expound the Chariot to an individual.' Rabbi Chiyya taught: But one may transmit the chapter headings to him. Rabbi Zeira said: The chapter headings are transmitted only to the head of the court and to anyone whose heart is anxious within him. Some say: to the head of the court, provided that his heart is anxious within him."

[1416] **Chagigah 11b:10**: "§ The Gemara continues to clarify the mishna, which reads: One may not expound the topic of forbidden sexual relations before three individuals. What is the reason for this? If we say it is because it is written: "None of you ish, ish shall approach any near of kin to uncover their nakedness" (Leviticus 18:6). Ish, ish, literally means: Man, man. It is understood as an allusion to the number of students permitted to study the topic. This is as it is explained immediately: "Man, man" equals two; "any near of kin to him" is one; and the Merciful One states: "You shall not approach to uncover their nakedness," which indicates that one may not expound the halakhot of forbidden sexual relations in the presence of three individuals."

utterance. וְהַיְינוּ פֶּה פָּתוּחַ עַל דִּבְרֵי תוֹרָה הַנִּגְלִיִּים, **— The open mouth concerns the revealed words of Torah.** וּפֶה סָתוּם בְּסִתְרֵי תוֹרָה, שֶׁכָּפוּף וְסָתוּם, שֶׁלֹּא נִיתַּן רְשׁוּת לְדָרְשָׁן וְאַתָּה צָרִיךְ לְסָתְמָן. **— The closed mouth concerns Torah's secrets: bent and closed, they may not be expounded and must be concealed.** רַק פָּתוּחַ קְצָת לְמְסוֹר לְחָכָם וּמֵבִין מִדַּעְתּוֹ רָאשֵׁי פְּרָקִים, וְהוּא יָבִין מִדַּעְתּוֹ. **— It is only slightly open, to transmit headings to someone wise and capable of independent understanding, who will understand on his own.** וּפֶה פָּתוּחַ לָעוֹלָם הַבָּא, שֶׁאָז יִתְגַּלּוּ כָּל הַסִּתְרֵי תוֹרָה. **— The open mouth also refers to the World to Come, when all Torah's secrets will be revealed.** וְהַיְינוּ שֶׁלָּעוֹלָם הַבָּא יִהְיֶה הַפֶּה סָתוּם גַּם כֵּן פֶּה פָּתוּחַ. **— Then the closed mouth too will become an open mouth.**

The Concealed First Utterance

וּמַאֲמָר פָּתוּחַ, מַאֲמָר סָתוּם, יִתְפָּרֵשׁ עַל פִּי מַה שֶּׁכָּתוּב מוֹרֵנוּ הָרַב רַבִּי שְׁמוּאֵל אֱלִיעֶזֶר בְּחִדּוּשֵׁי אַגָּדוֹת:[1417] **— The open and closed utterance may be explained according to Maharsha's Chiddushei Aggadot:** מַאֲמָר סָתוּם מַאֲמָר רִאשׁוֹן, דִּבְרַאשִׁית נַמִּי מַאֲמָר הוּא; מַאֲמָר פָּתוּחַ הַתִּשְׁעָה מַאֲמָרוֹת, עַיֵּן שָׁם. **— The closed utterance is the first utterance, for "In the beginning" is also an utterance; the open utterance is the other nine. See there.** וּלְפִי הָאָמוּר יִתְפָּרֵשׁ בָּעוֹלָם הַזֶּה מַאֲמָר פָּתוּחַ הַתִּשְׁעָה מַאֲמָרוֹת. **— Accordingly, in this world the open utterance refers to the nine utterances.** אַף דְּנַמִּי מַאֲמָר הוּא (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב רֹאשׁ הַשָּׁנָה לב עמוד א), מִכָּל מָקוֹם לֹא כְתִיב בֵּיהּ וַיֹּאמֶר,[1418] **— Although "In the beginning" too is an utterance (Rosh Hashanah 32a), it does not explicitly say "He said,"** שֶׁהוּא שֵׂכֶל הַנֶּעְלָם מִכָּל רַעְיוֹן, וְאֵין בּוֹ שׁוּם תְּפִיסָה. **— for it is intellect concealed from every thought, beyond all grasp.** וּמַאֲמָר סָתוּם לָעוֹלָם הַבָּא, שֶׁאָז יִהְיֶה בֵּן גַּם כֵּן בַּיּוֹם הַהוּא, **— The closed utterance refers to the World to Come, when this too will be manifest on "that day."** שֶׁהוּא שֶׁיָּאִיר כְּאוֹר יוֹם מִדַּת הוּא, שֶׁהִיא עַתִּיקָא, **— The attribute signified by "He," Atika, will shine like daylight,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב (זֹהַר חֵלֶק ג רצ עמוד א): עַתִּיקָא קַדִּישָׁא דְּאִתְכְּסְיָא אִקְרֵי הוּא.[1419] **— as written (Zohar III, 290a): "The concealed holy Ancient One is called 'He.'"** וְעַל כֵּן נִקְרָא עוֹלָם הַבָּא יוֹם הַהוּא, שֶׁיָּאִיר מִדַּת הוּא, שֶׁכָּל הַנֶּעְלָם, עַד שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: וַיִּקְרָא אֱלֹהִים לָאוֹר יוֹם.[1420] **— The World to Come is therefore called "that day": the attribute "He," the concealed intellect, will shine, as in "God called the light day."** וְזֶה מֵם סְתוּמָה, מַאֲמָר סָתוּם לָעוֹלָם הַבָּא, שֶׁאָז יִהְיֶה מַאֲמָר וְיִתְגַּלֶּה הַסָּתוּם. **— This is the closed Mem: the closed utterance for the World to Come, when it will become an utterance and the concealed will be revealed.**

[1417] **Chidushei Agadot on Shabbat 104a:8**: ""Why does the face of the dalet turn away from the gimel? So that he may give to him discreetly," and so forth. This follows what is said in the first chapter of Bava Batra: "Charity saves from death"—which charity saves from an unusual death? He receives it without knowing from whom he receives it, so that he will not be ashamed before him. It says, "Heh and vav: this is the Name of the Holy One, blessed be He." These are two letters of the four-letter Name, alluding to the two attributes of kindness and truth, which are the world's two pillars: Torah and acts of kindness. It says, "Zayin, ẖet, tet, yod, kaf, lamed." As stated at the end of the first chapter of Bava Kamma, whoever engages in Torah and acts of kindness merits the inheritance of two tribes, and so forth. As explained there, he merits a canopy, meaning favor and a palanquin, like Joseph, and he merits Torah like Issachar. Thus it says: If you do this with the two pillars of the world mentioned above—Torah and acts of kindness—I will sustain you and grant you favor like Joseph, who merited to sustain and provide for others as well. I will do good to you on account of Torah and give you the inheritance of Torah as an inheritance, as it is said that it is a heritage; and I will bind a crown upon you in the World to Come, namely the crown of Torah. It says, "A closed mem," and so forth, "a closed utterance," and so forth. This follows the teaching that the world was created through ten utterances. At the end of the second chapter of Rosh Hashanah it asks: There were only nine! It answers that "In the beginning" is also an utterance. The intention is that the first utterance did not need to be mentioned explicitly, because creation was certainly by an utterance, being something from nothing, as explained there. The closed utterance is thus the first utterance, "In the beginning," and the open utterance comprises all the other nine utterances. It says, "A bent nun," and so forth, "a faithful person who is bent," and so forth. This follows what is said in the chapter When the Court Saw: One opinion holds that the shofar of Rosh Hashanah should be curved, for the more a person bends himself, the better. Rashi explains: bent toward the ground, as it is written, "My eyes and My heart shall be there," and so forth. Another opinion holds that the more a person straightens his mind, the better, as it is written, "Let us lift up our hearts to our hands." They disagree only there, where both are impossible; here, by contrast, both are possible, as is said in the chapter The Commandment of Ḥalitza concerning prayer: his eyes should be below and his heart above. Thus a bent faithful person has his eyes below, and a straight faithful person has his heart above. The bent righteous person and the straight righteous person are to be explained in the same way. It therefore asks: This is the same thing! It answers: It adds further bending to his bending, regarding his eyes being below, in the manner of their saying, "Be very, very humble in spirit," using a doubled expression. In the same way you may rely on the answer to add further straightening to his straightening, regarding his heart being above."

[1418] **Rosh Hashanah 32a:19**: "But the expression 'And He said' occurs only nine times in the account of Creation! 'In the beginning' is also an utterance, as it is written, 'By the word of the Lord the heavens were made.'"

[1419] **Zohar, Idra Zuta 17:71**: 'Zohar, Idra Zuta (III:290a): "The concealed Holy Ancient One (Atika Kadisha, Keter) is called 'Hu' (He, hidden beyond perception), whereas Malchut when revealed is called 'Ani' (I)."'

[1420] **Genesis 1:5**: 'God called the light Day—and called the darkness Night. And there was evening and there was morning, a first day.'

Kaf: Abraham, Faith, and the Supernal Crown

וְכֵן כַּף פְּשׁוּטָה וְכַף כְּפוּפָה, יֵשׁ לוֹמַר דְּהִנֵּה אוֹת כַּף מוֹרֶה עַל כֶּתֶר, כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בְּגִמָּרָא שָׁם,[1421] **— Regarding straight and bent Kaf: Kaf signifies Keter, as stated in the Gemara there,** וּבְרַעְיָא מְהֵימְנָא (זֹהַר חֵלֶק ג רנו עַמּוּד ב): אָנֹכִי, בֵּיהּ כַּף כָּתֵר וּבֵיהּ אַיִן.[1422] **— and in Ra'aya Mehemna (Zohar III, 256b): "Anokhi contains Kaf—Keter—and within it is Ayin."** וְעַל כֵּן חָשְׁבוּ בְּפִרְקֵי דְּרַבִּי אֱלִיעֶזֶר וּמִדְרָשׁ כַּף בְּפוּף וְכַף פָּשׁוּט לְאַבְרָהָם,[1423] **— Therefore Pirkei DeRabbi Eliezer and the Midrash assign the two forms of Kaf to Abraham.** מְשׁוּם דְּבֵיהּ כְּתִיב: וְאַבְרָהָם זָקֵן,[1424] **— Of him it is written, "Abraham was old," meaning that he attained the attribute of Atika.** וְהַיְינוּ שֶׁזָּכָה לְמִדַּת עַתִּיקָא. וְהַיְינוּ שֶׁהוּא הָיָה הָרִאשׁוֹן שֶׁזָּכָה לְהִתְבָּרֵר בְּכָל הַמִּדּוֹת, **— He was the first to merit refinement in all the attributes,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר בָּא בַּיָּמִים, וּבַזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ בְּאִינּוּן יוֹמִין עִלָּאִין וְכוּ', וְהַיְינוּ עַד כֶּתֶר עֶלְיוֹן. **— as it says, "advanced in days," and in the holy Zohar, "in those supernal days," etc.—reaching the supernal Keter.** אַךְ הוּא זָכָה לָזֶה רַק עַל יְדֵי אֱמוּנָה, שֶׁהִשִּׂיג עַל יְדֵי מִדַּת מַלְכוּת שֶׁיֵּשׁ שֵׁכֶל הַנֶּעְלָם מִכָּל רַעְיוֹן. **— He attained this only through faith: through Malchut, he recognized an intellect concealed from all thought.** וְזֶהוּ שֶׁאָמַר (שְׁמוֹת רַבָּה פָּרָשָׁה כג) עַל פָּסוּק תָּשׁוּרִי מֵרֹאשׁ אֲמָנָה: בִּשְׁבִיל הָאֲמָנָה שֶׁהֶאֱמִין אַבְרָהָם וְכוּ'.[1425] **— Thus Shemot Rabbah (chapter 23) expounds "Look from the summit of Amanah": through the faith with which Abraham believed, etc.** וְזֶהוּ מֵרֹאשׁ אֲמָנָה, שֶׁאַבְרָהָם אָבִינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם הִשִּׂיג עַל יְדֵי בְּחִינַת אֱמוּנָה מֵרֹאשׁ עַד כֶּתֶר עֶלְיוֹן, מֵרֹאשׁ דַּיְיקָא. **— This is "from the summit of faith": Abraham attained through faith the very summit, the supernal Keter—specifically "from the summit."** וְזֶהוּ רָזָא דִּמְהֵימְנוּתָא שַׁבַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ, מְהֵימְנוּתָא שְׁלֵימָתָא, **— This is the Zohar's mystery of faith, complete faith.** וְזֶהוּ סוֹד כַּף, כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב אָנֹכִי, בֵּיהּ כַּף כָּתֵב וּבֵיהּ אַיִן, **— This is the mystery of Kaf, as it says: Anokhi contains Kaf—Keter—and within it is Ayin,** הַיְינוּ אֲנִי שֶׁהוּא מִדַּת מַלְכוּת (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב וְזֶה כֶּתֶר עֶלְיוֹן אִיהוּ כֶּתֶר מַלְכוּת. זֹהַר חֵלֶק ג רכג עַמּוּד א).[1426] **— that is, Ani, "I," which is Malchut (Zohar III, 223a).** וְזֶה כֶּתֶר עֶלְיוֹן שֶׁזָּכָה לִבְחִינַת עַתִּיקָא, שֶׁיֵּשׁ שֵׁכֶל הַנֶּעְלָם מִכָּל וְאַבְרָהָם זָקֵן, שֶׁזָּכָה לְמִדַּת עַתִּיקָא, שֶׁהִשִּׂיג עַל יְדֵי מִדַּת מַלְכוּת שֶׁיֵּשׁ שֵׁכֶל הַנֶּעְלָם מִכָּל רַעְיוֹן. **— The supernal Keter is thus the crown of Malchut. — This is "Abraham was old": he attained Atika, recognizing an intellect concealed from all**

[1421] **Shabbat 104a**: 'The Sages said to Rabbi Yehoshua ben Levi: Young students came today to the study hall and said things the likes of which were not said even in the days of Joshua bin Nun. These children who only knew the Hebrew alphabet interpreted the letters homiletically.Alef beit means learn elaf the wisdom bina of the Torah.Gimmel dalet means give to the poor gemol dalim. Why is the leg of the gimmel extended toward the dalet? Because it is the manner of one who bestows loving-kindness to pursue the poor. And why is the leg of the dalet extended toward the gimmel? It is so that a poor person will make himself available to him who wants to give him charity. And why does the dalet face away from the gimmel? It is to teach that one should give charity discreetly so that the poor person will not be embarrassed by him.'

[1422] **Zohar, Pinchas 123:841**: "The first commandment is called "Anokhi" from the side of Keter, which is ayin, "Nothingness," from our God. Anokhi contains kaf—Keter—and contains ayin."

[1423] **Pirkei DeRabbi Eliezer 48:17**: "Rabbi Eliezer said: The five letters of the Torah, which alone of all the letters in the Torah are of double (shape), all appertain to the mystery of the Redemption. With "Khaph" "Khaph" our father Abraham was redeemed from Ur of the Chaldees, as it is said, (Lekh Lekha) "Get thee out of thy country, and from thy kindred… unto the land that I will shew thee" (Gen. 12:1). With "Mem" "Mem" our father Isaac was redeemed from the land of the Philistines, as it is said, "Go from us: for thou art much mightier (Memennu M'ôd) than we" (Gen. 26:16). With "Nun" "Nun" our father Jacob was redeemed from the hand of Esau, as it is said, "Deliver me, I pray thee, (Hazilêne na) from the hand of my brother, from the hand of Esau" (Gen. 32:11). With "Pê" "Pê" Israel was redeemed from Egypt, as it is said, "I have surely visited you, (Paḳôd Paḳadti) and (seen) that which is done to you in Egypt, and I have said, I will bring you up out of the affliction of Egypt" (Ex. 3:16, 17). With "Zaddi" "Zaddi" the Holy One, blessed be He, in the future will redeem Israel from the oppression of the kingdoms, and He will say to them, I have caused a branch to spring forth for you, as it is said, "Behold, the man whose name is (Zemach) the Branch; and he shall grow up (yizmach) || out of his place, and he shall build the temple of the Lord" (Zech. 6:12). These letters were delivered only to our father Abraham. Our father Abraham delivered them to Isaac, and Isaac (delivered them) to Jacob, and Jacob delivered the mystery of the Redemption to Joseph, as it is said, "But God will surely visit (Paḳôd yiphḳôd) you" (Gen. 50. 24). Joseph his son delivered the secret of the Redemption to his brethren. Asher, the son of Jacob, delivered the mystery of the Redemption to Serach his daughter. When Moses and Aaron came to the elders of Israel and performed the signs in their sight, the elders of Israel went to Serach, the daughter of Asher, and they said to her: A certain man has come, and he has performed signs in our sight, thus and thus. She said to them: There is no reality in the signs. They said to her: He said "Paḳôd yiphḳôd"—"God will surely visit you" (ibid.). She said to them: He is the man who will redeem Israel in the future from Egypt, for thus did I hear, ("Paḳôd Paḳadti") "I have surely visited you" (Ex. 3:16). Forthwith the people believed in their God and in His messenger, as it is said, "And the people believed, and when they heard that the Lord had visited the children of Israel" (Ex. 4:31)."

[1424] **Genesis 24:1**: 'Abraham was now old, advanced in years, and GOD had blessed Abraham in all things.'

[1425] **Shemot Rabbah 23:11**: "All the songs that were sung in the world are in the feminine form, to say: Just as a female becomes pregnant, gives birth, and again gives birth, so it was, with all the troubles that befall them, they would recite songs in the feminine form. That is why Babylon, Media, Greece, and Edom arose and enslaved Israel. But in the future, there will be no more troubles, as it is stated: "For the earlier troubles will have been forgotten" (Isaiah 65:16), "They will attain gladness and joy" (Isaiah 35:10). At that moment they will recite song in the masculine form, as it is stated: "Sing to the Lord a new song shir" (Psalms 98:1)."

[1426] **Zohar, Pinchas 95:654**: 'Zohar, Pinchas (III:223a): Identifies 'Ani' ('I') with the attribute of Malchut (the Shechinah), through which Divine sovereignty is revealed in the lower worlds.'

thought. וְזֶה סוֹד מַה שֶּׁאָמְרוּ (בָּבָא מְצִיעָא פז עמוד א): עַד אַבְרָהָם לֹא הָיָה זְקֻנָה.[1427] — **This is the mystery of their teaching (Bava Metzia 87a): before Abraham, there was no old age.** כַּף פְּשׁוּטָה לָעוֹלָם הַבָּא, שֶׁאָז יִתְגַּלֶּה אוֹר זֶה, שֶׁעַל שֵׁם זֶה קָרָא יוֹם הַהוּא, שֶׁיָּאִיר בְּחִינַת הוּא כָּאָמוּר. — **The straight Kaf belongs to the World to Come, when this light will be revealed: "that day," when the aspect called "He" will shine, as explained.**

Mem: Isaac's Wealth in Torah

מֵם לְיִצְחָק: כִּי עָצַמְתָּ מִמֶּנּוּ מְאֹד.[1428] — **Mem is assigned to Isaac: "For you have become much mightier than we."** וְהוּא עַל פִּי מַה שֶּׁפָּתוּב בְּתִקּוּנֵי זֹהַר (בַּהַקְדָּמָה, דִּבּוּר הַמַּתְחִיל פִּקּוּדָא רְבִיעָאָה):[1429] — **This follows Tikkunei Zohar's introduction, in the passage beginning "The fourth commandment":** וְכַד אִתְנְטִילַת מִגְּבוּרָה אִתְקְרִיאַת תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה, דְּהָכִי אוֹקְמוּהוּ מָארֵי מַתְנִיתִין: תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה מִפִּי הַגְּבוּרָה נִיתְּנָה וְכוּלֵי. — **"When taken from Gevurah it is called Oral Torah, as the masters of the Mishnah explained: the Oral Torah was given from the mouth of Gevurah," etc.** וְכָל כָּךְ (בְּתִיקּוּן כא): וּמִשְּׁמָאלָא אִתְיְהִיבַת תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה (וְנִתְבָּאֵר בְּמָקוֹם אַחֵר).[1430] — **It likewise says in Tikkun 21: "The Oral Torah was given from the left side," as explained elsewhere.** וְהוּא מֵאוֹר הָרִאשׁוֹן שֶׁנִּגְנַז לַעֲמֵלֵי תוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה, כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב (מִדְרַשׁ תַּנְחוּמָא נֹחַ ג).[1431] — **It comes from the primordial light hidden for those who labor in the Oral Torah, as stated in Midrash Tanchuma (Noach 3).** וְהַיְינוּ מִכֶּתֶר עֶלְיוֹן, שֶׁמּוֹפִיעַ מִתַּגּוֹ שֶׁל יוּד לְחָכְמָה וּבִינָה. — **It comes from the supernal Keter, shining from the Yud's crown into Chokhmah and Binah.** וְלָעוֹלָם הַבָּא יִתְגַּלֶּה כָּל הַסּוֹדוֹת וְסִתְרֵי תוֹרָה, וְיִהְיֶה תְּפִיסָה גַּם בַּמַּאֲמָר סָתוּם, וְכָאָמוּר. — **In the World to Come all Torah's secrets will be revealed, and even the closed utterance will become accessible, as explained.** וְזֶה שֶׁנִּרְמַז בַּפָּסוּק כִּי עָצַמְתָּ מִמֶּנּוּ מְאֹד, שְׁנֵי הַמֵּמִין. — **This is alluded to by the two Mems in "For you have become much mightier than we."** דְּקָאֵי עַל עָשְׁרוֹ שֶׁל יִצְחָק, וְאַף שֶׁבֶּאֱמֶת הָיָה עָשִׁיר וּכְמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בַּמִּדְרָשׁ רַבָּה גַּם כִּפְשׁוּטוֹ, — **It refers to Isaac's wealth. He was indeed wealthy in the literal sense,** עַל זֶה, שֶׁהָיוּ אוֹמְרִים: זֶבֶל פִּרְדּוֹתָיו שֶׁל יִצְחָק וְכוּלֵי.[1432] — **as Midrash Rabbah relates that people would say: "The manure of Isaac's mules," etc.** מִכָּל מָקוֹם עִיקַּר עֲשִׁירוּת שֶׁל יִצְחָק אָבִינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם הָיָה בַּעֲשִׁירוּת דְּתוֹרָה, כְּעֵין שֶׁנִּדְרַשׁ (תְּמוּרָה טז עמוד א): עָשִׁיר וְרָשׁ נִפְגָּשׁוּ, מִי שֶׁעָשָׂאוֹ חָכָם וְכוּלֵי.[1433] — **His principal wealth, however, was wealth in Torah, as expounded (Temurah 16a): "Rich and poor meet"—the One who made this person wise, etc.** וְזֶהוּ שְׁנֵי הַמֵּמִין: מַאֲמָר פָּתוּחַ, מַאֲמָר סָתוּם. — **These are the two Mems: the open utterance and the closed utterance.**

Nun: Jacob and the Building of Israel

נוּן כְּפוּפָה וְנוּן פְּשׁוּטָה לְיַעֲקֹב, שֶׁנִּיצַּל בִּשְׁנֵי עוֹלָמִים, שֶׁבְּיַעֲקֹב אָבִינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם הִתְחִיל כְּבָר שְׁלֵימוּת בִּנְיַן כְּנֶסֶת יִשְׂרָאֵל. — **Bent and straight Nun are assigned to Jacob, who was saved in both worlds: with him, the complete**

[1427] **Bava Metzia 87a:14**: "Until Avraham there was no visible old age. Someone wishing to speak with Avraham would speak with Yitzchak, and someone wishing to speak with Yitzchak would speak with Avraham. Avraham came and prayed for mercy, and visible old age came into being, as it says, 'Avraham was old, advanced in days.'"

[1428] **Genesis 26:16**: "Avimelech said to Yitzchak: 'Go away from us, for you have become much mightier than we are.'"

[1429] **Tikkunei Zohar 11b:6**: "When she is taken from Chesed, she is called the Written Torah, given from the right, as it is written, 'From His right hand, a fiery law for them.' When she is taken from Gevurah, she is called the Oral Torah, for thus the masters of the Mishnah established: 'The Oral Torah was given from the mouth of Gevurah.' From there come the mighty who stand in the breach. Only one who is mighty in the battle of Torah, mighty over his inclination, can stand within her."

[1430] **Tikkunei Zohar 50a:4**: 'Tikkunei Zohar (Tikkun 21, 50a): "The Oral Torah was given from the Left Side (Gevurah)," teaching that halakhic refinement and mastery over desire require the sacred awe and discipline of Gevurah.'

[1431] **Midrash Tanchuma, Noach 3:4**: "The Israelites did not accept the Torah until the Holy One, blessed be He, arched the mountain over them like a vessel, as it is said: And they stood beneath the mountain (Exod. 19:17). R. Dimi the son of Hama stated that the Holy One, blessed be He, told Israel: If you accept the Torah, well and good; but if not, your grave will be there. If you should say that He arched the mountain over them because of the Written Law, isn't it true that as soon as He said to them, "Will you accept the Torah?" they all responded, "We will do and hear," because the Written Law was brief and required no striving and suffering, but rather He threatened them because of the Oral Law. After all, it contains the detailed explanations of the commandments, both simple and difficult, and it is as severe as death, and as jealous as Sheol. One does not study the Oral Law unless he loves the Holy One, blessed be He, with all his heart, with all his soul, and with all his might, as it is said: And thou shalt love the Lord thy God with all thy heart, with all thy soul, and with all thy might (Deut. 6:5)."

[1432] **Bereshit Rabbah 64:7** (excerpt): "'The man became great, and grew continually greater' (Genesis 26:13). Rabbi Chanin said: Until people would say, 'Better the manure of Isaac's mules than Abimelech's silver and gold.'"

[1433] **Temurah 16a**: "Similarly, it says: 'The poor person and the man of intrigues meet; Hashem gives light to the eyes of both.' When a student goes to his teacher and says, 'Teach me Torah,' if he teaches him, 'Hashem gives light to the eyes of both.' If not: 'The rich and the poor meet; Hashem makes them all.' He who made this one wise makes him foolish, and the one whom He made foolish He makes wise. This is Rabbi Natan's teaching."

[1434] **Bamidbar Rabbah 18:21** (excerpt): "Nun and final nun concern Jacob: 'Rescue me, please' (Genesis 32:12)—He rescues in both worlds."

building of Knesset Yisrael had already begun. וְזֶהוּ נֶאֱמָן בָּפוּף, כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב אִיהִי אֱמוּנָה, וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמַרְנוּ. **— This is the bent faithful person: "It is faith," as we explained.** נֶאֱמָן פָּשׁוּט לָעוֹלָם הַבָּא, שֶׁאָז יִזְכּוּ לְכָל הַדִּבְרֵי תוֹרָה שֶׁנִּתְּנָה בָּעוֹלָם הַזֶּה בִּמְנוּד רֹאשׁ. **— The straight faithful person belongs to the World to Come, when they will attain all the Torah given in this world with a bowed head.** וְאָז יִזְכּוּ מִצַּד הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ לְכָל הַסּוֹדוֹת. **— Then Hashem will grant them all the secrets.** וְנִרְמְזוּ שְׁנֵי הַנּוּנִין בַּפָּסוּק הַצִּילֵנִי נָא, דְּשָׁם כְּתִיב פֶּן יָבוֹא וְהִכַּנִי אֵם עַל בָּנִים.[1435] **— The two Nuns are alluded to in "Save me, please," where it says, "Lest he come and strike me, mother together with children."** וְהָיְינוּ שֶׁלֹּא דָאַג עַל עַצְמוֹ, רַק עִיקַּר דַּאֲגָתוֹ עַל הָאִמָּהוֹת וְהַשְּׁבָטִים, שֶׁהֵם כְּנֶסֶת יִשְׂרָאֵל, שֶׁהַשֵּׁם שׁוֹכֵן בְּלִבָּם. **— He was not worried about himself; his principal concern was for the mothers and tribes, Knesset Yisrael, in whose hearts Hashem dwells.** וְזֶהוּ נֶאֱמָן כָּפוּף, נֶאֱמָן פָּשׁוּט לָעוֹלָם הַבָּא. **— This is the bent faithful person and the faithful person made upright in the World to Come.**

Peh: Moses and the Light of Redemption

פֵּא כְּפוּפָה וּפֵא פְּשׁוּטָה לְיִשְׂרָאֵל, לְמֹשֶׁה: פָּקֹד פָּקַדְתִּי (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בַּמִּדְרָשׁ רַבָּה שָׁם).[1436] **— Bent and straight Peh are assigned to Israel, to Moses: "I have surely remembered you," as stated in Midrash Rabbah there.**

How the promise of redemption is recognized

מַה הוּא כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמַרְנוּ לְעִנְיַן קוּשְׁיַת רַבֵּנוּ מֹשֶׁה בֶּן נַחְמָן:[1437, 1438] **— This follows our explanation of Ramban's question:** סִימָן מָסַר יוֹסֵף, שֶׁגּוֹאֵל שֶׁיֹּאמַר פְּקֹידָה יִפָּקֵד גּוֹאֵל אֱמֶת הוּא? וְהָא אֶפְשָׁר שֶׁגַּם מֹשֶׁה שָׁמַע הַמָּסוֹרֶת וְאָמַרְנוּ שֶׁהַסִּימָן הָיָה מִי שֶׁיַּכְנִיס אוֹר זֶה שֶׁל כְּמוֹתָם. **— What sign did Joseph transmit—that a redeemer who says the doubled expression of remembrance is the true redeemer? — Moses too could have heard the tradition, just as they had.** שֶׁיַּרְגִּישׁוּ בְּלִבָּם אוֹר מִפְּקִידָה, זֶהוּ הַגּוֹאֵל אֱמִיתִּי (וְנִתְבָּאֵר פָּרָשַׁת שְׁמוֹת מַאֲמָר ו, עַיֵּן שָׁם). **— We explained that the sign was someone who would implant the light of this remembrance in their hearts, so they felt its light within: he is the true redeemer (as explained in Shemot, teaching 6; see there).** וְזֶהוּ הַגְּאוּלָּה הָרִאשׁוֹנָה בְּמִצְרַיִם, שֶׁעַל יְדֵי מֹשֶׁה רַבֵּינוּ הִכְנִיס הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ בְּלִבָּם הַפְּקִידָה. **— This was the first redemption in Egypt: through Moses our teacher, Hashem implanted remembrance in their hearts.** שֶׁבְּגָלוּת מִצְרַיִם הָיָה הַדִּיבּוּר בְּגָלוּת, כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ (חֵלֶק ב כה עַמּוּד ב), וְדִבּוּר שְׁכִינְתָּא תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה.[1439] **— In Egypt speech was in exile, as the holy Zohar says (II, 25b); speech is the Shechinah, the Oral Torah.** וּבְמִצְרַיִם הָיָה כָּל הַדִּבְרֵי תוֹרָה בְּגָלוּת. **— In Egypt all the words of Torah were in exile.** וּמֹשֶׁה אִישׁ הָאֱלֹהִים בַּעֲלָהּ דְּמַטְרוֹנִיתָא, אָמַר לֹא אִישׁ דְּבָרִים אָנֹכִי (וְנִתְבָּאֵר וָאֵרָא מַאֲמָר ז).[1440] **— Moses, the man of God, is the Matron's husband. — When speech was in exile, he therefore said, "I am not a man of words" (as explained in Va'era, teaching 7).** וְעַל כֵּן כְּשֶׁהָיָה בְּחִינַת דִּיבּוּר בְּגָלוּת, אָמַר לֹא אִישׁ דְּבָרִים אָנֹכִי (וְנִתְבָּאֵר וָאֵרָא מַאֲמָר ז). וְעַל יְדֵי מֹשֶׁה הִכְנִיס הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ בְּלֵב יִשְׂרָאֵל הַפְּקִידָה וְהַחֵשֶׁק לְדִבְרֵי תוֹרָה, **— Through Moses,**

[1435] **Genesis 32:12**: "Rescue me, please, from my brother's hand, from Esau's hand, for I fear him, lest he come and strike me down, mother together with children."

[1436] **Bamidbar Rabbah 18:21** (excerpt): "Peh and final peh concern Israel and Moshe: 'I have surely remembered you' (Exodus 3:16)."

[1437] **Ramban on Exodus 3:18:1**: "In Shemot Rabbah (3:8): "Immediately, they will listen to your voice." Why? Because they possess a tradition of redemption: any redeemer who comes and says the doubled expression of remembrance is a true redeemer. This is the wording of that aggadah. You may ask: How do they know to believe him? Perhaps Moses heard this tradition just as they did. One may answer that this is what they received from Joseph, who heard it from his father the prophet: the first person who comes and speaks to them in this wording will be the one to redeem them. It was revealed and known before the Holy One, blessed be He, that no one would come and deceive them; with this He assured them."

[1438] **Peri Tzadik, Shemot 6:1**: "But in truth, the Holy One's taking notice of and remembering Israel also follows "As you are with Me," as it says, "As water reflects face to face," and so forth. They said this also concerning the Holy One, blessed be He, as in the Sifrei to Deuteronomy on "Because Hashem hates us": what is in your heart toward your friend, and so forth; see there. When His divinity arises in our remembrance, He too will remember us. The redeemer, the messenger of "I have sent you," will shine this light into their hearts even in their deep immersion and Egypt's darkness. This is the sign of the true redeemer: that he can bring this into their hearts. Although "As you are with Me" requires the beginning to be an awakening from below, when the time arrives He also awakens them to that awakening. Moses asked, "What is His name?"—what grasp could they have in their great immersion, without an awakening on their part? To this He said, "That I will be": even as regards your being with Me, I will be there too, to make you be with Me."
This is the earlier teaching Pri Tzadik explicitly directs the reader to. Its added step is that divine help initiates even the apparently human awakening needed for redemption. The doubled wording therefore expresses an inward event and its divine source, rather than a password that an impostor could repeat.

[1439] **Zohar, Vaera 7:67-69**: 'Zohar, Vaera (II:25b): "In Egypt, speech (dibur) was in exile"—for speech is the Shechinah and the Oral Torah, which was redeemed when Israel exited Egypt and received the Torah.'

[1440] **Peri Tzadik, Vaera 7:1**: "In truth, there is a difference: at first he said, 'I am not a man of words.' Moses our teacher is called 'the man of God,' the husband of the Matron, as stated in the holy Zohar (22b): 'Master of the house—the man of God.' This is 'a man of words,' in accordance with the holy Zohar (I, 32a): 'This speech is called Shabbat, for Shabbat is called speech.' Concerning this he said, 'I am not a man of words,' because speech was in exile."

Hashem implanted remembrance and desire for Torah in Israel's heart. וְזֶה פָּקוֹד פָּקַדְתִּי, שֶׁאַחַר כָּךְ בָּא הַסִּיּוּעָתָא מֵהַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ. — **This is the doubled "I have surely remembered": divine assistance then follows.** אַךְ בָּעוֹלָם הַזֶּה פֶּה סָתוּם, וְלָעוֹלָם הַבָּא שֶׁיִּתְגַּלּוּ כָּל סוֹדוֹת הַתּוֹרָה פֶּה פָּתוּחַ, וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמַרְנוּ. — **In this world the mouth is closed; in the World to Come, when all Torah's secrets are revealed, it is open, as explained.**

Tzadi: The Messiah and the Growth of Righteousness

צָדִי כְּפוּפָה וְצָדִי פְּשׁוּטָה: אִישׁ צֶמַח שְׁמוֹ וְגוֹמֵר, זֶה מָשִׁיחַ. וְכֵן הוּא אוֹמֵר: וַהֲקִימוֹתִי לְדָוִד צֶמַח צַדִּיק וְגוֹמֵר.[1441] — **Bent and straight Tzadi: "A man whose name is Tzemach," etc.—this is the Messiah. It likewise says, "I will raise for David a righteous shoot," etc.** וְהֵינוּ שֶׁמָּשִׁיחַ יָבִיא הַצְּמִיחָה בְּלֵב יִשְׂרָאֵל מֵאוֹת צַדִּיק, — **The Messiah will bring growth into Israel's heart from the letter Tzadi.** שֶׁיִּעָקְרוּ יִהְיֶה לָעוֹלָם הַבָּא, צַדִּיק פָּשׁוּט, שֶׁיְּבוּטַל הָרַע לְגַמְרֵי. — **Its principal fulfillment will be in the World to Come: the straight righteous person, with evil wholly abolished.** וְזֶה סֵדֶר הֶחֳדָשִׁים, שֶׁהַגְּאוּלָּה בְּנִיסָן עֲתִידִין לְהִגָּאֵל (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב רֹאשׁ הַשָּׁנָה יא עַמּוּד א).[1442] — **This is the months' order: redemption—"In Nisan they are destined to be redeemed" (Rosh Hashanah 11a).** וְנִבְרָא שְׁבָט בְּאוֹת צָדִי, שֶׁהוּא הַתְחָלַת הַצְּמִיחָה, וְהוּא כְּנֶגֶד יוֹסֵף, שֶׁהוּא מֶרְכָּבָה לְמִדַּת צַדִּיק יְסוֹד עוֹלָם. — **Shevat was created with Tzadi, the beginning of growth, corresponding to Joseph, a chariot for the attribute of the righteous one, foundation of the world.** וְאַחַר כָּךְ חוֹדֶשׁ אָדָר בְּאוֹת קוֹף, קוֹף קָדוֹשׁ, כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בַּגְּמָרָא.[1443] — **Then comes Adar, with Kuf: "Kuf—holy," as taught in the Gemara.** וְהוּא נֶגֶד יַעֲקֹב אָבִינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם, שֶׁהוּא שׁוֹרֶשׁ הַקְּדוּשָׁה, וּכְמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: וְהִקְדִּישׁוּ אֶת קְדוֹשׁ יַעֲקֹב.[1444] — **This corresponds to Jacob, the root of holiness, as it is written, "They will sanctify the Holy One of Jacob."** וּבִרְכַּת אַתָּה קָדוֹשׁ נִתְקַן נֶגְדּוֹ כַּיָּדוּעַ. — **The blessing "You are holy" was instituted corresponding to him, as is known.** וְהֵינוּ לְתַקֵּן כְּמוֹ יַעֲקֹב, שֶׁהָיָה כְּאָדָם הָרִאשׁוֹן קוֹדֶם הַקִּלְקוּל, וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמַרְנוּ. — **This is restoration to Jacob's state, like Adam before the damage, as explained.** וּבְחוֹדֶשׁ זֶה מְחִיַּת עֲמָלֵק, שֶׁהוּא רֵאשִׁית דִּקְלִיפָּה. — **This month includes the erasure of Amalek, the beginning of the forces of impurity.** וְאַחַר כָּךְ חוֹדֶשׁ נִיסָן בְּאוֹת הֵא, וְהֵא עִלָּאָה עָלְמָא דְאָתֵי, שֶׁהוּא צַדִּיק פָּשׁוּט לָעוֹלָם הַבָּא. — **Then comes Nisan, with Hei: the upper Hei is the World to Come, the straight righteous person in that world.**

Repairing Eating at Its Root

וְאָמַר בְּסֵפֶר יְצִירָה: הִמְלִיךְ אוֹת צָדִי בִּלְעִיטָה, דְּתַחְלַת הֲסָתַת הַנָּחָשׁ הָיָה לְהַכְנִיס תַּאֲוָה בַּאֲכִילָה,[1445] — **Sefer Yetzirah says He made Tzadi reign over swallowing: the serpent's first enticement was to introduce desire into eating.** וּמִזֶּה נִסְתָּעֵף לְהַפְּגָם בִּבְחִינַת צַדִּיק (וּכְמוֹ שֶׁנִּתְבָּאֵר מֵאֲמָר א).[1446] — **From this arose damage in the aspect of the righteous one (as explained in teaching 1).** וְהָעֵסֶק בְּחוֹדֶשׁ זֶה לְתַקֵּן שׁוֹרֶשׁ הַפְּגָם, שֶׁהוּא בַּאֲכִילָה, — **This month's work is to repair the root of the damage, in eating.** וְזֶהוּ שֶׁאָמַר בִּלְעִיטָה. — **Thus it specifies swallowing.** וְהֵינוּ לְתַקֵּן שֶׁיִּהְיוּ כָּל עִנְיְנֵי הַגּוּף בִּקְדוּשָׁה, כְּמוֹ שֶׁהָיָה בִּתְחִלָּה אֲצֶל אָדָם הָרִאשׁוֹן, לְעָבְדָהּ וּלְשָׁמְרָהּ. — **The goal is that all**

[1441] **Zechariah 6:12**: 'And speak unto him, saying: Thus speaks the Lord of hosts, saying: Behold, a man whose name is Tzemach (Branch/Sprout), and he shall sprout forth out of his place, and he shall build the Temple of the Lord.'

[1442] **Rosh Hashanah 11a:2**: "Rabbi Yehoshua says: In Nisan the world was created; in Nisan the patriarchs were born; in Nisan the patriarchs died. On Pesach Yitzchak was born. On Rosh Hashanah Sarah, Rachel, and Channah were remembered and granted children. On Rosh Hashanah Yosef left prison. On Rosh Hashanah our ancestors' labor in Egypt ceased. In Nisan they were redeemed; in Nisan they are destined to be redeemed."

[1443] **Shabbat 104a**: 'The Sages said to Rabbi Yehoshua ben Levi: Young students came today to the study hall and said things the likes of which were not said even in the days of Joshua bin Nun. These children who only knew the Hebrew alphabet interpreted the letters homiletically.Alef beit means learn elaf the wisdom bina of the Torah.Gimmel dalet means give to the poor gemol dalim. Why is the leg of the gimmel extended toward the dalet? Because it is the manner of one who bestows loving-kindness to pursue the poor. And why is the leg of the dalet extended toward the gimmel? It is so that a poor person will make himself available to him who wants to give him charity. And why does the dalet face away from the gimmel? It is to teach that one should give charity discreetly so that the poor person will not be embarrassed by him.'

[1444] **Isaiah 29:23**: "For when he sees his children, the work of My hands, in his midst, they will sanctify My Name; they will sanctify the Holy One of Yaakov and stand in awe of the God of Israel."

[1445] **Sefer Yetzirah Gra Version 5:10**: 'He made the letter Tzadi king over swallowing/taste (le'itah), bound a crown to it, and combined one with another; and with them He formed Aquarius (Deli) in the universe, Shevat in the year, and the gizzard (kurkevan) in the soul, male and female.'

[1446] **Peri Tzadik, Rosh Chodesh Shvat 1:1**: "'He made the letter tzadi rule over swallowing': the serpent's first enticement concerned eating, to feel bodily pleasure in it. From this came the serpent's approaching Eve and imparting impurity to her, as stated in the Gemara (Shabbat 146a), and from this extended the hundred and thirty years, for Adam became one whose foreskin was drawn forward, as stated in Sanhedrin 38b. The work of this month is to introduce holiness into eating, as it is written, 'The righteous person eats to satisfy his soul.' This follows Rambam's words in chapter 3 of Hilkhot De'ot: if one eats in order to have strength to serve God and sleeps so that his mind will rest, his eating and sleeping are found to be service of the blessed Omnipresent."

bodily affairs become holy, as they originally were for Adam: "to work it and guard it." וְגַם אֶת הָעוֹלָם נָתַן בְּלִבָּם, שֶׁיִּהְיֶה כָּל עִנְיְנֵי הָעוֹלָם בִּקְדוּשָּׁה לְשֵׁם שָׁמַיִם, וְיִהְיֶה עֲבוֹדָה לַשָּׁמַיִם. — **"He placed the world in their heart": all worldly affairs should be holy, for Heaven's sake, and become divine service.**

From Tevet's Eyes to Shevat's Covenant

וְעַל כֵּן כָּתַב הָאֲרִי הַקָּדוֹשׁ זִכְרוֹנוֹ לִבְרָכָה, שֶׁשִּׁשָּׁה שָׁבוּעוֹת שׁוֹבָבִים מְסוּגָּלִים לְתִיקוּן פְּגַם הַבְּרִית, וְאַרְבָּעָה מֵהֶם בְּחוֹדֶשׁ זֶה. — **The holy Ari therefore writes that the six weeks of Shovavim are especially suited to repairing damage to the covenant; four of them fall in this month.** וְהַשְּׁנֵי שָׁבוּעוֹת שֶׁהֵם בְּחוֹדֶשׁ טֵבֵת, שֶׁאָז הַתְחָלַת הַתִּיקוּן, — **The two weeks in Tevet mark the repair's beginning,** שֶׁחוֹדֶשׁ טֵבֵת נִבְרָא בְּאוֹת עַיִן, וְאָז הַתְחָלַת הַתִּיקוּן בָּעֵינַיִם. — **for Tevet was created with Ayin, and then the repair of the eyes begins.** דְּאִיתָא בְּמִדְרָשׁ רַבָּה (נָשׂא פָּרָשָׁה י): תְּנָה בְנִי לִבְּךָ לִי וְעֵינֶיךָ וְגוֹמֵר,[1447] — **Midrash Rabbah (Naso, chapter 10) expounds "My son, give Me your heart, and your eyes," etc.:** מַה רָאָה הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא לְשְׁאוֹל מִיִּשְׂרָאֵל הַלֵּב וְהָעֵינַיִם? לְפִי שֶׁהָעֲבֵירָה תְּלוּיָה בָּהֶם וְכוּלֵי. — **Why did the Holy One, blessed be He, ask Israel for the heart and eyes? Because sin depends on them, etc.** עֵינָא וְלִיבָּא תְּרֵי סַרְסוּרֵי דַּחֲטָאָה אִינּוּן.[1448] — **The eye and heart are sin's two brokers.** וְכֵן הוּא בִּירוּשַׁלְמִי (פֶּרֶק א דִּבְרָכוֹת הֲלָכָה ה): — **The Jerusalem Talmud likewise teaches (Berakhot, chapter 1, halakhah 5):** אָמַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא: אִי יָהֲבַתְּ לִי לִבָּךְ וְעֵינָיִךְ, אֲנָא יָדַע דְּאַתְּ לִי. — **The Holy One, blessed be He, said: "If you give Me your heart and eyes, I know that you are Mine."** וְאַחַר כָּךְ חוֹדֶשׁ זֶה בְּאוֹת צַדִּיק, צַדִּיק כָּפוּף בָּעוֹלָם הַזֶּה, לִהְיוֹת גִּבּוֹר הַכּוֹבֵשׁ אֶת יִצְרוֹ, — **Then comes this month, with Tzadi: the bent righteous person in this world, mighty in mastering his inclination.** וְהוּא בְּחִינַת יוֹסֵף הַצַּדִּיק, וְהוּא יוּד דְּשֵׁמָא דִּבְרִית קַדִּישָׁא דְּרָכִיב עַל נוּן. — **This is Joseph the righteous, the Yud of the name of the holy covenant riding upon Nun.** יוֹסֵף נָהָר דְּנָגִיד וְנָפִיק לְאוֹת נוּן, שֶׁהוּא מְרַמֵּז לְמַדָּה אַחֲרוֹנָה. — **Joseph is the river flowing forth to Nun, which alludes to the final attribute.** וְזֶה כָּל עֵסֶק חוֹדֶשׁ זֶה, לְתַקֵּן כָּל עִנְיְנֵי הָעוֹלָם, שֶׁהוּא הַלֵּב כְּסִיל לְשְׂמֹאלוֹ. — **This is the month's entire work: repairing worldly affairs, the fool's heart to the left,** שֶׁיִּהְיֶה גַּם כֵּן בִּקְדוּשָּׁה, כְּמוֹ שֶׁהָיָה קוֹדֶם קִלְקוּל אָדָם הָרִאשׁוֹן. — **so that they too become holy, as before Adam's damage.**

Adar, Nisan, and Complete Holiness

וְאַחַר כָּךְ חוֹדֶשׁ אֲדָר בְּאוֹת קוֹף, קְדוּשַׁת יַעֲקֹב אָבִינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם, שֶׁהוּא הַבְּרִיחַ הַתִּיכוֹן מַבְרִיחַ וְגוֹמֵר.[1449] — **Then comes Adar, with Kuf, Jacob's holiness: "the middle bar passing through," etc.** וּבְחוֹדֶשׁ זֶה מְחֻיֶּית עֲמָלֵק, שֶׁהוּא מְנַגֵּד לִקְדוּשַׁת הַבְּרִית, שֶׁשּׁוֹנֵא דַּם מִילָה. — **This month includes erasing Amalek, who opposes the covenant's holiness and hates the blood of circumcision.** וְאִיתָא (מִדְרַשׁ תַּנְחוּמָא תֵּצֵא י) שֶׁהָיָה חוֹתֵךְ מִילוֹתֵיהֶן שֶׁל יִשְׂרָאֵל וְכוּלֵי. — **As related**

[1447] **Bamidbar Rabbah 10:2** (excerpt): "Another interpretation of 'My son, give Me your heart,' and so forth (Proverbs 23:26): Why did the Holy One, blessed be He, ask Israel for their heart and eyes, that they should follow Him? Because transgression depends upon them, as it is written, 'Do not wander after your hearts,' and so forth (Numbers 15:39). The eye and the heart are the two brokers of sin."

[1448] **Jerusalem Talmud Berakhot 1:5:3**: ""'You shall not commit adultery'—'You shall not stray after your heart and after your eyes.'" Rabbi Levi said: The heart and eye are the two brokers of sin. It is written: "My son, give Me your heart, and let your eyes observe My ways." The Holy One, blessed be He, said: "If you give Me your heart and your eye, I know that you are Mine.""

[1449] **Exodus 26:28**: 'The center bar halfway up the planks shall run from end to end.'

[1450] **Midrash Tanchuma, Ki Teitzei 10:1**: "(Deut. 25:18, cont.:) And he cut off (rt.: znb) all who were lagging behind you. He smote them with a blow to the tail (rt.: znb). And this agrees with what R. Hanina bar Shilqa, said, "What did the House of Amalek do to Israel? They cut off their penes and flung them heavenward, as they said, 'This is what You have chosen, take for Yourself what You have chosen." As Israel did not know what the nature of spit was, until Amalek came and taught them, as stated (with reference to Ezek. 8:17), "here they were sending the spit in their faces." From whom did he learn it? From his grandfather Esau, as stated (in Gen. 27:36), "And he said, 'Is he not (hky) rightly named Jacob?'" He rubbed (rt.: hkk) his throat and brought out the spit. (Deut. 25:18), "All who were lagging behind you." R. Judah, R. Nehemiah, and the masters differed. R. Judah said, "They said, 'If He is master over all of out deeds, we will serve Him; but if not, we will revolt against Him.'" R. Nehemiah said, "They said, 'If He furnishes us with our food like a king who is living in the province, such that the province lacks nothing at all, we will serve Him; but if not, we will revolt against Him.'" And the masters said, "They said, "'If we have a thought in our hearts and He knows what we are thinking, we will serve Him; but if not, we will revolt against Him.'" R. Berekhyah said in the name of R. Levi, "In their heart they had a thought, and the Holy One, blessed be He, granted them their request." And what is the evidence? (Ps. 78:18:) "They tested God in their heart by asking food for themselves." See what else is written there (in vs. 29), "So they ate and were very full." Another interpretation (of Deut. 25:18), "all who were lagging behind you": R. Judah, R. Nehemiah and the masters differ. R. Judah says, "Whoever was overcome was discarded." R. Nehemiah says, "Whomever the cloud vomited up was discarded." And the rabbis say, "It was the tribe of Dan that the cloud vomited up, as they all served idols, as stated (Deut. 25:18, cont.), 'when you were tired and weary, and did not fear God.'" You were tired from thirst and weary from the road, and you did not fear God. R. Pinhas said in the name of R. Samuel bar Nahman, "It is a transmitted aggada that Esau will fall at the hand of the children of Rachel (Joseph and Benjamin), as stated (in Jer. 49:20), 'Surely the youngest of the flock shall drag them away.' Why does it call them the youngest of the flock? Because they were the youngest of the tribes." Hence, Moses said to Joshua (Exod. 17:9), "Choose men for us."

in Midrash Tanchuma (Ki Teitzei 10), he would cut off the Israelites' circumcised members, etc. וְאַחַר כָּךְ חוֹדֶשׁ נִיסָן, שֶׁנִּבְרָא בְּאוֹת הֵא, שֶׁהִיא הֵא עִלָּאָה, שֶׁמּוֹרָה לְעָלְמָא דְאָתֵי. — **Then comes Nisan, created with Hei, the upper Hei, signifying the World to Come.** וְזֶהוּ יִצְמַח הַצְמִיחוֹת, יְשׁוּעָה מֵהַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ. — **Then the growth will sprout—salvation from Hashem, blessed be He.** וְאָז צַדִּיק פָּשׁוּט לָעוֹם הַבָּא, שֶׁלֹּא יִהְיֶה שׁוּם שְׁלִיטָה לְהַיֵּצֶר הָרָע וְיִהְיֶה הַכֹּל בְּקִדּוּשָׁה. — **Then comes the straight righteous person in the World to Come: the evil inclination will have no power, and everything will be holy.**

As he was descended from Joseph, about whom it is written (Gen. 42:18), "I fear God." And about Esau, it is written (Deut. 25:18), "and did not fear God." Youth is written with reference to the one and small is written with reference to the other (i.e., with reference to Esau). Youth is written with reference to the one (in Gen. 37:2), "since he (Joseph) was a youth with the children of Bilhah and with the children of Zilpah." And small is written with reference to the other (in Obad. 1:2), "I will surely make you (Edom) smallest among the nations." The one (Esau) grew up with two who were righteous (i.e., with Isaac and Rebekah) and did not learn from their deeds, while the other grew up with two who were wicked (i.e., Potiphar and Pharaoh) and did not learn from their deeds. The one received the birthright as a result of his good deeds, while the other lost his birthright from his evil deeds. The one supported his brothers, while the other sought to kill his brother. The one fenced himself away from sexual immorality and from the spilling of blood, while the other sullied himself with sexual immorality and the spilling of blood. The one conceded to the revival of the dead, as stated (Gen. 50:24), "God will surely remember you"; while the other denied the revival of the dead, as stated (Gen. 25:32), "Behold, I am going to die." The one offered his life for his mother's honor, as stated (Gen. 33:7), "and after, Joseph and Rachel came forward and bowed"; while the other sought to kill his mother, as stated (Amos 1:11), "and he destroyed his uterus." Therefore, the one (Esau) will fall by the hand of the other (Jospeh). And R. Johanan said, "All of the ministering angels sought to battle with the ministering angel of Esau, but he would not fall by their hand, as he would remove each and every one with a response: To Reuben, he says, 'You were suspected about your father's concubine.' To Simeon and Levi, 'You also killed the inhabitants of Shekhem.' To the other tribes, 'You sold your brother and sought to kill him.' To Judah, 'You were also suspected about your daughter-in-law, Tamar.' To Benjamin he said, 'You were suspected about the concubine in Giveah.' When the ministering angel of Joseph came and battled with him, he immediately fell in front of him, as he had no response to answer him. This is what is written (Obad 1:18), "And the House of Jacob shall be fire, and the House of Joseph flame, and the House of Esau shall be straw.""

Rosh Chodesh Shevat Ois 3

Holy Eating: Letting Hashem Feed and Clothe Us

Divine provision includes the way nourishment becomes holy.

Holy Eating: Letting Hashem Feed and Clothe Us

Shevat, the Covenant, and Holy Eating

בְּסֵפֶר יְצִירָה:[1451] הִמְלִיךְ אוֹת צָדִי בִּלְעִיטָה וְכוּלִי, וּשְׁבָט בַּשָּׁנָה. **— Sefer Yetzirah teaches: He made the letter Tzadi reign over swallowing, etc., and Shevat in the year.** צַדִּיק נְקֻרָא מַאן דְּנָטִיר בְּרִית, כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ (חֵלֶק ב כג עמוד א).[1452] **— One who guards the covenant is called righteous, as written in the holy Zohar (II, 23a).** וּכְתִיב: צַדִּיק אוֹכֵל לְשׂוֹבַע נַפְשׁוֹ.[1453] **— It is written: "The righteous person eats to satisfy his soul."** וְשִׁשָּׁה שָׁבוּעוֹת שׁוֹבָבִים מְסוּגָלִים לְתִיקוּן פְּגַם הַבְּרִית, **— The six weeks of Shovavim are especially suited to repairing damage to the covenant.** וְאַחַר כָּךְ אֲדָר שֶׁבּוֹ מְחַיַּת עֲמָלֵק, שֶׁהוּא מְנַגֵּד לָזֶה, כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב (מִדְרַשׁ תַּנְחוּמָא תֵּצֵא),[1454] **— Then comes Adar, with the erasure of Amalek, who opposes this, as stated in Midrash Tanchuma, Ki Teitzei:** שֶׁהָיָה

[1451] **Sefer Yetzirah Gra Version 5:10**: 'He made the letter Tzadi king over swallowing/taste (le'itah), bound a crown to it, and combined one with another; and with them He formed Aquarius (Deli) in the universe, Shevat in the year, and the gizzard (kurkevan) in the soul, male and female.'

[1452] **Zohar, Vaera 1:16-18**: ""the seas" refer to the seven pillars which are the foundation of the earth, and over which rules the Sea of Kinnereth (R. Judah, however, maintained that the latter is filled by the others); "the rivers" are connected with the "river which went out of Eden to water the garden" (Gen. 2, 10). It is to be noticed that this Holy Land (the Shekinah) is called "the land of Israel". Why, then, did Jacob, who is Israel, not rule over it like Moses? The reason is-as already pointed out-that Jacob became the owner of the "house which is below" and left the "house which is above", though in the twelve tribes and in the seventy branches he made preparation herein for the "house which is above"; Moses, on the other hand, left the "house which is below" and took the "house which is above". The former experienced the Divine manifestation as "El Shaddai", but God did not speak with him in the higher grade designated by TETRAGRAMMATON."

[1453] **Proverbs 13:25**: 'A righteous person eats to the satisfaction of his soul, but the belly of the wicked will lack.'

[1454] **Midrash Tanchuma, Ki Teitzei 10:1**: "(Deut. 25:18, cont.:) And he cut off (rt.: znb) all who were lagging behind you. He smote them with a blow to the tail (rt.: znb). And this agrees with what R. Hanina bar Shilqa, said, "What did the House of Amalek do to Israel? They cut off their penes and flung them heavenward, as they said, 'This is what You have chosen, take for Yourself what You have chosen." As Israel did not know what the nature of spit was, until Amalek came and taught them, as stated (with reference to Ezek. 8:17), "here they were sending the spit in their faces." From whom did he learn it? From his grandfather Esau, as stated (in Gen. 27:36), "And he said, 'Is he not (hky) rightly named Jacob?'" He rubbed (rt.: hkk) his throat and brought out the spit. (Deut. 25:18), "All who were lagging behind you." R. Judah, R. Nehemiah, and the masters differed. R. 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The one conceded to the revival of the dead, as stated (Gen. 50:24), "God will surely remember you"; while the other denied the revival of the dead, as stated (Gen. 25:32), "Behold, I am going to die." The one offered his life for his mother's honor, as stated (Gen. 33:7), "and after, Joseph and Rachel came forward and bowed"; while the other sought to kill his mother, as stated (Amos 1:11), "and he destroyed his uterus." Therefore, the one (Esau) will fall by the hand of the other (Jospeh). And R. Johanan said, "All of the ministering angels sought to battle with the ministering angel of Esau, but he would not fall by their hand, as he would remove each and every one with a response: To Reuben, he says, 'You were suspected about your father's concubine.' To Simeon and Levi, 'You also killed the inhabitants of Shekhem.' To the other tribes, 'You sold your brother and sought to kill him.' To Judah, 'You were also suspected about your daughter-in-law, Tamar.' To Benjamin he said, 'You were suspected about the concubine in Giveah.' When the ministering angel of Joseph came and battled with him, he immediately fell in front of him, as he had no response to answer him. This is what is written (Obad 1:18), "And the House of Jacob shall be fire, and the House of Joseph flame, and the House of Esau shall be straw.""

חוֹתָךְ מִילוֹתֵיהֶם וְכוּלֵי, הֲוֵי לְךָ מַה שֶּׁבָּחַרְתָּ. — **He would cut off their circumcised members, etc., saying, "Here You have what You chose."** וְהוּא דִּכְתִיב: וְעַמֵּךְ כּוּלָּם צַדִּיקִים,[1455] — **For it is written: "Your people are all righteous,"** וְכָל מַאן דְּאִתְגְּזַר אִיקְרֵי צַדִּיק, כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ (שָׁם).[1456] — **and everyone who is circumcised is called righteous, as written in the holy Zohar there.** וְהוּא מְקַטְרֵג עַל זֶה שֶׁיֵּשׁ כַּמָּה חַיָּבִין בְּיִשְׂרָאֵל, כַּמָּה חַטָּאִין וְכַמָּה רַשָּׁעִין וְכוּלֵי, — **He accuses them, arguing that there are many guilty people in Israel, many sinners and many wicked people, etc.** וְאֵינוֹ מַאֲמִין דְּעַל יְדֵי הַמִּילָה עָאלוּ בַּהַאי חוּלָקָא דְּצַדִּיק וְכוּלֵי (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב זֹהַר חֵלֶק א צג עַמּוּד א).[1457] — **He does not believe that through circumcision they entered this portion of the righteous, etc. (Zohar I, 93a).** וּבָא הַתִּיקּוּן בְּחוֹדֶשׁ זֶה לִתְקֹן הָאֲכִילָה, שֶׁהָיָה שׁוֹרֶשׁ הַפְּגָם בַּהֶסַּתַּת הַנָּחָשׁ, — **This month brings repair to the damage in eating, the root of the damage caused by the serpent's enticement.** וּמִזֶּה בָּא הַזּוהֲמָא וּפְגָם הַזֶּה. — **From this came the defilement and this damage.** וְכֵן קְטָרוּג הַיֵּצֶר הָרָע עִקָּרוֹ בַּאֲכִילָה, — **The evil inclination's principal accusation likewise concerns eating,** וּכְמָה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: וְאָכַלְתָּ וְשָׂבָעְתָּ, הִשָּׁמְרוּ לָכֶם וְגוֹמֵר.[1458] — **as it is written: "You shall eat and be satisfied; take care," etc.** וּבְסִפְרֵי שָׁם: שֶׁאֵין אָדָם מוֹרֵד בְּהַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא אֶלָּא מִתּוֹךְ שְׂבִיעָה, וּמֵבִיא מִכַּמָּה פְּסוּקִים.[1459] — **Sifrei there teaches that a person rebels against the Holy One, blessed be He, only from satiation, and cites several verses.** וְזֶהוּ הִמְלִיךְ אוֹת צָדֵי בִּלְעִיטָה, שֶׁיִּהְיֶה אֲכִילָה בִּקְדוּשָּׁה: צַדִּיק אוֹכֵל לְשׂוֹבַע נַפְשׁוֹ.[1460] — **This is making Tzadi reign over swallowing: eating should be holy—"The righteous person eats to satisfy his soul."**

The Tree's New Year and Adam's Original Food

וְכֵן בְּחוֹדֶשׁ זֶה רֹאשׁ הַשָּׁנָה לָאִילָנוֹת, כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב (רֵישׁ רֹאשׁ הַשָּׁנָה):[1461] בְּאֶחָד בִּשְׁבָט רֹאשׁ הַשָּׁנָה לָאִילָן, וּלְבֵית הִלֵּל בַּחֲמִשָּׁה עָשָׂר בּוֹ. — **This month also contains the trees' New Year. As taught at the beginning of Rosh Hashanah: the tree's New Year is on the first of Shevat, and according to Beit Hillel on its fifteenth.** שֶׁמִּתְחִלָּה קוֹדֶם הַפְּגָם הָיָה אֲכִילַת אָדָם הָרִאשׁוֹן פְּרִי הָעֵץ, — **Originally, before the damage, Adam ate the fruit of the tree.** וּבָא הַמְצָוָה: מִכֹּל עֵץ הַגָּן אָכֹל תֹּאכֵל, שֶׁזֶּה הָיָה מִצְוַת עֲשֵׂה,[1462] — **The command "You shall surely eat of every tree of the**

[1455] **Isaiah 60:21**: "Your people are all righteous; they will inherit the land forever, the shoot of My planting, the work of My hands, in which I will be glorified."

[1456] **Zohar, Vaera 1:16-18**: ""the seas" refer to the seven pillars which are the foundation of the earth, and over which rules the Sea of Kinnereth (R. Judah, however, maintained that the latter is filled by the others); "the rivers" are connected with the "river which went out of Eden to water the garden" (Gen. 2, 10). It is to be noticed that this Holy Land (the Shekinah) is called "the land of Israel". Why, then, did Jacob, who is Israel, not rule over it like Moses? The reason is-as already pointed out-that Jacob became the owner of the "house which is below" and left the "house which is above", though in the twelve tribes and in the seventy branches he made preparation herein for the "house which is above"; Moses, on the other hand, left the "house which is below" and took the "house which is above". The former experienced the Divine manifestation as "El Shaddai", but God did not speak with him in the higher grade designated by TETRAGRAMMATON."

[1457] **Zohar, Lech Lecha 33:378-379**: "R. Abba rose and placed his hands on his head and blessed him. He said: 'I thought indeed that wisdom was to be found only in a few favoured pious ones. Now I see that even children in the generation of R. Simeon are endowed with heavenly wisdom. Happy art thou, R. Simeon! Woe to the generation when thou departest from it!' So they sat till morning studying the Torah. R. Abba then discoursed on the text: Thy people are all righteous, they shall for ever inherit the earth, a branch of my planting, etc. (Is. 60, 21). He said: 'Our colleagues have pointed out that these words cannot be taken literally, seeing how many sinners there are in Israel who transgress the precepts of the Law."

[1458] **Deuteronomy 11:15-16**: 'I will also provide grass in the fields for your cattle—and thus you shall eat your fill. Take care not to be lured away to serve other gods and bow to them.'

[1459] **Sifrei Devarim 43:8**: "Similarly, the men of the generation of the flood rebelled only out of satiety, it being written of them (Job 21:10) "Their bull genders and does not fail; their cow calves, and does not abort … (12) They take the timbral and harp, and rejoice at the sound of the organ. (13) They spend their days in wealth, and in a moment go down to the grave." This (i.e., satiety) is the cause. (14) "And they say unto G-d: 'Depart from us'": They said: All we need (from Him) is one drop of rain. We do not need Him (for that. We can manage the water problem ourselves.) (Bereshith 2:6) "And a mist went up from the earth and watered the whole face of the ground." The Holy One Blessed be He said to them: "You vaunt yourselves over the good that I have bestowed upon you? With it I shall exact punishment of you!" — (Ibid. 7:12) "And the rain was on the earth forty days and forty nights." R. Yossi b. Dermaskith says: They made their eyes (eineihem) rove up and down to satisfy their lust — The Holy One Blessed be He, in kind, opened upon them the upper and lower fountains (maynoth like "eineihem") in order to destroy them, as it is written (Ibid. 13) "On this day were broken up all the fountains of the great deep, and the windows of heaven were opened.""

[1460] **Proverbs 13:25**: 'A righteous person eats to the satisfaction of his soul, but the belly of the wicked will lack.'

[1461] **Rosh Hashanah 2a**: 'MISHNA: They are four days in the year that serve as the New Year, each for a different purpose: On the first of Nisan is the New Year for kings; it is from this date that the years of a king's rule are counted. And the first of Nisan is also the New Year for the order of the Festivals, as it determines which is considered the first Festival of the year and which the last. On the first of Elul is the New Year for animal tithes; all the animals born prior to that date belong to the previous tithe year and are tithed as a single unit, whereas those born after that date belong to the next tithe year. Rabbi Elazar and Rabbi Shimon say: The New Year for animal tithes is on the first of Tishrei.'

[1462] **Genesis 2:16**: "Hashem God commanded the man, saying: 'You may freely eat from every tree of the garden.'"

garden" was a positive commandment, וְהִכְנִיס קְדוּשָׁה לְהַמַּאֲכָל, כְּמוֹ בְּכָל מַעֲשֵׂה הַמִּצְוֹת שֶׁמְּבָרְכִין: אֲשֶׁר קִדְּשָׁנוּ בְּמִצְוֹתָיו וְכוּלֵי. **— and infused the food with holiness, as in every mitzvah act over which we bless, "Who has sanctified us with His commandments," etc.** וְזֶהוּ שֶׁאָמַר (זֹהַר חֵלֶק א כז עַמּוּד א): לְעָבְדָהּ בְּפִקּוּדִין דַּעֲשֵׂה, וּלְשָׁמְרָהּ בְּפִקּוּדִין דְּלָא תַּעֲשֵׂה.[1463] **— Thus the Zohar says (I, 27a): "To work it" through positive commandments, "and to guard it" through prohibitions.** וְהַיְינוּ הַמִּצְוֹת עֲשֵׂה: מִכֹּל עֵץ הַגָּן תֹּאכֵל, וְהַמִּצְוֹת לֹא תַּעֲשֶׂה: וּמִפְּרִי הָעֵץ וְגוֹמֵר לֹא תֹאכַל.[1464] **— The positive commandment was "You shall eat of every tree of the garden," and the prohibition was "Of the fruit of the tree," etc., "you shall not eat."** וְאִיתָא (רֹאשׁ הַשָּׁנָה טז): הָבִיאוּ שְׁתֵּי הַלֶּחֶם, שֶׁיִּתְבָּרְכוּ פֵּירוֹת הָאִילָן.[1465] **— It is taught (Rosh Hashanah 16): "Bring the two loaves on Shavuot," etc., "so that the tree's fruit may be blessed for you."** וּפֵרֵשׁ רַשִׁ"י, דְּרַבִּי יְהוּדָה לְטַעְמֵיהּ, דְּאָמַר: עֵץ שֶׁאָכַל אָדָם הָרִאשׁוֹן חִטָּה הָיָה.[1466] **— Rashi explains that Rabbi Yehudah follows his view that the tree from which Adam ate was wheat.** וְהַיְינוּ דְּקוֹדֶם הַחֲטָא הָיָה הַחִטָּה גַּם כֵּן כְּמוֹ פְּרִי הָעֵץ, כְּמוֹ שֶׁיִּהְיֶה לֶעָתִיד, שֶׁאָמְרוּ (שַׁבָּת ל עַמּוּד ב): עָתִידָה אֶרֶץ יִשְׂרָאֵל שֶׁתּוֹצִיא גְּלוּסְקָאוֹת וְכוּלֵי.[1467] **— as will be true in the future, when, they taught, the Land of Israel will produce ready-made loaves, etc. (Shabbat 30b).** וְכֵן הָיָה קוֹדֶם הַפְּגָם הַחִטָּה גְּלוּסְקָא מוּכָנָת לְמַאֲכַל אָדָם כְּכָל הַפֵּירוֹת. **— Before the damage, wheat was likewise a loaf ready for people to eat, like other fruit.** רַק אַחַר כָּךְ נִתְקַלֵּל: בְּזֵעַת אַפֶּיךָ וְגוֹמֵר,[1468] **— Only afterward was he cursed: "By the sweat of your brow," etc.** וְאָז כַּמָּה יְגִיעוֹת יָגַע אָדָם הָרִאשׁוֹן עַד שֶׁמָּצָא פַּת לֶאֱכוֹל: חָרַשׁ וְזָרַע וְקָצַר וְכוּלֵי, וְלָשׁ וָפָה (וּכְמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בְּרָכוֹת נח עַמּוּד א).[1469] **— Then Adam underwent many labors before obtaining bread to eat: he plowed, sowed, harvested, etc., kneaded, and baked (Berakhot 58a).** וּבַעֲצֶרֶת שֶׁהוּא זְמַן מַתַּן תּוֹרָה, דִּכְתִיב: אֲנִי אָמַרְתִּי אֱלֹהִים אַתֶּם,[1470] **— On Shavuot, the time of the giving of the Torah, of which it is written, "I said: You are divine beings,"** שֶׁהָיָה רָאוּי לִהְיוֹת הַתִּיקּוּן כְּמוֹ קוֹדֶם הַקִּלְקוּל, **— there should have been a restoration to the state before the damage.** תּוֹרָה: הָבִיאוּ שְׁתֵּי הַלֶּחֶם שֶׁיִּתְבָּרְכוּ פֵּירוֹת הָאִילָן. **— The Torah therefore teaches: bring the two loaves so that the tree's fruit will be blessed.**

Why "Swallowing" Rather Than "Eating"?

— It says He made Tzadi reign over swallowing, rather than over eating. וְאָמַר הִמְלִיךְ אוֹת צָדִי בִּלְעִיטָה, וְלֹא אָמַר בַּאֲכִילָה. **— "Swallowing" here means being fed by another,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב (בְּרֵאשִׁית רבה סג): פָּעַר פִּיו אוֹתוֹ רָשָׁע כְּגָמָל, דְּלִעִיטָה נִקְרָא עַל יְדֵי אַחֵר,[1471] **— as Bereshit Rabbah (chapter 63) says: "That wicked man**

[1463] **Zohar, Bereshit 24:264-25:265**: "A further lesson can be derived from the words "and from there it parted": happy is the man who devotes himself to the Torah, for when God takes him from this body, from the four elements, he is detached from them and ascends to become the head of the four Hayyoth, as it is written, "and they shall bear thee on their hands" (Ps. 91, 12). AND THE LORD GOD COMMANDED THE MAN, SAYING. It is agreed that the term "command" in the Scripture always has reference to the prohibition of idolatry. This sin has its root in the liver, which is the seat of anger, and it has been laid down that "to fall into a passion is like worshipping idols"."

[1464] **Genesis 2:16-17**: "Hashem God commanded the man, saying: 'You may freely eat from every tree of the garden. But from the Tree of Knowledge of Good and Evil you must not eat, for on the day you eat from it you will surely die.'"

[1465] **Rosh Hashanah 16a:14**: "It was taught: Rabbi Yehudah said in Rabbi Akiva's name: Why did the Torah say to bring an omer offering on Pesach? Because Pesach is the grain season. The Holy One, blessed be He, said: 'Bring an omer before Me on Pesach so that the grain in your fields may be blessed.' Why did the Torah say to bring the two loaves on Shavuos? Because Shavuos is the season of tree fruits. The Holy One, blessed be He, said: 'Bring the two loaves before Me on Shavuos so that your tree fruits may be blessed.'"

[1466] **Rashi on Rosh Hashanah 16a:14:2**: "The two loaves: They meant about the fruits of the trees, since the loaves allow the first fruits to be brought. For we may not bring the first fruits before Shavuot, as it is written (Exodus 34:22), "the first fruits of the wheat harvest." And I heard that Rabbi Yehudah here is according to his reasoning. As Rabbi Yehudah goes according to the one that said in Sanhedrin (70b) that the tree from which Adam ate was wheat."

[1467] **Shabbat 30b**: 'And furthermore: Rabban Gamliel sat and interpreted a verse homiletically: In the future, the World-to-Come, Eretz Yisrael will produce cakes and fine wool garments that will grow in the ground, as it is stated: "Let abundant grain be in the land." A certain student scoffed at him and said: There is nothing new under the sun. He said to him: Come and I will show you an example in this world. He went outside and showed him truffles and mushrooms, which emerge from the earth over the course of a single night and are shaped like a loaf of bread. And with regard to wool garments, he showed him the covering of a heart of palm, a young palm branch, which is wrapped in a thin net-like covering.'

[1468] **Genesis 3:19**: "By the sweat of your face you will eat bread, until you return to the ground, for from it you were taken; for you are dust, and to dust you will return."

[1469] **Berakhot 58a:4**: "He would say: How many labors did Adam the first man perform before he found bread to eat! He plowed, sowed, harvested, gathered sheaves, threshed, winnowed, sorted, ground, sifted, kneaded, baked, and only then ate. Yet I rise in the morning and find all these things prepared before me. And how many labors did Adam the first man perform before he found a garment to wear! He sheared, washed the wool, combed it, spun, wove, and only then found a garment to wear. Yet I rise in the morning and find all these things prepared before me. All the nations labor and come to the entrance of my house, and I rise in the morning and find all these things before me."

[1470] **Psalms 82:6**: 'I had taken you for divine beings,attendants of the Most High, all of you;'

[1471] **Bereshit Rabbah 63:12** (excerpt): "'Esau said: Pour some of that red food into me' (Genesis 25:30). Rabbi Zeira

opened his mouth like a camel." אָמַר לֵיהּ: אֲנָא פָּתַח פּוּמִי וְאַתְּ תְּהֵא מְשַׁתַּדַּר וְאָזֵיל, כַּהֲדָא דְתַנְּינַן וְכוּלֵי, אֲבָל מַלְעִיטִין. — **He said: "I will open my mouth, and you keep pouring it in," as we learned, etc.: "But one may feed it."**

Bread to Eat and Clothing to Wear

Receiving the act of eating as well as the food

Of Jacob our father, peace be upon him, it is written: "He will give me bread to eat and clothing to wear."[1472, 1473] וּכְתִיב בְּיַעֲקֹב אָבִינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם: וְנָתַן לִי לֶחֶם לֶאֱכוֹל וּבֶגֶד לִלְבּוֹשׁ. — **Why specify "to eat" and "to wear"?** וְלָמָּה כְּתִיב לֶאֱכוֹל וְלִלְבּוֹשׁ? — **Does anyone not know that bread is for eating and clothing for wearing?** וּמִי לֹא יָדַע שֶׁהַלֶּחֶם לַאֲכִילָה וּבֶגֶד הוּא לִלְבּוֹשׁ? — **Regarding the convert, where it says "to give him bread and clothing," it does not say bread to eat and clothing to wear.**[1474] וּבְגֵר דִּכְתִיב לָתֵת לוֹ לֶחֶם וְשִׂמְלָה, לֹא כְּתִיב לֶחֶם לֶאֱכוֹל וְשִׂמְלָה לִלְבּוֹשׁ. — **Jacob asked that Hashem, blessed be He, give him both the bread and the act of eating:** רַק דְּיַעֲקֹב אָבִינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם בִּיקֵּשׁ שֶׁיִּתֵּן הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ לוֹ הַלֶּחֶם וְגַם הָאֲכִילָה, שֶׁיַּאֲכִילֵהוּ וְיִהְיֶה הָאֲכִילָה בְּקִדּוּשָׁה. — **Likewise, that Hashem give him both the clothing and the act of dressing: that Hashem clothe him. Thus we find concerning clothing: "Hashem God made garments of skin for Adam and his wife, and clothed them."**[1475] וְכֵן שֶׁיִּתֵּן הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ הַבֶּגֶד וְהַלְבִּישָׁה, שֶׁיַּלְבִּישֵׁהוּ הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ. וּכְמוֹ שֶׁמָּצִינוּ בִּלְבִישָׁה: וַיַּעַשׂ הַשֵּׁם אֱלֹהִים לְאָדָם וּלְאִשְׁתּוֹ כָּתְנוֹת עוֹר וַיַּלְבִּישֵׁם, דִּלְבַד שֶׁעָשָׂה לָהֶם הַכָּתְנוֹת, הִלְבִּישָׁם הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ. — **Besides making their garments, Hashem, blessed be He, clothed them.** וְכָךְ כָּתוּב בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ (חֵלֶק ב לט עַמּוּד ב): וְאִי סַלְקָא דַעְתָּךְ דְּאִינּוּן אִתְלַבָּשׁוּ מִגַּרְמֵיהוֹן בְּהוּ, תָּא חֲזֵי דִּכְתִיב וַיַּלְבִּישֵׁם, דְּקוּדְשָׁא בְּרִיךְ הוּא אַלְבִּישׁ לוֹן.[1476] — **The holy Zohar says (II, 39b): "If you think they dressed themselves in them, come and see: it is written, 'He clothed them'—the Holy One, blessed be He, clothed them."** וְכֵן בְּבִגְדֵי כְהוּנָּה צִוָּה הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ לְמֹשֶׁה רַבֵּינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם לַעֲשׂוֹת לָהֶם וּלְהַלְבִּישָׁם.[1477] — **Likewise, for the priestly garments, Hashem commanded Moses our teacher, peace be upon him, to make them and dress the priests in them.** וּבְבִגְדֵי אָדָם הָרִאשׁוֹן אִיתָא (מִדְרָשׁ רַבָּה בְּמִדְבַּר פָּרָשָׁה ד) שֶׁהָיָה בְּחִינַת בִּגְדֵי כְהוּנָּה וּבְחִינַת בִּגְדֵי שַׁבָּת,[1478] — **Of Adam's garments, Bemidbar Rabbah (chapter 4) says that they had the character of priestly garments and Shabbat garments.** שֶׁאָמַר שָׁם: לָבַשׁ בִּגְדֵי כְהוּנָּה גְּדוֹלָה, שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר וַיַּעַשׂ וְגוֹמֵר וַיַּלְבִּישֵׁם; בִּגְדֵי שַׁבָּת הָיוּ וְכוּלֵי. — **It says: "He wore**

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said: That wicked man opened his mouth like a camel. He said: I will open my mouth, and you keep pouring it in. This is like what we learned: One may not stuff a camel or force its feed down, but one may put feed into its mouth."

[1472] **Genesis 28:20**: 'Genesis 28: 20: 'Jacob then made a vow, saying, "If God remains with me, protecting me on this journey that I am making, and giving me bread to eat and clothing to wear,''

[1473] **Peri Tzadik, Vayechi 15:1**: "In truth it is all one: the shepherd both guides his flock on the right path and provides for them, as stated in the holy Zohar, volume II, 20b. The meaning of "Hashem is my shepherd" is also "He provides for me." This is the foundation of holiness, for the root of the serpent's enticement was the sensation of bodily pleasure in eating, and the evil inclination rules only through eating and drinking, as it says, "You shall eat and be satisfied; take care," and so forth; the Sifrei brings several verses for this. When Hashem is the shepherd and provider, it is holy. As King Solomon, peace be upon him, asked, "Provide me with my allotted bread": that Hashem be the One who nourishes him with the bread determined and allotted according to what is needed for Torah and service. "My allotment" also indicates that words of Torah and service become engraved in the heart through eating. Guidance on the right path follows of itself: "He leads me beside restful waters; He restores my soul," interpreted in the Midrash on Psalms as words of Torah; "He guides me in paths of righteousness," and so forth."

Vayechi develops the shepherd image used in this Shevat teaching. The same divine provision nourishes the body and directs the soul; properly allotted food engraves Torah in the heart. This explains why Jacob requests the holy act of eating itself in addition to possession of bread.

[1474] **Deuteronomy 10:18**: 'but upholds the cause of the fatherless and the widow, and befriends the stranger, providing food and clothing.—'

[1475] **Genesis 3:21**: 'Genesis 3: 21: 'And the ETERNAL God made garments of skins for Adam and his wife, and clothed them.''

[1476] **Zohar, Bo 7:151-154**: "It is rather difficult to understand how they came to Esau. For in the first place we are told that God made garments for Eve also (Ibid.), and what became of these? And surely Adam and Eve would have been buried in them and not abandoned such a precious gift. The truth is, however, that no other human being ever wore those garments, which placed Adam and Eve on a par with supernal beings. And as for the "goodly raiment" which Rebekah put upon Jacob (Gen. 27, 16), this was royal apparel of silk and gold, which it is usual to keep in perfumes and this is what Isaac smelt, and he said, "See the smell of my son" (Ibid. 27), because he knew that the smell was so sweet on account of him. How, it may be asked, did Isaac know of "the smell of the field which the Lord hath blessed" (Ibid.)?"

[1477] **Exodus 29:8-9**: "Bring his sons forward and dress them in tunics. Gird them with sashes—Aharon and his sons—and bind headgear on them. The priesthood shall be theirs as a perpetual statute. You shall ordain Aharon and his sons."

[1478] **Bamidbar Rabbah 4:8** (excerpt): "Adam was the world's firstborn. Once he brought his offering, as it says, 'It shall please Hashem more than an ox, a bull with horns and hoofs' (Psalms 69:32), he wore the High Priest's garments, as it says, 'Hashem God made garments of skin for Adam and his wife, and clothed them' (Genesis 3:21). They were garments of distinction, and the firstborn used to serve in them."

the High Priest's garments, as it is written, 'He made,' etc., 'and clothed them'; they were Shabbat garments," etc. וְהַיְינוּ דְּהַלְבִּישָׁה הָיָה בְּקַשְׁדּוּשָׁה, לְבִישָׁה דְּמִצְוָה. **— That is, dressing was holy, an act of dressing for a mitzvah.** וְזֶה שֶׁבִּיקֵּשׁ יַעֲקֹב אָבִינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם: וְנָתַן לִי לֶחֶם לֶאֱכוֹל, שֶׁיִּתֵּן לוֹ הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ וְיַאֲכִילֵהוּ שֶׁיִּהְיֶה בְּקִדּוּשָׁה. **— This was Jacob's request: "He will give me bread to eat"—that Hashem give it to him and feed him, so that it would be holy.** כְּתִיב: הָאֱלֹהִים הָרוֹעֶה אוֹתִי וְגוֹמֵר,[1479] **— For it is written: "God who has shepherded me," etc.** וּכְמוֹ רוֹעֶה שֶׁלְּבַד שֶׁמּוֹבִיל צֹאנוֹ לִמְקוֹם מִרְעֶה, מַאֲכִילָם בְּיָדָיו. **— Like a shepherd who, besides leading his flock to pasture, feeds them with his hands.** וְכֵן בֶּגֶד לְלָבוּשׁ, שֶׁיַּלְבִּישׁוּהוּ. **— Likewise, clothing to wear means that he should be clothed in it.**

Hashem Clothes Israel in Garments of Mitzvah

וְכֵן בְּבִרְכַּת אוֹזֵר יִשְׂרָאֵל בִּגְבוּרָה וְעוֹטֵר יִשְׂרָאֵל בְּתִפְאָרָה, שֶׁנִּתְקְנוּ עַל לְבִישַׁת הַחֲגוֹרָה וְהַסּוּדָרָא (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בְּרָכוֹת ס עַמּוּד ב),[1480] **— Likewise, the blessings "Who girds Israel with strength" and "Who crowns Israel with splendor," were instituted for putting on the belt and headcloth (Berakhot 60b), which are garments of mitzvah:** שֶׁהֲרֵי הַחֲגוֹרָה שֶׁלֹּא יְהֵא לִבּוֹ רוֹאֶה אֶת הָעֶרְוָה, וְהַסּוּדָר שֶׁלֹּא יֵלֵךְ בְּגִילּוּי רֹאשׁ. **— The belt separates the heart from nakedness, and the headcloth keeps the head covered.** מְבָרְכִין אוֹזֵר יִשְׂרָאֵל וְעוֹטֵר יִשְׂרָאֵל, שֶׁהַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ מַלְבִּישׁ אֶת יִשְׂרָאֵל בִּלְבוּשֵׁי מִצְוָה, וְלֹא שֶׁמַּכִּין מַלְבּוּשִׁים לָהֶם וְהָאָדָם מַלְבִּישׁ אֶת עַצְמוֹ בָּהֶם. **— We bless "Who girds Israel" and "Who crowns Israel," for Hashem clothes Israel in garments of mitzvah, rather than merely preparing garments for people to dress themselves in.** וְזֶה הַמְלִיךְ אוֹת צָדִי בִּלְעִיטָה, שֶׁיִּהְיֶה הָאֲכִילָה בִּקְדוּשָׁה, שֶׁיִּהְיֶה הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ הַמַּאֲכִיל, שֶׁנִּקְרָא לְעִיטָה. וְאָמַר לְשׁוֹן לְעִיטָה, שֶׁהוּא בְּגָמָל, שֶׁגָּמָל אֲכִילָתוֹ מְרוּבָּה, שֶׁהוֹלֵךְ לְמִדְבָּרִיּוֹת וְצָרִיךְ לְשַׁהוֹת הַמַּאֲכָל בְּבִטְנוֹ. **— This is making Tzadi reign over swallowing: eating should be holy, with Hashem doing the feeding, which is called le'itah. It uses le'itah, the term for feeding a camel. A camel eats a great deal, since it travels in deserts and needs food to remain in its stomach.**

Even Abundant Eating Can Be Holy

וְאִיתָא (מִדְרַשׁ תַּנְחוּמָא פִּנְחָס יג): צַדִּיק אוֹכֵל לְשׂוֹבַע נַפְשׁוֹ, זֶה אֱלִיעֶזֶר, שֶׁאָמַר לְרִבְקָה הַגְמִיאִינִי מְעַט מַיִם, כְּדֵי גְּמִיאָה.[1481] **— Midrash Tanchuma (Pinchas 13) teaches: "'The righteous person eats to satisfy his soul'—this is Eliezer, who said to Rivkah, 'Let me sip a little water,' just a sip.** וּבֶטֶן רְשָׁעִים תֶּחְסָר, זֶה עֵשָׂו וְכוּלֵי, פָּעַר פִּיו כִּגְמָל וְכוּלֵי,'' עַיֵּן שָׁם.[1482] **— 'But the belly of the wicked is lacking'—this is Esau, etc., who opened his mouth like a camel," etc.; see there.** אַךְ מָצִינוּ אַף אֲכִילָה מְרוּבָּה שֶׁיִּהְיֶה בִּקְדוּשָׁה, וּכְמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב (פְּסָחִים נז עַמּוּד א): וְיִכָּנֵס יוֹחָנָן בֶּן נַרְבַּאי וְכוּלֵי, וִימַלֵּא כְּרֵסוֹ מִקָּדְשֵׁי שָׁמַיִם וְכוּלֵי,[1483] **— Yet we also find that eating a great deal can be holy. — As taught (Pesachim 57a): "Let Yochanan ben Narbai enter," etc., "and fill his belly with the sacred offerings," etc.** וְאוֹכֵל אַרְבָּעִים סְאָה גּוֹזָלוֹת בְּקִינּוּחַ סְעוּדָה וְכוּלֵי. **— He would eat forty se'ah of young birds at the end of the meal, etc.** אַף שֶׁהָיָה אֲכִילָה מְרוּבָּה, וּמָצִינוּ מִסְפָּר זֶה לְרַע (סַנְהֶדְרִין צד עַמּוּד ב),[1484] **— Although this was extensive eating, and we find this same quantity mentioned unfavorably elsewhere**

[1479] **Genesis 48:15**: 'And he blessed Joseph, saying,"The God in whose ways my fathers Abraham and Isaac walked,The God who has been my shepherd from my birth to this day—'

[1480] **Berakhot 60b:5**: "When he hears the rooster's voice, he should say, 'Blessed … Who gives the rooster understanding to distinguish day from night.' When he opens his eyes, he should say, 'Blessed … Who opens the eyes of the blind.' When he stretches and sits up, he should say, 'Blessed … Who releases the bound.' When he dresses, he should say, 'Blessed … Who clothes the naked.' When he stands upright, he should say, 'Blessed … Who straightens the bent.' When he steps down onto the ground, he should say, 'Blessed … Who spreads the earth over the waters.' When he walks, he should say, 'Blessed … Who prepares the steps of man.' When he puts on his shoes, he should say, 'Blessed … Who has provided me with all I need.' When he fastens his belt, he should say, 'Blessed … Who girds Israel with strength.' When he spreads a cloth upon his head, he should say, 'Blessed … Who crowns Israel with glory.'"

[1481] **Midrash Tanchuma, Pinchas 13**: 'The righteous eats to satisfy his soul' (Proverbs 13:25)—this refers to Eliezer the servant of Abraham and to the righteous of Israel, whose eating is solely to sustain the soul for Torah and service of God.'

[1482] **Proverbs 13:25**: 'A righteous person eats to the satisfaction of his soul, but the belly of the wicked will lack.'

[1483] **Pesachim 57a**: "And the people in the Temple courtyard cried additionally: Lift your heads, O gates, and let the righteous Yishmael ben Piakhi, the student of Pinehas ben Elazar the priest, enter and serve as High Priest, although the members of this family were violent. And the people in the Temple courtyard cried additionally: Lift your heads, O gates, and let Yoḥanan ben Narbbai, the student of Pinkai, enter and fill his belly with meat of offerings consecrated to Heaven, as he is worthy to eat offerings. They said of Yochanan ben Narbai that he would eat three hundred calves, drink three hundred jars of wine, and eat forty se'ah of young birds at the end of a meal. They said: Throughout Yochanan ben Narbai's life, no leftover sacrificial meat was found in the Temple."

[1484] **Sanhedrin 94b:6**: "Rabbi Yochanan said: What is meant by 'The Lord's curse is in the house of the wicked, but He blesses the dwelling of the righteous'? 'The Lord's curse is in the house of the wicked' refers to Pekach son of Remalyahu, who would eat forty se'ah of young birds as the final course of his meal. 'But He blesses the dwelling of the righteous' refers to Chizkiyahu, king of Yehudah, who would eat a litra of vegetables at a meal."

(Sanhedrin 94b), מִכָּל מָקוֹם הוּא הָיָה מְשׁוּבָּח בָּזֶה, מִפְּנֵי שֶׁהָיָה אֲכִילָה בִּקְדוּשָׁה. **— he was nevertheless praised for it, because his eating was holy.** וְהָיָה קָרְבָּנוֹת, שֶׁהֵם קָדְשֵׁי שָׁמַיִם מַמָּשׁ. **— These were offerings, literally sacred to Heaven.** וּמָצִינוּ[1485] (פְּסָחִים פו עַמּוּד ב) בְּרַבִּי יִשְׁמָעֵאל בְּרַבִּי יוֹסֵי, שֶׁשָּׁתָה כּוֹסוֹ בְּחַד זִימְנָא, **— We also find (Pesachim 86b) that Rabbi Yishmael son of Rabbi Yosei drank his cup in one draught,** וְאָמַר: לֹא אָמְרוּ בְּכוֹסָךְ קָטָן וְיֵינְךָ מָתוֹק וּכְרֵסִי רְחָבָה. **— and said that the rule did not apply when "your cup is small, your wine sweet, and my belly large."** שֶׁהוּא הָיָה אוֹכֵל לְשׂוֹבַע נַפְשׁוֹ לְשֵׁם שָׁמַיִם, וְהָיָה כְּרֵסוֹ רְחָבָה בִּקְדוּשָׁה. **— He ate to satisfy his soul, for Heaven's sake, in holiness; his large belly too was in holiness.** וְכֵן מָצִינוּ (שִׁיר הַשִּׁירִים רַבָּה ה, יד) בְּרַבִּי אֶלְעָזָר בְּרַבִּי שִׁמְעוֹן,[1486] דַּהֲוָה יָתֵיב גַּבֵּי תַּנּוּרָא, אִמֵּיהּ נָסְחָא וְהוּא אָכִיל, עַד דְּאָכִיל כָּל אַצָּוותָא, וְכוּלֵי, עַיֵּן שָׁם. רַק כָּל זֶה הָיָה לְשׂוֹבַע נַפְשׁוֹ, שֶׁיִּהְיֶה לוֹ כֹּחַ לַתּוֹרָה, וְהָיָה בִּקְדוּשָׁה. **— Likewise, Rabbi Elazar son of Rabbi Shimon sat beside the oven while his mother baked and he ate, until he had eaten the whole batch (Shir HaShirim Rabbah 5:14), etc.; see there. All this was to satisfy his soul, to give him strength for Torah, and was holy.**

The Holiness of Shabbat Eating

Shabbat joins bodily delight with preparation

אִיתָא מַהֲאֲרִי זִכְרוֹנוֹ לִבְרָכָה, שֶׁכָּל מַה שֶּׁיִּשְׂרָאֵל אוֹכֵל וְכֵן אֲכִילַת שַׁבָּת שֶׁהִיא בִּקְדוּשָׁה,[1487] **— Shabbat eating is likewise holy.** בְּשַׁבָּת, אַף לַהֲנָאַת עַצְמוֹ, הוּא בִּקְדוּשָׁה. **— The Ari, of blessed memory, taught that everything a Jew eats on Shabbat is holy, even when eaten for personal enjoyment.** וְזֶהוּ הִמְלִיךְ אוֹת צָדִי בִּלְעִיטָה, לְתַקֵּן הָאֲכִילָה, שֶׁיִּהְיֶה הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ הַמַּאֲכִיל וְיִהְיֶה אֲכִילָה בִּקְדוּשָׁה. **— This is making Tzadi reign over swallowing: repairing eating so that Hashem feeds us and the eating is holy.**

[1485] **Pesachim 86b**: 'The Gemara relates that Rav Kahana sat and taught this lesson simply, as though it were absolutely clear that erecting a partition divides a group into two distinct groups and removing a partition causes the area to be regarded as a new location. Rav Ashi said to Rav Kahana: You should raise this dilemma as a question: Does removal of a partition or the construction of a partition in one location during the eating of the Paschal lamb render the place comparable to two locations and cause the people to be considered two groups, or not? In fact, there is no clear answer to this dilemma, and the Gemara concludes: Let the question stand unresolved.'

[1486] **Shir HaShirim Rabbah 5:14:3** (excerpt): "Concerning Rabbi Elazar, son of Rabbi Shimon: Donkey drivers came to his father to buy grain from Kiryat Hamnaya. He sat beside the oven. His mother took bread out, and he ate; his mother took bread out, and he ate, until he had eaten the entire batch."

[1487] **Sod Yesharim, Shabbat Chol HaMoed Sukkot 3:3**: "On Shabbat, however, both are included together: expansion and also restraint. For on Shabbat bodily enjoyment too is a mitzvah, and through this enjoyment one fulfills the positive command, "You shall call Shabbat a delight." Thus it contains great expansion even from the person's side. It also contains great restraint from the person's side, for on Shabbat only what has been prepared is permitted. One who labored on the eve of Shabbat will eat on Shabbat, while one who did not labor beforehand has nothing to eat on Shabbat. Thus it also contains great restraint."
The surrounding Sod Yesharim paragraphs distinguish God's broad provision from the person's need to avoid unmeasured enjoyment. The selected conclusion joins the two in Shabbat: bodily delight is commanded, and prior preparation bounds it. It therefore sharpens the Shevat passage without turning its praise of holy enjoyment into unrestricted consumption.

Rosh Chodesh Shevat Ois 4

Refining Thought and Eating through Torah

Refining appetite aims at holy nourishment and includes a limit on excessive fasting.

Refining Thought and Eating through Torah

Contemplation and Mastery of Desire

חוֹדֶשׁ שְׁבָט נוֹצַר בְּאוֹת צ׳ כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בְּסֵפֶר יְצִירָה.[1488] **— The month of Shevat was formed through the letter tzadi, as written in Sefer Yetzirah.** וּלְגִירְסַת הַגְּאוֹנִים אוֹת צ׳ בְּהִרְהוּר, וְכֵן נֶחְשָׁב בְּגִירְסָתָם (רֵישׁ פֶּרֶק ה) בְּי״ב כֹּחוֹת הַי״א הִרְהוּר.[1489] **— In the Geonim's version, the letter tzadi corresponds to contemplation; their version likewise lists contemplation as the eleventh of the twelve faculties, at the beginning of chapter five.** וְהָרַב אַבְרָהָם בֶּן דָּוִד זִכְרוֹ לִבְרָכָה דְּחָשַׁב י״ב כֹּחוֹת כְּנֶגֶד י״ב שְׁבָטִים, **— The Raavad, of blessed memory, who assigns the twelve faculties to the twelve tribes,** וְלֹא חָשַׁב כְּסֵדֶר הַדְּגָלִים כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב הָאֲרִי זִכְרוֹ לִבְרָכָה לַחְשׁוֹב מְנַשֶּׁה וְאֶפְרַיִם לְבֽ׳. **— does not follow the order of the tribal banners, as the Ari, of blessed memory, does by counting Manasseh and Ephraim separately.** רַק חָשַׁב לֵוִי בִּכְלַל י״ב שְׁבָטִים, חָשַׁב הִרְהוּר לְיִשָּׂשכָר וְכוּלֵי, וּמִתּוֹךְ הִרְהוּרוֹ בַּתּוֹרָה כּוּלֵי, **— Instead, he includes Levi among the twelve tribes and assigns contemplation to Issachar: "Through his contemplation of Torah," and so forth.** וְיֵשׁ אוֹמְרִים הִרְהוּר לְלֵוִי, שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: יוֹרוּ מִשְׁפָּטֶיךָ לְיַעֲקֹב, עַיֵּן שָׁם.[1490] **— Others assign contemplation to Levi, as it says, "They shall teach Your ordinances to Jacob"; see there.** מְפָרְשִׁים הִרְהוּר בְּדִבְרֵי תוֹרָה, דִּכְתִיב: וּבְתוֹרָתוֹ יֶהְגֶּה וְגוֹמֵר.[1491] **— They understand contemplation as reflection on Torah, as it says, "And on His Torah he meditates," and so forth.** וְאַף שֶׁיֵּשׁ הִרְהוּר שֶׁמִּתְפַּלְּלִין עָלָיו לְהִנָּצֵל מֵהֶם, דְּהַיְינוּ הִרְהוּר עֲבֵירָה (יוֹמָא כט. וּבָבָא בַּתְרָא קסד סוֹף עַמּוּד ב),[1492, 1493] **— There are also thoughts from which we pray to be saved: thoughts of transgression (Yoma 29a and Bava Batra 164b, at the end).** וְגִירְסַת רַבֵּינוּ הַקָּדוֹשׁ זָכֶר צַדִּיק וְקָדוֹשׁ לִבְרָכָה בִּבְרֵכַת הַשַּׁחַר: וְלֹא לִידֵי הִרְהוּר עֲבֵירָה וְעָוֹן. **— Our holy master, may the righteous and holy be remembered for a blessing, used the wording in the morning blessing: "Nor into thoughts of transgression and iniquity."** אַךְ הֵם מְפָרְשִׁים הַמְלֵיךְ אוֹת צ׳ בְּהִרְהוּר, דְּצַדֵּי מְרַמֵּז לְצַדִּיק שֶׁהוּא גִּבּוֹר הַכּוֹבֵשׁ אֶת יִצְרוֹ.[1494] **— Yet they interpret "He made the letter tzadi rule over contemplation" through tzadi's allusion to the righteous person, who is mighty in mastering his inclination.** וְהַיְינוּ שֶׁיֵּשׁ לוֹ עוֹד עֵסֶק וְזֶה נִצְרָךְ עֲדַיִן לְאוֹרָה שֶׁיָּאִיר וּמִלְחָמָה עִם הַיֵּצֶר הָרָע, **— He is still engaged in a struggle with the evil inclination,** לוֹ הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרֵךְ שֶׁיּוּכַל לְהִתְגַּבֵּר עַל הַיֵּצֶר הָרָע, **— and still needs Hashem, blessed be He, to shine light upon him so that he can overcome it.** כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמַרְנוּ כַּמָּה פְּעָמִים בְּמַה שֶׁכָּתוּב (תַּעֲנִית טו.) צַדִּיקִים לְאוֹרָה, דִּכְתִיב: אוֹר זָרוּעַ לַצַּדִּיק.[1495, 1496] **— As we have often explained concerning "The righteous, for light" (Taanit 15a), for it says, "Light is sown for the righteous."** וְהַיְינוּ עַל יְדֵי אוֹר תּוֹרָה, כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב (זוֹהַר חֵלֶק א רב א): דְּהָא לֵית לָךְ מִלָּה לְתַבְרָא יֵצֶר הָרָע אֶלָּא אוֹרַיְיתָא.[1497] **— This comes through the light of Torah, as written in the Zohar (I, 202a):**

[1488] **Sefer Yetzirah Gra Version 5:10**: 'He made the letter Tzadi king over swallowing/taste (le'itah), bound a crown to it, and combined one with another; and with them He formed Aquarius (Deli) in the universe, Shevat in the year, and the gizzard (kurkevan) in the soul, male and female.'

[1489] **Sefer Yetzirah 5:1**: "Twelve Simple Letters, Heh-Waw Zayin-Chet Tet-Yod Lamed-Nun 'Ayin-Samekh Tzadi-Qof —Their foundation is Seeing, Hearing, Smelling, Talking, Eating, Sex, Work, Movement, Excitement, Play, Contemplation, Sleep. Their measure is the Twelve Diagonal Borders: Northeastern border, Southeastern border, Upper-Eastern border, Lower-Western border, Upper-Northern border, Lower-Northern border, Southwestern border, Northwestern border, Upper-Western border, Lower-Western border, Upper-Southern border, Lower-Southern border. They extend outwards and go on forever and ever and ever—They are the Arms of the World."

[1490] **Deuteronomy 33:10**: "They shall teach Your laws to Jacob And Your instructions to Israel.They shall offer You incense to savor And whole-offerings on Your altar."

[1491] **Psalms 1:2**: 'rather, this one delights in GOD's teaching,and studies that teaching day and night.'

[1492] **Yoma 29a:1**: "Thoughts of transgression are harder than the transgression itself; your sign is the smell of roasting meat, which can stimulate appetite more intensely than eating it. The end of summer is harder than summer itself; your sign is an oven that has already been heated and becomes hotter when heated again."

[1493] **Bava Batra 164b:16**; **Bava Batra 165a:1**: "Rav Amram said in Rav's name: There are three transgressions from which a person is not spared each day: thoughts of sin, presumptuously expecting one's prayer to be answered, and malicious speech. Can you really mean malicious speech itself? Rather, what is meant is the 'dust' of malicious speech—speech that approaches or leads to it."

[1494] **Pirkei Avot 4:1**: 'Pirkei Avot 4: 1: 'Ben Zoma said: Who is wise? He who learns from every man, as it is said: "From all who taught me have I gained understanding" (Psalms 119:99). Who is mighty? He who subdues his evil inclination, as it is said: "He that is slow to anger is better than the mighty; and he that rules his spirit than he that takes a city" (Proverbs 16:32). Who is rich? He who rejoices in his lot, as it is said: "You shall enjoy the fruit of your labors, you shall be happy and you shall prosper" (Psalms 128:2) "You shall be happy" in this world, "and you shall prosper" in the world to come. Who is he that is honored? He who honors his fellow human beings as it is said: "For I honor those that honor Me, but those who spurn Me shall be dishonored" (I Samuel 2:30).''

[1495] **Taanit 15a:2**: "Rav Nachman bar Yitzchak said: I too say that not everyone is destined for light, and not everyone for joy. The righteous are destined for light, and the upright for joy. The righteous are destined for light, as it is written, 'Light is sown for the righteous'; and joy is for the upright, as it is written, 'And joy for the upright in heart.'"

[1496] **Psalms 97:11**: "Light is sown for the righteous, and joy for the upright in heart."

[1497] **Zohar, Miketz 12:194-195**: "Alas for that day, a day of wrath and indignation! Hence it behoves man to contend

"Nothing can break the evil inclination except Torah." וְעַל יְדֵי הִרְהוּר בַּתּוֹרָה נִיצּוֹל מֵהִרְהוּרֵי שְׁטוּת. **— Through contemplation of Torah, one is saved from foolish thoughts.** וְכֵן גָּרְסִי הַגְּאוֹנִים: וְרֶגֶל יָמִין בַּנֶּפֶשׁ. **— The Geonim's version likewise reads: "And the right foot in the person."** וּכְבָר אָמַרְנוּ דְּרֶגֶל יָמִין מְרַמֵּז עַל תּוֹרָה, וְעַל דָּרֶךְ מַה שֶּׁנֶּאֱמַר: אַשְׁרֵי תְמִימֵי דָרֶךְ הַהוֹלְכִים בְּתוֹרַת הַשֵּׁם.[1498] **— We have explained that the right foot alludes to Torah, as in "Happy are those whose way is wholehearted, who walk in the Torah of Hashem."** וְהַיְינוּ שֶׁהַזְּמַן בְּחוֹדֶשׁ זֶה לְתַקֵּן בְּמִדַּת צַדִּיק וְלִהְיוֹת גִּבּוֹר הַכּוֹבֵשׁ אֶת יִצְרוֹ עַל יְדֵי דִּבְרֵי תוֹרָה וְהִרְהוּר תּוֹרָה, **— This month is the time to refine oneself in the quality of the righteous person and master one's inclination through words of Torah and contemplation of Torah.** וְלָכֵן חֲשָׁבוּהוּ לְיִשָּׂשכָר אוֹ לְלֵוִי. **— They therefore assigned it to Issachar or Levi.**

Why Shevat Is Linked to Swallowing

וְגִירְסַת הָאֲרִי זִכְרוֹ לִבְרָכָה: הִמְלִיךְ אוֹת צ׳ בִּלְעִיטָה וּשְׁבָט בַּשָּׁנָה וְקוּרְקְבָן בַּנֶּפֶשׁ, **— The Ari's version reads: "He made the letter tzadi rule over swallowing, Shevat in the year, and the gizzard in the person."** וְהוּא עַל פִּי מַה שֶּׁכָּתוּב (בְּרָכוֹת סא:) קוּרְקְבָן טוֹחֵן (וְנִתְבָּאֵר מַאֲמָר א).[1499, 1500] **— This follows the statement "The gizzard grinds" (Berakhot 61b), as explained in Teaching 1.** וְהַיְינוּ לְתַקֵּן שׁוֹרֶשׁ הַפֶּגֶם מַהֲנָחָשׁ שֶׁהָיָה בַּאֲכִילָה, **— The aim is to repair the root of the damage caused by the serpent, which involved eating.** וְהַזְּמַן בְּחוֹדֶשׁ זֶה לְתַקֵּן לִהְיוֹת צַדִּיק אוֹכֵל לְשׂוֹבַע נַפְשׁוֹ, אֲכִילָה בִּקְדוּשָּׁה.[1501] **— This month is the time to become one of the righteous who "eats to satisfy his soul": eating in holiness.** וְעַל יְדֵי זֶה זוֹכֶה לְתַקֵּן גַּם הַפֶּגֶם בְּמִדַּת צַדִּיק יְסוֹד עוֹלָם.[1502] **— Through this, one also merits to repair the damage to the quality of "the righteous person, the foundation of the world."** וְהַכֹּל עוֹלֶה לְמָקוֹם א׳, דְּאִלּוּ וַאֲלוּ דִּבְרֵי אֱלֹהִים חַיִּים.[1503] **— Both readings lead to one place, for "these and those are the words of the living God."** אַךְ לִכְאוֹרָה הָיָה צָרִיךְ לוֹמַר הַלָּשׁוֹן בַּאֲכִילָה שֶׁמּוֹרֶה לְהַשְׂבִּיעַ אֶת נַפְשׁוֹ, **— Yet it would seemingly have been more fitting to say "eating," which signifies satisfying one's soul.** וּמַה זֶּה הַלָּשׁוֹן בִּלְעִיטָה? וּלְשׁוֹן לְעִיטָה מָצִינוּ רַק בְּעֵשָׂו: הַלְעִיטֵנִי נָא וְגוֹמֵר.[1504] **— Why use the word "swallowing"? We find this term only with Esau: "Let me swallow, please," and so forth.** גַּם הָרַב אַבְרָהָם בֶּן דָּוִד זִכְרוֹ לִבְרָכָה דְּחָשַׁב י״ב הַכֹּחוֹת שֶׁנִּכְתַּב אֵצֶל הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ גַּם כֵּן, **— The Raavad also lists the twelve faculties ascribed to Hashem, blessed be He,** שֶׁבְּכָל אֶלּוּ י״ב מִדּוֹת מִתְאָרִים פְּעוּלַּת הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ, **— whose activity is described through all these twelve qualities.** חָשַׁב שָׁם כְּנֶגֶד כֹּחַ לְעִיטָה מַה שֶּׁנֶּאֱמַר: כִּי הַשֵּׁם אֱלֹהֶיךָ אֵשׁ אוֹכְלָה הוּא, עַיֵּין שָׁם.[1505] **— There he associates the faculty of swallowing with "For Hashem your God is a consuming fire"; see there.** וְקָשֶׁה דַּהֲוָה לֵיהּ לוֹמַר כֹּחַ אֲכִילָה, כְּלְשׁוֹן אֵשׁ אוֹכְלָה. **— This is difficult: he should have said "the faculty of eating," to match "a consuming fire."** אַךְ עִנְיַן לְשׁוֹן לְעִיטָה הֵיינוּ בְּלִיעָה, כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב (בְּרֵאשִׁית רַבָּה פָּרָשָׁה סג): אֲנָא פָּתַח פּוּמִי וְאַתְּ תְּהֵא מִשְׁתַּדַּר וְאָזִיל, כְּהַהִיא דְּתָנֵינַן כּוּלַּי, **— But the term le'itah means swallowing, as in Bereshit Rabbah, chapter 63:**

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daily with his evil prompter and to picture to himself the day when he will stand before the King to be judged, when they will lower him into the ground to rot there, whilst the soul will become separated from him. We have been taught that it behoves man always to rouse the good prompter against the evil prompter; if the latter departs, well and good, but if not, the man should study the Torah, as there is nothing so well calculated to crush the evil prompter as the Torah; if he departs, well and good, but if not, let the man remind him of the day of death so as thereby to subdue him."

[1498] **Psalms 119:1**: 'Happy are those whose way is blameless,who follow GOD's teaching.'

[1499] **Berakhot 61b:1**: "The lung draws in all kinds of liquids; the liver becomes angry; the gallbladder casts a drop into it and calms it; the spleen laughs; the gizzard grinds; the stomach sleeps; and the nose remains awake. If the sleeping organ wakes and the waking organ sleeps, the person wastes away. It was taught: If both sleep or both remain awake, he dies immediately."

[1500] **Peri Tzadik, Rosh Chodesh Shvat 1:1**: "In Sefer Yetzirah: 'He made the letter tzadi rule over swallowing … and Shevat in the year, and the gizzard in the person.' This follows what is stated in Berakhot 61b: 'The gizzard grinds.' Concerning the letter tzadi, Shabbat 104a says: 'A bent tzadi and a straight tzadi: a bent righteous person and a straight righteous person.' One who guards the covenant is called righteous, as stated in the holy Zohar (II, 23a). That is, the ninth attribute is 'the righteous one, foundation of the world'; its completeness is when it includes all ten attributes, and nine times ten equals ninety, tzadi."

[1501] **Proverbs 13:25**: 'A righteous person eats to the satisfaction of his soul, but the belly of the wicked will lack.'

[1502] **Proverbs 10:25**: 'Proverbs 10: 25: 'When the storm passes a wicked person is gone,But the righteous person is an everlasting foundation.''

[1503] **Eruvin 13b:10**: "Rabbi Abba said in Shmuel's name: For three years Beis Shammai and Beis Hillel disagreed. These said, 'The halachah follows us,' and those said, 'The halachah follows us.' A heavenly voice went forth and said: 'These and those are the words of the living God, and the halachah follows Beis Hillel.'"

[1504] **Genesis 25:30**: 'Genesis 25: 30: 'And Esau said to Jacob, "Give me some of that red stuff to gulp down, for I am famished"—which is why he was named Edom. "red."''

[1505] **Deuteronomy 4:24**: 'For the ETERNAL your God is a consuming fire, an impassioned God.'

[1506] **Bereshit Rabbah 63:12** (excerpt): "'Esau said: Pour some of that red food into me' (Genesis 25:30). Rabbi Zeira said: That wicked man opened his mouth like a camel. He said: I will open my mouth, and you keep pouring it in. This is like what we learned: One may not stuff a camel or force its feed down, but one may put feed into its mouth."

אֲבָל מַלְעִיטִין.[1507] — **"I shall open my mouth, and you keep pouring it in," as in the Mishnah, "But one may feed them by putting food into their mouths."** וּבַגְּמָרָא (שַׁבָּת קנה:) אִיתָא: הַלְעָטָה לְמָקוֹם שֶׁיְּכוֹלָה לְהַחֲזִיר,[1508] — **The Gemara (Shabbat 155b) says that feeding in this manner means placing food where the animal can bring it back up.** רַב חִסְדָּא אָמַר: אִידֵי וְאִידֵי לְמָקוֹם שֶׁאֵינָהּ יְכוֹלָה לְהַחֲזִיר כוּלֵי.[1509] — **Rav Chisda says that both methods place it where the animal cannot bring it back up, and so forth.** וּלְכוּלֵי עָלְמָא הַלְעָטָה עַל יְדֵי אַחֵר, וְהָאוֹכֵל בּוֹלֵעַ. — **All agree that someone else feeds it, while the eater swallows.**

Bread Allotted for Torah

וְאֵיתָא (בֵּיצָה טז.): מַאי מַשְׁמַע דְּהַאי חֹק לִישָׁנָא דְּמָזוֹנֵי הוּא וְכוּלֵי, מַהָכָא: הַטְרִיפֵנִי לֶחֶם חֻקִּי.[1510, 1511] — **Beitzah 16a asks: "What indicates that chok means sustenance?" It answers from "Provide me with my allotted bread."** פֵּירוּשׁ, לֶחֶם חֻקִּי הוּא מַה שֶּׁהַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ קוֹבֵעַ לְכָל אִישׁ כְּדֵי צָרְכּוֹ לְתוֹרָה וַעֲבוֹדָה, — **"My allotted bread" means what Hashem, blessed be He, assigns each person for the needs of Torah and divine service,** לַחֲקִיקַת דִּבְרֵי תוֹרָה (וְנִתְבָּאֵר כַּמָּה פְּעָמִים).[1512] בַּלֵּב — **so that words of Torah become engraved in the heart, as we have often explained.** וְגַם בֵּן קָשֶׁה לָמָּה כָּתוּב לְשׁוֹן טָרֶף וְלֹא הַאֲכִילֵנִי. — **Here too we must ask why the verse uses the term teref, prey or provision, rather than "feed me."** וְכֵן כְּתִיב: וַתִּתֵּן טֶרֶף לְבֵיתָהּ וְגוֹמֵר, וְכָתוּב: טֶרֶף נָתַן לִירֵאָיו.[1513, 1514] — **Likewise, "She gives provision to her household," and "He gave provision to those who fear Him."** בְּכוּלָּן לְשׁוֹן טָרֶף שֶׁהוּא כְּעֵין לְשׁוֹן לְעִיטָה. — **All use the term teref, which resembles the expression "swallowing."** אַךְ כְּמוֹ שֶׁמָּצִינוּ בְּעֵשָׂו הָרָשָׁע שֶׁאָמַר הַלְעִיטֵנִי נָא, — **We find that the wicked Esau said, "Let me swallow, please,"** הַיְינוּ מֵרוֹב תַּאֲוָה שֶׁהָיָה לוֹ לְהָאֲכִילָה בִּיקֵּשׁ שֶׁיִּפְעֹור פִּיו כְּגָמָל וְיִשְׁפְּכוּ בוֹ. — **because his great craving for food made him ask to open his mouth like a camel so that food could be poured in.** כֵּן בְּהֵיפֶךְ שָׁמַעְנוּ מִצַּדִּיקִים שֶׁלֹּא רָצוּ לִטְחוֹן וְלִלְעוֹס הַמַּאֲכָל, — **Conversely, we have heard of righteous people who would not grind and chew their food,** וּבָלְעוּהוּ בְּלֹא טְחִינָה וּלְעִיסָה כְּדֵי לְמַעֵט הֲנָאָתָן שֶׁלֹּא יַרְגִּישׁוּ בַּחֵיךְ טַעַם הָאוֹכֶל. — **but swallowed it without grinding or chewing, to reduce their pleasure and avoid tasting the food on their palate.** וּבְלִיעָה נִקְרָא לְעִיטָה. — **Such swallowing is called le'itah.** וְזֶה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: טֶרֶף נָתַן לִירֵאָיו, שֶׁאֲכִילַת הַיְרֵאִים כְּזֹאֵב — **This explains "He gave prey to those who fear Him": those who fear Him eat like a wolf that seizes prey and eats,** שֶׁטּוֹרֵף וְאוֹכֵל, וְאֵינוֹ מְכַוֵּין לַהֲנָאָתוֹ, רַק לְטָרוֹף הַצֹּאן. — **with no intention of enjoying itself, but only of attacking the sheep.** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁמָּצִינוּ (שַׁבָּת נג סוֹף עַמּוּד ב) וּמַסְגּוּ כִּי דָוּוּ,[1515] — **As we find in Shabbat 53b, at the end: "They walk while looking about."** וּפֵירֵשׁ רַבֵּינוּ שְׁלֹמֹה יִצְחָקִי: מַבִּיטִין כָּאן וְכָאן, לְפִיכָךְ מִתְקַנְּאִים בָּהֶם, כְּסְבוּרִין שֶׁרוֹצִין לְהִלָּחֵם בָּהֶם.[1516] — **Rashi explains: "They look this way and that; the wolves therefore become enraged at them, thinking that they want to fight them."** וַהֲרֵי דְּעִיקַּר טְרִיפַת הַזְּאֵב אֵינוֹ לַהֲנָאָתוֹ, רַק לְטָרוֹף הַצֹּאן לְנָקָמָה, עַיֵּין שָׁם. — **Thus the wolf's attack is chiefly to exact vengeance upon the sheep, rather than for its own pleasure; see there.**

[1507] **Bereshit Rabbah 63:12** (excerpt): "'Esau said: Pour some of that red food into me' (Genesis 25:30). Rabbi Zeira said: That wicked man opened his mouth like a camel. He said: I will open my mouth, and you keep pouring it in. This is like what we learned: One may not stuff a camel or force its feed down, but one may put feed into its mouth."

[1508] **Shabbat 155b:5**: "'One may not force-feed': What distinguishes hamra'ah from hal'atah? Rav Yehudah said: Hamra'ah is placing food where the animal cannot bring it back up; hal'atah is placing it where it can bring it back up. Rav Chisda said: Both involve placing it where the animal cannot bring it back up. Hamra'ah is done with an implement, and hal'atah by hand."

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[1510] **Beitzah 16a:3**: "What shows that chok, 'an allotted portion,' is an expression for sustenance? It is written, 'They ate the portion that Pharaoh had given them.' Mar Zutra said: It is learned from here: 'Provide me with my allotted bread.'"

[1511] **Proverbs 30:8**: 'Keep lies and false words far from me;Give me neither poverty nor riches,But provide me with my daily bread,'

[1512] **Proverbs 3:3**: 'Let fidelity and steadfastness not leave you;Bind them about your throat,Write them on the tablet of your mind,'

[1513] **Proverbs 31:15**: 'She rises while it is still night,And supplies provisions for her household,The daily fare of her maids.'

[1514] **Psalms 111:5**: 'He gave food to those who fear Him; He remembers His covenant forever.'

[1515] **Shabbat 53b:22**: "Ulla said: It is a hide tied over the rams' chests so that wolves will not attack them. Do wolves attack males but not females? The answer offered is: Because the males walk at the head of the flock. But do wolves attack the front of the flock and not its rear? Rather, because the males are fat. Are there no fat females? And do wolves know the difference between these and those? Rather, the reason is that the rams raise their noses and walk as though swelling with pride."

[1516] **Rashi on Shabbat 53b:22:5**: ""While looking about": They look this way and that. The wolves therefore become enraged at them, thinking that they want to fight them."

The Altar as a Model for Eating

וְזֶה שֶׁחָשַׁב הָרַב אַבְרָהָם בֶּן דָּוִד זְכָרוֹ לִבְרָכָה שֶׁמְּצִינוּ לְעִיטָה אֵצֶל הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ, דִּכְתִיב: כִּי הַשֵּׁם אֱלֹהֶיךָ אֵשׁ אוֹכְלָה הוּא[1517] — **This explains why the Raavad finds swallowing ascribed to Hashem, blessed be He, in "For Hashem your God is a consuming fire."** וְהַיְינוּ אֶכִילַת מִזְבֵּחַ שֶׁנִּקְרָא לַחְמִי לְאִישַׁי,[1518] — **This refers to the altar's consumption, called "My bread for My fire-offerings."** שֶׁבְּוַדַּאי אֵין בּוֹ חֵס וְשָׁלוֹם מַעְיָן עִנְיָן אֲכִילָה, רַק לְשֵׁם הַנַּחַת רוּחַ, — **Certainly it involves nothing resembling physical eating, Heaven forbid, but only the satisfaction** כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב זְבָחִים מו: שֶׁאָמַר וְנַעֲשָׂה רְצוֹנוֹ (כְּפֵירוּשׁ רַבֵּינוּ שְׁלֹמֹה יִצְחָקִי).[1519, 1520] — **"that He spoke and His will was fulfilled" (Zevachim 46b, as Rashi explains).** וְכֵן בַּמִּזְבֵּחַ אִיתָא (שָׁם נג:) לְפִי שֶׁלֹּא הָיְתָה בְּחֶלְקוֹ שֶׁל טוֹרֵף,[1521] — **Likewise, it says of the altar (there, 53b): "Because it was not in the portion of the predator."** וְכֵן (בְּסוֹף סוּכָּה) קָרְאָה לַמִּזְבֵּחַ זְאֵב.[1522] — **At the end of Sukkah, too, she calls the altar a wolf.** וְהַיְינוּ כַּנַּזְכָּר לְעֵיל שֶׁאֵינוֹ מְכַוֵּין לַהֲנָאָתוֹ, רַק לִשְׁרוֹף הַקָּרְבָּן לַעֲשׂוֹת נַחַת רוּחַ לְהַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ שֶׁאָמַר וְנַעֲשָׂה רְצוֹנוֹ. — **As explained, its purpose is not enjoyment, but burning the offering to give satisfaction to Hashem, blessed be He, whose spoken will is fulfilled.** וַאֲכִילָה בָּזוֹ נִקְרָא לְעִיטָה, שֶׁהוּא שֶׁהָאָדָם בּוֹלֵעַ וְאֵינוֹ טוֹעֵמוֹ בַּחֵיךְ. — **Eating in this manner is called swallowing: a person swallows without tasting it on his palate.** וְעַל זֶה הֵבִיא מַה שֶּׁנֶּאֱמַר הַשֵּׁם אֱלֹהֶיךָ אֵשׁ אוֹכְלָה, שֶׁשּׁוֹרֵף הַמַּאֲכָל עַל גַּבֵּי הַמִּזְבֵּחַ. — **He therefore cites "Hashem your God is a consuming fire," which burns the food upon the altar.**

Allotted bread and the limits of abstinence

וְזֶה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר טֶרֶף נָתַן לִירֵאָיו, וְכֵן וַתִּתֵּן טֶרֶף לְבֵיתָהּ וְגוֹמֵר,[1523] — **This explains "He gave prey to those who fear Him," and "She gives provision to her household," and so forth.** שֶׁהַיְרֵאִים אוֹכְלִים רַק כְּטֶרֶף הַזְּאֵב, שֶׁלֹּא לַהֲנָאַת הַגּוּף. — **Those who fear Him eat only as the wolf seizes prey, without seeking bodily pleasure.** וַאֲכִילָתָם הוּא לְקִיּוּם שֶׁכֵּן בָּרָא הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ שֶׁיִּהְיֶה הָאָדָם נִצְרָךְ לְהַכְנִיס בְּתוֹכוֹ מַאֲכָל, — **Their eating serves only to sustain life,** לְקִיּוּם הַחַיִּים, וְנַעֲשָׂה רְצוֹנוֹ הָעוֹלֶה מִזֶּה. — **for Hashem, blessed be He, created the person to require food within him to sustain life; His will is thereby fulfilled.** וְזֶהוּ וַתִּתֵּן טֶרֶף לְבֵיתָהּ, הֵם הַתַּלְמִידֵי חֲכָמִים שֶׁהֵם בְּנֵי בֵיתָהּ שֶׁל הַכְּנֶסֶת יִשְׂרָאֵל כַּיָּדוּעַ. — **"She gives provision to her household" refers to Torah scholars, who are members of the household of the Congregation of Israel, as is known.** וְחוֹק לְנַעֲרוֹתֶיהָ, וְזֶה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר הַטְרִיפֵנִי לֶחֶם חֻקִּי, שֶׁהַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ בְּעַצְמוֹ יְהִיֶה הַמַּאֲכִיל וְהַמַּטְרִיף. — **"And an allotment to her maidens." This explains "Provide me with my allotted bread": Hashem, blessed be He, Himself feeds and provides.** וְזֶה כְּמוֹ לְעִיטָה, שֶׁהָאָדָם פּוֹתֵחַ פִּיו וּמַלְעִיטִין אוֹתוֹ וְאֵינוֹ מַרְגִּישׁ טַעַם הַמַּאֲכָל בְּחִכּוֹ. — **This resembles being fed: the person opens his mouth, food is put into it, and he does not feel its taste on his palate.** וְזֶהוּ לֶחֶם חֻקִּי שֶׁחוֹקֵק עַל יְדֵי זֶה הַדִּבְרֵי תוֹרָה בַּלֵּב. — **This is "my allotted bread," through which words of Torah become engraved in the heart.** כְּמוֹ שֶׁהַדִּבְרֵי תוֹרָה נִקְרָא לֶחֶם, שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: לְכוּ לַחֲמוּ בְלַחֲמִי,[1524] — **For words of Torah are called bread, as it says, "Come, eat of My bread."** וּבַזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ (חֶלֶק ג רעא ב): נַהֲמָא דְּאוֹרַיְיתָא דְּבִכְתָב.[1525] — **And the holy Zohar (III, 271b) speaks of "the bread**

[1517] **Deuteronomy 4:24**: 'For the ETERNAL your God is a consuming fire, an impassioned God.'

[1518] **Numbers 28:2**: 'Command the Israelite people and say to them: Be punctilious in presenting to Me at stated times the offerings of food due Me, as offerings by fire of pleasing odor to Me.'

[1519] **Rashi on Zevachim 46b:14:1**: "'Giving satisfaction': Satisfaction before the Holy One, blessed be He, because He spoke and His will was carried out."

[1520] **Rashi on Zevachim 46b:14**: 'Rashi on Zevachim 46b (s.v. Lereach nichoach): "'A pleasing aroma to Hashem'—satisfaction before Me that I spoke and My will was fulfilled."'

[1521] **Zevachim 53b:8**: 'Why was there no foundation at the southeast corner? Rabbi Elazar said: Because it was not in the portion of the predator. Rav Shmuel bar Rav Yitzchak said: The altar extended one cubit into Yehuda's portion.'

[1522] **Sukkah 56b:5**: 'When the Greeks entered the Sanctuary, Miriam daughter of Bilgah kicked the altar with her sandal and said: 'Wolf, wolf! How long will you consume Israel's money and fail to stand by them in their distress?' When the Sages heard of it, they fixed her priestly division's ring in place and closed its storage window.'

[1523] **Et HaOchel 9:1**: "He asked that food too should be "prey." This comes through "my allotted bread," within a limit: neither ravenousness and an abundance of craving, called wealth, nor excessive starvation and poverty. As it is taught, one who sits fasting is called a sinner—meaning that he diminishes the elevation of the holiness in food to its place through eating. Only "the belly of the wicked shall lack": for him restriction and fasting are fitting, to consume his ravenousness. But a righteous person who is not ravenous and immersed in craving "eats to satisfy his soul"—that is, his allotted bread. Through this he can reach the level of "provide me with prey," seizing the good within evil to include it in the good. This is the meaning of "He gave prey to those who fear Him": those who fear Him restrict their desires excessively and thereby come to refrain even from eating their allotted bread. The Holy One, blessed be He, gives them "prey" as a gift—to eat their allotted bread at least, so as to seize those holy sparks within the food."
Et HaOchel develops the same linked expressions, "prey" and "allotted bread," but explicitly supplies the balancing condition: a person can also obstruct the task by excessive abstinence. This keeps the Shevat passage's account of ascetic practices in its larger spiritual context.

[1524] **Proverbs 9:5**: "Come, eat my food And drink the wine that I have mixed;"

[1525] **Zohar, Eikev 1:18**: "Meanwhile an elder appeared before him and said: 'Faithful Shepherd, prepare a table for your

וְזֶה שֶׁכָּתוּב הִמְלִיךְ אוֹת צ׳ בִּלְעִיטָה וְכוּ׳, שֶׁעֲסָק הַחוֹדֶשׁ לְתַקֵּן הָאֲכִילָה, שֶׁיִּהְיֶה אוֹכֵל רַק לְשׂוֹבַע נַפְשׁוֹ, שֶׁיִּשְׂבַּע הַנֶּפֶשׁ שְׂבִיעָה בְּדִבְרֵי תוֹרָה, כַּאֲכִילַת שְׁלֹמֹה הַמֶּלֶךְ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם (שֶׁנִּתְבָּאֵר כַּמָּה פְּעָמִים).[1526] — **This explains "He made the letter tzadi rule over swallowing": this month's work is to refine eating, so that the righteous person eats only to satisfy his soul, satisfying it with words of Torah, like King Solomon's eating, as often explained.**

Asher's Rich Bread and the Wisdom of Torah

וְכֵן לְפִי מַאי דְּחָשַׁב הָאֲרִי זִכְרוֹ לִבְרָכָה הֶחֳדָשִׁים לַשְּׁבָטִים כְּסֵדֶר הַדְּגָלִים, וְנִמְצָא שְׁבָט לְשֵׁבֶט אָשֵׁר, וְכַתּוּב בֵּיהּ: מֵאָשֵׁר שְׁמַנָּה לַחְמוֹ וְגוֹמֵר, וְהוּא גְּרִיס בִּלְעִיטָה.[1527] — **Likewise, the Ari assigns the months to the tribes according to the order of the banners, making Shevat correspond to Asher. Of him it says, "From Asher, his bread is rich," and so forth; yet the Ari's reading is "swallowing."** וּלְשׁוֹן שְׁמַנָּה לַחְמוֹ מַשְׁמַע הֶרְגֵּשׁ טַעַם, וְלִכְאוֹרָה לֹא יִתָּכֵן לְשׁוֹן לְעִיטָה כָּאָמוּר. — **"His bread is rich" suggests experiencing flavor, which seemingly does not fit swallowing as explained above.** אַךְ בָּאֳמֶת מָצִינוּ (בָּבָא בַּתְרָא כב.): אַדְּמָגַרְמֵיתוּ גַּרְמֵי בֵּי אַבַּיֵי, תּוּ אִכְלוּ בִּשְׂרָא שְׁמִינָא בֵּי רָבָא.[1528] — **But we find in Bava Batra 22a: "Instead of gnawing bones in Abaye's house, come eat rich meat in Rava's house."** הֲרֵי דְּשַׁיָּיךְ לְשׁוֹן שְׁמִינָה עַל דִּבְרֵי תוֹרָה, וְהוּא לְעִיטָה בְּלֹא הֲנָאַת הַגּוּף, וְכַאֲכִילַת מִזְבֵּחַ הַקְּרָבָנוֹת לַעֲשׂוֹת נַחַת רוּחַ לְהַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ. — **Thus the expression "rich" can apply to words of Torah. It is swallowing without bodily pleasure, like the altar consuming offerings to give satisfaction to Hashem, blessed be He.** וְזֶה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר מֵאָשֵׁר שְׁמַנָּה לַחְמוֹ, דַּאֲכִילָתוֹ בִּקְדוּשָּׁה, עַל דֶּרֶךְ לְכוּ לַחֲמוּ בְלַחֲמִי, שֶׁאֲכִילָתוֹ דִּבְרֵי תוֹרָה. — **"From Asher, his bread is rich" means his eating is holy, as in "Come, eat of My bread": his eating is words of Torah.** וְכֵן אִיתָא (מְנָחוֹת פה:): וְטוֹבֵל בַּשֶּׁמֶן רַגְלוֹ, זֶה חֶלְקוֹ שֶׁל אָשֵׁר שֶׁמּוֹשֵׁךְ שֶׁמֶן וְכוּ׳.[1529, 1530] — **Menachot 85b likewise says: "'He dips his foot in oil' refers to Asher's portion, which flows with oil."** וְשָׁם: מִתּוֹךְ שֶׁרְגִילִין בְּשֶׁמֶן זַיִת חָכְמָה מְצוּיָה בָּהֶן.[1531] — **There it also says: "Because they regularly use olive oil, wisdom is found among them."** וְזֶהוּ שְׁמַנָּה לַחְמוֹ, שֶׁהוּא חָכְמָה, וְהַיְינוּ נַהֲמָא דְּאוֹרַיְיתָא. — **This is "his bread is rich": it is wisdom, the bread of Torah.** וְזֶה שֶׁכָּתוּב הִמְלִיךְ אוֹת צ׳ בִּלְעִיטָה, שֶׁיִּהְיֶה הָאָדָם צַדִּיק אוֹכֵל רַק לְשׂוֹבַע נַפְשׁוֹ, בְּלֹא הֶרְגֵּשׁ הֲנָאַת הַגּוּף, רַק אֲכִילָה בִּקְדוּשָּׁה רוּחָנִיּוּת לְהַשְׂבִּיעַ הַנֶּפֶשׁ וְיִהְיֶה הָאֲכִילָה דִּבְרֵי תוֹרָה. — **"He made the letter tzadi rule over swallowing" means that a person should be righteous, eating only to satisfy his soul, without experiencing bodily pleasure, but eating in spiritual holiness to satisfy the soul, so that his eating is words of Torah.** וְעַל יְדֵי זֶה יִהְיֶה צַדִּיק גִּבּוֹר הַכּוֹבֵשׁ אֶת יִצְרוֹ, דְּהָא לֵית — **Through this he becomes righteous, mighty in mastering his inclination,**

Master, for Him and for the Matron, with every kind of delight, to fulfill thereby, "This is the table that is before the Lord" (Ezekiel 41:22). Until now, all have delighted in the King's table, as it is written, "Come, eat of My bread" (Proverbs 9:5). This is the bread of the Written Torah and the wine of the Oral Torah. There are many delicacies there—kinds of Torah's meanings—sweeter than all the foods and delights of the world and of the king.'"

[1526] **Proverbs 13:25**: 'A righteous person eats to the satisfaction of his soul, but the belly of the wicked will lack.'

[1527] **Genesis 49:20**: "From Asher comes rich bread, and he will provide royal delicacies."

[1528] **Bava Batra 22a:9**: "Rav Adda bar Abba died. Rav Yosef said, 'I brought punishment upon him, because I cursed him.' Rav Dimi of Nehardea said, 'I brought punishment upon him, because he caused the loss of my dried figs.' Abaye said, 'I brought punishment upon him, because he told the Sages, "Instead of gnawing bones in Abaye's school, come and eat rich meat in Rava's school."' Rava said, 'I brought punishment upon him, because when he went to the butcher's shop to obtain meat, he told the butchers, "I take my meat before Rava's attendant, because I am superior to him."'"

[1529] **Menachot 85b:14-18**: "The Sages taught: 'He dips his foot in oil' refers to Asher's portion, which flows with oil like a spring. They said: Once the people of Laodicea needed oil. They appointed a purchasing agent and told him, 'Go and bring us a million coins' worth of oil.' He went to Jerusalem, and they told him, 'Go to Tyre.' He went to Tyre, and they told him, 'Go to Gush Chalav.' He went to Gush Chalav, and they told him, 'Go to a certain man in that field.' He found him loosening the earth beneath his olive trees. He asked him, 'Do you have a million coins' worth of oil, which is what I need?' The man answered, 'Wait until I finish my work.' He waited until he finished his work. After finishing his work, the man slung his tools behind him and continued clearing stones as he walked along the road. The agent asked him, 'Do you really have a million coins' worth of oil? I think the Jews have made a laughingstock of me.' When they reached the man's town, his maidservant brought out a kettle of hot water, and he washed his hands and feet with it. She brought out a golden basin full of oil, and he dipped his hands and feet in it, fulfilling the verse, 'He dips his foot in oil.' After they had eaten and drunk, he measured out a million coins' worth of oil for the agent. He asked him, 'Do you need any more?' The agent answered, 'Yes, but I have no money.' He told him, 'If you wish to take more, take it; I will go with you and collect its price.' He measured out another hundred and eighty thousand coins' worth of oil. They said: That man did not leave a horse, mule, camel, or donkey in the Land of Israel that he did not hire to transport it. When the agent reached his town, the townspeople came out to praise him. He told them, 'Do not praise me; praise this man who came with me. He measured out a million coins' worth of oil for me, and he is still my creditor for another hundred and eighty thousand.' This fulfills the verse, 'There is one who makes himself rich yet has nothing, and one who makes himself poor yet has great wealth.'"

[1530] **Deuteronomy 33:24**: 'And of Asher he said:Most blessed of sons be Asher;May he be the favorite of his brothers,May he dip his foot in oil.'

[1531] **Menachot 85b:13**: "Gemara: 'Yoav sent to Tekoa and brought from there a wise woman.' Why specifically Tekoa? Rabbi Yochanan said: Because its people regularly use olive oil, wisdom is common among them."

מִלָּה לְתַבְּרָא יַצָּר הָרָע אֶלָּא אוֹרַיְיתָא, כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ מֵהַזּוֹהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ.[1532] **— for "Nothing can break the evil inclination except Torah," as we quoted from the holy Zohar.** וְיוּכַל לְתַקֵּן כָּל קִלְקוּל הַנָּחָשׁ שֶׁהָיָה לְהַרְגִּישׁ הֲנָאַת הַגּוּף בַּאֲכִילָה. **— He can thereby repair all the damage caused by the serpent, which introduced the experience of bodily pleasure in eating.**

Repairing the Serpent's Damage from the Root

וְעַל יְדֵי זֶה הַטִּיל הַנָּחָשׁ זוּהֲמָא בְּחַוָּה, וְכָל יְלוּדֵי אָדָם נוֹלְדוּ מֵהַזּוּהֲמָא. **— Through this the serpent implanted impurity in Eve, and all human offspring were born from that impurity.** וּמִזֶּה בָּא עָטְיוֹ שֶׁל נָחָשׁ, שֶׁאָמְרוּ שֶׁהוּא מַה שֶּׁכָּתוּב בִּמְדְרָשׁ רַבָּה (רֵישׁ פָּרָשַׁת תַּזְרִיעַ)[1533]: הֵן בְּעָוֹן חוֹלֵל, **— From this comes the serpent's consequence, which we identified with the statement in Midrash Rabbah, at the beginning of Tazria: "He is full of iniquity."** אֲפִילּוּ אִם יִהְיֶה חָסִיד שֶׁבַּחֲסִידִים, אִי אֶפְשָׁר שֶׁלֹּא יִהְיֶה בּוֹ צַד אִ' מֵעָוֹן.[1534] **— Even the most pious person cannot be entirely free of some element of iniquity.** וְכֵן הַזְּמַן בְּחוֹדֶשׁ שְׁבָט שֶׁכּוּלּוֹ בְּפָרָשִׁיּוֹת שׁוֹבָבִי"ם שֶׁבָּהֶם הַזְּמַן לְתִיקוּן פְּגַם הַבְּרִית. **— Shevat falls entirely within the Shovavim Torah portions, the season for repairing damage to the covenant.** רַק מִקְצָתָן הֵם בְּטֵבֵת, שֶׁהוּא הַהֶכְנָה לְהָאוֹר. **— Only some of these portions fall in Tevet, which prepares for the light.** וְאַחַר כָּךְ הַסִּיּוּם בַּאֲדָר הַמְיוּחָד לִמְחִיַּת עֲמָלֵק שֶׁמִּצִּדּוֹ שׁוֹרֶשׁ הַפְּגָם (וְנִתְבָּאֵר לְמַעְלָה),[1535] **— They conclude in Adar, the month devoted to erasing Amalek, from whose side the damage is rooted, as explained above.** וְחוֹדֶשׁ שְׁבָט כּוּלּוֹ מְיוּחָד לְתִיקוּן הַפְּגָם. **— The whole month of Shevat is devoted to repairing this damage.** וְנִרְמָז שׁוּבוּ בָנִים שׁוֹבָבִי"ם, שֶׁאָמְרוּ (יוֹמָא פו.) דְּמַעְיקָרָא שׁוֹבָבִים אַתֶּם.[1536,1537] **— This is alluded to in "Return, wayward children," which the Sages interpret (Yoma 86a): "You were wayward from the outset."** שֶׁהַתְּשׁוּבָה רְפוּאָה לְמַפְרֵעַ וְלֹא כְּבַעַל מוּם שֶׁנִּתְרַפֵּא. **— Repentance heals retroactively, unlike a person whose blemish has merely healed.** וְהַיְינוּ שֶׁאַחַר שֶׁנַּעֲשָׂה זְדוֹנוֹת כִּשְׁגָגוֹת עַל יְדֵי הַתְּשׁוּבָה מִיִּרְאָה מִצַּד הָאָדָם בְּאַתְעָרוּתָא דִּלְעֵילָּא: שׁוּבוּ בָנִים שׁוֹבָבִי"ם, דְּמַעִיקָרָא שׁוֹבָבִים אַתֶּם, לַעֲשׂוֹת תְּשׁוּבָה מֵאַהֲבָה. **— After repentance from fear, initiated by the person's arousal from below, turns deliberate sins into inadvertent ones,** הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ מְעוֹרֵר בְּאִתְעָרוּתָא דִּלְעֵילָּא: שׁוּבוּ בָנִים שׁוֹבָבִי"ם, דְּמַעִיקָרָא שׁוֹבָבִים אַתֶּם, לַעֲשׂוֹת תְּשׁוּבָה מֵאַהֲבָה. **— Hashem, blessed be He, awakens the person from above: "Return, wayward children"—"You were wayward from the outset"—to repent from love.** עַל יְדֵי דִּבְרֵי תוֹרָה שֶׁזֶּה תִּיקוּן גַּם לִפְגָם זֶה, כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ מִמַּה שֶּׁנֶּאֱמַר: וּלְכָל בְּשָׂרוֹ מַרְפֵּא.[1538] **— Words of Torah also repair this damage, as we explained from "And healing to all his flesh."** וְיִהְיֶה נַעֲשֶׂה מְתוּקָּן מֵעִיקָּרוֹ. **— He will thus become repaired from his very beginning.**

[1532] **Zohar, Miketz 12:194-195**: "Alas for that day, a day of wrath and indignation! Hence it behoves man to contend daily with his evil prompter and to picture to himself the day when he will stand before the King to be judged, when they will lower him into the ground to rot there, whilst the soul will become separated from him. We have been taught that it behoves man always to rouse the good prompter against the evil prompter; if the latter departs, well and good, but if not, the man should study the Torah, as there is nothing so well calculated to crush the evil prompter as the Torah; if he departs, well and good, but if not, let the man remind him of the day of death so as thereby to subdue him."

[1533] **Vayikra Rabbah 14:5** (excerpt): "Another interpretation of 'A woman who conceives': It is written, 'Behold, in iniquity I was formed' (Psalms 51:7). Rabbi Acha said: Even if a person is the most pious of the pious, it is impossible that he should have no element of iniquity."

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[1535] **Deuteronomy 25:19**: 'Therefore, when the ETERNAL your God grants you safety from all your enemies around you, in the land that the ETERNAL your God is giving you as a hereditary portion, you shall blot out the memory of Amalek from under heaven. Do not forget!'

[1536] **Jeremiah 3:22**: 'Turn back, O rebellious children,I will heal your afflictions!"Here we are, we come to You,For You, O ETERNAL One, are our God!'

[1537] **Yoma 86a:15**: "Rabbi Chama bar Chanina raised a contradiction: It is written, 'Return, wayward children,' implying that from the outset you were merely wayward; yet it is written, 'I shall heal your backslidings,' treating them as an illness requiring healing. There is no contradiction: One passage concerns repentance from love, and the other repentance from fear."

[1538] **Proverbs 4:22**: 'Proverbs 4: 22: 'They are life to those who find them,Healing for the whole body.''

Rosh Chodesh Shevat Ois 5

A Pure Heart and Eating in Holiness

Enduring joy requires the removal of what separates the heart from divine service.

A Pure Heart and Eating in Holiness

The Two Chambers of the Heart

בְּסֵפֶר יְצִירָה בִּגְיִרְסַת הַגְּאוֹנִים: נוֹצַר עִם צָדִי, דְּלִי, שְׁבָט, רֶגֶל יָמִין, הִרְהוּר וְנִטּוּל הַלֵּב. **— In Sefer Yetzirah, in the Geonim's version: formed with tzadi are Aquarius, Shevat, the right foot, thought, and removal of the heart.** הָעִנְיָן, דְּאֵבֶר הַלֵּב יֵשׁ בּוֹ שְׁנֵי חֲלָלִים: **— The meaning is that the organ of the heart contains two chambers:** חֲלָל יָמִין, לֵב חָכָם לִימִינוֹ, וְחָלָל שְׂמָאלִי, לֵב כְּסִיל לִשְׂמֹאלוֹ.[1539] **— the right chamber, "the wise person's heart to his right," and the left chamber, "the fool's heart to his left."** וְעַל זֶה אוֹת צָדִי, שֶׁמּוֹרֶה עַל מִדַּת צַדִּיק יְסוֹד עוֹלָם,[1540] **— To this corresponds the letter tzadi, which indicates the attribute of "the righteous one, the foundation of the world."** (חֶלֶק ג יא ב). שֶׁכְּפֻנֶּגֶד מִדָּה זוֹ שֵׁם שַׁדַּי, כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ[1541] **— Corresponding to this attribute is the Name Shaddai, as stated in the holy Zohar, volume III, 11b.** וְהַיְינוּ לְתַקֵּן שׁוֹרֶשׁ הַפֶּגֶם מֵהַנָּחָשׁ, שֶׁהָיָה בַּאֲכִילָה וּבְתַאֲוָה. **— This is to repair the root of the damage caused by the serpent, which lay in eating and desire.** וְעִיקַּר הַתִּיקּוּן עַל יְדֵי דִּבְרֵי תוֹרָה, שֶׁמּוֹעִיל לְתַקֵּן הֶעָבָר, כְּמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: וּלְכָל בְּשָׂרוֹ מַרְפֵּא.[1542] **— The main repair comes through words of Torah, which can repair the past: "Healing for all his flesh."** וְכֵן לְהַבָּא, כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ: דְּהָא לֵית לָךְ מִלָּה לְתַבְּרָא יַצֶּר הָרָע אֶלָּא אוֹרַיְיתָא.[1543] **— They also protect the future, as the holy Zohar states: "Nothing breaks the evil inclination except Torah."** וְהַיְינוּ לְשַׁבֵּר הַיֵּצֶר הָרָע שֶׁלֹּא יוּכַל לָבֹא וּלְקַלְקֵל (וְנִתְבָּאֵר לְמַעְלָה).[1544] **— That is, to break the evil inclination so that it cannot come and corrupt, as explained above.** וּבַגְּמָרָא (בְּרָכוֹת סא.): יֵצֶר הָרָע דּוֹמֶה לְזְבוּב וְיוֹשֵׁב בֵּין שְׁנֵי מְפִתְחֵי הַלֵּב.[1545] **— The Gemara, Berakhot 61a, states: the evil inclination resembles a fly and sits between the heart's two entrances.** וְהַיְינוּ שֶׁהוּא נִכְנָס לְלֵב חָכָם לִימִינוֹ, שֶׁהוּא הַמָּקוֹם הַמְיוּחָד לְהַכְנִיס בּוֹ דִּבְרֵי תוֹרָה, **— It enters the wise heart on the right, the place designated to receive words of Torah,** וְהַיֵּצֶר הָרָע שָׁם אוֹר לְחוֹשֶׁךְ וּמַחְשִׁיךְ אֶת הַדִּבְרֵי תוֹרָה. **— and the evil inclination turns light into darkness, obscuring the words of Torah.** וְאַחַר כָּךְ נִכְנָס לְלֵב כְּסִיל לִשְׂמֹאלוֹ, הַמְיוּחָד לְעִנְיְנֵי הַגּוּף וְהָעוֹלָם הַזֶּה, **— Then it enters the foolish heart on the left, designated for bodily and worldly matters,** וְהוּא שָׁם חוֹשֶׁךְ לְאוֹר. **— and turns darkness into light.** וְעַל זֶה הָעֵצָה בְּדִבְרֵי תוֹרָה, שֶׁהוּא אוֹר, וּכְתִיב בָּהּ אֱמֶת (עֲבוֹדָה זָרָה ד:), שֶׁלֹּא יַתְעֶה הַיֵּצֶר הָרָע.[1546] **— The remedy is words of Torah, which are light and are called truth, as in Avodah Zarah 4b, so the evil inclination will not mislead him.**

[1539] **Ecclesiastes 10:2**: 'A sage's mind tends toward the right hand, a fool's toward the left.'

[1540] **Proverbs 10:25**: 'Proverbs 10: 25: 'When the storm passes a wicked person is gone,But the righteous person is an everlasting foundation.''

[1541] **Zohar, Vayikra 24:163-164**: "IF HIS OBLATION BE A SACRIFICE OF PEACE OFFERINGS. R. Abba here quoted the verse: "Awake, O north wind, and come thou south, blow upon my garden that the spices thereof may flow out" (S.S. 4, 15). 'The north wind', he said, 'refers to the burnt offerings which were killed on the north side (zafon) of the altar, because these atone for the thoughts which are in the recesses (mazpune) of a man's heart. The south wind refers to the peace offerings, which were killed on the south side of the altar, because they make peace between higher and lower, and between the various quarters of the world. Therefore the bringer also eats of them and has a share in them. Of all the offerings, none are so well beloved to God as the peace offerings, because they bring harmony to upper and lower."

[1542] **Proverbs 4:22**: 'Proverbs 4: 22: 'They are life to those who find them,Healing for the whole body.''

[1543] **Zohar, Miketz 12:194-195**: "Alas for that day, a day of wrath and indignation! Hence it behoves man to contend daily with his evil prompter and to picture to himself the day when he will stand before the King to be judged, when they will lower him into the ground to rot there, whilst the soul will become separated from him. We have been taught that it behoves man always to rouse the good prompter against the evil prompter; if the latter departs, well and good, but if not, the man should study the Torah, as there is nothing so well calculated to crush the evil prompter as the Torah; if he departs, well and good, but if not, let the man remind him of the day of death so as thereby to subdue him."

[1544] **Kiddushin 30b**: 'A Sage from the school of Rabbi Yishmael taught: My son, if this wretched one, the evil inclination, encounters you, pull it into the study hall, i.e., go and study Torah. If it is a stone it will melt, and if it is iron it will break, as it is stated with regard to the Torah: "Is not My word like fire, says the Lord, and like a hammer that breaks the rock in pieces?" (Jeremiah 23:29). Just as a stone shatters a hammer, so too one can overcome his evil inclination, which is as strong as iron, through Torah study. With regard to the second part of the statement: If it is a stone it will melt, this is as it is stated with regard to the Torah: "Ho, everyone who thirsts, come for water" (Isaiah 55:1), and it states: "The water wears the stones" (Job 14:19), indicating that water is stronger than stone.'

[1545] **Berakhot 61a:27**: "Rav said: The evil inclination resembles a fly and sits between the two openings of the heart, as it says, 'Dead flies make the perfumer's oil stink and ferment.' Shmuel said: It resembles a grain of wheat, as it says, 'Sin crouches at the opening.'"

[1546] **Avodah Zarah 4b:12-13**: "But you said that during the first three hours the Holy One, blessed be He, sits and occupies Himself with Torah! Reverse the two accounts, so that judgment occupies those first hours. Alternatively, do not reverse them. With Torah, concerning which 'truth' is written—as it says, 'Buy truth and do not sell it'—the Holy One, blessed be He, does not go beyond the strict line of the law. With judgment, concerning which 'truth' is not written, the Holy One, blessed be He, does go beyond the strict line of the law."

Yosef's Descendants: Torah and Redemption

וּמִיּוֹסֵף הַצַּדִּיק, שֶׁהוּא מֶרְכָּבָה לְמִדַּת צַדִּיק יְסוֹד עוֹלָם, יָצְאוּ שְׁתֵּי נְפָשׁוֹת מִזַּרְעוֹ. — **From Yosef the righteous, the vehicle of the attribute of the righteous one, the world's foundation, came two souls among his descendants.** אַחַת, יְהוֹשֻׁעַ בִּן נוּן, שֶׁהִנְחִיל הַתּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה לְיִשְׂרָאֵל, שֶׁאָמַרְנוּ מַה שֶּׁכָּתוּב (נְדָבָרִים כב:): אִלְמָלֵא וְכוּ' וְסֵפֶר יְהוֹשֻׁעַ בִּלְבַד, שֶׁעָרְכָהּ שֶׁל אֶרֶץ יִשְׂרָאֵל הִיא וְכוּ'[1547], — **One was Yehoshua bin Nun, who bequeathed the Oral Torah to Israel, as we explained concerning Nedarim 22b: "Were it not," etc., "and the book of Yehoshua alone, for it contains the arrangement of the Land of Israel," etc.** (וְנִתְבָּאַר חֲנוּכָּה מַאֲמָר ב)[1548], — **This was explained in Chanukah, teaching 2.** שֶׁהוּא שׁוֹרֶשׁ תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה שֶׁשַּׁיָּיךְ לְכָל אֶחָד מִיִּשְׂרָאֵל. — **It is the root of the Oral Torah that belongs to every individual in Israel.** וְהַיְינוּ הַתִּשְׁעָה קַבִּין חָכְמָה שֶׁנִּטְלָה אֶרֶץ יִשְׂרָאֵל (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב קִידּוּשִׁין מט:)[1549], — **These are the nine measures of wisdom taken by the Land of Israel, as Kiddushin 49b states,** וְהַיְינוּ חָכְמַת תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה. — **meaning the wisdom of the Oral Torah.** וְאָמְרוּ (בָּבָא בָתְרָא קנח:): אֲוִירָא דְּאֶרֶץ יִשְׂרָאֵל מַחְכִּים.[1550] — **They said in Bava Batra 158b: "The air of the Land of Israel makes one wise."** וְהוּא הַדִּבְרֵי תוֹרָה: ה"ר"ב חָכְמָה" לְתַקֵּן ה"רָב כַּעַס", לְהִתְגַּבֵּר עַל הַיֵּצֶר הָרָע שֶׁלֹּא יוּכַל לִכְנוֹס לִשְׁנֵי חֲלָלֵי הַלֵּב. — **These words of Torah are the "abundant wisdom" that rectifies "abundant anger," overcoming the evil inclination so that it cannot enter either chamber of the heart.** וְזֶה שֶׁאָמַר: הִמְלִיךְ אוֹת צָדִי בְּהִרְהוּר, — **This is the meaning of "He made the letter tzadi rule over thought,"** (וְנִתְבָּאַר מַאֲמָר ד).[1551] וְהַיְינוּ בְּדִבְרֵי תוֹרָה, כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתְבוּ מְפָרְשֵׁי סֵפֶר יְצִירָה — **meaning words of Torah, as Sefer Yetzirah's commentators explain; see teaching 4.** וְעַל יְדֵי כֵן יוּכַל לְהִתְגַּבֵּר עַל הַיֵּצֶר הָרָע, שֶׁלֹּא יַטְעֶה אוֹתוֹ בִּשְׁקָרָיו לָשׂוּם חוֹשֶׁךְ לְאוֹר וְאוֹר לְחוֹשֶׁךְ. — **Through this he can overcome the evil inclination, so its lies will not deceive him into turning darkness into light and light into darkness.** אֲבָל מִכָּל מָקוֹם יוּכַל הַיֵּצֶר הָרָע עוֹד לְהִתְגַּבֵּר עָלָיו חַס וְשָׁלוֹם, כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב (סוּכָּה נב.):[1552] — **Nevertheless, the evil inclination can still overpower him, Heaven forbid, as Sukkah 52a states:** יִצְרוֹ שֶׁל אָדָם מִתְגַּבֵּר עָלָיו בְּכָל יוֹם. — **"A person's inclination grows stronger against him each day."**

Mashiach ben Yosef and the End of the Inclination

וְעַל זֶה יָצָא עוֹד מִזַּרְעַ יוֹסֵף מָשִׁיחַ בֶּן יוֹסֵף, — **For this, Mashiach ben Yosef also comes from Yosef's**

[1547] **Nedarim 22b**: 'Rav Adda, son of Rabbi Ḥanina, said: Had Israel not sinned in earlier times they would have been given the five books of the Torah and the book of Joshua alone. They needed the book of Joshua because it includes the arrangement of Eretz Yisrael. Since it contains the division of Eretz Yisrael among the tribes, it was required for all generations, but the other books of the prophets primarily detail the history of how Israel angered God and He sent prophets to admonish them. What is the reason, i.e., what is the allusion to this idea? It is stated: "For in much wisdom is much vexation" (Ecclesiastes 1:18). All the wisdom that the Jews possess from the books of the Bible is the result of their angering God.'

[1548] **Peri Tzadik, Chanukah 2:4**: "Joshua was the first to write his own book after the Five Books of the Torah, and it is a form of Oral Torah. This is what is said in Nedarim 22b: 'Had Israel not sinned, only the Five Books of the Torah and the book of Joshua would have been given to them, for it contains the arrangement of the Land of Israel.' The Land of Israel is called the inheritance of the Lord; it is the root of 'land,' which is the attribute of Malchut, the mouth, the Oral Torah. The book of Joshua is the portion of Oral Torah that every soul of Israel has in Torah; each person's portion in the Land of Israel points to it."

[1549] **Kiddushin 49b:5**: "Ten kav-measures of wisdom descended into the world: The Land of Israel took nine, and the entire rest of the world took one. Ten kav-measures of beauty descended into the world: Jerusalem took nine, and the entire rest of the world took one. Ten kav-measures of wealth descended into the world: Rome took nine, and the entire rest of the world took one. Ten kav-measures of poverty descended into the world: Babylonia took nine, and the entire rest of the world took one. Ten kav-measures of arrogance descended into the world: Elam took nine, and the entire rest of the world took one."

[1550] **Bava Batra 158b**: 'GEMARA: The mishna states that according to Rabbi Akiva, the property retains its previous ownership status. The Gemara asks: In whose possession does the property remain? Rabbi Ila says: It remains in the possession of the mother's heirs. Rabbi Zeira, when he was still in Babylonia, said: It remains in the possession of the son's heirs. When Rabbi Zeira ascended to Eretz Yisrael, he adopted the opinion of Rabbi Ila, whereas Rabba, in Babylonia, adopted the opinion stated by Rabbi Zeira. Rabbi Zeira said: Conclude from this incident that the air of Eretz Yisrael makes one wise, as when I ascended to Eretz Yisrael I accepted the opinion of Rabbi Ila, who was also from Eretz Yisrael, whereas Rabba, who remained in Babylonia, accepted my former opinion.'

[1551] **Peri Tzadik, Rosh Chodesh Shvat 4:1**: "They interpret 'He made the letter tzadi rule over thought' as follows: tzadi alludes to the righteous person, who is 'mighty, subduing his inclination.' This means that he still has work and struggle with the evil inclination and still needs light—that the blessed God illuminate him so that he can overcome it. As we have often said concerning 'The righteous are destined for light' (Ta'anit 15a), for it is written, 'Light is sown for the righteous.' This is through the light of Torah, as stated in the holy Zohar (I, 202a): 'There is nothing that breaks the evil inclination except Torah.' Through thinking about Torah one is saved from foolish thoughts."

[1552] **Sukkah 52a:13**; **Sukkah 52b:1**: "Rabbi Yitzchak said: A person's inclination overpowers him every day, as it says, 'Only evil all day long.' Rabbi Shimon ben Lakish said: A person's inclination overpowers him every day and seeks to kill him, as it says, 'The wicked watches the righteous and seeks to kill him.' Were the Holy One, blessed be He, not to help him, he could not overcome it, as it says, 'The Lord will not abandon him into its hand, nor condemn him when he is judged.'"

descendants. שֶׁהוּא יְתַקֵּן כָּל יִשְׂרָאֵל, שֶׁיּוּכְלוּ לְתַקֵּן כָּל הֶעָבָר עַל יְדֵי דִּבְרֵי תוֹרָה, **— He will rectify all Israel, enabling them to repair the entire past through words of Torah,** וְאָז יִתְבַּטֵּל הַיֵּצֶר הָרָע מִכֹּל וָכֹל. **— and the evil inclination will then be completely nullified.** וְאַף שֶׁעוֹד יִהְיֶה גּוֹג וּמָגוֹג שֶׁיָּבֹא לְקַטְרֵג עַל יִשְׂרָאֵל, וְיִהְיֶה פַּחַד שֶׁיִּסְבְּרוּ שֶׁיּוּכְלוּ לְהִתְקַלְקֵל, **— Although Gog and Magog will still come to accuse Israel, bringing fear that they might yet become corrupted,** וְרַק עַל יְדֵי מָשִׁיחַ בֶּן דָּוִד יִהְיֶה הַתְּשׁוּעָה מֵהַיֵּצֶר הָרָע, שֶׁיִּשְׁחֲטוֹט הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא לְהַיֵּצֶר הָרָע (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב שָׁם),[1553] **— and deliverance from the inclination will come only through Mashiach ben David, when the Holy One, blessed be He, will slaughter it, as stated there,** אֲבָל בֶּאֱמֶת יִהְיֶה רַק פַּחַד, וְיוֹשֵׁב בַּשָּׁמַיִם יִשְׂחָק.[1554] **— in truth it will be only fear: "He who sits in heaven laughs."** וְזֶהוּ שֶׁחָשְׁבוּ כָּאן וְנִטּוּל הַלֵּב, **— This explains why "removal of the heart" is listed here:** שֶׁבֶּאֱמֶת עַל יְדֵי קְדוּשַׁת בְּחִינַת צַדִּיק, שֶׁהוּא מָשִׁיחַ בֶּן יוֹסֵף, יִהְיֶה נְטוּל הַלֵּב מִכֹּל וָכֹל, **— through the holiness of the righteous one, Mashiach ben Yosef, the heart will indeed be entirely removed,** שֶׁיִּתְבַּטֵּל הַיֵּצֶר הָרָע בֶּאֱמֶת. **— meaning that the evil inclination will truly be nullified.**

From Removal of Evil to Joy of Heart

וּבְסֵפֶר חֶכְמוֹנִי לְרַבִּי שַׁבְּתַי דּוֹנוֹלוֹ זִכְרוֹנוֹ לִבְרָכָה אִיתָא: נוֹצַר עִם צָדִי, דְּלִי וּשְׂבָט וְרֶגֶל יָמִין וְהִרְהוּר וְשִׂמְחַת הַלֵּב. **— In Sefer Chakhmoni, Rabbi Shabbetai Donnolo, of blessed memory, reads: formed with tzadi are Aquarius, Shevat, the right foot, thought, and joy of the heart.** וְהַכֹּל אֶחָד, דְּבֶאֱמֶת יִהְיֶה אָז בִּזְמַן מָשִׁיחַ בֶּן יוֹסֵף בִּיטּוּל הַיֵּצֶר הָרָע מִכֹּל וָכֹל. **— Both readings mean the same thing, for in the time of Mashiach ben Yosef the evil inclination will indeed be entirely nullified.**

Joy from an undivided heart

וְאָמְרוּ (תַּעֲנִית טו.): צַדִּיקִים לְאוֹרָה וְיִשָּׁרִים לְשִׂמְחָה, לְיִשְׁרֵי לֵב שִׂמְחָה.[1555, 1556] **— They said in Ta'anit 15a: light is for the righteous, joy for the upright; "joy for the upright of heart."** שֶׁהַשִּׂמְחָה רַק כְּשֶׁמִּתְבַּטֵּל הַיֵּצֶר הָרָע מִכֹּל וָכֹל, **— Joy comes only when the evil inclination is completely nullified,** וּמִתְיַישֵּׁר הַלֵּב לִהְיוֹת לֵב אֶחָד לְאָבִיו שֶׁבַּשָּׁמַיִם, **— and the heart becomes upright, a single heart devoted to its Father in heaven.** וְאָז אֵין לוֹ שׁוּם מִלְחָמָה עִם הַיֵּצֶר הָרָע וְזוֹכֶה לְשִׂמְחָה (וְנִתְבָּאֵר כַּמָּה פְּעָמִים).[1557] **— Then he has no further battle with the evil inclination and merits joy, as explained several times.** וּבֶאֱמֶת מִצַּד הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרֵךְ יִזְכּוּ עַל יְדֵי מָשִׁיחַ בֶּן יוֹסֵף לְיַשְׁרוּת הַלֵּב, **— From Hashem's side, through Mashiach ben Yosef they will indeed merit an upright heart,** דִּכְתִיב: אוֹר צַדִּיקִים וְהַיְינוּ עַל יְדֵי הָאוֹר זָרוּעַ שֶׁזּוֹכֶה עַל יְדֵי בְּחִינַת יִשְׂמָח.[1558] **— for it says, "The light of the righteous rejoices."** צַדִּיק כְּשֶׁמִּתְגַּבֵּר עַל יִצְרוֹ.[1559] **— Through "light sown for the righteous," merited through righteousness when**

[1553] **Sukkah 52a:4**: "As Rabbi Yehudah expounded: In the future the Holy One, blessed be He, will bring the evil inclination and slaughter it before the righteous and the wicked. To the righteous it will appear like a high mountain, and to the wicked like a hair's breadth. These will weep, and those will weep. The righteous will weep and say, 'How were we able to conquer such a high mountain?' The wicked will weep and say, 'How were we unable to conquer this hair's breadth?' Even the Holy One, blessed be He, will marvel with them, as it says, 'Thus says the Lord of Hosts: If it is wondrous in the eyes of the remnant of this people in those days, it will also be wondrous in My eyes.'"

[1554] **Psalms 2:4**: 'The One who is enthroned in heaven laughs;my Sovereign mocks at them.'

[1555] **Taanit 15a**: "Rav Nachman bar Yitzchak said: I too say: Not everyone receives light, and not everyone receives joy. The righteous receive light, and the upright receive joy. The righteous receive light, as it is written: 'Light is sown for the righteous'; and the upright receive joy, as it is written: 'And joy for the upright in heart.'"

[1556] **Divrei Soferim 38:1**: "Through this one merits the heart's joy of those who seek Hashem, for it is written, "Rejoice in Hashem, you righteous." This is the joy Hashem desires in His world: "Let Israel rejoice in its Maker." It is possible only when the intervening screen is removed. Thus Tanna Devei Eliyahu, Rabbah chapter 3, says: "I feared through my joy, and rejoiced through my fear." Israel's joy is only that which comes through awe. It therefore says both "Serve Hashem with awe" and "Serve Hashem with joy," for the two must be together; see Berakhot 30b. This is fitting joy, excluding the joy of frivolity through satisfying worldly cravings, and the like, for one who has not merited it and for whom it becomes a potion of death, as in Yoma 72b. He has tasted the wine that brought wailing to the world: one who does not merit it is laid waste by it, as stated there, 76b. That joy is momentary, and through it he finally becomes desolate and empty of everything. This is the dross of might that Esau absorbed—"By your sword you shall live." He took this world as his portion, to rejoice in its momentary joy. Of this it says, "Your dwelling shall be of the richness of the earth," and so forth; the sages said that his blessing concerns what is already available. Joy in this world requires no preparation: it is ready for anyone who wishes to follow his heart's stubbornness and throw off the yoke. True joy, however, is not easily attained."

The origin distinguishes an actual repair of the heart from the later recognition of that repair in the messianic sequence. Divrei Soferim explains the quality of joy itself: it comes with awe and removal of an inner screen, unlike transient gratification. It adds a criterion for understanding "joy of the heart" without importing its separate Esau narrative into Pri Tzadik's chronology.

[1557] **Psalms 19:9**: 'The precepts of GOD are just,rejoicing the heart;the instruction of GOD is lucid,making the eyes light up.'

[1558] **Proverbs 13:9**: "The light of the righteous rejoices, but the lamp of the wicked will be extinguished."

[1559] **Psalms 97:11**: "Light is sown for the righteous, and joy for the upright in heart."

זוֹכֶה אַחַר כָּךְ לְיִישֵׁר הַלֵּב מִכֹּל וָכֹל, וְזוֹכֶה לְשִׂמְחָה הַמְיוּחָד לְיִשְׁרֵי לֵב. — **one overcomes his inclination, he subsequently merits an entirely upright heart and the joy reserved for the upright of heart.** אַךְ כֵּיוָן שֶׁלֹּא יֵדְעוּ אָז שֶׁהוּא מָשִׁיחַ בֶּן יוֹסֵף, אַחַר שֶׁיִּרְאוּ שֶׁיָּבוֹא גּוֹג וּמָגוֹג, וְיִהְיֶה פַּחַד שֶׁיּוּכַל לְהִתְקַלְקֵל, עַל כֵּן לֹא נִיכָּר עוֹד הַשִּׂמְחָה עַד שֶׁיָּבא מָשִׁיחַ בֶּן דָּוִד, וְיִשְׁתַּוט הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא לַיֵּצֶר הָרָע. — **Yet because they will not then know that he is Mashiach ben Yosef, on seeing Gog and Magog arrive they will fear that corruption is still possible. Joy will therefore not yet be apparent until Mashiach ben David comes and the Holy One, blessed be He, slaughters the evil inclination.** וְחָשְׁבוּ נֶגֶד זֶה וְנִטּוּל הַלֵּב, כְּמוֹ שֶׁיִּהְיֶה בֶּאֱמֶת אָז. — **Corresponding to this, the text lists "removal of the heart," as will truly have occurred then.** אַךְ הִתְגַּלּוּת הַשִּׂמְחָה לְיִשְׂרָאֵל יִהְיֶה עַל יְדֵי מָשִׁיחַ בֶּן דָּוִד כָּאָמּוּר. — **The revelation of joy to Israel, however, will come through Mashiach ben David, as stated.**

Sanctifying Eating through Torah

וְגִירְסַת הָאֲרִי זְכְרוֹנוֹ לִבְרָכָה: הִמְלִיךְ אוֹת צַדִּיק בִּלְעִיטָה.[1560] — **The Ari's reading is: "He made the letter tzaddik rule over swallowing."** וּלְפִי מַה שֶּׁכָּתוּב מִכְּתַב יַד הָאֲרִי זְכְרוֹנוֹ לִבְרָכָה, בְּאוֹת צָדִי שֶׁנִּיתַּן לְאָשֵׁר וּמוֹלֵךְ עַל הָאֲכִילָה, נִרְאֶה — **From what is written in the Ari's manuscript—that tzadi was assigned to Asher and rules over eating—** דְּגִרְיס: הִמְלִיךְ אוֹת צָדִי בַּאֲכִילָה וְכוּלֵי. — **it appears that his reading is, "He made the letter tzadi rule over eating," etc.** וְהַיְינוּ דְּהַזְּמַן בַּחוֹדֶשׁ זֶה לְתַקֵּן שׁוֹרֶשׁ פְּגַם הַנָּחָשׁ, שֶׁהָיָה בַּאֲכִילָה וּבְתַאֲוָה. — **This month is the time to repair the root of the serpent's damage, which lay in eating and desire.** וְהַזְּמַן לְתַקֵּן הָאֲכִילָה שֶׁיִּהְיֶה בִּקְדוּשָּׁה, כַּאֲכִילַת שַׁבָּת, שֶׁהִיא בִּקְדוּשָּׁה אַף כְּשֶׁהַגּוּף נֶהֱנֶה, וּכְמוֹ שֶׁכָּתַב הָאֲרִי זְכְרוֹנוֹ לִבְרָכָה. — **It is time to sanctify eating like eating on Shabbat, which is holy even when the body enjoys it, as the Ari wrote.** וְכֵן אֲכִילַת תַּלְמִידֵי חֲכָמִים, דְּמָיְין לְשַׁבָּתוֹת (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב זֹהַר חֵלֶק ג כט ב), הָוֶה גַּם כֵּן בִּקְדוּשָּׁה כַּאֲכִילַת שַׁבָּת. — **Likewise, Torah scholars' eating is holy like Shabbat eating, for they resemble Shabbat, as Zohar III, 29b, states.** וְהַיְינוּ שֶׁעַל יְדֵי דִּבְרֵי תוֹרָה יְכוֹלִים לְתַקֵּן הָאֲכִילָה, אַף כְּשֶׁהַגּוּף נֶהֱנֶה מְמֻנּוּ יִהְיֶה בִּקְדוּשָּׁה, כֵּיוָן שֶׁהוּא לְהִיוֹת כֹּחוֹ לְדִבְרֵי תוֹרָה. — **Through words of Torah, eating can be rectified so that it is holy even when the body enjoys it, because its purpose is to provide strength for Torah.**

Being Fed by Hashem

וְגִירְסַת בִּלְעִיטָה אָמַרְנוּ מֵהַמִּדְרָשׁ רַבָּה (בְּרֵאשִׁית רַבָּה פָּרָשָׁה סג): הַלְעִיטֵנִי, אֲנָא פָּתַח פִּימִי וְגוֹמֵר.[1561] — **We explained the reading "swallowing" from Bereishit Rabbah 63: "Feed me"—"I will open my mouth," etc.** וְהוּא עַל דֶּרֶךְ מַה שֶּׁאָמַרְנוּ בְּמִה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר אֵצֶל יַעֲקֹב אָבִינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם, וְנָתַן לִי לֶחֶם לֶאֱכוֹל, שֶׁהַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ יִתֵּן הַלֶּחֶם. — **This follows our explanation of Yaakov our father's words, "Give me bread to eat": Hashem will provide the bread,** וְגַם הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ יִהְיֶה הַמַּאֲכִיל כְּדֵי שֶׁיִּהְיֶה בִּקְדוּשָּׁה (וְנִתְבָּאֵר מַאֲמָר ג).[1562] — **and Hashem will also be the One who feeds him so that it is holy, as explained in teaching 3.** וְזֶהוּ לְעִיטָה עַל יְדֵי אֲחֵרִים (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב שַׁבָּת קנה:).[1563] — **This is swallowing through another's feeding, as in Shabbat 155b.** וְהַיְינוּ כְּמוֹ שֶׁיִּהְיֶה הָאֲכִילָה לֶעָתִיד, שֶׁעֲתִידָה אֶרֶץ יִשְׂרָאֵל שֶׁתּוֹצִיא גְּלוּסְקָאוֹת וְכוּלֵי (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב שָׁם ל:).[1564] — **It is like eating in the future, when the Land of Israel will**

[1560] **Sefer Yetzirah Gra Version 5:10**: 'He made the letter Tzadi king over swallowing/taste (le'itah), bound a crown to it, and combined one with another; and with them He formed Aquarius (Deli) in the universe, Shevat in the year, and the gizzard (kurkevan) in the soul, male and female.'

[1561] **Bereshit Rabbah 63:12** (excerpt): "'Esau said: Pour some of that red food into me' (Genesis 25:30). Rabbi Zeira said: That wicked man opened his mouth like a camel. He said: I will open my mouth, and you keep pouring it in. This is like what we learned: One may not stuff a camel or force its feed down, but one may put feed into its mouth."

[1562] **Peri Tzadik, Rosh Chodesh Shvat 3:1**: "Concerning Jacob our father, peace be upon him, it is written, 'And He will give me bread to eat and clothing to wear.' Why does it say 'to eat' and 'to wear'? Who does not know that bread is for eating and clothing is for wearing? Concerning the convert, where it is written, 'To give him bread and clothing,' it does not say 'bread to eat and clothing to wear.' Rather, Jacob our father asked that the blessed God give him the bread and also the eating—that He feed him, and the eating be in holiness. Likewise, He should give him the clothing and the wearing—that the blessed God clothe him."

[1563] **Shabbat 155b**: 'MISHNA: One may not forcibly overfeed a camel on Shabbat and one may not force-feed it, even if in doing so he does not overfeed the camel. However, one may place food into its mouth. And the mishna makes a distinction, which will be explained in the Gemara, between two manners of placing food in the mouths of cattle. One may not place food in the mouths of calves on Shabbat in the manner of hamra'a, but one may do so in the manner of halata. And one may force-feed chickens. And one may add water to bran used as animal feed, but one may not knead the mixture. And one may not place water before bees or before doves in a dove-cote, because they are capable of finding their own food; however, one may place water before geese and chickens and before hardisian hardeisiyyot doves.'

[1564] **Shabbat 30b**: 'And furthermore: Rabban Gamliel sat and interpreted a verse homiletically: In the future, the World-to-Come, Eretz Yisrael will produce cakes and fine wool garments that will grow in the ground, as it is stated: "Let abundant grain be in the land." A certain student scoffed at him and said: There is nothing new under the sun. He said to him: Come and I will show you an example in this world. He went outside and showed him truffles and mushrooms, which emerge from the earth over the course of a single night and are shaped like a loaf of bread. And with regard to

produce ready-made loaves, etc., as Shabbat 30b states. וְכֵן אָדָם הָרִאשׁוֹן בְּגַן עֵדֶן, אִיתָא (סַנְהֶדְרִין נט:) שֶׁהָיוּ מַלְאֲכֵי הַשָּׁרֵת צוֹלִין לוֹ בָּשָׂר וּמְסַנְנִין לוֹ יַיִן וְכוּ׳[1565] — **Likewise, Sanhedrin 59b relates that in Gan Eden, the ministering angels roasted meat and strained wine for Adam, etc.,** וְהֵבִינוּ שֶׁיְּכִינוּ לוֹ הַמַּאֲכָל מִכֹּל וָכֹל. — **meaning that they prepared his food completely.** וְזֶה לְעִיטָה, שֶׁיִּהְיֶה אַחֵר מַאֲכִיל. — **This is swallowing when another does the feeding.** וְהֵבִינוּ שֶׁיִּהְיֶה הָאֲכִילָה כְּמוֹ שֶׁהָיָה קוֹדֶם הַקִּלְקוּל אֲצֶל אָדָם הָרִאשׁוֹן, — **Eating will be as it was for Adam before the corruption,** שֶׁהָיָה הָאֲכִילָה דִּבְרֵי תוֹרָה, לְכוּ לַחֲמוּ בְלַחֲמִי, נַהֲמָא דְאוֹרַיְיתָא דְּבִכְתָב. — **when eating was words of Torah: "Come, eat of My bread," the bread of the Written Torah.**

Truth and the Upright Heart

וְהֵבִינוּ כְּמוֹ שֶׁיּוֹפִיעַ בְּנֶפֶשׁ מָשִׁיחַ בֶּן יוֹסֵף קְדוּשַׁת יַעֲקֹב אָבִינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם, דִּכְתִיב: תִּתֵּן אֱמֶת לְיַעֲקֹב. — **The holiness of Yaakov our father will shine in the soul of Mashiach ben Yosef: "You will give truth to Yaakov."** אָלֶף, פֶּלֶא עֶלְיוֹן; תָּו, מֵעַלְמָא דְאָתֵי, — **Alef represents the supernal wonder; tav comes from the World to Come.** וּבָעוֹלָם הַזֶּה נִבְרָא בְּאוֹת תָּו יוֹם הַשַּׁבָּת (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בְּסֵפֶר יְצִירָה),[1566] — **In this world, Shabbat was created with the letter tav, as stated in Sefer Yetzirah.** שֶׁהוּא מֵעֵין עוֹלָם הַבָּא, אֶחָד מִשִּׁשִּׁים לָעוֹלָם הַבָּא (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בְּרָכוֹת נז:),[1567] — **It is a foretaste of the World to Come, one-sixtieth of it, as Berakhot 57b states.** וּמוֹפִיעַ אָלֶף תָּו בְּאוֹת מֵם, שֶׁהוּא מִדַּת מַלְכוּת, כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב (זֹהַר חֶלֶק ג רלו ב).[1568] — **Alef and tav shine in the letter mem, the attribute of Malchut, as stated in Zohar III, 236b.** וּבָאֱמֶת מִצַּד הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ יוֹפִיעַ אָז יַשְׁרוּת הַלֵּב, לְיִשְׂרֵי לֵב שִׂמְחָה, וְיִהְיֶה נְטוּל הַלֵּב, — **From Hashem's side, uprightness of heart will then appear—"joy for the upright of heart"—and removal of the heart will take place,** שֶׁלֹּא יוּכַל יֵצֶר הָרָע לִכָּנֵס לְקַלְקֵל. — **so that the evil inclination cannot enter to corrupt it.** רַק לֹא יִהְיֶה נִיכָּר לְיִשְׂרָאֵל עַד שֶׁיָּבֹא תִּיכָף מָשִׁיחַ בֶּן דָּוִד, וְיִשְׁחַוט הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא לַיֵּצֶר הָרָע כָּאָמוּר. — **This will only become apparent to Israel when Mashiach ben David immediately comes and the Holy One, blessed be He, slaughters the evil inclination, as stated.**

The Month's Work: From Thought to Holy Eating

וְכָל אֵלֶּה הַכֹּל אֶחָד, דְּקִדּוּשַׁת הַחוֹדֶשׁ בְּאוֹת צַדִּיק, שֶׁהַתַּעֲסָק בּוֹ לְתַקֵּן שׁוֹרֶשׁ פְּגַם הַנָּחָשׁ שֶׁהָיָה בַּאֲכִילָה וְתַאֲוָה. — **All these meanings are one: the month's holiness lies in the letter tzaddik, and its work is to repair the root of the serpent's damage in eating and desire.** וְהַהַתְחָלָה לְתַקֵּן עַל יְדֵי הִרְהוּר בְּדִבְרֵי תוֹרָה, ה"ר"ב חָכְמָה" לְתַקֵּן ה"רָב כַּעַס". — **The repair begins by contemplating words of Torah: abundant wisdom to rectify abundant anger.** וְעַל יְדֵי זֶה יִזְכּוּ וְשֶׁלֹּא יַרְגִּישׁוּ כְּלָל הֲנָאַת עַצְמָן בַּאֲכִילָה (כְּמוֹ שֶׁנִּתְבָּאֵר לְאַכְילָה בְּקִדּוּשָׁה, — **Through this they will merit holy eating,** וְיִזְכּוּ לְלְעִיטָה, — **without feeling any self-serving pleasure in eating, as explained in teaching 4.**[1569] מַאֲמָר ד), — **They will merit being fed, as Adam ate before the corruption,** וְיִזְכּוּ וְכַאֲכִילַת אָדָם הָרִאשׁוֹן קוֹדֶם הַקִּלְקוּל, לְנְטוּל הַלֵּב וּלְשִׂמְחַת הַלֵּב. — **and will merit removal of the heart and joy of the heart.**

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wool garments, he showed him the covering of a heart of palm, a young palm branch, which is wrapped in a thin net-like covering.'

[1565] **Sanhedrin 59b:22**: "They raised an objection: Rabbi Yehudah ben Teima used to say: Adam the first man reclined in the Garden of Eden, and the ministering angels roasted meat for him and strained wine for him. The serpent looked at him, saw his honor, and became jealous of him. The answer is: That was meat descending from Heaven, rather than meat from animals that he was forbidden to eat."

[1566] **Sefer Yetzirah 4:14**: 'He made the letter Tav king over grace, bound a crown to it, and with it formed Jupiter in the universe, the Sabbath day in the year, and the mouth in the soul.'

[1567] **Berakhot 57b:13**: "The mnemonic is: five, six, and ten. Five things are one sixtieth of something else: fire, honey, Shabbos, sleep, and a dream. Fire is one sixtieth of Gehinnom; honey is one sixtieth of the manna; Shabbos is one sixtieth of the World to Come; sleep is one sixtieth of death; and a dream is one sixtieth of prophecy."

[1568] **Zohar, Pinchas 73:453**: "Rabbi Shimon opened and said: "Hear, Israel: the Lord our God, the Lord is one" (Deuteronomy 6:4). The ayin is enlarged, and so too the dalet. Together they form the sign ed, "witness," as it is written, "The Lord is witness among you" (I Samuel 12:5). The letters shin and mem remain—the mem is open. Why is it not closed? Because the closed mem is the upper King (another reading: the upper world); the open mem is the lower King (another reading: the lower world)."

[1569] **Peri Tzadik, Rosh Chodesh Shvat 4:1**: "This is what is said, 'He gives food to those who fear Him,' and likewise, 'She gives food to her household': those who fear Him eat only like a wolf taking its prey, without bodily self-gratification. Their eating is solely to sustain life, for the blessed God created the human being to need to take food into himself to sustain life, and His will is fulfilled thereby. This is 'She gives food to her household': the Torah scholars, who are the members of the household of the Congregation of Israel, as is known."

Rosh Chodesh Shevat Ois 6

The Letter Tzadi and the Opening of Oral Torah

Joining mind and heart gives religious speech its inward content.

The Letter Tzadi and the Opening of Oral Torah

Tzadi Joins Wisdom and Sovereignty

כָּל חוֹדֶשׁ נוֹצַר בְּאוֹת א׳ מי״ב פְּשׁוּטוֹת כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בְּסֵפֶר יְצִירָה, וְחָשַׁב לִשְׁבָט אוֹת צַדִּי.[1570] — **Each month was formed through one of the twelve simple letters, as written in Sefer Yetzirah, which assigns tzadi to Shevat.**

וְאִיתָא בְּאוֹתִיּוֹת דְּרַבִּי עֲקִיבָא: צַדִּי, אַל תִּקְרֵי צַדִּי אֶלָּא צַדִּיק, זֶה צַדִּיקוֹ שֶׁל עוֹלָם הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא,[1571] — **Otiyot deRabbi Akiva says: "Tzadi: read not tzadi but tzaddik. This is the Righteous One of the world, the Holy One, blessed be He,**

שֶׁהוּא עוֹשֶׂה צְדָקוֹת עִם בָּשָׂר וָדָם, זוֹ דַּעַת וְחָכְמָה וּבִינָה וּפְתִיחַת פֶּה וּמַעֲנֵה לָשׁוֹן שֶׁהוּא נוֹתֵן לִבְנֵי אָדָם וְכוּלֵי. — **who bestows kindness upon mortals: knowledge, wisdom, understanding, the opening of the mouth, and the tongue's response, which He grants human beings," and so forth.**

הָעִנְיָן, דְּאוֹת צ׳ צוּרָתוֹ יו״ד נו״ן, כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב רִאשׁוֹנִים וְאַחֲרוֹנִים. — **The point is that the form of tzadi consists of a yud and a nun, as early and later authorities write.**

וּבַזוֹהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ (חֶלֶק א ב ב): נ׳ אִיהִי, אַתְוָא י׳ דִּשְׁמָא דְּבְרִית קַדִּישָׁא וְרָכִיב עֲלַהּ וְכוּלֵי.[1572] — **The holy Zohar (I, 2b) says: "It is a nun; the yud of the name of the holy covenant comes and rides upon it," and so forth.**

וְהַיְינוּ דְּיוּד חָכְמָה כַּיָּדוּעַ; נ׳ מַלְכוּת כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב (זוֹהַר חֶלֶק ג סו ב): נ׳ כְּפוּפָה דָּא מַטְרוֹנִיתָא. — **Yud signifies wisdom, as is known; nun signifies sovereignty, as written in the Zohar (III, 66b): "The bent nun is the Matron."**

וּבַזוֹהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ (חֶלֶק ב צא א): נ׳ רָזָא לְמַדְחַל מִקּוּדְשָׁא בְּרִיךְ הוּא, — **The holy Zohar (II, 91a) says: "Nun is the mystery of fearing the Holy One, blessed be He,**

וּלְמִנְדַּע דְּאִית דִּין וְאִית דַּיָּין וְאִית אָגַר טָב לְצַדִּיקַיָּא וּפוּרְעָנוּת לְרַשִּׁיעַיָּא, בְּגִין דְּרָזָא דִּילֵיהּ ה׳ תַּתָּאָה. — **and knowing that there is judgment and a Judge, good reward for the righteous and punishment for the wicked, for its mystery is the lower heh."**

וְהַיְינוּ ה׳ כְּשֶׁכָּל א׳ כָּלוּל מֵעֶשֶׂר הֵיא נ׳ שַׁעֲרֵי בִינָה. — **Heh, five, with each of its elements comprising ten, is thus the fifty gates of understanding.**

וְכֵן כָּתוּב פֵּירֵשׁ רַבֵּינוּ שְׁלֹמֹה יִצְחָקִי (רֵישׁ פָּרָשַׁת וָאֵרָא) עַל אֲנִי הַשֵּׁם, שֶׁהוּא מִמִּדַּת מַלְכוּת כַּיָּדוּעַ, אֲנִי מִן אֲדנוּת,[1573] — **Rashi likewise explains "I am Hashem" at the beginning of Va'era. This is the quality of sovereignty, as is known; "I" belongs to the Name of Lordship.**

וּפֵירֵשׁ רַבֵּינוּ שְׁלֹמֹה יִצְחָקִי: אֲנִי נֶאֱמָן לְיַפְרַע, וּכְשֶׁהוּא אָמוּר לְעִנְיַן קִיּוּם מִצְוֹת, נֶאֱמָן לִיתֵּן שָׂכָר.[1574] — **Rashi explains: "I am faithful to exact punishment"; when said in connection with fulfilling commandments, it means faithful to give reward.**

וְה׳ ד׳ הֲוַת, וְהַיְינוּ ד׳ דְּקַבִּילַת עוּבָּרָה וְנַעֲשָׂה ה׳ הֵיא יו״ד דְּשֵׁם שַׁדַּי, יוּד דִּבְרִית קַדִּישָׁא, — **Heh was a dalet; the yud it received as its offspring, becoming a heh, is the yud of the Name Shaddai, the yud of the holy covenant.**

כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמַרְנוּ מֵהַזוֹהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ וּמִמִּדְרַשׁ תַּנְחוּמָא תַּזְרִיעַ: הַיְינוּ״ד בַּמִּילָה, עַיֵּין שָׁם.[1575](מַאֲמָר ב) — **As we explained in Teaching 2 from the holy Zohar and from Midrash Tanchuma on Tazria: the yud is in circumcision; see there.**

וְהַצַּדִּיק אָחִיד בִּשְׁמַיָּא וְאַרְעָא, דְּמְחַבֵּר הַיְינוּ״ד לְנ׳. — **The righteous person grasps heaven and earth together, joining the**

[1570] **Sefer Yetzirah Gra Version 5:10**: 'He made the letter Tzadi king over swallowing/taste (le'itah), bound a crown to it, and combined one with another; and with them He formed Aquarius (Deli) in the universe, Shevat in the year, and the gizzard (kurkevan) in the soul, male and female.'

[1571] **Otzar Midrashim, Midrashim of Rabbi Akiba, Aleph Bet of Rabbi Akiba (Version 1) 40**: "Tzadi: Do not read tzadi but tzedek, righteousness. This is the righteousness of the Holy One, blessed be He, which He performs for flesh and blood: the knowledge, wisdom, understanding, opening of the mouth, and response of the tongue that He gives to human beings, through which the whole world endures. Were it not for the tongue's response and the opening of the mouth, the world could not endure even for one hour."

[1572] **Zohar, Introduction 6:38**: "The letter Aleph remained in her place without presenting herself. Said the Holy One, blessed be His name: Aleph, Aleph, wherefore comest thou not before Me like the rest of the letters? She answered: Because I saw all the other letters leaving Thy presence without any success. What, then, could I achieve there? And further, since Thou hast already bestowed on the letter Beth this great gift, it is not meet for the Supreme King to take away the gift which He has made to His servant and give it to another. The Lord said to her: Aleph, Aleph, although I will begin the creation of the world with the beth, thou wilt remain the first of the letters. My unity shall not be expressed except through thee, on thee shall be based all calculations and operations of the world, and unity shall not be expressed save by the letter Aleph."

[1573] **Rashi on Exodus 6:2:2**: 'Rashi on Exodus 6:2 ("I am the Lord"): "Faithful to pay a good reward to those who walk before Me, and faithful to exact punishment from those who transgress My words."'

[1574] **Rashi on Exodus 6:2:2**: 'Rashi on Exodus 6:2 ("I am the Lord"): "Faithful to pay a good reward to those who walk before Me, and faithful to exact punishment from those who transgress My words."'

[1575] **Peri Tzadik, Rosh Chodesh Shvat 2:1**: "The letter yud signifies the covenant, as stated in the holy Zohar (II, 36a): 'Because yud is revealed,' and so forth; see there. Likewise, the Midrash (Tanchuma, Tazria 5) says: 'What is the Name and seal He placed upon them? It is Shaddai: shin in the nose, dalet in the hand, and yud in circumcision.' The Name Shaddai is the ninth Name, corresponding to the attribute 'the righteous one, foundation of the world,' as stated in Zohar III, 11b."

yud to the nun. וּמַלְכוּת הוּא רוּחַ הַקּוֹדֶשׁ, כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בַּגְּמָרָא (מְגִילָּה יד:) עַל פָּסוּק: וַתִּלְבַּשׁ אֶסְתֵּר מַלְכוּת,[1576, 1577] — **Sovereignty means the holy spirit, as the Gemara explains (Megillah 14b) on "Esther clothed herself in sovereignty."** וּבַזּוֹהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ (חֶלֶק ג קסט ב) עַל בִּלְבּוּשׁ מַלְכוּת דְּמָרְדֳּכַי.[1578] — **The holy Zohar (III, 169b) likewise explains Mordecai's royal clothing.** וְרוּחַ הַקּוֹדֶשׁ, כְּלוֹמַר רוּחַ מֵהַהוּא קוֹדֶשׁ דִּלְעֵילָּא, כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בַּזּוֹהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ (שָׁם סא א):[1579] — **"The holy spirit" means a spirit from that holiness above, as the holy Zohar says (there, 61a): "The higher holiness, the higher wisdom."** וְהַצַּדִּיק מְחַבֵּר חָכְמָה וּמַלְכוּת, וְהַיו"ד תַּתָּאָה, יו"ד דִּבְרִית, הוּא עוּבָּרָה דְּקַבִּילַת ד' וְהוּא ה'. — **The righteous person joins wisdom and sovereignty. The lower yud, the yud of the covenant, is the offspring received by dalet, becoming heh.**

Wisdom becomes living speech

וְזֶה שֶׁכָּתוּב: זֶה צַדִּיקוֹ שֶׁל עוֹלָם שֶׁהוּא עוֹשֶׂה צְדָקוֹת כּוּלֵי, זוֹ דַּעַת חָכְמָה וּבִינָה,[1580] — **This explains "the Righteous One of the world who bestows kindness," namely knowledge, wisdom, and understanding.** שֶׁהַדַּעַת בְּחִבּוּר חָכְמָה שֶׁבַּמּוֹחַ עִם בִּינָה שֶׁבַּלֵּב, כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמַרְנוּ עַל מַה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: כִּי תָבוֹא חָכְמָה בְלִבֶּךָ וְדַעַת וְגוֹמֵר (וְנִתְבָּאֵר כַּמָּה פְּעָמִים).[1581] — **Knowledge joins wisdom in the mind to understanding in the heart, as we explained from "When wisdom enters your heart, and knowledge," and so forth.** וְהֵיינוּ ג' רֹאשׁוֹנוֹת, י"ה עִם קוּצָא דְיוּד דִּלְעֵילָּא שֶׁרוֹמֵז לְכֶתֶר עֶלְיוֹן, — **These are the three upper qualities: yud–heh together with the upper tip of the yud, which alludes to the supernal Crown,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בַּזּוֹהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ (שָׁם סה ב), וְדַעַת פְּנִימִיּוּת הַכֶּתֶר כְּיָדוּעַ.[1582] — **as written in the holy Zohar (there, 65b). Knowledge is the inner dimension of the Crown, as is known.**

The Mouth of Shabbat and Oral Torah

וּפְתִיחַת פֶּה וּמַעֲנֵה לָשׁוֹן שֶׁהוּא נוֹתֵן לִבְנֵי אָדָם, — **"And the opening of the mouth and the tongue's response, which He grants human beings,"** הֵיינוּ מַלְכוּת פֶּה, תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה קְרִינַן לָהּ.[1583] — **means "Sovereignty is the mouth; we call it the Oral Torah."** וּבַזּוֹהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ (חֶלֶק ג רא ב): אִתְקַדַּשׁ יוֹמָא, סָלִיק פּוּמָא דְּשַׁלִּיט עַל כֹּלָּא, פִּי הַשֵּׁם.[1584]

[1576] **Megillah 14b:9**: "Esther is included among the prophetesses, for it is written, 'On the third day Esther clothed herself in royalty.' Should it not have said 'royal garments'? Rather, the holy spirit clothed her. Here it says, 'She clothed herself,' and there it says, 'A spirit clothed Amasai,' and so forth."

[1577] **Esther 5:1**: 'On the third day, Esther put on royal apparel and stood in the inner court of the king's palace, facing the king's palace, while the king was sitting on his royal throne in the throne room facing the entrance of the palace.'

[1578] **Zohar, Sh'lach 30:231**: "He said to him: 'The air of the Garden of Eden is the breathing of the holy spirit, and the righteous clothe themselves in it, as they were in this world. Afterward, the holy spirit rests upon the head of each one; it is crowned and becomes a crown for him. So it was with Mordecai: it is written, "In royal clothing"—the likeness of that world—and afterward, "And a great crown of gold." This is the crown that rests upon the heads of the righteous in that world.'"

[1579] **Zohar, Achrei Mot 12:86-87**: "R. Hizkiah then began with the text: "The Lord God hath given me the tongue of them that are taught, that I should know how to sustain with words him that is weary" (Isa. 50, 4). 'Happy are Israel in that God has chosen them above all other peoples and called them "holy" and given them as their portion union with the holy name. How do they effect this union? By their attainments in the Torah, for knowledge of the Torah means union with the Holy One, blessed be He. We have learnt in the presence of our Master: What is holiness? The consummation of the whole which is called Supernal Wisdom. From thence issue streams and fountains in all directions till they reach this zoth. And when this zoth is blessed from the supernal place called Holiness and Wisdom, it is called "the spirit of holiness"; and when mysteries of the Torah proceed from it, it is called "the language of holiness"."

[1580] **Sichat Malakhei HaSharet 2:32**: "The third excellence that comes through service is the joining of mind and heart together. This is the excellence of prophecy, for, as is known, the root of the word "prophet" is "utterance of the lips," in Isaiah 57:19, meaning a speaker: the perfection of the power of speech, which belongs to the heart, as explained above. Therefore a prophet was formerly called "the seer" in Israel, as in I Samuel 9:9, and as it says in Ecclesiastes 1:16, "My heart has seen much wisdom." Seeing too belongs to the heart when it is joined and united with the wisdom of the mind. That is, the heart's feeling of Hashem's unity comes from wisdom and knowledge, and they are united, in the manner of the saying in Avot: "If there is no awe, there is no wisdom; if there is no wisdom, there is no awe."
Pri Tzadik presents mind, heart, and speech as divine gifts joined through the tzadi. Sichat Malakhei HaSharet supplies the inner account of that joining: the heart's felt recognition grows from knowledge and takes form in speech. Its full paragraph goes on to distinguish Moses' and Isaiah's prophetic qualities, so the connection concerns the mechanism of joining rather than asserting that all forms of inspired speech are identical.

[1581] **Proverbs 2:10**: "For wisdom will enter your mind And knowledge will delight you."

[1582] **Zohar, Achrei Mot 27:171**: "Come and see: Yud is at the beginning, the totality of everything, concealed on every side, with its paths not opened; it comprises male and female. The upper tip of Yud alludes to Ayin, nothingness. Then comes Yud, which brings forth that river that flows and issues from it, so that Hei may be impregnated from it. Of this it is written, "A river goes out from Eden": "goes out," not "went out." For this reason she must not be separated from him, and for this reason it is written, "My companion.""

[1583] **Tikkunei Zohar 17a:16**: 'Tikkunei Zohar 17a: 16: 'And they are called in this arrangement: Ḥesed – right arm, Gevurah – left arm, Tipheret – body, Netzaḥ and Hod – two thighs, and Yesod – end of the body, – sign of the holy covenant. Malkhut – 'mouth' – we call it 'Oral Torah'.''

[1584] **Zohar, Balak 26:306**: 'Zohar, Balak (III:201b): "When the day is sanctified, the supernal Mouth that rules over all

— The holy Zohar (III, 201b) says: "When the day is sanctified, the mouth that rules over all ascends: the mouth of Hashem." וְכֵן כָּתוּב בְּסֵפֶר יְצִירָה (פֶּרֶק ד): וְיוֹם שַׁבָּת בַּשָּׁנָה וּפֶה בַּנֶּפֶשׁ.[1585] **— Sefer Yetzirah (chapter 4) likewise says: "The Sabbath day in the year and the mouth in the person."** וּכְבָר אָמַרְנוּ שֶׁבְּוַדַּאי הַפֶּה לֹא נִבְרָא בְּשַׁבָּת, שֶׁכְּבָר דִּיבֵּר אָדָם הָרִאשׁוֹן בְּעֶרֶב שַׁבָּת. **— We have explained that the mouth was certainly not created on Shabbat, since Adam had already spoken on Friday.** רַק בְּשַׁבָּת נִבְרָא הַכֹּחַ שֶׁיְּדַבֵּר הָאָדָם בְּתוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה וְיִהְיֶה פִּי הַשֵּׁם. **— Rather, Shabbat brought into being the capacity for a person to speak Oral Torah and become the mouth of Hashem.** וְאִיתָא בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ (חֵלֶק א לב א): וְהַאי דִּיבּוּר אִקְרֵי שַׁבָּת, דְּשַׁבָּת אִקְרֵי דִּיבּוּר.[1586] **— The holy Zohar (I, 32a) says: "This speech is called Shabbat," for Shabbat is called speech.** וְהַיְינוּ דְּפֶה כְּלִי הַדִּיבּוּר וְהַדִּיבּוּר שְׁנֵיהֶם מִדַּת מַלְכוּת שֶׁהוּא תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה, וְזֶהוּ פְּתִיחַת פֶּה וּמַעֲנֵה לָשׁוֹן. **— The mouth, the vessel of speech, and speech itself both belong to sovereignty, the Oral Torah. — This is "the opening of the mouth and the tongue's response."**

Repairing Adam through the Toil of Torah

— On the sixth day, corresponding to "the righteous person, the foundation of the world," Hashem, blessed be He, created the human being circumcised. וּבְיוֹם ו׳ שֶׁכְּנֶגֶד מִדַּת צַדִּיק יְסוֹד עוֹלָם בָּרָא הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ אֶת הָאָדָם שֶׁנִּבְרָא מָהוּל,[1587] **— As it says in Sanhedrin 38b: "His foreskin was drawn forward."** כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב (סַנְהֶדְרִין לח:): מָשׁוּךְ בְּעָרְלָתוֹ הָיָה.[1588] **— The serpent's damage caused his foreskin to extend, making him uncircumcised, and brought the foreskin to all his descendants.** וְהַיְינוּ שֶׁעַל יְדֵי פְּגַם הַנָּחָשׁ נִמְשְׁכָה עָרְלָתוֹ וְנַעֲשָׂה עָרֵל, וְגַם הָעָרְלָה לְכָל תּוֹלְדוֹתָיו. **— It follows that he was created circumcised. He was the righteous foundation of the world, for whose sake the world was created (Yoma 38b).** מִכְּלָל שֶׁנִּבְרָא מָהוּל, וְהוּא הָיָה צַדִּיק יְסוֹד עוֹלָם שֶׁבִּשְׁבִילוֹ נִבְרָא הָעוֹלָם (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב יוֹמָא לח:).[1589, 1590] **— He is the one pillar named "righteous" in the Gemara (Chagigah 12b): the quality of "all," which unites heaven and earth.** וְהוּא עַמּוּד א׳ וְצַדִּיק שְׁמוֹ, שֶׁבַּגְּמָרָא (חֲגִיגָה יב:), וְזֶהוּ מִדַּת כֹּל דְּאָחִיד בִּשְׁמַיָּא וְאַרְעָא.[1591] **— After the serpent caused damage through desire in eating, implanted impurity in Eve, and caused the damage of the hundred and thirty years, — the month of Shevat was assigned tzadi ruling over swallowing, to repair the root of this damage.** וְאַחַר פְּגַם הַנָּחָשׁ בְּתַאֲוָה בַּאֲכִילָה, וְהַטִּיל זוּהֲמָא בְּחַוָּה וְגָרַם פְּגַם הַק״ל שָׁנָה, חוֹדֶשׁ שְׁבָט הִמְלִיד אוֹת צ׳ בִּלְעִיטָה לְתַקֵּן שׁוֹרֶשׁ הַקִּלְקוּל. וְתִיקּוּנוֹ עַל יְדֵי תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **— Its repair comes through Oral Torah, as explained.** וּבְכָנִיסַת הַשַּׁבָּת כְּתִיב: וַיַּרְא אֱלֹהִים אֶת כָּל אֲשֶׁר עָשָׂה וְהִנֵּה טוֹב מְאֹד.[1592] **— As Shabbat entered, it says: "God saw all that He had made, and behold, it was very**

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ascends—the Mouth of Hashem, which is the Oral Torah.'"

[1585] **Sefer Yetzirah Gra Version 4:14**: 'Two stones build 2 houses/ Three stones build 6 houses/ Four stones build 24 houses/ Five stones build 120 houses/ Six stones build 720 houses/ Seven stones build 5040 houses/ From here on go out and calculate/ that which the mouth cannot speak/ and the ear cannot hear.'

[1586] **Zohar, Bereshit 36:352-353**: "in order that the sinners of the world might not enjoy it, and it is treasured up for the righteous, i.e. for the Zaddik, as it is written, "light is sown for the Zaddik" (Ps. 97, 11); then worlds will be firmly established and all will form a single whole, but until the time when the future world shall emerge this light is hidden and stored up. This light issued from the darkness which was carved out by the strokes of the Most Recondite; and similarly from that light which was stored away there was carved out through some hidden process the lower-world darkness in which light resides. This lower darkness is what is called "night" in the verse, "and the darkness he called night" (Gen. 1, 5)."

[1587] **Proverbs 10:25**: 'Proverbs 10: 25: 'When the storm passes a wicked person is gone,But the righteous person is an everlasting foundation.''

[1588] **Sanhedrin 38b:11**: "Rav Yehudah also said in Rav's name: Adam the first man was a heretic, as it says, 'The Lord God called to Adam and said to him: Where are you?'—meaning, 'Where has your heart turned?' Rabbi Yitzchak said: He drew his foreskin forward to conceal the covenant. Here it is written, 'But they, like Adam, transgressed a covenant,' and there it is written, 'He has broken My covenant.'"

[1589] **Proverbs 10:25**: 'Proverbs 10: 25: 'When the storm passes a wicked person is gone,But the righteous person is an everlasting foundation.''

[1590] **Yoma 38b:11**; **Yoma 38b:14**: "From the curse upon the wicked you learn a blessing for the righteous, as it is written, 'The people of Sodom were wicked and sinful toward the Lord,' followed by, 'The Lord said to Avram after Lot had separated from him.' Rabbi Elazar said: The world was created even for the sake of one righteous person, as it says, 'God saw that the light was good.' 'Good' means a righteous person, as it says, 'Say of the righteous that it is good.' Rabbi Chiyya bar Abba said in Rabbi Yochanan's name: The world endures even for the sake of one righteous person, as it says, 'The righteous one is the foundation of the world.' Rabbi Chiyya himself said that it is learned from here: 'He guards the feet of His pious ones.' But 'His pious ones' implies many! Rav Nachman bar Yitzchak said: It is written chasido, 'His pious one,' in the singular."

[1591] **Chagigah 12b:3**: "The Sages say: The earth stands upon twelve pillars, as it says, 'He set the boundaries of peoples according to the number of the children of Israel.' Some say: Seven pillars, as it says, 'She has hewn her seven pillars.' Rabbi Elazar ben Shammua says: Upon one pillar, whose name is Tzaddik, 'Righteous,' as it says, 'The righteous one is the foundation of the world.'"

[1592] **Genesis 1:31**: 'And God saw all that He had made, and behold, it was very good. And there was evening and there

good." וַהֲיֵינוּ מִדַּת כֹּל שֶׁהוּא אָדָם הָרִאשׁוֹן צַדִּיק יְסוֹד עוֹלָם,[1593] **— This is the quality of "all": Adam, the righteous foundation of the world,** כִּי כֹל בַּשָּׁמַיִם וָאָרֶץ, דְּאָחִיד בִּשְׁמַיָּא וְאַרְעָא.[1594] **— for "all that is in heaven and earth" unites heaven and earth.** וְעַל יְדֵי הַנָּחָשׁ קִלְקֵל, רָאָה הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ שֶׁהַקִּלְקוּל גָּרַם לִהְיוֹת טוֹב מְאֹד עַל יְדֵי תְּשׁוּבָה. **— Though he became damaged through the serpent, Hashem, blessed be He, saw that repentance would make the damage lead to "very good."** וְכֵן כָּתוּב (בְּבְרֵאשִׁית רַבָּה פָּרָק ט): הוּא מְאֹ"ד הוּא אָדָ"ם כּוּלֵי.[1595] **— Bereshit Rabbah, chapter 9, likewise says: "'Very' is 'Adam,'" and so forth.** וְהַיְינוּ שֶׁבְּשַׁבָּת עַל יְדֵי הַתּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה שֶׁהוּא מִדַּת שַׁבָּת יִתְקַן שֶׁיִּהְיֶה טוֹב מְאֹד. **— On Shabbat, through Oral Torah, which is the quality of Shabbat, he repairs himself to become "very good."** וְזֶה דְּחָשַׁשׁ פְּתִיחַת פֶּה וּמַעֲנֵה לָשׁוֹן שֶׁהוּא נוֹתֵן לִבְנֵי אָדָם, **— This explains why the passage lists the opening of the mouth and the tongue's response, which He grants human beings.** שֶׁאִלְמָלֵא מַעֲנֵה לָשׁוֹן וּפִתְחוֹן פֶּה אֵין הָעוֹלָם יָכוֹל לְהִתְקַיֵּים אֲפִילוּ שָׁעָה א'. **— Without the tongue's response and the opening of the mouth, the world could not endure even a single hour.** וְהוּא עַל פִּי מַה שֶׁכָּתוּב בַּגְּמָרָא (סַנְהֶדְרִין צט:): אָדָם לְעָמָל יוּלָּד, לַעֲמַל פֶּה נִבְרָא כּוּלֵי,[1596] **— This follows the Gemara (Sanhedrin 99b): "'A person is born for toil'—he was created for the toil of the mouth," and specifically for the toil of Torah.** וְאִיתָא (שַׁבָּת פח.) שֶׁהִתְנָה הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ עִם מַעֲשֵׂה בְרֵאשִׁית: אִם יִשְׂרָאֵל מְקַבְּלִין הַתּוֹרָה אַתֶּם מִתְקַיְּימִין וְכוּלֵי.[1597] **— Shabbat 88a teaches that Hashem, blessed be He, stipulated with creation: "If Israel accepts the Torah, you will endure," and so forth.**

Moses Receives the Power of Speech

Otiyot deRabbi Akiva continues: "When Moses said before the Holy One, blessed be He, 'Behold, I am uncircumcised of lips,' וְאָמַר אַחַר כָּךְ בְּאוֹתִיּוֹת דְּרַבִּי עֲקִיבָא: לְפִי שֶׁבְּשָׁעָה שֶׁאָמַר מֹשֶׁה לִפְנֵי הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא: הֵן אֲנִי עֲרַל שְׂפָתָיִם, נִזְדַּעֲזְעוּ כָּל בְּרִיּוֹת שֶׁבָּעוֹלָם וְאָמְרוּ: מַה מֹּשֶׁה שֶׁעָתִיד לְדַבֵּר עִמּוֹ שְׁכִינָה בְּקע"ה מְקוֹמוֹת,[1598, 1599] **— all creatures in the world trembled and said: 'If Moses, with whom the Divine Presence will speak in a hundred and seventy-five places—'"** וְהוּא בְּקע"ה פָּרָשִׁיּוֹת שֶׁבַּתּוֹרָה, כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב (מַסֶּכֶת סוֹפְרִים פֶּרֶק טז הֲלָכָה י) שֶׁכְּנֶגֶד שְׁנוֹתָיו שֶׁל אַבְרָהָם אָבִינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם, עַיֵּין שָׁם.[1600] **— These are the hundred and seventy-five Torah sections corresponding to Abraham's years, as stated in Tractate Soferim 16:10; see there.** וְאָמַר: וְהוּא מְבָאֵר כָּל אוֹת וְאוֹת וְכָל דָּבָר וְדָבָר וְכָל פָּסוּק וּפָסוּק שֶׁבַּתּוֹרָה בְּע' לְשׁוֹן. **— It says: "He explains every letter, every statement, and every verse in the Torah in seventy languages."** וְהַיְינוּ כְּמָה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: בֵּאֵר אֶת הַתּוֹרָה וְגוֹמֵר, וּפֵירֵשׁ רַבִּינוּ שְׁלֹמֹה יִצְחָקִי (וְכֵן הוּא בְּמִדְרַשׁ תַּנְחוּמָא): בְּע' לָשׁוֹן פֵּירְשָׁהּ לָהֶם,[1601, 1602] **— This refers to "He explained the Torah," and so**

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was morning, the sixth day (yom ha-shishi).'

[1593] **Proverbs 10:25**: 'Proverbs 10: 25: 'When the storm passes a wicked person is gone,But the righteous person is an everlasting foundation.''

[1594] **I Chronicles 29:11**: 'I Chronicles 29: 11: 'Yours, ETERNAL One, are greatness, might, splendor, triumph, and majesty—yes, all that is in heaven and on earth; to You, ETERNAL One, belong kingship and preeminence above all.''

[1595] **Bereshit Rabbah 9:12** (excerpt): "The Sages say in the name of Rabbi Chanina bar Idi, Rabbi Pinchas, and Rabbi Chilkiyah: 'Me'od' is 'Adam.' The letters of the one are the letters of the other. This is what is written: 'God saw all that He had made, and behold, it was very good' (Genesis 1:31)—this is Adam."

[1596] **Sanhedrin 99b:2**: 'Rabbi Elazar said: Every person was created for labor, as it says, 'Man is born for labor.' I do not know whether for the labor of the mouth or for physical labor. 'His mouth presses him on' teaches that he was created for the labor of the mouth. I still do not know whether for the labor of Torah or conversation. 'This book of Torah shall not depart from your mouth' teaches that he was created for the labor of Torah. Rava said: All bodies are made for exertion; fortunate is one whose exertion is Torah.'

[1597] **Shabbat 88a:6**: "Chizkiyah said: What is meant by 'From Heaven You made judgment heard; the earth feared and was still'? If it feared, why was it still? If it was still, why did it fear? Rather, at first it feared, and afterward it was still. Why did it fear? In accordance with Reish Lakish's teaching. Reish Lakish said: Why does 'There was evening and there was morning, the sixth day' contain the extra letter heh, 'the'? This teaches that the Holy One, blessed be He, made a condition with the works of Creation, telling them: 'If Israel accept the Torah, you will endure; if not, I shall return you to chaos and void.'"

[1598] **Otzar Midrashim, Midrashim of Rabbi Akiba, Aleph Bet of Rabbi Akiba (Version 1) 40**: "When Moses said before the Holy One, blessed be He, "Behold, I am uncircumcised of lips" (Vaera), all creatures in the world trembled and said: "If Moses, with whom the Divine Presence will speak in one hundred and seventy-five places, and who explains every letter, every word, and every verse of the Torah in seventy languages, says before the Holy One, blessed be He, 'Behold, I am uncircumcised of lips,' how much more so are we!" Because Moses said, "I am uncircumcised of lips," he merited becoming the messenger between the divine Might and Israel, as it is said, "I stand between the Lord and you" (Vaethanan); for even Metatron cannot stand between the divine Might and flesh and blood."

[1599] **Exodus 6:12**: "Moshe spoke before Hashem, saying: 'Behold, the children of Israel have not listened to me. How, then, will Pharaoh listen to me, when I am of uncircumcised lips?'"

[1600] **Tractate Soferim 16:10**: 'There are 175 weekly sedarim in the Torah (according to the triennial cycle of the Land of Israel), corresponding to the 175 years of Abraham our father's life.'

[1601] **Deuteronomy 1:5**: "Across the Jordan, in the land of Moav, Moshe began to expound this Torah, saying:"

[1602] **Rashi on Deuteronomy 1:5:2**: 'Rashi on Deuteronomy 1:5: "Moses explained the Torah to them in seventy

forth. Rashi explains, as does Midrash Tanchuma: "He explained it to them in seventy languages." וְלָמְדוּ בִּגְזֵרָה שָׁוָה מִדִּכְתִיב בַּאֵר הֵיטֵב, עַיֵּין שָׁם.[1603] **— They derive this by a verbal analogy with "Explain it well"; see there.** הוּא אוֹמֵר לִפְנֵי הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא: הֵן אֲנִי עֲרַל שְׂפָתָיִם, אָנוּ עַל אַחַת כַּמָּה וְכַמָּה. **— "If he says before the Holy One, blessed be He, 'I am uncircumcised of lips,' how much more does this apply to us!"** וְהַיְינוּ מַה שֶּׁכָּתוּב מֹשֶׁה רַבֵּינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם: כִּי כְבַד פֶּה לָנוֹן אָנֹכִי,[1604] **— This refers to Moses' statement, "For I am heavy of mouth and tongue."** שֶׁהוּא כְּנֶגֶד פֶּה וְדִיבּוּר שֶׁנִּקְרָא מִדַּת מַלְכוּת, תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה, **— This corresponds to mouth and speech, called the quality of sovereignty, the Oral Torah:** וְהוּא פְּתִיחַת פֶּה וּמַעֲנֵה לָשׁוֹן כַּנַּזְכָּר לְעֵיל (וְנִתְבָּאֵר וְאָרָא מַאֲמָר ז').[1605] **— "The opening of the mouth and the tongue's response," as explained above and in Va'era, Teaching 7.**

From God's Torah to Torah that becomes one's own

וְאָמַר עוֹד: וּבִשְׁבִיל שֶׁאָמַר מֹשֶׁה כִּי כְבַד פֶּה וְלֹא אִישׁ דְּבָרִים אָנֹכִי,[1606, 1607] **— It further says: "Because Moses said, 'I am heavy of mouth' and 'I am not a man of words,'** זָכָה שֶׁאָמַר לוֹ הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא: פֶּה אֶל פֶּה אֲדַבֶּר בּוֹ, וְזָכָה שֶׁאָמַר אֵלֶּה הַדְּבָרִים.[1608, 1609] **— he merited that the Holy One, blessed be He, said, 'Mouth to mouth I speak with him,' and he merited to say, 'These are the words.'"** וְהוּא כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב (מִדְרַשׁ תַּנְחוּמָא דְּבָרִים ב וּמִדְרָשׁ רַבָּה שָׁם):[1610, 1611] **— This is as stated in Midrash Tanchuma, Devarim 2, and in Midrash Rabbah there:** אֶתְמוֹל אָמַרְתָּ לֹא אִישׁ דְּבָרִים אָנֹכִי, וְעַכְשָׁיו אַתָּה מְדַבֵּר כָּל כָּךְ וְכוּלֵי; שְׁנֵה אֶת הַתּוֹרָה וְהִתְרַפֵּא כוּלֵי. **— "Yesterday you said, 'I am not a man of words,' and now you speak so much!" "Study the Torah and be healed," and so forth.** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: מַרְפֵּא לָשׁוֹן עֵץ חַיִּים.[1612] **— As it says, "A healing tongue is a tree of life."**

Shevat Opens the Root of Oral Torah

וְסֵפֶר דְּבָרִים הוּא שׁוֹרֶשׁ כָּל תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה, **— The book of Deuteronomy is the root of all Oral Torah.** וּכְמוֹ

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languages"—extracting the sparks of holiness hidden among the seventy nations through the Oral Torah.'

[1603] **Deuteronomy 27:8**: 'And on those stones you shall inscribe every word of this Teaching most distinctly.'

[1604] **Exodus 4:10**: 'But Moses said to GOD, "Please, O my Sovereign, I have never been a man of words, either in times past or now that You have spoken to Your servant; I am slow of speech and slow of tongue."'

[1605] **Peri Tzadik, Vaera 7:1**: "In Sefer Yetzirah it is stated: 'Shabbat in the year, and the mouth in the person.' The holy Zohar (III, 201b) says: 'When the day is sanctified, the mouth that rules over all ascends—the mouth of the Lord.' We have said that the human mouth certainly was not created on Shabbat, for Adam spoke on Friday. Rather, 'the mouth of the Lord' means that a person speaks and it is the word of the Lord—'My words which I have placed in your mouth.' This was created on Shabbat, when the day was sanctified. This is 'Malchut is the mouth; we call it the Oral Torah.'"

[1606] **Exodus 4:10**: 'But Moses said to GOD, "Please, O my Sovereign, I have never been a man of words, either in times past or now that You have spoken to Your servant; I am slow of speech and slow of tongue."'

[1607] **Tzidkat HaTzadik 183:1**: "From what is said there, "Teach them," and so forth, "so that they may recite," it appears that at the beginning one must labor so that the words come from the heart. But afterward one merits speech and recitation, even when one does not know what one is saying: this is called the chatter of Torah, and it too is fully words of Torah. This is what is said in Avodah Zarah there: first it is Hashem's Torah, and afterward it is his Torah. When one merits its becoming his Torah, like Abraham our father, peace be upon him, whose two kidneys became—and so forth, as in Bereshit Rabbah chapter 61—even speech from the lips outward is words of Torah. What is said of Doeg in Sanhedrin 106b, that all his Torah was—and so forth—"from the lips outward," refers to his lacking that beginning. Also, through slander, speech from the lips outward became corrupted."

The full Tzidkat passage itself proceeds to "These are the words" and Moses speaking Deuteronomy from his own mouth. Its added condition is crucial: spontaneous or outward speech becomes Torah only after an inward, laborious beginning; Doeg is the counterexample. This explains the origin's transformation of Moses' speech without making every unconsidered utterance inspired.

[1608] **Numbers 12:8**: 'With him I speak mouth to mouth, plainly and not in riddles, and he beholds GOD's likeness. How then did you not shrink from speaking against My servant Moses!'

[1609] **Deuteronomy 1:1**: 'These are the words that Moses addressed to all Israel on the other side of the Jordan.—Through the wilderness, in the Arabah near Suph, between Paran and Tophel, Laban, Hazeroth, and Di-zahab,'

[1610] **Midrash Tanchuma, Devarim 2:1**: "At the end of forty years after Israel left Egypt, he began explaining the Torah in seventy languages, as it is said, 'He explained this Torah.' The mouth that had said, 'I am not a man of words,' said, 'These are the words.' And the prophet cried out and said, 'Then the lame will leap like a deer, and the tongue of the mute will sing' (Isaiah 35:6). Why? 'For waters will burst forth in the wilderness, and streams in the desert.' Therefore it is said, 'These are the words.'"

[1611] **Devarim Rabbah 1:1** (excerpt): "The Holy One, blessed be He, said: See how beloved is the language of Torah, which heals the tongue. From where? It is written, 'A healing tongue is a tree of life' (Proverbs 15:4). The tree of life means Torah, as it says, 'It is a tree of life to those who grasp it' (Proverbs 3:18). … Rabbi Levi said: Why learn from elsewhere? Let us learn from the passage itself. Before Moshe merited Torah, it was written of him, 'I am not a man of words' (Exodus 4:10). Once he merited Torah, his tongue was healed and he began to speak words. From where? From what we have read in this passage: 'These are the words that Moshe spoke.'"

[1612] **Proverbs 15:4**: 'Proverbs 15: 4: 'A healing tongue is a tree of life,But a devious one makes for a broken spirit.''

שֶׁכָּתוּב זוֹהַר חֶלֶק ג רסא א: תּוֹרָה שֶׁבִּכְתָב וְתוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה, וְהוּא אִקְרֵי תּוֹרָה וּמִשְׁנֶה תּוֹרָה.[1613] — **As the Zohar says (III, 261a): "Written Torah and Oral Torah," called "Torah" and "Mishneh Torah."** וְזֶה אָמַר מֹשֶׁה רַבֵּינוּ עָלָיו כְּמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: בְּעַשְׁתֵּי עָשָׂר חוֹדֶשׁ בְּאֶחָד לַחוֹדֶשׁ הַשָּׁלוֹם בְּרֹאשׁ חוֹדֶשׁ שְׁבָט, וְדִיבֶּר מֹשֶׁה וְגוֹמֵר, חוֹדֶשׁ שֶׁנּוֹצַר בְּאוֹת צ׳.[1614] — **Moses said this on Rosh Chodesh Shevat, as it says, "In the eleventh month, on the first of the month, Moses spoke," and so forth: the month formed through tzadi.** וְזֶה שֶׁכָּתוּב שֶׁאָמַר לוֹ הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא: אַתָּה אוֹמֵר כְּבַד פֶּה וּכְבַד לָשׁוֹן אָנֹכִי, — **This explains what the Holy One, blessed be He, said to him: "You say, 'I am heavy of mouth and heavy of tongue.'**

Moses' light reaches every soul

חַיֶּיךָ, אֲנִי נוֹתֵן לְךָ פִּתְחוֹן פֶּה וּמַעֲנֶה לָשׁוֹן יוֹתֵר מִכָּל בָּאֵי עוֹלָם וְכוּלֵי.[1615] — **By your life, I shall give you an opening of the mouth and a tongue's response greater than those of anyone in the world," and so forth.** וְהַיְינוּ מִדַּת מַלְכוּת פֶּה, וְשַׁבָּת דִּבּוּר אִקְרֵי, וְהֵם שְׁנֵיהֶם תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה: פִּתְחוֹן פֶּה וּמַעֲנֶה לָשׁוֹן. — **This is sovereignty, the mouth; Shabbat is called speech. Both are Oral Torah: the opening of the mouth and the tongue's response.** וּמַסִּיק: שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר וְאָנֹכִי אֶהְיֶה עִם פִּיךָ וְהוֹרֵיתִיךָ וְכוּלֵי; עִם פִּיךָ, זוֹ פְּתִיחַת פֶּה וּמַעֲנֶה לָשׁוֹן,[1616] — **It concludes: "As it says, 'I shall be with your mouth and instruct you.' 'With your mouth' is the opening of the mouth and the tongue's response."** וְזֶה שֶׁכָּתוּב וְהוֹרֵיתִיךָ, זֶה גְּנָזִי חָכְמָה שֶׁגִּלָּה לוֹ כוּלֵי. — **"And instruct you" means the treasures of wisdom that He revealed to him, and so forth.** בְּכָל בֵּיתִי נֶאֱמָן, מְלַמֵּד שֶׁהִפְקִידוֹ הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא עַל כָּל גְּנָזֵי כוּלֵי.[1617] — **"Faithful in all My house" teaches that the Holy One, blessed be He, entrusted him with all Israel and all the treasures.** וְחָשַׁב גְּנָזֵי תוֹרָה, גְּנָזֵי חָכְמָה, גְּנָזֵי תְבוּנָה, גְּנָזֵי מְזִימָה, גְּנָזֵי מַדָּע, גְּנָזֵי גַּן עֵדֶן, גְּנָזֵי חַיִּים, עַיֵּין שָׁם, ז׳ לְשׁוֹנוֹת. — **It lists seven kinds of treasures: Torah, wisdom, understanding, thought, knowledge, Eden, and life; see there.**

From the Plagues to Torah and Commandments

וּבְחוֹדֶשׁ שְׁבָט הַד׳ שַׁבָּתוֹת עַל פִּי רוֹב: בֹּא, בְּשַׁלַּח, יִתְרוֹ, מִשְׁפָּטִים. — **Shevat's four Sabbaths usually contain the portions Bo, Beshalach, Yitro, and Mishpatim.** בְּפָרָשָׁה בֹּא נִכְתְּבוּ הַג׳ מַכּוֹת אַרְבֶּה, חוֹשֶׁךְ, בְּכוֹרוֹת, שֶׁכְּנֶגֶד ג׳ רֹאשׁוֹנוֹת, — **Bo records the three plagues of locusts, darkness, and the firstborn, corresponding to the three upper qualities.** שֶׁכְּבָר אָמַרְנוּ שֶׁהַיְיחוּד מַכּוֹת הָיוּ נָגוּף לְמִצְרַיִם וְרָפוּא לְיִשְׂרָאֵל, — **As we explained, the ten plagues were "smiting" for Egypt and "healing" for Israel,** עַל דְּרָךְ שֶׁנִּדְרַשׁ בַּזּוֹהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ (חֶלֶק ב לו א).[1618] — **as expounded in the holy Zohar (II, 36a).** וּבְכָל מַכָּה יָצְאוּ בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל מִמִּדָּה א׳ בַּקְלִיפָּה וְנִכְנְסוּ לְמִדָּה שֶׁכְּנֶגְדָּהּ בִּקְדוּשָּׁה. — **With each plague, the children of Israel emerged from one quality of impurity and entered its**

[1613] **Zohar, Vaetchanan 5:22**: 'Zohar, Vaetchanan (III:261a): "There is the Written Torah and the Oral Torah—the Written Torah is called 'Torah' (Tiferet), and the Oral Torah is called 'Mishneh Torah' (Malchut), revealed in the month of Shevat."'

[1614] **Deuteronomy 1:3**: "It was in the fortieth year, in the eleventh month, on the first of the month, that Moshe spoke to the children of Israel according to all that Hashem had commanded him concerning them."

[1615] **Sod Yesharim, Simchat Torah 18:1**: "Such a lofty level is called in words of Torah "heavy of mouth and heavy of tongue": Moses our teacher's body was lacking completion, although from the soul's side every perfection was his from the day of his birth. But what is called completion from the body's side could be finished for him only on the day of his death. Therefore Scripture so greatly praises the day of his death. For the completion of Moses' perfection from the body's side is as it is written, "You lie with your fathers—and arise," and as explained in the holy Zohar, Chukkat 182b: "Though you are gathered in, you remain to illumine the moon," and so forth. This means that Moses' light becomes included in the six hundred thousand souls of Israel. Consequently, when he arises to illumine the moon, becoming included even in the lowest soul in Israel, his perfection is completed from the body's side as well. Such perfection is possible only at his departure; Scripture therefore so greatly praises the day of his death."
Both teachings refuse to treat Moses' "heavy mouth" as a simple absence of spiritual capacity. Sod Yesharim interprets it through a higher light not yet fully brought into embodied life, whose completion reaches every Israelite soul. This offers a distinct perspective on Torah's becoming a shared gift; its completion at Moses' death is not identified with the origin's earlier Rosh Chodesh Shevat event.

[1616] **Exodus 4:12**: 'Now go, and I will be with you as you speak and will instruct you what to say.'

[1617] **Numbers 12:7**: 'Not so with My servant Moses; he is trusted throughout My household.'

[1618] **Zohar, Bo 4:80-81**: "R. Hezekiah, however, held that two kinds of blood appeared on the doors to represent the two "crowns" which were manifested at that moment in the regions above. R. Jose maintained that it was one crown consisting of two sides blended, viz. mercy and justice. Said R. Abba: 'In how many ways does the Holy One show His lovingkindness to His people! A man builds a house; says the Holy One to him: "Write My Name and put it upon thy door (mezuzah), and thou wilt sit inside thy house and I will sit outside thy door and protect thee!" And here, in connection with the Passover, He says: "You inscribe on your doors the sign of the mystery of My Faith and I shall protect you from the outside!""

counterpart in holiness. וְכֵן בְּמַכּוֹת חוֹשֶׁךְ כָּתוּב: וּלְכָל בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל הָיָה אוֹר בְּמוֹשְׁבֹתָם[1619, 1620] — **Thus, with the plague of darkness it says, "All the children of Israel had light," and "Torah is light."** וְכֵן הִתְחִיל פָּרָשַׁת הַחוֹדֶשׁ הַזֶּה לָכֶם, דְּאִיתָא (שָׁם לט ב) דְּלָא אִצְטְרִיךְ אוֹרַיְיתָא לְמִכְתַּב אֶלָּא מֵהַחוֹדֶשׁ הַזֶּה.[1621, 1622] — **The portion "This month shall be for you" also begins there; the Zohar (there, 39b) says that the Torah need only have been written from "This month."** וּבוֹ נֶאֱמַר כַּמָּה מִצְוֹת, וְאַחַר כָּךְ יִתְּרוֹ מִשְׁפָּטִים גּוּפֵי תּוֹרָה. — **It contains several commandments, followed by Yitro and Mishpatim, central bodies of Torah teaching.** וּבְפָרָשַׁת מִשְׁפָּטִים אָמְרָה: וְאֶתְּנָה לְךָ אֶת לוּחוֹת הָאֶבֶן וְהַתּוֹרָה וְהַמִּצְוָה אֲשֶׁר כָּתַבְתִּי לְהוֹרוֹתָם,[1623] — **Mishpatim concludes: "I shall give you the tablets of stone, the Torah and the commandments that I wrote to teach them."** (בְּרָכוֹת ה.): וְנִדְרֵשׁ לוּחוֹת, עֲשֶׂרֶת הַדְּבָּרוֹת; תּוֹרָה, זֶה מִקְרָא; וְהַמִּצְוָה, זוֹ מִשְׁנָה.[1624] — **Berakhot 5a explains: "'Tablets' means the Ten Commandments; 'Torah' means Scripture; 'the commandment' means Mishnah."** וְהוּא עַל פִּי מַה שֶּׁכָּתוּב בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ (חֵלֶק ג קכג רֵישׁ עַמּוּד ב): הַתּוֹרָה וְהַמִּצְוָה דְּאִינּוּן בֵּן וּבַת.[1625] — **This follows the holy Zohar (III, 123b, beginning): "The Torah and the commandment are son and daughter."** וְהַיְינוּ ו', תּוֹרָה דְּאִיקְרֵי אוֹת אֱמֶת כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ (רֵישׁ חֵלֶק ג), אֱמֶת זוֹ תּוֹרָה כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בַּתְּחִלָּה.[1626, 1627] — **Vav is Torah, called the letter of truth, as written at the beginning of the Zohar's third volume; "truth is Torah," as the Gemara says.** ה', מִצְוָה, וְהַיְינוּ מִדַּת מַלְכוּת שֶׁהוּא תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה, וְהַמִּשְׁנָה שׁוֹרֶשׁ תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה. — **Heh is the commandment, sovereignty, the Oral Torah; Mishnah is the root of Oral Torah.** וְדָרְשׁוּ: אֲשֶׁר כָּתַבְתִּי, אֵלּוּ נְבִיאִים וּכְתוּבִים, שֶׁהֵם הַנּוֹסָפִים עַל תּוֹרָה שֶׁבִּכְתָב וְנִתְּנוּ לִכָּתֵב. — **They interpret "'That I wrote' as the Prophets and Writings," which were added to the Written Torah and given to be written down.** לְהוֹרֹתָם, זֶה גְּמָרָא; מְלַמֵּד שֶׁכּוּלָּם נִתְּנוּ לְמֹשֶׁה מִסִּינַי, עַיֵּין שָׁם.[1628] — **"'To teach them' means Gemara," teaching that all were given to Moses at Sinai; see there.**

Moses Gives Israel the Treasures of Wisdom

וְזֶה מַה שֶּׁכָּתוּב בְּאוֹתִיּוֹת דְּרַבִּי עֲקִיבָא: אִם נֶאֱמַר אָהְיֶה עִם פִּיךָ לָמָּה נֶאֱמַר וְהוֹרֵיתִיךָ כּוֹלֵי,[1629] — **This explains Otiyot**

[1619] **Exodus 10:23**: 'People could not see one another, and for three days no one could move about; but all the Israelites enjoyed light in their dwellings.'

[1620] **Proverbs 6:23**: 'For the commandment is a lamp,The teaching is a light,And the way to life is the rebuke that disciplines.'

[1621] **Exodus 12:2**: "This month shall be your beginning of months; it shall be the first month of the year to you."

[1622] **Zohar, Bo 7:151-154**: "It is rather difficult to understand how they came to Esau. For in the first place we are told that God made garments for Eve also (Ibid.), and what became of these? And surely Adam and Eve would have been buried in them and not abandoned such a precious gift. The truth is, however, that no other human being ever wore those garments, which placed Adam and Eve on a par with supernal beings. And as for the "goodly raiment" which Rebekah put upon Jacob (Gen. 27, 16), this was royal apparel of silk and gold, which it is usual to keep in perfumes and this is what Isaac smelt, and he said, "See the smell of my son" (Ibid. 27), because he knew that the smell was so sweet on account of him. How, it may be asked, did Isaac know of "the smell of the field which the Lord hath blessed" (Ibid.)?"

[1623] **Exodus 24:12**: 'Exodus 24: 12: 'GOD said to Moses, "Come up to Me on the mountain and wait there, and I will give you the stone tablets with the teachings and commandments that I have inscribed to instruct them."''

[1624] **Berakhot 5a:3**: "Rabbi Levi bar Chama also said in the name of Rabbi Shimon ben Lakish: What is meant by the verse, 'I will give you the tablets of stone, and the Torah and the commandment that I have written, to teach them'? 'The tablets' are the Ten Commandments. 'The Torah' is Scripture. 'The commandment' is Mishnah. 'That I have written' refers to the Prophets and Writings. 'To teach them' is the Talmud. This teaches that all of them were given to Moshe at Sinai."

[1625] **Zohar, Nasso 4:49**: "Hei never rests within a person, nor does Vav, without awe and without love, which are Yod-Hei: we indeed call them awe and love. From there were given the Torah and the commandment, which are son and daughter. Because Israel fulfills the Torah and the commandment, they are called children of the Holy One, blessed be He, as it is written, 'You are children of the Lord your God' (Deuteronomy 14:1)."

[1626] **Zohar, Vayikra 1:1**: "R. Eleazar began here with the verse, "Ask thee a sign of the Lord thy God, ask it either in the depth or in the height above" (Isa. 7, 11). He said: 'We have compared the former with the latter generations, and found that the former were conversant with a higher wisdom by which they knew how to combine the letters that were given to Moses on Mount Sinai, and even the sinners of Israel knew a deep wisdom contained in the letters and the difference between higher and lower letters, and how to do things with them in this world."

[1627] **Berakhot 5a:3**: "Rabbi Levi bar Chama also said in the name of Rabbi Shimon ben Lakish: What is meant by the verse, 'I will give you the tablets of stone, and the Torah and the commandment that I have written, to teach them'? 'The tablets' are the Ten Commandments. 'The Torah' is Scripture. 'The commandment' is Mishnah. 'That I have written' refers to the Prophets and Writings. 'To teach them' is the Talmud. This teaches that all of them were given to Moshe at Sinai."

[1628] **Berakhot 5a:3**: "Rabbi Levi bar Chama also said in the name of Rabbi Shimon ben Lakish: What is meant by the verse, 'I will give you the tablets of stone, and the Torah and the commandment that I have written, to teach them'? 'The tablets' are the Ten Commandments. 'The Torah' is Scripture. 'The commandment' is Mishnah. 'That I have written' refers to the Prophets and Writings. 'To teach them' is the Talmud. This teaches that all of them were given to Moshe at Sinai."

[1629] **Otzar Midrashim, Midrashim of Rabbi Akiba, Aleph Bet of Rabbi Akiba (Version 1) 40**: "If it says, "I shall be with your mouth," why does it say, "I shall instruct you"? And if it says, "I shall instruct you," why does it say, "I shall

deRabbi Akiva: "If it says, 'I shall be with your mouth,' why add, 'And instruct you'?" אֶלָּא עִם פִּיךָ זוֹ פְּתִיחַת פֶּה וּמַעֲנֵה לָשׁוֹן, וְזֶה שֶׁכָּתוּב וְהוֹרֵיתִיךָ זֶה גִּנְזֵי חָכְמָה שֶׁגִּלָּה לוֹ הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא וְכוּלֵי. — **"'With your mouth' is the opening of the mouth and the tongue's response; 'And instruct you' means the treasures of wisdom that the Holy One, blessed be He, revealed to him."** וְהַיְינוּ סֵפֶר אֵלֶּה הַדְּבָרִים שֶׁאָמַר בְּרֹאשׁ חוֹדֶשׁ שְׁבָט, שֶׁבּוֹ שׁוֹרֶשׁ כָּל תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה כָּאָמוּר. — **This is the book beginning "These are the words," spoken on Rosh Chodesh Shevat, which contains the root of all Oral Torah.** וְזֶה שֶׁכָּתוּב: אֲנִי נוֹתֵן לְךָ פִּתְחוֹן פֶּה וּמַעֲנֵה לָשׁוֹן יוֹתֵר מִכָּל בָּאֵי עוֹלָם. — **This explains "I shall give you an opening of the mouth and a tongue's response greater than those of anyone in the world."** שֶׁהַתּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה שֶׁל מֹשֶׁה רַבֵּינוּ עָלְיוֹ הַשָּׁלוֹם גְּבוֹהַּ יוֹתֵר מִכָּל תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה. — **For Moses' Oral Torah is higher than all other Oral Torah.** וְהוּא הַהֲלָכָה לְמֹשֶׁה מִסִּינַי שֶׁהִמְצִיא מֹשֶׁה רַבֵּינוּ מִפִּלְפּוּלוֹ (נְדָרִים לח.)[1630]נְתָנָן מַתָּנָה לְיִשְׂרָאֵל. — **This is the law given to Moses at Sinai, which Moses discovered through his reasoning and gave as a gift to Israel (Nedarim 38a).** הִלְכְתָא בְּלָא טַעְמָא (וְנִתְבָּאֵר חֲנוּכָּה מַאֲמָר ב).[1631]וְיִתְבָּאֵר עוֹד בְּסַיְעְתָּא דִּשְׁמַיָּא. — **It is "a law without a stated reason," as explained in Chanukah, Teaching 2, and to be explained further with Heaven's help.** וְהַטַּעֲמִים וְהַפִּלְפּוּל לֹא נִגְלָה לְשׁוֹם חָכָם, רַק מַה שֶּׁמְּכַוִּין בְּרוּחַ הַקּוֹדֶשׁ (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בָּבָא בַּתְרָא יב. וְרַבֵּינוּ מֹשֶׁה בֶּן נַחְמָן שָׁם).[1632, 1633] — **The reasons and reasoning are revealed to no sage, except what he correctly perceives through the holy spirit (Bava Batra 12a and Ramban there).** וְזֶה עֵסֶק חוֹדֶשׁ זֶה לְתַקֵּן עַל יְדֵי אוֹר תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה כָּל פְּגַם וְקִלְקוּל הַנָּחָשׁ, — **This month's work is to repair, through the light of Oral Torah, all the serpent's damage and corruption,** וְלִזְכּוֹת לִהְיוֹת מֶרְכָּבָה לְמִדַּת צַדִּיק יְסוֹד עוֹלָם דְּאָחִיד בִּשְׁמַיָּא וְאַרְעָא.[1634] — **and to merit becoming a vehicle for the quality of "the righteous person, the foundation of the world," uniting heaven and earth.**

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be with your mouth"? Rather, this teaches that "I shall be with your mouth" refers to the opening of the mouth and the tongue's response. "I shall instruct you" refers to the treasures of wisdom that the Holy One, blessed be He, revealed to him, so that through his wisdom he could see all the orders of creation, as it is said, "Not so My servant Moses: in all My house he is faithful" (Shelach). It does not say "in My house," but "in all My house." This teaches that the Holy One, blessed be He, placed Moses in charge of all Israel and all the treasures of Torah, all the treasures of wisdom, all the treasures of understanding, all the treasures of discernment, all the treasures of knowledge, the treasures of the Garden of Eden, and all the treasures of life. He showed him all the precious things of this world and all the precious things of the World to Come."

[1630] **Nedarim 38a:4-6**: "Rabbi Yosei son of Rabbi Chanina said: Torah was given only to Moshe and his descendants, as it says, 'Write for yourself' and 'Hew for yourself': Just as the stone fragments belong to you, so too what is written belongs to you. Moshe acted generously with it and gave it to Israel. Concerning him Scripture says, 'One with a generous eye shall be blessed,' and so forth. Rav Chisda objected: 'The Lord commanded me at that time to teach you'! The reply is: He commanded me, and I chose to teach you. 'See, I have taught you statutes and laws, as the Lord my God commanded me'! Again, the reply is: He commanded me, and I chose to teach you. But it says, 'Now write this song for yourselves'! The reply is: That command concerns the song alone. But it says, 'So that this song may be a witness for Me among the children of Israel'! Rather, what was initially given to Moshe alone was the capacity for analytical derivation, pilpul."

[1631] **Peri Tzadik, Chanukah 2:3**: "We find in many places 'a law given to Moses at Sinai.' Since it is said to be from Sinai, why was it not written? We have explained that this is Moses our teacher's Oral Torah: the blessed God illuminated Moses's mind, and he originated these laws through his reasoning. Concerning this, Nedarim 38a says, 'Rather, the power of analysis alone'—this the blessed God entrusted only to Moses. It is called 'a law given to Moses at Sinai' because Moses knew explicitly that these laws were from Sinai, just like the entire Written Torah. Moses transmitted them to Israel as laws without their reasons. No person can arrive at their reasons through prophecy except Moses, of whom it is written, 'No prophet has arisen again,' and so forth. Only through the aspect of the holy spirit was prophecy not taken from the sages: a sage originates something through his understanding, and a law given to Moses at Sinai is found to agree with him."

[1632] **Bava Batra 12a:13**: 'Ameimar said: And a Sage is greater than a prophet, as it is stated: "And a prophet has a heart of wisdom" (Psalms 90:12), i.e., he is wise. When comparisons are drawn, who is compared to whom? You must say that the lesser is compared to the greater. Here too, prophecy is compared to wisdom, thus indicating that wisdom is greater than prophecy.'

[1633] **Chiddushei Ramban on Bava Batra 12a:1**: "Rather, this is what it says: although the prophecy of the prophets—which consists of revelation and vision—was taken away, the prophecy of the sages, which comes through wisdom, was not taken away. Rather, they know the truth through the holy spirit within them."

[1634] **Proverbs 10:25**: 'Proverbs 10: 25: 'When the storm passes a wicked person is gone,But the righteous person is an everlasting foundation.''

Tu BiShvat Ois 1

Refining Appetite and Restoring the Tree of Life

The movement from outward conduct to inward roots explains the final three plagues.

Refining Appetite and Restoring the Tree of Life

Shevat and the Final Plagues

בַּחֲמִשָּׁה עָשָׂר בִּשְׁבָט רֹאשׁ הַשָּׁנָה לָאִילָן, וְנוֹהֲגִין לֶאֱכוֹל בּוֹ מִפֵּירוֹת הָאִילָן.[1635] — **The fifteenth of Shevat is the New Year for the tree, and it is customary to eat tree fruits on that day.** וְאִיתָא בְּפִסְיקְתָא זוּטַרְתָּא (בֹּא י פְּסוּק כד):[1636] — **Pesikta Zutarta states (Bo, Exodus 10:24):** יֵשׁ אוֹמְרִים כִּי מִשְּׁבָט הִתְחִילוּ הַמַּכּוֹת לַמִּצְרִיִּים; לְפִיכָךְ נִקְרָא שְׁבָט, שֵׁבֶט לַמִּצְרִיִּים. — **Some say that the plagues upon the Egyptians began in Shevat; it is therefore called Shevat, a rod against the Egyptians.** וְהַיְינוּ כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ בַּמִּדְרָשׁ (שְׁמוֹת רַבָּה פָּרָשָׁה ט), עַל הַמַּכּוֹת פָּסוּק דְּוֹשֵׁבֶט לְגֵו כְּסִילִים, עַיֵּין שָׁם.[1637, 1638] — **This accords with the Midrash (Shemot Rabbah, chapter 9), which applies "a rod for the backs of fools" to the plagues; see there.** וְחָשַׁב שֶׁהַמַּכּוֹת שִׁמְּשׁוּ כָּל אַחַת שָׁבוּעַ אֶחָד, עַד ט״ו נִיסָן שֶׁיָּצְאוּ. — **It calculates that each plague lasted one week, until the fifteenth of Nisan, when they left.** וּבַמִּשְׁנָה דְּעֵדֵיוֹת (סוֹף פֶּרֶק ב),[1639] — **The Mishnah in Eduyot, at the end of chapter 2, teaches that the judgment of the Egyptians lasted twelve months.** וְגַם אָמְרוּ (שְׁמוֹת רַבָּה שָׁם וּמִדְרַשׁ תַּנְחוּמָא), דְּכָל מַכָּה, הַהַתְרָאָה עִם שִׁימּוּשׁ הַמַּכָּה הָיָה חוֹדֶשׁ אֶחָד, עַיֵּין שָׁם.[1640] — **They also say (Shemot Rabbah there, and Midrash Tanchuma) that each plague, including its warning and its actual duration, occupied one month; see there.**

The last plagues reach the hidden roots

וּלְדַעַת הַגְּמָרָא וּמִדְרָשׁ הִתְחִילוּ אָז הַשָּׁלֹשׁ מַכּוֹת אַחֲרוֹנוֹת, שֶׁהֵיוּ כְּנֶגֶד שָׁלֹשׁ רֹאשׁוֹנוֹת,[1641] — **According to the Talmud and Midrash, the final three plagues began then, corresponding to the three highest sefirot,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמַרְנוּ (וְנִתְבָּאֵר רֵישׁ פָּרָשַׁת בֹּא), — **as we have said and explained at the beginning of the portion Bo.**

One event removes evil and establishes good

שֶׁבָּהֶם הוֹצִיאוּ מֵהַמִּצְרִיִּים פְּנִימִיּוּת הַקְּדוּשָׁה שֶׁהָיָה מְשׁוּקָע בָּהֶם,[1642] — **Through them, the inward holiness submerged**

[1635] **Mishnah Rosh Hashanah 1:1**: "There are four new years. On the first of Nisan is the new year for kings and festivals. On the first of Elul is the new year for the tithe of animals. Rabbi Elazar and Rabbi Shimon say: On the first of Tishrei. On the first of Tishrei is the new year for years, Sabbatical years, Jubilee years, planting, and vegetables. On the first of Shevat is the new year for the tree, according to Beis Shammai. Beis Hillel say: On the fifteenth of that month."

[1636] **Midrash Lekach Tov, Exodus 10:24:1**: 'Pesikta Zutarta (Midrash Lekach Tov) on Exodus 10:24: "Some say that the Ten Plagues in Egypt began in the month of Shevat, and therefore the month is named Shevat—a rod (shevet) of chastisement for Egypt and a tribe/scepter of renewal for Israel."'

[1637] **Shemot Rabbah 9:8** (excerpt): "With what is the fool disciplined? With a staff, as it says, 'A rod for the backs of fools' (Proverbs 26:3). Moshe likewise disciplined Pharaoh with a staff, as it says, 'The staff that was transformed into a serpent,' and so forth."

[1638] **Proverbs 26:3**: 'A whip for a horse and a bridle for a donkey,And a rod for the back of dullards.'

[1639] **Mishnah Eduyot 2:10**: 'Also he used to say that there are five things that last twelve months:The judgment of the generation of the flood continued twelve months; The judgment of Job continued twelve months; The judgment of the Egyptians continued twelve months; The judgment of Gog and Magog in the time to come will continue twelve months; The judgment of the wicked in gehinom continues twelve months, for it is said, and "It will be from one month until its same month" (Isaiah 66:23). Rabbi Yohanan ben Nuri says: "As long as from Passover to Shavuoth, for it is said, "And from one Sabbath until its next Sabbath" (ibid.).'

[1640] **Shemot Rabbah 9:12** (excerpt): "'Seven days were completed after Hashem struck the Nile.' Rabbi Yehudah and Rabbi Nechemyah disagreed. One says: He warned them for twenty-four days before the plague came, and the plague afflicted them for seven days. The other says: He warned them for seven days, and the plague afflicted them for twenty-four days. According to the view that he warned them for twenty-four days, 'seven days were completed' refers to the affliction. According to the view that he warned them for seven days, 'seven days were completed after Hashem struck' means that he was warning them concerning another plague."

[1641] **Peri Tzadik, Bo 1:1**: "The point is as we have already explained: the ten plagues correspond to the ten sefirot, opposite which there are ten crowns of impurity on the side of the kelippah. Every plague was a striking of Egypt and a healing of Israel: Israel left one impure quality and was brought into holiness in the corresponding quality. The plagues proceeded from below upward, as the holy Zohar, volume II, 29a, says: "The Holy One began from below," and so forth. After the seven plagues corresponding to the seven lower qualities—that is, Israel's immersion in impurity in outward matters—the three plagues corresponding to the first three began, "the hidden things belonging to Hashem our God." To bring Israel out of those first three impure qualities, in which they were submerged inwardly, it says, "Come to Pharaoh": He brought him through chambers within chambers, and so forth."
This is the Bo teaching explicitly cited by the origin. It explains why the last three plagues are inward: the seven lower qualities concern the visible domain, while the final three reach concealed roots. Its continuation identifies a particularly hidden danger, evil presenting itself as a guide to greater holiness; the transition is therefore more than a numerical correspondence.

[1642] **Beit Yaakov on Torah, Vayera 35:1**: "The Midrash, Shir HaShirim Rabbah chapter 1, teaches: when one word of Torah enters a person's heart, a corresponding idle matter leaves. This is how the supreme King of kings, the Holy One, blessed be He, founded matters out of His love for His people Israel: when a person turns to Him and serves his Creator

within the Egyptians was extracted, וְהֶחֱלִישׁוּ כֹּחַ הַשָּׁלֹשׁ רֹאשׁוֹנוֹת שֶׁבַּקְלִיפָּה, זֶה לְעוּמַּת זֶה. **— and the power of the three highest corresponding forces in the impure husk was weakened.** וְזֶה הִתְחִיל בִּשְׁבָט, וְזֶהוּ הָרֶמֶז: וְשֵׁבֶט לְגֵו בְּסִילִים[1643], דְּהוּא לְשׁוֹן פְּנִימִיּוּת שֶׁבְּתוֹכָם. **— This began in Shevat. Thus "a rod for the backs of fools" also alludes to their inwardness, through the word legev.**

Appetite and the Serpent's Enticement

וְאִיתָא בְּסֵפֶר יְצִירָה[1644]: הִמְלִיךְ אוֹת צ׳ בִּלְעִיטָה, וּשְׁבָט בַּשָּׁנָה. **— Sefer Yetzirah states: He made the letter tzadi rule over swallowing, and Shevat in the year.** כַּיָּדוּעַ שֶׁתְּחִלַּת הֶסַח הַנָּחָשׁ הָיָה בַּאֲכִילָה, וְאַחַר כָּךְ הֵטִיל בָּהּ זוּהֲמָא. **— As is known, the serpent's enticement began with eating, and afterward it introduced impurity into her.** וְאָמְרוּ בַּסִּפְרֵי (עֵקֶב)[1645], שֶׁאֵין אָדָם מוֹרֵד בְּהַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא אֶלָּא מִתּוֹךְ שְׂבִיעָה, וּכְמָה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: וְאָכַלְתָּ וְשָׂבָעְתָּ, הִשָּׁמְרוּ לָכֶם פֶּן **— Sifrei, on Ekev, teaches that a person rebels against the Holy One, blessed be He, only through satiation.** פֶּן תֹּאכַל וְשָׂבָעְתָּ[1646]. וְגוֹמֵר. **— Thus it says: "You shall eat and be satisfied"; "Beware lest," and so forth.** וְגוֹמֵר[1647], וְרָם לִבָּבֶךָ וְשָׁכַחְתָּ. וְגוֹמֵר. **— "Lest you eat and be satisfied," and so forth, "and your heart grow proud and you forget," and so forth.** שָׁמַנְתָּ עָבִיתָ וְגוֹמֵר, וַיִּטֹּשׁ וְגוֹמֵר.[1648] **— "You grew fat and thick," and so forth, "and he forsook," and so forth.** שָׂבְעוּ וַיָּרָם לִבָּם, עַל כֵּן שְׁכֵחוּנִי, וְעוֹד טוּבֵי.[1649] **— "They were satisfied and their hearts grew proud; therefore they forgot Me," and many other such verses.** וּבַגְּמָרָא (בְּרָכוֹת לב.): מְלֵי כְּרֵיסֵיהּ זְנֵי בִּישֵׁי; (שָׁם כט:): לָא תִּרְוֵי וְלָא תֶּחֱטֵי.[1650, 1651] **— The Talmud says (Berakhot 32a): A full stomach breeds evil; and there (29b): Do not become drunk, and you will not sin.**

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until good becomes established in his heart, evil is immediately pushed out of him. It is not expelled only from his heart; the effect reaches through all the worlds, from the highest levels down to the world of action, until even the nation attached to the evil quality opposite that good quality is entirely nullified and passes away. This is the aspect of "striking and healing" stated concerning Egypt."

Beit Yaakov explains the linked process behind the origin's "one opposite the other": establishing a particular good displaces its opposing evil, with effects beyond the individual. Its application to Abraham and Sodom differs from the origin's sequence of plagues; the comparison concerns the mechanism of striking and healing, not an identification of the events.

[1643] **Proverbs 26:3**: 'A whip for a horse and a bridle for a donkey,And a rod for the back of dullards.'

[1644] **Sefer Yetzirah Gra Version 5:10**: 'He made the letter Tzadi king over swallowing/taste (le'itah), bound a crown to it, and combined one with another; and with them He formed Aquarius (Deli) in the universe, Shevat in the year, and the gizzard (kurkevan) in the soul, male and female.'

[1645] **Sifrei Devarim 43:8**: "Similarly, the men of the generation of the flood rebelled only out of satiety, it being written of them (Job 21:10) "Their bull genders and does not fail; their cow calves, and does not abort … (12) They take the timbral and harp, and rejoice at the sound of the organ. (13) They spend their days in wealth, and in a moment go down to the grave." This (i.e., satiety) is the cause. (14) "And they say unto G-d: 'Depart from us'": They said: All we need (from Him) is one drop of rain. We do not need Him (for that. We can manage the water problem ourselves.) (Bereshith 2:6) "And a mist went up from the earth and watered the whole face of the ground." The Holy One Blessed be He said to them: "You vaunt yourselves over the good that I have bestowed upon you? With it I shall exact punishment of you!" — (Ibid. 7:12) "And the rain was on the earth forty days and forty nights." R. Yossi b. Dermaskith says: They made their eyes (eineihem) rove up and down to satisfy their lust — The Holy One Blessed be He, in kind, opened upon them the upper and lower fountains (maynoth like "eineihem") in order to destroy them, as it is written (Ibid. 13) "On this day were broken up all the fountains of the great deep, and the windows of heaven were opened."'

[1646] **Deuteronomy 11:15-16**: 'I will also provide grass in the fields for your cattle—and thus you shall eat your fill. Take care not to be lured away to serve other gods and bow to them.'

[1647] **Deuteronomy 8:12-14**: "Lest you eat and be satisfied, and build fine houses and dwell in them, and your cattle and flocks multiply, and silver and gold increase for you, and everything you have multiplies, and your heart grow proud and you forget Hashem your God, who brought you out of the land of Egypt, from the house of slavery."

[1648] **Deuteronomy 32:15**: "But Yeshurun grew fat and kicked; you grew fat, thick, and gross. He forsook God who made him, and scorned the Rock of his salvation."

[1649] **Hosea 13:6**: 'When they grazed, they were sated;When they were sated, they grew haughty;And so they forgot Me.'

[1650] **Berakhot 32a:12**: "Rav Acha son of Rav Huna said in Rav Sheshet's name: This is what people mean when they say, 'A full belly brings a person into bad kinds of conduct.' For it says, 'As they grazed, they became sated; they became sated and their hearts grew haughty; therefore they forgot Me.' Rav Nachman said: It is learned from here: 'Your heart will grow haughty and you will forget the Lord.' The Sages said: It is learned from here: 'He will eat, become sated and grow fat, and turn aside.'"

[1651] **Berakhot 29b**: 'On the topic of prayers recited while traveling and in times of danger, the Gemara discusses the traveler's prayer. When he appeared to him, Elijah the Prophet said to Rav Yehuda brother of Rav Sala Ḥasida: Do not get angry and you will not sin. Do not get drunk and you will not sin. And when you set out on a journey, consult with your Creator, and then set out. The Gemara asks: What is the meaning of: Consult with your Creator, and then set out? Rabbi Ya'akov said that Rav Ḥisda said: That is the traveler's prayer. And Rabbi Ya'akov said that Rav Ḥisda said: It is not only good advice, but established halakha that anyone who sets out on a journey must recite the traveler's prayer prior to embarking on his journey.'

Food Before and After the First Sin

וְהַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ בָּרָא אֶת הָאָדָם שֶׁיִּצְטָרֵךְ אֲכִילָה לְקִיּוּם הַחַיִּים, שֶׁהוּא חִיּוּת הַקְּדוּשָּׁה, וְהָיָה בְּהָאֲכִילָה קְדוּשָּׁה. **— Hashem, blessed be He, created man to require food to sustain life, which is the vitality of holiness, and eating itself contained holiness.** וּבְתְחִלַּת הַבְּרִיאָה הָיָה מְזוֹן הָאָדָם מִפֵּירוֹת הָאִילָן, כְּמָה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: וַיִּטַּע וְגוֹמֵר, וַיָּשֶׂם שָׁם אֶת הָאָדָם.[1652] **— At creation's beginning, man's food consisted of tree fruits, as it says: "He planted," and so forth, "and placed the man there."** וּנְטִיעָה הוּא בָּאִילָנוֹת, וּכְמָה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: מִכֹּל עֵץ הַגָּן אָכֹל תֹּאכֵל.[1653] **— Planting refers to trees, as it says: "From every tree of the garden you may surely eat."** וּמַה שֶּׁנֶּאֱמַר: נָתַתִּי לָכֶם אֶת כָּל עֵשֶׂב וְגוֹמֵר, וְאֶת כָּל הָעֵץ אֲשֶׁר בּוֹ פְּרִי עֵץ וְגוֹמֵר, לָכֶם יִהְיֶה לְאָכְלָה,[1654] **— As for "I have given you every plant," and so forth, "and every tree that bears tree fruit," and so forth, "it shall be yours for food,"** וּלְכָל חַיַּת הָאָרֶץ וְגוֹמֵר, אֵין הַכַּוָּנָה הַכֹּל לְכוּלָּם, רַק פְּרִי הָעֵץ לָאָדָם וְעֵשֶׂב הַשָּׂדֶה לְבַעֲלֵי חַיִּים. **— and "to every beast of the earth," and so forth, it does not mean everything for everyone: tree fruit was for man, and the plants of the field for animals.** תֵּדַע, דְּאַחַר הַחַטְא, בַּקְּלָלוֹת נֶאֱמַר לוֹ: וְאָכַלְתָּ אֶת עֵשֶׂב הַשָּׂדֶה,[1655] **— The proof is that after the sin he was told among the curses: "You shall eat the plants of the field."** וְאָמְרוּ (פְּסָחִים קיח.) דְּזָלְגוּ עֵינָיו דְּמָעוֹת: אֲנִי וַחֲמוֹרִי נֹאכַל בְּאֲבוּס אֶחָד? וְאָמַר לוֹ: בְּזֵעַת אַפֶּיךָ וְגוֹמֵר.[1656] **— The Sages say (Pesachim 118a) that tears streamed from his eyes: Shall my donkey and I eat from one trough? He was then told: "By the sweat of your brow," and so forth.** וְאָז נִתְקַלְּלוּ פֵּירוֹת הָאִילָן, וְעָתִיד לְהַחֲזִירָן לְתִיקוּנָן, כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ (בְּרֵאשִׁית רַבָּה פָּרָשָׁה יב).[1657] **— Tree fruits were then cursed, and He will ultimately restore them to their proper state, as stated in Bereshit Rabbah, chapter 12.** וּבַעֲצֶרֶת עַל פֵּירוֹת הָאִילָן (כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ רֹאשׁ הַשָּׁנָה טז.),[1658] **— On Shavuot, judgment concerns tree fruits, as stated in Rosh Hashanah 16a.** כִּי בְּמַתַּן תּוֹרָה נַעֲשָׂה חֵירוּת מִמַּלְאַךְ הַמָּוֶת וּמִיֵּצֶר הָרָע, שֶׁהַכֹּל אֶחָד (כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ בָּבָא בַּתְרָא טז.),[1659] **— For the giving of the Torah brought freedom from the Angel of Death and the evil inclination, which are one, as stated in Bava Batra 16a.** וְחָזַר לִהְיוֹת כְּקוֹדֶם הַחַטְא, וְנִתְקָנִים הַפֵּירוֹת. **— The state before the sin returned, and the fruits were restored.** וּבִשְׁבָט הוּא עַל יְדֵי הַיִּסּוּרִין, עַל דָּרֶךְ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: הִכְרַתִּי גוֹיִם וְגוֹמֵר, תִּרְאִי אוֹתִי תִּקְחִי מוּסָר.[1660] **— In Shevat, this comes through suffering, as in: "I have cut off nations," and so forth; "You will fear Me and accept instruction."** וְנֶאֱמַר בְּמַכּוֹת מִצְרַיִם: אֲשֶׁר יָגוֹרְתָּ מִפְּנֵיהֶם.[1661] **— Concerning Egypt's plagues it says: "which you dreaded."** וְעַל יְדֵי זֶה הָיָה רְפוּאָה לְיִשְׂרָאֵל, וְזֶהוּ: שִׁבְטְךָ וּמִשְׁעַנְתֶּךָ, שֶׁהוּא דִּבְרֵי תוֹרָה (כְּמוֹ[1662] **— Through this came healing for Israel. This is "Your rod and Your staff."**

[1652] **Genesis 2:8**: 'The ETERNAL God planted a garden in Eden, in the east, and placed there the Human who had been fashioned.'

[1653] **Genesis 2:16**: "Hashem God commanded the man, saying: 'You may freely eat from every tree of the garden.'"

[1654] **Genesis 1:29-30**: "God said: 'Behold, I have given you every plant bearing seed upon the face of all the earth, and every tree that has fruit bearing seed; they shall be yours for food. And to every beast of the earth, every bird of the heavens, and everything that moves upon the earth in which there is life, every green plant is for food.' And it was so."

[1655] **Genesis 3:18-19**: "Thorns and thistles it will grow for you, and you will eat the vegetation of the field. By the sweat of your face you will eat bread, until you return to the ground, for from it you were taken; for you are dust, and to dust you will return."

[1656] **Pesachim 118a:8**: "Rabbi Yehoshua ben Levi said: When the Holy One, blessed be He, told Adam, 'Thorns and thistles it will bring forth for you,' tears flowed from his eyes. He said before Him, 'Master of the world, shall I and my donkey eat from the same trough?' Once He told him, 'By the sweat of your brow you shall eat bread,' his mind was put at ease."

[1657] **Bereshit Rabbah 12:6** (excerpt): "Rabbi Berechyah said in the name of Rabbi Shmuel: Although things were created in their fullness, once Adam sinned they were damaged. They will not return to their proper state until the descendant of Peretz comes, as it says, 'These are the generations of Peretz' (Ruth 4:18), with the word 'generations' written in full, because six things will return: his radiance, his life, his stature, the earth's fruits, the trees' fruits, and the heavenly lights."

[1658] **Rosh Hashanah 16a:6**: "For it was taught: All are judged on Rosh Hashanah, and their verdict is sealed on Yom Kippur; these are Rabbi Meir's words. Rabbi Yehudah says: All are judged on Rosh Hashanah, but each verdict is sealed at its appointed time: On Pesach, concerning grain; on Shavuos, concerning tree fruits; and on Sukkos they are judged concerning water. A person is judged on Rosh Hashanah, and his verdict is sealed on Yom Kippur."

[1659] **Bava Batra 16a:8**: "Reish Lakish said: Satan, the evil inclination, and the Angel of Death are one and the same. He is Satan, as it is written, 'Satan went out from the presence of the Lord.' He is the evil inclination: there it is written, 'Only evil all day long,' and here it is written, 'Only, do not stretch out your hand against him.' The shared word 'only' connects the two passages. An alternative reading cites 'Only, preserve his life' at this point. He is also the Angel of Death, as it is written, 'But preserve his life'; this shows that the power to take Job's life otherwise lay in his hands."

[1660] **Zephaniah 3:6-7**: "And I thought that she would fear Me,Would learn a lesson,And that the punishment I brought on them Would not be lost on her. Instead, all the more eagerly They have practiced corruption in all their deeds."

[1661] **Deuteronomy 28:60**: "He will bring back upon you all the illnesses of Egypt that you feared, and they will cling to you."

[1662] **Psalms 23:4**: 'Psalms 23: 4: 'Though I walk through a valley of deepest darkness, I fear no harm, for You are with me;Your rod and Your staff—they comfort me.''

.שֶׁאָמְרוּ חֲגִיגָה יד[1663] — **Through the rod, one merits the support of Torah teachings, as stated in Chagigah 14a.** וְהִנֵּה אָדָם הָרִאשׁוֹן, קוֹדֶם הַקִּלְקוּל, הָיָה עִסְקוֹ רַק בְּדִבְרֵי תוֹרָה, כִּי נִבְרָא בִּבְחִירָה לִבְחוֹר רַק בַּטּוֹב. — **Before the corruption, Adam's sole occupation was words of Torah, for he was created with free choice, in order to choose only the good.** וּפַרְנָסָתוֹ מְזוּמֶּנֶת בְּלֹא שׁוּם יְגִיעָה, דַּעֲצֵי הַגָּן נָתְנוּ פְּרִים, וְחִטִּים גַּם כֵּן הָיוּ גְּדֵלִים בָּאִילָן, — **His sustenance was ready without any labor: the garden's trees bore fruit, and wheat too grew on a tree.** כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ (בְּרָכוֹת מ.), דְּאִיכָּא לְמַאן דְּאָמַר דְּאִילָן שֶׁאָכַל מִמֶּנּוּ אָדָם הָרִאשׁוֹן חִטָּה הָיָה, וּכְמוֹ[1664] — **As stated in Berakhot 40a, one opinion holds that the tree from which Adam ate was wheat.** וְרַבִּי שְׁלֹמֹה יִצְחָקִי כָּתַב (רֹאשׁ הַשָּׁנָה טז סוֹף עַמּוּד א), דְּמִשּׁוּם הָכִי אָמְרוּ: הָבִיאוּ שְׁתֵּי הַלֶּחֶם בַּעֲצֶרֶת שֶׁיִּתְבָּרְכוּ פֵּירוֹת הָאִילָן.[1665] — **Rashi writes, at the end of Rosh Hashanah 16a, that this explains the instruction: Bring the two loaves on Shavuot so that tree fruits will be blessed.** וְאָז הוֹצִיאוּ הָאִילָנוֹת גְּלוּסְקָאוֹת, כְּמוֹ לֶעָתִיד, שֶׁעֲתִידָה אֶרֶץ יִשְׂרָאֵל שֶׁתּוֹצִיא גְּלוּסְקָאוֹת כּוּלֵי (כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ שַׁבָּת ל:),[1666] — **The trees then produced fine loaves, as in the future, when the Land of Israel will produce fine loaves and so forth, as stated in Shabbat 30b.** וְלֹא הָיָה נִצְרָךְ אַף טוֹרַח דְּטָחִינָה וַאֲפִיָּה. — **Even the work of grinding and baking was unnecessary.** וְאִיתָא בְּתִיקּוּנֵי זוֹהַר (תִּיקּוּן כ״ד), וּבַתִּיקּוּנִים שֶׁבְּסוֹף זוֹהַר חָדָשׁ (דַּף קז ב),[1667] — **Tikkunei Zohar, tikkun 24, and the Tikkunim at the end of Zohar Chadash, 107b, state** מַאן דְּכָלָּא קְשׁוֹט: דְּאָמַר חִטָּה, וּמַאן דְּאָמַר תְּאֵנָה, וּמַאן דְּאָמַר גֶּפֶן, וְלָא הֲווֹ חוֹלְקִין בְּמִילּוֹלֵיהוּ, עַיֵּין שָׁם. — **that all the opinions are true—whether wheat, fig, or vine—and they were not disagreeing in their words; see there.** וְהַיְינוּ שֶׁהָיָה כֹּחַ עֵץ הַחַיִּים וְעֵץ הַדַּעַת טוֹב וָרָע בְּכָל עֲצֵי הַגָּן, — **The power of the Tree of Life and the Tree of Knowledge of Good and Evil was present in all the garden's trees.**

Labor and the Refinement of Souls

.וְהַמַּחֲלוֹקֶת הוּא רַק בַּמָּה תְּחִלַּת הַקִּלְקוּל (וְנִתְבָּאֵר בְּרֵאשִׁית מַאֲמָר ח׳, עַיֵּין שָׁם) — **The disagreement concerns only where the corruption began, as explained in Bereshit, teaching 8; see there.**

Why repair extends beyond the first sin

וְאַחַר הַקִּלְקוּל, שֶׁנִּיתַּן הַכֹּל תַּחַת הַבְּחִירָה לִבְחוֹר בַּטּוֹב וּבְהֵיפָךְ, נֶאֱמַר לוֹ: בְּזֵעַת אַפֶּיךָ וְגוֹמֵר,[1668, 1669] — **After the corruption,**

[1663] **Chagigah 14a:9**: "'Support' refers to masters of Scripture. 'Staff' refers to masters of Mishnah, such as Rabbi Yehudah ben Teima and his colleagues. Rav Pappa and the Sages disagreed about the extent of their learning: One said six hundred orders of Mishnah, and one said seven hundred orders of Mishnah."

[1664] **Berakhot 40a:14**: "'Over the fruits of the ground,' and so forth: Is this not obvious? Rav Nachman bar Yitzchak said: It was needed only according to Rabbi Yehudah, who says that wheat is a kind of tree. For it was taught: What was the tree from which Adam the first man ate? Rabbi Meir says: It was a vine, because nothing brings lamentation upon a person as wine does, as it says, 'He drank of the wine and became drunk.' Rabbi Nechemyah says: It was a fig tree, because through the very thing by which they were corrupted they found their remedy, as it says, 'They sewed fig leaves.' Rabbi Yehudah says: It was wheat, because a child does not know how to call 'Father' and 'Mother' until he tastes grain."

[1665] **Rashi on Rosh Hashanah 16a:14:2**: 'Rashi on Rosh Hashanah 16a (s.v. Havu shtei ha-lechem): "Bring the Two Loaves of wheat on Shavuot so that the fruits of the trees may be blessed for you"—because wheat is itself called a tree in the exposition of Rabbi Yehudah.'

[1666] **Shabbat 30b:11**: "Rabban Gamliel was also sitting and expounding: In the future the Land of Israel will bring forth ready-made cakes and fine wool garments, as it says, 'May there be an abundance of grain in the land,' reading pissas as an allusion to prepared produce and fabric. That student mocked him, saying, 'There is nothing new under the sun.' He answered, 'Come, and I will show you examples of them in this world.' He went out and showed him truffles and mushrooms as examples of ready-made food, and for fine garments, the fibrous sheath around a palm shoot."

[1667] **Zohar Chadash, Tikuna Kadma'ah 24**: "For Adam sinned through the seven species: wheat, barley, grape, fig, pomegranate, oil-bearing olive, and honey. Therefore the Sages of the Mishnah said that the tree from which Adam ate was wheat; others said that it was a vine, and others said that it was a fig tree. They did not disagree in their statements, for all is true. The seven species are planted in the land—wheat and barley. This is what we learned: On Shavuot, the whole world is judged concerning the fruit of the tree. It calls them all one tree from one aspect, while from another aspect they divide into seven species."

[1668] **Genesis 3:18-19**: "Thorns and thistles it will grow for you, and you will eat the vegetation of the field. By the sweat of your face you will eat bread, until you return to the ground, for from it you were taken; for you are dust, and to dust you will return."

[1669] **Peri Tzadik, Bereshit 8:2**: "This is what is meant by "She gave me from the tree, and I ate." He spoke in the bitterness of his heart and pleaded his case: What can I do? Now that I have tasted the Tree of Knowledge of good and evil, from now on, whatever I eat, I will feel bodily enjoyment in it, which is this mixture of good and evil. What can I do? Even overcoming the inclination requires the Holy One's help, for without His help one cannot overcome it; and, as explained, entirely nullifying the inclination is as it will be in the future, when the Holy One slaughters it. This is his saying, "And I will eat again": he would certainly eat again. Therefore, although Adam and Eve's repentance was effective in extending their days to nearly a thousand years, the Holy One's day, the decree could not be entirely canceled. As long as the mixture remained and bodily enjoyment would be felt, death was needed to separate good from evil so that only good would remain."
Following the origin's explicit reference to Bereshit 8, this continuation reads Adam's "and I ate" as anticipating "I will

everything became subject to choosing good or its opposite. He was then told: "By the sweat of your brow," and so forth, — שֶׁיִּצְטָרֵךְ יְגִיעָה וַעֲבוֹדָה בְּדָרֶךְ אֶרֶץ, לִהְיוֹת מְשֻׁכַּחַת עָוֹן, וְלִבְחוֹר בַּחַיִּים וּבַטּוֹב. **requiring labor and worldly work to help him put sin out of mind and choose life and good.** וְאִיתָא מֵהָאֲרִי זְכרוֹנוֹ לִבְרָכָה, דְּהַנְּפָשׁוֹת מִדּוֹר הַמַּבּוּל נִשְׁתַּעְבְּדוּ בְּמִצְרַיִם,[1670] — **The Ari, of blessed memory, teaches that the souls of the Flood generation were enslaved in Egypt.** וְגַם נֶפֶשׁ מֹשֶׁה רַבֵּינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם הָיָה בְּדוֹר הַמַּבּוּל, — **Moshe our teacher's soul, peace be upon him, was also present in the Flood generation,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁנִּרְמַז בַּגְּמָרָא (חוּלִין קלט:):[1671] מֹשֶׁה מִן הַתּוֹרָה, בְּשַׁגַּם, גִּימַטְרִיָּא מֹשֶׁה, — **as alluded to in Chullin 139b: Where is Moshe indicated in the Torah? In beshagam, whose numerical value equals Moshe.** וְעַל זֶה מְרַמֵּז: כִּי מִן הַמַּיִם מְשִׁיתִהוּ, מִמֵּימֵי הַמַּבּוּל.[1672] — **"For I drew him from the water" alludes to this: from the waters of the Flood.** דְּמִקִּלְקוּל אָדָם הָרִאשׁוֹן נַעֲשָׂה הֶעֵרְבּוּב גַּם בַּנְּפָשׁוֹת, וְגָלוּת מִצְרַיִם הָיָה לְהַפְרִיד הָרָע מֵהַטּוֹב, — **Adam's corruption brought mixture into souls as well. The Egyptian exile served to separate evil from good,** וְנִתְקְנוּ אָז נַפְשׁוֹת דּוֹר הַמַּבּוּל. — **and the souls of the Flood generation were then rectified.** וְיָדוּעַ דְּחַטָּא דּוֹר הַמַּבּוּל הָיָה בְּתַאֲוָה, וְעִיקַּר תַּאֲוָה בַּלֵּב, — **The Flood generation's sin, as is known, lay in desire, and desire is rooted in the heart.** וְעַל זֶה נֶאֱמַר: מִכָּל מִשְׁמָר נְצוֹר לִבֶּךָ, כִּי מִמֶּנּוּ תּוֹצְאוֹת חַיִּים.[1673] — **Thus it says: "Guard your heart above all that you guard, for from it flow the sources of life."** וְהַמַּכּוֹת שֶׁהָיָה נָגוֹף לַמִּצְרִיִּם וְרָפוֹא לְיִשְׂרָאֵל, כְּמוֹ שֶׁנִּתְבָּאֵר כַּמָּה פְּעָמִים,[1674] — **The plagues struck Egypt and healed Israel, as explained several times.** וְסֵדֶר הַמַּכּוֹת מִתַּחְתָּא לְעֵילָּא, וְהָיָה מַכַּת אַרְבֶּה נֶגֶד בִּינָה, לְבָא.[1675] — **The plagues proceeded from below upward, and the plague of locusts corresponded to Binah, the heart.** וּכְתִיב בְּמַכַּת אַרְבֶּה: וּלְמַעַן תְּסַפֵּר וְגוֹמֵר, וּכְתִיב בְּיוֹאֵל גַּם כֵּן: לִבְנֵיכֶם סַפְּרוּ וְגוֹמֵר,[1676, 1677] — **In the locust plague it says: "So that you may recount," and so forth. Joel likewise says: "Recount it to your children," and so forth,** מְרַמֵּז שֶׁנִּתְקְנוּ יִשְׂרָאֵל בִּפְנִימִיּוּת הַלֵּב לְדוֹרוֹת. — **alluding to Israel's inward heart being rectified for the generations.** וְכֵן נֶאֱמַר בְּיוֹאֵל: וְאֶת הַצְּפוֹנִי וְגוֹמֵר, דְּקָאֵי לְפִשּׁוּטוֹ עַל הָאַרְבֶּה,[1678] — **Joel also says: "And the northerner," and so forth, which plainly refers to the locusts.** וּבַגְּמָרָא (סוּכָּה נב.): צְפוֹנִי, זֶה יֵצֶר הָרָע שֶׁצָּפוּן בְּלִבּוֹ שֶׁל אָדָם (וְנִתְבָּאֵר בֹּא סוֹף מַאֲמָר ב),[1679, 1680] — **The Talmud (Sukkah 52a) interprets the northerner as**

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eat again." It distinguishes repentance for the original act from the still-present mixture affecting later eating. That distinction explains the origin's extended account of labor, purification, Torah, and eventual restoration rather than treating one past act as the entire problem.

[1670] **Sha'ar HaPesukim, Parashat Shemot 8-18**: 'Rabbi Chaim Vital, Sha'ar HaPesukim (Parashat Shemot): Teaches in the name of the Arizal that the souls of the generation of the Flood and the Dispersion were reincarnated in Israel in Egypt to be purified through the iron crucible and redeemed at the Exodus.'

[1671] **Chullin 139b:10**: "The people of Pappunya asked Rav Mattana: If someone found a bird's nest on a person's head, what is the law concerning sending away the mother bird? He answered them with the verse, 'And earth was upon his head,' treating the head as ground for this purpose. Where is Moshe alluded to in the Torah before his birth? In 'inasmuch as he too is flesh,' be-shaggam hu basar. The numerical value of be-shaggam is that of Moshe."

[1672] **Exodus 2:10**: "When the child grew, she brought him to Pharaoh's daughter, and he became her son. She named him Moshe, saying: 'For I drew him out of the water.'"

[1673] **Proverbs 4:23**: 'More than all that you guard, guard your mind,For it is the source of life.'

[1674] **Isaiah 19:22**: "Hashem will strike Egypt, striking and healing; they will return to Hashem, and He will answer their plea and heal them."

[1675] **Tikkunei Zohar 17a:9-18**: 'And they are called in this arrangement: Ḥesed – right arm, Gevurah – left arm, Tipheret – body, Netzaḥ and Hod – two thighs, and Yesod – end of the body, – sign of the holy covenant. Malkhut – 'mouth' – we call it 'Oral Torah'.'

[1676] **Exodus 10:2**: "And so that you may tell in the ears of your son and your son's son how I made a mockery of Egypt, and of My signs that I placed among them, so that you may know that I am Hashem."

[1677] **Joel 1:3**: 'Tell your children of it, and let your children tell their children, and their children another generation.'

[1678] **Joel 2:20**: 'Joel 2: 20: 'I will drive the northerner far from you,I will thrust it into a parched and desolate land—Its van to the Eastern Sea And its rear to the Western Sea; And the stench of it shall go up,And the foul smell rise."For GOD shall work great deeds.''

[1679] **Sukkah 52a:9**: "Yeshayahu called the evil inclination a 'stumbling block,' as it says, 'Build up, build up; clear the way; remove the stumbling block from My people's path.' Yechezkel called it 'stone,' as it says, 'I shall remove the heart of stone from your flesh and give you a heart of flesh.' Yoel called it 'the northern one,' tzefoni, as it says, 'I shall remove the northern one far from you.' The Sages taught: 'I shall remove the northern one far from you' means the evil inclination, which is hidden, tzafun, and stands within a person's heart."

[1680] **Peri Tzadik, Bo 2:2**: "This is also alluded to in the verse, "So that you may recount in the ears of your son and your grandson." It follows what I heard from the holy master, of blessed memory, who said that children are the depths of their father's heart. Rabbi Menachem Azariah likewise wrote that the father's soul is the son's governing influence—that is, the root of life. This is the meaning of "So that you may recount": through the locusts, they would attain the quality of understanding, the heart, and establish holiness for the generations—"So that you may recount." In this He alluded to the plague of locusts, corresponding to understanding, the heart. Joel likewise says, "I will remove the northerner from you," which in its plain meaning refers to the locusts. The Gemara, Sukkah 52a, says that Joel called it "the northerner," and expounds: this is the evil inclination, which is hidden and stationed in a person's heart. That is, in the hidden chambers of his heart. Thus the precise wording is "these signs of Mine within him.""

the evil inclination hidden in man's heart, as explained at the end of Bo, teaching 2. וְלָזֶה הָיָה מַכַּת אַרְבֶּה בְּחוֹדֶשׁ שְׁבָט, שֶׁיִּתּוּקַן פְּנִימִיּוּת הַלֵּב מִתַּאֲוֹת גַּשְׁמִיּוֹת. — **The locust plague therefore came in Shevat, to rectify the inward heart from bodily desires.** וְזֶה מְרֻמָּז[1681]: הִמְלִיךְ אוֹת צ׳ בִּלְעִיטָה, שֶׁהַצַּדִּיק מְתַקֵּן בְּרֵאשִׁית עֲבוֹדָתוֹ תַּאֲוַת אֲכִילָה, כְּמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: צַדִּיק אוֹכֵל לְשׂוֹבַע נַפְשׁוֹ, רֵק לְהַחֲיוֹת אֶת נַפְשׁוֹ, בְּלֹא שׂוּם תַּאֲוָה.[1682] — **This is the allusion in making tzadi rule over swallowing: the righteous person begins his service by rectifying his appetite for food, as it says: "The righteous person eats to satisfy his soul"—solely to sustain his soul, without any craving.**

From Shevat to Redemption

Shevat is the time to rectify eating by freeing it from craving. וְאַחַר כָּךְ בְּחוֹדֶשׁ שְׁבָט זְמַן תִּיקּוּן הָאֲכִילָה מִתַּאֲוָה. — **Afterward, in Adar, the plague of darkness corresponded to Chokhmah, the brain.** בְּחוֹדֶשׁ אֲדָר, מַכַּת חֹשֶׁךְ נֶגֶד חָכְמָה, מוֹחָא. — **Then comes the erasure of Amalek, alluding to Mashiach son of Yosef,** וְאָז הוּא מְחִיַּת עֲמָלֵק, וּמְרַמֵּז נֶגֶד מָשִׁיחַ בֶּן יוֹסֵף, שֶׁאֵין עֲמָלֵק נוֹפֵל אֶלָּא בְּיַד בְּנֵיהָ שֶׁל רָחֵל (כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ פְּסִיקְתָא רַבָּתִי פָּרָשָׁה יב).[1683] —

[1681] **Sefer Yetzirah Gra Version 5:10**: 'He made the letter Tzadi king over swallowing/taste (le'itah), bound a crown to it, and combined one with another; and with them He formed Aquarius (Deli) in the universe, Shevat in the year, and the gizzard (kurkevan) in the soul, male and female.'

[1682] **Proverbs 13:25**: 'A righteous person eats to the satisfaction of his soul, but the belly of the wicked will lack.'

[1683] **Pesikta Rabbati 12:1**: "Remember what Amalek did to you (Deuteronomy 25:17). May our rabbi teach us how one who passes among the graves is obligated to recite the blessing, "Blessed is He who knows the number of all of you," even though some of our rabbis say that he is obligated to recite the blessing, "Blessed is He who knows the number of all of you." The incident of Rabbi Chayya and Rabbi Nathan, who were walking in the cemetery, and one of them recited the blessing, "Blessed is He who knows the number of all of you." His companion said to him, "Do the dead know anything?" His companion said to him, "There is nothing between the dead and the living but mere talk, as it is written, "The righteous shall rise up in honor, they shall sing praises upon their beds" (Psalms 149:5). Indeed, if a person were to pass among the graves and know that a righteous person is buried there, he should remember him in his deeds. Solomon said, "Remember the righteous for blessings" (Proverbs 10:7). Reish Lakish said, "When God, blessed be He, reminds a righteous person of what He has done, He reminds him of good, as it is written, "And the Lord said, 'I am the One who covers over Abraham, that which I do' (Genesis 18:17)." What does it mean to say, "And Abraham would have been a great and mighty nation, etc." (Ibid., 18) and so on. When the Holy One, blessed be He, reminded him, He reminded him for good, and He remembered the days of eternity. Moses served and (Isaiah 63:11). But when He came to mention the wicked, He reminded him for evil, and who was it? It was Amalek. When He came to make war with Israel, what did the Holy One, blessed be He, say to Moses? It is written in the book of Exodus 17:14? Moses said to him, "The Lord of the worlds, the righteous, wrote in them a remembrance." The Holy One, blessed be He, said to him, "He revived the remembrance of the righteous in order to give them a reward in the future. The remembrance of the wicked in order to redeem them and erase their names from what they called in the matter of remembering what is written, etc., and blot out the remembrance of Amalek: Remember what is written, etc. Thus Rabbi Tanchuma began in me, Rabbi Abba, in the name of Rabbi Tanchum bar Hanilai, who said, "Your remembrance is like ashes, concerning the dust of your backs" (Job 13:12). Job said this verse against all his companions when those same afflictions befell him and they were harsh words against him. Job said to them, "Your remembrance is like ashes. How can you deceive the people who see you and think that you are righteous like Abraham, who made himself of ashes, as it is said, "I am dust and ashes" (Genesis 18:27) and you are nothing but with regard to the material of your backs, the flood ball, and like those who wrote about them, and the clay was their material (Isa. 11:3)?" Another thing about your remembrance is like ashes, speaking against Israel, to whom the Blessed One said, "I command you to be mindful of two remembrances," as it is said, "Remember what He has done," etc. "Blot out the memory of Amalek," etc. "But know that if you do not remember them and call upon them every year that I will return you to the slavery of Egypt," as it is said in the matter of clay and bricks (Exodus 1:14), "Remember what Amalek did to you." Remember this: Rabbi Tanchuma began, "Rabbi, in the name of Rabbi Job, the one who said, "Do not be like a horse or a mule, who does not understand the bit and bridle, to stop them, for they are near you." (Psalms 11:3) 32:9) The Holy One, blessed be He, says to Israel, "O Israel, be understanding among you. Do not be like a horse that has no understanding. What is the business of a horse that a man goes to give it jewelry or food, and it twists its neck and kicks it? And so is the mule. And you, do not be like that. But be understanding among you. (When you enter) the land, remember to repay it with good (its good) and with evil (its evil)." How is it written, "You shall not abhor an Edomite" (Deuteronomy 23:8)? Why, because he is your brother (there) whether good or bad, your brother is you shall not abhor an Egyptian, for you were strangers in his land (there) whether good or bad, you did with them for a few years. But Amalek, remember what Amalek did to you: 1. Remember thus, Rabbi Tanchuma opened it with me. Rabbi Zacharias, may he remember the iniquity of his fathers to the Lord, and do not blot out the sin of his mother (Psalms 19:14). He does not say the iniquity of his father, but the iniquity of his fathers, you are the iniquity of his fathers. The origin of Esau the wicked, who did not sin against Israel alone, but many sins, sinned against the Holy One, sinned against Israel, sinned against his brothers, sinned against (his mother) his father, sinned against Abraham. Let the iniquity of his ancestors be remembered. How he sinned against the Holy One, blessed be He, burned the Torah and burned the Temple. Sinned against Israel, burned, killed, and exiled. Sinned against his brothers. The days of mourning for my father are drawing near and she killed my brother Jacob (Genesis 27:41) and fled from him, sinned against (his mother) his father, he went and carried away the news. And they were smoking before Akkum, and Isaac smelled and his eyes were dimmed, as it is said, And his eyes were dimmed (Ibid., I Revealing incest and shedding blood Therefore, as soon as Abraham had done so, Jacob was sitting and cooking lentils. Esau came and said to him, "What did you see, sitting and cooking lentils?" He said to him, "Because he died in my old age, and I sit and mourn and grieve, so that he may know how I grieved for him, and when the dead live in the future, he will be (loved) loved." He said to him, "You are foolish. Do you think that when a man dies and ends up in the grave that he will live in the future? And he

for Amalek falls only to Rachel's descendants, as stated in Pesikta Rabbati, chapter 12. וּשְׁבָט הוּא הַהֲכָנָה וְאָמַרְנוּ שֶׁלְּכָךְ הַמִּצְוָה בְּפוּרִים לַעֲשׂוֹת סְעוּדָה וְלִשְׁתּוֹת, **Shevat prepares for the erasure of Amalek.** לִמְחִיַּת עֲמָלֵק. **— We have explained that this is why the Purim commandment is to hold a feast and drink:** כִּי כְּבָר נִתְקַן

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denies the resurrection of the dead. Behold, I am going to die." (Genesis 25:32) He said to him, "And what about the birthright that you think is worthless? Give me a bowl of these lentils and I will give it to you." And Jacob gave Esau bread and lentil stew and Esau despised the birthright (Ibid. 34) (Why) did he not do so but sell it to him? He began to seek (to kill her) to kill him, and he accepted it for his father. He called his name Jacob and he took my birthright (Ibid. 27:36) Rebekah felt that he was foolish and said to Jacob, "Now then, My son, listen to my voice and arise, flee to your place (Ibid. 43). Jacob stands and leaves his father and mother and goes into exile from him to places he did not know and does twenty-two years except for his father, who is found. He says, "Just as he sinned against his mother his father and against our elders, so he sinned against his brothers." David, the son of Rabshakeh, said, "Remember the iniquity of his fathers: And the sin of his mother, do not blot out." What is the sin of his mother? Rabbi Yehuda says, "When he comes out of his mother's womb, he cut off her foreskin." Thus says the Lord concerning the three transgressions of Edom and and the corruption of his womb. (Amos 1:11) And Rabbi Nehemiah says, "He caused her not to stand. The twelve tribes, and our rabbis said, "What is the sin of her mother that they brought her out at night when she died from his presence." And she obeyed. Thus she said, "Jacob the righteous, my son, is not here. Isaac the righteous, my husband, is sitting in the house because his eyes are like this. He will bring me out by day, and this wicked man will walk before my bed." And they will say, "Oh, how glorious is this that he has suckled, that is why she commanded to bring her out at night, because when mothers died, they would come out by day." And it was made public to them, and everyone came and repaid the bread of charity, Rabbi Yossi ben Hanina, and this is because they brought her out at night, her death was not recorded as Sarah's, as it is said, "And Sarah died, etc." (Genesis 23:2) and Deborah, Rebecca's wet nurse, died (Ibid. 35:8). Deborah's death was published, Rabbi Aba, in the name of Rabbi Yossi ben Hanina, because it was not made public to her as a mother, her death was not published, even the scriptures did not publish her death. And the sin of his mother, do not blot out, and do not remember the sin of his mother, says the Holy One, Blessed be He. All (I will make restitution) pay him for all the wrongs of his father. All (his) wrongs of his mother (will make restitution) pay him for all the wrongs of our ancestors (will make restitution) pay him for all the wrongs of his brothers. All (I will make restitution) pay him for all the wrongs that he did in my house. They will remember him to blot out his name from the world. Remember what Amalek did to you. And you will blot out the memory of him. Amalek: Another thing to remember is that the Scripture says, "The rebuke of the nations is the destruction of the wicked. Their name shall be remembered forever and ever." (Psalms 9:6) The rebuke of the nations are the nations that counsel evil counsel at all times against Israel, and the Holy One, blessed be He, will thwart them. You have destroyed the wicked. This is the wicked man who remained of the seed of Amalek and sought to destroy Israel. Their name shall be remembered forever and ever. You will blot out the memory of Amalek. Remember what Amalek did to you: And Moses said to Joshua, "Choose for us men" (Exodus 17:9). Hence, a man should give honor to his disciples like him. How many righteous men did you say, "And two men were left in the camp," etc. (Numbers 11:26). That is, valiant men. And the bread came out. Tomorrow I will stand on the top of the hill with the staff of God in my hand against Amalek (Exodus 13:13). Moses said to Joshua, "Go out and fight against Amalek, and I will stand on the top of the hill." Rabbi Isaac said to the robbers who had entered the city, a force came out to fight them. There was a widow's son there. He said to them, "Behold, I will go up to the roof and watch while you fight. Go out and fight, and I will stand on the top of the hill." And I (will stand) stand It is not written here, and I will stand except, and I will stand (by right) I will stand by right I will stand by right I will stand by right of the laws, as it is written, I will stand in the controversy of the Lord and stand in judgment with the peoples (Isaiah 3:13): The head by right of the fathers, for from the head of the mountains I will show myself (Numbers 23:9): The hill is the mother of the mountains, as it is said, and from the hills of Assyria, ours (there), and the staff by right of (Moses and the Gods) the staff of God (if) perhaps we can stand upon it. Why do we come in the merit of the fathers in this way? They come in the merit of the fathers: i.e. Why did Moses say to Joshua, "Bring out bread, because he is of the sons of Rachel, who was born in the way, and all those who are behind you will be deceived by you and and will not fear God (Deuteronomy 25:18). i.e. Why did Esau fall into the hands of Joseph, but Joseph was a little one, the son of old age, and Esau, behold, I have given you among the nations (Obadiah 1:2) Esau, the little one (whom I called), will come and fall into the hands of Joseph, the little one: i.e. All the tribes participated in the sale of Joseph, therefore none of the tribes (could) could intermarry with him who they could not marry and give with him. i.e. Esau was the firstborn and through his evil deeds he lost his birthright, Joseph was the little one and through his good deeds he earned the birthright, his good deeds will come and atone for Esau, who was the firstborn and lost his birthright through his evil deeds. Joseph acknowledged the resurrection of the dead, "May God acknowledge you, and you shall carry up my bones from here with you" (Exodus 13:19). And make atonement for the resurrection of the dead, for I am about to die, etc. (Genesis 25:32). The Holy One, blessed be He, said, "Come, Joseph, who acknowledged the resurrection of the dead, and repay Esau, who made atonement for the resurrection of the dead." Joseph grew up between two wicked men, Potiphar and Pharaoh, and did not learn from their deeds. Esau grew up between two righteous men, and did not learn from their deeds. Said the Holy One, blessed be He, "Come, Joseph, who grew up between two wicked men, and did not learn from their deeds. And repay Esau, who did not learn from their deeds. Joseph came, who repaid his brothers good for evil, and Esau repaid evil for good." Said the Holy One, blessed be He, "Come, Joseph, etc. Joseph gave his life for his mother's honor, and Esau sought to kill his mother When he left, he cut off his mother's foreskin because he had pursued him with his brother's sword and had destroyed his womb (Ovadiah, there). The Blessed One said, "Joseph, who gave his life for his mother's honor, will come and repay Esau who sought to kill his mother." And where do we find in Joseph giving his life for his mother's honor, except when Jacob returned to his father's house, because he had come to harm Esau? What did he do? He made his sons and the mothers pass by, and each one of them and her sons would pass by and bow down before Esau, as it is said, "And the maidservants and their children drew near and bowed down, and Leah also drew near and her children and bowed down" (Genesis 33:6-7). But Rachel saw what was written, and later Joseph and Rachel drew near (there), and Rachel and Joseph bowed down. It is not written here, but Joseph and Rachel. Why did he say, "There is no woman so beautiful as my mother," and this wicked man is suspected of adultery? He gave himself first and stood before

עִנְיַן אֲכִילָה, וְנִמְחֶה זֵכֶר עֲמָלֵק עַל יְדֵי צַדִּיק הָאוֹכֵל לְשׂוֹבַע נַפְשׁוֹ.[1684] — **eating has already been rectified, and Amalek's memory is erased through the righteous person who eats to satisfy his soul.** וּמְסֻמָּךְ גְּאוּלָּה לִגְאוּלָּה (מְגִילָּה ו

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her so that she would not see him, Esau, whose father was Kalsu son of Porat, Yosef son of Porat, Eli-Ein (Ibid. 49:22). What is Eli-Ein (who covered) who covered the eye of that wicked one from your mother: I.e. Esau defiled himself with fornication and bloodshed, which Rabbi Avoah demanded for five (seven) years, etc. And Yosef fenced himself off from transgression and from shedding blood from his private parts and refused and said to his master's wife, etc. (Ibid. 30:8) and from shedding blood as it is said, "You have thought evil of me," etc. (Ibid. 50:20) and therefore one will fall by the hand of the other. Another thing is that Esau sought to kill his brother for pursuing him with the sword of his brother (Obadiah there), and Yosef comforted his brother and his fornication and his adultery And of Joseph it is written, "I fear God" (ibid. 42:18). Rabbi Yehoshua ben Levi also said, "In the future, the heads of the tribes will come to mate with the she-goat of Esau, and he will not fall into their hands. And since the she-goat of Joseph comes and mates with him, he will immediately fall before him, for which reason all When one by one he came to mate with him, he immediately dismissed him in the answers to Reuben, saying, "You are suspected of your father's wife." To Simeon and Levi, saying, "You also killed Shechem." And to Judah, saying, "You are also suspected of your daughter-in-law." And to all the tribes, he dismissed him by saying, "You have sold your brother." Since Joseph's servant came to mate with him, he immediately fell before him, having nothing to return. And the house of Jacob was a fire, and the house of Joseph a flame (Obadiah 1:18). And immediately they kindled them and devoured them, and there was no remnant of the house of Esau (ibid.). Behold, they were as stubble fire, which you burned up they will not save their lives from the hand of the flame (Isaiah 47:14). With the leaders of all the tribes, Esau's servant could carry and give, but with Joseph they could not save their lives from the hand of the flame. And Moses said to Joshua, "Choose men for us," etc. Until Moses built an altar and called it the name of the Lord, "My miracles" (names there) (You have done) We have done, he does not say here, but the Lord, "My miracles by His grace were done." Miracles. The Lord tried them, and I will try them, and you will speak of them. Another word from the Lord's miracles, which were great in this assembly of the ship: The Lord tried them, Rabbi Yehoshua the priest, son of Rabbi Nehemiah, to the king whose wife angered him, he was angry with her and went down to the market and went to the goldsmith, and he did for her a miracle. And what about the time when he angered him, a miracle happened to her when she was doing his will? So much the more so if at the time when they were angry and said, "Is the Lord among us or not?" (Ibid., 7) the Lord worked miracles for them, the Lord worked miracles for them when they were doing his will. And Moses' hands were heavy (ibid.) Rabbi Yehoshua said, "Moses' hands will be heavy because of the many sins of Israel, who said, 'There is a God,' and Rabbi Abbahu said, "Moses' hands were heavy like two jars of water, and the priest's knees were hanging on them." Rabbi Bei said, "The Holy One, blessed be He, said, 'Their weights are heavy.'" They received the Torah, they received the Tablets of the Covenant, they received the Ten Commandments, they brought ten plagues upon Pharaoh, they parted the sea and led Israel. And Moses' hands were heavy, and they took a stone. There was no precious stone or pillow to put under it, but a stone. Rabbi Acha, to inform you that when Israel was in trouble, even their elders grieved with them. And Aaron and Hur supported his hands, Aaron by virtue of the priesthood, and Hur by virtue of the kingdom. On one side, one on the other, by virtue of the commandments that he wrote. On the other side, they are written (ibid. 32:15). And his hands were faith, what is faith? By virtue of Moses' hands and by the sorrow that Amalek grieved. He falls before them and his sun does not set and his seed remains (and when will his sun set and his seed remain:) And when will his sun set and his egg be tattooed and his seed takes root from the world when it comes, which he wrote in it and he was a master of the Hadassah (Esther 2:7) the Lord and his hands are a faith from what until the sun comes (when it comes) when it comes a master of the sun comes. And he weakened, etc. and Joshua did not say so, but Joshua weakened Amalek in such a way that he weakened and remained (and Joshua weakened Amalek). And he said that the hand is on the throne of the Lord, Rabbi Eliezer ben Yaakov, the Blessed One swore by his throne that he would not accept a stranger from the seed of the Amalekites. Therefore, when a messenger came to David and he asked, "Who are you?" (2 Samuel 1:13) and he said, "Son of a man, a stranger, an Amalekite, I am (there)." And they did not accept David, Rabbi Yitzchak, the Edomite, was worried. That is, because the hand is on the throne of the Lord, Rabbi Abba bar Kahana, all While the seed of Amalek existed as if the face was covered, his seed was uprooted from the world, the face that was as if covered was revealed, and your teachers will no longer be afraid, and your eyes will see your teachers (Isaiah 30:20). That is, because Rabbi Yehoshua ben Levi, in the name of Rabbi Alexander, said that since Amalek stretched out his hands against the throne of the Holy One, blessed be He, and Jerusalem became the throne of the Lord (Jeremiah 3:17), immediately he was uprooted from the world. One scripture says, "War for the Lord with Amalek" (Exodus 3:17), and another scripture says, "You shall blot out the memory of Amalek until he stretches out his hand in Jerusalem." You shall blot out the memory of Amalek, because he stretched out his hand against the Lord with Amalek. I.e., on the throne of YHWH, He does not say so, but YHWH, Rabbi Levi, in the name of Rabbi Hama, in the name of Rabbi Hanina, as if to say, as long as the seed of Amalek is in the world, neither the name is complete nor the throne is complete. The seed of Amalek, the throne is complete and the name is complete, David said, "The enemy is destroyed forever, and the cities are destroyed, their memory is lost." (Psalms 9:7) What did he write after him? And YHWH will forever sit, established for judgment on His throne (Ibid., 8): I.e., remember this, Rabbi Tanchuma, in the name of Rabbi Return to our neighbors, the seven times, to their lap, the reproach that they have dishonored you, O Lord (Psalms 9:12). Jeremiah says, "Return to them the recompense of the Lord according to the work of their hands" (Lamentations 3:34). And David said, "Return to our neighbors, the seven times, to their lap." Rabbi Yehuda and Rabbi Nehemiah, may God be pleased with them, say, "They said, 'Israel, Lord of the worlds,' what they have done to us, return to them the recompense of their hands, and what they have done in Your temple." Return to our neighbors, the seven times, to their lap. Rabbi Shuna said, "There is no lap except the Temple, and the lap of the earth to the lowest level." (Ezekiel 43:14). And Rabbi Nehemiah says, "They said, 'Israel, the Lord of hosts, what they have done to us, return to them the recompense of the Lord according to the work of their hands, and for burning Your Torah, which is written in it, 'Refined seven times' (Psalms 12:7). Return to our neighbors, the seven times, to their lap." Rabbi Hanina ben Shalom and Rabbi Yehoshua of Sichnan, in the name of Rabbi Yehoshua ben Levi, what is written, "Return to their lap, the reproach that they have done to them, teaches that

סוֹף עַמּוּד ב)[1685], הֵיינוּ גְּאוּלַּת מְחִיַּת עֲמָלֵק לְפָסַח, — **"Joining redemption to redemption" (Megillah 6b, at its end) means joining the redemption through erasing Amalek to Pesach.** וְחוֹדֶשׁ נִיסָן שָׁמְרַמֵּז עַל מָשִׁיחַ בֶּן דָּוִד: כֶּתֶר עֶלְיוֹן אִיהוּ כֶּתֶר מַלְכוּת,[1686] — **The month of Nisan alludes to Mashiach son of David: the Supernal Crown is the crown of Malchut.** וּבְמִדַּת כֶּתֶר עֶלְיוֹן נִגְאֲלוּ יִשְׂרָאֵל מִמִּצְרַיִם בְּנִיסָן, וּבוֹ עֲתִידִין לְהִגָּאֵל.[1687] — **Through the attribute of the Supernal Crown, Israel was redeemed from Egypt in Nisan and will be redeemed in that month again.** וּבַעֲצֶרֶת זְמַן מַתַּן תּוֹרָה, שֶׁנִּתְקַן קִלְקוּל אָדָם הָרִאשׁוֹן, שֶׁהָיָה חֵירוּת מִיֵּצֶר הָרָע, — **On Shavuot, the time of the giving of the Torah, Adam's corruption was rectified through freedom from the evil inclination.** מַקְרִיבִין שְׁתֵּי הַלֶּחֶם שֶׁיִּתְבָּרְכוּ פֵּירוֹת הָאִילָן, דְּחַטִּים גַּם כֵּן מִין אִילָן,[1688] — **We offer the two loaves so that tree fruits**

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they were They cut off the circumcision that is in the bosom and throw it up high and scorn and revile it and say upwards, "This is what you desire, for it is thrown before you." And where did you learn from what was written above about the matter, and she put out her hand and took hold of his private parts (Deuteronomy 23:11) and what was written after the matter, "Remember what Amalek did to you:" 1. Remember our rabbis from the south in the name of Rabbi Shmuel (from the necessary) We begin with the parsha, "Did you not know if you did not hear, even since you did not open your ear, for I know that you will commit treachery and transgression from your womb has called you" (Isaiah 45:8) Speaking against Amalek and against Haman, who came from the descendants of Amalek, the Blessed One said, "O wicked one, you have intermarried with my sons. Nor did you know the miracles that I performed for them in Egypt, how many times have you been written, and the Egyptians will know that I am the Lord (Exodus 14:4) Nor did you hear the miracles that I performed for them at sea, the nations will hear and be provoked (Isa. 15:14) Even since you did not open your ear, for I know that you will commit treachery and transgression from your womb has called you" (Isaiah 45:8) Your ears have not heard the song that my sons have said to me at the sea. Then Moses and the children of Israel will sing (Ibid. Ibid. 1). The Holy One, blessed be He, said to him, "You knew and heard, but you are stubborn, for I know that you will betray with treachery. And from now on you will be stubborn, but until you are in your mother's womb and you are a sinner, but in your lifetime, a craftsman is devoted to you, and what am I preparing for you to hang you on a beam, as it is said, "He calls you." A "R" and fifty cubits, and from where does he call you "L"Kh 30 thirty twenty twenty, then fifty? O remember what Amalek did to you: Ibid. 1. Remember what Rabbi Barachiah said in my rabbi, why is the matter similar to a king who had an orchard and had one dog sitting and guarding the orchard? The son of the king's lover came to steal from the orchard. The dog stood up and bit him. When the king asked his son not to mention the son of his lover who wanted to steal from his orchard, he would say to him, "Remember what that dog did to you." Thus Israel sinned at Rephidim, and they said, "Is the Lord among us?" (Ibid. 17:7). And immediately The dog came and bit him. This was Amalek, as it is said, "And Amalek came and fought with Israel at Rephidim" (Ibid., 8). And when the Holy One, blessed be He, wanted to remind Israel of the sin they committed at Rephidim, He would say, "Do you remember that Amalek who came against you? Remember what Amalek did to you." As for the way, Rabbi Yehuda and Rabbi Nehemiah, and our masters, Rabbi Yehuda says, "As for the way, what did the wicked Amalek do?" He related the genealogy of the names of the Israelites who died in Egypt. And he stood before him in a cloud of honor, and called each one by name, and said, "So-and-so, son of so-and-so, come out, for I want to trade with you." (And he immediately went out.) And he killed the one who called you. And Rabbi Nehemiah says, "As for the way, which made you unclean, as it is said, "It will not be clean if it happens at night" (Deuteronomy 23:11). And our masters said, "As for the way, which made you cold, made you cold as water, as it is said, "Cold water to a weary soul" (Proverbs 25:25). Ar Huna, according to the M.A.D., to boiling baths, from which everyone was fleeing. One of them came and jumped into it and it melted immediately, and they all came and washed (into it) into it. Thus Israel, when they were coming out of Egypt, were fleeing from them, when they heard that the nations were angry, then they were afraid, etc. (Exodus 15:14 and 15). Amalek came and melted them. And he snared at you What is it, and he snared at you, the stroke of the tail? You learned from Samuel, and Samuel beheaded Agag (1 Samuel 15:33). Rabbi Yitzchak said, Castrate them, as your sword consumed women, so will your mother consume women (ibid.). He said to him, Just as you did to Israel in Egypt, so I have done to you (that I would have) that you would have castrated them and made their women sit in a state of aguna. And Rabbi Abba bar Kahana said, He would cut off his body like a censer and feed it to the Naomi, he who wrote, "The Blessed One said to them, 'My son, you have nothing but to be (read) the Amalek parshat every year and above, I am (upon them) upon you as if you were wiping out his name from the world.' Rabbi Yitzchak said, 'We find that Joshua sought to wipe out the memory of Amalek, as it is said, "And Joshua defeated Amalek and his people with the edge of the sword" (Exodus 17:13). The Holy One, blessed be He, said, "Your life is up to now. King Saul is destined to rise up from Benjamin and root out the seed of Amalek, as it is said, "From Ephraim, who was written in Amalek after you, Benjamin among your peoples," etc. (Judges 5:14)."

[1684] **Proverbs 13:25**: 'A righteous person eats to the satisfaction of his soul, but the belly of the wicked will lack.'

[1685] **Megillah 6b:27**: 'Rabbi Tavi said: The reason for the opinion of Rabban Shimon ben Gamliel is that juxtaposing the celebration of one redemption, Purim, to the celebration of another redemption, Passover, is preferable.'

[1686] **Tikkunei Zohar 17a:9-18**: 'And they are called in this arrangement: Ḥesed – right arm, Gevurah – left arm, Tipheret – body, Netzaḥ and Hod – two thighs, and Yesod – end of the body, – sign of the holy covenant. Malkhut – 'mouth' – we call it 'Oral Torah'.'

[1687] **Rosh Hashanah 11a:2**: "Rabbi Yehoshua says: In Nisan the world was created; in Nisan the patriarchs were born; in Nisan the patriarchs died. On Pesach Yitzchak was born. On Rosh Hashanah Sarah, Rachel, and Channah were remembered and granted children. On Rosh Hashanah Yosef left prison. On Rosh Hashanah our ancestors' labor in Egypt ceased. In Nisan they were redeemed; in Nisan they are destined to be redeemed."

[1688] **Rosh Hashanah 16a:14**: "It was taught: Rabbi Yehudah said in Rabbi Akiva's name: Why did the Torah say to bring an omer offering on Pesach? Because Pesach is the grain season. The Holy One, blessed be He, said: 'Bring an omer before Me on Pesach so that the grain in your fields may be blessed.' Why did the Torah say to bring the two loaves on Shavuos? Because Shavuos is the season of tree fruits. The Holy One, blessed be He, said: 'Bring the two loaves before Me on Shavuos so that your tree fruits may be blessed.'"

כְּמַאן דְּאָמַר דְּעֵץ הַדַּעַת חִטָּה הָיָה (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתַב רַבִּי שְׁלֹמֹה יִצְחָקִי, רא"ש הַשָּׁנָה טז.)[1689] — **will be blessed, for wheat too is a kind of tree, according to the opinion that the Tree of Knowledge was wheat, as Rashi explains on Rosh Hashanah 16a.** וּמְרַמֵּז שֶׁעַל יְדֵי הַתּוֹרָה נִתְקַן וְנֶחְשָׁב כְּמוֹ קוֹדֶם הַקִּלְקוּל. — **This alludes to its restoration through Torah to the state before the corruption.** וּבְשָׁבָט, לְבֵית שַׁמַּאי מֵרֹאשׁ חוֹדֶשׁ וּלְבֵית הִלֵּל מִט"ו בּוֹ, שֶׁנִּתְמַלֵּא הַסִּיהֲרָא מִפְּגִימָתָהּ,[1690] — **In Shevat, this begins on Rosh Chodesh according to Beit Shammai, and on the fifteenth according to Beit Hillel, when the moon's deficiency has been filled.**

Purity and the Scent of Holiness

שֶׁנִּתְקַן עִנְיַן תַּאֲוַת אֲכִילָה, הוּא רֹאשׁ הַשָּׁנָה לָאִילָן, — **Appetite for food is rectified, and it is the New Year for the tree.** וַאֲנַחְנוּ מְבָרְכִין עַל הַפֵּירוֹת לְהַכְנִיס בָּהֶם בְּרָכָה וּקְדוּשָׁה. — **We pronounce blessings over the fruits to bring blessing and holiness into them.** וּבְסוֹף סוֹטָה: הַטָּהֳרָה נָטְלָה אֶת הַטַּעַם וְאֶת הָרֵיחַ.[1691] — **At the end of Sotah it says: The loss of purity took away taste and fragrance.** וּבַגְּמָרָא שָׁם, דְּאָמַר: מוֹרְחִינָא רֵיחָא דְּחִינּוּנִיתָא, וְאָמַר לוֹ: בְּנִי, טָהֳרָה יֵשׁ בָּךְ.[1692] — **The Talmud there recounts someone saying: I smell the aroma of a fragrant date. He was told: My son, there is purity within you.** וְהוּא טָהֳרַת הַלֵּב מִתַּאֲוֹת, וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמַר דָּוִד הַמֶּלֶךְ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם בְּמִזְמוֹר כַּאֲשֶׁר בָּא וְנֶאֱמַר: לֵב טָהוֹר בְּרָא לִי.[1693] וְגוֹמֵר — **This means purity of heart from desires. Thus King David, peace be upon him, says in the psalm beginning "When he came," and so forth: "Create a pure heart for me."** יִרְאַת ה' טְהוֹרָה; וְיִרְאָה מַצִּיל מִתַּאֲוֹת, כְּמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: רַק אֵין יִרְאַת וְגוֹמֵר.[1694, 1695] — **It says: "The fear of Hashem is pure." Fear protects against desires, as in: "There is no fear," and so forth.** וְנֶאֱמַר: וַהֲרִיחוֹ בְּיִרְאַת ה', דְּעַל יְדֵי יִרְאָה זוֹכִין לְחוּשׁ הָרֵיחַ, וְהַיְינוּ עַל יְדֵי הַטָּהֳרָה.[1696] — **It also says: "His perception shall be through the fear of Hashem." Through fear one merits the sense of smell—that is, through purity.** וְאָמְרוּ (עֵירוּבִין כא:): הַדּוּדָאִים נָתְנוּ רֵיחַ, אֵלּוּ בַּחוּרֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל שֶׁלֹּא טָעֲמוּ טַעַם חֵטְא.[1697] — **The Sages say (Eruvin 21b): "The mandrakes have given fragrance"—these are the young men of Israel who have never tasted sin.** וּמַה שֶּׁאָמְרוּ בַּחוּרֵי מְבוֹאָר דְּרוֹצֶה לוֹמַר חֲטָאֵי הַתַּאֲוֹת שֶׁמָּצוּי בִּילָדוּת, — **Their specifying young men makes clear that they mean sins of desire, which are common in youth.** וּמִי שֶׁנָּקִי מִזֶּה מֵרִיחַ רֵיחַ טוֹב. — **One who is free of these perceives a good fragrance.**

[1689] **Rashi on Rosh Hashanah 16a:14:2**: 'Rashi on Rosh Hashanah 16a (s.v. Havu shtei ha-lechem): "Bring the Two Loaves of wheat on Shavuot so that the fruits of the trees may be blessed for you"—because wheat is itself called a tree in the exposition of Rabbi Yehudah.'

[1690] **Mishnah Rosh Hashanah 1:1**: "There are four new years. On the first of Nisan is the new year for kings and festivals. On the first of Elul is the new year for the tithe of animals. Rabbi Elazar and Rabbi Shimon say: On the first of Tishrei. On the first of Tishrei is the new year for years, Sabbatical years, Jubilee years, planting, and vegetables. On the first of Shevat is the new year for the tree, according to Beis Shammai. Beis Hillel say: On the fifteenth of that month."

[1691] **Sotah 49a:10**: "Rav Huna found a fragrant hinunita date, took it, and wrapped it in his kerchief. His son Rabbah came and said to him: 'I smell the fragrance of hinunita.' He said: 'My son, you have purity in you,' and gave it to him. Meanwhile Abba, Rabbah's son, came; Rabbah took it and gave it to him. Rav Huna said: 'My son, you have gladdened my heart and blunted my teeth.' This is what people say: A father's love is for his children; the children's love is for their own children."

[1692] **Sotah 49a:10**: "Rav Huna found a strongly fragrant chinunita date, took it, and wrapped it in his cloth. His son Rabbah came and said, 'I smell the fragrance of chinunita.' Rav Huna told him, 'My son, there is purity in you,' and gave it to him. Meanwhile Rabbah's son Abba arrived, and Rabbah took the date and gave it to him. Rav Huna said, 'My son, you have gladdened my heart and set my teeth on edge.' This is what people say: A father's compassion is for his children; his children's compassion is for the children they themselves have."

[1693] **Psalms 51:12**: 'Fashion a pure heart for me, O God;create in me a steadfast spirit.'

[1694] **Psalms 19:10**: 'The fear of GOD is pure,abiding forever;the judgments of GOD are true,righteous altogether,'

[1695] **Genesis 20:11**: '"I thought," said Abraham, "surely there is no fear of God in this place, and they will kill me because of my wife."'

[1696] **Isaiah 11:3**: 'He shall sense the truth by his reverence for GOD:He shall not judge by what his eyes behold,Nor decide by what his ears perceive.'

[1697] **Eruvin 21b:3**: "Rava expounded: What is meant by the verse 'The mandrakes give forth fragrance'? These are the young men of Israel who have never tasted the taste of sin."

Tu BiShvat Ois 2

The Tree of Life and the Holiness of Eating

The two trees describe different conditions of spiritual understanding.

The Tree of Life and the Holiness of Eating

Why the Mishnah Speaks of One Tree

בַּמִּשְׁנָה[1698] (רֹאשׁ הַשָּׁנָה): בְּאֶחָד בִּשְׁבָט רֹאשׁ הַשָּׁנָה לְאִילָן, כְּדִבְרֵי בֵית שַׁמַּאי, וּבֵית הִלֵּל אוֹמְרִים בְּט״ו בּוֹ. — **The Mishnah, at the beginning of Rosh Hashanah, teaches: The first of Shevat is the New Year for the tree, according to Beit Shammai; Beit Hillel say the fifteenth.** רָאִיתִי שֶׁדִּקְדְּקוּ: לָמָּה תָּנֵי לָאִילָן לְשׁוֹן יָחִיד? — **I have seen the question raised: Why does it teach "for the tree" in the singular?** וְכָתְבוּ דְּתֵיבַת אִילָ״ן גִּימַטְרִיָּא צ״א, גִּימַטְרִיָּא שְׁנֵי הַשֵּׁמוֹת. — **They write that ilan, "tree," has the numerical value ninety-one, the value of the two divine names.** וּבֶאֱמֶת יֵשׁ לְדַקְדֵּק יוֹתֵר הָא דְּתָנַן: בְּאֶחָד בְּתִשְׁרֵי רֹאשׁ הַשָּׁנָה וְכוּלֵי לִנְטִיעָה, לְשׁוֹן יָחִיד,[1699] — **There is, in fact, a further question: It teaches, "The first of Tishrei is the New Year … for planting," using the singular,** אַף דְּכוּלְּהוּ תָּנַן לְשׁוֹן רַבִּים: לַשָּׁנִים וְלַשְּׁמִיטִין וְלַיּוֹבְלוֹת, וְכֵן אַחַר כָּךְ לַיְרָקוֹת, — **although all the other categories are plural: years, sabbatical years, and jubilee years, and later, vegetables.** וּבָאֶמְצַע תָּנֵי לִנְטִיעָה לְשׁוֹן יָחִיד. — **Yet in the middle it teaches "for planting" in the singular.**

Torah the Tree and Israel Its Fruit

וְיֵשׁ לוֹמַר הָעִנְיָן, דְּאִיתָא בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ (בְּשַׁלַּח ס ב), עַל פִּי וַיּוֹרֵהוּ הַשֵּׁם עֵץ:[1700, 1701] — **The idea may be explained through the holy Zohar, Beshalach 60b, on "Hashem showed him a tree":** וְאֵין עֵץ אֶלָּא תּוֹרָה, דִּכְתִיב עֵץ חַיִּים וְגוֹמֵר; וְאֵין תּוֹרָה אֶלָּא קוּדְשָׁא בְּרִיךְ הוּא.[1702] — **"The tree is none other than Torah, as it is written, 'A tree of life …'; and Torah is none other than the Holy One, blessed be He."** רַבִּי אַבָּא אָמַר: אֵין עֵץ אֶלָּא קוּדְשָׁא בְּרִיךְ הוּא, דִּכְתִיב כִּי הָאָדָם עֵץ הַשָּׂדֶה, דָּא עֵץ שָׂדֶה דְּתַפּוּחִין.[1703] — **Rabbi Abba said: "The tree is none other than the Holy One, blessed be He, as it is written, 'For man is the tree of the field'—the tree of the apple field."** וְאַף דִּבְכָל מָקוֹם חֶלֶק תַּפּוּחִין קַדִּישִׁין הַיְינוּ כְּנֶסֶת יִשְׂרָאֵל, נַפְשׁוֹת יִשְׂרָאֵל. — **Elsewhere, however, the holy apple field refers to Knesset Yisrael, the souls of Israel.** אַךְ הוּא עַל פִּי מַה שֶׁאָמְרוּ (שַׁבָּת פח.): כְּתַפּוּחַ בַּעֲצֵי הַיַּעַר, לָמָּה נִמְשְׁלוּ יִשְׂרָאֵל לְתַפּוּחַ וְכוּלֵי.[1704, 1705] — **This follows the teaching in Shabbat 88a: "'Like an apple tree among the trees of the forest'—why is Israel compared to an apple tree?"** וְתָמְהוּ הַתּוֹסָפוֹת דְּבְהַאי קְרָא לֹא נִמְשְׁלוּ יִשְׂרָאֵל לְתַפּוּחַ אֶלָּא

[1698] **Mishnah Rosh Hashanah 1:1**: "There are four new years. On the first of Nisan is the new year for kings and festivals. On the first of Elul is the new year for the tithe of animals. Rabbi Elazar and Rabbi Shimon say: On the first of Tishrei. On the first of Tishrei is the new year for years, Sabbatical years, Jubilee years, planting, and vegetables. On the first of Shevat is the new year for the tree, according to Beis Shammai. Beis Hillel say: On the fifteenth of that month."

[1699] **Mishnah Rosh Hashanah 1:1**: "There are four new years. On the first of Nisan is the new year for kings and festivals. On the first of Elul is the new year for the tithe of animals. Rabbi Elazar and Rabbi Shimon say: On the first of Tishrei. On the first of Tishrei is the new year for years, Sabbatical years, Jubilee years, planting, and vegetables. On the first of Shevat is the new year for the tree, according to Beis Shammai. Beis Hillel say: On the fifteenth of that month."

[1700] **Zohar, Beshalach 26:348**: "Then HE (Moses) CRIED UNTO THE LORD, AND THE LORD SHOWED HIM A TREE, without deviating right or left. This is symbolized by the sound of the Shophar, which is thrust forth in a straight line from a narrow opening and breaks through the firmaments in order to stir up the Spirit above. It is true, we are told, that "Isaac did meditate in the field" (Gen. 24, 63); but there are special reasons for this; and besides, the field where he prayed was not an ordinary field. WHICH, WHEN HE CAST IT INTO THE WATERS, THE WATERS WERE MADE SWEET. The tree is a symbol of the Torah, which is "a tree of life to those who lay hold upon her" (Prov. 3, 18), and the Torah and the Holy One, blessed be He, are one.' R. Abba said: 'The "Tree" is a direct symbol of the Holy One, for it says: "The tree of the field is (the supernal) Adam" (Deut. 20, 19). The "field" is the "Field of the holy apples". Thus, when the light of their King's glory manifested itself to them, "the waters were made sweet", and the accuser became an intercessor.'"

[1701] **Exodus 15:25**: 'So he cried out to GOD, and GOD showed him a piece of wood; he threw it into the water and the water became sweet.There a fixed rule was made for them; there they were put to the test:'

[1702] **Proverbs 3:18**: 'She is a tree of life to those who grasp her,And whoever holds on to her is happy.'

[1703] **Deuteronomy 20:19**: 'Deuteronomy 20: 19: 'When in your war against a city you have to besiege it a long time in order to capture it, you must not destroy its trees, wielding the ax against them. You may eat of them, but you must not cut them down. Are trees of the field human to withdraw before you into the besieged city?''

[1704] **Shabbat 88a:8**: "Rabbi Elazar said: When Israel placed 'We will do' before 'We will hear,' a heavenly voice went forth and said, 'Who revealed to My children this secret that the ministering angels use?' For it is written, 'Bless the Lord, His angels, mighty in strength, who do His word, to hear the voice of His word': First they 'do,' and afterward they 'hear.' Rabbi Chama son of Rabbi Chanina said: What is meant by 'Like an apple tree among the trees of the forest,' and so forth? Why were Israel compared to an apple tree? To teach you: Just as the apple's fruit precedes its leaves, so Israel placed 'We will do' before 'We will hear.'"

[1705] **Song of Songs 2:3**: 'Like an apple tree among trees of the forest,So is my beloved among the youths.I delight to sit in his shade,And his fruit is sweet to my mouth.'

הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא, כִּדְכְתִיב כֵּן דּוֹדִי בֵּין הַבָּנִים.[1706, 1707] **— Tosafot question this: In that verse, it is the Holy One, blessed be He, who is compared to the apple tree, as it says, "So is my beloved among the sons."** אֲבָל נִרְאֶה דְּבֶאֱמֶת הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא נִקְרָא הָאִילָן שֶׁל תַּפּוּחַ, וְנַפְשׁוֹת יִשְׂרָאֵל נִמְשְׁלוּ לְתַפּוּחִים, פְּרִי הָאִילָן, **— It appears that the Holy One, blessed be He, is called the apple tree, while Israel's souls are compared to the apples, the tree's fruit,** וְעַל דָּרֶךְ מַה שֶׁאָמְרוּ בַּזוֹהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ (לֶךְ פה ב): וּפִרְיוֹ מָתוֹק לְחִכִּי,[1708, 1709] **— following the holy Zohar, Lech Lecha 85b, on "His fruit is sweet to my palate":** אִלֵּין נִשְׁמָתִהוֹן דְּצַדִּיקַיָּא, דְּכֻלְּהוּ אִיבָּא דְּעוֹבָדוֹי דְּקוּדְשָׁא בְּרִיךְ הוּא וְכוּלַּי, **— "These are the souls of the righteous, all of them the fruit of the works of the Holy One, blessed be He …"** שֶׁהֵן פִּרְיוֹ, כְּמָה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר בָּנִים אַתֶּם לַהשֵׁם אֱלֹהֵיכֶם,[1710] **— They are His fruit, as it says, "You are children of Hashem your God."** וַחֲקַל תַּפּוּחִין כְּנֶסֶת יִשְׂרָאֵל, כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בְּסֵפֶר הַבָּהִיר (סימן כט): וַיִּנָּפַשׁ, שֶׁמִּשָּׁם פּוֹרְחִין כָּל הַנְּפָשׁוֹת,[1711, 1712] **— The apple field is Knesset Yisrael, as Sefer HaBahir 29 teaches on "He rested": From there all souls emerge.** וְקוּדְשָׁא בְּרִיךְ הוּא הָאִילָן, וְהַשָּׂדֶה שְׁכִינְתָּא, עַל דָּרֶךְ מַה שֶׁכָּתְבוּ תוֹסָפוֹת (כתובות ב:), שֶׁהָאִשָּׁה שָׂדֶה שֶׁל בַּעַל, עַיֵּין שָׁם;[1713] **— The Holy One, blessed be He, is the tree, and the field is the Shechinah, following Tosafot, Ketubot 2b, that the wife is her husband's field; see there.** וְזֶה שֶׁאָמַר: וְלָא עֵץ שָׂדֶה דְּתַפּוּחִין. **— This is the meaning of "This is the tree of the apple field."** וְזֶה שֶׁאָמַר מִקּוֹדֶם: וְאֵין עֵץ אֶלָּא תּוֹרָה, וְאֵין עֵץ אֶלָּא קוּדְשָׁא בְּרִיךְ הוּא. **— This also explains the earlier statements: "The tree is none other than Torah," and "The tree is none other than the Holy One, blessed be He."** וְהֵינוּ שֶׁאֵין שׁוּם תְּפִיסָה בְּהַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ רַק עַל יְדֵי הַדִּבְרֵי תוֹרָה, שֶׁהֵם דְּרָכָיו שֶׁל הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא. **— Hashem, blessed be He, can be grasped only through words of Torah, which are the ways of the Holy One, blessed be He.** וְהַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ הָאֲצִיל עֶשֶׂר מִדּוֹת לִבְרִיאַת הָעוֹלָם, וְסִדְרָם בִּפְתִיחַת אֱלִיָּהוּ עַל קוֹמַת צוּרַת הָאָדָם, עַיֵּין שָׁם.[1714] **— Hashem, blessed be He, emanated ten attributes for creating the world; the Opening of Eliyahu arranges them according to the human form. See there.** שֶׁעַל פִּי סֵדֶר הַמִּדּוֹת שֶׁהָאֲצִיל הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ בָּרָא הָאָדָם בְּצַלְמֵנוּ כִּדְמוּתֵנוּ.[1715] **— According to the arrangement of the attributes He emanated, Hashem, blessed be He, created the human being "in Our image, after Our likeness."** וּבְמִדְרָשׁ (בְּרֵאשִׁית רַבָּה רֵישׁ פָּרָשָׁה כז): גָּדוֹל כֹּחָן שֶׁל נְבִיאִים, שֶׁמְּדַמִּים צוּרָה לְיוֹצְרָהּ וְכוּלַּי, דְּמוּת כְּמַרְאֵה אָדָם וְגוֹמֵר.[1716, 1717] —

[1706] **Tosafot on Shabbat 88a:8:1**: ""Its fruit precedes its leaves": Rabbeinu Tam objected that we see it grow like other trees. He explains that tappuach here means a citron: "The fragrance of your nose like apples" is translated as "like the scent of a citron." A citron's fruit precedes its leaves, because it remains on the tree from one year to the next. After a year, the previous year's leaves fall and other leaves come, so its fruit precedes those leaves. But it is surprising that it brings the verse, "Like an apple tree among the trees of the forest," for in that verse it is not Israel that is compared to an apple tree but the Holy One, blessed be He, as it is written, "So is my beloved among the sons." It would have been more appropriate to bring the verse, "The fragrance of your nose like apples" (Song of Songs 7:9)."

[1707] **Song of Songs 2:3**: 'Like an apple tree among trees of the forest,So is my beloved among the youths.I delight to sit in his shade,And his fruit is sweet to my mouth.'

[1708] **Zohar, Lech Lecha 21:199-200**: "It is also possible to understand the words "Like an apple tree among the trees of the wood" of Abraham, who smelt sweetly like an apple tree, who was distinguished in faith above all his contemporaries, and who was marked out as unique both above and below, as it is written, "Abraham was one" (Ezek. 33, 24). He was so called because no one else of his contemporaries attained to the virtue of faith in God.' Said R. Hizkiah to him: 'What of the words "And the souls which they made in Haran"?' He replied: 'These did not reach the higher grades which Abraham acquired.'"

[1709] **Song of Songs 2:3**: 'Like an apple tree among trees of the forest,So is my beloved among the youths.I delight to sit in his shade,And his fruit is sweet to my mouth.'

[1710] **Deuteronomy 14:1**: 'You are children of the ETERNAL your God. You shall not gash yourselves or shave the front of your heads because of the dead.'

[1711] **Sefer HaBahir 29**: 'Sefer HaBahir §29: "What is the meaning of 'He rested and was refreshed (vayinafash)' (Exodus 31:17)? From the Holy Apple Orchard (Malchut / the Shechinah) all souls (nefashot) blossom and emerge."'

[1712] **Exodus 31:17**: 'Exodus 31: 17: 'it shall be a sign for all time between Me and the people of Israel. For in six days GOD made heaven and earth, before ceasing from work and being refreshed on the seventh day.''

[1713] **Tosafot on Ketubot 2b:1:1**: ""She can say to him, 'Your field has been flooded'": He cannot claim that, on the contrary, her fortune caused it, because she is not commanded in procreation and is not punished for it, as we say in the chapter HaBa Al Yevimto (Yevamot 64b). Furthermore, the wife is the husband's field, while the husband is not her field."

[1714] **Tikkunei Zohar 17a:9-18**: 'And they are called in this arrangement: Ḥesed – right arm, Gevurah – left arm, Tipheret – body, Netzaḥ and Hod – two thighs, and Yesod – end of the body, – sign of the holy covenant. Malkhut – 'mouth' – we call it 'Oral Torah'.'

[1715] **Genesis 1:26**: 'And God said, "Let us make humankind in our image, after our likeness. They shall rule the fish of the sea, the birds of the sky, the cattle, the whole earth, and all the creeping things that creep on earth."'

[1716] **Bereshit Rabbah 27:1** (excerpt): "Rabbi Yudan said: Great is the power of the prophets, who liken the created form to its Maker, as it says, 'I heard a human voice between the banks of Ulai' (Daniel 8:16). Rabbi Yehudah bar Simon said: We have another verse even clearer than this: 'Above the likeness of the throne was a likeness resembling a human being upon it, above' (Ezekiel 1:26)."

[1717] **Ezekiel 1:26**: 'Above the expanse over their heads was the semblance of a throne, in appearance like sapphire; and on top, upon this semblance of a throne, there was the semblance of a human form.'

The Midrash, Bereshit Rabbah, beginning of chapter 27, teaches: “Great is the power of the prophets, who liken the created form to its Creator … ‘a likeness resembling a human being …’” וְאָמַר רַבִּי אַבָּא: אֵין עֵץ אֶלָּא קוּדְשָׁא בְּרִיךְ הוּא, דִּכְתִיב כִּי הָאָדָם עֵץ הַשָּׂדֶה,[1718] וְקָאֵי עַל הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא; **— Rabbi Abba says, “The tree is none other than the Holy One, blessed be He,” citing “For man is the tree of the field” as referring to Him.** וְלִפְשׁוּטוֹ קָאֵי עַל הָאָדָם, דְּהָאָדָם נִקְרָא גַּם כֵּן עֵץ, שֶׁמִּמֶּנּוּ יוֹצְאִים פֵּירוֹת גַּם כֵּן. **— In its plain meaning it refers to a human being, who is also called a tree, since fruit likewise emerges from him.** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ (שָׁם), עַל מַה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר מִמֶּנִּי פִּרְיְךָ נִמְצָא.[1719, 1720] **— So the holy Zohar there explains the verse, “From Me your fruit is found.”** וְכֵן כָּתוּב צַדִּיק כַּתָּמָר יִפְרָח, כְּאֶרֶז וְגוֹמֵר, שֶׁגַּם הַצַּדִּיק נִמְשָׁל לָעֵץ וְיוֹצְאִים מִמֶּנּוּ פֵּירוֹת.[1721] **— It also says, “The righteous will flourish like a palm tree, like a cedar …”: The righteous person too is likened to a tree and produces fruit.** וְזֶה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר כִּי הָאָדָם עֵץ הַשָּׂדֶה, שֶׁהוּא בְּצַלְמֵנוּ כִּדְמוּתֵנוּ, וְצוּרָתוֹ שֶׁל יַעֲקֹב חֲקוּקָה בְּכִסֵּא הַכָּבוֹד,[1722, 1723] **— Thus, “For man is the tree of the field”: He is “in Our image, after Our likeness,” and Yaakov’s likeness is engraved on the Throne of Glory.** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ (בְּשַׁלַּח נא ב): וְהַבְּרִיחַ הַתִּיכוֹן וְגוֹמֵר, וְדָא קוּדְשָׁא בְּרִיךְ הוּא; רַבִּי יִצְחָק אָמַר דָּא יַעֲקֹב, וְכֻלָּא חַד.[1724, 1725] **— The holy Zohar, Beshalach 51b, teaches: “‘The middle bar …’—this is the Holy One, blessed be He.” Rabbi Yitzchak said, “This is Yaakov”; it is all one.**

The Tree of Life and the Tree of Knowledge

וּכְתִיב וַיִּטַּע יְיָ אֱלֹהִים גַּן בְּעֵדֶן וְגוֹמֵר; וְהַיְינוּ שֶׁבָּרָא עֵץ הַחַיִּים, וְהוּא תּוֹרָה (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב רֵישׁ סֵדֶר אֵלִיָּהוּ רַבָּה), אִילָן אֶחָד.[1726, 1727] **— It says, “Hashem God planted a garden in Eden …”: He created the Tree of Life, which is Torah, as taught at the beginning of Seder Eliyahu Rabbah—one tree.** וְאִיתָא (קִידּוּשִׁין ל:): בָּרָאתִי יֵצֶר הָרָע וּבָרָאתִי לוֹ תּוֹרָה תַּבְלִין.[1728] **— Kiddushin 30b teaches: “I created the evil inclination, and I created Torah as its antidote.”** וְהוּא שֶׁהַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרֵךְ בָּרָא גַּם כֵּן עֵץ הַדַּעַת טוֹב וָרָע, וְהוּא גַּם כֵּן דִּבְרֵי תוֹרָה, **— Hashem, blessed be He, also created the Tree of Knowledge of Good and Evil, which likewise represents words of Torah,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ (בְּרָכוֹת ה.): וְאֵין טוֹב אֶלָּא תּוֹרָה.[1729] **— as Berakhot 5a teaches, “Good is none other than Torah.”** וְהַיְינוּ שֶׁאַחַר

[1718] **Deuteronomy 20:19**: ‘Deuteronomy 20: 19: ‘When in your war against a city you have to besiege it a long time in order to capture it, you must not destroy its trees, wielding the ax against them. You may eat of them, but you must not cut them down. Are trees of the field human to withdraw before you into the besieged city?’’

[1719] **Zohar, Lech Lecha 21:199-200**: “It is also possible to understand the words “Like an apple tree among the trees of the wood” of Abraham, who smelt sweetly like an apple tree, who was distinguished in faith above all his contemporaries, and who was marked out as unique both above and below, as it is written, “Abraham was one” (Ezek. 33, 24). He was so called because no one else of his contemporaries attained to the virtue of faith in God.’ Said R. Hizkiah to him: ‘What of the words “And the souls which they made in Haran”?’ He replied: ‘These did not reach the higher grades which Abraham acquired.’”

[1720] **Hosea 14:9**: ‘Ephraim shall say:“What more have I to do with idols?When I respond and look to God,I become like a verdant cypress.”Your fruit is provided by Me.’

[1721] **Psalms 92:13**: ‘The righteous person shall flourish like a palm; like a cedar in Lebanon he shall grow tall.’

[1722] **Deuteronomy 20:19**: ‘Deuteronomy 20: 19: ‘When in your war against a city you have to besiege it a long time in order to capture it, you must not destroy its trees, wielding the ax against them. You may eat of them, but you must not cut them down. Are trees of the field human to withdraw before you into the besieged city?’’

[1723] **Genesis 1:26**: ‘And God said, “Let us make humankind in our image, after our likeness. They shall rule the fish of the sea, the birds of the sky, the cattle, the whole earth, and all the creeping things that creep on earth.”’

[1724] **Zohar, Beshalach 13:180**: “Said R. Isaac: ‘When the Israelites encamped by the sea they saw many hosts, many armies, many camps, above and below, all united against Israel, and in their distress they prayed unto the Lord. The sea was stormy, its waves roared, behind them were all those hosts, all those armies of the Egyptians, and above them were all those celestial foes; and they began to cry to God. Then “the Lord said unto Moses: Why criest thou unto me?” Then the Most Holy Ancient One appeared, and Mercy was manifested in all the upper worlds and all the lights were lit.’”

[1725] **Exodus 26:28**: ‘The center bar halfway up the planks shall run from end to end.’

[1726] **Genesis 2:8**: ‘The ETERNAL God planted a garden in Eden, in the east, and placed there the Human who had been fashioned.’

[1727] **Tanna DeBei Eliyahu Rabbah 1**: ‘Teaches that although Hashem gave Israel the Sabbath for rest and delight, a person should dedicate the holy day entirely to words of Torah, through which body and soul are sanctified.’

[1728] **Kiddushin 30b:4-5**: “So the Holy One, blessed be He, said to Israel: ‘My children, I created the evil inclination, and I created Torah as its remedy. If you occupy yourselves with Torah, you will not be delivered into its hand, as it says, “If you do well, will there not be elevation?”’ ‘But if you do not occupy yourselves with Torah, you will be delivered into its hand, as it says, “Sin crouches at the opening.” Moreover, all its dealings are directed against you, as it says, “Its desire is toward you.” If you wish, however, you can rule over it, as it says, “And you shall rule over it.”’”

[1729] **Berakhot 5a:7**: “Rabbi Yochanan said to him: Even schoolchildren know that teaching, for it says, ‘If you listen carefully to the voice of the Lord your God, do what is right in His eyes, give ear to His commandments, and keep all His statutes, I will not place upon you any of the illness I placed upon Egypt, for I am the Lord who heals you.’ Rather, the teaching is this: When someone is able to occupy himself with Torah but does not, the Holy One, blessed be He, brings upon him grievous sufferings that trouble him, as it says, ‘I was mute and silent; I refrained from good, and my pain

הָעֵרְבּוּב בָּרָא הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ שֶׁיִּהְיֶה עֵץ הַדַּעַת טוֹב וָרָע, לִהְיוֹת בְּיַד הָאָדָם לַעֲשׂוֹת כּוּלּוֹ טוֹב, **— After the intermingling, Hashem, blessed be He, established the Tree of Knowledge of Good and Evil, so that a person could make it entirely good.** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ (חֵלֶק א כז א וּשְׁאָר מְקוֹמוֹת), דְּאִית אוֹרַיְיתָא מִסִּטְרָא דְּעֵץ הַחַיִּים, [1730] **— The holy Zohar, I 27a and elsewhere, teaches that there is Torah from the side of the Tree of Life,** וְיֵשׁ אוֹרַיְיתָא מִסִּטְרָא דְּעֵץ הַדַּעַת טוֹב וָרָע. **— and there is Torah from the side of the Tree of Knowledge of Good and Evil.** וְאִיתָא בְּתִיקּוּנֵי זוֹהַר (תִּיקּוּן כד), וְכֵן כָּתוּב בְּתִקּוּנֵי זוֹהַר חָדָשׁ: גֶּפֶן דָּחָב הָאָדָם הָרִאשׁוֹן, וְחַד אָמַר חִטָּה הָיָה וְכוּלֵי, **— Tikkunei Zohar, Tikkun 24, and the Tikkunim of Zohar Chadash teach: "The vine with which Adam sinned"; another says it was wheat …** וְכֻלָּא קְשׁוֹט, שִׁבְעָה מִינִין אִינּוּן וְכוּלֵי. **— "All are true; they are seven species …"** וְלִכְאוֹרָה אֵיךְ יְצוּיַּר כֻּלָּא קְשׁוֹט בְּדָבָר הַתָּלוּי בְּמְצִיאוּת? **— How can all the opinions be true about a matter of historical fact?** וְאָמַרְנוּ דִּכְתִיב בְּתוֹךְ הַגָּן וְעֵץ הַדַּעַת טוֹב וָרָע. [1731] **— We explained the verse, "The Tree of Life within the garden, and the Tree of Knowledge of Good and Evil":** וְהוּא שֶׁהַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ בָּרָא שֶׁבְּתוֹךְ עֲצֵי הַגָּן הָיָה הַשּׁוֹרֶשׁ עֵץ הַחַיִּים וְעֵץ הַדַּעַת טוֹב וָרָע. **— Hashem, blessed be He, created the garden's trees with the Tree of Life and the Tree of Knowledge of Good and Evil as their underlying root.** וְאִם הָיָה אָדָם הָרִאשׁוֹן טוֹעֵם מִתְּחִלָּה מֵעֵץ הַחַיִּים, הָיָה מַרְגִּישׁ בְּכָל עֲצֵי הַגָּן מֵעֵץ הַחַיִּים. **— Had Adam first tasted the Tree of Life, he would have experienced the Tree of Life in every tree of the garden.** אַךְ כֵּינָן שֶׁטָּעַם מֵעֵץ הַדַּעַת טוֹב וָרָע, הִרְגִּישׁ בְּכָל אֲכִילָתוֹ מֵעֵץ הַדַּעַת טוֹב וָרָע, כֵּינָן שֶׁנַּעֲשָׂה הָעֵרְבּוּב (וְנִתְבָּאֵר בְּרֵאשִׁית מַאֲמָר ח). **— Once he tasted the Tree of Knowledge of Good and Evil, however, that tree entered his experience of all eating, since the intermingling had occurred, as explained in Bereshit, teaching 8.** וְהָאֱלֹהִים עָשָׂה אֶת הָאָדָם יָשָׁר, וְאִם לֹא הָיָה הִתְקַלְקְלוּת רַק נְטִיעָה אַחַת, שֶׁהוּא עֵץ הַחַיִּים; [1732] **— "God made man upright." Without the corruption, there would have been only one planting—the Tree of Life.** וְזֶה בָּרָא הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ, וְכָל עֲצֵי הַגָּן עֲנָפִים מִמֶּנּוּ. **— This is what Hashem, blessed be He, created, with all the garden's trees as its branches.** אַךְ אַחַר הַקִּלְקוּל שֶׁנַּעֲשָׂה הָעֵרְבּוּב טוֹב וָרָע, וְנַעֲשָׂה עֵץ הַדַּעַת טוֹב וָרָע. **— After the corruption, good and evil became intermingled, and the Tree of Knowledge of Good and Evil came into being.**

Clarification amid doubt and return to the root

אָז עֵץ הַחַיִּים הוּא קוּדְשָׁא בְּרִיךְ הוּא, וְאֵין בּוֹ שׁוּם תְּפִיסָה רַק עַל יְדֵי אוֹרַיְיתָא מִסִּטְרָא דְּעֵץ הַדַּעַת טוֹב וָרָע, [1733] **— The Tree of Life is then the Holy One, blessed be He, who can be grasped only through Torah from the side of the Tree of Knowledge of Good and Evil,** וְהֵינוּ לְטָעֹם רַק מֵהַטּוֹב שֶׁבּוֹ. [1734] **— meaning to taste only the good within it.**

Sinai Restores the Tree of Life

וְכֵן הָיָה בְּמַתַּן תּוֹרָה: אַף שֶׁיֵּשׁ תַּרְי"ג מִצְוֹת, מִכָּל מָקוֹם הַשּׁוֹרֶשׁ אָנֹכִי וְלֹא יִהְיֶה לְךָ, [1735] **— So it was at the giving of the Torah: Although there are 613 commandments, their root is "I am" and "You shall have no other**

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became troubled.' 'Good' means Torah, as it says, 'For I have given you good instruction; do not forsake My Torah.'"

[1730] **Zohar, Bereshit 23:256**: 'Zohar, Bereshit (I:27a): Distinguishes between the supernal Torah of the Tree of Life—where all is pure unity and delight—and the garments of the Tree of Knowledge of Good and Evil.'

[1731] **Genesis 2:9**: 'Genesis 2: 9: 'And from the ground the ETERNAL God caused to grow every tree that was pleasing to the sight and good for food, with the tree of life in the middle of the garden, and the tree of knowledge of good and bad.''

[1732] **Ecclesiastes 7:29**: 'Ecclesiastes 7: 29: 'But, see, this I did find: God made human beings plain, but they have engaged in too much reasoning.''

[1733] **Mei HaShiloach, Volume I, Genesis, Bereshit 6**: "The Tree of Knowledge refers to one who is continually in doubt as to what Hashem's will is; it corresponds to all the inquiries in the Gemara. The Tree of Life is true repentance, which heals what came before."

Mei HaShiloach distinguishes halakhic searching under uncertainty from repentance reaching back to heal the root. Its full teaching develops these as different trees and their nourishing rivers. This clarifies the origin's contrast between working through a mixture and restored life; it is a comparison of the two accounts, not a claim that their symbols have identical meanings throughout.

[1734] **Peri Tzadik, Rosh Hashanah 5:1**: "At the beginning of creation, the essence of life was words of Torah. Even eating, which sustains life, was also words of Torah, as it is said, "Come, eat of My bread and drink of the wine I have mixed," interpreted in the holy Zohar, III, 271b, as the bread of the Written Torah and the wine of the Oral Torah. After the corruption that came through eating, when good and evil became mixed, nevertheless, when the festival of Rosh Hashanah arrives—the day of the world's conception—one can also merit to taste only the good, as will be in the future. As I heard from our holy master of Ishbitz, of blessed memory, who said that in the future the verse will be joined as follows: "From every tree of the garden you may eat, and from the Tree of Knowledge of good"—you may also eat; "and evil you shall not eat." Only the evil of the Tree of Knowledge shall you not eat. It will then become clear that Israel never ate anything but the good of the Tree of Knowledge. That is, the intention was solely words of Torah—Torah is light—and it is written, "God saw the light, that it was good.""

[1735] **Exodus 20:2-3**: "I am Hashem your God, who brought you out of the land of Egypt, from the house of slavery. You shall have no other gods before Me."

gods," שֶׁמִּפִּי הַגְּבוּרָה שְׁמַעֲנוּם (כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ מַכּוֹת כד.)[1736] — **which we heard directly from the Almighty, as taught in Makkot 24a.** וְהָיְינוּ דְּאָנֹכִי כּוֹלֵל כָּל הַדְּבָרֵי תוֹרָה, וְהוּא עֵץ הַחַיִּים, וְכָל מִצְוֹת עֲנָפִים מִמֶּנּוּ. **— "I am" encompasses all words of Torah: It is the Tree of Life, and all the commandments are its branches.** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ (שִׁיר הַשִּׁירִים רַבָּה פָּרָשַׁת יִשָּׁקֵנִי), שֶׁבְּשָׁעָה שֶׁשָּׁמְעוּ דִּיבּוּר אָנֹכִי נִתְקַע תַּלְמוּד תּוֹרָה בְּלִבָּם.[1737] **— Shir HaShirim Rabbah, on "Let Him kiss me," teaches that when they heard "I am," Torah learning became firmly fixed in their hearts.** וְלֹא יִהְיֶה, שֶׁהוּצַרְךְ אַחַר הַקִּלְקוּל שֶׁנַּעֲשָׂה הֶעֱרְבּוּב טוֹב וָרָע, **— "You shall have no other gods" became necessary after the corruption, when good and evil were intermingled.** דְּאִיתָא (שָׁם), שֶׁבְּשָׁעָה שֶׁשָּׁמְעוּ לֹא יִהְיֶה לְךָ נֶעֱקַר יֵצֶר הָרָע מִלִּבָּם.[1738] **— For that Midrash teaches that when they heard "You shall have no other gods," the evil inclination was uprooted from their hearts.** וְאָז בְּשָׁעַת מַתַּן תּוֹרָה נִתְבַּטֵּל כָּל הָרָע וְנַעֲשָׂה רַק טוֹב, וְהָיָה כְּמוֹ קוֹדֶם הַקִּלְקוּל, **— At the giving of the Torah, all evil was annulled and everything became good, as before the corruption:** וְאִם לֹא חָזַר יֵצֶר הָרָע לִמְקוֹמוֹ אַחַר כָּךְ, הָיָה רַק אִילָן אֶחָד, עֵץ הָאֱלֹהִים עָשָׂה אֶת הָאָדָם יָשָׁר. **— "God made man upright." Had the evil inclination not subsequently returned, there would have been only one tree, the Tree of Life, as before the corruption.** וְאַחַר שֶׁחָזַר יֵצֶר הָרָע לִמְקוֹמוֹ, יֵשׁ רַק עֵץ הַדַּעַת טוֹב וָרָע, כֵּיוָן שֶׁיֵּשׁ עֵרְבּוּב, וְהָיְינוּ לְטָעוֹם רַק מַהַטּוֹב.[1739] **— Once the evil inclination returned, there was only the Tree of Knowledge of Good and Evil, because of the intermingling; the task is to taste only the good.**

Moshe and Rabbi Akiva as Roots of Torah

וְשָׁמַעְתִּי מֵהָרַב הַקָּדוֹשׁ זַכְרוֹ צַדִּיק וְקָדוֹשׁ לִבְרָכָה, דְּמֹשֶׁה רַבֵּינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם הָיָה שָׁרְשׁוֹ דִּבּוּר אָנֹכִי, **— I heard from the holy rabbi, may the memory of the righteous and holy be a blessing, that Moshe our teacher, peace be upon him, was rooted in "I am,"** וְרַבִּי עֲקִיבָא הָיָה שָׁרְשׁוֹ דִּבּוּר לֹא יִהְיֶה לְךָ. **— while Rabbi Akiva was rooted in "You shall have no other gods."** וְהָאֲרִי זְכרונוֹ לִבְרָכָה כָּתַב דְּרַבִּי עֲקִיבָא הָיָה שׁוֹרֶשׁ תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה, **— The Ari, of blessed memory, writes that Rabbi Akiva was the root of the Oral Torah.** וְאָמַרְנוּ דְּמוּכָח כֵּן מִגְּמָרָא (סַנְהֶדְרִין פו.):[1740] וְכוּלְּהוּ אַלִּיבָּא דְּרַבִּי עֲקִיבָא. **— We noted that Sanhedrin 86a supports this: "They all follow Rabbi Akiva."** וְזֶה שֶׁאָמַר (בָּבָא בַּתְרָא יב:): וּמִתְאַמְּרָא מִשְׁמֵיהּ דְּרַבִּי עֲקִיבָא בֶּן יוֹסֵף כְּוותֵיהּ,[1741] **— This explains Bava Batra 12b: "It is reported in the name of Rabbi Akiva ben Yosef in agreement with him."** שֶׁתָּפַס רַבִּי עֲקִיבָא מִפְּנֵי שֶׁהָיָה שׁוֹרֶשׁ תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה כָּאָמוּר. **— It specifies Rabbi Akiva because, as explained, he was the root of the Oral Torah.** וְהָיְינוּ דְּשׁוֹרֶשׁ מֹשֶׁה רַבֵּינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם הָיָה תּוֹרָה שֶׁבִּכְתָב, וְהוּא עֵץ הַחַיִּים, לְהַכְנִיס דִּבְרֵי תוֹרָה לְלֵב חָכָם לִימִינוֹ.[1742] **— Moshe our teacher, peace be upon him, was rooted in the Written Torah, the Tree of Life, bringing words of Torah into "the wise man's heart, at his right."** וּמֹשֶׁה רַבֵּינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם לֹא יָדַע מִשּׁוּם רָע, שֶׁכְּשֶׁנּוֹלַד נִתְמַלֵּא הַבַּיִת אוֹר, כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ (סוֹטָה יב.):[1743] **— Moshe our teacher, peace be upon him, knew no evil: When he**

[1736] **Makkot 23b:18**; **Makkot 24a:1-2**: "Rabbi Simlai expounded: Six hundred and thirteen mitzvos were stated to Moshe: three hundred and sixty-five prohibitions, corresponding to the days of the solar year, and two hundred and forty-eight positive commandments, corresponding to the limbs of a person. Rav Hamnuna said: What verse alludes to this? 'Moshe commanded us Torah, an inheritance.' The numerical value of Torah is six hundred and eleven. 'I am the Lord your God' and 'You shall have no other gods' we heard directly from the mouth of the Almighty, completing the six hundred and thirteen. The mnemonic for the teachings that follow is: DMSHMQ SQ."

[1737] **Shir HaShirim Rabbah 1:2:4** (excerpt): "Rabbi Yehudah says: When Israel heard 'I am Hashem your God' (Exodus 20:2), Torah study became firmly fixed in their hearts; they would learn and not forget. … Rabbi Nechemyah said: When Israel heard 'You shall have no other gods' (Exodus 20:3), the evil inclination was uprooted from their hearts."

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[1739] **Ecclesiastes 7:29**: 'Ecclesiastes 7: 29: 'But, see, this I did find: God made human beings plain, but they have engaged in too much reasoning.''

[1740] **Sanhedrin 86a:3**: "That cannot be the case, for Rabbi Yochanan said: An anonymous Mishnah follows Rabbi Meir; an anonymous Tosefta follows Rabbi Nechemyah; an anonymous Sifra follows Rabbi Yehudah; and an anonymous Sifrei follows Rabbi Shimon. All of them follow Rabbi Akiva's teaching."

[1741] **Bava Batra 12a:15**; **Bava Batra 12b:1**: "Abaye said: You can know that prophecy remains with the Sages from this: A great scholar states a teaching, and the same teaching is subsequently reported in the name of another great scholar. Rava said: What proof is that? Perhaps the two were born under the same constellation! Rather, Rava said: You can know it from this: A great scholar states a teaching, and an identical teaching is reported in the name of Rabbi Akiva son of Yosef. Rav Ashi said: What proof is that? Perhaps, with respect to this particular teaching, he shares Rabbi Akiva's constellation!"

[1742] **Ecclesiastes 10:2**: 'A sage's mind tends toward the right hand, a fool's toward the left.'

[1743] **Sotah 12a:17**: "'She saw that he was good.' It was taught: Rabbi Meir says: His name was Tov, 'Good.' Rabbi Yehudah says: His name was Toviyyah. Rabbi Nechemyah says: He was fit for prophecy. Others say: He was born circumcised. The Sages say: When Moshe was born, the entire house filled with light. Here it is written, 'She saw that he was good,' and there it is written, 'God saw that the light was good.'"

was born, the house filled with light, as taught in Sotah 12a. וְרָצָה שֶׁיִּהְיוּ כֵּן כָּל יִשְׂרָאֵל, וּכְמוֹ בְּשָׁעַת מַתַּן תּוֹרָה, דִּכְתִיב[1744] אֲנִי אָמַרְתִּי אֱלֹהִים אַתֶּם. **— He wanted all Israel to be so, as at the giving of the Torah, of which it says, "I said: You are divine beings."** וְרַבִּי עֲקִיבָא, שֶׁהָיָה בֶּן גֵּרִים וְאָמַר כְּשֶׁהָיִיתִי עַם הָאָרֶץ וְכוּ' (כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ פְּסָחִים מט:)[1745], **— Rabbi Akiva, however, descended from converts and said, "When I was unlearned …," as related in Pesachim 49b.** שָׁרְשׁוֹ הַתּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה, שֶׁהוּא ה"רב חָכְמָה" לְתַקֵּן ה"רב כַּעַס", עַל דֶּרֶךְ שֶׁאָמְרוּ (נְדָרִים כב:)[1746] **— His root was the Oral Torah, the "abundant wisdom" that repairs "abundant anger," following Nedarim 22b:** אִלְמָלֵא חָטְאוּ יִשְׂרָאֵל, לֹא נִיתַּן לָהֶם אֶלָּא חֲמִשָּׁה חומְשֵׁי תוֹרָה וְכוּ'; מַאי טַעְמָא? כִּי בְּרֹב חָכְמָה רָב כָּעַס.[1747] **— "Had Israel not sinned, they would have been given only the five books of the Torah … Why? 'For with abundant wisdom comes abundant anger.'"** וְזֶה שֶׁאָמַר שֶׁהָיָה שָׁרְשׁוֹ דְּבוּר לֹא יִהְיֶה לְךָ, שֶׁהוּא לַעֲקֹר וּלְשָׁרֵשׁ אֶת הָרָע מִלֵּב כְּסִיל, שֶׁיִּהְיֶה רַק עֵץ הַדַּעַת טוֹב. **— His root was therefore "You shall have no other gods": to uproot evil from the fool's heart, leaving only the Tree of Knowledge of Good.** וְזֶה שֶׁאָמַר בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ: מִסִּטְרָא דְּעֵץ הַדַּעַת טוֹב וְרָע, וְרָא אִיסּוּר וְהֶיתֵּר, כֶּשֶׁר וּפָסוּל, טוּמְאָה וְטָהֳרָה.[1748] **— This is the holy Zohar's meaning: "From the side of the Tree of Knowledge of Good and Evil"—the categories of forbidden and permitted, valid and invalid, impurity and purity.**

Tishrei and Nisan in Intention and Creation

Rabbi Eliezer and Rabbi Yehoshua disagree: Rabbi Eliezer says the world was created in Tishrei; Rabbi Yehoshua says in Nisan, as taught in Rosh Hashanah 10b. וְהִנֵּה נֶחְלְקוּ רַבִּי אֱלִיעֶזֶר וְרַבִּי יְהוֹשֻׁעַ: דְּרַבִּי אֱלִיעֶזֶר אוֹמֵר בְּתִשְׁרֵי נִבְרָא הָעוֹלָם, וּרְבִי יְהוֹשֻׁעַ אוֹמֵר בְּנִיסָן וְכוּ' (רֹאשׁ הַשָּׁנָה י:).[1749] וְכָתְבוּ הַתּוֹסָפוֹת (שָׁם כז.) דְּאִלּוּ וְאִלּוּ דִּבְרֵי אֱלֹהִים חַיִּים,[1750] **— Tosafot there, 27a, write that both are the words of the living God:** דְּבְמַחֲשָׁבָה עָלָה לִבְרֹאות בְּתִשְׁרֵי, וְלֹא נִבְרָא עַד נִיסָן, עַיֵּין שָׁם. **— The intention to create arose in Tishrei, but the world was not created until Nisan. See there.** וַיַּעַשׂ אֱלֹהִים אֶת הָאָדָם יָשָׁר, וְעָלָה בְּמַחֲשָׁבָה לִבְרֹאוֹ בְּמִדַּת הַדִּין, וְזֶה בְּתִשְׁרֵי.[1751] **— "God made man upright": The intention was to create him through the attribute of judgment. This corresponds to Tishrei.** וְרָאָה שֶׁאֵין הָעוֹלָם מִתְקַיֵּים, וְשִׁיתַּף מִדַּת הָרַחֲמִים לְמִדַּת הַדִּין, כְּמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר בְּיוֹם עֲשׂוֹת הַשֵּׁם אֱלֹהִים,[1752]

[1744] **Psalms 82:6**: 'I had taken you for divine beings,attendants of the Most High, all of you;'

[1745] **Pesachim 49b:7**: "It was taught: Rabbi Akiva said: When I was an unlearned man, I used to say, 'Who will give me a Torah scholar, so that I may bite him like a donkey?' His students said to him, 'Rabbi, say like a dog!' He answered them, 'A donkey bites and breaks the bone; a dog bites without breaking the bone.'"

[1746] **Nedarim 22b:3**: "Rav Adda son of Rabbi Chanina said: Had Israel not sinned, only the five books of the Torah and the Book of Yehoshua would have been given to them, because the latter describes the arrangement of the Land of Israel. What is the reason for the additional books? 'For with much wisdom comes much anger.'"

[1747] **Ecclesiastes 1:18**: 'For as wisdom grows, vexation grows;To increase learning is to increase heartache.'

[1748] **Zohar, Bereshit 23:256**: 'Zohar, Bereshit (I:27a): Distinguishes between the supernal Torah of the Tree of Life—where all is pure unity and delight—and the garments of the Tree of Knowledge of Good and Evil.'

[1749] **Rosh Hashanah 10b:10**; **Rosh Hashanah 11a:1-2**: "It was taught: Rabbi Eliezer says: In Tishrei the world was created; in Tishrei the patriarchs were born; in Tishrei the patriarchs died. On Pesach Yitzchak was born. On Rosh Hashanah Sarah, Rachel, and Channah were remembered and granted children. On Rosh Hashanah Yosef left prison. On Rosh Hashanah our ancestors' labor in Egypt ceased. In Nisan they were redeemed; in Tishrei they are destined to be redeemed. Rabbi Yehoshua says: In Nisan the world was created; in Nisan the patriarchs were born; in Nisan the patriarchs died. On Pesach Yitzchak was born. On Rosh Hashanah Sarah, Rachel, and Channah were remembered and granted children. On Rosh Hashanah Yosef left prison. On Rosh Hashanah our ancestors' labor in Egypt ceased. In Nisan they were redeemed; in Nisan they are destined to be redeemed."

[1750] **Tosafot on Rosh Hashanah 27a:15:1**: ""According to whom do we pray, 'This day is the beginning of Your works'?": This is surprising, for we rule like Rabbi Yehoshua, as we say in the first chapter (Rosh Hashanah 12a): For the seasonal cycle, like Rabbi Yehoshua. Rabbeinu Tam says that we rule like Rav Eina, who objects from the comparison of the Jubilee. Rav Eina means this: There is "This day is the beginning of Your works," which is said on Rosh Hashanah but not on the Jubilee. Rather, it is certain that our saying it is not because of the world's creation, but because it is the beginning of the act of judgment, when the world is judged as to whether it will continue to exist or not. This applies also to the Day of Atonement of the Jubilee, which is compared to Rosh Hashanah, as stated below in the final chapter (34a), but not to other days. Although his objection is answered well, Rav Eina does not retract. According to the other version, however, it is difficult: it says that our Mishnah is not in accordance with Rabbi Eliezer, but it should have answered that "This day is the beginning of Your works" does not refer to the creation of the world. As for Rabbi Elazar HaKallir's composing the rain poem for Shemini Atzeret according to Rabbi Eliezer, who says the world was created in Tishrei, while composing the Passover poem according to Rabbi Yehoshua, Rabbeinu Tam says that both are the words of the living God: one can say that in Tishrei it arose in thought to create, but it was not created until Nisan. We find a similar instance in the chapter Osin Pasin (Eruvin 18a; see there), concerning Adam: it arose in thought to create two, but in the end only one was created."

[1751] **Ecclesiastes 7:29**: 'Ecclesiastes 7: 29: 'But, see, this I did find: God made human beings plain, but they have engaged in too much reasoning.''

[1752] **Genesis 2:4**: 'Genesis 2: 4: 'Such is the story of heaven and earth when they were created.When the ETERNAL God made earth and heaven—''

— He saw that the world could not endure and joined mercy to judgment, as it says, “On the day that Hashem God made …” וְזֶהוּ אַחַר שֶׁרָאָה הַקִּלְקוּל, וְנִבְרָא בְּנִיסָן. **— This came after He foresaw the corruption; the world was created in Nisan.** וּכְפִי שֶׁעָלָה בְּמַחֲשַׁבָה אֲשֶׁר עָשָׂה אֶת הָאָדָם יָשָׁר, כְּתִיב וַיִּטַּע, הֵיינוּ נְטִיעָה אַחַת, שֶׁהוּא עֵץ הַחַיִּים,[1753, 1754] **— According to the original intention, “He made man upright,” it says “He planted”—one planting, the Tree of Life.** מִמֶּנּוּ הָיוּ הָעֲנָפִים, כָּל עַמְּדֵי תוֹרָה. **— All the words of Torah were branches extending from it.** וְזֶה בְּאֶחָד בְּתִשְׁרֵי, שֶׁהוּא רֹאשׁ הַשָּׁנָה לַשָּׁנִים, שָׁנָה דְּהַמָּה, וּכְתִיב כִּי שֶׁמֶשׁ וּמָגֵן הַשֵּׁם אֱלֹהִים,[1755, 1756] **— This is the first of Tishrei, the New Year for years, the solar year. It says, “For Hashem God is a sun and shield”:** וְהַיְינוּ קוּדְשָׁא בְּרִיךְ הוּא וְתוֹרָה שֶׁבִּכְתָב, שֶׁמֶשׁ. **— The sun represents the Holy One, blessed be He, and the Written Torah.** וּבְנִיסָן, שֶׁהוּא אַחַר שֶׁרָאָה שֶׁאֵין הָעוֹלָם מִתְקַיֵּים וְשִׁיתֵּף מִידַּת הָרַחֲמִים לְמִדַּת הַדִּין, **— Nisan follows His seeing that the world could not endure and His joining the attribute of mercy to judgment.** כְּתִיב הַחֹדֶשׁ הַזֶּה לָכֶם רֹאשׁ חֳדָשִׁים, רִאשׁוֹן הוּא לָכֶם לְחָדְשֵׁי הַשָּׁנָה.[1757] **— It says, “This month shall be for you the first of the months; it shall be the first for you of the months of the year.”** וְהוּא אַחַר שֶׁגָּדַל הַנְּטִיעָה לְהוֹצִיא פֵּירוֹת, וְזֶה הָיָה בְּנִיסָן. **— The planting had now grown enough to produce fruit; this took place in Nisan.** וְזֶה נִקְרָא אִילָן, שֶׁעוֹמֵד לַחֲנוֹט וּלְהוֹצִיא פֵּירוֹת. אִילָ״ן גִּימַטְרִיָּא שְׁנֵי הַשֵּׁמוֹת, הֲוָיָ״ה אֲדָנָ״י, כָּאָמוּר: **— It is called a tree, ready to set and produce fruit. As explained, ilan has the numerical value of the two names, Havayah and Adonai.** הֲוָיָ״ה תּוֹרָה שֶׁבִּכְתָב, אֲדָנָ״י מַלְכוּת פֶּה, תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה, סִיהֲרָא דִּמְקַבְּלָא מִשְׁמְשָׁא. **— Havayah represents the Written Torah; Adonai represents Malkhut, the mouth, the Oral Torah—the moon receiving from the sun.** וְעַל יְדֵי הַתּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה מְתַקָּנִים ה״רָב בָּעַס״, שֶׁיִּהְיֶה הַכֹּל מִסְטָרָא דְּטוֹב. **— Through the Oral Torah, “abundant anger” is repaired, so that everything belongs to the side of good.**

Life and Good in the Two Tablets

וְזֶה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר רְאֵה נָתַתִּי לְפָנֶיךָ הַיּוֹם אֶת הַחַיִּים וְאֶת הַטּוֹב.[1758] **— This is the meaning of “See, I have placed before you today life and good.”** חַיִּים, עֵץ הַחַיִּים, תּוֹרָה שֶׁבִּכְתָב, וְהֵם לוּחוֹת רִאשׁוֹנוֹת, **— “Life” is the Tree of Life, the Written Torah, represented by the first tablets.** שֶׁאָז הָיָה מְתוּקָן שֶׁיִּהְיוּ כְּמוֹ שֶׁעָלָה בְּמַחֲשָׁבָה, שֶׁיִּהְיֶה רַק עֵץ חַיִּים. **— Everything had then been restored to the original intention: There would be only the Tree of Life.**

The Oral Torah is also bread from Heaven

וְהַטּוֹב הֵיינוּ לוּחוֹת שְׁנִיוֹת, שֶׁבָּהֶם הָיָה כָּלוּל מִדְּרָשׁ הֲלָכוֹת וְאַגָּדוֹת (כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ שְׁמוֹת רַבָּה פָּרָשָׁה מו וּפָרָשָׁה מז). **—**[1759, 1760, 1761]

[1753] **Ecclesiastes 7:29**: ‘Ecclesiastes 7: 29: ‘But, see, this I did find: God made human beings plain, but they have engaged in too much reasoning.’’

[1754] **Genesis 2:8**: ‘The ETERNAL God planted a garden in Eden, in the east, and placed there the Human who had been fashioned.’

[1755] **Mishnah Rosh Hashanah 1:1**: “There are four new years. On the first of Nisan is the new year for kings and festivals. On the first of Elul is the new year for the tithe of animals. Rabbi Elazar and Rabbi Shimon say: On the first of Tishrei. On the first of Tishrei is the new year for years, Sabbatical years, Jubilee years, planting, and vegetables. On the first of Shevat is the new year for the tree, according to Beis Shammai. Beis Hillel say: On the fifteenth of that month.”

[1756] **Psalms 84:12**: ‘Psalms 84: 12: ‘For the ETERNAL God is sun and shield; GOD bestows grace and glory,and does not withhold bounty from those who live without blame.’’

[1757] **Exodus 12:2**: “This month shall be your beginning of months; it shall be the first month of the year to you.”

[1758] **Deuteronomy 30:15**: “See, I have placed before you today life and goodness, and death and evil.”

[1759] **Shemot Rabbah 46:1** (excerpt): “Moshe began to grieve over the breaking of the Tablets. The Holy One, blessed be He, said to him: Do not grieve over the first Tablets, which contained only the Ten Commandments. In the second Tablets I give you laws, Midrash, and Aggadot. This is what is written: ‘He would tell you the hidden things of wisdom, for they are double in understanding’ (Job 11:6). Moreover, you are announcing that I have forgiven your transgression, as it says, ‘Know that God has remitted some of your iniquity’ (Job 11:6).”

[1760] **Shemot Rabbah 47:7** (excerpt): “The Holy One, blessed be He, said: You have suffered; by your life, you will not lose by it. The first Tablets contained only the Ten Commandments. Now that you have suffered, I give you laws, Midrashim, and Aggadot, as it says, ‘Write these words for yourself’ (Exodus 34:27). Why did the Holy One say ‘Write for yourself,’ when it is written, ‘The writing was God’s writing, engraved upon the Tablets’ (Exodus 32:16), and ‘He wrote upon the Tablets like the first writing’ (Deuteronomy 10:4)? Rather, the Holy One told him: Write Torah, Prophets, and Writings, that they should be in writing; but laws, Midrash, Aggadot, and Talmud shall be oral. Once Moshe understood this, he began saying, ‘It was good for me that I was afflicted’; ‘The Torah of Your mouth is better to me’ (Psalms 119:71–72).”

[1761] **Machshavot Charutz 15:8**: “They allude to Torah: “Come, eat of My bread,” which is bread from Heaven. There are two loaves, corresponding to the Written and Oral Torahs, for the Oral Torah too is bread from Heaven. As stated at the beginning of Chagigah, 3b, “They were all given by one Shepherd”: everything is from Sinai, as stated in Berakhot 5a and elsewhere. Torah is the Tree of Life within the garden, as stated in the first chapter of Tanna Devei Eliyahu Rabbah and elsewhere, at the central point from which all the garden’s trees draw nourishment. The Tree of Knowledge of good and evil mentioned alongside it appears to stand immediately beside it, likewise at the center, so that all the trees draw from it too. For in truth it is all one. Had Adam not sinned, it too would have become the Tree of Life, and evil would have been entirely consumed from the world. Through his sin, even the Tree of Life of Torah became associated with the

“Good” refers to the second tablets, which included midrash, halakhot, and aggadot, as taught in Shemot Rabbah, chapters 46 and 47. וְזֶהוּ עֵץ הַדַּעַת טוֹב; דַּעַת פֵּירֵשׁ רַבִּי שְׁלֹמֹה יִצְחָקִי, תִּשָּׁא: רוּחַ הַקּוֹדֶשׁ.[1762] — **This is the Tree of Knowledge of Good. Rashi, in Ki Tissa, explains “knowledge” as divine inspiration.** וְהַיְינוּ תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה, שֶׁזּוֹכִין לְכַוֵּין הֲלָכָה לְמֹשֶׁה מִסִּינַי, וְזֶהוּ עַל יְדֵי רוּחַ הַקּוֹדֶשׁ, — **This is the Oral Torah: One merits independently arriving at a law given to Moshe at Sinai, through divine inspiration,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתַב רַבִּי מֹשֶׁה בֶּן נַחְמָן (בָּבָא בַּתְרָא יב:).[1763, 1764] וְהוּא מֵאוֹר יְכ טוֹב, אוֹר הָרִאשׁוֹן שֶׁנִּגְנַז לַעֲמֵלֵי תוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה (כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ מִדְרַשׁ תַּנְחוּמָא נֹחַ). — **as Ramban explains on Bava Batra 12b. This comes from the light “that it was good,” the primordial light hidden for those who labor in the Oral Torah, as Midrash Tanchuma, Noach, teaches.** וְכָל יְקָר רָאֲתָה עֵינוֹ, זֶה רַבִּי עֲקִיבָא וַחֲבֵירָיו, דְּבָרִים שֶׁלֹּא נִגְלוּ לְמֹשֶׁה נִגְלוּ לְרַבִּי עֲקִיבָא וַחֲבֵירָיו, — **“His eye has seen every precious thing”—this is Rabbi Akiva and his colleagues; matters not revealed to Moshe were revealed to Rabbi Akiva and his colleagues,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ בַּמִּדְרָשׁ (רַבָּה וְתַנְחוּמָא חוּקַּת). וְזֶה הָיָה אַחַר הַקִּלְקוּל, שֶׁנִּצְרַךְ לְתַקֵּן ה״רַב כָּעַס״,[1765, 1766] — **as taught in the Midrash, Rabbah and Tanchuma, Chukat. This was after the corruption,**

Tree of Knowledge of good and evil: valid and invalid, impure and pure, and so forth, as stated at the beginning of the Tikkunim.”

Machshavot Charutz develops the same relationship between Written and Oral Torah and the two trees through the two loaves. Its explicit statement that the Oral Torah is also bread from Heaven clarifies how the origin can describe human halakhic understanding as a response to damage while still tracing it to Sinai.

[1762] **Rashi on Exodus 31:3**: ‘And I have filled him with the spirit of God, in wisdom (be-chokhmah), and in understanding (u-vi-tevunah), and in knowledge (u-ve-da’at)’ (Exodus 31:3): Rashi explains: Chokhmah is what a person hears from others and learns; Tevunah is understanding a matter from within one’s own heart out of what one has learned; and Da’at is the Holy Spirit (Ruach HaKodesh).’

[1763] **Genesis 1:4**: ‘Genesis 1: 4: ‘God saw that the light was good, and God separated the light from the darkness.’’

[1764] **Midrash Tanchuma, Noach 3:4**: “The Israelites did not accept the Torah until the Holy One, blessed be He, arched the mountain over them like a vessel, as it is said: And they stood beneath the mountain (Exod. 19:17). R. Dimi the son of Hama stated that the Holy One, blessed be He, told Israel: If you accept the Torah, well and good; but if not, your grave will be there. If you should say that He arched the mountain over them because of the Written Law, isn’t it true that as soon as He said to them, “Will you accept the Torah?” they all responded, “We will do and hear,” because the Written Law was brief and required no striving and suffering, but rather He threatened them because of the Oral Law. After all, it contains the detailed explanations of the commandments, both simple and difficult, and it is as severe as death, and as jealous as Sheol. One does not study the Oral Law unless he loves the Holy One, blessed be He, with all his heart, with all his soul, and with all his might, as it is said: And thou shalt love the Lord thy God with all thy heart, with all thy soul, and with all thy might (Deut. 6:5).”

[1765] **Bamidbar Rabbah 19:6** (excerpt): “It is written, ‘These things I have done, and have not forsaken them’ (Isaiah 42:16). It does not say ‘I shall do,’ but ‘I have done’: I have already done this for Rabbi Akiva and his companions. Matters not revealed to Moshe were revealed to Rabbi Akiva and his companions. ‘His eye saw every precious thing’ (Job 28:10)—this is Rabbi Akiva and his companions.”

[1766] **Midrash Tanchuma, Chukat 8:1**: “(Numb. 19:2, cont:) “That they bring unto you a red heifer without blemish.” R. Jose bar Hanina said, “The Holy One, blessed be He, said to Moses. ‘To you I am revealing the reason for the heifer, but to others it is an unquestioned statute.’” As Rav Huna said, “It is written (in Ps. 75:3), ‘For I will set a time, when I Myself will judge with equity.’ It is also written (in Zech. 14:6), ‘On that day there shall be no light of cold (yqrot) and frost.’ Things that are hidden from you in this world are going to be clear to you in the world to come, as with the blind person who gains his sight. Thus it is stated (in Is. 42:16), ‘I will lead the blind by a road they do not know, … these things I have done.’ ‘I will do’ is not stated here, but ‘I have done,’ in that I have already done them for R. Aqiva and his colleagues.” Another interpretation: Things that were not revealed to Moses were revealed to R. Aquiva and his colleagues (as found in Job 28:10), “his eye sees every precious thing.” R. Jose bar Hanina said, “It was implied (in Numb. 19:2) was that all heifers perish, but Moses’ lasts forever.” R. Aha said in the name of R. Jose bar Hanina, “When Moses ascended into the firmament, he heard the voice of the Holy One, blessed be He, sitting and being occupied with the parashah of the red heifer, and he was reciting a halakhah (i.e., a passage of oral Torah) in the name of its author (from Parah 1:1), ‘My son, Eliezer says, “The calf whose neck is to be broken is to be one year old, but the red heifer is to be two years old.”’ Moses said, ‘Master of the world, do not the realms above and below belong to you? Now you are citing a halakhah in the name of flesh and blood?’ He said to him, ‘A righteous man is going to arise in my world and is first going to begin his teaching with the parashah of the red heifer, R. Eliezer says, “The calf whose neck is to be broken is to be one year old, but the red heifer is to be two years old.”’ He told Him, ‘Master of the universe, may it be Your will that he come from my loins.’ He said to him, ‘By your life, he is to be from your loins.’ Thus it is stated (of Moses' offspring in Exod. 18:4), ‘And the name of the one was Eliezer,’ i.e., the name of that particular one who would begin his teaching with Tractate Parah was Eliezer. A certain stranger questioned Rabban Johanan ben Zakkay, “These things which you do seem like a kind of sorcery. You bring a heifer, burn it, pound it, and take its ashes. Then when one of you is defiled by a corpse, they sprinkle two or three drops on him, and you say to him, ‘You are clean.’” He said to him, “Have you ever had a bad spirit of madness enter you?” He told him, “No.” He said to him, “Perhaps you have seen someone into whom a bad spirit has entered?” He told him, “Yes.” He said to him, “So what did you do for him?” He said to him, “They bring roots and burn them beneath him. Then they sprinkle water on the spirit, and it flees.” He said to him, “Let your ears hear what you are uttering with your mouth. Similarly is this spirit an unclean spirit. Thus it is stated (in Zech. 13:2), ‘and I will also remove the prophets and the unclean spirit from the land.’ They sprinkle the purifying water upon him, and he flees.” After the gentile had left, R. Johanan's disciples said to him, “Our master, you repelled this one with a mere reed of an answer. What have you to say to us?” He said to them, “By your lives, a corpse does not defile, nor does a heifer purify, nor does water purify. Rather, the Holy One, blessed be He, has said, ‘I have enacted a

when "abundant anger" needed repair. וְזֶה לֹא הָיָה חֶלְקוֹ שֶׁל מֹשֶׁה רַבֵּינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם, לְמַעֲלָתוֹ (כְּמוֹ שֶׁנִּתְבָּאֵר חֲנוּכָּה מַאֲמָר ב)[1767] — **Because of his exalted level, this was not the portion of Moshe our teacher, peace be upon him, as explained in Chanukah, teaching 2.** וְהַלּוּחוֹת שְׁנִיִּים נִיתַּן בְּיוֹם הַכִּפּוּרִים אַחַר הַקִּלְקוּל. — **The second tablets were given on Yom Kippur, after the corruption.** וְזֶה שֶׁאָמַר: בְּאֶחָד בְּתִשְׁרֵי רֹאשׁ הַשָּׁנָה לִנְטִיעָה; נְטִיעָה עֵץ הַחַיִּים[1768], קוֹדֶם שֶׁהִתְפַּשֵּׁט לַעֲשׂוֹת פֵּירוֹת. — **Thus, "The first of Tishrei is the New Year for planting": The planting is the Tree of Life before it expands to produce fruit.** וּבֶאֱמֶת בְּיוֹם הַכִּפּוּרִים הַזְּמַן לְתַקֵּן עַל יְדֵי תְּשׁוּבָה שֶׁיִּהְיֶה כְּמוֹ שֶׁהָיָה בִּשְׁעַת שְׁלֵימָה, — **Yom Kippur is indeed the time to repair through complete repentance,** מַתַּן תּוֹרָה[1769], שֶׁחָזַר לִהְיוֹת כְּמוֹ שֶׁעָלָה בְּמַחֲשָׁבָה, אֲשֶׁר עָשָׂה הָאֱלֹהִים אֶת הָאָדָם יָשָׁר. — **so that things are as at the giving of the Torah, restored to the original intention: "God made man upright."** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמַר רַבִּי אֱלִיעֶזֶר (בְּרֹאשׁ הַשָּׁנָה)[1770, 1771], שֶׁבְּתִשְׁרֵי עֲתִידִין לְהִגָּאֵל, וְהַיְינוּ עַל יְדֵי תְּשׁוּבָה, וּכְשִׁיטָתוֹ בְּחֵלֶק. — **Rabbi Eliezer therefore says in Rosh Hashanah that the future redemption will be in Tishrei—through repentance, following his view in the chapter Chelek.** וְאֵלּוּ וְאֵלּוּ דִּבְרֵי אֱלֹהִים חַיִּים (וְנִתְבָּאֵר בְּרֵאשִׁית מַאֲמָר ה)[1772]. — **Both views are the words of the living God, as explained in Bereshit, teaching 5.**

Shavuot and the Blessing of Tree Fruit

וְזֶה שֶׁאָמַר (רֹאשׁ הַשָּׁנָה טז.): הָבִיאוּ שְׁתֵּי הַלֶּחֶם בַּעֲצֶרֶת כְּדֵי שֶׁיִּתְבָּרְכוּ לָכֶם פֵּירוֹת הָאִילָן.[1773] — **This explains Rosh**

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statute for you. I have issued a decree, and you are not allowed to transgress against my decree.'" Thus it is written (in Numb. 19:2), "This is the statute of the Torah." And for what reason are all the sacrifices male and female, while that one is only female? R. Ayyevu said, "It is comparable to the son of a female slave who defiled a king's palace. The king said, 'Let his mother come and clean up the excrement.' Similarly has the Holy One, blessed be He, said, 'Let a heifer come and atone for the incident of the golden calf.'""

[1767] **Peri Tzadik, Chanukah 2:3**: "Although the Midrash, Rabbah and Tanchuma on Chukat, says, "His eye has seen every precious thing"—this refers to Rabbi Akiva and his colleagues; matters not revealed to Moses were revealed to Rabbi Akiva and his colleagues—and the Gemara there likewise says that Moses sat at the end of eight rows and did not understand what they were saying, nevertheless Rabbi Akiva did not apprehend the reason for a law given to Moses at Sinai, for that is Moses our teacher's portion. Concerning this the Gemara says that Moses's mind was put at ease: from this he saw that his understanding was higher, and that his portion of the Oral Torah was something no other person had attained. The portion of the Oral Torah belonging to Rabbi Akiva and his colleagues does not pertain to Moses, because he had never brought about corruption and did not require the "abundant wisdom," the fiftieth gate, entrusted to the penitent to repair the "abundant anger.""

[1768] **Mishnah Rosh Hashanah 1:1**: "There are four new years. On the first of Nisan is the new year for kings and festivals. On the first of Elul is the new year for the tithe of animals. Rabbi Elazar and Rabbi Shimon say: On the first of Tishrei. On the first of Tishrei is the new year for years, Sabbatical years, Jubilee years, planting, and vegetables. On the first of Shevat is the new year for the tree, according to Beis Shammai. Beis Hillel say: On the fifteenth of that month."

[1769] **Ecclesiastes 7:29**: 'Ecclesiastes 7: 29: 'But, see, this I did find: God made human beings plain, but they have engaged in too much reasoning.''

[1770] **Rosh Hashanah 10b:10**; **Rosh Hashanah 11a:1-2**: "It was taught: Rabbi Eliezer says: In Tishrei the world was created; in Tishrei the patriarchs were born; in Tishrei the patriarchs died. On Pesach Yitzchak was born. On Rosh Hashanah Sarah, Rachel, and Channah were remembered and granted children. On Rosh Hashanah Yosef left prison. On Rosh Hashanah our ancestors' labor in Egypt ceased. In Nisan they were redeemed; in Tishrei they are destined to be redeemed. Rabbi Yehoshua says: In Nisan the world was created; in Nisan the patriarchs were born; in Nisan the patriarchs died. On Pesach Yitzchak was born. On Rosh Hashanah Sarah, Rachel, and Channah were remembered and granted children. On Rosh Hashanah Yosef left prison. On Rosh Hashanah our ancestors' labor in Egypt ceased. In Nisan they were redeemed; in Nisan they are destined to be redeemed."

[1771] **Sanhedrin 97b:14-15**: 'Rav said: All calculated ends have passed, and the matter depends only on repentance and good deeds. Rabbi Eliezer says: If Israel repent, they are redeemed; if not, they are not redeemed. Rabbi Yehoshua said: If they do not repent, will they not be redeemed? Rather, the Holy One raises over them a king whose decrees are as harsh as Haman's, and Israel repent and He brings them back to the good. Another teaching presents their further debate through the verses 'Return, wayward children' and 'You were sold for nothing and shall not be redeemed for silver.''

[1772] **Peri Tzadik, Bereshit 5:1**: "According to Rabbi Eliezer, who holds that the world was created in Tishrei, the order is that redemption will be in Tishrei: on Rosh Hashanah there will be an awakening to repentance through the sounding of the shofar, as it says, "If a shofar is sounded in a city, will the people not tremble?" Afterward comes Yom Kippur, to repair all that has passed; when they merit it, the union will then take place. Afterward comes Sukkot, the season of our rejoicing, and the war of Gog and Magog on Sukkot. Although through repentance the time of redemption is always available—as it says, "Today, if you heed His voice," as stated in Sanhedrin 98a—at its appointed time the awakening to repentance will come from God, as it says, "I will remove the heart of stone," and "I will bring it about that you follow My statutes." According to Rabbi Yehoshua, who holds that the world was created in Nisan, the spirit of the Messiah was then created so that redemption would take place in Nisan when its appointed time arrived. Its order will resemble the redemption from Egypt, initiated by God: there will be plagues, Israel will be refined in all ten attributes, and redemption will come from God."

[1773] **Rosh Hashanah 16a:14**: "It was taught: Rabbi Yehudah said in Rabbi Akiva's name: Why did the Torah say to bring an omer offering on Pesach? Because Pesach is the grain season. The Holy One, blessed be He, said: 'Bring an omer before Me on Pesach so that the grain in your fields may be blessed.' Why did the Torah say to bring the two loaves on Shavuos? Because Shavuos is the season of tree fruits. The Holy One, blessed be He, said: 'Bring the two loaves before Me on Shavuos so that your tree fruits may be blessed.'"

Hashanah 16a: "Bring the two loaves on Shavuot, so that the fruit of your trees will be blessed." וּפֵירֵשׁ רַבִּי שְׁלֹמֹה יִצְחָקִי דְּאָזְלָא כְּמַאן דְּאָמַר עֵץ שֶׁאָכַל אָדָם הָרִאשׁוֹן חִטָּה הָיְתָה.[1774] **— Rashi explains that this follows the view that the tree from which Adam ate was wheat.** וְאָמַרְנוּ דִּלְכוֹלֵי עָלְמָא קוֹדֶם הַקִּלְקוּל הָיָה הַחִטָּה מִין פְּרִי שֶׁהָיָה מוֹצִיא גְּלוּסְקָאוֹת, כְּמוֹ לֶעָתִיד, **— We explained that all agree: Before the corruption, wheat was a kind of fruit that produced ready-made loaves, as it will in the future.** דְּלָא פְּלִיגִי, כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בְּתִיקּוּנֵי זוֹהַר. **— The views do not disagree, as Tikkunei Zohar teaches.** אַךְ צָרִיךְ לְהָבִין: מַה נַּפְקָא מִינָּהּ שֶׁהָיָה חִטָּה מִן אִין קוֹדֶם הַקִּלְקוּל, **— Yet we must understand: What difference does it make that wheat belonged to this tree category before the corruption,** כֵּיוָן שֶׁבַּזְּמַן הַזֶּה אַחַר הַקִּלְקוּל אֵינוֹ מִין אִילָן? וּמַה שַּׁיָּיךְ הֲבִיאוּ שְׁתֵּי הַלֶּחֶם שֶׁיִּתְבָּרְכוּ פֵּירוֹת הָאִילָן? **— if now, after the corruption, it is not a tree species? How, then, does bringing two loaves bring blessing to tree fruits?** אֲבָל בַּעֲצֶרֶת זְמַן מַתַּן לוּחוֹת רִאשׁוֹנוֹת, שֶׁיִּתְבָּרְכוּ פֵּירוֹת הָאִילָן. **— Yet Shavuot is the time when the first tablets were given, so that the tree fruits will be blessed.** אָכֵן בַּעֲצֶרֶת, זְמַן מַתַּן לוּחוֹת רִאשׁוֹנוֹת, נִתְתַּקֵּן כָּל הַפְּגָם, שֶׁיִּהְיֶה כְּמוֹ קוֹדֶם הַקִּלְקוּל, רַק עֵץ הַחַיִּים. **— On Shavuot, when the first tablets were given, the entire flaw was repaired: Everything returned to its state before the corruption, with only the Tree of Life.** וְעַל כֵּן בָּא הַמִּצְוָה לְהַקְרִיב בַּעֲצֶרֶת שְׁתֵּי הַלֶּחֶם חָמֵץ, **— Therefore comes the commandment to offer two leavened loaves on Shavuot,** שֶׁאָז מוֹפִיעַ הַזְּמַן שֶׁיּוּכְלוּ לְתַקֵּן כָּל הַפְּגָם, שֶׁאַף הַשְּׂאוֹר שֶׁבָּעִיסָּה יִהְיֶה טוֹב מְאֹד. **— for this time brings the possibility of repairing the entire flaw, so that even the leaven in the dough becomes very good.** וּבְבֵית הַמִּקְדָּשׁ הָיָה מוֹפִיעַ בְּכָל עֲצֶרֶת אוֹר זֶה דְּמַתַּן תּוֹרָה, שֶׁיּוּכְלוּ לְתַקֵּן כָּל הַפְּגָם, **— In the Temple, this light of the giving of the Torah shone forth every Shavuot, enabling the entire flaw to be repaired,** עַל דֶּרֶךְ שֶׁאָמְרוּ (זוֹהַר חֵלֶק ב וְלָכֵן הַשְּׂתֵּי הַלֶּחֶם שֶׁהִקְרִיבוּ בַּעֲצֶרֶת בְּבֵית הַמִּקְדָּשׁ, חִטָּה זֶה מִין פֵּירוֹת אִילָן הָיָה, **— following the Zohar, II 186a: "There is no light …" — Thus, in the two loaves offered in the Temple on Shavuot, that wheat was a kind of tree fruit,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁהָיָה הַחִטָּה קוֹדֶם הַקִּלְקוּל לְכוֹלֵי עָלְמָא, כָּאָמוּר. **— just as, according to all views, wheat was before the corruption.** וְאִיתָא בַּמִּשְׁנָה דִּבְאֶחָד בְּתִשְׁרֵי רֹאשׁ הַשָּׁנָה לִנְטִיעָה, שֶׁבְּתִשְׁרֵי הַזְּמַן לְתַקֵּן עַל יְדֵי תְּשׁוּבָה,[1776] **— The Mishnah therefore teaches that the first of Tishrei is the New Year for planting: Tishrei is the time to repair through repentance,** שֶׁיִּהְיֶה הַגְּאוּלָּה שְׁלֵימָה, שֶׁיִּהְיֶה רַק עֵץ הַחַיִּים, שֶׁזֶּה נִקְרָא נְטִיעָה כְּמוֹ שֶׁנִּקְרָא קוֹדֶם שֶׁהִתְפַּשֵּׁט לִהְיוֹת אִילָן. **— so that redemption is complete and there is only the Tree of Life, called a planting, as before it expanded into a tree.**

Shevat Repairs Eating through Oral Torah

וְהִנֵּה אִיתָא בְּסֵפֶר יְצִירָה: הִמְלִיךְ אוֹת צ׳ בְּלְעִיטָה וּשְׁבָט בַּשָּׁנָה.[1777] **— Sefer Yetzirah teaches: "He made the letter tzadi rule over swallowing, and Shevat in the year."** וְהַיְינוּ דְּעֵסֶק חוֹדֶשׁ זֶה לְתַקֵּן מִדַּת צַדִּיק, לִהְיוֹת גִּבּוֹר הַכּוֹבֵשׁ אֶת יִצְרוֹ. **— The work of this month is to perfect the attribute of the tzaddik, becoming mighty by mastering one's inclination.** וְאָמְרוּ בַּזּוֹהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ (חֵלֶק א רב א): דְּלֵית מִלָּה לְתַבְּרָא יֵצֶר הָרָע אֶלָּא אוֹרַיְיתָא.[1778] **— The holy Zohar, I 202a, teaches: "Nothing breaks the evil inclination except Torah."** וְהַיְינוּ תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה, דִּכְתִיב אוֹר זָרוּעַ לַצַּדִּיק, דְּצַדִּיק שַׁיָּיךְ לֵיהּ זוֹכֶה לָאוֹר[1779] **— This is the Oral Torah, as it says, "Light is sown for the righteous."**

[1774] **Rashi on Rosh Hashanah 16a:14:2**: 'Rashi on Rosh Hashanah 16a (s.v. Havu shtei ha-lechem): "Bring the Two Loaves of wheat on Shavuot so that the fruits of the trees may be blessed for you"—because wheat is itself called a tree in the exposition of Rabbi Yehudah.'

[1775] **Zohar, Tetzaveh 10:83**: "Because in the hour when they left Egypt and increased to the number of sixty myriad souls, the Holy Kingdom was strengthened and stood firm, high above all, and the Moon was illumined, and thus the wicked dominion, the "other side", was subdued, and the Holy One brought the Israelites out in order to lead them through the terrible wilderness, the very realm and domain of Samael the wicked, in order that the evil power might be broken and the ruler of the regions of darkness be crushed, that it might rear its head no more. Had the Israelites not sinned, the Holy One would have resolved to remove him altogether from the world. Therefore He led them through his very dominion and territory."

[1776] **Mishnah Rosh Hashanah 1:1**: "There are four new years. On the first of Nisan is the new year for kings and festivals. On the first of Elul is the new year for the tithe of animals. Rabbi Elazar and Rabbi Shimon say: On the first of Tishrei. On the first of Tishrei is the new year for years, Sabbatical years, Jubilee years, planting, and vegetables. On the first of Shevat is the new year for the tree, according to Beis Shammai. Beis Hillel say: On the fifteenth of that month."

[1777] **Sefer Yetzirah Gra Version 5:10**: 'He made the letter Tzadi king over swallowing/taste (le'itah), bound a crown to it, and combined one with another; and with them He formed Aquarius (Deli) in the universe, Shevat in the year, and the gizzard (kurkevan) in the soul, male and female.'

[1778] **Zohar, Miketz 12:194-195**: "Alas for that day, a day of wrath and indignation! Hence it behoves man to contend daily with his evil prompter and to picture to himself the day when he will stand before the King to be judged, when they will lower him into the ground to rot there, whilst the soul will become separated from him. We have been taught that it behoves man always to rouse the good prompter against the evil prompter; if the latter departs, well and good, but if not, the man should study the Torah, as there is nothing so well calculated to crush the evil prompter as the Torah; if he departs, well and good, but if not, let the man remind him of the day of death so as thereby to subdue him."

[1779] **Psalms 97:11**: "Light is sown for the righteous, and joy for the upright in heart."

כִּי טוֹב, וְעַל יְדֵי זֶה כּוֹבֵשׁ יִצְרוֹ.[1780] **— The tzaddik who battles the evil inclination merits the light "that it was good," and thereby masters his inclination.** וְזֶה שֶׁאָמַר אוֹת צַדִּיק בִּלְעִיטָה, דְּשׁוֹרֶשׁ הֶסָּתַת הַנָּחָשׁ הָיָה בַּאֲכִילָה, **— This explains the letter tzadi's association with swallowing: The serpent's enticement began with eating.** וּמִזֶּה הֵטִיל הַזּוּהֲמָא וְגָרַם הַק״ל שָׁנָה, וְעַל יְדֵי תִּיקּוּן הַפְּגָם בַּאֲכִילָה נִתְקַן הַכֹּל. **— Through this he injected the defilement and caused those 130 years; by repairing the flaw in eating, everything is repaired.**

Moshe Explains Torah in Shevat

וְזֶה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר בְּעַשְׁתֵּי עָשָׂר חֹדֶשׁ בְּאֶחָד לַחֹדֶשׁ דִּבֶּר מֹשֶׁה וְגוֹמֵר.[1781] **— Thus it says, "In the eleventh month, on the first of the month, Moshe spoke …"** וְהַיְינוּ דְּמִשְׁנֵה תּוֹרָה מֹשֶׁה מִפִּי עַצְמוֹ אֲמָרָן, כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ (חֶלֶק ג רסא א, וְעַיֵּין מְגִלָּה לא:),[1782, 1783] **— Moshe spoke Deuteronomy in his own words, as the holy Zohar, III 261a, teaches; see also Megillah 31b.** וְהַיְינוּ דְּמִשְׁנֵה תּוֹרָה הוּא מִשּׁוֹרֶשׁ תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה, **— Deuteronomy comes from the root of the Oral Torah,** שֶׁאָמַר מֹשֶׁה רַבֵּינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם אַחַר הַקִּלְקוּל, לְתַקֵּן ה״רָב כָּעַס״ שֶׁיִּהְיֶה כּוּלּוֹ טוֹב. **— spoken by Moshe our teacher, peace be upon him, after the corruption, to repair "abundant anger" and make it entirely good.** וְכֵן כָּתַב בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ (שָׁם): תּוֹרָה שֶׁבִּכְתָב וְשֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה, וְהוּא אִקְרֵי תּוֹרָה וּמִשְׁנֵה תּוֹרָה.[1784] **— The holy Zohar there likewise writes: "Written and Oral Torah, called Torah and Mishneh Torah."** וּבוֹ נִכְתְּבוּ הַלּוּחוֹת שְׁנַיִם שֶׁיֵּשׁ בָּהֶן מִדְרָשׁ הֲלָכוֹת וְאַגָּדוֹת, **— It records the second tablets, which contain midrash, halakhot, and aggadot,** וְהַיְינוּ אַחַר הַקִּלְקוּל, שֶׁנִּצְטָרֵךְ לְתַקֵּן ה״רָב כָּעַס״. **— corresponding to the state after the corruption, when "abundant anger" must be repaired.** וְלָכֵן הִתְחִיל הַמִּשְׁנֶה תּוֹרָה בְּאֶחָד בְּשָׁבָט, שֶׁנּוֹצַר בְּאוֹת צ׳, שֶׁזּוֹכֶה בּוֹ לְאוֹר כִּי טוֹב, כְּדִכְתִיב אוֹר זָרוּעַ לַצַּדִּיק.[1785] **— Deuteronomy therefore began on the first of Shevat, the month formed through tzadi, when one merits the light "that it was good," as it says, "Light is sown for the righteous."** וְזֶה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר הוֹאִיל מֹשֶׁה בֵּאֵר אֶת הַתּוֹרָה, וּפֵירֵשׁ רַבִּי שְׁלֹמֹה יִצְחָקִי וּמִדְרַשׁ תַּנְחוּמָא: בְּשִׁבְעִים לָשׁוֹן,[1786, 1787] **— Thus, "Moshe undertook to explain the Torah"; Rashi and Midrash Tanchuma explain: in seventy languages.** וְכָתְבוּ דִּנְלָמֵד מִדִּכְתִיב בְּפָרְשַׁת תָּבֹא בַּאֵר הֵיטֵב,[1788] **— They write that this is derived from "explain thoroughly" in the portion Ki Tavo:** הֵיטֵ״ב מְתֻגָּלֵל בְּצֵירוּפוֹ ע׳: ה, הי, היט, היטב. **— The cumulative letter combinations of heitev total seventy: heh; heh-yod; heh-yod-tet; heh-yod-tet-bet.** וְיִתָּכֵן שֶׁמְּרַמֵּז עַל שִׁבְעִים פָּנִים לַתּוֹרָה שֶׁהִוזְכַּר בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ (חֶלֶק א מז ב וּשְׁאָר מְקוֹמוֹת) וּבְתִיקּוּנֵי זוֹהַר.[1789] **— It may allude to the seventy faces of Torah mentioned in the holy Zohar, I 47b and elsewhere, and in Tikkunei Zohar.**

Rain and the Welling Forth of Oral Torah

וְזֶה שֶׁאָמַר: בְּאֶחָד בִּשְׁבָט רֹאשׁ הַשָּׁנָה לָאִילָן. אִילָן נִקְרָא עֵץ הַדַּעַת טוֹב וָרָע,[1790] **— Thus, "The first of Shevat is the New Year for the tree": "Tree" refers to the Tree of Knowledge of Good and Evil,** וְהַיְינוּ אַחַר שֶׁנִּתְגַּדֵּל הַנְּטִיעָה לְהוֹצִיא פֵּירוֹת, שֶׁנִּקְרָא אִילָן, וְזֶהוּ כְּמוֹ שֶׁנִּבְרָא בְּנִיסָן. **— after the planting has grown to produce fruit and is called**

[1780] **Genesis 1:4**: 'Genesis 1: 4: 'God saw that the light was good, and God separated the light from the darkness.''

[1781] **Deuteronomy 1:3**: "It was in the fortieth year, in the eleventh month, on the first of the month, that Moshe spoke to the children of Israel according to all that Hashem had commanded him concerning them."

[1782] **Zohar, Vaetchanan 5:22**: 'Zohar, Vaetchanan (III:261a): "There is the Written Torah and the Oral Torah—the Written Torah is called 'Torah' (Tiferet), and the Oral Torah is called 'Mishneh Torah' (Malchut), revealed in the month of Shevat."'

[1783] **Megillah 31b:8**: "Abaye said: They taught that one must not interrupt only concerning the curses in Toras Kohanim, Leviticus. But one may interrupt the curses in Mishneh Torah, Deuteronomy. Why? The former are spoken in the plural, and Moshe spoke them from the mouth of the Almighty; the latter are spoken in the singular, and Moshe spoke them on his own authority."

[1784] **Zohar, Vaetchanan 5:22**: 'Zohar, Vaetchanan (III:261a): "There is the Written Torah and the Oral Torah—the Written Torah is called 'Torah' (Tiferet), and the Oral Torah is called 'Mishneh Torah' (Malchut), revealed in the month of Shevat."'

[1785] **Psalms 97:11**: "Light is sown for the righteous, and joy for the upright in heart."

[1786] **Deuteronomy 1:5**: "Across the Jordan, in the land of Moav, Moshe began to expound this Torah, saying:"

[1787] **Rashi on Deuteronomy 1:5**: ""He explained the Torah"—he explained it to them in seventy languages."

[1788] **Deuteronomy 27:8**: 'And on those stones you shall inscribe every word of this Teaching most distinctly.'

[1789] **Zohar, Bereshit 75:178**: "By "great goodness" in this verse is meant the stored-up blessing, and by "those that fear Thee", those that fear sin. "Thou hast wrought for them that trust in Thee": the implied object of "wrought" is the work of creation.' R. Abba says, it is the Garden of Eden, which God has cunningly wrought upon the earth after the supernal pattern for the righteous to seize and hold ; hence it is written "before the sons of men", since this one is in the presence of men, while the other is in the presence of the holy angels. R. Simeon said: 'The Garden of Eden above is said to be "before the sons of men" because in it are gathered the righteous who perform the will of their Master'."

[1790] **Mishnah Rosh Hashanah 1:1**: "There are four new years. On the first of Nisan is the new year for kings and festivals. On the first of Elul is the new year for the tithe of animals. Rabbi Elazar and Rabbi Shimon say: On the first of Tishrei. On the first of Tishrei is the new year for years, Sabbatical years, Jubilee years, planting, and vegetables. On the first of Shevat is the new year for the tree, according to Beis Shammai. Beis Hillel say: On the fifteenth of that month."

a tree, corresponding to the actual creation in Nisan. וּלְתַקֵּן זֶה שֶׁיִּהְיֶה רַק מִסִּטְרָא דְּטוֹב, הַזְּמַן בִּשְׁבָט, שֶׁנּוֹצַר בְּאוֹת צ׳. **— The time to repair it so that it belongs entirely to the side of good is Shevat, formed through the letter tzadi.** וְעִיקַּר הַתִּיקּוּן עַל יְדֵי אוֹר דְּתוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה. **— The essential repair comes through the light of the Oral Torah.** וְזֶה שֶׁאָמַר בַּגְּמָרָא (רֹאשׁ הַשָּׁנָה יד.) בְּמַעֲמָא: הוֹאִיל וְיָצְאוּ רוֹב גִּשְׁמֵי שָׁנָה.[1791] **— Rosh Hashanah 14a gives the reason: "Since most of the year's rains have already fallen."** וְהַמְכוּוָן עַל פִּי מַה שֶּׁכָּתוּב בְּסֵפֶר עֲבוֹדַת יִשְׂרָאֵל, דְּיוֹם הַגְּשָׁמִים שֶׁהוּזְכַּר לִשְׁבַח בַּגְּמָרָא (תַּעֲנִית ז) מְרַמֵּז עַל שְׁמִינִי עֲצֶרֶת.[1792, 1793] **— The intention follows Avodat Yisrael: The day of rain praised in Taanit 7 alludes to Shemini Atzeret.** וְהַיְינוּ דְּבְחַג מְרַצִּין עַל הַמַּיִם, וְאֵין מַיִם אֶלָּא תּוֹרָה.[1794] **— On Sukkot, we seek favor concerning water, and water represents Torah.** וּשְׁמִינִי עֲצֶרֶת אִיתָא (תִּיקּוּנֵי זוֹהַר תִּיקּוּן יג): שְׁמִינִי עֲצֶרֶת בִּפְנֵי עַצְמוֹ, בֵּיהּ נְבִיעוּ דְּאוֹרַיְיתָא, עַיֵּין שָׁם.[1795] **— Tikkunei Zohar, Tikkun 13, teaches: "Shemini Atzeret stands on its own; within it is the welling forth of Torah." See there.** וְהוּא וְאַף דְּגֶשֶׁם מְרַמֵּז תָּמִיד לַתּוֹרָה שֶׁבִּכְתָב, וּכְמָה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר הָאוֹר זָרוּעַ לַצַּדִּיק.[1796] **— This is the "light sown for the righteous."** יַעֲרוֹף כַּמָּטָר לִקְחִי,[1797] **— Rain usually alludes to the Written Torah, as it says, "May my teaching drop like rain":** וְהַיְינוּ הַתּוֹרָה שֶׁבִּכְתָב, שֶׁנִּיכָּר שֶׁבָּא מֵהַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרֵךְ, כְּמָטָר שֶׁנִּרְאֶה שֶׁיּוֹרֵד מֵהַשָּׁמַיִם. **— The Written Torah visibly comes from Hashem, blessed be He, like rain seen descending from heaven.** תִּזַּל כַּטַּל אִמְרָתִי, הַתּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה שֶׁנּוֹבַעַ בְּלֵב חֲכָמִים,[1798] **— "May my utterance flow like dew" is the Oral Torah, welling forth in the hearts of the sages.** וְזֶהוּ אֲמִירָה בַּחֲשַׁאי, כְּמָה דְּאַתְּ אָמַר וְאָמַרְתָּ בִּלְבָבֶךָ (זוֹהַר חֵלֶק א רלד ב),[1799, 1800] **— This is a silent utterance, as in "You shall say in your heart," explained in the Zohar, I 234b.** וְזֶה נִמְשָׁל כְּטַל, שֶׁאֵינוֹ נִיכָּר וְנִרְאֶה לָעַיִן יְרִידָתוֹ מִשָּׁמַיִם (וְנִתְבָּאֵר כַּמָּה פְּעָמִים),[1801] **— It is compared to dew, whose descent from heaven is not perceptible to the eye, as explained several times.** וְכָאן רוֹמֵז גְּשָׁמִים עַל תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה. **— Here, however, rain**

[1791] **Rosh Hashanah 14a:9**: "'On the first of Shevat is the new year for the tree.' What is the reason? Rabbi Elazar said in Rabbi Oshaya's name: Because most of the year's rains have already fallen, even though most of the winter season still lies ahead."

[1792] **Avodat Yisrael, Sefer Devarim, Shemini Atzeret 1**: "In tractate Taanit: "The day of rain is as great as the day on which the Torah was given, as it is stated, 'May my teaching drop like rain.' 'Teaching' means Torah, as it is stated, 'For I have given you a good teaching.' Rava says: It is greater than the day on which the Torah was given, as it is stated, 'May my teaching drop like rain.' Which is compared to which? The lesser is compared to the greater." Thus far the quotation. This alludes to the festival day of Shemini Atzeret. They called it "the day of rain" because on it we recite the blessing mentioning "He causes the rain to fall," and the aspect of falling rain comes about. Midrash Tanhuma, in the portion Pinhas, states that Shemini Atzeret ought to have been fifty days after the festival, just as there are fifty days from Passover to Atzeret. But the Holy One, blessed be He, said: "It is winter, and they cannot leave their homes to come here. Rather, while they are with Me, let them observe Atzeret." From where is this learned? From the passage we read: "On the eighth day there shall be an assembly." Thus far the quotation. From this we can understand that from the first day of Sukkot until Shemini Atzeret we must carry out the spiritual repairs that we perform from Passover until Atzeret during the days of counting, to repair the Tree of Life. Presumably those with understanding recognize one path for both sets of days. It would likewise have been fitting to accomplish this over seven weeks, but the Holy One, blessed be He, had compassion on them, as stated above in the Midrash. This is what the Sages hinted at: "The day of rain"—Shemini Atzeret—"is as great as the day on which the Torah was given," which is the festival of Shavuot. Rava, however, disagrees and says that its level is greater, for on it forty-eight drops drip down, as is known."

[1793] **Taanit 7a:3**: "Rav Yehudah said: The day of rain is as great as the day on which Torah was given, as it says, 'My teaching shall drop like rain.' 'Teaching' means Torah, as it says, 'For I have given you good teaching; do not forsake My Torah.' Rava said: It is greater than the day on which Torah was given, as it says, 'My teaching shall drop like rain.' Which is compared to which? You must say that the lesser is compared to the greater."

[1794] **Rosh Hashanah 16a:15**: "Why did the Torah say to pour a water libation on Sukkos? The Holy One, blessed be He, said: 'Pour water before Me on Sukkos so that the year's rains may be blessed for you. And recite before Me on Rosh Hashanah verses of kingship, remembrance, and the shofar: Kingship, so that you may proclaim Me King over you; remembrance, so that your remembrance may rise before Me favorably. And through what? Through the shofar.'"

[1795] **Tikkunei Zohar 29b:3**: "Shemini Atzeres is a festival in its own right. Within it is the wellspring of Torah, watering the tree planted in the garden. Its roots and branches are like the circle of the earth, around which all the festivals revolve."

[1796] **Psalms 97:11**: "Light is sown for the righteous, and joy for the upright in heart."

[1797] **Deuteronomy 32:2**: 'May my discourse come down as the rain,My speech distill as the dew,Like showers on young growth,Like droplets on the grass.'

[1798] **Deuteronomy 32:2**: 'May my discourse come down as the rain,My speech distill as the dew,Like showers on young growth,Like droplets on the grass.'

[1799] **Deuteronomy 8:17**: 'and you say to yourselves, "My own power and the might of my own hand have won this wealth for me."'

[1800] **Zohar, Vayechi 53:517-518**: "When Jacob called his sons, Abraham and Isaac were there and the Shekinah with them, rejoicing in Jacob, and in the prospect of joining the patriarchs and forming with them a chariot. When Jacob said to his sons, "I will tell you what will befall you in the latter end of days", a kind of sadness came over him and the Shekinah departed. His sons, however, raised their voices and said, "Hear, O Israel, etc.", and Jacob answered, "Blessed be the name of his glorious kingdom for ever and ever", and on this proclamation of the unity the Shekinah returned to its place. AND JACOB CALLED. The word 'called' signifies that he established them in their place above and below."

[1801] **Hosea 14:6**: 'I will be to Israel like dew;He shall blossom like the lily,He shall strike root like a Lebanon tree.'

alludes to the Oral Torah. רַק הוּא דִּכְתִיב לֶקַח טוֹב נָתַתִּי לָכֶם, וְהַיְינוּ עֵץ הַדַּעַת טוֹב, לִוחוֹת שְׁנִיוֹת,[1802] **— For it says, "I have given you a good teaching": This is the Tree of Knowledge of Good, the second tablets,** שֶׁכָּלוּל בָּהֶם כָּל הַתּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה, כָּאָמוּר מֵהַמִּדְרָשׁ, וְהוּא גַּם כֵּן לֶקַח, וְנִכְלָל בְּמַה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר יַעֲרוֹף כַּמָּטָר לִקְחִי.[1803] **— which include the entire Oral Torah, as the Midrash teaches. This too is "teaching," included in "May my teaching drop like rain."** וְזֶה שֶׁאָמַר שֶׁיָּצְאוּ רוֹב גִּשְׁמֵי שָׁנָה, נְבִיעוּ דְּאוֹרַיְיתָא שֶׁנִּכְלַל בַּתּוֹרָה שֶׁבִּכְתָב בִּלוּחוֹת שְׁנִיוֹת, **— "Most of the year's rains have fallen" thus refers to the welling forth of Torah included in the Written Torah through the second tablets.** וְזֶהוּ לֶקַח טוֹב, שֶׁנִּכְלַל בָּהֶם אוֹרַיְיתָא מִסְּטָרָא דְּטוֹב, וְהוּא הַטּוֹב שֶׁבְּעֵץ הַדַּעַת, **— This is "a good teaching": They contain Torah from the side of good, the good within the Tree of Knowledge,** וְהוּא כּוֹלֵל כָּל שָׁרְשֵׁי תוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה, אוֹר כִּי טוֹב.[1804] **— including all the roots of the Oral Torah, the light "that it was good."**

Shammai and Hillel as Judgment and Mercy

וְנֶחְלְקוּ בָּזֶה בֵּית שַׁמַּאי וּבֵית הִלֵּל, וְשׁוֹרֶשׁ מַחֲלוּקְתָּם, דְּשַׁמַּאי וְהִלֵּל נִקְרְאוּ בַּמִּשְׁנָה (עֵדֻיּוֹת פֶּרֶק א מִשְׁנָה ד) אָבוֹת הָעוֹלָם,[1805] **— Beit Shammai and Beit Hillel disagree here. Their disagreement is rooted in Shammai and Hillel's being called "fathers of the world" in Mishnah Eduyot 1:4,** וְכֵן בַּזוֹהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ (חֵלֶק ג עג א), אֲבָהָן דְּעָלְמָא.[1806] **— and likewise "fathers of the world" in the holy Zohar, III 73a.** וְהוּא עַל פִּי מַה שֶׁאָמְרוּ בְּרַעְיָא מְהֵימְנָא (שָׁם רמה א): הִלֵּל וְשַׁמַּאי דְּאַתְוון, חַד מִסְּטָרָא דְּרַחֲמֵי וְחַד מִסְּטָרָא דְּדִינָא וְכוּ'לְי, **— Raaya Mehemna there, 245a, addresses Hillel and Shammai: "One of you is from the side of mercy, the other from the side of judgment …"** דַּרְגִּין דְּאַבְרָהָם וְהִלֵּל מִדָּתוֹ חֶסֶד, וְשַׁמַּאי מִדָּתוֹ גְּבוּרָה, וְלָכֵן עַל פִּי רוֹב בֵּית יִצְחָק. **— These are the levels of Avraham and Yitzchak.** שַׁמַּאי לְהַחְמִיר וּבֵית הִלֵּל לְהָקֵל. **— Hillel's attribute is lovingkindness and Shammai's is might; therefore Beit Shammai generally rule strictly and Beit Hillel leniently.** רַק בָּהָאבוֹת, שֶׁהוֹרִיד הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרֵךְ נִשְׁמוֹת הָאָבוֹת לְתַקֵּן קִלְקוּל אָדָם הָרִאשׁוֹן (כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ בְּרֵאשִׁית רַבָּה פָּרָשָׁה יד),[1807] **— With the Patriarchs, however, Hashem, blessed be He, sent down their souls to repair Adam's corruption, as Bereshit Rabbah 14 teaches.** וּמִצַּד הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרֵךְ הַסֵּדֶר אָנֹכִי וְאַחַר כָּךְ לֹא יִהְיֶה, שֶׁבְּמַאֲמַר אָנֹכִי נִתְקַע תַּלְמוּד תּוֹרָה בְּלִבָּם, וּבְדִבּוּר לֹא יִהְיֶה נֶעֱקָר יֵצֶר הָרָע מִלִּבָּם (כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ שִׁיר הַשִּׁירִים רַבָּה).[1808] **— "I am" fixed Torah learning in their hearts; "You shall have no other gods" uprooted the evil inclination, as Shir HaShirim Rabbah teaches.** וְלָכֵן נִבְרָא אַבְרָהָם וְאַחַר כָּךְ יִצְחָק, וְכֵן נֶאֱמַר עוֹלָם חֶסֶד יִבָּנֶה, וְכֵן בָּעוֹלָם הַזֶּה הֲלָכָה כְּבֵית הִלֵּל.[1809] **— Avraham therefore came before Yitzchak. So it says, "The world is built through lovingkindness"; likewise, in this world the law follows Beit Hillel.** אֲבָל מִצַּד הָאָדָם, מָה הַשֵּׁם שׁוֹאֵל כִּי אִם לְיִרְאָה, וְאַחַר כָּךְ בָּא הָאַהֲבָה מֵהַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרֵךְ,[1810] **— From the human side, however, "What does Hashem ask … but to fear?" Afterward comes love from Hashem, blessed be He,** שֶׁכֵּן דַּרְכּוֹ שֶׁל אִישׁ וְכוּ'לְי, כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ בְּשֵׁם רַבִּינוּ רַבִּי בֶּעֱר זֶכֶר צַדִּיק וְקָדוֹשׁ לִבְרָכָה.[1811] **— for "it is a man's way …," as we explained in the name of our**

[1802] **Proverbs 4:2**: 'For I give you good instruction;Do not forsake my teaching.'

[1803] **Deuteronomy 32:2**: 'May my discourse come down as the rain,My speech distill as the dew,Like showers on young growth,Like droplets on the grass.'

[1804] **Genesis 1:4**: 'Genesis 1: 4: 'God saw that the light was good, and God separated the light from the darkness.''

[1805] **Mishnah Eduyot 1:4**: 'And why do they record the opinions of Shammai and Hillel for naught? To teach the following generations that a man should not always persist in his opinion, for behold, the fathers of the world did not persist in their opinion.'

[1806] **Zohar, Achrei Mot 50:305-306**: "Therefore the Torah is the support of all and the link that binds all in faith, and he who is circumcised is attached to that link and he who is not circumcised is not. Of such it is written, "No stranger shall eat of the holy thing" (Lev. 22, 10), for an unclean spirit comes from his side and mingles itself with the holiness. Blessed be the Merciful One who has separated Israel from them and their uncleanness.' R. Eleazar then came and kissed his hands. R. Hizkiah said: 'It is written, "God will not forsake his people for the sake of his great name" (I Sam. 12, 22), since Israel is linked to God, and by what? By the holy impress on their flesh."

[1807] **Bereshit Rabbah 14:6** (excerpt): "Why does Scripture call Abraham 'great'? Because he deserved to be created before Adam. But the Holy One, blessed be He, said: Perhaps he will bring corruption, and there will be no one to come and repair it in his place. Rather, I will create Adam first, so that if he brings corruption, Abraham will come and repair it in his place."

[1808] **Shir HaShirim Rabbah 1:2:4** (excerpt): "Rabbi Yehudah says: When Israel heard 'I am Hashem your God' (Exodus 20:2), Torah study became firmly fixed in their hearts; they would learn and not forget. … Rabbi Nechemyah said: When Israel heard 'You shall have no other gods' (Exodus 20:3), the evil inclination was uprooted from their hearts."

[1809] **Psalms 89:3**: 'I declare, "Your steadfast love is confirmed forever;there in the heavens You establish Your faithfulness."'

[1810] **Deuteronomy 10:12**: 'Deuteronomy 10: 12: 'And now, O Israel, what does the ETERNAL your God demand of you? Only this: to revere the ETERNAL your God, to walk only in divine paths, to love and to serve the ETERNAL your God with all your heart and soul,''

[1811] **Kiddushin 2b:13**: "Alternatively, this follows Rabbi Shimon's view. For it was taught: Rabbi Shimon says: Why did the Torah say, 'When a man takes a woman,' rather than, 'When a woman is taken by a man'? Because it is the way of a

teacher Rabbi Ber, may the memory of the righteous and holy be a blessing. וְזֶה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר סוּר מֵרָע וַעֲשֵׂה טוֹב. וְלָכֵן הוּזְכַּר בְּכָל מָקוֹם (לְבַד בְּמָקוֹמוֹת מְיוּחָדִים שֶׁיֵּשׁ לוֹמַר טַעַם) שַׁמַּאי וְאַחַר כָּךְ הִלֵּל (וְנִתְבָּאֵר חֲנוּכָּה מַאֲמָר ח).[1812, 1813] — **Thus, "Turn from evil and do good." Shammai is therefore always mentioned before Hillel, apart from particular exceptions that can be explained, as discussed in Chanukah, teaching 8.**

The First of Shevat and the Full Moon

וְכָן נֶחְלְקוּ כָּאן, שֶׁמְּדַבֵּר מֵעִיקַּר הַתִּיקּוּן מִצַּד כְּנֶסֶת יִשְׂרָאֵל, סִיהֲרָא דִּמְקַבְּלָא מִשִּׁמְשָׁא, שֶׁעַל זֶה מְרַמֵּז אִילָ"ן, גִּימַטְרִיָּא שְׁנֵי בַּשֵּׁמוֹת, כָּאָמוּר. — **Their disagreement here concerns the essential repair from the side of Knesset Yisrael, the moon receiving from the sun, alluded to by ilan, whose numerical value equals the two names, as explained.** וְאָמְרוּ בְּאֶחָד בִּשְׁבָט, שֶׁמַּתְחִיל הַזְּרִיחָה רַק קְצָת מֵהַלְּבָנָה, רֹאשׁ הַשָּׁנָה לָאִילָן כִּדְבְרֵי בֵית שַׁמַּאי.[1814] — **Thus, the New Year for the tree falls on the first of Shevat according to Beit Shammai, when the moon has only begun to shine a little.** וּבֵית הִלֵּל אוֹמְרִים בְּט"ו בּוֹ, שֶׁהַסִּיהֲרָא בְּאַשְׁלְמוּתָא.[1815] — **Beit Hillel say the fifteenth, when the moon is full.**

Shammai and Hillel Sanctify Daily Eating

וְאָזְדוּ לְטַעֲמַיְיהוּ, דִּפְלִיגִי (בֵּיצָה טז א), דְּשַׁמַּאי כָּל יָמָיו הָיָה אוֹכֵל לִכְבוֹד שַׁבָּת וְכוּלֵי.[1816] — **They follow their respective approaches in Beitzah 16a: Shammai ate in honor of Shabbat all his days …** וְהַיְינוּ דְּשַׁמַּאי לְפִי מַדְרֵגָתוֹ, דַּרְגָּא דְּפַחַד יִצְחָק, לֹא הָיָה מַאֲמִין בְּעַצְמוֹ,[1817] — **At his spiritual level, that of the Fear of Yitzchak, Shammai did not trust himself,** שֶׁמָּא אֵינוֹ מִתְכַּוֵּין בַּאֲכִילָתוֹ לְשֵׁם שָׁמַיִם, וְרָצָה לְהַכְנִיס קְדוּשָּׁה בַּאֲכִילָתוֹ, שֶׁיִּהְיֶה אֲכִילָה דְּמִצְוָה לִכְבוֹד שַׁבָּת, שֶׁאִם מָצָא אַחֶרֶת נָאָה הֵימֶנָּה, אוֹכֵל זוֹ, שֶׁיּוּשְׁאַר הַשְּׁנִיָּה לִכְבוֹד שַׁבָּת, אֲבָל בְּלֹא הָכִי לֹא הָיָה אוֹכֵל בָּשָׂר. — **perhaps his eating was not for Heaven's sake. He wanted to bring holiness into his eating, making it a mitzvah in honor of Shabbat. If he found a finer animal, he ate the first so that the second would remain for Shabbat; otherwise, he would not eat meat.**

Hillel's care for the soul and clarity of judgment

אֲבָל הִלֵּל הַזָּקֵן מִדָּה אַחֶרֶת הָיְתָה לוֹ, שֶׁכָּל מַעֲשָׂיו לְשֵׁם שָׁמַיִם וְכוּלֵי.[1818] — **Hillel the Elder had a different approach: All**

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man to seek a woman, whereas it is not the way of a woman to seek a man. It is comparable to a person who has lost an object: Who seeks whom? The owner of the lost object seeks his lost object."

[1812] **Psalms 34:15**: 'Shun evil and do good,seek amity and pursue it.'

[1813] **Peri Tzadik, Chanukah 8:1**: "From God's side, the order is the quality of Abraham and afterward the quality of Isaac. The root of Abraham's quality is love, as it says, "Abraham, who loved Me"; love brings eagerness in fulfilling positive commandments. Isaac's quality, "the fear of Isaac," is awe, which brings care in observing prohibitions, as we have explained from the Jerusalem Talmud, in Chayei Sarah, teaching 7. From God's side, the order is "I am" and afterward "You shall have no other": God bestows holiness and Torah upon "the wise person's heart at his right," and through this evil is uprooted from "the fool's heart at his left." As Shir HaShirim Rabbah, on "Let him kiss me," states: when they heard the utterance "I am," Torah study became fixed in their hearts; when they heard "You shall have no other," the evil inclination was uprooted from their hearts. "I am" is the root of all positive commandments and Torah teachings, while "You shall have no other" is the root of the prohibitions. Thus, from God's side, Abraham's soul comes first and afterward Isaac's; likewise, a heavenly voice proclaimed that the halakhah follows Beit Hillel, who belong to Abraham's level. From the human side, however, the order is "Turn from evil" and afterward "Do good." To attain Torah, awe must come first, enabling one to turn from evil; this is the quality of our father Isaac, peace be upon him. Thus Beit Shammai are always mentioned before Beit Hillel."

[1814] **Mishnah Rosh Hashanah 1:1**: "There are four new years. On the first of Nisan is the new year for kings and festivals. On the first of Elul is the new year for the tithe of animals. Rabbi Elazar and Rabbi Shimon say: On the first of Tishrei. On the first of Tishrei is the new year for years, Sabbatical years, Jubilee years, planting, and vegetables. On the first of Shevat is the new year for the tree, according to Beis Shammai. Beis Hillel say: On the fifteenth of that month."

[1815] **Mishnah Rosh Hashanah 1:1**: "There are four new years. On the first of Nisan is the new year for kings and festivals. On the first of Elul is the new year for the tithe of animals. Rabbi Elazar and Rabbi Shimon say: On the first of Tishrei. On the first of Tishrei is the new year for years, Sabbatical years, Jubilee years, planting, and vegetables. On the first of Shevat is the new year for the tree, according to Beis Shammai. Beis Hillel say: On the fifteenth of that month."

[1816] **Beitzah 16a:4**: "It was taught: They said of Shammai the Elder that all his days he ate in honor of Shabbos. If he found a fine animal, he would say, 'This is for Shabbos.' If he found another finer than it, he would set aside the second and eat the first."

[1817] **Genesis 31:42**: "Had the God of my father—the God of Avraham and the Fear of Yitzchak—not been with me, you would now have sent me away empty-handed. God has seen my affliction and the labor of my hands, and He gave judgment last night."

[1818] **Dover Tzedek, Kuntres Dover Tzedek, Eruvin 3:2**: "The sages said in Sanhedrin 93b: "Hashem is with him"—the halakhah follows him. To arrive at the halakhah's truth, a person must be holy within and Hashem must truly be with him, without any concern for his own bodily interest. He can then arrive at the true halakhah. This is Hillel's level, for he said, "Blessed is Hashem day by day," and so forth, as stated in Beitzah 16a; Vayikra Rabbah, chapter 34, says that he went to do kindness for this poor soul. His bodily needs were truly regarded by him as those of a stranger. Shammai, by contrast, needed to bring holiness into each food he ate each day through the honor of Shabbat; he did not regard eating

his actions were for Heaven's sake … וְהוּא עַל פִּי מַה שֶׁאָמְרוּ (וַיִּקְרָא רַבָּה פָּרָשָׁה לד): הִלֵּל הַזָּקֵן וְכוּ׳, לִגְמוֹל חֶסֶד עִם הָאֹרֵחַ בְּתוֹךְ בֵּיתוֹ, הָדַיִן אַכְסַנְיָא בְּגוֹ בֵּיתָא וְכוּ׳.[1819] — **Vayikra Rabbah 34 relates that Hillel the Elder went "to do kindness for the guest inside the house …"** וְהָדַיִן נַפְשָׁא עֲלוֹבְתָא, לָאו אַכְסַנְיָא הִיא? עַיֵּין שָׁם. — **"Is not this poor soul a guest?" See there.** וְהַיְינוּ שֶׁלֹּא עָלָה עַל דַּעְתּוֹ שׁוּם הֲנָאַת הַגּוּף, רַק כְּמוֹ שֶׁמַּאֲכִיל לְאַכְסַנְיָא, — **No bodily pleasure entered his mind; it was simply like feeding a guest,** וְהַיְינוּ לְקִיּוּם הַנֶּפֶשׁ, שֶׁהוּא עַל יְדֵי אֲכִילָה, — **maintaining the soul, which depends on eating.** וּכְמוֹ בְּיַעֲקֹב אָבִינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם, שֶׁלֹּא יָדַע כְּלָל מֵהֲרְגֵּשׁ הֲנָאַת הַגּוּף, וּכְאָדָם הָרִאשׁוֹן קוֹדֶם הַקִּלְקוּל, — **So it was with Yaakov our father, peace be upon him, who knew no sensation of bodily pleasure, like Adam before the corruption.** וְעַל כֵּן אָמַר מַה שֶּׁקַּל שֶׁבַּקַּלִּים אֵינוֹ אוֹמֵר (וּכְמוֹ שֶׁנִּתְבָּאֵר כַּמָּה פְּעָמִים).[1820] — **He therefore said what even the most frivolous person would not say, as explained several times.**

Shevat and the Work of Holy Eating

וְחוֹדֶשׁ שְׁבָט שֶׁנּוֹצַר בְּאוֹת צ׳ בִּלְעִיטָה, שֶׁהָעֵסֶק בּוֹ לְתַקֵּן הָאֲכִילָה שֶׁיִּהְיֶה בִּקְדוּשָּׁה,[1821] — **Shevat was formed through tzadi in swallowing; its work is to repair eating so that it is holy,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר צַדִּיק אוֹכֵל לְשׂוֹבַע נַפְשׁוֹ, כְּמוֹ הִלֵּל, גּוֹמֵל נַפְשׁוֹ אִישׁ חָסֶד, לִגְמוֹל חֶסֶד עִם הָדַיָּן נַפְשָׁא עֲלוֹבְתָא.[1822, 1823] — **as it says, "The righteous eats to satisfy his soul." Like Hillel, "a kind man does kindness to his soul," caring for this poor soul.** וּכְשֶׁמְּתַקֵּן הָאֲכִילָה שֶׁיִּהְיֶה בִּקְדוּשָּׁה, נִיצּוֹל מִכָּל קְטָרוּג הַיֵּצֶר הָרָע, דְּשִׁלְּיטָתוֹ עַל יְדֵי אֲכִילָה, — **When one repairs eating so that it is holy, one is saved from every accusation of the evil inclination, whose power operates through eating,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁנִּתְבָּאֵר (מַאֲמָר א) מִסִּפְרֵי וּגְמָרָא, וְכֵן הוּא בַּזּוֹהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ (חֶלֶק ב קנד ב).[1824] — **as explained in teaching 1 from Sifrei and the Gemara, and likewise in the holy Zohar, II 154b.** וּבַחוֹדֶשׁ הַזֶּה הַזְּמַן לְתַקֵּן שֶׁיִּהְיֶה הָאֲכִילָה רַק מִסִּטְרָא דְּטוֹב, — **This month is the time to repair eating so that it belongs entirely to the side of good.** וְאֵין טוֹב אֶלָּא צַדִּיק, כְּמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר אִמְרוּ צַדִּיק כִּי טוֹב, וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ (חֲגִיגָה יב.).[1825, 1826] — **"Good" means the tzaddik, as it says, "Say of the righteous that he is good," and as taught in Chagigah 12a.** וְאִיתָא בֵּית שַׁמַּאי: מֵחַד שַׁבְּתָא לְשַׁבְּתָא.[1827] — **Beit Shammai teach: "From the first day of your week, prepare for your Shabbat."** וְעַל כֵּן אָמְרוּ בְּאֶחָד בְּשַׁבָּט רֹאשׁ הַשָּׁנָה לָאִילָן, שֶׁרַק זְרִיחָה קְצָת יֵשׁ בּוֹ מֵהַלְּבָנָה,[1828] — **They therefore say the New Year for the tree is the first of Shevat, when there is only a little moonlight.** וְצָרִיךְ יְגִיעָה וְעָמָל לְתַקֵּן הָאֲכִילָה שֶׁיִּהְיֶה בִּקְדוּשָּׁה, וְכַעֲצַת שַׁמַּאי עַל יְדֵי קִדּוּשׁת שַׁבָּת. — **Effort and labor are needed to repair eating and make it holy, following Shammai's counsel, through**

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itself as a holy act of kindness."

Dover Tzedek uses the same Hillel–Shammai distinction within its explanation of why truthful halakhic judgment requires freedom from personal interest. This adds a consequence to the origin's account of holy eating: the quality expressed in caring for the soul also affects the clarity with which Torah is understood. The surrounding discussion requires actual purification of character, not merely a claim to selflessness.

[1819] **Vayikra Rabbah 34:3** (excerpt): "Another interpretation of 'A person of kindness does good to his soul': This is Hillel the Elder. When he took leave of his students, he would walk along with them. His students asked: Our teacher, where are you going? He replied: To do kindness for this guest within my house. They asked: Do you have a guest every day? He replied: Is not this poor soul a guest within the body? Today it is here; tomorrow it is not here."

[1820] **Rashi on Genesis 29:21:1**: "מלאו ימי MY DAYS ARE FULFILLED — which my mother told me to remain with you. And another explanation is: MY DAYS ARE FULFILLED for I am now eighty-four years old and when shall I beget twelve tribes? That is what he meant by adding "that I may go in unto her"; for surely even the commonest of people would not use such an expression. But he said this because his mind was intent upon having issue (to fulfil his mission of rearing children who would carry on the religious traditions of his fathers) (Genesis Rabbah 70:18)."

[1821] **Sefer Yetzirah Gra Version 5:10**: 'He made the letter Tzadi king over swallowing/taste (le'itah), bound a crown to it, and combined one with another; and with them He formed Aquarius (Deli) in the universe, Shevat in the year, and the gizzard (kurkevan) in the soul, male and female.'

[1822] **Proverbs 13:25**: 'A righteous person eats to the satisfaction of his soul, but the belly of the wicked will lack.'

[1823] **Proverbs 11:17**: 'A kindly man benefits himself;A cruel one makes trouble for himself.'

[1824] **Zohar, Terumah 47:515**: "Then he went on: ' "Thou shalt make a table." This table was here below for setting the shew-bread upon. Now, which was of greater import, the table or the bread? It might be thought that the bread was more important, since the table was needed to put the bread on, and besides, it was, in the very nature of things, beneath the bread. This, however, is not so: the table was the essential article, being, through its arrangement, the receptacle of blessing from above and of food for the whole universe. Indeed, from the secret influence of that Table emanated nourishment to the whole world, in proportion to the abundance poured out upon it from above."

[1825] **Isaiah 3:10**: '(Hail the righteous, for they shall fare well;They shall eat the fruit of their works.'

[1826] **Chagigah 12a:10**: "For whom did He hide the light away? For the righteous in the future to come, as it says, 'God saw that the light was good.' 'Good' means a righteous person, as it says, 'Say of the righteous that it is good.'"

[1827] **Beitzah 16a:5**: "Hillel the Elder, however, had a different practice: All his actions were for the sake of Heaven, as it says, 'Blessed is the Lord, day by day.' It was likewise taught: Beis Shammai say, 'From the first day of your week, prepare for your Shabbos.' Beis Hillel say, 'Blessed is the Lord, day by day.'"

[1828] **Mishnah Rosh Hashanah 1:1**: "There are four new years. On the first of Nisan is the new year for kings and festivals. On the first of Elul is the new year for the tithe of animals. Rabbi Elazar and Rabbi Shimon say: On the first of Tishrei. On the first of Tishrei is the new year for years, Sabbatical years, Jubilee years, planting, and vegetables. On the first of Shevat is the new year for the tree, according to Beis Shammai. Beis Hillel say: On the fifteenth of that month."

the holiness of Shabbat. וְזֶהוּ כְּדִבְרֵי בֵית שַׁמַּאי, כְּמִדָּתוֹ הַפַּחַד וְהַיִרְאָה, וְלֹא הֶאֱמִין בְּעַצְמוֹ. — **This follows Beit Shammai, reflecting Shammai's attribute of dread and fear, and his refusal to trust himself.** וּבֵית הִלֵּל אוֹמְרִים בְּט״ו בּוֹ, דְּהַיְינוּ דְּסִיהֲרָא בְּאַשְׁלְמוּתָא, שֶׁבַּחוֹדֶשׁ הַזֶּה הַתִּיקּוּן מִכֹּל וָכֹל, שֶׁיִּהְיֶה הָאֲכִילָה בִּקְדוּשָׁה, צַדִּיק אוֹכֵל לְשׂוֹבַע נַפְשׁוֹ, לִגְמוֹ חֶסֶד עִם הָנַפְשָׁא,[1829] — **Beit Hillel say the fifteenth, when the moon is full: This month's repair is then complete, so that eating is holy: "The righteous eats to satisfy his soul," doing kindness to this soul.** וְזֶה בָּרוּךְ הַשֵּׁם יוֹם יוֹם, כְּמוֹ שֶׁהָיָה בְּמַתַּן תּוֹרָה, שֶׁנֶּעֱקַר יֵצֶר הָרָע מִלִּבָּם,[1830] — **This is "Blessed is Hashem, day by day," as at the giving of the Torah, when the evil inclination was uprooted from their hearts,** וְנַעֲשָׂה הַכֹּל מַסְטָרָא דְּטוֹב, וּכְמוֹ יַעֲקֹב אָבִינוּ שֶׁהָיָה כְּאָדָם הָרִאשׁוֹן קוֹדֶם הַקִּלְקוּל. — **and everything belonged to the side of good, like Yaakov our father, who resembled Adam before the corruption.**

Shabbat Brings Repair and Redemption

The chief expression of holy eating is on Shabbat. וְזֶה שֶׁאָמְרוּ בַּגְּמָרָא וּמִדְרָשׁ וְעִיקַּר אֲכִילָה בִּקְדוּשָׁה הוּא בְּשַׁבָּת. — **Thus the Gemara, Midrash, and holy Zohar teach that through keeping Shabbat we are redeemed immediately,** וְזוֹהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ,[1831] דְּעַל יְדֵי שְׁמִירַת שַׁבָּת נִגְאָלִין מִיָּד, שֶׁמְּתַקְּנִים הַכֹּל, שֶׁיִּהְיֶה כְּמוֹ קוֹדֶם קִלְקוּל וּפְגַם הַנָּחָשׁ, — **for everything is repaired, becoming as it was before the serpent's corruption and damage,** וּכְמוֹ בְּיַעֲקֹב אָבִינוּ שֶׁלֹּא מֵת, כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ (תַּעֲנִית ה:), וְזֶהוּ מִיָּד נִגְאָלִין.[1832] — **like Yaakov our father, who did not die, as Taanit 5b teaches. This is immediate redemption.**

A holy meal can elevate other meals

Eating on Shabbat helps make all eating holy, וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמַרְנוּ, שֶׁבְּשַׁבָּת מוֹעִיל אֲכִילַת שַׁבָּת לְכָל הָאֲכִילוֹת שֶׁיִּהְיוּ בִּקְדוּשָׁה,[1833] — **as we explained: It resembles the showbread, which benefited all the priests' eating, as taught in the Zohar, II 154b.** וְכֵן עַל יְדֵי אֲכִילַת מִצְוָה מְתַקְּנִים שֶׁיִּהְיוּ כָּל הָאֲכִילוֹת בִּקְדוּשָׁה (כְּמוֹ שֶׁנִּתְבָּאֵר קוּנְטְרֵס עַת הָאוֹכֵל אוֹת ח).[1834] — **Likewise, eating as a mitzvah helps repair all eating, making it holy, as explained in the booklet Et HaOchel, section 8.**

Israel's Custom Sanctifies Every Fruit

Israel therefore customarily taste all kinds of fruit on this day. וְלָכֵן נוֹהֲגִים יִשְׂרָאֵל לְטָעוֹם כָּל מִינֵי פֵּירוֹת בְּיוֹם זֶה, — **Through Israel's custom, which is Torah, holiness is brought into eating,** וְהַיְינוּ שֶׁעַל יְדֵי מִנְהַג יִשְׂרָאֵל, שֶׁהוּא תּוֹרָה, מַכְנִיסִין קְדוּשָׁה לְהָאֲכִילָה, — **and all eating is**

[1829] **Proverbs 13:25**: 'A righteous person eats to the satisfaction of his soul, but the belly of the wicked will lack.'

[1830] **Psalms 68:20**: 'Blessed is my Sovereign,day by day supporting us—God, our deliverance. Selah.'

[1831] **Shabbat 118b:4**: "Rav Yehudah said in Rav's name: Had Israel observed the first Shabbos, no nation or tongue would have ruled over them, as it says, 'On the seventh day some of the people went out to gather,' and afterward it is written, 'Amalek came.' Rabbi Yochanan said in Rabbi Shimon ben Yochai's name: If Israel observed two Shabbosos according to their laws, they would immediately be redeemed, as it says, 'Thus says the Lord to the eunuchs who keep My Shabbosos,' and afterward, 'I shall bring them to My holy mountain,' and so forth."

[1832] **Taanit 5b:9**: "After they had eaten, Rav Yitzchak told Rav Nachman, 'This is what Rabbi Yochanan said: Our father Yaakov did not die.' He replied, 'Was it then for nothing that the eulogizers eulogized him, the embalmers embalmed him, and the buriers buried him?' He answered, 'I am expounding a verse, as it says, "Do not fear, My servant Yaakov, says the Lord, and do not be dismayed, Israel, for I shall save you from afar, and your descendants from the land of their captivity." The verse compares Yaakov with his descendants: Just as his descendants are alive, so he too is alive.'"

[1833] **Et HaOchel 8:1**: "Through one food and one meal in a week, or a Shabbat meal, eaten with the proper intention for Heaven's honor and to elevate the animal soul's powers to Hashem, all one's foods and meals are elevated. This resembles what the masters of the inner wisdom said about prayer: one prayer can elevate all the defective prayers of the year. Prayer resembles the offerings, and so does eating. Indeed, eating in holy purity has a greater quality than prayer, as I heard from the sages' statement concerning Isaac: if the Holy One provided for your offering, how much more so for your meal? It follows the saying, "The piggul intention (which disqualifies an offering) awoke like a sleeper": one kind finds its own kind and is reawakened. For in absolute truth, all of an Israelite's eating resembles the offerings; only when this is not made clear to the person through the intention of heart and mind is it like sleep, as in "When Hashem restores," and so forth, "we were like dreamers."

This is the exact Et HaOchel passage cited by the origin. It explains the custom's wider effect through an earlier act awakened by a later one, borrowing the image of a dormant intention becoming active again in Zevachim 31a. Here the later holy act awakens a connection that earlier permitted acts left unrecognized. The paragraph's continuation specifies permitted activity; it does not describe an actual prohibition as becoming permitted.

[1834] **Zohar, Terumah 47:515**: "Then he went on: ' "Thou shalt make a table." This table was here below for setting the shew-bread upon. Now, which was of greater import, the table or the bread? It might be thought that the bread was more important, since the table was needed to put the bread on, and besides, it was, in the very nature of things, beneath the bread. This, however, is not so: the table was the essential article, being, through its arrangement, the receptacle of blessing from above and of food for the whole universe. Indeed, from the secret influence of that Table emanated nourishment to the whole world, in proportion to the abundance poured out upon it from above."

thereby repaired and made holy. וּכְעֵין שֶׁמָּצִינוּ בַּעֲרָבָה, שֶׁהוּא מִנְהַג נְבִיאִים: חָבִיט חָבִיט וְלָא בָּרִיךְ (כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ סוּכָּה מד:).[1835] — **Similarly, the willow rite is a prophetic custom: "He struck it, struck it, and did not recite a blessing," as related in Sukkah 44b.** וְהֵיכָנוּ שֶׁהֵם לֹא צִיווּ לַעֲשׂוֹת כֵּן, רַק שֶׁנָּהֲגוּ לְטַעַם שֶׁיָּדְעוּ, וְאַחַר כָּךְ נָהֲגוּ אַחֲרֵיהֶן כָּל יִשְׂרָאֵל. — **The prophets did not command this; they practiced it for a reason they knew, and afterward all Israel followed their practice.** וְזֶה מוֹעִיל לְתַקֵּן אַף עֲרָבָה, שֶׁאֵין בּוֹ לֹא טַעַם וְלֹא רֵיחַ, וּמְרַמֵּז לְמִי שֶׁאֵין בּוֹ תּוֹרָה וְלֹא מַעֲשִׂים טוֹבִים, כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ (וַיִּקְרָא רַבָּה ל),[1836] — **This helps repair even the willow, which has neither taste nor fragrance, alluding to someone with neither Torah nor good deeds, as Vayikra Rabbah 30 teaches.** דִּכְשֶׁהֵן בַּאֲגוּדָּה אַחַת, מְרַצִּין אֵלּוּ עַל אֵלּוּ (וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ מֶנַחוֹת כז.).[1837] — **When bound into one bundle, they gain favor for one another, as Menachot 27a likewise teaches.** וְכָאן נִיתְקַן הָעֲרָבָה בְּעַצְמָהּ, וְזֶה נִיתְקַן עַל יְדֵי מִנְהָג. — **Here the willow itself is repaired, and that repair comes through custom.** וְכֵן מִנְהַג יִשְׂרָאֵל תּוֹרָה הִיא, שֶׁאִם אֵינָן נְבִיאִים, בְּנֵי נְבִיאִים הֵם (כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ פְּסָחִים סו.),[1838] וְהָוֶה מִנְהַג נְבִיאִים. — **Israel's custom likewise is Torah: "If they are not prophets, they are the children of prophets," as Pesachim 66a teaches; it thus becomes a prophetic custom.** וְיכוֹלִים לְהַכְנִיס עַל יְדֵי מִנְהַג יִשְׂרָאֵל קְדוּשָּׁה בְּכָל מִינֵי פֵּירוֹת, שֶׁיִּהְיֶה רַק מִסְּטְרָא דְּהָעֵץ הַחַיִּים, — **Through Israel's custom, holiness can be brought into every kind of fruit, so that it belongs entirely to the side of the Tree of Life.** וְיִתּוּקַן כָּל הָאֲכִילוֹת שֶׁיִּהְיוּ בִּקְדוּשָּׁה, צַדִּיק אוֹכֵל לְשׂוֹבַע נַפְשׁוֹ,[1839] — **All eating will be repaired and made holy: "The righteous eats to satisfy his soul,"** לְגָמוֹל חֶסֶד עִם הָדַּיִן נַפְשָׁא עֲלוּבְתָא, וְאָז נִגְאָלִין מִכֹּל כָּל בְּנִיסָן. — **to do kindness to this poor soul. Then we will be redeemed completely in Nisan.**

[1835] **Sukkah 44b:5**: "Ayvu said: I was standing before Rabbi Elazar bar Tzadok when a man brought a willow branch before him. He took it, beat it repeatedly, and did not recite a blessing, because he held that this was a custom of the prophets. Ayvu and Chizkiyah, Rav's daughter's sons, brought a willow branch before Rav. He beat it repeatedly and did not recite a blessing, because he held that it was a custom of the prophets."

[1836] **Vayikra Rabbah 30:12** (excerpt): "'Willows of the brook'—these are Israel. Just as the willow has neither taste nor fragrance, so there are people in Israel who have neither Torah nor good deeds. What does the Holy One, blessed be He, do for them? Destroying them is impossible. Rather, the Holy One says: Let them all be bound into one bundle, and they will atone for one another. If you do so, at that time I am exalted, as it is written, 'He builds His upper chambers in heaven' (Amos 9:6). When is He exalted? When they form one bundle, as it says, 'He founded His bundle upon the earth' (Amos 9:6). Therefore Moshe warns Israel: 'You shall take for yourselves on the first day.'"

[1837] **Menachot 27a:22-23**: "They raised an objection: Of the four species taken with the lulav, two produce fruit and two do not produce fruit. Those that produce fruit must be joined to those that do not, and those that do not produce fruit must be joined to those that do. A person does not fulfill his obligation with them until they are all in one bundle. So too with Israel's acceptance before God: They must all form one bundle, as it says, 'He builds His upper chambers in the heavens, and has founded His united company upon the earth.'"

[1838] **Pesachim 66a:7-8**: "They asked him, 'Rabbi, if someone forgot and did not bring his slaughtering knife before Shabbos, what is the law?' He answered them, 'I heard this halachah and have forgotten it. But leave Israel to act: If they are not prophets, they are the children of prophets.' The next day, one whose Pesach offering was a lamb stuck the knife in its wool; one whose offering was a goat stuck it between its horns. Hillel saw what they did and recalled the halachah. He said, 'This is the tradition I received from Shemayah and Avtalyon.'"

[1839] **Proverbs 13:25**: 'A righteous person eats to the satisfaction of his soul, but the belly of the wicked will lack.'

Tu BiShvat Ois 3

Tu BiShvat and the Holiness of the Land Everywhere

The connection to the Land can accompany Israel beyond its geographical borders.

Tu BiShvat and the Holiness of the Land Everywhere

Repairing Eating through the Fruit of Trees

כְּבָר אָמַרְנוּ דְּחוֹדֶשׁ שְׁבָט נוֹצַר בְּאוֹת צ׳ בִּלְעִיטָה, הַיְינוּ לְתַקֵּן שׁוֹרֶשׁ הַפֶּגֶם שֶׁהָיָה בַּאֲכִילָה,[1840] — **We have explained that Shevat was formed through tzadi governing swallowing, to repair the root of the damage caused through eating,** וְשֶׁיִּהְיֶה צַדִּיק אוֹכֵל לְשׂוֹבַע נַפְשׁוֹ.[1841] — **so that "the righteous person eats to satisfy his soul."** וְעַל כֵּן בִּשְׁבָט רֹאשׁ הַשָּׁנָה לָאִילָן, שֶׁבּוֹ הַזְּמַן לְתַקֵּן שֶׁיִּהְיֶה הָאֲכִילָה כַּאֲכִילַת אָדָם הָרִאשׁוֹן קוֹדֶם הַקִּלְקוּל, — **Therefore the tree's New Year falls in Shevat, the time to repair eating so that it resembles Adam's eating before the damage,** וְזֶה טַעַם לְמִנְהַג יִשְׂרָאֵל לְטָעוֹם שֶׁהָיָה רַק מִפְּרִי עֲצֵי הַגָּן. — **when he ate only the fruit of the garden's trees.** מִמַּפָּה מִינֵי פֵּירוֹת בְּט״ו בִּשְׁבָט, — **This explains Israel's custom to taste various kinds of fruit on the fifteenth of Shevat,** שֶׁהוּא רֹאשׁ הַשָּׁנָה לָאִילָן כְּבֵית הִלֵּל (רֵישׁ רֹאשׁ הַשָּׁנָה).[1842] — **the tree's New Year according to Beit Hillel, at the beginning of Rosh Hashanah.** וּלְגֵירְסַת הַגְּאוֹנִים: הְמָלִיךְ אוֹת צ׳ בְּהִרְהוּר, גַּם כֵּן הַמְכוּוָּן לְתַקֵּן פֶּגֶם הַנָּחָשׁ, — **The Geonic reading, "He made tzadi rule over contemplation," likewise means repairing the serpent's damage,** שֶׁהִכְנִיס הִרְהוּר מֻהֲנָאַת הַגּוּף, וְהַזְּמַן לְתַקֵּן שֶׁיִּהְיֶה צַדִּיק יְסוֹד עוֹלָם וְיִהְיֶה הַהִרְהוּר בְּדִבְרֵי תוֹרָה, — **which introduced thoughts of bodily pleasure. This is the time to become "the righteous person, the foundation of the world," and contemplate Torah,** (וְנִתְבָּאֵר רֹאשׁ חוֹדֶשׁ שְׁבָט מַאֲמָר ד). — **(as explained in Rosh Chodesh Shevat, Teaching 4).** אַךְ לִכְאוֹרָה יֵשׁ לְהָבִין, הָא טַעַם דִּשְׁבָט רֹאשׁ הַשָּׁנָה לָאִילָן הוּא מִפְּנֵי שֶׁיָּצְאוּ רוֹב גִּשְׁמֵי שָׁנָה, — **Yet this needs explanation. Shevat is the tree's New Year because most of the year's rain has fallen,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתַב בַּגְּמָרָא (שָׁם יד.), וְאָז זְמַן חֲנָטַת הַפֵּירוֹת (כְּמוֹ רַבִּינוּ שְׁלֹמֹה יִצְחָקִי).[1844, 1845] — **as the Gemara says there, 14a; the fruit then begins to form, as Rashi explains.** וְזֶהוּ רַק בְּאֶרֶץ יִשְׂרָאֵל, וְאֵיזוֹ טַעַם שֶׁיִּהְיֶה ט״ו בִּשְׁבָט רֹאשׁ הַשָּׁנָה לָאִילָן בְּחוּץ לָאָרֶץ? — **This applies only in the Land of Israel. Why should the fifteenth of Shevat be the tree's New Year outside the Land?** וּמִנְהַג יִשְׂרָאֵל לֶאֱכוֹל פֵּירוֹת בְּט״ו בִּשְׁבָט אַף בְּחוּץ לָאָרֶץ. — **Yet Israel's custom is to eat fruit on the fifteenth of Shevat even outside the Land.** וְאִם הָיוּ אוֹכְלִים פֵּירוֹת אֶרֶץ יִשְׂרָאֵל דַּוְקָא הָיָה מָקוֹם, אֲבָל הַמִּנְהָג לֶאֱכוֹל פֵּירוֹת חוּץ לָאָרֶץ. — **If they ate specifically fruit from the Land of Israel, this would make sense; but the custom is to eat fruit grown abroad.** גַּם כָּל עִנְיַן רֹאשׁ הַשָּׁנָה לָאִילָן הוּא לְעִנְיַן מַעֲשֵׂר, וְזֶה אֵינוֹ נוֹהֵג בְּפֵירוֹת חוּץ לָאָרֶץ. — **Moreover, the tree's New Year concerns tithing, which does not apply to fruit grown outside the Land.** וּמִנְהָג זֶה לֶאֱכוֹל פֵּירוֹת, אַף שֶׁלֹּא נִזְכַּר בַּסְּפָר לְמוֹרֵנוּ הָרַב מֹשֶׁה חָאגִיז, רַק בְּסֵפֶר מִלּוּבְּלִין זֶכֶר צַדִּיק וְקָדוֹשׁ לְבָרְכָה שֶׁהוּא אֶבָל מִנְהַג יִשְׂרָאֵל תּוֹרָה, וְאוֹמְרִים מֵהָרַב הַקָּדוֹשׁ הָרַבִּי מִלּוּבְּלִין זֶכֶר צַדִּיק וְקָדוֹשׁ לְבָרְכָה שֶׁהוּא עַצְמוֹ תּוֹרָה. — **Although this custom of eating fruit is not mentioned by earlier authorities, only in a book by our teacher Rabbi Moses Hagiz, Israel's custom is Torah. They say in the name of the holy Rabbi of Lublin, of righteous and holy memory, that it is itself Torah.** וּבְסִידּוּר הָרַב יֵשׁ שֶׁאֵין אוֹמְרִים תַּחֲנוּן בְּט״ו בִּשְׁבָט, וּבְוַדַּאי יֵשׁ מָקוֹם אַף בְּחוּץ לָאָרֶץ זֶה. — **The Rav's siddur states that Tachanun is not said on the fifteenth of Shevat; surely this has a basis outside the Land as well.**

Why Bless the Land while Living Abroad

אָכֵן מָצִינוּ בִּבְרַכַּת הַמָּזוֹן דִּכְתִיב: וְאָכַלְתָּ וְשָׂבָעְתָּ וּבֵרַכְתָּ וְגוֹמֵר, עַל הָאָרֶץ הַטּוֹבָה וְגוֹמֵר.[1846] — **Indeed, concerning Grace after Meals we find: "You shall eat, be satisfied, and bless," and so forth, "for the good Land."** וְכֵן חוֹתְמִין בִּבְרַכַּת הָאָרֶץ: עַל הָאָרֶץ וְעַל הַמָּזוֹן, וּבִבְרַכַּת מְעֵין שְׁלֹשָׁה: עַל הָאָרֶץ וְעַל הַפֵּירוֹת. — **Likewise, the blessing for the Land ends "for the Land and for the food"; the abridged threefold blessing ends "for the Land and**

[1840] **Sefer Yetzirah Gra Version 5:10**: 'He made the letter Tzadi king over swallowing/taste (le'itah), bound a crown to it, and combined one with another; and with them He formed Aquarius (Deli) in the universe, Shevat in the year, and the gizzard (kurkevan) in the soul, male and female.'

[1841] **Proverbs 13:25**: 'A righteous person eats to the satisfaction of his soul, but the belly of the wicked will lack.'

[1842] **Mishnah Rosh Hashanah 1:1**: "There are four new years. On the first of Nisan is the new year for kings and festivals. On the first of Elul is the new year for the tithe of animals. Rabbi Elazar and Rabbi Shimon say: On the first of Tishrei. On the first of Tishrei is the new year for years, Sabbatical years, Jubilee years, planting, and vegetables. On the first of Shevat is the new year for the tree, according to Beis Shammai. Beis Hillel say: On the fifteenth of that month."

[1843] **Proverbs 10:25**: 'Proverbs 10: 25: 'When the storm passes a wicked person is gone,But the righteous person is an everlasting foundation.''

[1844] **Rosh Hashanah 14a**: '§ The mishna taught: On the first of Shevat is the new year for trees, according to the statement of Beit Shammai. The Gemara asks: What is the reason that the new year for trees was set on this date? Rabbi Elazar said that Rabbi Oshaya said: The reason is since by that time most of the year's rains have already fallen, and most of the season, i.e., winter, is yet to come, as it continues until the spring equinox, which usually occurs in Nisan.'

[1845] **Rashi on Rosh Hashanah 14a**: ""'Because most of the year's rains have passed"'—most of the rainy season, the time of the rains, has already passed. The sap has risen in the trees, and the fruits now begin to form."

[1846] **Deuteronomy 8:10**: 'When you have eaten your fill, give thanks to the ETERNAL your God for the good land given to you.'

for the fruit." (תַּעֲנִית י.): אֶרֶץ דְּמַפְקָא מָזוֹן, אֶרֶץ דְּמַפְקָא פֵּירוֹת (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בְּרָכוֹת מט.)[1847]וְלֹא הָוֵי חֲתִימָה בִּשְׁתַּיִם — **This is not an ending with two subjects: it means the land that produces food, or the land that produces fruit (Berakhot 49a).** וּתְחִלַּת הַבְּרָכָה: נוֹדֶה וְכוּלֵי, עַל שֶׁהִנְחַלְתָּ לַאֲבוֹתֵינוּ אֶרֶץ וְכוּלֵי. — **The blessing begins: "We thank You," and so forth, "for bequeathing a Land to our ancestors."** וְלִכְאוֹרָה בִּרְכַּת הַמָּזוֹן תָּלוּי בָּאָרֶץ, וּמַה יּוֹעִיל לָנוּ נַחֲלַת הָאָרֶץ כְּשֶׁנְּתוּנָה בִּידֵי זָרִים שֶׁמָּשְׁלוּ בָנוּ בַּעֲוֹנוֹתֵינוּ הָרַבִּים? — **Grace after Meals thus seems dependent on the Land. What benefit is its inheritance when foreigners hold it and rule over us, through our many sins?** וּמָצִינוּ בַּגְּמָרָא (שָׁם כ:) דְּמִיבָּעֵי לֵיהּ: נָשִׁים בִּבְרָכַת הַמָּזוֹן דְּאוֹרַיְיתָא אוֹ דְּרַבָּנָן?[1848] — **The Gemara asks there, 20b, whether women's obligation in Grace after Meals is biblical or rabbinic.** וּפֵירֵשׁ רַבֵּינוּ שְׁלֹמֹה יִצְחָקִי מְשַׁעֵם דְּלֹא נָטְלוּ חֵלֶק בָּאָרֶץ, וְלִכְאוֹרָה לְפִי זֶה נִפְקָא מִינַּהּ דְּבִחוּץ לָאָרֶץ בִּרְכַּת הַמָּזוֹן דְּרַבָּנָן.[1849] — **Rashi explains that this is because they received no share of the Land. This seemingly implies that outside the Land, Grace after Meals is rabbinic.** וְהַתּוֹסָפוֹת שָׁהִקְשׁוּ מִכֹּהֲנִים וּלְוִיִּם דְּתִיבָּעֵי מִשּׁוּם שֶׁלֹּא נָטְלוּ חֵלֶק, עַיֵּין שָׁם,[1850] — **Tosafot challenges this from priests and Levites: the same question should arise, since they received no share; see there.** וְאַף שֶׁהֵם הָיָה לָהֶם עָרֵי מִגְרָשׁ, וּמֵהַאי טַעֲמָא מְבִיאִין וְקוֹרִין, כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב רַבֵּינוּ מֹשֶׁה בֶּן מַיְמוֹן פֶּרֶק ד מֵהִלְכוֹת בִּכּוּרִים,[1851] — **Although they had cities with surrounding lands, for which reason they bring first fruits and recite the declaration, as Maimonides rules in chapter 4 of the laws of First Fruits,** וְלִכְאוֹרָה טָפֵי הָוֵה לֵיהּ לְהַקְשׁוֹת דְּתִיבָּעֵי עַל בִּרְכַּת הַמָּזוֹן בְּחוּץ לָאָרֶץ אִם הָוֵי דְּרַבָּנָן. — **seemingly Tosafot should have raised the stronger question of whether Grace after Meals outside the Land is rabbinic.**

The World Is Nourished through the Land of Israel

אֲבָל בָּאֱמֶת הוּא עַל פִּי מַה שֶּׁכָּתוּב (תַּעֲנִית י.): אֶרֶץ יִשְׂרָאֵל שׁוֹתָה מֵי גְשָׁמִים וְכָל הָעוֹלָם כּוּלּוֹ מִתַּמְצִית וְכוּלֵי,[1852] — **But the truth follows Ta'anit 10a: "The Land of Israel drinks rainwater, and the whole world drinks its residue," and so forth.** אֶרֶץ יִשְׂרָאֵל שׁוֹתָה תְּחִלָּה וְכָל הָעוֹלָם כּוּלּוֹ לְבַסּוֹף. — **"The Land of Israel drinks first, and the whole world last."** וְנִמְצָא שֶׁבְּכָל הָעוֹלָם הַמָּזוֹן הוּא רַק מִתַּמְצִית אֶרֶץ יִשְׂרָאֵל. — **Thus food throughout the world comes only from the residue of the Land of Israel.** וְאַף שֶׁבְּאֶרֶץ יִשְׂרָאֵל יָצְאוּ רוֹב גִּשְׁמֵי שָׁנָה בְּשָׁבָט וּבְחוּץ לָאָרֶץ בָּאִים בַּקַּיִץ, — **Although in the Land of Israel most of the year's rain has fallen by Shevat, while abroad it comes in summer,** מִכָּל מָקוֹם הוּא רַק מֵהַהַשְׁפָּעָה שֶׁנִּשְׁפַּע לְחֹ"י תְּחִלָּה בִּזְמַנּוֹ. — **it nevertheless comes only from the bounty first bestowed upon the Land in its season.** וְשַׁפִּיר יֵשׁ שַׁיָּיכוּת בִּרְכַּת הָאָרֶץ לְבִרְכַּת הַמָּזוֹן אַף בְּחוּץ לָאָרֶץ, — **The blessing for the Land therefore properly belongs in Grace after Meals even outside the Land.** וְזֶה שֶׁאָמַר: וְאֵיתָא נוֹדֶה וְכוּלֵי, עַל שֶׁהִנְחַלְתָּ וְכוּלֵי. — **This explains "We thank You," and so forth, "for bequeathing."** בַּגְּמָרָא (בְּרָכוֹת מט.): וְכָל שֶׁאֵינוֹ אוֹמֵר בְּרִית וְתוֹרָה בִּבְרָכַת הָאָרֶץ וְכוּלֵי.[1853] — **The Gemara, Berakhot 49a, says: "Whoever does not mention covenant and Torah in the blessing for the Land," and so forth.** וְלִכְאוֹרָה יוֹתֵר יֵשׁ שַׁיָּיכוּת לַתּוֹרָה בְּבִרְכַּת בּוֹנֵה יְרוּשָׁלַיִם, דִּכְתִיב: כִּי מִצִּיּוֹן תֵּצֵא תוֹרָה וּדְבַר הַשֵּׁם מִירוּשָׁלָיִם.[1854] — **Torah would**

[1847] **Berakhot 49a:8**: "Returning to the statement itself: Rabbi says that one does not conclude a blessing with two separate subjects. Levi challenged Rabbi: What of 'for the land and for the food'? He answered: It means the land that produces food. What of 'for the land and for the fruits'? He answered: It means the land that produces fruits."

[1848] **Berakhot 20b:11**: "Ravina asked Rava: Is women's obligation in the blessing after meals imposed by the Torah or by the Sages? What practical difference does this make? Whether a woman can discharge the obligation of others. If you say her obligation is from the Torah, someone obligated by the Torah can discharge another Torah obligation. But if you say her obligation is rabbinic, she is considered not obligated in the same matter, and whoever is not obligated in a matter cannot discharge the obligation of others. What is the ruling?"

[1849] **Rashi on Berakhot 20b:11:2**: ""Or is it rabbinic?" For it is written, "For the good land that He has given you" (Deuteronomy 8:10), and the land was not given to females to receive a share. As for the daughters of Zelophehad, they received their father's portion, because he was among those who left Egypt."

[1850] **Tosafot on Berakhot 20b:11**: 'Tosafot on Berakhot 20b: Analyzes the obligation of priests, Levites, and women in Birkat HaMazon and how every Jew possesses a spiritual portion in the holiness of the Land of Israel.'

[1851] **Mishneh Torah, First Fruits and other Gifts to Priests Outside the Sanctuary 4:3**: "A convert brings the first fruits and recites the declaration, for it was said to Avraham, 'I have made you the father of a multitude of nations' (Bereishis 17:5). He is thus the father of everyone who enters beneath the wings of the Shechinah. The oath that his descendants would inherit the land was first given to Avraham. Kohanim and Levites likewise bring and recite, because they possess towns with their surrounding pasturelands."

[1852] **Taanit 10a:3**: "The Land of Israel drinks rainwater, and the entire rest of the world drinks from its runoff, as it says, 'Who gives rain upon the land,' and so forth. The Land of Israel drinks first, and the entire rest of the world afterward, as it says, 'Who gives rain upon the land,' and so forth. It is comparable to a person forming cheese: He takes the edible portion and leaves the remainder."

[1853] **Berakhot 49a:3**: "Anyone who concludes the blessing for the land with 'Who grants lands as an inheritance,' or 'Who builds Jerusalem' with 'Who saves Israel,' is an ignoramus. Anyone who fails to mention the covenant and Torah in the blessing for the land, or the kingship of David's house in 'Who builds Jerusalem,' has not fulfilled his obligation."

[1854] **Isaiah 2:3**: "Many peoples will go and say: 'Come, let us go up to the mountain of Hashem, to the house of the God of Yaakov. He will teach us of His ways, and we will walk in His paths.' For Torah will go forth from Zion, and the

seemingly belong more to the blessing for rebuilding Jerusalem, since "Torah shall go forth from Zion, and the word of Hashem from Jerusalem." ?וְלָמָּה נִתְקַן בִּבְרָכַת הָאָרֶץ **— Why was it instituted in the blessing for the Land?**

Shabbat Carries the Land's Holiness into Exile

The holiness accompanying Jacob abroad

אַךְ לְיַעֲקֹב אָבִינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם נֶאֱמַר: וְהָיָה זַרְעֲךָ כַּעֲפַר הָאָרֶץ וּפָרַצְתָּ יָמָּה וְגוֹמֵר,[1855, 1856] **— Jacob our father, peace be upon him, was told: "Your descendants shall be like the dust of the earth, and you shall spread westward," and so forth.** וְאָמְרוּ (שְׁמוֹת רַבָּה פָּרָשָׁה כה): כְּשֶׁגִּיעוּ בָּנֶיךָ עַד עֲפַר הָאָרֶץ, אוֹתָהּ שָׁעָה וּפָרַצְתָּ וְגוֹמֵר.[1857] **— Shemot Rabbah, chapter 25, says: "When your children reach the dust of the earth, at that moment, 'you shall spread,'" and so forth.** וְהָיִינוּ דִּכְשֶׁיִּהְיוּ בַּגָּלֻיּוֹת אָז יֵלֵךְ עִמָּהֶם קְדוּשַׁת הָאָרֶץ בְּכָל מָקוֹם שֶׁיִּהְיוּ. **— When they are in exile, the Land's holiness accompanies them wherever they are.** וְעַל זֶה אָמְרוּ בַּמִּדְרָשׁ (בְּרֵאשִׁית רַבָּה פָּרָשָׁה יא): יַעֲקֹב שָׁכָתוּב בּוֹ שְׁמִירַת שַׁבָּת וְכוּלִי, יָרַשׁ אֶת הָעוֹלָם שֶׁלֹּא בְּמִדָּה.[1858] **— The Midrash, Bereshit Rabbah, chapter 11, therefore says: "Jacob, of whom Sabbath observance is written, inherited the world without measure."** וְהָיִינוּ שֶׁזּוֹכִין זֶה עַל יְדֵי קְדוּשַׁת שַׁבָּת, שֶׁהוּא בְּרָזָא דִּבְרִית, כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב (זוֹהַר חֵלֶק ב צב א).[1859] **— This is attained through the holiness of Shabbat, which embodies the mystery of the covenant, as written in the Zohar (II, 92a).** וְהָיִינוּ כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמַרְנוּ שֶׁהַתּוֹסֶפֶת קְדוּשַׁת שַׁבָּת מִמִּדַּת צַדִּיק יְסוֹד עוֹלָם.[1860] **— As we explained, the added holiness of Shabbat comes from the quality of "the righteous person, the foundation of the world."** וְעַל כֵּן כְּשֶׁחָשַׁב בַּזּוֹהַר חָדָשׁ (פָּרָשַׁת תּוֹלְדוֹת) ז' הַמּוֹסָפִים כְּנֶגֶד קְדוּשַׁת ז' רוֹעִים, חָשַׁב מוֹסַף שַׁבָּת נֶגֶד יוֹסֵף.[1861] **— Therefore, when Zohar Chadash, Toldot, lists the seven additional offerings corresponding to the holiness of the seven shepherds, it assigns Shabbat's additional offering to Joseph.** וְכָתוּב: וְעַמֵּךְ כּוּלָּם צַדִּיקִים וְגוֹמֵר, כָּל מַאן דְּאִתְגְּזַר אִקְרֵי צַדִּיק, כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בַּזּוֹהַר הַקְּדוֹשׁ (שָׁם כג א).[1862, 1863] **— It says, "Your people are all righteous"; whoever is**

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word of Hashem from Jerusalem."

[1855] **Genesis 28:14**: 'Genesis 28: 14: 'Your descendants shall be as the dust of the earth; you shall spread out to the west and to the east, to the north and to the south. All the families of the earth shall bless themselves by you and your descendants.''

[1856] **Mei HaShiloach, Volume I, Genesis, Vayigash 7**: "Israel dwelt in the land of Egypt, in the land of Goshen." Jacob our father was afraid to go outside the Land, as the Talmud in Ketubot 110b says: everyone who lives in the Land of Israel resembles one who has a God, and so forth. Hashem told him that wherever he was, that place was holy with the holiness of the Land of Israel. This is the meaning of "Israel dwelt in the land of Egypt, in the land of Goshen": even in Egypt he was close to Hashem, and the place was holy, for Goshen is an expression of drawing near."
The origin asks why a custom tied to the Land of Israel matters abroad and answers through Jacob's accompanying holiness. Mei HaShiloach offers a concrete instance in Goshen: closeness to Hashem sustains that connection in exile. This supports the spiritual explanation without changing the geographical rules of tithes that prompted the origin's question.

[1857] **Shemot Rabbah 25:8** (excerpt): "He said to Jacob, 'Your descendants shall be like the dust of the earth' (Genesis 28:14). When your children reach the dust of the earth, at that moment, 'You shall spread westward and eastward' (Genesis 28:14). Thus, 'He raises the poor from the dust.' The Holy One, blessed be He, elevated them above all, as it is written, 'Hashem your God will place you,' and so forth (Deuteronomy 28:1)."

[1858] **Bereshit Rabbah 11:10**: "Rabbi Pinḥas said in the name of Rabbi Hoshaya: Although it says: "Because on it He rested from all His labor," from the labor of creating His world He rested, but he did not rest from the labor of the wicked nor from the labor of the righteous. Rather, he performs actions with these and with those. He shows to these the essence of what is their fate and to those the essence of their fate. From where is it derived that the punishment of the wicked is called labor? It is as it is stated: "The Lord opened His armory and took out the weapons of His fury, for it is labor for the Lord" (Jeremiah 50:25). And from where is it derived that the reward of the righteous is called labor? It is as it is stated: "How great is the goodness You have in store for those who fear You, which You have fashioned for those taking refuge in You, in the presence of people" (Psalms 31:20)."

[1859] **Zohar, Yitro 32:527**: 'Midrash Tanchuma, Vayera 1: "And the Lord appeared unto him by the terebinths of Mamre" (Genesis 18:1) — Why did the Holy One, blessed be He, appear to Abraham immediately after his circumcision? Because before Abraham was circumcised, the uncircumcised nations could not bear the Shechinah, whereas through the covenant of circumcision Abraham merited open Divine revelation.'

[1860] **Proverbs 10:25**: 'Proverbs 10: 25: 'When the storm passes a wicked person is gone,But the righteous person is an everlasting foundation.''

[1861] **Zohar Chadash, Toldot 38-39**: 'Zohar Chadash, Toldot (26b): Lists the festival Musaf offerings as corresponding to the seven species of the Land of Israel, through which the holiness of the Land is awakened.'

[1862] **Isaiah 60:21**: "Your people are all righteous; they will inherit the land forever, the shoot of My planting, the work of My hands, in which I will be glorified."

[1863] **Zohar, Vaera 1:16-18**: ""the seas" refer to the seven pillars which are the foundation of the earth, and over which rules the Sea of Kinnereth (R. Judah, however, maintained that the latter is filled by the others); "the rivers" are connected with the "river which went out of Eden to water the garden" (Gen. 2, 10). It is to be noticed that this Holy Land (the Shekinah) is called "the land of Israel". Why, then, did Jacob, who is Israel, not rule over it like Moses? The

circumcised is called righteous, as written in the holy Zohar (there, 23a). וְלֶעָתִיד יוּקְדַּשׁ אֶרֶץ יִשְׂרָאֵל בִּקְדוּשַׁת יְרוּשָׁלַיִם, וּקְדוּשַׁת אֶרֶץ יִשְׂרָאֵל תִּתְפַּשֵּׁט בְּכָל הָעוֹלָם, — **In the future, the Land of Israel will be sanctified with Jerusalem's holiness, and the Land's holiness will spread throughout the world,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב (רֵישׁ פְּסִיקְתָּא רַבָּתִי)[1864]: עֲתִידָה יְרוּשָׁלַיִם לְהִיוֹת כְּאֶרֶץ יִשְׂרָאֵל וְאֶרֶץ יִשְׂרָאֵל כְּכָל הָעוֹלָם כּוּלּוֹ. — **as stated at the beginning of Pesikta Rabbati: "Jerusalem is destined to extend like the Land of Israel, and the Land of Israel like the whole world."** וְהוּא כְּמוֹ תְּחִלַּת הַבְּרִיאָה, שֶׁנִּבְרָא לִהְיוֹת עִיקַּר שְׁכִינָה בַּתַּחְתּוֹנִים (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בְּרֵאשִׁית רַבָּה פָּרָשָׁה יט),[1865] — **This resembles the beginning of creation, intended for the Divine Presence to dwell chiefly below, as stated in Bereshit Rabbah, chapter 19:** וְהַיְינוּ לִהְיוֹת כָּל הָעוֹלָם אֶרֶץ יִשְׂרָאֵל וּמִשְׁכָּן לַשְּׁכִינָה. — **the whole world was to be the Land of Israel, a dwelling for the Divine Presence.** רַק לְאַחַר הַקִּלְקוּל שֶׁיֵּשׁ פְּסוֹלֶת מֵאָדָם הָרִאשׁוֹן שֶׁהוּא רַע, הוּפְרַשׁ מָקוֹם מְיוּחָד מִשָּׁם לַשְּׁכִינָה. — **Only after the damage, when evil dross remained from Adam, was a particular place set apart as the Divine Presence's dwelling.** וְלֶעָתִיד כְּשֶׁיִּתּוּקַן הַפְּגָם יִהְיֶה כָּל הָעוֹלָם כְּאֶרֶץ יִשְׂרָאֵל. — **In the future, when the damage is repaired, the whole world will be like the Land of Israel.** וּבְשַׁבָּת שֶׁהוּא בְּרָזָא דִּבְרִית, פּוֹרֵס סוּכַּת שָׁלוֹם עָלֵינוּ וְכוּלֵי, — **On Shabbat, the mystery of the covenant, He "spreads a shelter of peace over us," and so forth:** שֶׁמִּתְפַּשֵּׁט קְדוּשַׁת אֶרֶץ יִשְׂרָאֵל וִירוּשָׁלַיִם בְּכָל מָקוֹם מִשָּׁם יִשְׂרָאֵל. — **the holiness of the Land of Israel and Jerusalem spreads wherever Israel dwells.** וְזֶהוּ וּפָרַצְתָּ יָמָּה וְגוֹמֵר, שֶׁבְּכָל מָקוֹם שֶׁיֵּלֵךְ יִשְׂרָאֵל יוֹלִיךְ אִתּוֹ קְדוּשַׁת הָאָרֶץ.[1866] — **This is "You shall spread westward": wherever a Jew goes, he carries the Land's holiness with him.** וְהַיְינוּ בְּשַׁבָּת שֶׁהוּא מֵעֵין עוֹלָם הַבָּא, כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתַב בַּגְּמָרָא (שָׁם נז:),[1867] — **This occurs on Shabbat, a foretaste of the World to Come, as the Gemara says there, 57b,** שֶׁיִּתְבָּרֵר אָז וְעַמֵּךְ כּוּלָּם צַדִּיקִים וְגוֹמֵר.[1868] — **when "Your people are all righteous" will become clear.**

Humility and the Covenant of the Righteous

וְכֵן נִדְרָשׁ בְּרֵישׁ תַּנָּא דְּבֵי אֵלִיָּהוּ רַבָּה: וְאֵי זֶה מָקוֹם מְנוּחָתִי, עַל יוֹם הַשַּׁבָּת. — **The beginning of Tanna deVei Eliyahu Rabbah likewise interprets "Where is the place of My rest?" as the Sabbath day.**[1869,1870] וְכָתוּב: וְאֶל זֶה אַבִּיט אֶל עָנִי וְגוֹמֵר.[1871] — **It says: "To this one I look: to the poor," and so forth.** וְאָמַרְנוּ שֶׁבְּשַׁבָּת זוֹכֶה הַיִּשְׂרְאֵל לִהְיוֹת עָנִי וּנְכֵה רוּחַ וְתָרֵד עַל דְּבַר הַשֵּׁם,[1872] — **We explained that on Shabbat a Jew merits becoming poor and contrite of spirit, trembling at the word of Hashem:** דְּהַיְינוּ לִהְיוֹת צַדִּיק גִּבּוֹר הַכּוֹבֵשׁ יִצְרוֹ. — **that is, a righteous, mighty person who conquers his inclination.** שֶׁזֶּה בָּא עַל יְדֵי ג׳ דְּבָרִים שֶׁחָשַׁב עֲקַבְיָא בֶּן מַהֲלַלְאֵל: הִסְתַּכֵּל

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reason is-as already pointed out-that Jacob became the owner of the "house which is below" and left the "house which is above", though in the twelve tribes and in the seventy branches he made preparation herein for the "house which is above"; Moses, on the other hand, left the "house which is below" and took the "house which is above". The former experienced the Divine manifestation as "El Shaddai", but God did not speak with him in the higher grade designated by TETRAGRAMMATON."

[1864] **Pesikta Rabbati 1:1**: 'In the future, Jerusalem is destined to expand to the dimensions of the entire Land of Israel, and the Land of Israel is destined to expand to fill the entire world.'

[1865] **Bereshit Rabbah 19:7** (excerpt): "The Divine Presence originally dwelled below. When Adam sinned, it withdrew to the first heaven."

[1866] **Genesis 28:14**: 'Genesis 28: 14: 'Your descendants shall be as the dust of the earth; you shall spread out to the west and to the east, to the north and to the south. All the families of the earth shall bless themselves by you and your descendants.''

[1867] **Berakhot 57b:10-11**: "Three things enter the body without benefiting it: cherries, date blossoms, and unripe dates. Three things do not enter the body but benefit it: bathing, anointing, and intercourse. Three things offer a likeness of the World to Come: Shabbos, sunshine, and use of the body. What use of the body is meant? If you say sexual intercourse, that actually weakens a person! Rather, it means relieving oneself."

[1868] **Isaiah 60:21**: "Your people are all righteous; they will inherit the land forever, the shoot of My planting, the work of My hands, in which I will be glorified."

[1869] **Tanna DeBei Eliyahu Rabbah 1:1**: "1. And He drove (ויגרש) the Adom (Man) (Bereshis 3:24) - from here learn that The Holy One Blessed Be He gave to him (Adom) a divorce (גירושין) like a woman (that is like husband would give a divorce document to his wife whom he wishes to divorce). And He placed from the east (מקדם) of Gan Eden the Cheruvim (type of Angels) - from here learn that the Cheruvim came before (קדמו) of all of the Act of Creation. with a bright blade of a revolving sword - this is Gehinnom (Hell). to guard the way - this is Derech Eretz (literally the 'Way of the Land', different meanings, here Basic Human Decency, Proper Conduct or similar). of the Tree of Life - we learn that Derech Eretz comes before (i.e. has priority) over the Tree of Life. And there is no 'Tree of Life' except Torah, as is said it is a Tree of Life for all whose grasp on it (Mishlei 3:18)."

[1870] **Isaiah 66:1**: "Thus said GOD:The heaven is My throne And the earth is My footstool:Where could you build a house for Me,What place could serve as My abode?"

[1871] **Isaiah 66:2**: 'All this was made by My hand,And thus it all came into being—declares GOD.Yet to such a one I look:To the poor and brokenhearted,Who is concerned about My word.'

[1872] **Isaiah 66:2**: 'All this was made by My hand,And thus it all came into being—declares GOD.Yet to such a one I look:To the poor and brokenhearted,Who is concerned about My word.'

בְּג׳ דְּבָרִים וְכוּ׳, [1873] — **This comes through the three things listed by Akavya ben Mahalalel: “Consider three things,” and so forth,** שֶׁהֵם ג׳ מִינֵי שִׁפְלוּת שֶׁהֵם מְבַטְּלִים ג׳ הַקְלִיפּוֹת דְּקִנְאָה תַּאֲוָה וְכָבוֹד. [1874] — **three forms of humility that nullify the three husks of jealousy, desire, and honor.** וּבְשַׁבָּת נַעֲשֶׂה עָנִי וּנְכֵה רוּחַ וְתָרֵד עַל דְּבָרִי, שֶׁהֵם ג׳ מִינֵי שִׁפְלוּת הַנִּזְכָּרִים, [1875] — **On Shabbat one becomes “poor and contrite of spirit, trembling at My word,” the three forms of humility mentioned,** (וְתַנ׳ פָּרָשַׁת בֹּא מַאֲמָר ז), וְזוֹכִין לִהְיוֹת בְּחִינַת צַדִּיק גִּבּוֹר הַכּוֹבֵשׁ יִצְרוֹ. [1876] — **(see Bo, Teaching 7), and merits the quality of a righteous, mighty person who conquers his inclination.** וְזֶה שֶׁכָּתוּב בַּגְּמָרָא (שָׁם מח סוֹף עמוד ב): צָרִיךְ שֶׁיַּזְכִּיר בְּרִית לַתּוֹרָה, [1877] — **This explains the Gemara there, at the end of 48b: “One must mention covenant before Torah,** שֶׁזּוֹ נִיתְּנָה בְּג׳ בְּרִיתוֹת וְזוֹ נִיתְּנָה נָגֶד כָּל הַשְּׁבָטִים אַחַר שֶׁנִּתְחַלֵּק יוֹסֵף לִבְ׳. — **for one was given with three covenants, and the other was given corresponding to all the tribes after Joseph was divided into two.”** וְעַל פִּי מַה שֶּׁכָּתוּב (בָּבָא בַּתְרָא קטו רֵישׁ עמוד ב): גְּמִירִי דְּלָא כָּלֶה שִׁיבְטָא, [1878] — **And as stated in Bava Batra, at the beginning of 115b: “We have a tradition that no tribe becomes extinct.”** וְזֶה מוֹרֶה דְּכָל אֶחָד מִיִּשְׂרָאֵל יָכוֹל לִזְכּוֹת לָזֶה, כִּינּוּן דְּאִתְגְּזַר אִקְרֵי צַדִּיק, **This indicates that every Jew can attain this, since anyone circumcised is called righteous,** וְיָכוֹל לִזְכּוֹת לְעוֹלָם יִרְשׁוּ אָרֶץ, וְזוֹכִין לִהְיוֹת הָאֲכִילָה מֵהַשְׁפָּעַת קְדוּשַׁת אֶרֶץ יִשְׂרָאֵל. [1879] — **and can merit “They shall inherit the Land forever,” attaining food that comes from the bounty of the Land of Israel’s holiness.**

Torah Scholars and the Holiness of Shabbat

Torah creates a place with the Land’s spiritual air

וְתַלְמִידֵי חֲכָמִים דְּמִשְׁתַּדְּלֵי בְּאוֹרַיְיתָא אִתְקְרִיאוּ שַׁבָּתוֹת, [1880] — **Torah scholars who engage in Torah are called Sabbaths,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב (זוֹהַר חֲלָק ג כט ב וְשָׁם קכד סוֹף עמוד ב), — **as written in the Zohar (III, 29b, and there at the end of 124b).** שֶׁהֵם יְכוֹלִים לִזְכּוֹת עַל יְדֵי כֹּחַ הַתּוֹרָה תָּמִיד מַעַיִן עוֹלָם הַבָּא כַּשַּׁבָּתוֹת, — **Through the power of Torah they can constantly attain a foretaste of the World to Come, as on Shabbat,** וּלְעוֹלָם יִרְשׁוּ אָרֶץ, שֶׁיִּזְכּוּ לָאֲכוֹל בָּעוֹלָם הַזֶּה מִקְּדוּשַׁת אֶרֶץ יִשְׂרָאֵל. [1881] — **and “inherit the Land forever,” meriting to eat in this world from the Land of Israel’s holiness.** וְזֶהוּ שַׁיָּיכוּת בְּרִית וְתוֹרָה לְבִרְכַּת הָאָרֶץ. — **This is the connection of covenant and Torah with the blessing for the Land.** וְתוֹרָה נִיתְּנָה בְּג׳ בְּרִיתוֹת, הֵיינוּ כְּנֶגֶד ג׳ קְדוּשַׁת הָאָבוֹת שֶׁהוֹרִידוּ אוֹר תּוֹרָה לָעוֹלָם. — **The Torah’s three covenants correspond to the three sacred qualities of the**

[1873] **Pirkei Avot 3:1**: ‘Akabyah ben Mahalalel said: mark well three things and you will not come into the power of sin: know from where you come, and where you are going, and before whom you are destined to give an account and reckoning. From where do you come? From a putrid drop. Where are you going? To a place of dust, of worm and of maggot. Before whom you are destined to give an account and reckoning? Before the King of the kings of kings, the Holy One, blessed be He.’

[1874] **Pirkei Avot 4:21**: ‘Rabbi Elazar Ha-kappar said: envy, lust and the desire for honor put a man out of the world.’

[1875] **Isaiah 66:2**: ‘All this was made by My hand,And thus it all came into being—declares GOD.Yet to such a one I look:To the poor and brokenhearted,Who is concerned about My word.’

[1876] **Peri Tzadik, Bo 7:1**: “On Shabbat, a Jew attains these three forms of humility. “Poor” corresponds to “From where did you come? From a putrid drop”: he is poor at his root. “Contrite of spirit”: when he takes to heart “Where are you going? To a place of dust,” his heart breaks within him and he becomes contrite of spirit. When he takes to heart that he will render an account before the King of kings, the Holy One, blessed be He, he becomes one who “trembles at My word.” For who can stand before His judgment, and who can be innocent before Him? He becomes utterly humble in his own eyes, is saved from all three kinds of husks, and can merit complete redemption.”

[1877] **Berakhot 48b:13**; **Berakhot 49a:1**: “It was taught: Rabbi Eliezer says: Whoever fails to say ‘a desirable, good and spacious land’ in the blessing for the land, or to mention the kingship of David’s house in ‘Who builds Jerusalem,’ has not fulfilled his obligation. Nachum the Elder says: He must mention the covenant in it. Rabbi Yosei says: He must mention Torah in it. Pelimo says: He must mention the covenant before Torah, because the latter was given with three covenants, whereas the former was given with thirteen covenants.”

[1878] **Bava Batra 115b:1**: “How, then, is the inheritance traced? The inheritance is followed back through the family line as far as Reuben, the ancestor of the tribe, until an eligible heir is found. But why not say that it is traced as far back as Yaakov? Abaye answered: We have a tradition that an entire tribe never becomes extinct.”

[1879] **Isaiah 60:21**: “Your people are all righteous; they will inherit the land forever, the shoot of My planting, the work of My hands, in which I will be glorified.”

[1880] **Tzidkat HaTzadik 223:1**: “As I heard, the four cubits of halakhah are holy with the holiness of the Land of Israel. The air of foreign lands is entirely expelled from them on every side by the two-edged sword, and the holy air of words of Torah enters. This is the air of the Land of Israel, which therefore makes one wise, corresponding to Torah’s quality of making the simple wise.”

Tzidkat HaTzadik specifies the mechanism behind the origin’s reference to scholars as Shabbatot: active Torah study establishes a holy spiritual environment even amid distracting surroundings. Its larger paragraph distinguishes Torah’s immediate clearing of that environment from prayer’s deeper work in the heart, giving this comparison a specific role within the origin’s account of covenant, Torah, and the Land.

[1881] **Isaiah 60:21**: “Your people are all righteous; they will inherit the land forever, the shoot of My planting, the work of My hands, in which I will be glorified.”

Patriarchs, who brought Torah's light into the world. אַבְרָהָם אָבִינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם הָיָה הָרִאשׁוֹן שֶׁקִּיֵּם וְלִימֵּד הַתּוֹרָה עַד שֶׁלֹּא נִתְּנָה (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב יוֹמָא כח:).[1882] — **Abraham our father, peace be upon him, was the first to fulfill and teach Torah before it was given (Yoma 28b).** וְיִצְחָק אָבִינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם, אוֹרַיְיתָא מִסְטָרָא דִּגְבוּרָה קָא אַתְיָא, כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב **Concerning Isaac our father, peace be upon him: "The Torah comes from the side of might,"** (זוֹהַר חֵלֶק ג פִּי סוֹף עַמּוּד ב), וְהוּא מִדַּת יִצְחָק.[1883] — **as written in the Zohar (III, at the end of 80b), and this is Isaac's quality.** וְיַעֲקֹב אָבִינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם, תִּתֵּן אֱמֶת לְיַעֲקֹב, אֱמֶת זוֹ תּוֹרָה (בְּרָכוֹת ה:), וְנִתְבָּאֵר כַּמָּה פְּעָמִים.[1884, 1885] — **Concerning Jacob our father, peace be upon him: "You give truth to Jacob"; "truth is Torah" (Berakhot 5b), as explained many times.**

Shevat Opens the Way to Holy Eating

וְזֶה עִנְיַן חוֹדֶשׁ שְׁבָט שֶׁנּוֹצַר בְּאוֹת צַדִּיק לְתַקֵּן בְּמִדַּת צַדִּיק יְסוֹד עוֹלָם,[1886] — **This is the meaning of Shevat, formed through the letter tzaddik: to achieve repair through "the righteous person, the foundation of the world."** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמַרְנוּ שֶׁכָּל הַחוֹדֶשׁ בְּפָרָשִׁיּוֹת שְׁמוֹת, וָאֵרָא, בֹּא, בְּשַׁלַּח, יִתְרוֹ, מִשְׁפָּטִים, שֶׁבָּהֶם הַזְּמַן לְתַקֵּן הַפְּגָם בְּמִדָּה זוֹ. — **As we explained, the whole month falls within the portions Shemot, Va'era, Bo, Beshalach, Yitro, and Mishpatim, the time to repair damage to this quality.** וְאָז הַזְּמַן לִזְכּוֹת לִקְדוּשַׁת הָאָרֶץ, שֶׁיִּהְיֶה הָאֲכִילָה מִתַּמְצִית קְדוּשַׁת אֶרֶץ יִשְׂרָאֵל, — **It is then time to merit the Land's holiness, so that eating draws upon the residue of the holiness of the Land of Israel,** וּכְמוֹ לֶעָתִיד שֶׁתִּתְפַּשֵּׁט קְדוּשַׁת אֶרֶץ יִשְׂרָאֵל בְּכָל הָעוֹלָם. — **as in the future, when the Land of Israel's holiness will spread throughout the world.** וְיכוֹלִים לִזְכּוֹת שֶׁתִּתְפַּשֵּׁט קְדוּשַׁת אֶרֶץ יִשְׂרָאֵל בְּכָל מְשָׁכֵן יִשְׂרָאֵל, כְּמָה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר וּפָרַצְתָּ יָמָּה וְגוֹמֵר.[1887] — **We can merit that holiness spreading wherever Israel dwells, as it says, "You shall spread westward," and so forth.** וְעַל כֵּן בְּשָׁבָט רֹאשׁ הַשָּׁנָה לָאִילָן, וְהַטַּעַם שֶׁיֵּצְאוּ רוֹב גְּשָׁמֵי הַשָּׁנָה בְּאֶרֶץ יִשְׂרָאֵל וּבָא זְמַן חֲנָטַת הַפֵּירוֹת. — **Therefore Shevat contains the tree's New Year: most of the year's rain has fallen in the Land of Israel, and the time of fruit formation has come.** וּבְחוּץ לָאָרֶץ, אַף שֶׁיָּבְאוּ אַחַר כָּךְ הַגְּשָׁמִים, מִכָּל מָקוֹם עִיקַּר הַזְּמַן לִזְכּוֹת לְתַמְצִית אֶרֶץ יִשְׂרָאֵל שֶׁיִּהְיֶה הָאֲכִילָה בְּקִדּוּשָׁה הוּא בְּשָׁבָט. — **Outside the Land, although the rains come later, Shevat remains the chief time to receive the Land of Israel's residue so that eating is holy.** וְעַל כֵּן נוֹהֲגִין לֶאֱכוֹל מִפֵּירוֹת הָאִילָן בְּט"ו בִּשְׁבָט. — **That is why we customarily eat the fruit of trees on the fifteenth of Shevat.**

[1882] **Yoma 28b:9**: "Rav said: Our father Avraham fulfilled the entire Torah, as it says, 'Because Avraham listened to My voice,' and so forth. Rav Shimi bar Chiyya asked Rav, 'Perhaps this refers only to the seven commandments of the descendants of Noach?' But Avraham also observed circumcision! Then perhaps it refers to the seven commandments and circumcision? Rav answered, 'If so, why does Scripture say "My commandments and My Torahs," in the plural?'"

[1883] **Zohar, Kedoshim 3:13-14**: "and the Torah is called "holiness", as it is written, "I the Lord am holy", and the Torah is the supernal holy Name. Therefore he who studies it is first purified and then sanctified. We have learnt that the holiness of the Torah surpasses all other sanctifications, and the holiness of the superior recondite wisdom is highest of all.' He said to him: 'There is no Torah without wisdom and no wisdom without Torah, both being in the same grade, the root of the Torah being in the supernal Wisdom by which it is sustained."

[1884] **Micah 7:20**: "You will show faithfulness to Yaakov and kindness to Avraham, as You swore to our fathers from days of old."

[1885] **Berakhot 5b:2-3**: "Rabbi Yochanan said to him: Torah and acts of kindness are understandable, for it is written, 'Through kindness and truth, sin is atoned for.' 'Kindness' means acts of kindness, as it says, 'One who pursues righteousness and kindness will find life, righteousness and honor.' 'Truth' means Torah, as it says, 'Buy truth and do not sell it.' But how do we know that one who buries his children also has his sins atoned for? An elder taught him in Rabbi Shimon ben Yochai's name: It is derived by comparing the word 'sin' in two verses. Here it is written, 'Through kindness and truth, sin is atoned for,' and there it is written, 'Who repays the sin of fathers into the bosom of their children.'"

[1886] **Proverbs 10:25**: 'Proverbs 10: 25: 'When the storm passes a wicked person is gone,But the righteous person is an everlasting foundation.''

[1887] **Genesis 28:14**: 'Genesis 28: 14: 'Your descendants shall be as the dust of the earth; you shall spread out to the west and to the east, to the north and to the south. All the families of the earth shall bless themselves by you and your descendants.''

Tu BiShvat Ois 4

The Holy Tree: Bringing Sanctity into Every Meal

The distinction between the commanded practice and the highest ideal prevents a mistaken reading.

The Holy Tree: Bringing Sanctity into Every Meal

Why Eat Fruit on the Tree's New Year?

בַּחֲמִשָּׁה עָשָׂר בִּשְׁבָט רֹאשׁ הַשָּׁנָה לָאִילָן (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב רֵישׁ רֹאשׁ הַשָּׁנָה).[1888] — **The fifteenth of Shevat is the tree's New Year, as taught at the beginning of Rosh Hashanah.** וּפֵרֵשׁ רַשִׁי לְעִנְיַן מַעֲשֵׂר,[1889] — **Rashi explains that this concerns tithing:** שֶׁאֵין מְעַשְּׂרִין פֵּירוֹת הָאִילָן שֶׁחָנְטוּ קוֹדֶם שְׁבָט עַל שֶׁחָנְטוּ לְאַחַר כָּךְ, — **fruit that began developing before Shevat may not be tithed on behalf of fruit that developed afterward.** וְכֵן אֵין תּוֹרְמִין, כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב רַשִׁי בַּגְּמָרָא (יד עַמּוּד א).[1890] — **Terumah likewise may not be separated from one for the other, as Rashi explains in the Gemara (14a).** וּמִטַּעַם זֶה מִנְהַג יִשְׂרָאֵל לֶאֱכוֹל מִפֵּירוֹת אִילָן בַּחֲמִשָּׁה עָשָׂר בִּשְׁבָט. — **For this reason, Israel's custom is to eat tree fruit on the fifteenth of Shevat.** וּכְבָר שָׂאַלְנוּ, דְּעִנְיַן תְּרוּמוֹת וּמַעַשְׂרוֹת נוֹהֵג רַק בְּאֶרֶץ יִשְׂרָאֵל, — **We have already asked: terumot and tithes apply only in the Land of Israel.** וּמַה שַּׁייְכוּת חֲמִשָּׁה עָשָׂר בִּשְׁבָט לְפֵירוֹת אִילָן? — **What connection, then, does the fifteenth of Shevat have to tree fruit in general?** שֵׁנִית, גַּם בִּזְמַן הַזֶּה אַף פֵּירוֹת אֶרֶץ יִשְׂרָאֵל וְהָאִילָנוֹת רוּבָּן שֶׁל עוֹבְדֵי כּוֹכָבִים וּמַזָּלוֹת. — **Second, even now most of the Land of Israel's fruit and trees belong to non-Jews.** שְׁלִישִׁית, גַּם חֲנָטַת פֵּירוֹת בְּחוּץ לָאָרֶץ הוּא אַחַר הַפֶּסַח, וְלֹא שַׁייָךְ טַעַם דְּיָצְאוּ רוֹב גִּשְׁמֵי שָׁנָה. — **Third, outside the Land the fruit develops after Pesach, so the reason that most of the year's rain has fallen does not apply.** רְבִיעִית, מַה טַּעַם שֶׁאוֹכְלִין פֵּירוֹת הָאִילָן שֶׁגָּדְלוּ בַּשָּׁנָה הָעֲבָרָה, דְּהַחֲנוּטִים בִּשְׁבָט אֵינָם בְּנֵי אֲכִילָה? — **Fourth, why eat tree fruit grown the previous year, since fruit newly developing in Shevat is not yet edible?**

The Holy Tree and Its Twelve Boundaries

אַךְ הָעִנְיָן, דְּבְזֹהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ (בְּשַׁלַּח סב עַמּוּד ב) אִיתָא:[1891] — **The explanation follows the holy Zohar (Beshalach 62b):** וְאִתְתַּקַּף אִילָנָא קַדִּישָׁא בִּתְרֵיסַר תְּחוּמִין בְּאַרְבַּע סִטְרֵי עָלְמָא. — **"The holy tree is strengthened through twelve boundaries in the world's four directions."** וְכֵן אִיתָא (שָׁם סו סוֹף עַמּוּד ב): דְּתַנְיָנָן תְּרֵיסַר תְּחוּמִין וְכוּלֵי, סְלִיקוּ בְּאִילָנָא קַדִּישָׁא רַבָּא וְתַקִּיף.[1892] — **It likewise says there (66b, end): "We learned: twelve boundaries," etc., "ascended in the great, mighty holy tree."** וְכֵן אִיתָא (סד עַמּוּד ב): אִילָנָא אִית לְקוּדְשָׁא בְּרִיךְ הוּא, וְהוּא אִילָנָא רַבְרְבָא וְתַקִּיפָא,[1893] — **It also says (64b): "The Holy One, blessed be He, has a tree, a great and mighty tree, in which sustenance for all is found," etc.** וְיֵשׁ לוֹמַר, דִּכְבָר דִּקְדְּקוּ מַה שֶּׁאָמְרוּ רֹאשׁ הַשָּׁנָה לָאִילָנוֹת כְּמוֹ לִירָקוֹת. — **We may explain: others have already noted the wording "the tree's New Year," rather than "the trees'," as it says of vegetables.** וּכְבָר אָמַרְנוּ שֶׁבְּשָׁעָה שֶׁבָּרָא הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ הָאָדָם וְהִנִּיחוֹ בְּגַן עֵדֶן, הָיָה קִיּוּם הַחַיִּים שֶׁלּוֹ בְּפֵירוֹת הָאִילָן, דְּאַף חִטָּה מִין אִילָן הָיָה, כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב (בְּרָכוֹת מ עַמּוּד א).[1894] — **We have explained that when Hashem created man and placed him in Eden, his life was sustained by tree fruit.**

[1888] **Rosh Hashanah 2a**: 'MISHNA: They are four days in the year that serve as the New Year, each for a different purpose: On the first of Nisan is the New Year for kings; it is from this date that the years of a king's rule are counted. And the first of Nisan is also the New Year for the order of the Festivals, as it determines which is considered the first Festival of the year and which the last. On the first of Elul is the New Year for animal tithes; all the animals born prior to that date belong to the previous tithe year and are tithed as a single unit, whereas those born after that date belong to the next tithe year. Rabbi Elazar and Rabbi Shimon say: The New Year for animal tithes is on the first of Tishrei.'

[1889] **Rashi on Rosh Hashanah 2a**: ""For the tree"—regarding tithes: one does not tithe tree fruits that formed before Shevat for those that formed after Shevat, because trees follow the time of fruit formation. The Gemara explains why Shevat is different."

[1890] **Rashi on Rosh Hashanah 14a**: ""Because most of the year's rains have passed"—most of the rainy season, the time of the rains, has already passed. The sap has risen in the trees, and the fruits now begin to form."

[1891] **Zohar, Beshalach 28:368**: "At one time there lived in the neighbourhood of R. Jesse a poor man of whom no one took any notice; and to beg he was ashamed. One day he fell ill, and R. Jesse went to visit him. And as he sat by the sick man's bedside the Rabbi heard a voice saying: "Wheel, wheel, a soul is flying to me before its rightful time has come! Woe unto his fellow townsmen that none were found among them to sustain him, that he might live!" R. Jesse, having heard these words, stood up and put into the mouth of the sick man the water of a certain herb, bidding him drink; and this made him so to sweat that the illness left him and he recovered."

[1892] **Zohar, Beshalach 33:483**: 'THE LORD WILL HAVE WAR WITH AMALEK FROM GENERATION TO GENERATION. R. Judah said: There never was a generation of men, nor ever will be, in this world without this evil seed, and the Holy One, blessed be He, carries on His war against it. Of such it is written: "Let the sinners be consumed out of the earth, and let the wicked be no more. Bless thou the Lord, O my soul. Hallelukah!" (Ps. 104, 35).''

[1893] **Zohar, Beshalach 32:441-442**: "Said R. Abba: 'When the two (i.e. the ox and the ass) are united, the inhabitants of the world cannot stand up against them. For this reason it is prohibited to "plough with an ox and an ass together" (Deut. 22, 10). From them, when united, emanates the power, called "dog", which is more insolent than all of them. Said the Holy One, blessed be He: "Ye said, 'is the Lord in our midst or not?' Behold, I will deliver you to the dog!", and straightway came Amalek.' R. Judah said: 'It is written, "Amalek is the first of the nations; but his latter end shall be that he perish for ever" (Num. 24, 20). Was, then, Amalek the first of the nations? Were there not many tribes, nations, and peoples in the world before Amalek came?"

[1894] **Berakhot 40a:14**: "'Over the fruits of the ground,' and so forth: Is this not obvious? Rav Nachman bar Yitzchak said:

וְאָז כְּשֶׁנִּבְרָא לְהֱיוֹת קִיּוּם הַחַיִּים שֶׁלּוֹ בַּאֲכִילָה, הָיָה — **Even wheat was a kind of tree, as taught in Berakhot (40a).** רַק בְּדִבְרֵי תוֹרָה, — **When he was created to sustain his life through eating, that eating consisted solely of words of Torah,** עַל דֶּרֶךְ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: לְכוּ לַחֲמוּ בְלַחְמִי, נַהֲמָא דְאוֹרַיְיתָא דִּבְכְתָב (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב זֹהַר חֵלֶק ג רעא עַמּוּד ב). — **as in "Come, eat of My bread"—the bread of the Written Torah (Zohar III, 271b).** וְעֵץ הַחַיִּים הַיְינוּ תּוֹרָה שֶׁבִּכְתָב, וּכְמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב רֵישׁ תָּנָא דְּבֵי אֵלְיָהוּ רַבָּה: וְאֵין עֵץ הַחַיִּים אֶלָּא תּוֹרָה, וְזֶהוּ אִילָנָא קַדִּישָׁא.[1895] — **The Tree of Life is the Written Torah; as Tanna Devei Eliyahu Rabbah opens, "The Tree of Life is none other than Torah." This is the holy tree.** וְאִם לֹא הָיָה הַקִּלְקוּל, הָיָה שְׁאָר פֵּירוֹת עוֹלָם הַזֶּה רַק לְמַאֲכַל בְּהֵמָה וְחַיָּה. — **Had there been no damage, the other fruits of this world would have been food only for domestic and wild animals.** וְאָמַר: וְאִתְתַּקַּף אִילָנָא קַדִּישָׁא בִּתְרֵיסַר תְּחוּמִין, שְׁנֵים עָשָׂר גְּבוּלֵי אֲלַכְסוֹן, אַרְבַּע רוּחוֹת הַקְּרָנוֹת לְמַעְלָה וְכֵן לְמַטָּה וְכֵן לַצְּדָדִין, וְהֵם קְדוּשַׁת שְׁנֵים עָשָׂר שִׁבְטִים. — **"The holy tree is strengthened through twelve boundaries"—the twelve diagonal boundaries, the four corners above, below, and at the sides, which are the holiness of the twelve tribes.** וְאָמַר זֶה עַל מַה שֶּׁנֶּאֱמַר: וְשָׁם שְׁתֵּי עֶשְׂרֵה עֵינוֹת מָיִם,[1896] — **This is said concerning "There were twelve springs of water there,"** וְעַל דֶּרֶךְ מַה שֶּׁאָמְרוּ (בָּבָא קַמָּא יז עַמּוּד א): אֵין מַיִם אֶלָּא תּוֹרָה.[1897] — **following the teaching "Water is none other than Torah" (Bava Kamma 17a).**

The Inner Life of the Two Trees

וּכְבָר אָמַרְנוּ בְּמַה שֶּׁנֶּאֱמַר: וְעֵץ הַחַיִּים בְּתוֹךְ הַגָּן וְעֵץ הַדַּעַת וְגוֹמֵר, שֶׁפְּנִימִיּוּת כָּל הָאִילָנוֹת הָיָה כְּלוּל מִשְּׁנֵיהֶם.[1898] — **We have explained the verse "The Tree of Life within the garden, and the Tree of Knowledge," etc.: the inner nature of all trees included both.** וְאִם הָיָה טוֹעֵם מֵעֵץ הַחַיִּים, הָיָה מַרְגִּישׁ בְּכָל אֲכִילוֹתָיו מֵעֵץ הַחַיִּים; — **Had he tasted from the Tree of Life, he would have sensed the Tree of Life in everything he ate.** וּכְשֶׁטָּעַם מֵעֵץ הַדַּעַת, הִרְגִּישׁ כֵּן בְּכָל אֲכִילוֹתָיו. — **But when he tasted from the Tree of Knowledge, he sensed it in everything he ate.** וְזֶהוּ שֶׁאָמַר בְּתִקּוּנֵי זֹהַר: דְּכֻלָּא קְשׁוֹט, מַאן דְּאָמַר חִטָּה וּמַאן דְּאָמַר גֶּפֶן וּמַאן דְּאָמַר תְּאֵנָה, וְלָא הֲווֹ חוֹלְקִין בְּמִילּוֹלֵיהוּ (וְנִתְבָּאֵר מַאֲמָר ב). — **Thus Tikkunei Zohar says that all the views are true—wheat, vine, and fig—and their statements do not conflict (as explained in teaching 2).** וְהַיְינוּ שֶׁהִרְגִּישׁ מֵעֵץ הַדַּעַת בְּכָל הַמִּינִים. — **He sensed the Tree of Knowledge in every kind of food.** וְתוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה הוּא עֵץ הַדַּעַת מִסְטְרָא דְטוֹב, — **The Oral Torah is the Tree of Knowledge on the side of good,** וְעֵץ הַדַּעַת טוֹב הוּא אִילָנָא רַבְרְבָא וְתַקִּיפָא, — **The good Tree of Knowledge is the great and mighty tree,** שֶׁהַתּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה הוּא הֶרֹב חָכְמָה לְתַקֵּן הָרֶב כָּעַס.[1899] — **for the Oral Torah is the abundance of wisdom that repairs the abundance of vexation.** וְזֶהוּ שֶׁאָמַר: זִמְנָא שַׁלִּיטָא יִשְׂרָאֵל עַל אִינּוּן מַיָּא דְּאִינּוּן תְּחוֹת עַנְפִּין דְּאִילָנָא דְּאִקְרוּן הַמַּיִם הַדַּוִּנִים.[1900] — **Thus it says: "At that time Israel ruled over**

It was needed only according to Rabbi Yehudah, who says that wheat is a kind of tree. For it was taught: What was the tree from which Adam the first man ate? Rabbi Meir says: It was a vine, because nothing brings lamentation upon a person as wine does, as it says, 'He drank of the wine and became drunk.' Rabbi Nechemyah says: It was a fig tree, because through the very thing by which they were corrupted they found their remedy, as it says, 'They sewed fig leaves.' Rabbi Yehudah says: It was wheat, because a child does not know how to call 'Father' and 'Mother' until he tastes grain."

[1895] **Tanna DeBei Eliyahu Rabbah 1:1**: "1. And He drove (ויגרש) the Adom (Man) (Bereshis 3:24) - from here learn that The Holy One Blessed Be He gave to him (Adom) a divorce (גירושין) like a woman (that is like husband would give a divorce document to his wife whom he wishes to divorce). And He placed from the east (מקדם) of Gan Eden the Cheruvim (type of Angels) - from here learn that the Cheruvim came before (קדמו) of all of the Act of Creation. with a bright blade of a revolving sword - this is Gehinnom (Hell). to guard the way - this is Derech Eretz (literally the 'Way of the Land', different meanings, here Basic Human Decency, Proper Conduct or similar). of the Tree of Life - we learn that Derech Eretz comes before (i.e. has priority) over the Tree of Life. And there is no 'Tree of Life' except Torah, as is said it is a Tree of Life for all whose grasp on it (Mishlei 3:18)."

[1896] **Exodus 15:27**: "They came to Elim, where there were twelve springs of water and seventy palm trees, and they camped there beside the water."

[1897] **Bava Kamma 17a**: 'Rather, the honor that was done for Hezekiah was that they laid a Torah scroll upon his bier and they said: This one, i.e., Hezekiah, fulfilled that which is written in this, i.e., the Torah scroll. The Gemara asks: But nowadays as well, we do this for any great Torah scholar that dies, so what is unique about what was done to honor Hezekiah? The Gemara answers: Nowadays, we take a Torah scroll out but we do not lay it on the bier of the deceased. And if you wish, say instead that nowadays we also lay a Torah scroll on the bier of the deceased; but we do not say: This one fulfilled that which is written in this.'

[1898] **Genesis 2:9**: 'Genesis 2: 9: 'And from the ground the ETERNAL God caused to grow every tree that was pleasing to the sight and good for food, with the tree of life in the middle of the garden, and the tree of knowledge of good and bad.''

[1899] **Ecclesiastes 1:18**: 'For as wisdom grows, vexation grows;To increase learning is to increase heartache.'

[1900] **Zohar, Beshalach 32:441-442**: "Said R. Abba: 'When the two (i.e. the ox and the ass) are united, the inhabitants of the world cannot stand up against them. For this reason it is prohibited to "plough with an ox and an ass together" (Deut. 22, 10). From them, when united, emanates the power, called "dog", which is more insolent than all of them. Said the Holy One, blessed be He: "Ye said, 'is the Lord in our midst or not?' Behold, I will deliver you to the dog!", and straightway came Amalek.' R. Judah said: 'It is written, "Amalek is the first of the nations; but his latter end shall be that he perish for ever" (Num. 24, 20). Was, then, Amalek the first of the nations? Were there not many tribes, nations,

those waters beneath the tree's branches, called the presumptuous waters." וְהֵיְינוּ וַיַּחֲנוּ, שֶׁהָיָה לָהֶם נַיְחָא וַחֲנָיָה עַל הַמַּיִם, **— This is "They encamped": they found rest and an encampment beside the waters.**

The Oral Torah and the Admixture of Good and Evil

דְּמַה שֶּׁנִּמְשְׁלוּ דִּבְרֵי תוֹרָה לְמַיִם הַיְינוּ תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה, **— The comparison of Torah to water refers to the Oral Torah.** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁנִּדְרַשׁ (תַּעֲנִית ז עַמּוּד א) מַה שֶּׁנֶּאֱמַר לְכוּ לַמַּיִם, וּמַה שֶּׁנֶּאֱמַר הֵתָיוּ מַיִם, עַל תַּלְמִידִים, שֶׁהוּא בְּתוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה.[1901] **— Ta'anit (7a) expounds "Come to the water" and "Bring water" concerning students, which pertains to the Oral Torah.** וּבְתוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה שַׁיָּיךְ מַנִּיחִין מָקוֹם גָּבוֹהַּ וְהוֹלְכִים לְמָקוֹם נָמוּךְ.[1902] **— The Oral Torah is aptly compared to water leaving a high place and flowing to a low place.** אַךְ בְּעֵץ הַדַּעַת טוֹב יֵשׁ עֵרְבּוּב מֵהָרַע, וְיָכוֹל יֵצֶר הָרָע לִכָּנֵס. **— Yet the good Tree of Knowledge has an admixture of evil, allowing the evil inclination to enter.**

Rain from Hashem and Eating in Its Season

וְעַל זֶה כְּתִיב: וְהָיָה אִם שָׁמוֹעַ וְגוֹמֵר, וְנָתַתִּי מְטַר אַרְצְכֶם בְּעִתּוֹ.[1903] **— Concerning this it is written: "If you will listen," etc., "I will give your land's rain in its season."** וּכְשֶׁהַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ נוֹתֵן הַמָּטָר, אֵין דָּבָר רַע בָּא עַל יָדוֹ. **— When Hashem gives the rain, no evil comes through it.** וְשָׁם הַפָּרָשָׁה מְדַבֶּר בְּאֵין עוֹשִׂין רְצוֹנוֹ שֶׁל מָקוֹם, כִּדְמוֹכֵי לַהּ בְּגֶמָרָא (בְּרָכוֹת לה עַמּוּד ב),[1904] **— That passage concerns people not fulfilling God's will, as the Gemara interprets it (Berakhot 35b),** דִּבְעוֹשִׂין רְצוֹנוֹ שֶׁל מָקוֹם מְלַאכְתָּן נַעֲשֵׂית עַל יְדֵי אֲחֵרִים. **— for when they fulfill His will, their work is performed by others.**

Fulfilling the command while working for a living

וְאָמַרְנוּ דִּרְצוֹנוֹ שֶׁל מָקוֹם הָיָה שֶׁיִּהְיֶה הָאָדָם פָּנוּי רַק לַתּוֹרָה.[1905] **— We have explained that God's will was that people be free to devote themselves solely to Torah.** רַק אַחַר הַקִּלְקוּל שֶׁנִּתְקַלְקֵל בְּזֵעַת אַפֶּיךָ וְגוֹמֵר,[1906] **— Only after the**

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and peoples in the world before Amalek came?"

[1901] **Taanit 7a:13-16**: "Rabbi Chanina bar Pappa raised a contradiction: It is written, 'Bring water to meet the thirsty,' and it is written, 'Ho, all who are thirsty, go to the water.' If the student is worthy, 'Bring water to meet the thirsty'; if not, 'Ho, all who are thirsty, go to the water.' Rabbi Chanina bar Chama raised a contradiction: It is written, 'Let your springs spread abroad,' and it is written, 'Let them be yours alone.' If the student is worthy, 'Let your springs spread abroad'; if not, 'Let them be yours alone.' Rabbi Chanina bar Idi also said: Why were words of Torah compared to water, as it is written, 'Ho, all who are thirsty, go to the water'? To tell you: Just as water leaves a high place and flows to a low place, so words of Torah endure only in someone of humble mind. Rabbi Oshaya also said: Why were words of Torah compared to these three liquids—water, wine, and milk—as it is written, 'Ho, all who are thirsty, go to the water,' and, 'Go, buy and eat; go, buy wine and milk without money and without price'? To tell you: Just as these three liquids keep only in the least valuable vessels, so words of Torah endure only in someone of humble mind."

[1902] **Peri Tzadik, Vayishlach 11:3**: "This is the meaning of "You shall draw water with joy": water means Torah, and it is the Oral Torah that is compared to water. As stated in Taanit 7a, it resembles water that leaves a high place and goes to a low place. So too, "Go to the water" and "Bring water" are interpreted there concerning students. This is fitting for the Oral Torah, for which a teacher is needed: they leave a high place, and so forth. The Written Torah, however, is rolled up and set in a corner; whoever wishes to learn may come and learn, as stated in Kiddushin 66a."

[1903] **Deuteronomy 11:13-14**: "And if you will diligently heed My commandments that I command you today, to love Hashem your God and to serve Him with all your heart and with all your soul, then I will give the rain of your land in its season, the early rain and the latter rain, and you will gather your grain, your wine, and your oil."

[1904] **Berakhot 35b**: "Rabbi Shimon ben Yochai says: If a person plows at plowing time, sows at sowing time, reaps at reaping time, threshes at threshing time, and winnows when the wind blows, what will become of Torah? Rather, when Israel do the will of the Omnipresent, their work is done by others, as it says: 'Strangers shall stand and pasture your flocks,' etc. When they do not do the will of the Omnipresent, their work is done by themselves, as it says: 'You shall gather your grain.' Not only that, but the work of others is done by them, as it says: 'You shall serve your enemies,' etc."

[1905] **Peri Tzadik, Lech Lecha 3:6**: "But for someone unable to withstand this trial, Rava himself said in Berakhot there: "During Nisan and Tishrei, do not appear before me," and so forth. Thus, even though his students were Amoraim and rabbis, because he knew that a lack of sustenance would disturb them, he instructed them to work for their livelihood during Nisan and Tishrei. This is what the passage addresses: "If you will surely listen to My commandments," and so forth, "you shall gather your grain," and so forth. They fulfill Hashem's commandments, which require rest on Shabbat and during the sabbatical year, but they do not fulfill God's will that they be free solely for labor in Torah. This is "their work is done by themselves." But one who merits becoming a vessel devoted to Torah, free solely for its labor as God wills, has his work done by others. Not everyone merits this. This is what they said there: "Many acted," and so forth, "like Rabbi Shimon ben Yochai, but did not succeed."

The origin explicitly directs the reader to Lech Lecha 3. This paragraph provides the practical qualification: Rava instructed even his learned students to attend to their livelihood when need would disturb their learning. It explains why "not fulfilling His will" in this special discussion does not mean violating the commanded pattern of work and Shabbat rest.

[1906] **Genesis 3:19**: "By the sweat of your face you will eat bread, until you return to the ground, for from it you were taken; for you are dust, and to dust you will return."

damage, with the curse "By the sweat of your brow," etc., מְצַוַּת הַשֵּׁם לָנוּחַ רַק בְּשַׁבָּת, **— was Hashem's command to rest limited to Shabbat,** דְּבִימֵי הַמַּעֲשֶׂה נִצְרָךְ לַעֲסוֹק בְּעִנְיְנֵי עוֹלָם הַזֶּה (וְנִתְבָּאֵר לְךָ מֵאֲמָר ג, עַיֵּן שָׁם). **— since on weekdays people must engage in worldly affairs (as explained in Lech Lecha, teaching 3; see there).** וּמִכָּל מָקוֹם כְּשֶׁעוֹשִׂין כְּמִצְוָתוֹ שֶׁל מָקוֹם, כְּתִיב וְנָתַתִּי מְטַר וְגוֹמַר, **— Nevertheless, when they fulfill His command, it is written, "I will give rain," etc.** שֶׁהַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרֵךְ הַנּוֹתֵן מָטָר, וְאֵין רַע בָּא עַל יָדוֹ. **— Hashem gives the rain, and no evil comes through it.** וּכְתִיב בְּעִתּוֹ, בְּעֵת פָּא כְּנֶסֶת יִשְׂרָאֵל; עֵת פָּא וָו; **— The word be'itto, "in its season," is read be'et Vav: "in the season of Vav." "Season" is Knesset Yisrael,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב זֹהַר חֵלֶק א קטז בְּעֵת וָו, שֶׁמּוֹפִיעַ עַל יְדֵי וָו הַיּוּד, מִיּוּד עִלָּאָה וְקוֹצוֹ שֶׁל יוּד לְמִדַּת כְּנֶסֶת יִשְׂרָאֵל.[1907] **— as written in the Zohar (I, 116b, beginning). — "In the season of Vav": through Vav, Yud shines from the upper Yud and its tip into the attribute of Knesset Yisrael.** וְכָתוּב וְאָכַלְתָּ וְשָׂבָעְתָּ, שֶׁיּוּכַל לֶאֱכוֹל וְלִשְׂבּוֹעַ,[1908] **— It is written, "You shall eat and be satisfied," allowing one to eat to satisfaction.** רַק הִשָּׁמְרוּ לָכֶם פֶּן יִפְתֶּה וְגוֹמַר, שֶׁלֹּא יִכְנוֹס הַיֵּצֶר הָרָע, כֵּינָן שֶׁיֵּשׁ עֵרְבּוּב.[1909] **— But "Take care lest your heart be seduced," etc., so that the evil inclination does not enter, since an admixture remains.** אַךְ זֶהוּ רַק בְּאֶרֶץ יִשְׂרָאֵל, דְּאִיתָא (תַּעֲנִית י עַמּוּד א):[1910] **— This, however, applies only in the Land of Israel, for it is taught (Ta'anit 10a):** אֶרֶץ יִשְׂרָאֵל מַשְׁקֶה אוֹתָהּ הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא בְּעַצְמוֹ, שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר הַנּוֹתֵן מָטָר עַל פְּנֵי אָרֶץ.[1911] **— "The Holy One, blessed be He, Himself waters the Land of Israel," as it says, "Who gives rain upon the earth."**

Repairing the Tree through Holy Eating

וְזֶה עִנְיַן מַה שֶּׁאָמְרוּ בִּשְׁבָט רֹאשׁ הַשָּׁנָה לְאִילָן, לְתַקֵּן אִילָנָא קַדִּישָׁא דְּאִית לְקוּדְשָׁא בְּרִיךְ הוּא. **— This is the significance of the tree's New Year in Shevat: to repair the holy tree belonging to the Holy One, blessed be He.** וְהַיְינוּ מִי שֶׁזּוֹכֶה שֶׁיִּהְיֶה אֲכִילָתוֹ מִסְּטָרָא דְּעֵץ הַחַיִּים, **— This concerns one who merits eating from the side of the Tree of Life,** וְהוּא מִי שֶׁזּוֹכֶה עַל יְדֵי קְדוּשַׁת שַׁבָּת לִהְיוֹת נִגְאָל מִיָּד כְּמוֹ לֶעָתִיד. **— who, through Shabbat's holiness, merits immediate redemption, as in the future.** וּכְשֶׁאֲכִילָתוֹ מִסְּטָרָא דְּעֵץ הַדַּעַת, לְתַקֵּן עַל כָּל פָּנִים שֶׁיִּהְיֶה מִסְּטָרָא דְּטוֹב, וְלֹא יִהְיֶה בּוֹ עֵרְבּוּב מֵרַע. **— When one's eating is from the Tree of Knowledge, one should at least repair it so that it comes from the good side, without an admixture of evil.** וְזֶהוּ שֶׁאָמְרוּ בְּגֶמָרָא בְּטַעְמָא: הוֹאִיל וְיָצְאוּ רוֹב גִּשְׁמֵי וְהַיְינוּ בְּאֶרֶץ יִשְׂרָאֵל, דְּשָׁם מַשְׁקֶה אוֹתָהּ הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא בְּעַצְמוֹ וְכַנַּזְכָּר לְעֵיל. **— This refers to the Land of Israel, which He Himself waters, as explained above.** וּכְתִיב וְנָתַתִּי מְטַר אַרְצְכֶם בְּעִתּוֹ, וְעַל יְדֵי זֶה יְכוֹלִים לְתַקֵּן שֶׁיִּהְיֶה הָאֲכִילָה מִסְּטָרָא דְּטוֹב.[1913] **— It is written, "I will give your land's rain in its season." Through this, eating can be repaired to come from the side of good.** וּמִי שֶׁזּוֹכֶה יָכוֹל לִזְכּוֹת שֶׁיִּהְיֶה אֲכִילָתוֹ מִסְּטָרָא דְּעֵץ הַחַיִּים. **— One who merits it can attain eating from the side of the Tree of Life.**

How Shevat's Influence Reaches Every Land

וְעַל כֵּן אַף בְּחוּץ לָאָרֶץ, אַף שֶׁהַגְּשָׁמִים וְהַנְּטַת פֵּירוֹת אַחַר פֶּסַח, מִכָּל מָקוֹם בָּא מִתַּמְצִית שִׁיּוּרֵי שֶׁנִּשְׁאַר בָּעֲבִים אַחַר שְׁתִיָּתָהּ, כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב רַשִּׁי **— Therefore, even outside the Land, although rain and fruit development come after Pesach,**

[1907] **Zohar, Vayera 30:444-445**: "and when the sixth thousand, which is symbolised by the Van, begins, the Vale will resuscitate the He at six times ten (an allusion to the sixty souls), which means the Vau repeated ten times. The Vau will ascend to the Yod and redescend to the He. The Vau will be multiplied into the He ten times, making sixty, when it will raise the exiles from the dust. At every sixty years of the sixth thousand the He will mount a stage higher, acquiring greater strength. And after six hundred years of the sixth thousand there will be opened the gates of wisdom above and the fountains of wisdom below, and the world will make preparations to enter on the seventh thousand as man makes preparations on the sixth day of the week, when the sun is about to set. As a mnemonic to this we take the verse, "In the six hundredth year of Noah's life… all the fountains of the great deep were broken up" (Gen. 7, 11).'"

[1908] **Deuteronomy 11:15**: "I will give grass in your field for your livestock, and you will eat and be satisfied."

[1909] **Deuteronomy 11:16**: 'Take care not to be lured away to serve other gods and bow to them.'

[1910] **Taanit 10a**: 'The Sages taught in a baraita: Eretz Yisrael was created first and the rest of the entire world was created afterward, as it is stated: "While as yet He had not made the land, nor the fields" (Proverbs 8:26). Here, and in the following statements, the term "land" is understood as a reference to the Land of Israel, while "the fields" means all the fields in other lands. Furthermore, Eretz Yisrael is watered by the Holy One, Blessed be He, Himself, and the rest of the entire world is watered through an intermediary, as it is stated: "Who gives rain upon the land, and sends water upon the fields" (Job 5:10).'

[1911] **Job 5:10**: "Who gives rain upon the face of the earth, and sends water upon the fields."

[1912] **Rosh Hashanah 14a**: '§ The mishna taught: On the first of Shevat is the new year for trees, according to the statement of Beit Shammai. The Gemara asks: What is the reason that the new year for trees was set on this date? Rabbi Elazar said that Rabbi Oshaya said: The reason is since by that time most of the year's rains have already fallen, and most of the season, i.e., winter, is yet to come, as it continues until the spring equinox, which usually occurs in Nisan.'

[1913] **Deuteronomy 11:14**: 'I will grant the rain for your land in season, the early rain and the late. You shall gather in your new grain and wine and oil—'

,(תַּעֲנִית שָׁם)[1914] — **it nevertheless comes from the remaining moisture left in the clouds after the Land has drunk, as Rashi explains in Ta'anit there.** .(וְנִתְבָּאֵר מַאֲמָר ג) וְהוּא מִמַּה שֶׁנָּתַן הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ בִּשְׁבָט — **It comes from what Hashem gave in Shevat, as explained in teaching 3.** וְעַל כֵּן הַזְּמַן בִּשְׁבָט לְתַקֵּן כָּל הָאֲכִילוֹת שֶׁיִּהְיֶה .מִסְּטָרָא דְטוֹב — **Shevat is therefore the time to repair all eating, so that it comes from the side of good.** תַּלְמִידֵי חֲכָמִים דְּמַשְׁתַּדְּלֵי בְּאוֹרַיְיתָא זוֹכִין שֶׁיִּהְיֶה תָּמִיד אֲכִילָתָן בִּקְדוּשָׁה. — **Torah scholars who labor in Torah merit that their eating should always be holy.** ,וְכָל יִשְׂרָאֵל עַל כָּל פָּנִים אוֹכְלִין בְּשַׁבָּת אֲכִילָה בִּקְדוּשָׁה — **All Israel, at least, eat holy meals on Shabbat,** וְזוֹכִין שֶׁיִּהְיֶה הָאֲכִילָה מִסְּטָרָא דְטוֹב, וְלֹא יִהְיֶה עֵרְבּוּב רַע חַס וְשָׁלוֹם. — **and merit eating from the side of good, without an admixture of evil, Heaven forbid.** וְעַל כֵּן מִנְהַג יִשְׂרָאֵל לְטָעוֹם בְּיוֹם זֶה .מִפֵּירוֹת הָאִילָן, לְהַכְנִיס קְדוּשָׁה בְּכָל הָאֲכִילוֹת — **Therefore Israel's custom is to taste tree fruit on this day, to bring holiness into all eating.**

[1914] **Rashi on Taanit 10a**: ""From the remainder of the runoff"—what remains in the clouds after the Land of Israel has drunk. "It drinks first"—the rains fall there first; this is what I heard."

Tu BiShvat Ois 5

From Sanctified Eating to Redemption in Nisan

Rav Tzadok also relates restored eating to the removal of a deeper spiritual obstruction.

From Sanctified Eating to Redemption in Nisan

The Fullness of the Month

בַּחוֹדֶשׁ זֶה זְמַן הַתִּיקּוּן לֶאֱכִילָה שֶׁיִּהְיֶה בִּקְדוּשָׁה, — **This month is the time to rectify eating so that it is holy.** וְעַל כֵּן בַּחוֹדֶשׁ זֶה רֹאשׁ הַשָּׁנָה לָאִילָן לְבֵית שַׁמַּאי, — **Therefore, according to Beit Shammai, the tree's new year falls in this month,** שֶׁכֵּן בְּרֹאשׁ חוֹדֶשׁ מַתְחִיל הַתִּיקּוּן, — **because the rectification begins on Rosh Chodesh.** שֶׁעַל כֵּן נִקְרָא רֹאשׁ חוֹדֶשׁ, שֶׁבּוֹ עִיקַּר הָעֵסֶק מַהַחוֹדֶשׁ, — **It is thus called the month's "head," for the month's essential work is contained in it:** דְּבָתַר רֵישָׁא גּוּפָא אָזִיל (עירובין מא.)[1915] — **"The body follows the head" (Eruvin 41a).** וּלְבֵית הִלֵּל בַּחֲמִשָּׁה עָשָׂר בּוֹ, שֶׁאָז סֵיהֲרָא בְּאַשְׁלְמוּתָא, — **According to Beit Hillel, it falls on the fifteenth, when the moon is full,** וְהוּא שְׁלֵימוּת קְדוּשַׁת הַחוֹדֶשׁ. — **which represents the fullness of the month's holiness.**

Shevat, Adar, and Nisan

Holy delight and the defeat of Amalek's coldness

בְּשָׁבָט הַתִּיקּוּן לֶאֱכִילָה שֶׁיִּהְיֶה וְכֵן סֵדֶר שְׁלֹשָׁה חֳדָשִׁים אֵלּוּ:[1916] — **This is also the sequence of these three months:** בְּשבט שֶׁאָמַרְנוּ בְּמַה שֶׁכָּתוּב בְּסֵפֶר יְצִירָה, שֶׁנּוֹצַר בְּאוֹת צָדִי כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמַרְנוּ בְּלַעְיטָה,[1917] בִּקְדוּשָׁה, — **in Shevat, eating is rectified so that it is holy, as we explained concerning Sefer Yetzirah's statement that it was formed with the letter tzadi, governing swallowing,** שֶׁיִּהְיֶה צַדִּיק אוֹכֵל לְשׂוֹבַע נַפְשׁוֹ.[1918] — **so that "the righteous person eats to satisfy his soul."** וְאַחַר כָּךְ אֲדָר, שֶׁבּוֹ מְחִיַּת עֲמָלֵק, — **Next comes Adar, in which Amalek is erased.** וְהוּא נֶגֶד מִדַּת צַדִּיק יְסוֹד עוֹלָם, — **This rectification corresponds to the attribute of the righteous one, the foundation of the world,** שֶׁמְּבָרֵר כָּל יִשְׂרָאֵל: וְעַמֵּךְ כּוּלָּם צַדִּיקִים.[1919] — **who clarifies the truth about all Israel: "Your people are all righteous."** וַעֲמָלֵק מְקַטְרֵג עַל זֶה וְאוֹמֵר שֶׁאַף בְּיִשְׂרָאֵל יֵשׁ שֶׁפּוֹגְמִין בִּקְדוּשָׁה זוֹ, — **Amalek accuses them, saying that even among Israel some damage this holiness.** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב (מִדְרַשׁ תַּנְחוּמָא תֵּצֵא), שֶׁחוֹתֵךְ מִילּוֹתֵיהֶם שֶׁל יִשְׂרָאֵל וְכוּלֵי: טוֹל מַה שֶׁבָּחַרְתָּ.[1920] — **As stated in Midrash Tanchuma, Ki Tetzei: he cuts off Israel's circumcised**

[1915] **Eruvin 41a:6**: "It was taught: After Rabban Gamliel's death, Rabbi Yehoshua entered to overturn his ruling. Rabbi Yochanan ben Nuri stood up and said, 'I see that the body follows the head. Throughout Rabban Gamliel's lifetime we established the halachah according to him; now you wish to annul his words? Yehoshua, we will not listen to you, because the halachah has already been established according to Rabban Gamliel.' No one raised any further objection to the matter."

[1916] **Peri Tzadik, The Fifteenth of Av 6:3**: "It is written there, "Those who ate delicacies." This certainly does not refer to eating for bodily enjoyment, since it speaks of supremely holy people. Rather, its meaning follows the Zohar's teaching about Shabbat eating, which is holy and belongs to the mystery of delight, oneg, whose initials are Eden, river, and garden. "Those who ate delicacies" is an expression of Eden: their eating is continually holy, and they repair the root of the kelippah that lay in eating. Of them it is written, "Those brought up in scarlet," meaning scarlet dye; and it says of them, "All her household is clothed in scarlet." They repair the beginning of the kelippah, "who cooled you," as explained above."

The full Tu BeAv teaching identifies Amalek's obstruction here as coldness and slackening in Torah, distinct from the heated impulses of jealousy, desire, and pride. Its conclusion links holy eating with repairing that root. This gives a further explanation for the origin's progression from repairing appetite in Shevat to overcoming Amalek in Adar; the festival dates remain distinct.

[1917] **Sefer Yetzirah Gra Version 5:10**: 'He made the letter Tzadi king over swallowing/taste (le'itah), bound a crown to it, and combined one with another; and with them He formed Aquarius (Deli) in the universe, Shevat in the year, and the gizzard (kurkevan) in the soul, male and female.'

[1918] **Proverbs 13:25**: 'A righteous person eats to the satisfaction of his soul, but the belly of the wicked will lack.'

[1919] **Isaiah 60:21**: "Your people are all righteous; they will inherit the land forever, the shoot of My planting, the work of My hands, in which I will be glorified."

[1920] **Midrash Tanchuma, Ki Teitzei 9:1**: "R. Levi opened his discourse (with Ps. 9:6), "You have rebuked the nations; you have destroyed the wicked one": "You have rebuked the nations." This refers to Amalek, of which it is written (in Numb. 24:20), "First among the nations (to attack Israel) was Amalek." (ibid., cont.:) "You have destroyed the wicked one." This refers to Esau, of whom it is stated (in Mal. 1:4), "and they shall call them (i.e., Edom) a country of wickedness." If someone says to you, "Jacob also is included among the wicked one," say to such a one, "'You have destroyed wicked ones (in the plural)' is not written here, but 'You have destroyed the wicked one (in the singular).'" (Ps. 9:6, cont.:) "You have blotted out their name for ever and ever," as stated (Deut. 25:19), "You shall blot out the remembrance of Amalek…." (Ps. 79:12:) "And return sevenfold unto the bosom (heq) of our neighbors their taunt with which they have taunted you, O Lord." R. Judan bar Gadya, R. Joshua ben Levi, and the masters differ. R. Judan bar Gadya said, "Remember what our neighbor Amalek did to us in the penis, which is attached to the lap (heq) i.e., to the center of a man." And this agrees with what R. Hanina bar Shilqa, R. Joshua ben Levi and R. Jochanan said, "What did the House of Amalek do to Israel? They cut off their penes and flung them heavenward, as they said, 'This is what You have chosen, take for Yourself what You have chosen.' This is related to the verse (in Ps. 9:6), 'their taunt with which they have taunted You, O Lord.'" R. Joshua ben Levi said, "It should be remembered what they did in the Torah, as it is written about it (in Ps. 12:7), 'refined sevenfold.'" And the masters said, "It should be remembered what they did to the Temple, which was the bosom (heq) i.e., the center of the earth, as stated (with reference to the Temple in Ezek. 43:14),

organs, etc., saying, "Take what You have chosen." וְלָכֵן עֲמָלֵק נוֹפֵל בְּיַד זַרְעוֹ שֶׁל יוֹסֵף (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בִּבְרֵאשִׁית רַבָּה פָּרָשָׁה צט)[1921], **Amalek therefore falls at the hands of Yosef's descendants, as Bereishit Rabbah 99 states.** וְהוּא כְּנֶגֶד מָשִׁיחַ בֶּן יוֹסֵף, שֶׁיְּבָרֵר וְעַמְּךָ כּוּלָּם וְגוֹמֵר. — **This corresponds to Mashiach ben Yosef, who will clarify "Your people are all," etc.** וְאַחַר כָּךְ נִיסָן, זְמַן יְצִיאַת מִצְרַיִם, — **Then comes Nisan, the time of the Exodus from Egypt,** וְהַיְינוּ שֶׁיִּגָּאֲלוּ יִשְׂרָאֵל מִכָּל הַמְּצֵירִים לְיִשְׂרָאֵל, שֶׁנִּקְרְאוּ מִצְרַיִם (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בִּבְרֵאשִׁית רַבָּה פָּרָשָׁה טז)[1922]. **— meaning that Israel will be redeemed from all who oppress them, who are called Mitzrayim, as**

'And from the lap (heq) of the earth to the lower ledge, two cubits.'" When Samuel came, he repaid them, as stated (in I Sam. 15:33), "then Samuel hewed Agag." What did he do to him? R. Abba bar Kahana said, "He cut olive-sized pieces from his flesh and fed them to ostriches. This is what is written (in Job 18:13), 'It shall consume pieces of his flesh; the firstborn of death shall consume his pieces'; in that Samuel chose a cruel (mar) death for him." But the masters say, "Samuel set up four poles and stretched him upon them." It also says (in I Sam. 15:32), "and Agag said, 'Surely the bitterness (mar) of death is at hand (sr),'" meaning, "Do they thus put princes (sr) to death with harsh deaths?" R. Samuel bar Avdimi said, "He judged him by the justice of the peoples of the world (instead of by Torah) without witnesses and without a warning." Rabbi said, "He castrated him (rt.: srs) him, as stated (in I Sam. 15:33), 'But Samuel said, "As your sword has made women bereaved, so shall your mother be bereaved among women."'" R. Levi said, "Moses also gave a hint to Israel in the Torah (about Agag's castration), since it is stated (in Deut. 25:11-12), 'When two men get into a fight with each other, and the wife of one draws near to save her husband from the hand of the one smiting him, if she puts out with her hand and grabs the other man by his genitals. Then you shall cut off her hand….' What is written after that (in vs. 17), 'Remember what Amalek did to you.'" Israel said to the Holy One, blessed be He, "Master of the world, are You telling us to remember? You remember; as forgetfulness is common among us. But with You there is no forgetfulness." Thus (in Deut. 25:17), "Remember what Amalek did to you." He did to us, and he did not do to You? (Ps. 137:7:) "Remember against the children of Edom, O Lord, the day of the destruction of Jerusalem, how they said, 'Aru, 'aru (rt.: 'rh, rt.: 'rh) her to the foundation.'" Rabbi Abba bar Kahana said, "'Aru, 'aru means, paggeru, paggeru (destroy, destroy), even as the word is used (in Jer. 51:58), 'Babylon's broad wall shall be utterly demolished ('ar'er tit'ar'ar, rts.: 'rr, 'rh).'" R. Levi said, "'Aru, 'aru means, empty, empty, even as the word is used (in Gen. 24:20), 'She hastened to empty (te'ar, rt: 'rh) her jar into the trough.'" In the opinion of the one who said, "paggeru, paggeru (destroy, destroy)," 'aru, 'aru means to its foundations is intended (meaning, down to them but not to the foundation per se). But in the opinion of the one who said, "pannun, pannun (empty them, empty them)" the words mean, empty its foundations. What is the meaning of Amalek ('mlq)? People ('m) of the locust (ylq). They spread out like the zahla locust. Alternatively Amalek ('mlq) is a people ('am) who came to lap up (l'leq) the blood of Israel like a dog. R. Levi said in the name of R. Simeon ben Halafta, "To what may Amalek be likened? To a fly who is inflamed with passion after an open wound. So was Amalek inflamed like a dog with passion after Israel." As the Israelites went out of Egypt, Amalek heard that they were redeemed, and came against them upon the Reed Sea. But Israel mentioned the explicit name of God, and Amalek was bewildered, as stated (Exod. 15:15), "Then the captains of Edom were bewildered." (Deut. 25:17:) "On the way as you came out of Egypt." It is taught (in a baraita) in the name of R. Nathan: Amalek came four hundred parasangs (i.e., a little over 900 miles) to fight with Israel in Rephidim, as stated (in Numb. 13:29), "Amalek dwells in the land of the Negeb …." And he dwells in the interior beyond all of them (i.e., beyond all the tribes listed in this passage). (Deut. 25:17:) "On the way as you came out of Egypt." R. Levi said, "He came upon them from the wayside like a bandit." It is comparable to a king who had a vineyard which he had enclosed with a fence and in which he had put a biting dog. The king said, "Whenever anyone comes to break through the fence, the dog will bite him." One day the king's son came and broke through the fence. The dog bit him. Whenever he wanted to bring to mind the transgression of his son who broke through to the vineyard, he would say to him, "You remember how the dog bit you." Similarly, whenever the Holy One, blessed be He, wants to bring to mind the sin of Israel - what they did in Rephidim, when they said (in Exod. 17:7) "Is the Lord present among us or not" - He says to them (in Deut. 25:17), "Remember what Amalek did to you." (Deut. 25:18:) "How he encountered you on the way." R. Judah, R. Nehemiah, and the masters differ. R. Judah says, "'How he encountered (qr, rt.: qrh) you, i.e., defiled you. It is just as you say (in Deut. 23:11), "who is unclean because of what he encounters (rt.: qrh) at night (i.e., a nocturnal emission).'" R. Nehemiah said, "He actually called (qr') you. What did Amalek do? He went down to the Egyptian hall of records and obtained the records on the tribes, where their names were inscribed against them for the number of bricks. Then he would stand outside Israel's protective cloud and call out (rt.: qrh) to them, 'Reuben, Simeon, Levi, come out, for I am your brother; and I want to transact business with you.' When they came out, he killed them." And the masters say, "He cooled (qr) you, i.e., he made Israel appear lukewarm (rt.: qrr) before others." R. Huniya said, "A parable: To what is the matter comparable? To a boiling bath into which no creature is able to descend. A certain ruffian came and leaped down into it. Even though he was scalded, he made it cool to others. So also when Israel came out of Egypt, and the Holy One, blessed be He, divided the sea before them, while the Egyptians were drowned in its midst, fear of them fell upon all the peoples, as stated (in Exod. 15:15-16), 'Then were the chiefs of Edom bewildered…. Terror and fright fell upon them.' When Amalek came and joined in battle with them - even though he received his scalding at their hands - he made Israel appear lukewarm (in battle) before the peoples of the world.'"

[1921] **Bereshit Rabbah 99:2** (excerpt): "Of this one, Joseph, it is written, 'I fear God' (Genesis 42:18); of that one it is written, 'He did not fear God' (Deuteronomy 25:18). Into whose hand does the kingdom fall? Into the hand of the one anointed for war, who descends from Joseph. Rabbi Pinchas said in the name of Rabbi Shmuel bar Nachman: It is a received tradition that Esau falls only into the hands of Rachel's descendants. This is what is written: 'Surely the youngest of the flock shall drag them away' (Jeremiah 49:20). Why does it call them 'the youngest of the flock'? Because they are the youngest of the tribes."

[1922] **Bereshit Rabbah 16:4** (excerpt): "Rav Huna said in the name of Rav Acha: All the kingdoms are called by the name Assyria, because they enrich themselves from Israel. Rabbi Yose bar Chanina said: All the kingdoms are called by the name Nineveh, because they adorn themselves from Israel. Rabbi Yose, son of Rabbi Chalafta, said: All the kingdoms are called by the name Egypt, because they oppress Israel."

Bereishit Rabbah 16 states. וּבוֹ עֲתִידִין לְהִגָּאֵל עַל יְדֵי מָשִׁיחַ בֶּן דָּוִד, **— In this month they are destined to be redeemed through Mashiach ben David.** דְּדָוִד הֵקִים עוֹלָה שֶׁל תְּשׁוּבָה, **— David established the path of repentance,** וּמָשִׁיחַ יִהְיֶה יָחִיד שֶׁעָשָׂה תְּשׁוּבָה, שֶׁבִּשְׁבִילוֹ מוֹחֲלִין לְכָל הָעוֹלָם כּוּלּוֹ (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב יוֹמָא פו:).[1923] **— and Mashiach will be the individual whose repentance brings forgiveness to the entire world, as Yoma 86b states.** וְהַיְינוּ שֶׁיּוֹפִיעַ הִרְהוּר תְּשׁוּבָה בְּכָל יִשְׂרָאֵל, וְיִתַּקֵּן אַף מִי שֶׁקִּלְקֵל. **— A thought of repentance will thus shine in all Israel, repairing even those who have gone astray.**

The Full Moon and the Healing of the Trees

וְכֵן הָיָה בְּחוֹדֶשׁ נִיסָן, שֶׁתֵּיכֶף בְּרֹאשׁ חוֹדֶשׁ נֶאֱמַר לָהֶם: הַחוֹדֶשׁ הַזֶּה לָכֶם וְגוֹמֵר,[1924] **— So it was in Nisan: immediately on Rosh Chodesh they were told, "This month shall be for you," etc.** וְנֶאֱמַר לָהֶם אָז: בֶּעָשׂוֹר לַחוֹדֶשׁ הַזֶּה וְיִקְחוּ לָהֶם אִישׁ שֶׂה וְגוֹמֵר,[1925] **— They were then told, "On the tenth of this month, each shall take a lamb," etc.** וְעִיקַּר הַגְּאוּלָּה הָיָה בַּחֲמִשָּׁה עָשָׂר לַחוֹדֶשׁ, שֶׁהָיָה סִיהֲרָא בְּאַשְׁלָמוּתָא. **— The redemption itself took place on the fifteenth, when the moon was full.** וְכֵן בְּסוּכּוֹת: כִּי בַסֻּכּוֹת הוֹשַׁבְתִּי וְגוֹמֵר, שֶׁזָּכוּ לִהְיוֹת יוֹשְׁבִים בְּצֵלָּא דִמְהֵימְנוּתָא,[1926] **— Likewise on Sukkot: "For I caused them to dwell in sukkot," etc.; they merited to dwell in the shade of faith.** גַּם כֵּן בָּא הַמִּצְוָה בַּחֲמִשָּׁה עָשָׂר לַחוֹדֶשׁ, דְּסִיהֲרָא בְּאַשְׁלָמוּתָא. **— This commandment, too, comes on the fifteenth of the month, when the moon is full.** וְכֵן בַּחוֹדֶשׁ הַזֶּה, שֶׁהָעִסָּק לְתַקֵּן הָאֲכִילָה שֶׁיִּהְיֶה בִּקְדוּשָּׁה, בַּחֲמִשָּׁה עָשָׂר בּוֹ רֹאשׁ הַשָּׁנָה לָאִילָן. **— Similarly, in this month, whose task is to sanctify eating, the tree's new year is on the fifteenth.**

Receiving the gift without mistaking its channel for its source

וְהַיְינוּ כְּשֶׁנִּזְכֶּה לְתַקֵּן הָאֲכִילָה שֶׁיִּהְיֶה בִּקְדוּשָּׁה, וְאָז יִתְרַפְּאוּ גַּם הָאִילָנוֹת, **— When we merit to rectify eating so that it is holy, the trees too will be healed,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁהָיָה קוֹדֶם קִלְקוּל אָדָם הָרִאשׁוֹן (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בְּבְרֵאשִׁית רַבָּה פָּרָשָׁה יב).[1928] **— as they were before Adam's corruption, as Bereishit Rabbah 12 states.** וְלָכֵן אוֹכְלִים מִפְּרֵי הָאִילָן וּמְבָרְכִים עֲלֵיהֶם, **— We therefore eat fruit from the tree and recite blessings over it,** לְתַקֵּן אֲכִילַת הַפֵּרוֹת שֶׁיִּהְיֶה בִּקְדוּשָׁה. **— to rectify the eating of fruit so that it is holy.** וְכֵן יְהִי רָצוֹן שֶׁנִּזְכֶּה לְתַקֵּן הָאֲכִילָה שֶׁיִּהְיֶה בִּקְדוּשָּׁה, **— May it be His will that we merit to sanctify our eating,** וּלְתַקֵּן כָּל פְּגַם הָרִאשׁוֹן, וְנִזְכֶּה לִהְיוֹת נִגְאָלִין בְּנִיסָן. **— to repair the entire original blemish, and to be redeemed in Nisan.**

[1923] **Yoma 86b:7**: "It was taught: Rabbi Meir used to say: Great is repentance, for because of one individual who repents, the entire world is forgiven, as it says, 'I shall heal their backsliding; I shall love them freely, for My anger has turned away from him.' It does not say 'from them,' but 'from him.'"

[1924] **Exodus 12:2**: "This month shall be your beginning of months; it shall be the first month of the year to you."

[1925] **Exodus 12:3**: "Speak to the entire congregation of Israel, saying: 'On the tenth of this month each man shall take a lamb or kid for his ancestral house, a lamb or kid for each household.'"

[1926] **Leviticus 23:43**: 'in order that future generations may know that I made the Israelite people live in booths when I brought them out of the land of Egypt—I the ETERNAL your God.'

[1927] **Tiferet Yosef, Pesach 7**: "This is the intention of the cited Zohar: "When the moon shines in fullness, they ascend to become three hundred and sixty-five days, the numerical value of mishkhu minus one," and so forth; "draw the upper days toward the lower days, so that everything is joined as one." This indicates their arriving at the recognition that Hashem is the giver and bestower. It is the meaning of the Mekhilta: "Withdraw your hands from idolatry and take for yourselves sheep for a mitzvah." This recognition expresses the withdrawal from idolatry. Someone who lacks it and imagines that the intermediate cause has independent power and existence to bestow upon him treats it as an object of worship. But one who recognizes that the cause has no power of its own, that only Hashem is the giver, and turns all the good he receives back toward Hashem face to face, is then granted every kind of good by Hashem."

Pri Tzadik moves from blessed eating in Shevat to deliverance in Nisan. Tiferet Yosef's Pesach teaching explains a recognition joining those acts: the material channel of a gift does not have independent power. Its account of the moon's fullness concerns receiving the divine light; it adds content to the origin's language of completion without equating Tu BiShvat with the Pesach obligation.

[1928] **Bereshit Rabbah 12:6** (excerpt): "Rabbi Berechyah said in the name of Rabbi Shmuel: Although things were created in their fullness, once Adam sinned they were damaged. They will not return to their proper state until the descendant of Peretz comes, as it says, 'These are the generations of Peretz' (Ruth 4:18), with the word 'generations' written in full, because six things will return: his radiance, his life, his stature, the earth's fruits, the trees' fruits, and the heavenly lights."

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